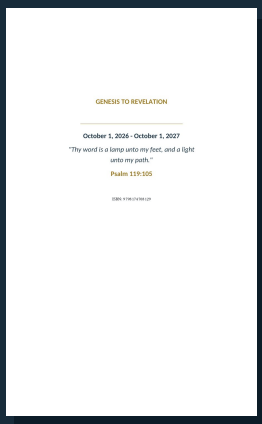
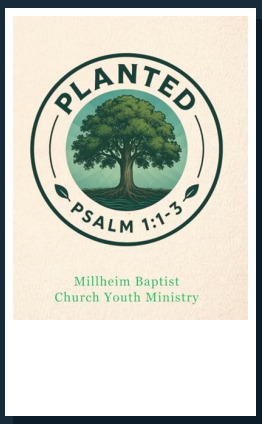
CURRICULUM DEVELOPER / EDUCATOR / AUTHOR

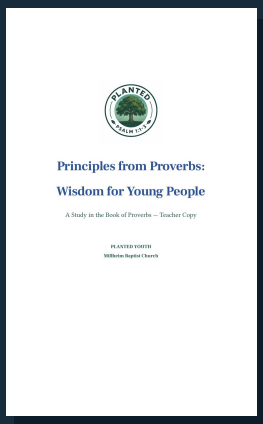
Luke Johnston

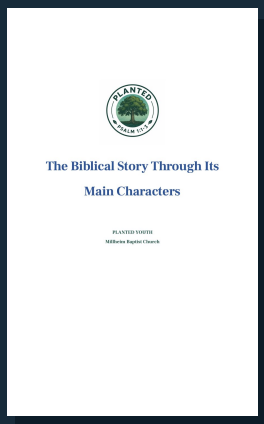
Curriculum & Teaching Portfolio

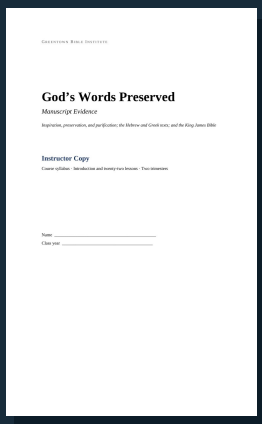
Full curricula, classroom series and missions training.
An evidence-based collection for employment review.











7 years
Teaching ages 6-11

5 years
Teaching ages 12-19

365
Daily devotions

drlukejohnston.com >

THE WORK BEHIND THE EXPERIENCE

From biblical research to teachable resources

I develop teaching materials that connect biblical explanation with clear questions, practical application and guidance for the teacher. This collection shows work across children's devotions, youth workbooks, adult learning, discipleship and volunteer training.

AUTHORING

Long-form curricula and books, organized into clear learning sequences.

TEACHING

Seven years with ages 6-11 and five years with ages 12-19, plus adult teaching.

TRAINING

Evangelism, missions preparation, mentoring and volunteer development.

PUBLISHING

Teacher and student editions, print preparation, research and digital resources.

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Read in this PDF. The linked contents lead to 29 curriculum and teaching collections. Each section contains the selected full documents, with original source credits retained.

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Select any title to jump to its complete review section. PDF bookmarks provide the same navigation.

C01 **Genesis to Revelation: Daily Bible Devotions for Children** 8

329 pages

C02 **PLANTED Youth Curriculum: Rooted in the Word** 338

171 pages

C03 **Principles from Proverbs: Wisdom for Young People** 510

66 pages

C04 **Story of the Bible** 577

100 pages

C05 **God’s Words Preserved** 678

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5 pages

A01 **Selected stand-alone Bible lessons** 1518

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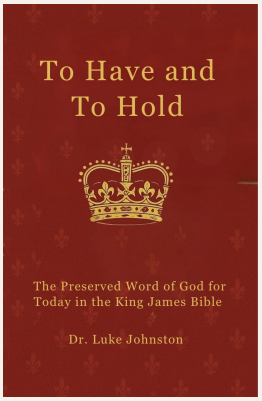
A02 **Ephesians BibleNoteTakers Edition** 1595

32 pages

WRITING BEYOND THE CLASSROOM

Books & research

Open a complete book or paper from the online library. Editions of To Have and To Hold are grouped as one book family.



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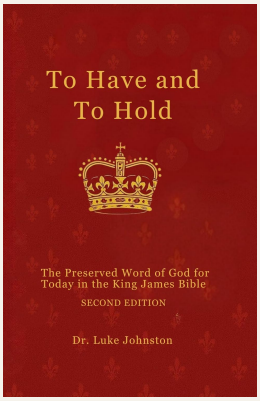

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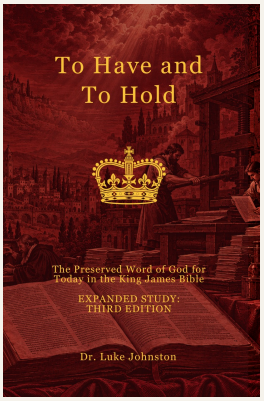

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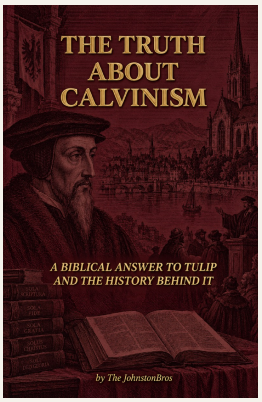

The Truth About Calvinism

Coauthored book

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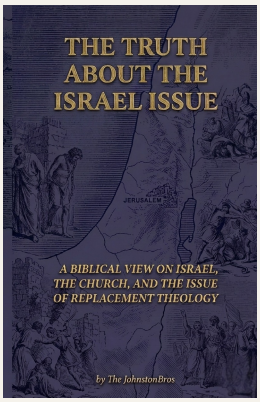

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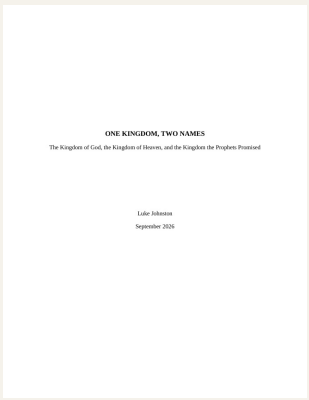

One Kingdom Two Names

Research paper

Read the full work >

Israel and Calvinism: Luke, Caleb, Jadon and Micah Johnston. Original bylines and source credits remain in the documents.

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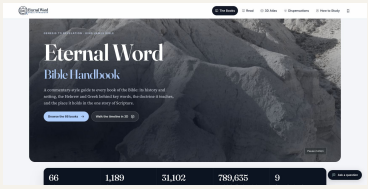
Resources people can use

Digital content, research organization and product direction complement the written curriculum. Open each project to explore the live experience.



Eternal Word Bible Handbook

Book-by-book Bible guides with historical background, outlines, language notes, commentary, a Bible reader, interactive chronology, and Old and New Testament atlases.

Explore the live resource >

How to Study the Bible

A passage-centered study workspace built around fifteen study rules, with Bible reading, rule-by-rule questions, quizzes, saved studies, and export tools.

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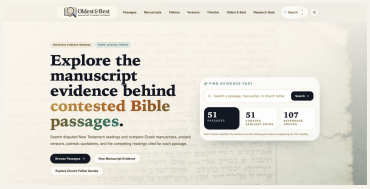

Oldest & Best

A searchable evidence database for disputed New Testament passages, connecting manuscript witnesses, ancient versions, patristic quotations, timelines, and comparison tools.

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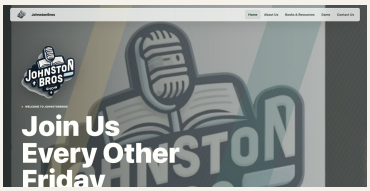

JohnstonBros

The JohnstonBros team platform for Bible conversations, books, curriculum, free study resources, and related interactive projects.

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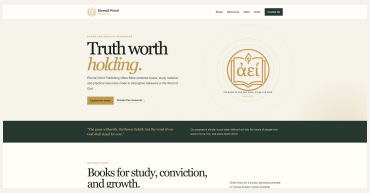

Eternal Word Publishing

A public catalog for Bible-centered books, free teaching resources, reference tools, and educational media.

Explore the live resource >

Johnston Bros mobile app

Educational media and study resources in an iPhone and iPad app. A companion to the JohnstonBros platform.

View the app >

C01 / CURRICULA AND WORKBOOKS

Genesis to Revelation: Daily Bible Devotions for Children

365 daily devotions with comprehension questions, answers, practical applications, and prayer.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Author and devotional curriculum developer.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

329 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

GENESIS TO REVELATION

October 1, 2026 - October 1, 2027

"Thy word is a lamp unto my feet, and a light unto my path."

Psalm 119:105

ISBN: 9 798 174 708 129

Welcome to Your Year in the Bible

Read one devotion together each day, moving from Genesis to Revelation. The printed Bible passages are KJV. Short questions help children understand what happened, and each lesson connects to something they might notice or experience. The dates run from October 1, 2026 through October 1, 2027; follow them or continue at your own pace. Each two-week unit has one memory verse.

A Short Daily Conversation

- Sit together. Put noisy toys and screens aside. A child may listen while sitting beside you rather than at a desk.
- Read the printed KJV passage aloud. Explain unfamiliar words in ordinary language, then reread the sentence. The explanation is a teaching aid, not a different Bible translation.
- Use the short story explanation to help the child follow the people and events. Let the child interrupt with a real question.
- Ask the comprehension questions one at a time. A one-word answer can be enough. The italic answers help the adult; they are not a script the child must repeat. If needed, reread the relevant line or give two choices.
- Talk about the everyday connection after checking understanding. Listen to the child's own example. Adapt a school, sibling, or playground situation to the child's actual life.
- Pray briefly in words the child understands. The child may add a sentence or simply listen. Do not require a performance.
- Practice a little of the memory verse. Use spoken phrases and gentle help. Keep it short; reading and writing ability are not required.

If You Miss a Day

Pick up where you stopped. You do not need to double up or finish every question when a child is tired. A short, understood conversation is enough for today.

Helping Your Child Understand

- Begin with who, what, and where. Ask what happened before asking why. Let the child point to a word or retell a small part of the story.
- Give thinking time. If the child is unsure, offer a simple choice such as light or darkness, or reread the answer in the passage. Help them learn rather than keeping score.
- Use real life. Let a child mention their own toy, friend, fear, or question. Do not insist that every child has experienced the example in the lesson.

- Keep the story and the example clear. A comparison helps us understand one point; it does not make an everyday event a miracle or turn every promise to Israel into a promise about our circumstances.
- Explain sin, Jesus' death and resurrection, forgiveness, and personal faith plainly. Welcome questions. A repeated prayer, correct answer, or Christian family does not by itself show that a child has trusted Christ.

When a Story Is Hard

Some accounts include death, cruelty, judgment, or fear. Read calmly without adding graphic detail. Ask what the child understood and what worried them. Give a truthful, short answer. Never use a story to make a child keep harm secret or obey someone who asks them to do wrong. Stay with difficult questions and seek help when needed.

KJV Word Help

Use these short meanings when an unfamiliar word appears. Then reread the verse. It is fine to explain the same word again on another day.

KJV word	Little-child explanation
behold	look; pay attention
thee / thou	you
thy / thine	your / yours
ye	you (usually more than one person)
hath	has
saith	says
unto	to
shall	will; is certain to
doth	does
wherefore	why; for what reason
therefore	because of that
iniquity	sin or crooked wrongdoing
transgression	breaking God's command
righteous	right before God; doing what is right
mercy	kind help instead of deserved punishment
grace	God's undeserved favor and gift
repent	turn from sin toward God
believe	trust; rely upon as true
salvation	God's rescue from sin and its penalty
Christ	the promised, anointed King and Saviour

Year Road Map

The year has 52 weeks in 26 two-week units, followed by a final day of reflection. Each unit includes a complete KJV memory verse. The road map helps you find a story or return to a favorite.

Unit	Dates	Bible story and memory verse
1 **Weeks 1-2**	Oct 1, 2026 Oct 14, 2026	God Creates a Good World Sin Enters; God Rescues Noah Memory: Genesis 1:1
2 **Weeks 3-4**	Oct 15, 2026 Oct 28, 2026	Babel and God's Call to Abram Abraham Learns to Trust Memory: Proverbs 3:5
3 **Weeks 5-6**	Oct 29, 2026 Nov 11, 2026	Jacob: God Is Faithful Joseph: God Is With Him Memory: Psalm 56:3
4 **Weeks 7-8**	Nov 12, 2026 Nov 25, 2026	Joseph Forgives and Saves His Family God Calls Moses Memory: Psalm 46:1
5 **Weeks 9-10**	Nov 26, 2026 Dec 9, 2026	The Plagues and the Passover Through the Sea and into the Wilderness Memory: Exodus 14:14
6 **Weeks 11-12**	Dec 10, 2026 Dec 23, 2026	God's Commands and His Dwelling Place Trusting God into the Promised Land Memory: Joshua 1:9
7 **Weeks 13-14**	Dec 24, 2026 Jan 6, 2027	Judges: God Sends Deliverers Ruth, Hannah, and Samuel Memory: Psalm 119:105
8 **Weeks 15-16**	Jan 7, 2027 Jan 20, 2027	Saul, David, and Goliath David Chooses Friendship and Mercy Memory: Psalm 118:6
9 **Weeks 17-18**	Jan 21, 2027 Feb 3, 2027	David the King Solomon Asks for Wisdom Memory: Psalm 51:10
10 **Weeks 19-20**	Feb 4, 2027 Feb 17, 2027	Songs and Wisdom for God's People Elijah Shows That the LORD Is God Memory: 1 Kings 18:39
11 **Weeks 21-22**	Feb 18, 2027 Mar 3, 2027	Elijah and Elisha: God Cares and Helps Jonah Runs; God Shows Mercy Memory: Psalm 86:5
12 **Weeks 23-24**	Mar 4, 2027 Mar 17, 2027	Hezekiah and Josiah Return to God Daniel Trusts God in Babylon Memory: Daniel 3:17

Unit	Dates	Bible story and memory verse
13 **Weeks** **25-26**	Mar 18, 2027 Mar 31, 2027	Esther Is Brave; God's People Return Rebuilding and Waiting for the Promised King Memory: Isaiah 9:6
14 **Weeks** **27-28**	Apr 1, 2027 Apr 14, 2027	John Is Promised; Jesus Is Born Shepherds, Wise Men, and Young Jesus Memory: Luke 2:11
15 **Weeks** **29-30**	Apr 15, 2027 Apr 28, 2027	Jesus Begins His Ministry Jesus Teaches Kingdom Living Memory: Matthew 4:19
16 **Weeks** **31-32**	Apr 29, 2027 May 12, 2027	Jesus Heals and Calms the Storm Jesus Feeds Thousands and Walks on Water Memory: Philippians 4:19
17 **Weeks** **33-34**	May 13, 2027 May 26, 2027	Parables of God's Kingdom Jesus Seeks the Lost and Teaches Neighbor Love Memory: Luke 19:10
18 **Weeks** **35-36**	May 27, 2027 Jun 9, 2027	Jesus Welcomes Children and Changes Zacchaeus Jesus Raises Lazarus Memory: John 11:25
19 **Weeks** **37-38**	Jun 10, 2027 Jun 23, 2027	The King Enters Jerusalem The Last Supper and Jesus' Arrest Memory: John 13:34
20 **Weeks** **39-40**	Jun 24, 2027 Jul 7, 2027	Jesus Dies for Our Sins Jesus Is Risen Memory: Matthew 28:6
21 **Weeks** **41-42**	Jul 8, 2027 Jul 21, 2027	Jesus Ascends and the Church Begins Bold Witnesses and Saul's Conversion Memory: Acts 1:8
22 **Weeks** **43-44**	Jul 22, 2027 Aug 4, 2027	The Gospel Goes to All Peoples Paul and Silas Carry the Gospel Memory: Acts 16:31
23 **Weeks** **45-46**	Aug 5, 2027 Aug 18, 2027	Paul Teaches in New Cities Paul Goes to Rome Memory: Philippians 4:13
24 **Weeks** **47-48**	Aug 19, 2027 Sep 1, 2027	The Gospel and a New Life Love, Service, and the Fruit of the Spirit Memory: Romans 5:8
25 **Weeks** **49-50**	Sep 2, 2027 Sep 15, 2027	Grace, Kindness, Joy, and God's Armor Be Faithful and Hold Fast to Scripture Memory: Ephesians 4:32
26 **Weeks** **51-52**	Sep 16, 2027 Sep 29, 2027	Faith, Truth, Love, and Hope Jesus Wins and Makes All Things New Memory: 1 John 4:19

Unit 01 | Days 1-14

God Creates a Good World + Sin Enters; God Rescues Noah

Thursday, October 1, 2026 through Wednesday, October 14, 2026

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 1:1

> 1 In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth.

Meaning in context God was there before everything else, and He made the whole world.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 01 | God Creates a Good World | Oct 1 - Oct 7, 2026

Bible story Genesis 1-2

Week overview God made everything from nothing by His word. His world was good, and people were specially made in His image.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1

Day 1 | Thursday, October 1, 2026 | In the Beginning

Read aloud Genesis 1:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 1:1-3

> 1 In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth.
> 2 And the earth was without form, and void; and darkness was upon the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters.
> 3 And God said, Let there be light: and there was light.

ALSO READ PSALM 90:2

> 2 Before the mountains were brought forth, or ever thou hadst formed the earth and the world, even from everlasting to everlasting, thou art God.

Talk about the story God was already there before He made the world. He has always been God (Psalm 90:2). The earth was dark. God spoke, and light appeared.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was there in the beginning? *Answer: God.*

2. Was anyone there before God? *Answer: No. God has always existed.*

3. Was the earth light or dark at first? *Answer: Dark.*

4. What did God say? *Answer: Let there be light.*

5. What happened when He said it? *Answer: There was light.*

In your day Think about waking in a dark room. How do you make it light? You need a lamp or switch. God made light just by speaking.

Pray together God, thank You for making light and our world. Amen.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 2 | Friday, October 2, 2026 | Sky, Seas, and Dry Land

Read aloud Genesis 1:6-10

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 1:6-10

> 6 And God said, Let there be a firmament in the midst of the waters, and let it divide the waters from the waters.
> 7 And God made the firmament, and divided the waters which were under the firmament from the waters which were above the firmament: and it was so.
> 8 And God called the firmament Heaven. And the evening and the morning were the second day.
> 9 And God said, Let the waters under the heaven be gathered together unto one place, and let the dry land appear: and it was so.
> 10 And God called the dry land Earth; and the gathering together of the waters called he Seas: and God saw that it was good.

Talk about the story God made the sky and gathered the water so dry land appeared. He called the land Earth and the gathered water Seas. He saw that it was good.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What appeared when God gathered the water? *Answer: Dry land.*

2. What did God call the gathered water? *Answer: Seas.*

3. Did God call His work good or bad? *Answer: Good.*

In your day Look out a window. Point toward the sky, then the ground. Imagine trying to stand where there was only water. God made land for us to live on.

Pray together God, thank You for the ground under our feet. Amen.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 3 | Saturday, October 3, 2026 | Plants and Trees

Read aloud Genesis 1:11-13

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 1:11-13

> 11 And God said, Let the earth bring forth grass, the herb yielding seed, and the fruit tree yielding fruit after his kind, whose seed is in itself, upon the earth: and it was so.
> 12 And the earth brought forth grass, and herb yielding seed after his kind, and the tree yielding fruit, whose seed was in itself, after his kind: and God saw that it was good.
> 13 And the evening and the morning were the third day.

Talk about the story God made grass, plants, and fruit trees. He put seeds in plants so more could grow. An apple seed grows into an apple tree, not a banana tree.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What grew on the earth? *Answer: Grass, plants, and fruit trees.*

2. What was inside the fruit? *Answer: Seed.*

3. Who told the plants to grow? *Answer: God.*

In your day Look for seeds in a piece of fruit with an adult. Name a fruit you enjoy. At your next snack, thank God for making plants that give us food.

Pray together God, thank You for fruit and the plants You made. Amen.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 4 | Sunday, October 4, 2026 | Sun, Moon, and Stars

Read aloud Genesis 1:14-18

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 1:14-18

> 14 And God said, Let there be lights in the firmament of the heaven to divide the day from the night; and let them be for signs, and for seasons, and for days, and years:
> 15 And let them be for lights in the firmament of the heaven to give light upon the earth: and it was so.
> 16 And God made two great lights; the greater light to rule the day, and the lesser light to rule the night: he made the stars also.
> 17 And God set them in the firmament of the heaven to give light upon the earth,
> 18 And to rule over the day and over the night, and to divide the light from the darkness: and God saw that it was good.

Talk about the story God put the sun, moon, and stars in the sky. They give light and mark days, seasons, and years. Even the huge sun is something God made.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Which light rules the day? *Answer: The sun.*

2. Which light rules the night? *Answer: The moon.*

3. Who made the stars? *Answer: God.*

In your day Talk about what you do in daylight and at bedtime. Watch for the moon tonight if it is visible. Remember its Maker when you see it.

Pray together God, thank You for daytime and nighttime. Amen.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 5 | Monday, October 5, 2026 | Fish, Birds, and Animals

Read aloud Genesis 1:20-25

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 1:20-25

> 20 And God said, Let the waters bring forth abundantly the moving creature that hath life, and fowl that may fly above the earth in the open firmament of heaven.
> 21 And God created great whales, and every living creature that moveth, which the waters brought forth abundantly, after their kind, and every winged fowl after his kind: and God saw that it was good.
> 22 And God blessed them, saying, Be fruitful, and multiply, and fill the waters in the seas, and let fowl multiply in the earth.
> 23 And the evening and the morning were the fifth day.
> 24 And God said, Let the earth bring forth the living creature after his kind, cattle, and creeping thing, and beast of the earth after his kind: and it was so.
> 25 And God made the beast of the earth after his kind, and cattle after their kind, and every thing that creepeth upon the earth after his kind: and God saw that it was good.

Talk about the story God filled the water with living creatures, the sky with birds, and the land with animals. The fish and birds did not make themselves. God made them.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where did God put the fish? *Answer: In the water.*

2. What did God make to fly? *Answer: Birds.*

3. Who made the animals on the land? *Answer: God.*

In your day Name an animal you have seen. Does it swim, fly, or walk? Watch a bird outside or look at an animal picture. Notice something about how God made it.

Pray together God, thank You for the animals we enjoy watching. Amen.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 6 | Tuesday, October 6, 2026 | People Made in God's Image

Read aloud Genesis 1:26-28

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 1:26-28

> 26 And God said, Let us make man in our image, after our likeness: and let them have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over the cattle, and over all the earth, and over every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth.
> 27 So God created man in his own image, in the image of God created he him; male and female created he them.
> 28 And God blessed them, and God said unto them, Be fruitful, and multiply, and replenish the earth, and subdue it: and have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over every living thing that moveth upon the earth.

Talk about the story God made people in His image. That makes every person valuable, including someone who looks different from you or cannot do the things you can do.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who made the first people? *Answer: God.*

2. Whose image were they made in? *Answer: God's image.*

3. Did God make both male and female? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Imagine a child being left out because they speak differently. Is that child made by God too? Think of a friendly thing you could say to include them.

Pray together God, help me treat the people You made with kindness. Amen.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 7 | Wednesday, October 7, 2026 | God Rested

Read aloud Genesis 2:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 2:1-3

> 1 Thus the heavens and the earth were finished, and all the host of them.
> 2 And on the seventh day God ended his work which he had made; and he rested on the seventh day from all his work which he had made.
> 3 And God blessed the seventh day, and sanctified it: because that in it he had rested from all his work which God created and made.

Talk about the story God finished His work of creation. On the seventh day He rested, meaning He stopped that work. Everything He had planned to create was finished.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Was God's work finished or unfinished? *Answer: Finished.*

2. On which day did God rest? *Answer: The seventh day.*

3. What did God do to that day? *Answer: He blessed it and made it holy.*

In your day Think of finishing a puzzle. You can stop putting pieces in because it is done. Look around and name two things in God's finished creation.

Pray together God, thank You for the good world You finished making. Amen.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 02 | Sin Enters; God Rescues Noah | Oct 8 - Oct 14, 2026

Bible story Genesis 2:15-9:17

Week overview Adam and Eve disobeyed God, and sin brought sorrow. Later, God judged a sinful world but graciously rescued Noah and his family through the ark.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1

Day 8 | Thursday, October 8, 2026 | One Clear Command

Read aloud Genesis 2:15-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 2:15-17

> 15 And the LORD God took the man, and put him into the garden of Eden to dress it and to keep it.
> 16 And the LORD God commanded the man, saying, Of every tree of the garden thou mayest freely eat:
> 17 But of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, thou shalt not eat of it: for in the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die.

Talk about the story God gave Adam a garden to care for and many trees to eat from. He clearly named one tree whose fruit Adam must not eat.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where did God put Adam? *Answer: In the garden of Eden.*

2. Could Adam eat from many trees? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Which tree was he told not to eat from? *Answer: The tree of the knowledge of good and evil.*

In your day Suppose an adult says, "You may have these snacks, but leave that one for later." Point out what you may have. What would obeying look like?

Pray together God, help me listen when You tell me what is right. Amen.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 9 | Friday, October 9, 2026 | Adam and Eve Disobey

Read aloud Genesis 3:6-9

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 3:6-9

> 6 And when the woman saw that the tree was good for food, and that it was pleasant to the eyes, and a tree to be desired to make one wise, she took of the fruit thereof, and did eat, and gave also unto her husband with her; and he did eat.
> 7 And the eyes of them both were opened, and they knew that they were naked; and they sewed fig leaves together, and made themselves aprons.
> 8 And they heard the voice of the LORD God walking in the garden in the cool of the day: and Adam and his wife hid themselves from the presence of the LORD God amongst the trees of the garden.
> 9 And the LORD God called unto Adam, and said unto him, Where art thou?

Talk about the story Adam and Eve ate what God had forbidden. Then they hid. Wanting something does not make it right to take, and hiding cannot undo a wrong choice.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Eve and Adam eat? *Answer: The forbidden fruit.*

2. What did they do when they heard God? *Answer: They hid among the trees.*

3. Who called to Adam? *Answer: The LORD God.*

In your day Imagine taking a cookie after being told to wait. Would hiding the crumbs make it right? Practice saying, "I took it. I was wrong. Please forgive me."

Pray together God, help me tell the truth when I have done wrong. Amen.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 10 | Saturday, October 10, 2026 | God Promises a Rescuer

Read aloud Genesis 3:14-15

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 3:14-15

> 14 And the LORD God said unto the serpent, Because thou hast done this, thou art cursed above all cattle, and above every beast of the field; upon thy belly shalt thou go, and dust shalt thou eat all the days of thy life:
> 15 And I will put enmity between thee and the woman, and between thy seed and her seed; it shall bruise thy head, and thou shalt bruise his heel.

Talk about the story God said the serpent would not win in the end. The promised victory points ahead to Jesus. The word enmity means being enemies; God would oppose the serpent's evil.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was God speaking to? *Answer: The serpent.*

2. Would the serpent and the woman's offspring be friends or enemies? *Answer: Enemies.*

3. What part of the serpent would be bruised? *Answer: Its head.*

4. Who is the promised Saviour? *Answer: Jesus.*

In your day Have you ever worried that the bad person in a story would win? This promise gives us hope. God knew how He would defeat evil.

Pray together God, thank You for promising a Saviour. Amen.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 11 | Sunday, October 11, 2026 | Noah Found Grace

Read aloud Genesis 6:8-9

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 6:8-9

> 8 But Noah found grace in the eyes of the LORD.
> 9 These are the generations of Noah: Noah was a just man and perfect in his generations, and Noah walked with God.

Talk about the story Noah lived among people who did wrong, but he walked with God. That means he trusted God and lived His way. Grace is God's kindness to us.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who found grace in God's eyes? *Answer: Noah.*

2. Did Noah walk with God? *Answer: Yes.*

3. What does walking with God mean here? *Answer: Trusting Him and living His way.*

In your day If other children are laughing at someone, you can choose not to join in. Name one thing you could do instead, such as sit beside the child.

Pray together God, help me follow You even when others do wrong. Amen.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 12 | Monday, October 12, 2026 | Safe in the Ark

Read aloud Genesis 7:17-18

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 7:17-18

> 17 And the flood was forty days upon the earth; and the waters increased, and bare up the ark, and it was lift up above the earth.
> 18 And the waters prevailed, and were increased greatly upon the earth; and the ark went upon the face of the waters.

Talk about the story As the flood rose, the ark floated on the water. God had told Noah to build it. Noah and his family were inside the ark God had provided.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What lifted the ark? *Answer: The rising water.*

2. Did the ark sink or float? *Answer: It floated.*

3. How many days is the flood described here? *Answer: Forty days.*

In your day Think about a seat belt. It helps keep you safe when you use it. Noah listened to God's warning and went into the ark before the flood.

Pray together God, thank You for caring for Noah and his family. Amen.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 13 | Tuesday, October 13, 2026 | God Remembered Noah

Read aloud Genesis 8:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 8:1-3

> 1 And God remembered Noah, and every living thing, and all the cattle that was with him in the ark: and God made a wind to pass over the earth, and the waters asswaged;
> 2 The fountains also of the deep and the windows of heaven were stopped, and the rain from heaven was restrained;
> 3 And the waters returned from off the earth continually: and after the end of the hundred and fifty days the waters were abated.

Talk about the story God had not forgotten Noah in the ark. He sent a wind, stopped the rain, and made the water go down. Noah still had to wait.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did God remember? *Answer: Noah and the living things with him.*

2. What did God send over the earth? *Answer: A wind.*

3. Did the water keep rising or begin going down? *Answer: It began going down.*

In your day Waiting for a ride can feel long even when someone knows you are there. Tell about something you are waiting for. You can talk to God while you wait.

Pray together God, help me remember You care while I wait. Amen.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 14 | Wednesday, October 14, 2026 | The Rainbow Promise

Read aloud Genesis 9:12-15

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 9:12-15

> 12 And God said, This is the token of the covenant which I make between me and you and every living creature that is with you, for perpetual generations:
> 13 I do set my bow in the cloud, and it shall be for a token of a covenant between me and the earth.
> 14 And it shall come to pass, when I bring a cloud over the earth, that the bow shall be seen in the cloud:
> 15 And I will remember my covenant, which is between me and you and every living creature of all flesh; and the waters shall no more become a flood to destroy all flesh.

Talk about the story God gave the rainbow as a sign of His promise. He would never again destroy all living creatures with a flood. A rainy day does not mean He has forgotten.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What sign did God put in the cloud? *Answer: A rainbow.*

2. What did the rainbow remind people of? *Answer: God's promise.*

3. Did God promise that it would never rain again? *Answer: No.*

In your day When you see a rainbow, tell someone what God promised. Rain can still cause local floods; this promise is about a flood destroying all life on earth.

Pray together God, thank You for keeping Your rainbow promise. Amen.

Memory verse Genesis 1:1 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 02 | Days 15-28

Babel and God's Call to Abram + Abraham Learns to Trust

Thursday, October 15, 2026 through Wednesday, October 28, 2026

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Proverbs 3:5

> 5 Trust in the LORD with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding.

Meaning in context Trust the LORD completely, even when you cannot see or understand the whole path.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 03 | Babel and God's Call to Abram | Oct 15 - Oct 21, 2026

Bible story Genesis 11-14

Week overview Proud people tried to make a name for themselves at Babel. God scattered them, then called Abram to leave home and trust His promise.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5

Day 15 | Thursday, October 15, 2026 | A Tower for Our Name

Read aloud Genesis 11:1-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 11:1-4

> 1 And the whole earth was of one language, and of one speech.
> 2 And it came to pass, as they journeyed from the east, that they found a plain in the land of Shinar; and they dwelt there.
> 3 And they said one to another, Go to, let us make brick, and burn them throughly. And they had brick for stone, and slime had they for morter.
> 4 And they said, Go to, let us build us a city and a tower, whose top may reach unto heaven; and let us make us a name, lest we be scattered abroad upon the face of the whole earth.

Talk about the story The people wanted a city and a tall tower to make a name for themselves. They wanted everyone to think they were great, and they refused to scatter.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What were the people building? *Answer: A city and a tower.*

2. What did they use to build? *Answer: Bricks.*

3. Did they want to scatter or stay together? *Answer: Stay together.*

4. Whose name did they want to make great? *Answer: Their own.*

In your day Think about building with blocks beside a friend. Is it kind to knock theirs down so yours looks best? Enjoy building without needing everyone to admire you most.

Pray together God, help me enjoy what I do without showing off. Amen.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 16 | Friday, October 16, 2026 | God Scatters the People

Read aloud Genesis 11:5-9

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 11:5-9

> 5 And the LORD came down to see the city and the tower, which the children of men builded.
> 6 And the LORD said, Behold, the people is one, and they have all one language; and this they begin to do: and now nothing will be restrained from them, which they have imagined to do.
> 7 Go to, let us go down, and there confound their language, that they may not understand one another's speech.
> 8 So the LORD scattered them abroad from thence upon the face of all the earth: and they left off to build the city.
> 9 Therefore is the name of it called Babel; because the LORD did there confound the language of all the earth: and from thence did the LORD scatter them abroad upon the face of all the earth.

Talk about the story God confused the people's language. They could not understand one another, so they stopped building and scattered. Their big plan could not stop God's plan.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did God change? *Answer: Their language.*

2. Could they still understand one another? *Answer: No.*

3. Did they finish the city or stop building? *Answer: They stopped building.*

In your day Imagine asking for a block and nobody understanding your words. What would be difficult? When someone speaks another language, be patient; their words have meaning too.

Pray together God, help me listen to You and be patient with people. Amen.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 17 | Saturday, October 17, 2026 | God Calls Abram

Read aloud Genesis 12:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 12:1-3

> 1 Now the LORD had said unto Abram, Get thee out of thy country, and from thy kindred, and from thy father's house, unto a land that I will shew thee:
> 2 And I will make of thee a great nation, and I will bless thee, and make thy name great; and thou shalt be a blessing:
> 3 And I will bless them that bless thee, and curse him that curseth thee: and in thee shall all families of the earth be blessed.

Talk about the story God told Abram to leave his country. He promised to show him a land and make his family a great nation. Abram could trust the One leading him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who told Abram to leave home? *Answer: The LORD.*

2. Who would show him the land? *Answer: God.*

3. Would God's blessing reach only Abram's family? *Answer: No, all families of the earth would be blessed through him.*

In your day Think about going somewhere new with a trusted parent. You may not know the way yet. Tell about a new place that made you nervous.

Pray together God, help me trust what You say when something is new. Amen.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 18 | Sunday, October 18, 2026 | Abram Goes

Read aloud Genesis 12:4-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 12:4-5

> 4 So Abram departed, as the LORD had spoken unto him; and Lot went with him: and Abram was seventy and five years old when he departed out of Haran.
> 5 And Abram took Sarai his wife, and Lot his brother's son, and all their substance that they had gathered, and the souls that they had gotten in Haran; and they went forth to go into the land of Canaan; and into the land of Canaan they came.

Talk about the story Abram did what God told him. He took Sarai and Lot and went to Canaan. Listening to God included getting up and going.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did Abram stay or go? *Answer: He went.*

2. Who was Abram's wife? *Answer: Sarai.*

3. What land did they reach? *Answer: Canaan.*

4. How old was Abram? *Answer: Seventy-five.*

In your day When it is time to put shoes on, saying "Okay" is a start. What needs to happen next? Practice responding by doing the job, as Abram acted on God's words.

Pray together God, help me do what is right after I hear it. Amen.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 19 | Monday, October 19, 2026 | Abram Chooses Peace

Read aloud Genesis 13:8-11

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 13:8-11

> 8 And Abram said unto Lot, Let there be no strife, I pray thee, between me and thee, and between my herdmen and thy herdmen; for we be brethren.
> 9 Is not the whole land before thee? separate thyself, I pray thee, from me: if thou wilt take the left hand, then I will go to the right; or if thou depart to the right hand, then I will go to the left.
> 10 And Lot lifted up his eyes, and beheld all the plain of Jordan, that it was well watered every where, before the LORD destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah, even as the garden of the LORD, like the land of Egypt, as thou comest unto Zoar.
> 11 Then Lot chose him all the plain of Jordan; and Lot journeyed east: and they separated themselves the one from the other.

Talk about the story Abram wanted the arguing to stop. He let Lot choose where to go. Keeping peace mattered more to Abram than choosing the best-looking land first.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who wanted the arguing to stop? *Answer: Abram.*

2. Who chose land first? *Answer: Lot.*

3. What did Lot choose? *Answer: The well-watered plain of Jordan.*

In your day Two children want the same seat. Try saying, "You can sit there this time; I will sit here." Talk about another fair way to take turns.

Pray together God, help me make peace when I want my own way. Amen.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 20 | Tuesday, October 20, 2026 | Look at God's Promise

Read aloud Genesis 13:14-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 13:14-17

> 14 And the LORD said unto Abram, after that Lot was separated from him, Lift up now thine eyes, and look from the place where thou art northward, and southward, and eastward, and westward:
> 15 For all the land which thou seest, to thee will I give it, and to thy seed for ever.
> 16 And I will make thy seed as the dust of the earth: so that if a man can number the dust of the earth, then shall thy seed also be numbered.
> 17 Arise, walk through the land in the length of it and in the breadth of it; for I will give it unto thee.

Talk about the story After Lot left, God repeated His promise to Abram. He would give the land to Abram's family. Lot's choice had not taken God's promise away.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who spoke to Abram after Lot left? *Answer: The LORD.*

2. What did God promise to give him? *Answer: The land he could see.*

3. Would Abram's family be small or too many to count? *Answer: Too many to count, like the dust.*

In your day Have you felt sad because someone chose first? Tell about it. Abram could remember God's promise even when Lot took the land he liked.

Pray together God, help me remember Your words when I feel left out. Amen.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 21 | Wednesday, October 21, 2026 | Abram Builds an Altar

Read aloud Genesis 13:18

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 13:18

> 18 Then Abram removed his tent, and came and dwelt in the plain of Mamre, which is in Hebron, and built there an altar unto the LORD.

Talk about the story Abram moved his tent to Hebron and built an altar to the LORD. An altar was a place for worship. Abram remembered God in his new home.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What kind of home did Abram move? *Answer: A tent.*

2. Where did he settle? *Answer: Hebron.*

3. What did he build for the LORD? *Answer: An altar.*

In your day When your family arrives somewhere, what do you unpack first? You can remember God there too. Stop together and thank Him for one thing about that place.

Pray together God, help us remember You wherever we are. Amen.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 04 | Abraham Learns to Trust | Oct 22 - Oct 28, 2026

Bible story Genesis 15-22

Week overview God repeated His promise, gave Abraham and Sarah a son, and taught Abraham that the LORD Himself provides.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5

Day 22 | Thursday, October 22, 2026 | Stars and a Promise

Read aloud Genesis 15:1-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 15:1-6

> 1 After these things the word of the LORD came unto Abram in a vision, saying, Fear not, Abram: I am thy shield, and thy exceeding great reward.
> 2 And Abram said, Lord GOD, what wilt thou give me, seeing I go childless, and the steward of my house is this Eliezer of Damascus?
> 3 And Abram said, Behold, to me thou hast given no seed: and, lo, one born in my house is mine heir.
> 4 And, behold, the word of the LORD came unto him, saying, This shall not be thine heir; but he that shall come forth out of thine own bowels shall be thine heir.
> 5 And he brought him forth abroad, and said, Look now toward heaven, and tell the stars, if thou be able to number them: and he said unto him, So shall thy seed be.
> 6 And he believed in the LORD; and he counted it to him for righteousness.

Talk about the story Abram had no child yet. God showed him the stars and promised a very large family. Abram believed God before he could see the promise come true.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What was Abram still waiting for? *Answer: A child.*

2. What did God tell him to look at? *Answer: The stars.*

3. Did Abram believe the LORD? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Look at the night sky with an adult, or a picture of it. Can you count every star? That picture helped Abram remember what God had promised.

Pray together God, help me believe Your words while I wait. Amen.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 23 | Friday, October 23, 2026 | Welcome the Visitors

Read aloud Genesis 18:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 18:1-5

> 1 And the LORD appeared unto him in the plains of Mamre: and he sat in the tent door in the heat of the day;
> 2 And he lift up his eyes and looked, and, lo, three men stood by him: and when he saw them, he ran to meet them from the tent door, and bowed himself toward the ground,
> 3 And said, My Lord, if now I have found favour in thy sight, pass not away, I pray thee, from thy servant:
> 4 Let a little water, I pray you, be fetched, and wash your feet, and rest yourselves under the tree:
> 5 And I will fetch a morsel of bread, and comfort ye your hearts; after that ye shall pass on: for therefore are ye come to your servant. And they said, So do, as thou hast said.

Talk about the story Abraham saw visitors and hurried to welcome them. He offered water, shade, and bread. He noticed what tired travelers might need.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. How many visitors did Abraham see? *Answer: Three.*

2. Did he walk slowly or run to meet them? *Answer: He ran.*

3. What did he offer them? *Answer: Water, rest under a tree, and bread.*

In your day When guests visit, you can move your toys so they have a place to sit. With an adult, think of one small way to help them feel welcome.

Pray together God, help me notice how I can welcome people. Amen.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 24 | Saturday, October 24, 2026 | Is Anything Too Hard?

Read aloud Genesis 18:9-14

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 18:9-14

> 9 And they said unto him, Where is Sarah thy wife? And he said, Behold, in the tent.
> 10 And he said, I will certainly return unto thee according to the time of life; and, lo, Sarah thy wife shall have a son. And Sarah heard it in the tent door, which was behind him.
> 11 Now Abraham and Sarah were old and well stricken in age; and it ceased to be with Sarah after the manner of women.
> 12 Therefore Sarah laughed within herself, saying, After I am waxed old shall I have pleasure, my lord being old also?
> 13 And the LORD said unto Abraham, Wherefore did Sarah laugh, saying, Shall I of a surety bear a child, which am old?
> 14 Is any thing too hard for the LORD? At the time appointed I will return unto thee, according to the time of life, and Sarah shall have a son.

Talk about the story Sarah laughed when she heard she would have a baby. She and Abraham were very old. But God was able to do exactly what He had promised.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did the LORD promise Sarah? *Answer: A son.*

2. Why did that seem surprising? *Answer: She and Abraham were very old.*

3. Was keeping this promise too hard for God? *Answer: No.*

In your day Name something you cannot do by yourself. God is stronger than we are. Sarah's story teaches us to trust His promises, not to expect every wish to come true.

Pray together God, thank You that You can do what You promise. Amen.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 25 | Sunday, October 25, 2026 | Isaac Is Born

Read aloud Genesis 21:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 21:1-3

> 1 And the LORD visited Sarah as he had said, and the LORD did unto Sarah as he had spoken.
> 2 For Sarah conceived, and bare Abraham a son in his old age, at the set time of which God had spoken to him.
> 3 And Abraham called the name of his son that was born unto him, whom Sarah bare to him, Isaac.

Talk about the story Sarah had the son God promised. Abraham named him Isaac. The baby arrived at the time God had said, after a long wait.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who had a baby? *Answer: Sarah.*

2. What was the baby's name? *Answer: Isaac.*

3. Did his birth happen when God had said? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Remember counting days until a birthday or visit. Waiting can be hard. Say one way to wait kindly instead of asking angrily again and again.

Pray together God, thank You for keeping Your promise to Abraham and Sarah. Amen.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 26 | Monday, October 26, 2026 | A Hard Test

Read aloud Genesis 22:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 22:1-3

> 1 And it came to pass after these things, that God did tempt Abraham, and said unto him, Abraham: and he said, Behold, here I am.
> 2 And he said, Take now thy son, thine only son Isaac, whom thou lovest, and get thee into the land of Moriah; and offer him there for a burnt offering upon one of the mountains which I will tell thee of.
> 3 And Abraham rose up early in the morning, and saddled his ass, and took two of his young men with him, and Isaac his son, and clave the wood for the burnt offering, and rose up, and went unto the place of which God had told him.

READ THE END OF THIS ACCOUNT TODAY TOO

Genesis 22:9-14 tells how God stopped Abraham and provided a ram. Read it here before discussing the story.

> 9 And they came to the place which God had told him of; and Abraham built an altar there, and laid the wood in order, and bound Isaac his son, and laid him on the altar upon the wood.
> 10 And Abraham stretched forth his hand, and took the knife to slay his son.
> 11 And the angel of the LORD called unto him out of heaven, and said, Abraham, Abraham: and he said, Here am I.
> 12 And he said, Lay not thine hand upon the lad, neither do thou any thing unto him: for now I know that thou fearest God, seeing thou hast not withheld thy son, thine only son from me.
> 13 And Abraham lifted up his eyes, and looked, and behold behind him a ram caught in a thicket by his horns: and Abraham went and took the ram, and offered him up for a burnt offering in the stead of his son.
> 14 And Abraham called the name of that place Jehovahjireh: as it is said to this day, In the mount of the LORD it shall be seen.

Talk about the story God tested Abraham's trust. In the end of this account, God stopped Abraham, and Isaac lived. This unusual test is not permission for anyone to hurt a child.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did God test? *Answer: Abraham.*

2. What was Abraham's son's name? *Answer: Isaac.*

3. In verses 12-13, did God let Abraham kill Isaac? *Answer: No; He stopped him and provided a ram.*

In your day A child may wonder, "Could God want someone to hurt me?" Answer plainly: no one may use this story as permission. If someone threatens you, tell a safe adult.

Pray together God, thank You that Isaac lived. Help us trust Your care. Amen.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 27 | Tuesday, October 27, 2026 | The LORD Provides

Read aloud Genesis 22:9-14

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 22:9-14

> 9 And they came to the place which God had told him of; and Abraham built an altar there, and laid the wood in order, and bound Isaac his son, and laid him on the altar upon the wood.
> 10 And Abraham stretched forth his hand, and took the knife to slay his son.
> 11 And the angel of the LORD called unto him out of heaven, and said, Abraham, Abraham: and he said, Here am I.
> 12 And he said, Lay not thine hand upon the lad, neither do thou any thing unto him: for now I know that thou fearest God, seeing thou hast not withheld thy son, thine only son from me.
> 13 And Abraham lifted up his eyes, and looked, and behold behind him a ram caught in a thicket by his horns: and Abraham went and took the ram, and offered him up for a burnt offering in the stead of his son.
> 14 And Abraham called the name of that place Jehovahjireh: as it is said to this day, In the mount of the LORD it shall be seen.

Talk about the story God told Abraham not to hurt Isaac. A ram was caught nearby, and Abraham offered it instead of his son. God Himself provided what was needed.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who called to stop Abraham? *Answer: The angel of the LORD.*

2. What animal was caught nearby? *Answer: A ram.*

3. Was Isaac or the ram offered? *Answer: The ram was offered instead of Isaac.*

In your day What part of this story felt frightening? Listen to the child's answer. Then reread God's words, "neither do thou any thing unto him." Isaac was kept alive.

Pray together God, thank You for providing the ram and sparing Isaac. Amen.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 28 | Wednesday, October 28, 2026 | God Repeats His Blessing

Read aloud Genesis 22:15-18

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 22:15-18

> 15 And the angel of the LORD called unto Abraham out of heaven the second time,
> 16 And said, By myself have I sworn, saith the LORD, for because thou hast done this thing, and hast not withheld thy son, thine only son:
> 17 That in blessing I will bless thee, and in multiplying I will multiply thy seed as the stars of the heaven, and as the sand which is upon the sea shore; and thy seed shall possess the gate of his enemies;
> 18 And in thy seed shall all the nations of the earth be blessed; because thou hast obeyed my voice.

Talk about the story God repeated His promise to Abraham. His family would become as many as the stars and sand. Through his offspring, blessing would reach every nation.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What two things pictured Abraham's many descendants? *Answer: Stars and sand.*

2. Would blessing reach one nation or all nations? *Answer: All nations.*

3. Had Abraham listened to God's voice? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Hold a pinch of sand, or imagine a whole beach. Could you count every grain? God used something Abraham could see to help him picture a great family.

Pray together God, thank You that Your promised blessing reaches many people. Amen.

Memory verse Proverbs 3:5 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 03 | Days 29-42

Jacob: God Is Faithful + Joseph: God Is With Him

Thursday, October 29, 2026 through Wednesday, November 11, 2026

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Psalm 56:3

> 3 What time I am afraid, I will trust in thee.

Meaning in context Feeling afraid is a reminder to choose trust in God.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 05 | Jacob: God Is Faithful | Oct 29 - Nov 4, 2026

Bible story Genesis 25-35

Week overview Jacob often tried to get his own way, yet God patiently worked in his life, kept His promise, and brought peace between Jacob and Esau.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3

Day 29 | Thursday, October 29, 2026 | A Poor Trade

Read aloud Genesis 25:29-34

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 25:29-34

> 29 And Jacob sod pottage: and Esau came from the field, and he was faint:
> 30 And Esau said to Jacob, Feed me, I pray thee, with that same red pottage; for I am faint: therefore was his name called Edom.
> 31 And Jacob said, Sell me this day thy birthright.
> 32 And Esau said, Behold, I am at the point to die: and what profit shall this birthright do to me?
> 33 And Jacob said, Swear to me this day; and he sware unto him: and he sold his birthright unto Jacob.
> 34 Then Jacob gave Esau bread and pottage of lentiles; and he did eat and drink, and rose up, and went his way: thus Esau despised his birthright.

Talk about the story Esau was hungry and wanted Jacob's stew immediately. He traded his birthright, an important family privilege, for one meal. A strong feeling led to a foolish choice.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who cooked the stew? *Answer: Jacob.*

2. Who was hungry? *Answer: Esau.*

3. What did Esau trade for food? *Answer: His birthright.*

In your day Suppose someone offers one sweet for your favorite book. Being hungry can make a bad trade seem good. Pause and ask a grown-up before giving something important away.

Pray together God, help me stop and think before I choose. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 30 | Friday, October 30, 2026 | Jacob Uses a Disguise

Read aloud Genesis 27:18-23

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 27:18-23

> 18 And he came unto his father, and said, My father: and he said, Here am I; who art thou, my son?
> 19 And Jacob said unto his father, I am Esau thy firstborn; I have done according as thou badest me: arise, I pray thee, sit and eat of my venison, that thy soul may bless me.
> 20 And Isaac said unto his son, How is it that thou hast found it so quickly, my son? And he said, Because the LORD thy God brought it to me.
> 21 And Isaac said unto Jacob, Come near, I pray thee, that I may feel thee, my son, whether thou be my very son Esau or not.
> 22 And Jacob went near unto Isaac his father; and he felt him, and said, The voice is Jacob's voice, but the hands are the hands of Esau.
> 23 And he discerned him not, because his hands were hairy, as his brother Esau's hands: so he blessed him.

Talk about the story Jacob told Isaac, "I am Esau." That was a lie. His disguise fooled his father, but getting the blessing did not make his lying right.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was really speaking to Isaac? *Answer: Jacob.*

2. Whom did Jacob pretend to be? *Answer: Esau.*

3. Did Isaac recognize the trick? *Answer: No.*

In your day If someone asks who spilled the juice, you might want to blame someone else. Practice an honest answer: "I spilled it. May I help clean it up?"

Pray together God, help me tell the truth even when I might get in trouble. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 31 | Saturday, October 31, 2026 | The Stairway Dream

Read aloud Genesis 28:12-15

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 28:12-15

> 12 And he dreamed, and behold a ladder set up on the earth, and the top of it reached to heaven: and behold the angels of God ascending and descending on it.
> 13 And, behold, the LORD stood above it, and said, I am the LORD God of Abraham thy father, and the God of Isaac: the land whereon thou liest, to thee will I give it, and to thy seed;
> 14 And thy seed shall be as the dust of the earth, and thou shalt spread abroad to the west, and to the east, and to the north, and to the south: and in thee and in thy seed shall all the families of the earth be blessed.
> 15 And, behold, I am with thee, and will keep thee in all places whither thou goest, and will bring thee again into this land; for I will not leave thee, until I have done that which I have spoken to thee of.

Talk about the story Jacob dreamed of a ladder reaching heaven, with angels going up and down. God promised to stay with him and bring him back to this land.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Jacob see in his dream? *Answer: A ladder reaching heaven.*

2. Who went up and down it? *Answer: Angels.*

3. Did God promise to leave Jacob or stay with him? *Answer: Stay with him.*

In your day Sleeping away from home can feel strange. Tell about a place where you miss your family. You can pray there; God hears you away from your own bedroom too.

Pray together God, thank You that I can talk to You away from home. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 32 | Sunday, November 1, 2026 | Jacob Worships

Read aloud Genesis 28:16-18

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 28:16-18

> 16 And Jacob awaked out of his sleep, and he said, Surely the LORD is in this place; and I knew it not.
> 17 And he was afraid, and said, How dreadful is this place! this is none other but the house of God, and this is the gate of heaven.
> 18 And Jacob rose up early in the morning, and took the stone that he had put for his pillows, and set it up for a pillar, and poured oil upon the top of it.

Talk about the story Jacob woke amazed that the LORD was there. He stood his stone pillow upright and poured oil on it. It marked the place where God had spoken.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What had Jacob used as a pillow? *Answer: A stone.*

2. Who did he realize was in that place? *Answer: The LORD.*

3. What did he pour on the stone? *Answer: Oil.*

In your day Do you keep a photo to remember something special? Jacob used a stone as a reminder. Tell one thing about God you want to remember today.

Pray together God, help me remember You and speak to You with respect. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 33 | Monday, November 2, 2026 | Years of Work

Read aloud Genesis 29:16-20

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 29:16-20

> 16 And Laban had two daughters: the name of the elder was Leah, and the name of the younger was Rachel.
> 17 Leah was tender eyed; but Rachel was beautiful and well favoured.
> 18 And Jacob loved Rachel; and said, I will serve thee seven years for Rachel thy younger daughter.
> 19 And Laban said, It is better that I give her to thee, than that I should give her to another man: abide with me.
> 20 And Jacob served seven years for Rachel; and they seemed unto him but a few days, for the love he had to her.

Talk about the story Jacob loved Rachel and worked seven years so he could marry her. His love made the long work worthwhile to him. Love can lead us to help willingly.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did Jacob love? *Answer: Rachel.*

2. How many years did he work? *Answer: Seven.*

3. Why did those years seem short to him? *Answer: Because he loved her.*

In your day Think of someone you love. Could you put their shoes away or carry napkins to the table? Choose a helpful job even if playing sounds more fun.

Pray together God, help me show love by helping. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 34 | Tuesday, November 3, 2026 | God Gives Jacob a New Name

Read aloud Genesis 32:24-30

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 32:24-30

> 24 And Jacob was left alone; and there wrestled a man with him until the breaking of the day.
> 25 And when he saw that he prevailed not against him, he touched the hollow of his thigh; and the hollow of Jacob's thigh was out of joint, as he wrestled with him.
> 26 And he said, Let me go, for the day breaketh. And he said, I will not let thee go, except thou bless me.
> 27 And he said unto him, What is thy name? And he said, Jacob.
> 28 And he said, Thy name shall be called no more Jacob, but Israel: for as a prince hast thou power with God and with men, and hast prevailed.
> 29 And Jacob asked him, and said, Tell me, I pray thee, thy name. And he said, Wherefore is it that thou dost ask after my name? And he blessed him there.
> 30 And Jacob called the name of the place Peniel: for I have seen God face to face, and my life is preserved.

Talk about the story Jacob wrestled through the night and asked for a blessing. God gave him the name Israel. Jacob knew he had met God and that his life had been spared.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What was Jacob doing through the night? *Answer: Wrestling.*

2. What did he ask for? *Answer: A blessing.*

3. What new name did he receive? *Answer: Israel.*

In your day Sometimes "I can do it myself" keeps us from asking for help. Name something hard for you. You can ask God for help instead of pretending you need none.

Pray together God, help me admit that I need You. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 35 | Wednesday, November 4, 2026 | Brothers Make Peace

Read aloud Genesis 33:1-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 33:1-4

> 1 And Jacob lifted up his eyes, and looked, and, behold, Esau came, and with him four hundred men. And he divided the children unto Leah, and unto Rachel, and unto the two handmaids.
> 2 And he put the handmaids and their children foremost, and Leah and her children after, and Rachel and Joseph hindermost.
> 3 And he passed over before them, and bowed himself to the ground seven times, until he came near to his brother.
> 4 And Esau ran to meet him, and embraced him, and fell on his neck, and kissed him: and they wept.

Talk about the story Jacob bowed as he approached Esau. Esau ran to hug him, and both brothers cried. After years apart and much hurt, they met with affection.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was coming toward Jacob? *Answer: Esau.*

2. What did Esau do when they met? *Answer: He ran and hugged Jacob.*

3. Did the brothers fight or cry together? *Answer: They cried together.*

In your day Think of making up after an argument. Practice saying, "I am sorry I hurt you." The other person may need time; speak gently and listen.

Pray together God, help me take a kind step after an argument. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 06 | Joseph: God Is With Him | Nov 5 - Nov 11, 2026

Bible story Genesis 37-41

Week overview Joseph's brothers hated him and sold him, yet the LORD stayed with Joseph in slavery and prison and prepared him to help many people.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3

Day 36 | Thursday, November 5, 2026 | A Special Coat and Jealous Hearts

Read aloud Genesis 37:3-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 37:3-4

> 3 Now Israel loved Joseph more than all his children, because he was the son of his old age: and he made him a coat of many colours.
> 4 And when his brethren saw that their father loved him more than all his brethren, they hated him, and could not speak peaceably unto him.

Talk about the story Joseph's father gave him a special coat and showed him more love than his brothers. The brothers hated Joseph. Favoritism and jealousy hurt this family.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Joseph receive? *Answer: A coat of many colors.*

2. Why were his brothers upset? *Answer: Their father loved Joseph more.*

3. Could they speak kindly to him? *Answer: No.*

In your day If another child gets a present, you may wish it were yours. Tell an adult how you feel without being mean to the child. Try, "That looks fun."

Pray together God, help me be kind when someone else gets something I want. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 37 | Friday, November 6, 2026 | Joseph's Dreams

Read aloud Genesis 37:5-8

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 37:5-8

> 5 And Joseph dreamed a dream, and he told it his brethren: and they hated him yet the more.
> 6 And he said unto them, Hear, I pray you, this dream which I have dreamed:
> 7 For, behold, we were binding sheaves in the field, and, lo, my sheaf arose, and also stood upright; and, behold, your sheaves stood round about, and made obeisance to my sheaf.
> 8 And his brethren said to him, Shalt thou indeed reign over us? or shalt thou indeed have dominion over us? And they hated him yet the more for his dreams, and for his words.

Talk about the story Joseph dreamed that his brothers' bundles of grain bowed to his bundle. His brothers understood it as Joseph ruling them. Their anger grew when he told them.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What stood upright in Joseph's dream? *Answer: His bundle of grain.*

2. What did the other bundles do? *Answer: They bowed to it.*

3. Were his brothers pleased or angry? *Answer: Angry.*

In your day If your sibling is chosen to lead a game, do you want to refuse everything they say? Tell why that can be hard, then practice joining without angry words.

Pray together God, help me with jealous and angry thoughts. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 38 | Saturday, November 7, 2026 | Thrown into a Pit

Read aloud Genesis 37:18-24

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 37:18-24

> 18 And when they saw him afar off, even before he came near unto them, they conspired against him to slay him.
> 19 And they said one to another, Behold, this dreamer cometh.
> 20 Come now therefore, and let us slay him, and cast him into some pit, and we will say, Some evil beast hath devoured him: and we shall see what will become of his dreams.
> 21 And Reuben heard it, and he delivered him out of their hands; and said, Let us not kill him.
> 22 And Reuben said unto them, Shed no blood, but cast him into this pit that is in the wilderness, and lay no hand upon him; that he might rid him out of their hands, to deliver him to his father again.
> 23 And it came to pass, when Joseph was come unto his brethren, that they stript Joseph out of his coat, his coat of many colours that was on him;
> 24 And they took him, and cast him into a pit: and the pit was empty, there was no water in it.

Talk about the story Joseph's brothers took his coat and threw him into an empty pit. Reuben had spoken against killing him. What the brothers did to Joseph was wrong.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who said not to kill Joseph? *Answer: Reuben.*

2. What did the brothers take from Joseph? *Answer: His coat.*

3. Where did they put him? *Answer: An empty pit.*

In your day If a group starts hurting a child, do not join in. Move to safety and get a trusted adult. Name an adult you could go to right away.

Pray together God, help me get help when someone is being hurt. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 39 | Sunday, November 8, 2026 | Sold Far from Home

Read aloud Genesis 37:25-28

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 37:25-28

> 25 And they sat down to eat bread: and they lifted up their eyes and looked, and, behold, a company of Ishmeelites came from Gilead with their camels bearing spicery and balm and myrrh, going to carry it down to Egypt.
> 26 And Judah said unto his brethren, What profit is it if we slay our brother, and conceal his blood?
> 27 Come, and let us sell him to the Ishmeelites, and let not our hand be upon him; for he is our brother and our flesh. And his brethren were content.
> 28 Then there passed by Midianites merchantmen; and they drew and lifted up Joseph out of the pit, and sold Joseph to the Ishmeelites for twenty pieces of silver: and they brought Joseph into Egypt.

Talk about the story The brothers sold Joseph to traders for silver. The traders took him to Egypt. Joseph was a person to love, never a thing to sell.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who suggested selling Joseph? *Answer: Judah.*

2. How much did the traders pay? *Answer: Twenty pieces of silver.*

3. Where was Joseph taken? *Answer: Egypt.*

In your day Think about missing someone you love. How might Joseph have felt going far away? Pray for a child who is separated from family or needs a safe home.

Pray together God, please care for children who are far from family. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 40 | Monday, November 9, 2026 | The LORD Was with Joseph

Read aloud Genesis 39:2-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 39:2-4

> 2 And the LORD was with Joseph, and he was a prosperous man; and he was in the house of his master the Egyptian.
> 3 And his master saw that the LORD was with him, and that the LORD made all that he did to prosper in his hand.
> 4 And Joseph found grace in his sight, and he served him: and he made him overseer over his house, and all that he had he put into his hand.

Talk about the story Joseph served in an Egyptian household. The LORD was with him, and his master trusted him with more responsibility. Joseph was not forgotten in this unfamiliar place.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was with Joseph? *Answer: The LORD.*

2. Did Joseph serve his master? *Answer: Yes.*

3. What was Joseph put in charge of? *Answer: His master's house and possessions.*

In your day Pick a small job, like feeding a pet with permission or putting books away. Do it carefully even if nobody is clapping. God sees ordinary work.

Pray together God, help me do my small jobs carefully. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 41 | Tuesday, November 10, 2026 | Faithful in Prison

Read aloud Genesis 39:20-23

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 39:20-23

> 20 And Joseph's master took him, and put him into the prison, a place where the king's prisoners were bound: and he was there in the prison.
> 21 But the LORD was with Joseph, and shewed him mercy, and gave him favour in the sight of the keeper of the prison.
> 22 And the keeper of the prison committed to Joseph's hand all the prisoners that were in the prison; and whatsoever they did there, he was the doer of it.
> 23 The keeper of the prison looked not to any thing that was under his hand; because the LORD was with him, and that which he did, the LORD made it to prosper.

Talk about the story Joseph was put in prison. Even there, the LORD showed him mercy. The prison keeper trusted him to look after work and other prisoners.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where was Joseph? *Answer: In prison.*

2. Was the LORD still with him? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Who trusted Joseph with responsibilities? *Answer: The prison keeper.*

In your day Being blamed unfairly hurts. You can tell a trusted adult what happened without making up a story to get even. God sees the truth even when people misunderstand.

Pray together God, help me when someone misunderstands what I did. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 42 | Wednesday, November 11, 2026 | God Gives the Answer

Read aloud Genesis 41:14-16

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 41:14-16

> 14 Then Pharaoh sent and called Joseph, and they brought him hastily out of the dungeon: and he shaved himself, and changed his raiment, and came in unto Pharaoh.
> 15 And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, I have dreamed a dream, and there is none that can interpret it: and I have heard say of thee, that thou canst understand a dream to interpret it.
> 16 And Joseph answered Pharaoh, saying, It is not in me: God shall give Pharaoh an answer of peace.

Talk about the story Pharaoh wanted Joseph to explain a dream. Joseph said the answer would come from God. He did not pretend the power belonged to him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who called Joseph out of prison? *Answer: Pharaoh.*

2. What did Pharaoh want explained? *Answer: His dream.*

3. Who did Joseph say would give the answer? *Answer: God.*

In your day When someone praises your drawing, remember the people who helped you learn and the abilities God gave you. Say thank you without pretending you did everything alone.

Pray together God, thank You for the help and abilities You give me. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 56:3 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 04 | Days 43-56

Joseph Forgives and Saves His Family + God Calls Moses

Thursday, November 12, 2026 through Wednesday, November 25, 2026

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Psalm 46:1

> 1 God is our refuge and strength, a very present help in trouble.

Meaning in context God is a safe place, strong help, and close help when trouble comes.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 07 | Joseph Forgives and Saves His Family | Nov 12 - Nov 18, 2026

Bible story Genesis 41-50

Week overview God raised Joseph to leadership before a famine. Joseph's brothers came for food, Joseph forgave them, and the whole family was preserved.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1

Day 43 | Thursday, November 12, 2026 | Joseph Becomes a Ruler

Read aloud Genesis 41:37-41

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 41:37-41

> 37 And the thing was good in the eyes of Pharaoh, and in the eyes of all his servants.
> 38 And Pharaoh said unto his servants, Can we find such a one as this is, a man in whom the Spirit of God is?
> 39 And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, Forasmuch as God hath shewed thee all this, there is none so discreet and wise as thou art:
> 40 Thou shalt be over my house, and according unto thy word shall all my people be ruled: only in the throne will I be greater than thou.
> 41 And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, See, I have set thee over all the land of Egypt.

Talk about the story Pharaoh made Joseph ruler over Egypt. He saw that God had given Joseph wisdom. Joseph would use his new responsibility to help people through hard years.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who made Joseph a ruler? *Answer: Pharaoh.*

2. What country would Joseph govern? *Answer: Egypt.*

3. Who had shown Joseph what Pharaoh needed to know? *Answer: God.*

In your day When you are the helper or game leader, you can look after everyone instead of bossing them around. Name one way a leader can help someone smaller.

Pray together God, help me use responsibility to help people. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 44 | Friday, November 13, 2026 | Food for the Hungry Years

Read aloud Genesis 41:47-49

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 41:47-49

> 47 And in the seven plenteous years the earth brought forth by handfuls.
> 48 And he gathered up all the food of the seven years, which were in the land of Egypt, and laid up the food in the cities: the food of the field, which was round about every city, laid he up in the same.
> 49 And Joseph gathered corn as the sand of the sea, very much, until he left numbering; for it was without number.

Talk about the story Egypt grew a great deal of food for seven years. Joseph stored it for the hungry years ahead. He did not waste the plenty.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. How many plentiful years were there? *Answer: Seven.*

2. What did Joseph store? *Answer: Food or grain.*

3. Was there a little grain or more than they could count? *Answer: More than they could count.*

In your day If you have a full box of crayons, taking care of them helps them last. Put the lids or wrappers back properly and save what you can use later.

Pray together God, help me take care of what we have. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 45 | Saturday, November 14, 2026 | The Brothers Come for Food

Read aloud Genesis 42:6-8

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 42:6-8

> 6 And Joseph was the governor over the land, and he it was that sold to all the people of the land: and Joseph's brethren came, and bowed down themselves before him with their faces to the earth.
> 7 And Joseph saw his brethren, and he knew them, but made himself strange unto them, and spake roughly unto them; and he said unto them, Whence come ye? And they said, From the land of Canaan to buy food.
> 8 And Joseph knew his brethren, but they knew not him.

Talk about the story Joseph's brothers came to Egypt to buy food and bowed before him. He recognized them, but they did not recognize him. His old dream was coming true.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Why did the brothers come? *Answer: To buy food.*

2. Did Joseph recognize them? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Did they recognize Joseph? *Answer: No.*

4. What did they do before him? *Answer: They bowed.*

In your day Look at an old family picture. People can look different after years pass. Joseph's brothers had changed, but God had not forgotten what He had shown Joseph.

Pray together God, thank You that You do not forget Your promises. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 46 | Sunday, November 15, 2026 | Joseph Sees Benjamin

Read aloud Genesis 43:29-31

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 43:29-31

> 29 And he lifted up his eyes, and saw his brother Benjamin, his mother's son, and said, Is this your younger brother, of whom ye spake unto me? And he said, God be gracious unto thee, my son.
> 30 And Joseph made haste; for his bowels did yearn upon his brother: and he sought where to weep; and he entered into his chamber, and wept there.
> 31 And he washed his face, and went out, and refrained himself, and said, Set on bread.

Talk about the story Seeing Benjamin made Joseph cry. He went into another room, then washed his face and returned. Loving someone deeply can bring tears.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Which brother did Joseph see? *Answer: Benjamin.*

2. What did Joseph do in his room? *Answer: He cried.*

3. What did he do before returning? *Answer: He washed his face.*

In your day Have you cried when you missed someone or saw them again? Tears are not always from being hurt. Tell an adult about someone you miss.

Pray together God, thank You for people we love. Help us when we miss them. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 47 | Monday, November 16, 2026 | Joseph Says, 'I Am Joseph'

Read aloud Genesis 45:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 45:1-5

> 1 Then Joseph could not refrain himself before all them that stood by him; and he cried, Cause every man to go out from me. And there stood no man with him, while Joseph made himself known unto his brethren.
> 2 And he wept aloud: and the Egyptians and the house of Pharaoh heard.
> 3 And Joseph said unto his brethren, I am Joseph; doth my father yet live? And his brethren could not answer him; for they were troubled at his presence.
> 4 And Joseph said unto his brethren, Come near to me, I pray you. And they came near. And he said, I am Joseph your brother, whom ye sold into Egypt.
> 5 Now therefore be not grieved, nor angry with yourselves, that ye sold me hither: for God did send me before you to preserve life.

Talk about the story Joseph told his brothers who he was. They were frightened, but he invited them near. God had used Joseph's life to keep people alive despite their wrongdoing.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Joseph tell his brothers? *Answer: I am Joseph.*

2. Were the brothers calm or frightened? *Answer: Frightened.*

3. Why did Joseph say God had sent him ahead? *Answer: To preserve life.*

In your day When someone admits hurting you, you do not have to pretend it did not hurt. You can choose not to hurt them back and ask an adult to help make peace.

Pray together God, help me forgive without trying to get even. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 48 | Tuesday, November 17, 2026 | God Leads Jacob to Egypt

Read aloud Genesis 46:1-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 46:1-4

> 1 And Israel took his journey with all that he had, and came to Beersheba, and offered sacrifices unto the God of his father Isaac.
> 2 And God spake unto Israel in the visions of the night, and said, Jacob, Jacob. And he said, Here am I.
> 3 And he said, I am God, the God of thy father: fear not to go down into Egypt; for I will there make of thee a great nation:
> 4 I will go down with thee into Egypt; and I will also surely bring thee up again: and Joseph shall put his hand upon thine eyes.

Talk about the story Jacob was going to Egypt. God told him not to be afraid and promised to go with him. His family would grow into a great nation there.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where was Jacob going? *Answer: Egypt.*

2. Did God tell him to be afraid? *Answer: No.*

3. Who promised to go with him? *Answer: God.*

In your day A move, a new classroom, or a different routine can feel scary. Name what you would miss. Ask God for help and tell a caring adult about the worry.

Pray together God, help our family when things change. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 49 | Wednesday, November 18, 2026 | God Meant It for Good

Read aloud Genesis 50:18-21

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 50:18-21

> 18 And his brethren also went and fell down before his face; and they said, Behold, we be thy servants.
> 19 And Joseph said unto them, Fear not: for am I in the place of God?
> 20 But as for you, ye thought evil against me; but God meant it unto good, to bring to pass, as it is this day, to save much people alive.
> 21 Now therefore fear ye not: I will nourish you, and your little ones. And he comforted them, and spake kindly unto them.

Talk about the story The brothers had meant to hurt Joseph, but God brought good through it and saved lives. Joseph spoke kindly and promised to feed them and their children.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did the brothers mean good or evil? *Answer: Evil.*

2. What did God bring through Joseph's life? *Answer: Good that saved many people.*

3. How did Joseph speak to his brothers? *Answer: Kindly.*

In your day Suppose someone breaks your project. It is right to tell an adult. You can also choose words that explain the hurt without threatening to break theirs.

Pray together God, help me use kind words when I have been hurt. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 08 | God Calls Moses | Nov 19 - Nov 25, 2026

Bible story Exodus 1-4

Week overview God protected baby Moses, heard Israel's cries, spoke from the burning bush, and called Moses to lead His people out of Egypt.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1

Day 50 | Thursday, November 19, 2026 | Brave Helpers

Read aloud Exodus 1:15-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 1:15-17

> 15 And the king of Egypt spake to the Hebrew midwives, of which the name of the one was Shiphrah, and the name of the other Puah:
> 16 And he said, When ye do the office of a midwife to the Hebrew women, and see them upon the stools; if it be a son, then ye shall kill him: but if it be a daughter, then she shall live.
> 17 But the midwives feared God, and did not as the king of Egypt commanded them, but saved the men children alive.

Talk about the story The king ordered the midwives to kill baby boys. These women feared God and kept the babies alive. Even a ruler's command can be wrong.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What work did the midwives do? *Answer: They helped mothers have babies.*

2. Did they obey the king's cruel order? *Answer: No.*

3. Whom did they fear and honor? *Answer: God.*

In your day If an older child orders you to hurt someone smaller, should you obey? Say no, move away, and tell a trusted adult. God wants us to protect people.

Pray together God, help me refuse to hurt someone. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 51 | Friday, November 20, 2026 | A Basket for Baby Moses

Read aloud Exodus 2:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 2:1-3

> 1 And there went a man of the house of Levi, and took to wife a daughter of Levi.
> 2 And the woman conceived, and bare a son: and when she saw him that he was a goodly child, she hid him three months.
> 3 And when she could not longer hide him, she took for him an ark of bulrushes, and daubed it with slime and with pitch, and put the child therein; and she laid it in the flags by the river's brink.

Talk about the story Moses' mother hid him to keep him safe. When she could hide him no longer, she placed him in a waterproof basket among reeds at the river's edge.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. How long did Moses' mother hide him? *Answer: Three months.*

2. What did she put him in? *Answer: A basket made of bulrushes.*

3. Where did she place the basket? *Answer: Among reeds by the river's edge.*

In your day Babies need someone to care for them. Ask an adult how you can help a younger child safely, perhaps by bringing a clean blanket or finding a toy.

Pray together God, thank You for people who care for little children. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 52 | Saturday, November 21, 2026 | The Princess Finds Moses

Read aloud Exodus 2:5-10

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 2:5-10

> 5 And the daughter of Pharaoh came down to wash herself at the river; and her maidens walked along by the river's side; and when she saw the ark among the flags, she sent her maid to fetch it.
> 6 And when she had opened it, she saw the child: and, behold, the babe wept. And she had compassion on him, and said, This is one of the Hebrews' children.
> 7 Then said his sister to Pharaoh's daughter, Shall I go and call to thee a nurse of the Hebrew women, that she may nurse the child for thee?
> 8 And Pharaoh's daughter said to her, Go. And the maid went and called the child's mother.
> 9 And Pharaoh's daughter said unto her, Take this child away, and nurse it for me, and I will give thee thy wages. And the woman took the child, and nursed it.
> 10 And the child grew, and she brought him unto Pharaoh's daughter, and he became her son. And she called his name Moses: and she said, Because I drew him out of the water.

Talk about the story Pharaoh's daughter found the crying baby and felt compassion. Moses' sister fetched his own mother to care for him. Several people helped this little boy.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who found the baby? *Answer: Pharaoh's daughter.*

2. Who fetched someone to feed him? *Answer: His sister.*

3. Whom did she fetch? *Answer: His own mother.*

4. What was the baby named? *Answer: Moses.*

In your day When a younger child cries, what might they need? Ask an adult before helping. You can notice a need even when you are not big enough to solve it alone.

Pray together God, help me notice when someone needs care. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 53 | Sunday, November 22, 2026 | God Hears His People

Read aloud Exodus 2:23-25

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 2:23-25

> 23 And it came to pass in process of time, that the king of Egypt died: and the children of Israel sighed by reason of the bondage, and they cried, and their cry came up unto God by reason of the bondage.
> 24 And God heard their groaning, and God remembered his covenant with Abraham, with Isaac, and with Jacob.
> 25 And God looked upon the children of Israel, and God had respect unto them.

Talk about the story The Israelites were suffering as slaves. God heard their cries and remembered His promise to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. Their suffering mattered to Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Why were the Israelites crying? *Answer: They were suffering in slavery.*

2. Who heard them? *Answer: God.*

3. Whose covenant did God remember? *Answer: His covenant with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob.*

In your day You do not need fancy words when you are upset. Tell God one thing that hurts or worries you, then tell a trusted adult who can help.

Pray together God, thank You for hearing us when we are hurting. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 54 | Monday, November 23, 2026 | The Burning Bush

Read aloud Exodus 3:1-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 3:1-6

> 1 Now Moses kept the flock of Jethro his father in law, the priest of Midian: and he led the flock to the backside of the desert, and came to the mountain of God, even to Horeb.
> 2 And the angel of the LORD appeared unto him in a flame of fire out of the midst of a bush: and he looked, and, behold, the bush burned with fire, and the bush was not consumed.
> 3 And Moses said, I will now turn aside, and see this great sight, why the bush is not burnt.
> 4 And when the LORD saw that he turned aside to see, God called unto him out of the midst of the bush, and said, Moses, Moses. And he said, Here am I.
> 5 And he said, Draw not nigh hither: put off thy shoes from off thy feet, for the place whereon thou standest is holy ground.
> 6 Moreover he said, I am the God of thy father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob. And Moses hid his face; for he was afraid to look upon God.

Talk about the story Moses saw a burning bush that did not burn up. God called his name and told him to remove his shoes. God was holy, and Moses needed to listen respectfully.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What was unusual about the bush? *Answer: It burned but was not burned up.*

2. Who called Moses' name? *Answer: God.*

3. What did God tell Moses to take off? *Answer: His shoes.*

In your day When someone calls your name, you may need to stop playing to hear. Set a toy aside while you listen to today's reading. God deserves your attention.

Pray together God, help me pay attention when we read Your words. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 55 | Tuesday, November 24, 2026 | God Sends Moses

Read aloud Exodus 3:7-12

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 3:7-12

> 7 And the LORD said, I have surely seen the affliction of my people which are in Egypt, and have heard their cry by reason of their taskmasters; for I know their sorrows;
> 8 And I am come down to deliver them out of the hand of the Egyptians, and to bring them up out of that land unto a good land and a large, unto a land flowing with milk and honey; unto the place of the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites.
> 9 Now therefore, behold, the cry of the children of Israel is come unto me: and I have also seen the oppression wherewith the Egyptians oppress them.
> 10 Come now therefore, and I will send thee unto Pharaoh, that thou mayest bring forth my people the children of Israel out of Egypt.
> 11 And Moses said unto God, Who am I, that I should go unto Pharaoh, and that I should bring forth the children of Israel out of Egypt?
> 12 And he said, Certainly I will be with thee; and this shall be a token unto thee, that I have sent thee: When thou hast brought forth the people out of Egypt, ye shall serve God upon this mountain.

Talk about the story God had seen His people's suffering. He sent Moses to bring them out of Egypt. When Moses felt too small for the job, God promised to be with him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who had heard the Israelites crying? *Answer: God.*

2. Whom did God send to Pharaoh? *Answer: Moses.*

3. What did God promise Moses? *Answer: I will be with thee.*

In your day Think of a good task that seems big, like welcoming a new child. You can ask God for courage and ask an adult to help you take the first step.

Pray together God, give me courage to do the good things I need to do. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 56 | Wednesday, November 25, 2026 | God Helps Moses Speak

Read aloud Exodus 4:10-12

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 4:10-12

> 10 And Moses said unto the LORD, O my Lord, I am not eloquent, neither heretofore, nor since thou hast spoken unto thy servant: but I am slow of speech, and of a slow tongue.
> 11 And the LORD said unto him, Who hath made man's mouth? or who maketh the dumb, or deaf, or the seeing, or the blind? have not I the LORD?
> 12 Now therefore go, and I will be with thy mouth, and teach thee what thou shalt say.

Talk about the story Moses worried that he could not speak well. God reminded him who made the mouth and promised to help him speak. Moses could depend on God's help.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What worried Moses? *Answer: He did not speak well.*

2. Who made people's mouths? *Answer: The LORD.*

3. What did God promise to teach Moses? *Answer: What to say.*

In your day Have you been nervous about answering aloud? Practice one sentence with a patient adult. Speaking slowly or needing help does not make you less valuable.

Pray together God, help me when I am nervous about speaking. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 46:1 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 05 | Days 57-70

The Plagues and the Passover + Through the Sea and into the Wilderness

Thursday, November 26, 2026 through Wednesday, December 9, 2026

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 14:14

> 14 The LORD shall fight for you, and ye shall hold your peace.

Meaning in context The LORD can fight for His people; they may be still and trust Him.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 09 | The Plagues and the Passover | Nov 26 - Dec 2, 2026

Bible story Exodus 5-12

Week overview Pharaoh proudly refused God's command. Through the plagues, the LORD showed His power, judged Egypt's false gods, and provided Passover protection for Israel.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14

Day 57 | Thursday, November 26, 2026 | Let My People Go

Read aloud Exodus 5:1-2

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 5:1-2

> 1 And afterward Moses and Aaron went in, and told Pharaoh, Thus saith the LORD God of Israel, Let my people go, that they may hold a feast unto me in the wilderness.
> 2 And Pharaoh said, Who is the LORD, that I should obey his voice to let Israel go? I know not the LORD, neither will I let Israel go.

Talk about the story Moses and Aaron told Pharaoh to let God's people go. Pharaoh refused to listen to the LORD. Being powerful did not give him the right to ignore God.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who spoke to Pharaoh? *Answer: Moses and Aaron.*

2. What did God want Pharaoh to do? *Answer: Let His people go.*

3. Did Pharaoh agree? *Answer: No.*

In your day When someone says "Stop" because you are hurting them, refusing to listen makes the hurt worse. Practice stopping a game when another person says it is hurting.

Pray together God, help me listen instead of stubbornly refusing. Amen.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 58 | Friday, November 27, 2026 | God Promises Deliverance

Read aloud Exodus 7:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 7:1-5

> 1 And the LORD said unto Moses, See, I have made thee a god to Pharaoh: and Aaron thy brother shall be thy prophet.
> 2 Thou shalt speak all that I command thee: and Aaron thy brother shall speak unto Pharaoh, that he send the children of Israel out of his land.
> 3 And I will harden Pharaoh's heart, and multiply my signs and my wonders in the land of Egypt.
> 4 But Pharaoh shall not hearken unto you, that I may lay my hand upon Egypt, and bring forth mine armies, and my people the children of Israel, out of the land of Egypt by great judgments.
> 5 And the Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD, when I stretch forth mine hand upon Egypt, and bring out the children of Israel from among them.

Talk about the story God told Moses what to say and gave Aaron the job of speaking to Pharaoh. He promised to bring Israel out. Pharaoh would learn who the LORD was.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who would speak to Pharaoh for Moses? *Answer: Aaron.*

2. Whom would God bring out of Egypt? *Answer: The Israelites.*

3. What would the Egyptians learn? *Answer: That He is the LORD.*

In your day Think about a locked door you cannot open. An adult with the key can help. Israel could not free themselves from Pharaoh, but God could rescue them.

Pray together God, thank You that powerful people cannot stop Your plans. Amen.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 59 | Saturday, November 28, 2026 | God Makes a Difference

Read aloud Exodus 8:20-23

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 8:20-23

> 20 And the LORD said unto Moses, Rise up early in the morning, and stand before Pharaoh; lo, he cometh forth to the water; and say unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Let my people go, that they may serve me.
> 21 Else, if thou wilt not let my people go, behold, I will send swarms of flies upon thee, and upon thy servants, and upon thy people, and into thy houses: and the houses of the Egyptians shall be full of swarms of flies, and also the ground whereon they are.
> 22 And I will sever in that day the land of Goshen, in which my people dwell, that no swarms of flies shall be there; to the end thou mayest know that I am the LORD in the midst of the earth.
> 23 And I will put a division between my people and thy people: to morrow shall this sign be.

Talk about the story God warned Pharaoh about swarms of flies. Goshen, where the Israelites lived, would have no swarms. This difference would show that the LORD was in control.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What insects would come? *Answer: Flies.*

2. Where would there be no swarms? *Answer: Goshen.*

3. What did God still tell Pharaoh to do? *Answer: Let His people go.*

In your day Have you tried eating with one fly buzzing nearby? Imagine flies all through a house. Talk about why Pharaoh should have listened to God's warning.

Pray together God, help me take Your warnings seriously. Amen.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 60 | Sunday, November 29, 2026 | That My Name May Be Known

Read aloud Exodus 9:13-16

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 9:13-16

> 13 And the LORD said unto Moses, Rise up early in the morning, and stand before Pharaoh, and say unto him, Thus saith the LORD God of the Hebrews, Let my people go, that they may serve me.
> 14 For I will at this time send all my plagues upon thine heart, and upon thy servants, and upon thy people; that thou mayest know that there is none like me in all the earth.
> 15 For now I will stretch out my hand, that I may smite thee and thy people with pestilence; and thou shalt be cut off from the earth.
> 16 And in very deed for this cause have I raised thee up, for to shew in thee my power; and that my name may be declared throughout all the earth.

Talk about the story Pharaoh acted as though no one could tell him what to do. God would show His power so people everywhere would know that no one was like Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who sent Moses to Pharaoh? *Answer: The LORD.*

2. Was anyone in all the earth like the LORD? *Answer: No.*

3. Where did God want His name known? *Answer: Throughout the earth.*

In your day A game leader can make rules for a game, but cannot become the boss of everything. Who is greater than even kings? Remember that all people answer to God.

Pray together God, help me remember that You are greater than every ruler. Amen.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 61 | Monday, November 30, 2026 | Tell Your Children

Read aloud Exodus 10:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 10:1-3

> 1 And the LORD said unto Moses, Go in unto Pharaoh: for I have hardened his heart, and the heart of his servants, that I might shew these my signs before him:
> 2 And that thou mayest tell in the ears of thy son, and of thy son's son, what things I have wrought in Egypt, and my signs which I have done among them; that ye may know how that I am the LORD.
> 3 And Moses and Aaron came in unto Pharaoh, and said unto him, Thus saith the LORD God of the Hebrews, How long wilt thou refuse to humble thyself before me? let my people go, that they may serve me.

Talk about the story God wanted parents and grandparents to tell children what He did in Egypt. These were true events to remember. Children could learn who the LORD was by hearing them.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who should hear what God did in Egypt? *Answer: Children and grandchildren.*

2. What would they learn? *Answer: That He is the LORD.*

3. Was Pharaoh willing to humble himself? *Answer: No.*

In your day Ask a parent or grandparent to tell you a Bible story they remember. Then tell them one thing you remember about Moses. Listening and retelling help us learn.

Pray together God, thank You that our family can learn Your Word together. Amen.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 62 | Tuesday, December 1, 2026 | The Passover Lamb

Read aloud Exodus 12:12-14

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 12:12-14

> 12 For I will pass through the land of Egypt this night, and will smite all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both man and beast; and against all the gods of Egypt I will execute judgment: I am the LORD.
> 13 And the blood shall be to you for a token upon the houses where ye are: and when I see the blood, I will pass over you, and the plague shall not be upon you to destroy you, when I smite the land of Egypt.
> 14 And this day shall be unto you for a memorial; and ye shall keep it a feast to the LORD throughout your generations; ye shall keep it a feast by an ordinance for ever.

Talk about the story God warned that death would come to Egypt. He told Israel how to mark their houses with a lamb's blood. He promised to pass over those houses.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What sign would be on the houses? *Answer: Blood.*

2. What did God promise when He saw the blood? *Answer: To pass over the house.*

3. Were the people to remember this day? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day When there is a serious warning, listening matters. This was a special rescue God gave Israel. Today we remember Jesus, the Saviour, rather than putting blood on our doors.

Pray together God, thank You for providing rescue for Your people. Amen.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 63 | Wednesday, December 2, 2026 | Pharaoh Lets Israel Go

Read aloud Exodus 12:31-33

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 12:31-33

> 31 And he called for Moses and Aaron by night, and said, Rise up, and get you forth from among my people, both ye and the children of Israel; and go, serve the LORD, as ye have said.
> 32 Also take your flocks and your herds, as ye have said, and be gone; and bless me also.
> 33 And the Egyptians were urgent upon the people, that they might send them out of the land in haste; for they said, We be all dead men.

Talk about the story After God's judgments, Pharaoh told Moses and Aaron to take the Israelites out. They could take their animals too. God had done what He promised.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who told Moses and Aaron to leave? *Answer: Pharaoh.*

2. Who could go with them? *Answer: The Israelites.*

3. Could they take their flocks and herds? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Imagine packing after a long wait to go home. What might you feel? Israel's wait was ending because God had acted, not because Pharaoh had become stronger.

Pray together God, thank You for keeping Your promise to free Israel. Amen.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 10 | Through the Sea and into the Wilderness | Dec 3 - Dec 9, 2026

Bible story Exodus 13-17

Week overview God led Israel with cloud and fire, opened the Red Sea, received their praise, and provided bread and water in the wilderness.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14

Day 64 | Thursday, December 3, 2026 | Cloud by Day, Fire by Night

Read aloud Exodus 13:17-22

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 13:17-22

> 17 And it came to pass, when Pharaoh had let the people go, that God led them not through the way of the land of the Philistines, although that was near; for God said, Lest peradventure the people repent when they see war, and they return to Egypt:
> 18 But God led the people about, through the way of the wilderness of the Red sea: and the children of Israel went up harnessed out of the land of Egypt.
> 19 And Moses took the bones of Joseph with him: for he had straitly sworn the children of Israel, saying, God will surely visit you; and ye shall carry up my bones away hence with you.
> 20 And they took their journey from Succoth, and encamped in Etham, in the edge of the wilderness.
> 21 And the LORD went before them by day in a pillar of a cloud, to lead them the way; and by night in a pillar of fire, to give them light; to go by day and night:
> 22 He took not away the pillar of the cloud by day, nor the pillar of fire by night, from before the people.

Talk about the story God led Israel with a cloud by day and fire by night. He knew the way they needed. His presence was visible as they traveled.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What led them during the day? *Answer: A pillar of cloud.*

2. What gave light at night? *Answer: A pillar of fire.*

3. Who was leading them? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day When walking somewhere unfamiliar, you stay near the adult who knows the way. Israel followed God's cloud. Today we learn what God wants by reading His Word.

Pray together God, help me listen to Your Word as You teach me. Amen.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 65 | Friday, December 4, 2026 | Stand Still and Trust

Read aloud Exodus 14:10-14

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 14:10-14

> 10 And when Pharaoh drew nigh, the children of Israel lifted up their eyes, and, behold, the Egyptians marched after them; and they were sore afraid: and the children of Israel cried out unto the LORD.
> 11 And they said unto Moses, Because there were no graves in Egypt, hast thou taken us away to die in the wilderness? wherefore hast thou dealt thus with us, to carry us forth out of Egypt?
> 12 Is not this the word that we did tell thee in Egypt, saying, Let us alone, that we may serve the Egyptians? For it had been better for us to serve the Egyptians, than that we should die in the wilderness.
> 13 And Moses said unto the people, Fear ye not, stand still, and see the salvation of the LORD, which he will shew to you to day: for the Egyptians whom ye have seen to day, ye shall see them again no more for ever.
> 14 The LORD shall fight for you, and ye shall hold your peace.

Talk about the story The Israelites saw the Egyptian army coming and were terrified. Moses told them that the LORD would fight for them. They needed the rescue God could give.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was coming after Israel? *Answer: The Egyptians.*

2. How did the people feel? *Answer: Very afraid.*

3. Who did Moses say would fight for them? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day When you feel frightened, stop and tell a trusted adult what you see. Pray a short prayer together. You do not have to face fear by yourself.

Pray together God, help me turn to You when I feel scared. Amen.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 66 | Saturday, December 5, 2026 | A Road through the Sea

Read aloud Exodus 14:21-22

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 14:21-22

> 21 And Moses stretched out his hand over the sea; and the LORD caused the sea to go back by a strong east wind all that night, and made the sea dry land, and the waters were divided.
> 22 And the children of Israel went into the midst of the sea upon the dry ground: and the waters were a wall unto them on their right hand, and on their left.

Talk about the story God sent a strong wind and divided the sea. The Israelites walked on dry ground with water on both sides. God made a way where none had been.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Moses stretch over the sea? *Answer: His hand.*

2. What did God use to move the water? *Answer: A strong east wind.*

3. Did the people walk on mud or dry ground? *Answer: Dry ground.*

In your day Picture needing to cross a huge stretch of water with no bridge. Draw two walls of water and a dry path between them to retell what God did.

Pray together God, thank You for making a way for Israel. Amen.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 67 | Sunday, December 6, 2026 | Safe on the Other Side

Read aloud Exodus 14:29-31

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 14:29-31

> 29 But the children of Israel walked upon dry land in the midst of the sea; and the waters were a wall unto them on their right hand, and on their left.
> 30 Thus the LORD saved Israel that day out of the hand of the Egyptians; and Israel saw the Egyptians dead upon the sea shore.
> 31 And Israel saw that great work which the LORD did upon the Egyptians: and the people feared the LORD, and believed the LORD, and his servant Moses.

Talk about the story Israel reached safety, and the army chasing them could not keep hurting them. The people saw God's great work and believed Him. This rescue was His doing.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who saved Israel? *Answer: The LORD.*

2. What was on each side as Israel crossed? *Answer: Walls of water.*

3. Whom did the people believe afterward? *Answer: The LORD and His servant Moses.*

In your day After someone helps you, remember who helped. Tell about a time an adult kept you safe. Thank them, and thank God for people who care for you.

Pray together God, thank You for rescuing Israel from their enemies. Amen.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 68 | Monday, December 7, 2026 | Moses Sings Praise

Read aloud Exodus 15:1-2

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 15:1-2

> 1 Then sang Moses and the children of Israel this song unto the LORD, and spake, saying, I will sing unto the LORD, for he hath triumphed gloriously: the horse and his rider hath he thrown into the sea.
> 2 The LORD is my strength and song, and he is become my salvation: he is my God, and I will prepare him an habitation; my father's God, and I will exalt him.

Talk about the story Moses and the Israelites sang to the LORD after the rescue. They called Him their strength and salvation. Singing helped them say thank you together.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who sang? *Answer: Moses and the Israelites.*

2. To whom did they sing? *Answer: The LORD.*

3. Who was their strength and salvation? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day Choose a Bible song your family knows. Before singing, say one thing you are thanking God for. You do not need a perfect singing voice to praise Him.

Pray together God, thank You for helping us. We want to praise You. Amen.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 69 | Tuesday, December 8, 2026 | Bread from Heaven

Read aloud Exodus 16:11-15

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 16:11-15

> 11 And the LORD spake unto Moses, saying,
> 12 I have heard the murmurings of the children of Israel: speak unto them, saying, At even ye shall eat flesh, and in the morning ye shall be filled with bread; and ye shall know that I am the LORD your God.
> 13 And it came to pass, that at even the quails came up, and covered the camp: and in the morning the dew lay round about the host.
> 14 And when the dew that lay was gone up, behold, upon the face of the wilderness there lay a small round thing, as small as the hoar frost on the ground.
> 15 And when the children of Israel saw it, they said one to another, It is manna: for they wist not what it was. And Moses said unto them, This is the bread which the LORD hath given you to eat.

Talk about the story God heard Israel's complaining and gave them food. Quails came in the evening, and bread called manna appeared in the morning. God knew they needed to eat.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What birds came in the evening? *Answer: Quails.*

2. What food appeared in the morning? *Answer: Manna.*

3. Who gave them this bread? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day At your next meal, notice the food before asking for something different. Thank God and the person who prepared it. You can say politely if you need help.

Pray together God, thank You for our food and those who prepare it. Amen.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 70 | Wednesday, December 9, 2026 | Water from the Rock

Read aloud Exodus 17:5-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 17:5-6

> 5 And the LORD said unto Moses, Go on before the people, and take with thee of the elders of Israel; and thy rod, wherewith thou smotest the river, take in thine hand, and go.
> 6 Behold, I will stand before thee there upon the rock in Horeb; and thou shalt smite the rock, and there shall come water out of it, that the people may drink. And Moses did so in the sight of the elders of Israel.

Talk about the story The people needed water. God told Moses to strike the rock, and water came out for them to drink. God provided what they could not find themselves.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Moses take in his hand? *Answer: His rod.*

2. What did God tell him to strike? *Answer: The rock.*

3. What would come out? *Answer: Water.*

In your day After running or playing, notice how thirsty you feel. Drink some water and thank God for it. Think about how relieved Israel must have been.

Pray together God, thank You for water to drink. Amen.

Memory verse Exodus 14:14 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 06 | Days 71-84

God's Commands and His Dwelling Place + Trusting God into the Promised Land

Thursday, December 10, 2026 through Wednesday, December 23, 2026

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Joshua 1:9

> 9 Have not I commanded thee? Be strong and of a good courage; be not afraid, neither be thou dismayed: for the LORD thy God is with thee whithersoever thou goest.

Meaning in context Courage comes from obeying God's command and remembering that He is with us.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 11 | God's Commands and His Dwelling Place | Dec 10 - Dec 16, 2026

Bible story Exodus 19-40

Week overview At Sinai, God made Israel His covenant nation, gave His commandments, and instructed them to build the tabernacle where His glory would dwell among them.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9

Day 71 | Thursday, December 10, 2026 | A Special People

Read aloud Exodus 19:3-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 19:3-6

> 3 And Moses went up unto God, and the LORD called unto him out of the mountain, saying, Thus shalt thou say to the house of Jacob, and tell the children of Israel;
> 4 Ye have seen what I did unto the Egyptians, and how I bare you on eagles' wings, and brought you unto myself.
> 5 Now therefore, if ye will obey my voice indeed, and keep my covenant, then ye shall be a peculiar treasure unto me above all people: for all the earth is mine:
> 6 And ye shall be unto me a kingdom of priests, and an holy nation. These are the words which thou shalt speak unto the children of Israel.

Talk about the story God reminded Israel that He had rescued them. He called them His special treasure and told them to obey Him. They were to belong to Him as a holy nation.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who had rescued Israel from Egypt? *Answer: God.*

2. What did God call them? *Answer: A special treasure.*

3. What did He tell them to do? *Answer: Obey His voice and keep His covenant.*

In your day Think of something you treasure and care for. God called Israel His treasure. When someone loves and cares for you, how can you listen to them well?

Pray together God, help us listen to You with grateful hearts. Amen.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 72 | Friday, December 11, 2026 | Worship God Alone

Read aloud Exodus 20:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 20:1-3

> 1 And God spake all these words, saying,
> 2 I am the LORD thy God, which have brought thee out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage.
> 3 Thou shalt have no other gods before me.

Talk about the story The LORD had freed Israel from slavery. He told them to have no other gods before Him. He alone deserved their worship.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who spoke these commands? *Answer: God.*

2. Where had He brought Israel from? *Answer: Egypt and slavery.*

3. Were they to worship other gods? *Answer: No.*

In your day A favorite toy can be fun without becoming the most important thing in your life. If it is time to hear God's Word, can you set the toy down?

Pray together God, help me love and worship You above everything else. Amen.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 73 | Saturday, December 12, 2026 | Honor God's Name and Day

Read aloud Exodus 20:7-8

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 20:7-8

> 7 Thou shalt not take the name of the LORD thy God in vain; for the LORD will not hold him guiltless that taketh his name in vain.
> 8 Remember the sabbath day, to keep it holy.

Talk about the story God told Israel to honor His name and keep the Sabbath holy. His name should never be a careless joke. The Sabbath was a day He set apart for Israel.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whose name must be honored? *Answer: The LORD's.*

2. What day did God tell Israel to remember? *Answer: The Sabbath.*

3. Were they to treat that day as holy? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Have you heard God's name used when someone is annoyed? Practice saying "I am frustrated" instead. Say God's name respectfully when you pray or talk about Him.

Pray together God, help me speak Your name with respect. Amen.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 74 | Sunday, December 13, 2026 | Honor Parents and Life

Read aloud Exodus 20:12-13

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 20:12-13

> 12 Honour thy father and thy mother: that thy days may be long upon the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee.
> 13 Thou shalt not kill.

Talk about the story God told children to honor their father and mother. He also commanded that people must not murder. People and families matter to Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom does God say to honor? *Answer: Father and mother.*

2. Does honor mean treating them with respect? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Does God permit murder? *Answer: No.*

In your day When a parent speaks, turn toward them and listen. Practice answering without shouting. Honoring parents also includes telling them honestly when you are hurt or afraid.

Pray together God, help me respect my parents and care about other people's lives. Amen.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 75 | Monday, December 14, 2026 | Honest Hands, Words, and Wants

Read aloud Exodus 20:15-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 20:15-17

> 15 Thou shalt not steal.
> 16 Thou shalt not bear false witness against thy neighbour.
> 17 Thou shalt not covet thy neighbour's house, thou shalt not covet thy neighbour's wife, nor his manservant, nor his maidservant, nor his ox, nor his ass, nor any thing that is thy neighbour's.

Talk about the story God forbids stealing, lying about others, and coveting. Coveting means wanting someone else's things in a way that makes you resentful. God cares about hands, words, and hearts.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. May we take what belongs to someone else? *Answer: No.*

2. May we tell lies about a neighbor? *Answer: No.*

3. What does covet mean? *Answer: Wanting someone else's things with a resentful heart.*

In your day If you find a toy that belongs to someone else, what should you do? Return it or ask an adult to help find its owner. Wanting it does not make it yours.

Pray together God, help me be honest and thankful for what I have. Amen.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 76 | Tuesday, December 15, 2026 | Make Me a Sanctuary

Read aloud Exodus 25:8-9

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 25:8-9

> 8 And let them make me a sanctuary; that I may dwell among them.
> 9 According to all that I shew thee, after the pattern of the tabernacle, and the pattern of all the instruments thereof, even so shall ye make it.

Talk about the story God told Israel to build a sanctuary, a special place for worship. They were to follow the pattern He gave. The tabernacle would be among His people.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did God ask them to make? *Answer: A sanctuary or tabernacle.*

2. Who gave the pattern? *Answer: God.*

3. Where did God say He would dwell? *Answer: Among His people.*

In your day Have you followed directions to build something? Leaving out a step changes it. Look at simple instructions together and notice why listening carefully matters.

Pray together God, help me listen carefully to what You say. Amen.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 77 | Wednesday, December 16, 2026 | The Glory Fills the Tabernacle

Read aloud Exodus 40:34-38

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Exodus 40:34-38

> 34 Then a cloud covered the tent of the congregation, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle.
> 35 And Moses was not able to enter into the tent of the congregation, because the cloud abode thereon, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle.
> 36 And when the cloud was taken up from over the tabernacle, the children of Israel went onward in all their journeys:
> 37 But if the cloud were not taken up, then they journeyed not till the day that it was taken up.
> 38 For the cloud of the LORD was upon the tabernacle by day, and fire was on it by night, in the sight of all the house of Israel, throughout all their journeys.

Talk about the story God's glory filled the tabernacle. When the cloud lifted, Israel traveled. When it stayed, they stayed. God was guiding them one journey at a time.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What filled the tabernacle? *Answer: The LORD's glory.*

2. When did Israel travel? *Answer: When the cloud lifted.*

3. What did they do when it stayed? *Answer: They stayed.*

In your day At a crossing, you may need to wait even when you want to go. Waiting can be part of listening. Practice stopping promptly when a trusted adult says to wait.

Pray together God, help me be willing to wait and listen. Amen.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 12 | Trusting God into the Promised Land | Dec 17 - Dec 23, 2026

Bible story Numbers 13-14; Deuteronomy 6; Joshua 1-6

Week overview Israel often feared instead of trusting. Joshua and Caleb believed God, and later Joshua led the next generation across Jordan and around Jericho.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9

Day 78 | Thursday, December 17, 2026 | A Good Land and Big Fears

Read aloud Numbers 13:27-28

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Numbers 13:27-28

> 27 And they told him, and said, We came unto the land whither thou sentest us, and surely it floweth with milk and honey; and this is the fruit of it.
> 28 Nevertheless the people be strong that dwell in the land, and the cities are walled, and very great: and moreover we saw the children of Anak there.

Talk about the story The spies found good land with plenty of food, but they also saw strong people and large walls. Their fear began to fill their thinking.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Was the land good? *Answer: Yes.*

2. What made the spies afraid? *Answer: Strong people and large walled cities.*

3. Did they bring back fruit? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day A hard puzzle can make you forget the pieces you already placed. Name the hard part, then remember the help available. Israel needed to remember God's promise too.

Pray together God, help me remember Your care when I notice something frightening. Amen.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 79 | Friday, December 18, 2026 | Caleb Says, 'We Are Able'

Read aloud Numbers 13:30-31

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Numbers 13:30-31

> 30 And Caleb stilled the people before Moses, and said, Let us go up at once, and possess it; for we are well able to overcome it.
> 31 But the men that went up with him said, We be not able to go up against the people; for they are stronger than we.

Talk about the story Caleb said they could enter the land. Other spies said the people there were too strong. Caleb trusted that God's promise mattered more than the size of the enemy.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who said they could go into the land? *Answer: Caleb.*

2. Did the other men agree? *Answer: No.*

3. What frightened the other men? *Answer: The people seemed stronger than they were.*

In your day If everyone says doing the right thing is too hard, you can still take a good step. Think of telling the truth even when friends want to hide a mistake.

Pray together God, help me do right even when others discourage me. Amen.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 80 | Saturday, December 19, 2026 | Do Not Rebel or Fear

Read aloud Numbers 14:6-9

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Numbers 14:6-9

> 6 And Joshua the son of Nun, and Caleb the son of Jephunneh, which were of them that searched the land, rent their clothes:
> 7 And they spake unto all the company of the children of Israel, saying, The land, which we passed through to search it, is an exceeding good land.
> 8 If the LORD delight in us, then he will bring us into this land, and give it us; a land which floweth with milk and honey.
> 9 Only rebel not ye against the LORD, neither fear ye the people of the land; for they are bread for us: their defence is departed from them, and the LORD is with us: fear them not.

Talk about the story Joshua and Caleb said the land was very good and the LORD was with Israel. They urged the people not to rebel. God could bring them into the land.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Which two men spoke to the people? *Answer: Joshua and Caleb.*

2. What did they say about the land? *Answer: It was very good.*

3. Who was with Israel? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day Sometimes a loud group pulls us toward a wrong choice. If friends want you to be cruel, step away and ask for help. You can listen to God instead.

Pray together God, help me trust You when other voices are loud. Amen.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 81 | Sunday, December 20, 2026 | Teach God's Words at Home

Read aloud Deuteronomy 6:4-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Deuteronomy 6:4-7

> 4 Hear, O Israel: The LORD our God is one LORD:
> 5 And thou shalt love the LORD thy God with all thine heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy might.
> 6 And these words, which I command thee this day, shall be in thine heart:
> 7 And thou shalt teach them diligently unto thy children, and shalt talk of them when thou sittest in thine house, and when thou walkest by the way, and when thou liest down, and when thou risest up.

Talk about the story God told families to talk about His words at home, on journeys, at bedtime, and in the morning. Learning about Him belongs in ordinary parts of a day.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. How should we love the LORD? *Answer: With all our heart, soul, and might.*

2. Who should be taught His words? *Answer: The children.*

3. Name one time families could talk about them. *Answer: At home, walking, bedtime, or getting up.*

In your day Choose one moment today, such as breakfast or a car ride. Tell each other something from this week's Bible stories. A short conversation counts.

Pray together God, help our family talk about You during our day. Amen.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 82 | Monday, December 21, 2026 | Be Strong and Courageous

Read aloud Joshua 1:5-9

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Joshua 1:5-9

> 5 There shall not any man be able to stand before thee all the days of thy life: as I was with Moses, so I will be with thee: I will not fail thee, nor forsake thee.
> 6 Be strong and of a good courage: for unto this people shalt thou divide for an inheritance the land, which I sware unto their fathers to give them.
> 7 Only be thou strong and very courageous, that thou mayest observe to do according to all the law, which Moses my servant commanded thee: turn not from it to the right hand or to the left, that thou mayest prosper whithersoever thou goest.
> 8 This book of the law shall not depart out of thy mouth; but thou shalt meditate therein day and night, that thou mayest observe to do according to all that is written therein: for then thou shalt make thy way prosperous, and then thou shalt have good success.
> 9 Have not I commanded thee? Be strong and of a good courage; be not afraid, neither be thou dismayed: for the LORD thy God is with thee whithersoever thou goest.

Talk about the story God told Joshua to be courageous, remember His law, and obey it. He promised not to leave him. Joshua's courage came from God's presence and words.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who promised to be with Joshua? *Answer: God.*

2. What was Joshua to think about day and night? *Answer: God's law.*

3. Was he only to hear it, or also obey it? *Answer: Also obey it.*

In your day Before a task that makes you nervous, say one Bible truth you know. Then take the next small step, such as asking for help or beginning the work.

Pray together God, help me remember Your words and do what they say. Amen.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 83 | Tuesday, December 22, 2026 | Across the Jordan

Read aloud Joshua 3:14-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Joshua 3:14-17

> 14 And it came to pass, when the people removed from their tents, to pass over Jordan, and the priests bearing the ark of the covenant before the people;
> 15 And as they that bare the ark were come unto Jordan, and the feet of the priests that bare the ark were dipped in the brim of the water, (for Jordan overfloweth all his banks all the time of harvest,)
> 16 That the waters which came down from above stood and rose up upon an heap very far from the city Adam, that is beside Zaretan: and those that came down toward the sea of the plain, even the salt sea, failed, and were cut off: and the people passed over right against Jericho.
> 17 And the priests that bare the ark of the covenant of the LORD stood firm on dry ground in the midst of Jordan, and all the Israelites passed over on dry ground, until all the people were passed clean over Jordan.

Talk about the story The priests stepped into the Jordan carrying the ark. God stopped the water, and the people crossed on dry ground. The priests stood there until everyone had crossed.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What were the priests carrying? *Answer: The ark of the covenant.*

2. What happened to the river? *Answer: The water stopped flowing through.*

3. Did all the people cross? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day When your family crosses a road, an adult looks after everyone, including the slowest walker. Notice that all Israel crossed; nobody was meant to be left behind.

Pray together God, thank You for bringing all the people across safely. Amen.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 84 | Wednesday, December 23, 2026 | Jericho's Walls Fall

Read aloud Joshua 6:20

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Joshua 6:20

> 20 So the people shouted when the priests blew with the trumpets: and it came to pass, when the people heard the sound of the trumpet, and the people shouted with a great shout, that the wall fell down flat, so that the people went up into the city, every man straight before him, and they took the city.

Talk about the story At Jericho the priests blew trumpets and the people shouted. The wall fell, and Israel entered. God gave this victory; shouting is not a trick for getting our wishes.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did the priests blow? *Answer: Trumpets.*

2. What did the people do? *Answer: They shouted.*

3. What happened to the wall? *Answer: It fell down flat.*

In your day A loud shout cannot normally knock down a wall. Retell this event using blocks if you like, and explain who made this unusual victory possible.

Pray together God, thank You for the powerful things You did for Israel. Amen.

Memory verse Joshua 1:9 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 07 | Days 85-98

Judges: God Sends Deliverers + Ruth, Hannah, and Samuel

Thursday, December 24, 2026 through Wednesday, January 6, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Psalm 119:105

> 105 Thy word is a lamp unto my feet, and a light unto my path.

Meaning in context God's Word shows the safe and right path, like a lamp in the dark.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 13 | Judges: God Sends Deliverers | Dec 24 - Dec 30, 2026

Bible story Judges 2-7

Week overview Israel repeatedly forgot the LORD, suffered under enemies, cried for help, and received judges whom God raised up to deliver them.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105

Day 85 | Thursday, December 24, 2026 | A Generation Forgets

Read aloud Judges 2:10-12

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Judges 2:10-12

> 10 And also all that generation were gathered unto their fathers: and there arose another generation after them, which knew not the LORD, nor yet the works which he had done for Israel.
> 11 And the children of Israel did evil in the sight of the LORD, and served Baalim:
> 12 And they forsook the LORD God of their fathers, which brought them out of the land of Egypt, and followed other gods, of the gods of the people that were round about them, and bowed themselves unto them, and provoked the LORD to anger.

Talk about the story A later generation did not know the LORD or remember His works. They worshiped other gods. Forgetting what God had done helped lead them away from Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did the new generation know the LORD? *Answer: No.*

2. Whom did they begin serving? *Answer: False gods, including Baalim.*

3. Who had brought their families out of Egypt? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day Tell a younger child, or an adult, one story about God's help from Exodus. If you forget a part, look it up together. Repeating true stories helps us remember.

Pray together God, help us remember You and teach others Your Word. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 86 | Friday, December 25, 2026 | God Raises Othniel

Read aloud Judges 3:9-11

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Judges 3:9-11

> 9 And when the children of Israel cried unto the LORD, the LORD raised up a deliverer to the children of Israel, who delivered them, even Othniel the son of Kenaz, Caleb's younger brother.
> 10 And the Spirit of the LORD came upon him, and he judged Israel, and went out to war: and the LORD delivered Chushanrishathaim king of Mesopotamia into his hand; and his hand prevailed against Chushanrishathaim.
> 11 And the land had rest forty years. And Othniel the son of Kenaz died.

Talk about the story Israel cried to the LORD, and He sent Othniel to rescue them. God's Spirit helped him. After the victory, the land had rest for forty years.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. To whom did Israel cry? *Answer: The LORD.*

2. Who was sent to rescue them? *Answer: Othniel.*

3. How long did the land have rest? *Answer: Forty years.*

In your day When you need help, name the problem clearly instead of hiding it. Practice asking a trusted adult for help, and remember you can ask God too.

Pray together God, thank You that we can ask You for help. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 87 | Saturday, December 26, 2026 | Deborah and Barak

Read aloud Judges 4:4-9

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Judges 4:4-9

> 4 And Deborah, a prophetess, the wife of Lapidoth, she judged Israel at that time.
> 5 And she dwelt under the palm tree of Deborah between Ramah and Bethel in mount Ephraim: and the children of Israel came up to her for judgment.
> 6 And she sent and called Barak the son of Abinoam out of Kedeshnaphtali, and said unto him, Hath not the LORD God of Israel commanded, saying, Go and draw toward mount Tabor, and take with thee ten thousand men of the children of Naphtali and of the children of Zebulun?
> 7 And I will draw unto thee to the river Kishon Sisera, the captain of Jabin's army, with his chariots and his multitude; and I will deliver him into thine hand.
> 8 And Barak said unto her, If thou wilt go with me, then I will go: but if thou wilt not go with me, then I will not go.
> 9 And she said, I will surely go with thee: notwithstanding the journey that thou takest shall not be for thine honour; for the LORD shall sell Sisera into the hand of a woman. And Deborah arose, and went with Barak to Kedesh.

Talk about the story Deborah told Barak God's command. Barak wanted her to come with him, and she agreed. God had promised to defeat the enemy.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who told Barak God's command? *Answer: Deborah.*

2. Whom did Barak want to go with him? *Answer: Deborah.*

3. Did she agree to go? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Have you asked someone to come with you when you felt nervous? You can encourage another child the same way. Offer to walk beside them to a new group.

Pray together God, help me encourage someone who feels nervous. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 88 | Sunday, December 27, 2026 | The LORD Is with Gideon

Read aloud Judges 6:11-16

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Judges 6:11-16

> 11 And there came an angel of the LORD, and sat under an oak which was in Ophrah, that pertained unto Joash the Abiezrite: and his son Gideon threshed wheat by the winepress, to hide it from the Midianites.
> 12 And the angel of the LORD appeared unto him, and said unto him, The LORD is with thee, thou mighty man of valour.
> 13 And Gideon said unto him, Oh my Lord, if the LORD be with us, why then is all this befallen us? and where be all his miracles which our fathers told us of, saying, Did not the LORD bring us up from Egypt? but now the LORD hath forsaken us, and delivered us into the hands of the Midianites.
> 14 And the LORD looked upon him, and said, Go in this thy might, and thou shalt save Israel from the hand of the Midianites: have not I sent thee?
> 15 And he said unto him, Oh my Lord, wherewith shall I save Israel? behold, my family is poor in Manasseh, and I am the least in my father's house.
> 16 And the LORD said unto him, Surely I will be with thee, and thou shalt smite the Midianites as one man.

Talk about the story Gideon was hiding his wheat from enemies. He felt too weak and unimportant to rescue Israel. God told him, "Surely I will be with thee."

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What was Gideon working with? *Answer: Wheat.*

2. Why was he hiding it? *Answer: Because of the Midianites.*

3. Who promised to be with him? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day You may think, "I am too small to help." Name a helpful thing you can do today, like checking on someone lonely or bringing an adult what they need.

Pray together God, help me trust You when I feel small. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 89 | Monday, December 28, 2026 | Gideon Asks for Assurance

Read aloud Judges 6:36-40

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Judges 6:36-40

> 36 And Gideon said unto God, If thou wilt save Israel by mine hand, as thou hast said,
> 37 Behold, I will put a fleece of wool in the floor; and if the dew be on the fleece only, and it be dry upon all the earth beside, then shall I know that thou wilt save Israel by mine hand, as thou hast said.
> 38 And it was so: for he rose up early on the morrow, and thrust the fleece together, and wringed the dew out of the fleece, a bowl full of water.
> 39 And Gideon said unto God, Let not thine anger be hot against me, and I will speak but this once: let me prove, I pray thee, but this once with the fleece; let it now be dry only upon the fleece, and upon all the ground let there be dew.
> 40 And God did so that night: for it was dry upon the fleece only, and there was dew on all the ground.

Talk about the story Gideon asked God to make wool wet while the ground stayed dry, then to reverse it. God answered patiently. This story does not tell us to demand signs before obeying.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Gideon put on the ground? *Answer: A fleece of wool.*

2. What was wet the first morning? *Answer: The fleece.*

3. What stayed dry the second time? *Answer: The fleece.*

In your day If you already know you should apologize, you do not need a special sign in the sky. Say the apology. Ask questions when confused, but follow what is clear.

Pray together God, help me trust Your words without demanding a sign. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 90 | Tuesday, December 29, 2026 | A Smaller Army

Read aloud Judges 7:2-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Judges 7:2-7

> 2 And the LORD said unto Gideon, The people that are with thee are too many for me to give the Midianites into their hands, lest Israel vaunt themselves against me, saying, Mine own hand hath saved me.
> 3 Now therefore go to, proclaim in the ears of the people, saying, Whosoever is fearful and afraid, let him return and depart early from mount Gilead. And there returned of the people twenty and two thousand; and there remained ten thousand.
> 4 And the LORD said unto Gideon, The people are yet too many; bring them down unto the water, and I will try them for thee there: and it shall be, that of whom I say unto thee, This shall go with thee, the same shall go with thee; and of whomsoever I say unto thee, This shall not go with thee, the same shall not go.
> 5 So he brought down the people unto the water: and the LORD said unto Gideon, Every one that lappeth of the water with his tongue, as a dog lappeth, him shalt thou set by himself; likewise every one that boweth down upon his knees to drink.
> 6 And the number of them that lapped, putting their hand to their mouth, were three hundred men: but all the rest of the people bowed down upon their knees to drink water.
> 7 And the LORD said unto Gideon, By the three hundred men that lapped will I save you, and deliver the Midianites into thine hand: and let all the other people go every man unto his place.

Talk about the story God made Gideon's army smaller so Israel could not claim they had saved themselves. Only three hundred men remained. The victory would show God's strength.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did God say the army was too large or too small? *Answer: Too large.*

2. How many men were finally chosen? *Answer: Three hundred.*

3. Who would save Israel? *Answer: God.*

In your day When an adult does the hard part of a project, it would be wrong to say you did it alone. Practice giving credit: "Thank you for helping me."

Pray together God, help me remember when You and others have helped me. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 91 | Wednesday, December 30, 2026 | Torches, Trumpets, and Victory

Read aloud Judges 7:19-22

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Judges 7:19-22

> 19 So Gideon, and the hundred men that were with him, came unto the outside of the camp in the beginning of the middle watch; and they had but newly set the watch: and they blew the trumpets, and brake the pitchers that were in their hands.
> 20 And the three companies blew the trumpets, and brake the pitchers, and held the lamps in their left hands, and the trumpets in their right hands to blow withal: and they cried, The sword of the LORD, and of Gideon.
> 21 And they stood every man in his place round about the camp: and all the host ran, and cried, and fled.
> 22 And the three hundred blew the trumpets, and the LORD set every man's sword against his fellow, even throughout all the host: and the host fled to Bethshittah in Zererath, and to the border of Abelmeholah, unto Tabbath.

Talk about the story Gideon's men blew trumpets, broke their pitchers, and held up lights. The enemy ran in confusion. The LORD brought the victory to this small army.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did the men blow? *Answer: Trumpets.*

2. What did they break? *Answer: Pitchers or jars.*

3. What did the enemy army do? *Answer: It ran away.*

In your day Use your hands to pretend to hold a trumpet and a light. Retell the actions in order. Then say why Israel should thank God for the outcome.

Pray together God, thank You that Israel's rescue did not depend on a huge army. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 14 | Ruth, Hannah, and Samuel | Dec 31, 2026 - Jan 6, 2027

Bible story Ruth 1-4; 1 Samuel 1-3

Week overview Ruth showed loyal love, Boaz showed kindness, Hannah prayed, and young Samuel learned to listen when God called.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105

Day 92 | Thursday, December 31, 2026 | Ruth Chooses Loyal Love

Read aloud Ruth 1:16-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Ruth 1:16-17

> 16 And Ruth said, Intreat me not to leave thee, or to return from following after thee: for whither thou goest, I will go; and where thou lodgest, I will lodge: thy people shall be my people, and thy God my God:
> 17 Where thou diest, will I die, and there will I be buried: the LORD do so to me, and more also, if ought but death part thee and me.

Talk about the story Ruth stayed with Naomi when life was sad and uncertain. She chose Naomi's people and God. Love showed itself in staying to care.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did Ruth stay with? *Answer: Naomi.*

2. Whose God did Ruth choose? *Answer: Naomi's God.*

3. Was she promising to leave or stay? *Answer: Stay.*

In your day When a friend is sad, you may not know how to fix it. Sit with them and listen instead of leaving them alone.

Pray together God, help me care for someone who is sad. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 93 | Friday, January 1, 2027 | Ruth Works in the Field

Read aloud Ruth 2:2-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Ruth 2:2-3

> 2 And Ruth the Moabitess said unto Naomi, Let me now go to the field, and glean ears of corn after him in whose sight I shall find grace. And she said unto her, Go, my daughter.
> 3 And she went, and came, and gleaned in the field after the reapers: and her hap was to light on a part of the field belonging unto Boaz, who was of the kindred of Elimelech.

Talk about the story Ruth gathered grain left in the field so she and Naomi could eat. She was willing to work at an ordinary, tiring job.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Ruth gather? *Answer: Leftover grain.*

2. Where did she work? *Answer: In a field.*

3. Whom was she helping feed? *Answer: Naomi and herself.*

In your day Helping put groceries away feeds nobody by itself, but it helps the whole household. Choose one small part of preparing or clearing a meal.

Pray together God, help me do useful work for my family. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 94 | Saturday, January 2, 2027 | Boaz Shows Kindness

Read aloud Ruth 2:8-12

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Ruth 2:8-12

> 8 Then said Boaz unto Ruth, Hearest thou not, my daughter? Go not to glean in another field, neither go from hence, but abide here fast by my maidens:
> 9 Let thine eyes be on the field that they do reap, and go thou after them: have I not charged the young men that they shall not touch thee? and when thou art athirst, go unto the vessels, and drink of that which the young men have drawn.
> 10 Then she fell on her face, and bowed herself to the ground, and said unto him, Why have I found grace in thine eyes, that thou shouldest take knowledge of me, seeing I am a stranger?
> 11 And Boaz answered and said unto her, It hath fully been shewed me, all that thou hast done unto thy mother in law since the death of thine husband: and how thou hast left thy father and thy mother, and the land of thy nativity, and art come unto a people which thou knewest not heretofore.
> 12 The LORD recompense thy work, and a full reward be given thee of the LORD God of Israel, under whose wings thou art come to trust.

Talk about the story Boaz welcomed Ruth and made sure she could work safely. He knew she had cared for Naomi. His kindness helped a newcomer.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who showed Ruth kindness? *Answer: Boaz.*

2. Was Ruth welcome in his field? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Whom had Ruth been caring for? *Answer: Naomi.*

In your day A new child may not know where to sit or play. Invite them beside you and show them what to do.

Pray together God, help me welcome someone who is new. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 95 | Sunday, January 3, 2027 | A Family Redeemed

Read aloud Ruth 4:13-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Ruth 4:13-17

> 13 So Boaz took Ruth, and she was his wife: and when he went in unto her, the LORD gave her conception, and she bare a son.
> 14 And the women said unto Naomi, Blessed be the LORD, which hath not left thee this day without a kinsman, that his name may be famous in Israel.
> 15 And he shall be unto thee a restorer of thy life, and a nourisher of thine old age: for thy daughter in law, which loveth thee, which is better to thee than seven sons, hath born him.
> 16 And Naomi took the child, and laid it in her bosom, and became nurse unto it.
> 17 And the women her neighbours gave it a name, saying, There is a son born to Naomi; and they called his name Obed: he is the father of Jesse, the father of David.

Talk about the story Boaz married Ruth, and they had a son. Naomi held the baby, and her neighbors shared her joy. God had brought care into a hurting family.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who married Ruth? *Answer: Boaz.*

2. Did they have a son? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Who held the baby and helped care for him? *Answer: Naomi.*

In your day Ask an adult about a happy moment after a hard time. Both sadness and happiness can be part of a family's story.

Pray together God, thank You for happy moments with people we love. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 96 | Monday, January 4, 2027 | Hannah Prays

Read aloud 1 Samuel 1:9-11

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 1:9-11

> 9 So Hannah rose up after they had eaten in Shiloh, and after they had drunk. Now Eli the priest sat upon a seat by a post of the temple of the LORD.
> 10 And she was in bitterness of soul, and prayed unto the LORD, and wept sore.
> 11 And she vowed a vow, and said, O LORD of hosts, if thou wilt indeed look on the affliction of thine handmaid, and remember me, and not forget thine handmaid, but wilt give unto thine handmaid a man child, then I will give him unto the LORD all the days of his life, and there shall no razor come upon his head.

Talk about the story Hannah was very sad because she had no child. She cried and prayed to the LORD for a son. She brought her hurt to God.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was praying? *Answer: Hannah.*

2. Was she happy or deeply sad? *Answer: Sad.*

3. What did she ask God for? *Answer: A son.*

In your day You can pray when tears make talking difficult. Tell God one sad thing in a few words; a caring adult can pray with you.

Pray together God, thank You for listening when I cry. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 97 | Tuesday, January 5, 2027 | Samuel Is Given to the LORD

Read aloud 1 Samuel 1:24-28

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 1:24-28

> 24 And when she had weaned him, she took him up with her, with three bullocks, and one ephah of flour, and a bottle of wine, and brought him unto the house of the LORD in Shiloh: and the child was young.
> 25 And they slew a bullock, and brought the child to Eli.
> 26 And she said, Oh my lord, as thy soul liveth, my lord, I am the woman that stood by thee here, praying unto the LORD.
> 27 For this child I prayed; and the LORD hath given me my petition which I asked of him:
> 28 Therefore also I have lent him to the LORD; as long as he liveth he shall be lent to the LORD. And he worshipped the LORD there.

Talk about the story Hannah kept her promise to God. She brought Samuel to serve at the LORD's house. She remembered that God had answered her prayer.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What was Hannah's son's name? *Answer: Samuel.*

2. Who had answered her prayer? *Answer: The LORD.*

3. Did Hannah keep her promise? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day If you promise to help put a game away, do it when the game ends. Ask an adult before making a promise you may not understand.

Pray together God, help me keep the promises I make. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 98 | Wednesday, January 6, 2027 | Speak, LORD; I Am Listening

Read aloud 1 Samuel 3:1-10

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 3:1-10

> 1 And the child Samuel ministered unto the LORD before Eli. And the word of the LORD was precious in those days; there was no open vision.
> 2 And it came to pass at that time, when Eli was laid down in his place, and his eyes began to wax dim, that he could not see;
> 3 And ere the lamp of God went out in the temple of the LORD, where the ark of God was, and Samuel was laid down to sleep;
> 4 That the LORD called Samuel: and he answered, Here am I.
> 5 And he ran unto Eli, and said, Here am I; for thou calledst me. And he said, I called not; lie down again. And he went and lay down.
> 6 And the LORD called yet again, Samuel. And Samuel arose and went to Eli, and said, Here am I; for thou didst call me. And he answered, I called not, my son; lie down again.
> 7 Now Samuel did not yet know the LORD, neither was the word of the LORD yet revealed unto him.
> 8 And the LORD called Samuel again the third time. And he arose and went to Eli, and said, Here am I; for thou didst call me. And Eli perceived that the LORD had called the child.
> 9 Therefore Eli said unto Samuel, Go, lie down: and it shall be, if he call thee, that thou shalt say, Speak, LORD; for thy servant heareth. So Samuel went and lay down in his place.
> 10 And the LORD came, and stood, and called as at other times, Samuel, Samuel. Then Samuel answered, Speak; for thy servant heareth.

Talk about the story Samuel heard his name at night and thought Eli was calling. Eli helped him understand that the LORD was speaking. Samuel answered, ready to listen.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who thought Eli was calling him? *Answer: Samuel.*

2. Who was really calling? *Answer: The LORD.*

3. Who helped Samuel understand? *Answer: Eli.*

In your day Put a toy down while someone gives you directions. Repeat what you heard. We listen to God's words today when we read the Bible.

Pray together God, help me listen when we read Your Word. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 119:105 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 08 | Days 99-112

Saul, David, and Goliath + David Chooses Friendship and Mercy

Thursday, January 7, 2027 through Wednesday, January 20, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Psalm 118:6

> 6 The LORD is on my side; I will not fear: what can man do unto me?

Meaning in context Because the LORD is with His people, human threats do not have the final word.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 15 | Saul, David, and Goliath | Jan 7 - Jan 13, 2027

Bible story 1 Samuel 8-17

Week overview Israel asked for a king. Saul began well but disobeyed, so God chose David, a shepherd boy who trusted the LORD against Goliath.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6

Day 99 | Thursday, January 7, 2027 | Israel Asks for a King

Read aloud 1 Samuel 8:4-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 8:4-7

> 4 Then all the elders of Israel gathered themselves together, and came to Samuel unto Ramah,
> 5 And said unto him, Behold, thou art old, and thy sons walk not in thy ways: now make us a king to judge us like all the nations.
> 6 But the thing displeased Samuel, when they said, Give us a king to judge us. And Samuel prayed unto the LORD.
> 7 And the LORD said unto Samuel, Hearken unto the voice of the people in all that they say unto thee: for they have not rejected thee, but they have rejected me, that I should not reign over them.

Talk about the story Israel wanted a king like other nations. Their request rejected God's rule over them. Wanting what everyone else has can lead us away from what is right.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Israel's leaders ask for? *Answer: A king.*

2. Whom did they want to be like? *Answer: Other nations.*

3. Whose rule were they rejecting? *Answer: God's.*

In your day Have you said, "But everyone else gets to"? Tell about it. Being popular does not make a choice good or necessary.

Pray together God, help me choose well instead of copying everyone. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 100 | Friday, January 8, 2027 | Saul Is Chosen

Read aloud 1 Samuel 9:15-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 9:15-17

> 15 Now the LORD had told Samuel in his ear a day before Saul came, saying,
> 16 To morrow about this time I will send thee a man out of the land of Benjamin, and thou shalt anoint him to be captain over my people Israel, that he may save my people out of the hand of the Philistines: for I have looked upon my people, because their cry is come unto me.
> 17 And when Samuel saw Saul, the LORD said unto him, Behold the man whom I spake to thee of! this same shall reign over my people.

Talk about the story God told Samuel that Saul would come. Saul was to lead Israel and help deliver the people. Samuel needed to follow God's direction.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who received God's message? *Answer: Samuel.*

2. Who would come to him? *Answer: Saul.*

3. What job would Saul have? *Answer: Leading Israel.*

In your day A helper needs to listen before doing a job. Ask an adult for one clear task, repeat the instructions, and then begin.

Pray together God, help me listen before I begin a job. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 101 | Saturday, January 9, 2027 | Samuel Anoints Saul

Read aloud 1 Samuel 10:1

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 10:1

> 1 Then Samuel took a vial of oil, and poured it upon his head, and kissed him, and said, Is it not because the LORD hath anointed thee to be captain over his inheritance?

Talk about the story Samuel poured oil on Saul's head as a sign that God had chosen him to lead. Becoming king gave Saul responsibility to care for Israel.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who poured the oil? *Answer: Samuel.*

2. On whose head? *Answer: Saul's.*

3. Who had chosen Saul to lead? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day If you lead a game, make room for everyone. A leader's job includes helping others, not always taking the first turn.

Pray together God, help me care for others when I lead. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 102 | Sunday, January 10, 2027 | Saul Does Not Obey

Read aloud 1 Samuel 13:13-14

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 13:13-14

> 13 And Samuel said to Saul, Thou hast done foolishly: thou hast not kept the commandment of the LORD thy God, which he commanded thee: for now would the LORD have established thy kingdom upon Israel for ever.
> 14 But now thy kingdom shall not continue: the LORD hath sought him a man after his own heart, and the LORD hath commanded him to be captain over his people, because thou hast not kept that which the LORD commanded thee.

Talk about the story Saul did not keep God's command. Samuel told him his family's kingdom would not continue. Being king did not excuse disobedience.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Had Saul kept God's command? *Answer: No.*

2. Who told him he had done foolishly? *Answer: Samuel.*

3. Would his family's kingdom continue? *Answer: No.*

In your day Breaking a game rule can spoil the game even if you are the leader. If you break a rule, admit it and accept a fair correction.

Pray together God, help me accept correction when I do wrong. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 103 | Monday, January 11, 2027 | God Looks on the Heart

Read aloud 1 Samuel 16:6-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 16:6-7

> 6 And it came to pass, when they were come, that he looked on Eliab, and said, Surely the LORD'S anointed is before him.
> 7 But the LORD said unto Samuel, Look not on his countenance, or on the height of his stature; because I have refused him: for the LORD seeth not as man seeth; for man looketh on the outward appearance, but the LORD looketh on the heart.

Talk about the story Samuel noticed Eliab's appearance. God told him that people look at the outside, but the LORD sees the heart. Looking impressive is not the same as being good.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whose appearance impressed Samuel? *Answer: Eliab's.*

2. What do people often look at? *Answer: The outside.*

3. What does the LORD look at? *Answer: The heart.*

In your day Do nice shoes tell you whether someone is kind? Think of a kind action that matters more than clothes, size, or being good at sports.

Pray together God, help me care about kindness more than appearances. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 104 | Tuesday, January 12, 2027 | David Is Anointed

Read aloud 1 Samuel 16:10-13

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 16:10-13

> 10 Again, Jesse made seven of his sons to pass before Samuel. And Samuel said unto Jesse, The LORD hath not chosen these.
> 11 And Samuel said unto Jesse, Are here all thy children? And he said, There remaineth yet the youngest, and, behold, he keepeth the sheep. And Samuel said unto Jesse, Send and fetch him: for we will not sit down till he come hither.
> 12 And he sent, and brought him in. Now he was ruddy, and withal of a beautiful countenance, and goodly to look to. And the LORD said, Arise, anoint him: for this is he.
> 13 Then Samuel took the horn of oil, and anointed him in the midst of his brethren: and the Spirit of the LORD came upon David from that day forward. So Samuel rose up, and went to Ramah.

Talk about the story David was the youngest son and was looking after sheep. God chose him, and Samuel anointed him. Being youngest did not make him invisible to God.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where was David before he was called? *Answer: With the sheep.*

2. Was he the oldest or youngest son? *Answer: Youngest.*

3. Who told Samuel to anoint him? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day If older children leave you out, tell a caring adult. Being smaller does not mean you have nothing to offer. Name something helpful you can do.

Pray together God, thank You that You see the youngest too. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 105 | Wednesday, January 13, 2027 | David Faces Goliath

Read aloud 1 Samuel 17:45-47

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 17:45-47

> 45 Then said David to the Philistine, Thou comest to me with a sword, and with a spear, and with a shield: but I come to thee in the name of the LORD of hosts, the God of the armies of Israel, whom thou hast defied.
> 46 This day will the LORD deliver thee into mine hand; and I will smite thee, and take thine head from thee; and I will give the carcases of the host of the Philistines this day unto the fowls of the air, and to the wild beasts of the earth; that all the earth may know that there is a God in Israel.
> 47 And all this assembly shall know that the LORD saveth not with sword and spear: for the battle is the LORD'S, and he will give you into our hands.

Talk about the story David told Goliath that he came in the LORD's name. The battle belonged to God. David's hope was in the LORD, not impressive weapons.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was David speaking to? *Answer: Goliath.*

2. In whose name did David come? *Answer: The LORD's.*

3. Who did David say would give the victory? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day A bigger child's mean words can feel frightening. You do not need to fight them. Tell a safe adult and ask God for courage to do right.

Pray together God, help me trust You when I feel afraid. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 16 | David Chooses Friendship and Mercy | Jan 14 - Jan 20, 2027

Bible story 1 Samuel 18-26

Week overview Jonathan loved David faithfully. Saul became jealous and hunted David, but David trusted God and refused to take revenge.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6

Day 106 | Thursday, January 14, 2027 | Jonathan Loves David

Read aloud 1 Samuel 18:1-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 18:1-4

> 1 And it came to pass, when he had made an end of speaking unto Saul, that the soul of Jonathan was knit with the soul of David, and Jonathan loved him as his own soul.
> 2 And Saul took him that day, and would let him go no more home to his father's house.
> 3 Then Jonathan and David made a covenant, because he loved him as his own soul.
> 4 And Jonathan stripped himself of the robe that was upon him, and gave it to David, and his garments, even to his sword, and to his bow, and to his girdle.

Talk about the story Jonathan loved David as himself and gave him valuable gifts. Their friendship included generosity. Jonathan was willing to share things that mattered to him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was David's friend? *Answer: Jonathan.*

2. How did Jonathan love David? *Answer: As himself.*

3. Did he give David gifts or take things from him? *Answer: Give gifts.*

In your day Ask permission to share something you value with a friend. A good friend can also share time, listen, or help without buying a gift.

Pray together God, help me be a generous friend. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 107 | Friday, January 15, 2027 | Saul Is Jealous

Read aloud 1 Samuel 18:12-16

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 18:12-16

> 12 And Saul was afraid of David, because the LORD was with him, and was departed from Saul.
> 13 Therefore Saul removed him from him, and made him his captain over a thousand; and he went out and came in before the people.
> 14 And David behaved himself wisely in all his ways; and the LORD was with him.
> 15 Wherefore when Saul saw that he behaved himself very wisely, he was afraid of him.
> 16 But all Israel and Judah loved David, because he went out and came in before them.

Talk about the story Saul was afraid of David, but David kept behaving wisely. The LORD was with David. Saul's anger did not have to decide David's actions.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was afraid of David? *Answer: Saul.*

2. How did David behave? *Answer: Wisely.*

3. Who was with David? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day If someone is grumpy with you, you may want to be grumpy back. Try a calm answer and get help if they keep being unkind.

Pray together God, help me make good choices when others are upset. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 108 | Saturday, January 16, 2027 | Jonathan Speaks Up

Read aloud 1 Samuel 19:1-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 19:1-7

> 1 And Saul spake to Jonathan his son, and to all his servants, that they should kill David.
> 2 But Jonathan Saul's son delighted much in David: and Jonathan told David, saying, Saul my father seeketh to kill thee: now therefore, I pray thee, take heed to thyself until the morning, and abide in a secret place, and hide thyself:
> 3 And I will go out and stand beside my father in the field where thou art, and I will commune with my father of thee; and what I see, that I will tell thee.
> 4 And Jonathan spake good of David unto Saul his father, and said unto him, Let not the king sin against his servant, against David; because he hath not sinned against thee, and because his works have been to thee-ward very good:
> 5 For he did put his life in his hand, and slew the Philistine, and the LORD wrought a great salvation for all Israel: thou sawest it, and didst rejoice: wherefore then wilt thou sin against innocent blood, to slay David without a cause?
> 6 And Saul hearkened unto the voice of Jonathan: and Saul sware, As the LORD liveth, he shall not be slain.
> 7 And Jonathan called David, and Jonathan shewed him all those things. And Jonathan brought David to Saul, and he was in his presence, as in times past.

Talk about the story Jonathan warned David about danger and spoke to Saul on his behalf. He reminded Saul that David had done good. Friendship sometimes means speaking up.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did Jonathan warn? *Answer: David.*

2. To whom did he speak for David? *Answer: Saul.*

3. Did Saul promise not to kill David? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day If a child is blamed for something they did not do, tell the truth kindly. Practice, "I saw what happened. It wasn't them."

Pray together God, give me courage to speak truthfully for a friend. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 109 | Sunday, January 17, 2027 | A Promise Between Friends

Read aloud 1 Samuel 20:41-42

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 20:41-42

> 41 And as soon as the lad was gone, David arose out of a place toward the south, and fell on his face to the ground, and bowed himself three times: and they kissed one another, and wept one with another, until David exceeded.
> 42 And Jonathan said to David, Go in peace, forasmuch as we have sworn both of us in the name of the LORD, saying, The LORD be between me and thee, and between my seed and thy seed for ever. And he arose and departed: and Jonathan went into the city.

Talk about the story David and Jonathan cried as they said goodbye. They remembered their promise before the LORD. Friends can love each other even when they must be apart.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Which friends said goodbye? *Answer: David and Jonathan.*

2. Were they crying or laughing? *Answer: Crying.*

3. Before whom had they made their promise? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day Think of someone you do not see often. With an adult's help, send a note or picture to say you remember them.

Pray together God, care for our friends when we are apart. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 110 | Monday, January 18, 2027 | David Will Not Take Revenge

Read aloud 1 Samuel 24:3-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 24:3-7

> 3 And he came to the sheepcotes by the way, where was a cave; and Saul went in to cover his feet: and David and his men remained in the sides of the cave.
> 4 And the men of David said unto him, Behold the day of which the LORD said unto thee, Behold, I will deliver thine enemy into thine hand, that thou mayest do to him as it shall seem good unto thee. Then David arose, and cut off the skirt of Saul's robe privily.
> 5 And it came to pass afterward, that David's heart smote him, because he had cut off Saul's skirt.
> 6 And he said unto his men, The LORD forbid that I should do this thing unto my master, the LORD'S anointed, to stretch forth mine hand against him, seeing he is the anointed of the LORD.
> 7 So David stayed his servants with these words, and suffered them not to rise against Saul. But Saul rose up out of the cave, and went on his way.

Talk about the story David could have hurt Saul in the cave. He stopped himself and his men because Saul was the LORD's chosen king. He refused revenge.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where was Saul? *Answer: In a cave.*

2. Did David let his men attack Saul? *Answer: No.*

3. Why did David refuse? *Answer: Saul was the LORD's anointed king*.

In your day If someone pushes in front of you, pushing back can start a fight. Tell them calmly and ask an adult for help when needed.

Pray together God, help me refuse to get even. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 111 | Tuesday, January 19, 2027 | Saul Admits David's Kindness

Read aloud 1 Samuel 24:16-20

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 24:16-20

> 16 And it came to pass, when David had made an end of speaking these words unto Saul, that Saul said, Is this thy voice, my son David? And Saul lifted up his voice, and wept.
> 17 And he said to David, Thou art more righteous than I: for thou hast rewarded me good, whereas I have rewarded thee evil.
> 18 And thou hast shewed this day how that thou hast dealt well with me: forasmuch as when the LORD had delivered me into thine hand, thou killedst me not.
> 19 For if a man find his enemy, will he let him go well away? wherefore the LORD reward thee good for that thou hast done unto me this day.
> 20 And now, behold, I know well that thou shalt surely be king, and that the kingdom of Israel shall be established in thine hand.

Talk about the story Saul admitted that David had answered his evil with good. David had spared him. Kindness made the wrongness of Saul's actions clear.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who admitted David had treated him well? *Answer: Saul.*

2. Had David killed Saul? *Answer: No.*

3. Had David repaid evil with evil or good? *Answer: Good.*

In your day When someone has been unkind, you can still pass them their dropped pencil. Doing good does not mean hiding the hurt from an adult.

Pray together God, help me choose kindness without joining in wrongdoing. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 112 | Wednesday, January 20, 2027 | David Spares Saul Again

Read aloud 1 Samuel 26:21-25

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Samuel 26:21-25

> 21 Then said Saul, I have sinned: return, my son David: for I will no more do thee harm, because my soul was precious in thine eyes this day: behold, I have played the fool, and have erred exceedingly.
> 22 And David answered and said, Behold the king's spear! and let one of the young men come over and fetch it.
> 23 The LORD render to every man his righteousness and his faithfulness: for the LORD delivered thee into my hand to day, but I would not stretch forth mine hand against the LORD'S anointed.
> 24 And, behold, as thy life was much set by this day in mine eyes, so let my life be much set by in the eyes of the LORD, and let him deliver me out of all tribulation.
> 25 Then Saul said to David, Blessed be thou, my son David: thou shalt both do great things, and also shalt still prevail. So David went on his way, and Saul returned to his place.

Talk about the story Saul again admitted that he had sinned. David had spared his life again. Saying sorry matters, but our choices must change too.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who admitted his sin? *Answer: Saul.*

2. Had David spared his life again? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Did David kill Saul? *Answer: No.*

In your day If you say sorry for grabbing and then grab again, what needs to change? Practice asking for a turn instead of taking one.

Pray together God, help my actions match my apology. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 118:6 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 09 | Days 113-126

David the King + Solomon Asks for Wisdom

Thursday, January 21, 2027 through Wednesday, February 3, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Psalm 51:10

> 10 Create in me a clean heart, O God; and renew a right spirit within me.

Meaning in context We need God to cleanse our hearts and renew right desires within us.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 17 | David the King | Jan 21 - Jan 27, 2027

Bible story 2 Samuel 5-22; Psalm 51

Week overview David became king, brought the ark to Jerusalem, received God's covenant promise, showed kindness, confessed sin, and praised the LORD his rock.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10

Day 113 | Thursday, January 21, 2027 | David Becomes King

Read aloud 2 Samuel 5:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Samuel 5:1-5

> 1 Then came all the tribes of Israel to David unto Hebron, and spake, saying, Behold, we are thy bone and thy flesh.
> 2 Also in time past, when Saul was king over us, thou wast he that leddest out and broughtest in Israel: and the LORD said to thee, Thou shalt feed my people Israel, and thou shalt be a captain over Israel.
> 3 So all the elders of Israel came to the king to Hebron; and king David made a league with them in Hebron before the LORD: and they anointed David king over Israel.
> 4 David was thirty years old when he began to reign, and he reigned forty years.
> 5 In Hebron he reigned over Judah seven years and six months: and in Jerusalem he reigned thirty and three years over all Israel and Judah.

Talk about the story Israel's leaders came to David and made him king. They remembered God's promise that he would lead His people like a shepherd.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who gathered to David? *Answer: Israel's leaders.*

2. What did they make him? *Answer: King over Israel.*

3. Whose people was he to care for? *Answer: God's people.*

In your day A shepherd looks after sheep. How could a class helper look after others? Name a way to help someone who is being overlooked.

Pray together God, help leaders care for the people they lead. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 114 | Friday, January 22, 2027 | Joy before the LORD

Read aloud 2 Samuel 6:12-15

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Samuel 6:12-15

> 12 And it was told king David, saying, The LORD hath blessed the house of Obededom, and all that pertaineth unto him, because of the ark of God. So David went and brought up the ark of God from the house of Obededom into the city of David with gladness.
> 13 And it was so, that when they that bare the ark of the LORD had gone six paces, he sacrificed oxen and fatlings.
> 14 And David danced before the LORD with all his might; and David was girded with a linen ephod.
> 15 So David and all the house of Israel brought up the ark of the LORD with shouting, and with the sound of the trumpet.

Talk about the story David and the people brought the ark toward Jerusalem with joyful music and shouting. David was glad to honor the LORD.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What were they bringing? *Answer: The ark of God.*

2. Were they quiet with sadness or celebrating? *Answer: Celebrating.*

3. Whom was David honoring? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day When your family sings at church, listen to the words. Pick one line you understand and sing it as something you really mean.

Pray together God, help me praise You with a glad heart. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 115 | Saturday, January 23, 2027 | God's Promise to David

Read aloud 2 Samuel 7:8-13

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Samuel 7:8-13

> 8 Now therefore so shalt thou say unto my servant David, Thus saith the LORD of hosts, I took thee from the sheepcote, from following the sheep, to be ruler over my people, over Israel:
> 9 And I was with thee whithersoever thou wentest, and have cut off all thine enemies out of thy sight, and have made thee a great name, like unto the name of the great men that are in the earth.
> 10 Moreover I will appoint a place for my people Israel, and will plant them, that they may dwell in a place of their own, and move no more; neither shall the children of wickedness afflict them any more, as beforetime,
> 11 And as since the time that I commanded judges to be over my people Israel, and have caused thee to rest from all thine enemies. Also the LORD telleth thee that he will make thee an house.
> 12 And when thy days be fulfilled, and thou shalt sleep with thy fathers, I will set up thy seed after thee, which shall proceed out of thy bowels, and I will establish his kingdom.
> 13 He shall build an house for my name, and I will stablish the throne of his kingdom for ever.

Talk about the story God reminded David that He had brought him from tending sheep to leading Israel. He promised a lasting kingdom through David's family, fulfilled in Jesus the King.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What had David cared for before becoming king? *Answer: Sheep.*

2. Who had been with him? *Answer: God.*

3. Would God's promise to David's family be lasting? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Look at a picture of yourself when you were smaller. Who cared for you then? Remember past help when you wonder about the future.

Pray together God, thank You for Your promise of Jesus the King. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 116 | Sunday, January 24, 2027 | Kindness to Mephibosheth

Read aloud 2 Samuel 9:1-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Samuel 9:1-7

> 1 And David said, Is there yet any that is left of the house of Saul, that I may shew him kindness for Jonathan's sake?
> 2 And there was of the house of Saul a servant whose name was Ziba. And when they had called him unto David, the king said unto him, Art thou Ziba? And he said, Thy servant is he.
> 3 And the king said, Is there not yet any of the house of Saul, that I may shew the kindness of God unto him? And Ziba said unto the king, Jonathan hath yet a son, which is lame on his feet.
> 4 And the king said unto him, Where is he? And Ziba said unto the king, Behold, he is in the house of Machir, the son of Ammiel, in Lodebar.
> 5 Then king David sent, and fetched him out of the house of Machir, the son of Ammiel, from Lodebar.
> 6 Now when Mephibosheth, the son of Jonathan, the son of Saul, was come unto David, he fell on his face, and did reverence. And David said, Mephibosheth. And he answered, Behold thy servant!
> 7 And David said unto him, Fear not: for I will surely shew thee kindness for Jonathan thy father's sake, and will restore thee all the land of Saul thy father; and thou shalt eat bread at my table continually.

Talk about the story David remembered his promise to Jonathan. He welcomed Jonathan's son Mephibosheth, who could not walk well, to eat at the king's table.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whose son was Mephibosheth? *Answer: Jonathan's.*

2. Who showed him kindness? *Answer: David.*

3. Where would he eat? *Answer: At the king's table.*

In your day If a child moves more slowly or uses a wheelchair, make room beside you. Ask how you can help instead of assuming they cannot join in.

Pray together God, help me make room for others. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 117 | Monday, January 25, 2027 | David Confesses

Read aloud 2 Samuel 12:13

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Samuel 12:13

> 13 And David said unto Nathan, I have sinned against the LORD. And Nathan said unto David, The LORD also hath put away thy sin; thou shalt not die.

Talk about the story David told Nathan, "I have sinned against the LORD." He did not pretend his wrong choices were someone else's fault. Nathan told him the LORD had forgiven him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who admitted his sin? *Answer: David.*

2. Against whom had he sinned? *Answer: The LORD.*

3. Who brought him God's answer? *Answer: Nathan.*

In your day Practice a plain apology about a real wrong: "I did it. It was wrong." Leave out "but they started it." Ask how to put things right.

Pray together God, help me admit my sin and ask Your forgiveness. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 118 | Tuesday, January 26, 2027 | Create in Me a Clean Heart

Read aloud Psalm 51:10-12

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Psalm 51:10-12

> 10 Create in me a clean heart, O God; and renew a right spirit within me.
> 11 Cast me not away from thy presence; and take not thy holy spirit from me.
> 12 Restore unto me the joy of thy salvation; and uphold me with thy free spirit.

Talk about the story David asked God for a clean heart and a right spirit. He wanted more than feeling better; he needed God's help to change inside.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What kind of heart did David ask for? *Answer: A clean heart.*

2. Whom did he ask? *Answer: God.*

3. What did he want restored? *Answer: The joy of God's salvation.*

In your day Washing your hands removes dirt, but cannot remove a lie or mean intention. Tell God one wrong attitude you need help with.

Pray together God, help me want what is right inside. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 119 | Wednesday, January 27, 2027 | The LORD Is My Rock

Read aloud 2 Samuel 22:1-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Samuel 22:1-4

> 1 And David spake unto the LORD the words of this song in the day that the LORD had delivered him out of the hand of all his enemies, and out of the hand of Saul:
> 2 And he said, The LORD is my rock, and my fortress, and my deliverer;
> 3 The God of my rock; in him will I trust: he is my shield, and the horn of my salvation, my high tower, and my refuge, my saviour; thou savest me from violence.
> 4 I will call on the LORD, who is worthy to be praised: so shall I be saved from mine enemies.

Talk about the story David called the LORD his rock, fortress, and shield. Those pictures describe strength and protection. David remembered the God who had rescued him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was David praising? *Answer: The LORD.*

2. Name one picture David used. *Answer: Rock, fortress, shield, or deliverer.*

3. Who had rescued David? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day Think about sheltering indoors during a storm. What makes you feel safe? David used pictures of safety to thank God for His care.

Pray together God, thank You for the care David sang about. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 18 | Solomon Asks for Wisdom | Jan 28 - Feb 3, 2027

Bible story 1 Kings 2-10

Week overview David charged Solomon to walk in God's ways. Solomon asked for wisdom, built the temple, prayed at its dedication, and became famous for God-given understanding.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10

Day 120 | Thursday, January 28, 2027 | David's Last Charge

Read aloud 1 Kings 2:1-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 2:1-4

> 1 Now the days of David drew nigh that he should die; and he charged Solomon his son, saying,
> 2 I go the way of all the earth: be thou strong therefore, and shew thyself a man;
> 3 And keep the charge of the LORD thy God, to walk in his ways, to keep his statutes, and his commandments, and his judgments, and his testimonies, as it is written in the law of Moses, that thou mayest prosper in all that thou doest, and whithersoever thou turnest thyself:
> 4 That the LORD may continue his word which he spake concerning me, saying, If thy children take heed to their way, to walk before me in truth with all their heart and with all their soul, there shall not fail thee (said he) a man on the throne of Israel.

Talk about the story Near the end of his life, David told Solomon to follow the LORD and keep His commands. A king needed God's direction too.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. To whom did David speak? *Answer: Solomon.*

2. Whose ways should Solomon follow? *Answer: The LORD's.*

3. What should he keep? *Answer: God's commands.*

In your day Ask an older family member for one wise lesson they learned. Listen without interrupting, then compare that advice with what the Bible teaches.

Pray together God, help me listen to wise advice and Your Word. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 121 | Friday, January 29, 2027 | Ask for an Understanding Heart

Read aloud 1 Kings 3:5-9

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 3:5-9

> 5 In Gibeon the LORD appeared to Solomon in a dream by night: and God said, Ask what I shall give thee.
> 6 And Solomon said, Thou hast shewed unto thy servant David my father great mercy, according as he walked before thee in truth, and in righteousness, and in uprightness of heart with thee; and thou hast kept for him this great kindness, that thou hast given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is this day.
> 7 And now, O LORD my God, thou hast made thy servant king instead of David my father: and I am but a little child: I know not how to go out or come in.
> 8 And thy servant is in the midst of thy people which thou hast chosen, a great people, that cannot be numbered nor counted for multitude.
> 9 Give therefore thy servant an understanding heart to judge thy people, that I may discern between good and bad: for who is able to judge this thy so great a people?

Talk about the story God invited Solomon to ask for something. Solomon asked for an understanding heart to lead fairly. He knew he needed help judging right and wrong.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who invited Solomon to ask? *Answer: God.*

2. What did Solomon ask for? *Answer: An understanding heart.*

3. Whom did he need to lead? *Answer: God's people, Israel.*

In your day If two friends both say the same toy is theirs, guessing is not enough. Ask an adult to hear both sides. Wisdom includes listening before deciding.

Pray together God, help me listen and understand before deciding. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 122 | Saturday, January 30, 2027 | God Is Pleased with the Request

Read aloud 1 Kings 3:10-14

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 3:10-14

> 10 And the speech pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing.
> 11 And God said unto him, Because thou hast asked this thing, and hast not asked for thyself long life; neither hast asked riches for thyself, nor hast asked the life of thine enemies; but hast asked for thyself understanding to discern judgment;
> 12 Behold, I have done according to thy words: lo, I have given thee a wise and an understanding heart; so that there was none like thee before thee, neither after thee shall any arise like unto thee.
> 13 And I have also given thee that which thou hast not asked, both riches, and honour: so that there shall not be any among the kings like unto thee all thy days.
> 14 And if thou wilt walk in my ways, to keep my statutes and my commandments, as thy father David did walk, then I will lengthen thy days.

Talk about the story God was pleased that Solomon asked for wisdom. He had not asked simply for riches or long life. God gave him understanding to serve others.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Was God pleased with Solomon's request? *Answer: Yes.*

2. Had Solomon asked for riches? *Answer: No.*

3. What did God give him? *Answer: Wisdom and understanding.*

In your day If you could ask for help with one thing, would you remember being kind or fair? Pray about a choice where you need wisdom.

Pray together God, help me want wisdom, not just more things. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 123 | Sunday, January 31, 2027 | Israel Sees God's Wisdom

Read aloud 1 Kings 3:27-28

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 3:27-28

> 27 Then the king answered and said, Give her the living child, and in no wise slay it: she is the mother thereof.
> 28 And all Israel heard of the judgment which the king had judged; and they feared the king: for they saw that the wisdom of God was in him, to do judgment.

Talk about the story Solomon's decision kept a baby alive and returned him to his mother. Israel recognized God's wisdom in their king. Wise judgment protected someone helpless.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Was the baby to be killed? *Answer: No.*

2. To whom should the baby be given? *Answer: His mother.*

3. Whose wisdom did Israel recognize in Solomon? *Answer: God's.*

In your day Babies cannot explain what they need. Ask an adult how to notice when a baby needs quiet, comfort, or help. Be gentle with smaller children.

Pray together God, help us protect those who cannot protect themselves. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 124 | Monday, February 1, 2027 | A House for God's Name

Read aloud 1 Kings 5:3-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 5:3-5

> 3 Thou knowest how that David my father could not build an house unto the name of the LORD his God for the wars which were about him on every side, until the LORD put them under the soles of his feet.
> 4 But now the LORD my God hath given me rest on every side, so that there is neither adversary nor evil occurrent.
> 5 And, behold, I purpose to build an house unto the name of the LORD my God, as the LORD spake unto David my father, saying, Thy son, whom I will set upon thy throne in thy room, he shall build an house unto my name.

Talk about the story Solomon planned to build a temple for the LORD, as God had promised. Peace gave him the opportunity to begin this important work.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who planned to build the temple? *Answer: Solomon.*

2. Whose name would it honor? *Answer: The LORD's.*

3. Who had wanted to build it before Solomon? *Answer: David.*

In your day Think of a job too big for one person, like cleaning the whole house. Ask which small part you can help with and do that part well.

Pray together God, help us work together to honor You. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 125 | Tuesday, February 2, 2027 | Solomon Prays at the Temple

Read aloud 1 Kings 8:22-30

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 8:22-30

> 22 And Solomon stood before the altar of the LORD in the presence of all the congregation of Israel, and spread forth his hands toward heaven:
> 23 And he said, LORD God of Israel, there is no God like thee, in heaven above, or on earth beneath, who keepest covenant and mercy with thy servants that walk before thee with all their heart:
> 24 Who hast kept with thy servant David my father that thou promisedst him: thou spakest also with thy mouth, and hast fulfilled it with thine hand, as it is this day.
> 25 Therefore now, LORD God of Israel, keep with thy servant David my father that thou promisedst him, saying, There shall not fail thee a man in my sight to sit on the throne of Israel; so that thy children take heed to their way, that they walk before me as thou hast walked before me.
> 26 And now, O God of Israel, let thy word, I pray thee, be verified, which thou spakest unto thy servant David my father.
> 27 But will God indeed dwell on the earth? behold, the heaven and heaven of heavens cannot contain thee; how much less this house that I have builded?
> 28 Yet have thou respect unto the prayer of thy servant, and to his supplication, O LORD my God, to hearken unto the cry and to the prayer, which thy servant prayeth before thee to day:
> 29 That thine eyes may be open toward this house night and day, even toward the place of which thou hast said, My name shall be there: that thou mayest hearken unto the prayer which thy servant shall make toward this place.
> 30 And hearken thou to the supplication of thy servant, and of thy people Israel, when they shall pray toward this place: and hear thou in heaven thy dwelling place: and when thou hearest, forgive.

Talk about the story Solomon prayed at the temple and praised God for keeping His promises. He knew even the heavens could not contain God. The building could not hold Him in.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who prayed at the temple? *Answer: Solomon.*

2. Could even heaven contain God? *Answer: No.*

3. What did Solomon ask God to hear? *Answer: His people's prayers.*

In your day You can pray at church, but God also hears you at the kitchen table. Choose an ordinary place and thank Him there today.

Pray together God, thank You that You hear us wherever we pray. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 126 | Wednesday, February 3, 2027 | The Queen Sees the Wisdom

Read aloud 1 Kings 10:6-9

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 10:6-9

> 6 And she said to the king, It was a true report that I heard in mine own land of thy acts and of thy wisdom.
> 7 Howbeit I believed not the words, until I came, and mine eyes had seen it: and, behold, the half was not told me: thy wisdom and prosperity exceedeth the fame which I heard.
> 8 Happy are thy men, happy are these thy servants, which stand continually before thee, and that hear thy wisdom.
> 9 Blessed be the LORD thy God, which delighted in thee, to set thee on the throne of Israel: because the LORD loved Israel for ever, therefore made he thee king, to do judgment and justice.

Talk about the story The queen of Sheba saw Solomon's wisdom for herself. She praised the LORD who had made him king. Good leadership showed care and justice.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who visited Solomon? *Answer: The queen of Sheba.*

2. What impressed her? *Answer: His wisdom.*

3. Whom did she praise? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day When someone patiently teaches you a skill, what do you notice about them? Thank that person. The good they do can remind you to thank God too.

Pray together God, thank You for people who teach and lead wisely. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 51:10 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 10 | Days 127-140

Songs and Wisdom for God's People + Elijah Shows That the LORD Is God

Thursday, February 4, 2027 through Wednesday, February 17, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 18:39

> 39 And when all the people saw it, they fell on their faces: and they said, The LORD, he is the God; the LORD, he is the God.

Meaning in context The LORD alone is the true God, and every heart should bow to Him.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 19 | Songs and Wisdom for God's People | Feb 4 - Feb 10, 2027

Bible story Psalms and Proverbs

Week overview The Psalms teach God's people to worship, trust, lament, and give thanks. Proverbs gives wise guidance for everyday words, choices, and relationships.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39

Day 127 | Thursday, February 4, 2027 | Like a Tree by Water

Read aloud Psalm 1:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Psalm 1:1-3

> 1 Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly, nor standeth in the way of sinners, nor sitteth in the seat of the scornful.
> 2 But his delight is in the law of the LORD; and in his law doth he meditate day and night.
> 3 And he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water, that bringeth forth his fruit in his season; his leaf also shall not wither; and whatsoever he doeth shall prosper.

Talk about the story A person who loves God's Word is compared to a tree beside water. Water helps the tree grow; God's teaching helps us know how to live.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What does the person delight in? *Answer: God's law.*

2. What is that person compared to? *Answer: A tree.*

3. Where is the tree planted? *Answer: Beside rivers of water.*

In your day Look at a plant and ask what it needs. Plan a small time to hear the Bible today, as regularly as a plant needs water.

Pray together God, help me enjoy learning Your Word. Amen.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 128 | Friday, February 5, 2027 | The LORD Is My Shepherd

Read aloud Psalm 23:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Psalm 23:1-3

> 1 The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want.
> 2 He maketh me to lie down in green pastures: he leadeth me beside the still waters.
> 3 He restoreth my soul: he leadeth me in the paths of righteousness for his name's sake.

Talk about the story David calls the LORD his shepherd. A shepherd leads sheep to grass, water, and safe paths. David trusts God's care and guidance.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who is David's shepherd? *Answer: The LORD.*

2. Where does He lead him for rest? *Answer: Green pastures.*

3. What kind of water is mentioned? *Answer: Still waters.*

In your day Think of someone who makes sure you eat and rest. Say thank you to them, and thank God for caring for His people.

Pray together God, thank You for caring like a good shepherd. Amen.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 129 | Saturday, February 6, 2027 | I Will Fear No Evil

Read aloud Psalm 23:4-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Psalm 23:4-6

> 4 Yea, though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil: for thou art with me; thy rod and thy staff they comfort me.
> 5 Thou preparest a table before me in the presence of mine enemies: thou anointest my head with oil; my cup runneth over.
> 6 Surely goodness and mercy shall follow me all the days of my life: and I will dwell in the house of the LORD for ever.

Talk about the story David says he need not be afraid even in a dark valley because the LORD is with him. Hard places do not mean God has disappeared.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where is David walking in the picture? *Answer: A dark valley, the valley of the shadow of death.*

2. Who is with him? *Answer: The LORD.*

3. Does the shepherd's care comfort him? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day If you feel scared at bedtime, tell an adult what worries you. Read "thou art with me" together and pray about the fear.

Pray together God, help me remember Your care in frightening moments. Amen.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 130 | Sunday, February 7, 2027 | Make a Joyful Noise

Read aloud Psalm 100:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Psalm 100:1-5

> 1 Make a joyful noise unto the LORD, all ye lands.
> 2 Serve the LORD with gladness: come before his presence with singing.
> 3 Know ye that the LORD he is God: it is he that hath made us, and not we ourselves; we are his people, and the sheep of his pasture.
> 4 Enter into his gates with thanksgiving, and into his courts with praise: be thankful unto him, and bless his name.
> 5 For the LORD is good; his mercy is everlasting; and his truth endureth to all generations.

Talk about the story Psalm 100 invites us to thank and praise the LORD. He made us, and His goodness lasts. We have real reasons to sing.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who made us? *Answer: The LORD.*

2. How should we serve Him? *Answer: With gladness.*

3. Does His mercy end quickly or last forever? *Answer: It lasts forever.*

In your day Name one good thing from today, even if the day was hard. Sing a short song or say thank you to God for it.

Pray together God, thank You for Your goodness and lasting mercy. Amen.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 131 | Monday, February 8, 2027 | Where Wisdom Begins

Read aloud Proverbs 1:7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Proverbs 1:7

> 7 The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge: but fools despise wisdom and instruction.

Talk about the story Wisdom begins with honoring the LORD. A foolish person refuses instruction. We begin learning when we admit that God knows more than we do.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where does knowledge begin? *Answer: With the fear of the LORD.*

2. Does fearing Him here include respect? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Who despises wisdom and instruction? *Answer: Fools.*

In your day When an adult shows you a safer way to use something, listen before saying "I know." What can you learn from the instruction?

Pray together God, help me respect You and be willing to learn. Amen.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 132 | Tuesday, February 9, 2027 | Trust with All Your Heart

Read aloud Proverbs 3:5-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Proverbs 3:5-6

> 5 Trust in the LORD with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding.
> 6 In all thy ways acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths.

Talk about the story We are told to trust the LORD with all our hearts. We do not know everything. He can direct us as we acknowledge Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom should we trust? *Answer: The LORD.*

2. With how much of our heart? *Answer: All of it.*

3. Who can direct our paths? *Answer: He can.*

In your day Before deciding what to do in an argument, pause. Ask God for help and ask a wise adult what would be right.

Pray together God, help me trust You when I do not know what to do. Amen.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 133 | Wednesday, February 10, 2027 | A Soft Answer

Read aloud Proverbs 15:1

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Proverbs 15:1

> 1 A soft answer turneth away wrath: but grievous words stir up anger.

Talk about the story Gentle words can quiet an argument. Harsh words make anger grow. We can choose our tone even when we feel upset.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What can turn away anger? *Answer: A soft or gentle answer.*

2. What stirs anger up? *Answer: Harsh words.*

3. Can our words make an argument worse? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Say "Please stop taking my blocks" once in a shout and once calmly. Which helps someone listen? Use the calm version today.

Pray together God, help me answer gently when I am upset. Amen.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 20 | Elijah Shows That the LORD Is God | Feb 11 - Feb 17, 2027

Bible story 1 Kings 12; 17-18

Week overview After Solomon, the kingdom divided and many worshiped idols. God sent Elijah, fed him in famine, cared for a widow, and answered by fire at Carmel.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39

Day 134 | Thursday, February 11, 2027 | A Kingdom Divides

Read aloud 1 Kings 12:16-20

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 12:16-20

> 16 So when all Israel saw that the king hearkened not unto them, the people answered the king, saying, What portion have we in David? neither have we inheritance in the son of Jesse: to your tents, O Israel: now see to thine own house, David. So Israel departed unto their tents.
> 17 But as for the children of Israel which dwelt in the cities of Judah, Rehoboam reigned over them.
> 18 Then king Rehoboam sent Adoram, who was over the tribute; and all Israel stoned him with stones, that he died. Therefore king Rehoboam made speed to get him up to his chariot, to flee to Jerusalem.
> 19 So Israel rebelled against the house of David unto this day.
> 20 And it came to pass, when all Israel heard that Jeroboam was come again, that they sent and called him unto the congregation, and made him king over all Israel: there was none that followed the house of David, but the tribe of Judah only.

Talk about the story Israel split into two kingdoms. The people would no longer follow David's family together, and Jeroboam became king over much of Israel. Their division was serious.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did Israel remain one united kingdom? *Answer: No.*

2. Who became king over the northern tribes? *Answer: Jeroboam.*

3. Did everyone keep following David's family? *Answer: No.*

In your day When everyone insists on getting their own way, even a game can fall apart. Practice listening to another person's idea before arguing for yours.

Pray together God, help me listen instead of making arguments worse. Amen.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 135 | Friday, February 12, 2027 | Elijah Announces a Drought

Read aloud 1 Kings 17:1

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 17:1

> 1 And Elijah the Tishbite, who was of the inhabitants of Gilead, said unto Ahab, As the LORD God of Israel liveth, before whom I stand, there shall not be dew nor rain these years, but according to my word.

Talk about the story Elijah told Ahab that no dew or rain would come except by God's word. The king would see that the LORD ruled even the rain.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who spoke to King Ahab? *Answer: Elijah.*

2. What would stop? *Answer: Dew and rain.*

3. Whose word controlled when rain returned? *Answer: God's.*

In your day Think of grass drying out when there is no rain. Why do plants need water? Notice rain as a gift rather than only a spoiled playtime.

Pray together God, thank You for rain that helps things grow. Amen.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 136 | Saturday, February 13, 2027 | Ravens Bring Food

Read aloud 1 Kings 17:2-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 17:2-6

> 2 And the word of the LORD came unto him, saying,
> 3 Get thee hence, and turn thee eastward, and hide thyself by the brook Cherith, that is before Jordan.
> 4 And it shall be, that thou shalt drink of the brook; and I have commanded the ravens to feed thee there.
> 5 So he went and did according unto the word of the LORD: for he went and dwelt by the brook Cherith, that is before Jordan.
> 6 And the ravens brought him bread and flesh in the morning, and bread and flesh in the evening; and he drank of the brook.

Talk about the story God sent Elijah to a brook. Ravens brought him bread and meat, and he drank the brook's water. God cared for him in an unexpected way.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What birds brought Elijah food? *Answer: Ravens.*

2. What did they bring? *Answer: Bread and meat.*

3. Where did he get water? *Answer: The brook.*

In your day Name the people who help food reach your table. God can care for us through ordinary helpers too. Thank one of them today.

Pray together God, thank You for providing food and water. Amen.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 137 | Sunday, February 14, 2027 | The Widow's Flour and Oil

Read aloud 1 Kings 17:8-16

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 17:8-16

> 8 And the word of the LORD came unto him, saying,
> 9 Arise, get thee to Zarephath, which belongeth to Zidon, and dwell there: behold, I have commanded a widow woman there to sustain thee.
> 10 So he arose and went to Zarephath. And when he came to the gate of the city, behold, the widow woman was there gathering of sticks: and he called to her, and said, Fetch me, I pray thee, a little water in a vessel, that I may drink.
> 11 And as she was going to fetch it, he called to her, and said, Bring me, I pray thee, a morsel of bread in thine hand.
> 12 And she said, As the LORD thy God liveth, I have not a cake, but an handful of meal in a barrel, and a little oil in a cruse: and, behold, I am gathering two sticks, that I may go in and dress it for me and my son, that we may eat it, and die.
> 13 And Elijah said unto her, Fear not; go and do as thou hast said: but make me thereof a little cake first, and bring it unto me, and after make for thee and for thy son.
> 14 For thus saith the LORD God of Israel, The barrel of meal shall not waste, neither shall the cruse of oil fail, until the day that the LORD sendeth rain upon the earth.
> 15 And she went and did according to the saying of Elijah: and she, and he, and her house, did eat many days.
> 16 And the barrel of meal wasted not, neither did the cruse of oil fail, according to the word of the LORD, which he spake by Elijah.

Talk about the story A widow had very little flour and oil. She followed God's word through Elijah, and her supplies did not run out. God kept His promise.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What supplies were nearly gone? *Answer: Flour and oil.*

2. Whom did the widow feed? *Answer: Elijah, as well as her household.*

3. Did the flour and oil run out then? *Answer: No.*

In your day When you share a snack, you notice what you have left. This was a special miracle, not a promise that snacks never end. Thank God for today's food.

Pray together God, thank You for caring for the widow and her son. Amen.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 138 | Monday, February 15, 2027 | The Widow's Son Lives

Read aloud 1 Kings 17:17-24

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 17:17-24

> 17 And it came to pass after these things, that the son of the woman, the mistress of the house, fell sick; and his sickness was so sore, that there was no breath left in him.
> 18 And she said unto Elijah, What have I to do with thee, O thou man of God? art thou come unto me to call my sin to remembrance, and to slay my son?
> 19 And he said unto her, Give me thy son. And he took him out of her bosom, and carried him up into a loft, where he abode, and laid him upon his own bed.
> 20 And he cried unto the LORD, and said, O LORD my God, hast thou also brought evil upon the widow with whom I sojourn, by slaying her son?
> 21 And he stretched himself upon the child three times, and cried unto the LORD, and said, O LORD my God, I pray thee, let this child's soul come into him again.
> 22 And the LORD heard the voice of Elijah; and the soul of the child came into him again, and he revived.
> 23 And Elijah took the child, and brought him down out of the chamber into the house, and delivered him unto his mother: and Elijah said, See, thy son liveth.
> 24 And the woman said to Elijah, Now by this I know that thou art a man of God, and that the word of the LORD in thy mouth is truth.

Talk about the story The widow's son died, and Elijah cried to the LORD. God restored the boy's life. His mother saw that God's word through Elijah was true.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was very ill and died? *Answer: The widow's son.*

2. Who prayed for him? *Answer: Elijah.*

3. Who restored the boy's life? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day If death worries you, tell an adult and ask your questions. This miracle shows God's power; it does not mean every person who dies returns now.

Pray together God, comfort families who are grieving and help us trust You. Amen.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 139 | Tuesday, February 16, 2027 | How Long between Two Choices?

Read aloud 1 Kings 18:20-24

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 18:20-24

> 20 So Ahab sent unto all the children of Israel, and gathered the prophets together unto mount Carmel.
> 21 And Elijah came unto all the people, and said, How long halt ye between two opinions? if the LORD be God, follow him: but if Baal, then follow him. And the people answered him not a word.
> 22 Then said Elijah unto the people, I, even I only, remain a prophet of the LORD; but Baal's prophets are four hundred and fifty men.
> 23 Let them therefore give us two bullocks; and let them choose one bullock for themselves, and cut it in pieces, and lay it on wood, and put no fire under: and I will dress the other bullock, and lay it on wood, and put no fire under:
> 24 And call ye on the name of your gods, and I will call on the name of the LORD: and the God that answereth by fire, let him be God. And all the people answered and said, It is well spoken.

Talk about the story Elijah told Israel to choose whom they would follow: the LORD or Baal. The true God would answer by fire. The people needed to stop wavering.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Which prophet challenged the people? *Answer: Elijah.*

2. What false god were they following? *Answer: Baal.*

3. How would the true God answer? *Answer: By fire.*

In your day Can you walk in two opposite directions at once? Choosing to follow God means saying no when someone asks you to do what He forbids.

Pray together God, help me choose to follow You. Amen.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 140 | Wednesday, February 17, 2027 | The Fire Falls

Read aloud 1 Kings 18:36-39

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 18:36-39

> 36 And it came to pass at the time of the offering of the evening sacrifice, that Elijah the prophet came near, and said, LORD God of Abraham, Isaac, and of Israel, let it be known this day that thou art God in Israel, and that I am thy servant, and that I have done all these things at thy word.
> 37 Hear me, O LORD, hear me, that this people may know that thou art the LORD God, and that thou hast turned their heart back again.
> 38 Then the fire of the LORD fell, and consumed the burnt sacrifice, and the wood, and the stones, and the dust, and licked up the water that was in the trench.
> 39 And when all the people saw it, they fell on their faces: and they said, The LORD, he is the God; the LORD, he is the God.

Talk about the story Elijah prayed, and the LORD sent fire. The people fell on their faces and said that the LORD is God. God answered clearly.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who prayed? *Answer: Elijah.*

2. What did God send? *Answer: Fire.*

3. Who did the people say was God? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day Tell the story using three steps: Elijah prayed, God answered, the people worshiped. What did this show them about the God Elijah served?

Pray together LORD, help us know and worship You as God. Amen.

Memory verse 1 Kings 18:39 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 11 | Days 141-154

Elijah and Elisha: God Cares and Helps + Jonah Runs; God Shows Mercy

Thursday, February 18, 2027 through Wednesday, March 3, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Psalm 86:5

> 5 For thou, Lord, art good, and ready to forgive; and plenteous in mercy unto all them that call upon thee.

Meaning in context The Lord is good, ready to forgive, and rich in mercy toward those who call on Him.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 21 | Elijah and Elisha: God Cares and Helps | Feb 18 - Feb 24, 2027

Bible story 1 Kings 19; 2 Kings 2-5

Week overview God cared for discouraged Elijah, spoke quietly, gave him more work, continued His ministry through Elisha, and helped needy people.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5

Day 141 | Thursday, February 18, 2027 | Elijah Feels Afraid and Alone

Read aloud 1 Kings 19:1-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 19:1-4

> 1 And Ahab told Jezebel all that Elijah had done, and withal how he had slain all the prophets with the sword.
> 2 Then Jezebel sent a messenger unto Elijah, saying, So let the gods do to me, and more also, if I make not thy life as the life of one of them by to morrow about this time.
> 3 And when he saw that, he arose, and went for his life, and came to Beersheba, which belongeth to Judah, and left his servant there.
> 4 But he himself went a day's journey into the wilderness, and came and sat down under a juniper tree: and he requested for himself that he might die; and said, It is enough; now, O LORD, take away my life; for I am not better than my fathers.

Talk about the story Even after the victory on Mount Carmel, Elijah became frightened and discouraged. He ran away and sat under a tree. God's servants can have very hard days.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was afraid? *Answer: Elijah.*

2. Where did he sit? *Answer: Under a tree.*

3. Was he feeling hopeful or deeply discouraged? *Answer: Discouraged.*

In your day Sometimes you feel upset even after something good happened. Tell a trusted adult how you feel. You do not need to hide sadness or fear.

Pray together God, help me tell someone when I feel overwhelmed. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 142 | Friday, February 19, 2027 | Rest and Food

Read aloud 1 Kings 19:5-8

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 19:5-8

> 5 And as he lay and slept under a juniper tree, behold, then an angel touched him, and said unto him, Arise and eat.
> 6 And he looked, and, behold, there was a cake baken on the coals, and a cruse of water at his head. And he did eat and drink, and laid him down again.
> 7 And the angel of the LORD came again the second time, and touched him, and said, Arise and eat; because the journey is too great for thee.
> 8 And he arose, and did eat and drink, and went in the strength of that meat forty days and forty nights unto Horeb the mount of God.

Talk about the story God cared for tired Elijah with sleep, food, and water. He did not ignore Elijah's body. The journey ahead required strength.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who brought Elijah food? *Answer: An angel.*

2. Did Elijah get to rest? *Answer: Yes.*

3. What did the food help him do? *Answer: Have strength for the journey.*

In your day When you are tired or hungry, small problems may feel huge. Ask for a drink, some rest, or help instead of trying to handle everything alone.

Pray together God, thank You for food, rest, and people who care. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 143 | Saturday, February 20, 2027 | A Still Small Voice

Read aloud 1 Kings 19:9-12

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 19:9-12

> 9 And he came thither unto a cave, and lodged there; and, behold, the word of the LORD came to him, and he said unto him, What doest thou here, Elijah?
> 10 And he said, I have been very jealous for the LORD God of hosts: for the children of Israel have forsaken thy covenant, thrown down thine altars, and slain thy prophets with the sword; and I, even I only, am left; and they seek my life, to take it away.
> 11 And he said, Go forth, and stand upon the mount before the LORD. And, behold, the LORD passed by, and a great and strong wind rent the mountains, and brake in pieces the rocks before the LORD; but the LORD was not in the wind: and after the wind an earthquake; but the LORD was not in the earthquake:
> 12 And after the earthquake a fire; but the LORD was not in the fire: and after the fire a still small voice.

Talk about the story Elijah saw powerful wind, an earthquake, and fire. Afterward came a still small voice. He needed to attend to God's words, not only dramatic events.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Was there a strong wind? *Answer: Yes.*

2. What came after the wind? *Answer: An earthquake, then fire.*

3. What followed the fire? *Answer: A still small voice.*

In your day Can you hear a quiet voice while toys are making noise? Make a quiet moment for today's Bible reading so you can listen carefully.

Pray together God, help me be quiet enough to listen well. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 144 | Sunday, February 21, 2027 | God Gives Elijah Work

Read aloud 1 Kings 19:15-18

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Kings 19:15-18

> 15 And the LORD said unto him, Go, return on thy way to the wilderness of Damascus: and when thou comest, anoint Hazael to be king over Syria:
> 16 And Jehu the son of Nimshi shalt thou anoint to be king over Israel: and Elisha the son of Shaphat of Abelmeholah shalt thou anoint to be prophet in thy room.
> 17 And it shall come to pass, that him that escapeth the sword of Hazael shall Jehu slay: and him that escapeth from the sword of Jehu shall Elisha slay.
> 18 Yet I have left me seven thousand in Israel, all the knees which have not bowed unto Baal, and every mouth which hath not kissed him.

Talk about the story God gave Elijah more work and told him many people had not worshiped Baal. Elijah felt alone, but he was not the only person serving God.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did God have more work for Elijah? *Answer: Yes.*

2. Was Elijah the only person left serving God? *Answer: No.*

3. Had those faithful people bowed to Baal? *Answer: No.*

In your day Have you thought, "Nobody else is trying to do right"? Ask an adult to help you name people who love God and can encourage you.

Pray together God, thank You for others who follow You. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 145 | Monday, February 22, 2027 | Elisha Receives the Mantle

Read aloud 2 Kings 2:9-12

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Kings 2:9-12

> 9 And it came to pass, when they were gone over, that Elijah said unto Elisha, Ask what I shall do for thee, before I be taken away from thee. And Elisha said, I pray thee, let a double portion of thy spirit be upon me.
> 10 And he said, Thou hast asked a hard thing: nevertheless, if thou see me when I am taken from thee, it shall be so unto thee; but if not, it shall not be so.
> 11 And it came to pass, as they still went on, and talked, that, behold, there appeared a chariot of fire, and horses of fire, and parted them both asunder; and Elijah went up by a whirlwind into heaven.
> 12 And Elisha saw it, and he cried, My father, my father, the chariot of Israel, and the horsemen thereof. And he saw him no more: and he took hold of his own clothes, and rent them in two pieces.

Talk about the story Elisha stayed close to Elijah and saw him taken up to heaven. Their time together ended, but God's work would continue through Elisha.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was taken up? *Answer: Elijah.*

2. Who saw him go? *Answer: Elisha.*

3. Did God's work stop with Elijah's departure? *Answer: No; Elisha would continue serving.*

In your day Think of someone who has taught you something good. Practice what they taught even when they are not beside you, and thank God for their help.

Pray together God, help me use the good things others teach me. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 146 | Tuesday, February 23, 2027 | A Widow's Oil Multiplies

Read aloud 2 Kings 4:1-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Kings 4:1-7

> 1 Now there cried a certain woman of the wives of the sons of the prophets unto Elisha, saying, Thy servant my husband is dead; and thou knowest that thy servant did fear the LORD: and the creditor is come to take unto him my two sons to be bondmen.
> 2 And Elisha said unto her, What shall I do for thee? tell me, what hast thou in the house? And she said, Thine handmaid hath not any thing in the house, save a pot of oil.
> 3 Then he said, Go, borrow thee vessels abroad of all thy neighbours, even empty vessels; borrow not a few.
> 4 And when thou art come in, thou shalt shut the door upon thee and upon thy sons, and shalt pour out into all those vessels, and thou shalt set aside that which is full.
> 5 So she went from him, and shut the door upon her and upon her sons, who brought the vessels to her; and she poured out.
> 6 And it came to pass, when the vessels were full, that she said unto her son, Bring me yet a vessel. And he said unto her, There is not a vessel more. And the oil stayed.
> 7 Then she came and told the man of God. And he said, Go, sell the oil, and pay thy debt, and live thou and thy children of the rest.

Talk about the story A widow needed help with a debt. Elisha told her to collect empty containers. God supplied oil that she could sell to pay what she owed.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who needed help? *Answer: A widow.*

2. What did she collect? *Answer: Empty containers.*

3. What did God multiply? *Answer: Her oil.*

In your day An empty cupboard can worry a family. Ask an adult whether your family can share food with someone who needs it. Small help matters.

Pray together God, care for families who need food or money. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 147 | Wednesday, February 24, 2027 | Naaman Washes and Is Clean

Read aloud 2 Kings 5:9-14

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Kings 5:9-14

> 9 So Naaman came with his horses and with his chariot, and stood at the door of the house of Elisha.
> 10 And Elisha sent a messenger unto him, saying, Go and wash in Jordan seven times, and thy flesh shall come again to thee, and thou shalt be clean.
> 11 But Naaman was wroth, and went away, and said, Behold, I thought, He will surely come out to me, and stand, and call on the name of the LORD his God, and strike his hand over the place, and recover the leper.
> 12 Are not Abana and Pharpar, rivers of Damascus, better than all the waters of Israel? may I not wash in them, and be clean? So he turned and went away in a rage.
> 13 And his servants came near, and spake unto him, and said, My father, if the prophet had bid thee do some great thing, wouldest thou not have done it? how much rather then, when he saith to thee, Wash, and be clean?
> 14 Then went he down, and dipped himself seven times in Jordan, according to the saying of the man of God: and his flesh came again like unto the flesh of a little child, and he was clean.

Talk about the story Naaman wanted healing but disliked the command to wash in the Jordan. When he finally washed seven times, he was healed. Pride had nearly kept him from listening.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where was Naaman told to wash? *Answer: The Jordan River.*

2. How many times? *Answer: Seven.*

3. What happened when he obeyed? *Answer: He was healed.*

In your day Do you sometimes reject help because it sounds too simple? Try the helpful instruction before arguing that your own way must be better.

Pray together God, help me accept good instructions without pride. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 22 | Jonah Runs; God Shows Mercy | Feb 25 - Mar 3, 2027

Bible story Jonah 1-4

Week overview Jonah ran from God's call, prayed from inside the great fish, preached in Nineveh, and learned that God is compassionate toward repentant sinners.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5

Day 148 | Thursday, February 25, 2027 | Jonah Runs Away

Read aloud Jonah 1:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Jonah 1:1-3

> 1 Now the word of the LORD came unto Jonah the son of Amittai, saying,
> 2 Arise, go to Nineveh, that great city, and cry against it; for their wickedness is come up before me.
> 3 But Jonah rose up to flee unto Tarshish from the presence of the LORD, and went down to Joppa; and he found a ship going to Tarshish: so he paid the fare thereof, and went down into it, to go with them unto Tarshish from the presence of the LORD.

Talk about the story God sent Jonah to Nineveh, but Jonah went toward Tarshish instead. Getting on a ship did not make his disobedience right.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where did God send Jonah? *Answer: Nineveh.*

2. Did Jonah head there at first? *Answer: No.*

3. What did he board to go away? *Answer: A ship.*

In your day If you are told to put a toy away and hide it under the sofa, have you obeyed? Practice finishing the actual job you were given.

Pray together God, help me do what You say instead of running away. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 149 | Friday, February 26, 2027 | A Great Storm

Read aloud Jonah 1:4-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Jonah 1:4-6

> 4 But the LORD sent out a great wind into the sea, and there was a mighty tempest in the sea, so that the ship was like to be broken.
> 5 Then the mariners were afraid, and cried every man unto his god, and cast forth the wares that were in the ship into the sea, to lighten it of them. But Jonah was gone down into the sides of the ship; and he lay, and was fast asleep.
> 6 So the shipmaster came to him, and said unto him, What meanest thou, O sleeper? arise, call upon thy God, if so be that God will think upon us, that we perish not.

Talk about the story The LORD sent a great storm. The sailors were afraid, but Jonah was asleep. The captain woke him and urged him to call on his God.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who sent the storm? *Answer: The LORD.*

2. How did the sailors feel? *Answer: Afraid.*

3. What was Jonah doing before the captain woke him? *Answer: Sleeping.*

In your day When people around you need help, pretending not to notice does not solve it. Look for one household job you can help with today.

Pray together God, help me notice when others need help. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 150 | Saturday, February 27, 2027 | The Sea Grows Calm

Read aloud Jonah 1:11-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Jonah 1:11-17

> 11 Then said they unto him, What shall we do unto thee, that the sea may be calm unto us? for the sea wrought, and was tempestuous.
> 12 And he said unto them, Take me up, and cast me forth into the sea; so shall the sea be calm unto you: for I know that for my sake this great tempest is upon you.
> 13 Nevertheless the men rowed hard to bring it to the land; but they could not: for the sea wrought, and was tempestuous against them.
> 14 Wherefore they cried unto the LORD, and said, We beseech thee, O LORD, we beseech thee, let us not perish for this man's life, and lay not upon us innocent blood: for thou, O LORD, hast done as it pleased thee.
> 15 So they took up Jonah, and cast him forth into the sea: and the sea ceased from her raging.
> 16 Then the men feared the LORD exceedingly, and offered a sacrifice unto the LORD, and made vows.
> 17 Now the LORD had prepared a great fish to swallow up Jonah. And Jonah was in the belly of the fish three days and three nights.

Talk about the story Jonah admitted the storm had come because of him. After he was thrown into the sea, it became calm. God prepared a great fish to swallow him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did Jonah admit why the storm came? *Answer: Yes.*

2. What happened to the sea afterward? *Answer: It became calm.*

3. What did God prepare? *Answer: A great fish.*

In your day Admitting a wrong choice can be hard. Practice saying, "That happened because of what I did." Tell a trusted adult instead of keeping a dangerous secret.

Pray together God, help me admit my wrong choices honestly. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 151 | Sunday, February 28, 2027 | Jonah Prays

Read aloud Jonah 2:1-2

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Jonah 2:1-2

> 1 Then Jonah prayed unto the LORD his God out of the fish's belly,
> 2 And said, I cried by reason of mine affliction unto the LORD, and he heard me; out of the belly of hell cried I, and thou heardest my voice.

Talk about the story Inside the fish, Jonah prayed. He was in a frightening place, but God heard him. Being far from home did not put him beyond God's hearing.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where was Jonah? *Answer: Inside the fish.*

2. To whom did he pray? *Answer: The LORD.*

3. Did God hear him? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Think of an unusual place where you could pray: a car, a waiting room, or a playground. You can speak to God there too.

Pray together God, thank You that I can pray wherever I am. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 152 | Monday, March 1, 2027 | Salvation Is of the LORD

Read aloud Jonah 2:9-10

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Jonah 2:9-10

> 9 But I will sacrifice unto thee with the voice of thanksgiving; I will pay that that I have vowed. Salvation is of the LORD.
> 10 And the LORD spake unto the fish, and it vomited out Jonah upon the dry land.

Talk about the story Jonah thanked God and said salvation belongs to the LORD. God spoke to the fish, and Jonah was put onto dry land. God had rescued him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. To whom does salvation belong? *Answer: The LORD.*

2. Who spoke to the fish? *Answer: God.*

3. Where did Jonah end up? *Answer: On dry land.*

In your day After someone helps you out of trouble, remember to thank them. Tell one way you can show thanks rather than immediately forgetting the help.

Pray together God, thank You for rescuing Jonah. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 153 | Tuesday, March 2, 2027 | Jonah Goes to Nineveh

Read aloud Jonah 3:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Jonah 3:1-5

> 1 And the word of the LORD came unto Jonah the second time, saying,
> 2 Arise, go unto Nineveh, that great city, and preach unto it the preaching that I bid thee.
> 3 So Jonah arose, and went unto Nineveh, according to the word of the LORD. Now Nineveh was an exceeding great city of three days' journey.
> 4 And Jonah began to enter into the city a day's journey, and he cried, and said, Yet forty days, and Nineveh shall be overthrown.
> 5 So the people of Nineveh believed God, and proclaimed a fast, and put on sackcloth, from the greatest of them even to the least of them.

Talk about the story God sent Jonah to Nineveh again. This time he went and gave God's warning. The people believed God and responded seriously.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where did Jonah go this time? *Answer: Nineveh.*

2. Did he give God's message? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Did the people believe God? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day If you did not listen the first time, you can still do right now. Think of an unfinished instruction and begin it without more excuses.

Pray together God, help me respond rightly when I have another chance. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 154 | Wednesday, March 3, 2027 | God Spares the City

Read aloud Jonah 3:10

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Jonah 3:10

> 10 And God saw their works, that they turned from their evil way; and God repented of the evil, that he had said that he would do unto them; and he did it not.

Talk about the story God saw Nineveh turn from evil. He did not bring the destruction He had warned about. Their response involved changing what they were doing.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did the people turn away from? *Answer: Evil.*

2. Who saw their change? *Answer: God.*

3. Did He bring the announced destruction then? *Answer: No.*

In your day Saying "sorry" for teasing should be followed by stopping the teasing. Name a kind action that can take its place.

Pray together God, help me turn away from wrong, not just say sorry. Amen.

Memory verse Psalm 86:5 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 12 | Days 155-168

Hezekiah and Josiah Return to God + Daniel Trusts God in Babylon

Thursday, March 4, 2027 through Wednesday, March 17, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Daniel 3:17

> 17 If it be so, our God whom we serve is able to deliver us from the burning fiery furnace, and he will deliver us out of thine hand, O king.

Meaning in context God is able to rescue; faithful people obey Him whether or not He chooses the rescue they expect.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 23 | Hezekiah and Josiah Return to God | Mar 4 - Mar 10, 2027

Bible story 2 Kings 18-23

Week overview Kings Hezekiah and Josiah trusted the LORD, rejected idols, prayed in danger, and honored God's rediscovered Word.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17

Day 155 | Thursday, March 4, 2027 | Hezekiah Trusts the LORD

Read aloud 2 Kings 18:5-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Kings 18:5-7

> 5 He trusted in the LORD God of Israel; so that after him was none like him among all the kings of Judah, nor any that were before him.
> 6 For he clave to the LORD, and departed not from following him, but kept his commandments, which the LORD commanded Moses.
> 7 And the LORD was with him; and he prospered whithersoever he went forth: and he rebelled against the king of Assyria, and served him not.

Talk about the story Hezekiah trusted the LORD and kept His commands. He stayed close to God instead of giving up on Him. The LORD was with him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did Hezekiah trust? *Answer: The LORD.*

2. Did he keep God's commands? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Who was with him? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day Following a rule once is easier than keeping it every day. Choose one good habit, such as telling the truth, and practice it again today.

Pray together God, help me keep following You day after day. Amen.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 156 | Friday, March 5, 2027 | A Frightening Letter Becomes a Prayer

Read aloud 2 Kings 19:14-19

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Kings 19:14-19

> 14 And Hezekiah received the letter of the hand of the messengers, and read it: and Hezekiah went up into the house of the LORD, and spread it before the LORD.
> 15 And Hezekiah prayed before the LORD, and said, O LORD God of Israel, which dwellest between the cherubims, thou art the God, even thou alone, of all the kingdoms of the earth; thou hast made heaven and earth.
> 16 LORD, bow down thine ear, and hear: open, LORD, thine eyes, and see: and hear the words of Sennacherib, which hath sent him to reproach the living God.
> 17 Of a truth, LORD, the kings of Assyria have destroyed the nations and their lands,
> 18 And have cast their gods into the fire: for they were no gods, but the work of men's hands, wood and stone: therefore they have destroyed them.
> 19 Now therefore, O LORD our God, I beseech thee, save thou us out of his hand, that all the kingdoms of the earth may know that thou art the LORD God, even thou only.

Talk about the story Hezekiah took a threatening letter to the LORD and spread it out before Him. He asked God to rescue Jerusalem. The frightening message became a reason to pray.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Hezekiah receive? *Answer: A threatening letter.*

2. Before whom did he spread it? *Answer: The LORD.*

3. What did he ask God for? *Answer: Rescue for his people.*

In your day If a message or someone's words frighten you, show a trusted adult. Pray about the exact thing that worries you instead of carrying it alone.

Pray together God, help me bring frightening things to You. Amen.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 157 | Saturday, March 6, 2027 | God Defends Jerusalem

Read aloud 2 Kings 19:32-36

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Kings 19:32-36

> 32 Therefore thus saith the LORD concerning the king of Assyria, He shall not come into this city, nor shoot an arrow there, nor come before it with shield, nor cast a bank against it.
> 33 By the way that he came, by the same shall he return, and shall not come into this city, saith the LORD.
> 34 For I will defend this city, to save it, for mine own sake, and for my servant David's sake.
> 35 And it came to pass that night, that the angel of the LORD went out, and smote in the camp of the Assyrians an hundred fourscore and five thousand: and when they arose early in the morning, behold, they were all dead corpses.
> 36 So Sennacherib king of Assyria departed, and went and returned, and dwelt at Nineveh.

Talk about the story God promised that the enemy would not enter Jerusalem. He defended the city, and the enemy king left. The rescue came as God had said.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What city was threatened? *Answer: Jerusalem.*

2. Did God say the enemy would enter it? *Answer: No.*

3. Who defended the city? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day Remember a promise from this week's reading. Say what God actually promised, rather than adding a promise that nothing hard will ever happen.

Pray together God, thank You for keeping Your word to Jerusalem. Amen.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 158 | Sunday, March 7, 2027 | Hezekiah Prays When Sick

Read aloud 2 Kings 20:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Kings 20:1-5

> 1 In those days was Hezekiah sick unto death. And the prophet Isaiah the son of Amoz came to him, and said unto him, Thus saith the LORD, Set thine house in order; for thou shalt die, and not live.
> 2 Then he turned his face to the wall, and prayed unto the LORD, saying,
> 3 I beseech thee, O LORD, remember now how I have walked before thee in truth and with a perfect heart, and have done that which is good in thy sight. And Hezekiah wept sore.
> 4 And it came to pass, afore Isaiah was gone out into the middle court, that the word of the LORD came to him, saying,
> 5 Turn again, and tell Hezekiah the captain of my people, Thus saith the LORD, the God of David thy father, I have heard thy prayer, I have seen thy tears: behold, I will heal thee: on the third day thou shalt go up unto the house of the LORD.

Talk about the story Hezekiah became very sick and prayed with tears. God heard him and promised healing. God listened to a prayer spoken in pain.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was sick? *Answer: Hezekiah.*

2. What did he do? *Answer: Prayed and wept.*

3. Did God hear his prayer? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day When someone is ill, pray for them and ask an adult how to help. A drawing or quiet visit may show care while they rest.

Pray together God, please help the sick person we are thinking of. Amen.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 159 | Monday, March 8, 2027 | Young Josiah Does Right

Read aloud 2 Kings 22:1-2

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Kings 22:1-2

> 1 Josiah was eight years old when he began to reign, and he reigned thirty and one years in Jerusalem. And his mother's name was Jedidah, the daughter of Adaiah of Boscath.
> 2 And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, and walked in all the way of David his father, and turned not aside to the right hand or to the left.

Talk about the story Josiah became king when he was eight. He did what was right in the LORD's sight. A child can begin making choices that honor God.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. How old was Josiah when he became king? *Answer: Eight.*

2. Did he do right or wrong before the LORD? *Answer: Right.*

3. Was he an adult when he began? *Answer: No.*

In your day You do not need to wait until you are grown to be honest or kind. Choose one right thing you can do today without being reminded.

Pray together God, help me do right while I am young. Amen.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 160 | Tuesday, March 9, 2027 | The Book Is Found

Read aloud 2 Kings 22:8-11

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Kings 22:8-11

> 8 And Hilkiah the high priest said unto Shaphan the scribe, I have found the book of the law in the house of the LORD. And Hilkiah gave the book to Shaphan, and he read it.
> 9 And Shaphan the scribe came to the king, and brought the king word again, and said, Thy servants have gathered the money that was found in the house, and have delivered it into the hand of them that do the work, that have the oversight of the house of the LORD.
> 10 And Shaphan the scribe shewed the king, saying, Hilkiah the priest hath delivered me a book. And Shaphan read it before the king.
> 11 And it came to pass, when the king had heard the words of the book of the law, that he rent his clothes.

Talk about the story God's law was found in the temple and read to Josiah. He tore his clothes in grief because his people had not obeyed. God's words mattered deeply to him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What book was found? *Answer: The book of God's law.*

2. To whom was it read? *Answer: Josiah.*

3. Was he pleased with their disobedience? *Answer: No; he was grieved.*

In your day If the Bible shows that you have done wrong, do not shut it and pretend you did not hear. Tell God and ask how to make things right.

Pray together God, help me take Your words seriously. Amen.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 161 | Wednesday, March 10, 2027 | Josiah Makes a Covenant

Read aloud 2 Kings 23:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Kings 23:1-3

> 1 And the king sent, and they gathered unto him all the elders of Judah and of Jerusalem.
> 2 And the king went up into the house of the LORD, and all the men of Judah and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem with him, and the priests, and the prophets, and all the people, both small and great: and he read in their ears all the words of the book of the covenant which was found in the house of the LORD.
> 3 And the king stood by a pillar, and made a covenant before the LORD, to walk after the LORD, and to keep his commandments and his testimonies and his statutes with all their heart and all their soul, to perform the words of this covenant that were written in this book. And all the people stood to the covenant.

Talk about the story Josiah gathered the people and read God's covenant to them. He promised to follow the LORD with his heart and soul. The people joined in.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who read God's words to the people? *Answer: Josiah.*

2. Whom did he promise to follow? *Answer: The LORD.*

3. Did the people stand with the covenant? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Hearing directions is only the beginning. After today's reading, name one small thing you will do because of what you heard.

Pray together God, help us do what we hear in Your Word. Amen.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 24 | Daniel Trusts God in Babylon | Mar 11 - Mar 17, 2027

Bible story Daniel 1-6

Week overview Daniel and his friends served God far from home. God gave wisdom, protected the three men in the furnace, and shut the lions' mouths.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17

Day 162 | Thursday, March 11, 2027 | Daniel Purposes in His Heart

Read aloud Daniel 1:3-8

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Daniel 1:3-8

> 3 And the king spake unto Ashpenaz the master of his eunuchs, that he should bring certain of the children of Israel, and of the king's seed, and of the princes;
> 4 Children in whom was no blemish, but well favoured, and skilful in all wisdom, and cunning in knowledge, and understanding science, and such as had ability in them to stand in the king's palace, and whom they might teach the learning and the tongue of the Chaldeans.
> 5 And the king appointed them a daily provision of the king's meat, and of the wine which he drank: so nourishing them three years, that at the end thereof they might stand before the king.
> 6 Now among these were of the children of Judah, Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah:
> 7 Unto whom the prince of the eunuchs gave names: for he gave unto Daniel the name of Belteshazzar; and to Hananiah, of Shadrach; and to Mishael, of Meshach; and to Azariah, of Abednego.
> 8 But Daniel purposed in his heart that he would not defile himself with the portion of the king's meat, nor with the wine which he drank: therefore he requested of the prince of the eunuchs that he might not defile himself.

Talk about the story Far from home, Daniel decided he would not defile himself with the king's food. He asked for permission to avoid it. He wanted to honor God there too.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was far from home? *Answer: Daniel.*

2. What did he decide to avoid? *Answer: Defiling himself with the king's food.*

3. Did he ask permission? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day If you visit a friend's home, your good choices still matter. Think ahead about politely saying no to a game that involves hurting or lying.

Pray together God, help me honor You away from home. Amen.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 163 | Friday, March 12, 2027 | Ten Days of Faithful Obedience

Read aloud Daniel 1:11-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Daniel 1:11-17

> 11 Then said Daniel to Melzar, whom the prince of the eunuchs had set over Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah,
> 12 Prove thy servants, I beseech thee, ten days; and let them give us pulse to eat, and water to drink.
> 13 Then let our countenances be looked upon before thee, and the countenance of the children that eat of the portion of the king's meat: and as thou seest, deal with thy servants.
> 14 So he consented to them in this matter, and proved them ten days.
> 15 And at the end of ten days their countenances appeared fairer and fatter in flesh than all the children which did eat the portion of the king's meat.
> 16 Thus Melzar took away the portion of their meat, and the wine that they should drink; and gave them pulse.
> 17 As for these four children, God gave them knowledge and skill in all learning and wisdom: and Daniel had understanding in all visions and dreams.

Talk about the story Daniel asked for a ten-day test with vegetables and water. The young men remained healthy, and God gave them knowledge and skill. Daniel made his request respectfully.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. How long was the test? *Answer: Ten days.*

2. What did they drink? *Answer: Water.*

3. Who gave them knowledge and wisdom? *Answer: God.*

In your day Practice asking for what you need with a calm voice. "May I have help?" is easier to hear than an angry demand.

Pray together God, help me speak respectfully when I make a request. Amen.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 164 | Saturday, March 13, 2027 | Friends Pray Together

Read aloud Daniel 2:17-23

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Daniel 2:17-23

> 17 Then Daniel went to his house, and made the thing known to Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah, his companions:
> 18 That they would desire mercies of the God of heaven concerning this secret; that Daniel and his fellows should not perish with the rest of the wise men of Babylon.
> 19 Then was the secret revealed unto Daniel in a night vision. Then Daniel blessed the God of heaven.
> 20 Daniel answered and said, Blessed be the name of God for ever and ever: for wisdom and might are his:
> 21 And he changeth the times and the seasons: he removeth kings, and setteth up kings: he giveth wisdom unto the wise, and knowledge to them that know understanding:
> 22 He revealeth the deep and secret things: he knoweth what is in the darkness, and the light dwelleth with him.
> 23 I thank thee, and praise thee, O thou God of my fathers, who hast given me wisdom and might, and hast made known unto me now what we desired of thee: for thou hast now made known unto us the king's matter.

Talk about the story Daniel and his friends asked God for mercy about the king's mystery. God revealed it, and Daniel praised Him. The friends prayed together in danger.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did Daniel ask to pray with him? *Answer: His friends.*

2. Who revealed the mystery? *Answer: God.*

3. What did Daniel do afterward? *Answer: He praised God.*

In your day Ask a family member to pray with you about something difficult. When help comes, remember to tell them and thank God together.

Pray together God, thank You that we can pray together. Amen.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 165 | Sunday, March 14, 2027 | God Is Able to Deliver

Read aloud Daniel 3:13-18

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Daniel 3:13-18

> 13 Then Nebuchadnezzar in his rage and fury commanded to bring Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego. Then they brought these men before the king.
> 14 Nebuchadnezzar spake and said unto them, Is it true, O Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, do not ye serve my gods, nor worship the golden image which I have set up?
> 15 Now if ye be ready that at what time ye hear the sound of the cornet, flute, harp, sackbut, psaltery, and dulcimer, and all kinds of musick, ye fall down and worship the image which I have made; well: but if ye worship not, ye shall be cast the same hour into the midst of a burning fiery furnace; and who is that God that shall deliver you out of my hands?
> 16 Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, answered and said to the king, O Nebuchadnezzar, we are not careful to answer thee in this matter.
> 17 If it be so, our God whom we serve is able to deliver us from the burning fiery furnace, and he will deliver us out of thine hand, O king.
> 18 But if not, be it known unto thee, O king, that we will not serve thy gods, nor worship the golden image which thou hast set up.

Talk about the story The three men refused to worship the king's image. They knew God could rescue them, but would obey even if He did not. They would not trade worship for safety.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What would the men not worship? *Answer: The king's image.*

2. Could God rescue them? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Would they worship the image if He did not? *Answer: No.*

In your day If someone says they will dislike you unless you do wrong, tell a trusted adult. Being accepted is not a reason to disobey God.

Pray together God, help me stay faithful when obedience is hard. Amen.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 166 | Monday, March 15, 2027 | Not Alone in the Fire

Read aloud Daniel 3:24-27

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Daniel 3:24-27

> 24 Then Nebuchadnezzar the king was astonied, and rose up in haste, and spake, and said unto his counsellors, Did not we cast three men bound into the midst of the fire? They answered and said unto the king, True, O king.
> 25 He answered and said, Lo, I see four men loose, walking in the midst of the fire, and they have no hurt; and the form of the fourth is like the Son of God.
> 26 Then Nebuchadnezzar came near to the mouth of the burning fiery furnace, and spake, and said, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, ye servants of the most high God, come forth, and come hither. Then Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, came forth of the midst of the fire.
> 27 And the princes, governors, and captains, and the king's counsellors, being gathered together, saw these men, upon whose bodies the fire had no power, nor was an hair of their head singed, neither were their coats changed, nor the smell of fire had passed on them.

Talk about the story The king saw four men in the fire, though three had been thrown in. God's servants came out unharmed. Even their clothes did not smell of smoke.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. How many men did the king see in the fire? *Answer: Four.*

2. Were the three men hurt? *Answer: No.*

3. Did their clothes smell of smoke? *Answer: No.*

In your day This was a miracle, not something to try. Tell the story with a drawing, and remember that God was with His servants in danger.

Pray together God, thank You for caring for Your servants in the fire. Amen.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 167 | Tuesday, March 16, 2027 | Daniel Keeps Praying

Read aloud Daniel 6:4-10

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Daniel 6:4-10

> 4 Then the presidents and princes sought to find occasion against Daniel concerning the kingdom; but they could find none occasion nor fault; forasmuch as he was faithful, neither was there any error or fault found in him.
> 5 Then said these men, We shall not find any occasion against this Daniel, except we find it against him concerning the law of his God.
> 6 Then these presidents and princes assembled together to the king, and said thus unto him, King Darius, live for ever.
> 7 All the presidents of the kingdom, the governors, and the princes, the counsellors, and the captains, have consulted together to establish a royal statute, and to make a firm decree, that whosoever shall ask a petition of any God or man for thirty days, save of thee, O king, he shall be cast into the den of lions.
> 8 Now, O king, establish the decree, and sign the writing, that it be not changed, according to the law of the Medes and Persians, which altereth not.
> 9 Wherefore king Darius signed the writing and the decree.
> 10 Now when Daniel knew that the writing was signed, he went into his house; and his windows being open in his chamber toward Jerusalem, he kneeled upon his knees three times a day, and prayed, and gave thanks before his God, as he did aforetime.

Talk about the story Daniel's enemies arranged a law against praying to anyone but the king. Daniel still prayed to God as he had before. His prayer habit continued under pressure.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did the new law restrict? *Answer: Prayer to anyone except the king.*

2. Did Daniel stop praying to God? *Answer: No.*

3. Was praying already his habit? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Choose a regular moment to pray, such as before sleeping. A short, honest prayer can become part of your day instead of something you only do in trouble.

Pray together God, help me keep talking with You each day. Amen.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 168 | Wednesday, March 17, 2027 | God Shuts the Lions' Mouths

Read aloud Daniel 6:19-23

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Daniel 6:19-23

> 19 Then the king arose very early in the morning, and went in haste unto the den of lions.
> 20 And when he came to the den, he cried with a lamentable voice unto Daniel: and the king spake and said to Daniel, O Daniel, servant of the living God, is thy God, whom thou servest continually, able to deliver thee from the lions?
> 21 Then said Daniel unto the king, O king, live for ever.
> 22 My God hath sent his angel, and hath shut the lions' mouths, that they have not hurt me: forasmuch as before him innocency was found in me; and also before thee, O king, have I done no hurt.
> 23 Then was the king exceeding glad for him, and commanded that they should take Daniel up out of the den. So Daniel was taken up out of the den, and no manner of hurt was found upon him, because he believed in his God.

Talk about the story The king hurried to the lions' den and found Daniel alive. God had sent His angel to shut the lions' mouths. Daniel's God had rescued him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where was Daniel? *Answer: In the lions' den.*

2. Who shut the lions' mouths? *Answer: God sent His angel.*

3. Was Daniel hurt? *Answer: No.*

In your day Imagine the king calling into the den and hearing Daniel answer. Retell what each person said. Thank God for the rescue rather than pretending lions are safe pets.

Pray together God, thank You for rescuing Daniel. Amen.

Memory verse Daniel 3:17 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 13 | Days 169-182

Esther Is Brave; God's People Return + Rebuilding and Waiting for the Promised King

Thursday, March 18, 2027 through Wednesday, March 31, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Isaiah 9:6

> 6 For unto us a child is born, unto us a son is given: and the government shall be upon his shoulder: and his name shall be called Wonderful, Counsellor, The mighty God, The everlasting Father, The Prince of Peace.

Meaning in context The promised child is the divine Son and peaceful King, Jesus Christ.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 25 | Esther Is Brave; God's People Return | Mar 18 - Mar 24, 2027

Bible story Esther 2-8; Ezra 1

Week overview God placed Esther in the palace and used her courage to preserve her people. Later, God moved a Persian king to let the Jews return to Jerusalem.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6

Day 169 | Thursday, March 18, 2027 | Esther Receives Kindness

Read aloud Esther 2:5-9

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Esther 2:5-9

> 5 Now in Shushan the palace there was a certain Jew, whose name was Mordecai, the son of Jair, the son of Shimei, the son of Kish, a Benjamite;
> 6 Who had been carried away from Jerusalem with the captivity which had been carried away with Jeconiah king of Judah, whom Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon had carried away.
> 7 And he brought up Hadassah, that is, Esther, his uncle's daughter: for she had neither father nor mother, and the maid was fair and beautiful; whom Mordecai, when her father and mother were dead, took for his own daughter.
> 8 So it came to pass, when the king's commandment and his decree was heard, and when many maidens were gathered together unto Shushan the palace, to the custody of Hegai, that Esther was brought also unto the king's house, to the custody of Hegai, keeper of the women.
> 9 And the maiden pleased him, and she obtained kindness of him; and he speedily gave her her things for purification, with such things as belonged to her, and seven maidens, which were meet to be given her, out of the king's house: and he preferred her and her maids unto the best place of the house of the women.

Talk about the story Mordecai had raised Esther after her parents died. At the palace she received kindness. Her life reminds us how much caring people matter to a child.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who had raised Esther? *Answer: Mordecai.*

2. Was she taken to the palace? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Did she receive kindness there? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Families are not all the same. Name people who care for you, and show kindness to a child whose family is different from yours.

Pray together God, thank You for people who care for children. Amen.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 170 | Friday, March 19, 2027 | Esther Becomes Queen

Read aloud Esther 2:15-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Esther 2:15-17

> 15 Now when the turn of Esther, the daughter of Abihail the uncle of Mordecai, who had taken her for his daughter, was come to go in unto the king, she required nothing but what Hegai the king's chamberlain, the keeper of the women, appointed. And Esther obtained favour in the sight of all them that looked upon her.
> 16 So Esther was taken unto king Ahasuerus into his house royal in the tenth month, which is the month Tebeth, in the seventh year of his reign.
> 17 And the king loved Esther above all the women, and she obtained grace and favour in his sight more than all the virgins; so that he set the royal crown upon her head, and made her queen instead of Vashti.

Talk about the story Esther listened to advice and became queen. Her new position would bring important responsibilities. She would need courage and wisdom as well as favor.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who became queen? *Answer: Esther.*

2. Did she listen to advice? *Answer: Yes.*

3. What was placed on her head? *Answer: A royal crown.*

In your day When learning a new job, listen to someone who understands it. Try following their advice before deciding you already know enough.

Pray together God, help me listen to good advice. Amen.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 171 | Saturday, March 20, 2027 | A Wicked Plan

Read aloud Esther 3:8-11

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Esther 3:8-11

> 8 And Haman said unto king Ahasuerus, There is a certain people scattered abroad and dispersed among the people in all the provinces of thy kingdom; and their laws are diverse from all people; neither keep they the king's laws: therefore it is not for the king's profit to suffer them.
> 9 If it please the king, let it be written that they may be destroyed: and I will pay ten thousand talents of silver to the hands of those that have the charge of the business, to bring it into the king's treasuries.
> 10 And the king took his ring from his hand, and gave it unto Haman the son of Hammedatha the Agagite, the Jews' enemy.
> 11 And the king said unto Haman, The silver is given to thee, the people also, to do with them as it seemeth good to thee.

Talk about the story Haman spoke against the Jewish people and planned their destruction. He persuaded the king to approve it. Hateful lies can put innocent people in danger.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who made the wicked plan? *Answer: Haman.*

2. Whom did he accuse? *Answer: The Jewish people.*

3. Did he want to help or destroy them? *Answer: Destroy them.*

In your day If someone says a whole group of children is bad, do not repeat it. Ask what is true, and speak to an adult when people are being threatened.

Pray together God, help me refuse hateful words about people. Amen.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 172 | Sunday, March 21, 2027 | For Such a Time as This

Read aloud Esther 4:13-16

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Esther 4:13-16

> 13 Then Mordecai commanded to answer Esther, Think not with thyself that thou shalt escape in the king's house, more than all the Jews.
> 14 For if thou altogether holdest thy peace at this time, then shall there enlargement and deliverance arise to the Jews from another place; but thou and thy father's house shall be destroyed: and who knoweth whether thou art come to the kingdom for such a time as this?
> 15 Then Esther bade them return Mordecai this answer,
> 16 Go, gather together all the Jews that are present in Shushan, and fast ye for me, and neither eat nor drink three days, night or day: I also and my maidens will fast likewise; and so will I go in unto the king, which is not according to the law: and if I perish, I perish.

Talk about the story Mordecai urged Esther to help her people. She asked the Jews to fast and prepared to approach the king despite danger. She chose to act.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who urged Esther to act? *Answer: Mordecai.*

2. What did she ask the Jews to do? *Answer: Fast.*

3. Whom would she approach? *Answer: The king.*

In your day Speaking up for someone can feel scary. Practice telling a trusted adult clearly when another child needs help, even if others want you to stay quiet.

Pray together God, give me courage to help someone who needs it. Amen.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 173 | Monday, March 22, 2027 | The King Welcomes Esther

Read aloud Esther 5:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Esther 5:1-3

> 1 Now it came to pass on the third day, that Esther put on her royal apparel, and stood in the inner court of the king's house, over against the king's house: and the king sat upon his royal throne in the royal house, over against the gate of the house.
> 2 And it was so, when the king saw Esther the queen standing in the court, that she obtained favour in his sight: and the king held out to Esther the golden sceptre that was in his hand. So Esther drew near, and touched the top of the sceptre.
> 3 Then said the king unto her, What wilt thou, queen Esther? and what is thy request? it shall be even given thee to the half of the kingdom.

Talk about the story Esther entered the king's court. He held out his golden sceptre to welcome her and asked what she wanted. She now had an opportunity to speak.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who entered the court? *Answer: Esther.*

2. What did the king hold out? *Answer: His golden sceptre.*

3. Did he welcome her request? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Before asking an adult for help, think of the main thing you need to say. Practice a clear first sentence rather than giving up because you feel nervous.

Pray together God, help me speak clearly when someone needs help. Amen.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 174 | Tuesday, March 23, 2027 | Sorrow Turns to Joy

Read aloud Esther 8:15-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Esther 8:15-17

> 15 And Mordecai went out from the presence of the king in royal apparel of blue and white, and with a great crown of gold, and with a garment of fine linen and purple: and the city of Shushan rejoiced and was glad.
> 16 The Jews had light, and gladness, and joy, and honour.
> 17 And in every province, and in every city, whithersoever the king's commandment and his decree came, the Jews had joy and gladness, a feast and a good day. And many of the people of the land became Jews; for the fear of the Jews fell upon them.

Talk about the story After the danger to the Jews was challenged, they had joy and celebration. People who had feared for their lives could rejoice. Their relief was real.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Which people were joyful? *Answer: The Jewish people.*

2. Had they been in danger? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Was there mourning or celebration now? *Answer: Celebration.*

In your day Think about feeling better after a big worry. Tell the story of what helped, and thank the people who supported you.

Pray together God, thank You for relief after frightening times. Amen.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 175 | Wednesday, March 24, 2027 | The Door Opens for Home

Read aloud Ezra 1:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Ezra 1:1-5

> 1 Now in the first year of Cyrus king of Persia, that the word of the LORD by the mouth of Jeremiah might be fulfilled, the LORD stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of Persia, that he made a proclamation throughout all his kingdom, and put it also in writing, saying,
> 2 Thus saith Cyrus king of Persia, The LORD God of heaven hath given me all the kingdoms of the earth; and he hath charged me to build him an house at Jerusalem, which is in Judah.
> 3 Who is there among you of all his people? his God be with him, and let him go up to Jerusalem, which is in Judah, and build the house of the LORD God of Israel, (he is the God,) which is in Jerusalem.
> 4 And whosoever remaineth in any place where he sojourneth, let the men of his place help him with silver, and with gold, and with goods, and with beasts, beside the freewill offering for the house of God that is in Jerusalem.
> 5 Then rose up the chief of the fathers of Judah and Benjamin, and the priests, and the Levites, with all them whose spirit God had raised, to go up to build the house of the LORD which is in Jerusalem.

Talk about the story God stirred King Cyrus to let the Jews return to Jerusalem and rebuild the temple. After years away, a way home opened.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Which king allowed the return? *Answer: Cyrus.*

2. What city would they return to? *Answer: Jerusalem.*

3. What would they rebuild? *Answer: The LORD's house, the temple.*

In your day Have you missed home while away? Talk about what you would be glad to see again. Imagine how these families felt about returning.

Pray together God, care for people who long to go home. Amen.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 26 | Rebuilding and Waiting for the Promised King | Mar 25 - Mar 31, 2027

Bible story Ezra 3; Nehemiah 1-8; Micah 5; Malachi 4

Week overview The returned people rebuilt the temple and Jerusalem's walls, listened to God's law, and waited for the promised Ruler and Sun of righteousness.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6

Day 176 | Thursday, March 25, 2027 | The Temple Foundation

Read aloud Ezra 3:10-13

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Ezra 3:10-13

> 10 And when the builders laid the foundation of the temple of the LORD, they set the priests in their apparel with trumpets, and the Levites the sons of Asaph with cymbals, to praise the LORD, after the ordinance of David king of Israel.
> 11 And they sang together by course in praising and giving thanks unto the LORD; because he is good, for his mercy endureth for ever toward Israel. And all the people shouted with a great shout, when they praised the LORD, because the foundation of the house of the LORD was laid.
> 12 But many of the priests and Levites and chief of the fathers, who were ancient men, that had seen the first house, when the foundation of this house was laid before their eyes, wept with a loud voice; and many shouted aloud for joy:
> 13 So that the people could not discern the noise of the shout of joy from the noise of the weeping of the people: for the people shouted with a loud shout, and the noise was heard afar off.

Talk about the story When the temple foundation was laid, people praised the LORD. Some older people cried as they remembered the earlier temple. Joy and sadness were heard together.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What had been laid? *Answer: The temple foundation.*

2. Did people praise God? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Did some older people weep too? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Two people can feel differently about the same event. If someone cries while others celebrate, listen kindly instead of telling them they should not be sad.

Pray together God, help me care about other people's feelings. Amen.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 177 | Friday, March 26, 2027 | Nehemiah Weeps and Prays

Read aloud Nehemiah 1:3-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Nehemiah 1:3-4

> 3 And they said unto me, The remnant that are left of the captivity there in the province are in great affliction and reproach: the wall of Jerusalem also is broken down, and the gates thereof are burned with fire.
> 4 And it came to pass, when I heard these words, that I sat down and wept, and mourned certain days, and fasted, and prayed before the God of heaven,

Talk about the story Nehemiah heard that Jerusalem's wall was broken. He sat down and cried, then prayed. News about people far away mattered to him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What was broken? *Answer: Jerusalem's wall.*

2. How did Nehemiah feel? *Answer: Very sad.*

3. What did he do besides weeping? *Answer: Fasted and prayed.*

In your day When you hear that a family has lost a home, stop and pray. Ask an adult whether there is a useful way your family can help.

Pray together God, help people whose homes are damaged or unsafe. Amen.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 178 | Saturday, March 27, 2027 | Rise Up and Build

Read aloud Nehemiah 2:17-20

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Nehemiah 2:17-20

> 17 Then said I unto them, Ye see the distress that we are in, how Jerusalem lieth waste, and the gates thereof are burned with fire: come, and let us build up the wall of Jerusalem, that we be no more a reproach.
> 18 Then I told them of the hand of my God which was good upon me; as also the king's words that he had spoken unto me. And they said, Let us rise up and build. So they strengthened their hands for this good work.
> 19 But when Sanballat the Horonite, and Tobiah the servant, the Ammonite, and Geshem the Arabian, heard it, they laughed us to scorn, and despised us, and said, What is this thing that ye do? will ye rebel against the king?
> 20 Then answered I them, and said unto them, The God of heaven, he will prosper us; therefore we his servants will arise and build: but ye have no portion, nor right, nor memorial, in Jerusalem.

Talk about the story Nehemiah told the people how God had helped him. They agreed to rebuild Jerusalem's wall. Together they could begin the work.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What needed rebuilding? *Answer: Jerusalem's wall.*

2. Who told the people about God's help? *Answer: Nehemiah.*

3. Did they agree to begin? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day A messy room can look too big to clean alone. Give each person a small job and begin together. Encouraging words can help everyone start.

Pray together God, help us encourage each other and work together. Amen.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 179 | Sunday, March 28, 2027 | The People Had a Mind to Work

Read aloud Nehemiah 4:4-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Nehemiah 4:4-6

> 4 Hear, O our God; for we are despised: and turn their reproach upon their own head, and give them for a prey in the land of captivity:
> 5 And cover not their iniquity, and let not their sin be blotted out from before thee: for they have provoked thee to anger before the builders.
> 6 So built we the wall; and all the wall was joined together unto the half thereof: for the people had a mind to work.

Talk about the story Enemies mocked the builders, but they prayed and kept working. The wall rose because the people had a mind to work. Mocking did not stop the job.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did enemies do? *Answer: Mocked them.*

2. Did the people stop building? *Answer: No.*

3. Why did the work keep moving? *Answer: The people had a mind to work.*

In your day If someone laughs while you learn to draw or read, tell an adult and keep practicing. Their teasing does not decide what you can learn.

Pray together God, help me keep doing useful work when I am discouraged. Amen.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 180 | Monday, March 29, 2027 | All Ears to God's Word

Read aloud Nehemiah 8:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Nehemiah 8:1-3

> 1 And all the people gathered themselves together as one man into the street that was before the water gate; and they spake unto Ezra the scribe to bring the book of the law of Moses, which the LORD had commanded to Israel.
> 2 And Ezra the priest brought the law before the congregation both of men and women, and all that could hear with understanding, upon the first day of the seventh month.
> 3 And he read therein before the street that was before the water gate from the morning until midday, before the men and the women, and those that could understand; and the ears of all the people were attentive unto the book of the law.

Talk about the story The people gathered to hear Ezra read God's law. They paid attention because God's words mattered. Listening was something they did together.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who read God's law? *Answer: Ezra.*

2. Did the people gather together? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Were they paying attention? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Close a noisy toy or screen during Bible reading. Afterward, tell one thing you heard. If you missed it, ask to hear it again.

Pray together God, help me listen and understand Your Word. Amen.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 181 | Tuesday, March 30, 2027 | A Ruler from Bethlehem

Read aloud Micah 5:2

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Micah 5:2

> 2 But thou, Bethlehem Ephratah, though thou be little among the thousands of Judah, yet out of thee shall he come forth unto me that is to be ruler in Israel; whose goings forth have been from of old, from everlasting.

Talk about the story God promised a ruler from little Bethlehem. A small place could be part of His great plan. This promise points ahead to Jesus.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What town is named? *Answer: Bethlehem.*

2. Was it described as a great or small place? *Answer: Small.*

3. What would come from it? *Answer: A ruler for Israel.*

In your day Find a small town on a map with an adult. Important people do not all come from famous places. God also sees small homes and small children.

Pray together God, thank You for promising the King from Bethlehem. Amen.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 182 | Wednesday, March 31, 2027 | The Sun of Righteousness

Read aloud Malachi 4:1-2

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Malachi 4:1-2

> 1 For, behold, the day cometh, that shall burn as an oven; and all the proud, yea, and all that do wickedly, shall be stubble: and the day that cometh shall burn them up, saith the LORD of hosts, that it shall leave them neither root nor branch.
> 2 But unto you that fear my name shall the Sun of righteousness arise with healing in his wings; and ye shall go forth, and grow up as calves of the stall.

Talk about the story Malachi warned that God would judge evil. He also promised healing and joy for those who honor His name. Evil would not have the last word.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Does this passage warn about judgment? *Answer: Yes.*

2. Who are given a promise of healing? *Answer: Those who fear God's name.*

3. What bright picture is used? *Answer: The Sun of righteousness.*

In your day After a cold, gloomy day, sunshine can feel wonderful. God's picture of light and healing helps His people look forward with hope.

Pray together God, help us honor You and look forward to Your goodness. Amen.

Memory verse Isaiah 9:6 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 14 | Days 183-196

John Is Promised; Jesus Is Born + Shepherds, Wise Men, and Young Jesus

Thursday, April 1, 2027 through Wednesday, April 14, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 2:11

> 11 For unto you is born this day in the city of David a Saviour, which is Christ the Lord.

Meaning in context Jesus was born as the Saviour, the promised Christ, and the Lord.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 27 | John Is Promised; Jesus Is Born | Apr 1 - Apr 7, 2027

Bible story Luke 1-2

Week overview God announced the births of John the Baptist and Jesus. Mary believed, Zechariah praised, and Jesus was born in Bethlehem.

Memory verse Luke 2:11

Day 183 | Thursday, April 1, 2027 | John's Birth Is Promised

Read aloud Luke 1:5-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 1:5-17

> 5 There was in the days of Herod, the king of Judaea, a certain priest named Zacharias, of the course of Abia: and his wife was of the daughters of Aaron, and her name was Elisabeth.
> 6 And they were both righteous before God, walking in all the commandments and ordinances of the Lord blameless.
> 7 And they had no child, because that Elisabeth was barren, and they both were now well stricken in years.
> 8 And it came to pass, that while he executed the priest's office before God in the order of his course,
> 9 According to the custom of the priest's office, his lot was to burn incense when he went into the temple of the Lord.
> 10 And the whole multitude of the people were praying without at the time of incense.
> 11 And there appeared unto him an angel of the Lord standing on the right side of the altar of incense.
> 12 And when Zacharias saw him, he was troubled, and fear fell upon him.
> 13 But the angel said unto him, Fear not, Zacharias: for thy prayer is heard; and thy wife Elisabeth shall bear thee a son, and thou shalt call his name John.
> 14 And thou shalt have joy and gladness; and many shall rejoice at his birth.
> 15 For he shall be great in the sight of the Lord, and shall drink neither wine nor strong drink; and he shall be filled with the Holy Ghost, even from his mother's womb.
> 16 And many of the children of Israel shall he turn to the Lord their God.
> 17 And he shall go before him in the spirit and power of Elias, to turn the hearts of the fathers to the children, and the disobedient to the wisdom of the just; to make ready a people prepared for the Lord.

Talk about the story An angel told Zacharias that Elisabeth would have a son named John. John would prepare people for the Lord. God had a purpose for this baby's life.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who received the angel's message? *Answer: Zacharias.*

2. What would the baby be called? *Answer: John.*

3. Whose coming would he help people prepare for? *Answer: The Lord's.*

In your day Before a visitor comes, you may help get things ready. John would get people ready to hear about the Lord. Name one way you prepare to listen.

Pray together God, help us be ready to listen to You. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 2:11 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 184 | Friday, April 2, 2027 | The Angel Visits Mary

Read aloud Luke 1:26-33

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 1:26-33

> 26 And in the sixth month the angel Gabriel was sent from God unto a city of Galilee, named Nazareth,
> 27 To a virgin espoused to a man whose name was Joseph, of the house of David; and the virgin's name was Mary.
> 28 And the angel came in unto her, and said, Hail, thou that art highly favoured, the Lord is with thee: blessed art thou among women.
> 29 And when she saw him, she was troubled at his saying, and cast in her mind what manner of salutation this should be.
> 30 And the angel said unto her, Fear not, Mary: for thou hast found favour with God.
> 31 And, behold, thou shalt conceive in thy womb, and bring forth a son, and shalt call his name JESUS.
> 32 He shall be great, and shall be called the Son of the Highest: and the Lord God shall give unto him the throne of his father David:
> 33 And he shall reign over the house of Jacob for ever; and of his kingdom there shall be no end.

Talk about the story Gabriel told Mary she would have a son named Jesus. He would be called the Son of the Highest and reign forever. This was no ordinary baby.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who visited Mary? *Answer: Gabriel.*

2. What name should she give her son? *Answer: Jesus.*

3. Would His kingdom ever end? *Answer: No.*

In your day A baby's name often matters to a family. Ask who chose your name. God's message gave Jesus' name and told Mary who He is.

Pray together God, thank You for sending Jesus, the everlasting King. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 2:11 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 185 | Saturday, April 3, 2027 | Mary Believes God's Word

Read aloud Luke 1:34-38

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 1:34-38

> 34 Then said Mary unto the angel, How shall this be, seeing I know not a man?
> 35 And the angel answered and said unto her, The Holy Ghost shall come upon thee, and the power of the Highest shall overshadow thee: therefore also that holy thing which shall be born of thee shall be called the Son of God.
> 36 And, behold, thy cousin Elisabeth, she hath also conceived a son in her old age: and this is the sixth month with her, who was called barren.
> 37 For with God nothing shall be impossible.
> 38 And Mary said, Behold the handmaid of the Lord; be it unto me according to thy word. And the angel departed from her.

Talk about the story Mary asked how she could have this baby. Gabriel explained God's power. Mary accepted God's word even though the news was beyond her understanding.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did Mary ask a question? *Answer: Yes.*

2. Was anything impossible with God? *Answer: No.*

3. Did Mary accept His word? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day It is okay to ask an honest question when confused. Practice saying, "I do not understand. Can you explain?" Then listen to the answer.

Pray together God, help me bring honest questions and trust Your words. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 2:11 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 186 | Sunday, April 4, 2027 | Joy before Jesus Is Born

Read aloud Luke 1:39-45

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 1:39-45

> 39 And Mary arose in those days, and went into the hill country with haste, into a city of Juda;
> 40 And entered into the house of Zacharias, and saluted Elisabeth.
> 41 And it came to pass, that, when Elisabeth heard the salutation of Mary, the babe leaped in her womb; and Elisabeth was filled with the Holy Ghost:
> 42 And she spake out with a loud voice, and said, Blessed art thou among women, and blessed is the fruit of thy womb.
> 43 And whence is this to me, that the mother of my Lord should come to me?
> 44 For, lo, as soon as the voice of thy salutation sounded in mine ears, the babe leaped in my womb for joy.
> 45 And blessed is she that believed: for there shall be a performance of those things which were told her from the Lord.

Talk about the story Mary visited Elisabeth. The baby John leaped, and Elisabeth welcomed Mary with joy. She said Mary was blessed for believing God's promise.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did Mary visit? *Answer: Elisabeth.*

2. What did the baby do? *Answer: Leaped.*

3. Was Elisabeth joyful or angry? *Answer: Joyful.*

In your day When someone shares happy news, listen and celebrate with them. You can say, "I am glad for you," even when the news is not about you.

Pray together God, help me share in other people's happiness. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 2:11 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 187 | Monday, April 5, 2027 | John Is Born

Read aloud Luke 1:57-66

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 1:57-66

> 57 Now Elisabeth's full time came that she should be delivered; and she brought forth a son.
> 58 And her neighbours and her cousins heard how the Lord had shewed great mercy upon her; and they rejoiced with her.
> 59 And it came to pass, that on the eighth day they came to circumcise the child; and they called him Zacharias, after the name of his father.
> 60 And his mother answered and said, Not so; but he shall be called John.
> 61 And they said unto her, There is none of thy kindred that is called by this name.
> 62 And they made signs to his father, how he would have him called.
> 63 And he asked for a writing table, and wrote, saying, His name is John. And they marvelled all.
> 64 And his mouth was opened immediately, and his tongue loosed, and he spake, and praised God.
> 65 And fear came on all that dwelt round about them: and all these sayings were noised abroad throughout all the hill country of Judaea.
> 66 And all they that heard them laid them up in their hearts, saying, What manner of child shall this be! And the hand of the Lord was with him.

Talk about the story Elisabeth's baby was born, and the neighbors rejoiced. Zacharias wrote that his name was John. God had kept the promise given before his birth.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who had the baby? *Answer: Elisabeth.*

2. What did Zacharias say his name was? *Answer: John.*

3. Did the neighbors rejoice? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Ask about a time your family welcomed a baby. Who was glad? Remember that a child's life matters before anyone knows what that child will do.

Pray together God, thank You for children and those who welcome them. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 2:11 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 188 | Tuesday, April 6, 2027 | Preparing the Lord's Ways

Read aloud Luke 1:76-79

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 1:76-79

> 76 And thou, child, shalt be called the prophet of the Highest: for thou shalt go before the face of the Lord to prepare his ways;
> 77 To give knowledge of salvation unto his people by the remission of their sins,
> 78 Through the tender mercy of our God; whereby the dayspring from on high hath visited us,
> 79 To give light to them that sit in darkness and in the shadow of death, to guide our feet into the way of peace.

Talk about the story Zacharias said John would prepare the Lord's way. He would help people learn about salvation and forgiveness. The Lord would guide people into peace.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whose way would John prepare? *Answer: The Lord's.*

2. What would people learn about? *Answer: Salvation and forgiveness of sins.*

3. Into what would the Lord guide their feet? *Answer: The way of peace.*

In your day A sign points you toward a place; it is not the destination. John would point people toward the Lord. Who helps you learn about Jesus?

Pray together God, help me listen to those who teach me about Jesus. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 2:11 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 189 | Wednesday, April 7, 2027 | Jesus Is Born in Bethlehem

Read aloud Luke 2:1-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 2:1-7

> 1 And it came to pass in those days, that there went out a decree from Caesar Augustus, that all the world should be taxed.
> 2 (And this taxing was first made when Cyrenius was governor of Syria.)
> 3 And all went to be taxed, every one into his own city.
> 4 And Joseph also went up from Galilee, out of the city of Nazareth, into Judaea, unto the city of David, which is called Bethlehem; (because he was of the house and lineage of David:)
> 5 To be taxed with Mary his espoused wife, being great with child.
> 6 And so it was, that, while they were there, the days were accomplished that she should be delivered.
> 7 And she brought forth her firstborn son, and wrapped him in swaddling clothes, and laid him in a manger; because there was no room for them in the inn.

Talk about the story Mary and Joseph went to Bethlehem. Jesus was born there and laid in a manger, an animal feeding place. The promised Saviour came into an ordinary, humble setting.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where was Jesus born? *Answer: Bethlehem.*

2. Who was His mother? *Answer: Mary.*

3. Where did she lay Him? *Answer: In a manger.*

In your day Think about the soft place where a baby usually sleeps. Jesus' first bed was a manger. You do not need an impressive room to be precious to God.

Pray together God, thank You that Jesus came into our world. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 2:11 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 28 | Shepherds, Wise Men, and Young Jesus | Apr 8 - Apr 14, 2027

Bible story Luke 2; Matthew 2-3

Week overview Angels announced Jesus to shepherds, wise men worshiped Him, God protected the child, and years later Jesus was baptized before beginning His public ministry.

Memory verse Luke 2:11

Day 190 | Thursday, April 8, 2027 | Good Tidings of Great Joy

Read aloud Luke 2:8-14

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 2:8-14

> 8 And there were in the same country shepherds abiding in the field, keeping watch over their flock by night.
> 9 And, lo, the angel of the Lord came upon them, and the glory of the Lord shone round about them: and they were sore afraid.
> 10 And the angel said unto them, Fear not: for, behold, I bring you good tidings of great joy, which shall be to all people.
> 11 For unto you is born this day in the city of David a Saviour, which is Christ the Lord.
> 12 And this shall be a sign unto you; Ye shall find the babe wrapped in swaddling clothes, lying in a manger.
> 13 And suddenly there was with the angel a multitude of the heavenly host praising God, and saying,
> 14 Glory to God in the highest, and on earth peace, good will toward men.

Talk about the story Shepherds were watching sheep at night when an angel brought good news. The Saviour had been born. The frightened shepherds heard a message of great joy.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who heard the angel? *Answer: Shepherds.*

2. What were they watching? *Answer: Their sheep.*

3. Who had been born? *Answer: The Saviour, Christ the Lord.*

In your day Remember being surprised by a sudden sound at night. The angel first told the shepherds not to fear. Read the happy news slowly together.

Pray together God, thank You for the good news of Jesus' birth. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 2:11 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 191 | Friday, April 9, 2027 | The Shepherds Go and Tell

Read aloud Luke 2:15-20

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 2:15-20

> 15 And it came to pass, as the angels were gone away from them into heaven, the shepherds said one to another, Let us now go even unto Bethlehem, and see this thing which is come to pass, which the Lord hath made known unto us.
> 16 And they came with haste, and found Mary, and Joseph, and the babe lying in a manger.
> 17 And when they had seen it, they made known abroad the saying which was told them concerning this child.
> 18 And all they that heard it wondered at those things which were told them by the shepherds.
> 19 But Mary kept all these things, and pondered them in her heart.
> 20 And the shepherds returned, glorifying and praising God for all the things that they had heard and seen, as it was told unto them.

Talk about the story The shepherds hurried to find Jesus. They saw Him, told others what they had heard, and returned praising God. They acted on the angel's message.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did the shepherds hurry or refuse to go? *Answer: They hurried.*

2. Whom did they find? *Answer: Mary, Joseph, and the baby Jesus.*

3. What did they do afterward? *Answer: Told others and praised God.*

In your day Tell someone the three things you remember about Jesus' birth. If you forget a detail, look back at the passage instead of making one up.

Pray together God, help me share true things about Jesus. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 2:11 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 192 | Saturday, April 10, 2027 | Wise Men Seek the King

Read aloud Matthew 2:1-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 2:1-6

> 1 Now when Jesus was born in Bethlehem of Judaea in the days of Herod the king, behold, there came wise men from the east to Jerusalem,
> 2 Saying, Where is he that is born King of the Jews? for we have seen his star in the east, and are come to worship him.
> 3 When Herod the king had heard these things, he was troubled, and all Jerusalem with him.
> 4 And when he had gathered all the chief priests and scribes of the people together, he demanded of them where Christ should be born.
> 5 And they said unto him, In Bethlehem of Judaea: for thus it is written by the prophet,
> 6 And thou Bethlehem, in the land of Juda, art not the least among the princes of Juda: for out of thee shall come a Governor, that shall rule my people Israel.

Talk about the story Wise men came looking for the King of the Jews. The chief priests and scribes used Scripture to name Bethlehem. God's written words pointed to the place.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom were the wise men seeking? *Answer: The newborn King of the Jews.*

2. Where had they come from? *Answer: The east.*

3. What town did Scripture name? *Answer: Bethlehem.*

In your day When you need to find something, good directions help. Open the Bible and find Bethlehem in the reading; God's promise had named it.

Pray together God, thank You that Your Word tells us about Jesus. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 2:11 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 193 | Sunday, April 11, 2027 | They Worship Jesus

Read aloud Matthew 2:9-11

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 2:9-11

> 9 When they had heard the king, they departed; and, lo, the star, which they saw in the east, went before them, till it came and stood over where the young child was.
> 10 When they saw the star, they rejoiced with exceeding great joy.
> 11 And when they were come into the house, they saw the young child with Mary his mother, and fell down, and worshipped him: and when they had opened their treasures, they presented unto him gifts; gold, and frankincense, and myrrh.

Talk about the story The wise men found Jesus with Mary. They bowed, worshiped Him, and gave valuable gifts. Their visit was about honoring Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did the wise men worship? *Answer: Jesus.*

2. Did they bring gifts? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Name one gift. *Answer: Gold, frankincense, or myrrh.*

In your day At a birthday, the celebration is for someone else. When we worship Jesus, our attention belongs to Him. Name one thing about Him worth praising.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for coming. You deserve our worship. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 2:11 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 194 | Monday, April 12, 2027 | God Protects the Child

Read aloud Matthew 2:13-15

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 2:13-15

> 13 And when they were departed, behold, the angel of the Lord appeareth to Joseph in a dream, saying, Arise, and take the young child and his mother, and flee into Egypt, and be thou there until I bring thee word: for Herod will seek the young child to destroy him.
> 14 When he arose, he took the young child and his mother by night, and departed into Egypt:
> 15 And was there until the death of Herod: that it might be fulfilled which was spoken of the Lord by the prophet, saying, Out of Egypt have I called my son.

Talk about the story God warned Joseph to take Jesus and Mary to Egypt. Joseph got up and went. He listened promptly to protect the child.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who received the warning? *Answer: Joseph.*

2. Whom did he take? *Answer: Jesus and Mary.*

3. Where did they go? *Answer: Egypt.*

In your day When a trusted adult says to move away from danger, stop playing and listen. Practice coming promptly when called, then ask questions once you are safe.

Pray together God, help those who care for children keep them safe. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 2:11 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 195 | Tuesday, April 13, 2027 | Jesus Grows

Read aloud Luke 2:51-52

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 2:51-52

> 51 And he went down with them, and came to Nazareth, and was subject unto them: but his mother kept all these sayings in her heart.
> 52 And Jesus increased in wisdom and stature, and in favour with God and man.

Talk about the story Jesus returned to Nazareth and obeyed Mary and Joseph. He grew in wisdom and height. Ordinary childhood was part of His real human life.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where did Jesus return? *Answer: Nazareth.*

2. Did He obey Mary and Joseph? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Did He grow in wisdom as well as height? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Name something you are learning as you grow. Practice doing one household task when asked, remembering that Jesus also obeyed at home.

Pray together Jesus, help me learn and obey as I grow. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 2:11 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 196 | Wednesday, April 14, 2027 | Jesus Is Baptized

Read aloud Matthew 3:13-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 3:13-17

> 13 Then cometh Jesus from Galilee to Jordan unto John, to be baptized of him.
> 14 But John forbad him, saying, I have need to be baptized of thee, and comest thou to me?
> 15 And Jesus answering said unto him, Suffer it to be so now: for thus it becometh us to fulfil all righteousness. Then he suffered him.
> 16 And Jesus, when he was baptized, went up straightway out of the water: and, lo, the heavens were opened unto him, and he saw the Spirit of God descending like a dove, and lighting upon him:
> 17 And lo a voice from heaven, saying, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased.

Talk about the story John baptized Jesus. The Spirit descended like a dove, and the Father declared His love and pleasure in His Son. We see Father, Son, and Holy Spirit here.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was baptized? *Answer: Jesus.*

2. Like what did the Spirit descend? *Answer: A dove.*

3. What did the Father call Jesus? *Answer: His beloved Son.*

In your day Point to each part as an adult rereads the passage: Jesus in the water, the Spirit descending, and the Father's voice. Listen to what the Father says about Jesus.

Pray together Father, thank You for Your beloved Son, Jesus. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 2:11 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 15 | Days 197-210

Jesus Begins His Ministry + Jesus Teaches Kingdom Living

Thursday, April 15, 2027 through Wednesday, April 28, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 4:19

> 19 And he saith unto them, Follow me, and I will make you fishers of men.

Meaning in context Jesus calls people to follow Him and help others hear about Him.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 29 | Jesus Begins His Ministry | Apr 15 - Apr 21, 2027

Bible story Matthew 4; John 1-2; Luke 5

Week overview Jesus resisted Satan with Scripture, called disciples to follow Him, changed water into wine, and showed His power through a great catch of fish.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19

Day 197 | Thursday, April 15, 2027 | Man Shall Live by God's Word

Read aloud Matthew 4:1-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 4:1-4

> 1 Then was Jesus led up of the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted of the devil.
> 2 And when he had fasted forty days and forty nights, he was afterward an hungred.
> 3 And when the tempter came to him, he said, If thou be the Son of God, command that these stones be made bread.
> 4 But he answered and said, It is written, Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of God.

Talk about the story Jesus was hungry when Satan tempted Him to disobey. He answered with God's written Word. Feeling hungry did not make a wrong choice right.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who tempted Jesus? *Answer: Satan.*

2. Was Jesus hungry? *Answer: Yes.*

3. What did Jesus use to answer? *Answer: God's Word, Scripture.*

In your day Waiting for food can make you cross. Practice asking politely for help instead of grabbing or shouting. Remember a Bible command that helps you choose.

Pray together Jesus, help me do right when my feelings are strong. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 198 | Friday, April 16, 2027 | Worship the Lord Alone

Read aloud Matthew 4:8-10

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 4:8-10

> 8 Again, the devil taketh him up into an exceeding high mountain, and sheweth him all the kingdoms of the world, and the glory of them;
> 9 And saith unto him, All these things will I give thee, if thou wilt fall down and worship me.
> 10 Then saith Jesus unto him, Get thee hence, Satan: for it is written, Thou shalt worship the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve.

Talk about the story Satan offered Jesus kingdoms if He would worship him. Jesus refused. God alone deserves worship, even when someone offers something attractive in exchange.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Satan offer? *Answer: Kingdoms.*

2. What did he want Jesus to do? *Answer: Worship him.*

3. Whom did Jesus say to worship? *Answer: The Lord God alone.*

In your day If someone offers you a prize for lying, should you take the deal? Say no. Getting something you want does not make wrongdoing worthwhile.

Pray together God, help me refuse things that pull me away from You. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 199 | Saturday, April 17, 2027 | Come and See

Read aloud John 1:35-42

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 1:35-42

> 35 Again the next day after John stood, and two of his disciples;
> 36 And looking upon Jesus as he walked, he saith, Behold the Lamb of God!
> 37 And the two disciples heard him speak, and they followed Jesus.
> 38 Then Jesus turned, and saw them following, and saith unto them, What seek ye? They said unto him, Rabbi, (which is to say, being interpreted, Master,) where dwellest thou?
> 39 He saith unto them, Come and see. They came and saw where he dwelt, and abode with him that day: for it was about the tenth hour.
> 40 One of the two which heard John speak, and followed him, was Andrew, Simon Peter's brother.
> 41 He first findeth his own brother Simon, and saith unto him, We have found the Messias, which is, being interpreted, the Christ.
> 42 And he brought him to Jesus. And when Jesus beheld him, he said, Thou art Simon the son of Jona: thou shalt be called Cephas, which is by interpretation, A stone.

Talk about the story Two disciples followed Jesus and spent time with Him. Andrew then brought his brother Simon. He wanted someone he loved to meet Jesus too.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did the disciples follow? *Answer: Jesus.*

2. Who brought his brother? *Answer: Andrew.*

3. What was his brother's name? *Answer: Simon.*

In your day Think of someone with whom you enjoy sharing good news. Tell them one thing you learned about Jesus, without pressuring them to give a certain answer.

Pray together Jesus, help me share what I am learning about You. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 200 | Sunday, April 18, 2027 | Follow Me

Read aloud Matthew 4:18-22

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 4:18-22

> 18 And Jesus, walking by the sea of Galilee, saw two brethren, Simon called Peter, and Andrew his brother, casting a net into the sea: for they were fishers.
> 19 And he saith unto them, Follow me, and I will make you fishers of men.
> 20 And they straightway left their nets, and followed him.
> 21 And going on from thence, he saw other two brethren, James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother, in a ship with Zebedee their father, mending their nets; and he called them.
> 22 And they immediately left the ship and their father, and followed him.

Talk about the story Jesus called fishermen to follow Him. They left their nets and went with Him. He would teach them to bring people to Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What work were the men doing? *Answer: Fishing.*

2. Who called them? *Answer: Jesus.*

3. What did they leave behind? *Answer: Their nets and boats.*

In your day When it is time to learn, leaving a game can be hard. Practice stopping and coming when called. These fishermen left their work to follow Jesus.

Pray together Jesus, help me be willing to follow You. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 201 | Monday, April 19, 2027 | A Need at the Wedding

Read aloud John 2:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 2:1-5

> 1 And the third day there was a marriage in Cana of Galilee; and the mother of Jesus was there:
> 2 And both Jesus was called, and his disciples, to the marriage.
> 3 And when they wanted wine, the mother of Jesus saith unto him, They have no wine.
> 4 Jesus saith unto her, Woman, what have I to do with thee? mine hour is not yet come.
> 5 His mother saith unto the servants, Whatsoever he saith unto you, do it.

Talk about the story At a wedding, the wine ran out. Mary told Jesus about the need and told the servants to do what He said. She brought the problem to Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where were Jesus and Mary? *Answer: At a wedding.*

2. What had run out? *Answer: Wine.*

3. What did Mary tell the servants? *Answer: Do whatever Jesus says.*

In your day If something is missing at a meal, tell an adult calmly. You can help with the next instruction rather than blaming someone or making fun of the problem.

Pray together Jesus, help me bring needs to You and listen. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 202 | Tuesday, April 20, 2027 | Water Becomes Wine

Read aloud John 2:6-11

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 2:6-11

> 6 And there were set there six waterpots of stone, after the manner of the purifying of the Jews, containing two or three firkins apiece.
> 7 Jesus saith unto them, Fill the waterpots with water. And they filled them up to the brim.
> 8 And he saith unto them, Draw out now, and bear unto the governor of the feast. And they bare it.
> 9 When the ruler of the feast had tasted the water that was made wine, and knew not whence it was: (but the servants which drew the water knew;) the governor of the feast called the bridegroom,
> 10 And saith unto him, Every man at the beginning doth set forth good wine; and when men have well drunk, then that which is worse: but thou hast kept the good wine until now.
> 11 This beginning of miracles did Jesus in Cana of Galilee, and manifested forth his glory; and his disciples believed on him.

Talk about the story The servants filled the waterpots as Jesus directed. He changed the water into wine. This sign showed His glory, and His disciples believed on Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did the servants put in the pots? *Answer: Water.*

2. What did Jesus make it become? *Answer: Wine.*

3. What did this sign show? *Answer: His glory.*

In your day Think of following recipe directions with an adult. The servants listened carefully, but only Jesus could do this miracle. Name what they did and what He did.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for showing who You are. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 203 | Wednesday, April 21, 2027 | A Miraculous Catch

Read aloud Luke 5:4-11

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 5:4-11

> 4 Now when he had left speaking, he said unto Simon, Launch out into the deep, and let down your nets for a draught.
> 5 And Simon answering said unto him, Master, we have toiled all the night, and have taken nothing: nevertheless at thy word I will let down the net.
> 6 And when they had this done, they inclosed a great multitude of fishes: and their net brake.
> 7 And they beckoned unto their partners, which were in the other ship, that they should come and help them. And they came, and filled both the ships, so that they began to sink.
> 8 When Simon Peter saw it, he fell down at Jesus' knees, saying, Depart from me; for I am a sinful man, O Lord.
> 9 For he was astonished, and all that were with him, at the draught of the fishes which they had taken:
> 10 And so was also James, and John, the sons of Zebedee, which were partners with Simon. And Jesus said unto Simon, Fear not; from henceforth thou shalt catch men.
> 11 And when they had brought their ships to land, they forsook all, and followed him.

Talk about the story The fishermen had caught nothing, but at Jesus' word they lowered the net again. So many fish came that the nets began to break. They followed Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Had they caught fish during the night? *Answer: No.*

2. Who told them to let down the net? *Answer: Jesus.*

3. Was the catch small or very large? *Answer: Very large.*

In your day Trying again after disappointment can be hard. Ask for help with a task you have been learning, and give it another careful try.

Pray together Jesus, help me listen even when I feel discouraged. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 30 | Jesus Teaches Kingdom Living | Apr 22 - Apr 28, 2027

Bible story Matthew 5-7

Week overview In the Sermon on the Mount, Jesus taught about true blessing, shining light, loving enemies, prayer, trusting the Father, and obeying His words.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19

Day 204 | Thursday, April 22, 2027 | Blessed Hearts

Read aloud Matthew 5:1-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 5:1-6

> 1 And seeing the multitudes, he went up into a mountain: and when he was set, his disciples came unto him:
> 2 And he opened his mouth, and taught them, saying,
> 3 Blessed are the poor in spirit: for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.
> 4 Blessed are they that mourn: for they shall be comforted.
> 5 Blessed are the meek: for they shall inherit the earth.
> 6 Blessed are they which do hunger and thirst after righteousness: for they shall be filled.

Talk about the story Jesus called humble and gentle people blessed. He promised comfort to those who mourn and satisfaction to those who hunger for righteousness. He values a heart that needs God.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was teaching? *Answer: Jesus.*

2. What did He promise those who mourn? *Answer: Comfort.*

3. What do some blessed people hunger and thirst for? *Answer: Righteousness, what is right.*

In your day You may feel that only loud or popular children matter. Jesus notices the gentle child too. Tell about a time someone was gentle with you.

Pray together Jesus, help me want what is right and be gentle. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 205 | Friday, April 23, 2027 | Let Your Light Shine

Read aloud Matthew 5:14-16

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 5:14-16

> 14 Ye are the light of the world. A city that is set on an hill cannot be hid.
> 15 Neither do men light a candle, and put it under a bushel, but on a candlestick; and it giveth light unto all that are in the house.
> 16 Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven.

Talk about the story Jesus told His followers to let their light shine through good works. Other people should see those works and glorify the Father. Kind actions can point toward God.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Are His followers compared to darkness or light? *Answer: Light.*

2. Should that light be hidden? *Answer: No.*

3. Who should receive glory for their good works? *Answer: The Father in heaven.*

In your day Help put away something you did not use. If someone asks why, you can say you are learning to care for others as Jesus teaches.

Pray together God, help my kind actions point others toward You. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 206 | Saturday, April 24, 2027 | Love Your Enemies

Read aloud Matthew 5:43-48

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 5:43-48

> 43 Ye have heard that it hath been said, Thou shalt love thy neighbour, and hate thine enemy.
> 44 But I say unto you, Love your enemies, bless them that curse you, do good to them that hate you, and pray for them which despitefully use you, and persecute you;
> 45 That ye may be the children of your Father which is in heaven: for he maketh his sun to rise on the evil and on the good, and sendeth rain on the just and on the unjust.
> 46 For if ye love them which love you, what reward have ye? do not even the publicans the same?
> 47 And if ye salute your brethren only, what do ye more than others? do not even the publicans so?
> 48 Be ye therefore perfect, even as your Father which is in heaven is perfect.

Talk about the story Jesus told His followers to love enemies and pray for those who mistreat them. We can ask God to help a person without approving their hurtful behavior.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did Jesus say to love? *Answer: Even our enemies.*

2. For whom should we pray? *Answer: Those who mistreat us.*

3. Does God give sunshine to both good and evil people? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Think of someone who has been mean. Pray that they will choose kindness. Still tell an adult if they hurt or threaten you.

Pray together God, help those who hurt others change their ways. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 207 | Sunday, April 25, 2027 | The Father Hears in Secret

Read aloud Matthew 6:5-8

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 6:5-8

> 5 And when thou prayest, thou shalt not be as the hypocrites are: for they love to pray standing in the synagogues and in the corners of the streets, that they may be seen of men. Verily I say unto you, They have their reward.
> 6 But thou, when thou prayest, enter into thy closet, and when thou hast shut thy door, pray to thy Father which is in secret; and thy Father which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly.
> 7 But when ye pray, use not vain repetitions, as the heathen do: for they think that they shall be heard for their much speaking.
> 8 Be not ye therefore like unto them: for your Father knoweth what things ye have need of, before ye ask him.

Talk about the story Jesus warned against praying just to be admired. The Father hears private prayers and knows our needs. Many impressive words are not required.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Should we pray to impress people? *Answer: No.*

2. Does the Father hear in secret? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Does He know what we need? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Try a quiet prayer about one real need. You can use ordinary words. Nobody has to hear it except God.

Pray together Father, thank You for hearing my simple prayers. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 208 | Monday, April 26, 2027 | The Lord's Prayer

Read aloud Matthew 6:9-13

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 6:9-13

> 9 After this manner therefore pray ye: Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name.
> 10 Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven.
> 11 Give us this day our daily bread.
> 12 And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors.
> 13 And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.

Talk about the story Jesus taught His disciples to honor the Father, ask for daily bread, seek forgiveness, and ask for help against evil. Prayer includes both praise and needs.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. To whom does the prayer begin? *Answer: Our Father in heaven.*

2. What food does it ask for? *Answer: Daily bread.*

3. Does it ask for forgiveness? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Name a need for today, not a whole year's worries. Pray for it, then ask God to help you forgive someone and choose what is right.

Pray together Father, give us what we need today and help us forgive. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 209 | Tuesday, April 27, 2027 | Birds, Flowers, and the Father's Care

Read aloud Matthew 6:25-30

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 6:25-30

> 25 Therefore I say unto you, Take no thought for your life, what ye shall eat, or what ye shall drink; nor yet for your body, what ye shall put on. Is not the life more than meat, and the body than raiment?
> 26 Behold the fowls of the air: for they sow not, neither do they reap, nor gather into barns; yet your heavenly Father feedeth them. Are ye not much better than they?
> 27 Which of you by taking thought can add one cubit unto his stature?
> 28 And why take ye thought for raiment? Consider the lilies of the field, how they grow; they toil not, neither do they spin:
> 29 And yet I say unto you, That even Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these.
> 30 Wherefore, if God so clothe the grass of the field, which to day is, and to morrow is cast into the oven, shall he not much more clothe you, O ye of little faith?

Talk about the story Jesus pointed to birds and flowers as reminders of the Father's care. Worry does not make us stronger. We can bring our needs to Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What animals did Jesus mention? *Answer: Birds.*

2. What growing things did He mention? *Answer: Lilies or flowers.*

3. Who cares for His children? *Answer: The heavenly Father.*

In your day Watch a bird or notice a flower. Tell an adult one worry on your mind. Pray about it together rather than trying to keep it hidden.

Pray together Father, help me bring my worries to You. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 210 | Wednesday, April 28, 2027 | Build on the Rock

Read aloud Matthew 7:24-27

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 7:24-27

> 24 Therefore whosoever heareth these sayings of mine, and doeth them, I will liken him unto a wise man, which built his house upon a rock:
> 25 And the rain descended, and the floods came, and the winds blew, and beat upon that house; and it fell not: for it was founded upon a rock.
> 26 And every one that heareth these sayings of mine, and doeth them not, shall be likened unto a foolish man, which built his house upon the sand:
> 27 And the rain descended, and the floods came, and the winds blew, and beat upon that house; and it fell: and great was the fall of it.

Talk about the story Both builders heard, but only the wise one acted on Jesus' words. His house stood on rock. Hearing God's Word should lead to doing it.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where did the wise man build? *Answer: On rock.*

2. Where did the foolish man build? *Answer: On sand.*

3. Which house stood in the storm? *Answer: The house on rock.*

In your day If you hear "Put the lid on" but leave it off, paint can dry out. Name one instruction from Jesus that you can actually do today.

Pray together Jesus, help me do what I hear You teach. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 4:19 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 16 | Days 211-224

Jesus Heals and Calms the Storm + Jesus Feeds Thousands and Walks on Water

Thursday, April 29, 2027 through Wednesday, May 12, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Philippians 4:19

> 19 But my God shall supply all your need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus.

Meaning in context God faithfully supplies His people's true needs according to His riches in Christ.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 31 | Jesus Heals and Calms the Storm | Apr 29 - May 5, 2027

Bible story Mark 1-5

Week overview Jesus healed sickness, forgave sins, helped a man through faithful friends, commanded wind and sea, and raised Jairus's daughter.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19

Day 211 | Thursday, April 29, 2027 | Jesus Heals Many

Read aloud Mark 1:29-34

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Mark 1:29-34

> 29 And forthwith, when they were come out of the synagogue, they entered into the house of Simon and Andrew, with James and John.
> 30 But Simon's wife's mother lay sick of a fever, and anon they tell him of her.
> 31 And he came and took her by the hand, and lifted her up; and immediately the fever left her, and she ministered unto them.
> 32 And at even, when the sun did set, they brought unto him all that were diseased, and them that were possessed with devils.
> 33 And all the city was gathered together at the door.
> 34 And he healed many that were sick of divers diseases, and cast out many devils; and suffered not the devils to speak, because they knew him.

Talk about the story Jesus healed Simon's mother-in-law of a fever. That evening many sick people came to Him. He cared about people whose bodies were hurting.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who had a fever? *Answer: Simon's mother-in-law.*

2. Who healed her? *Answer: Jesus.*

3. Who came to the door that evening? *Answer: Many sick and suffering people.*

In your day When someone at home is sick, ask what would help. You might bring water with permission or play quietly while they rest.

Pray together Jesus, please help those who are sick today. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 212 | Friday, April 30, 2027 | Friends Open the Roof

Read aloud Mark 2:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Mark 2:1-5

> 1 And again he entered into Capernaum after some days; and it was noised that he was in the house.
> 2 And straightway many were gathered together, insomuch that there was no room to receive them, no, not so much as about the door: and he preached the word unto them.
> 3 And they come unto him, bringing one sick of the palsy, which was borne of four.
> 4 And when they could not come nigh unto him for the press, they uncovered the roof where he was: and when they had broken it up, they let down the bed wherein the sick of the palsy lay.
> 5 When Jesus saw their faith, he said unto the sick of the palsy, Son, thy sins be forgiven thee.

Talk about the story Four people carried a man who could not walk. When the crowded doorway blocked them, they opened the roof and lowered him to Jesus. Their faith led to practical help.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. How many people carried the man? *Answer: Four.*

2. Why could they not use the doorway? *Answer: The crowd blocked it.*

3. How did they get him to Jesus? *Answer: They lowered him through the roof.*

In your day If a friend cannot join an activity easily, ask how to include them. Move a chair or change the game instead of leaving them watching alone.

Pray together God, help me find ways to include and help others. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 213 | Saturday, May 1, 2027 | Rise, Take Up Thy Bed

Read aloud Mark 2:6-12

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Mark 2:6-12

> 6 But there were certain of the scribes sitting there, and reasoning in their hearts,
> 7 Why doth this man thus speak blasphemies? who can forgive sins but God only?
> 8 And immediately when Jesus perceived in his spirit that they so reasoned within themselves, he said unto them, Why reason ye these things in your hearts?
> 9 Whether is it easier to say to the sick of the palsy, Thy sins be forgiven thee; or to say, Arise, and take up thy bed, and walk?
> 10 But that ye may know that the Son of man hath power on earth to forgive sins, (he saith to the sick of the palsy,)
> 11 I say unto thee, Arise, and take up thy bed, and go thy way into thine house.
> 12 And immediately he arose, took up the bed, and went forth before them all; insomuch that they were all amazed, and glorified God, saying, We never saw it on this fashion.

Talk about the story Jesus forgave the man's sins and then told him to get up. The man walked away carrying his bed. Jesus showed His authority to forgive.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Jesus first forgive? *Answer: The man's sins.*

2. What did He tell the man to carry? *Answer: His bed.*

3. Did the man get up? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day A wrong choice and a hurt body are different needs. Jesus cared about both. You can ask forgiveness for wrongdoing and ask for help when you hurt.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for Your power to forgive sins. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 214 | Sunday, May 2, 2027 | A Hand Made Whole

Read aloud Mark 3:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Mark 3:1-5

> 1 And he entered again into the synagogue; and there was a man there which had a withered hand.
> 2 And they watched him, whether he would heal him on the sabbath day; that they might accuse him.
> 3 And he saith unto the man which had the withered hand, Stand forth.
> 4 And he saith unto them, Is it lawful to do good on the sabbath days, or to do evil? to save life, or to kill? But they held their peace.
> 5 And when he had looked round about on them with anger, being grieved for the hardness of their hearts, he saith unto the man, Stretch forth thine hand. And he stretched it out: and his hand was restored whole as the other.

Talk about the story Jesus told a man to stretch out his withered hand. The hand was restored. Some watchers cared more about accusing Jesus than helping the man.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What part of the man needed healing? *Answer: His hand.*

2. What did Jesus tell him to do? *Answer: Stretch it out.*

3. What happened to the hand? *Answer: It was restored.*

In your day When someone struggles with a task, do not stare or laugh. Ask kindly whether they would like help, and listen to their answer.

Pray together Jesus, help me care when someone needs help. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 215 | Monday, May 3, 2027 | Peace, Be Still

Read aloud Mark 4:35-41

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Mark 4:35-41

> 35 And the same day, when the even was come, he saith unto them, Let us pass over unto the other side.
> 36 And when they had sent away the multitude, they took him even as he was in the ship. And there were also with him other little ships.
> 37 And there arose a great storm of wind, and the waves beat into the ship, so that it was now full.
> 38 And he was in the hinder part of the ship, asleep on a pillow: and they awake him, and say unto him, Master, carest thou not that we perish?
> 39 And he arose, and rebuked the wind, and said unto the sea, Peace, be still. And the wind ceased, and there was a great calm.
> 40 And he said unto them, Why are ye so fearful? how is it that ye have no faith?
> 41 And they feared exceedingly, and said one to another, What manner of man is this, that even the wind and the sea obey him?

Talk about the story A storm frightened the disciples while Jesus slept in the boat. He commanded the wind and water, and they became calm. They wondered at His power.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where was Jesus? *Answer: In the boat.*

2. What did He say to the sea? *Answer: Peace, be still.*

3. What happened? *Answer: There was a great calm.*

In your day During a storm, stay near a caring adult and talk about your fear. Jesus can hear a frightened prayer; you do not have to pretend to be brave.

Pray together Jesus, help me trust You when I feel frightened. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 216 | Tuesday, May 4, 2027 | Jairus Asks for Help

Read aloud Mark 5:21-24

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Mark 5:21-24

> 21 And when Jesus was passed over again by ship unto the other side, much people gathered unto him: and he was nigh unto the sea.
> 22 And, behold, there cometh one of the rulers of the synagogue, Jairus by name; and when he saw him, he fell at his feet,
> 23 And besought him greatly, saying, My little daughter lieth at the point of death: I pray thee, come and lay thy hands on her, that she may be healed; and she shall live.
> 24 And Jesus went with him; and much people followed him, and thronged him.

Talk about the story Jairus begged Jesus to help his dying daughter. Jesus went with him. A father's frightened request mattered to Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who came to Jesus? *Answer: Jairus.*

2. Who needed help? *Answer: His daughter.*

3. Did Jesus go with him? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day When someone you love is ill, you may not know what to do. Tell an adult, and pray together for that person by name.

Pray together Jesus, please care for the sick people we love. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 217 | Wednesday, May 5, 2027 | Little Girl, Arise

Read aloud Mark 5:35-43

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Mark 5:35-43

> 35 While he yet spake, there came from the ruler of the synagogue's house certain which said, Thy daughter is dead: why troublest thou the Master any further?
> 36 As soon as Jesus heard the word that was spoken, he saith unto the ruler of the synagogue, Be not afraid, only believe.
> 37 And he suffered no man to follow him, save Peter, and James, and John the brother of James.
> 38 And he cometh to the house of the ruler of the synagogue, and seeth the tumult, and them that wept and wailed greatly.
> 39 And when he was come in, he saith unto them, Why make ye this ado, and weep? the damsel is not dead, but sleepeth.
> 40 And they laughed him to scorn. But when he had put them all out, he taketh the father and the mother of the damsel, and them that were with him, and entereth in where the damsel was lying.
> 41 And he took the damsel by the hand, and said unto her, Talitha cumi; which is, being interpreted, Damsel, I say unto thee, arise.
> 42 And straightway the damsel arose, and walked; for she was of the age of twelve years. And they were astonished with a great astonishment.
> 43 And he charged them straitly that no man should know it; and commanded that something should be given her to eat.

Talk about the story People said Jairus' daughter had died. Jesus took her hand and told her to arise. She got up, and He told them to give her food.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did people say had happened to the girl? *Answer: She had died.*

2. What did Jesus tell her to do? *Answer: Arise.*

3. What did He say to give her afterward? *Answer: Something to eat.*

In your day Notice that Jesus cared about the girl eating after this miracle. Caring for someone includes ordinary needs, like food, rest, and comfort.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for Your power and tender care. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 32 | Jesus Feeds Thousands and Walks on Water | May 6 - May 12, 2027

Bible story John 6; Matthew 14; Mark 6

Week overview Jesus multiplied a boy's lunch, walked on the sea, rescued Peter, healed crowds, and taught that He is the bread of life.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19

Day 218 | Thursday, May 6, 2027 | A Boy Shares His Lunch

Read aloud John 6:1-9

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 6:1-9

> 1 After these things Jesus went over the sea of Galilee, which is the sea of Tiberias.
> 2 And a great multitude followed him, because they saw his miracles which he did on them that were diseased.
> 3 And Jesus went up into a mountain, and there he sat with his disciples.
> 4 And the passover, a feast of the Jews, was nigh.
> 5 When Jesus then lifted up his eyes, and saw a great company come unto him, he saith unto Philip, Whence shall we buy bread, that these may eat?
> 6 And this he said to prove him: for he himself knew what he would do.
> 7 Philip answered him, Two hundred pennyworth of bread is not sufficient for them, that every one of them may take a little.
> 8 One of his disciples, Andrew, Simon Peter's brother, saith unto him,
> 9 There is a lad here, which hath five barley loaves, and two small fishes: but what are they among so many?

Talk about the story A large crowd needed food. Andrew pointed out a boy with five barley loaves and two fish. That small amount could not feed everyone without Jesus' help.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who had the food? *Answer: A boy.*

2. How many loaves were there? *Answer: Five.*

3. How many fish? *Answer: Two.*

In your day Look at a small snack and imagine sharing it with a whole crowd. Your small gift can still be useful; let an adult help you decide how to share.

Pray together Jesus, help me be willing to share what I have. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 219 | Friday, May 7, 2027 | Enough for Everyone

Read aloud John 6:10-13

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 6:10-13

> 10 And Jesus said, Make the men sit down. Now there was much grass in the place. So the men sat down, in number about five thousand.
> 11 And Jesus took the loaves; and when he had given thanks, he distributed to the disciples, and the disciples to them that were set down; and likewise of the fishes as much as they would.
> 12 When they were filled, he said unto his disciples, Gather up the fragments that remain, that nothing be lost.
> 13 Therefore they gathered them together, and filled twelve baskets with the fragments of the five barley loaves, which remained over and above unto them that had eaten.

Talk about the story Jesus gave thanks and provided enough food for the crowd. After everyone ate, the disciples gathered twelve baskets of pieces. He told them not to waste it.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Jesus do before giving the food? *Answer: Gave thanks.*

2. Did everyone have enough? *Answer: Yes.*

3. How many baskets remained? *Answer: Twelve.*

In your day At a meal, take an amount you can eat and save useful leftovers safely with an adult. Plenty is a reason for thanks, not waste.

Pray together God, thank You for our food. Help us avoid wasting it. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 220 | Saturday, May 8, 2027 | Jesus Walks on the Sea

Read aloud Matthew 14:22-27

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 14:22-27

> 22 And straightway Jesus constrained his disciples to get into a ship, and to go before him unto the other side, while he sent the multitudes away.
> 23 And when he had sent the multitudes away, he went up into a mountain apart to pray: and when the evening was come, he was there alone.
> 24 But the ship was now in the midst of the sea, tossed with waves: for the wind was contrary.
> 25 And in the fourth watch of the night Jesus went unto them, walking on the sea.
> 26 And when the disciples saw him walking on the sea, they were troubled, saying, It is a spirit; and they cried out for fear.
> 27 But straightway Jesus spake unto them, saying, Be of good cheer; it is I; be not afraid.

Talk about the story The disciples were on the water in a strong wind. Jesus came walking on the sea. He told the frightened men who He was and said not to fear.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. How did Jesus come toward the boat? *Answer: Walking on the sea.*

2. Were the disciples afraid? *Answer: Yes.*

3. What did He tell them? *Answer: It is I; be not afraid.*

In your day Sometimes a shadow looks frightening until you know what it is. Tell an adult what scared you and listen to the truth that helps you understand.

Pray together Jesus, help me listen to Your words when I am scared. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 221 | Sunday, May 9, 2027 | Peter Looks to Jesus

Read aloud Matthew 14:28-33

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 14:28-33

> 28 And Peter answered him and said, Lord, if it be thou, bid me come unto thee on the water.
> 29 And he said, Come. And when Peter was come down out of the ship, he walked on the water, to go to Jesus.
> 30 But when he saw the wind boisterous, he was afraid; and beginning to sink, he cried, saying, Lord, save me.
> 31 And immediately Jesus stretched forth his hand, and caught him, and said unto him, O thou of little faith, wherefore didst thou doubt?
> 32 And when they were come into the ship, the wind ceased.
> 33 Then they that were in the ship came and worshipped him, saying, Of a truth thou art the Son of God.

Talk about the story Peter walked toward Jesus, then became afraid and began to sink. He cried for help, and Jesus caught him immediately. His short prayer was heard.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who began to sink? *Answer: Peter.*

2. To whom did he cry? *Answer: Jesus.*

3. Did Jesus wait or catch him immediately? *Answer: He caught him immediately.*

In your day You can say "Help me" when you do not know any longer prayer. Also call to a trusted adult when you are in danger or need help.

Pray together Jesus, help me turn to You when I need help. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 222 | Monday, May 10, 2027 | All Who Touched Him Were Whole

Read aloud Mark 6:53-56

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Mark 6:53-56

> 53 And when they had passed over, they came into the land of Gennesaret, and drew to the shore.
> 54 And when they were come out of the ship, straightway they knew him,
> 55 And ran through that whole region round about, and began to carry about in beds those that were sick, where they heard he was.
> 56 And whithersoever he entered, into villages, or cities, or country, they laid the sick in the streets, and besought him that they might touch if it were but the border of his garment: and as many as touched him were made whole.

Talk about the story People recognized Jesus and brought sick neighbors to Him. Those who touched Him were healed. People helped others reach the One they trusted.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did the people recognize? *Answer: Jesus.*

2. Whom did they bring? *Answer: Sick people.*

3. Were those who touched Him healed? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day A sick neighbor may need practical care. With an adult, offer a meal, card, or help with a small job. Do not visit if it would disturb their rest.

Pray together Jesus, help us notice sick people who need care. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 223 | Tuesday, May 11, 2027 | I Am the Bread of Life

Read aloud John 6:35-40

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 6:35-40

> 35 And Jesus said unto them, I am the bread of life: he that cometh to me shall never hunger; and he that believeth on me shall never thirst.
> 36 But I said unto you, That ye also have seen me, and believe not.
> 37 All that the Father giveth me shall come to me; and him that cometh to me I will in no wise cast out.
> 38 For I came down from heaven, not to do mine own will, but the will of him that sent me.
> 39 And this is the Father's will which hath sent me, that of all which he hath given me I should lose nothing, but should raise it up again at the last day.
> 40 And this is the will of him that sent me, that every one which seeth the Son, and believeth on him, may have everlasting life: and I will raise him up at the last day.

Talk about the story Jesus called Himself the bread of life. Ordinary bread feeds our bodies; He gives everlasting life to those who believe on Him. He welcomes those who come.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Jesus call Himself? *Answer: The bread of life.*

2. What kind of life does He give? *Answer: Everlasting life.*

3. Will He cast out someone who comes to Him? *Answer: No.*

In your day Feeling hungry helps us understand needing food. Jesus meets an even deeper need: life with God. Ask an adult what believing in Him means.

Pray together Jesus, help me understand and believe Your promise of life. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 224 | Wednesday, May 12, 2027 | To Whom Shall We Go?

Read aloud John 6:66-69

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 6:66-69

> 66 From that time many of his disciples went back, and walked no more with him.
> 67 Then said Jesus unto the twelve, Will ye also go away?
> 68 Then Simon Peter answered him, Lord, to whom shall we go? thou hast the words of eternal life.
> 69 And we believe and are sure that thou art that Christ, the Son of the living God.

Talk about the story Many people stopped following Jesus. Peter stayed because Jesus had the words of eternal life. He believed Jesus was the Christ, the Son of God.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did some people leave Jesus? *Answer: Yes.*

2. Who said Jesus had the words of eternal life? *Answer: Peter.*

3. Who did Peter believe Jesus was? *Answer: The Christ, the Son of the living God.*

In your day If others stop listening during Bible time, you can still pay attention. Ask your own honest questions rather than deciding by what everyone else does.

Pray together Jesus, help me keep learning who You are. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:19 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 17 | Days 225-238

Parables of God's Kingdom + Jesus Seeks the Lost and Teaches Neighbor Love

Thursday, May 13, 2027 through Wednesday, May 26, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 19:10

> 10 For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost.

Meaning in context Jesus came with a saving purpose: to seek and save sinners who are lost.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 33 | Parables of God's Kingdom | May 13 - May 19, 2027

Bible story Matthew 13; Luke 8

Week overview Jesus used everyday pictures - soil, seed, lamps, treasure, and pearls - to reveal truths about hearing God's Word and valuing His kingdom.

Memory verse Luke 19:10

Day 225 | Thursday, May 13, 2027 | Seed on Four Soils

Read aloud Matthew 13:1-9

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 13:1-9

> 1 The same day went Jesus out of the house, and sat by the sea side.
> 2 And great multitudes were gathered together unto him, so that he went into a ship, and sat; and the whole multitude stood on the shore.
> 3 And he spake many things unto them in parables, saying, Behold, a sower went forth to sow;
> 4 And when he sowed, some seeds fell by the way side, and the fowls came and devoured them up:
> 5 Some fell upon stony places, where they had not much earth: and forthwith they sprung up, because they had no deepness of earth:
> 6 And when the sun was up, they were scorched; and because they had no root, they withered away.
> 7 And some fell among thorns; and the thorns sprung up, and choked them:
> 8 But other fell into good ground, and brought forth fruit, some an hundredfold, some sixtyfold, some thirtyfold.
> 9 Who hath ears to hear, let him hear.

Talk about the story Jesus told of seeds landing on different ground. Some were eaten or withered or choked. Seed on good soil grew and produced a crop.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who scattered the seed? *Answer: A sower.*

2. What ate the seed on the path? *Answer: Birds.*

3. Which soil produced a good crop? *Answer: Good soil.*

In your day Look at soil with an adult. Would a seed grow well on a hard path? Retell where the four groups of seed landed.

Pray together Jesus, help me listen carefully to this story. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 19:10 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 226 | Friday, May 14, 2027 | Good Ground Hears and Understands

Read aloud Matthew 13:18-23

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 13:18-23

> 18 Hear ye therefore the parable of the sower.
> 19 When any one heareth the word of the kingdom, and understandeth it not, then cometh the wicked one, and catcheth away that which was sown in his heart. This is he which received seed by the way side.
> 20 But he that received the seed into stony places, the same is he that heareth the word, and anon with joy receiveth it;
> 21 Yet hath he not root in himself, but dureth for a while: for when tribulation or persecution ariseth because of the word, by and by he is offended.
> 22 He also that received seed among the thorns is he that heareth the word; and the care of this world, and the deceitfulness of riches, choke the word, and he becometh unfruitful.
> 23 But he that received seed into the good ground is he that heareth the word, and understandeth it; which also beareth fruit, and bringeth forth, some an hundredfold, some sixty, some thirty.

Talk about the story Jesus explained that the seed pictures the message of God's kingdom. Good soil pictures someone who hears, understands, and bears fruit. Listening should make a difference.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What does the seed picture? *Answer: The word of the kingdom.*

2. Does good ground hear and understand? *Answer: Yes.*

3. What does good ground produce? *Answer: Fruit or a crop.*

In your day After hearing "Be kind," think of what that could look like while playing today. Then try it; do more than repeat the words.

Pray together God, help Your Word change how I live. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 19:10 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 227 | Saturday, May 15, 2027 | A Tiny Mustard Seed

Read aloud Matthew 13:31-32

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 13:31-32

> 31 Another parable put he forth unto them, saying, The kingdom of heaven is like to a grain of mustard seed, which a man took, and sowed in his field:
> 32 Which indeed is the least of all seeds: but when it is grown, it is the greatest among herbs, and becometh a tree, so that the birds of the air come and lodge in the branches thereof.

Talk about the story Jesus compared the kingdom of heaven to a mustard seed. It starts small and grows into a large plant. Small beginnings are not always small endings.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What seed did Jesus mention? *Answer: A mustard seed.*

2. Did it begin large or small? *Answer: Small.*

3. What could birds do in its branches? *Answer: Lodge or nest there.*

In your day Think about a tiny seed becoming a plant. Learning one Bible truth today may seem small, but it is worth beginning and continuing.

Pray together God, help me value small beginnings in learning Your Word. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 19:10 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 228 | Sunday, May 16, 2027 | Treasure in a Field

Read aloud Matthew 13:44

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 13:44

> 44 Again, the kingdom of heaven is like unto treasure hid in a field; the which when a man hath found, he hideth, and for joy thereof goeth and selleth all that he hath, and buyeth that field.

Talk about the story Jesus told of a man finding hidden treasure in a field. He gladly gave up what he had to obtain it. God's kingdom is worth more than possessions.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where was the treasure? *Answer: In a field.*

2. Was the man sad or joyful to obtain it? *Answer: Joyful.*

3. What did he sell? *Answer: All he had.*

In your day If you had to leave toys behind to be with someone you love, which would matter more? This story helps us think about what is most valuable.

Pray together God, help me see the value of belonging to Your kingdom. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 19:10 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 229 | Monday, May 17, 2027 | The Pearl of Great Price

Read aloud Matthew 13:45-46

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 13:45-46

> 45 Again, the kingdom of heaven is like unto a merchant man, seeking goodly pearls:
> 46 Who, when he had found one pearl of great price, went and sold all that he had, and bought it.

Talk about the story A merchant found one pearl of great value and sold all he had to buy it. Jesus used this picture to show the kingdom's great worth, not a price for salvation.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What was the merchant seeking? *Answer: Beautiful pearls.*

2. What did he find? *Answer: One pearl of great price.*

3. What did he sell to buy it? *Answer: All he had.*

In your day Talk about something precious that cannot be bought, like forgiveness or love. Knowing God is worth more than having a room full of toys.

Pray together God, help me treasure You above the things I own. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 19:10 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 230 | Tuesday, May 18, 2027 | Do Not Hide the Light

Read aloud Luke 8:16-18

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 8:16-18

> 16 No man, when he hath lighted a candle, covereth it with a vessel, or putteth it under a bed; but setteth it on a candlestick, that they which enter in may see the light.
> 17 For nothing is secret, that shall not be made manifest; neither any thing hid, that shall not be known and come abroad.
> 18 Take heed therefore how ye hear: for whosoever hath, to him shall be given; and whosoever hath not, from him shall be taken even that which he seemeth to have.

Talk about the story A lamp belongs where its light can be seen. Jesus told people to take care how they hear. His teaching was to be received and made known.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Should a lamp go under a bed? *Answer: No.*

2. Where should it go? *Answer: On a stand where people can see.*

3. What did Jesus tell listeners to take care about? *Answer: How they hear.*

In your day Turn on a lamp with an adult. What happens if its light is blocked? Tell someone one true thing you heard in today's lesson.

Pray together Jesus, help me hear Your teaching and share it clearly. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 19:10 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 231 | Wednesday, May 19, 2027 | A Teacher Trained for the Kingdom

Read aloud Matthew 13:51-52

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 13:51-52

> 51 Jesus saith unto them, Have ye understood all these things? They say unto him, Yea, Lord.
> 52 Then said he unto them, Therefore every scribe which is instructed unto the kingdom of heaven is like unto a man that is an householder, which bringeth forth out of his treasure things new and old.

Talk about the story Jesus compared a teacher of the kingdom to someone bringing treasures out of a house. The teacher uses what is newly learned alongside what is already known.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did Jesus ask whether they understood? *Answer: Yes.*

2. What did they answer? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Were the treasures only new? *Answer: No, new and old.*

In your day Tell an old favorite Bible story, then one new thing you learned this week. Both can help you understand God better.

Pray together God, help me remember old lessons and keep learning new ones. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 19:10 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 34 | Jesus Seeks the Lost and Teaches Neighbor Love | May 20 - May 26, 2027

Bible story Luke 10; 15

Week overview Through the good Samaritan, lost sheep, lost coin, and lost son, Jesus showed active compassion and heaven's joy over repentance.

Memory verse Luke 19:10

Day 232 | Thursday, May 20, 2027 | Who Is My Neighbor?

Read aloud Luke 10:25-29

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 10:25-29

> 25 And, behold, a certain lawyer stood up, and tempted him, saying, Master, what shall I do to inherit eternal life?
> 26 He said unto him, What is written in the law? how readest thou?
> 27 And he answering said, Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy strength, and with all thy mind; and thy neighbour as thyself.
> 28 And he said unto him, Thou hast answered right: this do, and thou shalt live.
> 29 But he, willing to justify himself, said unto Jesus, And who is my neighbour?

Talk about the story A lawyer knew the commands to love God and love his neighbor. Then he asked, "Who is my neighbour?" Jesus would show him what mercy looks like.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who asked Jesus a question? *Answer: A lawyer or expert in the law.*

2. Whom should we love with our whole heart? *Answer: God.*

3. Whom should we love as ourselves? *Answer: Our neighbor.*

In your day Do you only help people who are already your friends? Name someone outside your usual group who might need kindness.

Pray together God, help me care beyond my own group of friends. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 19:10 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 233 | Friday, May 21, 2027 | The Samaritan Stops

Read aloud Luke 10:30-35

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 10:30-35

> 30 And Jesus answering said, A certain man went down from Jerusalem to Jericho, and fell among thieves, which stripped him of his raiment, and wounded him, and departed, leaving him half dead.
> 31 And by chance there came down a certain priest that way: and when he saw him, he passed by on the other side.
> 32 And likewise a Levite, when he was at the place, came and looked on him, and passed by on the other side.
> 33 But a certain Samaritan, as he journeyed, came where he was: and when he saw him, he had compassion on him,
> 34 And went to him, and bound up his wounds, pouring in oil and wine, and set him on his own beast, and brought him to an inn, and took care of him.
> 35 And on the morrow when he departed, he took out two pence, and gave them to the host, and said unto him, Take care of him; and whatsoever thou spendest more, when I come again, I will repay thee.

Talk about the story A wounded man needed help. Others passed, but a Samaritan stopped, treated his wounds, and paid for his care. Compassion became action.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was lying hurt? *Answer: A man attacked by robbers.*

2. Who stopped to help? *Answer: A Samaritan.*

3. Did he pay for the man's care? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day If a child falls at play, call an adult and stay nearby if safe. Asking "Are you okay?" matters more than staring or laughing.

Pray together God, help me stop and get help when someone is hurt. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 19:10 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 234 | Saturday, May 22, 2027 | Go, and Do Thou Likewise

Read aloud Luke 10:36-37

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 10:36-37

> 36 Which now of these three, thinkest thou, was neighbour unto him that fell among the thieves?
> 37 And he said, He that shewed mercy on him. Then said Jesus unto him, Go, and do thou likewise.

Talk about the story Jesus asked who had been a neighbor to the wounded man. The answer was the one who showed mercy. Jesus said to do likewise.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who acted as a neighbor? *Answer: The one who showed mercy.*

2. Did Jesus say only to talk about mercy? *Answer: No.*

3. What did He say to do? *Answer: Go and do likewise.*

In your day Look for one person who needs help today. Ask what they need instead of waiting until they can do something for you.

Pray together God, help me show mercy with my actions. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 19:10 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 235 | Sunday, May 23, 2027 | The Shepherd Finds One Sheep

Read aloud Luke 15:1-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 15:1-7

> 1 Then drew near unto him all the publicans and sinners for to hear him.
> 2 And the Pharisees and scribes murmured, saying, This man receiveth sinners, and eateth with them.
> 3 And he spake this parable unto them, saying,
> 4 What man of you, having an hundred sheep, if he lose one of them, doth not leave the ninety and nine in the wilderness, and go after that which is lost, until he find it?
> 5 And when he hath found it, he layeth it on his shoulders, rejoicing.
> 6 And when he cometh home, he calleth together his friends and neighbours, saying unto them, Rejoice with me; for I have found my sheep which was lost.
> 7 I say unto you, that likewise joy shall be in heaven over one sinner that repenteth, more than over ninety and nine just persons, which need no repentance.

Talk about the story Jesus told of a shepherd searching for one lost sheep. Finding it brought joy. He said there is joy in heaven over a sinner who repents.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. How many sheep were lost? *Answer: One.*

2. Did the shepherd give up looking? *Answer: No.*

3. Was he glad when he found it? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Have you searched carefully for a lost pet or favorite thing? That helps you picture the search. People matter much more, and Jesus seeks lost sinners.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for caring about lost people. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 19:10 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 236 | Monday, May 24, 2027 | The Woman Finds Her Coin

Read aloud Luke 15:8-10

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 15:8-10

> 8 Either what woman having ten pieces of silver, if she lose one piece, doth not light a candle, and sweep the house, and seek diligently till she find it?
> 9 And when she hath found it, she calleth her friends and her neighbours together, saying, Rejoice with me; for I have found the piece which I had lost.
> 10 Likewise, I say unto you, there is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner that repenteth.

Talk about the story A woman searched carefully for a lost coin and celebrated when she found it. Jesus used her joy to explain heaven's joy over one sinner turning to God.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did the woman lose? *Answer: A coin.*

2. Did she search carefully? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Whom did she call to rejoice with her? *Answer: Friends and neighbors.*

In your day Imagine looking under furniture for something precious. Why keep looking? Discuss how valuable people are to God, including someone others overlook.

Pray together God, thank You that one person matters to You. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 19:10 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 237 | Tuesday, May 25, 2027 | The Father Welcomes His Son

Read aloud Luke 15:20-24

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 15:20-24

> 20 And he arose, and came to his father. But when he was yet a great way off, his father saw him, and had compassion, and ran, and fell on his neck, and kissed him.
> 21 And the son said unto him, Father, I have sinned against heaven, and in thy sight, and am no more worthy to be called thy son.
> 22 But the father said to his servants, Bring forth the best robe, and put it on him; and put a ring on his hand, and shoes on his feet:
> 23 And bring hither the fatted calf, and kill it; and let us eat, and be merry:
> 24 For this my son was dead, and is alive again; he was lost, and is found. And they began to be merry.

Talk about the story The son returned and admitted his sin. His father ran to welcome him and celebrated his return. Jesus shows the joy of receiving someone who turns back.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did the son admit doing wrong? *Answer: Yes.*

2. Did the father run away or toward him? *Answer: Toward him.*

3. Was there a celebration? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day After doing wrong, you may be afraid to admit it. Practice a truthful apology with a caring adult. Hiding keeps you from getting help.

Pray together God, help me turn back to You when I sin. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 19:10 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 238 | Wednesday, May 26, 2027 | Come into the Father's Joy

Read aloud Luke 15:25-32

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 15:25-32

> 25 Now his elder son was in the field: and as he came and drew nigh to the house, he heard musick and dancing.
> 26 And he called one of the servants, and asked what these things meant.
> 27 And he said unto him, Thy brother is come; and thy father hath killed the fatted calf, because he hath received him safe and sound.
> 28 And he was angry, and would not go in: therefore came his father out, and intreated him.
> 29 And he answering said to his father, Lo, these many years do I serve thee, neither transgressed I at any time thy commandment: and yet thou never gavest me a kid, that I might make merry with my friends:
> 30 But as soon as this thy son was come, which hath devoured thy living with harlots, thou hast killed for him the fatted calf.
> 31 And he said unto him, Son, thou art ever with me, and all that I have is thine.
> 32 It was meet that we should make merry, and be glad: for this thy brother was dead, and is alive again; and was lost, and is found.

Talk about the story The older brother resented the welcome given to his brother. The father urged him to share the joy. His brother had been lost and was found.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was angry about the celebration? *Answer: The older brother.*

2. Who came to speak to him? *Answer: His father.*

3. Why was the father glad? *Answer: His lost son had returned.*

In your day When someone who behaved badly gets help, you may think it is unfair. Can you be glad they are changing rather than wishing they stayed in trouble?

Pray together God, help me rejoice when someone turns from wrong. Amen.

Memory verse Luke 19:10 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 18 | Days 239-252

Jesus Welcomes Children and Changes Zacchaeus + Jesus Raises Lazarus

Thursday, May 27, 2027 through Wednesday, June 9, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 11:25

> 25 Jesus said unto her, I am the resurrection, and the life: he that believeth in me, though he were dead, yet shall he live:

Meaning in context Jesus Himself is the resurrection and life, so death cannot defeat His people.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 35 | Jesus Welcomes Children and Changes Zacchaeus | May 27 - Jun 2, 2027

Bible story Mark 10; Luke 18-19; John 10

Week overview Jesus welcomed little children, healed a blind beggar, called Zacchaeus down from a tree, and described Himself as the good shepherd.

Memory verse John 11:25

Day 239 | Thursday, May 27, 2027 | Let the Little Children Come

Read aloud Mark 10:13-16

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Mark 10:13-16

> 13 And they brought young children to him, that he should touch them: and his disciples rebuked those that brought them.
> 14 But when Jesus saw it, he was much displeased, and said unto them, Suffer the little children to come unto me, and forbid them not: for of such is the kingdom of God.
> 15 Verily I say unto you, Whosoever shall not receive the kingdom of God as a little child, he shall not enter therein.
> 16 And he took them up in his arms, put his hands upon them, and blessed them.

Talk about the story The disciples tried to send children away, but Jesus welcomed them. He took them in His arms and blessed them. Children mattered to Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who tried to stop the children? *Answer: The disciples.*

2. Did Jesus want them sent away? *Answer: No.*

3. What did He do for them? *Answer: Welcomed and blessed them.*

In your day You are not too small to matter to Jesus. Tell Him one thing on your mind. Adults should make room for children to ask and learn.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for welcoming children. Amen.

Memory verse John 11:25 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 240 | Friday, May 28, 2027 | A Blind Man Calls to Jesus

Read aloud Luke 18:35-39

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 18:35-39

> 35 And it came to pass, that as he was come nigh unto Jericho, a certain blind man sat by the way side begging:
> 36 And hearing the multitude pass by, he asked what it meant.
> 37 And they told him, that Jesus of Nazareth passeth by.
> 38 And he cried, saying, Jesus, thou Son of David, have mercy on me.
> 39 And they which went before rebuked him, that he should hold his peace: but he cried so much the more, Thou Son of David, have mercy on me.

Talk about the story A blind man heard that Jesus was passing and called for mercy. Others told him to be quiet, but he kept calling. He knew he needed help.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What could the man not do? *Answer: See.*

2. Whom did he call to? *Answer: Jesus.*

3. Did he stop when others told him to be quiet? *Answer: No.*

In your day If you need help and someone does not hear, ask again or find another trusted adult. Your need matters even when people are busy.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for hearing people others overlook. Amen.

Memory verse John 11:25 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 241 | Saturday, May 29, 2027 | Receive Thy Sight

Read aloud Luke 18:40-43

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 18:40-43

> 40 And Jesus stood, and commanded him to be brought unto him: and when he was come near, he asked him,
> 41 Saying, What wilt thou that I shall do unto thee? And he said, Lord, that I may receive my sight.
> 42 And Jesus said unto him, Receive thy sight: thy faith hath saved thee.
> 43 And immediately he received his sight, and followed him, glorifying God: and all the people, when they saw it, gave praise unto God.

Talk about the story Jesus stopped and asked the blind man what he wanted. He asked to see, and Jesus healed him. The man followed Him and praised God.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Jesus ask? *Answer: What the man wanted Him to do.*

2. What did the man want? *Answer: To see.*

3. What did he do after receiving sight? *Answer: Followed Jesus and praised God.*

In your day When someone asks for help, listen to what they actually need. Do not decide for them before hearing their answer.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for caring about people's real needs. Amen.

Memory verse John 11:25 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 242 | Sunday, May 30, 2027 | Zacchaeus Climbs a Tree

Read aloud Luke 19:1-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 19:1-4

> 1 And Jesus entered and passed through Jericho.
> 2 And, behold, there was a man named Zacchaeus, which was the chief among the publicans, and he was rich.
> 3 And he sought to see Jesus who he was; and could not for the press, because he was little of stature.
> 4 And he ran before, and climbed up into a sycomore tree to see him: for he was to pass that way.

Talk about the story Zacchaeus could not see Jesus over the crowd because he was short. He climbed a sycamore tree. He really wanted to see who Jesus was.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Why could Zacchaeus not see well? *Answer: He was short and the crowd blocked him.*

2. What did he climb? *Answer: A sycamore tree.*

3. Whom did he want to see? *Answer: Jesus.*

In your day Have taller people blocked your view? Remember that feeling when a smaller child is behind you. Make space so they can see too.

Pray together God, help me notice people who cannot see or join in. Amen.

Memory verse John 11:25 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 243 | Monday, May 31, 2027 | Jesus Calls His Name

Read aloud Luke 19:5-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 19:5-7

> 5 And when Jesus came to the place, he looked up, and saw him, and said unto him, Zacchaeus, make haste, and come down; for to day I must abide at thy house.
> 6 And he made haste, and came down, and received him joyfully.
> 7 And when they saw it, they all murmured, saying, That he was gone to be guest with a man that is a sinner.

Talk about the story Jesus looked up and called Zacchaeus by name. He chose to stay at his house. Zacchaeus hurried down and received Him joyfully.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who called Zacchaeus? *Answer: Jesus.*

2. What did Jesus want to do? *Answer: Stay at his house.*

3. How did Zacchaeus receive Him? *Answer: Joyfully.*

In your day Being called by name can make you feel noticed. Learn a new child's name and greet them kindly instead of treating them like part of the crowd.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for noticing people others avoid. Amen.

Memory verse John 11:25 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 244 | Tuesday, June 1, 2027 | A Changed Man

Read aloud Luke 19:8-10

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 19:8-10

> 8 And Zacchaeus stood, and said unto the Lord; Behold, Lord, the half of my goods I give to the poor; and if I have taken any thing from any man by false accusation, I restore him fourfold.
> 9 And Jesus said unto him, This day is salvation come to this house, forsomuch as he also is a son of Abraham.
> 10 For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost.

Talk about the story Zacchaeus promised to help the poor and repay people he had cheated. His actions showed a changed direction. Jesus came to seek and save the lost.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did Zacchaeus promise to help? *Answer: The poor.*

2. What would he do for people he cheated? *Answer: Repay them.*

3. Whom did Jesus come to seek and save? *Answer: The lost.*

In your day If you took someone's pencil, saying sorry includes returning it. Ask an adult how to repair harm you caused instead of only wishing it away.

Pray together Jesus, help me put right what I have done wrong. Amen.

Memory verse John 11:25 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 245 | Wednesday, June 2, 2027 | The Good Shepherd

Read aloud John 10:11-14

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 10:11-14

> 11 I am the good shepherd: the good shepherd giveth his life for the sheep.
> 12 But he that is an hireling, and not the shepherd, whose own the sheep are not, seeth the wolf coming, and leaveth the sheep, and fleeth: and the wolf catcheth them, and scattereth the sheep.
> 13 The hireling fleeth, because he is an hireling, and careth not for the sheep.
> 14 I am the good shepherd, and know my sheep, and am known of mine.

Talk about the story Jesus called Himself the good shepherd who gives His life for the sheep. He knows His own and does not abandon them like a hired helper might.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who is the good shepherd? *Answer: Jesus.*

2. What does He give for the sheep? *Answer: His life.*

3. Does He know His sheep? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day A caring grown-up knows more than your name; they know your needs. Jesus' care for His people is deeper still. Ask what giving His life means.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for giving Your life to save sinners. Amen.

Memory verse John 11:25 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 36 | Jesus Raises Lazarus | Jun 3 - Jun 9, 2027

Bible story John 11-12

Week overview Jesus loved Martha, Mary, and Lazarus. He wept with the sisters, called Lazarus from the tomb, and revealed Himself as the resurrection and the life.

Memory verse John 11:25

Day 246 | Thursday, June 3, 2027 | Jesus Loves This Family

Read aloud John 11:1-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 11:1-4

> 1 Now a certain man was sick, named Lazarus, of Bethany, the town of Mary and her sister Martha.
> 2 (It was that Mary which anointed the Lord with ointment, and wiped his feet with her hair, whose brother Lazarus was sick.)
> 3 Therefore his sisters sent unto him, saying, Lord, behold, he whom thou lovest is sick.
> 4 When Jesus heard that, he said, This sickness is not unto death, but for the glory of God, that the Son of God might be glorified thereby.

Talk about the story Mary and Martha sent Jesus word that Lazarus was sick. They knew Jesus loved him. Sickness did not mean that Jesus had stopped loving their family.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was sick? *Answer: Lazarus.*

2. Who sent word to Jesus? *Answer: His sisters.*

3. Did they know Jesus loved him? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day When someone you love is ill, it can be confusing. Tell God plainly, "This person is sick. Please help." Stay close to people who can comfort you.

Pray together Jesus, help our loved ones who are sick. Amen.

Memory verse John 11:25 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 247 | Friday, June 4, 2027 | I Am the Resurrection

Read aloud John 11:17-27

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 11:17-27

> 17 Then when Jesus came, he found that he had lain in the grave four days already.
> 18 Now Bethany was nigh unto Jerusalem, about fifteen furlongs off:
> 19 And many of the Jews came to Martha and Mary, to comfort them concerning their brother.
> 20 Then Martha, as soon as she heard that Jesus was coming, went and met him: but Mary sat still in the house.
> 21 Then said Martha unto Jesus, Lord, if thou hadst been here, my brother had not died.
> 22 But I know, that even now, whatsoever thou wilt ask of God, God will give it thee.
> 23 Jesus saith unto her, Thy brother shall rise again.
> 24 Martha saith unto him, I know that he shall rise again in the resurrection at the last day.
> 25 Jesus said unto her, I am the resurrection, and the life: he that believeth in me, though he were dead, yet shall he live:
> 26 And whosoever liveth and believeth in me shall never die. Believest thou this?
> 27 She saith unto him, Yea, Lord: I believe that thou art the Christ, the Son of God, which should come into the world.

Talk about the story Martha was grieving when Jesus told her He is the resurrection and the life. She believed He was the Christ, the Son of God. Her hope rested in Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who met Jesus? *Answer: Martha.*

2. What did Jesus call Himself? *Answer: The resurrection and the life.*

3. Did Martha believe He was the Son of God? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day If you have questions about death, ask a trusted adult. Read Jesus' promise together and take time with words you do not understand.

Pray together Jesus, help me understand Your promise of life. Amen.

Memory verse John 11:25 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 248 | Saturday, June 5, 2027 | Jesus Wept

Read aloud John 11:32-36

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 11:32-36

> 32 Then when Mary was come where Jesus was, and saw him, she fell down at his feet, saying unto him, Lord, if thou hadst been here, my brother had not died.
> 33 When Jesus therefore saw her weeping, and the Jews also weeping which came with her, he groaned in the spirit, and was troubled,
> 34 And said, Where have ye laid him? They said unto him, Lord, come and see.
> 35 Jesus wept.
> 36 Then said the Jews, Behold how he loved him!

Talk about the story Mary cried, and Jesus was deeply moved. He wept too. His tears showed care for people grieving the death of someone they loved.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was crying at Jesus' feet? *Answer: Mary.*

2. Did Jesus weep too? *Answer: Yes.*

3. What did people notice? *Answer: How He loved Lazarus.*

In your day When a friend cries, you do not have to hurry them to be happy. Sit nearby, listen, and tell an adult if they need more help.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for caring when we are sad. Amen.

Memory verse John 11:25 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 249 | Sunday, June 6, 2027 | Lazarus, Come Forth

Read aloud John 11:38-44

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 11:38-44

> 38 Jesus therefore again groaning in himself cometh to the grave. It was a cave, and a stone lay upon it.
> 39 Jesus said, Take ye away the stone. Martha, the sister of him that was dead, saith unto him, Lord, by this time he stinketh: for he hath been dead four days.
> 40 Jesus saith unto her, Said I not unto thee, that, if thou wouldest believe, thou shouldest see the glory of God?
> 41 Then they took away the stone from the place where the dead was laid. And Jesus lifted up his eyes, and said, Father, I thank thee that thou hast heard me.
> 42 And I knew that thou hearest me always: but because of the people which stand by I said it, that they may believe that thou hast sent me.
> 43 And when he thus had spoken, he cried with a loud voice, Lazarus, come forth.
> 44 And he that was dead came forth, bound hand and foot with graveclothes: and his face was bound about with a napkin. Jesus saith unto them, Loose him, and let him go.

Talk about the story Jesus called Lazarus from the tomb, and he came out alive. Jesus told the people to loose his graveclothes. His voice had power over death.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did Jesus call? *Answer: Lazarus.*

2. Did Lazarus come out alive? *Answer: Yes.*

3. What did Jesus tell people to remove? *Answer: His graveclothes or wrappings.*

In your day Retell the moment from the stone being moved to Lazarus coming out. This was Jesus' miracle; the people could only help remove the wrappings afterward.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for showing Your power over death. Amen.

Memory verse John 11:25 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 250 | Monday, June 7, 2027 | Mary Honors Jesus

Read aloud John 12:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 12:1-3

> 1 Then Jesus six days before the passover came to Bethany, where Lazarus was which had been dead, whom he raised from the dead.
> 2 There they made him a supper; and Martha served: but Lazarus was one of them that sat at the table with him.
> 3 Then took Mary a pound of ointment of spikenard, very costly, and anointed the feet of Jesus, and wiped his feet with her hair: and the house was filled with the odour of the ointment.

Talk about the story Mary used costly ointment on Jesus' feet and wiped them with her hair. The house filled with its scent. She honored Jesus with something valuable.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who anointed Jesus' feet? *Answer: Mary.*

2. Was the ointment cheap or costly? *Answer: Costly.*

3. What filled the house? *Answer: Its fragrance.*

In your day A gift can show love when it costs time or effort. Make a thoughtful thank-you for someone instead of giving only what you no longer want.

Pray together Jesus, help me honor You with love and gratitude. Amen.

Memory verse John 11:25 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 251 | Tuesday, June 8, 2027 | Many Come to See

Read aloud John 12:9-11

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 12:9-11

> 9 Much people of the Jews therefore knew that he was there: and they came not for Jesus' sake only, but that they might see Lazarus also, whom he had raised from the dead.
> 10 But the chief priests consulted that they might put Lazarus also to death;
> 11 Because that by reason of him many of the Jews went away, and believed on Jesus.

Talk about the story People came to see Jesus and Lazarus. Many believed because Lazarus was alive, but hostile leaders planned to kill him. The same miracle drew very different responses.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did people come to see besides Jesus? *Answer: Lazarus.*

2. Were many people believing in Jesus? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Were the chief priests pleased about this? *Answer: No.*

In your day When someone else does well, do you celebrate or feel threatened? Practice being glad about another person's good news instead of trying to spoil it.

Pray together God, help me welcome what is true instead of resenting it. Amen.

Memory verse John 11:25 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 252 | Wednesday, June 9, 2027 | A Grain of Wheat

Read aloud John 12:23-26

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 12:23-26

> 23 And Jesus answered them, saying, The hour is come, that the Son of man should be glorified.
> 24 Verily, verily, I say unto you, Except a corn of wheat fall into the ground and die, it abideth alone: but if it die, it bringeth forth much fruit.
> 25 He that loveth his life shall lose it; and he that hateth his life in this world shall keep it unto life eternal.
> 26 If any man serve me, let him follow me; and where I am, there shall also my servant be: if any man serve me, him will my Father honour.

Talk about the story Jesus pictured His coming death with a grain of wheat that falls into the ground and bears much fruit. Through His death, life would come to many.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What seed did Jesus describe? *Answer: A grain of wheat.*

2. Can it bear much fruit after falling into the ground? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Whom should His servants follow? *Answer: Jesus.*

In your day Look at a seed with an adult. It is small, but a crop can grow from it. Jesus used that picture to explain why His death mattered.

Pray together Jesus, thank You that Your death brings life to those who believe. Amen.

Memory verse John 11:25 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 19 | Days 253-266

The King Enters Jerusalem + The Last Supper and Jesus' Arrest

Thursday, June 10, 2027 through Wednesday, June 23, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 13:34

> 34 A new commandment I give unto you, That ye love one another; as I have loved you, that ye also love one another.

Meaning in context Jesus' disciples are to love one another by the pattern of His own sacrificial love.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 37 | The King Enters Jerusalem | Jun 10 - Jun 16, 2027

Bible story Matthew 21; 24-25; Mark 12

Week overview Jesus entered Jerusalem as King, cleansed the temple, answered leaders, praised a widow's gift, and taught His followers to love and stay ready.

Memory verse John 13:34

Day 253 | Thursday, June 10, 2027 | Hosanna to the Son of David

Read aloud Matthew 21:1-9

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 21:1-9

> 1 And when they drew nigh unto Jerusalem, and were come to Bethphage, unto the mount of Olives, then sent Jesus two disciples,
> 2 Saying unto them, Go into the village over against you, and straightway ye shall find an ass tied, and a colt with her: loose them, and bring them unto me.
> 3 And if any man say ought unto you, ye shall say, The Lord hath need of them; and straightway he will send them.
> 4 All this was done, that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet, saying,
> 5 Tell ye the daughter of Sion, Behold, thy King cometh unto thee, meek, and sitting upon an ass, and a colt the foal of an ass.
> 6 And the disciples went, and did as Jesus commanded them,
> 7 And brought the ass, and the colt, and put on them their clothes, and they set him thereon.
> 8 And a very great multitude spread their garments in the way; others cut down branches from the trees, and strawed them in the way.
> 9 And the multitudes that went before, and that followed, cried, saying, Hosanna to the Son of David: Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord; Hosanna in the highest.

Talk about the story Jesus rode into Jerusalem on a donkey. People spread garments and branches on the road and shouted praise. They welcomed Him as the Son of David.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What animal did Jesus ride? *Answer: A donkey.*

2. What did people spread on the road? *Answer: Garments and branches.*

3. What word did they shout? *Answer: Hosanna.*

In your day Think of welcoming someone important. What could you say to honor Jesus? Choose words about who He is, not only about getting something from Him.

Pray together Jesus, You are worthy of our praise. Amen.

Memory verse John 13:34 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 254 | Friday, June 11, 2027 | God's House Is for Prayer

Read aloud Matthew 21:12-16

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 21:12-16

> 12 And Jesus went into the temple of God, and cast out all them that sold and bought in the temple, and overthrew the tables of the moneychangers, and the seats of them that sold doves,
> 13 And said unto them, It is written, My house shall be called the house of prayer; but ye have made it a den of thieves.
> 14 And the blind and the lame came to him in the temple; and he healed them.
> 15 And when the chief priests and scribes saw the wonderful things that he did, and the children crying in the temple, and saying, Hosanna to the Son of David; they were sore displeased,
> 16 And said unto him, Hearest thou what these say? And Jesus saith unto them, Yea; have ye never read, Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings thou hast perfected praise?

Talk about the story Jesus called the temple a house of prayer. He drove out the sellers, healed people, and received children's praise. Worship and care belonged there.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Jesus call God's house? *Answer: A house of prayer.*

2. Did He heal people there? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Who praised Him? *Answer: Children.*

In your day At church, there is room to pray, learn, and care for people. Name a way you can help someone listen or feel welcome.

Pray together Jesus, help us honor You when we gather at church. Amen.

Memory verse John 13:34 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 255 | Saturday, June 12, 2027 | Jesus' Authority Questioned

Read aloud Matthew 21:23-27

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 21:23-27

> 23 And when he was come into the temple, the chief priests and the elders of the people came unto him as he was teaching, and said, By what authority doest thou these things? and who gave thee this authority?
> 24 And Jesus answered and said unto them, I also will ask you one thing, which if ye tell me, I in like wise will tell you by what authority I do these things.
> 25 The baptism of John, whence was it? from heaven, or of men? And they reasoned with themselves, saying, If we shall say, From heaven; he will say unto us, Why did ye not then believe him?
> 26 But if we shall say, Of men; we fear the people; for all hold John as a prophet.
> 27 And they answered Jesus, and said, We cannot tell. And he said unto them, Neither tell I you by what authority I do these things.

Talk about the story Leaders questioned Jesus' authority. When He asked about John's baptism, they worried about people's reactions instead of answering honestly. They avoided the truth.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did the leaders question? *Answer: Jesus' authority.*

2. Whose baptism did Jesus ask about? *Answer: John's.*

3. Did they give Him a clear answer? *Answer: No.*

In your day Have you changed your answer because friends might laugh? Practice telling the truth kindly even when it is not the popular answer.

Pray together God, help me care more about truth than looking good. Amen.

Memory verse John 13:34 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 256 | Sunday, June 13, 2027 | Love God and Your Neighbor

Read aloud Mark 12:28-34

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Mark 12:28-34

> 28 And one of the scribes came, and having heard them reasoning together, and perceiving that he had answered them well, asked him, Which is the first commandment of all?
> 29 And Jesus answered him, The first of all the commandments is, Hear, O Israel; The Lord our God is one Lord:
> 30 And thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind, and with all thy strength: this is the first commandment.
> 31 And the second is like, namely this, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself. There is none other commandment greater than these.
> 32 And the scribe said unto him, Well, Master, thou hast said the truth: for there is one God; and there is none other but he:
> 33 And to love him with all the heart, and with all the understanding, and with all the soul, and with all the strength, and to love his neighbour as himself, is more than all whole burnt offerings and sacrifices.
> 34 And when Jesus saw that he answered discreetly, he said unto him, Thou art not far from the kingdom of God. And no man after that durst ask him any question.

Talk about the story Jesus said the greatest commands are to love God with our whole selves and love our neighbor as ourselves. Love should guide our choices.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom should we love with all our heart? *Answer: God.*

2. How should we love our neighbor? *Answer: As ourselves.*

3. Did Jesus call these great commandments? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day If you were the new child, how would you want to be treated? Do that for someone else today, such as inviting them to join.

Pray together God, help me love You and care for my neighbor. Amen.

Memory verse John 13:34 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 257 | Monday, June 14, 2027 | The Widow Gives Two Mites

Read aloud Mark 12:41-44

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Mark 12:41-44

> 41 And Jesus sat over against the treasury, and beheld how the people cast money into the treasury: and many that were rich cast in much.
> 42 And there came a certain poor widow, and she threw in two mites, which make a farthing.
> 43 And he called unto him his disciples, and saith unto them, Verily I say unto you, That this poor widow hath cast more in, than all they which have cast into the treasury:
> 44 For all they did cast in of their abundance; but she of her want did cast in all that she had, even all her living.

Talk about the story Jesus noticed a poor widow give two small coins. Her gift mattered because she gave from her need. He saw what others might overlook.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. How many coins did the widow give? *Answer: Two.*

2. Was she rich or poor? *Answer: Poor.*

3. Who noticed the meaning of her gift? *Answer: Jesus.*

In your day A small drawing made with care can mean more than an expensive gift given carelessly. Discuss how thought and love matter when giving.

Pray together Jesus, help me give with a loving heart. Amen.

Memory verse John 13:34 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 258 | Tuesday, June 15, 2027 | Watch and Be Ready

Read aloud Matthew 24:42-44

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 24:42-44

> 42 Watch therefore: for ye know not what hour your Lord doth come.
> 43 But know this, that if the goodman of the house had known in what watch the thief would come, he would have watched, and would not have suffered his house to be broken up.
> 44 Therefore be ye also ready: for in such an hour as ye think not the Son of man cometh.

Talk about the story Jesus said His followers should be ready because they do not know when He will come. Readiness means faithfully following Him, not guessing dates.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Do we know the hour Jesus will come? *Answer: No.*

2. What did He tell His followers to do? *Answer: Watch and be ready.*

3. Should we claim to know a date from this passage? *Answer: No.*

In your day If you are waiting for a parent to pick you up, keep doing what you were asked to do. Waiting does not have to mean doing nothing.

Pray together Jesus, help me follow You while I wait for Your return. Amen.

Memory verse John 13:34 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 259 | Wednesday, June 16, 2027 | Serving the Least

Read aloud Matthew 25:37-40

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 25:37-40

> 37 Then shall the righteous answer him, saying, Lord, when saw we thee an hungred, and fed thee? or thirsty, and gave thee drink?
> 38 When saw we thee a stranger, and took thee in? or naked, and clothed thee?
> 39 Or when saw we thee sick, or in prison, and came unto thee?
> 40 And the King shall answer and say unto them, Verily I say unto you, Inasmuch as ye have done it unto one of the least of these my brethren, ye have done it unto me.

Talk about the story The King said that caring for His needy brothers counted as care given to Him. He noticed food, welcome, clothing, and visits that others might consider small.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did the hungry need? *Answer: Food.*

2. What did the stranger need? *Answer: A welcome.*

3. Who said He counted this care as done to Him? *Answer: The King, Jesus.*

In your day With an adult, choose one practical kindness: share food, welcome someone alone, or make a card for a sick person. Let care become something you do.

Pray together Jesus, help us notice people who need care. Amen.

Memory verse John 13:34 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 38 | The Last Supper and Jesus' Arrest | Jun 17 - Jun 23, 2027

Bible story John 13; Luke 22; John 18

Week overview Jesus washed His disciples' feet, commanded love, gave the supper as a remembrance, prayed in Gethsemane, and willingly faced arrest and trial.

Memory verse John 13:34

Day 260 | Thursday, June 17, 2027 | Jesus Washes Feet

Read aloud John 13:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 13:1-5

> 1 Now before the feast of the passover, when Jesus knew that his hour was come that he should depart out of this world unto the Father, having loved his own which were in the world, he loved them unto the end.
> 2 And supper being ended, the devil having now put into the heart of Judas Iscariot, Simon's son, to betray him;
> 3 Jesus knowing that the Father had given all things into his hands, and that he was come from God, and went to God;
> 4 He riseth from supper, and laid aside his garments; and took a towel, and girded himself.
> 5 After that he poureth water into a bason, and began to wash the disciples' feet, and to wipe them with the towel wherewith he was girded.

Talk about the story Jesus took a towel and washed His disciples' feet. Their Lord did a servant's work. He showed love through a simple, humble action.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who washed the disciples' feet? *Answer: Jesus.*

2. What did He tie around Himself? *Answer: A towel.*

3. What did He pour into a basin? *Answer: Water.*

In your day An ordinary chore can show love. Help wipe a table or put dirty clothes in the basket without saying, "That is someone else's job."

Pray together Jesus, help me be willing to serve in small ways. Amen.

Memory verse John 13:34 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 261 | Friday, June 18, 2027 | Follow My Example

Read aloud John 13:12-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 13:12-17

> 12 So after he had washed their feet, and had taken his garments, and was set down again, he said unto them, Know ye what I have done to you?
> 13 Ye call me Master and Lord: and ye say well; for so I am.
> 14 If I then, your Lord and Master, have washed your feet; ye also ought to wash one another's feet.
> 15 For I have given you an example, that ye should do as I have done to you.
> 16 Verily, verily, I say unto you, The servant is not greater than his lord; neither he that is sent greater than he that sent him.
> 17 If ye know these things, happy are ye if ye do them.

Talk about the story Jesus explained that His disciples should serve one another as He had served them. Knowing His example was not enough; they should act on it.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whose example should the disciples follow? *Answer: Jesus'.*

2. What had He done for them? *Answer: Washed their feet.*

3. Should they only know this, or do it? *Answer: Do it.*

In your day Choose a small job that helps someone else. Do it before waiting for them to praise you. Talk afterward about whom it helped.

Pray together Jesus, help me follow Your example by serving others. Amen.

Memory verse John 13:34 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 262 | Saturday, June 19, 2027 | A New Commandment

Read aloud John 13:34-35

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 13:34-35

> 34 A new commandment I give unto you, That ye love one another; as I have loved you, that ye also love one another.
> 35 By this shall all men know that ye are my disciples, if ye have love one to another.

Talk about the story Jesus told His disciples to love one another as He loved them. Their love would show people that they belonged to Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What command did Jesus give? *Answer: Love one another.*

2. Whose love is the example? *Answer: Jesus' love.*

3. What would this love show? *Answer: That they are His disciples.*

In your day If two children at church argue over a game, what would love look like? Practice listening, taking turns, and making room for both.

Pray together Jesus, help us love one another in ways people can see. Amen.

Memory verse John 13:34 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 263 | Sunday, June 20, 2027 | Remember Me

Read aloud Luke 22:14-20

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 22:14-20

> 14 And when the hour was come, he sat down, and the twelve apostles with him.
> 15 And he said unto them, With desire I have desired to eat this passover with you before I suffer:
> 16 For I say unto you, I will not any more eat thereof, until it be fulfilled in the kingdom of God.
> 17 And he took the cup, and gave thanks, and said, Take this, and divide it among yourselves:
> 18 For I say unto you, I will not drink of the fruit of the vine, until the kingdom of God shall come.
> 19 And he took bread, and gave thanks, and brake it, and gave unto them, saying, This is my body which is given for you: this do in remembrance of me.
> 20 Likewise also the cup after supper, saying, This cup is the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you.

Talk about the story At supper Jesus gave bread and the cup to help His followers remember His body and blood given for them. He was preparing them for His death.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What two things did Jesus give? *Answer: Bread and the cup.*

2. Whom were they to remember? *Answer: Jesus.*

3. What did the bread point to? *Answer: His body given for them.*

In your day Ask an adult about the Lord's Supper at your church. Watch how the church remembers Jesus with seriousness and thanks; ask about anything you do not understand.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for giving Yourself for sinners. Amen.

Memory verse John 13:34 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 264 | Monday, June 21, 2027 | Not My Will, but Thine

Read aloud Luke 22:39-46

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 22:39-46

> 39 And he came out, and went, as he was wont, to the mount of Olives; and his disciples also followed him.
> 40 And when he was at the place, he said unto them, Pray that ye enter not into temptation.
> 41 And he was withdrawn from them about a stone's cast, and kneeled down, and prayed,
> 42 Saying, Father, if thou be willing, remove this cup from me: nevertheless not my will, but thine, be done.
> 43 And there appeared an angel unto him from heaven, strengthening him.
> 44 And being in an agony he prayed more earnestly: and his sweat was as it were great drops of blood falling down to the ground.
> 45 And when he rose up from prayer, and was come to his disciples, he found them sleeping for sorrow,
> 46 And said unto them, Why sleep ye? rise and pray, lest ye enter into temptation.

Talk about the story Jesus prayed in great distress and submitted to His Father's will. He told the disciples to pray too. He brought His hardest moment to the Father.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where did Jesus go to pray? *Answer: The Mount of Olives.*

2. Whose will did He choose? *Answer: The Father's.*

3. What did He tell the disciples to do? *Answer: Pray.*

In your day When you dread something difficult, tell God honestly. Ask for help to do what is right, and talk to a trusted adult about the fear.

Pray together Father, help me do what is right when it is hard. Amen.

Memory verse John 13:34 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 265 | Tuesday, June 22, 2027 | Jesus Is Arrested

Read aloud John 18:1-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 18:1-6

> 1 When Jesus had spoken these words, he went forth with his disciples over the brook Cedron, where was a garden, into the which he entered, and his disciples.
> 2 And Judas also, which betrayed him, knew the place: for Jesus ofttimes resorted thither with his disciples.
> 3 Judas then, having received a band of men and officers from the chief priests and Pharisees, cometh thither with lanterns and torches and weapons.
> 4 Jesus therefore, knowing all things that should come upon him, went forth, and said unto them, Whom seek ye?
> 5 They answered him, Jesus of Nazareth. Jesus saith unto them, I am he. And Judas also, which betrayed him, stood with them.
> 6 As soon then as he had said unto them, I am he, they went backward, and fell to the ground.

Talk about the story The group came to arrest Jesus, and He stepped forward. When He identified Himself, they fell backward. He knew what was happening and faced them.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did the group seek? *Answer: Jesus of Nazareth.*

2. Did Jesus hide His identity? *Answer: No.*

3. What happened when He said "I am he"? *Answer: They went backward and fell to the ground.*

In your day It can be tempting to hide when a hard conversation is coming. If you have done wrong, ask a caring adult to help you speak honestly.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for willingly facing what lay ahead. Amen.

Memory verse John 13:34 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 266 | Wednesday, June 23, 2027 | Jesus before Pilate

Read aloud John 18:33-38

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 18:33-38

> 33 Then Pilate entered into the judgment hall again, and called Jesus, and said unto him, Art thou the King of the Jews?
> 34 Jesus answered him, Sayest thou this thing of thyself, or did others tell it thee of me?
> 35 Pilate answered, Am I a Jew? Thine own nation and the chief priests have delivered thee unto me: what hast thou done?
> 36 Jesus answered, My kingdom is not of this world: if my kingdom were of this world, then would my servants fight, that I should not be delivered to the Jews: but now is my kingdom not from hence.
> 37 Pilate therefore said unto him, Art thou a king then? Jesus answered, Thou sayest that I am a king. To this end was I born, and for this cause came I into the world, that I should bear witness unto the truth. Every one that is of the truth heareth my voice.
> 38 Pilate saith unto him, What is truth? And when he had said this, he went out again unto the Jews, and saith unto them, I find in him no fault at all.

Talk about the story Jesus told Pilate that His kingdom was not of this world. He had come to bear witness to the truth. Pilate found no fault in Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. To whom was Jesus speaking? *Answer: Pilate.*

2. Was His kingdom from this world? *Answer: No.*

3. What had He come to bear witness to? *Answer: The truth.*

In your day When different people say different things, ask, "What is true?" We learn about Jesus from His words, not from guessing what a king must be like.

Pray together Jesus, help me listen to the truth You teach. Amen.

Memory verse John 13:34 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 20 | Days 267-280

Jesus Dies for Our Sins + Jesus Is Risen

Thursday, June 24, 2027 through Wednesday, July 7, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 28:6

> 6 He is not here: for he is risen, as he said. Come, see the place where the Lord lay.

Meaning in context The tomb is empty because Jesus truly rose exactly as He had said.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 39 | Jesus Dies for Our Sins | Jun 24 - Jun 30, 2027

Bible story Luke 23; John 19; Isaiah 53

Week overview Though innocent, Jesus was condemned, crucified, and buried. He prayed for enemies and completed the saving work foretold in Scripture.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6

Day 267 | Thursday, June 24, 2027 | The Innocent One Is Condemned

Read aloud Luke 23:13-25

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 23:13-25

> 13 And Pilate, when he had called together the chief priests and the rulers and the people,
> 14 Said unto them, Ye have brought this man unto me, as one that perverteth the people: and, behold, I, having examined him before you, have found no fault in this man touching those things whereof ye accuse him:
> 15 No, nor yet Herod: for I sent you to him; and, lo, nothing worthy of death is done unto him.
> 16 I will therefore chastise him, and release him.
> 17 (For of necessity he must release one unto them at the feast.)
> 18 And they cried out all at once, saying, Away with this man, and release unto us Barabbas:
> 19 (Who for a certain sedition made in the city, and for murder, was cast into prison.)
> 20 Pilate therefore, willing to release Jesus, spake again to them.
> 21 But they cried, saying, Crucify him, crucify him.
> 22 And he said unto them the third time, Why, what evil hath he done? I have found no cause of death in him: I will therefore chastise him, and let him go.
> 23 And they were instant with loud voices, requiring that he might be crucified. And the voices of them and of the chief priests prevailed.
> 24 And Pilate gave sentence that it should be as they required.
> 25 And he released unto them him that for sedition and murder was cast into prison, whom they had desired; but he delivered Jesus to their will.

Talk about the story Pilate said Jesus had done nothing deserving death. Yet he gave in to the crowd and condemned Him. A loud crowd can still be wrong.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did Pilate find Jesus guilty of a crime deserving death? *Answer: No.*

2. What did the crowd demand? *Answer: That Jesus be crucified.*

3. Did Pilate give in? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day If several children blame an innocent person, do not join them just to fit in. Tell a trusted adult what you actually saw.

Pray together God, help me stand for truth when a crowd is wrong. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 268 | Friday, June 25, 2027 | Father, Forgive Them

Read aloud Luke 23:32-34

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 23:32-34

> 32 And there were also two other, malefactors, led with him to be put to death.
> 33 And when they were come to the place, which is called Calvary, there they crucified him, and the malefactors, one on the right hand, and the other on the left.
> 34 Then said Jesus, Father, forgive them; for they know not what they do. And they parted his raiment, and cast lots.

Talk about the story Jesus was crucified between two criminals. Even while people hurt Him, He prayed, "Father, forgive them." His mercy was greater than their cruelty.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where was Jesus between the other men? *Answer: On a cross between two criminals.*

2. To whom did He pray? *Answer: The Father.*

3. What did He ask for them? *Answer: Forgiveness.*

In your day When someone hurts your feelings, ask for help without planning revenge. Pray that they will turn from the wrong and that you can forgive.

Pray together Jesus, help me forgive instead of planning revenge. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 269 | Saturday, June 26, 2027 | Today Shalt Thou Be with Me

Read aloud Luke 23:39-43

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 23:39-43

> 39 And one of the malefactors which were hanged railed on him, saying, If thou be Christ, save thyself and us.
> 40 But the other answering rebuked him, saying, Dost not thou fear God, seeing thou art in the same condemnation?
> 41 And we indeed justly; for we receive the due reward of our deeds: but this man hath done nothing amiss.
> 42 And he said unto Jesus, Lord, remember me when thou comest into thy kingdom.
> 43 And Jesus said unto him, Verily I say unto thee, To day shalt thou be with me in paradise.

Talk about the story One criminal admitted his guilt and asked Jesus to remember him. Jesus promised that he would be with Him in paradise. The man depended on Jesus, not earned goodness.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did the man admit being guilty? *Answer: Yes.*

2. Whom did he ask to remember him? *Answer: Jesus.*

3. Where did Jesus promise he would be? *Answer: With Him in paradise.*

In your day Forgiveness is not a prize for pretending you have never sinned. Talk with an adult about admitting sin and trusting Jesus to save.

Pray together Jesus, help me understand what it means to trust You. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 270 | Sunday, June 27, 2027 | It Is Finished

Read aloud John 19:25-30

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 19:25-30

> 25 Now there stood by the cross of Jesus his mother, and his mother's sister, Mary the wife of Cleophas, and Mary Magdalene.
> 26 When Jesus therefore saw his mother, and the disciple standing by, whom he loved, he saith unto his mother, Woman, behold thy son!
> 27 Then saith he to the disciple, Behold thy mother! And from that hour that disciple took her unto his own home.
> 28 After this, Jesus knowing that all things were now accomplished, that the scripture might be fulfilled, saith, I thirst.
> 29 Now there was set a vessel full of vinegar: and they filled a spunge with vinegar, and put it upon hyssop, and put it to his mouth.
> 30 When Jesus therefore had received the vinegar, he said, It is finished: and he bowed his head, and gave up the ghost.

Talk about the story Jesus cared for His mother while on the cross. Then He declared, "It is finished," and died. He completed the work He had come to do.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did Jesus arrange care for? *Answer: His mother.*

2. What did He say before He died? *Answer: It is finished.*

3. Did Jesus really die? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Notice Jesus' care for Mary during His own suffering. If you are having a hard day, you may still be able to speak kindly to someone else.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for finishing Your work to save sinners. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 271 | Monday, June 28, 2027 | The Saviour Dies

Read aloud Luke 23:44-49

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 23:44-49

> 44 And it was about the sixth hour, and there was a darkness over all the earth until the ninth hour.
> 45 And the sun was darkened, and the veil of the temple was rent in the midst.
> 46 And when Jesus had cried with a loud voice, he said, Father, into thy hands I commend my spirit: and having said thus, he gave up the ghost.
> 47 Now when the centurion saw what was done, he glorified God, saying, Certainly this was a righteous man.
> 48 And all the people that came together to that sight, beholding the things which were done, smote their breasts, and returned.
> 49 And all his acquaintance, and the women that followed him from Galilee, stood afar off, beholding these things.

Talk about the story Darkness covered the land. Jesus committed His spirit to the Father and died. The centurion recognized that Jesus was righteous. He had not deserved this death.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What covered the land? *Answer: Darkness.*

2. To whom did Jesus commit His spirit? *Answer: The Father.*

3. Did the centurion call Jesus righteous? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Read this slowly and allow questions. A child may feel sad. Explain that tomorrow's burial and the coming resurrection are parts of the same true story.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for giving Your life for us. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 272 | Tuesday, June 29, 2027 | Jesus Is Buried

Read aloud Luke 23:50-56

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 23:50-56

> 50 And, behold, there was a man named Joseph, a counsellor; and he was a good man, and a just:
> 51 (The same had not consented to the counsel and deed of them;) he was of Arimathaea, a city of the Jews: who also himself waited for the kingdom of God.
> 52 This man went unto Pilate, and begged the body of Jesus.
> 53 And he took it down, and wrapped it in linen, and laid it in a sepulchre that was hewn in stone, wherein never man before was laid.
> 54 And that day was the preparation, and the sabbath drew on.
> 55 And the women also, which came with him from Galilee, followed after, and beheld the sepulchre, and how his body was laid.
> 56 And they returned, and prepared spices and ointments; and rested the sabbath day according to the commandment.

Talk about the story Joseph of Arimathaea put Jesus' body in a new tomb. Women watched where He was laid and prepared spices. Jesus' death and burial were real.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who placed Jesus' body in the tomb? *Answer: Joseph of Arimathaea.*

2. Had the tomb been used before? *Answer: No.*

3. Who watched where Jesus was laid? *Answer: The women who followed Him.*

In your day When someone dies, those who love them grieve. Listen to any questions the child has. Jesus' friends did not yet understand the joy that was coming.

Pray together God, help us understand Jesus' death and burial. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 273 | Wednesday, June 30, 2027 | He Was Wounded for Us

Read aloud Isaiah 53:4-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Isaiah 53:4-6

> 4 Surely he hath borne our griefs, and carried our sorrows: yet we did esteem him stricken, smitten of God, and afflicted.
> 5 But he was wounded for our transgressions, he was bruised for our iniquities: the chastisement of our peace was upon him; and with his stripes we are healed.
> 6 All we like sheep have gone astray; we have turned every one to his own way; and the LORD hath laid on him the iniquity of us all.

Talk about the story Isaiah wrote that the Servant would suffer for our sins. Like sheep wandering away, we have all gone our own way. Jesus bore sin that was ours.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who is compared to wandering sheep? *Answer: All of us.*

2. For whose sins was the Servant wounded? *Answer: Ours.*

3. Who laid our sin on Him? *Answer: The LORD.*

In your day Think of a time you knew the right thing but chose your own way. Admit it honestly. Jesus' death shows how seriously God treats sin and how He loves sinners.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for bearing the sin that was ours. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 40 | Jesus Is Risen | Jul 1 - Jul 7, 2027

Bible story Matthew 28; Luke 24; John 20-21

Week overview The tomb was empty, the risen Jesus met His followers, explained Scripture, brought peace, answered Thomas, and restored Peter.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6

Day 274 | Thursday, July 1, 2027 | He Is Not Here

Read aloud Matthew 28:1-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 28:1-6

> 1 In the end of the sabbath, as it began to dawn toward the first day of the week, came Mary Magdalene and the other Mary to see the sepulchre.
> 2 And, behold, there was a great earthquake: for the angel of the Lord descended from heaven, and came and rolled back the stone from the door, and sat upon it.
> 3 His countenance was like lightning, and his raiment white as snow:
> 4 And for fear of him the keepers did shake, and became as dead men.
> 5 And the angel answered and said unto the women, Fear not ye: for I know that ye seek Jesus, which was crucified.
> 6 He is not here: for he is risen, as he said. Come, see the place where the Lord lay.

Talk about the story The women came to the tomb, but Jesus was not there. An angel said He had risen, just as He had said. His promise had come true.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who came to the tomb? *Answer: Women who followed Jesus.*

2. Was Jesus' body still there? *Answer: No.*

3. What did the angel say had happened? *Answer: He had risen.*

In your day Think of the difference between expecting sad news and hearing wonderful news. Say the angel's message together: "He is risen."

Pray together Jesus, thank You that You are alive. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 275 | Friday, July 2, 2027 | Jesus Meets the Women

Read aloud Matthew 28:7-10

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Matthew 28:7-10

> 7 And go quickly, and tell his disciples that he is risen from the dead; and, behold, he goeth before you into Galilee; there shall ye see him: lo, I have told you.
> 8 And they departed quickly from the sepulchre with fear and great joy; and did run to bring his disciples word.
> 9 And as they went to tell his disciples, behold, Jesus met them, saying, All hail. And they came and held him by the feet, and worshipped him.
> 10 Then said Jesus unto them, Be not afraid: go tell my brethren that they go into Galilee, and there shall they see me.

Talk about the story As the women hurried to tell the disciples, Jesus met them. They held His feet and worshiped Him. The risen Jesus was truly there with them.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did the women meet? *Answer: Jesus.*

2. What did they hold? *Answer: His feet.*

3. What did they do? *Answer: Worshiped Him.*

In your day Good news is hard to keep to yourself. Tell someone in your family why these women were both amazed and glad.

Pray together Jesus, we worship You as our risen Lord. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 276 | Saturday, July 3, 2027 | Walking toward Emmaus

Read aloud Luke 24:13-21

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 24:13-21

> 13 And, behold, two of them went that same day to a village called Emmaus, which was from Jerusalem about threescore furlongs.
> 14 And they talked together of all these things which had happened.
> 15 And it came to pass, that, while they communed together and reasoned, Jesus himself drew near, and went with them.
> 16 But their eyes were holden that they should not know him.
> 17 And he said unto them, What manner of communications are these that ye have one to another, as ye walk, and are sad?
> 18 And the one of them, whose name was Cleopas, answering said unto him, Art thou only a stranger in Jerusalem, and hast not known the things which are come to pass there in these days?
> 19 And he said unto them, What things? And they said unto him, Concerning Jesus of Nazareth, which was a prophet mighty in deed and word before God and all the people:
> 20 And how the chief priests and our rulers delivered him to be condemned to death, and have crucified him.
> 21 But we trusted that it had been he which should have redeemed Israel: and beside all this, to day is the third day since these things were done.

Talk about the story Two sad disciples walked toward Emmaus. Jesus joined them, but they did not recognize Him. He listened as they told what had happened.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where were the two going? *Answer: Emmaus.*

2. Who joined them? *Answer: Jesus.*

3. Did they recognize Him at first? *Answer: No.*

In your day When someone is disappointed, listen before trying to answer. Ask, "What happened?" and let them finish, as Jesus listened to these travelers.

Pray together Jesus, help me listen kindly to someone who is sad. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 277 | Sunday, July 4, 2027 | He Opens the Scriptures

Read aloud Luke 24:25-32

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Luke 24:25-32

> 25 Then he said unto them, O fools, and slow of heart to believe all that the prophets have spoken:
> 26 Ought not Christ to have suffered these things, and to enter into his glory?
> 27 And beginning at Moses and all the prophets, he expounded unto them in all the scriptures the things concerning himself.
> 28 And they drew nigh unto the village, whither they went: and he made as though he would have gone further.
> 29 But they constrained him, saying, Abide with us: for it is toward evening, and the day is far spent. And he went in to tarry with them.
> 30 And it came to pass, as he sat at meat with them, he took bread, and blessed it, and brake, and gave to them.
> 31 And their eyes were opened, and they knew him; and he vanished out of their sight.
> 32 And they said one to another, Did not our heart burn within us, while he talked with us by the way, and while he opened to us the scriptures?

Talk about the story Jesus explained the Scriptures about His suffering and glory. Later the disciples recognized Him and remembered how His words had stirred their hearts. Scripture helped them understand.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Jesus explain? *Answer: The Scriptures about Himself.*

2. Did they finally recognize Him? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Had His explanation affected their hearts? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day If a Bible story confuses you, ask someone to read and explain it with you. Understanding may take time; you do not have to guess.

Pray together Jesus, help us understand what the Bible says about You. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 278 | Monday, July 5, 2027 | Peace Be unto You

Read aloud John 20:19-23

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 20:19-23

> 19 Then the same day at evening, being the first day of the week, when the doors were shut where the disciples were assembled for fear of the Jews, came Jesus and stood in the midst, and saith unto them, Peace be unto you.
> 20 And when he had so said, he shewed unto them his hands and his side. Then were the disciples glad, when they saw the Lord.
> 21 Then said Jesus to them again, Peace be unto you: as my Father hath sent me, even so send I you.
> 22 And when he had said this, he breathed on them, and saith unto them, Receive ye the Holy Ghost:
> 23 Whose soever sins ye remit, they are remitted unto them; and whose soever sins ye retain, they are retained.

Talk about the story The disciples met behind shut doors because they were afraid. Jesus stood among them, showed His wounds, and spoke peace. They were glad to see Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Why were the doors shut? *Answer: The disciples were afraid.*

2. Who stood among them? *Answer: Jesus.*

3. What did He show them? *Answer: His hands and side.*

In your day When frightened, we sometimes hide and stop talking. Tell a trusted adult what scares you. Read the words Jesus spoke to His frightened friends.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for caring for Your frightened friends. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 279 | Tuesday, July 6, 2027 | Thomas Believes

Read aloud John 20:24-29

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 20:24-29

> 24 But Thomas, one of the twelve, called Didymus, was not with them when Jesus came.
> 25 The other disciples therefore said unto him, We have seen the Lord. But he said unto them, Except I shall see in his hands the print of the nails, and put my finger into the print of the nails, and thrust my hand into his side, I will not believe.
> 26 And after eight days again his disciples were within, and Thomas with them: then came Jesus, the doors being shut, and stood in the midst, and said, Peace be unto you.
> 27 Then saith he to Thomas, Reach hither thy finger, and behold my hands; and reach hither thy hand, and thrust it into my side: and be not faithless, but believing.
> 28 And Thomas answered and said unto him, My Lord and my God.
> 29 Jesus saith unto him, Thomas, because thou hast seen me, thou hast believed: blessed are they that have not seen, and yet have believed.

Talk about the story Thomas struggled to believe Jesus had risen. When Jesus appeared to him, Thomas said, "My Lord and my God." Jesus welcomed belief based on trustworthy testimony too.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who had doubted the report? *Answer: Thomas.*

2. Who appeared to him? *Answer: Jesus.*

3. What did Thomas call Jesus? *Answer: My Lord and my God.*

In your day If you have a question about Jesus, say it honestly. Ask an adult to show you what the Bible says instead of pretending you understand.

Pray together Jesus, help me bring my questions and believe what is true. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 280 | Wednesday, July 7, 2027 | Feed My Sheep

Read aloud John 21:15-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | John 21:15-17

> 15 So when they had dined, Jesus saith to Simon Peter, Simon, son of Jonas, lovest thou me more than these? He saith unto him, Yea, Lord; thou knowest that I love thee. He saith unto him, Feed my lambs.
> 16 He saith to him again the second time, Simon, son of Jonas, lovest thou me? He saith unto him, Yea, Lord; thou knowest that I love thee. He saith unto him, Feed my sheep.
> 17 He saith unto him the third time, Simon, son of Jonas, lovest thou me? Peter was grieved because he said unto him the third time, Lovest thou me? And he said unto him, Lord, thou knowest all things; thou knowest that I love thee. Jesus saith unto him, Feed my sheep.

Talk about the story Jesus asked Peter about his love and told him to care for His sheep. Peter was given work to do for people who belonged to Jesus.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did Jesus question? *Answer: Peter.*

2. What did He ask about? *Answer: Peter's love for Him.*

3. Whose sheep should Peter care for? *Answer: Jesus' sheep.*

In your day Saying "I love you" can be followed by helpful care. Ask someone in your family what would help them today, then do what you can.

Pray together Jesus, help me show love by caring for people. Amen.

Memory verse Matthew 28:6 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 21 | Days 281-294

Jesus Ascends and the Church Begins + Bold Witnesses and Saul's Conversion

Thursday, July 8, 2027 through Wednesday, July 21, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 1:8

> 8 But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me both in Jerusalem, and in all Judaea, and in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part of the earth.

Meaning in context The Holy Ghost empowered Christ's witnesses to carry the gospel outward to the whole world.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 41 | Jesus Ascends and the Church Begins | Jul 8 - Jul 14, 2027

Bible story Acts 1-3

Week overview Jesus promised the Holy Ghost and ascended. The Spirit came at Pentecost, many believed, the church grew, and a lame man was healed.

Memory verse Acts 1:8

Day 281 | Thursday, July 8, 2027 | Wait for the Promise

Read aloud Acts 1:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 1:1-5

> 1 The former treatise have I made, O Theophilus, of all that Jesus began both to do and teach,
> 2 Until the day in which he was taken up, after that he through the Holy Ghost had given commandments unto the apostles whom he had chosen:
> 3 To whom also he shewed himself alive after his passion by many infallible proofs, being seen of them forty days, and speaking of the things pertaining to the kingdom of God:
> 4 And, being assembled together with them, commanded them that they should not depart from Jerusalem, but wait for the promise of the Father, which, saith he, ye have heard of me.
> 5 For John truly baptized with water; but ye shall be baptized with the Holy Ghost not many days hence.

Talk about the story For forty days Jesus showed His followers that He was alive. He told them to wait for the Father's promise of the Holy Ghost. Waiting was His instruction.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. How many days did Jesus show Himself alive? *Answer: Forty.*

2. What did He tell them to do? *Answer: Wait.*

3. Whom had the Father promised? *Answer: The Holy Ghost.*

In your day Sometimes you must wait before beginning a job. Ask what you can do while waiting, rather than rushing ahead without the help you need.

Pray together God, help me wait when waiting is part of obedience. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 1:8 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 282 | Friday, July 9, 2027 | Jesus Goes Up

Read aloud Acts 1:6-11

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 1:6-11

> 6 When they therefore were come together, they asked of him, saying, Lord, wilt thou at this time restore again the kingdom to Israel?
> 7 And he said unto them, It is not for you to know the times or the seasons, which the Father hath put in his own power.
> 8 But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me both in Jerusalem, and in all Judaea, and in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part of the earth.
> 9 And when he had spoken these things, while they beheld, he was taken up; and a cloud received him out of their sight.
> 10 And while they looked stedfastly toward heaven as he went up, behold, two men stood by them in white apparel;
> 11 Which also said, Ye men of Galilee, why stand ye gazing up into heaven? this same Jesus, which is taken up from you into heaven, shall so come in like manner as ye have seen him go into heaven.

Talk about the story Jesus told His followers to be His witnesses. Then He went up into heaven. Angels promised He would return. The disciples had work to do while they waited.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What were the disciples to be? *Answer: Jesus' witnesses.*

2. Where did Jesus go? *Answer: Into heaven.*

3. Would He come again? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day A witness tells what is true. Practice explaining one event from Jesus' life accurately. If you do not know an answer, say so and look together.

Pray together Jesus, help us tell the truth about You while we wait. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 1:8 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 283 | Saturday, July 10, 2027 | The Disciples Pray Together

Read aloud Acts 1:12-14

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 1:12-14

> 12 Then returned they unto Jerusalem from the mount called Olivet, which is from Jerusalem a sabbath day's journey.
> 13 And when they were come in, they went up into an upper room, where abode both Peter, and James, and John, and Andrew, Philip, and Thomas, Bartholomew, and Matthew, James the son of Alphaeus, and Simon Zelotes, and Judas the brother of James.
> 14 These all continued with one accord in prayer and supplication, with the women, and Mary the mother of Jesus, and with his brethren.

Talk about the story The disciples returned to Jerusalem and prayed together. They stayed united while waiting for God's promise. They did not have to wait alone.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where did the disciples return? *Answer: Jerusalem.*

2. What did they do together? *Answer: Prayed.*

3. Were they united in prayer? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Ask each family member for one thing to pray about. Let anyone who wants to pray use a short sentence; listening quietly is welcome too.

Pray together God, thank You that our family can pray together. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 1:8 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 284 | Sunday, July 11, 2027 | The Holy Ghost Comes

Read aloud Acts 2:1-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 2:1-4

> 1 And when the day of Pentecost was fully come, they were all with one accord in one place.
> 2 And suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled all the house where they were sitting.
> 3 And there appeared unto them cloven tongues like as of fire, and it sat upon each of them.
> 4 And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance.

Talk about the story At Pentecost the Holy Ghost filled the disciples and enabled them to speak in other languages. God was equipping them to share His message.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What special day was it? *Answer: Pentecost.*

2. Who filled the disciples? *Answer: The Holy Ghost.*

3. What were they enabled to speak? *Answer: Other languages.*

In your day People around the world speak different languages. Learn how to say hello in one with an adult, and remember that people of every language need God's good news.

Pray together God, help people of every language hear about Jesus. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 1:8 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 285 | Monday, July 12, 2027 | Gladly Receiving the Word

Read aloud Acts 2:37-41

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 2:37-41

> 37 Now when they heard this, they were pricked in their heart, and said unto Peter and to the rest of the apostles, Men and brethren, what shall we do?
> 38 Then Peter said unto them, Repent, and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins, and ye shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost.
> 39 For the promise is unto you, and to your children, and to all that are afar off, even as many as the Lord our God shall call.
> 40 And with many other words did he testify and exhort, saying, Save yourselves from this untoward generation.
> 41 Then they that gladly received his word were baptized: and the same day there were added unto them about three thousand souls.

Talk about the story Peter's listeners asked what to do. He called them to repent, and many received the message and were baptized. About three thousand were added that day.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who spoke to the crowd? *Answer: Peter.*

2. What did he tell them to do? *Answer: Repent.*

3. About how many were added? *Answer: Three thousand.*

In your day If God's Word shows you something wrong in your life, take it seriously. Ask an adult about turning from sin and trusting Jesus; a correct classroom answer is not enough.

Pray together God, help me respond honestly to Your Word. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 1:8 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 286 | Tuesday, July 13, 2027 | Life in the First Church

Read aloud Acts 2:42-47

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 2:42-47

> 42 And they continued stedfastly in the apostles' doctrine and fellowship, and in breaking of bread, and in prayers.
> 43 And fear came upon every soul: and many wonders and signs were done by the apostles.
> 44 And all that believed were together, and had all things common;
> 45 And sold their possessions and goods, and parted them to all men, as every man had need.
> 46 And they, continuing daily with one accord in the temple, and breaking bread from house to house, did eat their meat with gladness and singleness of heart,
> 47 Praising God, and having favour with all the people. And the Lord added to the church daily such as should be saved.

Talk about the story The first believers learned, prayed, ate together, and shared with those in need. Their faith brought them into a caring church family.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whose teaching did they follow? *Answer: The apostles'.*

2. Did they pray together? *Answer: Yes.*

3. What did they do for people in need? *Answer: Shared with them.*

In your day Notice someone at church who sits alone or needs help. With an adult, greet them or help carry something. Church life includes caring, not only attending.

Pray together God, help our church learn, pray, and care together. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 1:8 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 287 | Wednesday, July 14, 2027 | Rise Up and Walk

Read aloud Acts 3:1-8

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 3:1-8

> 1 Now Peter and John went up together into the temple at the hour of prayer, being the ninth hour.
> 2 And a certain man lame from his mother's womb was carried, whom they laid daily at the gate of the temple which is called Beautiful, to ask alms of them that entered into the temple;
> 3 Who seeing Peter and John about to go into the temple asked an alms.
> 4 And Peter, fastening his eyes upon him with John, said, Look on us.
> 5 And he gave heed unto them, expecting to receive something of them.
> 6 Then Peter said, Silver and gold have I none; but such as I have give I thee: In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth rise up and walk.
> 7 And he took him by the right hand, and lifted him up: and immediately his feet and ankle bones received strength.
> 8 And he leaping up stood, and walked, and entered with them into the temple, walking, and leaping, and praising God.

Talk about the story Peter had no silver or gold to give the man who could not walk. In Jesus' name he told him to rise. The healed man praised God.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did Peter have money to give? *Answer: No.*

2. In whose name did he tell the man to walk? *Answer: Jesus Christ's.*

3. What did the man do after healing? *Answer: Walked, leaped, and praised God.*

In your day Sometimes you cannot give what someone asks for, but you can seek useful help. Ask an adult how to respond kindly when you cannot solve a need yourself.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for the man's healing and joy. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 1:8 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 42 | Bold Witnesses and Saul's Conversion | Jul 15 - Jul 21, 2027

Bible story Acts 4-9

Week overview The early church prayed for boldness, served needs, endured persecution, carried the gospel to new people, and saw Saul the persecutor meet Jesus.

Memory verse Acts 1:8

Day 288 | Thursday, July 15, 2027 | No Other Name

Read aloud Acts 4:8-12

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 4:8-12

> 8 Then Peter, filled with the Holy Ghost, said unto them, Ye rulers of the people, and elders of Israel,
> 9 If we this day be examined of the good deed done to the impotent man, by what means he is made whole;
> 10 Be it known unto you all, and to all the people of Israel, that by the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, whom ye crucified, whom God raised from the dead, even by him doth this man stand here before you whole.
> 11 This is the stone which was set at nought of you builders, which is become the head of the corner.
> 12 Neither is there salvation in any other: for there is none other name under heaven given among men, whereby we must be saved.

Talk about the story Peter said the man was healed through Jesus Christ. He also declared that salvation is found in no other name. Jesus is the Saviour we need.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who had healed the man? *Answer: Jesus Christ.*

2. Who was speaking? *Answer: Peter.*

3. Is salvation found in another name? *Answer: No.*

In your day Different keys do not all open the same door. Peter was clear about whom we trust for salvation. Ask what it means to depend on Jesus.

Pray together Jesus, help me understand why I need You as Saviour. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 1:8 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 289 | Friday, July 16, 2027 | Praying for Boldness

Read aloud Acts 4:23-31

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 4:23-31

> 23 And being let go, they went to their own company, and reported all that the chief priests and elders had said unto them.
> 24 And when they heard that, they lifted up their voice to God with one accord, and said, Lord, thou art God, which hast made heaven, and earth, and the sea, and all that in them is:
> 25 Who by the mouth of thy servant David hast said, Why did the heathen rage, and the people imagine vain things?
> 26 The kings of the earth stood up, and the rulers were gathered together against the Lord, and against his Christ.
> 27 For of a truth against thy holy child Jesus, whom thou hast anointed, both Herod, and Pontius Pilate, with the Gentiles, and the people of Israel, were gathered together,
> 28 For to do whatsoever thy hand and thy counsel determined before to be done.
> 29 And now, Lord, behold their threatenings: and grant unto thy servants, that with all boldness they may speak thy word,
> 30 By stretching forth thine hand to heal; and that signs and wonders may be done by the name of thy holy child Jesus.
> 31 And when they had prayed, the place was shaken where they were assembled together; and they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and they spake the word of God with boldness.

Talk about the story After being threatened, the believers prayed together. They asked God for boldness to speak His Word. They needed courage, not a way to get revenge.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What had happened to the believers? *Answer: They had been threatened.*

2. What did they do together? *Answer: Prayed.*

3. What did they ask for? *Answer: Boldness to speak God's Word.*

In your day If you feel shy about saying something true and kind, practice it with an adult. Ask God for courage before the conversation.

Pray together God, give us courage to speak Your truth kindly. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 1:8 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 290 | Saturday, July 17, 2027 | Many Are Helped

Read aloud Acts 5:12-16

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 5:12-16

> 12 And by the hands of the apostles were many signs and wonders wrought among the people; (and they were all with one accord in Solomon's porch.
> 13 And of the rest durst no man join himself to them: but the people magnified them.
> 14 And believers were the more added to the Lord, multitudes both of men and women.)
> 15 Insomuch that they brought forth the sick into the streets, and laid them on beds and couches, that at the least the shadow of Peter passing by might overshadow some of them.
> 16 There came also a multitude out of the cities round about unto Jerusalem, bringing sick folks, and them which were vexed with unclean spirits: and they were healed every one.

Talk about the story God worked through the apostles, and many sick people were brought for help. The signs showed His power. People who suffered were not forgotten.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Through whom were signs done? *Answer: The apostles.*

2. Whom did crowds bring? *Answer: Sick and troubled people.*

3. Were these people helped? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Ask about someone your church is helping. Draw a card or pray for that person by name. You can care without being able to heal them.

Pray together God, help our church care for people who suffer. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 1:8 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 291 | Sunday, July 18, 2027 | Seven Servants Are Chosen

Read aloud Acts 6:1-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 6:1-7

> 1 And in those days, when the number of the disciples was multiplied, there arose a murmuring of the Grecians against the Hebrews, because their widows were neglected in the daily ministration.
> 2 Then the twelve called the multitude of the disciples unto them, and said, It is not reason that we should leave the word of God, and serve tables.
> 3 Wherefore, brethren, look ye out among you seven men of honest report, full of the Holy Ghost and wisdom, whom we may appoint over this business.
> 4 But we will give ourselves continually to prayer, and to the ministry of the word.
> 5 And the saying pleased the whole multitude: and they chose Stephen, a man full of faith and of the Holy Ghost, and Philip, and Prochorus, and Nicanor, and Timon, and Parmenas, and Nicolas a proselyte of Antioch:
> 6 Whom they set before the apostles: and when they had prayed, they laid their hands on them.
> 7 And the word of God increased; and the number of the disciples multiplied in Jerusalem greatly; and a great company of the priests were obedient to the faith.

Talk about the story Some widows were being overlooked when food was shared. The church chose seven faithful men to organize care. A real problem needed a practical response.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who were being overlooked? *Answer: Some widows.*

2. How many men were chosen? *Answer: Seven.*

3. What needed better care? *Answer: The daily sharing of food.*

In your day When snacks are passed around, look to see whether someone was missed. Tell the adult serving instead of assuming everyone already received some.

Pray together God, help us notice when someone is left out. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 1:8 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 292 | Monday, July 19, 2027 | Stephen Forgives

Read aloud Acts 7:54-60

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 7:54-60

> 54 When they heard these things, they were cut to the heart, and they gnashed on him with their teeth.
> 55 But he, being full of the Holy Ghost, looked up stedfastly into heaven, and saw the glory of God, and Jesus standing on the right hand of God,
> 56 And said, Behold, I see the heavens opened, and the Son of man standing on the right hand of God.
> 57 Then they cried out with a loud voice, and stopped their ears, and ran upon him with one accord,
> 58 And cast him out of the city, and stoned him: and the witnesses laid down their clothes at a young man's feet, whose name was Saul.
> 59 And they stoned Stephen, calling upon God, and saying, Lord Jesus, receive my spirit.
> 60 And he kneeled down, and cried with a loud voice, Lord, lay not this sin to their charge. And when he had said this, he fell asleep.

Talk about the story Stephen's enemies killed him, but he prayed for their forgiveness and looked to Jesus. Their cruelty did not turn his final words into hatred.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was being attacked? *Answer: Stephen.*

2. Whom did he see in glory? *Answer: Jesus.*

3. Did he pray for revenge or forgiveness? *Answer: Forgiveness.*

In your day When anger rises, you can ask God to help you avoid revenge. Always tell a trusted adult if someone is hurting you; forgiveness does not require hiding danger.

Pray together Jesus, help us forgive and care for those who are in danger. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 1:8 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 293 | Tuesday, July 20, 2027 | Philip Explains Jesus

Read aloud Acts 8:26-35

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 8:26-35

> 26 And the angel of the Lord spake unto Philip, saying, Arise, and go toward the south unto the way that goeth down from Jerusalem unto Gaza, which is desert.
> 27 And he arose and went: and, behold, a man of Ethiopia, an eunuch of great authority under Candace queen of the Ethiopians, who had the charge of all her treasure, and had come to Jerusalem for to worship,
> 28 Was returning, and sitting in his chariot read Esaias the prophet.
> 29 Then the Spirit said unto Philip, Go near, and join thyself to this chariot.
> 30 And Philip ran thither to him, and heard him read the prophet Esaias, and said, Understandest thou what thou readest?
> 31 And he said, How can I, except some man should guide me? And he desired Philip that he would come up and sit with him.
> 32 The place of the scripture which he read was this, He was led as a sheep to the slaughter; and like a lamb dumb before his shearer, so opened he not his mouth:
> 33 In his humiliation his judgment was taken away: and who shall declare his generation? for his life is taken from the earth.
> 34 And the eunuch answered Philip, and said, I pray thee, of whom speaketh the prophet this? of himself, or of some other man?
> 35 Then Philip opened his mouth, and began at the same scripture, and preached unto him Jesus.

Talk about the story A traveler was reading Isaiah but needed help understanding. Philip explained that the passage pointed to Jesus. Asking a question opened the way to learning.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What book was the traveler reading? *Answer: Isaiah.*

2. Who helped him understand? *Answer: Philip.*

3. About whom did Philip teach? *Answer: Jesus.*

In your day Choose one word in today's reading that is unfamiliar. Ask an adult what it means, then reread the sentence with that help.

Pray together God, thank You for people who help us understand Scripture. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 1:8 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 294 | Wednesday, July 21, 2027 | Saul Meets the Risen Jesus

Read aloud Acts 9:1-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 9:1-6

> 1 And Saul, yet breathing out threatenings and slaughter against the disciples of the Lord, went unto the high priest,
> 2 And desired of him letters to Damascus to the synagogues, that if he found any of this way, whether they were men or women, he might bring them bound unto Jerusalem.
> 3 And as he journeyed, he came near Damascus: and suddenly there shined round about him a light from heaven:
> 4 And he fell to the earth, and heard a voice saying unto him, Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me?
> 5 And he said, Who art thou, Lord? And the Lord said, I am Jesus whom thou persecutest: it is hard for thee to kick against the pricks.
> 6 And he trembling and astonished said, Lord, what wilt thou have me to do? And the Lord said unto him, Arise, and go into the city, and it shall be told thee what thou must do.

Talk about the story Saul was going to harm believers when light from heaven stopped him. Jesus spoke to him. Saul learned that attacking Jesus' people meant opposing Jesus Himself.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was traveling? *Answer: Saul.*

2. What shone around him? *Answer: A light from heaven.*

3. Who spoke to him? *Answer: Jesus.*

In your day If you realize you have been hurting someone, stop. Do not keep going just because you already started. Tell an adult and ask how to put things right.

Pray together Jesus, help me stop and listen when I am doing wrong. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 1:8 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 22 | Days 295-308

The Gospel Goes to All Peoples + Paul and Silas Carry the Gospel

Thursday, July 22, 2027 through Wednesday, August 4, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 16:31

> 31 And they said, Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ, and thou shalt be saved, and thy house.

Meaning in context Salvation is received by believing on the Lord Jesus Christ.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 43 | The Gospel Goes to All Peoples | Jul 22 - Jul 28, 2027

Bible story Acts 9-13

Week overview Ananias welcomed Saul, Peter learned that God receives believing Gentiles, believers were called Christians in Antioch, and missionaries were sent.

Memory verse Acts 16:31

Day 295 | Thursday, July 22, 2027 | Ananias Obeys

Read aloud Acts 9:10-19

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 9:10-19

> 10 And there was a certain disciple at Damascus, named Ananias; and to him said the Lord in a vision, Ananias. And he said, Behold, I am here, Lord.
> 11 And the Lord said unto him, Arise, and go into the street which is called Straight, and enquire in the house of Judas for one called Saul, of Tarsus: for, behold, he prayeth,
> 12 And hath seen in a vision a man named Ananias coming in, and putting his hand on him, that he might receive his sight.
> 13 Then Ananias answered, Lord, I have heard by many of this man, how much evil he hath done to thy saints at Jerusalem:
> 14 And here he hath authority from the chief priests to bind all that call on thy name.
> 15 But the Lord said unto him, Go thy way: for he is a chosen vessel unto me, to bear my name before the Gentiles, and kings, and the children of Israel:
> 16 For I will shew him how great things he must suffer for my name's sake.
> 17 And Ananias went his way, and entered into the house; and putting his hands on him said, Brother Saul, the Lord, even Jesus, that appeared unto thee in the way as thou camest, hath sent me, that thou mightest receive thy sight, and be filled with the Holy Ghost.
> 18 And immediately there fell from his eyes as it had been scales: and he received sight forthwith, and arose, and was baptized.
> 19 And when he had received meat, he was strengthened. Then was Saul certain days with the disciples which were at Damascus.

Talk about the story Ananias was afraid of Saul because Saul had hurt believers. But Jesus specifically sent him. He obeyed and helped Saul. This was God's instruction to Ananias, not a rule to approach unsafe people.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was sent to Saul? *Answer: Ananias.*

2. Why was he afraid? *Answer: Saul had harmed believers.*

3. Did he follow Jesus' instruction? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day When someone with a bad reputation changes, adults can help decide what is safe. You can pray for their change without going near danger.

Pray together Jesus, help us be wise and compassionate when people change. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 16:31 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 296 | Friday, July 23, 2027 | Saul Preaches Jesus

Read aloud Acts 9:20-22

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 9:20-22

> 20 And straightway he preached Christ in the synagogues, that he is the Son of God.
> 21 But all that heard him were amazed, and said; Is not this he that destroyed them which called on this name in Jerusalem, and came hither for that intent, that he might bring them bound unto the chief priests?
> 22 But Saul increased the more in strength, and confounded the Jews which dwelt at Damascus, proving that this is very Christ.

Talk about the story Saul began preaching that Jesus is the Son of God. People were amazed because he had opposed Jesus' followers. His message and direction had changed.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom did Saul preach about? *Answer: Jesus.*

2. Who did he say Jesus is? *Answer: The Son of God.*

3. Why were people amazed? *Answer: Saul had previously attacked believers.*

In your day An apology becomes believable as actions change over time. If you have been unkind, start speaking kindly today and keep practicing tomorrow.

Pray together Jesus, help my changed choices show that I am listening to You. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 16:31 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 297 | Saturday, July 24, 2027 | Cornelius Seeks God

Read aloud Acts 10:1-8

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 10:1-8

> 1 There was a certain man in Caesarea called Cornelius, a centurion of the band called the Italian band,
> 2 A devout man, and one that feared God with all his house, which gave much alms to the people, and prayed to God alway.
> 3 He saw in a vision evidently about the ninth hour of the day an angel of God coming in to him, and saying unto him, Cornelius.
> 4 And when he looked on him, he was afraid, and said, What is it, Lord? And he said unto him, Thy prayers and thine alms are come up for a memorial before God.
> 5 And now send men to Joppa, and call for one Simon, whose surname is Peter:
> 6 He lodgeth with one Simon a tanner, whose house is by the sea side: he shall tell thee what thou oughtest to do.
> 7 And when the angel which spake unto Cornelius was departed, he called two of his household servants, and a devout soldier of them that waited on him continually;
> 8 And when he had declared all these things unto them, he sent them to Joppa.

Talk about the story Cornelius prayed and helped people in need. An angel told him to send for Peter, and he obeyed. He still needed to hear the message about Jesus.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What was Cornelius doing regularly? *Answer: Praying and giving to those in need.*

2. Who brought him instructions? *Answer: An angel.*

3. For whom should he send? *Answer: Peter.*

In your day Being generous is good, and we also need to learn about Jesus. Ask a Bible question you have been wondering about and listen carefully to the answer.

Pray together God, help me be ready to hear Your message. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 16:31 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 298 | Sunday, July 25, 2027 | Peter's Vision

Read aloud Acts 10:9-16

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 10:9-16

> 9 On the morrow, as they went on their journey, and drew nigh unto the city, Peter went up upon the housetop to pray about the sixth hour:
> 10 And he became very hungry, and would have eaten: but while they made ready, he fell into a trance,
> 11 And saw heaven opened, and a certain vessel descending unto him, as it had been a great sheet knit at the four corners, and let down to the earth:
> 12 Wherein were all manner of fourfooted beasts of the earth, and wild beasts, and creeping things, and fowls of the air.
> 13 And there came a voice to him, Rise, Peter; kill, and eat.
> 14 But Peter said, Not so, Lord; for I have never eaten any thing that is common or unclean.
> 15 And the voice spake unto him again the second time, What God hath cleansed, that call not thou common.
> 16 This was done thrice: and the vessel was received up again into heaven.

Talk about the story God gave Peter a vision of animals and told him not to call unclean what God had cleansed. He was preparing Peter to welcome people he might have avoided.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who saw the vision? *Answer: Peter.*

2. What did he see coming down? *Answer: Something like a great sheet containing animals.*

3. Who spoke to him? *Answer: A voice from heaven.*

In your day People may eat different foods or have different customs from yours. Ask kindly about their life instead of assuming they cannot belong among God's people.

Pray together God, help me welcome people without unfair judgments. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 16:31 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 299 | Monday, July 26, 2027 | God Is No Respecter of Persons

Read aloud Acts 10:34-43

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 10:34-43

> 34 Then Peter opened his mouth, and said, Of a truth I perceive that God is no respecter of persons:
> 35 But in every nation he that feareth him, and worketh righteousness, is accepted with him.
> 36 The word which God sent unto the children of Israel, preaching peace by Jesus Christ: (he is Lord of all:)
> 37 That word, I say, ye know, which was published throughout all Judaea, and began from Galilee, after the baptism which John preached;
> 38 How God anointed Jesus of Nazareth with the Holy Ghost and with power: who went about doing good, and healing all that were oppressed of the devil; for God was with him.
> 39 And we are witnesses of all things which he did both in the land of the Jews, and in Jerusalem; whom they slew and hanged on a tree:
> 40 Him God raised up the third day, and shewed him openly;
> 41 Not to all the people, but unto witnesses chosen before of God, even to us, who did eat and drink with him after he rose from the dead.
> 42 And he commanded us to preach unto the people, and to testify that it is he which was ordained of God to be the Judge of quick and dead.
> 43 To him give all the prophets witness, that through his name whosoever believeth in him shall receive remission of sins.

Talk about the story Peter explained Jesus' life, death, and resurrection. He said everyone who believes on Jesus receives forgiveness through His name. God's welcome is not limited to one nation.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was preaching? *Answer: Peter.*

2. Did God raise Jesus from the dead? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Who can receive forgiveness through His name? *Answer: Everyone who believes on Him.*

In your day Find another country on a map. Children there need to hear about Jesus too. Pray for them and for someone who can explain the good news.

Pray together God, help people everywhere hear about Jesus and believe. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 16:31 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 300 | Tuesday, July 27, 2027 | Called Christians at Antioch

Read aloud Acts 11:19-26

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 11:19-26

> 19 Now they which were scattered abroad upon the persecution that arose about Stephen travelled as far as Phenice, and Cyprus, and Antioch, preaching the word to none but unto the Jews only.
> 20 And some of them were men of Cyprus and Cyrene, which, when they were come to Antioch, spake unto the Grecians, preaching the Lord Jesus.
> 21 And the hand of the Lord was with them: and a great number believed, and turned unto the Lord.
> 22 Then tidings of these things came unto the ears of the church which was in Jerusalem: and they sent forth Barnabas, that he should go as far as Antioch.
> 23 Who, when he came, and had seen the grace of God, was glad, and exhorted them all, that with purpose of heart they would cleave unto the Lord.
> 24 For he was a good man, and full of the Holy Ghost and of faith: and much people was added unto the Lord.
> 25 Then departed Barnabas to Tarsus, for to seek Saul:
> 26 And when he had found him, he brought him unto Antioch. And it came to pass, that a whole year they assembled themselves with the church, and taught much people. And the disciples were called Christians first in Antioch.

Talk about the story Many people at Antioch turned to the Lord. Barnabas encouraged them, and the disciples were called Christians there. Their new name pointed to Christ.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. In what city were disciples called Christians? *Answer: Antioch.*

2. Who encouraged them? *Answer: Barnabas.*

3. To whom had many turned? *Answer: The Lord.*

In your day Ask what the word Christian means. It is about belonging to Christ, not merely being polite or living in a certain family. Talk about personal trust in Him.

Pray together Jesus, help me understand what it means to belong to You. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 16:31 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 301 | Wednesday, July 28, 2027 | Missionaries Are Sent

Read aloud Acts 13:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 13:1-5

> 1 Now there were in the church that was at Antioch certain prophets and teachers; as Barnabas, and Simeon that was called Niger, and Lucius of Cyrene, and Manaen, which had been brought up with Herod the tetrarch, and Saul.
> 2 As they ministered to the Lord, and fasted, the Holy Ghost said, Separate me Barnabas and Saul for the work whereunto I have called them.
> 3 And when they had fasted and prayed, and laid their hands on them, they sent them away.
> 4 So they, being sent forth by the Holy Ghost, departed unto Seleucia; and from thence they sailed to Cyprus.
> 5 And when they were at Salamis, they preached the word of God in the synagogues of the Jews: and they had also John to their minister.

Talk about the story The Holy Ghost directed the church to send Barnabas and Saul. The church prayed and sent them to preach. Missionaries went with the church's support.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Which two men were sent? *Answer: Barnabas and Saul.*

2. Who directed the church? *Answer: The Holy Ghost.*

3. What did the church do before sending them? *Answer: Prayed and fasted.*

In your day Ask your church about a missionary it supports. Pray for a real person or family by name and learn one thing about the people they serve.

Pray together God, help the missionaries our church supports. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 16:31 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 44 | Paul and Silas Carry the Gospel | Jul 29 - Aug 4, 2027

Bible story Acts 13-16

Week overview Paul's missionary team preached through opposition, followed God's direction to Macedonia, met Lydia, sang in prison, and led the jailer to Christ.

Memory verse Acts 16:31

Day 302 | Thursday, July 29, 2027 | A False Prophet Is Stopped

Read aloud Acts 13:6-12

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 13:6-12

> 6 And when they had gone through the isle unto Paphos, they found a certain sorcerer, a false prophet, a Jew, whose name was Barjesus:
> 7 Which was with the deputy of the country, Sergius Paulus, a prudent man; who called for Barnabas and Saul, and desired to hear the word of God.
> 8 But Elymas the sorcerer (for so is his name by interpretation) withstood them, seeking to turn away the deputy from the faith.
> 9 Then Saul, (who also is called Paul,) filled with the Holy Ghost, set his eyes on him,
> 10 And said, O full of all subtilty and all mischief, thou child of the devil, thou enemy of all righteousness, wilt thou not cease to pervert the right ways of the Lord?
> 11 And now, behold, the hand of the Lord is upon thee, and thou shalt be blind, not seeing the sun for a season. And immediately there fell on him a mist and a darkness; and he went about seeking some to lead him by the hand.
> 12 Then the deputy, when he saw what was done, believed, being astonished at the doctrine of the Lord.

Talk about the story A false prophet tried to keep the governor from believing. Paul confronted the deception, and the governor believed. God's message must not be twisted to mislead people.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who tried to turn the governor from faith? *Answer: A false prophet, Elymas.*

2. Who confronted him? *Answer: Paul.*

3. Did the governor believe? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day If someone tells you something about God that sounds strange, ask a trusted adult to check it in the Bible. Confident words are not proof.

Pray together God, help us recognize and follow what is true. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 16:31 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 303 | Friday, July 30, 2027 | A Lame Man Walks

Read aloud Acts 14:8-10

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 14:8-10

> 8 And there sat a certain man at Lystra, impotent in his feet, being a cripple from his mother's womb, who never had walked:
> 9 The same heard Paul speak: who stedfastly beholding him, and perceiving that he had faith to be healed,
> 10 Said with a loud voice, Stand upright on thy feet. And he leaped and walked.

Talk about the story A man who had never walked listened to Paul. Paul told him to stand, and he leaped and walked. God gave him an ability he had never known.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Had the man walked before? *Answer: No.*

2. Who told him to stand? *Answer: Paul.*

3. What did he do? *Answer: Leaped and walked.*

In your day Think about a skill you are still learning. This man's healing happened by God's power. Be patient with people whose bodies cannot do what yours can.

Pray together God, thank You for helping the man who could not walk. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 16:31 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 304 | Saturday, July 31, 2027 | Continuing through Trouble

Read aloud Acts 14:19-22

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 14:19-22

> 19 And there came thither certain Jews from Antioch and Iconium, who persuaded the people, and, having stoned Paul, drew him out of the city, supposing he had been dead.
> 20 Howbeit, as the disciples stood round about him, he rose up, and came into the city: and the next day he departed with Barnabas to Derbe.
> 21 And when they had preached the gospel to that city, and had taught many, they returned again to Lystra, and to Iconium, and Antioch,
> 22 Confirming the souls of the disciples, and exhorting them to continue in the faith, and that we must through much tribulation enter into the kingdom of God.

Talk about the story After enemies attacked Paul, he continued serving and encouraged the disciples. Following Jesus did not remove every hardship. Believers needed support to keep going.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was attacked? *Answer: Paul.*

2. Did he stop teaching about Jesus? *Answer: No.*

3. Whom did he encourage afterward? *Answer: The disciples.*

In your day If doing right brings teasing, tell a caring adult. Find someone who will encourage you instead of trying to handle the difficulty alone.

Pray together God, strengthen people who suffer for following Jesus. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 16:31 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 305 | Sunday, August 1, 2027 | Come over into Macedonia

Read aloud Acts 16:6-10

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 16:6-10

> 6 Now when they had gone throughout Phrygia and the region of Galatia, and were forbidden of the Holy Ghost to preach the word in Asia,
> 7 After they were come to Mysia, they assayed to go into Bithynia: but the Spirit suffered them not.
> 8 And they passing by Mysia came down to Troas.
> 9 And a vision appeared to Paul in the night; There stood a man of Macedonia, and prayed him, saying, Come over into Macedonia, and help us.
> 10 And after he had seen the vision, immediately we endeavoured to go into Macedonia, assuredly gathering that the Lord had called us for to preach the gospel unto them.

Talk about the story God redirected Paul's journey. In a vision, a man from Macedonia asked for help. Paul and his companions prepared to go where God was sending them.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whose route was changed? *Answer: Paul's.*

2. Where was the man in the vision from? *Answer: Macedonia.*

3. Did the group prepare to go there? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day A changed plan can be disappointing. If a family plan changes for a good reason, ask how you can help with the new plan.

Pray together God, help me respond patiently when plans change. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 16:31 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 306 | Monday, August 2, 2027 | Lydia Opens Her Home

Read aloud Acts 16:11-15

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 16:11-15

> 11 Therefore loosing from Troas, we came with a straight course to Samothracia, and the next day to Neapolis;
> 12 And from thence to Philippi, which is the chief city of that part of Macedonia, and a colony: and we were in that city abiding certain days.
> 13 And on the sabbath we went out of the city by a river side, where prayer was wont to be made; and we sat down, and spake unto the women which resorted thither.
> 14 And a certain woman named Lydia, a seller of purple, of the city of Thyatira, which worshipped God, heard us: whose heart the Lord opened, that she attended unto the things which were spoken of Paul.
> 15 And when she was baptized, and her household, she besought us, saying, If ye have judged me to be faithful to the Lord, come into my house, and abide there. And she constrained us.

Talk about the story Lydia listened as Paul taught. The Lord opened her heart to the message, and she welcomed the missionaries into her home. Her welcome supported their work.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who listened to Paul? *Answer: Lydia.*

2. Who opened her heart? *Answer: The Lord.*

3. What did she offer the missionaries? *Answer: Hospitality in her home.*

In your day Think of someone who teaches you God's Word. With an adult, find a simple way to help them, such as a thank-you note or practical assistance.

Pray together God, help me listen and care for those who teach Your Word. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 16:31 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 307 | Tuesday, August 3, 2027 | Songs at Midnight

Read aloud Acts 16:22-25

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 16:22-25

> 22 And the multitude rose up together against them: and the magistrates rent off their clothes, and commanded to beat them.
> 23 And when they had laid many stripes upon them, they cast them into prison, charging the jailor to keep them safely:
> 24 Who, having received such a charge, thrust them into the inner prison, and made their feet fast in the stocks.
> 25 And at midnight Paul and Silas prayed, and sang praises unto God: and the prisoners heard them.

Talk about the story Paul and Silas had been beaten and put in prison. At midnight they prayed and sang to God, while other prisoners listened. They still turned to Him in pain.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where were Paul and Silas? *Answer: In prison.*

2. What did they do at midnight? *Answer: Prayed and sang praises.*

3. Who listened? *Answer: The other prisoners.*

In your day On a hard day, choose a familiar Bible song. Singing need not hide your sadness; it can help you remember God while you tell Him how you feel.

Pray together God, help us turn to You during hard days. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 16:31 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 308 | Wednesday, August 4, 2027 | What Must I Do to Be Saved?

Read aloud Acts 16:26-34

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 16:26-34

> 26 And suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken: and immediately all the doors were opened, and every one's bands were loosed.
> 27 And the keeper of the prison awaking out of his sleep, and seeing the prison doors open, he drew out his sword, and would have killed himself, supposing that the prisoners had been fled.
> 28 But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, Do thyself no harm: for we are all here.
> 29 Then he called for a light, and sprang in, and came trembling, and fell down before Paul and Silas,
> 30 And brought them out, and said, Sirs, what must I do to be saved?
> 31 And they said, Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ, and thou shalt be saved, and thy house.
> 32 And they spake unto him the word of the Lord, and to all that were in his house.
> 33 And he took them the same hour of the night, and washed their stripes; and was baptized, he and all his, straightway.
> 34 And when he had brought them into his house, he set meat before them, and rejoiced, believing in God with all his house.

Talk about the story After the earthquake, the jailer asked how to be saved. Paul told him to believe on the Lord Jesus Christ. His household heard the message too; each needed faith.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What shook the prison? *Answer: An earthquake.*

2. What did the jailer ask? *Answer: What must I do to be saved?*

3. Whom was he told to believe on? *Answer: The Lord Jesus Christ.*

In your day Ask an adult what trusting Jesus means. Being in a Christian family does not do your believing for you. You may ask honest questions as you learn.

Pray together Jesus, help me understand and trust Your good news. Amen.

Memory verse Acts 16:31 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 23 | Days 309-322

Paul Teaches in New Cities + Paul Goes to Rome

Thursday, August 5, 2027 through Wednesday, August 18, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Philippians 4:13

> 13 I can do all things through Christ which strengtheneth me.

Meaning in context In context, Christ gives strength to remain faithful and content in every circumstance.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 45 | Paul Teaches in New Cities | Aug 5 - Aug 11, 2027

Bible story Acts 17-20

Week overview Paul reasoned from Scripture in Thessalonica, met careful Bereans, spoke of the Creator in Athens, worked in Corinth, and taught in Ephesus.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13

Day 309 | Thursday, August 5, 2027 | Reasoning from the Scriptures

Read aloud Acts 17:1-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 17:1-4

> 1 Now when they had passed through Amphipolis and Apollonia, they came to Thessalonica, where was a synagogue of the Jews:
> 2 And Paul, as his manner was, went in unto them, and three sabbath days reasoned with them out of the scriptures,
> 3 Opening and alleging, that Christ must needs have suffered, and risen again from the dead; and that this Jesus, whom I preach unto you, is Christ.
> 4 And some of them believed, and consorted with Paul and Silas; and of the devout Greeks a great multitude, and of the chief women not a few.

Talk about the story Paul opened the Scriptures to explain that Christ had to suffer and rise again. He showed that Jesus is the Christ. His message came from God's written Word.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Paul use to explain his message? *Answer: The Scriptures.*

2. What did Christ do after suffering? *Answer: Rose from the dead.*

3. Who did Paul say is the Christ? *Answer: Jesus.*

In your day When someone teaches you about Jesus, ask where the Bible says it. Looking together helps you learn rather than relying only on someone's confidence.

Pray together God, help me learn about Jesus from Your Word. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 310 | Friday, August 6, 2027 | The Bereans Search Daily

Read aloud Acts 17:10-12

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 17:10-12

> 10 And the brethren immediately sent away Paul and Silas by night unto Berea: who coming thither went into the synagogue of the Jews.
> 11 These were more noble than those in Thessalonica, in that they received the word with all readiness of mind, and searched the scriptures daily, whether those things were so.
> 12 Therefore many of them believed; also of honourable women which were Greeks, and of men, not a few.

Talk about the story The Bereans welcomed the message and searched the Scriptures daily to check it. Careful questions did not mean they were refusing to learn.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did the Bereans search? *Answer: The Scriptures.*

2. How often? *Answer: Daily.*

3. What were they checking? *Answer: Whether the message was true.*

In your day If you hear a surprising Bible claim, ask an adult to read the passage with you. Be willing to learn and willing to check.

Pray together God, help me eagerly learn and carefully check Your Word. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 311 | Saturday, August 7, 2027 | The Creator Is Not Far

Read aloud Acts 17:22-28

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 17:22-28

> 22 Then Paul stood in the midst of Mars' hill, and said, Ye men of Athens, I perceive that in all things ye are too superstitious.
> 23 For as I passed by, and beheld your devotions, I found an altar with this inscription, TO THE UNKNOWN GOD. Whom therefore ye ignorantly worship, him declare I unto you.
> 24 God that made the world and all things therein, seeing that he is Lord of heaven and earth, dwelleth not in temples made with hands;
> 25 Neither is worshipped with men's hands, as though he needed any thing, seeing he giveth to all life, and breath, and all things;
> 26 And hath made of one blood all nations of men for to dwell on all the face of the earth, and hath determined the times before appointed, and the bounds of their habitation;
> 27 That they should seek the Lord, if haply they might feel after him, and find him, though he be not far from every one of us:
> 28 For in him we live, and move, and have our being; as certain also of your own poets have said, For we are also his offspring.

Talk about the story Paul told the people of Athens that God made the world and gives us life. He does not live inside a temple made by people or need us to keep Him alive.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who made the world? *Answer: God.*

2. Who gives life and breath? *Answer: God.*

3. Can a building made by people contain Him? *Answer: No.*

In your day Take a breath and notice your heartbeat. We need what God provides every day. God is not like a toy that stops working when its battery runs out.

Pray together God, thank You for my life and every breath. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 312 | Sunday, August 8, 2027 | Work and Witness in Corinth

Read aloud Acts 18:1-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 18:1-4

> 1 After these things Paul departed from Athens, and came to Corinth;
> 2 And found a certain Jew named Aquila, born in Pontus, lately come from Italy, with his wife Priscilla; (because that Claudius had commanded all Jews to depart from Rome:) and came unto them.
> 3 And because he was of the same craft, he abode with them, and wrought: for by their occupation they were tentmakers.
> 4 And he reasoned in the synagogue every sabbath, and persuaded the Jews and the Greeks.

Talk about the story Paul worked making tents with Aquila and Priscilla. He also taught about Jesus. Ordinary work and sharing God's truth were both parts of his days.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who worked with Paul? *Answer: Aquila and Priscilla.*

2. What did they make? *Answer: Tents.*

3. Did Paul also teach about Jesus? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day You can speak kindly about God while doing ordinary things, like cleaning up with a friend. A useful job does not have to interrupt caring for people.

Pray together God, help me work well and speak kindly during my day. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 313 | Monday, August 9, 2027 | Apollos Learns More Clearly

Read aloud Acts 18:24-28

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 18:24-28

> 24 And a certain Jew named Apollos, born at Alexandria, an eloquent man, and mighty in the scriptures, came to Ephesus.
> 25 This man was instructed in the way of the Lord; and being fervent in the spirit, he spake and taught diligently the things of the Lord, knowing only the baptism of John.
> 26 And he began to speak boldly in the synagogue: whom when Aquila and Priscilla had heard, they took him unto them, and expounded unto him the way of God more perfectly.
> 27 And when he was disposed to pass into Achaia, the brethren wrote, exhorting the disciples to receive him: who, when he was come, helped them much which had believed through grace:
> 28 For he mightily convinced the Jews, and that publickly, shewing by the scriptures that Jesus was Christ.

Talk about the story Apollos taught boldly but needed fuller understanding. Aquila and Priscilla explained God's way more clearly to him. A good teacher can still learn.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who needed more teaching? *Answer: Apollos.*

2. Who helped him? *Answer: Aquila and Priscilla.*

3. Can a teacher still need to learn? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day If you answer a question incorrectly, listen to the correction. Try, "Thank you; I understand that better now," instead of pretending you knew all along.

Pray together God, help me welcome correction and keep learning. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 314 | Tuesday, August 10, 2027 | Teaching Boldly in Ephesus

Read aloud Acts 19:8-12

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 19:8-12

> 8 And he went into the synagogue, and spake boldly for the space of three months, disputing and persuading the things concerning the kingdom of God.
> 9 But when divers were hardened, and believed not, but spake evil of that way before the multitude, he departed from them, and separated the disciples, disputing daily in the school of one Tyrannus.
> 10 And this continued by the space of two years; so that all they which dwelt in Asia heard the word of the Lord Jesus, both Jews and Greeks.
> 11 And God wrought special miracles by the hands of Paul:
> 12 So that from his body were brought unto the sick handkerchiefs or aprons, and the diseases departed from them, and the evil spirits went out of them.

Talk about the story Paul kept teaching about God's kingdom in Ephesus. God also worked special miracles through him. Many people had opportunities to hear the Lord's message.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who taught in Ephesus? *Answer: Paul.*

2. What did he teach about? *Answer: God's kingdom.*

3. Who worked the special miracles? *Answer: God.*

In your day Some things take many lessons to learn. Ask one question about a Bible truth you have heard before, and listen for something you understand better now.

Pray together God, help us keep listening and learning Your truth. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 315 | Wednesday, August 11, 2027 | Finish My Course with Joy

Read aloud Acts 20:17-24

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 20:17-24

> 17 And from Miletus he sent to Ephesus, and called the elders of the church.
> 18 And when they were come to him, he said unto them, Ye know, from the first day that I came into Asia, after what manner I have been with you at all seasons,
> 19 Serving the Lord with all humility of mind, and with many tears, and temptations, which befell me by the lying in wait of the Jews:
> 20 And how I kept back nothing that was profitable unto you, but have shewed you, and have taught you publickly, and from house to house,
> 21 Testifying both to the Jews, and also to the Greeks, repentance toward God, and faith toward our Lord Jesus Christ.
> 22 And now, behold, I go bound in the spirit unto Jerusalem, not knowing the things that shall befall me there:
> 23 Save that the Holy Ghost witnesseth in every city, saying that bonds and afflictions abide me.
> 24 But none of these things move me, neither count I my life dear unto myself, so that I might finish my course with joy, and the ministry, which I have received of the Lord Jesus, to testify the gospel of the grace of God.

Talk about the story Paul wanted to finish the work Jesus gave him. He served humbly even through tears and trouble. Telling people God's good news mattered to him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom had Paul served? *Answer: The Lord.*

2. Did his work include difficulties? *Answer: Yes.*

3. What did he want to finish? *Answer: The ministry Jesus gave him.*

In your day Finishing a helpful job can take patience. Choose a small task you have started, and finish it with care instead of leaving it for someone else.

Pray together Jesus, help me be faithful with the work I have. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 46 | Paul Goes to Rome | Aug 12 - Aug 18, 2027

Bible story Acts 21-28

Week overview Paul accepted suffering, testified before rulers, trusted God's promise during a storm and shipwreck, and finally preached in Rome.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13

Day 316 | Thursday, August 12, 2027 | Ready to Suffer for Jesus

Read aloud Acts 21:10-14

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 21:10-14

> 10 And as we tarried there many days, there came down from Judaea a certain prophet, named Agabus.
> 11 And when he was come unto us, he took Paul's girdle, and bound his own hands and feet, and said, Thus saith the Holy Ghost, So shall the Jews at Jerusalem bind the man that owneth this girdle, and shall deliver him into the hands of the Gentiles.
> 12 And when we heard these things, both we, and they of that place, besought him not to go up to Jerusalem.
> 13 Then Paul answered, What mean ye to weep and to break mine heart? for I am ready not to be bound only, but also to die at Jerusalem for the name of the Lord Jesus.
> 14 And when he would not be persuaded, we ceased, saying, The will of the Lord be done.

Talk about the story Paul heard a warning that he would be arrested. He was ready to suffer for Jesus. His friends finally entrusted him to the Lord's will.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What was Paul warned about? *Answer: Arrest.*

2. For whose name was he willing to suffer? *Answer: The Lord Jesus'.*

3. Whose will did the friends accept? *Answer: The Lord's.*

In your day Doing right can have a cost, such as admitting a mistake and losing a privilege. Ask God for courage; do not choose danger just to prove bravery.

Pray together Jesus, give Your people courage when following You is costly. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 317 | Friday, August 13, 2027 | Paul Tells What Jesus Did

Read aloud Acts 22:6-10

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 22:6-10

> 6 And it came to pass, that, as I made my journey, and was come nigh unto Damascus about noon, suddenly there shone from heaven a great light round about me.
> 7 And I fell unto the ground, and heard a voice saying unto me, Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me?
> 8 And I answered, Who art thou, Lord? And he said unto me, I am Jesus of Nazareth, whom thou persecutest.
> 9 And they that were with me saw indeed the light, and were afraid; but they heard not the voice of him that spake to me.
> 10 And I said, What shall I do, Lord? And the Lord said unto me, Arise, and go into Damascus; and there it shall be told thee of all things which are appointed for thee to do.

Talk about the story Paul retold how Jesus stopped him on the road. He heard Jesus' voice and asked what he should do. He remembered the event clearly.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What shone around Paul? *Answer: A great light from heaven.*

2. Who spoke to him? *Answer: Jesus.*

3. What did Paul ask? *Answer: What shall I do, Lord?*

In your day Tell one true event from your own day without adding exciting details that did not happen. Honest storytelling helps people trust what you say.

Pray together Jesus, help me listen and tell the truth about what You do. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 318 | Saturday, August 14, 2027 | Be of Good Cheer

Read aloud Acts 23:11

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 23:11

> 11 And the night following the Lord stood by him, and said, Be of good cheer, Paul: for as thou hast testified of me in Jerusalem, so must thou bear witness also at Rome.

Talk about the story At night the Lord stood by Paul and told him to be courageous. He would also testify in Rome. His imprisonment had not ended God's work for him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who stood by Paul? *Answer: The Lord.*

2. Was Paul told to despair or be courageous? *Answer: Be courageous.*

3. Where would he testify next? *Answer: Rome.*

In your day A hard day can make you think nothing good is ahead. Tell an adult that feeling, and remember one true promise of God's care.

Pray together God, encourage those who feel trapped or discouraged. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 319 | Sunday, August 15, 2027 | Felix Hears about Faith

Read aloud Acts 24:24-27

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 24:24-27

> 24 And after certain days, when Felix came with his wife Drusilla, which was a Jewess, he sent for Paul, and heard him concerning the faith in Christ.
> 25 And as he reasoned of righteousness, temperance, and judgment to come, Felix trembled, and answered, Go thy way for this time; when I have a convenient season, I will call for thee.
> 26 He hoped also that money should have been given him of Paul, that he might loose him: wherefore he sent for him the oftener, and communed with him.
> 27 But after two years Porcius Festus came into Felix' room: and Felix, willing to shew the Jews a pleasure, left Paul bound.

Talk about the story Felix heard Paul speak about faith, right living, self-control, and judgment. He was frightened but put off responding. Hearing truth is not the same as responding to it.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who listened to Paul? *Answer: Felix.*

2. Did the message concern him? *Answer: Yes; he trembled.*

3. Did he respond promptly or put it off? *Answer: Put it off.*

In your day If you know you need to apologize, "later" can become never. Choose a good next step you can take now, with an adult's help.

Pray together God, help me respond to truth instead of always waiting. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 320 | Monday, August 16, 2027 | Paul Testifies before Agrippa

Read aloud Acts 26:19-23

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 26:19-23

> 19 Whereupon, O king Agrippa, I was not disobedient unto the heavenly vision:
> 20 But shewed first unto them of Damascus, and at Jerusalem, and throughout all the coasts of Judaea, and then to the Gentiles, that they should repent and turn to God, and do works meet for repentance.
> 21 For these causes the Jews caught me in the temple, and went about to kill me.
> 22 Having therefore obtained help of God, I continue unto this day, witnessing both to small and great, saying none other things than those which the prophets and Moses did say should come:
> 23 That Christ should suffer, and that he should be the first that should rise from the dead, and should shew light unto the people, and to the Gentiles.

Talk about the story Paul told Agrippa he had obeyed the heavenly vision. He preached turning to God and living in ways that showed repentance. He also told of Christ's resurrection.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. To whom did Paul testify? *Answer: Agrippa.*

2. Did Paul obey the heavenly vision? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Should repentance be followed by changed actions? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day If you promise to stop teasing, practice a kind sentence instead. A changed direction can be seen in what you do next.

Pray together God, help my actions show that I am turning toward You. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 321 | Tuesday, August 17, 2027 | God's Promise in the Storm

Read aloud Acts 27:21-26

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 27:21-26

> 21 But after long abstinence Paul stood forth in the midst of them, and said, Sirs, ye should have hearkened unto me, and not have loosed from Crete, and to have gained this harm and loss.
> 22 And now I exhort you to be of good cheer: for there shall be no loss of any man's life among you, but of the ship.
> 23 For there stood by me this night the angel of God, whose I am, and whom I serve,
> 24 Saying, Fear not, Paul; thou must be brought before Caesar: and, lo, God hath given thee all them that sail with thee.
> 25 Wherefore, sirs, be of good cheer: for I believe God, that it shall be even as it was told me.
> 26 Howbeit we must be cast upon a certain island.

Talk about the story During the storm, Paul told the sailors that God had promised to preserve their lives. He believed God. This was a specific promise for that voyage.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where were Paul and the others? *Answer: On a ship in a storm.*

2. Had God promised to spare their lives? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Did Paul believe that promise? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day When afraid, remember what God actually says rather than inventing a promise. Ask an adult to help you find a Bible verse about His care.

Pray together God, help me trust Your true words in frightening times. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 322 | Wednesday, August 18, 2027 | Preaching in Rome

Read aloud Acts 28:30-31

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Acts 28:30-31

> 30 And Paul dwelt two whole years in his own hired house, and received all that came in unto him,
> 31 Preaching the kingdom of God, and teaching those things which concern the Lord Jesus Christ, with all confidence, no man forbidding him.

Talk about the story In Rome, Paul welcomed visitors and taught about Jesus. His circumstances were limited, but people could still hear the good news. He used the opportunity he had.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. In what city was Paul? *Answer: Rome.*

2. Did he welcome visitors? *Answer: Yes.*

3. About whom did he teach? *Answer: The Lord Jesus Christ.*

In your day If you are stuck indoors, you can still encourage someone nearby or send a kind note with permission. Look for what you can do today.

Pray together God, help me use today's opportunities to do good. Amen.

Memory verse Philippians 4:13 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 24 | Days 323-336

The Gospel and a New Life + Love, Service, and the Fruit of the Spirit

Thursday, August 19, 2027 through Wednesday, September 1, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Romans 5:8

> 8 But God commendeth his love toward us, in that, while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us.

Meaning in context God showed His love by sending Christ to die for us while we were still sinners.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 47 | The Gospel and a New Life | Aug 19 - Aug 25, 2027

Bible story Romans 3-12

Week overview Romans explains righteousness through faith, peace with God, Christ's love for sinners, new life, security in God's love, and transformed living.

Memory verse Romans 5:8

Day 323 | Thursday, August 19, 2027 | Righteousness through Faith

Read aloud Romans 3:21-24

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Romans 3:21-24

> 21 But now the righteousness of God without the law is manifested, being witnessed by the law and the prophets;
> 22 Even the righteousness of God which is by faith of Jesus Christ unto all and upon all them that believe: for there is no difference:
> 23 For all have sinned, and come short of the glory of God;
> 24 Being justified freely by his grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus:

Talk about the story Everyone has sinned and needs God's grace. Through Jesus, God declares believers right with Him. Justified means being declared right; it is His gift, not our perfect record.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who has sinned? *Answer: All people.*

2. Through whom does God give salvation? *Answer: Jesus Christ.*

3. Is His grace earned or given freely? *Answer: Given freely.*

In your day A dirty window cannot claim to be clean by comparing itself with a dirtier one. We all need forgiveness, even when someone else has done wrong too.

Pray together God, help me admit my need for Your grace. Amen.

Memory verse Romans 5:8 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 324 | Friday, August 20, 2027 | Peace with God

Read aloud Romans 5:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Romans 5:1-5

> 1 Therefore being justified by faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ:
> 2 By whom also we have access by faith into this grace wherein we stand, and rejoice in hope of the glory of God.
> 3 And not only so, but we glory in tribulations also: knowing that tribulation worketh patience;
> 4 And patience, experience; and experience, hope:
> 5 And hope maketh not ashamed; because the love of God is shed abroad in our hearts by the Holy Ghost which is given unto us.

Talk about the story Those made right with God through faith have peace with Him through Jesus. Trouble can still happen, but it does not erase this peace. Their hope rests in God.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. How are believers justified? *Answer: By faith.*

2. With whom do they have peace? *Answer: God.*

3. Through whom? *Answer: The Lord Jesus Christ.*

In your day Making peace after an argument feels different from still being enemies. This passage describes peace with God, something Jesus makes possible for those who trust Him.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for making peace with God possible. Amen.

Memory verse Romans 5:8 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 325 | Saturday, August 21, 2027 | Christ Died for Us

Read aloud Romans 5:6-8

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Romans 5:6-8

> 6 For when we were yet without strength, in due time Christ died for the ungodly.
> 7 For scarcely for a righteous man will one die: yet peradventure for a good man some would even dare to die.
> 8 But God commendeth his love toward us, in that, while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us.

Talk about the story God did not wait for us to become good enough. Christ died for us while we were sinners. His death shows God's love for undeserving people.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Did Christ die only for people who were already good? *Answer: No.*

2. What were we when He died for us? *Answer: Sinners.*

3. Whose love does this show? *Answer: God's.*

In your day If you make a mistake, hiding will not make you more lovable to God. Admit your sin and learn why Jesus came to save sinners.

Pray together God, thank You for loving sinners and sending Jesus. Amen.

Memory verse Romans 5:8 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 326 | Sunday, August 22, 2027 | Walk in Newness of Life

Read aloud Romans 6:4-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Romans 6:4-6

> 4 Therefore we are buried with him by baptism into death: that like as Christ was raised up from the dead by the glory of the Father, even so we also should walk in newness of life.
> 5 For if we have been planted together in the likeness of his death, we shall be also in the likeness of his resurrection:
> 6 Knowing this, that our old man is crucified with him, that the body of sin might be destroyed, that henceforth we should not serve sin.

Talk about the story Believers are joined to Jesus in His death and resurrection. Baptism pictures this. They are called to walk in newness of life, living as people who belong to Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who was raised from the dead? *Answer: Jesus Christ.*

2. What does baptism picture? *Answer: Sharing in His death and resurrection.*

3. How are believers called to live? *Answer: In newness of life.*

In your day A new way of living includes small choices. If you used to hide a mistake, practice admitting it. Good actions follow faith; they do not buy salvation.

Pray together Jesus, help those who trust You live in Your new way. Amen.

Memory verse Romans 5:8 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 327 | Monday, August 23, 2027 | No Condemnation in Christ

Read aloud Romans 8:1-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Romans 8:1-4

> 1 There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.
> 2 For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus hath made me free from the law of sin and death.
> 3 For what the law could not do, in that it was weak through the flesh, God sending his own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh, and for sin, condemned sin in the flesh:
> 4 That the righteousness of the law might be fulfilled in us, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.

Talk about the story Those who are in Christ Jesus are not condemned. God dealt with sin through His Son. Salvation rests on Jesus' work, not on pretending we have never failed.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Is there condemnation for those in Christ? *Answer: No.*

2. Whom did God send to deal with sin? *Answer: His own Son.*

3. Can we save ourselves by perfect rule-keeping? *Answer: No.*

In your day After doing wrong, a believer should confess it rather than think Jesus has stopped being Saviour. Ask an adult to explain forgiveness and belonging to Christ.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for what You have done to free believers from condemnation. Amen.

Memory verse Romans 5:8 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 328 | Tuesday, August 24, 2027 | Nothing Can Separate Us

Read aloud Romans 8:38-39

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Romans 8:38-39

> 38 For I am persuaded, that neither death, nor life, nor angels, nor principalities, nor powers, nor things present, nor things to come,
> 39 Nor height, nor depth, nor any other creature, shall be able to separate us from the love of God, which is in Christ Jesus our Lord.

Talk about the story Paul says nothing can separate believers from God's love in Christ Jesus. Death, life, present trouble, and future things cannot overpower that love.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Can death separate believers from God's love? *Answer: No.*

2. Can things to come separate them? *Answer: No.*

3. In whom is this love? *Answer: Christ Jesus our Lord.*

In your day Think of a worry about tomorrow. You can tell God and a caring adult. For someone who belongs to Jesus, a hard tomorrow cannot remove God's love.

Pray together God, thank You for Your unbreakable love in Jesus. Amen.

Memory verse Romans 5:8 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 329 | Wednesday, August 25, 2027 | Be Transformed

Read aloud Romans 12:1-2

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Romans 12:1-2

> 1 I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that ye present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable unto God, which is your reasonable service.
> 2 And be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind, that ye may prove what is that good, and acceptable, and perfect, will of God.

Talk about the story God calls believers to offer their lives to Him and let Him renew their minds. Following the crowd is not the way to learn what pleases Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Should believers simply copy the world? *Answer: No.*

2. What needs renewing? *Answer: Their minds.*

3. To whom should they offer their lives? *Answer: God.*

In your day If a show or game makes cruelty seem funny, talk with an adult about it. Choose something that helps you think about what is good.

Pray together God, help me think carefully about what I copy. Amen.

Memory verse Romans 5:8 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 48 | Love, Service, and the Fruit of the Spirit | Aug 26 - Sep 1, 2027

Bible story 1 Corinthians 3-13; Galatians 5-6

Week overview The letters teach that God gives growth, believers belong to Him and one another, love acts selflessly, and the Spirit grows beautiful fruit.

Memory verse Romans 5:8

Day 330 | Thursday, August 26, 2027 | God Gives the Increase

Read aloud 1 Corinthians 3:5-9

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Corinthians 3:5-9

> 5 Who then is Paul, and who is Apollos, but ministers by whom ye believed, even as the Lord gave to every man?
> 6 I have planted, Apollos watered; but God gave the increase.
> 7 So then neither is he that planteth any thing, neither he that watereth; but God that giveth the increase.
> 8 Now he that planteth and he that watereth are one: and every man shall receive his own reward according to his own labour.
> 9 For we are labourers together with God: ye are God's husbandry, ye are God's building.

Talk about the story Paul planted and Apollos watered, but God gave the growth. Different teachers served the same Lord. Neither teacher could create spiritual life himself.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who planted? *Answer: Paul.*

2. Who watered? *Answer: Apollos.*

3. Who gave the increase? *Answer: God.*

In your day A plant may need one person to plant and another to water. Thank two different people who help you learn about God, without making them compete.

Pray together God, thank You for different people who help us grow. Amen.

Memory verse Romans 5:8 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 331 | Friday, August 27, 2027 | Your Body Belongs to God

Read aloud 1 Corinthians 6:19-20

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Corinthians 6:19-20

> 19 What? know ye not that your body is the temple of the Holy Ghost which is in you, which ye have of God, and ye are not your own?
> 20 For ye are bought with a price: therefore glorify God in your body, and in your spirit, which are God's.

Talk about the story A believer's body belongs to God and is a temple of the Holy Ghost. Jesus paid the price to save His people. Their bodies should honor Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whose temple is the believer's body? *Answer: The Holy Ghost's.*

2. Do believers belong only to themselves? *Answer: No, they belong to God.*

3. Whom should they glorify with their bodies? *Answer: God.*

In your day Caring for your body includes rest, food, and safe choices. If someone touches you in a wrong or frightening way, tell a trusted adult; your body matters.

Pray together God, help us care for our bodies and honor You. Amen.

Memory verse Romans 5:8 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 332 | Saturday, August 28, 2027 | God Makes a Way to Escape

Read aloud 1 Corinthians 10:13

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Corinthians 10:13

> 13 There hath no temptation taken you but such as is common to man: but God is faithful, who will not suffer you to be tempted above that ye are able; but will with the temptation also make a way to escape, that ye may be able to bear it.

Talk about the story Temptation is the pull to do wrong. God is faithful and provides a way to resist. A strong urge does not mean we must obey it.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Is God faithful when we are tempted? *Answer: Yes.*

2. Does He provide a way to resist? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Must we do wrong just because we feel tempted? *Answer: No.*

In your day If you want to hit because you are angry, step back, put your hands down, and call an adult. Practice that escape before the next argument.

Pray together God, help me take the way out when I want to do wrong. Amen.

Memory verse Romans 5:8 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 333 | Sunday, August 29, 2027 | Many Members, One Body

Read aloud 1 Corinthians 12:12-18

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Corinthians 12:12-18

> 12 For as the body is one, and hath many members, and all the members of that one body, being many, are one body: so also is Christ.
> 13 For by one Spirit are we all baptized into one body, whether we be Jews or Gentiles, whether we be bond or free; and have been all made to drink into one Spirit.
> 14 For the body is not one member, but many.
> 15 If the foot shall say, Because I am not the hand, I am not of the body; is it therefore not of the body?
> 16 And if the ear shall say, Because I am not the eye, I am not of the body; is it therefore not of the body?
> 17 If the whole body were an eye, where were the hearing? If the whole were hearing, where were the smelling?
> 18 But now hath God set the members every one of them in the body, as it hath pleased him.

Talk about the story The church is like one body with different parts. An ear is not useless because it is not an eye. God gives different people places to serve.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Is the body made of only one part? *Answer: No.*

2. Does an ear have to be an eye to belong? *Answer: No.*

3. Who places the parts in the body? *Answer: God.*

In your day Try tying a shoe with only one hand. Parts work together. Name something someone else does well without wishing everyone were just like you.

Pray together God, help us value each person's part in the church. Amen.

Memory verse Romans 5:8 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 334 | Monday, August 30, 2027 | What Love Does

Read aloud 1 Corinthians 13:4-8

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Corinthians 13:4-8

> 4 Charity suffereth long, and is kind; charity envieth not; charity vaunteth not itself, is not puffed up,
> 5 Doth not behave itself unseemly, seeketh not her own, is not easily provoked, thinketh no evil;
> 6 Rejoiceth not in iniquity, but rejoiceth in the truth;
> 7 Beareth all things, believeth all things, hopeth all things, endureth all things.
> 8 Charity never faileth: but whether there be prophecies, they shall fail; whether there be tongues, they shall cease; whether there be knowledge, it shall vanish away.

Talk about the story Love is patient and kind. It does not boast or delight in wrongdoing. Love is more than a nice feeling; it changes how we treat people.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Is love patient? *Answer: Yes.*

2. Is love kind or cruel? *Answer: Kind.*

3. Does love rejoice in wrongdoing or truth? *Answer: Truth.*

In your day If your friend takes longer to learn a game, explain again without laughing. That is one way patience and kindness can look during play.

Pray together God, help me love with patient, kind actions. Amen.

Memory verse Romans 5:8 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 335 | Tuesday, August 31, 2027 | The Spirit's Fruit

Read aloud Galatians 5:22-23

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Galatians 5:22-23

> 22 But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, longsuffering, gentleness, goodness, faith,
> 23 Meekness, temperance: against such there is no law.

Talk about the story The Holy Spirit produces good fruit in believers' lives. This includes love, peace, patience, gentleness, and self-control. These qualities show in everyday choices.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who produces this fruit? *Answer: The Spirit.*

2. Is gentleness one part of it? *Answer: Yes.*

3. What does temperance mean? *Answer: Self-control.*

In your day When you lose a game, practice saying, "Good game," without throwing pieces. Ask God for self-control when disappointment feels strong.

Pray together God, help Your good fruit grow in my choices. Amen.

Memory verse Romans 5:8 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 336 | Wednesday, September 1, 2027 | Do Not Grow Weary

Read aloud Galatians 6:7-10

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Galatians 6:7-10

> 7 Be not deceived; God is not mocked: for whatsoever a man soweth, that shall he also reap.
> 8 For he that soweth to his flesh shall of the flesh reap corruption; but he that soweth to the Spirit shall of the Spirit reap life everlasting.
> 9 And let us not be weary in well doing: for in due season we shall reap, if we faint not.
> 10 As we have therefore opportunity, let us do good unto all men, especially unto them who are of the household of faith.

Talk about the story Our choices are like seeds. Paul urges believers not to grow tired of doing good. Good work is worth continuing even before we see results.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What picture does Paul use for our choices? *Answer: Sowing and reaping.*

2. Should we give up doing good? *Answer: No.*

3. To whom should we do good? *Answer: All people, especially fellow believers.*

In your day A seed does not become a flower the day you plant it. Keep doing one helpful job this week even if nobody notices right away.

Pray together God, help me keep doing good without giving up. Amen.

Memory verse Romans 5:8 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 25 | Days 337-350

Grace, Kindness, Joy, and God's Armor + Be Faithful and Hold Fast to Scripture

Thursday, September 2, 2027 through Wednesday, September 15, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Ephesians 4:32

> 32 And be ye kind one to another, tenderhearted, forgiving one another, even as God for Christ's sake hath forgiven you.

Meaning in context Because God forgave us for Christ's sake, we should be kind, tenderhearted, and forgiving.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 49 | Grace, Kindness, Joy, and God's Armor | Sep 2 - Sep 8, 2027

Bible story Ephesians 2-6; Philippians 4; Colossians 3

Week overview These letters celebrate salvation by grace, unity, kind words, children's obedience, spiritual armor, prayerful joy, and Christlike character.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32

Day 337 | Thursday, September 2, 2027 | Saved by Grace

Read aloud Ephesians 2:8-10

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Ephesians 2:8-10

> 8 For by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God:
> 9 Not of works, lest any man should boast.
> 10 For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus unto good works, which God hath before ordained that we should walk in them.

Talk about the story Salvation is God's gift through faith, not payment for good deeds. God makes His people new so they can do good. The gift comes before the work.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Is salvation a gift or wages? *Answer: A gift.*

2. Can good works earn it? *Answer: No.*

3. Does God still want believers to do good works? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day When someone gives you a gift, you do not earn it by paying them afterward. Discuss how good actions can say thank you without buying God's salvation.

Pray together God, thank You for salvation by grace through faith. Amen.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 338 | Friday, September 3, 2027 | Walk Worthy Together

Read aloud Ephesians 4:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Ephesians 4:1-3

> 1 I therefore, the prisoner of the Lord, beseech you that ye walk worthy of the vocation wherewith ye are called,
> 2 With all lowliness and meekness, with longsuffering, forbearing one another in love;
> 3 Endeavouring to keep the unity of the Spirit in the bond of peace.

Talk about the story Paul calls believers to humility, gentleness, patience, and love. Living together peacefully takes care with how we treat each other, especially when we disagree.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Should believers be proud or humble? *Answer: Humble.*

2. Should they be impatient or patient? *Answer: Patient.*

3. What should they seek to keep? *Answer: Unity in peace.*

In your day If someone builds differently from you, ask about their idea instead of taking over. Practice saying, "Show me what you mean."

Pray together God, help us be gentle and patient with one another. Amen.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 339 | Saturday, September 4, 2027 | Kind Words and Forgiving Hearts

Read aloud Ephesians 4:29-32

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Ephesians 4:29-32

> 29 Let no corrupt communication proceed out of your mouth, but that which is good to the use of edifying, that it may minister grace unto the hearers.
> 30 And grieve not the holy Spirit of God, whereby ye are sealed unto the day of redemption.
> 31 Let all bitterness, and wrath, and anger, and clamour, and evil speaking, be put away from you, with all malice:
> 32 And be ye kind one to another, tenderhearted, forgiving one another, even as God for Christ's sake hath forgiven you.

Talk about the story Our words should help people rather than tear them down. God calls us to kindness and forgiveness, remembering His forgiveness in Christ.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Should our words hurt or help? *Answer: Help.*

2. What should replace bitterness and angry speech? *Answer: Kindness and forgiveness.*

3. Whose forgiveness is our example? *Answer: God's forgiveness in Christ.*

In your day Before repeating a hurtful nickname, stop. Use the person's real name. If you already said it, apologize and choose helpful words instead.

Pray together God, help my words bring kindness instead of hurt. Amen.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 340 | Sunday, September 5, 2027 | Children, Obey Your Parents

Read aloud Ephesians 6:1-4

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Ephesians 6:1-4

> 1 Children, obey your parents in the Lord: for this is right.
> 2 Honour thy father and mother; (which is the first commandment with promise;)
> 3 That it may be well with thee, and thou mayest live long on the earth.
> 4 And, ye fathers, provoke not your children to wrath: but bring them up in the nurture and admonition of the Lord.

Talk about the story Children should obey and honor parents in the Lord. Fathers must also care for children and teach them without stirring up needless anger. God cares how both treat each other.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whom are children told to honor? *Answer: Father and mother.*

2. Should parents teach children about the Lord? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Should fathers deliberately provoke their children? *Answer: No.*

In your day Practice listening when a parent gives a reasonable instruction. Parents can practice giving it calmly. Tell a safe adult if an instruction involves harm or secrecy about wrongdoing.

Pray together God, help our family listen, teach, and care well. Amen.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 341 | Monday, September 6, 2027 | Put on God's Armor

Read aloud Ephesians 6:10-13

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Ephesians 6:10-13

> 10 Finally, my brethren, be strong in the Lord, and in the power of his might.
> 11 Put on the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil.
> 12 For we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world, against spiritual wickedness in high places.
> 13 Wherefore take unto you the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand.

Talk about the story Believers need the Lord's strength to stand against spiritual evil. God's armor is a picture of the help He provides. People are not the enemy to attack.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. In whom should believers be strong? *Answer: The Lord.*

2. Whose armor should they put on? *Answer: God's.*

3. Is this a command to fight other people? *Answer: No.*

In your day When tempted to lie, the battle is not won by hurting someone. Tell the truth and ask God for strength to stand by it.

Pray together God, help me stand for what is right in Your strength. Amen.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 342 | Tuesday, September 7, 2027 | Rejoice and Pray

Read aloud Philippians 4:4-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Philippians 4:4-7

> 4 Rejoice in the Lord alway: and again I say, Rejoice.
> 5 Let your moderation be known unto all men. The Lord is at hand.
> 6 Be careful for nothing; but in every thing by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your requests be made known unto God.
> 7 And the peace of God, which passeth all understanding, shall keep your hearts and minds through Christ Jesus.

Talk about the story Paul tells believers to bring needs to God with thanks. His peace guards their hearts and minds in Christ. They can pray about what worries them.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What should we do with our concerns? *Answer: Bring them to God in prayer.*

2. What should accompany prayer? *Answer: Thanksgiving.*

3. Whose peace can guard believers' hearts? *Answer: God's.*

In your day Name one worry and one thing you are thankful for. Pray about both, and tell an adult if the worry keeps troubling you.

Pray together God, here is what worries me. Thank You for caring. Amen.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 343 | Wednesday, September 8, 2027 | Put on Christlike Character

Read aloud Colossians 3:12-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Colossians 3:12-17

> 12 Put on therefore, as the elect of God, holy and beloved, bowels of mercies, kindness, humbleness of mind, meekness, longsuffering;
> 13 Forbearing one another, and forgiving one another, if any man have a quarrel against any: even as Christ forgave you, so also do ye.
> 14 And above all these things put on charity, which is the bond of perfectness.
> 15 And let the peace of God rule in your hearts, to the which also ye are called in one body; and be ye thankful.
> 16 Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly in all wisdom; teaching and admonishing one another in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing with grace in your hearts to the Lord.
> 17 And whatsoever ye do in word or deed, do all in the name of the Lord Jesus, giving thanks to God and the Father by him.

Talk about the story Believers are told to put on kindness, patience, forgiveness, and love, like getting dressed. These are ways to treat others because they belong to Christ.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What should believers put on? *Answer: Kindness, patience, love, and other Christlike qualities.*

2. Should they forgive? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Whose word should dwell in them richly? *Answer: Christ's.*

In your day As you choose clothes, choose one kind action for today too. You might wait patiently for a sibling or help without making a complaint.

Pray together Jesus, help my actions show kindness and love today. Amen.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 50 | Be Faithful and Hold Fast to Scripture | Sep 9 - Sep 15, 2027

Bible story 1 Thessalonians 5; 2 Thessalonians 3; 1-2 Timothy; Titus; Hebrews 12

Week overview The later letters encourage constant prayer, trust in God's faithfulness, godly example, courage, confidence in Scripture, grace-shaped living, and endurance.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32

Day 344 | Thursday, September 9, 2027 | Rejoice, Pray, Give Thanks

Read aloud 1 Thessalonians 5:16-18

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Thessalonians 5:16-18

> 16 Rejoice evermore.
> 17 Pray without ceasing.
> 18 In every thing give thanks: for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus concerning you.

Talk about the story Paul gives three short instructions: rejoice, pray, and give thanks. We can turn to God throughout the day, including when things are hard.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What does Paul tell believers to do always? *Answer: Rejoice.*

2. Should prayer be part of ordinary life? *Answer: Yes.*

3. In how many circumstances can we give thanks? *Answer: In every situation.*

In your day At bedtime, name something good and something difficult. Thank God for His care and ask for help with the difficult part; do not pretend it was pleasant.

Pray together God, thank You that I can talk to You all day. Amen.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 345 | Friday, September 10, 2027 | The Lord Is Faithful

Read aloud 2 Thessalonians 3:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Thessalonians 3:1-5

> 1 Finally, brethren, pray for us, that the word of the Lord may have free course, and be glorified, even as it is with you:
> 2 And that we may be delivered from unreasonable and wicked men: for all men have not faith.
> 3 But the Lord is faithful, who shall stablish you, and keep you from evil.
> 4 And we have confidence in the Lord touching you, that ye both do and will do the things which we command you.
> 5 And the Lord direct your hearts into the love of God, and into the patient waiting for Christ.

Talk about the story Paul asked people to pray that God's Word would spread. He reminded them that the Lord is faithful and can strengthen His people.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What did Paul ask people to pray about? *Answer: God's Word spreading.*

2. Is the Lord faithful? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Who can strengthen His people? *Answer: The Lord.*

In your day Pray for a real teacher, pastor, or missionary. Ask God to help them explain His Word clearly and help listeners understand.

Pray together God, strengthen those who teach Your Word today. Amen.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 346 | Saturday, September 11, 2027 | Be an Example

Read aloud 1 Timothy 4:12

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Timothy 4:12

> 12 Let no man despise thy youth; but be thou an example of the believers, in word, in conversation, in charity, in spirit, in faith, in purity.

Talk about the story Timothy was young, but he could set a good example through his words and conduct. Being young did not make faithful living unimportant.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Was Timothy young? *Answer: Yes.*

2. Could he still be an example? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Name one way he could set an example. *Answer: Words, behavior, love, faith, or purity.*

In your day A younger child may copy you. Show them how to put a toy away gently or speak politely. Your example can teach without a speech.

Pray together God, help me set a kind example even while I am young. Amen.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 347 | Sunday, September 12, 2027 | A Spirit of Power, Love, and a Sound Mind

Read aloud 2 Timothy 1:5-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Timothy 1:5-7

> 5 When I call to remembrance the unfeigned faith that is in thee, which dwelt first in thy grandmother Lois, and thy mother Eunice; and I am persuaded that in thee also.
> 6 Wherefore I put thee in remembrance that thou stir up the gift of God, which is in thee by the putting on of my hands.
> 7 For God hath not given us the spirit of fear; but of power, and of love, and of a sound mind.

Talk about the story Paul remembered the sincere faith of Timothy's mother and grandmother. He encouraged Timothy to serve with God's power, love, and a sound mind. Fear need not lead him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Which family members had sincere faith before Timothy? *Answer: His grandmother and mother.*

2. Does God's gift lead to fearful shrinking back? *Answer: No.*

3. Name something God gives for serving Him. *Answer: Power, love, or a sound mind.*

In your day Think of someone who has helped you learn about God. Thank them. When nervous, pause, pray, and choose a thoughtful next step.

Pray together God, help me act with love and a clear mind. Amen.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 348 | Monday, September 13, 2027 | God-Breathed Scripture

Read aloud 2 Timothy 3:14-17

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Timothy 3:14-17

> 14 But continue thou in the things which thou hast learned and hast been assured of, knowing of whom thou hast learned them;
> 15 And that from a child thou hast known the holy scriptures, which are able to make thee wise unto salvation through faith which is in Christ Jesus.
> 16 All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness:
> 17 That the man of God may be perfect, throughly furnished unto all good works.

Talk about the story Timothy had learned the Scriptures as a child. All Scripture is given by God and teaches, corrects, and prepares His people to do good. Children can begin learning now.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. When did Timothy begin learning Scripture? *Answer: As a child.*

2. Who gave all Scripture? *Answer: God.*

3. Can Scripture correct and teach us? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Choose a short verse you know. Ask what it teaches and where it could help you today. Memorizing and understanding can grow together.

Pray together God, thank You that I can learn Your Word now. Amen.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 349 | Tuesday, September 14, 2027 | Grace Makes Us New

Read aloud Titus 3:3-7

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Titus 3:3-7

> 3 For we ourselves also were sometimes foolish, disobedient, deceived, serving divers lusts and pleasures, living in malice and envy, hateful, and hating one another.
> 4 But after that the kindness and love of God our Saviour toward man appeared,
> 5 Not by works of righteousness which we have done, but according to his mercy he saved us, by the washing of regeneration, and renewing of the Holy Ghost;
> 6 Which he shed on us abundantly through Jesus Christ our Saviour;
> 7 That being justified by his grace, we should be made heirs according to the hope of eternal life.

Talk about the story God saves because of His mercy, not because we have done enough good. Through the Holy Spirit He gives new life. His kindness changes people who have sinned.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Does God save because we earned it? *Answer: No.*

2. Because of what does He save? *Answer: His mercy.*

3. Who renews believers? *Answer: The Holy Ghost.*

In your day Cleaning up a mess does not erase every wrong choice you have made. You need God's mercy, as everyone does. Ask what receiving mercy means.

Pray together God, thank You for Your mercy toward sinners. Amen.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 350 | Wednesday, September 15, 2027 | Run Looking unto Jesus

Read aloud Hebrews 12:1-3

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Hebrews 12:1-3

> 1 Wherefore seeing we also are compassed about with so great a cloud of witnesses, let us lay aside every weight, and the sin which doth so easily beset us, and let us run with patience the race that is set before us,
> 2 Looking unto Jesus the author and finisher of our faith; who for the joy that was set before him endured the cross, despising the shame, and is set down at the right hand of the throne of God.
> 3 For consider him that endured such contradiction of sinners against himself, lest ye be wearied and faint in your minds.

Talk about the story Following Jesus is compared to running a race with patience. Believers should lay aside sin and keep looking to Jesus. He endured the cross and is their example.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What is following Jesus compared to? *Answer: Running a race.*

2. What should be laid aside? *Answer: Weights and sin that hinder.*

3. At whom should believers look? *Answer: Jesus.*

In your day Imagine running while carrying a heavy bag. What slows you down from doing right? Ask an adult to help you change one unhelpful habit.

Pray together Jesus, help me keep following You with patience. Amen.

Memory verse Ephesians 4:32 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Unit 26 | Days 351-364

Faith, Truth, Love, and Hope + Jesus Wins and Makes All Things New

Thursday, September 16, 2027 through Wednesday, September 29, 2027

Memory Verse for These Two Weeks

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 John 4:19

> **19** We love him, because he first loved us.

Meaning in context Our love is an answer to God's love, which always came first.

Practice a short part each day. An adult can say a phrase and let the child echo it. Explain unfamiliar words and give help with forgotten words.

Week 51 | Faith, Truth, Love, and Hope | Sep 16 - Sep 22, 2027

Bible story Hebrews 11; James 1; 1-2 Peter; 1-2 John; Jude

Week overview The general letters call believers to trust God, do His Word, cast cares on Him, grow in grace, walk in truth and love, and rely on His keeping power.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19

Day 351 | Thursday, September 16, 2027 | Faith Pleases God

Read aloud Hebrews 11:1-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Hebrews 11:1-6

> 1 Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.
> 2 For by it the elders obtained a good report.
> 3 Through faith we understand that the worlds were framed by the word of God, so that things which are seen were not made of things which do appear.
> 4 By faith Abel offered unto God a more excellent sacrifice than Cain, by which he obtained witness that he was righteous, God testifying of his gifts: and by it he being dead yet speaketh.
> 5 By faith Enoch was translated that he should not see death; and was not found, because God had translated him: for before his translation he had this testimony, that he pleased God.
> 6 But without faith it is impossible to please him: for he that cometh to God must believe that he is, and that he is a rewarder of them that diligently seek him.

Talk about the story Faith trusts what God says even before we see the outcome. Those who come to Him believe that He exists and rewards those who seek Him. Faith matters to God.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Can we please God without faith? *Answer: No.*

2. What must those who come to Him believe? *Answer: That He is, or exists.*

3. Whom does He reward? *Answer: Those who diligently seek Him.*

In your day You cannot see tomorrow yet. That does not mean God cannot be trusted. Name one promise He has already kept in the Bible stories you know.

Pray together God, help me trust what You have said. Amen.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

Day 352 | Friday, September 17, 2027 | Hear and Do the Word

Read aloud James 1:19-22

KJV KEY PASSAGE | James 1:19-22

> 19 Wherefore, my beloved brethren, let every man be swift to hear, slow to speak, slow to wrath:
> 20 For the wrath of man worketh not the righteousness of God.
> 21 Wherefore lay apart all filthiness and superfluity of naughtiness, and receive with meekness the engrafted word, which is able to save your souls.
> 22 But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves.

Talk about the story James tells us to listen quickly, speak slowly, and be slow to anger. We should do God's Word as well as hear it. Listening can change our next action.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Should we be quick to listen or quick to argue? *Answer: Quick to listen.*

2. Should we be quick to anger? *Answer: No.*

3. Is hearing God's Word enough without doing it? *Answer: No.*

In your day Before arguing, let the other person finish one sentence. Repeat what you heard, then answer calmly. Practice this with an adult.

Pray together God, help me listen first and act on Your Word. Amen.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19 — Say the first phrase together. Let the child fill in one familiar word.

Day 353 | Saturday, September 18, 2027 | Cast Your Care upon Him

Read aloud 1 Peter 5:6-9

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 Peter 5:6-9

> 6 Humble yourselves therefore under the mighty hand of God, that he may exalt you in due time:
> 7 Casting all your care upon him; for he careth for you.
> 8 Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary the devil, as a roaring lion, walketh about, seeking whom he may devour:
> 9 Whom resist stedfast in the faith, knowing that the same afflictions are accomplished in your brethren that are in the world.

Talk about the story God invites believers to cast their cares on Him because He cares for them. They should also stay watchful. Trusting Him does not mean ignoring real problems.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What may believers cast on God? *Answer: All their care or worries.*

2. Why? *Answer: Because He cares for them.*

3. Should they stay watchful? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Name a worry as if handing a heavy bag to someone strong. Pray about it, then ask a trusted adult for any practical help you need.

Pray together God, I bring You this worry because You care. Amen.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19 — Repeat yesterday's words, then add one short phrase. Help without rushing.

Day 354 | Sunday, September 19, 2027 | Grow in Grace

Read aloud 2 Peter 3:13-18

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 Peter 3:13-18

> 13 Nevertheless we, according to his promise, look for new heavens and a new earth, wherein dwelleth righteousness.
> 14 Wherefore, beloved, seeing that ye look for such things, be diligent that ye may be found of him in peace, without spot, and blameless.
> 15 And account that the longsuffering of our Lord is salvation; even as our beloved brother Paul also according to the wisdom given unto him hath written unto you;
> 16 As also in all his epistles, speaking in them of these things; in which are some things hard to be understood, which they that are unlearned and unstable wrest, as they do also the other scriptures, unto their own destruction.
> 17 Ye therefore, beloved, seeing ye know these things before, beware lest ye also, being led away with the error of the wicked, fall from your own stedfastness.
> 18 But grow in grace, and in the knowledge of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ. To him be glory both now and for ever. Amen.

Talk about the story Believers look forward to the new heaven and earth God promised. While waiting, they should grow in grace and in knowing Jesus. Learning continues.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What new creation do believers look for? *Answer: New heavens and a new earth.*

2. What should fill it? *Answer: Righteousness.*

3. In whose knowledge should they grow? *Answer: Jesus Christ's.*

In your day A height chart shows growing bodies. Tell one thing about Jesus you understand better now than last month. What would you like to learn next?

Pray together Jesus, help me keep learning about You. Amen.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19 — Explain one unfamiliar word, then say that part of the verse together.

Day 355 | Monday, September 20, 2027 | Love One Another

Read aloud 1 John 4:7-11

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 1 John 4:7-11

> 7 Beloved, let us love one another: for love is of God; and every one that loveth is born of God, and knoweth God.
> 8 He that loveth not knoweth not God; for God is love.
> 9 In this was manifested the love of God toward us, because that God sent his only begotten Son into the world, that we might live through him.
> 10 Herein is love, not that we loved God, but that he loved us, and sent his Son to be the propitiation for our sins.
> 11 Beloved, if God so loved us, we ought also to love one another.

Talk about the story God showed His love by sending His Son as the sacrifice for our sins. Because He loved His people this way, they should love one another.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Where does true love come from? *Answer: God.*

2. Whom did He send? *Answer: His Son.*

3. How should believers respond to His love? *Answer: Love one another.*

In your day Love sometimes costs time, like stopping your play to help a sibling. Choose one small act of care and remember God's much greater love.

Pray together God, thank You for sending Your Son. Help me love others. Amen.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19 — Take turns saying short phrases. The adult can supply any words the child forgets.

Day 356 | Tuesday, September 21, 2027 | Walking in Truth and Love

Read aloud 2 John 1:4-6

KJV KEY PASSAGE | 2 John 1:4-6

> 4 I rejoiced greatly that I found of thy children walking in truth, as we have received a commandment from the Father.
> 5 And now I beseech thee, lady, not as though I wrote a new commandment unto thee, but that which we had from the beginning, that we love one another.
> 6 And this is love, that we walk after his commandments. This is the commandment, That, as ye have heard from the beginning, ye should walk in it.

Talk about the story John was glad that believers were walking in truth. He urged them to love one another and follow God's commands. Truth and love belong together.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What made John glad? *Answer: People walking in truth.*

2. What command did he repeat? *Answer: Love one another.*

3. Does love include following God's commands? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day If a friend is doing something wrong, you can speak truth gently. Practice, "That could hurt someone. Let's do something else."

Pray together God, help me speak truth with love. Amen.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19 — Say the verse slowly together. Stop after one good practice rather than drilling.

Day 357 | Wednesday, September 22, 2027 | God Is Able to Keep You

Read aloud Jude 1:24-25

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Jude 1:24-25

> 24 Now unto him that is able to keep you from falling, and to present you faultless before the presence of his glory with exceeding joy,
> 25 To the only wise God our Saviour, be glory and majesty, dominion and power, both now and ever. Amen.

Talk about the story Jude praises God, who can keep His people and present them before His glory with joy. Their hope rests in His power and care.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who is able to keep His people? *Answer: God.*

2. Can He present them faultless before His glory? *Answer: Yes.*

3. With sadness or great joy? *Answer: Great joy.*

In your day A small child needs steady help learning to walk. Believers also depend on God. Ask for His help with one place where you struggle to obey.

Pray together God, thank You for Your power to keep those who trust You. Amen.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19 — Let the child say the words they know. Gently help with the rest.

Week 52 | Jesus Wins and Makes All Things New | Sep 23 - Sep 29, 2027

Bible story Revelation 1-22

Week overview Revelation shows the risen Jesus in glory, heaven worshiping the Creator and Lamb, Christ defeating evil, final judgment, and the new heaven and new earth.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19

Day 358 | Thursday, September 23, 2027 | The Glorious Risen Jesus

Read aloud Revelation 1:9-18

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Revelation 1:9-18

> 9 I John, who also am your brother, and companion in tribulation, and in the kingdom and patience of Jesus Christ, was in the isle that is called Patmos, for the word of God, and for the testimony of Jesus Christ.
> 10 I was in the Spirit on the Lord's day, and heard behind me a great voice, as of a trumpet,
> 11 Saying, I am Alpha and Omega, the first and the last: and, What thou seest, write in a book, and send it unto the seven churches which are in Asia; unto Ephesus, and unto Smyrna, and unto Pergamos, and unto Thyatira, and unto Sardis, and unto Philadelphia, and unto Laodicea.
> 12 And I turned to see the voice that spake with me. And being turned, I saw seven golden candlesticks;
> 13 And in the midst of the seven candlesticks one like unto the Son of man, clothed with a garment down to the foot, and girt about the paps with a golden girdle.
> 14 His head and his hairs were white like wool, as white as snow; and his eyes were as a flame of fire;
> 15 And his feet like unto fine brass, as if they burned in a furnace; and his voice as the sound of many waters.
> 16 And he had in his right hand seven stars: and out of his mouth went a sharp twoedged sword: and his countenance was as the sun shineth in his strength.
> 17 And when I saw him, I fell at his feet as dead. And he laid his right hand upon me, saying unto me, Fear not; I am the first and the last:
> 18 I am he that liveth, and was dead; and, behold, I am alive for evermore, Amen; and have the keys of hell and of death.

Talk about the story John saw the glorious risen Jesus and fell at His feet. Jesus told him not to fear. He had died, but now lives forever and holds authority over death.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who saw Jesus? *Answer: John.*

2. Had Jesus been dead? *Answer: Yes.*

3. How long does He now live? *Answer: Forevermore.*

In your day Think about the Jesus you have read about caring for children. This glorious Lord is the same Jesus. Listen to His reassuring words to John.

Pray together Jesus, thank You that You are alive forever. Amen.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19 — Begin with the reference, then say the verse together once.

Day 359 | Friday, September 24, 2027 | Holy, Holy, Holy

Read aloud Revelation 4:8-11

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Revelation 4:8-11

> 8 And the four beasts had each of them six wings about him; and they were full of eyes within: and they rest not day and night, saying, Holy, holy, holy, Lord God Almighty, which was, and is, and is to come.
> 9 And when those beasts give glory and honour and thanks to him that sat on the throne, who liveth for ever and ever,
> 10 The four and twenty elders fall down before him that sat on the throne, and worship him that liveth for ever and ever, and cast their crowns before the throne, saying,
> 11 Thou art worthy, O Lord, to receive glory and honour and power: for thou hast created all things, and for thy pleasure they are and were created.

Talk about the story Heaven worships the holy LORD, who was and is and is to come. He created all things. Everything exists because He willed it.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What word is repeated three times about God? *Answer: Holy.*

2. Who created all things? *Answer: The Lord.*

3. Does He deserve worship? *Answer: Yes.*

In your day Look around and name something God made. Tell Him why you are thankful for it. Praise is about His worth, not only our requests.

Pray together Holy God, thank You for making all things. Amen.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19 — Leave out one familiar word for the child to supply. Read it again correctly.

Day 360 | Saturday, September 25, 2027 | Worthy Is the Lamb

Read aloud Revelation 5:9-13

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Revelation 5:9-13

> 9 And they sung a new song, saying, Thou art worthy to take the book, and to open the seals thereof: for thou wast slain, and hast redeemed us to God by thy blood out of every kindred, and tongue, and people, and nation;
> 10 And hast made us unto our God kings and priests: and we shall reign on the earth.
> 11 And I beheld, and I heard the voice of many angels round about the throne and the beasts and the elders: and the number of them was ten thousand times ten thousand, and thousands of thousands;
> 12 Saying with a loud voice, Worthy is the Lamb that was slain to receive power, and riches, and wisdom, and strength, and honour, and glory, and blessing.
> 13 And every creature which is in heaven, and on the earth, and under the earth, and such as are in the sea, and all that are in them, heard I saying, Blessing, and honour, and glory, and power, be unto him that sitteth upon the throne, and unto the Lamb for ever and ever.

Talk about the story Heaven praises Jesus as the Lamb who was slain. He redeemed people from every nation by His blood. Redeemed means rescued at a price.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who is called worthy? *Answer: The Lamb, Jesus.*

2. Was He slain? *Answer: Yes.*

3. Are His redeemed people from only one nation? *Answer: No, every nation.*

In your day Picture children speaking many languages worshiping Jesus. His people are not all from one place. Pray for families in another country to hear about Him.

Pray together Jesus, thank You for saving people from around the world. Amen.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19 — Ask what one phrase means. Give a simple explanation if the child is unsure.

Day 361 | Sunday, September 26, 2027 | The Faithful and True King

Read aloud Revelation 19:11-16

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Revelation 19:11-16

> 11 And I saw heaven opened, and behold a white horse; and he that sat upon him was called Faithful and True, and in righteousness he doth judge and make war.
> 12 His eyes were as a flame of fire, and on his head were many crowns; and he had a name written, that no man knew, but he himself.
> 13 And he was clothed with a vesture dipped in blood: and his name is called The Word of God.
> 14 And the armies which were in heaven followed him upon white horses, clothed in fine linen, white and clean.
> 15 And out of his mouth goeth a sharp sword, that with it he should smite the nations: and he shall rule them with a rod of iron: and he treadeth the winepress of the fierceness and wrath of Almighty God.
> 16 And he hath on his vesture and on his thigh a name written, KING OF KINGS, AND LORD OF LORDS.

Talk about the story John saw Jesus coming as the faithful and true King. He judges rightly and is King of kings and Lord of lords. No ruler is above Him.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who is faithful and true? *Answer: Jesus.*

2. Does He judge rightly? *Answer: Yes.*

3. What royal title is written on Him? *Answer: King of kings and Lord of lords.*

In your day People in charge sometimes make unfair decisions. Jesus never needs to guess what is right. Tell Him about an unfair situation without deciding to get revenge.

Pray together Jesus, thank You that You are a just and faithful King. Amen.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19 — Let the child choose who will listen while they practice. Help as needed.

Day 362 | Monday, September 27, 2027 | The Great White Throne

Read aloud Revelation 20:11-15

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Revelation 20:11-15

> 11 And I saw a great white throne, and him that sat on it, from whose face the earth and the heaven fled away; and there was found no place for them.
> 12 And I saw the dead, small and great, stand before God; and the books were opened: and another book was opened, which is the book of life: and the dead were judged out of those things which were written in the books, according to their works.
> 13 And the sea gave up the dead which were in it; and death and hell delivered up the dead which were in them: and they were judged every man according to their works.
> 14 And death and hell were cast into the lake of fire. This is the second death.
> 15 And whosoever was not found written in the book of life was cast into the lake of fire.

Talk about the story John saw the dead before God's throne for judgment. God knows what people have done. Sin is serious, and our hope of salvation is in Jesus, not in hiding wrongdoing.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. What kind of throne did John see? *Answer: A great white throne.*

2. Can people hide their deeds from God's judgment? *Answer: No.*

3. What book is named? *Answer: The book of life.*

In your day Talk gently about a child trying to hide a broken rule. God knows the truth. Invite questions about judgment and explain the good news of forgiveness through Jesus.

Pray together God, help me understand sin and the forgiveness You offer in Jesus. Amen.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19 — Say the verse in short parts, taking turns with an adult.

Day 363 | Tuesday, September 28, 2027 | All Things New

Read aloud Revelation 21:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Revelation 21:1-5

> 1 And I saw a new heaven and a new earth: for the first heaven and the first earth were passed away; and there was no more sea.
> 2 And I John saw the holy city, new Jerusalem, coming down from God out of heaven, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband.
> 3 And I heard a great voice out of heaven saying, Behold, the tabernacle of God is with men, and he will dwell with them, and they shall be his people, and God himself shall be with them, and be their God.
> 4 And God shall wipe away all tears from their eyes; and there shall be no more death, neither sorrow, nor crying, neither shall there be any more pain: for the former things are passed away.
> 5 And he that sat upon the throne said, Behold, I make all things new. And he said unto me, Write: for these words are true and faithful.

Talk about the story God will dwell with His people in a new heaven and earth. He will wipe away tears. Death, sorrow, crying, and pain will be gone.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who will live with His people? *Answer: God.*

2. What will He wipe away? *Answer: Their tears.*

3. Will death and pain remain? *Answer: No.*

In your day Name something sad or painful you wish could end. This promise gives God's people hope; it describes His future world, not a promise that today will never hurt.

Pray together God, thank You for promising a world without tears and pain. Amen.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19 — Try the verse without looking. Read it together afterward to check the words.

Day 364 | Wednesday, September 29, 2027 | They Shall See His Face

Read aloud Revelation 22:1-5

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Revelation 22:1-5

> 1 And he shewed me a pure river of water of life, clear as crystal, proceeding out of the throne of God and of the Lamb.
> 2 In the midst of the street of it, and on either side of the river, was there the tree of life, which bare twelve manner of fruits, and yielded her fruit every month: and the leaves of the tree were for the healing of the nations.
> 3 And there shall be no more curse: but the throne of God and of the Lamb shall be in it; and his servants shall serve him:
> 4 And they shall see his face; and his name shall be in their foreheads.
> 5 And there shall be no night there; and they need no candle, neither light of the sun; for the Lord God giveth them light: and they shall reign for ever and ever.

Talk about the story God's servants will see His face and serve Him. There will be no more curse or night, and the Lord will give them light. They will be with Him forever.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Whose face will God's servants see? *Answer: His face.*

2. Will there still be night? *Answer: No.*

3. Who will give them light? *Answer: The Lord God.*

In your day Think of waiting to see someone you love. God's people look forward to being with Him. Talk about why His presence is the best part of this promise.

Pray together God, thank You that Your people will be with You forever. Amen.

Memory verse 1 John 4:19 — Celebrate the words learned. Say the verse together; needing help is okay.

Day 365 | Thursday, September 30 - Friday, October 1, 2027 | Come, Lord Jesus

Read aloud Revelation 22:20-21

KJV KEY PASSAGE | Revelation 22:20-21

> 20 He which testifieth these things saith, Surely I come quickly. Amen. Even so, come, Lord Jesus.
> 21 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen.

Talk about the story Jesus promises to come again, and His people answer, "Come, Lord Jesus." Our year ends looking forward to Him. The Bible's story leads us to the living Saviour.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

1. Who promises to come? *Answer: Jesus.*

2. How do His people answer? *Answer: Come, Lord Jesus.*

3. Whose grace closes the Bible? *Answer: The Lord Jesus Christ's.*

4. Who made the world at the beginning of our year? *Answer: God.*

In your day Choose one favorite Bible story from this year and retell it. Name one thing you learned about Jesus and one everyday choice that has changed as you learned.

Pray together Lord Jesus, thank You for what we have learned. Help us keep following You. Amen.

Celebrate the year Choose a favorite memory verse to say together. Let the child tell a favorite story or draw a scene from it. Thank God for the year of learning.

Scripture and Teaching Notes

Scripture Text

All quoted Scripture is from the King James Version. The explanations, questions, answer hints, and everyday examples are teaching aids. Scripture remains the authority for each lesson.

How the Lessons Handle the Text

Read the passage before using the explanation and questions. Some answers rely on the brief explanation or the story learned on a previous day. Old Testament people and promises keep their place in Israel's history. Everyday connections illustrate a point; they do not change the promise or event in the passage.

For Parents and Teachers

Use this book alongside the life and teaching of your local church. Listen when a child is confused, and admit when you need to study a question further. Read the surrounding chapter together or ask a trusted pastor or Bible teacher for help.

C02 / CURRICULA AND WORKBOOKS

PLANTED Youth Curriculum: Rooted in the Word

Twenty lessons for youth, with an introduction and supporting appendices.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Author and youth curriculum developer.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

171 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

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Introduction — Rooted in the Word

Big Idea:

A tree only grows strong when its roots go deep. Your life will only stand firm when it's rooted in God's Word. When you plant yourself close to the Bible, you'll grow, thrive, and bear fruit that lasts and so will this ministry and this church.

Key Verse:

"And he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water, that bringeth forth his fruit in his season; his leaf also shall not wither; and whatsoever he doeth shall prosper." — Psalm 1:3

1. Planted by the Rivers

"Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly, nor standeth in the way of sinners, nor sitteth in the seat of the scornful." — Psalm 1:1

The world offers its own advice, opinions, and voices, but the one who is blessed learns to say *no* to ungodly influence. The key to spiritual strength

is choosing where you plant yourself. If your roots are in God's Word, you'll draw from His strength every day.- Prov. 13:20; 1 Cor. 15:33

Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the _____.

2. Delighting in God's Word

"But his delight is in the law of the Lord; and in his law doth he meditate day and night." — Psalm 1:2

To be planted means to *delight* in God's Word, not reading out of duty, but because you love it. God's Word refreshes us, gives us wisdom, and keeps our hearts clean. The more time you spend in the Bible, the stronger your roots grow.- Psa. 119:97; Jer. 15:16; Job 23:12

His delight is in the _____ of the Lord.

3. Deep Roots Bring Stability

"And he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water." — Psalm 1:3a

When storms come, and they will, a tree with deep roots doesn't fall. In the same way, when your life is grounded in God's Word, you won't be easily shaken by temptation, trials, or pressure. Your strength is not in you, it's in where you're planted.- Col. 2:6-7

He shall be like a tree _____ by the rivers of water.

4. Fruit That Lasts

"That bringeth forth his fruit in his season." — Psalm 1:3b

A healthy tree produces fruit, not because it tries harder, but because it's alive and nourished. When your life is rooted in God's Word, the fruit of the Spirit, love, joy, peace, longsuffering, and more, will show in your words and actions.- John 15:5,8

When I am rooted in God's Word, I will bring forth _____ in my season.

Direct Application

- **Plant Yourself:** Make God's Word your foundation. Read it daily, even if only a few verses.
- **Stay Near the Water:** Don't pull away from church, prayer, and godly friends, they keep you nourished.
- **Grow Steadily:** Growth takes time; don't rush it—stay faithful.
- **Bear Fruit:** Let others see Jesus Christ through your life and choices.

If I stay planted by God's Word, my life will _____ and prosper.

Reflection Question:

What kind of "soil" are your roots in right now? God's Word or the world's influence? What can you change this week to stay planted near Him?

Prayer:

"Lord, help me to root my life deeply in Your Word. Keep me close to You, growing stronger each day, and help me bear fruit that brings You glory."

Memory Verse: Psalm 1:3

Root 1— Why We Believe: Is Christianity True, and Why?

Big Idea:

Everything we believe rises or falls on the **truth of God's Word**. If the Bible is true, our faith is not in vain. If it is false, our faith is in vain (1 Cor 15:14). Christianity alone stands on verifiable truth about God, creation, history, and salvation.

Key Verse:

Sanctify them through thy truth: thy word is truth.- John 17:17

1) Why Believe in God?

Romans 1:20 — "For the invisible things of him… are clearly seen, being understood by the things that are made."

Creation points to a Creator. Design always shows a Designer.

- A building proves a builder.
- A painting proves a painter.
- A song proves a musician.

Imagine this: you take your phone apart piece by piece and put all of the pieces into a bag, you then take that bag and shake it up. How long will it be until your phone comes out put together perfectly and powered on? It won't happen! The universe is so much more complex than even this, it could not have happened on accident.

Design always shows a _____.

2) Why Morality Proves God

Everyone knows some things are truly right or wrong. We don't decide morality; we discover it from the word of God.

If there were no God, right and wrong would be only opinions. But we all know some things are absolutely evil (murder, lying, injustice). That means a real Moral Lawgiver exists. The Bible says that God gave us this law in our hearts.- Romans 2:14-15

Blank: A moral law means there is a moral _____.

3) What Is Truth?

John 17:17 — "Sanctify them through thy truth: Thy word is truth."

Truth isn't about our feelings or what is popular in the world; it is reality as God defines it. Two opposite ideas can't both be true.

Example: Either God exists, or He doesn't, both can't be right.

Blank: Truth is what _____ says.

4) Why the Bible? The Foundation of Our Faith

The Bible is not some myth or just a collection of religious writings—it's verifiable history:

- Manuscript evidence: There is more ancient proof for Jesus Christ's life, death, and resurrection than there is for any other major ancient historical figure/event.

Person	Approx. Time of Life	Earliest Copies Written	Estimated Time Gap	Number of Manuscripts
Plato	427–347 BC	~900 AD	~1,200 years after	20
Julius Caesar	100–44 BC	~900 AD	~1,000 years after	10
Aristotle	384–322 BC	~1,100 AD	~1,400 years after	49
Socrates	470–399 BC	~900 AD	~1,200 years after	103
Alexander the Great	356–323 BC	~300 AD	~600 years after	5
Jesus Christ	4 BC–30 AD	~125 AD	**< 100 years after**	**5,856 Greek + 10,000 Latin + 9,000 others**

- Archaeology: confirms places, kings, coins, and customs the Bible names (e.g., Pool of Siloam, Hezekiah's tunnel).
- Prophecy: hundreds fulfilled exactly; even the odds of just 48 of them coming true is about **1 in 10^{157}**. That is 1 in 1,000,000,000

- Unity: 66 books, 40+ authors, 1,500 years, one message of redemption, no errors, no provable contradictions.

The Bible has no contradictions and no provable _____.

KEY: No other religion or belief has the EVIDENCE behind it that the Bible has. The book of Mormon, the Quran, Catholic tradition, etc.. all have errors and contradictions. Our faith is based on the Bible, a book we can trust 100% of the time.

Direct Application

1. Write your "why I believe" story—what convinced you and why.
2. Ask a friend: "Do you believe truth exists?"—then share John 14:6.
3. Pray for one person trapped in false belief and plan how to show them truth with love.

Memory Verse

1 Corinthians 15:14 — And if Christ be not risen, then is our preaching _____, and your faith is also vain.

Root 2 — Knowing God

Big Idea:

God is one in being but three in persons—the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit. Each person is fully God, working together in perfect unity to create, redeem, and transform us.

Key Verse:

1 John 5:7- For there are three that bear
record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one.

1) One God in Three Persons

"Hear, O Israel: The Lord our God is one Lord." — Deuteronomy 6:4

There is only one true God—but He has revealed Himself in three persons. This is called the **Godhead or Trinity**. The Father, Son, and Holy Spirit are **distinct** yet **equal**. They share the same nature, purpose, and glory.

God is not three gods, nor one person acting in three ways. He is one God who has always existed in a perfect relationship of love and unity.- Isa. 45:5-6; Matt. 28:19; 2 Cor. 13:14

Example: Many things we observe are three parts and yet one. An Egg (yolk, shell, white), Water (1 part hydrogen, 2 parts Oxygen: H^20 OR solid, liquid, gas), Time (Past, Present, Future), etc..

The Sun is a great example of their relationship:

- **Sun** = Father (source)
- **Light** = Son (visible expression)
- **Heat** = Holy Spirit (felt presence and power)

Key Truth: God is one in essence, three in persons.

The Lord our God is _____ Lord.

2) God the Father — The Source and Sustainer

"Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above, and cometh down from the Father of lights." — James 1:17

God the Father is the **planner** of all things.- John 3:16

He knows all things, and rules in love and righteousness.

He calls, forgives, provides, and protects His children.- Eph. 4:6

The Father's Work:

- **Provider** for His people (Matthew 6:26–30).
- **Loving Father** who adopts us through Christ (Romans 8:15).

Every good gift comes from the _____ of lights.

3) God the Son — The Savior and Revealer

"And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us." — John 1:14

Jesus Christ, the Son of God, is **fully God** and **fully man**.- Col. 2:9

He came to reveal the Father, die for our sins, and rise again so that we could have eternal life.- Acts 4:12; Titus 2:13

He is the visible image of the invisible God- Col. 1:15

The Son's Work:

- **Reveals** the Father (John 14:9).
- **Redeems** through His death and resurrection (1 Corinthians 15:3–4).
- **Reigns** as Lord forever (Philippians 2:9–11).

He that hath seen me hath seen the _____.

4) God the Holy Spirit — The Comforter and Transformer

"But the Comforter, which is the Holy Ghost, … shall teach you all things." — John 14:26

The Holy Spirit is not a force but a **Person**—the presence of God living in every believer.

He gives new life, teaches truth, convicts of sin, and produces spiritual fruit.- John 16:13; Rom. 8:9; Gal. 5:22-23

The Spirit's Work:

- **Convicts** the world of sin (John 16:8).
- **Lives** inside every believer (1 Corinthians 6:19).
- **Empowers** us to live and serve (Acts 1:8).

The Spirit dwells _____ you and shall be in you.

5) The Trinity Working Together

At creation, all three were present (Genesis 1:26).

At Jesus' baptism, the Father spoke, the Son was baptized, and the Spirit descended (Matthew 3:16–17).

In salvation, the Father **plans**, the Son **purchases**, and the Spirit **preserves**.

God is one, yet His work shows perfect teamwork and love between the three Persons.

Let us make man in our _____, after our likeness.

Direct Application

- **Worship God for who He is**—Father, Son, and Spirit.
- **Pray with awareness** of the Trinity: to the Father, through the Son, in the Spirit.- Matt. 6:9; John 16:23; Eph. 2:18
- **Thank God** for His role in your life: the Father's love, the Son's sacrifice, the Spirit's guidance.

When I pray, I am talking to the _____, through the _____, by the _____.-

Reflection Question

Which person of the Trinity do you feel you understand least—and what could you learn this week to know Him better?

Prayer

"Father, thank You for loving me and sending Your Son to save me.

Lord Jesus, thank You for giving Your life for mine.

Holy Spirit, thank You for living in me and helping me grow.

Help me worship You as the one true God—Father, Son, and Holy Ghost."

Memory Verse: 1 John 5:7

For there are _____ that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are _____.

Root 3 — Saved & Sure

Big Idea: Salvation is God's free gift through Jesus Christ, and once you've received Him, you belong to Him forever.

Key Verse:

"For by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God: not of works, lest any man should boast."

— Ephesians 2:8–9

1) What Is Salvation?

Salvation means God rescues you from sin's penalty and brings you into His family through faith in Jesus Christ.

- You don't earn it. It's by **grace**, received by **faith**. (Eph 2:8–9)
- You are born **again** into God's family (John 1:12–13; John 3:3)

Salvation is a **gift**, not something we _____.- Titus 3:5

2) Why Do We Need It?

We are all born sinners (Rom 3:23; 5:12) and need forgiveness and new life that only Christ can give (John 14:6).

3) How Does a Person Get Saved?

1 Cor 15:1-4 teaches the **gospel**—Christ died for our sins, was buried, and rose again.

John 1:12 and 3:16 says that we must **receive** and **believe** Jesus Christ

Rom 10:9-10,13 says we must **call out to** Jesus as Lord.

4) What Changes When You're Saved?

- You're made a **brand new creature** in Christ (2 Cor 5:17).
- You become God's **child** (John 1:12).
- The Holy Ghost lives in you and seals you (1 Cor. 6:19-20; Rom. 8:11; Eph. 1:13; 4:30)

When I receive Jesus, God makes me His _____.

5) Can I be sure?

If God gives "eternal life," it doesn't end! (John 10:27-29; Titus 1:2)

Your confidence rests in Christ's **finished work**, not your works.

6) Common Doubts

- Feelings change; God's promise does not (1 John 5:13).

- When you sin, you need to restore fellowship (1 John 1:9), but your relationship remains the same.

Think of it this way: with your parents, you may do things that are wrong and upset them. This affects your fellowship with them — things may feel off or awkward. But it **never** changes your relationship. You are still their child, no matter what. In the same way, when we sin, it affects our closeness with God, but we never stop being His child.

My security rests on Jesus' **finished** _____, not my performance.

Direct Application:

1. Write a **three-sentence testimony**: Before Christ → How I trusted Christ → What's changed.
2. Each morning this week, read John 10:27-29 and thank God that He holds you secure.
3. Tell one friend or family member what God did in your life.

Key Terms

- **Grace** — God's undeserved favor.
- **Faith** — Trusting Jesus alone to save.

- **Gospel** — Christ died, was buried, rose again (1 Cor 15:1-4).
- **Assurance** — Knowing you have eternal life (1 John 5:13).

Prayer:

"Lord, thank You for saving me by grace through faith. Help me rest in Your promise and live like Your child this week. Amen."

Because I'm saved, I belong to _____ forever.

Memory Verse Review: Ephesians 2:8-9

Extra Reading: Romans 10:9-10; Colossians 1:12-14; John 14:6.

Jesus said, "I am the way, the truth, and the _____." (John 14:6)

WRITE OUT YOUR SALVATION TESTIMONY BELOW

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Root 4 — New Life, New Desires

Big Idea: When you got saved, God didn't just change your destination—He changed who you are: your heart, your values, and what you love.- 2 Cor. 5:17

Key Verse:

"If ye then be risen with Christ, seek those things which are above, where Christ sitteth on the right hand of God. Set your affection on things above, not on things on the earth." — **Colossians 3:1–2**

1) A Brand-New Life

When you trusted Christ, God didn't just clean up your life—He made you **brand new**.

"Therefore if any man be in Christ, he is a new creature: old things are passed away; behold, all things are become new." — 2 Corinthians 5:17

You're no longer who you were. Your mistakes, your past, your reputation — are gone. You've been given a new identity in Jesus.- Gal. 2:20; Romans 6:4

In Christ, I am a **new** _____.

2) A Different Focus

Now that you belong to Christ, your attention should shift upward.

"Set your affection on things above, not on things on the earth." — Colossians 3:2

This doesn't mean you ignore life here—it means you see everything God's viewpoint (eternal perspective). You now live for eternal things, not temporary ones.

- Before Christ: I lived for what felt good or looked fun.
- After Christ: I live for what's **true**, **pure**, and **pleasing to God** (Philippians 3:13-14; 4:8).

God wants me to set my **affections** on things _____.

3) Learning to Love What God Loves

A changed heart means changed desires. You'll begin to love the Bible, prayer, worship, and the people of God.

"As newborn babes, desire the sincere milk of the word, that ye may grow thereby." — 1 Peter 2:2

But you'll also notice a battle inside—your new nature fighting your old one (Galatians 5:17). The Holy Spirit helps you choose what's right.

4) Signs of Growing Love for God

- You start **hungering** for the Word.- 1 Pet. 2:2
- You want to **serve** in church.- Eph. 2:8-10
- You notice conviction when you sin.- 1 Jn. 2:1-3
- You find **joy** in obeying.

Spiritual growth begins when I **desire the** _____ of the Word.

5) Standing Out Gracefully

You're still in the same world, but you're not the same person.

"Be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind." — Romans 12:2

People around you might not understand. That's okay! God is shaping your thinking and habits. Let your life quietly show that Jesus lives in you.

6) Remember:

Your salvation gave you eternal life, but your **new affections** show that life daily.

Be not **conformed** to this _____ but be transformed.

Direct Application

1. **Check Your Loves:** Make two lists this week:
    - "Things I Love Most"
    - "Things I Know Please God"

Compare them. Are they the same? What needs to change?

2. **Renew Your Mind:** Read one chapter of Colossians each day for four days.
3. **Practical Step:** Ask God to replace one old habit or entertainment choice with something that grows you spiritually.

My new life shows in the way I **love**, **think**, and _____.

Reflection Question:

What's one area of your life that God is beginning to change?

Prayer:

"Father, thank You for giving me new life in Christ. Teach me to love what You love, and help me keep my mind focused on eternal things."

Memory Verse:

Colossians 3:1–2

God calls me to seek things that are _____.

Root 5 — Worship

Big Idea:

Worship isn't just something you *do* at church; it's how you *live* every day when your heart honors God in ordinary moments.

Key Verse:

"Whether therefore ye eat, or drink, or whatsoever ye do, do all to the glory of God." — **1 Corinthians 10:31**

What Is Worship?

1) Worship Means Worth-Ship

Worship is giving God the honor He deserves. It comes from the word *worth-ship*—showing how valuable He is to you.- Psa. 29:2; Rev. 4:11

"O come, let us worship and bow down: let us kneel before the LORD our maker." — Psalm 95:6

Worship is not limited to singing; it's the attitude of your heart when you obey, give thanks, or put God first in decisions.- Gen. 22:5 (***first mention***)

Worship is showing God His true _____.

2) Worship Is More Than Music

Singing is one way to worship, but your **actions**, **words**, and **choices** reveal what you truly love.

"This people draweth nigh unto me with their mouth, and honoureth me with their lips; but their heart is far from me." — Matthew 15:8

Worship happens when you share the gospel, do homework honestly, or forgive someone because you love Jesus Christ.- Jn. 4:23-24; Mic. 6:6-8

True worship starts in the _____, not just the mouth.

3) Doing Ordinary Things for God's Glory

Paul reminds us that even eating or drinking can glorify God (1 Cor 10:31). That means anything—school, chores, sports—can become worship when you do it with the right attitude.

"And whatsoever ye do, do it heartily, as to the Lord, and not unto men."
— Colossians 3:23

When you clean your room, finish homework, or help a sibling with patience, you're showing that Jesus rules your heart.- Ecc. 9:10

Do everything **heartily**, as unto the _____.

4) Obeying Out of Love

"If ye love me, keep my commandments." — John 14:15

Obedience isn't about fear; it's about love. Every time you choose right when no one's watching, that's worship.
Disobedience says, "I know better." Obedience says, "God, You're worth trusting."- 1 Jn. 5:3; Jn. 15:10

Obedience that comes from **love** is real _____.

Direct Application

1. **Morning Challenge:** Each morning this week, pray: *"Lord, help me worship You through everything I do today."*
2. **Ordinary Worship Checklist:**
    - Do your schoolwork as service to God.
    - Speak respectfully to parents and teachers.
    - Encourage one friend today in Jesus' name.
3. **Reflection Prompt:** Where am I giving God only words instead of my heart?

Worship is not only in a church building; it's in my daily _____.

Reflection Question:

How can your daily routine become a place of worship this week?

Prayer:

"Father, teach me to worship You in every part of my day. Help my attitude, words, and actions to show that You are worthy."

Memory Verse: 1 Corinthians 10:31

Whatsoever I do, I should do it to the _____ of God.

Root 6 — The Bible

Big Idea:

The Bible is not just another book—it's God's perfect Word. Every word matters, and through it we learn to know Him, trust Him, and obey Him.

Key Verse:

"All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness." — **2 Timothy 3:16**

What Makes the Bible Different

1) The Bible Is God's Word, Not Man's Opinion

"Knowing this first, that no prophecy of the scripture is of any private interpretation. For the prophecy came not in old time by the will of man: but holy men of God spake as they were moved by the Holy Ghost." — 2 Peter 1:20–21

The Bible didn't come from man's ideas but from the **Spirit of God** guiding men to write exactly what He wanted. That means every single word is important and trustworthy.- Prov. 30:5; Jn. 17:17

Holy men of God wrote as they were moved by the _____ _____.

2) God Preserves His Words Forever

"The words of the LORD are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times. Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever." — Psalm 12:6–7

God didn't just inspire the Bible—He preserved it. That means we can still hold, read, and believe every word today. His Word has survived time, persecution, translation, and unbelief.

God promised to **preserve** His words for ever.- Isa. 40:8; Matt. 24:35; Psa. 119:89

3) Words Reveal God's Heart

God uses his Word to reveal who he is. He calls himself the Word (1 Jn. 5:7; Jn. 1:1) and He elevates his word above his name (Psa. 138:2).

"Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of God." — Matthew 4:4

Every word matters because it shows what God is like. (John 1:1; 1 Jn. 5:7) When we ignore or change His words, we change the message.

We are called to live our entire lives by faith; the word of God is where faith comes from.- Rom. 10:17; Heb. 11:6

Man shall live by **every** _____ that proceedeth out of the mouth of God.

Direct Application

1. **Daily Reading Plan:** Read one chapter of **Psalms** and one chapter of **Proverbs** each day this week.
    - Circle one verse each day that stands out to you.
    - Write a sentence explaining why you think God wanted you to see that verse.

2. **Bible Care Challenge:** Bring your Bible to school this week.
3. **Word Focus:** Memorize an extra verse for this week (try Psalm 119:9-11)

I can trust the Bible because God has kept His _____ pure.

Reflection Question:

How can I show respect for God's Word in the way I read, handle, and share it?

Prayer:

"Lord, thank You for giving us Your Word. Help me to love it, study it, and live by it every day. Keep me faithful to every word You've spoken."

Memory Verse: 2 Timothy 3:16

All scripture is given by **inspiration of** _____.

Root 7 — Prayer

Big Idea:

Prayer isn't about saying perfect words—it's about knowing God personally. Jesus didn't just tell us to pray; He showed us how.

Key Verse:

"Lord, teach us to pray." — Luke 11:1

1. What Is Prayer?

"After this manner therefore pray ye: Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name." — Matthew 6:9

Prayer is simply talking to your heavenly Father. You don't have to impress Him with specific fancy words; He already knows your heart. Prayer grows your relationship with God the same way real conversation grows a friendship.- Philippians 4:6; 1 Thess. 5:17; 1 Pet. 5:7

Prayer is **talking** to God as my heavenly _____.

2. How Jesus Taught Us to Pray

Jesus gave us a model prayer in Matthew 6:9–13 that shows what a healthy prayer life looks like.

1. **Praise** — "Hallowed be thy name."
2. **Purpose** — "Thy kingdom come."
3. **Provision** — "Give us this day our daily bread."
4. **Pardon** — "Forgive us our debts."
5. **Protection** — "Deliver us from evil."

Each part reminds us that prayer is about ***God first, me second***.

Jesus taught us to pray, "Thy kingdom _____."

3. Why We Pray

"Be careful for nothing; but in every thing by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your requests be made known unto God." — Philippians 4:6

Prayer changes things—starting with you. When you pray, you are asking God to work in your life. You find peace, direction, and strength to face whatever comes.- James 5:17; Jer. 33:3; 1 Jn. 5:14-15; Psa. 34:17

In every thing by prayer and _____ let your requests be made known unto God.

4. How to Grow a Daily Prayer Life

"Pray without ceasing." — 1 Thessalonians 5:17

Use the simple A.C.T.S. pattern to guide your daily time with God:

- A — Adoration: praise God for who He is.
- C — Confession: be honest about sin.
- T — Thanksgiving: thank Him for what He's done.
- S — Supplication: ask for others and for yourself.

Pray without _____.

Direct Application

- **Create a Prayer List:** Write five people or needs to pray for each day.
- **Start Small:** Pray for five minutes in the morning and five at night.
- **Journal Your Answers:** Mark each time God answers a prayer.

- **Pray Together:** Find a friend or leader and pray once a week for your youth group.

Prayer grows my **relationship** with _____.

Reflection Question:

What keeps you from praying more often, and how can you change that this week?

Prayer:

"Father, thank You for inviting me to talk with You. Teach me to pray like Jesus—honestly, faithfully, and from the heart."

The disciples said, "Lord, _____ us to pray."

Memory Verse: Luke 1:11

Lord Teach us to _____

Root 8 — Learning to Hear and Do

Big Idea:

Hearing God's Word isn't enough; real disciples listen carefully and obey it. The goal of Bible study is obedience, **not just knowledge**.

Key Verse:

"But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves." — **James 1:22**

Listening With the Heart

1) God Speaks Through His Word

"Faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God." — Romans 10:17

God still speaks today—not through new revelations, but through His written Word. When we read or hear the Bible, He is talking to us personally.- Heb. 1:1-2; Psa. 119:105

Faith comes by **hearing**, and hearing by the _____ of God.

2) Knowing Is Not the Same as Doing

"But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves." — James 1:22

It's possible to hear hundreds of sermons and still not change. God wants us to respond.- John 13:17; Luke 11:28; Matt. 7:24-27

Be ye **doers** of the word, and not hearers only.

3) The Bible Shows Us Ourselves

"For if any be a hearer of the word, and not a doer, he is like unto a man beholding his natural face in a glass." — James 1:23-25

The Bible works like a mirror—it shows what needs to change.
But a mirror doesn't help unless you do something about what you see.
When God's Word reveals pride, anger, or dishonesty, that's His invitation to change it.- Heb. 4:12-13

The Word of God is like a **mirror** that shows me my true _____.

4) Four Steps for Living the Word:

1. **Read It** — Find a consistent time every day.
2. **Understand It** — Ask, "What does this say about God, me, and obedience?"
3. **Apply It** — Write one way to live it out.
4. **Share It** — Tell someone what you learned.

"Blessed are they that hear the word of God, and keep it." — Luke 11:28

When you practice the Bible, it becomes part of your life- 1 Jn. 2:3

Blessed are they that hear the Word of God and _____ it.

Direct Application

1. **SOAP Challenge:** Each day this week, do one SOAP entry (Scripture, Observation, Application, Prayer).
    - Use a notebook or the charts for this in the back of this book.

- Write 1–2 sentences under each section.

2. **Action Step:** Choose one verse to obey this week.
3. **Share:** Tell one friend or family member what verse you're putting into practice.

God's Word only changes me when I **apply** what I have _____.

Reflection Question:

What's one verse you've heard often but haven't fully lived out yet?

Prayer:

"Lord, help me not just to hear Your Word but to do it. Show me where I need to obey today, and give me courage to live what You say."

Memory Verse: James 1:22

Be ye _____ of the word, not hearers only.

Root 9 — Sound Doctrine and Solid Living

Big Idea:

What you *believe* shapes how you *live*. Sound doctrine keeps your life strong, balanced, and protected from false ideas.

Key Verse:

"Hold fast the form of sound words, which thou hast heard of me, in faith and love which is in Christ Jesus." — **2 Timothy 1:13**

What Is Doctrine?

1) Doctrine Means Teaching

Doctrine simply means *what you believe and teach*. Everyone has doctrine—good or bad. What makes Christian doctrine right is that it comes straight from the Bible, not from opinions, and the Bible is 100% reliable.- Psa. 19:7

"Take heed unto thyself, and unto the doctrine; continue in them: for in doing this thou shalt both save thyself, and them that hear thee." — 1 Timothy 4:16

Sound (healthy) doctrine builds spiritual health. False (sick) doctrine spreads confusion and weakness spiritually.

Sound doctrine means **healthy** _____.

2) What You Believe Becomes How You Live

"As he thinketh in his heart, so is he." — Proverbs 23:7

Wrong beliefs lead to wrong choices. Truth renews your mind and strengthens your decisions.- Rom. 12:2

If you believe God's Word is final, you'll obey it. If you believe God loves you, you'll rest in Him.

- Right doctrine → right direction.
- Wrong doctrine → wrong direction.

What if your doctor gave you a prescription label that said "take one pill daily," but it was really supposed to be "take one pill weekly"? That bad "doctrine" (teaching) could destroy your health. A small doctrinal error can have massive consequences for your spiritual health and daily walk.

What I **believe** shapes what I **become**.

3) Beware of Ideas That Twist Truth

"For the time will come when they will not endure sound doctrine; but after their own lusts shall they heap to themselves teachers, having itching ears." — 2 Timothy 4:3

In every generation, people try to reshape God's truth to fit their feelings. That's why you must compare everything, books, songs, social media, even sermons, with the Word of God.- Acts 17:11; 2 Pet. 2:1

"These were more noble… in that they received the word with all readiness of mind, and searched the scriptures daily, whether those things were so." — Acts 17:11

Always **search** the Scriptures to see whether those things are _____.

4) Four Anchors of Sound Living:

1. **God's Word** — The final authority for truth.
2. **Prayer** — Keeps doctrine connected to relationship.
3. **Church** — Where sound doctrine is taught and upheld.
4. **Obedience** — The proof that you really believe.

"If ye continue in my word, then are ye my disciples indeed." — John 8:31

Believing right isn't just about knowledge—it's about faith in action.

If ye continue in my **word**, then are ye my _____ indeed.

Direct Application

1. **Doctrine Check:** Write down three key truths you believe (about God, salvation, or the Bible). Then find one verse to support each one.
2. **Truth Filter:** When you hear something, ask, *Does this match what God's Word teaches?*
3. **Stability Challenge:** Pick one area (music, friends, goals) where you'll stand firm on truth this week.

I stay solid by comparing every idea to the _____ of God.

Reflection Question:

What truth from Scripture keeps you steady when life feels uncertain?

Prayer:

"Lord, thank You for giving me sound doctrine that never changes. Help me stand firm in truth and live it out with love."

Memory Verse: 2 Timothy 1:13

Hold fast the form of **sound** _____.

Root 10 — Why Church Matters

Big Idea:

The church isn't a building—it's a family of believers who gather to grow, serve, and glorify Jesus together. God never meant for Christians to live or grow alone.

Key Verse:

"Not forsaking the assembling of ourselves together, as the manner of some is; but exhorting one another: and so much the more, as ye see the day approaching." — **Hebrews 10:25**

God's Plan for His People

1) The Church Belongs to Jesus

"And I say also unto thee, That thou art Peter, and upon this rock I will build my church; and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it." — Matthew 16:18

The church isn't something that man made up, it was instituted by Jesus Cr. He purchased it with His blood and calls every believer to be part of it.- Eph. 5:25; Acts 2:28

The local church is where God's people meet to worship, learn, and reach others. Without it, your faith will weaken and your gifts will go unused.

Jesus said, "I will build my _____."

2) We Need Each Other

"Now ye are the body of Christ, and members in particular." — 1 Corinthians 12:27

Each believer has a part to play, some teach, some serve, some encourage, but all are needed.- Rom. 12:4-5; Eph. 4:16

A hand can't survive separated from the body. Likewise, Christians grow best when connected to a church family.- Gal. 6:2

Ye are the **body** of Christ, and members one of _____.

3) Learning and Growing Together

"And he gave some, apostles; and some, prophets; and some, evangelists; and some, pastors and teachers; for the perfecting of the saints, for the work of the ministry, for the edifying of the body of Christ." — Ephesians 4:11–12

God gave pastors and teachers to help believers mature.
When you listen to sermons, attend Bible study, and serve with others, you grow stronger and wiser.

The church is your training ground for ministry.

God gave pastors and teachers for the **edifying** of the _____ of Christ.

4) Serving Together

"As every man hath received the gift, even so minister the same one to another, as good stewards of the manifold grace of God." — 1 Peter 4:10

You have spiritual gifts meant to bless others. Serving in church builds unity and joy.

Whether it's greeting, music, helping kids, or cleaning up—you serve Jesus by serving His people.- 1 Cor. 15:58

5) Encouraging One Another

"Two are better than one… for if they fall, the one will lift up his fellow." — Ecclesiastes 4:9–10

Church is where believers pray, comfort, and strengthen each other through every season.- Matt. 18:20

As every man hath received the gift, so minister the same one to _____.

Direct Application

1. **Commit:** Decide today that church will be a non-negotiable part of your week.
2. **Connect:** Learn one person's name you don't know at church and encourage them.
3. **Contribute:** Find one way to serve this month (ushering, music, kids, setup, cleaning, outreach).
4. **Consistency Challenge:** Write down three reasons church attendance matters to *you*.

Church is where I **grow**, **serve**, and **encourage** others.

Reflection Question:

What's one way you can strengthen your connection to your church family this week?

Prayer:

"Lord, thank You for my church family. Help me to be faithful, to serve with love, and to use my gifts for Your glory."

Memory Verse: Hebrews 10:25

Not forsaking the _____ of ourselves together.

Root 11 — Baptism & Communion

Big Idea:

After salvation, God gives us two simple ways to show our faith publicly and remember His sacrifice—**baptism** and **the Lord's Supper**. Both are acts of obedience, not ways to earn salvation.

Key Verse:

"Therefore we are buried with him by baptism into death: that like as Christ was raised up from the dead by the glory of the Father, even so we also should walk in newness of life." — Romans 6:4

1.Baptism Shows What Happened Inside

"Then they that gladly received his word were baptized." — Acts 2:41

KEY: Baptism is a symbol of what already happened in your heart. It shows others that you've trusted Jesus as Savior and are not ashamed to follow Him. When you go under the water, it pictures Jesus' death and burial; coming up pictures His resurrection and your new life in Him.- Acts 8:36-38

Baptism doesn't save you—it *shows others* that you are saved.

Baptism pictures the death, burial, and _____ of Jesus Christ.

2. Why Baptism Matters

"Go ye therefore, and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost." — Matthew 28:19

Jesus commands every believer to be baptized. It's the first step of obedience after salvation. Baptism also connects you with a local church family where you can grow and serve.- Matt. 3:16; Acts 18:8

Obedience in baptism says, "I belong to _____."

3. The Lord's Supper Reminds Us of the Cross

"This do in remembrance of me." — 1 Corinthians 11:24

The Lord's Supper (sometimes called communion) is a time for believers to remember what Jesus did for us on the cross. The bread represents His body that was broken; the cup represents His blood that was shed for our sins.- 1 Cor. 11:23-34

It's not something to rush through or take lightly—it's a time remembrance and self-evaluation.- Psa. 139:23-24; 2 Cor. 13:5

We take the bread and cup to remember Jesus' body and _____.

4. Preparing Your Heart for the Lord's Supper

"But let a man examine himself, and so let him eat of that bread, and drink of that cup." — 1 Corinthians 11:28

Before taking the Lord's Supper, we should examine our hearts, confess sin, and make things right with others. God wants our relationship with him to be real, not "religious" or fake. This is a good time to evaluate where we are and course correct.

We should always _____ ourselves before taking the Lord's Supper.

Direct Application

- **If you've been saved but not baptized,** talk to your pastor or youth leader about taking that next step.
- **If you've already been baptized,** remember what it meant—you're not who you used to be.
- **When your church observes the Lord's Supper,** take time to pray and thank God for His sacrifice and get right with God if needed.
- **Encourage others** to obey Christ and publicly follow Him too.

Obedience is how I show my love and _____ for Christ.

Reflection Question:

Have you taken the step of baptism since you trusted Christ? What does obedience look like for you right now?

Prayer:

“Lord, thank You for saving me and giving me new life. Help me to obey You in every way and to never forget what You did for me on the cross.”

Memory Verse: Romans 6:4

_____ as Christ was raised up from the dead….

Root 12 — Spiritual Mentors & Accountability

Big Idea:

You grow best when you don't grow alone. God uses spiritual leaders (disciplers) and accountability partners to help you follow Jesus faithfully and grow in your relationship with him.

Key Verse:

"Iron sharpeneth iron; so a man sharpeneth the countenance of his friend." — **Proverbs 27:17**

Why We Need Others

1) God Designed Growth to Be Shared

"Two are better than one; because they have a good reward for their labour. For if they fall, the one will lift up his fellow." — Ecclesiastes 4:9–10

No one was meant to walk with God alone. When we're surrounded by other believers, we stay encouraged, challenged, and protected from temptation.- Prov. 13:20; 1 Thess. 5:11

Two are better than _____; for if they fall, one will lift up his fellow.

2) A Mentor Is a Mature Believer Who Helps You Grow

"Be ye followers of me, even as I also am of Christ." — 1 Corinthians 11:1

A spiritual mentor is someone who teaches you, prays for you, and models what it looks like to follow Jesus. Heb. 13:7; 2 Tim. 2:2; Philippians 3:17

They don't replace your walk with God—they help guide it.

- Paul mentored Timothy.
- Elijah mentored Elisha.
- Jesus mentored His disciples.
- Moses mentored Joshua

Think of mentors in life: for school you have teachers and tutors, for sports you have coaches and trainers, for a job in the world you have apprentices working with tradesmen, etc.. This is a biblical concept.

Be ye followers of me, even as I also am of _____.

3) Accountability Keeps You Honest and Growing

"Confess your faults one to another, and pray one for another, that ye may be healed." — James 5:16

Accountability means inviting someone you trust to help you stay faithful. It's not about being judged, it's about being strengthened.- Gal. 6:1-2

Examples:

- Ask a friend to check on your Bible reading.
- Text a leader when you're struggling.
- Be open when you mess up and want to do better.

Confess your faults one to another, and _____ one for another.

4) Three Qualities of a Godly Mentor or Friend:

1. **Faithful** — They walk with God daily.
2. **Honest** — They tell you truth with love.
3. **Encouraging** — They push you forward, not down.

“Let us consider one another to provoke unto love and to good works.” — Hebrews 10:24

It has been said: “If you want to know what your life will look like and who you will become in life; look at those you spend the most time with.”

Let us consider one another to provoke unto love and to good _____.

Direct Application

1. **Find a Mentor:** Pray about one older believer you can learn from (youth leader, pastor, parent, teacher).
2. **Be Accountable:** Ask a trusted friend to help you stay consistent in one spiritual habit—Bible reading, prayer, or service.
3. **Meet Regularly:** Set one time this week to talk, pray, or share victories and struggles.
4. **Encourage Someone Younger:** Be the kind of mentor you wish you had!

Accountability helps me stay **faithful**, **honest**, and **growing**.

Reflection Question:

Who in your life helps you follow Jesus more closely—and who can you help in the same way?

Prayer:

"Lord, thank You for putting people in my life who help me grow. Teach me to listen, to be honest, and to encourage others to walk faithfully with You."

Memory Verse: Proverbs 27:17

Iron sharpeneth iron; so a man sharpeneth the _____ of his friend.

Root 13 — The Lost World and Sharing the Gospel

Big Idea:

Jesus loves every person on this planet, and He has sent us to tell them the good news. The world is lost without Christ, but God wants to use *you* to point people to Him.

Key Verse:

"For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost." — **Luke 19:10**

How God Sees the World

1) The World Is Lost Without Jesus

"All we like sheep have gone astray; we have turned every one to his own way; and the Lord hath laid on him the iniquity of us all." — Isaiah 53:6

Every person is born separated from God because of sin. That's what "lost" means, cut off from the One who made us. Like sheep wandering and aimless.- Rom. 3:23; 5:12

But God's heart is full of mercy. He sent His Son to bring people back to himself.

All we like _____ have gone astray.

2) Jesus Cares About Every Soul

"The Lord is not slack concerning his promise… but is longsuffering to us-ward, not willing that any should perish, but that all should come to repentance." — 2 Peter 3:9

God doesn't want *anyone* to die without salvation. His heart breaks for the lost, and He calls His people to share the gospel.- John 3:16; 1 Tim. 2:3-4

God is not willing that any should _____, but that all should come to repentance.

3) Jesus Sends Us Out

"Go ye therefore, and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost: teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you." — Matthew 28:19–20

The command is simple:

- **Go** — Be intentional and active.
- **Teach** — Share the gospel.
- **Baptize** — Help new believers take their first step.
- **Train** — Disciple them to go and do the same.

Every believer has a part in this mission—not just pastors or missionaries.- Mark 16:15; 1 Cor. 9:16

Go ye therefore, and _____ all nations.

4) Shine Where You Are

"Ye are the light of the world. A city that is set on an hill cannot be hid." — Matthew 5:14

Our world is full of spiritual darkness, confusion, sin, fear, and pride. But the moment you received Christ, His light began shining through you. People should see something different in the way that you live.- Phil. 2:25-16; Eph. 5:8-9

"Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven." — Matthew 5:16

Let your light so _____ before men.

Direct Application

1. **Pray for the Lost:** Write down three names of unsaved friends or family members. Pray for them every day this week.
2. **Be a Witness:** Ask God for one chance this week to start a gospel conversation or invite someone to church.
3. **Shine Daily:** Think of one attitude or habit that could better show Jesus to others—and change it.
4. **Encourage Each Other:** Share testimonies of answered prayers or opportunities next week in youth group.

God wants to use **me** to reach people who are _____.

Reflection Question:

Who in your life doesn't know Jesus—and what can you do this week to reach out to them?

Prayer:

"Lord, thank You for loving me when I was lost. Give me Your heart for others and courage to share Your truth wherever I go."

Memory Verse: Luke 19:10

The Son of man is come to seek and to _____ that which was lost.

For more specific methods of "how to share the gospel", refer to Addendum B at the end of this book.

Root 14 — Holiness & Purity

Big Idea:

God saved us to make us holy, as he is holy. Holiness means being set apart for God's purpose in every part of life—your heart, mind, words, and body.

Key Verse:

"For this is the will of God, even your sanctification, that ye should abstain from fornication." — 1 Thessalonians 4:3

1. God Calls Us to Be Different

"But as he which hath called you is holy, so be ye holy in all manner of conversation." — 1 Peter 1:15

Holiness isn't about being perfect, it's about being set apart. God calls us to live differently from the world, not because we're better, but because

we belong to Him. What you watch, say, listen to, and do should all reflect who you are in Christ.- Rom. 12:2; 2 Cor. 6:17-18

God wants me to be _____ in all I do.

2. Guard Your Heart and Mind

"Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life." — Proverbs 4:23

Everything you think and say flows from your heart. If your heart is full of worldly influences, your life will show it. If your heart is filled with God's Word, you'll grow in holiness. What you allow into your eyes and mind shapes your heart, and this shapes your actions.- Psa. 101:3; Job. 31:1; Prov. 4:23-27

Keep thy _____ with all diligence.

3. Your Body Belongs to God

"Know ye not that your body is the temple of the Holy Ghost which is in you, which ye have of God, and ye are not your own?" — 1 Corinthians 6:19

As believers, our bodies are temples of the Holy Spirit. That means the choices we make, what we wear, how we act, who we date, should honor God. Purity isn't just avoiding sin; it's choosing to glorify God with every part of who you are.- 2 Tim. 2:21

My body is the temple of the _____ _____.

4. Walking in Holiness Every Day

"I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that ye present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable unto God." — Romans 12:1

Holiness is a daily decision. Each morning, you can present your life to God and ask Him to use it for His glory. You stay pure because you love the One who made you new and who saved you from your sin.- John 17:17; Gal 5:16

Present your bodies a _____ sacrifice, holy, acceptable unto God.

Direct Application

- **Watch What You Are Consuming:** Ask, "Does this honor God?" before watching, listening, or posting.
- **Set Boundaries:** Guard your phone, thoughts, and friendships with wisdom.
- **Walk in the Spirit:** Spend time daily in prayer and in the Word of God. He will sanctify you and help keep you pure in your life.
- **Confess Quickly:** When you fail, don't hide it, make it right with God.
- **Stay Accountable:** Find a trusted mentor to help you grow in purity.

Holiness is not about being perfect—it's about being _____ apart for God.

Reflection Question:

What area of your life do you need to surrender to God's control so you can walk in holiness?

Prayer:

"Lord, thank You for calling me to live for You. Help me stay pure in heart, mind, and body. Let others see Your holiness through my life."

Memory Verse: 1 Thess. 4:3

For this is the _____ of God…..

Root 15 — Spiritual Warfare & Temptation

Big Idea:

Every day you face a battle you can't see. The Christian life is not meant to be easy—it's a battleground. God gives you armor to stand strong against temptation and the enemy's attacks.

Key Verse:

"Put on the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil." — Ephesians 6:11

1. Know Your Enemy

"Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary the devil, as a roaring lion, walketh about, seeking whom he may devour." — 1 Peter 5:8

Satan wants to distract, discourage, and destroy believers. He can't take your salvation, but he can weaken your walk. Recognize that temptation is

real and constant—but so is God's power to overcome it.- 2 Cor. 2:11; John 8:44; Job 41:22

Your adversary the _____ walketh about, seeking whom he may devour.

2. The Real Battle Is Spiritual

"For we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world." — Ephesians 6:12

The battle isn't with people, it's spiritual. The enemy attacks through lies, fear, pride, and temptation. That's why you can't fight in your own strength. Victory comes when you depend on God and His Word every day.- 1 Cor. 10:3-5; Gal. 5:17

We wrestle not against _____ and blood.

3. Put On the Armor of God

"Wherefore take unto you the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to withstand in the evil day." — Ephesians 6:13

God provides spiritual armor to protect you:

- **Belt of Truth** — Stand on the truth.
- **Breastplate of Righteousness** — Doing "right" in all situations.- Isa. 59:17
- **Shoes of the Gospel** — Ready to share the gospel.- Rom 1:16
- **Shield of Faith** — Trust God to take care of your needs.
- **Helmet of Salvation** — Have assurance of your salvation.
- **Sword of the Spirit** — The Word of God is our Offensive and Defensive weapon.- Heb. 4:12

Take unto you the whole _____ of God.

4. Resist and Stand Firm

"Submit yourselves therefore to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you." — James 4:7

You can't overcome temptation by willpower, you overcome it by surrendering to God's power. Temptation isn't sin; **giving in is**. Jesus Himself fought temptation with the Word of God. You can do the same.- Matt. 4:1-11; 1 Cor. 10:13

Resist the _____, and he will flee from you.

Direct Application

- **Start with Scripture:** Memorize verses that strengthen you in weak areas.
- **Pray Daily:** Ask for strength before the battle begins.
- **Stay Alert:** Identify your biggest spiritual distractions.
- **Stand Together:** Don't fight alone—surround yourself with godly friends.

Victory begins when I choose to _____ on God's strength, not my own.

Reflection Question:

What areas of your life feel like a spiritual battle right now, and how can you stand firm through them?

Prayer:

"Lord, thank You for giving me armor to stand strong. Help me stay alert, depend on You, and use Your Word to overcome temptation."

Memory Verse: Eph. 6:11

Put on the _____ armour of God that ye may be able to stand…

Root 16 — Serving Like Jesus

Big Idea:

Jesus didn't come to be served—He came to serve. When you serve others humbly, you're following Jesus example of how we are to live.

Key Verse:

"For even the Son of man came not to be ministered unto, but to minister, and to give his life a ransom for many." — **Mark 10:45**

The Example of Jesus

1) Jesus Led by Serving

"If I then, your Lord and Master, have washed your feet; ye also ought to wash one another's feet." — John 13:14

On the night before His crucifixion, Jesus did a servant's job—He washed His disciples' feet. He wanted them to see that leadership in His kingdom means humility.- Mk. 10:45; Phil. 2:5-7

Jesus washed His disciples' _____ to show humility.

2) Serving Starts in the Heart

"Let nothing be done through strife or vainglory; but in lowliness of mind let each esteem other better than themselves." — Philippians 2:3

God doesn't want us to serve for attention or praise.
Real service flows from love and humility, seeing others as more important than ourselves. When you serve with joy, you show the heart of Jesus to the people around you.- Rom. 12:10; Gal. 5:13; Matt. 23:11-12

In lowliness of mind, let each esteem others _____ than themselves.

3) Every Believer Has a Place to Serve

"As every man hath received the gift, even so minister the same one to another, as good stewards of the manifold grace of God." — 1 Peter 4:10

Some are gifted to teach, some to help, some to encourage or give.
Whatever your gift is, it's meant to bless the body of Christ.- Rom. 12:4-6

As every man hath received the gift, so minister the same one to _____.

Direct Application

1. **Find a Way to Serve:** Pick one area in your church or youth group where you can help (greeter, setup, cleaning, music, nursery, etc.).
2. **Serve at Home:** Ask your parents how you can serve them without being asked.
3. **Serve Someone New:** Do something kind this week for a person who doesn't expect it.
4. **Pray Before Serving:** Ask God to give you the right attitude—humble, joyful, thankful.

When I serve others, I am really serving _____.

Reflection Question:

Where can you serve this week to make Jesus more visible to others?

Prayer:

"Lord, thank You for showing me what real service looks like. Help me to serve with humility, love, and joy—just like You."

Memory Verse: Mark 10:45

The Son of man came not to be _____ unto, but to minister.

Root 17 — The Judgment Seat of Christ

Big Idea:

Every believer will one day stand before Jesus, not to be condemned, but to be rewarded or to suffer loss of rewards. How we live today matters forever.

Key Verse:

"For we must all appear before the judgment seat of Christ; that every one may receive the things done in his body, according to that he hath done, whether it be good or bad." — **2 Corinthians 5:10**

What Is the Judgment Seat?

1) A Meeting for Believers Only

"So then every one of us shall give account of himself to God." — Romans 14:12

The Judgment Seat of Christ is not about heaven or hell—those decisions were settled when you trusted Jesus.- John 3:16; Romans 10:9,13

This is a *review* of your life as His servant. It's where Jesus will reward your faithfulness and test the motives behind your works.- 1 Cor. 3:12-14; Gal. 6:9

Every one of us shall give _____ of himself to God.

2) Salvation Is a Gift; Rewards Are Earned

"For other foundation can no man lay than that is laid, which is Jesus Christ." — 1 Corinthians 3:11

Salvation is by grace through faith alone.
Rewards come from how we build on the foundation of Christ—our obedience, motives, and service. At the Judgment Seat, our works will be tested by fire (1 Corinthians 3:12–14).
What we did for eternity (gospel/making disciples) will remain and we will be rewarded; everything else will burn away.- Luke 19:11-27

Salvation is by grace; rewards are for faithful _____.

3) Jesus Promised Crowns to the Faithful

Some examples of rewards mentioned in Scripture:

- Crown of Righteousness — for those who love His appearing (2 Timothy 4:8).
- Crown of Life — for enduring trials faithfully (James 1:12).
- Incorruptible Crown — for self-control and discipline (1 Corinthians 9:25).
- Crown of Glory — for faithful shepherding and leadership (1 Peter 5:4).
- Crown of Rejoicing — for winning souls (1 Thessalonians 2:19).

"And, behold, I come quickly; and my reward is with me, to give every man according as his work shall be." — Revelation 22:12

Jesus said, "My _____ is with me, to give every man according as his work shall be."

4) What You Do Now Matters Forever

“Therefore, my beloved brethren, be ye stedfast, unmoveable, always abounding in the work of the Lord, forasmuch as ye know that your labour is not in vain in the Lord.” — 1 Corinthians 15:58

When life feels hard or unnoticed, remember: Jesus sees every act of service, every prayer, every sacrifice. Living for eternity gives purpose to today.

The Judgment Seat isn’t meant to scare you, it’s meant to motivate you to live for things that last.- Matt. 6:20

Be ye stedfast, unmoveable, always _____ in the work of the Lord.

Direct Application

1. **Examine:** What are you living for—temporary rewards or eternal ones?
2. **Evaluate:** Ask God to reveal one area where you can serve with better motives.
3. **Encourage:** Remind someone this week that what they do for Christ *matters*.

4. **Engage:** Commit to one act of "eternal work" this week—serve, witness, or give with the right heart.

My labour is not in _____ in the Lord.

Reflection Question:

If you stood before Christ today, what kind of rewards would your life reveal?

Prayer:

"Lord, thank You for saving me and giving my life eternal purpose. Help me to live every day in light of Your judgment seat, serving You with a pure heart."

Memory Verse: 2 Corinthians 5:10

We must all appear before the _____ seat of Christ.

Root 18— Stewardship: Time, Talents, and Treasure

Big Idea:

Everything you have—your time, your gifts, your money, and your life—belongs to God. He wants your heart and full devotion of service to Him. Good stewardship means using what God has given you for His glory.

Key Verse:

"Moreover it is required in stewards, that a man be found faithful." — 1 Corinthians 4:2

1. God Owns It All

"The earth is the Lord's, and the fulness thereof; the world, and they that dwell therein." — Psalm 24:1

Everything in your life comes from God, your breath, your talents, your opportunities, even the time you have today. When you understand that it

all belongs to Him, it changes the way you live. Stewardship begins with recognizing ownership, God's ownership.- 1 Chron. 29:11-14; Hag. 2:8; Psa. 50:1-12

The earth is the _____'s, and the fulness thereof.

2. Be Faithful With Your Time

"Redeeming the time, because the days are evil." — Ephesians 5:16

Time is one thing you can never get back once it's gone. God calls us to use every moment wisely, spending time in His Word, serving others, and growing in what truly matters. You don't need more hours in the day; you need to give your hours to God.- Col. 4:5; Psa. 90:12; John 9:4

Redeeming the _____, because the days are evil.

3. Use Your Talents for God's Glory

"As every man hath received the gift, even so minister the same one to another, as good stewards of the manifold grace of God." — 1 Peter 4:10

God gave every believer gifts and abilities to be used in ministry. Whether you sing, teach, help, create, encourage, or lead, your talent is not an accident. When you serve others, you're serving Jesus.- Rom. 12:6-8; Matt. 25:14-30; 1 Cor. 10:31

Every man hath received the _____, even so minister the same one to another.

4. Honor God With Your Treasure

"But this I say, He which soweth sparingly shall reap also sparingly; and he which soweth bountifully shall reap also bountifully." — 2 Corinthians 9:6

Giving is an act of worship. When you give to God through your church, you're investing in eternity. God blesses a cheerful giver, not just financially but spiritually. You can't outgive the One who gave everything for you.- Prov. 3:9-10; 2 Cor. 9:7; Luke 6:38; Matt. 6:19-21

He which soweth _____ shall reap also bountifully.

Direct Application

- **Time:** Schedule a few minutes each day for Bible and prayer; make it a priority, not an afterthought.
- **Talents:** Ask your youth leader or pastor how you can serve in your church or youth group.
- **Treasure:** Set aside a small amount each week to give back to God's work.
- **Testimony:** Be a faithful example—show others what it means to live with open hands.

Stewardship means managing everything I have for God's _____.

Reflection Question:

Which area—time, talents, or treasure—do you struggle most to give back to God? How can you start improving this week?

Prayer:

“Lord, thank You for trusting me with time, abilities, and resources. Help me to use all that I have for Your glory. Make me a faithful steward who lives with eternity in mind.”

Memory Verse: 1 Corinthians 4:2

Moreover it is _____ in stewards, that a man be found faithful.

Root 19 — Spiritual Gifts

Big Idea

God has given every believer **spiritual gifts**—special abilities through the Holy Spirit—to build up His church and glorify Jesus. You are saved to serve.

> Key Verse
>
> **1 Peter 4:10** — "As every man hath received the gift, even so minister the same one to another, as good stewards of the manifold grace of God."

1) Every Believer Has Gifts

1 Corinthians 12:7 — "But the manifestation of the Spirit is given to every man to profit withal."

The moment you are saved, the Holy Spirit gives you at least one gift to help others (usually multiple). These are not natural talents but **Spirit-given abilities** for ministry. God designed the church to need every member.- Eph. 4:7; 1 Cor. 7:7

Every believer has a spiritual _____.

2) The Source of All Gifts

1 Corinthians 12:4 — "Now there are diversities of gifts, but the same Spirit."

All gifts come from the same God. You didn't earn yours—it's grace. The Spirit gives as He chooses (1 Cor. 12:11). That means no one should boast, compare, or envy. The giver is the **Holy Spirit**, and the goal is **God's glory**.

Gifts come from the same _____.

3) The Purpose of Gifts

Ephesians 4:12 — "For the perfecting of the saints, for the work of the ministry, for the edifying of the body of Christ."

God didn't give gifts for competition or attention. They exist to build, strengthen, and unite His people. When we use our gifts, others grow, needs are met, and Christ is seen more clearly.- Rom. 13:19

Blank: Gifts are given to build up the _____.

4) The Variety of Gifts in the Body

Romans 12:4–6 — "We have many members in one body… having then gifts differing according to the grace that is given to us."

The church is like a body—many parts, one purpose. Every gift matters. The ones that seem small are often the most essential. Without each part doing its work, the body becomes weak.- 1 Cor. 12:22-23

Every part of the body is _____.

5) The Gifts of the Spirit (Brief Descriptions)

Gift	Description
Evangelist	Boldly shares the gospel clearly and often; loves souls.
Pastor	Cares for and spiritually leads a local church.
Teacher	Explains Scripture so others understand and apply it.
Word of Wisdom	Knows how to use biblical truth rightly in difficult moments.
Word of Knowledge	Understands and recalls truth easily when needed.
Faith	Believes God can do the impossible when others doubt.
Prophecy	Proclaims God's truth about the future or His will through Scripture.
Discerning of Spirits	Recognizes what is of God, man, or the devil.
Helps	Sees needs and serves quietly and faithfully.
Governments	Organizes and leads ministries effectively.
Ministering (Service)	Joyfully meets practical needs of others.
Exhorting	Encourages and motivates others to do what's right.
Giving	Freely and cheerfully shares resources for God's work.
Ruling (Leadership)	Leads others with diligence and direction.
Mercy	Shows compassion and care for the hurting.
Singleness	Chooses to remain unmarried to serve the Lord fully.

Found in 1 Cor. 12:8-10; Romans 12:6-8; Eph. 4:11; 1 Cor. 7:7

6) Discovering Your Gift

You discover your gift by **serving**, not sitting around leaving your gifts unused. Try different areas of ministry, teaching, helping, encouraging,

and see where God blesses and others are built up. As you walk in the Spirit, your gift/s becomes clear.

You find your gift by _____.

7) Using Your Gift Faithfully

Romans 12:11 — "Not slothful in business; fervent in spirit; serving the Lord."

Gifts grow when used. The more you obey, the stronger your gift becomes. The Holy Spirit empowers you every step, so stay yielded, humble, and faithful. God is not impressed with big gifts, but with **obedient hearts**.- 2 Tim. 1:6; 1 Cor. 15:58

Gifts grow stronger when we _____ them.

Direct Application

1. **Serve somewhere** this week, nursery, cleaning, greeting, music, youth help, and pray for God to reveal your gift.
2. **Ask a mentor** what gift they see in you.

3. **Memorize one verse** from Romans 12 or 1 Corinthians 12 about spiritual gifts.
4. **Pray**: "Lord, use me today to build up someone in Your body."

Memory Verse

As every man hath received the _____, even so minister the same one to another. — 1 Peter 4:10

Root 20 — Next Steps: Multiply Disciples

Big Idea:

Discipleship doesn't stop with you. The goal of following Jesus is to help someone else follow Him too. Real growth multiplies.

Key Verse:

"And the things that thou hast heard of me among many witnesses, the same commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also." — 2 Timothy 2:2

God's Plan for Reproduction

1) Disciples Make Disciples

"Go ye therefore, and teach all nations… teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you." — Matthew 28:19–20

The Christian life is meant to multiply. Jesus discipled twelve men, who taught others, who then reached the world.- Jn. 17:4

Consider: If anyone could have preached the gospel and reached millions, it would have been God himself (Jesus). However, he didn't do this. He knew if he did, it would start out great and fizzle out shortly. Instead, he invested all his time into his 12 disciples. From them, we are now here today, still making disciples and reaching the world!

Jesus said, "teaching them to _____ all things…"

2) What You've Learned Is Not Meant to Stay with You

"And the things that thou hast heard of me among many witnesses, the same commit thou to faithful men." — 2 Timothy 2:2

God wants you to pass on truth to others who will continue the chain. When you teach or encourage someone younger in their faith, you're taking part in God's eternal work.- Titus 2:3-4; Deut. 6:5-7; 1 Thess. 2:8

Commit the truth to **faithful** men who shall teach _____ also.

3) God Uses Faithful People, Not Perfect Ones

“Moreover it is required in stewards, that a man be found faithful.” — 1 Corinthians 4:2

You don’t have to know everything, just be faithful. Faithfulness means showing up, being dependable, and living what you teach.- Luke 16:10; Prov. 20:6; 1 Cor. 1:26-27

It is required in stewards that a man be found _____.

“And let us consider one another to provoke unto love and to good works.” — Hebrews 10:24

This relationship of building into someone else, what God has given you, this is discipleship.- Prov. 27:17

Let us consider one another to provoke unto love and good _____.

Direct Application

1. **Identify:** Pray for one person younger in faith that you could help grow in the Lord.

2. **Invite:** Ask them to meet once a week to read the Bible or go through the Journey Discipleship together.
3. **Invest:** Teach what you've learned from Jesus Christ.
4. **Inspire:** Remind them to pass it on someday too!

True disciples don't just learn, they help **others** _____.

Reflection Question:

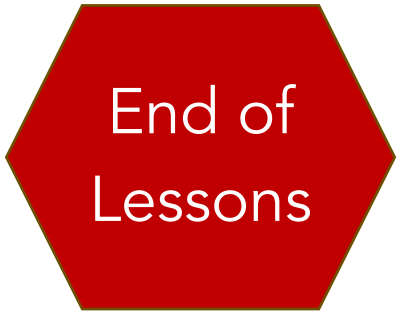
Who can you begin discipling or encouraging in their walk with Jesus this month?

Prayer:

"Lord, thank You for teaching me and helping me grow. Help me to pass on what I've learned, and use my life to multiply faithful followers of Jesus."

Memory Verse:

2 Timothy 2:2- The things thou hast heard… commit to faithful men who shall teach _____ also.



Addendum A — Memory Verse List

Root Intro — *Psalm 1:3*

"And he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water, that bringeth forth his fruit in his season; his leaf also shall not wither; and whatsoever he doeth shall prosper."

Root 1 — *John 17:17*

"Sanctify them through thy truth: thy word is truth."

Root 2 — *1 John 5:7*

"For there are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one."

Root 3 — *Ephesians 2:8–9*

"For by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God: not of works, lest any man should boast."

Root 4 — *Colossians 3:1–2*

"If ye then be risen with Christ, seek those things which are above, where Christ sitteth on the right hand of God. Set your affection on things above, not on things on the earth."

Root 5 — *1 Corinthians 10:31*

"Whether therefore ye eat, or drink, or whatsoever ye do, do all to the glory of God."

Root 6 — *2 Timothy 3:16*

"All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness."

Root 7 — *Luke 11:1*

"And it came to pass, that, as he was praying in a certain place, when he ceased, one of his disciples said unto him, Lord, teach us to pray, as John also taught his disciples."

Root 8 — *James 1:22*

"But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves."

Root 9 — *2 Timothy 1:13*

"Hold fast the form of sound words, which thou hast heard of me, in faith and love which is in Christ Jesus."

Root 10 — *Hebrews 10:25*

"Not forsaking the assembling of ourselves together, as the manner of some is; but exhorting one another: and so much the more, as ye see the day approaching."

Root 11 — *Romans 6:4*

"Therefore we are buried with him by baptism into death: that like as Christ was raised up from the dead by the glory of the Father, even so we also should walk in newness of life."

Root 12 — *Proverbs 27:17*

"Iron sharpeneth iron; so a man sharpeneth the countenance of his friend."

Root 13 — *Luke 19:10*

"For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost."

Root 14 — *1 Thessalonians 4:3*

"For this is the will of God, even your sanctification, that ye should abstain from fornication."

Root 15 — *Ephesians 6:11*

"Put on the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil."

Root 16 — *Mark 10:45*

"For even the Son of man came not to be ministered unto, but to minister, and to give his life a ransom for many."

Root 17 — *2 Corinthians 5:10*

"For we must all appear before the judgment seat of Christ; that every one may receive the things done in his body, according to that he hath done, whether it be good or bad."

Root 18 — *1 Corinthians 4:2*

"Moreover it is required in stewards, that a man be found faithful."

Root 19 — *1 Peter 4:10*

"As every man hath received the gift, even so minister the same one to another, as good stewards of the manifold grace of God."

Root 20 — *2 Timothy 2:2*

"And the things that thou hast heard of me among many witnesses, the same commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also."

Addendum B — How to Share the Gospel

1. Pray for Opportunities

Evangelism starts with prayer. Ask God every day to open doors (Col. 4:3). Don't only wait for "open doors" — learn to *open them*. Fishermen don't wait for fish to jump into the boat — they go fishing.

2. Think and Plan Ahead

Be intentional. Before you meet friends, family, or classmates, think of natural ways to turn a normal conversation spiritual — weekend plans, news events, or struggles that lead to questions about life and death.

3. The A.S.K Method

A — Ask questions | S — Share the Gospel | K — Keep the conversation going

- "Do you have a minute for a question?"
- "Who do you think Jesus is?"
- "Do you believe there's a heaven and hell?"

- "If you died today, where would you go — and why?"

Let their answers guide the conversation. Keep it conversational, not presentational.

4. Share the Gospel Simply —

When unsure what to say next, say: "Let me share what the Bible says."
Then walk through these truths:

- All have sinned — Romans 3:23
- Sin brings death — Romans 6:23
- Christ died for our sin — Romans 5:8
- Salvation is a free gift — Ephesians 2:8-9
- Believe and call upon Him — Romans 10:9-10, 13; John 3:16

Make clear: sin is the problem; Jesus is God's solution; each person must personally receive that gift by faith.

5. Use the A B C Plan of Salvation

A — Admit you are a sinner.

"For all have sinned, and come short of the glory of God." — Romans 3:23

Everyone has broken God's law. Sin separates us from Him and deserves judgment.

B — Believe that Jesus died for you and rose again.

But as many as received him, to them gave he power to become the sons of God, even to them that believe on his name: — John 1:12

"That if thou shalt confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and shalt believe in thine heart that God hath raised him from the dead, thou shalt be saved." — Romans 10:9

Jesus took the punishment we deserve. He died, was buried, and rose again to offer forgiveness and eternal life.

C — Call upon Him as Lord and ask him to save you.

"For whosoever shall call upon the name of the Lord shall be saved." — Romans 10:13

6. Leave a Tract or Follow Up

If they don't have time or interest, leave a tract. God can use it later.
If they respond well, offer to meet again and answer questions.

7. Overcome Fear

Most people are not hostile — 99 % will be kind or neutral.
Even rejection is a win: Jesus said, *"Rejoice…. leap for joy"* when people reject you for His sake (Luke 6:22-23).

8. Memorize Key Verses for Evangelism

- **Romans 3:23** For all have sinned, and come short of the glory of God.
- **Romans 6:23** For the wages of sin is death; but the gift of God is eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord.

- **Romans 5:8** But God commendeth his love toward us, in that, while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us.
- **Romans 10:9-10, 13** That if thou shalt confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and shalt believe in thine heart that God hath raised him from the dead, thou shalt be saved… For whosoever shall call upon the name of the Lord shall be saved.
- **John 3:16** For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life.

Addendum C — Key Doctrines and Scripture Index

The Trinity (Godhead)

Summary:

God is one in being, yet eternally exists in three Persons: Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.

Key Scriptures:

- Deuteronomy 6:4
- 1 John 5:7
- Matthew 28:19
- Genesis 1:26
- John 1:1,14
- John 14:9,26
- 2 Corinthians 13:14

The Bible — Inspiration & Preservation

Summary:

The Bible is the inspired, inerrant, infallible, and perfectly preserved Word of God — final authority in all matters of faith and life.

Key Scriptures:

- 2 Timothy 3:16–17
- 2 Peter 1:20–21
- Psalm 12:6–7
- Matthew 24:35
- Psalm 119:89
- Isaiah 40:8
- John 17:17
- Matthew 4:4

God as Creator

Summary:

God, through Jesus Christ, created all things from nothing by His Word and power — purposeful, intelligent design, not accident or evolution.

Key Scriptures:

- Genesis 1:1,26–27
- John 1:3
- Colossians 1:16–17
- Psalm 19:1
- Romans 1:20

- Hebrews 11:3

Salvation — By Grace Through Faith

Summary:

Salvation is a free gift of God; we are saved by grace through faith in Jesus Christ alone.

Key Scriptures:

- Ephesians 2:8–9
- Titus 3:5
- Romans 10:9–10,13
- John 1:12–13
- John 3:3
- 1 Corinthians 15:1–4
- Acts 4:12

Assurance of Salvation / Eternal Security

Summary:

The true believer is eternally secure in Christ — salvation cannot be lost because it is based on Christ's finished work, not our works.

Key Scriptures:

- John 10:27–29
- Ephesians 1:13
- Ephesians 4:30
- Romans 8:38–39
- Titus 1:2
- 1 John 5:13

New Life / Regeneration

Summary:

At salvation, a believer becomes a new creature in Christ, indwelt by the Holy Spirit with new desires and a new identity.

Key Scriptures:

- 2 Corinthians 5:17
- Galatians 2:20
- Romans 6:4
- Colossians 3:1–3
- 1 Peter 2:2
- John 3:3

Worship

Summary:

Worship is a lifestyle that honors God in spirit and truth — not only singing, but obedience, gratitude, and holiness in everyday life.

Key Scriptures:

- 1 Corinthians 10:31
- John 4:23–24
- Psalm 95:6
- Matthew 15:8
- Romans 12:1
- Colossians 3:23

Prayer

Summary:

Prayer is personal communication with God — worship, confession, thanksgiving, and requests. Believers should pray continually.

Key Scriptures:

- Luke 11:1–4
- Matthew 6:9–13

- Philippians 4:6
- 1 Thessalonians 5:17
- 1 Peter 5:7
- Jeremiah 33:3

Obedience & Doing the Word

Summary:

True disciples don't only hear God's Word but obey it. Faith produces action.

Key Scriptures:

- James 1:22
- John 14:15
- Luke 11:28
- Matthew 7:24–27
- John 13:17
- Romans 10:17

Sound Doctrine

Summary:

Believers must guard, hold fast, and continue in sound doctrine, testing all teaching by the Scriptures.

Key Scriptures:

- 2 Timothy 1:13
- 1 Timothy 4:16
- Acts 17:11
- Titus 2:1
- 2 Timothy 4:3
- Romans 12:2

The Church

Summary:

The church is the body of Christ on earth — a living family of believers united in doctrine, worship, and mission. Every believer is called to gather, serve, and grow within a local church.

Key Scriptures:

- Matthew 16:18
- Ephesians 4:11–13
- 1 Corinthians 12:12–27

- Hebrews 10:24–25
- Acts 2:42–47
- Galatians 6:2

Baptism

Summary:

Baptism is a public declaration of faith in Jesus Christ — symbolizing death to sin, burial with Christ, and resurrection to new life. It follows salvation as an act of obedience.

Key Scriptures:

- Matthew 28:19–20
- Acts 2:41
- Romans 6:3–4
- Acts 8:36–38
- Colossians 2:12

The Lord's Supper

Summary:

Communion is a memorial ordinance reminding believers of Christ's broken body and shed blood. It looks back to the cross, inward to the heart, and forward to His coming.

Key Scriptures:

- 1 Corinthians 11:23–29
- Luke 22:19–20
- Matthew 26:26–28
- John 6:53–56

Mentorship & Discipleship

Summary:

Discipleship is spiritual reproduction — growing in Christ and helping others grow. Every believer should be both a disciple and a discipler.

Key Scriptures:

- Matthew 28:19–20
- 2 Timothy 2:2
- Luke 9:23
- Colossians 1:28–29
- Proverbs 27:17

Evangelism / The Gospel

Summary:

The gospel is the good news that Christ died for our sins, was buried, and rose again. Every believer is called to share this message.

Key Scriptures:

- 1 Corinthians 15:1–4
- Romans 1:16
- Mark 16:15
- John 3:16–18
- Acts 1:8
- Romans 10:13–15

Purity & Holiness

Summary:

God calls His people to live holy lives, set apart from sin and dedicated to Him — pure in mind, body, and spirit.

Key Scriptures:

- 1 Peter 1:15–16
- 2 Corinthians 7:1

- 1 Thessalonians 4:3–4
- Romans 12:1–2
- Psalm 119:9–11
- Galatians 5:16–17

Spiritual Warfare

Summary:

The Christian life is a battle against sin, Satan, and the flesh. God gives every believer spiritual armor and authority through His Word and Spirit.

Key Scriptures:

- Ephesians 6:10–18
- 1 Peter 5:8–9
- James 4:7
- 2 Corinthians 10:3–5
- Matthew 4:1–11
- 1 Corinthians 10:13

Serving Like Jesus

Summary:

True leadership is found in serving others. Jesus modeled humility and compassion — His followers are called to serve in the same manner.

Key Scriptures:

- Mark 10:43–45
- John 13:14–15
- Philippians 2:3–7
- Galatians 5:13
- Matthew 23:11

The Judgment Seat of Christ

Summary:

Believers will stand before Christ to give account of their stewardship — not for salvation, but for reward for faithfulness.

Key Scriptures:

- 2 Corinthians 5:10
- Romans 14:12
- 1 Corinthians 3:11–15
- Revelation 22:12
- Matthew 6:20

Stewardship (Time, Talents, Treasure)

Summary:

All we have belongs to God. Faithful stewardship means managing our time, gifts, and resources for His glory and kingdom.

Key Scriptures:

- 1 Corinthians 4:2
- Luke 16:10–13
- Malachi 3:10
- Matthew 6:19–21
- Colossians 3:23–24

Spiritual Gifts

Summary:

The Holy Spirit equips every believer with gifts to serve and strengthen the body of Christ. Each gift matters and is meant for ministry.

Key Scriptures:

- 1 Corinthians 12:4–11,27
- Romans 12:4–8

- Ephesians 4:11–13
- 1 Peter 4:10–11

Christian Living

Summary:

The Christian life is about daily surrender and obedience — walking in the Spirit, living by faith, showing love, and reflecting Christ in word and action.

Key Scriptures:

- Galatians 2:20
- Galatians 5:22–25
- Romans 12:1–2
- Colossians 3:1–3, 12–17
- Philippians 1:27
- Titus 2:11–12

Who I Am in Christ

Summary:

Believers have a new identity in Christ — forgiven, accepted, and empowered by His Spirit. Our purpose flows from being God's children.

Key Scriptures:

- 2 Corinthians 5:17
- Ephesians 1:3–7
- Galatians 4:6–7
- 1 Peter 2:9–10
- Romans 8:15–17, 37–39
- John 1:12

Christian Family & Relationships

Summary:

God designed relationships to reflect His love — beginning with family, friendships, and marriage.

Key Scriptures:

- Ephesians 5:22–25, 6:1–4
- Colossians 3:18–21
- Proverbs 17:17
- 1 Thessalonians 3:12
- 1 Corinthians 13:4–7
- Matthew 22:37–39

The Will of God

Summary:

God's will is that His children live holy lives, serve faithfully, and seek His direction in every decision through His Word and Spirit.

Key Scriptures:

- Romans 12:1–2
- 1 Thessalonians 4:3
- Proverbs 3:5–6
- Psalm 37:4–5
- Ephesians 5:15–17

Faith & Works

Summary:

Salvation is by faith alone, but true faith produces good works as evidence of new life in Christ.

Key Scriptures:

- Ephesians 2:8–10
- James 2:17–20

- Galatians 5:6
- Titus 2:14
- Matthew 5:16

Suffering & Trials

Summary:

God uses trials to strengthen faith, build character, and draw believers closer to Him. Suffering produces growth.

Key Scriptures:

- James 1:2–4
- Romans 5:3–5
- 1 Peter 1:6–7
- 2 Corinthians 12:9–10
- 1 Peter 5:10
- John 16:33

Heaven & Eternity

Summary:

Heaven is the eternal home of believers — a place of joy, reward, and perfect fellowship with Christ forever.

Key Scriptures:

- John 14:1–3
- Philippians 3:20–21
- Revelation 21:1–4
- 2 Corinthians 5:1–8
- 1 Thessalonians 4:16–17

Sin & Forgiveness

Summary:

All have sinned, but through Christ we are forgiven, cleansed, and restored. Confession of our sins **after salvation** brings freedom and renewed **fellowship** with God.

Key Scriptures:

- Romans 3:23
- 1 John 1:9
- Psalm 103:12
- Isaiah 1:18
- Ephesians 1:7
- Micah 7:18–19

Growth & Fruit of the Spirit

Summary:

Spiritual growth happens as believers yield to the Holy Spirit, study God's Word, and obey. Fruit is the outward proof of inward change.

Key Scriptures:

- Galatians 5:22–23
- John 15:4–5
- Philippians 1:6
- 2 Peter 3:18
- Colossians 1:10
- Romans 8:29

Addendum D — SOAP Reading Guide

How to Use S.O.A.P.

S — Scripture

Read the passage of scripture that you are in. Write out the reference for the passage you are in.
Some people find that writing out the scripture they read daily helps them to focus and retain more.- Deut. 17:18-20

O — Observation

What stands out? What does this teach about God, man, sin, or salvation?
Look for repeated words, commands, promises, contrasts, and examples.

A — Application

How does this truth apply to you right now?
Ask: "What is God telling me to believe, change, or do today?"
Make it specific and measurable: "Today I will _____."- James 1:22-25

P — Prayer

Turn what you've learned into a personal prayer.
Ask the Lord to help you obey what you've written.
Ask him to help you understand what you have read.- Psa. 119:33-35

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C03 / CURRICULA AND WORKBOOKS

Principles from Proverbs: Wisdom for Young People

Twelve lessons in four units, organized around wisdom and practical decisions. The final teacher edition includes answers.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Curriculum development and teacher-resource preparation.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

66 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

Teacher edition with answer support.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

Principles from Proverbs:

Wisdom for Young People

A Study in the Book of Proverbs — Teacher Copy

PLANTED YOUTH

Millheim Baptist Church

Introduction

The book of Proverbs was written by a father to his son, and God preserved it for every young person who wants to live wisely. It speaks directly to the choices of the teenage years: whom to listen to, whom to walk with, how to speak, how to handle anger, desire, work, and money, and which way to go in life.

These twelve lessons gather the teaching of Proverbs into broad subjects. Each lesson covers several related principles of wisdom, compares Proverbs with the rest of Scripture, and ends by pointing to the Lord Jesus Christ, who is made unto us wisdom (1 Corinthians 1:30).

> **Proverbs 1:7 —** *The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge: but fools despise wisdom and instruction.*

Read the listed passages, fill in each blank (answers are shown in red in this teacher copy), and use the charts to connect each principle with the proverbs that teach it. Proverbs has thirty-one chapters, so reading one chapter a day will take you through the book every month (see Appendix A).

Lessons at a Glance

Unit 1 — The Foundation of Wisdom	
1	The Beginning of Wisdom: The Fear of the LORD and the Two Ways
2	Hear, My Son: Parents, Correction, and a Teachable Spirit
3	Keep Thy Heart: Thoughts, Trust, and Contentment
Unit 2 — Wisdom in Relationships	
4	Choose Your Companions: Friends, Peer Pressure, and Loyalty
5	The Strange Woman and the Virtuous Woman: Purity, Dating, and Marriage
6	Life and Death in the Tongue: Words, Lies, and Gossip
Unit 3 — Wisdom in Self-Control	
7	Ruling Your Spirit: Anger, Strife, and Revenge
8	Wine Is a Mocker: Alcohol, Substances, and Appetites
9	Go to the Ant: Diligence, Laziness, and Excuses
Unit 4 — Wisdom for the Future	
10	Better Than Gold: Money, Integrity, and a Good Name
11	The Path of Life: Decisions, Plans, and God's Direction
12	Christ, the Wisdom of God: The Choice That Matters Most

UNIT 1 — THE FOUNDATION OF WISDOM

Lesson 1 — The Beginning of Wisdom: The Fear of the LORD and the Two Ways

Lesson Overview: Solomon wrote Proverbs so that young people would receive wisdom, instruction, and discretion. The book begins with its foundation, the fear of the LORD, and then sets two paths before every young person: the way of wisdom and the way of folly. It also introduces the kinds of people who walk those paths: the wise, the simple, the fool, and the scorner.

MAIN PASSAGES: Proverbs 1:1–33; 2:1–22; 3:1–18; 4:10–27; 9:10

KEY VERSE | Proverbs 1:7 — *The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge: but fools despise wisdom and instruction.*

READ: Proverbs 1:1–33; 2:1–22; 3:1–18; 4:10–27; 9:1–18; 1 Kings 3:5–14; 4:29–34; Psalm 111:10; Ecclesiastes 12:13; James 1:5; 3:13–18.

Wisdom from Proverbs

Principle	Proverb
Why Proverbs was written	Proverbs 1:4 — ***"To give subtilty to the simple, to the young man knowledge and discretion"***
Where wisdom begins	Proverbs 9:10 — ***"The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom"***
Where wisdom comes from	Proverbs 2:6 — ***"For the LORD giveth wisdom: out of his mouth cometh knowledge and understanding."***
What wisdom is worth	Proverbs 3:15 — ***"She is more precious than rubies"***

Principle	Proverb
The path of the just	Proverbs 4:18 — ***"But the path of the just is as the shining light, that shineth more and more unto the perfect day."***
The way of the wicked	Proverbs 4:19 — ***"The way of the wicked is as darkness: they know not at what they stumble"***

1. Why God Gave Us Proverbs

God gave Solomon ***"wisdom and understanding exceeding much, and largeness of heart"***. Solomon spoke three thousand proverbs (1 Kings 4:32), and God preserved the ones He wanted us to have in this book. Proverbs states its own purpose in its first verses: to know wisdom and instruction, to receive the instruction of wisdom, justice, judgment, and equity, and ***"to the young man knowledge and discretion"***.

Proverbs is written as a father speaking to his son. Over and over the book says, "My **son**" (Proverbs 1:8; 2:1; 3:1; 4:1). That makes it one of the most direct books in the Bible for young people. It does not give wisdom for some distant future; it gives wisdom for the decisions a young person faces now: what to listen to, who to follow, how to speak, how to work, and what to do with desire, money, and time.

Key Words in Proverbs 1:2–5

Word	Meaning
Wisdom	Seeing life from God's point of view and living skillfully by it
Instruction	Teaching that corrects and disciplines
Understanding	Discerning the difference between right and wrong, true and false
Subtilty	Shrewdness; the ability to see through deception (Proverbs 1:4)

Word	Meaning
Discretion	Careful judgment that thinks before acting (Proverbs 2:11)
Learning	Continued growth, even for the wise (Proverbs 1:5)

2. The Fear of the LORD

Everything in Proverbs rests on one foundation: ***"The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge: but fools despise wisdom and instruction"***. The fear of the LORD is not terror that runs from God; it is **reverence** that takes God seriously. It means living with the awareness that God sees, God speaks, and God will judge. A person may have a high IQ and a full education, but without the fear of the LORD he has not even begun to be wise.

Proverbs shows that the fear of the LORD shapes the whole of life. It turns a person away from evil, lengthens life, gives confidence, and becomes a fountain of life.

What the Fear of the LORD Does

Result	Proverb
Hates evil	Proverbs 8:13 — ***"The fear of the LORD is to hate evil"***
Departs from evil	Proverbs 16:6 — ***"by the fear of the LORD men depart from evil"***
Gives confidence	Proverbs 14:26 — ***"In the fear of the LORD is strong confidence"***
Is a fountain of life	Proverbs 14:27 — ***"The fear of the LORD is a fountain of life, to depart from the snares of death"***
Is better than riches	Proverbs 15:16 — ***"Better is little with the fear of the LORD than great treasure and trouble therewith."***

Result	Proverb
Brings honour	Proverbs 22:4 — ***"By humility and the fear of the LORD are riches, and honour, and life."***

Proverbs 3:5–6 — *Trust in the LORD with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding. In all thy ways acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths.*

3. Two Ways and the People Who Walk Them

Proverbs presents life as a road with **two** directions. Wisdom calls in the streets and invites the simple to turn (Proverbs 1:20–23), while sinners entice the young man to join them (Proverbs 1:10–14). Chapter 9 pictures two women, Wisdom and Folly, each inviting the passerby into her house. Wisdom's house leads to life; of Folly's guests Solomon says, ***"he knoweth not that the dead are there"***.

Proverbs also describes the kinds of people found on these two roads. Learning to recognize them helps a young person see where he is and where he is headed.

The People of Proverbs

Person	Description	Proverb
The wise	Hears, fears God, receives correction, and keeps growing	Proverbs 1:5; 9:9
The simple	Naive and easily led; believes every word	Proverbs 14:15; 22:3
The fool	Trusts his own heart and despises instruction	Proverbs 12:15; 28:26
The scorner	Mocks correction and spreads contempt	Proverbs 9:7–8; 13:1
The sluggard	Lazy, full of excuses, and always wanting	Proverbs 13:4; 26:13–16
The prudent	Foresees danger and acts carefully	Proverbs 14:8; 22:3

The good news is that no one is locked on a path. Wisdom calls, ***"Turn you at my reproof"***, and promises, ***"those that seek me early shall find me"***.

Check Your Understanding

1. According to Proverbs 1:1–6, why did God give the book of Proverbs?
2. What does it mean to fear the LORD, and why is it the beginning of wisdom?
3. List four results of the fear of the LORD from Proverbs.
4. Describe the two invitations in Proverbs 9 and where each one leads.
5. Name and describe four kinds of people found in Proverbs.

UNIT 1 — THE FOUNDATION OF WISDOM

Lesson 2 — Hear, My Son: Parents, Correction, and a Teachable Spirit

Lesson Overview: The first human voice Proverbs tells a young person to listen to is the voice of his parents. Proverbs teaches that honoring father and mother, receiving correction, and staying teachable are marks of wisdom, while pride, scorn, and rebellion lead to ruin. This lesson covers three connected principles: honor your parents, love correction, and walk in humility.

MAIN PASSAGES: Proverbs 1:8–9; 4:1–13; 6:20–23; 12:1; 13:1; 15:5, 31–33; 16:18–19

KEY VERSE | Proverbs 1:8 — *My son, hear the instruction of thy father, and forsake not the law of thy mother:*

READ: Exodus 20:12; Proverbs 1:8–9; 3:11–12; 4:1–13; 6:20–23; 9:7–9; 10:1, 17; 11:2; 12:1, 15; 13:1, 18; 15:5, 10, 20, 31–33; 16:18–19; 19:20, 26; 20:20; 23:22–25; 29:1, 23; 30:17; Ephesians 6:1–3; Hebrews 12:5–11.

Wisdom from Proverbs

Principle	Proverb
Hear your father	Proverbs 4:1 — ***"Hear, ye children, the instruction of a father"***
Honor your mother	Proverbs 23:22 — ***"Hearken unto thy father that begat thee, and despise not thy mother when she is old."***
Love correction	Proverbs 12:1 — ***"Whoso loveth instruction loveth knowledge: but he that hateth reproof is brutish."***

Principle	Proverb
A wise son gladdens	Proverbs 10:1 — ***"A wise son maketh a glad father"***
Pride goes before a fall	Proverbs 16:18 — ***"Pride goeth before destruction, and an haughty spirit before a fall."***
Humility before honour	Proverbs 15:33 — ***"and before honour is humility"***

1. Honor Your Father and Mother

Proverbs opens its teaching with the home: ***"My son, hear the instruction of thy father, and forsake not the law of thy mother"***. God gave parents the first responsibility to teach their children, and He gave children the responsibility to hear. Their instruction is described as ***"an ornament of grace unto thy head, and chains about thy neck"***. Obedience is not a burden that limits a young person; it is a crown that adorns him.

The father in Proverbs 4 passes on what his own father taught him (Proverbs 4:3–4). Godly instruction is meant to move from generation to generation. Proverbs 6:20–23 says that a parent's commandment will lead, keep, and talk with the young person, ***"For the commandment is a lamp; and the law is light"***. The New Testament repeats the command with a promise: ***"Honour thy father and mother; which is the first commandment with promise"***.

Honor and Dishonor Toward Parents

The wise child	The foolish child	Proverb
Hears instruction	Despises his mother	Proverbs 15:20
Makes his father glad	Is a heaviness to his mother	Proverbs 10:1
Keeps the commandment	Curses father or mother; his lamp is put out	Proverbs 6:20; 20:20

The wise child	The foolish child	Proverb
Brings joy to those who begat him	Mocks and despises obedience	Proverbs 23:24–25; 30:17

2. Love Correction

Nobody enjoys being corrected, but Proverbs is blunt: ***"he that hateth reproof is brutish"***. The difference between a wise person and a fool is not that the wise never make mistakes. It is that the wise receive correction and grow, while the fool rejects it and stays the same. ***"Give instruction to a wise man, and he will be yet wiser"***.

Correction may come from parents, pastors, teachers, or friends, and ultimately it comes from God Himself. ***"For whom the LORD loveth he correcteth; even as a father the son in whom he delighteth"***. Hebrews 12 quotes this proverb and explains that God's chastening is proof that He treats us as sons (Hebrews 12:5–8).

How the Wise and the Fool Respond to Correction

The wise	The fool or scorner	Proverb
Loves instruction	Hates reproof	Proverbs 12:1
Hearkens unto counsel	Is right in his own eyes	Proverbs 12:15
Regards reproof and is prudent	Despises his father's instruction	Proverbs 15:5
Loves the one who rebukes him	Hates the one who rebukes him	Proverbs 9:8
Is honoured	Comes to poverty and shame	Proverbs 13:18

> **Proverbs 29:1 —** *He, that being often reproved hardeneth his neck, shall suddenly be destroyed, and that without remedy.*

3. Pride and Humility

The root of an unteachable spirit is **pride**. Pride says, "I already know," "I don't need anyone," and "No one can tell me what to do." Proverbs warns that ***"When pride cometh, then cometh shame: but with the lowly is wisdom"***. Among the seven things the LORD hates, the first listed is ***"A proud look"*** (Proverbs 6:16–17).

Humility is not thinking poorly of yourself; it is thinking rightly of God and honestly of yourself. The humble person knows he needs God, needs counsel, and needs correction. ***"Surely he scorneth the scorners: but he giveth grace unto the lowly"***. James and Peter both quote this verse (James 4:6; 1 Peter 5:5), showing that the principle holds for believers today.

Pride and Humility in Proverbs

Pride	Humility	Proverb
Goes before destruction	Comes before honour	Proverbs 16:18; 18:12
Brings shame	Brings wisdom	Proverbs 11:2
Is an abomination to the LORD	Receives grace from the LORD	Proverbs 16:5; 3:34
Brings a man low	Upholds the humble in spirit	Proverbs 29:23
Breeds contention	Takes counsel	Proverbs 13:10

Check Your Understanding

1. What does Proverbs 1:8–9 teach about a young person's responsibility to parents?
2. According to Proverbs 6:20–23, what does a parent's commandment do for a young person?
3. How do the wise and the foolish respond differently to correction? Give three contrasts.
4. What does Proverbs 3:11–12 teach about God's correction, and how does Hebrews 12 apply it?
5. Why is pride the root of an unteachable spirit? Use two proverbs in your answer.

UNIT 1 — THE FOUNDATION OF WISDOM

Lesson 3 — Keep Thy Heart: Thoughts, Trust, and Contentment

Lesson Overview: Proverbs teaches that life flows out of the heart. What a young person thinks about, trusts in, and desires will shape the words he speaks and the path he walks. This lesson covers three inner principles of wisdom: guard the heart and mind, trust the LORD rather than your own understanding, and replace envy and discontent with a sound and cheerful heart.

MAIN PASSAGES: Proverbs 3:5–8; 4:20–27; 14:30; 23:17–19; 24:1–2, 19–20; 28:26

KEY VERSE | Proverbs 4:23 — *Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life.*

READ: Proverbs 3:5–8; 4:20–27; 12:25; 14:10, 13, 30; 15:13–15; 16:2, 9; 17:22; 18:14; 20:27; 21:2; 23:7, 17–19; 24:1–2, 19–20; 27:19; 28:26; Jeremiah 17:9–10; Matthew 15:18–19; Philippians 4:6–8.

Wisdom from Proverbs

Principle	Proverb
Guard the heart	Proverbs 4:23 — ***"Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life."***
Thoughts shape a man	Proverbs 23:7 — ***"For as he thinketh in his heart, so is he"***
Trust the LORD	Proverbs 3:5 — ***"Trust in the LORD with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding."***

Principle	Proverb
Do not trust yourself	Proverbs 28:26 — ***"He that trusteth in his own heart is a fool"***
Envy destroys	Proverbs 14:30 — ***"A sound heart is the life of the flesh: but envy the rottenness of the bones"***
A merry heart heals	Proverbs 17:22 — ***"A merry heart doeth good like a medicine"***

1. Guard Your Heart and Mind

Proverbs 4:20–27 gives a complete guard for the inner life. The father tells his son to keep God's words in the midst of his heart (Proverbs 4:21), and then says, ***"Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life"***. In the Bible the heart is the **inner** man: the mind, the will, and the affections. Whatever fills it will eventually flow out of it.

The passage continues by guarding the mouth, the eyes, and the feet (Proverbs 4:24–27). What we say, what we look at, and where we go all affect the heart. A young person who guards those gates guards his heart. The Lord Jesus taught the same truth: ***"For out of the heart proceed evil thoughts, murders, adulteries, fornications, thefts, false witness, blasphemies"***.

The Guard of Proverbs 4:20–27

Gate	Command	Verse
The ears	Incline thine ear unto my sayings	Proverbs 4:20
The heart	Keep thy heart with all diligence	Proverbs 4:23
The mouth	Put away from thee a froward mouth	Proverbs 4:24
The eyes	Let thine eyes look right on	Proverbs 4:25

Gate	Command	Verse
The feet	Ponder the path of thy feet; remove thy foot from evil	Proverbs 4:26–27

2. Trust in the LORD, Not in Yourself

Proverbs 3:5–6 may be the best-known passage in the book. It calls for trust in the LORD ***"with all thine heart"***, not part of it. It warns, ***"lean not unto thine own understanding"***. Human understanding is limited and often deceived. ***"There is a way which seemeth right unto a man, but the end thereof are the ways of death"***.

The heart that trusts itself is the heart of a fool (Proverbs 28:26). Jeremiah says the heart ***"is deceitful above all things, and desperately wicked"***. The popular advice to "follow your heart" is the opposite of Proverbs. The wise young person acknowledges God in all his ways, and God promises, ***"he shall direct thy paths"***.

Trusting Self Versus Trusting God

Trusting self	Trusting God	Proverb
Leans on his own understanding	Trusts the LORD with all his heart	Proverbs 3:5
Is wise in his own eyes	Fears the LORD and departs from evil	Proverbs 3:7
Takes a way that seems right	Acknowledges God in all his ways	Proverbs 14:12; 3:6
Is a fool	Shall be delivered	Proverbs 28:26
Weighs his own ways as clean	Lets the LORD weigh the spirits	Proverbs 16:2

3. Envy, Discontent, and a Cheerful Heart

Envy is one of the most common heart sins among young people, and it grows when we constantly see what others have. Proverbs warns three times against envying the wicked (Proverbs 3:31; 23:17; 24:1, 19). The wicked may seem to prosper, but ***"For there shall be no reward to the evil man; the candle of the wicked shall be put out"***. Envy does not hurt the one envied; it **rots** the one who envies (Proverbs 14:30).

The cure for envy is a heart that is fixed on the LORD and satisfied with Him: ***"Let not thine heart envy sinners: but be thou in the fear of the LORD all the day long"***. Proverbs also speaks honestly about heaviness of heart and shows the value of a good word and a merry heart.

The Condition of the Heart

Heart condition	Result	Proverb
Heaviness	Makes the heart stoop; a good word makes it glad	Proverbs 12:25
Sorrow	Breaks the spirit	Proverbs 15:13
Merry heart	Makes a cheerful countenance; a continual feast	Proverbs 15:13, 15
Envy	Rottenness of the bones	Proverbs 14:30
Sound heart	The life of the flesh	Proverbs 14:30

> **Proverbs 15:16 —** *Better is little with the fear of the LORD than great treasure and trouble therewith.*

Check Your Understanding

1. What is the “heart” in Scripture, and why must it be kept with all diligence?
2. List the five gates guarded in Proverbs 4:20–27.
3. Why is “follow your heart” the opposite of Proverbs 3:5–6 and 28:26?
4. What does Proverbs teach about envying the wicked? Give two references.
5. According to Proverbs 12:25, 15:13, and 17:22, how does the condition of the heart affect a person?

UNIT 2 — WISDOM IN RELATIONSHIPS

Lesson 4 — Choose Your Companions: Friends, Peer Pressure, and Loyalty

Lesson Overview: Proverbs teaches that a young person will become like the people he walks with. The very first warning the father gives is about companions who entice him to sin. This lesson covers three principles: refuse the enticement of sinners, choose companions who make you wiser, and be the kind of faithful friend Proverbs describes.

MAIN PASSAGES: Proverbs 1:10–19; 4:14–19; 13:20; 17:17; 18:24; 22:24–25; 27:5–6, 9–10, 17

KEY VERSE | Proverbs 13:20 — *He that walketh with wise men shall be wise: but a companion of fools shall be destroyed.*

READ: Proverbs 1:10–19; 4:14–19; 12:26; 13:20; 14:7; 16:28–29; 17:9, 17; 18:24; 19:4, 6–7; 20:19; 22:24–25; 23:20–21; 24:1–2, 21; 27:5–6, 9–10, 17; 28:7; 1 Samuel 18:1–4; 1 Corinthians 15:33.

Wisdom from Proverbs

Principle	Proverb
Say no to enticement	Proverbs 1:10 — ***"My son, if sinners entice thee, consent thou not."***
Companions shape you	Proverbs 13:20 — ***"He that walketh with wise men shall be wise: but a companion of fools shall be destroyed."***
Avoid the angry	Proverbs 22:24 — ***"Make no friendship with an angry man; and with a furious man thou shalt not go"***

Principle	Proverb
A friend loves always	Proverbs 17:17 — ***"A friend loveth at all times"***
Friends sharpen	Proverbs 27:17 — ***"Iron sharpeneth iron; so a man sharpeneth the countenance of his friend."***
Be friendly	Proverbs 18:24 — ***"A man that hath friends must shew himself friendly"***

1. When Sinners Entice Thee

The father's first warning in Proverbs is about **peer pressure**: ***"My son, if sinners entice thee, consent thou not"***. The sinners in Proverbs 1 promise excitement, belonging, and gain. They say, ***"Cast in thy lot among us; let us all have one purse"***. The appeal is not only to the sin itself but to being part of the group.

Proverbs exposes where that path leads. The ones who lay wait for others ***"lurk privily for their own lives"***. The father does not say to go along a little way and then turn back; he says, ***"walk not thou in the way with them; refrain thy foot from their path"***. Proverbs 4:15 adds, ***"Avoid it, pass not by it, turn from it, and pass away"***.

The Enticement of Proverbs 1:10–19

What sinners offer	What really happens	Verse
Excitement: "Come with us"	They run to evil and make haste to shed blood	Proverbs 1:11, 16
Belonging: "Cast in thy lot among us"	They lay wait for their own blood	Proverbs 1:14, 18
Gain: "We shall find all precious substance"	Greed takes away the life of its owners	Proverbs 1:13, 19

> **Proverbs 4:14 —** *Enter not into the path of the wicked, and go not in the way of evil men*

2. Choose Companions Who Make You Wiser

Proverbs 13:20 states a principle that never fails: ***"He that walketh with wise men shall be wise: but a companion of fools shall be destroyed"***. Companions do not merely influence opinions; they shape **habits**, speech, desires, and direction. ***"Be not deceived: evil communications corrupt good manners"***.

Proverbs names specific kinds of people to avoid as close companions. This does not mean refusing to be kind to them or to witness to them. It means refusing to let them set the direction of your life. ***"The righteous is more excellent than his neighbour: but the way of the wicked seduceth them"***.

Companions to Avoid

Companion	Why	Proverb
The angry man	Lest thou learn his ways and get a snare to thy soul	Proverbs 22:24–25
The foolish man	You will not find knowledge in him	Proverbs 14:7
The talebearer	He reveals secrets; meddle not with him	Proverbs 20:19
The riotous and gluttonous	A companion of riotous men shameth his father	Proverbs 23:20–21; 28:7
Those given to change	Rebellion brings sudden calamity	Proverbs 24:21–22

3. Be a Faithful Friend

Proverbs not only tells young people whom to avoid; it describes what a true friend looks like. A true friend is loyal in hard times, honest when honesty hurts, and present when

needed. ***"Faithful are the wounds of a friend; but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful"***. A friend who flatters you into sin is no friend at all.

Proverbs also warns about the false friendships that come with money and popularity (Proverbs 19:4, 6–7) and about the things that destroy friendships: gossip and repeating a matter (Proverbs 16:28; 17:9). The best friendships are built on love that **covers** a transgression rather than spreading it. The greatest Friend of all is the Lord Jesus, who said, ***"Ye are my friends, if ye do whatsoever I command you"***.

Marks of a Faithful Friend

Mark	Proverb
Loves at all times	Proverbs 17:17
Sticks closer than a brother	Proverbs 18:24
Tells the truth	Proverbs 27:5–6
Gives hearty counsel	Proverbs 27:9 — ***"so doth the sweetness of a man's friend by hearty counsel"***
Sharpens his friend	Proverbs 27:17
Covers a transgression	Proverbs 17:9
Stays loyal to family friends	Proverbs 27:10

> **Proverbs 17:9 —** *He that covereth a transgression seeketh love; but he that repeateth a matter separateth very friends*

Check Your Understanding

1. What three things did the sinners of Proverbs 1 offer, and what really happened to them?
2. Explain Proverbs 13:20 in your own words and connect it to 1 Corinthians 15:33.
3. Name three kinds of companions Proverbs warns against and why.
4. Why are the “wounds of a friend” better than the “kisses of an enemy”?
5. List five marks of a faithful friend. Which one do you most need to grow in?

UNIT 2 — WISDOM IN RELATIONSHIPS

Lesson 5 — The Strange Woman and the Virtuous Woman: Purity, Dating, and Marriage

Lesson Overview: Proverbs devotes more space to sexual purity than to almost any other subject. Chapters 5, 6, and 7 warn the young man about the strange woman, and chapter 31 describes the virtuous woman. Together they teach young men and young women to guard their purity, recognize the tactics of temptation, value character above appearance, and look forward to God's gift of marriage.

MAIN PASSAGES: Proverbs 2:16–19; 5:1–23; 6:20–35; 7:1–27; 31:10–31

KEY VERSE | Proverbs 31:30 — *Favour is deceitful, and beauty is vain: but a woman that feareth the LORD, she shall be praised.*

READ: Proverbs 2:10–19; 5:1–23; 6:20–35; 7:1–27; 11:16, 22; 12:4; 18:22; 19:14; 21:9, 19; 22:14; 23:26–28; 31:10–31; Genesis 39:7–12; 1 Corinthians 6:18–20; 1 Thessalonians 4:3–7; 1 Timothy 5:1–2.

Wisdom from Proverbs

Principle	Proverb
Stay far away	Proverbs 5:8 — ***"Remove thy way far from her, and come not nigh the door of her house:"***
Guard the heart and eyes	Proverbs 6:25 — ***"Lust not after her beauty in thine heart; neither let her take thee with her eyelids"***
Sin always costs	Proverbs 6:27 — ***"Can a man take fire in his bosom, and his clothes not be burned?"***

Principle	Proverb
Rejoice in God's gift	Proverbs 5:18 — ***"rejoice with the wife of thy youth"***
A good wife is from the LORD	Proverbs 18:22 — ***"Whoso findeth a wife findeth a good thing, and obtaineth favour of the LORD."***
Character over beauty	Proverbs 31:30 — ***"Favour is deceitful, and beauty is vain: but a woman that feareth the LORD, she shall be praised"***

1. The Tactics of Temptation (Proverbs 7)

Proverbs 7 is a detailed picture of how sexual temptation works. The father looks through his window and sees ***"among the youths, a young man void of understanding"***. The young man is not dragged into sin; he wanders toward it, walking near her corner in the twilight (Proverbs 7:8–9). He puts himself where temptation is waiting.

The strange woman uses flattery, boldness, secrecy, and the promise that no one will know (Proverbs 7:13–20). ***"With her much fair speech she caused him to yield, with the flattering of her lips she forced him"***. The young man follows ***"as an ox goeth to the slaughter"***. The chapter ends with a sober warning: ***"Her house is the way to hell, going down to the chambers of death"***. The same tactics appear today in the images, messages, and media that lure young people into impurity.

The Steps of Proverbs 7

Step	What happened	Verse
Simple	A young man void of understanding	Proverbs 7:7
Wandering	He went the way to her house	Proverbs 7:8
In the dark	In the twilight, in the black and dark night	Proverbs 7:9
Met	She caught him and kissed him	Proverbs 7:10–13

Step	What happened	Verse
Flattered	Fair speech and the promise of secrecy	Proverbs 7:14–21
Captured	He goeth after her straightway	Proverbs 7:22–23

2. The Cost of Impurity (Proverbs 5–6)

The strange woman's words are ***"smoother than oil"***, ***"But her end is bitter as wormwood"***. Sexual sin always promises more than it gives and takes more than it promises. Proverbs lists its cost: honour given to others, years wasted, strength spent, and mourning at the end (Proverbs 5:9–11).

The father's command is simple: ***"Remove thy way far from her, and come not nigh the door of her house"***. **Distance** is the best defense. Joseph fled from Potiphar's wife (Genesis 39:12), and Paul commands, ***"Flee fornication"***. These warnings apply equally to young women, who must guard their own hearts and refuse to become a snare to others. ***"As a jewel of gold in a swine's snout, so is a fair woman which is without discretion"***.

What Impurity Costs

Cost	Proverb
Honour and years given away	Proverbs 5:9
Strength and wealth spent on strangers	Proverbs 5:10
Mourning and regret at the end	Proverbs 5:11–13
Held by the cords of one's own sins	Proverbs 5:22
A wound and dishonour that will not be wiped away	Proverbs 6:32–33
Death and hell	Proverbs 7:26–27

> **Proverbs 6:23 —** *For the commandment is a lamp; and the law is light; and reproofs of instruction are the way of life*

3. The Virtuous Woman and the Gift of Marriage

Proverbs does not only warn; it points young people toward something good. ***"Whoso findeth a wife findeth a good thing, and obtaineth favour of the LORD"***. ***"a prudent wife is from the LORD"***. Marriage is God's gift, and purity before marriage protects the joy of marriage (Proverbs 5:15–19).

Proverbs 31:10–31 describes the virtuous woman. She is trustworthy, hardworking, generous, wise in speech, and above all she fears the LORD. Her description gives young women a goal to become, and it gives young men a standard for the kind of wife to seek and the kind of man worth her trust. In a culture that measures people by appearance, Proverbs says, ***"Favour is deceitful, and beauty is vain"***.

The Virtuous Woman (Proverbs 31:10–31)

Quality	Verse
Trustworthy: her husband safely trusts in her	Proverbs 31:11–12
Diligent: she works willingly with her hands	Proverbs 31:13–19, 27
Generous: she stretches out her hand to the poor	Proverbs 31:20
Strong and honourable	Proverbs 31:25
Wise and kind in speech	Proverbs 31:26
Fears the LORD	Proverbs 31:30

Check Your Understanding

1. Trace the steps of the young man in Proverbs 7. Where could he have stopped?
2. What tactics did the strange woman use, and how do the same tactics appear today?
3. List four costs of sexual impurity from Proverbs 5–7.
4. What is the best defense against sexual temptation according to Proverbs 5:8 and 1 Corinthians 6:18?
5. What qualities of the virtuous woman in Proverbs 31 matter most, and why is beauty called vain?

UNIT 2 — WISDOM IN RELATIONSHIPS

Lesson 6 — Life and Death in the Tongue: Words, Lies, and Gossip

Lesson Overview: Proverbs has more to say about the tongue than almost any other book of the Bible. Words can build or destroy, heal or wound, tell the truth or spread lies. These principles apply to every conversation, text, post, and comment. This lesson covers the power of words, the sins of the tongue, and the marks of wise speech.

MAIN PASSAGES: Proverbs 10:19–21; 12:17–22; 15:1–4; 16:24–28; 18:6–8, 21; 26:18–28

KEY VERSE | Proverbs 18:21 — *Death and life are in the power of the tongue: and they that love it shall eat the fruit thereof.*

READ: Proverbs 4:24; 6:16–19; 10:11, 18–21, 31–32; 11:9, 12–13; 12:18–19, 22, 25; 13:3; 15:1–4, 23, 28; 16:24, 27–28; 17:27–28; 18:6–8, 13, 21; 20:19; 21:23; 25:11; 26:18–28; 27:1–2; 29:5, 20; James 3:1–12; Ephesians 4:29.

Wisdom from Proverbs

Principle	Proverb
Words carry power	Proverbs 18:21 — ***"Death and life are in the power of the tongue"***
Fewer words, less sin	Proverbs 10:19 — ***"In the multitude of words there wanteth not sin"***
Soft answers calm	Proverbs 15:1 — ***"A soft answer turneth away wrath: but grievous words stir up anger."***
Lies are abomination	Proverbs 12:22 — ***"Lying lips are abomination to the LORD"***

Principle	Proverb
Gossip divides	Proverbs 16:28 — ***"a whisperer separateth chief friends"***
Kind words heal	Proverbs 16:24 — ***"Pleasant words are as an honeycomb, sweet to the soul, and health to the bones."***

1. The Power of Words

Proverbs teaches that words are never neutral. ***"There is that speaketh like the piercings of a sword: but the tongue of the wise is health"***. ***"A wholesome tongue is a tree of life"***. A single sentence can encourage someone for years or wound someone for years. The same is true of words typed and sent.

Because words carry such power, Proverbs commends restraint. ***"He that keepeth his mouth keepeth his life"***. ***"Even a fool, when he holdeth his peace, is counted wise"***. The wise person thinks before he speaks: ***"The heart of the righteous studieth to answer"***.

Words That Build and Words That Destroy

Words that build	Words that destroy	Proverb
The tongue of the wise is health	Speech like the piercings of a sword	Proverbs 12:18
A wholesome tongue is a tree of life	Perverseness is a breach in the spirit	Proverbs 15:4
A good word makes the heart glad	Heaviness makes it stoop	Proverbs 12:25
Pleasant words are as an honeycomb	An ungodly man's lips are as a burning fire	Proverbs 16:24, 27

Words that build	Words that destroy	Proverb
A word fitly spoken is like apples of gold	A flattering mouth worketh ruin	Proverbs 25:11; 26:28

2. Sins of the Tongue

Of the seven things the LORD hates in Proverbs 6:16–19, three involve the **tongue**: ***"a lying tongue"***, ***"A false witness that speaketh lies"***, and ***"he that soweth discord among brethren"***. God takes speech seriously because truth matters to Him. ***"The lip of truth shall be established for ever: but a lying tongue is but for a moment"***.

Gossip is especially destructive among young people. ***"The words of a talebearer are as wounds, and they go down into the innermost parts of the belly"***. Gossip spreads like fire, and Proverbs gives the way to put it out: ***"Where no wood is, there the fire goeth out: so where there is no talebearer, the strife ceaseth"***.

Sins of the Tongue in Proverbs

Sin	Description	Proverb
Lying	Abomination to the LORD; lasts but for a moment	Proverbs 12:19, 22
Gossip (talebearing)	Reveals secrets and wounds deeply	Proverbs 11:13; 18:8
Sowing discord	Stirs up strife between friends	Proverbs 6:19; 16:28
Flattery	Spreads a net for the neighbour's feet	Proverbs 29:5
Boasting	Praising oneself instead of letting another do it	Proverbs 27:1–2
Hasty words	There is more hope of a fool	Proverbs 29:20

Sin	Description	Proverb
Answering before hearing	It is folly and shame	Proverbs 18:13

3. The Marks of Wise Speech

Proverbs does not simply tell young people to stop speaking; it teaches them to speak well. Wise speech is truthful, timely, gentle, and helpful. ***"A word fitly spoken is like apples of gold in pictures of silver". "a word spoken in due season, how good is it!"***

The New Testament gives the same standard for the believer: ***"Let no corrupt communication proceed out of your mouth, but that which is good to the use of edifying, that it may minister grace unto the hearers"***. James warns that no man can tame the tongue by his own strength (James 3:8). Wise speech comes from a heart filled with God's Word and yielded to God's Spirit.

Tests for Every Word, Text, and Post

Test	Proverb
Is it true?	Proverbs 12:19, 22
Is it necessary, or am I talking too much?	Proverbs 10:19; 17:27
Have I heard the whole matter first?	Proverbs 18:13
Is it gentle, or will it stir up anger?	Proverbs 15:1
Is it the right time?	Proverbs 15:23; 25:11
Would it spread something I should cover?	Proverbs 11:13; 17:9

Proverbs 21:23 — *Whoso keepeth his mouth and his tongue keepeth his soul from troubles.*

Check Your Understanding

1. What does Proverbs 18:21 mean, and how does it apply to texting and posting?
2. Which three of the seven things the LORD hates involve the tongue?
3. How does Proverbs 26:20 teach us to stop gossip?
4. List four sins of the tongue from Proverbs with a reference for each.
5. Give four tests from Proverbs that every word should pass before it is spoken or sent.

UNIT 3 — WISDOM IN SELF-CONTROL

Lesson 7 — Ruling Your Spirit: Anger, Strife, and Revenge

Lesson Overview: Proverbs praises the person who can control himself more than the one who can conquer a city. Anger, arguments, grudges, and revenge are some of the most common struggles for young people, and Proverbs addresses each one. This lesson covers three principles: be slow to anger, avoid and end strife, and leave vengeance to God.

MAIN PASSAGES: Proverbs 14:17, 29; 15:1, 18; 16:32; 17:14; 19:11; 20:3, 22; 25:21–28

KEY VERSE | Proverbs 16:32 — *He that is slow to anger is better than the mighty; and he that ruleth his spirit than he that taketh a city.*

READ: Proverbs 10:12; 12:16; 14:16–17, 29; 15:1, 18; 16:32; 17:14, 19; 18:19; 19:11, 19; 20:3, 22; 22:24–25; 24:17–18, 29; 25:21–22, 28; 26:17, 21; 29:8, 11, 22; 30:33; Romans 12:17–21; Ephesians 4:26–32; James 1:19–20.

Wisdom from Proverbs

Principle	Proverb
Slow to anger is strength	Proverbs 16:32 — ***"He that is slow to anger is better than the mighty"***
No self-control, no defense	Proverbs 25:28 — ***"He that hath no rule over his own spirit is like a city that is broken down, and without walls."***
Overlook offenses	Proverbs 19:11 — ***"it is his glory to pass over a transgression"***

Principle	Proverb
Stop strife early	Proverbs 17:14 — ***"leave off contention, before it be meddled with"***
Leave revenge to God	Proverbs 20:22 — ***"Say not thou, I will recompense evil; but wait on the LORD, and he shall save thee."***
Repay evil with good	Proverbs 25:21 — ***"If thine enemy be hungry, give him bread to eat"***

1. Slow to Anger

The world praises the person who wins every argument and never backs down. Proverbs praises something greater: ***"He that is slow to anger is better than the mighty; and he that ruleth his spirit than he that taketh a city"***. Ruling your own spirit takes more strength than conquering an army.

A person without self-control is defenseless: ***"He that hath no rule over his own spirit is like a city that is broken down, and without walls"***. Anger that is quick and uncontrolled leads to foolish words and actions. ***"He that is soon angry dealeth foolishly"***. ***"A fool uttereth all his mind: but a wise man keepeth it in till afterwards"***.

The Quick-Tempered and the Slow to Anger

Quick-tempered	Slow to anger	Proverb
Deals foolishly	Has great understanding	Proverbs 14:17, 29
Stirs up strife	Appeases strife	Proverbs 15:18
Exalts folly	Is better than the mighty	Proverbs 14:29; 16:32
Utters all his mind	Keeps it in till afterwards	Proverbs 29:11

Quick-tempered	Slow to anger	Proverb
Will suffer punishment again and again	Passes over a transgression	Proverbs 19:19, 11

2. Avoiding and Ending Strife

Proverbs compares strife to a leak in a dam: ***"The beginning of strife is as when one letteth out water"***. The time to stop it is at the beginning, before it becomes a flood. ***"It is an honour for a man to cease from strife: but every fool will be meddling"***. Walking away from a fight is not weakness; Proverbs calls it honour.

Proverbs also identifies what feeds strife: pride (Proverbs 13:10), gossip (Proverbs 26:20), hatred (Proverbs 10:12), and meddling in quarrels that are not our business. ***"He that passeth by, and meddleth with strife belonging not to him, is like one that taketh a dog by the ears"***. The antidote is love: ***"Hatred stirreth up strifes: but love covereth all sins"***.

What Feeds Strife and What Stops It

Feeds strife	Stops strife	Proverb
Pride	Taking counsel	Proverbs 13:10
Grievous words	A soft answer	Proverbs 15:1
A talebearer	Removing the wood	Proverbs 26:20
Hatred	Love that covers	Proverbs 10:12
Meddling	Leaving off contention early	Proverbs 26:17; 17:14
Forcing wrath	Refusing to churn it	Proverbs 30:33

3. Leave Vengeance to God

When someone wrongs us, the natural response is to get even. Proverbs forbids it: ***"Say not, I will do so to him as he hath done to me: I will render to the man according to his work"***. Instead, ***"wait on the LORD, and he shall save thee"***. Even when an enemy falls, the wise do not gloat (Proverbs 24:17–18).

Proverbs goes further and commands kindness toward enemies: ***"If thine enemy be hungry, give him bread to eat; and if he be thirsty, give him water to drink"***. Paul quotes this proverb in Romans 12:20 and concludes, ***"Be not overcome of evil, but overcome evil with good"***. The Lord Jesus is the perfect example: ***"when he was reviled, reviled not again; when he suffered, he threatened not; but committed himself to him that judgeth righteously"***.

Responding to Wrongs God's Way

Response	Scripture
Do not repay evil for evil	Proverbs 20:22; 24:29
Do not rejoice when an enemy falls	Proverbs 24:17–18
Do good to your enemy	Proverbs 25:21–22; Romans 12:20
Wait on the LORD	Proverbs 20:22
Commit yourself to the righteous Judge	1 Peter 2:23

> **Proverbs 24:17 —** *Rejoice not when thine enemy falleth, and let not thine heart be glad when he stumbleth:*

Check Your Understanding

1. Why does Proverbs 16:32 say ruling your spirit is greater than taking a city?
2. Compare the quick-tempered person with the one who is slow to anger. Give three contrasts.
3. What does Proverbs 17:14 teach about the best time to stop strife?
4. Name four things that feed strife and what Proverbs says stops each one.
5. How do Proverbs 25:21–22 and Romans 12:17–21 teach us to respond to an enemy?

UNIT 3 — WISDOM IN SELF-CONTROL

Lesson 8 — Wine Is a Mocker: Alcohol, Substances, and Appetites

Lesson Overview: Alcohol, vaping, marijuana, and other substances are pressed on young people as normal, fun, and harmless. Proverbs gives the Bible's most vivid description of drunkenness and its effects, and it teaches that the wise do not let any appetite rule them. This lesson covers the deception of strong drink, the wisdom of abstaining, and self-control over every appetite.

MAIN PASSAGES: Proverbs 20:1; 23:19–21, 29–35; 31:4–7

KEY VERSE | Proverbs 20:1 — *Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging: and whosoever is deceived thereby is not wise.*

READ: Proverbs 20:1; 21:17; 23:1–3, 19–21, 29–35; 25:16, 27–28; 31:4–7; Genesis 9:20–27; Isaiah 5:11, 22; 28:7; Habakkuk 2:15; Romans 13:13–14; 1 Corinthians 6:12, 19–20; 9:25–27; Galatians 5:19–23; Ephesians 5:18.

Wisdom from Proverbs

Principle	Proverb
Strong drink deceives	Proverbs 20:1 — ***"Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging"***
Do not look at it	Proverbs 23:31 — ***"Look not thou upon the wine when it is red"***
It bites in the end	Proverbs 23:32 — ***"At the last it biteth like a serpent, and stingeth like an adder."***

Principle	Proverb
It leads to poverty	Proverbs 23:21 — ***"For the drunkard and the glutton shall come to poverty"***
Leaders must abstain	Proverbs 31:4 — ***"it is not for kings to drink wine; nor for princes strong drink"***
Rule every appetite	Proverbs 23:2 — ***"put a knife to thy throat, if thou be a man given to appetite"***

1. The Deception of Strong Drink

Proverbs calls wine a **mocker** and strong drink raging, and it adds, ***"whosoever is deceived thereby is not wise"***. Alcohol mocks the one who uses it: it promises fun, confidence, and relief, and then delivers shame, foolishness, and bondage. The deception is that no one thinks he will become the drunkard; every drunkard began with a **first** drink.

Proverbs 23:29–35 gives a detailed description of the one who tarries long at the wine. It begins with six questions: ***"Who hath woe? who hath sorrow? who hath contentions? who hath babbling? who hath wounds without cause? who hath redness of eyes?"*** The answer is those who linger at the wine and go to seek mixed wine (Proverbs 23:30). The same effects follow drugs, marijuana, and every substance that takes control of the mind.

The Effects of Strong Drink (Proverbs 23:29–35)

Effect	Verse
Woe, sorrow, contentions, and babbling	Proverbs 23:29
Wounds without cause and redness of eyes	Proverbs 23:29
It bites like a serpent and stings like an adder	Proverbs 23:32

Effect	Verse
Eyes behold strange women; the heart utters perverse things	Proverbs 23:33
Loss of balance and awareness, like one lying in the sea	Proverbs 23:34–35
Bondage: "I will seek it yet again"	Proverbs 23:35

2. The Wisdom of Abstaining

Proverbs does not tell the young man to drink carefully; it tells him, ***"Look not thou upon the wine when it is red, when it giveth his colour in the cup, when it moveth itself aright"***. The safest distance from what bites like a serpent is to never pick it up. The command to kings is the same: ***"Lest they drink, and forget the law, and pervert the judgment of any of the afflicted"***.

Believers in the church age are called kings and priests unto God (Revelation 1:6), and their bodies are temples of the Holy Ghost (1 Corinthians 6:19). The Bible's picture of the believer is a clear mind under the control of God's Spirit, not a mind under the control of a substance: ***"And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit"***. For those reasons Bible-believing Christians have long chosen total **abstinence** from alcohol and from every mind-altering substance.

Why the Wise Abstain

Reason	Scripture
It deceives	Proverbs 20:1
God says not to look on it	Proverbs 23:31
It clouds judgment	Proverbs 31:4–5; Isaiah 28:7

Reason	Scripture
The body is the temple of the Holy Ghost	1 Corinthians 6:19–20
The believer is to be Spirit-filled, not controlled	Ephesians 5:18
It can cause others to stumble	Romans 14:21

3. Self-Control Over Every Appetite

Proverbs applies the same wisdom to every appetite. It warns against gluttony alongside drunkenness (Proverbs 23:20–21) and tells the man at the ruler's table to ***"put a knife to thy throat, if thou be a man given to appetite"***. Even good things become harmful without restraint: ***"Hast thou found honey? eat so much as is sufficient for thee, lest thou be filled therewith, and vomit it"***.

This principle reaches to anything that can master a young person: food, entertainment, gaming, screens, or pleasure itself. ***"He that loveth pleasure shall be a poor man"***. Paul wrote, ***"But I keep under my body, and bring it into subjection"***. Temperance is part of the fruit of the Spirit (Galatians 5:23), and it grows as the believer walks in the Spirit.

> **Proverbs 25:28 —** *He that hath no rule over his own spirit is like a city that is broken down, and without walls.*

Check Your Understanding

1. Why does Proverbs call wine a mocker? What does it promise and what does it deliver?
2. List four effects of strong drink from Proverbs 23:29–35.
3. What command does Proverbs 23:31 give, and why is distance the wisest choice?
4. How do Proverbs 31:4–5, 1 Corinthians 6:19, and Ephesians 5:18 support abstaining from alcohol and drugs?
5. Name two appetites other than alcohol that Proverbs warns us to control.

UNIT 3 — WISDOM IN SELF-CONTROL

Lesson 9 — Go to the Ant: Diligence, Laziness, and Excuses

Lesson Overview: Proverbs contrasts two kinds of people in every area of work: the sluggard and the diligent. The sluggard is not always idle; he is full of excuses, delays, and good intentions that never become action. The diligent person works steadily, plans ahead, and finishes what he starts. These principles apply to schoolwork, chores, jobs, and the service of God.

MAIN PASSAGES: Proverbs 6:6–11; 10:4–5; 12:24, 27; 13:4; 20:4, 13; 24:30–34; 26:13–16

KEY VERSE | Proverbs 6:6 — *Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise:*

READ: Proverbs 6:6–11; 10:4–5, 26; 12:11, 24, 27; 13:4; 14:23; 15:19; 18:9; 19:15, 24; 20:4, 13; 21:5, 25–26; 22:13, 29; 24:30–34; 26:13–16; 27:23–27; 28:19; Ecclesiastes 9:10; Colossians 3:23–24; 2 Thessalonians 3:10–12.

Wisdom from Proverbs

Principle	Proverb
Learn from the ant	Proverbs 6:6 — ***"Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise:"***
Diligence makes rich	Proverbs 10:4 — ***"the hand of the diligent maketh rich"***
Labor brings profit	Proverbs 14:23 — ***"In all labour there is profit: but the talk of the lips tendeth only to penury"***

Principle	Proverb
Desire without work	Proverbs 13:4 — ***"The soul of the sluggard desireth, and hath nothing"***
Excuses are foolish	Proverbs 22:13 — ***"The slothful man saith, There is a lion without"***
Skill is honored	Proverbs 22:29 — ***"Seest thou a man diligent in his business? he shall stand before kings"***

1. Lessons from the Ant

God sends the sluggard to school with an insect: ***"Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise"***. The ant has ***"no guide, overseer, or ruler"***, yet she works without being told. She ***"Provideth her meat in the summer, and gathereth her food in the harvest"***. She works ahead, not at the last minute.

The sluggard's problem is not that he plans to fail; it is that he keeps postponing: ***"Yet a little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to sleep"***. Poverty comes on him ***"as one that travelleth, and thy want as an armed man"***. Small delays add up to large losses.

What the Ant Teaches

Lesson	Verse
Self-motivation: she works without a supervisor	Proverbs 6:7
Planning ahead: she prepares in summer for winter	Proverbs 6:8
Seizing the season: she gathers in harvest	Proverbs 6:8; 10:5
Steady work: little by little	Proverbs 13:11; 30:25

2. The Portrait of the Sluggard

Proverbs paints a detailed picture of the sluggard so that young people will recognize him in themselves. He desires much but has **nothing** (Proverbs 13:4). He will not plow because it is cold (Proverbs 20:4). He is so lazy that he will not even bring his hand to his mouth (Proverbs 19:24). He turns on his bed like a door on its hinges (Proverbs 26:14). And he is convinced he is right: ***"The sluggard is wiser in his own conceit than seven men that can render a reason"***.

Solomon walked past the field of the slothful and saw it overgrown with thorns and nettles, its stone wall broken down (Proverbs 24:30–31). ***"Then I saw, and considered it well: I looked upon it, and received instruction"***. Neglect does not destroy all at once; it slowly lets the weeds take over.

The Sluggard's Excuses and Habits

Habit	Proverb
Wishing without working	Proverbs 13:4; 21:25
Blaming conditions: "It's too cold"	Proverbs 20:4
Imagining dangers: "There is a lion in the way"	Proverbs 22:13; 26:13
Loving sleep	Proverbs 20:13; 26:14
Not finishing: will not bring his hand to his mouth	Proverbs 19:24; 26:15
Thinking himself wise	Proverbs 26:16
Wasting what he has	Proverbs 12:27; 18:9

3. The Blessing of Diligence

Diligence is steady, careful, persistent effort. Proverbs promises that ***"The hand of the diligent shall bear rule: but the slothful shall be under tribute"***. The diligent gain substance (Proverbs 12:27), are made fat (Proverbs 13:4), and ***"shall stand before kings"***. Faithfulness in small duties now prepares a young person for larger responsibilities later.

For the believer, all work is ultimately done for the Lord. ***"And whatsoever ye do, do it heartily, as to the Lord, and not unto men"***. Solomon wrote, ***"Whatsoever thy hand findeth to do, do it with thy might"***. Homework, chores, a job, and service in the church are all opportunities to glorify God through diligence.

The Diligent and the Slothful Compared

The diligent	The slothful	Proverb
Made rich	Becomes poor	Proverbs 10:4
Bears rule	Under tribute	Proverbs 12:24
Made fat	Desires and has nothing	Proverbs 13:4
His way is made plain	His way is an hedge of thorns	Proverbs 15:19
Thoughts tend to plenteousness	Hasty and in want	Proverbs 21:5

Check Your Understanding

1. What four lessons does the ant teach in Proverbs 6:6–8?
2. How does "a little sleep, a little slumber" lead to poverty?
3. List four habits or excuses of the sluggard from Proverbs.
4. What did Solomon learn from the field of the slothful in Proverbs 24:30–34?
5. How does Colossians 3:23 change the way a believer does schoolwork and chores?

UNIT 4 — WISDOM FOR THE FUTURE

Lesson 10 — Better Than Gold: Money, Integrity, and a Good Name

Lesson Overview: Proverbs speaks often about money, but it speaks even more about the character behind it. Honest scales, a good name, generosity, and contentment are worth more than riches gained the wrong way. This lesson covers three connected principles: walk in integrity, handle money wisely, and value a good name and godly character above wealth.

MAIN PASSAGES: Proverbs 3:9–10; 10:9; 11:1–3, 24–25; 13:11; 22:1, 7; 23:4–5; 30:7–9

KEY VERSE | Proverbs 22:1 — *A good name is rather to be chosen than great riches, and loving favour rather than silver and gold.*

READ: Proverbs 3:9–10, 27–28; 10:2, 9, 22; 11:1–3, 24–28; 13:7, 11, 22; 15:16–17, 27; 16:8, 11, 16; 19:1, 17; 20:10, 17, 21, 23; 21:6, 13, 20; 22:1, 7, 9, 16, 26–27; 23:4–5; 28:6, 8, 20, 22, 27; 30:7–9; Luke 16:10–12; 1 Timothy 6:6–10.

Wisdom from Proverbs

Principle	Proverb
Integrity keeps you safe	Proverbs 10:9 — ***"He that walketh uprightly walketh surely"***
God hates dishonesty	Proverbs 11:1 — ***"A false balance is abomination to the LORD: but a just weight is his delight."***
Honour God first	Proverbs 3:9 — ***"Honour the LORD with thy substance, and with the firstfruits of all thine increase:"***

Principle	Proverb
Riches fly away	Proverbs 23:4 — ***"Labour not to be rich"***
Generosity increases	Proverbs 11:25 — ***"The liberal soul shall be made fat"***
A good name is better	Proverbs 22:1 — ***"A good name is rather to be chosen than great riches"***

1. Walk in Integrity

Integrity means being the same person in private as in public, whole and undivided in doing right. ***"The integrity of the upright shall guide them: but the perverseness of transgressors shall destroy them"***. The person of integrity does not have to remember which lie he told to whom. ***"He that walketh uprightly walketh surely: but he that perverteth his ways shall be known"***.

Proverbs repeatedly condemns cheating: false balances, divers weights, and bread gained by deceit (Proverbs 11:1; 20:10, 23). Cheating on a test, lying on a form, and taking what is not ours are modern forms of a false balance. ***"Bread of deceit is sweet to a man; but afterwards his mouth shall be filled with gravel"***.

Honesty and Dishonesty

Honesty	Dishonesty	Proverb
A just weight is His delight	A false balance is abomination	Proverbs 11:1
The upright are guided	Transgressors are destroyed	Proverbs 11:3
Walking uprightly is secure	Perverse ways are exposed	Proverbs 10:9
Better poor with integrity	Than perverse in lips and a fool	Proverbs 19:1; 28:6
Righteousness delivers from death	Treasures of wickedness profit nothing	Proverbs 10:2

2. Handle Money Wisely

Proverbs gives practical principles for money that every young person should learn before earning a first paycheck. Honour the LORD **first** (Proverbs 3:9–10). Build wealth slowly through labor rather than quickly through schemes (Proverbs 13:11; 28:20). Save rather than spend everything (Proverbs 21:20). Avoid debt and co-signing (Proverbs 22:7, 26–27). Be generous to the poor (Proverbs 19:17).

Proverbs also warns against making money the goal of life: ***"Labour not to be rich: cease from thine own wisdom"***. ***"for riches certainly make themselves wings; they fly away as an eagle toward heaven"***. Agur prayed for balance: ***"give me neither poverty nor riches; feed me with food convenient for me"***, lest riches make him deny God or poverty tempt him to steal (Proverbs 30:9).

Proverbs' Principles for Money

Principle	Proverb
Honour the LORD with the firstfruits	Proverbs 3:9–10
Gather by labour, little by little	Proverbs 13:11
Do not hasten to be rich	Proverbs 28:20, 22
Save; do not consume everything	Proverbs 21:20
The borrower is servant to the lender	Proverbs 22:7
Do not become surety for debts	Proverbs 22:26–27
He that giveth to the poor lendeth unto the LORD	Proverbs 19:17

3. A Good Name and True Riches

A reputation takes years to build and moments to destroy. ***"A good name is rather to be chosen than great riches, and loving favour rather than silver and gold"***. Every

choice a young person makes, including what he posts and how he treats others, is building or tearing down his name.

Proverbs points to riches that money cannot buy. Wisdom is better than gold (Proverbs 16:16). A little with the fear of the LORD is better than great treasure with trouble (Proverbs 15:16). ***"The blessing of the LORD, it maketh rich, and he addeth no sorrow with it"***. The Lord Jesus asked, ***"For what shall it profit a man, if he shall gain the whole world, and lose his own soul?"***

What Is Better Than Riches

Better	Proverb
A good name and loving favour	Proverbs 22:1
Wisdom and understanding	Proverbs 16:16
A little with the fear of the LORD	Proverbs 15:16
A dinner of herbs where love is	Proverbs 15:17
A little with righteousness	Proverbs 16:8
The poor that walketh in his uprightness	Proverbs 28:6

> **Proverbs 16:16 —** *How much better is it to get wisdom than gold! and to get understanding rather to be chosen than silver!*

Check Your Understanding

1. What is integrity, and what does Proverbs 11:3 and 10:9 promise to the one who walks in it?
2. What are some modern forms of a "false balance"?
3. List five principles for handling money from Proverbs.
4. What did Agur ask for in Proverbs 30:7–9, and why?
5. Name three things Proverbs says are better than riches.

UNIT 4 — WISDOM FOR THE FUTURE

Lesson 11 — The Path of Life: Decisions, Plans, and God's Direction

Lesson Overview: High school is a season of big decisions: college, career, relationships, and the direction of life. Proverbs teaches that man plans but God directs, that the wise seek counsel, and that the path of the righteous grows brighter over time. This lesson covers how to make decisions wisely, how to plan while trusting God, and how to stay on the right path.

MAIN PASSAGES: Proverbs 3:5–6; 4:18–27; 11:14; 14:12; 15:22; 16:1–3, 9, 33; 19:20–21; 27:1

KEY VERSE | Proverbs 16:9 — *A man's heart deviseth his way: but the LORD directeth his steps.*

READ: Proverbs 3:5–7; 4:18–27; 11:14; 12:15; 14:8, 12, 15; 15:22; 16:1–3, 9, 25, 33; 19:2, 20–21; 20:18, 24; 21:30–31; 22:3; 24:3–6, 27; 27:1, 12; Psalm 37:23; James 4:13–15.

Wisdom from Proverbs

Principle	Proverb
Commit your plans to God	Proverbs 16:3 — ***"Commit thy works unto the LORD, and thy thoughts shall be established."***
God directs the steps	Proverbs 16:9 — ***"A man's heart deviseth his way: but the LORD directeth his steps."***
His counsel stands	Proverbs 19:21 — ***"the counsel of the LORD, that shall stand"***

Principle	Proverb
Seek counsel	Proverbs 15:22 — ***"in the multitude of counsellors they are established"***
Look ahead	Proverbs 22:3 — ***"A prudent man foreseeth the evil, and hideth himself"***
Do not boast of tomorrow	Proverbs 27:1 — ***"Boast not thyself of to morrow; for thou knowest not what a day may bring forth."***

1. Man Plans, God Directs

Proverbs does not tell young people to stop planning; it tells them to plan under God. ***"A man's heart deviseth his way: but the LORD directeth his steps"***. ***"There are many devices in a man's heart; nevertheless the counsel of the LORD, that shall stand"***. Even what seems like chance is under His control: ***"The lot is cast into the lap; but the whole disposing thereof is of the LORD"***.

That truth brings both humility and peace. It brings humility because our plans are not final (Proverbs 27:1; James 4:13–15). It brings peace because the One directing our steps is wise and good. ***"Commit thy works unto the LORD, and thy thoughts shall be established"***.

God's Sovereignty Over Our Plans

Truth	Proverb
The preparations of the heart are from the LORD	Proverbs 16:1
The LORD directs a man's steps	Proverbs 16:9; 20:24
The counsel of the LORD shall stand	Proverbs 19:21

Truth	Proverb
No wisdom or counsel succeeds against the LORD	Proverbs 21:30
Safety is of the LORD	Proverbs 21:31

2. How the Wise Make Decisions

Proverbs gives clear principles for making decisions. First, beware of the way that only seems right: ***"There is a way which seemeth right unto a man, but the end thereof are the ways of death"***. Second, do not rush: ***"he that hasteth with his feet sinneth"***. Third, look ahead to consequences: ***"the prudent man looketh well to his going"***.

Fourth, seek godly counsel. ***"Where no counsel is, the people fall: but in the multitude of counsellors there is safety"***. Parents, pastors, and mature believers can see what a young person cannot yet see. ***"The way of a fool is right in his own eyes: but he that hearkeneth unto counsel is wise"***. Finally, build in the right order: ***"Prepare thy work without, and make it fit for thyself in the field; and afterwards build thine house"***.

Decision Principles from Proverbs

Principle	Proverb
Acknowledge God in all your ways	Proverbs 3:6
Distrust the way that only seems right	Proverbs 14:12; 16:25
Take time; do not rush	Proverbs 19:2; 21:5
Consider the end, not only the start	Proverbs 14:15; 22:3
Seek many godly counsellors	Proverbs 11:14; 15:22; 20:18
Prepare first, then build	Proverbs 24:3–4, 27

3. Staying on the Path of Life

Proverbs describes the life of the righteous as a path that grows brighter: ***"But the path of the just is as the shining light, that shineth more and more unto the perfect day"***. The wicked walk in darkness and do not even know what makes them stumble (Proverbs 4:19).

To stay on that path requires focus and ongoing care. ***"Let thine eyes look right on, and let thine eyelids look straight before thee"***. ***"Ponder the path of thy feet, and let all thy ways be established"***. ***"Turn not to the right hand nor to the left: remove thy foot from evil"***. A young person who keeps God's Word before him will find that ***"The steps of a good man are ordered by the LORD"***.

> **Proverbs 3:6 —** *In all thy ways acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths.*

Check Your Understanding

1. What does Proverbs 16:9 and 19:21 teach about our plans and God's direction?
2. Why should we be careful with "the way which seemeth right" (Proverbs 14:12)?
3. List five principles for making wise decisions from Proverbs.
4. Why is seeking counsel a mark of wisdom? Use Proverbs 11:14 and 12:15.
5. How does Proverbs 4:18–27 describe staying on the path of life?

UNIT 4 — WISDOM FOR THE FUTURE

Lesson 12 — Christ, the Wisdom of God: The Choice That Matters Most

Lesson Overview: Proverbs is not only a book of good advice. Its wisdom points to a Person. The New Testament reveals that Jesus Christ is the wisdom of God, in whom are hid all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge. This final lesson sees Christ pictured in Proverbs 8 and 30, returns to the two invitations of Proverbs 9, and calls every young person to receive the One who is Wisdom and to share Him with others.

MAIN PASSAGES: Proverbs 8:1–36; 9:1–18; 30:4; 1 Corinthians 1:18–31; Colossians 2:3

KEY VERSE | 1 Corinthians 1:30 — *But of him are ye in Christ Jesus, who of God is made unto us wisdom, and righteousness, and sanctification, and redemption:*

READ: Proverbs 1:20–33; 8:1–36; 9:1–18; 11:30; 14:12; 30:4–5; John 1:1–3; 14:6; 1 Corinthians 1:18–31; Colossians 1:15–17; 2:2–3; James 1:5; 3:17.

Wisdom from Scripture

Truth	Scripture
Christ is God's wisdom	1 Corinthians 1:24 — ***"Christ the power of God, and the wisdom of God"***
All treasure is in Him	Colossians 2:3 — ***"In whom are hid all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge."***
Wisdom was with God	Proverbs 8:30 — ***"Then I was by him, as one brought up with him"***

Truth	Scripture
Finding wisdom is finding life	Proverbs 8:35 — ***"For whoso findeth me findeth life, and shall obtain favour of the LORD."***
What is His Son's name?	Proverbs 30:4 — ***"what is his name, and what is his son's name, if thou canst tell?"***
The wise win souls	Proverbs 11:30 — ***"he that winneth souls is wise"***

1. Wisdom in Proverbs 8 and the Son in Proverbs 30

In Proverbs 8 wisdom speaks as a person. Wisdom was set up from everlasting, before the earth was (Proverbs 8:23). When God prepared the heavens, wisdom was there (Proverbs 8:27). ***"Then I was by him, as one brought up with him: and I was daily his delight, rejoicing always before him"***. The New Testament applies this language to the Lord Jesus Christ, the eternal Word who was with God in the beginning and by whom all things were made (John 1:1–3; Colossians 1:16–17).

Proverbs 30:4 asks a series of questions that only God can answer: who has ascended into heaven, gathered the wind, bound the waters, and established the ends of the earth? Then it asks, ***"what is his name, and what is his son's name, if thou canst tell?"*** The Old Testament raised the question; the New Testament answers it with the name of **Jesus Christ**, the only begotten Son of God (John 3:16).

Wisdom in Proverbs 8 and Christ in the New Testament

Proverbs 8	Fulfilled in Christ
Set up from everlasting (8:23)	In the beginning was the Word (John 1:1)
Present at creation (8:27–30)	All things were made by Him (John 1:3; Colossians 1:16)

Proverbs 8	Fulfilled in Christ
Daily God's delight (8:30)	"This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased" (Matthew 3:17)
Speaks excellent things and truth (8:6–7)	Grace and truth came by Jesus Christ (John 1:17)
Whoso findeth me findeth life (8:35)	He that hath the Son hath life (1 John 5:12)

2. Two Invitations (Proverbs 9)

Proverbs 9 closes the opening section of the book with two banquets. Wisdom has built her house, prepared her table, and sent out her maidens: ***"Whoso is simple, let him turn in hither"***. ***"Forsake the foolish, and live; and go in the way of understanding"***. The foolish woman sits at the door of her house and calls to the same passersby with the same words (Proverbs 9:13–16), offering stolen waters and secret bread (Proverbs 9:17).

Every young person hears both invitations. The world offers pleasure, freedom, and secrecy; Wisdom offers life. The difference is the destination: ***"But he knoweth not that the dead are there; and that her guests are in the depths of hell"***. The Lord Jesus gave the same choice between the broad way and the narrow way (Matthew 7:13–14).

The Two Invitations

	Wisdom	Folly
Her house	Built on seven pillars (9:1)	She sits at the door (9:14)
Her offer	Bread and mingled wine (9:5)	Stolen waters and secret bread (9:17)
Her call	"Forsake the foolish, and live" (9:6)	"Whoso is simple, let him turn in hither" (9:16)

	Wisdom	Folly
Her guests' end	Days multiplied; years of life increased (9:11)	The dead are there; the depths of hell (9:18)

3. Receiving Wisdom and Winning Souls

True wisdom begins not with a better set of rules but with a new **birth**. The world's wisdom cannot save anyone: ***"For after that in the wisdom of God the world by wisdom knew not God, it pleased God by the foolishness of preaching to save them that believe"***. Christ ***"of God is made unto us wisdom, and righteousness, and sanctification, and redemption"***. A person receives Him by believing the gospel: that Christ died for our sins, was buried, and rose again the third day (1 Corinthians 15:3–4).

Once a young person has received Christ, he can ask God for wisdom in every decision: ***"If any of you lack wisdom, let him ask of God, that giveth to all men liberally, and upbraideth not; and it shall be given him"***. The wisest thing a believer can do with his life is to bring others to the Saviour. ***"The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life; and he that winneth souls is wise"***.

The Wisdom from Above (James 3:17)

Quality	Meaning
Pure	Clean and free from sin
Peaceable	Seeks peace, not strife
Gentle	Kind and reasonable
Easy to be intreated	Willing to listen and yield
Full of mercy and good fruits	Shows compassion in action

Quality	Meaning
Without partiality, without hypocrisy	Sincere and fair to all

Proverbs 8:17 — *I love them that love me; and those that seek me early shall find me.*

Check Your Understanding

1. How does the description of wisdom in Proverbs 8:22–31 point to the Lord Jesus Christ?
2. What question does Proverbs 30:4 ask, and how does the New Testament answer it?
3. Compare the two invitations of Proverbs 9. Where does each one lead?
4. According to 1 Corinthians 1:21–30, how does a person receive the wisdom of God?
5. Why does Proverbs 11:30 say that he that winneth souls is wise?

REFERENCE APPENDIX

Appendix A — Proverbs in a Month

Read the chapter that matches the day of the month. In one year you will read the whole book of Proverbs twelve times.

Day	Chapter	Theme
1	Proverbs 1	Wisdom's call and the enticement of sinners
2	Proverbs 2	Searching for wisdom as for silver
3	Proverbs 3	Trust in the LORD; wisdom more precious than rubies
4	Proverbs 4	The path of the just; keep thy heart
5	Proverbs 5	The strange woman; rejoice with the wife of thy youth
6	Proverbs 6	The ant; seven things the LORD hates
7	Proverbs 7	The young man void of understanding
8	Proverbs 8	Wisdom at creation; whoso findeth me findeth life
9	Proverbs 9	Wisdom's house and Folly's house
10	Proverbs 10	The wise son and the mouth of the righteous
11	Proverbs 11	Integrity, generosity, and winning souls
12	Proverbs 12	Loving instruction; lips of truth
13	Proverbs 13	Companions, diligence, and hope deferred
14	Proverbs 14	The way that seemeth right; the fear of the LORD
15	Proverbs 15	The soft answer; better is little
16	Proverbs 16	The LORD directs the steps; pride before destruction

Day	Chapter	Theme
17	Proverbs 17	Friendship, strife, and a merry heart
18	Proverbs 18	The power of the tongue; a friend closer than a brother
19	Proverbs 19	Poor with integrity; hearing counsel
20	Proverbs 20	Wine is a mocker; honest weights
21	Proverbs 21	The king's heart; the sluggard's desire
22	Proverbs 22	A good name; train up a child
23	Proverbs 23	Riches fly away; wine when it is red
24	Proverbs 24	Envy not the wicked; the field of the slothful
25	Proverbs 25	Words fitly spoken; rule over your spirit
26	Proverbs 26	The fool, the sluggard, and the talebearer
27	Proverbs 27	Boast not of tomorrow; iron sharpeneth iron
28	Proverbs 28	Bold as a lion; confessing and forsaking sin
29	Proverbs 29	Hardened after reproof; the fear of man
30	Proverbs 30	Agur's words; what is His Son's name?
31	Proverbs 31	Lemuel's mother; the virtuous woman

REFERENCE APPENDIX

Appendix B — Memory Verses

Memorize the key verse from each lesson. Hide God's Word in your heart (Psalm 119:11).

Lesson	Key verse
1	Proverbs 1:7 — *"The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge: but fools despise wisdom and instruction."*
2	Proverbs 1:8 — *"My son, hear the instruction of thy father, and forsake not the law of thy mother:"*
3	Proverbs 4:23 — *"Keep thy heart with all diligence; for out of it are the issues of life."*
4	Proverbs 13:20 — *"He that walketh with wise men shall be wise: but a companion of fools shall be destroyed."*
5	Proverbs 31:30 — *"Favour is deceitful, and beauty is vain: but a woman that feareth the LORD, she shall be praised."*
6	Proverbs 18:21 — *"Death and life are in the power of the tongue: and they that love it shall eat the fruit thereof."*
7	Proverbs 16:32 — *"He that is slow to anger is better than the mighty; and he that ruleth his spirit than he that taketh a city."*
8	Proverbs 20:1 — *"Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging: and whosoever is deceived thereby is not wise."*
9	Proverbs 6:6 — *"Go to the ant, thou sluggard; consider her ways, and be wise:"*

Lesson	Key verse
10	Proverbs 22:1 — ***"A good name is rather to be chosen than great riches, and loving favour rather than silver and gold."***
11	Proverbs 16:9 — ***"A man's heart deviseth his way: but the LORD directeth his steps."***
12	1 Corinthians 1:30 — ***"But of him are ye in Christ Jesus, who of God is made unto us wisdom, and righteousness, and sanctification, and redemption:"***

REFERENCE APPENDIX

Appendix C — How to Be Saved

Every issue in this workbook finally comes back to one question: Do you know Jesus Christ as your Saviour? Salvation is not earned by religion, good works, or church membership. It is the free gift of God received by faith in the Lord Jesus Christ.

Truth	Scripture
All have sinned	Romans 3:23 — ***"For all have sinned, and come short of the glory of God;"***
Sin brings death	Romans 6:23 — ***"For the wages of sin is death; but the gift of God is eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord."***
Christ died for sinners	Romans 5:8 — ***"But God commendeth his love toward us, in that, while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us."***
The gospel	1 Corinthians 15:3–4 — ***"Christ died for our sins according to the scriptures"***; ***"he was buried, and that he rose again the third day"***
Salvation is by grace	Ephesians 2:8–9 — ***"For by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God: Not of works, lest any man should boast."***
Call on the Lord	Romans 10:13 — ***"For whosoever shall call upon the name of the Lord shall be saved."***
You can know	1 John 5:13 — ***"These things have I written unto you that believe on the name of the Son of God; that ye may know that ye have eternal life"***

Truth	Scripture
You are kept for ever	John 10:28 — ***"And I give unto them eternal life; and they shall never perish"***

After salvation, a believer should follow the Lord in baptism (Acts 8:36–38), join himself to a sound local church (Acts 2:41–42), and grow by reading and obeying the Word of God (1 Peter 2:2).

> **John 3:16 —** *For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life.*

C04 / CURRICULA AND WORKBOOKS

Story of the Bible

Nineteen lessons in seven units tracing the biblical story through its people. Includes a final teacher edition and an earlier student workbook.

MY CONTRIBUTION

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The Biblical Story Through Its Main Characters

PLANTED YOUTH

Millheim Baptist Church

Introduction

The Bible tells one connected history through real people and events. These lessons follow the major characters and stories from Lucifer's rebellion and Adam's fall through Israel's patriarchs, kings, and prophets; Jesus Christ and His apostles; the Church's mission; and Christ's return and eternal kingdom.

Read the listed passages, fill in the blanks as you go through each section, look up the verses, and use the charts to connect each person and event with the whole story.

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UNIT 1 — REBELLION, RECONSTRUCTION, AND THE FIRST WORLD

Lesson 1 — Lucifer: The First Rebel and the Ruined Earth

Lesson Overview: The Bible's story begins with God, His original creation, and a created cherub who becomes proud. Lucifer's rebellion brings judgment and darkness; God then speaks light, order, and life into the ruined earth.

MAIN PASSAGES: Genesis 1:1–2:3; Job 38:4–7; Isaiah 14:12–15; Ezekiel 28:12–19; Isaiah 45:18

KEY VERSE | Ezekiel 28:15 — *Thou wast perfect in thy ways from the day that thou wast created, till iniquity was found in thee.*

READ: Genesis 1:1–2:3; Job 38:4–7; Isaiah 14:12–15; 45:18; Ezekiel 28:12–19; John 1:1–5; Revelation 12:7–12.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
God creates the heaven and the earth	Genesis 1:1 — ***"In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth."***
The heavenly host rejoices	Job 38:4–7 describes the morning stars singing and the sons of God shouting at the earth's foundation.
Pride rises in Lucifer	Isaiah 14:12–15 records his five proud ***"I will"*** statements.
Iniquity is found in the cherub	Ezekiel 28:12–17 describes beauty, wisdom, pride, and corruption.

Story movement	Scripture
The earth lies under darkness	Genesis 1:2; compare Isaiah 45:18 and Jeremiah 4:23–26.
God begins reconstruction	Genesis 1:3 — ***"And God said, Let there be light: and there was light."***

1. Lucifer's Position, Pride, and Fall

Lucifer is a created **cherub**, not God's equal. Ezekiel describes an anointed cherub who was perfect in his ways until iniquity was found in him. Isaiah records five "I will" statements as his heart was lifted up in **pride** and he tried to be like the most High.

- Before God ever made man, He had already created the angels. The "morning stars" and "sons of God" shouted for joy when He laid the foundations of the earth (Job 38:4–7).
- Lucifer was one of the highest of these created beings, but he wanted God's throne for himself.
- His rebellion starts the conflict that runs through the whole Bible: God moves history toward His purpose, while Satan opposes God's Word, God's people, God's land, and God's promised King.

Isaiah 14:13–14 — *For thou hast said in thine heart, I will ascend into heaven, I will exalt my throne above the stars of God: I will sit also upon the mount of the congregation, in the sides of the north: I will ascend above the heights of the clouds; I will be like the most High.*

Ezekiel 28:17 — *Thine heart was lifted up because of thy beauty, thou hast corrupted thy wisdom by reason of thy brightness: I will cast thee to the ground…*

Lucifer's Fall

Stage	What Scripture shows	Passages
Created	Perfect in his ways; wise, beautiful, and appointed as an anointed cherub	Ezekiel 28:12–15
Proud	His heart is lifted up because of beauty	Ezekiel 28:17
Rebellious	He seeks a higher throne and God's place	Isaiah 14:12–14
Cast down	God announces humiliation and judgment	Isaiah 14:15; Ezekiel 28:16–19
Still opposing	He deceives, accuses, and fights until his final judgment	Genesis 3; Revelation 12:9–12; 20:10

2. God Reconstructs the Earth

Genesis 1:1 records God's original creation. By Genesis 1:2 the earth is without form, void, and covered in **darkness**. Beginning in verse 3, God speaks **light** into the darkness and restores order day by day, preparing the earth for mankind. On the sixth day He makes man in His own **image**.

- God did not create the earth ruined. Isaiah 45:18 says He "created it not in vain" (the word "vain" is the same Hebrew word translated "without form" in Genesis 1:2).
- Jeremiah 4:23–26 uses the same words, "without form, and void," to describe a land under God's judgment.
- The six days prepare the ruined earth as a home for Adam. The next lesson picks up the story in the garden of Eden.

> **Genesis 1:2–3 —** *And the earth was without form, and void; and darkness was upon the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters. And God said, Let there be light: and there was light.*

Isaiah 45:18 — *...God himself that formed the earth and made it; he hath established it, he created it not in vain, he formed it to be inhabited...*

The Days of Reconstruction

Day	God's work	Scripture
1	Light divided from darkness	Genesis 1:3–5
2	Firmament divides the waters	Genesis 1:6–8
3	Dry land, seas, grass, herbs, and fruit trees	Genesis 1:9–13
4	Sun, moon, and stars appointed	Genesis 1:14–19
5	Sea creatures and flying creatures	Genesis 1:20–23
6	Land animals; man and woman	Genesis 1:24–31; 2:7, 18–25
7	God rests from His finished work	Genesis 2:1–3

Check Your Understanding

1. What does Scripture reveal about Lucifer before his rebellion?
2. What five proud desires appear in Isaiah 14:12–14?
3. How does Satan oppose God's purpose throughout the Bible?
4. What condition does Genesis 1:2 describe?
5. List the days of reconstruction and their passages.

UNIT 1 — REBELLION, RECONSTRUCTION, AND THE FIRST WORLD

Lesson 2 — Adam and Eve: Eden, the Fall, and the Promised Seed

Lesson Overview: God places Adam and Eve in Eden with life, fellowship, work, marriage, and dominion. The serpent attacks God's Word; Adam disobeys; sin and death enter; and God promises the Seed who will defeat the serpent.

MAIN PASSAGES: Genesis 1:26–31; Genesis 2–3; Romans 5:12–21; 1 Timothy 2:13–14; Revelation 12:9

KEY VERSE | Genesis 3:15 — *And I will put enmity between thee and the woman, and between thy seed and her seed; it shall bruise thy head, and thou shalt bruise his heel.*

READ: Genesis 1:26–31; 2:7–25; 3:1–24; Romans 5:12–21; 1 Corinthians 15:21–22, 45–49; 1 Timothy 2:13–14; Revelation 12:9.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
God forms Adam	Genesis 2:7 — God forms man from dust and breathes into him the breath of life.
God forms Eve	Genesis 2:18–25 — God makes a help meet for Adam and establishes marriage.
The serpent attacks the Word	Genesis 3:1–5 — he questions, contradicts, and changes God's command.
Adam and Eve eat	Genesis 3:6–7 — shame and separation immediately follow.

Story movement	Scripture
God pronounces judgment	Genesis 3:14–19 — the serpent, woman, man, and ground are addressed.
God promises the Seed	Genesis 3:15 points forward to the serpent's defeat.

1. Life in Eden

God forms Adam from the dust of the ground and breathes into him the breath of life. Adam is made in God's image and receives dominion under God. God puts him in the garden to dress it and to **keep** it, gives him one clear command, and makes Eve as an help **meet** for him. Marriage begins as one man and one woman joined by God.

- Remember, God had just prepared the earth in six days (Lesson 1). Now He places man at the center of His restored creation.
- Eden had everything Adam needed: food, work, fellowship with God, and a wife.
- There was only one restriction, the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, so obeying God was simple.

Genesis 2:15 — *And the LORD God took the man, and put him into the garden of Eden to dress it and to keep it.*

Genesis 2:16–17 — *...Of every tree of the garden thou mayest freely eat: But of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, thou shalt not eat of it: for in the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die.*

2. The First Attack on God's Word

The serpent's first recorded attack is aimed at what God **said**. He questions, contradicts, and changes God's Word. Eve is deceived, but Adam knowingly disobeys. Through one man, sin and **death** enter the world.

- The serpent is Satan himself, the same proud rebel from Lesson 1 (Revelation 12:9).

- Satan could not take God's throne, so he attacked God's newest creation, man, by attacking God's Word.
- Eve also added to God's Word ("neither shall ye touch it"). Changing God's Word, by adding to it or taking away from it, always leads to trouble.

Genesis 3:1 — *Now the serpent was more subtil than any beast of the field which the LORD God had made. And he said unto the woman, Yea, hath God said, Ye shall not eat of every tree of the garden?*

Romans 5:12 — *Wherefore, as by one man sin entered into the world, and death by sin; and so death passed upon all men, for that all have sinned:*

The Serpent's Strategy

Attack	Words or action	What changed
Questions	***"Yea, hath God said...?"*** (Genesis 3:1)	Doubt is introduced.
Contradicts	***"Ye shall not surely die"*** (Genesis 3:4)	God's warning is denied.
Changes	Disobedience is presented as advancement (Genesis 3:5)	A false promise replaces God's truth.
Eve adds	***"neither shall ye touch it"*** (Genesis 3:3)	Words not in Genesis 2:16–17 are added.

3. Judgment and the First Promise

God seeks the guilty pair, exposes their sin, and pronounces judgment. Yet judgment is not the last word. God promises that the **Seed** of the woman will be wounded, but He will crush the serpent's head. The rest of the Bible follows this promise to Jesus Christ, who is called the last **Adam**.

- Genesis 3:15 is the first promise of a Saviour in the Bible.
- God clothed Adam and Eve with coats of skins (Genesis 3:21). An animal died to cover their shame, a first picture of sacrifice.
- From here on, the story follows the line of the promised Seed through Seth, Noah, Abraham, Israel, and David until Christ is born. Satan will keep trying to destroy that line.

Romans 5:19 — *For as by one man's disobedience many were made sinners, so by the obedience of one shall many be made righteous.*

1 Corinthians 15:45 — *And so it is written, The first man Adam was made a living soul; the last Adam was made a quickening spirit.*

Check Your Understanding

1. What responsibilities did God give Adam in Eden?
2. How did the serpent attack God's Word?
3. How does 1 Timothy 2 distinguish Eve's deception from Adam's transgression?
4. What entered the world through Adam's sin?
5. How does Genesis 3:15 direct the story toward Christ?

UNIT 1 — REBELLION, RECONSTRUCTION, AND THE FIRST WORLD

Lesson 3 — Cain, Abel, Enoch, and Noah: Sin Spreads and God Preserves

Lesson Overview: Outside Eden, sin spreads through Adam's family and fills the earth with violence. Abel worships by faith, Enoch walks with God, and Noah finds grace. God judges the world through the Flood while preserving Noah's household in the ark.

MAIN PASSAGES: Genesis 4–9; Hebrews 11:4–7; Matthew 24:37–39; 1 Peter 3:20; 2 Peter 2:5

KEY VERSE | Genesis 6:8 — *But Noah found grace in the eyes of the LORD.*

READ: Genesis 4:1–16; 5:1–32; 6:1–9:29; Hebrews 11:4–7; Matthew 24:37–39; 1 Peter 3:18–22; 2 Peter 2:5; 3:3–7.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Abel offers by faith	Genesis 4:1–5; Hebrews 11:4.
Cain murders Abel	Genesis 4:6–16 — Cain ignores God's warning that sin lies at the door.
Enoch walks with God	Genesis 5:21–24; Hebrews 11:5–6.
The earth becomes corrupt	Genesis 6:5, 11–13.
Noah builds the ark	Genesis 6:14–22; Hebrews 11:7.

Story movement	Scripture
The Flood judges the world	Genesis 7:1–24.
God gives the rainbow	Genesis 8:20–9:17.

1. Three Men in a Fallen World

Outside Eden, sin spreads to the next generation. Abel offers unto God by **faith**, but Cain refuses God's warning and kills his brother. Later, Enoch walks with **God** in a wicked generation and is taken to heaven without dying.

- Remember, God promised a Seed from the woman (Genesis 3:15). When Abel is murdered, Satan is attacking the family line of that promise.
- God gives Adam and Eve another son, Seth, and the line of promise continues through him (Genesis 4:25).
- Genesis 5 repeats "and he died" again and again. Sin's penalty had come just as God said. Enoch is the one exception.

> **Hebrews 11:4 —** *By faith Abel offered unto God a more excellent sacrifice than Cain, by which he obtained witness that he was righteous, God testifying of his gifts: and by it he being dead yet speaketh.*
>
> **Genesis 5:24 —** *And Enoch walked with God: and he was not; for God took him.*

Cain, Abel, and Enoch

Person	Choice	Result	Passages
Abel	Offers to God by faith	Receives witness that he is righteous	Genesis 4:2–5; Hebrews 11:4

Person	Choice	Result	Passages
Cain	Rejects warning and murders Abel	Is judged and becomes a fugitive	Genesis 4:5–16; 1 John 3:11–12
Enoch	Walks with God by faith	Is translated without seeing death	Genesis 5:21–24; Hebrews 11:5–6; Jude 14–15

2. Noah, the Ark, and the Flood

The earth becomes corrupt and filled with violence. Noah finds **grace** in the eyes of the LORD, believes God's warning, and builds the ark. The Flood judges the old world, while the ark preserves Noah's family, **eight** souls in all. Afterward God sets the **rainbow** in the cloud as the sign of His covenant with the earth.

- Noah comes from the line of Seth, so the line of promise continues through him (Genesis 5:28–32).
- If all mankind had been destroyed, there would be no Seed to crush the serpent. God preserved one family so His promise would stand.
- Jesus said the days before His return will be like the days of Noah (Matthew 24:37).

> **Genesis 6:5 —** *And GOD saw that the wickedness of man was great in the earth, and that every imagination of the thoughts of his heart was only evil continually.*
>
> **Genesis 9:13 —** *I do set my bow in the cloud, and it shall be for a token of a covenant between me and the earth.*

Noah's Story

Movement	What happened	Scripture
Grace	Noah finds grace and walks with God	Genesis 6:8–9

Movement	What happened	Scripture
Warning	God announces judgment and gives the ark's plan	Genesis 6:11–22
Obedience	Noah enters with his family and the animals	Genesis 7:1–10
Judgment	The Flood covers the earth	Genesis 7:11–24
Preservation	God remembers Noah; the waters recede	Genesis 8:1–19
Covenant	God gives the rainbow sign	Genesis 8:20–9:17

Check Your Understanding

1. How did Abel, Cain, and Enoch respond differently to God?
2. What does the repeated phrase “and he died” teach in Genesis 5?
3. Why did God send the Flood?
4. How did Noah demonstrate faith?
5. What did God promise in the Noahic covenant?

UNIT 1 — REBELLION, RECONSTRUCTION, AND THE FIRST WORLD

Lesson 4 — Babel and Abraham: The Nations Scatter and One Man Is Called

Lesson Overview: At Babel mankind unites in pride, builds a city and tower, and seeks to reach God on their own. God scatters the nations, then calls Abram from Ur and promises to form a nation through which all families of the earth will be blessed.

MAIN PASSAGES: Genesis 10–12; Genesis 15; Genesis 17; Genesis 22; Galatians 3:6–18

KEY VERSE | Genesis 12:2–3 — *And I will make of thee a great nation, and I will bless thee, and make thy name great…and in thee shall all families of the earth be blessed.*

READ: Genesis 10:1–32; 11:1–32; 12:1–9; 13:14–18; 15:1–21; 17:1–21; 22:1–18; Romans 4:1–5; Galatians 3:6–18.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Families become nations	Genesis 10 traces the descendants of Shem, Ham, and Japheth; the sons of Noah.
Men build Babel	Genesis 11:1–4 — they seek a city, tower, and name.
God scatters mankind	Genesis 11:5–9 — languages are confounded.
God calls Abram	Genesis 12:1–3 — land, nation, name, and worldwide blessing are promised to Abram.
Abram believes God	Genesis 15:6 — faith is counted for righteousness to Abram. This set a biblical pattern for us.

Story movement	Scripture
The covenant is confirmed	Genesis 15; 17; 22.

1. Babel: Man's Name and God's Judgment

After the Flood, God tells Noah's sons to replenish the earth. Instead, at Babel mankind stays together, builds a city and a tower that reaches toward heaven, and tries to make themselves a **name**. God confounds their **language** and scatters them across the earth.

- Remember, God told Noah's family to "replenish the earth" (Genesis 9:1). Babel was open disobedience.
- This is the same pride we saw in Lucifer. "I will ascend into heaven" (Isaiah 14:13) becomes "let us build us… a tower, whose top may reach unto heaven."
- Genesis 10 lists the nations that came from Noah's three sons. These are the "nations" the rest of the Bible talks about.

> **Genesis 11:4 —** *And they said, Go to, let us build us a city and a tower, whose top may reach unto heaven; and let us make us a name, lest we be scattered abroad upon the face of the whole earth.*
>
> **Genesis 11:9 —** *Therefore is the name of it called Babel; because the LORD did there confound the language of all the earth: and from thence did the LORD scatter them abroad upon the face of all the earth.*

2. Abraham: God's Name and God's Promise

God answers the pride of the nations by calling one man. Abram leaves **Ur** of the Chaldees at God's word. God promises him **land**, seed, and blessing, and through his seed all families of the earth will be blessed. Abraham believed God, and it was counted to him for **righteousness**.

- The nations turned from God at Babel. Now God starts a new nation from one man, and that nation will become Israel.
- The promised Seed from Genesis 3:15 will come through Abraham's family (Galatians 3:16).
- Abraham is not perfect, and his failures are recorded. But God keeps His covenant, and Abraham's faith becomes the Bible's pattern for how a person is counted righteous.

Genesis 12:1 — *Now the LORD had said unto Abram, Get thee out of thy country, and from thy kindred, and from thy father's house, unto a land that I will shew thee:*

Genesis 15:6 — *And he believed in the LORD; and he counted it to him for righteousness.*

The Abrahamic Promises

Promise	Content	Main passages
Land	A literal land is promised to Abraham's seed	Genesis 12:1, 7; 13:14–17; 15:18–21
Seed	Abraham will become a great nation and father of many nations	Genesis 12:2; 15:1–6; 17:1–8
Blessing	God will bless Abraham and bless all families through his seed	Genesis 12:2–3; 22:15–18; Galatians 3:16

KEY — Abraham was promised both a physical and a spiritual seed. God promised that his descendants would be both numerable and innumerable, describing his seed as the sand of the sea (Gen. 13:16; 22:17; 32:12) and also as the stars of heaven (Gen. 15:5; 22:17). The New Testament subsequently distinguishes Abraham's physical descendants, "the children of the flesh," from "the children of the promise" (Rom. 9:6–8). Those who possess Abraham's faith are described as his children spiritually: "they which are of faith, the same are the children of Abraham" (Gal. 3:7; cf. Rom. 4:11, 16; Gal. 3:29).

Check Your Understanding

1. What did mankind seek at Babel?
2. How did God judge Babel and why?
3. What did God command Abram to leave?
4. State the land, seed, and blessing promises.
5. How does the New Testament connect Abraham's promised Seed with Christ?

UNIT 2 — THE FAMILY THAT BECOMES ISRAEL

Lesson 5 — Isaac and Jacob: The Promise Continues and Israel Is Named

Lesson Overview: The covenant line continues through Isaac, the promised son of Abraham and Sarah, and then through Jacob. God changes Jacob's name to Israel, and Jacob's twelve sons become the tribal fathers of the nation.

MAIN PASSAGES: Genesis 17:15–21; Genesis 21–22; Genesis 25–35; Genesis 48–49; Numbers 1:5–16

KEY VERSE | Genesis 32:28 — *Thy name shall be called no more Jacob, but Israel: for as a prince hast thou power with God and with men, and hast prevailed.*

READ: Genesis 17:15–21; 21:1–12; 22:1–18; 25:19–34; 27–28; 32:22–32; 35:9–29; 48–49; 1 Chronicles 2:1–2.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Isaac is born	Genesis 21:1–7 — God fulfills His promise to Abraham and Sarah.
Isaac is offered	Genesis 22:1–18 — God provides a ram and confirms the promise.
Jacob receives the birthright and blessing	Genesis 25:29–34; 27:1–40.
God meets Jacob at Bethel	Genesis 28:10–22 — the Abrahamic promises are repeated.

Story movement	Scripture
Jacob becomes Israel	Genesis 32:22–32; 35:9–12.
Israel's twelve sons are named	Genesis 35:22–26; 49:1–28.

1. Isaac: The Promised Son

Isaac, the promised son of Abraham and **Sarah**, is born when his parents are old. His birth proves that the promise depends upon God's power and that God always keeps His word. At Moriah, God tests Abraham, Isaac is bound on the altar, and God provides a **ram** in his place.

- Remember, God promised Abraham a seed (Lesson 4). Abraham and Sarah waited about twenty-five years for that son.
- Abraham also had a son named Ishmael by Hagar, but God said the covenant would continue through Isaac (Genesis 17:19–21).
- Moriah is a picture of the cross: a father offering his son, and God providing a substitute.

> **Genesis 21:1–2 —** *And the LORD visited Sarah as he had said, and the LORD did unto Sarah as he had spoken. For Sarah conceived, and bare Abraham a son in his old age, at the set time of which God had spoken to him.*
>
> **Genesis 22:8 —** *...My son, God will provide himself a lamb for a burnt offering...*

2. Jacob Becomes Israel

Isaac's son Jacob often relies on scheming and deception, but God disciplines and preserves him. At **Bethel** God repeats the Abrahamic promises to Jacob. At Peniel Jacob wrestles with God, is broken and blessed, and God changes his name to **Israel**.

- Isaac had twin sons, Esau and Jacob. Esau despised his birthright, and God chose Jacob to carry the promise (Genesis 25:23, 34).
- Jacob deceived his father to get the blessing and had to run from Esau. That is why he is alone when God meets him at Bethel.
- The new name "Israel" becomes the name of the whole nation that comes from him.

Genesis 28:13 — *And, behold, the LORD stood above it, and said, I am the LORD God of Abraham thy father, and the God of Isaac: the land whereon thou liest, to thee will I give it, and to thy seed;*

From Abraham to Israel's Tribes

Generation	Key people	Place in the story	Passages
1	Abraham and Sarah	Receive the covenant promises	Genesis 12; 15; 17
2	Isaac and Rebekah	The promise continues through Isaac	Genesis 21–27
3	Jacob / Israel	Receives the promise and becomes father of twelve sons	Genesis 28; 32; 35
4	Twelve sons	Become the tribal fathers of Israel	Genesis 35:22–26; 49

3. The Twelve Sons

Jacob's twelve sons become the tribal fathers of the nation of Israel. Levi is set apart for priestly service. Joseph receives a double portion through his sons Ephraim and Manasseh. The royal promise that leads to David and to Jesus Christ comes through the tribe of **Judah**.

- Abram had children with more than one woman, and so did Jacob. This is not proof that God is okay with it; He clearly is not (Genesis 2:24). It shows that God will take our mistakes and still make something beautiful out of our lives.
- Watch the tribe of Judah. The sceptre (the right to rule as king) will stay with Judah until Shiloh, the Messiah, comes.
- In the next lesson, one of these sons, Joseph, is sold into Egypt, and God uses it to save the whole family.

Genesis 49:10 — *The sceptre shall not depart from Judah, nor a lawgiver from between his feet, until Shiloh come; and unto him shall the gathering of the people be.*

Jacob's Sons and Important Tribal Connections

Mother	Sons	Important connection
Leah	Reuben, Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Zebulun	Priesthood through Levi; royal line through Judah
Rachel	Joseph, Benjamin	Joseph represented by Ephraim and Manasseh
Bilhah	Dan, Naphtali	Tribal fathers in Israel
Zilpah	Gad, Asher	Tribal fathers in Israel

Check Your Understanding

1. Why was Isaac's birth important to the covenant story?
2. What did God provide at Moriah?
3. Where did God repeat the Abrahamic promises to Jacob?
4. Why did God rename Jacob Israel?
5. How do Levi, Joseph, and Judah have special tribal roles?

UNIT 2 — THE FAMILY THAT BECOMES ISRAEL

Lesson 6 — Joseph: God Sends a Preserver to Egypt

Lesson Overview: Joseph, one of the 12 sons of Jacob, is hated, sold, falsely accused, and imprisoned, but the LORD remains with him. God raises him beside Pharaoh and uses him to preserve Jacob's family, moving Israel into Egypt for the next stage of the story.

MAIN PASSAGES: Genesis 37–50; Psalm 105:16–24; Acts 7:9–16; Hebrews 11:22

KEY VERSE | Genesis 50:20 — *But as for you, ye thought evil against me; but God meant it unto good…to save much people alive.*

READ: Genesis 37; 39–50; Psalm 105:16–24; Acts 7:9–16; Hebrews 11:22.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Joseph dreams	Genesis 37:1–11 — his brothers and parents will bow before him.
Joseph is sold	Genesis 37:18–36 — he is taken into Egypt.
Joseph serves and suffers	Genesis 39–40 — the LORD is with him in Potiphar's house and prison.
Joseph interprets Pharaoh's dreams	Genesis 41 — he is raised to authority.
Joseph's brothers come for food	Genesis 42–45 — Joseph tests and reveals himself to them.

Story movement	Scripture
Jacob's family moves to Egypt	Genesis 46–47.
Joseph explains God's providence	Genesis 50:15–21.

1. From Favorite Son to Prisoner

Jacob favors Joseph and gives him a coat of many colours. Joseph's dreams of ruling over his family make his brothers hate him even more, and they sell him into **Egypt**. In Potiphar's house and in prison, Joseph refuses to sin because it would be sin against **God**.

- Remember, Jacob (Israel) had twelve sons (Lesson 5). Joseph was the son of Rachel and his father's favorite.
- The brothers first planned to kill him, but Judah suggested selling him to traders instead (Genesis 37:26–27).
- Even as a slave and a prisoner, "the LORD was with Joseph" (Genesis 39:2, 21).

Genesis 37:28 — *...they drew and lifted up Joseph out of the pit, and sold Joseph to the Ishmeelites for twenty pieces of silver: and they brought Joseph into Egypt.*

Genesis 39:9 — *...how then can I do this great wickedness, and sin against God?*

2. From Prisoner to Preserver

God gives Joseph understanding of dreams. Pharaoh sets Joseph over all the land of Egypt, and Joseph stores up food during seven years of plenty before seven years of **famine**. The famine brings his brothers to Egypt, and Jacob's whole household of **seventy** souls moves there. What his brothers meant for evil, God meant for **good**.

- Joseph's brothers bow down before him, just as his dreams had said (Genesis 42:6).

- Joseph forgives his brothers because he sees God's hand in everything that happened (Genesis 45:5–8).
- This is how Israel ends up in Egypt. It is good at first, but in the next lesson a new Pharaoh makes them slaves, just as God had told Abraham (Genesis 15:13).

Genesis 41:41 — *And Pharaoh said unto Joseph, See, I have set thee over all the land of Egypt.*

Genesis 45:7 — *And God sent me before you to preserve you a posterity in the earth, and to save your lives by a great deliverance.*

Joseph's Reversals

Low point	God's providence	Result	Passages
Rejected by brothers	Taken to Egypt	Placed in Potiphar's house	Genesis 37; 39:1–6
Falsely accused	The LORD is with him in prison	Trusted by the keeper	Genesis 39:7–23
Forgotten by the butler	Pharaoh dreams at God's appointed time	Joseph is summoned	Genesis 40–41
Family famine	Joseph has stored food	Israel's household is preserved	Genesis 42–47

Check Your Understanding

1. Why did Joseph's brothers hate him?
2. How did Joseph respond to temptation?
3. Why did Jacob's family move to Egypt?

UNIT 3 — ISRAEL IS CALLED OUT AND ESTABLISHED

Lesson 7 — Moses and Pharaoh: Passover and the Exodus

Lesson Overview: Egypt enslaves Israel, but God remembers His covenant, calls Moses, judges Egypt, shelters Israel through the Passover blood, and brings the nation through the Red Sea.

MAIN PASSAGES: Exodus 1–15; Psalm 105:23–45; 1 Corinthians 5:7; Hebrews 11:23–29

KEY VERSE | Exodus 12:13 — *And the blood shall be to you for a token upon the houses where ye are: and when I see the blood, I will pass over you…*

READ: Exodus 1–6; 7–11; 12:1–51; 13:17–15:21; Psalm 105:23–45; 1 Corinthians 5:7; Hebrews 11:23–29.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Israel is enslaved	Exodus 1:8–22.
Moses is preserved	Exodus 2:1–10; Hebrews 11:23.
God calls Moses	Exodus 3:1–4:17.
The plagues strike Egypt	Exodus 7–11; 12:12.
The Passover lamb is slain	Exodus 12:1–36.
Israel leaves Egypt	Exodus 12:37–51.

Story movement	Scripture
God opens the Red Sea	Exodus 14–15.

1. Moses Is Called

A new Pharaoh enslaves Israel and orders the Hebrew baby boys killed. God preserves baby Moses, who grows up in Pharaoh's own house and later spends forty years in Midian. Then God calls him from the burning **bush**. God has seen Israel's affliction and remembered His covenant, and He reveals His name: I AM THAT **I AM**.

- Remember, all of Jacob's sons (Israel, the 12 tribes) came to Egypt for help. They stayed there, and a few hundred years later their descendants were enslaved because Pharaoh feared they would take over.
- God had told Abraham this would happen, and that He would bring them out again (Genesis 15:13–14).
- Satan tries again to destroy the line of promise by killing the Hebrew sons, but God preserves the deliverer.

Exodus 2:24 — *And God heard their groaning, and God remembered his covenant with Abraham, with Isaac, and with Jacob.*

Exodus 3:14 — *And God said unto Moses, I AM THAT I AM…*

2. Pharaoh, the Plagues, and Passover

Pharaoh hardens his heart again and again. The plagues show the LORD's power and judge the gods of Egypt. Before the final plague, each household must kill a lamb without **blemish** and put its blood on the door posts. God promises, "when I see the **blood**, I will pass over you."

- Each plague showed that Egypt's gods were powerless before the LORD (Exodus 12:12).

- The last plague was the death of the firstborn. Only the blood of the lamb kept death out of a house.
- Israel was to keep the Passover every year so they would never forget how God redeemed them (Exodus 12:14).

Exodus 12:5 — *Your lamb shall be without blemish, a male of the first year...*

1 Corinthians 5:7 — *...For even Christ our passover is sacrificed for us:*

Passover Instructions

Element	Instruction	Meaning in the story	Scripture
Lamb	Male of the first year, without blemish	A spotless substitute is selected	Exodus 12:3–5
Blood	Placed on two side posts and upper door post	Marks the house under God's promise	Exodus 12:7, 13
Meal	Roasted lamb, unleavened bread, bitter herbs	Israel eats ready to depart	Exodus 12:8–11
Memorial	Kept as a feast in Israel	The deliverance is remembered	Exodus 12:14–28
Christ	Called our Passover	The New Testament identifies the greater sacrifice	1 Corinthians 5:7; 1 Peter 1:18–19

3. Through the Sea

Pharaoh changes his mind and chases Israel to the Red Sea. God opens the sea, Israel crosses on **dry** ground, and the waters return and destroy Egypt's army. The Exodus calls Israel out of bondage in Egypt to serve the LORD.

- Israel was trapped, with the sea in front and Pharaoh's army behind. Moses told them, “Stand still, and see the salvation of the LORD” (Exodus 14:13).
- On the other side, Moses and Israel sing a song of praise for their deliverance (Exodus 15:1).
- From here Israel travels toward Mount Sinai, where God will give the Law (next lesson).

Exodus 14:22 — *And the children of Israel went into the midst of the sea upon the dry ground: and the waters were a wall unto them on their right hand, and on their left.*

KEY — This pictures our salvation: FIRST, they are saved by the blood of a lamb. This blood rescues them from death and delivers them from bondage in the world (Egypt). THEN, they are “baptized” in the Red Sea as the next step of obedience. It was not their salvation, but the next step.

KEY VERSE | 1 Cor. 10:1-2 — *Moreover, brethren, I would not that ye should be ignorant, how that all our fathers were under the cloud, and all passed through the sea; And were all baptized unto Moses in the cloud and in the sea;*

Check Your Understanding

1. Why did God send Moses to Pharaoh?
2. What did the plagues reveal about the LORD?
3. What were the instructions for the Passover lamb and blood?
4. How does the New Testament connect Passover with Christ?
5. What did crossing the Red Sea picture?

UNIT 3 — ISRAEL IS CALLED OUT AND ESTABLISHED

Lesson 8 — Moses in the Wilderness: Sinai, the Tabernacle, and Kadesh

Lesson Overview: God brings Israel to Sinai, gives the Law, establishes the priesthood and sacrifices, and places the tabernacle at the center. Israel's unbelief at Kadesh brings forty years of wandering before Joshua leads the next generation.

MAIN PASSAGES: Exodus 19–40; Leviticus 1–17; Numbers 13–21; Deuteronomy 6–8; Hebrews 9–10

KEY VERSE | Exodus 25:8 — *And let them make me a sanctuary; that I may dwell among them.*

READ: Exodus 19–24; 25–31; 32–34; 40; Leviticus 1–7; 16–17; Numbers 13–14; 21:4–9; Deuteronomy 6–8; 31; 34; Hebrews 9–10.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Israel arrives at Sinai	Exodus 19 — God calls the nation a peculiar treasure, kingdom of priests, and holy nation.
God gives the commandments	Exodus 20–24.
God gives the tabernacle pattern	Exodus 25–31.
Israel worships the golden calf	Exodus 32–34.

Story movement	Scripture
The glory fills the tabernacle	Exodus 40:33–38.
Israel refuses the land	Numbers 13–14.
God provides the brazen serpent	Numbers 21:4–9; John 3:14–15.

1. Sinai: A Redeemed Nation Receives the Law

In the third month after leaving Egypt, Israel arrives at Mount Sinai. God redeemed Israel before He gave them the **Law**. The Law orders Israel's national life, worship, sacrifices, calendar, and justice. It also exposes **sin** and teaches that only God is perfectly holy.

- Remember, God brought Israel out of Egypt by the blood of the lamb and through the Red Sea (Lesson 7). Now He forms them into a nation.
- God calls Israel a peculiar treasure, a kingdom of priests, and an holy nation (Exodus 19:5–6).
- While Moses is on the mountain, the people make a golden calf. That shows how quickly the heart turns from God (Exodus 32).

Exodus 20:2–3 — *I am the LORD thy God, which have brought thee out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage. Thou shalt have no other gods before me.*

Romans 3:20 — *...for by the law is the knowledge of sin.*

2. The Tabernacle: God Dwells Among Israel

God gives Moses the pattern for the tabernacle, a tent where He will dwell among His people. It stands at the center of Israel's **camp**. Its court, altar, laver, holy place, and most holy place show that Israel must approach God in the way He commands. When it is finished, the glory of the LORD fills it.

- The tabernacle could be taken down and carried, because Israel was still traveling toward the promised land.
- The ark and mercy seat sat in the most holy place, where the high priest went in only once a year with blood (Leviticus 16; Hebrews 9:7).
- The tabernacle points forward to Christ, our better sacrifice and High Priest.

Exodus 40:34 — *Then a cloud covered the tent of the congregation, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle.*

Hebrews 9:12 — *Neither by the blood of goats and calves, but by his own blood he entered in once into the holy place, having obtained eternal redemption for us.*

The Tabernacle and Its Furniture

Area	Furniture	Function	Study
Court	Brazen altar	Sacrifice is offered	Exodus 27:1–8; Leviticus 1
Court	Laver	Priests wash before service	Exodus 30:17–21
Holy place	Candlestick	Light burns before the LORD	Exodus 25:31–40
Holy place	Table of shewbread	Bread stands before the LORD	Exodus 25:23–30
Holy place	Altar of incense	Incense rises before the veil	Exodus 30:1–10
Most holy place	Ark and mercy seat	God meets with the high priest	Exodus 25:10–22; Leviticus 16

3. Kadesh: Unbelief Delays the Journey

At Kadesh, twelve spies are sent to search out the promised land. Ten spies fear the giants, but Joshua and **Caleb** trust the LORD. The nation refuses to go in, and God sentences them to wander **forty** years in the wilderness because of **unbelief**.

- Remember, this is the land God promised to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob (Lessons 4–5). Israel was standing at its border!
- Every adult twenty years old and upward who refused would die in the wilderness, except Joshua and Caleb (Numbers 14:29–30).
- God still provided manna, water, and even healing through the brazen serpent (Numbers 21:8–9; John 3:14–15).
- Moses dies on Mount Nebo, and Joshua leads the new generation. That is where Lesson 9 begins (Deuteronomy 34).

Numbers 13:30 — *And Caleb stilled the people before Moses, and said, Let us go up at once, and possess it; for we are well able to overcome it.*

Hebrews 3:19 — *So we see that they could not enter in because of unbelief.*

The Kadesh Decision

Response	Spokesmen	Message	Result
Unbelief	Ten spies	The people are stronger; we cannot go up	Israel fears and rebels
Faith	Joshua and Caleb	The LORD is with us; fear them not	They are preserved to enter the land
Judgment	The LORD	The unbelieving generation will not enter	Forty years of wandering

Check Your Understanding

1. What did the Law regulate in Israel's national life?
2. How did the tabernacle teach God's holiness and presence?
3. Why did Israel refuse the land at Kadesh?

UNIT 3 — ISRAEL IS CALLED OUT AND ESTABLISHED

Lesson 9 — Joshua and Rahab: Israel Enters the Promised Land

Lesson Overview: Joshua succeeds Moses and leads Israel across Jordan. Rahab believes the LORD and is preserved at Jericho. God gives the victories, the land is divided among the tribes, and Israel renews the covenant.

MAIN PASSAGES: Joshua 1–24; Hebrews 11:30–31; James 2:25; Psalm 78:52–55

KEY VERSE | Joshua 1:9 — *Have not I commanded thee? Be strong and of a good courage…for the LORD thy God is with thee whithersoever thou goest.*

READ: Joshua 1–8; 10–12; 13–21; 23–24; Hebrews 11:30–31; James 2:25.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Joshua is commissioned	Joshua 1:1–9.
Rahab receives the spies	Joshua 2; Hebrews 11:31.
Israel crosses Jordan	Joshua 3–4.
Jericho falls	Joshua 5:13–6:27; Hebrews 11:30.
Achan's sin is judged	Joshua 7.
The land is conquered and divided	Joshua 10–21.

Story movement	Scripture
Joshua renews the covenant	Joshua 23–24.

1. Joshua Leads by God's Word

Joshua's courage is tied to obedience. He is to meditate in the book of the **law** and do what it says. God brings Israel across Jordan and commands memorial **stones** so later generations will know what He did.

- Remember, God promised to Abram and to his sons a LAND and NATION that would go on forever.
- When Israel is led out of Egypt, it is finally time to go to possess this land.
- Moses has died, and Joshua, one of the two faithful spies, now leads the new generation (Joshua 1:1–2).
- There were giants and major cities (Jericho) in that land that they had to overcome to get the promised land as God promised and commanded.

> **Joshua 1:8 —** *This book of the law shall not depart out of thy mouth; but thou shalt meditate therein day and night, that thou mayest observe to do according to all that is written therein: for then thou shalt make thy way prosperous, and then thou shalt have good success.*

> **Joshua 3:17 —** *And the priests that bare the ark of the covenant of the LORD stood firm on dry ground in the midst of Jordan, and all the Israelites passed over on dry ground, until all the people were passed clean over Jordan.*

2. Rahab Believes the LORD

Rahab has heard what the LORD did in Egypt and believes that He is God in Heaven and earth. She hides the spies and places the scarlet line in her window. Her household is preserved when Jericho falls, and she later appears in the line of David and **Jesus**.

- Joshua sends two spies to look over Jericho, the first walled city in Israel's path (Joshua 2:1).
- Rahab is a Canaanite who lives on the wall of Jericho. The whole city is afraid because they heard how God dried up the Red Sea forty years earlier (Joshua 2:9–10).
- The spies promise to spare her family if the scarlet line is in her window, much like the blood on the door at Passover.

Joshua 2:11 — *...the LORD your God, he is God in heaven above, and in earth beneath.*

Matthew 1:5 — *And Salmon begat Booz of Rachab; and Booz begat Obed of Ruth; and Obed begat Jesse;*

3. Conquest, Inheritance, and Choice

Jericho falls by God's power. Achan's hidden **sin** brings defeat at Ai until it is judged. The major campaigns break Canaanite resistance, the tribes receive inheritances, and Joshua calls Israel to **choose** whom they will serve.

- Israel marched around Jericho once a day for six days and seven times on the seventh day, and then the walls fell (Joshua 6:15–20).
- Achan kept silver, gold, and a garment that God had said to destroy. One man's hidden sin affected the whole nation (Joshua 7:1, 21).
- The land promise to Abraham is now being fulfilled as each tribe receives its portion (Joshua 21:43).

Hebrews 11:30 — *By faith the walls of Jericho fell down, after they were compassed about seven days.*

Joshua 24:15 — *...choose you this day whom ye will serve... but as for me and my house, we will serve the LORD.*

Joshua's Major Movements

Movement	Story	Scripture
Entrance	Jordan crossing and memorial stones	Joshua 3–4
Central campaign	Jericho, Achan, and Ai	Joshua 5–8
Southern campaign	Gibeon and southern kings	Joshua 9–10
Northern campaign	Northern coalition defeated	Joshua 11–12
Inheritance	Land divided among the tribes	Joshua 13–21
Renewal	Joshua's final charge and covenant renewal	Joshua 23–24

Check Your Understanding

1. How were Joshua's courage and obedience connected?
2. What did Rahab believe about the LORD?
3. Why did Jericho fall?
4. What did Achan's story teach Israel?
5. How did Joshua complete Israel's entrance into the land?

UNIT 3 — ISRAEL IS CALLED OUT AND ESTABLISHED

Lesson 10 — The Judges and Ruth: Collapse, Deliverance, and a Redeemer

Lesson Overview: After Joshua, Israel repeatedly forsakes the LORD, suffers oppression, cries for help, and receives deliverance through judges. During this unstable period, Ruth trusts Israel's God, Boaz redeems her family, and the line of David is preserved.

MAIN PASSAGES: Judges 1–21; Ruth 1–4; Hebrews 11:32–34; Matthew 1:5–6

KEY VERSE | Ruth 1:16 — *...thy people shall be my people, and thy God my God:*

READ: Judges 2:6–23; 3–8; 10–16; 17:6; 21:25; Ruth 1–4; Hebrews 11:32–34; Matthew 1:5–6.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Israel forsakes the LORD	Judges 2:6–15.
God raises judges	Judges 2:16–19.
Deborah and Barak deliver Israel	Judges 4–5.
Gideon defeats Midian	Judges 6–8.
Samson fights the Philistines	Judges 13–16.

Story movement	Scripture
Ruth follows Naomi to Bethlehem	Ruth 1.
Boaz redeems Ruth	Ruth 2–4.

1. The Cycle of the Judges

After Joshua and his generation die, Israel fails to drive out the Canaanites and their idols. Each new generation turns from the LORD, and the same cycle repeats: sin, oppression, crying out, and deliverance. God raises up judges to **deliver** Israel. The problem is summed up in the words, "every man did that which was right in his own **eyes**."

- Remember, God gave Israel the land under Joshua (Lesson 9), but they did not finish removing the idol-worshipping nations as God commanded (Judges 1:27–28; 2:2).
- A new generation grew up that did not know the LORD or the works He had done.
- Judges like Deborah, Gideon, and Samson delivered Israel for a time, but the nation kept sliding downward.

Judges 2:10 — *...there arose another generation after them, which knew not the LORD, nor yet the works which he had done for Israel.*

Judges 2:16 — *Nevertheless the LORD raised up judges, which delivered them out of the hand of those that spoiled them.*

The Judges Cycle

Step	What happens	Key passages
Sin	Israel serves other gods	Judges 2:11–13
Oppression	God gives Israel into enemy hands	Judges 2:14–15

Step	What happens	Key passages
Crying	The people groan under bondage	Judges 2:18; 3:9, 15
Deliverer	The LORD raises a judge	Judges 2:16, 18
Rest	The land rests while the judge lives	Judges 3:11, 30; 5:31
Return	The people become corrupt again	Judges 2:19

2. Ruth and Boaz

During the days of the judges, a famine sends Naomi's family to Moab, where her husband and sons die. Ruth, her Moabite daughter-in-law, chooses Naomi's people and Naomi's God. In Bethlehem she gleans in the field of **Boaz**, a near kinsman. Boaz acts as kinsman-**redeemer**, buys back the family inheritance, and marries Ruth. Their son Obed becomes the grandfather of King **David**.

- Ruth takes place "in the days when the judges ruled" (Ruth 1:1), a bright spot in a dark time.
- Ruth was a Gentile, yet God brought her into Israel and into the line of the promised Seed (Matthew 1:5).
- In the darkest period of Judges, God quietly preserves the royal line that leads to David and to Jesus Christ.

> **Ruth 2:1** — *And Naomi had a kinsman of her husband's, a mighty man of wealth, of the family of Elimelech; and his name was Boaz.*
>
> **Ruth 4:17** — *...and they called his name Obed: he is the father of Jesse, the father of David.*

Ruth's Place in the Story

Character	Action	Importance	Passages
Naomi	Returns to Bethlehem in bitterness	The family and inheritance need restoration	Ruth 1
Ruth	Trusts Israel's God and serves faithfully	A Gentile believer enters Israel and David's line	Ruth 1–2; Matthew 1:5
Boaz	Acts as kinsman-redeemer	Redeems the inheritance and takes Ruth as wife	Ruth 2–4
Obed	Son of Boaz and Ruth	Grandfather of David	Ruth 4:13–22

Check Your Understanding

1. What caused the repeated cycle in Judges?
2. Name several judges and the enemies they faced.
3. What did Ruth choose in Ruth 1:16?
4. What did Boaz do as kinsman-redeemer?
5. How does Ruth connect Judges with David and Christ?

UNIT 4 — ISRAEL'S KINGS AND PROPHETS

Lesson 11 — Samuel and Saul: From Judges to Kings

Lesson Overview: Samuel hears God's voice and leads Israel at the end of the judges. The nation demands a king like the surrounding nations. Saul begins with promise but repeatedly disobeys, and God rejects his dynasty.

MAIN PASSAGES: 1 Samuel 1–15; 1 Samuel 28–31; Acts 13:20–22

KEY VERSE | 1 Samuel 15:22 — *Behold, to obey is better than sacrifice, and to hearken than the fat of rams.*

READ: 1 Samuel 1–3; 7–10; 12–15; 28–31; Acts 13:20–22.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Hannah prays for a son	1 Samuel 1.
Samuel hears the LORD	1 Samuel 3.
Samuel judges Israel	1 Samuel 7.
Israel demands a king	1 Samuel 8.
Saul is chosen and anointed	1 Samuel 9–10.
Saul acts presumptuously	1 Samuel 13.

Story movement	Scripture
Saul spares Agag	1 Samuel 15.
Saul dies on Gilboa	1 Samuel 28–31.

1. Samuel: A Prophet Who Hears God

Hannah prays for a son and gives Samuel to the LORD. As a boy serving at the tabernacle, he hears God's call and answers, "Speak; for thy servant **heareth**." Samuel grows to be both a prophet and the last **judge** of Israel, and he leads the nation back from idolatry.

- Remember, the time of the judges was dark: "every man did that which was right in his own eyes" (Lesson 10). Even the priest Eli's sons were wicked (1 Samuel 2:12).
- "The word of the LORD was precious in those days" (1 Samuel 3:1). God was not speaking often.
- Samuel will anoint Israel's first two kings, Saul and David.

> **1 Samuel 3:10** — *And the LORD came, and stood, and called as at other times, Samuel, Samuel. Then Samuel answered, Speak; for thy servant heareth.*
>
> **1 Samuel 3:19** — *And Samuel grew, and the LORD was with him, and did let none of his words fall to the ground.*

2. Saul: A King Who Will Not Obey

Israel demands a king to judge them like all the **nations**. The request shows they are rejecting the LORD's rule. Saul looks impressive, but he will not fully obey God's Word. He offers a sacrifice he had no right to offer, and later spares King Agag and the best of the spoil. Samuel tells him that to **obey** is better than sacrifice, and God seeks a man after His own **heart**.

- Remember, God promised that kings would come from Judah (Genesis 49:10). Saul was from the tribe of Benjamin.

- God planned for Israel to have a king (Deuteronomy 17:14–15), but they wanted one like the other nations instead of waiting for God's choice.
- Because Saul would not obey, God chose David to be the next king (next lesson).

1 Samuel 8:7 — *...for they have not rejected thee, but they have rejected me, that I should not reign over them.*

1 Samuel 13:14 — *But now thy kingdom shall not continue: the LORD hath sought him a man after his own heart...*

Saul's Rise and Rejection

Stage	Event	What it reveals	Scripture
Chosen	Saul is publicly presented	Outward strength and public approval	1 Samuel 9–10
Presumptuous	Offers sacrifice instead of waiting	Will not remain under God's command	1 Samuel 13:8–14
Partly obedient	Spares Agag and the best spoil	Calls disobedience obedience	1 Samuel 15:1–23
Rejected	Kingdom will not continue in his line	God seeks a man after His own heart	1 Samuel 13:14; 15:26–29
Ruined	Consults the witch at Endor and dies	A tragic end to continued rebellion	1 Samuel 28–31

Check Your Understanding

1. How did Samuel enter the LORD's service?
2. Why was Israel's demand for a king spiritually serious?
3. What happened at Gilgal in 1 Samuel 13?
4. What did Saul do with Agag and the spoil?
5. Why did God reject Saul's dynasty?

UNIT 4 — ISRAEL'S KINGS AND PROPHETS

Lesson 12 — David: Shepherd, Warrior, King, and Covenant Man

Lesson Overview: God chooses David from Judah, tests him through Goliath and Saul, and establishes him as king in Jerusalem. David sins seriously and faces consequences, yet he repents. God promises him an enduring house, throne, and kingdom fulfilled in Jesus Christ.

MAIN PASSAGES: 1 Samuel 16–31; 2 Samuel 1–24; 1 Chronicles 10–29; Psalm 51; Psalm 89; Luke 1:30–33

KEY VERSE | 2 Samuel 7:16 — *And thine house and thy kingdom shall be established for ever before thee: thy throne shall be established for ever.*

READ: 1 Samuel 16–17; 18–24; 30–31; 2 Samuel 2; 5–7; 11–12; 15–19; 22–24; Psalm 51; 89:19–37; Luke 1:30–33.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
David is anointed	1 Samuel 16.
David defeats Goliath	1 Samuel 17.
David flees Saul	1 Samuel 18–24.
David becomes king	2 Samuel 2; 5.
God makes the Davidic covenant	2 Samuel 7.

Story movement	Scripture
David sins and repents	2 Samuel 11–12; Psalm 51.
Absalom rebels	2 Samuel 15–19.
David prepares for the temple	1 Chronicles 22–29.

1. David Is Chosen and Tested

God sends Samuel to Bethlehem to anoint one of Jesse's sons. God looks on the **heart** rather than the outward appearance, and He chooses David, the youngest, a shepherd. David faces Goliath in the name of the **LORD** and later refuses to take Saul's throne by force. Years of danger prepare the shepherd to rule the nation.

- Remember, Saul had been rejected as king (Lesson 11). David is from the tribe of Judah, the royal tribe promised in Genesis 49:10.
- David is the great-grandson of Ruth and Boaz (Lesson 10).
- Saul becomes jealous and tries to kill David, but David spares Saul's life twice because he is "the LORD's anointed" (1 Samuel 24:6; 26:9).

> **1 Samuel 16:7 —** *...for the LORD seeth not as man seeth; for man looketh on the outward appearance, but the LORD looketh on the heart.*
>
> **1 Samuel 17:45 —** *...Thou comest to me with a sword, and with a spear, and with a shield: but I come to thee in the name of the LORD of hosts, the God of the armies of Israel, whom thou hast defied.*

David's Preparation

Test	David's response	Lesson	Scripture
Anointing	Receives God's choice while still a shepherd	God sees the heart	1 Samuel 16:1–13
Goliath	Trusts the name of the LORD	Victory belongs to God	1 Samuel 17
Saul's hatred	Flees without taking revenge	Waits for God's time	1 Samuel 18–24
Ziklag	Encourages himself in the LORD	Seeks God in loss	1 Samuel 30

2. David Rules and Receives the Covenant

After Saul dies, David becomes king, unites Israel, captures **Jerusalem** as the royal city, and brings the ark there. David wants to build a house (a temple) for God, but God says no. Instead, God promises to build David a house: an enduring dynasty, throne, and **kingdom** forever.

- This is the Davidic covenant (2 Samuel 7). It adds a KING to the promises of land, seed, and blessing given to Abraham.
- David's son Solomon will build the temple (next lesson).
- The angel Gabriel tells Mary that her Son will receive "the throne of his father David." Jesus is the King this promise points to.

2 Samuel 5:7 — *Nevertheless David took the strong hold of Zion: the same is the city of David.*

Luke 1:32–33 — *...the Lord God shall give unto him the throne of his father David: And he shall reign over the house of Jacob for ever...*

3. David Sins and Repents

David commits adultery with Bathsheba and arranges the death of her husband Uriah. The prophet Nathan confronts him with the words, "Thou art the **man**." David confesses and is forgiven, but he bears painful consequences in his household.

- Even the man after God's own heart was a sinner. The Bible does not hide the failures of its heroes.
- Psalm 51 is the prayer David wrote after Nathan confronted him.
- The consequences were real: the child died, and trouble came to David's family, including Absalom's rebellion (2 Samuel 12:10–14; 15–18).

2 Samuel 12:13 — *And David said unto Nathan, I have sinned against the LORD. And Nathan said unto David, The LORD also hath put away thy sin; thou shalt not die.*

Psalm 51:10 — *Create in me a clean heart, O God; and renew a right spirit within me.*

Check Your Understanding

1. Why did God choose David?
2. What did David's years under Saul teach him?
3. What did God promise in the Davidic covenant?
4. How did Nathan confront David's sin?
5. How does Jesus fulfill the promise to David?

UNIT 4 — ISRAEL'S KINGS AND PROPHETS

Lesson 13 — Solomon, Rehoboam, and Jeroboam: Temple Glory and a Divided Kingdom

Lesson Overview: Solomon receives wisdom, builds the temple, and rules at the height of the united kingdom. His compromised heart prepares judgment. Rehoboam's harsh answer and Jeroboam's false worship divide the nation into Israel and Judah.

MAIN PASSAGES: 1 Kings 1–12; 2 Chronicles 1–12; Deuteronomy 17:14–20; Ecclesiastes 12:13–14

KEY VERSE | 1 Kings 12:20 — *...there was none that followed the house of David, but the tribe of Judah only.*

READ: 1 Kings 1–3; 5–8; 10–12; 2 Chronicles 1–12; Deuteronomy 17:14–20; Ecclesiastes 12:13–14.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Solomon asks for wisdom	1 Kings 3.
Solomon builds the temple	1 Kings 5–8.
The kingdom reaches glory	1 Kings 10.
Solomon's heart turns	1 Kings 11:1–13.

Story movement	Scripture
Rehoboam rejects wise counsel	1 Kings 12:1–15.
The kingdom divides	1 Kings 12:16–24.
Jeroboam creates false worship	1 Kings 12:25–33.

1. Solomon: Wisdom, Temple, and Compromise

David's son Solomon becomes king and asks God for an understanding heart to judge the people. He builds and dedicates the **temple** in Jerusalem, and Israel reaches great wealth and influence. Yet Solomon multiplies horses, riches, and wives against God's command in Deuteronomy 17, and his wives turn his **heart** after other gods.

- Remember, God promised David that his son would build God's house (2 Samuel 7:12–13). Solomon fulfills that promise.
- When the temple is dedicated, the glory of the LORD fills it, just as it filled the tabernacle (1 Kings 8:10–11).
- Solomon's reign is the high point of Israel's kingdom, but it does not last because his heart is divided.

> **1 Kings 3:9 —** *Give therefore thy servant an understanding heart to judge thy people, that I may discern between good and bad…*
>
> **1 Kings 11:4 —** *For it came to pass, when Solomon was old, that his wives turned away his heart after other gods: and his heart was not perfect with the LORD his God, as was the heart of David his father.*

Solomon's Reign

Stage	Strength or failure	Scripture
Wisdom	God gives wisdom to judge Israel	1 Kings 3:5–28; 4:29–34
Temple	The house of the LORD is built and dedicated	1 Kings 5–8
Glory	Israel reaches great wealth and international influence	1 Kings 10
Compromise	Horses, riches, and wives multiply	Deuteronomy 17:14–20; 1 Kings 10–11
Judgment	God announces that the kingdom will be torn	1 Kings 11:9–13, 26–40

2. Rehoboam and Jeroboam Divide the Nation

After Solomon dies, his son Rehoboam answers the people harshly, and ten tribes follow **Jeroboam**. The kingdom splits in two: the northern kingdom, called **Israel**, and the southern kingdom, called **Judah**, which keeps David's line and the temple. Jeroboam fears that worship in Jerusalem will pull the people back, so he sets up golden calves, false priests, and a substitute feast.

- God had warned Solomon that the kingdom would be torn from his son because of his idolatry, but for David's sake one tribe would remain (1 Kings 11:11–13).
- From here on, the Bible follows two kingdoms with two lines of kings. Keep the chart below handy!
- Even with the split, God keeps His promise to David. A son of David stays on the throne in Jerusalem.

> **1 Kings 12:28 —** *Whereupon the king took counsel, and made two calves of gold, and said unto them, It is too much for you to go up to Jerusalem: behold thy gods, O Israel, which brought thee up out of the land of Egypt.*

The Split Kingdom

Feature	Northern Kingdom — Israel	Southern Kingdom — Judah
First ruler	Jeroboam I	Rehoboam
Tribes	Ten northern tribes	Judah and Benjamin; faithful Levites also move south
Capital	First Shechem; later Samaria	Jerusalem
Worship	Golden calves at Bethel and Dan	Temple at Jerusalem
Ruling line	Several changing dynasties	Davidic dynasty
Final exile	Assyria takes Samaria	Babylon destroys Jerusalem
Main passages	1 Kings 12–2 Kings 17	1 Kings 12–2 Kings 25; 2 Chronicles 10–36

Check Your Understanding

1. What did Solomon ask God to give him?
2. What did the temple represent in Israel's story?
3. Which warnings in Deuteronomy 17 did Solomon violate?
4. Why did the kingdom divide after Solomon?
5. How did Jeroboam establish counterfeit worship?

UNIT 4 — ISRAEL'S KINGS AND PROPHETS

Lesson 14 — Elijah, Elisha, the Kings, and the Prophets: Warning Before Exile

Lesson Overview: Israel and Judah continue under different kings while prophets call both kingdoms back to the LORD. Elijah and Elisha confront northern apostasy. Isaiah, Jeremiah, and other prophets warn Judah. Israel falls to Assyria, and Judah later falls to Babylon.

MAIN PASSAGES: 1 Kings 16–22; 2 Kings 1–25; 2 Chronicles 13–36; Isaiah; Jeremiah; Hosea; Amos

KEY VERSE | 2 Kings 17:13 — *Yet the LORD testified against Israel, and against Judah, by all the prophets, and by all the seers, saying, Turn ye from your evil ways…*

READ: 1 Kings 16:29–22:53; 2 Kings 1–10; 13–25; 2 Chronicles 26–36; Isaiah 1; 6; 36–39; Jeremiah 1; 7; 25; Hosea 4; Amos 5.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Ahab and Jezebel establish Baal worship	1 Kings 16:29–34.
Elijah confronts Israel at Carmel	1 Kings 17–18.
Elisha continues the witness	2 Kings 2–8.

Story movement	Scripture
Israel rejects the prophets	2 Kings 17:7–23.
Assyria takes Samaria	2 Kings 17:5–6.
Hezekiah trusts the LORD	2 Kings 18–20; Isaiah 36–39.
Josiah responds to the Law	2 Kings 22–23.
Babylon destroys Jerusalem	2 Kings 24–25; 2 Chronicles 36.

1. Elijah and Elisha Confront the Northern Kingdom

King Ahab and his wife Jezebel make Baal worship official in the northern kingdom. Elijah announces a drought, is fed by God, and challenges the prophets of **Baal** at Mount Carmel, where God answers by fire. Elisha succeeds **Elijah** and continues the prophetic witness through signs, warnings, and counsel.

- Remember, the kingdom split after Solomon (Lesson 13). The northern kingdom began with Jeroboam's golden calves, and every one of its kings continued in false worship.
- A prophet was God's messenger, sent to call the people and their kings back to God's Word.
- Elijah is taken up to heaven by a whirlwind, and Elisha asks for a double portion of his spirit (2 Kings 2:9–11).

1 Kings 18:21 — *...How long halt ye between two opinions? if the LORD be God, follow him: but if Baal, then follow him...*

1 Kings 18:39 — *And when all the people saw it, they fell on their faces: and they said, The LORD, he is the God; the LORD, he is the God.*

2. The Kings and Prophets of Israel

Every northern king continues Jeroboam's false worship. Jonah, Amos, and Hosea preach during the later years of the northern kingdom. The nation refuses warning after warning, and **Assyria** captures the capital, Samaria, and carries Israel away.

- The northern kingdom lasted about 200 years and never had a godly king.
- God sent prophet after prophet before He judged them. He is patient, but His warnings are real.
- 2 Kings 17 gives God's own explanation of why Israel fell.

2 Kings 17:6 — *In the ninth year of Hoshea the king of Assyria took Samaria, and carried Israel away into Assyria…*

2 Kings 17:14 — *Notwithstanding they would not hear, but hardened their necks, like to the neck of their fathers, that did not believe in the LORD their God.*

Northern Kingdom — Selected Kings and Prophets

Period	Selected kings	Prophets and message	Outcome / study
First dynasty	Jeroboam I, Nadab	A man of God condemns the altar	Counterfeit worship begins (1 Kings 12–14)
Baasha to Omri	Baasha, Elah, Zimri, Omri	Jehu son of Hanani warns Baasha	Dynasties change through violence (1 Kings 15–16)
House of Omri	Ahab, Ahaziah, Joram	Elijah and Elisha confront Baal	Drought, Carmel, signs, judgment (1 Kings 17–2 Kings 9)

Period	Selected kings	Prophets and message	Outcome / study
House of Jehu	Jehu, Jehoahaz, Joash, Jeroboam II	Jonah, Amos, Hosea	Temporary strength; deep corruption (2 Kings 10–14)
Final years	Zechariah, Shallum, Menahem, Pekahiah, Pekah, Hoshea	Warnings continue, but Israel will not hear	Samaria falls to Assyria (2 Kings 15–17)

3. Judah's Reforms and Final Fall

Judah keeps David's line but often follows idolatry too. When Assyria threatens Jerusalem, Hezekiah takes the enemy's letter to the LORD in **prayer**, and God destroys the Assyrian army. Josiah turns the nation back when the lost book of the Law is found. Isaiah, Micah, Jeremiah, Habakkuk, and Zephaniah warn Judah. At last **Babylon** destroys Jerusalem and the temple and carries the people captive.

- Judah lasted over 130 years longer than Israel, helped by godly kings like Hezekiah and Josiah.
- Jeremiah warned that the captivity would last seventy years (Jeremiah 25:11).
- Even in judgment, God keeps His promises. He preserves a remnant and David's royal line.

> **2 Kings 19:19 —** *Now therefore, O LORD our God, I beseech thee, save thou us out of his hand, that all the kingdoms of the earth may know that thou art the LORD God, even thou only.*

> **2 Chronicles 36:16 —** *But they mocked the messengers of God, and despised his words, and misused his prophets, until the wrath of the LORD arose against his people, till there was no remedy.*

Southern Kingdom — Selected Kings and Prophets

Period	Selected rulers	Prophets and message	Outcome / study
Early kingdom	Rehoboam, Abijah, Asa, Jehoshaphat	Shemaiah, Azariah, Hanani, Jehu	Compromise and reform (2 Chronicles 10–20)
Athaliah crisis	Jehoram, Ahaziah, Athaliah, Joash	Elijah's letter; Jehoiada and Zechariah	David's line preserved (2 Chronicles 21–24)
Assyrian era	Amaziah, Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, Hezekiah	Isaiah, Micah, Hosea	Jerusalem delivered from Assyria (2 Kings 18–20)
Final reform	Manasseh, Amon, Josiah	Nahum, Zephaniah, Jeremiah	Josiah responds to the Law (2 Kings 21–23)
Final kings	Jehoahaz, Jehoiakim, Jehoiachin, Zedekiah	Jeremiah, Habakkuk, Ezekiel	Jerusalem falls to Babylon (2 Kings 24–25)

Check Your Understanding

1. What did Elijah prove at Mount Carmel?
2. How did Elisha continue Elijah's ministry?
3. Why did Assyria conquer the northern kingdom?
4. What did Hezekiah and Josiah do differently from many kings?
5. Why did Babylon finally destroy Jerusalem?

UNIT 5 — EXILE, PRESERVATION, AND RETURN

Lesson 15 — Daniel, Esther, Ezra, and Nehemiah: God Preserves His People

Lesson Overview: During Gentile rule, Daniel shows that the most High governs kingdoms, Esther's story displays providential preservation, and the return leaders rebuild the temple, teach the Law, and restore Jerusalem's walls while Israel awaits the promised King.

MAIN PASSAGES: Daniel 1–9; Esther 1–10; Ezra 1–10; Nehemiah 1–13; Haggai; Zechariah; Malachi

KEY VERSE | Daniel 2:21 — *And he changeth the times and the seasons: he removeth kings, and setteth up kings...*

READ: Daniel 1–7; 9; Esther 3–9; Ezra 1–7; Nehemiah 1–8; Haggai 1–2; Zechariah 9; 12–14; Malachi 3–4.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
Daniel purposes faithfulness	Daniel 1.
God reveals the course of kingdoms	Daniel 2; 7.
The three Hebrews refuse the image	Daniel 3.

Story movement	Scripture
Daniel survives the lions' den	Daniel 6.
Esther intercedes for her people	Esther 3–9.
Zerubbabel rebuilds the temple	Ezra 1–6; Haggai; Zechariah.
Ezra teaches the Law	Ezra 7–10.
Nehemiah rebuilds the wall	Nehemiah 1–8.

1. Daniel and His Friends in Gentile Kingdoms

Daniel and his friends are taken to Babylon as young men. Daniel purposes in his **heart** not to defile himself with the king's food. God gives Daniel understanding of dreams and visions. The image in Daniel 2 and the beasts in Daniel 7 trace the Gentile empires until the kingdom is given to the Son of man. God preserves His servants in the fiery furnace and the lions' den, proving that the most High rules in the kingdom of **men**.

- Remember, Judah was carried captive to Babylon because they would not listen to the prophets (Lesson 14).
- Daniel was probably a teenager when he was taken. He stayed faithful far from home, family, and temple.
- For the first time, God's people are living under Gentile kings. Daniel shows that God is still in control of every kingdom.

Daniel 1:8 — *But Daniel purposed in his heart that he would not defile himself with the portion of the king's meat, nor with the wine which he drank…*

Daniel 4:17 — *...to the intent that the living may know that the most High ruleth in the kingdom of men, and giveth it to whomsoever he will...*

Daniel's Kingdom Visions

Empire	Daniel 2 image	Daniel 7 beast	Historical kingdom
1	Head of gold	Lion	Babylon
2	Breast and arms of silver	Bear	Medo-Persia
3	Belly and thighs of brass	Leopard	Greece
4	Legs of iron; feet of iron and clay	Dreadful beast with ten horns	Rome and its final form
Final	Stone becomes a great mountain	Son of man receives the kingdom	Christ's everlasting kingdom

2. Esther and God's Providential Preservation

Persia conquers Babylon, and many Jews still live scattered across the empire. Haman plots to destroy them all. Mordecai tells Queen Esther she may have come to the kingdom "for such a **time** as this," and she goes to the king at the risk of her life. The plot is reversed, Haman is hanged on his own gallows, and the Jewish people are preserved.

- God's name is never mentioned in the book of Esther, yet His hand is seen all through it.
- If Haman's plan had worked, the line of the promised Seed would have been wiped out. This is another attack on God's promise.
- The Jews still celebrate this deliverance at the feast of Purim (Esther 9:26–28).

Esther 4:14 — *...who knoweth whether thou art come to the kingdom for such a time as this?*

Esther 4:16 — *...and so will I go in unto the king, which is not according to the law: and if I perish, I perish.*

3. The Return Leaders

After seventy years, Cyrus king of Persia allows the Jews to return home. Zerubbabel and Jeshua rebuild the **temple**. Ezra teaches the Law. Nehemiah rebuilds Jerusalem's **wall** and leads the people to renew the covenant. The restored nation is still under Gentile rule and still waits for the Messiah.

- Isaiah named Cyrus long before he was born (Isaiah 44:28; 45:1).
- Jeremiah's seventy years were fulfilled exactly as God said (Jeremiah 29:10; Ezra 1:1).
- Malachi is the last Old Testament prophet. After him, God is silent for about 400 years until John the Baptist (next lesson).

Ezra 1:1 — *Now in the first year of Cyrus king of Persia, that the word of the LORD by the mouth of Jeremiah might be fulfilled, the LORD stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of Persia...*

Nehemiah 6:15 — *So the wall was finished in the twenty and fifth day of the month Elul, in fifty and two days.*

The Main Returns to Jerusalem

Leader	Persian ruler	Main work	Bible record
Zerubbabel and Jeshua	Cyrus	Return, altar, and rebuilt temple	Ezra 1–6; Haggai; Zechariah
Ezra	Artaxerxes	Teach the Law and correct disorder	Ezra 7–10

Leader	Persian ruler	Main work	Bible record
Nehemiah	Artaxerxes	Rebuild the wall and renew covenant order	Nehemiah 1–13

Check Your Understanding

1. What did Daniel decide before facing Babylon's tests?
2. How do Daniel 2 and 7 describe Gentile kingdoms?
3. How did Esther help preserve the Jewish people?
4. What work belongs to Zerubbabel, Ezra, and Nehemiah?
5. What promises still remained unfulfilled after the return?

UNIT 6 — JESUS CHRIST, THE PROMISED KING

Lesson 16 — John the Baptist, Mary, Joseph, and Jesus: The King Comes to Israel

Lesson Overview: After centuries of prophetic expectation, John prepares the way, Jesus is born of a virgin in Bethlehem, and the eternal Word becomes flesh. His teaching, signs, and call of the disciples reveal Him as Israel's Messiah, Son of God, and promised King.

MAIN PASSAGES: Matthew 1–17; Mark 1–9; Luke 1–9; John 1–12; Isaiah 7:14; Micah 5:2

KEY VERSE | Luke 2:11 — *For unto you is born this day in the city of David a Saviour, which is Christ the Lord.*

READ: Matthew 1–4; 8–9; 13; 16–17; Mark 1–9; Luke 1–2; 4–9; John 1–12; Isaiah 7:14; 9:6–7; Micah 5:2.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
John's birth is announced	Luke 1:5–25, 57–80.
Jesus' birth is announced	Luke 1:26–38; Matthew 1:18–25.
Jesus is born in Bethlehem	Luke 2:1–20; Matthew 2:1–12.
John prepares Israel	Matthew 3:1–12; John 1:19–36.

Story movement	Scripture
Jesus is baptized and tempted	Matthew 3:13–4:11.
Jesus calls the disciples	Mark 1:14–20; 3:13–19.
Jesus teaches and performs signs	Matthew 5–13; John 2–11.
Peter confesses the Christ	Matthew 16:13–21.

1. The Forerunner and the Birth of Christ

After about 400 years of silence, God sends the angel Gabriel to announce two births. John the Baptist will prepare the way of the **Lord**, just as Isaiah and Malachi foretold. Jesus is conceived by the Holy Ghost, born of the virgin Mary in the city of **Bethlehem**, and legally placed in David's house through Joseph.

- Remember, God promised the Seed of the woman (Genesis 3:15), the Seed of Abraham (Genesis 12:3), and a Son of David who would reign forever (2 Samuel 7). All of these promises meet in Jesus.
- Matthew 1 traces Jesus' legal right to David's throne through Joseph, His legal father.
- Wise men from the east come to worship Him as the one “born King of the Jews” (Matthew 2:2).

> **Isaiah 7:14 —** *Therefore the Lord himself shall give you a sign; Behold, a virgin shall conceive, and bear a son, and shall call his name Immanuel.*
>
> **Micah 5:2 —** *But thou, Bethlehem Ephratah, though thou be little among the thousands of Judah, yet out of thee shall he come forth unto me that is to be ruler in Israel…*

Prophecy and the Birth Narratives

Promise	Old Testament	Gospel fulfillment
Forerunner	Isaiah 40:3; Malachi 3:1	Matthew 3:1–3; Mark 1:1–4
Virgin-born Immanuel	Isaiah 7:14	Matthew 1:18–25
Born in Bethlehem	Micah 5:2	Matthew 2:1–6; Luke 2:1–7
Son of David	2 Samuel 7:12–16; Isaiah 9:6–7	Matthew 1:1; Luke 1:30–33
Called out of Egypt	Hosea 11:1	Matthew 2:13–15

2. The King and the Kingdom

John and Jesus both preach that the kingdom of **heaven** is at hand. This message concerns Israel's promised King and Heaven's visible rule on earth. Jesus also teaches the spiritual Kingdom of God, which Romans 14:17 describes as righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Ghost.

- Remember, the prophets promised a real King on David's throne ruling over Israel (Lesson 12). John and Jesus announced that this King had arrived.
- The kingdom was “at hand” because the King Himself was present.
- Before His ministry began, Jesus was baptized by John and then tempted by Satan in the wilderness. He won where Adam failed (Matthew 4:1–11).

> **Matthew 3:1–2 —** *In those days came John the Baptist, preaching in the wilderness of Judaea, And saying, Repent ye: for the kingdom of heaven is at hand.*
>
> **Romans 14:17 —** *For the kingdom of God is not meat and drink; but righteousness, and peace, and joy in the Holy Ghost.*

Two Kingdom Expressions

Expression	Main emphasis	Key passages
Kingdom of Heaven	Heaven's visible rule on earth through Israel's promised King	Matthew 3:1–2; 4:17; 5–7; 13; Luke 1:30–33
Kingdom of God	God's spiritual rule; righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Ghost	Luke 17:20–21; John 3:3–5; Romans 14:17

3. Jesus and His Disciples

Jesus chooses twelve men whom He names **apostles**. He teaches with authority and performs signs: He heals sickness, commands nature, casts out devils, feeds multitudes, forgives sins, and raises the dead. When Peter confesses Him as the Christ, the Son of the living **God**, Jesus begins to teach the disciples that He must suffer, die, and rise again.

- The miracles were proof of who Jesus is. John wrote them down "that ye might believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God" (John 20:31).
- As the religious leaders reject Him, Jesus speaks more and more about the cross (Matthew 16:21).
- These twelve will later carry the message to the world (next lesson).

> **Luke 6:13** — *And when it was day, he called unto him his disciples: and of them he chose twelve, whom also he named apostles;*
>
> **Matthew 16:16** — *And Simon Peter answered and said, Thou art the Christ, the Son of the living God.*

The Twelve Apostles

Group	Names	Key passages
First four	Simon Peter, Andrew, James, John	Matthew 10:2; Mark 1:16–20

Group	Names	Key passages
Next four	Philip, Bartholomew, Thomas, Matthew	Matthew 10:3; John 1:43–51; 20:24–29
Final four	James son of Alphaeus, Lebbaeus / Judas, Simon the Canaanite, Judas Iscariot	Matthew 10:3–4; Luke 6:15–16

Check Your Understanding

1. How did John the Baptist prepare Israel?
2. How do the birth narratives connect Jesus with David and Bethlehem?
3. What is the main distinction between the Kingdom of Heaven and the Kingdom of God?
4. What did Jesus' miracles reveal about Him?
5. Why did Jesus begin teaching the disciples about the cross after Peter's confession?

UNIT 6 — JESUS CHRIST, THE PROMISED KING

Lesson 17 — Jesus Christ and the Apostles: Rejection, Cross, Resurrection, and Commission

Lesson Overview: Israel's leaders reject their King, but Christ willingly fulfills God's redemptive purpose. He dies for sins, is buried, rises bodily on the third day, appears to witnesses, commissions the apostles, and ascends with the promise of His return.

MAIN PASSAGES: Psalm 22; Isaiah 52:13–53:12; Matthew 21–28; Luke 22–24; John 18–21; Acts 1:1–11; 1 Corinthians 15:1–28

KEY VERSE | 1 Corinthians 15:3–4 — *Christ died for our sins according to the scriptures; And...he was buried, and...he rose again the third day according to the scriptures:*

READ: Psalm 22; Isaiah 52:13–53:12; Zechariah 9:9; Matthew 21–28; Luke 22–24; John 18–21; Acts 1:1–11; 1 Corinthians 15:1–28.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
The King enters Jerusalem	Matthew 21:1–11; Zechariah 9:9.
Judas betrays Jesus	Matthew 26:14–16, 47–56.
Jesus is tried and condemned	Matthew 26:57–27:26; John 18–19.
Jesus is crucified	Matthew 27; John 19; Psalm 22; Isaiah 53.

Story movement	Scripture
Jesus is buried	Matthew 27:57–66.
Jesus rises bodily	Matthew 28; Luke 24; John 20–21.
Jesus commissions the apostles	Matthew 28:18–20; Luke 24:46–49; Acts 1:8.
Jesus ascends	Acts 1:9–11.

1. The King Is Rejected

Jesus rides into Jerusalem on a donkey as Zechariah's promised **King**. The religious leaders plot His death, Judas betrays Him for thirty pieces of silver, and Pilate says, "I find no **fault** in him," yet gives in to the crowd. Christ willingly lays down His life.

- Remember, Satan has attacked the promised Seed since Genesis 3:15. Now he enters Judas to betray Jesus (Luke 22:3). But the cross will be Satan's defeat, not Christ's.
- The rejection involves specific leaders, Judas, Roman authority, and a pressured crowd. The Gospel must never be twisted into hatred of Jewish people.
- Jesus was not a victim: "No man taketh it from me, but I lay it down of myself" (John 10:18).

> **Zechariah 9:9 —** *...behold, thy King cometh unto thee: he is just, and having salvation; lowly, and riding upon an ass, and upon a colt the foal of an ass.*
>
> **John 19:4 —** *...Behold, I bring him forth to you, that ye may know that I find no fault in him.*

From Jerusalem's Gate to the Cross

Event	People involved	Scripture
Triumphal entry	Jesus, disciples, crowds	Matthew 21:1–11

Event	People involved	Scripture
Final teaching	Jesus, disciples, religious leaders	Matthew 21–25; John 12–17
Last Supper	Jesus and the Twelve	Luke 22:14–20; John 13–17
Arrest	Judas, officers, disciples	Matthew 26:47–56; John 18:1–12
Trials	Jewish council, Pilate, Herod	Matthew 26:57–27:26; Luke 23; John 18–19
Crucifixion	Jesus between two thieves	Matthew 27:27–56; John 19:16–37

2. Christ Died, Was Buried, and Rose Again

Christ dies for our sins according to the **scriptures**. Joseph of Arimathaea places His body in a known tomb. On the **third** day the tomb is empty, and Jesus appears bodily to many named witnesses. The Gospel declared in this age is Christ's death for our sins, burial, and resurrection, and salvation is found in Him alone (1 Corinthians 15:1–4; Acts 4:12; Romans 1:16).

- The cross was foretold centuries earlier in Psalm 22 and Isaiah 53.
- Like the Passover lamb (Lesson 7), Jesus was without blemish, and His blood saves all who trust Him (1 Peter 1:18–19).
- The serpent bruised His heel at the cross, but by rising again Christ crushed the serpent's head (Genesis 3:15; Hebrews 2:14).

> **Isaiah 53:5 —** *But he was wounded for our transgressions, he was bruised for our iniquities: the chastisement of our peace was upon him; and with his stripes we are healed.*
>
> **Matthew 28:6 —** *He is not here: for he is risen, as he said. Come, see the place where the Lord lay.*

Resurrection Witnesses

Witness	Passage
Mary Magdalene and other women	Matthew 28:1–10; John 20:1–18
Two disciples on the Emmaus road	Luke 24:13–35
The gathered disciples	Luke 24:36–49; John 20:19–29
More than five hundred brethren	1 Corinthians 15:6
James, the apostles, and Paul	1 Corinthians 15:7–8

3. The Apostles Are Sent

The risen Christ commands His followers to teach all nations and preach the Gospel to every **creature**, as witnesses in the power of the Holy Ghost. Forty days after His resurrection He ascends to heaven, and the angels promise He will return in like **manner**.

- Jesus told them to wait in Jerusalem until the Holy Ghost came (Acts 1:4–5). That happens at Pentecost in the next lesson.
- The disciples asked if He would now restore the kingdom to Israel. Jesus did not say "never"; He said the timing belongs to the Father (Acts 1:6–7).
- The story now moves from the Gospels into the book of Acts.

> **Mark 16:15 —** *And he said unto them, Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature.*
>
> **Acts 1:11 —** *...this same Jesus, which is taken up from you into heaven, shall so come in like manner as ye have seen him go into heaven.*

Check Your Understanding

1. How did the triumphal entry identify Jesus?
2. Who was involved in Christ's rejection and condemnation?
3. What did Christ accomplish at the cross?
4. What evidence supports the bodily resurrection?
5. What did Jesus command the apostles to do?

UNIT 7 — THE CHURCH AND THE COMPLETION OF GOD'S PLAN

Lesson 18 — Peter, Stephen, Philip, and Paul: The Gospel Goes to the Nations

Lesson Overview: The Holy Ghost comes at Pentecost, Peter proclaims the risen Christ, persecution scatters witnesses, Philip preaches in Samaria and to the Ethiopian, and Paul carries the Gospel through the Roman world while churches are established and taught.

MAIN PASSAGES: Acts 1–28; Romans 1:16–17; 1 Corinthians 15:1–4; Ephesians 2–3; Romans 9–11

KEY VERSE | Acts 1:8 — *But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me...unto the uttermost part of the earth.*

READ: Acts 1–2; 4; 6–11; 13–21; 22–28; Romans 1:14–17; 3:21–28; 9–11; 1 Corinthians 12; Ephesians 2–3.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
The Holy Ghost comes	Acts 2.
Peter preaches Christ	Acts 2–5.
Stephen is martyred	Acts 6–7.
Philip preaches in Samaria and to the Ethiopian	Acts 8.

Story movement	Scripture
Saul meets the risen Christ	Acts 9.
Peter enters Cornelius's house	Acts 10–11.
Antioch sends Barnabas and Saul	Acts 13.
Paul's witness reaches Rome	Acts 13–28.

1. Peter and the Jerusalem Witness

About ten days after Jesus ascends, the Holy Ghost comes on the day of **Pentecost**. Peter preaches the crucified and risen Christ, and about three thousand who receive the word are baptized and added to the church. Acts 1–7 centers on the witness to Israel in Jerusalem and ends with Stephen's rejection and death.

- Remember, Jesus told the apostles to wait in Jerusalem for the Holy Ghost (Lesson 17). Pentecost is the fulfillment.
- Peter, who had denied Jesus three times, now boldly preaches in the same city.
- Stephen is stoned for his witness, and a young man named Saul watches and approves (Acts 7:58; 8:1).

> **Acts 2:41** — *Then they that gladly received his word were baptized: and the same day there were added unto them about three thousand souls.*
>
> **Acts 2:42** — *And they continued stedfastly in the apostles' doctrine and fellowship, and in breaking of bread, and in prayers.*

2. Philip, Peter, and the Gentile Door

After Stephen's death, persecution scatters the believers into Judaea and Samaria, and they preach the word wherever they go. Philip preaches Christ from Isaiah 53 to the Ethiopian eunuch. Peter preaches in the house of **Cornelius**, a Roman centurion, and Gentiles receive the Word of God.

- Persecution was meant to stop the Gospel, but it spread it instead, following the pattern of Acts 1:8: Jerusalem, Judaea, Samaria, and the uttermost part of the earth.
- Cornelius was a Gentile. God showed Peter in a vision that the Gospel was for the nations too (Acts 10:28, 34–35).
- Remember, God promised Abraham that all families of the earth would be blessed through his seed (Lesson 4). Now it is happening.

> **Acts 8:35 —** *Then Philip opened his mouth, and began at the same scripture, and preached unto him Jesus.*
>
> **Acts 10:44 —** *While Peter yet spake these words, the Holy Ghost fell on all them which heard the word.*

3. Paul and the Missionary Churches

Saul, who persecuted the church, meets the risen Jesus on the road to Damascus and becomes Paul, the apostle to the Gentiles. The church at **Antioch** sends out Barnabas and Saul. Paul plants churches, defends the Gospel, writes epistles, and witnesses before rulers until Acts ends with him preaching in **Rome**.

- Paul wrote thirteen of the New Testament letters (Romans through Philemon), many of them to churches he started.
- Paul's usual pattern was to preach “to the Jew first, and also to the Greek” (Romans 1:16).
- Use the charts below to trace his journeys.

Acts 9:15 — *...for he is a chosen vessel unto me, to bear my name before the Gentiles, and kings, and the children of Israel:*

Acts 13:2 — *As they ministered to the Lord, and fasted, the Holy Ghost said, Separate me Barnabas and Saul for the work whereunto I have called them.*

The Three Main Movements of Acts

Chapters	Main movement	Key people and places
Acts 1–7	Witness to Israel centered in Jerusalem	Peter, John, Stephen; Jerusalem
Acts 8–20	Witness spreads outward; Gentiles receive the Word; churches are established	Philip, Peter, Paul, Barnabas; Samaria, Caesarea, Antioch, Asia, Macedonia, Achaia
Acts 21–28	Paul is arrested, appeals to Caesar, and witnesses toward Rome	Paul; Jerusalem, Caesarea, Malta, Rome

Paul's Missionary Movement

Journey / stage	Main regions	Acts
First journey	Cyprus and southern Galatia	Acts 13–14
Jerusalem council	Jerusalem	Acts 15:1–35
Second journey	Macedonia and Achaia	Acts 15:36–18:22
Third journey	Ephesus, Macedonia, and Greece	Acts 18:23–21:17
To Rome	Arrest, hearings, voyage, and Roman witness	Acts 21:18–28:31

4. Israel and the Church Remain Distinct

Believing Jews and Gentiles serve Christ together in this age, but the Church does not replace **Israel** or cancel Israel's land, throne, and national-restoration promises. Romans 11 says Israel's present blindness is partial and temporary and that God has not cast away His people.

- Remember, God made unconditional promises to Abraham (land, seed, blessing) and to David (throne, kingdom). God does not break His promises.
- In this age God is visiting the Gentiles "to take out of them a people for his name" (Acts 15:14).
- "Blindness in part is happened to Israel, until the fulness of the Gentiles be come in" (Romans 11:25). After that, Israel will be restored, which is where Revelation picks up (next lesson).

Romans 11:1 — *I say then, Hath God cast away his people? God forbid...*

Romans 11:26 — *And so all Israel shall be saved: as it is written, There shall come out of Sion the Deliverer, and shall turn away ungodliness from Jacob:*

Israel and the Church in the Story

Question	Israel	Church
Beginning	Abraham, Isaac, Jacob; called out of Egypt as a nation	Promised by Christ; formed after the Holy Ghost came at Pentecost
Identity	The nation descended from Jacob / Israel	Believing Jews and Gentiles serving Christ; expressed through local churches
Primary calling	Literal nation connected with promised land and throne	Heavenly calling with a present Gospel mission among all nations

Question	Israel	Church
Present	Partly blinded and set aside nationally, but not cast away	Witnessing, teaching, and serving while waiting for Christ
Future	National turning, regathering, land, and Davidic kingdom	Gathered to Christ before the Tribulation; returns and reigns with Him
Key passages	Genesis 12; 15; 17; 2 Samuel 7; Ezekiel 36–37; Romans 11	Matthew 16:18; Acts 2; Ephesians 2–3; 1 Thessalonians 4

Check Your Understanding

1. What did Peter preach at Pentecost?
2. How did Stephen's death change the movement of Acts?
3. How did Philip and Peter help open the Gentile mission?
4. Trace Paul's witness from Antioch to Rome.
5. How does Romans 11 preserve Israel's future?

UNIT 7 — THE CHURCH AND THE COMPLETION OF GOD'S PLAN

Lesson 19 — John's Revelation: Christ Returns and Makes All Things New

Lesson Overview: John sees the risen Christ, Christ's messages to the churches, the judgments of the Tribulation, the visible return of the King, the thousand-year kingdom, Satan's final defeat, the Great White Throne, and eternity in the new creation.

MAIN PASSAGES: John 14:1–3; 1 Corinthians 15:51–58; 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18; Daniel 9:24–27; Revelation 1–22

KEY VERSE | Revelation 21:3 — *Behold, the tabernacle of God is with men, and he will dwell with them, and they shall be his people…*

READ: John 14:1–3; 1 Corinthians 3:11–15; 15:51–58; 1 Thessalonians 4:13–5:11; Daniel 9:24–27; Revelation 1–3; 6–22; 2 Peter 3:10–13.

The Story in Scripture

Story movement	Scripture
John sees the risen Christ	Revelation 1.
Christ addresses seven churches	Revelation 2–3.
Christ gathers His Church	John 14:1–3; 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18.
Tribulation judgments unfold	Daniel 9:24–27; Revelation 6–18.

Story movement	Scripture
Christ returns as King	Revelation 19:11–21.
Christ reigns one thousand years	Revelation 20:1–6.
Satan is defeated and the dead are judged	Revelation 20:7–15.
God makes all things new	Revelation 21–22.

1. Christ and the Churches

The apostle John, exiled on the isle of **Patmos**, sees Jesus Christ glorified and hears His messages to seven literal churches. Their order also gives a broad spiritual picture from early zeal through persecution, compromise, reform, missionary opportunity, and final decline. The last church, Laodicea, is described as **lukewarm**.

- Remember, Jesus ascended and promised to return (Lesson 17). Revelation shows how the story ends.
- John was the last living apostle, the same John who wrote the Gospel of John and 1–3 John.
- Revelation 1:19 gives the outline of the book: what John had seen, "the things which are" (the churches), and "the things which shall be hereafter."

Revelation 1:9 — *I John, who also am your brother, and companion in tribulation... was in the isle that is called Patmos, for the word of God, and for the testimony of Jesus Christ.*

Revelation 3:16 — *So then because thou art lukewarm, and neither cold nor hot, I will spue thee out of my mouth.*

The Seven Churches of Revelation 2–3

Church	Christ's main message	Spiritual picture
Ephesus	Sound labor, but first love left	Early strength with declining love
Smyrna	Faithful through suffering	Persecuted church
Pergamos	Faithfulness mixed with false doctrine	Worldly alliance and compromise
Thyatira	Service mixed with deep corruption	Growing religious corruption
Sardis	A name to live, but spiritually dead	Formal profession needing revival
Philadelphia	An open door and faithful Word	Missionary opportunity and faithfulness
Laodicea	Lukewarm, self-satisfied, and poor	Final apostasy and self-sufficiency

2. The Rapture, Judgment Seat, and Tribulation

Christ will descend from heaven, the dead in Christ will rise, and living believers will be caught up to meet Him in the **air**. This comes before the Tribulation and is different from Christ's public return. Believers' service is evaluated at the judgment seat of Christ. Daniel's seventieth week concerns Daniel's people and holy city. During the Tribulation the Antichrist rises, judgment falls, and Israel is brought through trouble toward national repentance.

- Remember, Daniel was shown God's plan for Israel in “seventy weeks” (Daniel 9:24–27). Sixty-nine were completed up to the Messiah; the last “week” of seven years is still future. That is the Tribulation.

- The Church is promised deliverance “from the wrath to come” (1 Thessalonians 1:10).
- The judgment seat of Christ is not about salvation. It is about rewards for believers' service (1 Corinthians 3:11–15).

> **1 Thessalonians 4:16–17 —** *For the Lord himself shall descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel, and with the trump of God: and the dead in Christ shall rise first: Then we which are alive and remain shall be caught up together with them in the clouds, to meet the Lord in the air: and so shall we ever be with the Lord.*

The Rapture and Second Coming Distinguished

Question	Rapture	Second Coming
Christ's movement	Believers meet Christ in the air	Christ returns openly to earth
People emphasized	Dead in Christ and living believers	Israel and the nations; saints return with Christ
Purpose	Gather the Church to Christ	Judge enemies, deliver Israel, establish the kingdom
Timing	Before the Tribulation	After the Tribulation
Passages	John 14:1–3; 1 Corinthians 15:51–58; 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18	Zechariah 12–14; Matthew 24:29–31; Revelation 19:11–21

3. The King Returns and Reigns

Jesus Christ returns visibly as King of kings, defeats His enemies, delivers Israel's believing remnant, and sets up the promised Davidic kingdom. Satan is bound while Christ reigns on earth for one thousand **years**. After the thousand years Satan leads a final rebellion and is cast into the lake of fire. Then the unsaved dead are judged at the Great White **Throne**.

- Remember, God promised David a King and a kingdom that would last forever (Lesson 12). This is when that promise is seen on earth.
- Remember, God promised Abraham the land (Lesson 4). In the kingdom, Israel will finally possess it in peace.
- Satan, the rebel from Lesson 1, meets his final end, just as Genesis 3:15 promised.

Revelation 19:16 — *And he hath on his vesture and on his thigh a name written, KING OF KINGS, AND LORD OF LORDS.*

Revelation 20:10 — *And the devil that deceived them was cast into the lake of fire and brimstone, where the beast and the false prophet are, and shall be tormented day and night for ever and ever.*

From Christ's Return to Final Judgment

Event	What happens	Scripture
Second Coming	Christ returns openly as King of kings	Revelation 19:11–21
Satan bound	The deceiver is confined for one thousand years	Revelation 20:1–3
Millennium	Christ reigns; Israel's kingdom promises are fulfilled	Isaiah 11; Ezekiel 36–37; Revelation 20:4–6
Final rebellion	Satan is released and leads one last revolt	Revelation 20:7–10
Great White Throne	The unsaved dead are judged according to the books	Revelation 20:11–15

4. New Creation and Eternity

God makes a new heaven and a new earth. New Jerusalem comes down, there is no more **curse**, and God's servants see His face and serve Him. The story that began with rebellion, darkness, and a lost garden ends with Christ victorious and God dwelling with His people.

- Look at the chart below: what was lost in Genesis is restored in Revelation.
- The tree of life, guarded after Adam's sin (Lesson 2), is open again (Revelation 22:2).
- The whole Bible is one story: God keeping His promises through His King, Jesus Christ.

> **Revelation 22:3** — *And there shall be no more curse: but the throne of God and of the Lamb shall be in it; and his servants shall serve him:*
>
> **Revelation 22:20** — *...Surely I come quickly. Amen. Even so, come, Lord Jesus.*

The Bible Story Completed

Beginning	Completion	Scripture
Heaven and earth created	New heaven and new earth	Genesis 1:1; Revelation 21:1
Darkness and rebellion	No night and no more rebellion	Genesis 1:2; Revelation 21:23–27; 22:5
Tree of life guarded	Tree of life freely available	Genesis 3:22–24; Revelation 22:2, 14
Curse enters	No more curse	Genesis 3:14–19; Revelation 22:3
Man driven from God's presence	God dwells with His people	Genesis 3:23–24; Revelation 21:3

Beginning	Completion	Scripture
Serpent promised defeat	Satan in the lake of fire	Genesis 3:15; Revelation 20:10

Check Your Understanding

1. What do Christ's messages to the seven churches teach?
2. How is the Rapture distinct from the Second Coming?
3. How do Daniel 9 and Revelation describe the Tribulation?
4. What happens during and after the thousand-year kingdom?
5. How do Revelation 21–22 complete the story begun in Genesis?

REFERENCE APPENDIX

Appendix A — The Sixty-Six Books and Their Place in the Story

Each book belongs to a major division and contributes to the Bible's connected history.

Division	Book	Role in the story
Law	Genesis	Beginnings; patriarchs; covenant promise
Law	Exodus	Israel redeemed from Egypt and formed as a nation
Law	Leviticus	Holiness, priesthood, sacrifices, worship
Law	Numbers	Wilderness testing and the new generation
Law	Deuteronomy	Covenant instruction renewed before Canaan
History	Joshua	Conquest and distribution of the land
History	Judges	Cycles of apostasy, oppression, and deliverance
History	Ruth	Kinsman redemption and David's family line
History	1 Samuel	Samuel, Saul, and David's rise
History	2 Samuel	David's reign and covenant
History	1 Kings	Solomon and the divided kingdom begins
History	2 Kings	Both kingdoms decline and go into exile
History	1 Chronicles	Genealogies and David with temple emphasis
History	2 Chronicles	Solomon and Judah with temple emphasis
History	Ezra	Return and rebuilding of the temple
History	Nehemiah	Jerusalem's walls and covenant renewal

Division	Book	Role in the story
History	Esther	Providential preservation in Persia
Poetry/Wisdom	Job	Suffering, human limits, and God's wisdom
Poetry/Wisdom	Psalms	Inspired worship, prayer, and Messianic hope
Poetry/Wisdom	Proverbs	Wisdom under the fear of the LORD
Poetry/Wisdom	Ecclesiastes	Life under the sun and the whole duty of man
Poetry/Wisdom	Song of Solomon	Covenant love in marriage poetry
Major Prophets	Isaiah	Judgment, comfort, Servant, and Messianic King
Major Prophets	Jeremiah	Judah's last days and new-covenant promise
Major Prophets	Lamentations	Mourning Jerusalem's destruction
Major Prophets	Ezekiel	Glory, exile, new heart, restoration, temple
Major Prophets	Daniel	Faithful witness and the course of kingdoms
Minor Prophets	Hosea	Israel's unfaithfulness and God's covenant love
Minor Prophets	Joel	The day of the LORD and promised Spirit
Minor Prophets	Amos	Justice, judgment, and Davidic restoration
Minor Prophets	Obadiah	Edom judged; the kingdom belongs to the LORD
Minor Prophets	Jonah	God's mercy to Nineveh and a reluctant prophet
Minor Prophets	Micah	Judgment, Bethlehem's ruler, and restoration
Minor Prophets	Nahum	Nineveh's final judgment
Minor Prophets	Habakkuk	Questions, faith, and God's sovereign justice
Minor Prophets	Zephaniah	The day of the LORD and a restored remnant

Division	Book	Role in the story
Minor Prophets	Haggai	Rebuild the temple; future glory
Minor Prophets	Zechariah	Visions, the Branch, the pierced King, the kingdom
Minor Prophets	Malachi	Corrupt worship and the coming messenger
Gospels	Matthew	Jesus the Messiah and King
Gospels	Mark	Jesus the authoritative Servant
Gospels	Luke	Jesus the perfect Son of man and Saviour
Gospels	John	Jesus the divine Son who gives life
History	Acts	The Spirit-empowered witness from Jerusalem to Rome
Epistles	Romans	The gospel, justification, sanctification, Israel
Epistles	1 Corinthians	Church correction, gifts, resurrection
Epistles	2 Corinthians	Ministry, weakness, comfort, giving
Epistles	Galatians	Justification by faith apart from the Law
Epistles	Ephesians	The Church in Christ and one new body
Epistles	Philippians	Joy, humility, and Christ-centered living
Epistles	Colossians	The supremacy and sufficiency of Christ
Epistles	1 Thessalonians	A model church and Christ's return
Epistles	2 Thessalonians	The day of the Lord and steadfastness
Epistles	1 Timothy	Doctrine, leadership, and church order
Epistles	2 Timothy	Guard and pass on the Word

Division	Book	Role in the story
Epistles	Titus	Sound doctrine and good works
Epistles	Philemon	Gospel reconciliation in a personal case
General Epistles	Hebrews	Christ better than the old-covenant shadows
General Epistles	James	Living faith shown through works
General Epistles	1 Peter	Hope and holiness in suffering
General Epistles	2 Peter	Growth, Scripture, false teachers, coming day
General Epistles	1 John	Assurance, truth, obedience, and love
General Epistles	2 John	Truth and love with discernment
General Epistles	3 John	Faithful hospitality and harmful ambition
General Epistles	Jude	Contend for the faith against apostasy
General Epistles	Revelation	Christ's victory, judgment, kingdom, and new creation

REFERENCE APPENDIX

Appendix B — Key Bible-Story Terms

Read each term according to its immediate biblical context.

Term	Definition
Covenant	A binding promise or agreement established by God; always identify its parties and terms.
Dispensation / stewardship	An order of responsibility entrusted by God for a particular period (Ephesians 3:2; Colossians 1:25).
Gentile	A person or nation outside Israel.
Hebrew	A name first used of Abram and later of his descendants.
Israel	Jacob's God-given name and the name of the nation descended from him; after the split it can also mean the northern kingdom.
Jew	A name connected with Judah and commonly used for Israel's people after the exile and in the New Testament.
Church	An assembly belonging to Christ; Acts and the Epistles show local churches carrying out His commands.
Kingdom of Heaven	Heaven's visible rule on earth through Israel's promised King.
Kingdom of God	God's spiritual rule, marked by righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Ghost.
Day of the LORD / Day of Jesus Christ	The Day of the LORD concerns God's intervention in judgment and Christ's public return; the Day of Jesus Christ concerns Christ's gathering of believers and the completion of His work in the Church.

Term	Definition
Messiah / Christ	The Anointed One promised in the Old Testament and revealed as Jesus.
Gospel	The good news that Christ died for our sins, was buried, and rose again the third day (1 Corinthians 15:1–4).
Rapture	Christ's gathering of the dead in Christ and living believers to meet Him in the air.
Tribulation	Daniel's final week and the time of judgment preceding Christ's public return.
Second Coming	Christ's visible return to earth as King of kings.
Millennium	Christ's literal thousand-year reign described in Revelation 20.

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Appendix C — Kings and Prophets Master Reference

Kings and prophets belong to the same history. These tables connect the rulers, prophetic ministries, and national outcomes.

Northern Kingdom — Selected Kings and Prophets

Period	Selected kings	Prophets and message	Outcome / study
First dynasty	Jeroboam I, Nadab	A man of God condemns the altar	Counterfeit worship begins (1 Kings 12–14)
Baasha to Omri	Baasha, Elah, Zimri, Omri	Jehu son of Hanani warns Baasha	Dynasties change through violence (1 Kings 15–16)
House of Omri	Ahab, Ahaziah, Joram	Elijah and Elisha confront Baal	Drought, Carmel, signs, judgment (1 Kings 17–2 Kings 9)
House of Jehu	Jehu, Jehoahaz, Joash, Jeroboam II	Jonah, Amos, Hosea	Temporary strength; deep corruption (2 Kings 10–14)
Final years	Zechariah, Shallum, Menahem, Pekahiah, Pekah, Hoshea	Warnings continue, but Israel will not hear	Samaria falls to Assyria (2 Kings 15–17)

Southern Kingdom — Selected Kings and Prophets

Period	Selected rulers	Prophets and message	Outcome / study
Early kingdom	Rehoboam, Abijah, Asa, Jehoshaphat	Shemaiah, Azariah, Hanani, Jehu	Compromise and reform (2 Chronicles 10–20)
Athaliah crisis	Jehoram, Ahaziah, Athaliah, Joash	Elijah's letter; Jehoiada and Zechariah	David's line preserved (2 Chronicles 21–24)
Assyrian era	Amaziah, Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, Hezekiah	Isaiah, Micah, Hosea	Jerusalem delivered from Assyria (2 Kings 18–20)
Final reform	Manasseh, Amon, Josiah	Nahum, Zephaniah, Jeremiah	Josiah responds to the Law (2 Kings 21–23)
Final kings	Jehoahaz, Jehoiakim, Jehoiachin, Zedekiah	Jeremiah, Habakkuk, Ezekiel	Jerusalem falls to Babylon (2 Kings 24–25)

Prophets in their historical settings

Period	Audience	Prophets	Primary emphasis
Divided kingdom—early	Judah/Israel	Shemaiah, Ahijah, Hanani, Jehu son of Hanani	Division, covenant warning, royal accountability
Ahab/Omri dynasty	Israel	Elijah, Micaiah, Elisha	Baal confronted; the LORD alone is God
Jeroboam II and after	Israel	Jonah, Amos, Hosea	Prosperity cannot hide injustice and apostasy
Assyrian crisis	Judah	Isaiah, Micah	Trust the LORD; judgment and Messianic hope

Period	Audience	Prophets	Primary emphasis
Josiah/final kings	Judah	Zephaniah, Habakkuk, Jeremiah, Huldah	Day of the LORD; Babylon coming; return promised
Babylonian exile	Exiles/ Gentile courts	Ezekiel, Daniel	Glory, responsibility, empires, restoration
Return and rebuilding	Returned community	Haggai, Zechariah	Rebuild; the Branch and coming King
Post-exilic decline	Judah	Malachi	Pure worship; coming messenger and Lord

REFERENCE APPENDIX

Appendix D — Selected Messianic Prophecies and Fulfillments

These Old Testament promises are paired with their New Testament fulfillment or inspired explanation. Some passages also include future kingdom elements beyond Christ's first coming.

Promise	Old Testament	New Testament	Significance
Seed of the woman	Genesis 3:15	Galatians 4:4; Hebrews 2:14	Human birth and victory over the serpent
Blessing through Abraham's seed	Genesis 12:3; 22:18	Galatians 3:8, 16	Gospel blessing reaches the nations
Ruler from Judah	Genesis 49:10	Luke 3:33; Revelation 5:5	Messiah comes from Judah
Prophet like Moses	Deuteronomy 18:15–18	Acts 3:20–23	Authoritative Prophet must be heard
Son and throne of David	2 Samuel 7:12–16	Luke 1:32–33	Everlasting Davidic King
Resurrection / no corruption	Psalm 16:10	Acts 2:25–32; 13:35–37	Christ rises from the dead
Suffering described	Psalm 22	Matthew 27; John 19	Mocking, pierced suffering, garments divided
Virgin-born Immanuel	Isaiah 7:14	Matthew 1:22–23	God with us

Promise	Old Testament	New Testament	Significance
Divine Davidic ruler	Isaiah 9:6–7	Luke 1:32–35	Son given; everlasting government
Forerunner's voice	Isaiah 40:3	Matthew 3:1–3	John prepares the Lord's way
Sin-bearing Servant	Isaiah 52:13–53:12	Acts 8:30–35; 1 Peter 2:24	Substitution, death, burial, vindication
New covenant	Jeremiah 31:31–34	Luke 22:20; Hebrews 8	Promised to Israel and Judah; ratified by Christ's blood
Ruler born in Bethlehem	Micah 5:2	Matthew 2:5–6	David's city and ancient goings forth
Humble King enters Jerusalem	Zechariah 9:9	Matthew 21:4–9	Royal entry on an ass
Pierced One	Zechariah 12:10	John 19:37; Revelation 1:7	Piercing and future recognition
Coming messenger	Malachi 3:1; 4:5–6	Luke 1:16–17; Mark 1:2–4	John ministers in Elijah's spirit and power

C05 / CURRICULA AND WORKBOOKS

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Prerequisite	None. Bring a King James Bible, this workbook, and a pen to every session.

Course Description

A study of the biblical doctrine of Scripture and the history of its transmission. The course establishes from the Bible the doctrines of revelation, inspiration, preservation, and purification, and then examines the evidence of the Hebrew Old Testament, the Greek New Testament, the ancient versions and fathers, the printed Received Text, and the English Bible from Wycliffe to 1611. It concludes with translation method, the doctrinal significance of textual differences, and common questions concerning the King James Bible.

Course Rationale

The contest over the Bible once concerned what it teaches; it now concerns where it is to be found. The believer is a soldier (2 Tim. 2:3–4) whose weapon is *the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God* (Eph. 6:17). This course equips him to know where that Word is, why he may trust it, and how to give an answer *with meekness and fear* (1 Pet. 3:15).

Method

The course proceeds from Scripture to history. Biblical promises and principles are established first; manuscripts, versions, fathers, and printed editions are then examined in their light. Class sessions follow the numbered outline of the workbook, with Scripture read aloud, blanks completed, and one review question discussed at the close of each lesson.

Course Objectives

Upon completing the course, the student will be able to:

1. Define and distinguish revelation, inspiration, illumination, preservation, purification, and propagation, citing the principal texts for each.
2. Explain from Scripture the doctrine of verbal, plenary inspiration and the promise of providential preservation.
3. Describe the materials, forms, and scripts of biblical manuscripts and trace the stages from autograph to printed text and translation.
4. Explain the custody of the Old Testament in the Masoretic tradition and evaluate the Dead Sea Scrolls and the Septuagint in relation to it.
5. Summarize the manuscript, versional, and patristic evidence for the Received Text and evaluate the Alexandrian codices.
6. Narrate the history of the English Bible from Wycliffe to 1611, including the rules, companies, and review process of the King James translators.
7. Distinguish formal from dynamic equivalence and assess the doctrinal significance of differences between the King James Bible and modern versions.
8. Answer common objections from Scripture and evidence, *in meekness instructing those that oppose themselves* (2 Tim. 2:25).
9. Research and write a documented paper in Turabian style.

Required Texts

- *The Holy Bible*, King James Version.
- *God's Words Preserved: Manuscript Evidence* (this workbook).
- D. A. Waite, *Defending the King James Bible: A Fourfold Superiority*, 3rd ed. (Collingswood, NJ: Bible for Today Press, 2006). Read in full during the course, marking highlights; submit the marked copy with the research paper.

Recommended Reading

- Edward F. Hills, *The King James Version Defended*, 5th ed. (Des Moines, IA: Christian Research Press, 2006).
- Jack Moorman, *Forever Settled: A Survey of the Documents and History of the Bible* (Collingswood, NJ: Bible for Today Press, 1985).
- John William Burgon, *The Revision Revised* (London: John Murray, 1883).
- Alexander W. McClure, *The Translators Revived* (New York: Charles Scribner, 1853).
- Samuel C. Gipp, *Gipp's Understandable History of the Bible* (Miamitown, OH: Day Star Publishing, 2004).
- F. H. A. Scrivener, *The Authorized Edition of the English Bible (1611)* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1884).

Course Requirements

1. *Attendance and participation.* Attend each session, complete the blanks, and prepare the review question. A student who misses a session obtains the notes before the next class.
2. *Scripture memory.* Memorize the ten passages listed below; five are written at each examination.
3. *Reading.* Read Waite's *Defending the King James Bible* in full, marking key statements, and follow the recommended preparation in the schedule.
4. *Examinations.* A take-home Trimester One Examination follows Lesson 11. The Final Examination covers Lessons 12–22 and includes one cumulative essay question.
5. *Research paper.* "The Men and Their Methods" (see the following page).

Evaluation

Component	Weight
Attendance, participation, and completed workbook pages	15%
Scripture memory (ten passages, written at the examinations)	10%
Reading: *Defending the King James Bible*, highlighted and submitted with the paper	5%
Trimester One Examination (Introduction and Lessons 1–11)	20%
Final Examination (Lessons 12–22, with a cumulative essay question)	17%
Research paper: "The Men and Their Methods"	33%

Grading Scale

A	B	C	D	F
93–100	85–92	77–84	70–76	Below 70

Course Policies

Scripture is quoted from the King James Bible. Written work follows Kate L. Turabian, *A Manual for Writers of Research Papers, Theses, and Dissertations*, 9th ed. (notes-bibliography style). All submitted work must be the student's own; quotations and borrowed information are acknowledged in footnotes. Late work is accepted only by arrangement with the instructor.

Research Paper: "The Men and Their Methods"

The paper, worth one third of the final grade, examines the translators of the King James Bible and the method by which their work was done.

1. *Title and length.* The title is "The Men and Their Methods." Length is twelve to twenty-four pages, double-spaced, excluding the front matter and bibliography.
2. *Format.* Include a cover page, a table of contents, footnotes, and a bibliography in Turabian style. Present the paper in a notebook or binder.
3. *The men.* Choose seven translators and write a brief but thorough biography of each, showing his training, languages, company, and part in the work.
4. *The method.* Explain in detail how the translation was made and completed: the Hampton Court Conference, the fifteen rules, the six companies, the stages of review, the final committee, and the printing of 1611.
5. *Sources.* Use at least six sources, including primary sources such as "The Translators to the Reader" and the rules of 1604. Waite, McClure, and Allen are recommended starting points.
6. *Due date.* _____. Submit the paper together with the highlighted copy of Waite.

Scripture Memory

Trimester One	Trimester Two
1. 2 Timothy 3:16–17	6. Isaiah 40:8
2. 2 Peter 1:20–21	7. Proverbs 30:5–6
3. Psalm 12:6–7	8. Romans 3:1–2
4. Matthew 24:35	9. Romans 10:17
5. Psalm 119:89	10. 1 Peter 1:23–25

Using This Workbook

Each lesson opens with its chapter heading, key texts, and objectives, and closes with a review question. Scripture is printed in *italics*; other quotations appear in quotation marks. Footnotes document key historical and textual claims, and full references appear in the bibliography. The appendices contain a timeline, the companies of the King James translators, and the translators' rules.

Course Schedule

Dates are assigned according to the institute's calendar. "Recommended preparation" refers to the works listed in the syllabus.

Trimester One

Session	Date	Lesson and topic	Recommended preparation
1		Orientation and syllabus; Introduction: The Real Issue at Stake	Waite, *Defending the KJB*, introduction
2		Lesson 1: Revelation and the Giving of God's Words	Hills, *KJV Defended*, chap. 1
3		Lesson 2: The Promised New Testament and the Written Word	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 43–47
4		Lesson 3: The Promises of Preservation	Waite, *Defending the KJB*, chap. 1
5		Lesson 4: Copies and Translations as Scripture	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 37–43
6		Lesson 5: The Pure Words and Jeremiah's Rolls	Hills, *KJV Defended*, chap. 4
7		Lesson 6: Providence and the Settled English Bible	Hills, *KJV Defended*, chap. 8
8		Lesson 7: The Attack upon God's Words	Hills, *KJV Defended*, chap. 9
9		Lesson 8: How Scripture Reached Us	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 48–53; Hills, *KJV Defended*, chap. 5
10		Lesson 9: Antioch, Alexandria, and the Critical Text	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 53–64; Hills, *KJV Defended*, chap. 6
11		Lesson 10: Israel's Custody of the Old Testament	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 1–9
12		Lesson 11: The Hebrew Text before and after Christ	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 32–36
		Trimester One Examination (take-home), covering the Introduction and Lessons 1–11	Scripture memory 1–5

TRIMESTER TWO

Session	Date	Lesson and topic	Recommended preparation
13		Lesson 12: Greek Witnesses and the Hebrew Standard	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 10–17
14		Lesson 13: The Word Received, Read, and Kept	Hills, *KJV Defended*, chap. 7
15		Lesson 14: Three Kinds of Witnesses	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 65–80
16		Lesson 15: The Great Codices Examined	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 81–92
17		Lesson 16: The Preparation and Completion of the English Bible	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 129–89; Waite, *Defending the KJB*, chap. 3
18		Lesson 17: Translating the Words God Gave	Waite, *Defending the KJB*, chap. 4
19		Lesson 18: The Person of Christ and the Gospel	Waite, *Defending the KJB*, chap. 5
20		Lesson 19: Prayer, Accuracy, and the Gospel	Waite, *Defending the KJB*, chap. 5
21		Lesson 20: Understanding and Teaching the Words	Waite, *Defending the KJB*, introduction, sec. B
22		Lesson 21: General Questions about the King James Bible	Waite, *Defending the KJB*, introduction, secs. D–E
23		Lesson 22: Technical Questions and Concluding Confidence	Moorman, *Forever Settled*, chap. 31
		Final Examination; research paper and highlighted reading due	Scripture memory 6–10

The instructor may adjust the schedule for holidays and breaks. Where the calendar allows fewer sessions, the Introduction may be taught with Lesson 1.

Course Introduction

This course follows a single argument from the promises of Scripture to the English Bible. Each lesson builds on the one before it, and each step below is established from Scripture before the historical evidence is examined.

The Argument of the Course

1. God inspired His words, not merely His ideas.
2. God promised that those words would be preserved.
3. The Bible itself calls faithful copies and translations Scripture.
4. God committed the Old Testament to the Jews and preserved it in the Hebrew tradition.
5. God placed the New Testament in the life of believing churches, where it was read, copied, preached, and carried.
6. Those words passed from manuscripts into printed Hebrew and Greek texts and then into English.
7. Earlier English Bibles prepared the language, and the King James translators joined the preserved text to that tradition.
8. The result is the King James Bible, the preserved and purified Word of God in English.

Course Outline

The lessons follow the four parts of the course's argument and the order of their chapters. Record the class date beside each lesson.

INTRODUCTION

Introduction The Real Issue at Stake Date _____ 11

PART I: FAITH-BASED

INSPIRATION: What God Did Once

Lesson 1 Revelation and the Giving of God's Words Date _____ 14

Lesson 2 The Promised New Testament and the Written Word Date _____ 17

PRESERVATION: What God Promised to Continue

Lesson 3 The Promises of Preservation Date _____ 20

Lesson 4 Copies and Translations as Scripture Date _____ 23

PURIFICATION: How God Actively Refines the Bible

Lesson 5 The Pure Words and Jeremiah's Rolls Date _____ 26

Lesson 6 Providence and the Settled English Bible Date _____ 29

WAR ON WORDS

Lesson 7 The Attack upon God's Words Date _____ 32

TEXTUAL TRANSMISSION AND THE TWO TEXTUAL STREAMS: ANTIOCH AND ALEXANDRIA

Lesson 8 How Scripture Reached Us Date _____ 35

Lesson 9 Antioch, Alexandria, and the Critical Text Date _____ 39

PART II: THE OLD TESTAMENT

To the Jew Were Committed the Oracles

Lesson 10 Israel's Custody of the Old Testament Date _____ 43

Masoretic Text and the Dead Sea Scrolls

Lesson 11 The Hebrew Text before and after Christ Date _____ 46

Trimester Two begins

What the Septuagint Is (and Isn't)

Lesson 12 Greek Witnesses and the Hebrew Standard Date _____ 49

Course Outline (continued)

PART III: THE NEW TESTAMENT

The Text the Church Actually Used

Lesson 13 The Word Received, Read, and Kept Date _____ 52

Evidence: Manuscripts, Versions, and Fathers

Lesson 14 Three Kinds of Witnesses Date _____ 55

The Alexandrian Cluster (B, ℵ, A) in Context

Lesson 15 The Great Codices Examined Date _____ 58

FROM THE RECEIVED TEXT TO THE KING JAMES BIBLE

Lesson 16 The Preparation and Completion of the English Bible Date _____ 61

PART IV: OTHER ISSUES

Translation Practices: Dynamic vs. Formal Equivalence: Why Translation Philosophy Matters

Lesson 17 Translating the Words God Gave Date _____ 65

Doctrinal Issues (Why the "small" changes aren't small)

Lesson 18 The Person of Christ and the Gospel Date _____ 68

Lesson 19 Prayer, Accuracy, and the Gospel Date _____ 71

Ease of Reading

Lesson 20 Understanding and Teaching the Words Date _____ 74

Major FAQs

Lesson 21 General Questions about the King James Bible Date _____ 77

Lesson 22 Technical Questions and Concluding Confidence Date _____ 80

Conclusion: The Word of God Endureth Forever

Lesson 22 (concluded) 82

Trimester One: Introduction and Lessons 1–11. Trimester Two: Lessons 12–22. Appendices, glossary, and bibliography begin on page 84.

Introduction

INTRODUCTION The Real Issue at Stake

KEY TEXTS: Jer. 23:36; Eph. 6:10–17; Jude 3; Matt. 23:23; 1 Cor. 8:1; Jas. 1:22; 2 Tim. 2:24–25; Ps. 119

OBJECTIVES: *(1) State the central question of the course. (2) Describe the spirit in which the question is to be studied and discussed.*

1. The Real Issue at Stake

a. Discussion of Bible versions usually turns to preference: which translation reads most easily or sounds most natural. The prior questions are theological. Has God __preserved__ His words? Does a perfect Word of God exist today, and if so, where can it be found?

b. The ground of the debate has shifted. The contest once concerned what the Bible teaches; it now concerns where the Bible is to be ____found____. In the English-speaking world the Revised New Testament of 1881, translated from a newly constructed Greek text, marks the turning point.

> **JEREMIAH 23:36**
> *And the burden of the LORD shall ye mention no more: for every man's word shall be his burden; for ye have perverted the words of the living God, of the LORD of hosts our God.*

c. The question is one of final __authority__. Whatever a believer treats as the last court of appeal, whether the oldest manuscripts, a printed Greek text, the consensus of scholars, or the Bible in his hand, will govern every other judgment he makes.

2. The Believer's Weapon

a. Paul describes the believer as a soldier (2 Tim. 2:3–4) armed for a conflict with *spiritual wickedness in high places* (Eph. 6:12). Truth, righteousness, the gospel, faith, and salvation are all supplied by the Word of God, and the Word is itself his one offensive weapon.[1]

> **EPHESIANS 6:17**
> *And take the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God:*

[1] Jasper James Ray, *God Wrote Only One Bible* (Junction City, OR: Eye Opener Publishers, 1955).

b. Jude therefore exhorts believers to *earnestly contend for the faith which was once delivered unto the saints* (Jude 3). Contending requires knowing what was delivered and where it may be found.

3. The Word Must Be Believed and Obeyed

a. Knowledge of this subject must not displace *the weightier matters of the law, judgment, mercy, and faith* (Matt. 23:23). Knowledge alone *puffeth up*, while charity ___edifieth___ (1 Cor. 8:1).

> **JAMES 1:22**
> *But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves.*

b. The servant of the Lord must be *gentle unto all men, apt to teach, patient* (2 Tim. 2:24). A faulty reading does not become true because a sincere believer reads it, and a sincere believer does not become an enemy because he has not yet studied the question. Evaluating a Bible is distinct from ___judging___ the person who holds it.

4. Marks of Love for the Word (Psalm 119)

a. The course concerns the heart as well as the evidence. Psalm 119 supplies tests by which a believer may examine his own love for the Word of God.

Mark	Text
What he hates: *I hate every false way*	Ps. 119:104, 128, 163
What occupies his mind: *it is my meditation all the day*	Ps. 119:97
What gives him joy: *as one that findeth great spoil*	Ps. 119:162
What he obeys: *My soul hath kept thy testimonies*	Ps. 119:167
What cannot offend him: *nothing shall offend them*	Ps. 119:165

b. The purpose of the course is therefore practical: to know what God has said, to believe it, to obey it, and to place it in the hands of ___others___.

> **PSALM 119:97**
> *O how love I thy law! it is my meditation all the day.*

REVIEW

Why must the question *Where is the Word of God?* be settled before the question *What does it teach?* can be answered with confidence?

PART I: FAITH-BASED

INSPIRATION: What God Did Once

LESSON 1 Revelation and the Giving of God's Words

KEY TEXTS: Deut. 29:29; Ps. 19:1–6; Rom. 1:20; Heb. 1:1–2; 2 Tim. 3:16–17; 2 Pet. 1:21; Matt. 4:4

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Distinguish general revelation, special revelation, and inspiration. (2) Explain from Scripture the meaning of verbal, plenary inspiration.*

1. Defining Revelation

a. Revelation is God's __uncovering__ of what was hidden, so that it may be seen for what it is. The Hebrew verb *galah* is rendered in the KJV *uncovered* (Gen. 9:21), *appeared* (Gen. 35:7), *discovered* (Exod. 20:26), *opened* (Num. 22:31), *published* (Esth. 8:13), and *disclose* (Isa. 26:21).

> **DEUTERONOMY 29:29**
> *The secret things belong unto the LORD our God: but those things which are revealed belong unto us and to our children for ever, that we may do all the words of this law.*

b. The first mention sets the principle: what God reveals belongs to His people and to their children *for ever*, and it is given in order to be obeyed.

2. General Revelation

a. ___General___ revelation is the knowledge of God given to all men through creation and conscience (Ps. 19:1–6; Rom. 1:20). It declares His existence, power, and glory, and it leaves men without excuse. Because both creation and the human mind are marred by sin (Gen. 3:17; Rom. 8:22), it cannot reveal the way of salvation.

3. Special Revelation

a. ___Special___ revelation is God's direct disclosure of Himself and His will. He spoke *at sundry times and in divers manners*:

Means	Example
Dreams	Joseph (Gen. 37:5–10)
Visions	Daniel (Dan. 8:1)
The Urim and Thummim	The high priest (Exod. 28:30)
An audible voice	Samuel (1 Sam. 3:10)
An animal	Balaam's ass (Num. 22:28)
Prophets and apostles	2 Pet. 1:21; Eph. 3:5

> **HEBREWS 1:1–2**
> *1 God, who at sundry times and in divers manners spake in time past unto the fathers by the prophets, 2 Hath in these last days spoken unto us by his Son, whom he hath appointed heir of all things, by whom also he made the worlds;*

b. The crown of special revelation is the _____Son_____ (John 1:14; 14:9). Its written and completed form is the Scripture, which alone now carries God's revelation to every generation.

4. The Meaning of Inspiration

a. The Greek adjective in 2 Timothy 3:16, θεόπνευστος (*theopneustos*), means __God-breathed__.[2] Inspiration identifies God as the source of Scripture; it describes the product He breathed out, not a heightened human insight.

> **2 TIMOTHY 3:16–17**
> *16 All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness: 17 That the man of God may be perfect, throughly furnished unto all good works.*

b. In Scripture the breath of God imparts life: man became a living soul (Gen. 2:7), dry bones lived (Ezek. 37:9–10), and *the inspiration of the Almighty giveth them understanding* (Job 32:8). The written Word carries the same divine life and authority.

> **2 PETER 1:21**
> *For the prophecy came not in old time by the will of man: but holy men of God spake as they were moved by the Holy Ghost.*

c. The prophets spoke as they were moved, or borne along, by the __Holy Ghost__. Inspiration occurred once, when they first wrote; later copyists and translators were not inspired in this sense.

[2] Joseph Henry Thayer, *A Greek-English Lexicon of the New Testament* (New York: American Book Company, 1889), s.v. "θεόπνευστος."

5. Inspiration Extends to the Words

a. David testified, *The Spirit of the LORD spake by me, and his word was in my tongue* (2 Sam. 23:2), and Christ built an argument on one word of Psalm 110:1 (Matt. 22:43–45).

b. Because man lives *by every word* of God (Matt. 4:4), inspiration is ___verbal___, reaching the words and their smallest marks (Matt. 5:18). Because *all scripture* is given by inspiration, it is ___plenary___. Scripture is therefore inerrant and infallible, for God cannot lie (Titus 1:2).

6. The Divine Order

Term	Meaning	Key text
Revelation	God makes truth known	Deut. 29:29
Inspiration	God gives that truth in written words	2 Tim. 3:16
Illumination	The Spirit enables the believer to understand it	1 Cor. 2:12
Preservation	God keeps His words intact	Ps. 12:6–7
Propagation	God's people carry the words to the world	Matt. 28:19–20

a. A believer may affirm preservation without propagating the Word, but no one can propagate it with conviction unless he knows it has been __preserved__ without error.

REVIEW

Explain the difference between saying the Bible *contains* God's message and saying it *is* God's words. Which does Matthew 4:4 require?

INSPIRATION: What God Did Once

LESSON 2 The Promised New Testament and the Written Word

KEY TEXTS: John 14:26; 16:12–13; Amos 8:11–12; Col. 2:6–7; Rom. 10:17; John 1:1, 14; 5:39–40; 12:48

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Show from Christ's promises that the New Testament is the Spirit-given witness to Him. (2) Explain the relationship between the Incarnate Word and the written Word.*

1. Christ Promised the New Testament Before It Was Written

a. Before the crucifixion Christ promised that the Holy Ghost would bring His teaching to the apostles' __remembrance__. The Gospels rest on that provision, not on the unaided memory of aging men.

> **JOHN 14:26**
> *But the Comforter, which is the Holy Ghost, whom the Father will send in my name, he shall teach you all things, and bring all things to your remembrance, whatsoever I have said unto you.*

b. The Spirit would also testify of Christ through the apostles (John 15:26–27), guide them *into all truth*, and show them *things to come* (16:13), anticipating the Gospels, Acts, the Epistles, and Revelation.

2. Where Is the Perfect Word Today?

a. Many doctrinal statements affirm inerrancy only "in the original autographs." Pressed further, they place the perfect Word either in __originals__ that perished long ago and were never gathered into one volume, or collectively among thousands of witnesses, none of which is identified as complete and correct. Neither answer points the believer to a Bible he can hold (cf. Amos 8:11–12).

3. Faith-Based?

a. The position of this course is that the perfect, inerrant, and plenary Word of God exists today in a book that can be read and believed. The argument begins with the __promises__ and principles of Scripture and interprets history in their light.

> **COLOSSIANS 2:6–7**
> *6 As ye have therefore received Christ Jesus the Lord, so walk ye in him: 7 Rooted and built up in him, and stablished in the faith, as ye have been taught, abounding therein with thanksgiving.*

b. The Christian life begins and continues by ____faith____; *without faith it is impossible to please him* (Heb. 11:6). The believer who received Christ by faith walks in Him by faith, including in his view of Scripture.

> **ROMANS 10:17**
> *So then faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.*

c. Faith comes by ___hearing___ the word of God. Faith is not credulity; it is trust in what God has said, and it governs how the believer weighs evidence, as the Bereans tested preaching by the Scriptures (Acts 17:11).

4. The Incarnate Word and the Inscripturated Word

> **JOHN 1:1**
> *In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.*

a. *The Word was made flesh* (John 1:14). Jesus Christ is the __Incarnate__ Word, the eternal Son who took human nature while remaining fully God (Rev. 19:13).

b. The Bible is the __inscripturated__ Word, God's revelation committed to writing through prophets and apostles. The term does not make paper or ink divine; it describes God's words placed in written form.

c. The two must be distinguished, for Christ is a divine Person and Scripture is not; yet they cannot be separated in source, truth, or authority. Christ gave the disciples the words the Father gave Him (John 17:8), and He said, *thy word is truth* (John 17:17). God has *magnified* His word *above all* His name (Ps. 138:2).

5. The Scriptures Testify of Christ

> **JOHN 5:39–40**
> *39 Search the scriptures; for in them ye think ye have eternal life: and they are they which testify of me. 40 And ye will not come to me, that ye might have life.*

a. The Jews searched the Scriptures yet refused the One of whom they ___testify___. After His resurrection Christ expounded *in all the scriptures the things concerning himself* (Luke 24:27).

6. Christ Judges by His Words

> **JOHN 12:48**
> *He that rejecteth me, and receiveth not my words, hath one that judgeth him: the word that I have spoken, the same shall judge him in the last day.*

a. Two errors must be avoided: claiming to honor Christ while doubting or correcting His ___written___ Word, and claiming to honor the Book while refusing to come to Christ and obey Him.

b. God speaks through His Word *to withdraw man from his purpose, and hide pride from man,* and to keep back *his soul from the pit* (Job 33:14–18). A perfect Christ gave a perfect Word for that saving purpose.

REVIEW

How does the relationship between Christ and Scripture bear on the question of whether God would allow His written Word to be lost?

PRESERVATION: What God Promised to Continue

LESSON 3 The Promises of Preservation

KEY TEXTS: Ps. 12:6–7; Ps. 119:89, 152, 160; Isa. 40:8; 59:21; Matt. 5:18; 24:35; 1 Pet. 1:23–25

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Define preservation and state its biblical basis. (2) Distinguish the preservation of words from the survival of materials.*

1. The Basic Logic of Preservation

a. If God had not preserved His words, they would in time have eroded away, and men would be left with their own opinions. Believers would lack the confidence to proclaim His warnings and promises, and no one could be sure of the way back to the Creator.

b. To preserve is to keep or _____save_____ from corruption. Applied to Scripture, preservation is God's supernatural securing and transmission of every inspired word.

2. The Promises of Preservation

> **PSALM 12:6–7**
> 6 *The words of the LORD are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times.* 7 *Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever.*

a. The object of the promise is the ____words_____ of the LORD, and its duration is ___for ever___.

b. The Old Testament repeats the promise. God's word is *settled in heaven* (Ps. 119:89); His testimonies are *founded … for ever* (119:152); His word shall *stand for ever* (Isa. 40:8). Isaiah 59:21 extends the covenant to the believer's *seed's seed*, that is, to succeeding __generations__.

> **MATTHEW 24:35**
> *Heaven and earth shall pass away, but my words shall not pass away.*

c. Christ's words shall not __pass away__. His guarantee reaches the jot, the smallest Hebrew letter, and the tittle, the small stroke that distinguishes one letter from another (Matt. 5:18; Luke 16:17). *The scripture cannot be broken* (John 10:35).

d. See also Deut. 7:9; 1 Chron. 16:15; Ps. 33:11; 100:5; 105:8; 117:2; 119:111, 160; Eccl. 3:14; Matt. 5:17–18; Luke 21:33; 1 Pet. 1:23–25.

e. Peter applies Isaiah 40:8 to the gospel his readers heard: *the word of the Lord endureth for ever. And this is the word which by the gospel is preached unto you* (1 Pet. 1:25). Preservation concerns the Word God's people actually possess.

> "Building a road across a vast wilderness (inspiration) would be much more difficult than patching the holes (preservation) in that same road after it has been built. But if the road isn't preserved it will soon deteriorate."[3]

3. A Historic Baptist Confession of Preservation

a. The Second London Baptist Confession (1689) states that the Hebrew Old Testament and Greek New Testament, "being immediately inspired by God, and by his singular care and providence kept _____pure_____ in all ages, are therefore authentic."[4]

b. The same paragraph directs that Scripture be translated into the __common language__ of every nation. The Westminster Confession (1646) and the Savoy Declaration (1658) use nearly identical words; the doctrine was shared across the Reformed confessions.

4. God Preserved His Words, Not the Material

a. The promise attaches to the words, not to the sheets that carried them. *The grass withereth, and the flower thereof falleth away* (1 Pet. 1:24), and so do papyrus and parchment. A manuscript may decay while its text continues in faithful ___copies___.

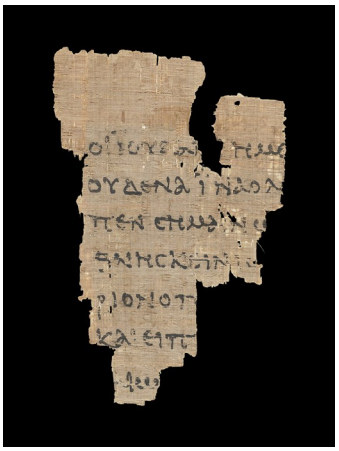

Figure 1. Papyrus P52 (John Rylands Library, Greek P 457), recto, preserving parts of John 18:31–33. The horizontal fibers of the papyrus sheet are visible.

[3] Samuel C. Gipp, *Gipp's Understandable History of the Bible* (Miamitown, OH: Day Star Publishing, 2004), 20, 30.

[4] The Second London Baptist Confession of Faith (1689), chap. 1, para. 8, "Of the Holy Scriptures."

b. ___Papyrus___ was made from strips of the pith of the papyrus plant laid in two layers at right angles, pressed, and dried.[5] Parchment was untanned skin of sheep, goats, or calves prepared for writing; vellum is a fine grade (cf. 2 Tim. 4:13).[6]

5. The Materials of Transmission

Material or instrument	Description	Scripture
Stone	Tables engraved by God; plastered stones written on	Exod. 34:1; Deut. 27:2–3
Table (tablet)	A writing board or tablet	Isa. 30:8; Hab. 2:2; Luke 1:63
Roll (scroll)	Sheets joined and rolled; *the volume of the book*	Jer. 36:2; Ezek. 2:9; Heb. 10:7
Book (codex)	Leaves folded and bound on one side	2 Tim. 4:13 (*the books*)
Paper (papyrus)	Sheets made from the papyrus plant	2 John 12
Parchments	Prepared animal skin	2 Tim. 4:13
Iron pen (stylus)	A pointed tool that cuts letters	Job 19:24; Jer. 17:1
Pen and ink	A reed pen laying ink of soot and gum	Jer. 36:18; 3 John 13

a. Material and format are separate questions. The age of a surviving sheet does not settle the age or truth of the ___readings___ it carries.

REVIEW

Why can the destruction of a writing surface be distinguished from the loss of the words written on it? Support your answer from 1 Peter 1:24–25.

[5] Rebecca Capua, "Papyrus-Making in Egypt," *Heilbrunn Timeline of Art History*, Metropolitan Museum of Art, March 2015, https://www.metmuseum.org/essays/papyrus-making-in-egypt.

[6] Frederic G. Kenyon, *Handbook to the Textual Criticism of the New Testament*, 2nd ed. (London: Macmillan, 1912), 38–39, 47, 49, 124–25.

PRESERVATION: What God Promised to Continue

LESSON 4 Copies and Translations as Scripture

KEY TEXTS: Deut. 17:18–19; 2 Kings 22:8–13; Luke 4:17–21; Acts 8:28–35; 17:11; 2 Tim. 3:15; Acts 2:6–11; Col. 1:13

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Demonstrate from Scripture that faithful copies are called Scripture. (2) Show that Scripture itself records and approves translation.*

1. Copies as Scripture

a. Scripture never restricts its authority to the autographs. God's people read, obeyed, and were judged by ____copies____.

> **DEUTERONOMY 17:18–19**
> 18 *And it shall be, when he sitteth upon the throne of his kingdom, that he shall write him a copy of this law in a book out of that which is before the priests the Levites:* 19 *And it shall be with him, and he shall read therein all the days of his life: that he may learn to fear the LORD his God, to keep all the words of this law and these statutes, to do them:*

b. Israel's king was to write a copy of the law from the text kept by the Levites and read it *all the days of his life*. God's plan has always been to pass His words along as a copy of a ____copy____, carrying the authority of the law itself.

c. When Hilkiah found *the book of the law*, Josiah rent his clothes because the nation had not obeyed *the words of this book* (2 Kings 22:8–13). Ezra held *the law of thy God which is in thine hand* (Ezra 7:14), and the Levites read it and gave the ____sense____ (Neh. 8:8).

d. At Nazareth Christ read from *the book of the prophet Esaias*, a scroll copied centuries after Isaiah, and declared, *This day is this scripture fulfilled in your ears* (Luke 4:17–21). He called the copy in His hand __scripture__.

e. The Ethiopian read Isaiah, and Philip *began at the same scripture, and preached unto him Jesus* (Acts 8:35). The Bereans *searched the scriptures daily* to test Paul's preaching (Acts 17:11).

> **2 TIMOTHY 3:15**
> *And that from a child thou hast known the holy scriptures, which are able to make thee wise unto salvation through faith which is in Christ Jesus.*

f. Timothy had known the Scriptures __from a child__. Paul calls the copies in his home *holy scriptures* able to make him wise unto salvation, and in the next verse says that *all scripture is given by inspiration of God*.

2. Translations Can Still Be Scripture

a. At Pentecost each hearer heard *in our tongues the wonderful works of God* (Acts 2:11). God had foretold that He would speak to His people *with men of other tongues* (Isa. 28:11; 1 Cor. 14:21), and the everlasting gospel is for *every nation, and kindred, and tongue* (Rev. 14:6). The command to *teach all nations* (Matt. 28:19) requires __translation__.

Account	Spoken in	Recorded in Scripture in
Joseph and his brethren, through an interpreter (Gen. 42:23)	Egyptian	Hebrew
Paul's defense at Jerusalem (Acts 21:40–22:21)	Hebrew	Greek
Christ's words to Saul (Acts 26:14)	Hebrew	Greek
Talitha cumi (Mark 5:41)	Aramaic	Greek, with translation

b. In each case no record survives in the language first spoken. The words God preserved in __translation__ are Scripture, and Ezra 4:8–6:18 and Daniel 2:4–7:28 were themselves written in Aramaic.

3. A Biblical Picture of Translation

a. In the King James Bible, *translate* describes a God-ordained transfer into a better condition: the kingdom from Saul's house to David (2 Sam. 3:10), the believer from darkness into the kingdom of God's dear Son, and Enoch from earth into God's presence (Heb. 11:5).

> **Colossians 1:13**
> *Who hath delivered us from the power of darkness, and hath translated us into the kingdom of his dear Son:*

b. Translation under God's hand therefore need not mean __degradation__. Words do not become weaker merely because they cross into another language.

c. This does not mean every translation is pure. It establishes that a _____pure_____ translation is possible and prepares for the question of which text and which translation God has used to keep His words.

REVIEW

List three passages in which a copy of Scripture is treated as Scripture. What does each imply about the claim that only the autographs were inspired?

PURIFICATION: How God Actively Refines the Bible

LESSON 5 The Pure Words and Jeremiah's Rolls

Key texts: Ps. 12:6–7; Prov. 30:5–6; Ps. 18:30; Jer. 36:1–32

Objectives: *(1) Define purification and distinguish it from inspiration and preservation. (2) Explain the lesson of Jeremiah's two rolls.*

Most Christians affirm inspiration, fewer affirm preservation, and fewer still affirm purification. Yet Scripture speaks of the __purifying__ of God's words as plainly as it speaks of the other two.

1. The Pure Words

> **Psalm 12:6**
> *The words of the LORD are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times.*

a. The words of the LORD are compared to silver *purified seven times*. In Scripture ___seven___ marks completeness, so the figure describes refining carried to its end: a settled form that needs no further refining.

> **Proverbs 30:5–6**
> 5 *Every word of God is pure: he is a shield unto them that put their trust in him.* 6 *Add thou not unto his words, lest he reprove thee, and thou be found a liar.*

b. Every word of God is ___pure___, and the warning against adding to His words follows at once. Psalm 18:30 adds that *the word of the LORD is tried*, tested as metal is tested.

2. Keeping the Three Terms Separate

a. __Inspiration__ is God's initial giving of His words through the prophets and apostles.

b. __Preservation__ is His keeping of those words through history, so that they do not pass away.

c. __Purification__ is His providential work of bringing the preserved words through copying, printing, translation, comparison, and reception until they stand in a settled form. It does not make later copyists or translators prophets, and it does not produce new revelation.

d. The history of the English Bible illustrates the process. Seven major English Bibles preceded the King James: Wycliffe (1382), Tyndale (1525–26), Coverdale (1535), Matthew's (1537), the Great Bible (1539), Geneva (1560), and the Bishops' (1568). Many have noted the parallel with the *seven times* of Psalm 12:6.

> **PSALM 18:30**
> *As for God, his way is perfect: the word of the LORD is tried: he is a buckler to all those that trust in him.*

3. Case Study: Jeremiah's Rolls

a. The original was written. Baruch wrote *from the mouth of Jeremiah all the words of the LORD … upon a roll of a book* (Jer. 36:4).

b. The original was destroyed. Jehoiakim cut the roll with a penknife and burned it *until all the roll was consumed* (36:23).

> **JEREMIAH 36:32**
> *Then took Jeremiah another roll, and gave it to Baruch the scribe, the son of Neriah; who wrote therein from the mouth of Jeremiah all the words of the book which Jehoiakim king of Judah had burned in the fire: and there were added besides unto them many like words.*

c. The second roll contained *all the former words* and *many like words* besides. It was not less than the first but ___greater___. Had only the first roll survived, it would have lacked words God intended His people to have.

d. The added words were new prophetic revelation, which later scribes and translators do not receive. The lesson for this course is that God did not make the autograph an object of veneration; He preserved His words in a ____second____ roll.

REVIEW

Why did God not simply preserve Jeremiah's first roll? What does the second roll teach about the place of the "original" document?

PURIFICATION: How God Actively Refines the Bible

LESSON 6 Providence and the Settled English Bible

KEY TEXTS: Jer. 36:27–32; Ps. 12:6–7; Ps. 119:140; 1 John 5:7; Jer. 32:27

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Answer the charge of "double inspiration." (2) State the question of final authority and its alternatives.*

1. "Double Inspiration"?

a. Critics sometimes say that defenders of the King James Bible teach __double inspiration__, as though God breathed out Scripture a second time in 1611. The charge misstates the position.

b. Inspiration is by definition God's initial act of breathing out His words, and it occurred _____once_____, in the originals. The King James Bible is not newly inspired; it consists of inspired words that God has preserved and purified.

c. What the charge overlooks is the biblical category of purification. God can refine through __providence__ what He first gave by inspiration, as the history of Jeremiah's second roll shows.

> **PSALM 119:140**
> *Thy word is very pure: therefore thy servant loveth it.*

d. Scripture itself distinguishes the acts. God spoke *at sundry times and in divers manners* by the prophets (Heb. 1:1); He also promised to keep what He had spoken (Ps. 12:7). Keeping is not a second speaking.

2. Purification and Providence in the King James Bible

a. Edward Hills argued that the Latin-speaking church preserved a few genuine readings that had become rare in Greek copies. He described the Textus Receptus as a further step in the providential __preservation__ of the New Testament:

> "In it the few errors of any consequence occurring in the Traditional Greek Text were corrected by the providence of God operating through the usage of the Latin speaking Church of Western Europe."[7]

[7] Edward F. Hills, *The King James Version Defended: A Christian View of the New Testament Manuscripts*, 5th ed. (Des Moines, IA: Christian Research Press, 2006), 139.

b. The clearest example is 1 John 5:7. Absent from most late Greek copies, the verse was retained in the ____Latin____ tradition, and Cyprian (c. A.D. 250) cites its closing words, *and these three are one*.[8] Erasmus omitted it in 1516 and 1519 and included it in his ____third____ edition of 1522.

> **1 John 5:7**
> *For there are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one.*

3. The Choice: Purification or Degradation

a. The King James translators began their work in 1604 with the Received Greek Text of Erasmus, Stephanus, and Beza and with the English Bibles from Wycliffe to Geneva. The result is understood here as the fruit of purification, both textual and __linguistic__.

b. Every step required decisions: Erasmus with 1 John 5:7, the translators with variant readings, believers with the manuscripts they received. The question beneath all of them is whether God is still at work in the ___process___.

c. If He is, a perfect Bible exists today, complete to the jot and tittle. If He is not, the believer holds at best a fallible approximation of lost originals. *If the foundations be destroyed, what can the righteous do?* (Ps. 11:3).

> **Psalm 12:7**
> *Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever.*

4. Preservation versus Inspiration: The Question of Final Authority

a. Many evangelical leaders hold that the originals were perfect but that every copy and translation is imperfect. The position is widely assumed, yet no scriptural proof is offered for it.

Possible final authority	Difficulty or answer
The "oldest and best" Greek and Hebrew manuscripts	They disagree with one another and change with each discovery.
The printed Masoretic and Received texts	Their printed editions differ slightly among themselves.
The King James Bible	A present, complete Book that can be read, preached, and obeyed.

[8] Cyprian, *De Unitate Ecclesiae* 6. Cyprian writes, "The Lord says, 'I and the Father are one'; and again it is written of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit, 'And these three are one.'"

> **JEREMIAH 32:27**
> *Behold, I am the LORD, the God of all flesh: is there any thing too hard for me?*

b. If God could overcome human weakness in giving the originals and preserve them in Hebrew and Greek, He is able to do the same in a __translation__. The believer who holds that God has kept His words can at least produce the Book he claims to believe.

REVIEW

Explain why purification is not "double inspiration." Use Jeremiah 36 in your answer.

WAR ON WORDS

LESSON 7 The Attack upon God's Words

Key texts: Gen. 2:16–17; 3:1–6, 16; Deut. 4:2; Prov. 30:6; Rev. 22:18–19; 2 Cor. 2:17; 11:3–4; Isa. 14:14

Objectives: *(1) Trace the satanic pattern of attack on God's words from Genesis 3. (2) Recognize the counterfeits Satan offers in place of the truth.*

God is committed to purifying His words; the devil is committed to corrupting them. A student who ignores this conflict will misread the history of the text, because Scripture presents God's Word as a target of spiritual ___warfare___.

1. God's Repeated Warnings

a. God forbids adding to or __taking from__ His words at the beginning of the canon (Deut. 4:2), in its middle (Prov. 30:6), and at its end (Rev. 22:18–19).

> **Revelation 22:19**
> *And if any man shall take away from the words of the book of this prophecy, God shall take away his part out of the book of life, and out of the holy city, and from the things which are written in this book.*

2. False Letters in the Early Church

a. While the New Testament was still being written, Paul warned the Thessalonians not to be shaken *by letter as from us* (2 Thess. 2:2) and marked every genuine epistle with his own __signature__ (3:17). He also warned of *many, which corrupt the word of God* (2 Cor. 2:17).

3. The Devil's First Appearance

> **Genesis 3:1**
> *Now the serpent was more subtil than any beast of the field which the LORD God had made. And he said unto the woman, Yea, hath God said, Ye shall not eat of every tree of the garden?*

a. The serpent's first words ___question___ God's word: *Yea, hath God said?* The same question lies at the heart of modern textual doubt: what did God actually say, and can it be known?

b. He then __contradicts__ it. God had not forbidden *every tree of the garden*; He had forbidden one (Gen. 2:16–17).

c. Finally he ___changes___ it: *Ye shall not surely die* (3:4) reverses *thou shalt surely die*.

> **GENESIS 2:16–17**
> *16 And the LORD God commanded the man, saying, Of every tree of the garden thou mayest freely eat: 17 But of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, thou shalt not eat of it: for in the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die.*

d. Eve also added to the word, saying *neither shall ye touch it* (3:3). Under pressure from a corrupted word, even the defender of the word misquoted it.

4. The Pattern and the Continuing Attack

a. In a few verses the method is complete: question the word, contradict it, change it. The Fall followed an attack on the ____word____ of God, and the method has not changed.

b. The same tactic appears at the temptation of Christ. Satan quoted Psalm 91:11–12 but omitted the words *to keep thee in all thy ways* (Matt. 4:6). Christ answered, *It is written again* (Matt. 4:7).

5. Example: Genesis 3:16

> **GENESIS 3:16**
> *Unto the woman he said, I will greatly multiply thy sorrow and thy conception; in sorrow thou shalt bring forth children; and thy desire shall be to thy husband, and he shall rule over thee.*

a. The English Standard Version (2016) reads, "Your desire shall be contrary to your husband."[9] The KJV directs the woman's desire ____to____ her husband; the ESV sets it against him. The two statements are opposites.

6. Satan the Counterfeiter

a. Satan's ambition is to be *like the most High* (Isa. 14:14). He therefore imitates what God has given, offering a plurality in place of each divine unity.

> **2 CORINTHIANS 11:4**
> *For if he that cometh preacheth another Jesus, whom we have not preached, or if ye receive another spirit, which ye have not received, or another gospel, which ye have not accepted, ye might well bear with him.*

[9] English Standard Version (Wheaton, IL: Crossway, 2016), Gen. 3:16; 1 Tim. 3:16; John 1:18.

God's provision	Satan's counterfeit
One God (1 Cor. 8:6)	Many "gods"
One Christ	Many false christs (Matt. 24:24)
One Spirit (Eph. 4:4)	*another spirit* (2 Cor. 11:4)
One gospel	*another gospel* (Gal. 1:6–8)
One body (Eph. 4:4)	Many religions and sects
One Bible	Many "bibles"

b. A counterfeit is recognized by comparison with the ___genuine___. The believer who knows the true Word can discern its imitations.

REVIEW

Identify the three steps of the serpent's method in Genesis 3:1–5. Where do you see the same pattern in modern discussion of the Bible?

TEXTUAL TRANSMISSION AND THE TWO TEXTUAL STREAMS: ANTIOCH AND ALEXANDRIA

LESSON 8 How Scripture Reached Us

Key texts: Jer. 36:28; Col. 4:16; 2 Pet. 3:15–16; Mark 12:37

Objectives: *(1) Trace the stages from autograph to English translation. (2) Identify a manuscript by its material, format, script, and text-type.*

1. How Scripture Reached Us

a. The autographs, the documents first written by the prophets and apostles, are no longer known to exist. Their words were copied by hand in __manuscripts__, handwritten copies of all or part of a biblical book.

b. Hand copying produced __textual variants__: differences of spelling, word order, omission, addition, or substitution. Most concern spelling or word order; some involve whole passages, such as Mark 16:9–20 and 1 John 5:7.

c. Manuscripts that repeatedly share readings form a textual tradition, or __text-type__. The Byzantine text is found in the majority of surviving Greek manuscripts; the Alexandrian text is associated with manuscripts preserved in Egypt. Neither label means that every manuscript in the group is identical.

d. The course of transmission may be summarized in six stages:

Original writings → handwritten manuscripts → textual variants → textual traditions → printed Hebrew and Greek texts → English translations

2. Reading a Manuscript: Handwriting

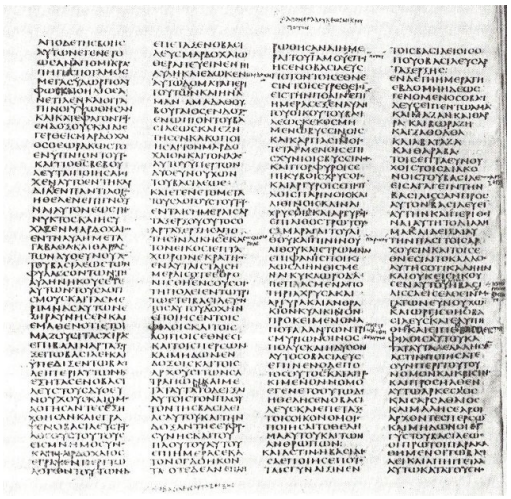

Figure 2. Majuscule (uncial) hand: Codex Sinaiticus, fourth century.

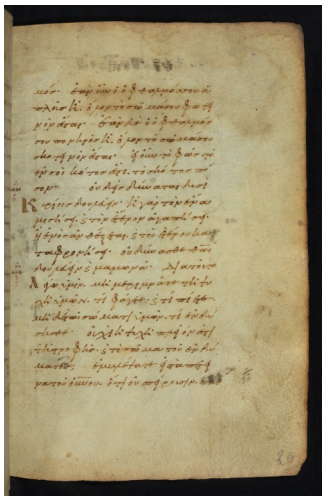

Figure 3. Minuscule hand: Walters Art Museum W.523, tenth century.

a. __Majuscules__, or uncials, are written in separate capital letters. *Uncial* comes from the Latin *uncia*, a twelfth part or inch, describing letters about an inch high. The great codices of the fourth and fifth centuries are majuscules. Minuscules, in a smaller joined hand, predominate from the ninth century onward.[10]

b. Early scribes wrote without spaces between words (*scriptio continua*). In English, GODISNOWHERE could be read "God is now here" or "God is nowhere"; context and a received tradition of reading decide.

3. The Vocabulary of Manuscripts

Term	Meaning
Scribe; scriptorium	A professional copyist; the room set apart for copying
Exemplar	The manuscript from which a copy is made
Chirography	The handwriting of a scribe or period, used to date a manuscript
Palimpsest	A manuscript scraped and written over, such as Codex Ephraemi Rescriptus (C)
Koine	The common Greek of the first century, the language of the New Testament
Sigla	Catalogue symbols: P52 (papyri), ℵ = 01 and B = 03 (majuscules), 61 (minuscules), ℓ (lectionaries)

a. __Lectionaries__ are service books arranging Scripture for public reading. The

[10] Kenyon, *Handbook*, 124–25.

synaxaria begin the church year at Easter, the *menologia* on September 1; Kurt Aland counted 2,143 lectionary manuscripts.[11]

b. Material, format, script, and text-type answer four different __questions__ about a manuscript. A papyrus codex may be written in a majuscule hand and carry any text-type.

4. From Manuscripts to Printed Greek Texts

a. Erasmus published the first Greek New Testament in 1516 and revised it in 1519, 1522, 1527, and 1535. Stephanus issued editions in 1546, 1549, 1550, and 1551; Beza's editions of 1588–89 and 1598 were used extensively by the King James translators.[12]

b. The name __Textus Receptus__ derives from the preface of the Elzevir edition of 1633: *Textum ergo habes, nunc ab omnibus receptum* ("You have therefore the text now received by all").[13]

c. The Byzantine Text is a manuscript tradition; the Majority Text denotes the readings of most surviving manuscripts; the Textus Receptus is the family of printed editions from Erasmus to the Elzevirs. Scrivener's Greek text of 1881 reconstructs the Greek underlying the KJV; it was not the translators' source.[14]

d. Modern critical editions, NA28 and UBS5, print essentially the same __eclectic__ text, which gives greater weight to Alexandrian witnesses.

[11] Jack Moorman, *Forever Settled: A Survey of the Documents and History of the Bible* (Collingswood, NJ: Bible for Today Press, 1985), 49.

[12] Bruce M. Metzger and Bart D. Ehrman, *The Text of the New Testament: Its Transmission, Corruption, and Restoration*, 4th ed. (New York: Oxford University Press, 2005), 142–52.

[13] J. K. Elliott, "'Novum Testamentum editum est': The Five-Hundredth Anniversary of Erasmus's New Testament," *The Bible Translator* 67, no. 1 (2016): 24, https://doi.org/10.1177/2051677016628242.

[14] F. H. A. Scrivener, ed., *The New Testament in the Original Greek according to the Text Followed in the Authorised Version, Together with the Variations Adopted in the Revised Version* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1881), vii–xii, 648–56.

REVIEW

Distinguish a manuscript, a text-type, a printed edition, and a translation. Where does the Textus Receptus belong?

TEXTUAL TRANSMISSION AND THE TWO TEXTUAL STREAMS: ANTIOCH AND ALEXANDRIA

LESSON 9 Antioch, Alexandria, and the Critical Text

KEY TEXTS: Acts 11:19–26; 13:1–3; 6:9; 18:24–26; Gen. 12:10–20; Exod. 20:2; Mark 12:37

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Contrast the naturalistic and faith-based methods of textual criticism. (2) Evaluate the canons and theories used to set aside the Byzantine text.*

1. Two Starting Points: Preservation or Reconstruction

a. The __naturalistic__ method treats the New Testament by the rules applied to any ancient book. It begins with the surviving manuscripts, reconstructs what the authors most probably wrote, and treats no received text as final.

b. Edward Hills contrasted it with the "consistently Christian" method, which interprets the same evidence in accordance with the doctrines of inspiration and providential __preservation__.[15] That method does not reject manuscripts, versions, or fathers; it declines to interpret them apart from Scripture.

c. One method asks which reading is most probable by the canons of criticism; the other asks which reading fits God's promises and the historical ____usage____ of His people.

> **1 CORINTHIANS 2:14**
> *But the natural man receiveth not the things of the Spirit of God: for they are foolishness unto him: neither can he know them, because they are spiritually discerned.*

2. The Canons of Textual Criticism

Canon	Claim	Response
Lectio brevior potior	The shorter reading is preferred, since scribes tended to add.	Scribes also omitted, often by accident (see Royse, below).
Lectio difficilior potior	The harder reading is preferred, since scribes tended to simplify.	A copying error also makes a reading "harder."
Manuscripts are weighed, not counted	Agreement of many late copies counts as one witness.	Hort conceded that a majority normally reflects a majority of ancestors.[16]

[15] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, vii–viii.

[16] Brooke Foss Westcott and Fenton John Anthony Hort, *The New Testament in the Original Greek*, vol. 2, *Introduction and Appendix* (London: Macmillan, 1881), 45.

a. The course notes set against these canons the "canons of the common man." The Received Text reads plainly, and *the common people heard him gladly* (Mark 12:37). It is full and complete, without broken sentences. Its copies are late because they were _____used_____ and worn out, while unused copies survived.

3. Antioch: The Line of Preservation

a. At Antioch the disciples were first called Christians (Acts 11:26), and from Antioch the Holy Ghost sent Paul and Barnabas on the first missionary journey (Acts 13:1–3). Scripture presents that church as a model of teaching, missions, and __faithfulness__; later heresies in the region do not overturn that testimony.

b. The Byzantine text, associated with this region and the Greek-speaking churches, is found in roughly 80 to 95 percent of surviving Greek manuscripts and stands behind the Textus Receptus.[17]

4. Alexandria: The Line of Corruption

a. Egypt's first appearance in Scripture is Abraham's compromise (Gen. 12:10–20); thereafter it is *the house of bondage* (Exod. 20:2). Alexandrians disputed with Stephen (Acts 6:9), and Apollos of Alexandria needed the way of God expounded *more perfectly* (Acts 18:24–26).

b. The city's best-known Christian scholar, ____Origen____ (c. 184–254), allegorized Scripture and taught the pre-existence of souls.[18] Philip Schaff judged that "the predilection of Origen for Plato misled him into many grand and fascinating errors."[19]

5. The Revision of 1881

a. In 1870 the Convocation of Canterbury appointed a committee to revise the Authorized Version. Its Revised New Testament (1881) followed a new Greek text prepared by Brooke Foss Westcott and Fenton John Anthony _____Hort_____, published the same year; the American Standard Version (1901) followed.

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[17] Wilbur N. Pickering, *The Identity of the New Testament Text IV* (Brasília: Wilbur N. Pickering, 2014), 114; Zane C. Hodges and Arthur L. Farstad, eds., *The Greek New Testament According to the Majority Text*, 2nd ed. (Nashville: Thomas Nelson, 1985), v–vi.

[18] Origen, *De Principiis*, I.6.1–3, II.3.3, in *Ante-Nicene Fathers*, vol. 4, ed. Alexander Roberts and James Donaldson (Grand Rapids: Christian Classics Ethereal Library, 2006), 259–61, 273; Philip Schaff, *History of the Christian Church*, vol. 2, *Ante-Nicene Christianity, A.D. 100–325* (New York: Charles Scribner's Sons, 1910), 791.

[19] Philip Schaff, *History of the Christian Church*, vol. 2, *Ante-Nicene Christianity, A.D. 100–325* (New York: Charles Scribner's Sons, 1910), 791.

b. Hort's attitude was fixed early. In 1851, at age twenty-three, he wrote of having "dragged on with the villainous Textus Receptus."[20] Their correspondence shows sympathy for Mariolatry: Hort wrote that "Mary-worship and 'Jesus'-worship have very much in common."[21]

c. Westcott helped found a Cambridge society, the "Ghostlie Guild" (1851), for the investigation of apparitions.[22] The men who set aside the Received Text did not approach Scripture from a __faith-based__ starting point.

d. Their text rested chiefly on B and ℵ. The Revised Version was received coolly by ordinary believers; the flood of later versions came with the marketing of the twentieth century.

6. "Reasoned Eclecticism" and Why the Issue Still Matters

a. Modern editors weigh external and internal evidence for each variant. Kurt and Barbara Aland nonetheless place most Byzantine manuscripts in Category V, of little value for establishing the original text.[23] Gregory Lanier found ____98.5____ percent agreement between NA28/ECM and Westcott and Hort's text of 1881 in sampled passages.[24]

7. Theories Used to Dismiss the Byzantine Text

a. *Prefer the shorter reading.* James Royse found that the scribes of six major early papyri ___omitted___ material more often than they added it.[25]

b. *Conflation.* Harry Sturz showed that supposed conflations are not confined to Byzantine manuscripts; P66 (c. 200) supports the fuller Byzantine readings at John 10:19 and 10:31.

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[20] Arthur Fenton Hort, *Life and Letters of Fenton John Anthony Hort*, 2 vols. (London: Macmillan, 1896), 1:211; quoted in Jack Moorman, *Forever Settled: A Survey of the Documents and History of the Bible* (Collingswood, NJ: Bible for Today Press, 1985), 197.

[21] Hort to Westcott, October 17, 1865, and Westcott to Hort, November 17, 1865, quoted in Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 129.

[22] Arthur Westcott, *Life and Letters of Brooke Foss Westcott*, 2 vols. (London: Macmillan, 1903), 1:117–19.

[23] Kurt Aland and Barbara Aland, *The Text of the New Testament: An Introduction to the Critical Editions and to the Theory and Practice of Modern Textual Criticism*, 2nd ed., trans. Erroll F. Rhodes (Grand Rapids: Eerdmans; Leiden: Brill, 1989), 106–9, 159–60.

[24] Gregory R. Lanier, "The Critical Editions of the Greek NT and OT: Stability, Change, and Implications," *Tyndale Bulletin* 71, no. 1 (2020): 43–63, esp. 49–54, https://doi.org/10.53751/001c.27734.

[25] James R. Royse, *Scribal Habits in Early Greek New Testament Papyri*, New Testament Tools, Studies and Documents 36 (Leiden: Brill, 2008), 705–36, especially 734.

c. *The Lucian recension.* No historical source describes Lucian of Antioch revising the Greek New Testament. Sturz catalogued about 150 distinctively Byzantine readings in early papyri, older than the supposed __recension__.[26]

REVIEW

Compare the naturalistic and faith-based methods. How does each account for the large number of Byzantine manuscripts?

[26] Harry A. Sturz, *The Byzantine Text-Type and New Testament Textual Criticism* (Nashville: Thomas Nelson, 1984), 55–69, 79–96, 122–30, 145–59.

Part II: The Old Testament

To the Jew Were Committed the Oracles

LESSON 10 Israel's Custody of the Old Testament

Key texts: Rom. 3:1–2; 9:4; Deut. 31:24–26; 17:18; Mal. 2:7; Neh. 8:8; Ps. 147:19–20

Objectives: *(1) Explain from Scripture the Jewish custody of the Old Testament. (2) Describe the work of the scribes, Masoretes, and later punctuators.*

> **Romans 3:1–2**
> 1 *What advantage then hath the Jew? or what profit is there of circumcision?* 2 *Much every way: chiefly, because that unto them were committed the oracles of God.*

Paul names Israel's chief advantage: to them were committed the ___oracles___ of God. *Committed* denotes a trust placed in ___custody___. God gave the Old Testament through Jewish prophets and charged the Jewish people with its keeping (Rom. 9:4).

1. Custody Given by God Himself

a. When Moses finished writing the law, he gave it to the ___Levites___ to keep beside the ark of the covenant.

> **Deuteronomy 31:26**
> *Take this book of the law, and put it in the side of the ark of the covenant of the LORD your God, that it may be there for a witness against thee.*

b. The priest's lips were to *keep knowledge* (Mal. 2:7), and even the king copied the law from the text kept *before the priests the Levites* (Deut. 17:18).

2. The Keepers of the Hebrew Text

Group	Period	Work
Levitical priests	From Moses	Kept the book of the law beside the ark and taught it (Deut. 31:26; Neh. 8:8)
Soferim (scribes)	From Ezra onward	Copied the consonantal text and expounded it; counted its letters
Masoretes	c. A.D. 500–1000	Added vowel points, accents, and marginal notes (the Masorah) to protect the reading
Nakdanim (punctuators)	c. 1100–1500	Supplied and corrected vowel and accent signs in later manuscripts until the printing era

a. The Talmud explains that the early scribes were called *soferim* ("counters") because they ___counted___ all the letters of the Torah.[27] The rules for preparing sacred scrolls are recorded in the tractate *Soferim*.[28]

> **NEHEMIAH 8:8**
> *So they read in the book in the law of God distinctly, and gave the sense, and caused them to understand the reading.*

3. The Rules of the Scribes

a. Traditional rules for a synagogue roll show the ___care___ with which the text was guarded:[29]

b. The roll was written on the skins of clean animals, prepared by a Jew, and fastened with strings from clean animals.

c. Columns were of fixed length; the whole was ruled; the ink was black, prepared by a set recipe.

d. The copy was made from an authentic exemplar; no word or letter might be written from ___memory___, and each word was pronounced aloud before it was written.

e. Set spaces separated letters, sections, and books. The name of God was written with a pen freshly dipped, and a copy containing a single error was withdrawn from use.

f. Josephus (c. A.D. 95) wrote that through long ages no one had dared to add to the Jewish Scriptures, to take from them, or to alter them (*Against Apion* 1.42).

4. The Contrast with Greek Handling of the Text

a. Scripture never says that the Old Testament was entrusted to a Gentile king or to Alexandrian scholars. The question of Old Testament authority begins with Romans 3:2, not with the Letter of Aristeas or with fourth-century Greek ___codices___.

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[27] Babylonian Talmud, Kiddushin 30a, in *The Talmud of Babylonia: A Translation and Commentary*, ed. Jacob Neusner (Peabody, MA: Hendrickson, 2011).

[28] Emanuel Tov, *Textual Criticism of the Hebrew Bible*, 3rd ed., rev. and exp. (Minneapolis: Fortress Press, 2012), 29–39, 107–10.

[29] Samuel Davidson, *The Hebrew Text of the Old Testament*, 2nd ed. (London: Samuel Bagster and Sons, 1859), 89.

5. A Faith-Based Conclusion

a. The line of custody can be traced. God committed the Hebrew Scriptures to the Jews; their scribes copied and guarded them; the Masoretes continued that work; printed Hebrew Bibles, including the Second Rabbinic Bible of Jacob ben Chayyim (1524–25), carried the text into the Reformation; and the King James translators used that __Masoretic__ text.

> **Psalm 147:19–20**
> 19 *He sheweth his word unto Jacob, his statutes and his judgments unto Israel.* 20 *He hath not dealt so with any nation: and as for his judgments, they have not known them. Praise ye the LORD.*

REVIEW

What does Romans 3:1–2 imply about where the student of the Old Testament should look for its text?

Masoretic Text and the Dead Sea Scrolls

LESSON 11 The Hebrew Text before and after Christ

KEY TEXTS: Isa. 40:8; Matt. 5:18; Luke 24:44

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Summarize the evidence of the Dead Sea Scrolls for the Masoretic Text. (2) Explain why a later copy can preserve an older reading.*

The Masoretic Text (MT) is the traditional Hebrew text copied by Jewish scribes and furnished with vowels, accents, and marginal notes. Its great complete codices, such as the Aleppo Codex (c. 930) and the Leningrad Codex (1008), are medieval.

1. The Dead Sea Scrolls Confirm the Masoretic Text

a. The scrolls found near ____Qumran____ between 1947 and 1956 supplied Hebrew biblical manuscripts about a ___thousand___ years older than those codices. Rather than overturning the MT, they showed how carefully the Hebrew Bible had been transmitted.[30]

Figure 4. The Great Isaiah Scroll (1QIsa[a]), Israel Museum, Jerusalem: all fifty-four columns of the scroll, shown in three rows.

b. The Great ____Isaiah____ Scroll (1QIsa[a]), dated about 125 B.C., contains all sixty-six chapters of Isaiah. Millar Burrows wrote in 1948 that "the whole book is here, and it is substantially the book preserved in the Masoretic text."[31]

c. Gleason Archer estimated that the Qumran Isaiah scrolls agree word for word with the standard Hebrew text in more than _____95_____ percent of their text; most of the remainder consists of spelling variations and obvious slips of the pen.[32]

d. The second Isaiah scroll (1QIsa[b]) agrees still more closely. Jarod Jacobs counted 157

[30] Tov, *Textual Criticism of the Hebrew Bible*, 29–39.

[31] Millar Burrows, "Variant Readings in the Isaiah Manuscript," *Bulletin of the American Schools of Oriental Research*, no. 111 (October 1948): 16.

[32] Gleason L. Archer Jr., *A Survey of Old Testament Introduction*, updated and rev. ed. (Chicago: Moody Press, 1994), 29.

variants among 4,627 preserved words, about 3.4 percent, and Peter Flint and Eugene Ulrich classify the scroll as __proto-Masoretic__.[33]

e. Surveys of the biblical scrolls commonly classify about 60 percent as proto-Masoretic and about 5 percent as aligned with distinctive __Septuagint__ readings.[34] The Masoretic line was already established in Jewish use more than a century before Christ.

> **ISAIAH 40:8**
> *The grass withereth, the flower fadeth: but the word of our God shall stand for ever.*

2. Archaeological Support

a. The Tel Dan Stele (ninth century B.C.) spells David's name DWD (דוד). The Great Isaiah Scroll sometimes uses the fuller DWYD (דויד), while the MT keeps the older _____DWD_____. A later copy can preserve an older form; the date of a manuscript does not fix the age of its text.

b. The Masoretes marked some words with a *qere* ("what is read") in the margin while leaving the written *ketiv* ("what is written") untouched. They would not alter the consonants they had received.

3. Jesus and the Hebrew Text Preserved by the Jews

a. Christ's *jot* and *tittle* (Matt. 5:18) are features of Hebrew script. His threefold description of the Scriptures follows the Hebrew ____canon_____, which did not include the Apocrypha.

> **LUKE 24:44**
> *And he said unto them, These are the words which I spake unto you, while I was yet with you, that all things must be fulfilled, which were written in the law of Moses, and in the prophets, and in the psalms, concerning me.*

[33] Jarod T. Jacobs, "The Balance of Probability: A Statistically Based Analysis of the Linguistic Character of the 'Biblical' Dead Sea Scrolls" (PhD diss., University of Manchester, 2015), 91–96; Peter W. Flint and Eugene Ulrich, "The Variant Textual Readings in the Hebrew University Isaiah Scroll (1QIsab)," *Journal of Jewish Studies* 60, no. 1 (2009): 60.

[34] Lawrence H. Schiffman, *Reclaiming the Dead Sea Scrolls* (Philadelphia: Jewish Publication Society, 1994), 138.

REVIEW

Why can a later copy preserve an older reading? Use the spelling of David's name as an example.

What the Septuagint Is (and Isn't)

LESSON 12 Greek Witnesses and the Hebrew Standard

KEY TEXTS: Rom. 3:2; Luke 4:16–21; Matt. 5:18; Luke 24:44

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Distinguish the three things commonly called "the Septuagint." (2) Explain why the Hebrew text remains the standard for the Old Testament.*

The Septuagint (LXX, the Roman numeral seventy) is often described as one complete Greek Old Testament made in Alexandria about 250 B.C. and used by Jesus and the apostles. Greek translations of parts of the Old Testament existed before Christ, but the surviving evidence does not show one complete and ____fixed____ Greek Bible at that date.

1. The Modern Claim

a. Common statements combine three different things: an early Greek translation of the Law, later translations of other books, and the fourth- and fifth-century ___codices___ from which the Septuagint is reconstructed today. Evidence for one is not evidence for all three.

2. The Letter of Aristeas

a. The Letter claims that Ptolemy II Philadelphus brought seventy-two elders to Alexandria to translate the Law for his library. Even on its own terms it concerns only the __Pentateuch__, and scholars widely regard it as pseudepigraphical, probably written in the second century B.C.[35]

3. Later Accounts and the Earliest Fragments

a. Philo and Josephus repeat the story. Josephus himself says that the king received "only the books of the law" (*Antiquities* 1.12). Paul ____Kahle____ argued against the idea of one original, complete Septuagint in Jesus' day.[36]

b. The earliest Greek Old Testament manuscript, Rylands Papyrus 458 (second century B.C.), preserves only fragments of __Deuteronomy__.[37] No complete Greek Old Testament survives from before the Christian era.

[35] Karen H. Jobes and Moisés Silva, *Invitation to the Septuagint*, 2nd ed. (Grand Rapids: Baker Academic, 2015), 37–41.

[36] Paul E. Kahle, *The Cairo Geniza*, 2nd ed. (Oxford: Basil Blackwell, 1959), 223–26.

[37] C. H. Roberts, ed., *Two Biblical Papyri in the John Rylands Library, Manchester* (Manchester: Manchester University Press, 1936).

4. Origen's Hexapla

a. Origen's Hexapla (third century) set the Hebrew text, a Greek transliteration, and the Greek versions of Aquila, Symmachus, the Septuagint, and Theodotion in six parallel ___columns___.[38] He marked his changes to the Septuagint column with critical signs; later copyists often dropped the signs, so his revisions entered the Greek text itself.[39]

5. Why the Hebrew Text Remains the Standard

a. *Custody.* God committed His oracles to the Jews (Rom. 3:2), not to a pagan king or an Alexandrian library.

b. *Canon.* The Greek codices place apocryphal books among the canonical books.

c. *Unity.* Vaticanus, Sinaiticus, and Alexandrinus differ from one another in wording, order, and contents.

d. *Method.* It is ___circular___ to correct the Hebrew by a later Greek codex and then cite the corrected reading as proof that the Hebrew is wrong.

6. Did Jesus and the Apostles Use Greek Translations?

a. New Testament quotations sometimes follow the Hebrew wording, sometimes known Greek forms, and sometimes neither, because the inspired writers translate, condense, or apply the passage. At Nazareth Christ read from a ____scroll____ of Isaiah (Luke 4:17), not from a fourth-century codex.

[38] Frederick Field, *Origenis Hexaplorum quae supersunt*, 2 vols. (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1875).

[39] Henry Barclay Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 69–72.

REVIEW

What three things does the word "Septuagint" commonly describe, and why does the distinction matter?

Part III: The New Testament

The Text the Church Actually Used

LESSON 13 The Word Received, Read, and Kept

Key texts: 1 Thess. 2:13; 5:27; Col. 4:16; Rom. 16:22; 2 Tim. 2:2; 1 Pet. 2:5, 9; 1 Tim. 3:15

Objectives: *(1) Describe how the New Testament was written, circulated, copied, and received. (2) Explain the priesthood of believers as the means of New Testament preservation.*

The decisive question is not only which manuscript is oldest but which text the churches actually ___received___, read, preached, and copied.

> **1 Thessalonians 2:13**
> *For this cause also thank we God without ceasing, because, when ye received the word of God which ye heard of us, ye received it not as the word of men, but as it is in truth, the word of God, which effectually worketh also in you that believe.*

The traditional text is not always represented by the oldest surviving copies, because heavily used copies were read, recopied, and ___worn out___. The name *Textus Receptus* reflects that history of use.

1. The Process of New Testament Preservation

Stage	Scripture
1. The Holy Spirit revealed truth to the apostles	John 16:13
2. The apostles and their scribes wrote it down	1 Cor. 5:9; Eph. 3:3; Rom. 16:22
3. The letters were delivered to churches and individuals	Col. 4:16; 3 John 9
4. The recipients read them aloud, copied, and exchanged them	Col. 4:16; 1 Thess. 5:27
5. Faithful men received and passed them to others	2 Tim. 2:2; 1 Tim. 6:20

a. Because the New Testament passed through many scattered Gentile churches rather than one central priesthood, its transmission was more laborious than that of the Old Testament. It was preserved by the __priesthood__ of believers functioning in local churches (1 Pet. 2:5).

> **Colossians 4:16**
> *And when this epistle is read among you, cause that it be read also in the church of the Laodiceans; and that ye likewise read the epistle from Laodicea.*

b. John Burgon observed that lectionaries "establish the Text which has been publicly

read in the churches of the East, from at least A.D. 400 until the time of the invention of printing."[40]

c. The church did not make Scripture inspired by receiving it, but its reception is historical ___evidence___ of preservation. A text read in worship, translated for missions, and copied for generations has a different history from a manuscript that fell out of use.

2. Edward Hills on Naturalism and Faith

a. Hills, trained at Yale, Westminster, and Harvard, argued that naturalistic criticism studies the New Testament "in the same way in which we study the texts of secular books which have not been preserved by God's special providence."[41] Westcott and Hort had declared that they dared not introduce considerations that could not reasonably be applied to other ___ancient___ texts.[42]

b. Daniel Wallace states the principle directly: "A theological a priori has no place in textual criticism."[43]

c. Hills did not reject scholarship. He insisted that it remain under the authority of Scripture and the faith of God's people.

> **PSALM 119:99**
> *I have more understanding than all my teachers: for thy testimonies are my meditation.*

3. The Priesthood of Believers and the Preservation of Scripture

a. Hills wrote that "the New Testament text has been preserved by the universal priesthood of believers, by faithful Christians in every walk of life."[44]

> **1 PETER 2:9**
> *But ye are a chosen generation, a royal priesthood, an holy nation, a peculiar people; that ye should shew forth the praises of him who hath called you out of darkness into his marvellous light:*

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[40] John William Burgon, *The Revision Revised* (London: John Murray, 1883), 11.

[41] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 320.

[42] Westcott and Hort, *New Testament in the Original Greek*, 2:277.

[43] Daniel B. Wallace, "Challenges in New Testament Textual Criticism for the Twenty-First Century," *Journal of the Evangelical Theological Society* 52, no. 1 (March 2009): 86.

[44] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 144.

b. As the Levites kept the Old Testament, the New Testament was entrusted to the believing ____church____, which Paul calls *the pillar and ground of the truth* (1 Tim. 3:15).

4. From the Church's Received Text to the King James Bible

a. The chain runs from apostolic circulation to early versions, lectionaries, patristic quotation, and the multiplication of Byzantine manuscripts; printing then carried that tradition into the Reformation as the Textus Receptus, which the King James Bible rendered into ___English___.

REVIEW

Why might the most-used manuscripts be less likely to survive than unused ones? What does this imply for the claim that the oldest is best?

Evidence: Manuscripts, Versions, and Fathers

LESSON 14 Three Kinds of Witnesses

KEY TEXTS: Deut. 19:15; Matt. 18:16; 2 Cor. 13:1

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Classify the witnesses to the New Testament text. (2) Summarize the evidence favoring the Received Text.*

Textual evidence comes in three kinds: Greek __manuscripts__, ancient versions (translations), and quotations in early Christian writers. The date of a witness, the date of its reading, and the kind of witness must be kept distinct.

> **DEUTERONOMY 19:15**
> *One witness shall not rise up against a man for any iniquity, or for any sin, in any sin that he sinneth: at the mouth of two witnesses, or at the mouth of three witnesses, shall the matter be established.*

1. Manuscript Evidence

a. The Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF) in Münster catalogues about __5,700__ Greek New Testament manuscripts, most of them partial, in four categories: papyri, majuscules, minuscules, and lectionaries.[45]

b. The readings of these manuscripts reflect the Byzantine text-type 80 to 95 percent of the time.[46] Fewer than fifty are consistently Alexandrian, and three of them, B, א, and A, form the __backbone__ of the critical text.

c. Zane Hodges argued that "the copies nearest the autograph will normally have the largest number of descendants."[47] Hort himself allowed "a theoretical presumption" that a majority of extant documents represents a __majority__ of ancestral documents.[48]

d. Jack Moorman observed that with some 85 percent of manuscripts belonging to the Received Text, there is in fact one textual family; the remainder is too mixed to form genuine families.[49]

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[45] Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), "The Greek Manuscripts of the New Testament," New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room (NTVMR), University of Münster, accessed June 30, 2026, https://ntvmr.uni-muenster.de/.

[46] Wilbur N. Pickering, *The Identity of the New Testament Text* (Nashville: Thomas Nelson, 1977), 155–56.

[47] Zane C. Hodges, "Modern Textual Criticism and the Majority Text: A Defense," *Bibliotheca Sacra* 125, no. 517 (January–March 1968): 1.

[48] Westcott and Hort, *New Testament in the Original Greek*, 2:45.

[49] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 54.

2. Early Readings

a. Byzantine readings appear early in the Syriac ___Peshitta___[50] and in the Old Latin, which most scholars place in North Africa by the late second century.[51] The Gothic version was translated by Ulfilas about A.D. 350.[52]

b. P66 (c. 200) and P45 (third century) contain readings later preserved in the Byzantine tradition, and Sturz identified about 150 distinctively Byzantine readings in early papyri.[53] Codex Alexandrinus (A) is predominantly Byzantine in the ___Gospels___.

c. Moorman compared the great uncials ℵ, A, C, D(05), and D(06) with the Textus Receptus and Vaticanus where those two differ: the uncials side with the TR 7,909 times and with Vaticanus 5,924 times.[54]

3. Patristic Quotations

a. From Polycarp to A.D. 400, more than 2,630 patristic quotations reflect the Received Text.[55] ___Irenaeus___ (c. 180) quotes Mark 16:19 as the conclusion of Mark's Gospel,[56] and Cyprian (c. 250) cites *and these three are one* from 1 John 5:7.

b. Patristic evidence is weighed with care, since a writer may quote loosely and his works were copied by hand. A clear citation nevertheless fixes a reading at a known date and place, and these witnesses show disputed Received Text readings in the second and third __centuries__.

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[50] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 227.

[51] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 50.

[52] Kenyon, *Handbook*, 240.

[53] Sturz, *Byzantine Text-Type*, 145–59.

[54] Jack A. Moorman, *Early Manuscripts, Church Fathers, and the Authorized Version: With Manuscript Digests and Summaries* (Collingswood, NJ: Bible for Today Press, 2005), 45–51.

[55] Frederic G. Kenyon, *Handbook to the Textual Criticism of the New Testament* (London: Macmillan, 1901), 375–76.

[56] Irenaeus, *Against Heresies* 3.10.5, in *Ante-Nicene Fathers*, vol. 1, ed. Alexander Roberts and James Donaldson (Peabody, MA: Hendrickson, 1994), 426.

4. Factors Favoring the Received Text

Factor	Evidence
1. Number	The large majority of Greek manuscripts
2. Antiquity of use	Readings attested in the second-century versions and fathers
3. Breadth	Used and translated in Asia, Africa, and Europe; read in the lectionaries
4. Reception	Received and believed by the churches for well over a thousand years
5. Character of its rivals	The Alexandrian witnesses disagree with one another (Lesson 15)

a. The traditional text was defended in the nineteenth century by John William Burgon, Edward Miller, and Herman Hoskier, whose arguments, the course notes observe, were more often set aside than ___answered___.

REVIEW

Which kind of witness provides the earliest evidence for Mark 16:9–20? Why is that significant?

The Alexandrian Cluster (B, א, A) in Context

LESSON 15 The Great Codices Examined

KEY TEXTS: Matt. 7:16–20; Matt. 24:35

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Describe the history and contents of Vaticanus, Sinaiticus, and Alexandrinus. (2) Evaluate the claim that these codices are the "oldest and best."*

Modern critical editions give the greatest weight to three codices: Vaticanus (B, c. 325–350), Sinaiticus (א, c. 330–360), and Alexandrinus (A, c. 400–450). Each is connected with Egypt and the Alexandrian text.

1. Vaticanus (B)

a. Some scholars identify B and א with the ____fifty____ Bibles Constantine ordered from Eusebius of Caesarea for the churches of Constantinople.[57] A. T. Robertson judged it "quite possible that א and B are two of these fifty, though the actual copying was probably done in Egypt or by Egyptian scribes."[58]

b. Through physical loss, B's New Testament breaks off at ___Hebrews___ 9:14; it lacks the Pastoral Epistles, Philemon, and Revelation. Its Old Testament includes the Apocrypha. It appears in a Vatican Library catalogue of 1475.[59] Tischendorf was permitted to study it for about forty-two hours before publishing his edition of 1867.[60]

c. B ends Mark at 16:8 but leaves the following column blank, the only such blank column in its New Testament.

[57] Eusebius of Caesarea, *Life of Constantine*, trans. Averil Cameron and Stuart G. Hall (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1999), 166–69 (IV.36–37); T. C. Skeat, "The Codex Sinaiticus, the Codex Vaticanus and Constantine," *Journal of Theological Studies*, n.s., 50, no. 2 (1999): 583–625.

[58] A. T. Robertson, *An Introduction to the Textual Criticism of the New Testament* (Nashville: Sunday School Board of the Southern Baptist Convention, 1925), 80.

[59] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 48.

[60] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 129.

2. Sinaiticus (א)

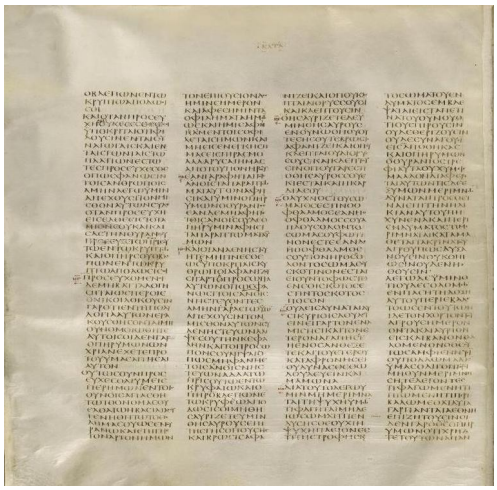

Figure 5. Codex Sinaiticus (א), British Library, Matthew 6:4–32. Four columns of majuscule script per page; later correctors' marks appear between the lines and in the margins.

a. Constantin von Tischendorf obtained leaves of א at St. Catherine's Monastery, Mount Sinai, in 1844; by his own account some lay in a ____basket____ of material to be burned. The bulk followed in 1859, and the British Museum bought the codex from the Soviet government in 1933.[61]

b. The codex has four columns of forty-eight lines per page.[62] It bears thousands of corrections by later hands; a note at the end of Esdras states that its exemplar was corrected against the Hexapla of ____Origen____.[63]

3. The Testimony of the Collations

a. Using the Received Text as a standard, Burgon tabulated the departures of B and א in the four Gospels:[64]

Codex	Omits	Adds	Substitutes	Transposes	Modifies	Total
B	2,877	536	935	2,098	1,132	7,578
א	3,455	839	1,114	2,299	1,265	8,972

b. Herman Hoskier counted 3,036 differences between B and א in the Gospels alone.[65]

[61] Codex Sinaiticus Project, "History of Codex Sinaiticus," accessed September 22, 2026, https://www.codexsinaiticus.org/en/codex/history.aspx.

[62] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 83.

[63] J. F. Fenlon, "Codex Sinaiticus," *The Catholic Encyclopedia* 4 (New York: Robert Appleton, 1908), 85–86.

[64] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 84–85.

[65] H. C. Hoskier, *Codex B and Its Allies: A Study and an Indictment*, 2 vols. (London: Bernard Quaritch, 1914), 2:1.

Burgon remarked, "It is in fact easier to find two consecutive verses in which B and א differ, than two consecutive verses in which they ___agree___."[66]

4. Alexandrinus (A)

a. Codex A was presented to __Charles I___ of England in 1627. Its text is mixed: Byzantine in the Gospels, Alexandrian in Acts and the Epistles, and distinctive in Revelation.

5. Two Streams in Summary

	Majority (Byzantine) line	**Minority (Alexandrian) line**
Origin	Antioch and the Greek-speaking churches	Alexandria, Egypt
Principal witnesses	Most Greek manuscripts; lectionaries	B, א, and a small group of allies
Support	Early versions and fathers	Some papyri; Origen's tradition
Printed form	The Textus Receptus	Westcott–Hort (1881); NA/UBS
English Bible	The King James Bible	RV (1881) and modern versions
History	Read and copied by the churches	Preserved chiefly in __libraries

> **MATTHEW 7:16**
> *Ye shall know them by their fruits. Do men gather grapes of thorns, or figs of thistles?*

REVIEW

"Age without use is no virtue." Evaluate this statement in light of the history of B and א.

[66] Burgon, *Revision Revised*, 12.

FROM THE RECEIVED TEXT TO THE KING JAMES BIBLE

LESSON 16 The Preparation and Completion of the English Bible

KEY TEXTS: Ps. 12:6–7; Prov. 11:14; Eccl. 8:4; Acts 15:6, 22

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Trace the English Bible from Wycliffe to 1611. (2) Describe the rules, companies, and review process of the King James translators.*

1. The English Bible Prepared the Way

a. John Wycliffe, called "the morning star of the Reformation," appealed to Scripture as the supreme authority.[67] The Wycliffite Bible of the 1380s, the first complete Bible in English, was translated from Latin and copied by hand; about 250 manuscripts survive.[68]

b. William ___Tyndale___ vowed that a boy that driveth the plough should know more of the Scripture than a learned opponent.[69] He printed the first English New Testament translated from Greek (1526) and the Pentateuch from Hebrew (1530). Nielson and Skousen estimate that about 84 percent of the words of the KJV New Testament are Tyndale's.[70]

c. Tyndale was strangled and burned at Vilvorde in 1536, praying, "Lord, open the King of England's eyes." Within three years the Great Bible stood in England's ___churches___.

2. Printing, Erasmus, and the Reformation Bibles

a. Johannes Gutenberg's press, using movable type, produced its first great book, the Latin Bible, about 1455.[71] Printing multiplied identical copies and carried the Scriptures further than any means before it.

b. Desiderius ___Erasmus___ (c. 1466–1536), the leading scholar of his age, printed the first Greek New Testament in 1516. In its preface he wished the Scriptures translated into all languages, that the farmer might sing them at the plow and the weaver at his loom.[72]

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[67] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 139.

[68] Anne Hudson, "The First Complete English Bible," *Tyndale Society Journal*, no. 2; Mary Dove, *The First English Bible: The Text and Context of the Wycliffite Versions* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2007), 281–306.

[69] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 160.

[70] Jon Nielson and Royal Skousen, "How Much of the King James Bible Is William Tyndale's? An Estimation Based on Sampling," *Reformation* 3, no. 1 (1998): 49–74, https://doi.org/10.1179/ref_1998_3_1_004.

[71] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 112–13.

[72] Desiderius Erasmus, *Paraclesis*, preface to *Novum Instrumentum omne* (Basel: Johann Froben, 1516).

Reformation Bible	Date
Luther's German New Testament; complete Bible	1522; 1534
Olivetan's French Bible	1535
Swedish (Uppsala) Bible	1541
Danish (Christian III) Bible	1550
Spanish Bible of Casiodoro de Reina	1569
Czech (Kralice) Bible	1579–93
Diodati's Italian Bible	1607

c. Coverdale (1535) produced the first complete printed English Bible; Matthew's Bible (1537) joined Tyndale and Coverdale; the Great Bible (1539) was appointed for the parish churches.[73] The Geneva Bible (1560) was the first complete English Bible with numbered ____verses____.[74]

3. The Hampton Court Conference

a. On his way south in 1603, James VI of Scotland, now James I of England, received the Millenary Petition, said to bear the names of a thousand Puritan ministers. He answered it with a conference at __Hampton Court__ in January 1604.[75]

b. There John Rainolds (Reynolds), president of Corpus Christi College, Oxford, asked that "the Bible be new translated, such as are extant not answering the original."[76] The king ordered a translation "as consonant as can be to the original Hebrew and Greek," to be printed without marginal notes and read in all the churches.

c. No existing Bible could unite the nation: the Great Bible was cumbersome, the king objected to the Geneva notes, and the Bishops' Bible had not won the people. The Bishops' Bible of 1602 became the translators' ___starting___ text.[77]

> **ECCLESIASTES 8:4**
> *Where the word of a king is, there is power: and who may say unto him, What doest thou?*

[73] J. F. Mozley, *Coverdale and His Bibles* (London: Lutterworth Press, 1953), 221.

[74] Kent P. Jackson, Frank F. Judd Jr., and David R. Seely, "Chapters, Verses, Punctuation, Spelling, and Italics," in *The King James Bible and the Restoration*, ed. Kent P. Jackson (Provo, UT: Religious Studies Center, Brigham Young University, 2011), 95–117; Bruce M. Metzger, "The Geneva Bible of 1560," *Theology Today* 17, no. 3 (October 1960): 339–52.

[75] Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 186–87.

[76] William Barlow, *The Summe and Substance of the Conference … at Hampton Court* (London: Mathew Law, 1604), 45–46.

[77] "The Rules to Be Observed in the Translation of the Bible," in Alfred W. Pollard, ed., *Records of the English Bible* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1911), 53–55; David Norton, *A Textual History of the King James Bible* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2005), 8, 23–24.

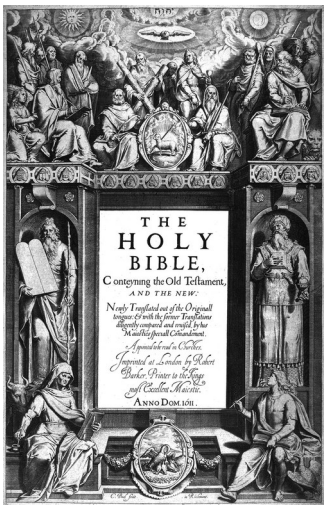

Figure 6. Title page of the 1611 King James Bible: "Newly Translated out of the Originall tongues: & with the former Translations diligently compared and reuised."

4. How the King James Translators Worked

a. Fifty-four men were appointed; the names of forty-seven survive. They worked in ____six____ companies, two each at Westminster, Oxford, and Cambridge (see Appendix B).[78]

b. Fifteen ___rules___ governed the work (Appendix C). Rule 1 made the Bishops' Bible the base, "as little altered as the Truth of the original will permit"; Rule 14 required comparison with Tyndale, Matthew, Coverdale, Whitchurch (the Great Bible), and Geneva "when they agree better with the Text."

c. Each translator worked the passage alone; his company compared and agreed on a text; finished books went to the other companies; differences went to a general __meeting__ (Rules 8–10).

d. A final committee of twelve, two from each company, reviewed the whole for about nine months at Stationers' Hall in London.[79] Miles Smith and Thomas Bilson saw it through the press, and Robert Barker, the King's Printer, issued it in 1611 with 8,422 marginal notes.[80]

[78] David Norton, *The King James Bible: A Short History from Tyndale to Today* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2011), 54–55.

[79] Ward Allen, *Translating for King James: Notes Made by a Translator of King James's Bible* (Nashville: Vanderbilt University Press, 1969), 28–35.

[80] F. H. A. Scrivener, *The Authorized Edition of the English Bible (1611): Its Subsequent Reprints and Modern Representatives* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1884), 56, 69–71.

5. The Historical Setting

a. The work was carried through in a dangerous season: the Spanish Armada was defeated in 1588, the Gunpowder Plot against King James and Parliament failed in November 1605, and the Roman Catholic Douay–Rheims Bible was completed in 1609–10.

6. Why the Process Ends with the King James Bible

a. Six marks converge: the Masoretic Hebrew text, the Received Greek Text, a ___formal___ (word-for-word) method, the strength of earlier English Bibles, layered review, and centuries of reception by English-speaking churches.

> **Proverbs 11:14**
> *Where no counsel is, the people fall: but in the multitude of counsellors there is safety.*

REVIEW

Why would repeated independent and group review strengthen a translation? Compare Proverbs 11:14 and Acts 15:6, 22.

Part IV: Other Issues

Translation Practices: Dynamic vs. Formal Equivalence: Why Translation Philosophy Matters

LESSON 17 Translating the Words God Gave

Key texts: Deut. 4:2; Prov. 30:5–6; Matt. 4:4; Jer. 23:36

Objectives: *(1) Define translation, version, paraphrase, and transliteration. (2) Distinguish formal from dynamic equivalence and evaluate their consequences.*

English Bibles differ for two reasons: they translate different Hebrew or Greek readings, or they translate the same reading by different ___methods___. In the worst cases both causes combine.

1. Four Terms

Term	Definition	Example
Translation	Rendering a work from one language into another	The Geneva Bible
Version	A particular translation of Scripture	The King James Version
Paraphrase	Restating the sense in the translator's own words	The Living Bible (1971)
Transliteration	Carrying a word over by its sound	*Amen, hallelujah, baptize*

2. Formal and Dynamic Equivalence

a. ___Formal___ (verbal) equivalence renders the words and structures of the original as closely as the receiving language allows. The King James Bible follows this method, consistent with Scripture's claim to the inspiration of words (Matt. 4:4; Prov. 30:5).

b. ___Dynamic___ (functional) equivalence, formulated by Eugene Nida in the mid-twentieth century, seeks to reproduce the thought or effect the translator believes the text conveys, restructuring sentences for the modern reader.[81] Its measure is the reader's response rather than fidelity to the words. Nida's method shaped the Good News Bible (1976) and the New Living Translation (1996).

> **Deuteronomy 4:2**
> *Ye shall not add unto the word which I command you, neither shall ye diminish ought from it, that ye may keep the commandments of the LORD your God which I command you.*

[81] Eugene A. Nida, *Toward a Science of Translating* (Leiden: E. J. Brill, 1964), 159, 166–68.

3. The Translator's Responsibility

a. Formal equivalence lets the reader see what the text says and interpret it himself. Dynamic equivalence places the translator's __interpretation__ into the text itself, where the reader cannot separate it from the original.

b. D. A. Waite warned that for a work presented as a translation of God's words to add words of its own "is adding to the Words of God."[82] He likened the serpent's handling of God's command in Genesis 3 to a loose __paraphrase__.[83]

c. The King James translators marked ___supplied___ words, those required by English but not represented by a separate Hebrew or Greek word. The 1611 printing set them in roman type within its blackletter; later editions use italics.[84]

> **PROVERBS 30:6**
> *Add thou not unto his words, lest he reprove thee, and thou be found a liar.*

4. The Aim of the 1611 Translators

a. The translators described their purpose: "to make a good one better, or out of many good ones, one principal good one, not justly to be excepted against."[85] They set out to perfect a received English tradition, not to replace it.

5. Conclusion: The Dangers of Dynamic Equivalence

a. Even a sound underlying text can be corrupted by a thought-for-thought method, because the translator is free to restate God's words in his own. The issue is both which manuscripts are used and _____how_____ they are translated.

b. At root the difference concerns what the Bible is: the very words of God, or a vehicle for religious ____ideas____.

> **JEREMIAH 23:36**
> *And the burden of the LORD shall ye mention no more: for every man's word shall be his burden; for ye have perverted the words of the living God, of the LORD of hosts our God.*

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[82] D. A. Waite, *Defending the King James Bible: A Fourfold Superiority—Texts, Translators, Technique, Theology*, 3rd ed. (Collingswood, NJ: Bible for Today Press, 2006), 151.

[83] Waite, *Defending the King James Bible*, 119.

[84] Jackson, Judd, and Seely, "Chapters, Verses," 101–2.

[85] "Translators to the Reader," 296–97.

REVIEW

Choose a verse and compare a formal rendering with a dynamic one. What is gained, and what is lost?

Doctrinal Issues (Why the "small" changes aren't small)

LESSON 18 The Person of Christ and the Gospel

KEY TEXTS: 1 Tim. 3:16; Phil. 2:6; John 1:18; 1 John 5:7; Luke 2:33; Dan. 3:25; Col. 1:14; Acts 8:37

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Explain why textual and translational differences bear on doctrine. (2) Evaluate readings concerning the deity of Christ and the gospel.*

It is often said that the differences between versions affect no doctrine. A doctrine may survive elsewhere while a particular verse's testimony to it is weakened or removed. God promised to preserve every word (Matt. 4:4), not merely enough ____verses____ for each doctrine.

1 Timothy 3:16

KJV *God was manifest in the flesh*

ESV "He was manifested in the flesh"[86]

The Received Text reads θεός (God); the critical text reads ὅς (who). The KJV states that ____God____ Himself was manifest in the flesh; *He* leaves the subject indefinite.[87]

Philippians 2:6

KJV *Who, being in the form of God, thought it not robbery to be equal with God*

ESV "who, though he was in the form of God, did not count equality with God a thing to be grasped"

The KJV states that equality with God was Christ's by right; the modern rendering can be read as though it were something He did not possess.

John 1:18

KJV *the only begotten Son, which is in the bosom of the Father*

ESV "the only God, who is at the Father's side"

The KJV reads μονογενὴς υἱός (only begotten Son), preserving the distinction of Father and ____Son____ within the one Godhead.

1 John 5:7

KJV *For there are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one.*

NIV "For there are three that testify"

Modern versions omit the heavenly witnesses or relegate them to a ___footnote___, removing the most explicit statement of the ___Trinity___ in Scripture. Lesson 22 examines the verse's history.

[86] English Standard Version.

[87] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, chap. 5, sec. 3(h), discussion of 1 Timothy 3:16.

Luke 2:33

KJV *And Joseph and his mother marvelled*

ESV "And his father and his mother marveled"

The KJV names Joseph, guarding the __virgin birth__; the critical text calls him Jesus' father (ὁ πατὴρ αὐτοῦ). Luke records that Jesus was *as was supposed* the son of Joseph (Luke 3:23).

Luke 2:22

KJV *the days of her purification*

CSB "the days of their purification"

The law of Moses required the purification of the mother after childbirth (Lev. 12:2–6), not of both parents.

Daniel 3:25

KJV *the form of the fourth is like the Son of God*

NASB "the appearance of the fourth is like a son of the gods"

The KJV preserves the testimony that the fourth man in the fire bore the likeness of the Son of God.

Colossians 1:14

KJV *In whom we have redemption through his blood, even the forgiveness of sins*

NIV "in whom we have redemption, the forgiveness of sins"

The critical text omits *through his blood*. The phrase remains in Ephesians 1:7, but Colossians loses its own statement of the ____means_____ of redemption (cf. Heb. 9:12, 22).

Acts 8:37

KJV *If thou believest with all thine heart, thou mayest. … I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God.*

CSB Verse omitted; placed in a footnote

The omission removes the testimony that faith in Christ precedes ___baptism___. Irenaeus (c. 180) already cites the eunuch's confession.[88]

[88] Irenaeus, *Against Heresies* 3.12.8.

REVIEW

Choose one of the passages above and explain what doctrine is affected by the modern reading.

Doctrinal Issues (Why the "small" changes aren't small)

LESSON 19 Prayer, Accuracy, and the Gospel

KEY TEXTS: Mark 9:29; Matt. 17:21; Luke 11:2–4; Mark 1:2; Ps. 12:7; Matt. 9:13; Rom. 8:1; Matt. 6:13; John 7:8; 3:16; Matt. 5:22

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Evaluate textual differences affecting prayer, accuracy, and the gospel. (2) Distinguish differences of text from differences of translation.*

Mark 9:29

KJV *This kind can come forth by nothing, but by prayer and fasting.*

CSB "This kind can come out by nothing but prayer."

The shorter reading removes ___fasting___ from Christ's instruction. The words *and fasting* stand in P45 (third century), the earliest manuscript of the passage, and are omitted chiefly by ℵ and B.

Matthew 17:21

KJV *Howbeit this kind goeth not out but by prayer and fasting.*

NIV Verse omitted

The parallel verse is removed entirely, so the teaching disappears from both ___Gospels___. Christ assumed His disciples would fast (Matt. 6:16–18; 9:15). When a teaching is removed in two places at once, the change is a ___pattern___.

Luke 11:2

KJV *Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth.*

NASB "Father, hallowed be Your name. Your kingdom come."

The shorter text of Luke's prayer also omits *deliver us from evil* in verse 4.

Mark 1:2

KJV *As it is written in the prophets*

ESV "As it is written in Isaiah the prophet"

Mark quotes Malachi 3:1 and then Isaiah 40:3. *In the prophets* is exact; *in Isaiah the prophet* attributes a quotation of Malachi to ___Isaiah___.

Psalm 12:7

KJV *Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever.*

NIV "You, LORD, will keep the needy safe and will protect us forever from the wicked."

The KJV applies verse 7 to the *words* of verse 6; the NIV applies it to people, removing a principal Old Testament promise of preservation.

Matthew 9:13

KJV *I am not come to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance.*

CSB "For I didn't come to call the righteous, but sinners."

Without *to repentance* the purpose of Christ's call is incomplete; even the critical text retains the words at Luke 5:32.

Romans 8:1

KJV *There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.*

ESV "There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."

The KJV retains Paul's description of those in Christ as walking after the ___Spirit___, the theme of 8:4–14.

Matthew 6:13

KJV *For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.*

ESV Omitted from the text; placed in a footnote

The closing ___doxology___ of the Lord's Prayer returns the prayer to the praise of God.

John 7:8

KJV *I go not up yet unto this feast*

ESV "I am not going up to this feast"

Christ went up to the feast a few days later (John 7:10). *Yet* preserves the truthfulness of His statement.

John 3:16

KJV *his only begotten Son*

NIV "his one and only Son"

Believers are sons of God by adoption (Gal. 4:5), but Christ alone is the only ___begotten___ Son of the Father.

1. Further Comparisons from the Class Notes

a. Some differences arise from the underlying text, others from translation. The first example below is textual; the rest are __translational__.

Passage	KJV	Modern rendering	Observation
Matt. 5:22	*angry with his brother without a cause*	"angry with his brother" (ESV)	Omits the qualifier; compare *hated me without a cause* (Ps. 69:4; John 15:25)
Gen. 37:3	*a coat of many colours*	"an ornate robe" (NIV)	The same Hebrew phrase describes Tamar's royal garment of *divers colours* (2 Sam. 13:18)
Rom. 1:25	*changed the truth of God into a lie*	"exchanged the truth about God for a lie" (ESV)	The KJV keeps the truth *of* God, which men corrupt
2 Tim. 2:15	*Study to shew thyself approved*	"Do your best to present yourself" (ESV)	The KJV joins diligence to the study of the Word
Judg. 5:14	*they that handle the pen of the writer*	"those who bear a commander's staff" (NIV)	The KJV records writing with a pen in the time of the judges
1 Cor. 11:1	*Be ye followers of me*	"Be imitators of me" (ESV)	Following is obedience; imitation can be counterfeit (2 Cor. 11:13–15)

b. In each case the reader of a formal English Bible can see the words and weigh the __difference__ for himself.

REVIEW

Why is it insufficient to say that a doctrine "is still taught somewhere else in the Bible"?

Ease of Reading

LESSON 20 Understanding and Teaching the Words

Key texts: Ps. 119:130; Prov. 2:4–5; Luke 22:31–32; Mark 12:37; Ps. 19:7

Objectives: *(1) Evaluate the claim that the KJV is too difficult to read. (2) Explain the value of the KJV's pronouns and oral cadence.*

The most frequent practical objection to the King James Bible is that it is too hard to read. The claim can be tested rather than assumed.

1. What the Numbers Actually Say

a. Readability formulas such as the Flesch–Kincaid ___Grade Level___ measure sentence length and syllables per word. Sample KJV passages score near the eighth grade: Genesis 1 at 8.1, Romans 8 at 7.7, and Romans 3:1–23 at 5.6.

b. Emilio Matricciani (2023) estimated about eight years of schooling for the KJV of Matthew, compared with more than ___thirteen___ for the NASB and about six for the NIV.[89]

c. By these measures the KJV is not the ___hardest___ English Bible. Readability formulas measure form, not depth: *In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God* (John 1:1) is written almost entirely in words of one syllable.

2. Archaic Words: A Help, Not a Hindrance

a. *Thou*, *thee*, and *thy* are ___singular___; *ye*, *you*, and *your* are plural.[90] Modern English has lost the distinction.

> **Luke 22:31–32**
> 31 *And the Lord said, Simon, Simon, behold, Satan hath desired to have you, that he*
> *may sift you as wheat:* 32 *But I have prayed for thee, that thy faith fail not: and when*
> *thou art converted, strengthen thy brethren.*

b. Satan desired to have *you*, all the disciples; Christ prayed for *thee*, Peter. Versions that render both as *you* obscure the ___contrast___. The older verb forms (*thou hast, he hath*) likewise mark person and number.

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[89] Emilio Matricciani, "Readability across Time and Languages: The Case of Matthew's Gospel Translations," *AppliedMath* 3, no. 2 (2023): 497–509.

[90] *Oxford English Dictionary*, s.v. "thou, pron.," OED Online (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2023).

3. Designed for Oral Clarity

a. Gordon Campbell describes the KJV's formal idiom as rhetorical, suited to public reading;[91] Leland Ryken argues that its archaisms are few and its diction concrete.[92] It was made for the _____ear_____ as well as the eye.

4. Readability Is Not Shallowness

> **Psalm 119:130**
> *The entrance of thy words giveth light; it giveth understanding unto the simple.*

a. Understanding comes by searching *as for hid treasures* (Prov. 2:4–5). The KJV's vocabulary is largely plain Anglo-Saxon (*sin, blood, law, grace*), while its cadence invites __memorization__.

5. Historical Reality: Ordinary People Read It

a. For four centuries the KJV was the Bible of ordinary believers, as Christ's own words were heard by the common people *gladly* (Mark 12:37). David Crystal traces more than 250 of its expressions into everyday English ____idiom____.[93]

b. The difficulty of Scripture lies less in its vocabulary than in the heart: *the natural man receiveth not the things of the Spirit of God* (1 Cor. 2:14).

> **Psalm 19:7**
> *The law of the LORD is perfect, converting the soul: the testimony of the LORD is sure, making wise the simple.*

[91] Gordon Campbell, *Bible: The Story of the King James Version, 1611–2011* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2010), 170.

[92] Leland Ryken, "Ten Fallacies about the King James Version," *Southern Baptist Journal of Theology* 15, no. 4 (2011): 11–14.

[93] David Crystal, *Begat: The King James Bible and the English Language* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2010).

REVIEW

Explain the difference between *thee* and *you* in Luke 22:31–32 and why it matters for interpretation.

Major FAQs

LESSON 21 General Questions about the King James Bible

KEY TEXTS: Ps. 12:6–7; Matt. 24:35; Num. 25:9; 1 Cor. 10:8; Acts 12:1–4; 2 Cor. 2:17

OBJECTIVES: *(1) Answer the common general objections to the King James Bible. (2) Support each answer from Scripture and history.*

Q1. How can the King James Bible be the standard when it is one translation among many?

a. Every generation must have a standard. God promised to preserve His words (Ps. 12:6–7; Matt. 24:35), so they must exist in a form His people can use. For nearly three centuries the KJV was the ___standard___ by which English-speaking believers measured other translations.

Q2. Did the translators admit their work was imperfect?

a. The preface grants that even the "meanest" translation is still the Word of God, but that humility does not limit God's use of the work. The translators "trusted in him that hath the key of David" and ____prayed____ that they might not be deceived in the Scriptures nor deceive by them.[94]

Q3. Is the language too archaic for modern readers?

a. See Lesson 20. Edward Hills argued that the language of the Bible "should be venerable as well as intelligible," and that the KJV fulfills both requirements better than any other English Bible.[95]

Q4. Does the KJV contain errors or contradictions?

a. Alleged discrepancies have reasonable explanations. Numbers 25:9 records 24,000 deaths and 1 Corinthians 10:8 records 23,000 *in one day*. Differing ages of kings often reflect __co-regency__ with a father.

Q5. Did the 1611 edition include the Apocrypha?

a. Yes, but set apart between the Testaments, not mingled with Scripture as in Vaticanus

[94] "Translators to the Reader," 296–97.

[95] Hills, *King James Version Defended*, 170.

and Sinaiticus. The confessions of the period declare that these books, "not being of divine inspiration, are no part of the ____canon_____ of the Scripture."[96]

Q6. Which revision of the KJV is the perfect one?

a. The question confuses revisions with ___editions___. Later printings standardized spelling and type and corrected printers' errors; the standard text today derives from Benjamin Blayney's Oxford edition of 1769. Waite counts only 421 changes of sound between the 1611 text and the present one.[97]

Q7. Is it divisive to insist on the KJV?

a. Unity must rest on truth. Paul warned of *many, which corrupt the word of God* (2 Cor. 2:17), and the question of which Bible concerns the source of all doctrine. The conviction is held *in meekness* (2 Tim. 2:25).

Q8. Did God preserve His Word only in English?

a. God's preserved words stand in the Masoretic Hebrew and the Received Greek, purified in English in the KJV. Faithful translations from those texts into other languages are *perfect* in the biblical sense of complete, lacking nothing ____needed____.

Q9. Are modern scholars better equipped than those of 1611?

a. The translators included the leading Hebraists and Grecians of their day. Lancelot Andrewes was master of some fifteen languages, and John Bois had read the Bible in Hebrew by the age of five.[98] Modern databases increase access to data but do not decide which text God has preserved.

Q10. If the KJV is perfect, why not call it inspired?

a. Inspiration is the initial giving; preservation is the keeping; purification is the providential refining. The KJV is not newly inspired but ___purified___ (Lesson 6).

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[96] Westminster Assembly, *The Westminster Confession of Faith* (1647), 1.3.

[97] Waite, *Defending the King James Bible*, introduction, sec. D.

[98] Waite, *Defending the King James Bible*, chap. 3, secs. D–E.

Q11. Is "Easter" in Acts 12:4 a mistake?

a. The Greek πάσχα can denote the Passover or the wider festival season. Verse 3 places Peter's arrest during *the days of unleavened bread*, after the Passover itself, and Herod planned to act after the season. Tyndale had used *ester* for πάσχα, and the KJV retains the ___English___ name of the season here.

Q12. Why does the KJV use italicized words?

a. Italics mark ___supplied___ words required by English grammar but not represented by a separate word in the original. They show the translators' candor; most modern versions supply words without marking them.

REVIEW

Choose one question above and write a two-sentence answer you could give to a fellow believer.

Major FAQs

LESSON 22 Technical Questions and Concluding Confidence

Key texts: 1 John 5:7; Mark 16:9–20; Acts 8:37; Rev. 22:19; Prov. 22:20–21; Isa. 40:8

Objectives: *(1) Summarize the evidence for three disputed passages. (2) State the argument of the course from inspiration to the King James Bible.*

Q13. Did Erasmus add the Johannine Comma (1 John 5:7)?

a. The Greek manuscript support is late: GA 629 (1362–63), GA 61 (c. 1520), and GA 918 (sixteenth century) contain it. The reading is much older in Latin: Cyprian (c. 250) cites *these three are one*, Priscillian (c. 380) gives the full heavenly-witness form, and the African bishops at Carthage cited it in _____484_____.[99]

b. The Complutensian Polyglot printed the verse in 1514; Erasmus included it in his third edition of 1522. Henk Jan de Jonge showed there is no evidence that Erasmus ___promised___ to include it if shown a Greek manuscript.[100]

Q14. Is Mark 16:9–20 a later addition?

a. About 1,653 Greek manuscripts and more than 1,000 lectionaries contain the passage; the principal Greek manuscripts ending at 16:8 are א, B, and minuscule 304. Codices A, C, D, and W contain it, and it was known to Tatian's Diatessaron (c. 170) and to ___Irenaeus___ (c. 180), who quotes 16:19.[101]

Q15. Why does the KJV include Acts 8:37?

a. The earliest Greek manuscript with the verse is Codex Laudianus (E, c. 550–650), but the confession is much older: Irenaeus cites it about A.D. 180, Cyprian about 250, and it stands in the Old Latin and the ___Vulgate___.

[99] Priscillian, *Liber Apologeticus* 1.4, in *The Works of Priscillian of Avila*, trans. Marco Conti (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2010), 36; Victor of Vita, *Historia Persecutionis Africanae Provinciae* 3.11, in *Victor Vitensis: Historia Persecutionis*, ed. and trans. John Moorhead (Liverpool: Liverpool University Press, 1992), 78–79.

[100] Henk Jan de Jonge, "Erasmus and the Comma Johanneum," *Ephemerides Theologicae Lovanienses* 56 (1980): 381–89.

[101] John William Burgon, *The Last Twelve Verses of the Gospel according to S. Mark Vindicated against Recent Critical Objectors and Established* (Oxford: James Parker and Co., 1871).

Q16. Did Erasmus back-translate Revelation?

a. Erasmus's only Greek manuscript of Revelation (1r) lacked its final leaf, so in 1516 he supplied 22:16–21 from the ____Latin_____. At 22:19 Latin witnesses such as Ambrose support "book of life" long before any surviving Greek copy.[102] The reading passed through the Received Text into the KJV.

Q17. Did Erasmus and the translators know Codex Vaticanus?

a. Yes. In 1521 the Vatican librarian Paulus Bombasius sent Erasmus 1 John 4–5 from Vaticanus, and in 1533 Sepúlveda sent him a list of its variants; Erasmus cited it on Acts 27:16 yet did not adopt its text.[103] The translators knew its readings through Beza and the Sixtine Septuagint of 1587. Their choice of text was __deliberate__.

[102] Jan Krans, "Erasmus and the Text of Revelation 22:19," *TC: A Journal of Biblical Textual Criticism* 15 (2010): 1–17; S. P. Tregelles, *An Account of the Printed Text of the Greek New Testament* (London: Samuel Bagster and Sons, 1854), 20–23.

[103] S. P. Tregelles, *An Account of the Printed Text of the Greek New Testament* (London: Samuel Bagster and Sons, 1854), 22; Desiderius Erasmus, *Erasmus' Annotations on the New Testament: Acts–Romans–I and II Corinthians*, ed. Anne Reeve and M. A. Screech (Leiden: Brill, 1990), 931.

Conclusion: The Word of God Endureth Forever

Every controversy over the Bible returns to authority. Beneath the debate over manuscripts and translations lies the serpent's question, *Yea, hath God said?* (Gen. 3:1), and the believer's answer rests on God's promises (Ps. 12:6–7; Matt. 24:35; 1 Pet. 1:25).

History confirms the promises. The line of Antioch, the Masoretic Hebrew, and the Byzantine Greek was received and carried by the churches; the line of Alexandria survived chiefly in __libraries__.

The King James Bible is not newly inspired. It consists of inspired words that God preserved and purified, and it stands as the settled Word of God in __English__.

> **Proverbs 22:20–21**
> *20 Have not I written to thee excellent things in counsels and knowledge, 21 That I might make thee know the certainty of the words of truth; that thou mightest answer the words of truth to them that send unto thee?*

The Great Conclusion of the Matter

a. Proverbs 22:20–21 gathers the course into five truths: God's words are *written*; they are *words of truth*; they are *certain*; they are *excellent things*; and they give *answers* to them that send to the believer.

b. Men of great learning who deny preservation lack one thing, __faith__, and so find no evidence that God could, would, or did preserve His words (Heb. 11:6).

c. The objections examined in this course, concerning readability, the Apocrypha, revisions, and the editions of Erasmus, do not overturn that conclusion. The believer's calling is to read the Word, believe it, obey it, and place it in the hands of __others__.

> **Isaiah 40:8**
> *The grass withereth, the flower fadeth: but the word of our God shall stand for ever.*

REVIEW

Summarize the argument of the course in five steps, from inspiration to the King James Bible.

Appendix A: Timeline of the Bible's Transmission

Selected dates for the transmission of the Hebrew and Greek texts and the English Bible. Dates before the printing era are approximate.

Date	Event
c. 1400 B.C.	Moses completes the Law and commits it to the Levites (Deut. 31:24–26).
c. 445 B.C.	Ezra reads the Law publicly; the Levites give the sense (Neh. 8:8).
3rd–2nd cent. B.C.	Greek translation of the Pentateuch at Alexandria (Letter of Aristeas tradition).
c. 125 B.C.	The Great Isaiah Scroll (1QIsa[a]) is copied.
A.D. 45–95	The New Testament books are written.
2nd century	Old Latin and Syriac translations; P52 (John 18) copied.
c. 170	Tatian's *Diatessaron* includes Mark 16:9–20.
c. 180	Irenaeus, *Against Heresies*, quotes Mark 16:19 and Acts 8:37.
c. 240	Origen compiles the Hexapla at Caesarea.
c. 250	Cyprian, *On the Unity of the Church*, cites "these three are one."
313	Edict of Milan; Constantine favors Christianity.
c. 325–360	Codices Vaticanus (B) and Sinaiticus (א) produced.
c. 350	Ulfilas translates the Bible into Gothic.
382–405	Jerome prepares the Latin Vulgate.
c. 400–450	Codex Alexandrinus (A) produced.
484	African bishops at Carthage cite 1 John 5:7.
c. 500–1000	The Masoretes add vowels, accents, and the Masorah to the Hebrew text.
c. 930; 1008	The Aleppo Codex; the Leningrad Codex.
1380s	The Wycliffite Bible, the first complete English Bible, copied by hand.
c. 1455	Gutenberg prints the Latin Bible with movable type.
1475; 1481	Codex Vaticanus listed in the Vatican Library catalogues.
1516; 1522	Erasmus's first Greek New Testament; his third edition includes 1 John 5:7.
1517	Luther's Ninety-five Theses; the Reformation begins.
1524–25	The Second Rabbinic Bible of Jacob ben Chayyim printed at Venice.
1526	Tyndale's New Testament, the first printed English New Testament from Greek.
1534	Luther completes the German Bible.
1535–39	Coverdale (1535), Matthew's (1537), and the Great Bible (1539).
1536	Tyndale strangled and burned at Vilvorde.
1550	Stephanus's third edition of the Greek New Testament.
1560; 1568	The Geneva Bible; the Bishops' Bible.
1582	The Rheims New Testament (Roman Catholic).
1588	Defeat of the Spanish Armada; Beza's edition of 1588–89.
1603–04	The Millenary Petition; the Hampton Court Conference (January 1604).
1605	The Gunpowder Plot against King James fails.
1611	The King James Bible is published.
1627	Codex Alexandrinus presented to Charles I.
1633	The Elzevir preface: "the text now received by all."
1769	Benjamin Blayney's Oxford edition standardizes the KJV text.
1844; 1859	Tischendorf obtains leaves of Sinaiticus, then the bulk of the codex.
1870–81	The Revision Committee; the Revised New Testament and the Westcott–Hort Greek text (1881).
1901	The American Standard Version.
1947–56	The Dead Sea Scrolls discovered.

Date	Event
1952–2001	RSV (1952), NASB (1971), NIV (1978), NKJV (1982), ESV (2001).

Appendix B: The King James Translators

Fifty-four men were appointed in 1604; the names of forty-seven survive. They worked in six companies, two each at Westminster, Oxford, and Cambridge.

Company	Director	Assignment	Other members (partial)
First Westminster	Lancelot Andrewes	Genesis–2 Kings	John Overall, Hadrian Saravia, Richard Clarke, John Layfield, Robert Tighe, Francis Burleigh, Geoffrey King, Richard Thomson, William Bedwell
First Cambridge	Edward Lively	1 Chronicles–Song of Solomon	John Richardson, Lawrence Chaderton, Francis Dillingham, Roger Andrewes, Thomas Harrison, Robert Spalding, Andrew Bing
First Oxford	John Harding	Isaiah–Malachi	John Rainolds (Reynolds), Thomas Holland, Richard Kilby, Miles Smith, Richard Brett, Daniel Fairclough, William Thorne
Second Cambridge	John Duport	The Apocrypha	William Branthwaite, Jeremiah Radcliffe, Samuel Ward, Andrew Downes, John Bois, Robert Ward
Second Oxford	Thomas Ravis	Gospels, Acts, Revelation	George Abbot, Richard Eedes, Giles Tomson, Henry Savile, John Peryn, Ralph Ravens, John Harmar
Second Westminster	William Barlow	Romans–Jude	John Spencer, Roger Fenton, Ralph Hutchinson, William Dakins, Michael Rabbett, Thomas Sanderson

Stages of Review

Stage	Description
1. Individual	Each member of a company translated the assigned chapters himself (Rule 8).
2. Company	The company met, read the renderings aloud, compared them, and agreed on a text (Rule 8).
3. Other companies	Each finished book was sent to the other companies for review (Rule 9).
4. General meeting	Unresolved differences were settled at a general meeting of the chief members (Rule 10).
5. Final review	Twelve men, two from each company, reviewed the whole for about nine months (1609–10), meeting at Stationers' Hall, London.
6. Press	Miles Smith and Thomas Bilson saw the work through the press; Robert Barker, the King's Printer, issued it in 1611.

Sources: Pollard, *Records of the English Bible*, 53–55; Norton, *The King James Bible*, 54–55; Allen, *Translating for King James*, 28–35; Moorman, *Forever Settled*, 186–87.

Appendix C: The Rules of Translation (1604)

The fifteen rules issued through Richard Bancroft, bishop of London, to govern the translation. Spelling is modernized.

1. The ordinary Bible read in the church, commonly called the Bishops' Bible, to be followed, and as little altered as the truth of the original will permit.
2. The names of the prophets and holy writers, with the other names in the text, to be retained as near as may be, according as they are vulgarly used.
3. The old ecclesiastical words to be kept, as the word *church* not to be translated *congregation*.
4. When any word hath divers significations, that to be kept which hath been most commonly used by the most eminent fathers, being agreeable to the propriety of the place and the analogy of faith.
5. The division of the chapters to be altered either not at all or as little as may be, if necessity so require.
6. No marginal notes at all to be affixed, but only for the explanation of the Hebrew or Greek words which cannot, without some circumlocution, so briefly and fitly be expressed in the text.
7. Such quotations of places to be marginally set down as shall serve for the fit reference of one Scripture to another.
8. Every particular man of each company to take the same chapter or chapters, and having translated or amended them severally by himself, all to meet together, confer what they have done, and agree for their parts what shall stand.
9. As any one company hath dispatched any one book in this manner, they shall send it to the rest, to be considered of seriously and judiciously.
10. If any company, upon review of the book so sent, doubt or differ upon any place, to send them word thereof, note the place, and withal send the reasons; if they consent not, the difference to be compounded at the general meeting.
11. When any place of special obscurity is doubted of, letters to be directed by authority to any learned man in the land for his judgment.
12. Letters to be sent from every bishop to the rest of his clergy, admonishing them of this translation, and charging as many as are skilful in the tongues to send their observations to the companies.
13. The directors in each company to be the Deans of Westminster and Chester, and the King's Professors in Hebrew and Greek in either university.
14. These translations to be used when they agree better with the text than the Bishops' Bible: Tyndale's, Matthew's, Coverdale's, Whitchurch's (the Great Bible), and Geneva.
15. Besides the directors, three or four of the most ancient and grave divines in either university, not employed in translating, to be overseers of the translations.

Source: "The Rules to Be Observed in the Translation of the Bible," in Pollard, *Records of the English Bible*, 53–55.

Glossary of Terms

Alexandrian text. A text-type associated with Alexandria, Egypt, and represented chiefly by Codex Vaticanus (B) and Codex Sinaiticus (ℵ). It survives in comparatively few manuscripts but receives substantial weight in modern critical editions.

Allegorical interpretation. A method, associated with Philo and Origen, that assigns hidden or spiritual meanings to Scripture in place of its normal, literal sense.

Ante-Nicene; Post-Nicene. The periods of church history before and after the Council of Nicaea (A.D. 325).

Apocrypha. Jewish religious writings not recognized as inspired Scripture. The great Greek codices intermingle them with canonical books; the 1611 Bible printed them separately, between the Testaments.

Autograph. The first manuscript of a biblical book, written by its author or his authorized scribe.

Bibliology. The doctrine of the Bible.

Byzantine text. The form of the Greek New Testament found in the great majority of surviving manuscripts and transmitted throughout the Greek-speaking church; also called the Antiochian or Traditional text.

Canon. The recognized collection of books received as inspired Scripture.

Canonicity. The recognition by God's people of the books that bear divine authority, as distinct from uninspired writings.

Chirography. The handwriting of an individual scribe or period.

Codex. A manuscript in book form, with leaves folded and joined along one side, as distinguished from a scroll.

Conflation. The combining of two variant readings into one longer reading.

Critical text. The modern eclectic Greek New Testament (Nestle–Aland, UBS) that underlies most modern translations and relies heavily on Alexandrian witnesses.

Dynamic equivalence. A thought-for-thought method of translation that aims to convey the translator's understanding of the meaning rather than to render each word.

Eclectic text. A text formed by selecting readings from different manuscripts and traditions rather than following one textual tradition.

Edition. A particular printed form of a text prepared by one or more editors, such as the Greek New Testaments of Erasmus, Stephanus, or Beza.

Formal equivalence. A word-for-word method of translation that preserves the words and structure of the original as closely as the receiving language allows.

Illumination. The Spirit's work of enabling a believer to understand revealed truth (1 Cor. 2:12–14); it produces understanding, not new Scripture.

Inerrancy. The quality of Scripture by which it is without error.

Infallibility. The quality of Scripture by which, as the word of the God who cannot lie, it cannot fail or mislead.

Inspiration. God's supernatural act by which the biblical writers recorded His words; from θεόπνευστος, "God-breathed" (2 Tim. 3:16).

Interpolation. An unauthorized insertion of words into a text.

Jot and tittle. The smallest Hebrew letter and the small stroke that distinguishes one letter from another (Matt. 5:18).

Koine. The common Greek of the first century, in which the New Testament was written.

Lectionary. A book that arranges Scripture passages for public reading in the churches; the *synaxaria* begin the year at Easter, the *menologia* on September 1.

Majority Text. A Greek New Testament built from the readings found in most surviving manuscripts. It represents the Byzantine tradition but is not identical to the Textus Receptus.

Majuscule (uncial). A manuscript written in separate capital letters, typical of the fourth through ninth centuries; *uncial* is from the Latin *uncia*, a twelfth part or inch.

Manuscript. A handwritten copy of all or part of a biblical book.

Masoretic Text (MT). The traditional Hebrew text of the Old Testament, transmitted by Jewish scribes and furnished by the Masoretes with vowels, accents, and marginal notes; the basis of the KJV Old Testament.

Millenary Petition. The petition of Puritan ministers, said to bear a thousand names, presented to James I in 1603; it led to the Hampton Court Conference.

Minuscule. A manuscript written in a smaller, joined hand, typical from the ninth century onward.

Nakdanim. Later Jewish punctuators who supplied and corrected vowel and accent signs in Hebrew manuscripts until the printing era.

Old Latin. The Latin translations that circulated before Jerome's Vulgate.

Palimpsest. A manuscript whose original writing was scraped away and written over.

Papyrus. A writing material made from the pith of the papyrus plant; also a manuscript written on it.

Paraphrase. A restatement of the sense of a text in the translator's own words rather than a rendering of its words.

Parchment. Prepared, untanned animal skin used as a writing material; vellum is a fine grade.

Patristic quotation. A citation of Scripture in an early Christian writer, used as a witness to the text.

Perfect. From the Latin *perficere*, "to complete": complete and lacking nothing needed (Job 1:1; 2 Tim. 3:17).

Peshitta. The standard Syriac translation of the Bible, often supporting Byzantine readings.

Plenary inspiration. The doctrine that inspiration extends to all of Scripture.

Preservation. God's providential keeping of His words through history, to every word and mark (Ps. 12:7; Matt. 24:35).

Propagation. The carrying of God's preserved Word to every nation (Matt. 28:19–20; Acts 1:8).

Purification. God's providential refining of His preserved words through copying, printing, translation, and reception until they stand in settled form (Ps. 12:6).

Recension. A deliberate, planned revision of a text.

Revelation. God's uncovering of truth that man could not discover by his own understanding (Deut. 29:29).

Scribe; scriptorium. A professional copyist; the room set apart for copying manuscripts.

Scriptio continua. Writing without spaces between words, as in the early majuscule manuscripts.

Septuagint (LXX). A collective name for ancient Greek translations of the Old Testament; its nearly complete witnesses are fourth- and fifth-century codices that include the Apocrypha.

Soferim. The ancient Jewish scribes, from the time of Ezra, who copied and expounded the Hebrew text.

Supplied words. Words required by English but not represented by a separate Hebrew or Greek word; printed in italics in later editions of the KJV.

Text-type. A broad group of manuscripts that share characteristic readings.

Textual criticism. The discipline that compares the surviving witnesses to establish the wording of the text.

Textual variant. A difference in wording between witnesses, such as spelling, word order, omission, addition, or substitution.

Textus Receptus (TR). The Received Text: the family of printed Greek New Testaments from Erasmus (1516) through Stephanus, Beza, and the Elzevirs (1633), predominantly Byzantine and underlying the KJV New Testament.

Transliteration. Carrying a word from one language into another by its sound (e.g., *amen*, *baptize*).

Transmission. The providentially guarded process by which Scripture has been copied and passed down.

Universalism. The teaching that all men will finally be saved, held by Origen and others.

Verbal inspiration. The doctrine that inspiration extends to the very words of Scripture, not merely the thoughts of the writers.

Version. A particular translation of Scripture, such as the Geneva Bible or the King James Bible.

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S01 / TEACHING SERIES

How to Study the Bible

A twelve-week Bible-study course with teacher notes, student resources, presentations, rule cards, and related digital study resources.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Teaching, course adaptation, and resource preparation; underlying sources retain their credit.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

117 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

Compiled teacher resource with supporting weekly teacher and student materials.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

How to Study the Bible

Course materials adapted for instruction by Luke Johnston using existing Bible-study resources; original source credits retained.

Compiled teacher resource with supporting weekly teacher/student materials.

Full teaching files

How to Study the Bible - TEACHER - Millheim copy (Sep 9 2026)	*37 pages*
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how to study the bible snapshot student	*2 pages*
how to study the bible student week 1 mbc	*10 pages*
updated how to study the bible teacher	*10 pages*
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Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

How to Study the Bible

2 Timothy 2:15

Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth.

This study will focus on **what the Bible says**.

Personal Bible Study Check-up Questions

Be honest…

1. Have you ever read the entire Bible all the way through?
2. How often per week do you spend **reading** your Bible?
3. How often per week do you spend **studying** your Bible?
4. When you study, do you understand what you are reading?
5. Do you think it is possible to understand the Bible?
6. What is the last verse in the Bible you memorized?
7. Do you have anybody that has helped you when you didn't understand a verse/passage from the Bible?
8. Do you feel blessed by God when you read and study His Bible?
9. Do you ever take time during the week to review your notes from Sunday's Bible messages?
10. Will you commit to spending time each day with God in the Bible?
11. Are you tired of me asking questions?

WEEK #1 Introduction

This is a very important study. These are foundational principles for all Bible reading and study. If you want something to last, you have to build on a solid foundation.

Because of the power of God's word, this will be an awesome opportunity to expose seekers of truth to the truth of the Bible.

- John 18:33-38, 19:9 – Pilate's question to Jesus…What is truth?
- John 17:17 – …*thy word is truth.*

Important for this Study:

- ✓ Get a notebook to keep all of your study sheets together
- ✓ Continue to reflect on the Personal Bible Study Check-up questions
- ✓ Pray for someone you know that would benefit from this study
- ✓ Ask that person and others to come in the following weeks

The Bible is no ordinary Book:

- Hebrews 4:12 – The Bible is alive. It discerns thoughts and intents. It cuts right to it.
- James 1:21-25 – The Bible is a true mirror.
- James 1:5-8; 4:2 – The Bible is God's Book, we must come to it humbly.
- 2 Peter 1:21 – Men were the pen God used to write it, but God was the author.
- Psalm 119:97-105 –
- Job 23:12 –
- Jeremiah 15:16 –
- Luke 4:4 – …*man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word of God.*

I. The word of God **TRANSFORMS** lives!

1. It is the agent which God uses to bring forth life.

Psalm 33:6-9	*By the word of the LORD were the heavens made…For he spake, and it was done…*
John 11:43	*And when he thus had spoken, he cried with a loud voice, Lazarus, come forth.*
1 Pet. 1:23-25	*Being born again…by the word of God…But the word of the Lord endureth for ever…*
Matt. 24:35	*Heaven and earth shall pass away, but my words shall not pass away.*

Key Point:

IF God's word can make something out of **NOTHING**;

IF God's word can raise a **DEAD** man from a grave;

IF God's word can deliver the salvation of one's **SOUL**;

IF God's word will endure for ever and **NEVER** pass away…

THEN…we ought to…

- Pay close attention to it!
- Read it!
- Believe it!
- Study it!
- Memorize it!
- Obey it!
- Love it!
- …for the rest of our lives!!!

2. Consider the time in which we live.

Amos 8:11-12	*Behold, the days come…I will send a famine…but of hearing the words of the LORD:*
2 Timothy 3:1-7	*…the last days…Ever learning, and never able to come to the knowledge of the truth*
Daniel 12:4	*…the time of the end…many shall run to and fro, and knowledge shall be increased.*

Key Point:

The time of Amos is a lot like the time in which we live…materialistic, prosperous, swelling church attendance, but not many really know God, not many are preaching, and not many are **HEARING** the Bible...it's a famine!

The time 2 Timothy and Daniel prophesied about is now…

This is why WE *must* pay attention to what God says in His word!

II. Foundational principles of Bible study

1. The Bible overall is **NOT** difficult to understand. We make it difficult by **NOT** believing every word we read.

   2 Peter 3:16 *…in which are **some things** hard to be understood…*

   2 Cor. 11:1-3 *…as the serpent beguiled Eve through his subtilty…simplicity that is in Christ.*

   Gen. 2:16 *And the LORD God commanded the man, saying…*

   Genesis 3:1-3 *Now the serpent was more subtil…Yea, hath God said…* (He **questions** God's word)

   Genesis 3:4 *And the serpent said unto the woman, Ye shall not surely die:* (He **contradicts** God's word)

   Genesis 3:5 *For God doth know that in the day ye eat thereof…* (He **changes** God's word)

   Note: Why? Satan understands something…

   1 Thess. 2:13 *…when ye received the word of God…ye received it…as it is in truth, the word of God…*

2. Anyone can get a working knowledge of the Bible if they want it. There is **NO** special secret, **NO** magic formula. An education may be helpful, but it is **NOT** necessary. Knowledge of other languages can be helpful, but it is **NOT** necessary.

   The disciples were common men, not scholars.

   Mark 12:37 *…And the common people heard him gladly.*

   Rev. 2:6 *…thou hatest the deeds of the Nicolaitans, which I also hate.*

   Rev. 2:15 *…the doctrine of the Nicolaitans, which thing I hate.*

   God wrote the Bible to reveal truth, not hide it.

   Ps. 119:105 *Thy word is a lamp unto my feet, and a light unto my path.*

   Ps. 119:130 *The entrance of thy words giveth light…*

   Prov. 6:23 *For the commandment is a lamp, and the law is light…*

3. The Holy Spirit teaches the Bible. God can and will use other instruments (preachers, Bible teachers, videos, CD's, books, commentaries, etc.), but all truth is imparted by the Holy Spirit. How much you learn depends **SOLELY** on your responsiveness to Him.

   Note: I will not teach you anything throughout this class series. What you learn will depend on your reliance upon the Holy Spirit to be your teacher as you – by faith – believe what the Bible clearly says.

   John 14:16, 26 *…But the Comforter, which is the Holy Ghost…he shall teach you all things…*

   John 16:7-13 *…Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth…*

   1 Cor. 2:9-16 *…but which the Holy Ghost teacheth; comparing spiritual things with spiritual…*

   Note: Only the Holy Ghost can reveal truth…

In this respect, God did not author a Bible that anyone could understand!

4. Why are there "rules" of Bible study?

   - There are rules to just about everything else …

     1 Cor. 14:40 *Let all things be done decently and in order.*

     2 Tim. 2:5 *And if a man also strive for masteries, yet is he not crowned, except he strive lawfully.*

     …governmental operation, traffic, medicine, mechanics, engineering, sports, cooking, nature (gravity), life (golden rule, etc.)…everything! Think about it…when people come to the living, eternal word of God, then we throw the rules out the window! No! This violates common sense and logic!

     2 Tim. 3:16 *All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine…*

     During this study, we will be looking at **15** basic rules (there are more)…these rules come from the Bible itself and just good, sound, common sense!

   - Note: The "official" title for the study of how to interpret the Bible is called **HERMENEUTICS**.

     It is the "science" of interpreting the Bible (how to study the Bible). It is a man-made term that is important to know for your own reference.

After reading and considering everything we have today, will you take a moment and make a personal commitment to the Lord Jesus Christ?

Personal Commitment to Christ

III. Basic rules of biblical study and interpretation

Fifteen factors to focus Bible study

#1 THE CONTEXT FACTOR

1. There is no understanding of the Bible without a proper understanding of **CONTEXT**.

Note: ***Every*** verse, ***every*** passage **MUST** be studied in light of its context…

This has always been a common problem.

Psalm 56:5 Every day they wrest my words…

Jer. 23:36 …for ye have perverted the words of the living God, of the LORD of hosts our God.

Matt. 22:29 Jesus answered and said unto them, Ye do err, not knowing the scriptures…

2 Pet. 3:15-18 …which they that are unlearned and unstable wrest, as they do also the other scriptures…

It will always be a common problem.

Acts 20:28-31 …shall grievous wolves enter in among you, not sparing the flock…

Note: If this was going on 2,000 years ago…how much more today!?!

2 Cor. 11:3-4 …For if he that cometh preacheth another Jesus, whom we have not preached…

2 Cor. 11:13-15 …And no marvel; for Satan himself is transformed into an angel of light…

1 Tim. 1:19-20 …which some having put away concerning faith have made shipwreck…

Biblical context is a factor by which God sheds light upon a subject through either near passages or remote details bearing upon the same theme.

Note: Every verse in the Bible has something that precedes it and something that follows it, except two verses, Genesis 1:1 and Revelation 22:21.

Never, never, never take a verse out of its setting and give it a foreign meaning!

Establishing biblical **CONTEXT** includes:

1) **NEAR** context

- ✓ The preceding **VERSE**(s)
- ✓ The following verse(s)

- ✓ The preceding **PASSAGE**(s)
- ✓ The following passage(s)

- ✓ The preceding **CHAPTER**(s)
- ✓ The following chapter(s)

2) **REMOTE** context

- ✓ The **THEME** of the particular book of the Bible the scripture is located in
- ✓ How that particular Book fits into the **THEME** of the Bible
- ✓ Always keeping in mind the **THEME** of the entire Bible

3) **OBSERVATION** of other important rules of Bible study

- ✓ Historical framework
- ✓ Ethnic division
- ✓ Comparing things spiritual with things spiritual
- ✓ Other critical details, etc.

This evening we will examine examples of near and remote passages…

Some questions to ponder: (think for a minute…)

Have you ever had your words or statements taken out of context?

- Removed from your intention?
- Taken away from your heart's motive?
- Stripped from your character?
- Used against you?

How did it make you feel?

- Hurt?
- Betrayed?
- Misunderstood?
- Angry?

How do you think God feels about His words being taken out of context?

Hold that thought as we look at some examples…

2. Some common examples:

Near Context *(These passages are often misunderstood because they have been removed from their proper near context)*

Matthew 7:1-2 -

WHAT IT IS *NOT* TEACHING: It is not teaching us **NOT** to judge but rather teaching us not to have a critical or judgmental heart towards others…and what happens to someone who does!!

WHAT IT IS TEACHING: It teaches us how to **JUDGE**!!

Galatians 5:4-

WHAT IT IS *NOT* TEACHING: That those who are already saved can somehow **LOSE** their salvation.

WHAT IT IS TEACHING: Those who are trusting in their works for salvation, are missing out on the very thing that saves them, **GRACE**! They have not lost salvation

or God's grace, but they have not remembered that grace in their lives.

John 6:56 -

WHAT IT IS *NOT* TEACHING: That Jesus somehow wants us to eat His **LITERAL** flesh and drink His literal blood! Jesus had just fed 5,000 people. Many were still following Him because they wanted a free lunch. Verse 66…and took their false doctrine with them!!

WHAT IT IS TEACHING: A spiritual principle – His **WORDS** are life!!

Acts 2:38 –

WHAT IT IS *NOT* TEACHING: How **GENTILES** in the NT church age are to get saved!
How **GENTILES** in the NT church age should speak babble!

WHAT IT IS TEACHING: What actually happened as a matter of **HISTORICAL** significance after Jesus ascended into Heaven to be with God the Father and answers the question for the Jews that had killed their Messiah – oh no – what shall we do?!?! It was a special "dispensation" of God's **SPIRIT** for the Jews that had rejected and killed Jesus Christ!

Remote Context *(Passages in these books are often misunderstood because they have been removed from their remote context)*

1 Corinthians A **REPROVE** – a rebuke…it is more about what **NOT** to do rather than what to do – be careful!

Hebrews Some of the hardest passages in the Bible regarding **ETERNAL** security. It appears like you can lose your salvation?

- Remember – it was written to **HEBREWS** – who had a works-based religion!
- Remember – it is a **TRANSITIONAL** book in the Bible – like Matthew and Acts!

Observations *(Passages and chapters can be understood in light of the big picture painted by the order of the following books therefore establishing a broad overall doctrinal context)*

Example #1 Consider the big picture doctrinal context painted by the first 6 books of the Bible:

Genesis The book of beginnings…ends with God's man dead in a coffin in **EGYPT**…

Exodus God's people are redeemed by the blood of the **LAMB**…

Leviticus God's people are **JOINED** to God and the priests are established…

Numbers God's people wander in the wilderness of **UNBELIEF**…

Deuteronomy	God gave the law a second time…this time serve out of **LOVE** not duty…
Joshua	Joshua (**JESUS**) leads God's people to conquer the Promised Land…

Example #2 Consider the big picture doctrinal context painted by the order of the following books:

Ezra	The Jews **RETURN** to their land and the temple is rebuilt in Jerusalem…
Nehemiah	The Jews continue to return to their land and the **DEFENSE** network is rebuilt…
Esther	A Gentile bride is replaced with a **JEWISH** bride…
Job	There is a time of great **TRIBULATION**…
Psalms	King **DAVID** takes the throne from Saul (antichrist) and is King on the throne in Jerusalem leading worship…
Proverbs	The reign of the **WISDOM** of God – Jesus Christ – the living Word …

#2 THE PEOPLE FACTOR

1. There is no correct understanding of the Bible without understanding that the Bible is written to **THREE** types of people. This is often called the "ethnic division principle" – by those with higher education.

1 Corinthians 10:32-33

When God deals with mankind, He sees ***3*** different, unique divisions of people:

a. **JEW**

b. **GENTILE**

c. **CHURCH** of **GOD**

KEY – You must take into account to whom the passage was primarily written.

So…the old song goes…"All the promises in the Bible are mine, every chapter, every verse, every line"…No they are not! …aren't you glad – this Book promises hell to the lost – not me!

The entire Bible is broken down, directly and indirectly, into one of these three people groups…pay close attention!

These three people groups break down into the **TWO** types of people we are all familiar with in this world…

a. **SAVED** = **CHURCH** of **GOD**

b. **LOST** = **JEWS** & **GENTILES**

Although there is a very distinct difference in these two, both are equally lost!

The entire Bible is written **FOR** you; not all the Bible is written **TO** you: *(repeat until it sinks in)*

Note: All scripture is divinely inspired and has some application to your life (2 Timothy 3:16); you must determine whether it is direct or indirect…

Some examples:

a. James 1:1 (12 twelve tribes = **JEWS**; consider the author…)

James, a servant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ, to the twelve tribes which are scattered abroad, greeting.

b. 1 Peter 1:1 (Strangers = **SAVED JEWS**, not Israel)

Peter, an apostle of Jesus Christ, to the strangers scattered throughout Pontus, Galatia, Cappadocia, Asia, and Bithynia,

2 Peter 3:1

This second epistle, beloved, I now write unto you; in both which I stir up your pure minds by way of remembrance:

c. Ephesians 1:1 ("saints", "faithful" saints…written to a church, **NOT** to an individual!)

Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the will of God, to the saints which are at Ephesus, and to the faithful in Christ Jesus:

d. Isaiah 1:1; 13:1, 19; 15:1; 17:1; 18:1; 19:1; 34:1, 16 (pay close attention!)

e. Hebrews (The title gives it away – written to **JEWS**!)

f. 1 & 2 Timothy; Titus (written to individuals – church leaders – who are saved!)

g. Matthew - It is the Gospel with a uniquely **JEWISH** nature:

The **THEME** of this Gospel is: "The **KING** and His **KINGDOM**"

Chapter 1 - The genealogy of the **KING**. (1:1, 6)
Chapter 2 - The **BIRTH** of the King.
Chapter 3 - John the Baptist announces the King. *(John is the last OT prophet; Isa. 40)*
Chapter 4 - The **TESTING** and preparation of the King.
Chapter 5-7 - The constitution of the **KINGDOM**.
Chapter 8-9 - Christ presents His **CREDENTIALS** as the King.
Chapter 10 - The 12 apostles are sent forth to preach the gospel of the **KINGDOM** to Israel.
Chapter 11-12 - The **REJECTION** of the King and His Kingdom by the leaders of Israel.
Chapter 13-25 - The Kingdom enters a state of mysteries or **PARABLES** because of Israel's unbelief.

Matthew 24:13

Note: this is often misapplied to the church – Jesus is speaking to 12 **JEWISH** converts – still in **OT**!

- He is answering their question from verse 3, "Tell us, when shall these things be? and what *shall be* the sign of thy coming, and of the end of the world?"
- He is telling them of events of the Tribulation period. Look at verse 15, only 2 verses later: "When ye therefore shall see the abomination of desolation, spoken of by Daniel the prophet, stand in the holy place, (whoso readeth, let him understand:)"

KEY – part of understanding the *context* is taking into account the primary group of people to whom the passage was written.

Chapter 26 - The final night of the King.
Chapter 27 - The crucifixion and burial of the King. (Isa. 53)
Chapter 28 - The resurrection of the King.

NOTE: The danger of not understanding this point is expressed by Christ in Rev. 2:8-9; 3:7-9

Rev. 2:8-9 … and I know **the blasphemy of them <u>which say they are Jews, and are not</u>, but are the synagogue of Satan**.

Rev. 3:7-9 … I will make **them of the synagogue of Satan, <u>which say they are Jews, and are not</u>, but do lie**…

Question: Who, by their loud and clear doctrines, "say they are Jews and are not"?

Answer: Many cults/heretical groups do this, but we also can do it when we misapply passages/promises to Jews, to us as Christians

NOTE: Be careful – be aware – remember 2 Tim. 3:16 – don't tear out whole sections of your Bible!

#3 THE DIVISION (time) FACTOR

1. In order to rightly divide God's word, you must have ***GOD'S PERSPECTIVE*** ON HIS WORD:

   a. **The purpose of the Bible**:

   2 Timothy 3:16-17 - All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness: That the man of God may be perfect, throughly furnished unto all good works.

   Doctrine = Teaching. Truth!
   Perfect = Complete. Fully **informed**.

   b. **The theme of the Bible: A King and His Kingdom**. This is chronicled in the Bible in 3 primary ways:

      1. The POWERS: God (Father, Son, Holy Spirit) and Satan – Matt. 28:19, 3:16-17; John 14:16-17; 2 Cor. 13:14; Gen. 3; Job 1; Isaiah 14:12-15; Ezekiel 28:11-19.
      2. The PLACES: Heaven, Earth, Hell – Gen. 1:1-25; Job 22:12; Ps. 14:2, 146:5-6; Matt. 10:28, 25:41; 2 Peter 2:4. (*Hell removed from most Bibles*)
      3. The PEOPLE: Jew, Gentile, Church – Rom. 2:9-10; 1 Cor. 10:32; Gal. 3:28.

   c. **The instruction of the Bible - God deals with mankind in different ways at different times**. It is critical to recognize how God divides His word. You must see how God has dealt differently with man over time. Some places in the Bible deal specifically with the Nation of Israel, other places, the Church. How can you know and recognize who and when? By **STUDYING**:

   2 Timothy 2:15 - Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth.

   This is our key verse for this factor. It tells us 5 important things:

      1. What do we do with the Bible? **STUDY!** *(missing from most versions)*
      2. Why? To show ourselves APPROVED unto **God – NOT MAN!**
      3. HOW? **RIGHTLY** DIVIDING **– which indicates that you can WRONGLY DIVIDE IT!**

         Divide means to cut or to separate. An example of rightly dividing: What does this phrase say?

         GODISNOWHERE - GOD|IS|NOW|HERE - GOD|IS|NOWHERE

         Notice an improper division completely changes the meaning!

      4. The posture we must maintain – that of a workman **– it will take some work.**
      5. The result – We are NOT ASHAMED. There are people who will be ashamed as they stand before God for what they did to God and His word – 2 Cor. 5:8-10!

2. **HOW** does God divide His word?

   a. Times and seasons – Daniel 2:21; Ecc. 3:1-8; Acts 1:7; 1 Thess. 5:1; Heb. 1:1-2.

   b. Dispensations – Eph 1:10, 3:2-3; Col 1:25-26; 1 Cor 9:17.

   Dispensation = Distribution: The manner in which God deals out (dispenses) His grace/truth/law in specific ways to specific people. An economy or way of doing things; a certain administration. That which is dispensed or bestowed.

   - ✓ **NOTE**: It does NOT simply mean "a period of time." We may use times and dates to help us separate dispensations, but the time period does NOT define the dispensation, it's the other way around!

- ✓ The greatest and most obvious dispensation in the Bible: The Old and New **Testaments** - Hebrews 9:15-17. Consider what this means in each of the 4 gospels – Matt. 27:50-51!!
- ✓ Times and dispensations can be divided within a book, chapter, verse, or **PART** of a verse!!

  Isaiah 61:1-2 - Luke 4:17-21.
  Isaiah 9:6-7.
  Luke 1:30-33.

3. Locating the dispensations:

One of the easiest and most effective ways to find dispensations in the Bible is by looking at the **covenants** God makes with man. These lay out what God is going to do and how He is going to deal with man.

NOTE: Both covenants and dispensations often have more than one part to them and can overlap with others, skip time periods, or show up in the middle of others. Hence the reason a dispensation is not just a period of time.

Dispensation	**Covenant**	**Description**	**Scripture**
Eternity Past	None	Original creation. Lucifer & angels.	Gen. 1:1-2
Innocence	Edenic	Reconstruction of earth. Creation of man.	Gen. 1:3 – 3:24
Conscience	Adamic	Adam's lineage and sons of God.	Gen. 3:16 – 8:14
Human government	Noahic	Noah's flood and lineage.	Gen. 6 – 11
Promise	Abrahamic	Abraham's seed and birth of nation of Israel.	Genesis 12 – Exodus 19
Law-Kingdom	Mosaic	Moses leading the exodus, the giving of the law, the kingdom's rise & fall.	Exodus – Malachi
	Davidic	The line and Kingdom of David.	1 Samuel – 2 Chronicles
Christ's 1st coming	Davidic	2 Kingdoms. The start of the Church after Christ's death.	Matthew – Acts 7
The Church & God's grace	None	Transition of Church from Jew to Gentile oversight.	Acts - Revelation
Tribulation-judgment	None	A time of great trouble for the Jew.	Matthew 24-25, 1&2 Thessalonians, Hebrews, Revelation 4-19, Daniel 9. (Rapture of Church to 2nd coming).
Millennium	Palestinian	The 1,000-year reign of Christ on the earth.	Rev. 20; Matt. 5-7; Eze. 40:48; Zech. 14
Eternity	New	The new Heaven & Earth.	Rev. 21-22

4. **Key rules** for dispensations and rightly dividing:

   a. Do not take truth from one part of the past and read it into another part of the past – Gen. 1:29 vs 9:3.

   b. Do not take truth from the past and read it into the present – that is what some did in Acts 15:1-11 (7th Day).

   c. Do not take truth from the present and read it into the past – Rom. 8:9 vs Num. 11:29.

   d. Do not take truth from the future and read it into the present – Rev. 14:1-4 (JW's).

   e. Do not take truth from the future and read it into another part of the **future** – 1 Thess. 4:13-18 vs 2 Thess. 1:7-9.

      a. More examples

#4 THE APPLICATION FACTOR

All Scripture has **THREE** basic applications.

1) **HISTORICAL**

All Scripture has a single, obvious meaning rooted in the context of History, grammar and literary usage – thus the historical application.

a. **KEY:** The Bible is unlike any other book of religious writings in that it is primarily a book of **HISTORY** and its history is ***true***. Our God has chosen to work within the framework of time and space. It is important to note that the Bible has **NEVER** been proven to be ***historically*** incorrect. Mark it down – rest assured!

b. Every **PERSON**, **PLACE**, and **EVENT** is real. Everything we read actually took place *(or will take place)* and existed ***historically***, unless God tells us otherwise *(IE. parables or symbolism – example – "Hear the parable of the…")*

c. This historical application concerns:
*Bible Characters (*people*)*
*Geography (*places*)*
*Chronology (*time*)*
*Experiences (*events*)*

KEY: You must **FIRST** understand the history of any given passage before you will properly comprehend other basic applications. If you misunderstand the history, you will violate the obvious and literal meaning of scripture.

2) **DOCTRINAL**

a. The word doctrine simply means "*teaching."* In every thing that God says, He is always interested in teaching us something.

b. The biblical usages of the word doctrine (it has a two-fold meaning or usage):

- God uses historical events to teach a general practical truth. This is also called the **PLAIN** teaching

- God uses historical events to teach a deeper truth. This is also called the **PROPHETIC** teaching.

KEY: God establishes His eternal truths through sound doctrine that always stands sure throughout the entire Bible.

3) **DEVOTIONAL**

a. This "*old"* book applies to my life today. Every book, chapter, and verse **APPLIES** to me right now, somehow. The question we must always ask is this,

"*How must I apply what the Bible says to my personal life?"*

b. All scripture has a ***devotional*** application - *2 Timothy 3:16-17* – memorize it!

Note: *This factor is also referred to as* personal *or* **INSPIRATIONAL** *application.*

God's purpose in Scripture – watch how this is defined in Scripture…1 Corinthians 10:1-12; Romans 15:4; Luke 24:27; *John 5:39; 46-47*

The Bible is a **PICTURE** Book.

…to see the pictures best you must put on your "**3**-*D Glasses."*

Some examples:

a. The Brasen Serpent *(Numbers 21:4-9)*

i. ***History*** – this is a true story – it really happened
ii. ***Doctrine*** – The **plain** meaning in the time was that any and all bitten by the serpents needed to look at the brazen serpent for healing. **Prophetically**, it pointed to the cross of Christ – 2 Cor. 5:21; Jn. 3:14-15
iii. ***Devotion*** – there is always a price to pay when you don't believe God…

b. Isaiah's Sign of Immanuel (Isaiah 7:14-16)

i. ***History*** – a child born in Isaiah's day served as a sign to Ahaz that Syria and Israel would soon be defeated
ii. ***Doctrine*** – In the day, the **plain** teaching was that a child would be born as a sign of their victory in battle. The **PARTIAL FULFILLMENT** pointed forward **prophetically** to the complete fulfillment in the virgin birth of Jesus Christ, "God with us" – Matthew 1:18-23
iii. ***Devotion*** – God keeps his promises, remains with his people, and can be trusted even when circumstances appear hopeless!

c. Leviathan (Job 41)

i. ***History*** – God describes an actual historical animal in **hyperbole** (poetic section of books, uses much figure of speech), in order to show Job the true source of his troubles since ch. 1.
ii. ***Doctrine*** – Job is facing a foe that is so awful, so strong, so wicked, that he would have understood as an actual animal in his day. God used the animal to give Job the picture. But he also gave **prophetic/deeper** language that Job would have known (as we do today) cannot apply to ANY regular animal. It was **prophetically** showing Job a description of the devil.
iii. ***Devotion*** – how to deal with trials, suffering and attacks from the devil!

d. This is **not** an exhaustive list. Remember "all" of the OT pictured Jesus and NT truths for us.
   i. The Strange Woman of Proverbs (Proverbs 5:3-7; 6:20-24; 7:1-5; Revelation 17:1-6); Abraham Offering Isaac (Genesis 22:1-14; Hebrews 11:17-19); The Passover Lamb (Exodus 12:1-13; John 1:29; 1 Corinthians 5:7); Noah and the Flood (Genesis 6-8; Matthew 24:37-39); Jonah and the Great Fish (Jonah 1:17-2:10; Matthew 12:39-41); The Manna from Heaven (Exodus 16:4-18; John 6:32-35); Water from the Rock (Exodus 17:1-6; 1 Corinthians 10:4); Adam as a Picture of Christ (Genesis 3; Romans 5:12-19; 1 Corinthians 15:45-49)

**** WARNING ****
This Bible study factor is not to be confused with the **ABSTRACT** method of Bible study developed by the epitome of all false teachers, *Adamantius Origen*. He developed what is known as the "*Allegorical method of Bible Study"...*

It is a method of reasoning that draws everything down to a metaphorical, figurative, or symbolic perspective. The danger, when applied as a method of Bible study, is that any passage is subject to the feelings or personal perspectives of the reader. This leaves the passage open for assorted types of interpretation that likely have nothing to do with what God is actually imparting. Who cares what someone thinks it means…what does it **SAY**! Be careful of Bible studies that go…read a verse then say," What do you think it means?"

KEY: The Bible says what it means, and means what it says. Anytime we apply the three basic applications to scripture, we must allow the biblical **TEXTS** to dictate the clear meaning.

#5 THE INDIVIDUAL WORD FACTOR

1. God has chosen every **EVENT** and every individual **WORD** in the Bible for a specific purpose.

   a. John 20:30-31; 21:24-25

   KEY: If there was a multitude of other things Jesus said and did events), we must ***have the most important*** things preserved for us in the Bible!!

   b. Every word of God is ***key*** as opposed to man's interpretation of God's intended thoughts, message, concepts and ideals. (Deut. 4:2; Deut. 6:6; Deut. 8:3; Ps. 12:6-7; Ps. 119:89, 160; Prov. 30:5-6; Jer. 26:2; Matt. 4:4; Matt. 5:18; Matt. 24:35; Luke 16:17; Rev. 22:18-19)

   KEY: The key to the word of God, is the **words of God**
   KEY: This is why God does not want us to **ADD**, subtract, or **CHANGE** His perfect word!!

2. It is the **WORDS** that are most important! The Bible does not just contain the words of God; the Bible is the pure word of God that will last forever (all of it…cover to cover)! – Psalm 12:6-7

   NOTE: This is in direct opposition to a belief system called Neo-Orthodoxy within theological circles which says that the ***thoughts*** are what really count! These so-called scholars proclaim that it does not matter what God actually said as long as we get the main point…be careful when you hear that!

   These men by their own admission, do NOT use the Bible as their authority for translating, studying, or handling the Bible. They rely upon textual sciences, human philosophies, and NOT THE BIBLE

   * Remember – God did not write a Bible for just anyone to understand – but only for those who are indwelt by His Spirit. Not all Bible "scholars" even claim to be believers!

   a. Matthew 5:18

   Psalm 119 is what is known as an ***acrostic*** psalm. There are 22 Hebrew letters in the Hebrew alphabet. Each stanza in Psalm 119 begins with a letter from the Hebrew alphabet.

   "Jot" – Psalm 119:73

   "Tittle" – Psalm 119:25 & 153

   b. In modern bible versions, precise words are ***admittedly*** abandoned for the flow of thoughts and concepts for readability's sake. Words are replaced/changed without thought of preservation. This is known in textual criticism as "***dynamic equivalence***"

      i. ***Leland Ryken (PhD) professor of English at Wheaton College***: "Dynamic equivalence is popularly known as a thought-for-thought translation instead of a word-for-word translation."[1]

3. **KEY:** God preserved every word in English in the King James Bible – exactly the way He intended …

   Some Examples:

   - ✓ Hebrews 4:8; Acts 7:45 "Jesus" vs. "Joshua"
     - This is a "***transliteration***" that when translated exactly, word for word, teaches us a deep (doctrinal) truth of the Old Testament!

[1] Leland Ryken, *Choosing a Bible: Understanding Bible Translation Differences* (Wheaton, IL: Crossway Books, 2005), 7.

NOTICE: Just **ONE** word makes a BIG difference!!!

- ✓ John 1:1 "**A**" (many bible translations add this word; JW's infamously)
- ✓ John 7:8 "**yet**" (many bible translations remove this word)
- ✓ Acts 12:4 "**Easter**" (many bible translations change this word to "Passover")
- ✓ 2 Timothy 2:15 "**dividing**" (changed to "handling" or "teaching" in many versions)
- ✓ 1 Cor. 1:18 "**being**" (many bible translations add this word")
- ✓ Genesis 3:4 "**not**" (the original update to God's word: "thou shalt surely die." (Gen. 2:14)
- ✓ *This is NOT an exhaustive list of all examples. There are countless examples where every word added, subtracted, or changed makes a difference when studying the Bible. It is inevitable that when words are not the same, meanings change; hence God's warnings.*

4. God uses key words and phrases

- ✓ God uses key words and phrases in the Bible consistently to communicate truth…
- ✓ They establish contexts and provide ***keys*** for comparing scripture with scripture

Some examples:

- That day; The day; the day of the **LORD** …begins with Rapture and ends with close of Millennium
- **THOSE** days; woman in travail; time of Jacob's Trouble…all references to the Tribulation Period
- **LIKE** and **AS** (similes) are key words God uses to demonstrate deeper understanding of something
  - ✓ Luke 17:26-30
  - ✓ 1 John 3:2 - *Beloved, now are we the sons of God, and it doth not yet appear what we shall be: but we know that, when he shall appear, we shall be* **like** *him; for we shall see him* **as** *he is.*
  - ✓ Eph. 5:25 - *Husbands, love your wives, even* ***as*** *Christ also loved the church, and gave himself for it*
  - ✓ Matthew 10:16
- **YE/YOU VS. THEE/THOU;** "ye" in the Bible is plural while "thee/thou" are singular (ex. Luke 22:31-32)
- Law of First Mention; the Bible study principle that the first time God uses a word, he defines it and establishes its meaning for the rest of scripture. If words are changed throughout to get the "ideas/thoughts", then this definition is easily lost (ex. "lovest" in Gen. 22:2; "worship" in Gen. 22:5)

FINAL THOUGHTS

- If we will approach the Bible with the attitude that **every word** is important, that **every word** is in place on purpose, and that **every word** is in fact the word of God…

  …it will change **what we see** and **what we UNDERSTAND**!!

- 1 Thessalonians 2:13 – *For this cause also thank we God without ceasing, because,* ***when ye received the word of God*** *which ye heard of us, ye received it not as the word of men, but as it is in truth,* ***the word of God****, which* ***effectually worketh*** *also in you that believe.*

#6 THE COMPARISON FACTOR

1. The Bible is of no **PRIVATE** interpretation. All interpretations must be done by comparing **SCRIPTURE** with **SCRIPTURE**.

   a. No private interpretations – 2 Peter 1:20

      NOTE: Verse 20 clearly teaches us that the Bible is of ***no private interpretation***!

      - Whether we like it or not…
      - No matter what anybody else says…

      KEY: In a literal sense, this destroys the argument of all those who **hide behind** the saying…

      …"Well, that's just **your** interpretation."

      At issue is not your interpretation or mine, but rather **the interpretation of the Author** of the Bible – the **HOLY SPIRIT**.

      Example – Who would be the best person to interpret a letter from me to you? **ME (AUTHOR)**

   b. Proper interpretation comes by comparing **spiritual** things with **spiritual** things– 1 Corinthians 2:1-14

      - Vs 1-8 Paul explains the contrast between man's wisdom and God's wisdom as revealed in His word
      - Vs 9-12 Even the "*deep things of God"* are revealed to those who possess His Spirit.
      - Vs 13 Comparing spiritual things with spiritual things is how the Holy Spirit teaches us.
      - Vs 14 The Word of God cannot be understood by mere human reasoning alone.

      NOTE: This is why the Bible is not meant to be read in the common "lingo" of any given day/age. It is meant to record God's exact words, that we are meant to study. The truth of the Bible is spiritually discerned as we **COMPARE** scripture with scripture (Romans 7:14; John 6:63). And this is only done effectively through the use of the exact words that God says.

      KEY: There comes a time in **serious study of the Bible**, to rightly divide the Scripture and pay due diligence to **every word**. That is the time to make certain you have a Bible that is not going to be dropping "jots" or "tittles" and removing the road signs and **landmarks!**

   c. God emphasizes the importance of two or three witnesses.

      NOTE: Having more than one witness/testimony to determine an unknown difficulty was established long ago by God! (2 Corinthians 13:1; Deuteronomy 19:15; Numbers 35:30)

   d. How cross referencing works – Isaiah 28:9-10, 13

      KEY: The best commentary on the Bible is the **BIBLE** itself, not our personal opinions.

      - To become proficient at understanding the Bible, we **MUST** exercise ourselves in the use of cross-referencing (e.g. – *study to shew thyself approved unto God*); tracking words and phrases throughout the Bible through the use of a **concordance** (hardback, online, on phone, etc.), through tools such as ***Treasury of Scripture Knowledge*** (hardback, online, on phone,

etc.)**,** and by **taking notes**.

- With today's technology, we have more capabilities at our fingertips than any other people throughout the course of human history!
- Remember, studying in this manner (comparing scripture with scripture) is how we're told to understand exactly what God is communicating to us…
- This is how we avoid our own personal opinions and private interpretations…
- Don't miss this critical **RULE** of Bible study…The Bible is of no private interpretation. All interpretations must be done by comparing scripture with scripture.
- Jesus, Paul, and the NT writers modeled use of this rule of Bible study when they would say **IT IS WRITTEN**…

2. An illustration of this Bible study factor:

a. **Revelation 4:1-4**

What is this event? What is going on? **When we get context of the book, study every word, and compare scripture with scripture: we don't have to guess!**

What does the Bible say? …let's compare scripture with scripture…

- **1 Corinthians 15:51–54**
  The Lord calls, a trumpet sounds, and in a single moment, someone is raised in a spiritual body
- **1 Thessalonians 4:13–18**
  A voice yells, a trumpet sounds, and immediately we are "caught up" to be in the presense of the Lord forever!
  - These all describe **the rapture** The book of Revelation is the only definitive place in the New Testament that gives us the timeline of the rapture.

b. **Genesis 3:1-15**

NOTE: The devil tries to hide his identity all over the Bible, but we can identify him!

- **Revelation 12:9**
  He is called a dragon, that old serpent, the Devil, Satan.
- **Revelation 20:2**
  He is called a dragon, that old serpent, the Devil, Satan…AGAIN!

b. **Leaven**

- **Hipocrisy** (Luke 12:1)
- **Bad/False Doctrine** (Matt. 16:6, 11-12)
- **Negative** (Exod. 12:15–20; 13:3–7; 23:18; 34:25; Lev. 2:11; 6:17; 10:12; Deut. 16:3–4; Amos 4:5; Matt. 16:6, 11–12; Mark 8:15; Luke 12:1; 1 Cor. 5:6–8; Gal. 5:7–9)

We must remember…

- The Bible is of **NO** private interpretation.
- **ALL** interpretations must be done by comparing scripture with scripture.

#7 THE CREATION FACTOR

1. The eternal truths of God that are revealed in the Bible can be enhanced by studying the **CREATION** which He has made. God is a master artist!

   - Psalm 19:1-4a The Bible clearly says the heavens declare His righteousness.

     NOTE: God says His creation **declares**, **sheweth**, **uttereth** His righteousness…creation has a **voice**, **speech**, and a **line** of communication so unique that **all** people of **all** languages in **ALL** time periods of earth's history can hear it – see also Psalm 97:6, Job 12:7-9.

   - Romans 1:18-20 The invisible things of God are understood by **STUDYING** the creation He has made.

     NOTE: Creation is referred to as God's **GENERAL** REVELATION of Himself because anybody anywhere **can** see Him in it (Rom. 1:20). According to God, nobody can **honestly** give excuse that they did not know the truth about God (2 Pet. 3:3-5…because of the testimony of creation, God calls them willingly ignorant). **The Bible** is God's **SPECIAL** REVELATION because it is written to those who **want** to know more about the God that they see in Creation and what His great plan is for man. The Bible and creation work hand-in-hand together proclaiming the truths of God.

     According to Romans 1:20…

     a. No one has an excuse because of:

        1. **GENERAL** revelation — It is general because creation is observable by everyone

        2. **SPECIAL** revelation — The Bible – God is always faithful to send a missionary

        NOTE: The "pigmy" or the lost multitudes in India, etc. are all included in this category…

     b. We also find that creation reveals an attribute of God called omnipotence (*omni* = all, *potent* = powerful):

        1. Examples of God's power seen in creation – **TORNADOES, HURRICANES, TSUNAMIS**
        2. Examples of God's eternal power seen in creation – **STARS, SAND, GALAXIES**

     c. God had a pattern when He created everything...the pattern was **HIMSELF**.

        The Godhead = the trinity = 3 (Father, Son, Holy Spirit)

        NOTE: He is the pattern! (see below)

2. **Examples of the Godhead that CAN be seen in creation:**
   - ✓ An atom (smallest matter known) is made up of protons, neutrons, and electrons.
   - ✓ A human being is made of 3 parts according to the Bible: **body**, soul, and spirit – see Gen. 1:26-27.
   - ✓ Time is either past, present, or future. It also breaks down to years, months, and days. Each day has hours, minutes, and seconds. Every day has a morning, afternoon, and night.
   - ✓ Color breaks down to 3 primary colors: red, blue, and yellow.
   - ✓ The common states of matter are solid, liquid, or gas form.
   - ✓ Space equals height, width, and depth.
   - ✓ Reality has space, matter, and **time** associated with it.
   - ✓ Electrical charge is either positive, negative, or neutral.
   - ✓ Water (a basic compound) has 3 parts = H20 (2 hydrogen atoms, 1 oxygen).

- ✓ To make fire you need heat, fuel, and oxygen.
- ✓ There are 3 heavens according to the Bible: earth's atmosphere, outer space, and the 3rd heaven.
- ✓ Skin has a dermis, epidermis, and hypodermis.
- ✓ Teeth are made of the crown, neck/cervix, and root.
- ✓ A family consists of mother, father, and child(ren).
- ✓ There are 3 types of levers.
- ✓ There are 3 laws of **motion**.
- ✓ There are 3 dimensions to space/objects.
- ✓ A triangle is the strongest shape in creation.
- ✓ There are 3 God-ordained institutions: family, government, and the church.

3. **Examples of Bible principles/teachings that CAN be enhanced by observing/studying creation:**
   - ✓ **Wind** - John 3:8, Acts 2:2-4 = **A TYPE OF THE HOLY SPIRIT**
   - ✓ **Trees** - Psalm 1:1-3, Mark 8:24 = **A PICTURE OF A PERSON/PEOPLE**
   - ✓ **Grass** - Isaiah 40:7,1 Peter 1:24 = **THE SHORTNESS OF LIFE**
   - ✓ **Fog/Fog Breath**- James 4:14
   - ✓ **Clouds** - Matthew 26:64, Acts 1:11, 1 Thessalonians 4:17, Revelation 1:7
   - ✓ **Night** - Romans 13:1-11, 1 Thessalonians 5:2-5
   - ✓ **Rain** - Isaiah 55:10, Jeremiah 5:24
   - ✓ **Snow** - Isaiah 1:18, Mark 9:3, Revelation 1:14
   - ✓ **The Sun** - Malachi 4:2, Psalm 84:11, John 8:12
   - ✓ **Moon** - Job 25:5, Isaiah 60:1-3, Psalm 136:9
   - ✓ **Stars** - Revelation 1:20, 12:3-4
   - ✓ **Ants** - Proverbs 6:6-9, 30:25
   - ✓ **Fish** – Matthew 4:19, 17:24-27
   - ✓ **Deer** (Hart) - Psalm 42:1, Song 2:9, 17
   - ✓ **Rabbits** (Conies) - Psalm 104:18, Proverbs 30:26
   - ✓ **Rocks** - Psalm 18:2,46; 28:1; 31:3; 42:9; 62:2,6; 71:3; 92:15
   - ✓ **Gardens** - Matthew 13:18-23, Mark 4:14-20

KEY: After looking at some of the examples above, we are reminded of two very important words that will link the Bible to these examples in creation:

"LIKE" and **"AS"**

Why is this a Factor in Bible Study?: Rule #7 shows us that God uses the things that He made in creation to give us further evidence of the Bible. It is also important to use creation in witnessing because it is part of God's "general revelation" **seen by everybody, everyday**…there's no excuse…creation speaks to the lost and saved!!

#8 THE APPARENT CONTRADICTION FACTOR

1. There are **NO** contradictions in the Bible, only "apparent contradictions." Always give God and the Bible the benefit of the doubt. To say that there is an error or discrepancy in your Bible and then move on like it is no big deal is heresy in light of Ps. 12:6-7, Pr. 30:5, etc.

   FIRST Understand that this important conclusion is first reached by **FAITH**…believing that God's word is divinely inspired and without error. To those who believe, God will confirm His truth by demonstrating that there are **NO** genuine contradictions that cannot be resolved.

   NEXT Although our conclusion for this factor is reached by faith, let us be reminded that genuine faith always has substance and evidence - Hebrews 11:1.

   THEN Consider that God's use of over **40** different authors to pen the Bible over 2,000 years in different cultures, time periods, etc. is going to bring some differences in style and the way events are recorded.

   FINALLY Whenever you find an "apparent" contradiction, immediately apply the rules of Bible study that you know to draw the **RIGHT** conclusion.

2. There are **PURPOSES** for "apparent" contradictions in the Bible.

   - To give skeptics a lie to believe.

     Ezekiel 14:1-4, 9
     Isaiah 29:9-14
     1 Kings 22:8-28

     NOTE If you come to God with your own pre-conceived ideas, not at all sincerely interested in what God says (wanting to appear religious, etc.)…God will give you a lie to believe! This is not because God is a liar! It is because you were not willing to **BELIEVE** Him, but rather your own lie! Most Christians miss this…in counseling…they believe the world's ways instead of God's ways. Why? It appeals to and satisfies the flesh! (Isaiah 30:1-3)

   - To reveal hidden truth to the faithful believer.

     Matthew 13:10-23 – Jesus said that the purpose of the parables was to hide truth to unbelievers and skeptics and to reveal truth to those who believe.

     John 6 – Jesus teaches the disciples words that seem to contradict (John 6:53; Gen. 9:4; Lev. 17:10-11; Duet. 12:23) The **SKEPTICS** walk away, while the believers stay (even though they don't fully understand yet; Jn. 6:67-69). Only once they had done this, were they then later allowed to understand the full truth of the story (Mt. 26:26-28; Mark 14:22-24; Luke 22:19-20; 1 Corinthians 11:23-26)

3. Regarding the skeptics…

   - You will see/hear this accusation against the Bible often. Nine times out of ten when someone tells you there are contradictions in the Bible, they cannot show you one. So, ask them to show you one to prove it ... this will usually make them quiet on this accusation!

   - However, there is that tenth person…so let's look at a few "apparent contradictions" in the Bible…

4. Examples of some "apparent" contradictions:

a. **Proverbs 26:4-5** – Do you answer a fool according to his folly or not? How would you biblically figure that out?

b. **Exodus 20:13** (also Deut. 5:17)
Exodus 21:12-19 (*aka…thou shalt kill*)

Which is right? Do we have the right to kill or not?

Is this a contradiction in Chapters right next to each other, or is God empowering government?

See also Romans 13:1-4 in the New Testament!

c. **Mark 15:25** – According to this passage, Jesus was crucified in the **3rd** hour of the day.
John 19:14 – According to this passage, Pilate presented Jesus to the Jews who said "crucify him" in the **6th** hour of the day…and He was then crucified (that same day!)…Uh, oh.

You indeed need some deeper **study** to clear up this "apparent" contradiction!

The gospel of Mark is recorded using **JEWISH** time.

The Jewish day begins at 6:00 AM which places the crucifixion at 9:00 AM, which is the **3rd** hour of the **Jewish day.**

The gospel of John is recorded using **ROMAN** time.

The Roman day begins at 12:00 AM *(like ours does today)*. This places the trial of Christ by Pilate at 6:00 AM, which is the **6th** hour of the **Roman day**.

This time schedule works out perfectly (from different perspectives…Jewish/Gentile) and lines up perfectly as an accurate, detailed record of scripture.

It clearly demonstrates our factor tonight…that there are **NO** contradictions in the Bible…

…only ***apparent*** contradictions.

Key Points

- ✓ Have a right heart attitude toward God and the Bible.
- ✓ Always approach the Bible by giving it the **BENEFIT** of the doubt.
- ✓ Every apparent contradiction has a **SOLUTION**, even though you may not be mature enough or gifted enough just yet to find it.

#9 THE CONSISTENCY FACTOR

1. When studying the Bible, we must pay attention to the **CONSISTENCY** of God.

   - There is a consistency to layout, words, and principles of the **BIBLE**…because there is a consistent nature to our God!

     Col. 1:17 The laws and order we find in creation are consistent because of Jesus Christ. (Newton's laws of motion, Laws of Thermodynamics, gravity's pull, how atoms work, etc.)

     Heb.13:8 *Jesus Christ the same yesterday, and to day, and for ever*. (He is the Word!)

     James 1:17 *…from the Father of lights, with whom is no variableness, neither shadow of turning.*

     Malachi 3:6 *For I am the LORD, I change not; therefore ye sons of Jacob are not consumed.*

   NOTE This does not contradict the fact that God does things differently at different times (the Time Period Factor). These are two distinctly different points.

2. God's consistency and the "Law of First Mention"

   - It is very common for the **1ST** mention of something in the Bible to establish a truth or **PATTERN** that is ***consistently*** followed throughout the entire Bible. You will observe these truths and patterns illustrated in figures (*pictures*) and truth (*words*) ***throughout the scriptures***.

   - This Bible phenomenon has been nicknamed… "The **LAW** of First Mention."

   - Genesis is a key book for many *"First Mentions."* Here are a few examples:

     "The serpent and his attack" - Genesis 3:1-5 (first mention)
     - ✓ The serpent is consistently associated with sin and the devil (see also Rev. 12:9, 20:2).
     - ✓ The devil's main attack is always against God's **WORD** (questions/contradicts/changes).
     - ✓ 2 Cor. 11:3 – *"But I fear…as the **serpent** beguiled Eve through his subtilty, **so** your minds should be corrupted from the simplicity that is in Christ."*
     - ✓ John 3:14 – *"…as Moses lifted up **the serpent** in the wilderness, **even so** must the Son of man be lifted up"* (see Numbers 21)

     "*Babel* or *Babylon*" - Genesis 10:10; 11:1-9 (first mention)
     - ✓ The first mention of Babel or Babylon involves false **RELIGION** and is and will be just like the false religion that Antichrist will use to deceive during the tribulation period (Rev. 17:5).

     "*love*" - Genesis 22:2 (first mention)
     - ✓ The first mention of *love* in the Bible is associated with a loving father offering up his only son as a sacrifice. A New Testament word used as synonymously for love is **CHARITY!**

     "*worship*" - Genesis 22:5 (first mention)
     - ✓ The first mention of *worship* involves a man being tested and trusting God to do the super-natural. True worship is associated with deep personal **sacrifice** and **faith** leading to a life changing encounter with God!

     "Egypt"- Genesis 12:10 (first mention)
     - ✓ "Egypt is mentioned some 600 times in the Bible and its first mention is significant. It is mentioned first in Genesis 12:10 when we read that Abraham, faced with a famine in the Promised Land, "went down into Egypt to sojourn there." Egypt, when used in the Bible,

symbolizes the world: this world's system, human life, and society with God left out. In its wealth and wisdom, its politics and religion, its culture and magnificence, this world is a snare to the believer."[2]

- When seeking understanding or clarification about an issue in the Bible, always check the 1st time the word or subject is mentioned. This factor is a great key, but it does not unlock every door.

NOTE. God's consistency and the "Law of Progressive Mention": First Mention introduces the subject; Progressive Mention follows the subject as God adds more revelation.

- The Lamb is a perfect example: Genesis 22 introduces God's provided lamb as a picture; Exodus 12 develops this idea of substitution and blood; Isaiah 53 reveals the Lamb as a suffering person; John 1:29 identifies Him as Jesus; Revelation 5 presents the slain Lamb risen and reigning.

3. God's consistency and His use of numbers in the Bible:

- **Three** - Romans 1:20, 1 John 5:7 (see also rule #7 study sheet)
  - ✓ Three is associated with the **UNIVERSE** and the trinity.
  - ✓ Three also has significance with resurrection and the new life associated with Jesus Christ (**3RD** day).
- **Four** – Isaiah 11:12
  - ✓ Four seems to associate with the **EARTH**
  - ✓ Mark 13:27 – *"And then shall he send his angels, and shall gather together his elect from the **four winds**, **from the uttermost part of the earth** to the uttermost part of heaven."*
- **Five** - Genesis 5:5 (first mention)
  - ✓ Five IS associated all over the Bible with death – death, grave, beast, grave, Satan, devil, **JESUS**
- **Six** - Revelation 13:18
  - ✓ God emphasizes this one! Six is the number of **MAN**. Specifically, fallen man or man's incompleteness.
- **Seven** - Genesis 2:2-3 (first mention)
  - ✓ God finishes with creation and He rests on the **7TH** day. Seven is emphasized throughout the Bible as God's number for **COMPLETION**.
- **Eight** - 2 Peter 2:5
  - ✓ Eight is the number representing new **BEGINNINGS**. (Seven is the number of completion!)
- **Nine** - Genesis 9:1, 9 (first mention) – Noah commissioned to bear fruit
  - ✓ Nine seems to be a number God uses related to **FRUITFULNESS/FRUITBEARING**.
- **Ten** - Genesis 10:10 (The first **GENTILE** kingdom)
  - ✓ Ten is a number that represents **Gentiles**, or non-Jews.
- **Twelve** - Genesis 12
  - ✓ Twelve is the number associated with the nation of **ISRAEL** and Jews.
- **Thirteen** – Genesis 14:4 (first mention)
  - ✓ Thirteen is associated with **REBELLION**
  - ✓ "Number THIRTEEN is the number of rebellion and apostasy. Its first occurrence is in Genesis 14:4 – "'Twelve years they served Chedorlaomer, and in the thirteenth year they rebelled." In this verse, thirteen appears and proves rebellion and government resisted. Beginning at this point, and appearing throughout Scripture, thirteen suggests rebellion, sin, and disobedience."[3]
- **Forty** – Genesis 7:4 (first mention)
  - ✓ Forty is related to a time of being tested or **TESTING**.

CONCLUSION

We must look for and apply the **CONSISTENT** patterns God has established throughout the Bible as we study it. God is very consistent with His words, principles, and even how He uses numbers. Also, when seeking understanding or clarification on an issue in the Bible, always check the **first time** the word or subject is **mentioned**.

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[2] John Phillips, *Bible Explorer's Guide: How to Understand and Interpret the Bible* (Grand Rapids, MI: Kregel Publications, 2002), 127.

[3] J. Edwin Hartill, *Principles of Biblical Hermeneutics* (CreateSpace Independent Publishing Platform, 2015), 149–50.

#10 THE LITERAL FACTOR

1. Always take a passage **LITERALLY** until it is impossible to take it literally or if there is clear instruction from the scripture that we are dealing with **SYMBOLISM**.

- This is commonly known in Biblical Studies as the "**GOLDEN RULE**" of Bible study. It is typically stated this way, "When the plain sense of Scripture makes common sense, seek no other sense."[4] [5] [6]
- It is also important to remember that we can interpret the Bible literally, consistently only because of the foundational rules established earlier in this class. These principles cannot be ignored or passed over.

NOTE Many will say something is "symbolic" in the scripture as opposed to taking it literally, exactly as it is written, as an excuse to justify lack of understanding.

Matthew 13:1-23 **PARABLES** What is a parable? Verses 10-12; Jesus explains them!
- Jesus then interprets the symbols in **verses 18-23**, showing that it was all clearly meant as symbolism/not literal/imagery

Revelation 1:12-20 **SYMBOLISM**

Ezekiel 37:1-11 **SYMBOLISM**
- Ezekiel sees a valley full of dry bones. As he prophesies, the bones come together, receive flesh and breath, and become a great living army. God explains that the bones symbolize the whole house of Israel, pictured as dead and hopeless but later restored by God.

John 6:35, 53-63 **SYMBOLISM**

KEY Very few passages in the Bible are symbolic. Symbolism that does exist is usually clearly defined in the immediate context. *(Those not defined in the context can be defined elsewhere in the Bible by comparing scripture with scripture. Ex. – Rev. 12:1-5)*

2. Keep in mind that God **TALKS** to us, through the words of the Bible, just like we talk: *(God records real life)*

- **Figures of speech** - Gen. 4:10; Lev. 18:25; Nu. 14:9; Joshua 24:27; Prov. 18:2
  - *Figure of speech - Figuratively explaining something (IE. sunrise / sunset…Matt. 5:45; Mark 1:32)*
- **Sarcasm** - Judges 9:7-15; 10:14; 1 Kings 18:27; Job 12:2-3; 18:5; 2 Co. 11:16-19; Acts 2:13
  - Elijah clearly does not believe that they may have a god who is just sleeping or on a trip, he is mocking and using sarcasm. Job clearly does not believe his friends possess all wisdom and when they die, all wisdom will cease to exist (as evidenced by the context vs. 3)
  - *Sarcasm - cutting or taunting in order to aggravate or hurt someone's feelings; a mocking remark utilizing statements opposite or irrelevant to the underlying meaning.*
- **Hyperboles** - Gen. 33:10; Deut. 1:28; Judges 7:12; 2 Kings 19:24; Jer. 15:16; 1 Co. 13:1-2; 2 Co. 7:14

[4] Roy B. Zuck, *Basic Bible Interpretation: A Practical Guide to Discovering Biblical Truth* (Wheaton, IL: Victor Books, 1991), 146.
[5] John Phillips, *Bible Explorer's Guide: How to Understand and Interpret the Bible* (Grand Rapids, MI: Kregel Publications, 2002), 26.
[6] Charles C. Ryrie, *Dispensationalism*, rev. and expanded ed. (Chicago: Moody Press, 1995), 80.

- *Hyperbole - An exaggerated statement used for effect not meant to be taken literally.*

- **Satire** - Isaiah 44:14-17; Gen. 37:19; 1 Samuel 17:41-44; Eccl. 2:1-11; Matthew 23:1-33
  - *Satire - A literary work in which irony, derision, or wit is used to expose folly or wickedness.*
  - The events described are literal, but Isaiah presents them satirically to show the absurdity of worshipping something a man made with his own hands. The purpose is what we are to understand. He is not giving instruction on woodworking, but using this as a condemnation of making gods with mans own hands.

KEY POINT **Always** take a passage **literally** unless it is impossible to do so!

This factor **SIMPLIFIES** what you read and will increase your comprehension of the Bible!

#11 THE ATTITUDE FACTOR

1. Always be ready to **CHANGE** whatever you have been taught or you have believed when you find it goes **CONTRARY** to the Bible – James 1:22-25.

- John 3:1-18 **RELIGION** can **blind us** from what we should believe.
  - **o** Nicodemus was so religious, so entrenched in his beliefs and religion, that he was unable to see clear and simple teaching that was right in front of him. He was so wound up he was thinking ridiculous things! Jesus speaks to him in one of the simplest and strongest statements of the Bible about salvation in Christ. **Are we so religious that we are unable to see clearly when God wants us to change what we believe, when confronted with his word?**

- Mark 7:1-13 **TRADITION** can **bind us** to unbiblical beliefs.
  - o We can "worship" God in vain (empty, fake), when it is according to our traditions and not God's word. Worship is sacrifice and giving of ourselves to God completely. How sad is it that someone could waste their life, sacrificing it to God, all in vain, because it was based on tradition and not God's word. Many do it never knowing that they were doing it in vain.
  - o How do we fix this? Ask the question: "Is what I am doing/sacrificing for BIBLICAL? Or, is it a tradition of men? If it is not Biblical, ask, "Why am I doing this? Who is telling me to do this? God or man/tradition?"

- John 11:23-27 – God will **CHALLENGE** our beliefs.
  - o Jesus is speaking to Martha about the death of Lazarus and he tells her that "he is the resurrection and the life." There were many disagreements amongst the Pharisees and Saducees about the resurrection of the dead at this time in history. Martha was thinking in their terms, Jesus fixes it all and clarifies that HE IS THE RESSURECTION AND THE LIFE.

- Mark 10:17-26 – Sometimes we will choose not to believe. We know better.
  - o The issue in this story is an issue as old as time, and it is the basis of all sin in our lives and it is the killer of any fruit, any learning, and growth: PRIDE! The rich young man did not have a lack of knowledge of what to do; he clearly understood. He simply did not want to do it. Just as the Devil has no lack of knowledge of the power, glory, eternality, death, resurrection, etc.. of Christ; he simply will not bow his life to Him.
  - o Many have no problem comprehending what the Bible teaches, it is written in plain English for our understanding. However, our issue as mankind, is our unwillingness to submit ourselves to God's word and his will for us.

- Luke 6:46-49 – Our beliefs will determine the **FOUNDATION** and steadfastness of our lives.
  - o Those who hear and refuse to obey, their lives always are shaky, unbalanced, constantly collapsing, etc.. because they refuse to obey, even though they know what they are supposed to do. There is no harder life than this life as a runaway child of God (prodigal son).

- 2 Kings 22-23 – The example of good king Josiah and his crisis of belief.
  - o Judah had drifted far from God and had been living contrary to His Word. While the temple was being repaired, Hilkiah the priest found "the book of the law in the house of the LORD" (2 Kings 22:8).
    When the book was read to Josiah, he realized how far the nation had departed from Scripture. "When the king had heard the words of the book of the law, that he rent his clothes" (22:11). He immediately recognized that Judah was doing things against God and his word: "Great is the wrath of the LORD... because our fathers have not hearkened unto the words of this book" (22:13).
    Josiah did not defend what they had always done or their "tradition". He gathered the people and "read in their ears all the words of the book of the covenant" (23:2). Then he "made a covenant before the LORD, to walk after the LORD, and to keep his commandments" (23:3).
    After that, Josiah began removing the idols, false worship, corrupt priests, and practices that contradicted God's Word. When Josiah discovered that what he and his nation had been doing was contrary to Scripture, he changed it.

KEY #1 We must always line ourselves up to what the Bible **clearly SAYS**!

KEY #2 We must be careful not to make the Bible say what we want it to say!

2. Our **personal beliefs** are formed by our upbringing, societal pressures/teaching, and personal experience. The following are a few examples of issues the Bible speaks about that may challenge your own personal beliefs and actions:

✓ *Managing finances –*
✓ *Dating –*
✓ *Biblical relationships –*
✓ *Marriage responsibilities –*
✓ *Child rearing and discipline –*
✓ *Proper use of alcohol –*
✓ *Giving –*
✓ *Church service schedules –*
✓ *Attitudes/actions toward authority –*
✓ *Work ethic –*

3. Have an **HONEST** attitude toward God when you come to a crisis of belief with His word.

- Mark 9:23-24 –

NOTE Changes in our beliefs will cause changes in our **ACTIONS** and attitudes.

KEY Many people are not able to apply this factor of Bible study because they **do not** have a final authority. If you **do not** have a final authority, **YOU** become the final authority.

#12 THE CLARITY FACTOR

1. Never violate a **CLEAR** passage when trying to understand an **OBSCURE** (uncertain) passage.

    - There are obscure passages in the Bible – 2 Peter 3:16
    - Some passages are clearly **CLOSED** for now – Proverbs 25:2; Daniel 12:4, 8-9; Ephesians 3:1-7; 1 Pet. 1:6-12; John 16:12
    - A few examples:

    FAITH ALONE VS. WORKS

    Clear

    ✓ Ephesians 2:8-9; Titus 3:5; Rom. 10:9-10; John 3:16; Romans 4:5; Galatians 2:16; Romans 11:6; 2 Timothy 1:9

    Obscure

    ✓ James 2:24; Hebrews 3:6

    BAPTISM AS PART OF SALVATION PROCESS

    Clear

    ✓ John 3:16; Ephesians 2:8–9; Titus 3:5; Romans 4:5; Romans 10:9–10; Acts 16:30–31; 1 Corinthians 1:14–17; Acts 8:36–38; Luke 23:42–43

    Obscure

    ✓ 1 Peter 3:21; Acts 2:38

2. Key points to remember when you encounter an obscure passage:

    - There are always **many, many more CLEAR** passages about a subject than obscure ones!
    - Apply the rules of Bible study to find the clear meaning of any difficult passage. If you cannot get clarity on a verse or passage concerning the subject matter after applying the rules of Bible study, move on for now, give God the benefit of the doubt, and trust the clear verses/passages that you do understand.
    - Eventually, you will always find that whatever an obscure passage means will **NEVER** conflict with other scripture taken in context. (Ps. 12:6-7; Pr. 30:5)

#13 THE QUESTION FACTOR

1. Never base a doctrine on a **QUESTION**. Questions are designed to investigate, interrogate, and **EXPOSE** an answer. Sometimes questions in the Bible can be rhetorical to support an answer, but remember, they are questions, NOT answers. This rule is strongly connected to the CLARITY FACTOR, yet they are distinct.

    "Obscure passages must always give way to clear passages. Further, we must never build a doctrine on obscure or difficult passages. Everything essential to salvation or to Christian living is clearly revealed in the Bible. We have no need to resort to obscure passages to support a Biblical belief. One such obscure passage in the Bible is found in 1 Corinthians 15:29, where we read: "Else what shall they do which are baptized for the dead, if the dead rise not at all? why are they then baptized for the dead?" The meaning of this passage is the subject of considerable controversy. The Mormons have formulated a doctrine of baptism for the dead based on this passage."[7]

[7] John Phillips, Bible Explorer's Guide: How to Understand and Interpret the Bible (Grand Rapids, MI: Kregel Publications, 2002), 108.

- Many strange and heretical doctrines are based on **QUESTIONS** in the Bible, not clear teachings of God:

  ✓ Extremist views of predestination (Calvinism) are based on a series of questions – *Rom. 9:13-24*

  While there are many passages used by Calvinists, their main areas used for doctrine are questions!

  ✓ Heretical teachings concerning grace plus works are based on a series of questions – *Jam. 2:20-26*

  The James text poses a question…a question cannot be the foundation for something as significant as teaching the Christian's salvation and eternal life are based on grace + works.

  ✓ The bizarre Mormon doctrine *,"baptism for the dead,"* is based on a single question in 1 Corinthians – *1 Cor. 15:29*

Key Point When a sole verse or passage is a question, it will **NOT** be the foundation for any significant Biblical doctrine. Therefore, ***never base a Bible doctrine on a question***.

#14 THE CONFIRMATION FACTOR

1. Never base a particular doctrine on **ONE** verse or passage alone. God always bases Bible doctrine (His clear teachings) on more than one verse!

   - Anytime God establishes a significant foundational truth, He ***always*** confirms it in the mouth of two or three **WITNESSES** –2 Cor. 13:1; *Deut. 19:15; Num. 35:30; Isa. 28:9-10, 13*

     ✓ 1 Cor. 15:29 — As we have already seen, the strange doctrine of "*baptism for the dead"* is based on **ONE** lone verse in the Bible (and a question at that!). Where else is baptism for the dead ever mentioned? Nowhere!

     - 1 Cor. 13:1 — Is there a heavenly language that angels speak? Or is this just a figure of speech? It is a figure of speech because when we compare scripture with scripture, we find that angels speak in **HEBREW**!! When angels speak, people understand them!! What other verses support a heavenly angelic language?

     - Matt.16:18 — Does this verse establish that Peter was to be the first pope in Rome? **1.2 billion people** follow a leadership system based on this **ONE** single verse.
       - Peter is not presented as the Rock, Christ is (**1 Cor. 10:4; 1 Pet. 2:4–8; Eph. 2:20; Isa. 28:16**); Peter was married (**Matt. 8:14; Mark 1:30; 1 Cor. 9:5**); Peter called himself a "fellow elder," not the supreme ruler of the church (**1 Pet. 5:1–4**); Peter explicitly refused religious reverence from Cornelius (**Acts 10:25–26**); Peter was publicly rebuked and corrected by Paul when he was wrong (**Gal. 2:11–14**); Peter was not the final authority at the Jerusalem council. James gave the concluding judgment (**Acts 15:7–20**); Christ, not Peter, is repeatedly called the Head of the Church (**Eph. 1:22–23; 4:15; 5:23; Col. 1:18; 2:19**); The foundation of the church is not Peter alone, but the apostles and prophets, with Jesus Christ as the chief cornerstone (**Eph. 2:20; Rev. 21:14**); Paul wrote an entire epistle to the Christians at Rome and greeted many believers by name without mentioning Peter (**Rom. 16:1–16**); When Paul was imprisoned in Rome, he mentioned numerous fellow workers but never identified Peter as the head of the Roman church (**Col. 4:7–14; 2 Tim. 4:9–12, 16**).

   - Remember to always **COMPARE** scripture with scripture *(Factor #6)*.

Key Point If an unusual doctrine in a verse/passage is not found supported anywhere else in the Bible... leave it alone.

#15 THE MATURITY FACTOR

1. God is infinitely wise. We will **NEVER** completely understand God. We are on a **LIFE**-long mission to know God and understand/experience His ways more until the day we are physically glorified - Ex. 33:18-23; Phil. 3:9-17.

    - Isaiah 55:8-9 – If we could ever completely understand God, we would be His **EQUAL**!

    - If you find something you don't understand, try your best to get it, being careful not to violate any of the rules of Bible study. If you still can't understand it, don't worry about it. God reveals His word to us in progression... ***as we are able to handle it***. We must also remember a humbling fact…God will not **TRUST** us with more if we are not faithful with what we have now.

    KEY We must work to **LIVE** what we ***do understand***, and then wait on God for more – Phil. 2:12-13

2. Always keep John 16:12 in your thinking… *"I have yet **many things** to say unto you, but ye cannot bear them now."*

15 Factors to Focus your Bible Study:

1. The Context Factor
2. The People Factor
3. The Division (time) Factor
4. The Application Factor
5. The Individual Word Factor
6. The Comparison Factor
7. The Creation Factor
8. The Apparent Contradiction Factor
9. The Consistency Factor
10. The Literal Factor
11. The Attitude Factor
12. The Clarity Factor
13. The Question Factor
14. The Confirmation Factor
15. The Maturity Factor

FINAL THOUGHTS

1. A Few More Key Principles to Store in your Toolbelt

    a. **The Kingdom of Heaven Vs. The Kingdom of God**
        i. "The Kingdom of Heaven is Jewish, the Kingdom which God promised to the nation of Israel in the Old Testament and is a literal Kingdom with a literal king upon a literal throne."[8] (Matt. 3:1-2; Hos. 1:4; Acts 1:6-8; Rev. 11:15)
        ii. "The Kingdom of God is inclusive in character, including: all who in any period believed God, the seed of Abraham, The Church, All who believe after the Tribulation."[9] (Rom. 14:17; Luke 17:20-21; 1 Cor. 4:20; 1 Cor. 15:50; John 3:3-5)
            1. Beyond this, going back to our Every Word factor: Are God and Heaven the same? Do we pray to Heaven? Do we live in God when we die?
            2. The Kingdom of God is a spiritual, inward kingdom entered through the new birth.

    b. **The Law of Full Mention**
        i. We have looked at the Laws of First Mention and Progressive Mention, but this principle is, "That principle by which God declares his full mind upon any subject vital to our spiritual life. Somewhere in the Word, God gathers together the scattered fragments that have to do with a particular truth, and puts them into one exhaustive statement. That is his full mind concerning that truth."[10]
            1. Examples — **Resurrection** (1 Corinthians 15); **Restoration of Israel** (Romans 11); **Faith Examples** (Hebrews 11); **The Church** (Ephesians 1); **Principles of the Kingdom of Heaven** (Matthew 5-7); **Righteousness by Faith** (Romans 3-4); **Charity/Love** (1 Corinthians 13); **Spiritual Gifts** (1 Corinthians 12); etc.

    c. **The Repetition Principle**
        i. The principle by which God repeats something already stated, in order to add to it, or to draw close attention to it. It is never done to "waste space".
            1. Examples:
                a. "Verily, Verily" (Jn. 5:24, 25; 6:26, 32, 47, 53; 8:34) —The statement means, "Truly, Truly". When he says it twice, it is meant to tell us to listen very closely.
                b. The Gospels — Four accounts of the Life of Jesus, all written to give us a different perspective of His life, not simply wasteful repeating of the same stories.
                c. Revelation — Four accounts of the events of the Tribulation, leading up to Jesus Second Coming.
                d. Kings/Chronicles — Both give the same basic telling of the events during this time in Israel/Judah, but from a different perspective. Many have noted that 1 and 2 Kings is mankind's perspective of these events, while 1 and 2 Chronicles is God's perspective of these events.

2. A Few More Tools To Use

    a. **Recommended Books**: *The Keys of Bible Study* (Mark Trotter); *Principles of Biblical Hermeneutics* (J. Edwin Hartill); *Bible Explorer's Guide* (John Phillips); *The Treasury of Scripture Knowledge* (R. A. Torrey edition); *Halley's Bible Handbook* (Henry H. Halley); *Willmington's Guide to the Bible* (Harold L. Willmington)
    b. **Recommended Bible Study Software**: *Blue Letter Bible (website and mobile app); Logos Bible Software (desktop, web, and mobile); e-Sword (Windows, Mac, Android, iPhone, and iPad); and SwordSearcher (Windows software).*
    c. **Recommended Audio Learning:** Mark Trotter's *Keys of Bible Study* is also available as a free 13-session WordStrong audio course (wordstrong.me). Also, on Apple Podcasts *WordStrong* channel.

[8] J. Edwin Hartill, *Principles of Biblical Hermeneutics* (CreateSpace Independent Publishing Platform, 2015), 41.
[9] J. Edwin Hartill, *Principles of Biblical Hermeneutics* (CreateSpace Independent Publishing Platform, 2015), 41.
[10] J. Edwin Hartill, *Principles of Biblical Hermeneutics* (CreateSpace Independent Publishing Platform, 2015), 94.

I. **MAIN TEXT: 2 TIMOTHY 2:15**- "Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth."

a. What do we do with the Bible? **STUDY!**

b. Why? To show ourselves APPROVED unto **God – NOT MAN!**

c. HOW? **RIGHTLY** DIVIDING **–which indicates that you can wrongly divide it!**

d. The posture we must maintain – that of a workman **– it will take some work.**

e. The result – We are NOT ASHAMED. There are people who will be ashamed as they stand before God for what they did to God and His word.

KEY: Before applying a passage to ourselves, we must understand what God said, through whom He said it, to whom He said it, when He said it, and why He said it.

II. **THE REVEALER OF TRUTH**

a. **The Holy Spirit is the Teacher of the Bible.**

i. **John 14:26**: "The Holy Ghost...he shall teach you all things."

ii. **John 16:13**: "The Spirit of truth...will guide you into all truth."

1. God may use preachers, teachers, and books, but spiritual truth is ultimately revealed by the Holy Spirit.

b. **The Holy Spirit teaches by the words of Scripture.**

i. **John 17:17**: "Thy word is truth."

ii. **1 Corinthians 2:13**: "Comparing spiritual things with spiritual."

1. We have learned the best commentary on the Bible. Many people desire to find a commentary that can help them to understand the Bible and in this class, we looked at the ultimate Bible commentary… The BIBLE. It defines and explains itself! (comparing scripture with scripture.

iii. **Psalm 119:18**: "Open thou mine eyes, that I may behold wondrous things out of thy law."

KEY: Depend upon the Holy Spirit, but never separate His teaching from His written words.

III. **THE MAIN RULE OF BIBLE STUDY: BELIEVE THE BOOK!**

a. **Come humbly and willing to change** (James 1:21)

b. **Be willing to change what you believe (**James 1:22-25; Mark 7:8-13 Religious tradition can make "the word of God of none effect.")

i. Never change the Bible to agree with your beliefs. Change your beliefs to agree with the Bible.

KEY: Do not ask, "How can I make this support what I believe?" Ask, "What must I believe because this is what God's word says?"

IV. **SOME OF THE QUESTIONS WE ARE ANSWERING WITH THE 15 RULES OF BIBLE STUDY**

a. **What is the CONTEXT?**

i. What do the preceding and following verses, passages, and chapters say? What is the theme of the book? Where does the book fit within the Bible? How does it relate to the Bible's overall theme of **a King and His Kingdom**? What kind of writing is it? Poetry, history, epistles, etc.. (Psalm 56:5; 2 Peter 3:16)

ii. We learned that the Bible is meant to be taken literally unless it cannot be. Like with obvious figurative language or when the context tells us it is not literal (parables, symbols, "spiritual" truths)

KEY: Never remove a verse from its setting and give it a foreign meaning.

b. **Who is SPEAKING or WRITING? And To WHOM was it written?**

i. **1 Corinthians 10:32** identifies three primary groups: "the Jews...the Gentiles...the church of God."

1. Is the passage addressed to Israel, Gentile nations, or the church?

a. **James 1:1** is addressed "to the twelve tribes."

b. **Ephesians 1:1** is addressed “to the saints...and to the faithful in Christ Jesus.”

ii. **KEY:** All Scripture is written **for** us, but not every passage is written directly **to** us.

c. **WHEN does the passage concern?**

i. Which “dispensation” does this passage concern? **A dispensation simply means: God deals with different people, in different ways, at different times.**

1. Is it before the Law, under the Law, during Christ’s earthly ministry, in the church age, the Tribulation, the Millennium, or eternity? (Heb. 1:1-2; 2 Tim. 2:15; Eph. 3:2)

a. Do not take truth addressed to one people or time and force it into another.

d. **What do the exact WORDS say?**

i. Observe every word. Repeated words, pronouns, verb tenses, connecting words, questions, and comparisons. (Proverbs 30:5; Matt. 4:4; 5:18)

1. Do not merely read what you expect the verse to say. Ask what EXACTLY does it say?

2. The Bible NEVER promises to preserve ideas, thoughts, doctrines, etc.. It promises to preserve words, every word, and even markings! God is interested in every word!

e. **What is the passage TEACHING?**

i. Every passage has three basic applications:

1. **Historical:** What people, places, times, and events are being described?

2. **Doctrinal:** What truth is God teaching?

a. **The Bible is FULL of pictures, deep truths, prophetic truths, etc.**. (Luke 24:27; *John 5:39; 46-47)*

3. **Devotional or inspirational:** How should this truth change my beliefs, attitudes, or actions?

ii. **KEY:** Establish the historical setting first, determine the doctrinal teaching second, and make the personal application third.

V. WHY LEARN HOW TO STUDY THE BIBLE?

a. We are commanded to **study** it **correctly** (2 Tim. 2:15; 2 Pet. 1:20)

b. It changes us and makes us who God wants us to be (2 Tim. 3:16-17; John 17:17; Psalm 119:9-11)

c. The word of God is our lifeblood; it is how we know God and what he wants from us (John 15:1-8; Matt. 4:4; 1 John 2:3-5)

VI. Salvation

a. Maybe you are in here and you don’t know God.

i. **Romans 10:17-** “So then faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.”

ii. You have heard the word of God today, and you can by faith receive Jesus Christ today and be saved.

iii. Romans 3:23; 6:23; 10:9,13

iv. Maybe you think, “I don’t understand the Bible when I read it. I never get anything out of it.”

1. Our teacher is the Holy Ghost. MAYBE, you just need to spend more time studying and exercising yourself in the word, or MAYBE you don’t have the teacher, the Holy Ghost living inside of you. When you receive Christ, your understanding will be opened up in ways you never thought possible!

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a. **James 1:1** is addressed “to the twelve tribes.”

b. **Ephesians 1:1** is addressed “to the saints...and to the faithful in Christ Jesus.”

KEY: All Scripture is written for us, but not every passage is written directly to us.

c. **_____does the passage concern?**

i. Which “dispensation” does this passage concern? **A dispensation simply means: God deals with different people, in different ways, at different times.**

1. Is it before the Law, under the Law, during Christ’s earthly ministry, in the church age, the Tribulation, the Millennium, or eternity? (Heb. 1:1-2; 2 Tim. 2:15; Eph. 3:2)

a. Do not take truth addressed to one people or time and force it into another.

d. **What do the _____ WORDS say?**

i. Observe every word. Repeated words, pronouns, verb tenses, connecting words, questions, and comparisons. (Proverbs 30:5; Matt. 4:4; 5:18)

1. Do not merely read what you expect the verse to say. Ask what EXACTLY does it say?
2. The Bible NEVER promises to preserve ideas, thoughts, doctrines, etc.. It promises to preserve words, every word, and even markings! God is interested in every word!

e. **What is the passage TEACHING?**

i. Every passage has three basic applications:

1. **Historical:** What people, places, times, and events are being described?
2. **Doctrinal:** What truth is God teaching?
    a. **The Bible is FULL of pictures, deep truths, prophetic truths, etc.**. (Luke 24:27; John 5:39; 46-47)
3. **Devotional or inspirational:** How should this truth change my beliefs, attitudes, or actions?

ii. **KEY:** Establish the historical setting first, determine the doctrinal teaching second, and make the personal application third.

V. _____LEARN HOW TO STUDY THE BIBLE?

a. We are commanded to _____ it _____ (2 Tim. 2:15; 2 Pet. 1:20)

b. It changes us and makes us who God wants us to be (2 Tim. 3:16-17; John 17:17; Psalm 119:9-11)

c. The word of God is our lifeblood; it is how we know God and what he wants from us (John 15:1-8; Matt. 4:4; 1 John 2:3-5)

How to Study the Bible

2 Timothy 2:15

Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth.

This study will focus on **what the Bible says**.

Personal Bible Study Check-up Questions

Be honest… ☺

1. Have you ever read the entire Bible all the way through?
2. How often per week do you spend **reading** your Bible?
3. How often per week do you spend **studying** your Bible?
4. When you study, do you understand what you are reading?
5. Do you think it is possible to understand the Bible?
6. What is the last verse in the Bible you memorized?
7. Do you have anybody that has helped you when you didn't understand a verse/passage from the Bible?
8. Do you feel blessed by God when you read and study His Bible?
9. Do you ever take time during the week to review your notes from Sunday's Bible messages?
10. Will you commit to spending time each day with God in the Bible?
11. Are you tired of me asking questions?

WEEK #1 Introduction

This is a very important study. These are foundational principles for all Bible reading and study. If you want something to last, you have to build on a solid foundation.

Because of the power of God's word, this will be an awesome opportunity to expose seekers of truth to the truth of the Bible.

- John 18:33-38, 19:9 – Pilate's question to Jesus…What is _____?
- John 17:17 – …*thy word is truth.*

Important for this Study:

- ✓ Get a notebook to keep all of your study sheets together
- ✓ Continue to reflect on the Personal Bible Study Check-up questions
- ✓ Pray for someone you know that would benefit from this study
- ✓ Ask that person and others to come in the following weeks

The Bible is no ordinary Book:

- Hebrews 4:12 – The Bible is _____. It discerns thoughts and intents. It cuts right to it.
- James 1:21-25 – The Bible is a _____ mirror.
- James 1:5-8; 4:2 – The Bible is _____ Book, we must come to it humbly.
- 2 Peter 1:21 – Men were the _____ God used to write it, but God was the author.
- Psalm 119:97-105 –
- Job 23:12 –
- Jeremiah 15:16 –
- Luke 4:4 – …*man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word of God.*

I. The word of God _____ lives!

1. It is the agent which God uses to bring forth life.

Psalm 33:6-9	*By the word of the LORD were the heavens made…For he spake, and it was done…*
John 11:43	*And when he thus had spoken, he cried with a loud voice, Lazarus, come forth.*
1 Pet. 1:23-25	*Being born again…by the word of God…But the word of the Lord endureth for ever…*
Matt. 24:35	*Heaven and earth shall pass away, but my words shall not pass away.*

Key Point:

IF God's word can make something out of _____;

IF God's word can raise a _____ man from a grave;

IF God's word can deliver the salvation of one's _____;

IF God's word will endure for ever and _____ pass away…

THEN…we ought to…

- Pay close attention to it!
- Read it!
- Believe it!
- Study it!
- Memorize it!
- Obey it!
- Love it!
- …for the rest of our lives!!!

2. Consider the time in which we live.

Amos 8:11-12	*Behold, the days come…I will send a famine…but of hearing the words of the LORD:*
2 Timothy 3:1-7	*…the last days…Ever learning, and never able to come to the knowledge of the truth*
Daniel 12:4	*…the time of the end…many shall run to and fro, and knowledge shall be increased.*

Key Point:

The time of Amos is a lot like the time in which we live…materialistic, prosperous, swelling church attendance, but not many really know God, not many are preaching, and therefore, not many are _____ the Bible.

The time 2 Timothy and Daniel prophesied about is now…

This is why WE *must* pay attention to what God says in his word!

II. Foundational principles of Bible study

1. The Bible overall is _____ difficult to understand. We make it difficult by _____ believing every word we read.

   2 Peter 3:16 *…in which are **some things** hard to be understood…*

   2 Cor. 11:1-3 *…as the serpent beguiled Eve through his subtilty…simplicity that is in Christ.*

   Gen. 2:16 *And the LORD God commanded the man, saying…*

   Genesis 3:1-3 *Now the serpent was more subtil…Yea, hath God said…* (He **questions** God's word)

   Genesis 3:4 *And the serpent said unto the woman, Ye shall not surely die:* (He **contradicts** God's word)

   Genesis 3:5 *For God doth know that in the day ye eat thereof…* (He **changes** God's word)

   Note: Why? Satan understands something…

   1 Thess. 2:13 *…when ye received the word of God…ye received it…as it is in truth, the word of God…*

2. Anyone can get a working knowledge of the Bible if they want it. There is _____ special secret, _____ magic formula. An education may be helpful, but it is _____ necessary. Knowledge of other languages can be helpful, but it is _____ necessary.

   The disciples were common men, not scholars.

   Mark 12:37 *…And the common people heard him gladly.*

   Rev. 2:6 *…thou hatest the deeds of the Nicolaitans, which I also hate.*

   Rev. 2:15 *…the doctrine of the Nicolaitans, which thing I hate.*

   God wrote the Bible to reveal truth, not hide it.

   Ps. 119:105 *Thy word is a lamp unto my feet, and a light unto my path.*

   Ps. 119:130 *The entrance of thy words giveth light…*

   Prov. 6:23 *For the commandment is a lamp, and the law is light…*

3. The Holy Spirit teaches the Bible. God can and will use other instruments (preachers, Bible teachers, tapes, CD's, books, etc.), but all truth is imparted by the Holy Spirit. How much you learn depends _____ on your responsiveness to Him.

   Note: I will not teach you anything throughout this class series. What you learn will depend on your reliance upon the Holy Spirit to be your teacher as you – by faith – believe what the Bible clearly says.

   John 14:16, 26 *…But the Comforter, which is the Holy Ghost…he shall teach you all things…*

   John 16:7-13 *…Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth…*

   1 Cor. 2:9-16 *…but which the Holy Ghost teacheth; comparing spiritual things with spiritual…*

   Note: Only the Holy Ghost can reveal truth…

In this respect, God did not author a Bible that anyone could understand!

4. Why are there "rules" of Bible study?

   - There are rules to just about everything else …

     1 Cor. 14:40 *Let all things be done decently and in order.*

     2 Tim. 2:5 *And if a man also strive for masteries, yet is he not crowned, except he strive lawfully.*

     …governmental operation, traffic, medicine, mechanics, engineering, sports, cooking, nature (gravity), life (golden rule, etc.)…everything! Think about it…when people come to the living, eternal word of God, then we throw the rules out the window! No! This violates common sense and logic!

     2 Tim. 3:16 *All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for* _____…

     During this study, we will be looking at _____ basic rules (there are more)…these rules come from the Bible itself and just good, sound, common sense!

   - Note: The "official" title for the study of how to interpret the Bible is called _____.

     It is the "science" of interpreting the Bible (how to study the Bible). It is a man-made term that is important to know for your own reference.

After reading and considering everything we have today, will you take a moment and make a personal commitment to the Lord Jesus Christ?

Personal Commitment to Christ

III. Basic rules of biblical study and interpretation

Fifteen factors to focus Bible study

#1 THE CONTEXT FACTOR

1. There is no understanding of the Bible without a proper understanding of _____.

Note: ***Every*** verse, ***every*** passage **MUST** be studied in light of its context…

This has always been a common problem.

Psalm 56:5 *Every day they wrest my words…*

Jer. 23:36 *…for ye have perverted the words of the living God, of the LORD of hosts our God.*

Matt. 22:29 *Jesus answered and said unto them, Ye do err, not knowing the scriptures…*

2 Pet. 3:15-18 *…which they that are unlearned and unstable wrest, as they do also the other scriptures…*

It will always be a common problem.

Acts 20:28-31 *…shall grievous wolves enter in among you, not sparing the flock…*

Note: If this was going on 2,000 years ago…how much more today!?!

2 Cor. 11:3-4 *…For if he that cometh preacheth another Jesus, whom we have not preached…*

2 Cor. 11:13-15 *…And no marvel; for Satan himself is transformed into an angel of light…*

1 Tim. 1:19-20 *…which some having put away concerning faith have made shipwreck…*

Biblical context is a factor by which God sheds light upon a subject through either near passages or remote details bearing upon the same theme.

Note: Every verse in the Bible has something that precedes it and something that follows it, except two verses, Genesis 1:1 and Revelation 22:21.

Never, never, never take a verse out of its setting and give it a foreign meaning!

Establishing biblical _____ includes:

1) _____ context

- ✓ The preceding _____(s)
- ✓ The following verse(s)

- ✓ The preceding _____(s)
- ✓ The following passage(s)

- ✓ The preceding _____(s)
- ✓ The following chapter(s)

2) _____ context

- ✓ The _____ of the particular book of the Bible the scripture is located in
- ✓ How that particular Book fits into the _____ of the Bible
- ✓ Always keeping in mind the _____ of the entire Bible

3) _____ of other important rules of Bible study

- ✓ Historical framework
- ✓ Ethnic division
- ✓ Comparing things spiritual with things spiritual
- ✓ Other critical details, etc.

This morning we will examine examples of near and remote passages…

Some questions to ponder: (think for a minute…)

Have you ever had your words or statements taken out of context?

- Removed from your intention?
- Taken away from your heart's motive?
- Stripped from your character?
- Used against you?

How did it make you feel?

- Hurt?
- Betrayed?
- Misunderstood?
- Angry?

How do you think God feels about his words being taken out of context?

Hold that thought as we look at some examples…

2. Some common examples:

Near Context *(These passages are often misunderstood because they have been removed from their proper near context)*

Matthew 7:1-2 -

WHAT IT IS *NOT* TEACHING: It is not teaching us _____ to judge but rather teaching us not to have a critical or judgmental heart towards others…and what happens to someone who does!!

WHAT IT IS TEACHING: It teaches us how to _____!!

Galatians 5:4-

WHAT IT IS *NOT* TEACHING: That those who are already saved can somehow _____ their salvation.

WHAT IT IS TEACHING: Those who are trusting in their works for salvation, are missing out on the very thing that saves them, _____! They have not lost salvation or God's grace, but they have not remembered that grace in their lives.

John 6:56 -

WHAT IT IS *NOT* TEACHING: That Jesus somehow wants us to eat his _____ flesh and drink his literal blood! Jesus had just fed 5,000 people. Many were still following him because they wanted a free lunch. Verse 66…and took their false doctrine with them!!

WHAT IT IS TEACHING: A spiritual principle – His _____ are life!!

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WHAT IT IS *NOT* TEACHING: How _____ in the NT church age are to get saved!
How _____ in the NT church age should speak babble!

WHAT IT IS TEACHING: What actually happened as a matter of _____ significance after Jesus ascended into Heaven to be with God the Father and answers the question for the Jews that had killed their Messiah – oh no – what shall we do?!?! It was a special "dispensation" of God's _____ for the Jews that had rejected and killed Jesus Christ!

Remote Context *(Passages in these books are often misunderstood because they have been removed from their remote context)*

1 Corinthians A _____ – a rebuke…it is more about what ____ to do rather than what to do – be careful!

Hebrews Some of the hardest passages in the Bible regarding _____ security. It appears like you can lose your salvation?

- Remember – it was written to _____ – who had a works-based religion!
- Remember – it is a _____ book in the Bible – like Matthew and Acts!

Observations *(Passages and chapters can be understood in light of the big picture painted by the order of the following books therefore establishing a broad overall doctrinal context)*

Example #1 Consider the big picture doctrinal context painted by the first 6 books of the Bible:

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Numbers God's people wander in the wilderness of _____…

Deuteronomy God gave the law a second time…this time serve out of _____ not duty…

Joshua Joshua (_____) leads God's people to conquer the Promised Land…

Example #2 Consider the big picture doctrinal context painted by the order of the following books:

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1. It is the agent which God uses to bring forth life.

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     2 Tim. 2:5 *And if a man also strive for masteries, yet is he not crowned, except he strive lawfully.*

     …governmental operation, traffic, medicine, mechanics, engineering, sports, cooking, nature (gravity), life (golden rule, etc.)…everything! Think about it…when people come to the living, eternal word of God, then we throw the rules out the window! No! This violates common sense and logic!

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   - Note: The "official" title for the study of how to interpret the Bible is called **HERMENEUTICS**.

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After reading and considering everything we have today, will you take a moment and make a personal commitment to the Lord Jesus Christ?

Personal Commitment to Christ

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Fifteen factors to focus Bible study

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1. There is no understanding of the Bible without a proper understanding of **CONTEXT**.

Note: ***Every*** verse, ***every*** passage **MUST** be studied in light of its context…

This has always been a common problem.

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Jer. 23:36 …for ye have perverted the words of the living God, of the LORD of hosts our God.

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Note: Every verse in the Bible has something that precedes it and something that follows it, except two verses, Genesis 1:1 and Revelation 22:21.

Never, never, never take a verse out of its setting and give it a foreign meaning!

Establishing biblical **CONTEXT** includes:

1) **NEAR** context

- ✓ The preceding **VERSE**(s)
- ✓ The following verse(s)

- ✓ The preceding **PASSAGE**(s)
- ✓ The following passage(s)

- ✓ The preceding **CHAPTER**(s)
- ✓ The following chapter(s)

2) **REMOTE** context

- ✓ The **THEME** of the particular book of the Bible the scripture is located in
- ✓ How that particular Book fits into the **THEME** of the Bible
- ✓ Always keeping in mind the **THEME** of the entire Bible

3) **OBSERVATION** of other important rules of Bible study

- ✓ Historical framework
- ✓ Ethnic division
- ✓ Comparing things spiritual with things spiritual
- ✓ Other critical details, etc.

This evening we will examine examples of near and remote passages…

Some questions to ponder: (think for a minute…)

Have you ever had your words or statements taken out of context?

- Removed from your intention?
- Taken away from your heart's motive?
- Stripped from your character?
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How did it make you feel?

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- Angry?

How do you think God feels about His words being taken out of context?

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2. Some common examples:

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WHAT IT IS TEACHING: It teaches us how to **JUDGE**!!

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WHAT IT IS *NOT* TEACHING: That those who are already saved can somehow **LOSE** their salvation.

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1 Corinthians A **REPROVE** – a rebuke…it is more about what **NOT** to do rather than what to do – be careful!

Hebrews Some of the hardest passages in the Bible regarding **ETERNAL** security. It appears like you can lose your salvation?

- Remember – it was written to **HEBREWS** – who had a works-based religion!
- Remember – it is a **TRANSITIONAL** book in the Bible – like Matthew and Acts!

Observations *(Passages and chapters can be understood in light of the big picture painted by the order of the following books therefore establishing a broad overall doctrinal context)*

Example #1 Consider the big picture doctrinal context painted by the first 6 books of the Bible:

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Numbers God's people wander in the wilderness of **UNBELIEF**…

Deuteronomy	God gave the law a second time…this time serve out of **LOVE** not duty…
Joshua	Joshua (**JESUS**) leads God's people to conquer the Promised Land…

Example #2 Consider the big picture doctrinal context painted by the order of the following books:

Ezra	The Jews **RETURN** to their land and the temple is rebuilt in Jerusalem…
Nehemiah	The Jews continue to return to their land and the **DEFENSE** network is rebuilt…
Esther	A Gentile bride is replaced with a **JEWISH** bride…
Job	There is a time of great **TRIBULATION**…
Psalms	King **DAVID** takes the throne from Saul (antichrist) and is King on the throne in Jerusalem leading worship…
Proverbs	The reign of the **WISDOM** of God – Jesus Christ – the living Word …

#2 THE PEOPLE FACTOR

1. There is no correct understanding of the Bible without understanding that the Bible is written to _____ types of people. This is often called the "ethnic division principle" – by those with higher education.

   1 Corinthians 10:32-33

   When God deals with mankind, He sees ***3*** different, unique divisions of people:

   a. _____

   b. _____

   c. _____ of _____

   KEY – You must take into account <u>to whom the passage was primarily written</u>.

   So…the old song goes…"All the promises in the Bible are mine, every chapter, every verse, every line"…No they are not!…aren't you glad – this Book promises hell to the lost – not me!

   The entire Bible is broken down, directly and indirectly, into one of these three people groups…pay close attention!

   These three people groups break down into the _____ types of people we are all familiar with in this world…

   a. _____ = _____ of _____

   b. _____ = _____ & _____

   Although there is a very distinct difference in these two, both are equally lost!

   The entire Bible is written _____ you; not all the Bible is written _____ you: *(repeat until it sinks in)*

   Note: All scripture is divinely inspired and has some application to your life (2 Timothy 3:16); you must determine whether it is direct or indirect…

   Some examples:

   a. James 1:1 (12 twelve tribes = _____; consider the author…)

      James, a servant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ, to the twelve tribes which are scattered abroad, greeting.

   b. 1 Peter 1:1 (Strangers = _____ _____, not Israel)

      Peter, an apostle of Jesus Christ, to the strangers scattered throughout Pontus, Galatia, Cappadocia, Asia, and Bithynia,

      2 Peter 3:1

      This second epistle, beloved, I now write unto you; in both which I stir up your pure minds by way of remembrance:

c. Ephesians 1:1 ("saints", "faithful" saints…written to a church, _____ to an individual!)

Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the will of God, to the saints which are at Ephesus, and to the faithful in Christ Jesus:

d. Isaiah 1:1; 13:1, 19; 15:1; 17:1; 18:1; 19:1; 34:1, 16 (pay close attention!)

e. Hebrews (The title gives it away – written to _____!)

f. 1 & 2 Timothy; Titus (written to individuals – church leaders – who are saved!)

g. Matthew - It is the Gospel with a uniquely _____ nature:

The _____ of this Gospel is: "The _____ and His _____"

Chapter 1 - The genealogy of the _____. (1:1, 6)
Chapter 2 – The _____ of the King.
Chapter 3 - John the Baptist announces the King. *(John is the last OT prophet; Isa. 40)*
Chapter 4 - The _____ and preparation of the King.
Chapter 5-7 - The constitution of the _____.
Chapter 8-9 - Christ presents His _____ as the King.
Chapter 10 - The 12 apostles are sent forth to preach the gospel of the _____ to Israel.
Chapter 11-12 - The _____ of the King and His Kingdom by the leaders of Israel.
Chapter 13-25 - The Kingdom enters a state of mysteries or _____ because of Israel's unbelief.

Matthew 24:13

Note: this is often misapplied to the church – Jesus is speaking to 12 _____ converts – still in ___!

- He is answering their question from verse 3, "Tell us, when shall these things be? and what *shall be* the sign of thy coming, and of the end of the world?"
- He is telling them of events of the Tribulation period. Look at verse 15, only 2 verses later: "When ye therefore shall see the abomination of desolation, spoken of by Daniel the prophet, stand in the holy place, (whoso readeth, let him understand:)"

KEY – part of understanding the *context* is taking into account the primary group of people to whom the passage was written.

Chapter 26 - The final night of the King.
Chapter 27 - The crucifixion and burial of the King. (Isa. 53)
Chapter 28 - The resurrection of the King.

NOTE: The danger of not understanding this point is expressed by Christ in Rev. 2:8-9; 3:7-9

Rev. 2:8-9 … and I know **the blasphemy of them <u>which say they are Jews, and are not</u>, but are the synagogue of Satan**.

Rev. 3:7-9 … I will make **them of the synagogue of Satan, <u>which say they are Jews, and are not</u>, but do lie**…

Question: Who, by their loud and clear doctrines, "say they are Jews and are not"?

Answer:

NOTE: Be careful – be aware – remember 2 Tim. 3:16 – don't tear out whole sections of your Bible!

John 6:56 -

WHAT IT IS *NOT* TEACHING: That Jesus somehow wants us to eat His **LITERAL** flesh and drink His literal blood! Jesus had just fed 5,000 people. Many were still following Him because they wanted a free lunch. Verse 66…and took their false doctrine with them!!

WHAT IT IS TEACHING: A spiritual principle – His **WORDS** are life!!

Acts 2:38 –

WHAT IT IS *NOT* TEACHING: How **GENTILES** in the NT church age are to get saved!
How **GENTILES** in the NT church age should speak babble!

WHAT IT IS TEACHING: What actually happened as a matter of **HISTORICAL** significance after Jesus ascended into Heaven to be with God the Father and answers the question for the Jews that had killed their Messiah – oh no – what shall we do?!?! It was a special "dispensation" of God's **SPIRIT** for the Jews that had rejected and killed Jesus Christ!

Remote Context *(Passages in these books are often misunderstood because they have been removed from their remote context)*

1 Corinthians A **REPROVE** – a rebuke…it is more about what **NOT** to do rather than what to do – be careful!

Hebrews Some of the hardest passages in the Bible regarding **ETERNAL** security. It appears like you can lose your salvation?

- Remember – it was written to **HEBREWS** – who had a works-based religion!
- Remember – it is a **TRANSITIONAL** book in the Bible – like Matthew and Acts!

Observations *(Passages and chapters can be understood in light of the big picture painted by the order of the following books therefore establishing a broad overall doctrinal context)*

Example #1 Consider the big picture doctrinal context painted by the first 6 books of the Bible:

Genesis The book of beginnings…ends with God's man dead in a coffin in **EGYPT**…

Exodus God's people are redeemed by the blood of the **LAMB**…

Leviticus God's people are **JOINED** to God and the priests are established…

Numbers God's people wander in the wilderness of **UNBELIEF**…

Deuteronomy	God gave the law a second time…this time serve out of **LOVE** not duty…
Joshua	Joshua (**JESUS**) leads God's people to conquer the Promised Land…

Example #2 Consider the big picture doctrinal context painted by the order of the following books:

Ezra	The Jews **RETURN** to their land and the temple is rebuilt in Jerusalem…
Nehemiah	The Jews continue to return to their land and the **DEFENSE** network is rebuilt…
Esther	A Gentile bride is replaced with a **JEWISH** bride…
Job	There is a time of great **TRIBULATION**…
Psalms	King **DAVID** takes the throne from Saul (antichrist) and is King on the throne in Jerusalem leading worship…
Proverbs	The reign of the **WISDOM** of God – Jesus Christ – the living Word …

#2 THE PEOPLE FACTOR

1. There is no correct understanding of the Bible without understanding that the Bible is written to **THREE** types of people. This is often called the "ethnic division principle" – by those with higher education.

1 Corinthians 10:32-33

When God deals with mankind, He sees ***3*** different, unique divisions of people:

a. **JEW**

b. **GENTILE**

c. **CHURCH** of **GOD**

KEY – You must take into account to whom the passage was primarily written.

So…the old song goes…"All the promises in the Bible are mine, every chapter, every verse, every line"…No they are not! …aren't you glad – this Book promises hell to the lost – not me!

The entire Bible is broken down, directly and indirectly, into one of these three people groups…pay close attention!

These three people groups break down into the **TWO** types of people we are all familiar with in this world…

a. **SAVED** = **CHURCH** of **GOD**

b. **LOST** = **JEWS** & **GENTILES**

Although there is a very distinct difference in these two, both are equally lost!

The entire Bible is written **FOR** you; not all the Bible is written **TO** you: *(repeat until it sinks in)*

Note: All scripture is divinely inspired and has some application to your life (2 Timothy 3:16); you must determine whether it is direct or indirect…

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The **THEME** of this Gospel is: "The **KING** and His **KINGDOM**"

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Chapter 8-9 - Christ presents His **CREDENTIALS** as the King.
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Note: this is often misapplied to the church – Jesus is speaking to 12 **JEWISH** converts – still in **OT**!

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Question: Who, by their loud and clear doctrines, "say they are Jews and are not"?

Answer: Many cults/heretical groups do this, but we also can do it when we misapply passages/promises to Jews, to us as Christians

NOTE: Be careful – be aware – remember 2 Tim. 3:16 – don't tear out whole sections of your Bible!

Addendum 1- How To Study the Bible- Rightly Dividing the Word

This is a list (not exhaustive) of some of the prophesies that we see were fulfilled literally, exactly as God promised they would be. We even see some of them being fulfilled in front of us in recent history. These give us confidence that God's promises are not to be "spiritualized", but rather are to be taken literally.

- **Israel would go into Egypt, be afflicted, and come out later.**

  Prophecy: Genesis 15:13-14.

  Fulfillment: Exodus 1:8-14; Exodus 12:40-41; Exodus 12:51.
- **Israel would be scattered for disobedience.**

  Prophecy: Deuteronomy 28:64; Leviticus 26:33.

  Fulfillment: 2 Kings 17:6; 2 Kings 25:8-11; Luke 21:24.
- **Judah would be captive in Babylon for seventy years.**

  Prophecy: Jeremiah 25:11-12; Jeremiah 29:10.

  Fulfillment: Daniel 9:2; Ezra 1:1-3; 2 Chronicles 36:20-23.
- **Cyrus would allow Jerusalem and the temple to be rebuilt.**

  Prophecy: Isaiah 44:28; Isaiah 45:1.

  Fulfillment: Ezra 1:1-4.
- **Messiah would be born in Bethlehem.**

  Prophecy: Micah 5:2.

  Fulfillment: Matthew 2:1-6; Luke 2:4-7.
- **Messiah would be born of a virgin.**

  Prophecy: Isaiah 7:14.

  Fulfillment: Matthew 1:22-25; Luke 1:26-35.
- **Messiah would come from David's line.**

  Prophecy: 2 Samuel 7:12-16; Isaiah 11:1; Jeremiah 23:5.

  Fulfillment: Matthew 1:1; Luke 1:32-33; Romans 1:3.
- **Messiah would enter Jerusalem on a donkey.**

  Prophecy: Zechariah 9:9.

  Fulfillment: Matthew 21:1-11; John 12:14-16.
- **Messiah would be betrayed for thirty pieces of silver.**

  Prophecy: Zechariah 11:12-13.

  Fulfillment: Matthew 26:14-16; Matthew 27:3-10.
- **Messiah would be rejected, wounded, silent before His accusers, killed, and buried with the rich.**

  Prophecy: Isaiah 53:3-9.

  Fulfillment: Matthew 26:63; Matthew 27:12-14; Matthew 27:57-60; Mark 15:28; 1 Peter 2:24.

- **Messiah's hands and feet would be pierced, and His garments divided.**

  Prophecy: Psalm 22:16-18.

  Fulfillment: John 19:23-24; John 20:25-27.
- **Messiah would rise from the dead without seeing corruption.**

  Prophecy: Psalm 16:10.

  Fulfillment: Acts 2:25-32; Acts 13:34-37.
- **Gentile world kingdoms would rise in order.**

  Prophecy: Daniel 2:31-45; Daniel 7:1-7.

  Fulfillment: Babylon, Medo-Persia, Greece, and Rome literally rose in history. See Daniel 5:30-31; Daniel 8:20-21; Luke 2:1.
- **Israel would return to her land after worldwide scattering.**

  Prophecy: Deuteronomy 30:3-5; Ezekiel 36:22-24; Ezekiel 37:21-22; Isaiah 11:11-12; Jeremiah 30:3.

  Modern evidence: Israel exists again as a nation in her land. This does not mean every restoration prophecy is complete yet, but it does show a literal national return exactly as the Bible said. They are still be become "born again" as a nation in the future.
- **Israel would return as a nation, but not before going through the judgment of God.**

  Prophecy: Ezekiel 36:24-28; Ezekiel 37:1-14; Zechariah 12:10; Zechariah 13:1.

#3 THE DIVISION (time) FACTOR

1. In order to rightly divide God's word, you must have ***GOD'S PERSPECTIVE*** ON HIS WORD:

   a. **The purpose of the Bible**:

   2 Timothy 3:16-17 - All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness: That the man of God may be perfect, throughly furnished unto all good works.

   Doctrine = Teaching. Truth!
   Perfect = Complete. Fully **informed**.

   b. **The theme of the Bible: A King and His Kingdom**. This is chronicled in the Bible in 3 primary ways:

      1. The POWERS: God (Father, Son, Holy Spirit) and Satan – Matt. 28:19, 3:16-17; John 14:16-17; 2 Cor. 13:14; Gen. 3; Job 1; Isaiah 14:12-15; Ezekiel 28:11-19.
      2. The PLACES: Heaven, Earth, Hell – Gen. 1:1-25; Job 22:12; Ps. 14:2, 146:5-6; Matt. 10:28, 25:41; 2 Peter 2:4. (*Hell removed from most Bibles*)
      3. The PEOPLE: Jew, Gentile, Church – Rom. 2:9-10; 1 Cor. 10:32; Gal. 3:28.

   c. **The instruction of the Bible - God deals with mankind in different ways at different times**. It is critical to recognize how God divides His word. You must see how God has dealt differently with man over time. Some places in the Bible deal specifically with the Nation of Israel, other places, the Church. How can you know and recognize who and when? By **STUDYING**:

   2 Timothy 2:15 - Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth.

   This is our key verse for this factor. It tells us 5 important things:

      1. What do we do with the Bible? **STUDY!** *(missing from most versions)*
      2. Why? To show ourselves APPROVED unto **God – NOT MAN!**
      3. HOW? **RIGHTLY** DIVIDING **– which indicates that you can WRONGLY DIVIDE IT!**

         Divide means to cut or to separate. An example of rightly dividing: What does this phrase say?

         GODISNOWHERE - GOD|IS|NOW|HERE - GOD|IS|NOWHERE

         Notice an improper division completely changes the meaning!

      4. The posture we must maintain – that of a workman **– it will take some work.**
      5. The result – We are NOT ASHAMED. There are people who will be ashamed as they stand before God for what they did to God and His word – 2 Cor. 5:8-10!

2. **HOW** does God divide His word?

   a. Times and seasons – Daniel 2:21; Ecc. 3:1-8; Acts 1:7; 1 Thess. 5:1; Heb. 1:1-2.

   b. Dispensations – Eph 1:10, 3:2-3; Col 1:25-26; 1 Cor 9:17.

   Dispensation = Distribution: The manner in which God deals out (dispenses) His grace/truth/law in specific ways to specific people. An economy or way of doing things; a certain administration. That which is dispensed or bestowed.

      ✓ **NOTE**: It does NOT simply mean "a period of time." We may use times and dates to help us separate dispensations, but the time period does NOT define the dispensation, it's the other way around!

- ✓ The greatest and most obvious dispensation in the Bible: The Old and New **Testaments** - Hebrews 9:15-17. Consider what this means in each of the 4 gospels – Matt. 27:50-51!!
- ✓ Times and dispensations can be divided within a book, chapter, verse, or **PART** of a verse!!

  Isaiah 61:1-2 - Luke 4:17-21.
  Isaiah 9:6-7.
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3. Locating the dispensations:

   One of the easiest and most effective ways to find dispensations in the Bible is by looking at the **covenants** God makes with man. These lay out what God is going to do and how He is going to deal with man.

   NOTE: Both covenants and dispensations often have more than one part to them and can overlap with others, skip time periods, or show up in the middle of others. Hence the reason a dispensation is not just a period of time.

Dispensation	Covenant	Description	Scripture
Eternity Past	None	Original creation. Lucifer & angels.	Gen. 1:1-2
Innocence	Edenic	Reconstruction of earth. Creation of man.	Gen. 1:3 – 3:24
Conscience	Adamic	Adam's lineage and sons of God.	Gen. 3:16 – 8:14
Human government	Noahic	Noah's flood and lineage.	Gen. 6 – 11
Promise	Abrahamic	Abraham's seed and birth of nation of Israel.	Genesis 12 – Exodus 19
Law-Kingdom	Mosaic	Moses leading the exodus, the giving of the law, the kingdom's rise & fall.	Exodus – Malachi
	Davidic	The line and Kingdom of David.	1 Samuel – 2 Chronicles
Christ's 1st coming	Davidic	2 Kingdoms. The start of the Church after Christ's death.	Matthew – Acts 7
The Church & God's grace	None	Transition of Church from Jew to Gentile oversight.	Acts - Revelation
Tribulation-judgment	None	A time of great trouble for the Jew.	Matthew 24-25, 1&2 Thessalonians, Hebrews, Revelation 4-19, Daniel 9. (Rapture of Church to 2nd coming).
Millennium	Palestinian	The 1,000-year reign of Christ on the earth.	Rev. 20; Matt. 5-7; Eze. 40:48; Zech. 14
Eternity	New	The new Heaven & Earth.	Rev. 21-22

4. **Key rules** for dispensations and rightly dividing:
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   b. Do not take truth from the past and read it into the present – that is what some did in Acts 15:1-11 (7th Day).
   c. Do not take truth from the present and read it into the past – Rom. 8:9 vs Num. 11:29.
   d. Do not take truth from the future and read it into the present – Rev. 14:1-4 (JW's).
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         GODISNOWHERE - GOD|IS|NOW|HERE - GOD|IS|NOWHERE

         Notice an improper division completely changes the meaning!

      4. The posture we must maintain – that of a workman **– it will take some work.**
      5. The result – We are NOT ASHAMED. There are people who will be ashamed as they stand before God for what they did to God and His word – 2 Cor. 5:8-10!

2. **HOW** does God divide His word?

   a. Times and seasons – Daniel 2:21; Ecc. 3:1-8; Acts 1:7; 1 Thess. 5:1; Heb. 1:1-2.

   b. Dispensations – Eph 1:10, 3:2-3; Col 1:25-26; 1 Cor 9:17.

   Dispensation = Distribution: The manner in which God deals out (dispenses) His grace/truth/law in specific ways to specific people. An economy or way of doing things; a certain administration. That which is dispensed or bestowed.

      ✓ **NOTE**: It does NOT simply mean "a period of time." We may use times and dates to help us separate dispensations, but the time period does NOT define the dispensation, it's the other way around!

- ✓ The greatest and most obvious dispensation in the Bible: The Old and New _____ - Hebrews 9:15-17. Consider what this means in each of the 4 gospels – Matt. 27:50-51!!
- ✓ Times and dispensations can be divided within a book, chapter, verse, or _____ of a verse!!

  Isaiah 61:1-2 - Luke 4:17-21.
  Isaiah 9:6-7.
  Luke 1:30-33.

3. Locating the dispensations:

   One of the easiest and most effective ways to find dispensations in the Bible is by looking at the _____ God makes with man. These lay out what God is going to do and how He is going to deal with man.

   NOTE: Both covenants and dispensations often have more than one part to them and can overlap with others, skip time periods, or show up in the middle of others. Hence the reason a dispensation is not just a period of time.

Dispensation	**Covenant**	**Description**	**Scripture**
Eternity Past	None	Original creation. Lucifer & angels.	Gen. 1:1-2
Innocence	Edenic	Reconstruction of earth. Creation of man.	Gen. 1:3 – 3:24
Conscience	Adamic	Adam's lineage and sons of God.	Gen. 3:16 – 8:14
Human government	Noahic	Noah's flood and lineage.	Gen. 6 – 11
Promise	Abrahamic	Abraham's seed and birth of nation of Israel.	Genesis 12 – Exodus 19
Law-Kingdom	Mosaic	Moses leading the exodus, the giving of the law, the kingdom's rise & fall.	Exodus – Malachi
	Davidic	The line and Kingdom of David.	1 Samuel – 2 Chronicles
Christ's 1st coming	Davidic	2 Kingdoms. The start of the Church after Christ's death.	Matthew – Acts 7
The Church & God's grace	None	Transition of Church from Jew to Gentile oversight.	Acts - Revelation
Tribulation-judgment	None	A time of great trouble for the Jew.	Matthew 24-25, 1&2 Thessalonians, Hebrews, Revelation 4-19, Daniel 9. (Rapture of Church to 2nd coming).
Millennium	Palestinian	The 1,000-year reign of Christ on the earth.	Rev. 20; Matt. 5-7; Eze. 40:48; Zech. 14
Eternity	New	The new Heaven & Earth.	Rev. 21-22

4. **Key rules** for dispensations and rightly dividing:
   a. Do not take truth from one part of the past and read it into another part of the past – Gen. 1:29 vs 9:3.
   b. Do not take truth from the past and read it into the present – that is what some did in Acts 15:1-11 (7th Day).
   c. Do not take truth from the present and read it into the past – Rom. 8:9 vs Num. 11:29.
   d. Do not take truth from the future and read it into the present – Rev. 14:1-4 (JW's).
   e. Do not take truth from the future and read it into another part of the _____ – 1 Thess. 4:13-18 vs 2 Thess. 1:7-9.

Matthew Henry Commentary on Job 41

"Whether this leviathan be a whale or a crocodile is a great dispute among the learned, which I will not undertake to determine; some of the particulars agree more easily to the one, others to the other; both are very strong and fierce, and the power of the Creator appears in them. The ingenious Sir Richard Blackmore, though he admits the more received opinion concerning the behemoth, that it must be meant of the elephant, yet agrees with the learned Bochart's notion of the leviathan, that it is the crocodile, which was so well known in the river of Egypt. I confess that that which inclines me rather to understand it of the whale is not only because it is much larger and a nobler animal, but because, in the history of the Creation, there is such an express notice taken of it as is not of any other species of animals whatsoever **(Gen. 1:21**, God created great whales), by which it appears, not only that whales were well known in those parts in the time of Moses, who lived a little after Job, but that the creation of whales was generally looked upon as a most illustrious proof of the eternal power and godhead of the Creator; and we may conjecture that this was the reason (for otherwise it seems unaccountable) why Moses there so particularly mentions the creation of the whales, because God had so lately insisted upon the bulk and strength of that creature than of any other, as the proof of his power; and the leviathan is here spoken of as an inhabitant of the sea (**v. 31**), which the crocodile is not; and **Ps. 104:25, 26**, there in the great and wide sea, is that leviathan."

Jamieson, Fausset & Brown Commentary on Job 41

"Leviathan--literally, "the twisted animal," A poetical generalization for all cetacean, serpentine, and saurian monsters (see on JF & B for **Job 40:15**, hence all the description applies to no one animal); especially the crocodile; which is naturally described after the river horse, as both are found in the Nile."

The Biblical Definition

In Job 41 we have a prideful creature whose "scales are his pride" and who is "a king over all the children of pride" (**Job 41:15, 34; cf. Isaiah 14:13-14; Ezekiel 28:17; 1 Timothy 3:6**), a king and ruler who "beholdeth all high things" (**Job 41:34; cf. John 12:31; 14:30; 16:11; 2 Corinthians 4:4; Ephesians 2:2, 6:12**), an overwhelmingly powerful being whom no man can tame, bind, defeat, or even safely provoke (**Job 41:1-10, 25-30**), of whom God says, "upon earth there is not his like, who is made without fear" (**Job 41:33; cf. 1 Peter 5:8; Jude 9**), a cruel being before whom "sorrow is turned into joy" (**Job 41:22; cf. John 8:44; 10:10; Revelation 12:12**), a hard-hearted creature whose heart is "as firm as a stone" (**Job 41:24**), and a terrifying, fire-breathing dragon whose sneezings flash light, whose eyes shine, and out of whose mouth "go burning lamps, and sparks of fire leap out" (**Job 41:18-21**). This creature is specifically called Leviathan (**Job 41:1)**; Psalm 74 connects Leviathan with "the dragons in the waters" and says that he has multiple "heads" **(Psalm 74:13-14**); Isaiah identifies Leviathan as "the piercing serpent," "that crooked serpent," and "the dragon that is in the sea" (**Isaiah 27:1**); and Revelation identifies the great red dragon with seven heads as "that old serpent, called the Devil, and Satan" (**Revelation 12:3, 9; 20:2**). Thus, the biblical descriptions fit together: the prideful king of Job 41 is Leviathan; Leviathan is the many-headed dragon and crooked serpent of Psalms and Isaiah; and the dragon and old serpent are plainly identified in Revelation as the Devil and Satan.

#4 THE APPLICATION FACTOR

All Scripture has **THREE** basic applications.

1) **HISTORICAL**

All Scripture has a single, obvious meaning rooted in the context of History, grammar and literary usage – thus the historical application.

a. **KEY:** The Bible is unlike any other book of religious writings in that it is primarily a book of **HISTORY** and its history is ***true***. Our God has chosen to work within the framework of time and space. It is important to note that the Bible has **NEVER** been proven to be ***historically*** incorrect. Mark it down – rest assured!

b. Every **PERSON**, **PLACE**, and **EVENT** is real. Everything we read actually took place *(or will take place)* and existed ***historically***, unless God tells us otherwise *(IE. parables or symbolism – example – "Hear the parable of the…")*

c. This historical application concerns: *Bible Characters (*people*)*
*Geography (*places*)*
*Chronology (*time*)*
*Experiences (*events*)*

KEY: You must **FIRST** understand the history of any given passage before you will properly comprehend other basic applications. If you misunderstand the history, you will violate the obvious and literal meaning of scripture.

2) **DOCTRINAL**

a. The word doctrine simply means "*teaching."* In every thing that God says, He is always interested in teaching us something.

b. The biblical usages of the word doctrine (it has a two-fold meaning or usage):

- God uses historical events to teach a general practical truth. This is also called the **PLAIN** teaching

- God uses historical events to teach a deeper truth. This is also called the **PROPHETIC** teaching.

KEY: God establishes His eternal truths through sound doctrine that always stands sure throughout the entire Bible.

3) **DEVOTIONAL**

a. This "*old"* book applies to my life today. Every book, chapter, and verse **APPLIES** to me right now, somehow. The question we must always ask is this,

"*How must I apply what the Bible says to my personal life?"*

b. All scripture has a ***devotional*** application - *2 Timothy 3:16-17* – memorize it!

Note: *This factor is also referred to as* personal *or* **INSPIRATIONAL** *application.*

God's purpose in Scripture – watch how this is defined in Scripture…1 Corinthians 10:1-12; Romans 15:4; Luke 24:27; *John 5:39; 46-47*

The Bible is a **PICTURE** Book.

…to see the pictures best you must put on your "**3**-*D Glasses."*

Some examples:

a. The Brasen Serpent *(Numbers 21:4-9)*

i. ***History*** – this is a true story – it really happened
ii. ***Doctrine*** – The **plain** meaning in the time was that any and all bitten by the serpents needed to look at the brazen serpent for healing. **Prophetically**, it pointed to the cross of Christ – 2 Cor. 5:21; Jn. 3:14-15
iii. ***Devotion*** – there is always a price to pay when you don't believe God…

b. Isaiah's Sign of Immanuel (Isaiah 7:14-16)

i. ***History*** – a child born in Isaiah's day served as a sign to Ahaz that Syria and Israel would soon be defeated
ii. ***Doctrine*** – In the day, the **plain** teaching was that a child would be born as a sign of their victory in battle. The **PARTIAL FULFILLMENT** pointed forward **prophetically** to the complete fulfillment in the virgin birth of Jesus Christ, "God with us" – Matthew 1:18-23
iii. ***Devotion*** – God keeps his promises, remains with his people, and can be trusted even when circumstances appear hopeless!

c. Leviathan (Job 41)

i. ***History*** – God describes an actual historical animal in **hyperbole** (poetic section of books, uses much figure of speech), in order to show Job the true source of his troubles since ch. 1.
ii. ***Doctrine*** – Job is facing a foe that is so awful, so strong, so wicked, that he would have understood as an actual animal in his day. God used the animal to give Job the picture. But he also gave **prophetic/deeper** language that Job would have known (as we do today) cannot apply to ANY regular animal. It was **prophetically** showing Job a description of the devil.
iii. ***Devotion*** – how to deal with trials, suffering and attacks from the devil!

d. This is **not** an exhaustive list. Remember "all" of the OT pictured Jesus and NT truths for us.
i. The Strange Woman of Proverbs (Proverbs 5:3-7; 6:20-24; 7:1-5; Revelation 17:1-6); Abraham Offering Isaac (Genesis 22:1-14; Hebrews 11:17-19); The Passover Lamb (Exodus 12:1-13; John 1:29; 1 Corinthians 5:7); Noah and the Flood (Genesis 6-8; Matthew 24:37-39); Jonah and the Great Fish (Jonah 1:17-2:10; Matthew 12:39-41); The Manna from Heaven (Exodus 16:4-18; John 6:32-35); Water from the Rock (Exodus 17:1-6; 1 Corinthians 10:4); Adam as a Picture of Christ (Genesis 3; Romans 5:12-19; 1 Corinthians 15:45-49)

**** WARNING ****
This Bible study factor is not to be confused with the **ABSTRACT** method of Bible study developed by the epitome of all false teachers, *Adamantius Origen*. He developed what is known as the "*Allegorical method of Bible Study"...*

It is a method of reasoning that draws everything down to a metaphorical, figurative, or symbolic perspective. The danger, when applied as a method of Bible study, is that any passage is subject to the feelings or personal perspectives of the reader. This leaves the passage open for assorted types of interpretation that likely have nothing to do with what God is actually imparting. Who cares what someone thinks it means…what does it **SAY**! Be careful of Bible studies that go…read a verse then say," What do you think it means?"

KEY: The Bible says what it means, and means what it says. Anytime we apply the three basic applications to scripture, we must allow the biblical **TEXTS** to dictate the clear meaning.

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3) _____

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KEY: The Bible says what it means, and means what it says. Anytime we apply the three basic applications to scripture, we must allow the biblical texts to dictate the clear meaning.

Addendum 3

Deuteronomy 4:2

Ye shall **not add unto the word** which I command you, neither shall ye diminish ought from it, that ye may keep the commandments of the LORD your God which I command you.

Deuteronomy 6:6

And **these words**, which I command thee this day, shall be in thine heart:

Deuteronomy 8:3

And he humbled thee, and suffered thee to hunger, and fed thee with manna, which thou knewest not, neither did thy fathers know; that he might make thee know that man doth not live by bread only, but **by every word** that proceedeth out of the mouth of the LORD doth man live.

Psalm 12:6-7

The **words** of the LORD are **pure words**: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times. Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever.

Psalm 119:89

For ever, O LORD, **thy word** is settled in heaven.

Psalm 119:160

Thy word is true from the beginning: and **every one of thy righteous judgments** endureth for ever.

Proverbs 30:5-6

Every word of God is pure: he is a shield unto them that put their trust in him. **Add thou not unto his words**, lest he reprove thee, and thou be found a liar.

Jeremiah 26:2

Thus saith the LORD; Stand in the court of the LORD'S house, and speak unto all the cities of Judah, which come to worship in the LORD'S house, **all the words** that I command thee to speak unto them; **diminish not a word**:

Matthew 4:4

But he answered and said, It is written, Man shall not live by bread alone, but **by every word** that proceedeth out of the mouth of God.

Matthew 5:18

For verily I say unto you, Till heaven and earth pass, **one jot** or **one tittle** shall in no wise pass from the law, till all be fulfilled.

Matthew 24:35

Heaven and earth shall pass away, but **my words** shall not pass away.

Luke 16:17

And it is easier for heaven and earth to pass, than **one tittle** of the law to fail.

Revelation 22:18-19

For I testify unto every man that heareth **the words** of the prophecy of this book, If any man shall add unto these things, God shall add unto him the plagues that are written in this book: And if any man shall take away from **the words** of the book of this prophecy, God shall take away his part out of the book of life, and out of the holy city, and from the things which are written in this book.

#5 THE INDIVIDUAL WORD FACTOR

1. God has chosen every _____ and every individual _____ in the Bible for a specific purpose.

   a. John 20:30-31; 21:24-25

   KEY: If there was a multitude of other things Jesus said and did events), we must ***have the most important*** things preserved for us in the Bible!!

   b. Every word of God is ***key*** as opposed to man's interpretation of God's intended thoughts, message, concepts and ideals. (Deut. 4:2; Deut. 6:6; Deut. 8:3; Ps. 12:6-7; Ps. 119:89, 160; Prov. 30:5-6; Jer. 26:2; Matt. 4:4; Matt. 5:18; Matt. 24:35; Luke 16:17; Rev. 22:18-19)

   KEY: The key to the word of God, is the _____ _____ _____
   KEY: This is why God does not want us to _____, subtract, or _____ His perfect word!!

2. It is the _____ that are most important! The Bible does not just contain the words of God; the Bible is the pure word of God that will last forever (all of it…cover to cover)! – Psalm 12:6-7

   NOTE: This is in direct opposition to a belief system called Neo-Orthodoxy within theological circles which says that the ***thoughts*** are what really count! These so-called scholars proclaim that it does not matter what God actually said as long as we get the main point…be careful when you hear that!

   These men by their own admission, do NOT use the Bible as their authority for translating, studying, or handling the Bible. They rely upon textual sciences, human philosophies, and NOT THE BIBLE

   * Remember – God did not write a Bible for just anyone to understand – but only for those who are indwelt by His Spirit. Not all Bible "scholars" even claim to be believers!

   a. Matthew 5:18

   Psalm 119 is what is known as an ***acrostic*** psalm. There are 22 Hebrew letters in the Hebrew alphabet. Each stanza in Psalm 119 begins with a letter from the Hebrew alphabet.

   "Jot" – Psalm 119:73

   "Tittle" – Psalm 119:25 & 153

   b. In modern Bible versions, precise words are ***admittedly*** abandoned for the flow of thoughts and concepts for readability's sake. Words are replaced/changed without thought of preservation. This is known in textual criticism as "***dynamic equivalence***"

      i. ***Leland Ryken (PhD) professor of English at Wheaton College***: "Dynamic equivalence is popularly known as a thought-for-thought translation instead of a word-for-word translation."[1]

3. **KEY:** God preserved every word in English in the King James Bible – exactly the way He intended …

   Some Examples:

   - ✓ Hebrews 4:8; Acts 7:45 "Jesus" vs. "Joshua"
     - This is a "***transliteration***" that when translated exactly, word for word, teaches us a deep (doctrinal) truth of the Old Testament!

[1] Leland Ryken, *Choosing a Bible: Understanding Bible Translation Differences* (Wheaton, IL: Crossway Books, 2005), 7.

NOTICE: Just **_____** word makes a **BIG** difference!!!

- ✓ John 1:1 "**_____**" (many bible translations add this word; JW's infamously)
- ✓ John 7:8 "**yet**" (many bible translations remove this word)
- ✓ Acts 12:4 "**_____**" (many bible translations change this word to "Passover")
- ✓ 2 Timothy 2:15 "**dividing**" (changed to "handling" or "teaching" in many versions)
- ✓ 1 Cor. 1:18 "**being**" (many bible translations add this word")
- ✓ Genesis 3:4 (Gen. 2:14) "**_____**" (the original update to God's word: "thou shalt surely die."
- ✓ *This is NOT an exhaustive list of all examples. There are countless examples where every word added, subtracted, or changed makes a difference when studying the Bible. It is inevitable that when words are not the same, meanings change; hence God's warnings.*

4. God uses key words and phrases

- ✓ God uses key words and phrases in the Bible consistently to communicate truth…
- ✓ They establish contexts and provide ***keys*** for comparing scripture with scripture

Some examples:

- That day; The day; the day of the **_____** …begins with Rapture and ends with close of Millennium
- **_____** days; woman in travail; time of Jacob's Trouble…all references to the Tribulation Period
- **_____** and **_____** (similes) are key words God uses to demonstrate deeper understanding of something
  - ✓ Luke 17:26-30
  - ✓ 1 John 3:2 - *Beloved, now are we the sons of God, and it doth not yet appear what we shall be: but we know that, when he shall appear, we shall be* **like** *him; for we shall see him* **as** *he is.*
  - ✓ Eph. 5:25 - *Husbands, love your wives, even* ***as*** *Christ also loved the church, and gave himself for it*
  - ✓ Matthew 10:16
- **_____** */_____* **VS.** **_____** */_____***;** "ye" in the Bible is plural while "thee/thou" are singular (ex. Luke 22:31-32)
- Law of First Mention; the Bible study principle that the first time God uses a word, he defines it and establishes its meaning for the rest of scripture. If words are changed throughout to get the "ideas/thoughts", then this definition is easily lost (ex. "lovest" in Gen. 22:2; "worship" in Gen. 22:5)

FINAL THOUGHTS

- If we will approach the Bible with the attitude that **every word** is important, that **every word** is in place on purpose, and that **every word** is in fact the word of God…

  …it will change **what we see** and **what we _____**!!

- 1 Thessalonians 2:13 – *For this cause also thank we God without ceasing, because,* ***when ye received the word of God*** *which ye heard of us, ye received it not as the word of men, but as it is in truth,* ***the word of God****, which* ***effectually worketh*** *also in you that believe.*

#5 THE INDIVIDUAL WORD FACTOR

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- ✓ 2 Timothy 2:15 "**dividing**" (changed to "handling" or "teaching" in many versions)
- ✓ 1 Cor. 1:18 "**being**" (many bible translations add this word")
- ✓ Genesis 3:4 "**not**" (the original update to God's word: "thou shalt surely die." (Gen. 2:14)
- ✓ *This is NOT an exhaustive list of all examples. There are countless examples where every word added, subtracted, or changed makes a difference when studying the Bible. It is inevitable that when words are not the same, meanings change; hence God's warnings.*

4. God uses key words and phrases

- ✓ God uses key words and phrases in the Bible consistently to communicate truth…
- ✓ They establish contexts and provide ***keys*** for comparing scripture with scripture

Some examples:

- That day; The day; the day of the **LORD** …begins with Rapture and ends with close of Millennium
- **THOSE** days; woman in travail; time of Jacob's Trouble…all references to the Tribulation Period
- **LIKE** and **AS** (similes) are key words God uses to demonstrate deeper understanding of something
  - ✓ Luke 17:26-30
  - ✓ 1 John 3:2 - *Beloved, now are we the sons of God, and it doth not yet appear what we shall be: but we know that, when he shall appear, we shall be **like** him; for we shall see him **as** he is.*
  - ✓ Eph. 5:25 - *Husbands, love your wives, even **as** Christ also loved the church, and gave himself for it*
  - ✓ Matthew 10:16
- **YE/YOU VS. THEE/THOU;** "ye" in the Bible is plural while "thee/thou" are singular (ex. Luke 22:31-32)
- Law of First Mention; the Bible study principle that the first time God uses a word, he defines it and establishes its meaning for the rest of scripture. If words are changed throughout to get the "ideas/thoughts", then this definition is easily lost (ex. "lovest" in Gen. 22:2; "worship" in Gen. 22:5)

FINAL THOUGHTS

- If we will approach the Bible with the attitude that **every word** is important, that **every word** is in place on purpose, and that **every word** is in fact the word of God…

  …it will change **what we see** and **what we UNDERSTAND**!!

- 1 Thessalonians 2:13 – *For this cause also thank we God without ceasing, because, **when ye received the word of God** which ye heard of us, ye received it not as the word of men, but as it is in truth, **the word of God**, which **effectually worketh** also in you that believe.*

#6 THE COMPARISON FACTOR

1. The Bible is of no _____ interpretation. All interpretations must be done by comparing _____ with _____.

   a. No private interpretations – 2 Peter 1:20

      NOTE: Verse 20 clearly teaches us that the Bible is of ***no private interpretation***!

      - Whether we like it or not…
      - No matter what anybody else says…

      KEY: In a literal sense, this destroys the argument of all those who **hide behind** the saying…

      …"Well, that's just **your** interpretation."

      At issue is not your interpretation or mine, but rather **the interpretation of the Author** of the Bible – the _____ _____.

      Example – Who would be the best person to interpret a letter from me to you? _____

   b. Proper interpretation comes by comparing **spiritual** things with **spiritual** things– 1 Corinthians 2:1-14

      - Vs 1-8 Paul explains the contrast between man's wisdom and God's wisdom as revealed in His word
      - Vs 9-12 Even the "*deep things of God"* are revealed to those who possess His Spirit.
      - Vs 13 Comparing spiritual things with spiritual things is how the Holy Spirit teaches us.
      - Vs 14 The Word of God cannot be understood by mere human reasoning alone.

      NOTE: This is why the Bible is not meant to be read in the common "lingo" of any given day/age. It is meant to record God's exact words, that we are meant to study. The truth of the Bible is spiritually discerned as we _____ scripture with scripture (Romans 7:14; John 6:63). And this is only done effectively through the use of the exact words that God says.

      KEY: There comes a time in **serious study of the Bible**, to rightly divide the Scripture and pay due diligence to **every word**. That is the time to make certain you have a Bible that is not going to be dropping "jots" or "tittles" and removing the road signs and **landmarks!**

   c. God emphasizes the importance of two or three witnesses.

      NOTE: Having more than one witness/testimony to determine an unknown difficulty was established long ago by God! (2 Corinthians 13:1; Deuteronomy 19:15; Numbers 35:30)

   d. How cross referencing works – Isaiah 28:9-10, 13

      KEY: The best commentary on the Bible is the _____ itself, not our personal opinions.

      - To become proficient at understanding the Bible, we _____ exercise ourselves in the use of cross-referencing (e.g. – *study to shew thyself approved unto God*); tracking words and phrases throughout the Bible through the use of a **concordance** (hardback, online, on phone, etc.), through tools such as ***Treasury of Scripture Knowledge*** (hardback, online, on phone, etc.)***,*** and by **taking notes**.

- With today's technology, we have more capabilities at our fingertips than any other people throughout the course of human history!

- Remember, studying in this manner (comparing scripture with scripture) is how we're told to understand exactly what God is communicating to us…

- This is how we avoid our own personal opinions and private interpretations…

- Don't miss this critical _____ of Bible study…The Bible is of no private interpretation. All interpretations must be done by comparing scripture with scripture.

- Jesus, Paul, and the NT writers modeled use of this rule of Bible study when they would say _____ _____ _____

2. An illustration of this Bible study factor:

a. **Revelation 4:1-4**

What is this event? What is going on? **When we get context of the book, study every word, and compare scripture with scripture: we don't have to guess!**

What does the Bible say? …let's compare scripture with scripture…

- **1 Corinthians 15:51–54**
  The Lord calls, a trumpet sounds, and in a single moment, someone is raised in a spiritual body
- **1 Thessalonians 4:13–18**
  A voice yells, a trumpet sounds, and immediately we are "caught up" to be in the presense of the Lord forever!
  - These all describe _____ _____ The book of Revelation is the only definitive place in the New Testament that gives us the timeline of the rapture.

b. **Genesis 3:1-15**

NOTE: The devil tries to hide his identity all over the Bible, but we can identify him!

- **Revelation 12:9**
  He is called a dragon, that old serpent, the Devil, Satan.

- **Revelation 20:2**
  He is called a dragon, that old serpent, the Devil, Satan…AGAIN!

b. _____

- **Hipocrisy** (Luke 12:1)
- **Bad/False Doctrine** (Matt. 16:6, 11-12)
- **Negative** (Exod. 12:15–20; 13:3–7; 23:18; 34:25; Lev. 2:11; 6:17; 10:12; Deut. 16:3–4; Amos 4:5; Matt. 16:6, 11–12; Mark 8:15; Luke 12:1; 1 Cor. 5:6–8; Gal. 5:7–9)

We must remember…

- The Bible is of _____ private interpretation.

- _____ interpretations must be done by comparing scripture with scripture.

#6 THE COMPARISON FACTOR

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      …"Well, that's just **your** interpretation."

      At issue is not your interpretation or mine, but rather **the interpretation of the Author** of the Bible – the **HOLY SPIRIT**.

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      NOTE: This is why the Bible is not meant to be read in the common "lingo" of any given day/age. It is meant to record God's exact words, that we are meant to study. The truth of the Bible is spiritually discerned as we **COMPARE** scripture with scripture (Romans 7:14; John 6:63). And this is only done effectively through the use of the exact words that God says.

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      KEY: The best commentary on the Bible is the **BIBLE** itself, not our personal opinions.

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We must remember…

- The Bible is of **NO** private interpretation.

- **ALL** interpretations must be done by comparing scripture with scripture.

#7 THE CREATION FACTOR

1. The eternal truths of God that are revealed in the Bible can be enhanced by studying the _____ which He has made. God is a master artist!

   - Psalm 19:1-4a The Bible clearly says the heavens declare His righteousness.

     NOTE: God says His creation **declares**, **sheweth**, **uttereth** His righteousness…creation has a **voice**, **speech**, and a **line** of communication so unique that **all** people of **all** languages in _____ time periods of earth's history can hear it – see also Psalm 97:6, Job 12:7-9.

   - Romans 1:18-20 The invisible things of God are understood by _____ the creation He has made.

     NOTE: Creation is referred to as God's _____ REVELATION of Himself because anybody anywhere **can** see Him in it (Rom. 1:20). According to God, nobody can **honestly** give excuse that they did not know the truth about God (2 Pet. 3:3-5…because of the testimony of creation, God calls them willingly ignorant). **The Bible** is God's _____ REVELATION because it is written to those who **want** to know more about the God that they see in Creation and what His great plan is for man. The Bible and creation work hand-in-hand together proclaiming the truths of God.

     According to Romans 1:20…

     a. No one has an excuse because of:

        1. **GENERAL** revelation — It is general because creation is observable by everyone

        2. **SPECIAL** revelation — The Bible – God is always faithful to send a missionary

        NOTE: The "pigmy" or the lost multitudes in India, etc. are all included in this category…

     b. We also find that creation reveals an attribute of God called omnipotence (*omni* = all, *potent* = powerful):

        1. Examples of God's power seen in creation – _____
        2. Examples of God's eternal power seen in creation – _____

     c. God had a pattern when He created everything...the pattern was _____.

        The Godhead = the trinity = 3 (Father, Son, Holy Spirit)

        NOTE: He is the pattern! (see below)

2. **Examples of the Godhead that CAN be seen in creation:**
   - ✓ An atom (smallest matter known) is made up of protons, neutrons, and electrons.
   - ✓ A human being is made of 3 parts according to the Bible: _____, soul, and spirit – see Gen. 1:26-27.
   - ✓ Time is either past, present, or future. It also breaks down to years, months, and days. Each day has hours, minutes, and seconds. Every day has a morning, afternoon, and night.
   - ✓ Color breaks down to 3 primary colors: red, blue, and yellow.
   - ✓ The common states of matter are solid, liquid, or gas form.
   - ✓ Space equals height, width, and depth.
   - ✓ Reality has space, matter, and _____ associated with it.
   - ✓ Electrical charge is either positive, negative, or neutral.
   - ✓ Water (a basic compound) has 3 parts = H20 (2 hydrogen atoms, 1 oxygen).

- ✓ To make fire you need heat, fuel, and oxygen.
- ✓ There are 3 heavens according to the Bible: earth's atmosphere, outer space, and the 3rd heaven.
- ✓ Skin has a dermis, epidermis, and hypodermis.
- ✓ Teeth are made of the crown, neck/cervix, and root.
- ✓ A family consists of mother, father, and child(ren).
- ✓ There are 3 types of levers.
- ✓ There are 3 laws of _____.
- ✓ There are 3 dimensions to space/objects.
- ✓ A triangle is the strongest shape in creation.
- ✓ There are 3 God-ordained institutions: family, government, and the church.

3. **Examples of Bible principles/teachings that CAN be enhanced by observing/studying creation:**
   - ✓ **Wind** - John 3:8, Acts 2:2-4 = _____
   - ✓ **Trees** - Psalm 1:1-3, Mark 8:24 = _____
   - ✓ **Grass** - Isaiah 40:7,1 Peter 1:24 = _____
   - ✓ **Fog/Fog Breath**- James 4:14
   - ✓ **Clouds** - Matthew 26:64, Acts 1:11, 1 Thessalonians 4:17, Revelation 1:7
   - ✓ **Night** - Romans 13:1-11, 1 Thessalonians 5:2-5
   - ✓ **Rain** - Isaiah 55:10, Jeremiah 5:24
   - ✓ **Snow** - Isaiah 1:18, Mark 9:3, Revelation 1:14
   - ✓ **The Sun** - Malachi 4:2, Psalm 84:11, John 8:12
   - ✓ **Moon** - Job 25:5, Isaiah 60:1-3, Psalm 136:9
   - ✓ **Stars** - Revelation 1:20, 12:3-4
   - ✓ **Ants** - Proverbs 6:6-9, 30:25
   - ✓ **Fish** – Matthew 4:19, 17:24-27
   - ✓ **Deer** (Hart) - Psalm 42:1, Song 2:9, 17
   - ✓ **Rabbits** (Conies) - Psalm 104:18, Proverbs 30:26
   - ✓ **Rocks** - Psalm 18:2,46; 28:1; 31:3; 42:9; 62:2,6; 71:3; 92:15
   - ✓ **Gardens** - Matthew 13:18-23, Mark 4:14-20

KEY: After looking at some of the examples above, we are reminded of two very important words that will link the Bible to these examples in creation:

"_____" and "_____"

Why is this a Factor in Bible Study?: Rule #7 shows us that God uses the things that He made in creation to give us further evidence of the Bible. It is also important to use creation in witnessing because it is part of God's "general revelation" **seen by everybody, everyday**…there's no excuse…creation speaks to the lost and saved!!

#8 THE APPARENT CONTRADICTION FACTOR

1. There are _____ contradictions in the Bible, only "apparent contradictions." Always give God and the Bible the benefit of the doubt. To say that there is an error or discrepancy in your Bible and then move on like it is no big deal is heresy in light of Ps. 12:6-7, Pr. 30:5, etc.

   FIRST Understand that this important conclusion is first reached by _____ …believing that God's word is divinely inspired and without error. To those who believe, God will confirm His truth by demonstrating that there are _____ genuine contradictions that cannot be resolved.

   NEXT Although our conclusion for this factor is reached by faith, let us be reminded that genuine faith always has substance and evidence - Hebrews 11:1.

   THEN Consider that God's use of over _____ different authors to pen the Bible over 2,000 years in different cultures, time periods, etc. is going to bring some differences in style and the way events are recorded.

   FINALLY Whenever you find an "apparent" contradiction, immediately apply the rules of Bible study that you know to draw the _____ conclusion.

2. There are _____ for "apparent" contradictions in the Bible.

   - To give skeptics a lie to believe.

     Ezekiel 14:1-4, 9
     Isaiah 29:9-14
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     NOTE If you come to God with your own pre-conceived ideas, not at all sincerely interested in what God says (wanting to appear religious, etc.)…God will give you a lie to believe! This is not because God is a liar! It is because you were not willing to _____ Him, but rather your own lie! Most Christians miss this…in counseling…they believe the world's ways instead of God's ways. Why? It appeals to and satisfies the flesh! (Isaiah 30:1-3)

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3. Regarding the skeptics…

   - You will see/hear this accusation against the Bible often. Nine times out of ten when someone tells you there are contradictions in the Bible, they cannot show you one. So, ask them to show you one to prove it ... this will usually make them quiet on this accusation!

   - However, there is that tenth person…so let's look at a few "apparent contradictions" in the Bible…

4. Examples of some "apparent" contradictions:

a. **Proverbs 26:4-5** – Do you answer a fool according to his folly or not? How would you biblically figure that out?

b. **Exodus 20:13** (also Deut. 5:17)
Exodus 21:12-19 (*aka…thou shalt kill*)

Which is right? Do we have the right to kill or not?

Is this a contradiction in Chapters right next to each other, or is God empowering government?

See also Romans 13:1-4 in the New Testament!

c. **Mark 15:25** – According to this passage, Jesus was crucified in the **3rd** hour of the day.
John 19:14 – According to this passage, Pilate presented Jesus to the Jews who said "crucify him" in the **6th** hour of the day…and He was then crucified (that same day!)…Uh, oh.

You indeed need some deeper **study** to clear up this "apparent" contradiction!

The gospel of Mark is recorded using _____ time.

The Jewish day begins at 6:00 AM which places the crucifixion at 9:00 AM, which is the **3rd** hour of the **Jewish day.**

The gospel of John is recorded using _____ time.

The Roman day begins at 12:00 AM *(like ours does today)*. This places the trial of Christ by Pilate at 6:00 AM, which is the **6th** hour of the **Roman day**.

This time schedule works out perfectly (from different perspectives…Jewish/Gentile) and lines up perfectly as an accurate, detailed record of scripture.

It clearly demonstrates our factor tonight…that there are _____ contradictions in the Bible…

…only ***apparent*** contradictions.

Key Points

- ✓ Have a right heart attitude toward God and the Bible.
- ✓ Always approach the Bible by giving it the _____ of the doubt.
- ✓ Every apparent contradiction has a _____, even though you may not be mature enough or gifted enough just yet to find it.

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  1. Examples of God's power seen in creation – **TORNADOES, HURRICANES, TSUNAMIS**
  2. Examples of God's eternal power seen in creation – **STARS, SAND, GALAXIES**

  c. God had a pattern when He created everything...the pattern was **HIMSELF**.

  The Godhead = the trinity = 3 (Father, Son, Holy Spirit)

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   FINALLY Whenever you find an "apparent" contradiction, immediately apply the rules of Bible study that you know to draw the **RIGHT** conclusion.

2. There are **PURPOSES** for "apparent" contradictions in the Bible.

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     NOTE If you come to God with your own pre-conceived ideas, not at all sincerely interested in what God says (wanting to appear religious, etc.)…God will give you a lie to believe! This is not because God is a liar! It is because you were not willing to **BELIEVE** Him, but rather your own lie! Most Christians miss this…in counseling…they believe the world's ways instead of God's ways. Why? It appeals to and satisfies the flesh! (Isaiah 30:1-3)

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     John 6 – Jesus teaches the disciples words that seem to contradict (John 6:53; Gen. 9:4; Lev. 17:10-11; Duet. 12:23) The **SKEPTICS** walk away, while the believers stay (even though they don't fully understand yet; Jn. 6:67-69). Only once they had done this, were they then later allowed to understand the full truth of the story (Mt. 26:26-28; Mark 14:22-24; Luke 22:19-20; 1 Corinthians 11:23-26)

3. Regarding the skeptics…

   - You will see/hear this accusation against the Bible often. Nine times out of ten when someone tells you there are contradictions in the Bible, they cannot show you one. So, ask them to show you one to prove it ... this will usually make them quiet on this accusation!

   - However, there is that tenth person…so let's look at a few "apparent contradictions" in the Bible…

4. Examples of some "apparent" contradictions:

a. **Proverbs 26:4-5** – Do you answer a fool according to his folly or not? How would you biblically figure that out?

b. **Exodus 20:13** (also Deut. 5:17)
Exodus 21:12-19 (*aka…thou shalt kill*)

Which is right? Do we have the right to kill or not?

Is this a contradiction in Chapters right next to each other, or is God empowering government?

See also Romans 13:1-4 in the New Testament!

c. **Mark 15:25** – According to this passage, Jesus was crucified in the **3rd** hour of the day.
John 19:14 – According to this passage, Pilate presented Jesus to the Jews who said "crucify him" in the **6th** hour of the day…and He was then crucified (that same day!)…Uh, oh.

You indeed need some deeper **study** to clear up this "apparent" contradiction!

The gospel of Mark is recorded using **JEWISH** time.

The Jewish day begins at 6:00 AM which places the crucifixion at 9:00 AM, which is the **3rd** hour of the **Jewish day.**

The gospel of John is recorded using **ROMAN** time.

The Roman day begins at 12:00 AM *(like ours does today)*. This places the trial of Christ by Pilate at 6:00 AM, which is the **6th** hour of the **Roman day**.

This time schedule works out perfectly (from different perspectives…Jewish/Gentile) and lines up perfectly as an accurate, detailed record of scripture.

It clearly demonstrates our factor tonight…that there are **NO** contradictions in the Bible…

…only ***apparent*** contradictions.

Key Points

- ✓ Have a right heart attitude toward God and the Bible.
- ✓ Always approach the Bible by giving it the **BENEFIT** of the doubt.
- ✓ Every apparent contradiction has a **SOLUTION**, even though you may not be mature enough or gifted enough just yet to find it.

#9 THE CONSISTENCY FACTOR

1. When studying the Bible, we must pay attention to the _____ of God.

   - There is a consistency to layout, words, and principles of the _____ …because there is a consistent nature to our God!

     Col. 1:17 The laws and order we find in creation are consistent because of Jesus Christ. (Newton's laws of motion, Laws of Thermodynamics, gravity's pull, how atoms work, etc.)

     Heb.13:8 *Jesus Christ the same yesterday, and to day, and for ever*. (He is the Word!)

     James 1:17 *…from the Father of lights, with whom is no variableness, neither shadow of turning.*

     Malachi 3:6 *For I am the LORD, I change not; therefore ye sons of Jacob are not consumed.*

   NOTE This does not contradict the fact that God does things differently at different times (the Time Period Factor). These are two distinctly different points.

2. God's consistency and the "Law of First Mention"

   - It is very common for the _____mention of something in the Bible to establish a truth or _____ that is ***consistently*** followed throughout the entire Bible. You will observe these truths and patterns illustrated in figures (*pictures*) and truth (*words*) ***throughout the scriptures***.

   - This Bible phenomenon has been nicknamed… "The _____ of First Mention."

   - Genesis is a key book for many *"First Mentions."* Here are a few examples:

     "The serpent and his attack" - Genesis 3:1-5 (first mention)
     - ✓ The serpent is consistently associated with sin and the devil (see also Rev. 12:9, 20:2).
     - ✓ The devil's main attack is always against God's _____(questions/contradicts/changes).
     - ✓ 2 Cor. 11:3 – *"But I fear…as the **serpent** beguiled Eve through his subtilty, **so** your minds should be corrupted from the simplicity that is in Christ."*
     - ✓ John 3:14 – *"…as Moses lifted up **the serpent** in the wilderness, **even so** must the Son of man be lifted up"* (see Numbers 21)

     "*Babel* or *Babylon*" - Genesis 10:10; 11:1-9 (first mention)
     - ✓ The first mention of Babel or Babylon involves false _____and is and will be just like the false religion that Antichrist will use to deceive during the tribulation period (Rev. 17:5).

     "*love*" - Genesis 22:2 (first mention)
     - ✓ The first mention of *love* in the Bible is associated with a loving father offering up his only son as a sacrifice. A New Testament word used as synonymously for love is _____**!**

     "*worship*" - Genesis 22:5 (first mention)
     - ✓ The first mention of *worship* involves a man being tested and trusting God to do the super-natural. True worship is associated with deep personal **sacrifice** and **faith** leading to a life changing encounter with God!

     "Egypt"- Genesis 12:10 (first mention)
     - ✓ "Egypt is mentioned some 600 times in the Bible and its first mention is significant. It is mentioned first in Genesis 12:10 when we read that Abraham, faced with a famine in the Promised Land, "went down into Egypt to sojourn there." Egypt, when used in the Bible, symbolizes the world: this world's system, human life, and society with God left out. In its

wealth and wisdom, its politics and religion, its culture and magnificence, this world is a snare to the believer."[2]

- When seeking understanding or clarification about an issue in the Bible, always check the 1st time the word or subject is mentioned. This factor is a great key, but it does not unlock every door.

NOTE. God's consistency and the "Law of Progressive Mention": First Mention introduces the subject; Progressive Mention follows the subject as God adds more revelation.

- The Lamb is a perfect example: Genesis 22 introduces God's provided lamb as a picture; Exodus 12 develops this idea of substitution and blood; Isaiah 53 reveals the Lamb as a suffering person; John 1:29 identifies Him as Jesus; Revelation 5 presents the slain Lamb risen and reigning.

3. God's consistency and His use of numbers in the Bible:

- **Three** - Romans 1:20, 1 John 5:7 (see also rule #7 study sheet)
  - ✓ Three is associated with the structure of the _____ and the trinity.
  - ✓ Three also has significance with resurrection and the new life associated with Jesus Christ (____day).
- **Four** – Isaiah 11:12
  - ✓ Four seems to associate with the _____
  - ✓ Mark 13:27 – *"And then shall he send his angels, and shall gather together his elect from the **four winds**, **from the uttermost part of the earth** to the uttermost part of heaven."*
- **Five** - Genesis 5:5 (first mention)
  - ✓ Five IS associated all over the Bible with death – death, grave, beast, grave, Satan, devil, _____
- **Six** - Revelation 13:18
  - ✓ God emphasizes this one! Six is the number of _____. Specifically, fallen man or man's incompleteness.
- **Seven** - Genesis 2:2-3 (first mention)
  - ✓ God finishes with creation and He rests on the _____day. Seven is emphasized throughout the Bible as God's number for _____.
- **Eight** - 2 Peter 2:5
  - ✓ Eight is the number representing new _____. (Seven is the number of completion!)
- **Nine** - Genesis 9:1, 9 (first mention) – Noah commissioned to bear fruit
  - ✓ Nine seems to be a number God uses related to _____.
- **Ten** - Genesis 10:10 (The first _____ kingdom)
  - ✓ Ten is a number that represents **Gentiles**, or non-Jews.
- **Twelve** - Genesis 12
  - ✓ Twelve is the number associated with the nation of _____ and Jews.
- **Thirteen** – Genesis 14:4 (first mention)
  - ✓ Thirteen is associated with_____
  - ✓ "Number THIRTEEN is the number of rebellion and apostasy. Its first occurrence is in Genesis 14:4 – "'Twelve years they served Chedorlaomer, and in the thirteenth year they rebelled." In this verse, thirteen appears and proves rebellion and government resisted. Beginning at this point, and appearing throughout Scripture, thirteen suggests rebellion, sin, and disobedience."[3]
- **Forty** – Genesis 7:4 (first mention)
  - ✓ Forty is related to a time of being tested or _____.

CONCLUSION

We must look for and apply the _____ patterns God has established throughout the Bible as we study it. God is very consistent with His words, principles, and even how He uses numbers. Also, when seeking understanding or clarification on an issue in the Bible, always check the **first time** the word or subject is **mentioned**.

[2] John Phillips, *Bible Explorer's Guide: How to Understand and Interpret the Bible* (Grand Rapids, MI: Kregel Publications, 2002), 127.

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- **Six** - Revelation 13:18
  - ✓ God emphasizes this one! Six is the number of **MAN**. Specifically, fallen man or man's incompleteness.
- **Seven** - Genesis 2:2-3 (first mention)
  - ✓ God finishes with creation and He rests on the **7TH** day. Seven is emphasized throughout the Bible as God's number for **COMPLETION**.
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  - ✓ Eight is the number representing new **BEGINNINGS**. (Seven is the number of completion!)
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  - ✓ Nine seems to be a number God uses related to **FRUITFULNESS/FRUITBEARING**.
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  - ✓ Ten is a number that represents **Gentiles**, or non-Jews.
- **Twelve** - Genesis 12
  - ✓ Twelve is the number associated with the nation of **ISRAEL** and Jews.
- **Thirteen** – Genesis 14:4 (first mention)
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CONCLUSION

We must look for and apply the **CONSISTENT** patterns God has established throughout the Bible as we study it. God is very consistent with His words, principles, and even how He uses numbers. Also, when seeking understanding or clarification on an issue in the Bible, always check the **first time** the word or subject is **mentioned**.

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#10 THE LITERAL FACTOR

1. Always take a passage _____ until it is impossible to take it literally or if there is clear instruction from the scripture that we are dealing with _____.

   - This is commonly known in Biblical Studies as the "_____ _____" of Bible study. It is typically stated this way, "When the plain sense of Scripture makes common sense, seek no other sense."[4] [5] [6]
   - It is also important to remember that we can interpret the Bible literally, consistently only because of the foundational rules established earlier in this class. These principles cannot be ignored or passed over.

   NOTE Many will say something is "symbolic" in the scripture as opposed to taking it literally, exactly as it is written, as an excuse to justify lack of understanding.

   Matthew 13:1-23 _____ What is a parable? Verses 10-12; Jesus explains them!
   Revelation 1:12-20 _____
   Ezekiel 37:1-11 _____
   John 6:35, 53-63 _____

   KEY Very few passages in the Bible are symbolic. Symbolism that does exist is usually clearly defined in the immediate context. *(Those not defined in the context can be defined elsewhere in the Bible by comparing scripture with scripture. Ex. – Rev. 12:1-5)*

2. Keep in mind that God _____to us, through the words of the Bible, just like we talk: *(God records real life)*

   - **Figures of speech** - Gen. 4:10; Lev. 18:25; Nu. 14:9; Joshua 24:27; Prov. 18:2
     - *Figure of speech - Figuratively explaining something (IE. sunrise / sunset…Matt. 5:45; Mark 1:32)*
   - **Sarcasm** - Judges 9:7-15; 10:14; 1 Kings 18:27; Job 12:2-3; 18:5; 2 Co. 11:16-19; Acts 2:13
     - *Sarcasm - cutting or taunting in order to aggravate or hurt someone's feelings; a mocking remark utilizing statements opposite or irrelevant to the underlying meaning.*
   - **Hyperboles** - Gen. 33:10; Deut. 1:28; Judges 7:12; 2 Kings 19:24; Jer. 15:16; 1 Co. 13:1-2; 2 Co. 7:14
     - *Hyperbole - An exaggerated statement used for effect not meant to be taken literally.*
   - **Satire** - Isaiah 44:14-17; Gen. 37:19; 1 Samuel 17:41-44; Eccl. 2:1-11; Matthew 23:1-33
     - *Satire - A literary work in which irony, derision, or wit is used to expose folly or wickedness.*

KEY POINT **Always** take a passage **literally** unless it is impossible to do so!

This factor _____what you read and will increase your comprehension of the Bible!

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[4] Roy B. Zuck, *Basic Bible Interpretation: A Practical Guide to Discovering Biblical Truth* (Wheaton, IL: Victor Books, 1991), 146.
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[6] Charles C. Ryrie, *Dispensationalism*, rev. and expanded ed. (Chicago: Moody Press, 1995), 80.

#11 THE ATTITUDE FACTOR

1. Always be ready to _____whatever you have been taught or you have believed when you find it goes _____to the Bible – James 1:22-25.

   - John 3:1-18 _____can **blind us** from what we should believe.
   - Mark 7:1-13 _____can **bind us** to unbiblical beliefs.
   - John 11:23-27 – God will _____our beliefs.
   - Mark 10:17-26 – Sometimes we will choose not to believe. We know better.
   - Luke 6:46-49 – Our beliefs will determine the _____and steadfastness of our lives.
   - 2 Kings 22-23 – The example of good king Josiah and his crisis of belief.

   KEY #1 We must always line ourselves up to what the Bible **clearly** _____!

   KEY #2 We must be careful not to make the Bible say what we want it to say!

2. Our **personal beliefs** are formed by our upbringing, societal pressures/teaching, and personal experience. The following are a few examples of issues the Bible speaks about that may challenge your own personal beliefs and actions:

   - ✓ *Managing finances –*
   - ✓ *Dating –*
   - ✓ *Biblical relationships –*
   - ✓ *Marriage responsibilities –*
   - ✓ *Child rearing and discipline –*
   - ✓ *Proper use of alcohol –*
   - ✓ *Giving –*
   - ✓ *Church service schedules –*
   - ✓ *Attitudes/actions toward authority –*
   - ✓ *Work ethic –*

3. Have an _____attitude toward God when you come to a crisis of belief with His word.

   - Mark 9:23-24 –

   NOTE Changes in our beliefs will cause changes in our _____and attitudes.

   KEY Many people are not able to apply this factor of Bible study because they **do not** have a final authority. If you **do not** have a final authority, _____become the final authority.

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1. Always take a passage **LITERALLY** until it is impossible to take it literally or if there is clear instruction from the scripture that we are dealing with **SYMBOLISM**.

- This is commonly known in Biblical Studies as the "**GOLDEN RULE**" of Bible study. It is typically stated this way, "When the plain sense of Scripture makes common sense, seek no other sense."[4] [5] [6]
- It is also important to remember that we can interpret the Bible literally, consistently only because of the foundational rules established earlier in this class. These principles cannot be ignored or passed over.

NOTE Many will say something is "symbolic" in the scripture as opposed to taking it literally, exactly as it is written, as an excuse to justify lack of understanding.

Matthew 13:1-23 **PARABLES** What is a parable? Verses 10-12; Jesus explains them!
- Jesus then interprets the symbols in **verses 18-23**, showing that it was all clearly meant as symbolism/not literal/imagery

Revelation 1:12-20 **SYMBOLISM**

Ezekiel 37:1-11 **SYMBOLISM**
- Ezekiel sees a valley full of dry bones. As he prophesies, the bones come together, receive flesh and breath, and become a great living army. God explains that the bones symbolize the whole house of Israel, pictured as dead and hopeless but later restored by God.

John 6:35, 53-63 **SYMBOLISM**

KEY Very few passages in the Bible are symbolic. Symbolism that does exist is usually clearly defined in the immediate context. *(Those not defined in the context can be defined elsewhere in the Bible by comparing scripture with scripture. Ex. – Rev. 12:1-5)*

2. Keep in mind that God **TALKS** to us, through the words of the Bible, just like we talk: *(God records real life)*

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- **Sarcasm** - Judges 9:7-15; 10:14; 1 Kings 18:27; Job 12:2-3; 18:5; 2 Co. 11:16-19; Acts 2:13
  - Elijah clearly does not believe that they may have a god who is just sleeping or on a trip, he is mocking and using sarcasm. Job clearly does not believe his friends possess all wisdom and when they die, all wisdom will cease to exist (as evidenced by the context vs. 3)
  - *Sarcasm - cutting or taunting in order to aggravate or hurt someone's feelings; a mocking remark utilizing statements opposite or irrelevant to the underlying meaning.*
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  - *Satire - A literary work in which irony, derision, or wit is used to expose folly or wickedness.*
  - The events described are literal, but Isaiah presents them satirically to show the absurdity of worshipping something a man made with his own hands. The purpose is what we are to understand. He is not giving instruction on woodworking, but using this as a condemnation of making gods with mans own hands.

KEY POINT **Always** take a passage **literally** unless it is impossible to do so!

This factor **SIMPLIFIES** what you read and will increase your comprehension of the Bible!

#11 THE ATTITUDE FACTOR

1. Always be ready to **CHANGE** whatever you have been taught or you have believed when you find it goes **CONTRARY** to the Bible – James 1:22-25.

- John 3:1-18 **RELIGION** can **blind us** from what we should believe.
  - Nicodemus was so religious, so entrenched in his beliefs and religion, that he was unable to see clear and simple teaching that was right in front of him. He was so wound up he was thinking ridiculous things! Jesus speaks to him in one of the simplest and strongest statements of the Bible about salvation in Christ. **Are we so religious that we are unable to see clearly when God wants us to change what we believe, when confronted with his word?**

- Mark 7:1-13 **TRADITION** can **bind us** to unbiblical beliefs.
  - We can "worship" God in vain (empty, fake), when it is according to our traditions and not God's word. Worship is sacrifice and giving of ourselves to God completely. How sad is it that someone could waste their life, sacrificing it to God, all in vain, because it was based on tradition and not God's word. Many do it never knowing that they were doing it in vain.
  - How do we fix this? Ask the question: "Is what I am doing/sacrificing for BIBLICAL? Or, is it a tradition of men? If it is not Biblical, ask, "Why am I doing this? Who is telling me to do this? God or man/tradition?"

- John 11:23-27 – God will **CHALLENGE** our beliefs.
  - Jesus is speaking to Martha about the death of Lazarus and he tells her that "he is the resurrection and the life." There were many disagreements amongst the Pharisees and Saducees about the resurrection of the dead at this time in history. Martha was thinking in their terms, Jesus fixes it all and clarifies that HE IS THE RESSURECTION AND THE LIFE.

- Mark 10:17-26 – Sometimes we will choose not to believe. We know **BETTER**.
  - The issue in this story is an issue as old as time, and it is the basis of all sin in our lives and it is the killer of any fruit, any learning, and growth: PRIDE! The rich young man did not have a lack of knowledge of what to do; he clearly understood. He simply did not want to do it. Just as the Devil has no lack of knowledge of the power, glory, eternality, death, resurrection, etc.. of Christ; he simply will not bow his life to Him.
  - Many have no problem comprehending what the Bible teaches, it is written in plain English for our understanding. However, our issue as mankind, is our unwillingness to submit ourselves to God's word and his will for us.

- Luke 6:46-49 – Our beliefs will determine the **FOUNDATION** and steadfastness of our lives.
  - Those who hear and refuse to obey, their lives always are shaky, unbalanced, constantly collapsing, etc.. because they refuse to obey, even though they know what they are supposed to do. There is no harder life than this life as a runaway child of God (prodigal son).

- 2 Kings 22-23 – The example of good king Josiah and his **CRISIS** of belief.
  - Judah had drifted far from God and had been living contrary to His Word. While the temple was being repaired, Hilkiah the priest found "the book of the law in the house of the LORD" (2 Kings 22:8).
    When the book was read to Josiah, he realized how far the nation had departed from Scripture. "When the king had heard the words of the book of the law, that he rent his clothes" (22:11). He immediately recognized that Judah was doing things against God and his word: "Great is the wrath of the LORD... because our fathers have not hearkened unto the words of this book" (22:13).
    Josiah did not defend what they had always done or their "tradition". He gathered the people and "read in their ears all the words of the book of the covenant" (23:2). Then he "made a covenant before the LORD, to walk after the LORD, and to keep his commandments" (23:3).
    After that, Josiah began removing the idols, false worship, corrupt priests, and practices that contradicted God's Word. When Josiah discovered that what he and his nation had been doing was contrary to Scripture, he changed it.

KEY #1 We must always line ourselves up to what the Bible **clearly SAYS**!

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2. Our **personal beliefs** are formed by our upbringing, societal pressures/teaching, and personal experience. The following are a few examples of issues the Bible speaks about that may challenge your own personal beliefs and actions:

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- Mark 9:23-24 –

NOTE Changes in our beliefs will cause changes in our **ACTIONS** and attitudes.

KEY Many people are not able to apply this factor of Bible study because they **do not** have a final authority. If you **do not** have a final authority, **YOU** become the final authority.

#12 THE CLARITY FACTOR

1. Never violate a _____ passage when trying to understand an _____ (uncertain) passage.

    - There are obscure passages in the Bible – 2 Peter 3:16
    - Some passages are clearly _____ for now – Proverbs 25:2; Daniel 12:4, 8-9; Ephesians 3:1-7; 1 Pet. 1:6-12; John 16:12
    - A few examples:

    FAITH ALONE VS. WORKS

    Clear

    ✓ Ephesians 2:8-9; Titus 3:5; Rom. 10:9-10; John 3:16; Romans 4:5; Galatians 2:16; Romans 11:6; 2 Timothy 1:9

    Obscure

    ✓ James 2:24; Hebrews 3:6

    BAPTISM AS PART OF SALVATION PROCESS

    Clear

    ✓ John 3:16; Ephesians 2:8–9; Titus 3:5; Romans 4:5; Romans 10:9–10; Acts 16:30–31; 1 Corinthians 1:14–17; Acts 8:36–38; Luke 23:42–43

    Obscure

    ✓ 1 Peter 3:21; Acts 2:38

2. Key points to remember when you encounter an obscure passage:

    - There are always **many, many more** _____ passages about a subject than obscure ones!
    - Apply the rules of Bible study to find the clear meaning of any difficult passage. If you cannot get clarity on a verse or passage concerning the subject matter after applying the rules of Bible study, move on for now, give God the benefit of the doubt, and trust the clear verses/passages that you do understand.
    - Eventually, you will always find that whatever an obscure passage means will _____ conflict with other scripture taken in context. (Ps. 12:6-7; Pr. 30:5)

#13 THE QUESTION FACTOR

1. Never base a doctrine on a _____. Questions are designed to investigate, interrogate, and _____ an answer. Sometimes questions in the Bible can be rhetorical to support an answer, but remember, they are questions, NOT answers. This rule is strongly connected to the CLARITY FACTOR, yet they are distinct.

    "Obscure passages must always give way to clear passages. Further, we must never build a doctrine on obscure or difficult passages. Everything essential to salvation or to Christian living is clearly revealed in the Bible. We have no need to resort to obscure passages to support a Biblical belief. One such obscure passage in the Bible is found in 1 Corinthians 15:29, where we read: "Else what shall they do which are baptized for the dead, if the dead rise not at all? why are they then baptized for the dead?" The meaning of this passage is the subject of considerable controversy. The Mormons have formulated a doctrine of baptism for the dead based on this passage."[7]

[7] John Phillips, Bible Explorer's Guide: How to Understand and Interpret the Bible (Grand Rapids, MI: Kregel Publications, 2002), 108.

- Many strange and heretical doctrines are based on _____in the Bible, not clear teachings of God:

  - ✓ Extremist views of predestination (Calvinism) are based on a series of questions – *Rom. 9:13-24*

    While there are many passages used by Calvinists, their main areas used for doctrine are questions!

  - ✓ Heretical teachings concerning grace plus works are based on a series of questions – *Jam. 2:20-26*

    The James text poses a question…a question cannot be the foundation for something as significant as teaching the Christian's salvation and eternal life are based on grace + works.

  - ✓ The bizarre Mormon doctrine *,"baptism for the dead,"* is based on a single question in 1 Corinthians – *1 Cor. 15:29*

Key Point When a sole verse or passage is a question, it will _____ be the foundation for any significant Biblical doctrine. Therefore, ***never base a Bible doctrine on a question***.

#14 THE CONFIRMATION FACTOR

1. Never base a particular doctrine on _____verse or passage alone. God always bases Bible doctrine (His clear teachings) on more than one verse!

   - Anytime God establishes a significant foundational truth, He ***always*** confirms it in the mouth of two or three _____ –2 Cor. 13:1; *Deut. 19:15; Num. 35:30*; *Isa. 28:9-10, 13*

     - ✓ 1 Cor. 15:29 — As we have already seen, the strange doctrine of "*baptism for the dead"* is based on _____lone verse in the Bible (and a question at that!). Where else is baptism for the dead ever mentioned? Nowhere!

     - ✓ 1 Cor. 13:1 — Is there a heavenly language that angels speak? Or is this just a figure of speech? It is a figure of speech because when we compare scripture with scripture, we find that angels speak in _____!! When angels speak, people understand them!! What other verses support a heavenly angelic language?

     - ✓ Matt.16:18 — Does this verse establish that Peter was to be the first pope in Rome? **1.2 billion people** follow a leadership system based on this _____ single verse.
       - Peter is not presented as the Rock, Christ is (**1 Cor. 10:4; 1 Pet. 2:4–8; Eph. 2:20; Isa. 28:16**); Peter was married (**Matt. 8:14; Mark 1:30; 1 Cor. 9:5**); Peter called himself a "fellow elder," not the supreme ruler of the church (**1 Pet. 5:1–4**); Peter explicitly refused religious reverence from Cornelius (**Acts 10:25–26**); Peter was publicly rebuked and corrected by Paul when he was wrong (**Gal. 2:11–14**); Peter was not the final authority at the Jerusalem council. James gave the concluding judgment (**Acts 15:7–20**); Christ, not Peter, is repeatedly called the Head of the Church (**Eph. 1:22–23; 4:15; 5:23; Col. 1:18; 2:19**); The foundation of the church is not Peter alone, but the apostles and prophets, with Jesus Christ as the chief cornerstone (**Eph. 2:20; Rev. 21:14**); Paul wrote an entire epistle to the Christians at Rome and greeted many believers by name without mentioning Peter (**Rom. 16:1–16**); When Paul was imprisoned in Rome, he mentioned numerous fellow workers but never identified Peter as the head of the Roman church (**Col. 4:7–14; 2 Tim. 4:9–12, 16**).

   - Remember to always _____ scripture with scripture *(Factor #6)*.

Key Point If an unusual doctrine in a verse/passage is not found supported anywhere else in the Bible... leave it

#12 THE CLARITY FACTOR

1. Never violate a **CLEAR** passage when trying to understand an **OBSCURE** (uncertain) passage.

    - There are obscure passages in the Bible – 2 Peter 3:16
    - Some passages are clearly **CLOSED** for now – Proverbs 25:2; Daniel 12:4, 8-9; Ephesians 3:1-7; 1 Pet. 1:6-12; John 16:12
    - A few examples:

FAITH ALONE VS. WORKS

Clear

✓ Ephesians 2:8-9; Titus 3:5; Rom. 10:9-10; John 3:16; Romans 4:5; Galatians 2:16; Romans 11:6; 2 Timothy 1:9

Obscure

✓ James 2:24; Hebrews 3:6

BAPTISM AS PART OF SALVATION PROCESS

Clear

✓ John 3:16; Ephesians 2:8–9; Titus 3:5; Romans 4:5; Romans 10:9–10; Acts 16:30–31; 1 Corinthians 1:14–17; Acts 8:36–38; Luke 23:42–43

Obscure

✓ 1 Peter 3:21; Acts 2:38

2. Key points to remember when you encounter an obscure passage:

    - There are always **many, many more CLEAR** passages about a subject than obscure ones!
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    "Obscure passages must always give way to clear passages. Further, we must never build a doctrine on obscure or difficult passages. Everything essential to salvation or to Christian living is clearly revealed in the Bible. We have no need to resort to obscure passages to support a Biblical belief. One such obscure passage in the Bible is found in 1 Corinthians 15:29, where we read: "Else what shall they do which are baptized for the dead, if the dead rise not at all? why are they then baptized for the dead?" The meaning of this passage is the subject of considerable controversy. The Mormons have formulated a doctrine of baptism for the dead based on this passage."[7]

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  The James text poses a question…a question cannot be the foundation for something as significant as teaching the Christian's salvation and eternal life are based on grace + works.

  ✓ The bizarre Mormon doctrine *,"baptism for the dead,"* is based on a single question in 1 Corinthians – *1 Cor. 15:29*

Key Point When a sole verse or passage is a question, it will **NOT** be the foundation for any significant Biblical doctrine. Therefore, ***never base a Bible doctrine on a question***.

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1. Never base a particular doctrine on **ONE** verse or passage alone. God always bases Bible doctrine (His clear teachings) on more than one verse!

   - Anytime God establishes a significant foundational truth, He ***always*** confirms it in the mouth of two or three **WITNESSES** –2 Cor. 13:1; *Deut. 19:15; Num. 35:30; Isa. 28:9-10, 13*

     ✓ 1 Cor. 15:29 — As we have already seen, the strange doctrine of "*baptism for the dead"* is based on **ONE** lone verse in the Bible (and a question at that!). Where else is baptism for the dead ever mentioned? Nowhere!

     - 1 Cor. 13:1 — Is there a heavenly language that angels speak? Or is this just a figure of speech? It is a figure of speech because when we compare scripture with scripture, we find that angels speak in **HEBREW**!! When angels speak, people understand them!! What other verses support a heavenly angelic language?

     - Matt.16:18 — Does this verse establish that Peter was to be the first pope in Rome? **1.2 billion people** follow a leadership system based on this **ONE** single verse.
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   - Remember to always **COMPARE** scripture with scripture *(Factor #6)*.

Key Point If an unusual doctrine in a verse/passage is not found supported anywhere else in the Bible... leave it alone.

#15 THE MATURITY FACTOR

1. God is infinitely wise. We will _____ completely understand God. We are on a **LIFE**-long mission to know God and understand/experience His ways more until the day we are physically glorified - Ex. 33:18-23; Phil. 3:9-17.

    - Isaiah 55:8-9 – If we could ever completely understand God, we would be His _____!

    - If you find something you don't understand, try your best to get it, being careful not to violate any of the rules of Bible study. If you still can't understand it, don't worry about it. God reveals His word to us in progression... ***as we are able to handle it***. We must also remember a humbling fact…God will not _____ us with more if we are not faithful with what we have now.

    KEY We must work to _____ what we ***do understand***, and then wait on God for more – Phil. 2:12-13

2. Always keep John 16:12 in your thinking… *"I have yet **many things** to say unto you, but ye cannot bear them now."*

15 Factors to Focus your Bible Study:

1. The Context Factor
2. The People Factor
3. The Division (time) Factor
4. The Application Factor
5. The Individual Word Factor
6. The Comparison Factor
7. The Creation Factor
8. The Apparent Contradiction Factor
9. The Consistency Factor
10. The Literal Factor
11. The Attitude Factor
12. The Clarity Factor
13. The Question Factor
14. The Confirmation Factor
15. The Maturity Factor

FINAL THOUGHTS

1. A Few More Key Principles to Store in your Toolbelt

    a. The Kingdom of Heaven Vs. The Kingdom of God
        i. "The Kingdom of Heaven is Jewish, the Kingdom which God promised to the nation of Israel in the Old Testament and is a literal Kingdom with a literal king upon a literal throne."[8] (Matt. 3:1-2; Hos. 1:4; Acts 1:6-8; Rev. 11:15)
        ii. "The Kingdom of God is inclusive in character, including: all who in any period believed God, the seed of Abraham, The Church, All who believe after the Tribulation."[9] (Rom. 14:17; Luke 17:20-21; 1 Cor. 4:20; 1 Cor. 15:50; John 3:3-5)

    b. **The Law of Full Mention**
        i. We have looked at the Laws of First Mention and Progressive Mention, but this principle is, "That principle by which God declares his full mind upon any subject vital to our spiritual life. Somewhere in the Word, God gathers together the scattered fragments that have to do with a particular truth, and puts them into one exhaustive statement. That is his full mind concerning that truth."[10]
            1. Examples — **Resurrection** (1 Corinthians 15); **Restoration of Israel** (Romans 11); **Faith Examples** (Hebrews 11); **The Church** (Ephesians 1); **Principles of the Kingdom of Heaven** (Matthew 5-7); **Righteousness by Faith** (Romans 3-4); **Charity/Love** (1 Corinthians 13); **Spiritual Gifts** (1 Corinthians 12); etc.

    c. **The Repetition Principle**
        i. The principle by which God repeats something already stated, in order to add to it, or to draw close attention to it. It is never done to "waste space".
            1. Examples:
                a. "Verily, Verily" (Jn. 5:24, 25; 6:26, 32, 47, 53; 8:34) —The statement means, "Truly, Truly". When he says it twice, it is meant to tell us to listen very closely.
                b. The Gospels — Four accounts of the Life of Jesus, all written to give us a different perspective of His life, not simply wasteful repeating of the same stories.
                c. Revelation — Four accounts of the events of the Tribulation, leading up to Jesus Second Coming.
                d. Kings/Chronicles — Both give the same basic telling of the events during this time in Israel/Judah, but from a different perspective. Many have noted that 1 and 2 Kings is mankind's perspective of these events, while 1 and 2 Chronicles is God's perspective of these events.

2. A Few More Tools to Use

    a. **Recommended Books**: *The Keys of Bible Stud*y (Mark Trotter); *Principles of Biblical Hermeneutics* (J. Edwin Hartill); *Bible Explorer's Guide* (John Phillips); *The Treasury of Scripture Knowledge* (R. A. Torrey edition); *Halley's Bible Handbook* (Henry H. Halley); *Willmington's Guide to the Bible* (Harold L. Willmington)
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[8] J. Edwin Hartill, *Principles of Biblical Hermeneutics* (CreateSpace Independent Publishing Platform, 2015), 41.
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            1. Beyond this, going back to our Every Word factor: Are God and Heaven the same? Do we pray to Heaven? Do we live in God when we die?
            2. The Kingdom of God is a spiritual, inward kingdom entered through the new birth.

    b. **The Law of Full Mention**
        i. We have looked at the Laws of First Mention and Progressive Mention, but this principle is, "That principle by which God declares his full mind upon any subject vital to our spiritual life. Somewhere in the Word, God gathers together the scattered fragments that have to do with a particular truth, and puts them into one exhaustive statement. That is his full mind concerning that truth."[10]
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S02 / TEACHING SERIES

Practical Bible Study (including 2.0)

Passage-based Bible-study sequences, including Practical Bible Study 2.0, with teacher/student materials and applied study exercises.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Bible teaching and lesson preparation.

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Luke Johnston's selected teaching, writing or development sample; original bylines and citations retained.

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Final Copy of PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY 2.0- COLOSSIANS 318-25	*1 pages*
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song of solomon finished	*2 pages*
Song of Solomon student	*2 pages*
practical bible study 2	*2 pages*
practical bible study 2(2)	*1 pages*
practical bible study 4	*2 pages*
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practical bible study student rev 4	*1 pages*
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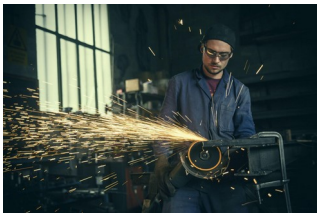
Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.



Wednesday, April 27th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Perfecting Our Faith- ***James 2:14-26***

1. These verses we find in James are often wrested by many false teachers to say something that they do not mean. The truth is, these verses are found in a very challenging letter, written to suffering Christians, in order to urge them to press on doing the right things, and to separate the true followers from the fakes (as persecution does). When we see these verses in the correct light, **comparing scripture with scripture,** we will be blessed and challenged by God in amazing ways to _____ ____ _____ and not lose confidence in our faith (as those who wrest these scriptures would have us do).

2. FAITH, FAITH, AND MORE FAITH

   a. There are many different types of faith in the Bible. Not all apply to us "being saved" and our saving faith in Jesus and what he did on the cross and after.
      i. The faith by which we _____
         1. 2 Timothy 4:7; Col. 2:6-7; Rom. 14:1
      ii. The faith by which we received the gift of _____
         1. Gal 1:23; 2:16
      iii. Faith as described in Hebrews 11:1 (faith in its simplest form, the word "faith")
         1. Matt. 6:30; 8:10,26; 9:2, etc…

3. "FAITH MADE PERFECT"

   a. From all we know about salvation in the Bible, can we "perfect" our saving faith? _____
      i. **Gal. 3:3- "Are ye so foolish? having begun in the Spirit, are ye now made perfect by the flesh?"**
      ii. John 3:16; Rom. 10:9-10; Eph. 2:8-9
   b. If we cannot perfect our saving faith, we must be able to perfect another type of faith. The faith he is talking about is the faith we walk in after we are saved.
      i. Jam. 1:3-4; Eph. 4:13; 1 Thess. 3:10

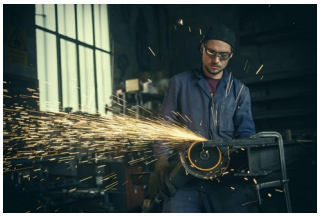
4. Where the rubber meets the road

   a. We cannot simply write off the words of James. These are sound words and they need to cause us to reevaluate our lives and fix what needs fixing (James 1:22-25)
   b. Where is your faith today?
      i. Do you have THE saving faith by which we are made right with God through Jesus Christ?
         1. Ephesians 2:8-9- This faith is how we receive the grace
         2. John 3:16; Romans 10:9-10- This is how we receive this gift THROUGH faith
      ii. Are you walking in Christ as you received him? (by _____)
         1. We CANNOT live our Christian lives successfully outside of faith. We walk in Christ by faith for our entire Christian lives.

a. **Rom. 10:17-** “So then faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.”
    i. How much time are you spending in the word of God? This is where we get faith, and where we can exercise faith by believing and obeying what God’s word tells us to do.
b. **James 1:5-6-** “If any of you lack wisdom, let him ask of God, that giveth to all men liberally, and upbraideth not; and it shall be given him. But let him ask in faith, nothing wavering. For he that wavereth is like a wave of the sea driven with the wind and tossed.”
    i. Are you praying to God in faith? Do you believe when you ask God for something that he can/will do it?
c. **Heb. 11:6-** “But without faith it is impossible to please him: for he that cometh to God must believe that he is, and that he is a rewarder of them that diligently seek him.”
    i. Without faith it is _____ to please God, so are you pleasing to God?

2. Are you perfecting your faith by showing your faith by your works?
    a. James tells us that our faith is shown by our works. As we perfect our faith, we ought to have works that much up more and more to what we profess to believe.
        i. 2 Tim. 3:16-17

5. As we have seen today, there are many types of faith in the bible. All are important and so it is of utmost importance that we understand them. We MUST have faith to be fruitful and glorifying to God in our lives. The faith that saves us is just the beginning, we have whole lives to live for God that require us to have faith each day. This faith must be _____ as we are sanctified and conformed to the image of Jesus Christ more and more each day.



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        i. Do you have THE saving faith by which we are made right with God through Jesus Christ?
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            2. John 3:16; Romans 10:9-10- This is how we receive this gift THROUGH faith
        ii. Are you walking in Christ as you received him? (by faith)
            1. We CANNOT live our Christian lives successfully outside of faith. We walk in Christ by faith for our entire Christian lives.

a. **Rom. 10:17-** “So then faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.”
    i. How much time are you spending in the word of God? This is where we get faith, and where we can exercise faith by believing and obeying what God’s word tells us to do.
b. **James 1:5-6-** “If any of you lack wisdom, let him ask of God, that giveth to all men liberally, and upbraideth not; and it shall be given him. But let him ask in faith, nothing wavering. For he that wavereth is like a wave of the sea driven with the wind and tossed.”
    i. Are you praying to God in faith? Do you believe when you ask God for something that he can/will do it?
c. **Heb. 11:6-** “But without faith it is impossible to please him: for he that cometh to God must believe that he is, and that he is a rewarder of them that diligently seek him.”
    i. Without faith it is impossible to please God, so are you pleasing to God?

2. Are you perfecting your faith by showing your faith by your works?
    a. James tells us that our faith is shown by our works. As we perfect our faith, we ought to have works that much up more and more to what we profess to believe.
        i. 2 Tim. 3:16-17

5. As we have seen today, there are many types of faith in the bible. All are important and so it is of utmost importance that we understand them. We MUST have faith to be fruitful and glorifying to God in our lives. The faith that saves us is just the beginning, we have whole lives to live for God that require us to have faith each day. This faith must be perfected as we are sanctified and conformed to the image of Jesus Christ more and more each day.

PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY 2.0- 1 TIMOTHY 3:1-13

1. **Who** is writing/Who are they writing to/**When** are they writing?

   Paul is writing to his disciple and commissioned pastor Timothy around the year 63-65 AD

2. What is the **context** of this verse/passage/book?

   This letter is the first of Paul's two letters to his most well know disciple Timothy. He is writing after the time of Acts 28, between his 1st and 2nd Roman imprisonments. Paul speaks in this letter to Timothy about how a local NT church should operate, the leadership, and the members (1 Tim. 3:15). He deals with how to deal with heresy in chapter 1, orderly church behavior in chapter 2 and 3, and then our daily Christian living in chapters 4-6. This letter teaches us about a model disciple: one who is faithful, grows, becomes a sent out pastor/leader of a church, and desires to lead it well and the way the Bible teaches us to. He deals with specific issues such as: sound doctrine, prayer, men/women roles in the church, purity, personal holy conduct, sharing the gospel, false doctrines/teachers, how to treat elderly members of the church, servants and masters, riches and contentment, etc... This letter really has all we need to be model disciples from the time we are saved all the way to starting and ordering a church if God calls us to.

3. What is happening **historically?**

   Paul writes to his beloved disciple about, a young pastor, to detail the order and conduct of a local NT church. In our specific passage, he writes about the necessary character qualities for a bishop/elder/deacon (church leadership). He outlines the only 2 offices in the NT local church: pastors and deacons (pastors are also called bishops and elders)

4. What is the **doctrinal** (in context biblical truth) teaching here?

   Doctrinally, this passage teaches us about the character qualities that are required for a pastor or a deacon in the church. We learn that God is not interested as much in the orators, knowledgeable, charismatic leaders but those that have CHARACTER. God can use any man as a leader that has character. God's leaders of his church are REQUIRED to have these character qualities in their lives. If we see discrepancies in what God has said and who is in leadership, there is an element of grace and understanding BUT we need to evaluate based on God's clear standards he gives us. Doctrinally, we understand that bishops/elders/pastors are all the same office (Titus 1:5,7) We would be 100% okay to use bishop and elder as terms for pastors, however we don't due to the way they have been perverted by false religions. We also see almost an identical copy of this letter and the character qualities listed in Titus (another disciple/pastor of Paul's) that we can compare this letter to.

5. Is there any **prophetic** teaching here?

   There are many passages in the NT that do NOT contain prophesy unless it is plainly stated. There does not seems to be a deeper prophetic teaching in this passage that is clear. I am sure you could find some though if you looked hard enough and make enough connections. We can definitely see the breakdown of this order in the local church today, with added offices, women in leadership positions, men who have no business in leadership but are put there anyway, etc...

6. What can you apply **devotionally** from this?

   Devotionally we can and should ALL APPLY these principles of living. This is NOT a standard only for God's leadership "elite" but for all of us in the local church. We have to be living this way BEFORE we can ever be in a position of leadership in the church and we NEVER KNOW when God might call us to that place; are we ready for it and living ready for it if he calls?

7. What other **cross references** apply to this passage?

   Titus 1-3; Jeremiah 2:8; 3:15; 10:21; 12:10; 17:16; 22:22; 23:1-2; Luke 22:66; Acts 20:17, 28; Eph. 4:11-13;1 Pet. 4:9; 1 Pet. 5:1-3; Prov. 31:4-7; Eph. 5:18; Acts 6:3

8. What **word**/phrase studies did you do in this passage?

   elder, bishop, pastor, deacon, shepherd, wine, strike, lucre, etc...

9. What **consistent** patterns is God using in this passage to help you understand it/make connections?

   God shows us the pattern of bishops/elders/pastors all being the same thing in places such as Titus 1:5,7 and 1 Peter. 5:1-3. We see the "higher standard" to which God's leaders are called also throughout the Bible in places such as Prov. 31:4-7

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PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY 2.0- ACTS 2:1-13

1. **Who** is writing/Who are they writing to/**When** are they writing?

   Luke: writing to Teophilus a student/peer of some sort that was interested in the details of the church from Christ to the early church (Luke 1: 1-3) He wrote this around 65-70 AD

2. What is the **context** of this verse/passage/book?

   The book as a whole is a TRANSITIONAL BOOK. This is key to understand. The book before it ends with Jesus Christ and his twelve disciples and then the book following it starts with the Apostle Paul. Without Acts we have no idea about him, his story, his KEY position in the NT as it pertains to doctrine and Jesus Christ's ministry he gave Paul. Some key transitions in this book are: Jew to Gentile, Israel to the church, Kingdom of Heaven to the Kingdom of God, Peter to Paul, Jerusalem to Antioch, etc... Everything is changing as a result of Jesus death/resurrection and the rejection of the Messiah by Israel in the gospels and beginning parts of Acts. The book is a historical record of events, not a doctrine treatise. It gives multiples accounts of how to be saved at different points and the only consistent thing about the book, is that it is inconsistent. The previous chapter details the ascension of Christ and his commands to his disciples to go to Jerusalem FIRST.

3. What is happening **historically?**

   Luke is writing about the when the Apostles are at Jerusalem as Jesus told them to be and they are "waiting for the Holy Ghost" as they were told to do. They are to go to ISRAEL FIRST (Acts 1:8; Matt. 28:18-20; Lk. 24:47-49). They are at Jerusalem during the major Jewish holiday of Pentecost for the feast and festivities, when there are a million or more Jews in the area for the celebration. This is when the Holy Ghost first comes to the Apostles and gives them the power to preach and the SIGNS that are REQUIRED for JEWS to believe. They are preaching repentance for the murder of the Messiah (vs. 22-36) and they are doing signs to prove the message as the Bible says Jews are to looks for (1 Cor. 1:22; Acts 7:37; 3:22; Exo. 7-9; Acts 2:5)

4. What is the **doctrinal** (in context biblical truth) teaching here?

   Miracles/Signs purpose were to convince unbelieving Jews of the message being from God and God's spokesperson. Signs were NEVER about being signs of extra spirituality, salvation, given to all people to use/not use at their own power/discretion. They were given from God, by the power of his spirit to convince unbelieving Jews by the signs he told them to look for. Also they always WORK and people UNDERSTAND THEM and know that they are miracles (vs. 11-12) They are given to the Jews who had the savior who died to pay for their sin as promised in the OT, and now they are being offered the Kingdom on earth they were always promised if they would repent as a whole and receive Christ, the signs were to show absolute proof this was from God, yet they rejected as a majority.

5. Is there any **prophetic** teaching here?

   During the end times, when God is working through the Jews again and about to bring in the Kingdom before the Day of the Lord/Last Days (vs. 17; Joel 2:28-32) God will use his Jewish witnesses to reach the Jewish people through signs and wonders. Only this time they will receive him and he will come back and the prophesy in Joel will be fulfilled and finished as it was meant to be in Acts 2. (If they received him, the rest of the events would have happened/2nd coming and Jesus would have established his kingdom- Acts 2:16).
   "This is that" when you study it in the Bible typically means that it is a picture, metaphor, type of something else. In this case it was because Israel rejected Jesus still.

6. What can you apply **devotionally** from this?

   The Holy Ghost is the TRUE power in our lives. We don't need the signs/wonders in order to reach the world. We see people repent and come to receive Christ without any of these signs because the word of God is a greater sign! (1 Pet. 1:16-21; Psa. 19:7; Lk. 16:29-31; 1 Cor. 13:10)
   Live in repentance! Do not ever get the place where you are not repenting anymore because of the hardness of your heart. Repent when you know you are wrong, pride will lead to your destruction.

7. What other **cross references** apply to this passage?

   Luke 1:1-3; Acts 1:8; Matt. 28:18-20; Lk. 24:47-49; 1 Cor. 1:22; Acts 7:37; 3:22; Exo. 7-9; Acts 2:5; Joel 2:28-32; 1 Pet. 1:16-21; Psa. 19:7; Lk. 16:29-31; 1 Cor. 13:10

8. What **word**/phrase studies did you do in this passage?

   "this is that"; tongues; Pentecost; rushing wind; cloven

9. What **consistent** patterns is God using in this passage to help you understand it/make connections?

   "this is that" is a phrase meaning it is a type, picture, metaphor of something else. In our way of speaking we would assume it means that it is something else, but seeing the phrase usage in the Bible we see it has a different biblical definition. Usually dependent on the response of the hearers of the message of God, as is the case in Acts 2

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PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY 2.0- COLOSSIANS 3:18-25

1. **Who** is writing/Who are they writing to/**When** are they writing?

   Paul is writing to the church of believers at Colosi around 60 to 63 AD

2. What is the **context** of this verse/passage/book?

   Keeping in mind that Paul is writing to the church during this time of grace, and during the church age to exhort, correct and warn this church in Colosi we understand that the context applies to our lives today. This is a Pauline letter to whom the mysteries of the church were revealed, during the dispensation of grace, and during the church. Another context application we get from this book is when we see that it is closely connected with Laodicea as he tells them to read this epistle that he wrote to colossi in Laodicea, and he tells the audience to read the letter from Colosi. When understood in context helps us to understand how this is connected with the time in which we live now. It also helps us to understand from the historical perspective that the area of Colossi was very similar in wealth, education, industry, and lifestyle to the place we live now. Specifically the instructions he is giving in chapter 3 and the verses we are looking at applied to people who lived during the church age who lived very similar to how we do and Paul connect it with Laodicea, deepening the understanding that we need to hear these very words today because these are things that we struggle with. It is also important to recognize the context of this specific passage within the book. So far Paul has shown us how Christ is all we need, and he is above all in the world. He has shown us how Jesus Christ is preeminent in the gospel, cross, creation, church, etc. and he has also warned this church against empty philosophy, religious, legalism, and man-made disciplines, such as science. He was warning them, because he said all of these are dangers against the pin of Christ. All of this leads into the passage in chapter 3, where Paul is telling us the Jesus Christ needs to be pent in all of our relationships . Always remember the theme when it comes to context. How does this passage relate to the theme that Jesus Christ is all in all and that he has everything we need!

3. What is happening **historically?**

   When we put all of the above together, we understand that first and foremost. Historically Paul is writing to a church in the area of Colosi around the time of 60 to 63 a A.D., which is also during the church age, which means that we can apply it directly. He is writing to encourage them about their completeness in Jesus Christ, and he confronts the false doctrines of human self-sufficiency that says that Jesus Christ was not sufficient for their ever need. We understand that these words have a very direct application to our lives today in multiple ways. First, because it is written to a church in the New Testament just like we are and then also because he associates it with the Laodicean Church which we know that we are doctrinally as well

4. What is the **doctrinal** (in context biblical truth) teaching here?

   The in context, actual biblical teaching of this passage is simply that this is the way that Christians during the church age ought to live into interact within these different relationships. These are direct command given by God for us to follow in the church age, and he very clearly tells us that our obedience or disobedience to these commands, is obedience or disobedience to him, and it will have an effect on our eternal reward.

5. Is there any **prophetic** teaching here?

   Because of the keywords that we find throughout this book in the context of this passage, referring to Laodicea, we can understand that doctrinally this is a letter that is also written directly to us (Laodicean church period). This is the deeper doctrinal meaning behind this book. Not many New Testament letters from Paul have a deeper doctrinal meaning outside of what he plainly says, but in this case, there is one that we can find.

   We also see that while it is simple, and it is not hard to understand, but it is plainly stated that we will receive the reward of the inheritance for obeying the command given in this passage. We see this in verse 24. This is still future and prophetic, and something that we believe by faith and therefore it cannot be ignored. Also, we see the warning prophetically for those who do not obey these commands in verse 25.

6. What can you apply **devotionally** from this?

   When we put together that this letter is not only written to church, age Saints, but also very directly to the period of church, history, in which we live, we understand that devotion, God intends for us to know and obey these commands. He knows that we struggle with submission. There are many different devotions that can be applied from this passage to all people in all walks of life. The overarching devotional is that we need to be submissive, and we need to be obedient to these commands, because it directly affects our relationship with God and our rewards in eternity.
   - Husbands need to love their wives
   - Wives need to submit to their husbands (spiritually and physically))
   - Children need to obey their parents (spiritually and physically)
   - Servants need to obey their masters in the flesh (spiritually and physically)

7. What other **cross references** apply to this passage?

   Ephesians 5:21-6:9; 1 Cor. 11:3; Genesis 28:7; 1 Peter 3:1-6; Genesis 2:23-24; 1 Peter 3:7; Genesis 28:7; Exodus 20:12; Proverbs 6:20; 3:12; 4:1-4; 7; 1 Thess. 2:11; 1 Timothy 6:1-2; Titus 2:9-10; Philemon; 1 Peter 2:18-19; Deut. 15:12-15; 24:14-15; Jeremiah 34:9-17; Revelation 2-3

8. What **word**/phrase studies did you do in this passage?

   Wife, wives, husband, child, parent, father, mother, servant, steward, master, as Christ

9. What **consistent** patterns is God using in this passage to help you understand it/make connections?

   The connection between being a servant, and being a steward; also the phrase as Christ, which reveals to us the reason that he is telling us to do these things which is our relationship with him being affected

PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY 2.0- JAMES 2:14-26

1. **Who** is writing/Who are they writing to/**When** are they writing?

   James the Apostle, the brother of John (1 of the 3 apostles to the Jews); he is writing to the early Christian Jews that were being persecuted for their faith around the year 40-42 AD

2. What is the **context** of this verse/passage/book?

   While James is writing to "saved" Jews (12 tribes), they did not know about the church even though they were a part of it (Eph. 2:16;3:1-7), the title " Christian" was likely something he never heard (this happened in Acts 11:26; he was killed 5 verse later in Acts 12:2), Peter and the other disciples still struggled with church age doctrine and salvation by grace through faith ALONE without works until Acts 15 (Acts 15; Gal. 2:11-16), the mysteries of the New Testament had not been revealed yet THROUGH PAUL from Christ, Paul was not even saved yet, and this letter is the earliest written letter in the New Testament (40-42 AD) All throughout the first part of the book of James he is encouraging them to prove their faith! Your faith is DEAD if there are no works to prove it, that is his point and the theme of the book "faith that works". If there are no works, your faith is dead (you probably aren't saved, it was a false conversion) or AT BEST you are fruitless and dead like a dead tree that bears no fruit.

3. What is happening **historically?**

   James is writing to the scattered saved Jews of the first century after the resurrection, encouraging them of the proper response to suffering and explaining the evidence of true saving faith. He is speaking without any knowledge from God through Paul about the church, body of Christ, NT salvation, Christianity, or ANY of the NT mysteries that are ESSENTIAL for us to know in the church age. These were revealed through Paul YEARS later as he transitioned into the church age as we know it today. We know that the Jews all struggled with these NT doctrines for a while and yet they all recognized Paul and the teachings he was given as being from God and they knew HE was the guy God was using to reveal NT doctrine (2 Pet. 3:15-16; Acts 10; Gal. 2:1-11; Eph. 3:3; 6:19; Col. 4:3) This lack of understanding and the timing of this letter though was NOT a mistake, God had a divine plan for it and was doing this for a deeper purpose. Historically, we must get the context and read this letter in light of that context of the CLEAR Pauline epistles and the doctrines they contain.

4. What is the **doctrinal** (in context biblical truth) teaching here?

   The in context biblical truth that this is teaching is that our faith is DEAD if it is not accompanied by works. We are either not saved or we are not going to bear any fruit, but we should definitely EXAMINE ourselves and work out our salvation in FEAR AND TREMBLING (Philippians 2:12) and if we have no works, we ought to be fearful and repent. Even in Ephesians 2 where we KNOW faith is all that is required for salvation (vs. 8-9) we are told that we are saved to produce good works (vs 10).
   Keeping in mind that this was written by a Jewish author, to the 12 tribes of Israel who were saved and who were on the run from Rome being persecuted, before any of the NT church doctrine was known or taught; this helps us to understand why it was worded in such a way as this.

5. Is there any **prophetic** teaching here?

   The prophetic teaching in this passage cannot be overlooked and is absolutely essential to understanding the passage/book. Understanding that James (a Jew) is writing to the 12 tribes (Jews) who have been saved (trust in Christ) during a time of tribulation, on the run from Rome, about proving their faith by their works; this clearly let's us know that prophetically this is about the tribulation period and how salvation willl work during this time. They will have anchor passages in Hebrews, Matthew, and Revelation (Rev. 12:17) and will understand that this is about them and about their salvation in light of those other books that are directly talking about/to them.
   The book of James only references Christ 2x (1:1; 2:1), references the OT 57x, mirrors the language of Christ's sermon on the mount, talks about wind tossed waves (1:6), withering grass and flowers under a burning sun (1:10-11), fire of iniquity (3:6), fountains of bitter and sweet water (3:11), fig trees and olive trees (3:12), sowing and harvesting of peace (3:18), early and latter rain before the husbandman returns (5:7), Job is mentioned (5:11, only mention in NT, picture of tribulation), Elijah is mentioned shutting up the heavens (5:17) just like he will during the tribulation, and the name James is the Greek form of the Hebrew name JACOB (all about trouble and tribulation with Jacob)

6. What can you apply **devotionally** from this?

   Devotionally, we understand that even though our salvation is NOT tied to our works as the NT Pauline letters make abundantly clear once God revealed these truths; we OUGHT to have works with our faith and we were made for good works! (Eph. 2:8-10) We LOVE the first verses of this scripture (vs 8-9) but many don't focus on vs 10 because it means we have to live out what we say we believe. You will be more secure in your salvation if you live out your faith, you DOUBT because you are DEAD and fruitless and you don't even see the evidence in your own life. Have faith that WORKS!

7. What other **cross references** apply to this passage?

   Eph. 2:8-10; Romans 3:20,28; 4:2; 10:9-10,13; 2 Tim. 1:9; Titus 3:5; Gal. 2:16; John 3:16; Rom. 5:1,9; 8:3; Job; 1 Kings 17:1; Rev. 11:6; Rev. 12:17; Eph. 2:16; 3:1-7; Acts 11:26; 12: 2; 15; Gal. 2:11-16; 2 Pet. 3:15-16; Acts 10; Philip 2:12; Col. 4:3; Gal. 2:1-11

8. What **word**/phrase studies did you do in this passage?

   faith, work, justify, Abraham, made perfect, etc...

9. What **consistent** patterns is God using in this passage to help you understand it/make connections?

   True, genuine, real faith will be accompanied by WORKS; if not, it is DEAD (false belief) or at best it is fruitless and you will doubt your whole life. Faith and works go together, even if we don't like it. This does not contradict Paul and his writings about salvation.

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PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY 2.0- SONG OF SOLOMON 2:7-13

1. **Who** is writing/Who are they writing to/**When** are they writing?

   Solomon is writing to his Shulamite bride around the year 1014 AD

2. What is the **context** of this verse/passage/book?

   Solomon is writing to his Shulamite bride who he loves deeply. When you look in the Bible you find out he cared about this bride deeply and it seems she is the same woman in the story in 1 Kings 1-3, the "Shunamite" who took care of David, who his brother tries to make him jealous over which Solomon kills him for. To give context, this is a love letter between Solomon and this special bride of his. She is a Gentile, she was 1 of 700 wives and 300 concubines of his, and yet THIS IS HIS SONG OF SONGS, TO HIS BRIDE OF BRIDES. There is no song of the 1,005 songs he wrote (1 Kings 4:32) which was like this song. This was different. It shows his true love for this special woman and her love for him in a personal and intimate way. It is located within the Poetical books and contains a lot of OBVIOUS metaphors which we take as metaphorical because of the fact it is clearly metaphorical.

3. What is happening **historically?**

   The love shown between a Shulamite shepherdess by King Solomon and the joys and heartaches of wedded love. He writes this song about their relationship and words exchanged, feelings had, and encounters between them.

4. What is the **doctrinal** (in context biblical truth) teaching here?

   This shows the true love that a husband and wife ought to have for one another in marriage. They should desire to be together and to spend time together and long for each other like this couple. This particular passage shows us the importance of showing love to each other through quality time and words of affirmation (they talk about longing to be together and he writes in in a love letter to her)

5. Is there any **prophetic** teaching here?

   This book/passage shows the intimate relationship between Jesus Christ and his (primarily) Gentile bride, the church (also each of us as individual believers). This passage particularly talks about the rapture call of Christ to his church and the metaphors surrounding it give us details concerning the events around the rapture.
   Fig Tree fruit- Israel is growing, fruitful, a nation again and growing as a NATION
   Tender Grapes- Directly connected with the fig tree and rapture call (all in vs. 13) we see the "grapes are tender" which always symbolizes and is connected with bloodshed, war, and blood in general in the Bible. Bloodshed surrounding Israel as a nation is a sign of this rapture call. It also happens in the spring according to vss. 11-12

6. What can you apply **devotionally** from this?

   I should long daily to spend time with God personally. While this book deals with Christ and his bride, it is also specific to individual believers relationship with him because of the 1 on 1 nature of this love letter. This passage teaches that I should long DAILY to spend time with him, be near him, close to him, learn about him, etc... Also that I should long for and desire his return at the rapture.

7. What other **cross references** apply to this passage?

   1 Kings 1:3, 15; 2:17, 21, 22; 4:32; Rev. 4:1; 1 Thess. 4:16; Eph. 5:22-33; 2 Cor. 11:2; Rev. 19:7-8; Matt. 24:9; Luke 21:17; Pro. 27:18; Gen. 7:11; 8:2; Isa. 24:18; 1 Kings 4:25; Prov. 27:18; Hos. 9:10; Joel 1:1-7; Micah 4:1-4; Matt. 21:19-21; 24:32; Mark 11:13-21; Luke 13:1-9; Isa. 63:3; Rev. 14:14-20

8. What **word**/phrase studies did you do in this passage?

   window*, fig tree, grape*, tender grape*, arise*

9. What **consistent** patterns is God using in this passage to help you understand it/make connections?

   God uses the pattern of A KING and his GENTILE BRIDE into the NT mysteries and shows us what this book is about doctrinally.
   He also teaches us about the order of heaven with windows and doors in it to show us this is the rapture call from heaven.
   God teaches us about the fig tree as Israel and also about tender grapes as blood shed and blood in general to show us the signs surrounding the end times and rapture

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PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY 2.O- Song of Solomon 2:7-13

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2. What is the **context** of this verse/passage/book?

3. What is happening **historically?**

4. What is the **doctrinal** (in context biblical truth) teaching here?

5. Is there any **prophetic** teaching here?

6. What can you apply **devotionally** from this?

7. What other **cross references** apply to this passage?

8. What **word**/phrase studies did you do in this passage?

9. What **consistent** patterns is God using in this passage to help you understand it/make connections?

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PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

1) James Chapter 2, Verse 17
   - **a)** Context-
     - i) Who is writing?
       - (1) What do you know about James? Anything pertaining to who he was and who he was called to reach?
       - (2) Hint: Paul was the apostle to the Gentiles and James, Peter, and John were to the Jews (Gal. 2:8-9)
       - (3) Talk about how after Hebrews we have Hebrews, James, and John and Peter that write the General Epistles for this reason
     - ii) Who are they writing to?
     - iii) When are they writing? (dispensation)
     - iv) What is going on in the previous/following chapters?
     - v) What is the tone of this book in terms of who he is writing to?
     - vi) Are there doctrinal implications of this book that effect the way it is written?
     - vii) Historical, Doctrinal, Devotional
     - viii) Mention that we have notes with this information and we will give to you if you want them
   - **b)** READ WHOLE PASSAGE (James 2:14-26)
   - **c)** Some people read this passage and use it to teach that you must live a good life and add "works" to your faith or else you are not saved or can lose your salvation
   - **d)** First thing you want to consider with one like this is what exactly is this saying
     - i) Does it say "without works you are not saved"?
     - ii) Or Does it say "without works you can lose your salvation"?
       - (1) The bottom line is that this passage is very unclear in terms of what it is talking about.
       - (2) There are multiple kinds of faith talked about in the Bible, what kind of faith is being talked about here?
     - iii) Do we know exactly what this means when it says your faith is dead?
       - (1) Does that mean non existent?
       - (2) Does it mean unfruitful?
     - iv) KEY: We already established that although this book is written to believers, it was written to Jewish believers directly after the death and resurrection of Christ, by a guy who was sent as an apostle to the Jews, was a Jew himself, and grew up Jewish. It has a tribulation context and is not written by the Apostle to the Gentiles and the head figure of NT doctrine (Who am I talking about?) PAUL
     - v) With all of this in mind, we want to go to clear passages of scripture that we have no doubt about what they are saying FIRST, and then use those to define this
       - (1) What are some clear passages of scripture about how to be saved?
       - (2) John 3:16; Romans 10:9-10, 13; 3:28; Ephesians 2:8-9; Galatians 2:16; Rom. 4:1-2 along with Romans 5:1

e) Now that we have established the CLEAR biblical teaching on this subject, we can now define what James is saying, within the context which he said it, and understand exactly what it means for us.

i) We now know that this is not saying that faith without works is not existent. That is to say that we know it is not saying that without works you are not saved or you are not in the faith.

ii) What is the teaching here for us then?

f) Now that we have discovered exactly what this means for us, the next natural question might be why did God say it this way?

i) Consider the context of what we are reading and the other areas of time that we said it applies to

ii) Talk about dual application

iii) Talk about the dispensations chart on the board

g) Review the rules of bible study we used

i) Context

ii) Clarity

iii) People Group

iv) Time Period

v) Application

vi) Every Word/Event

vii) Comparing Scripture

viii) Consistency (law of first mention)

ix) Literal

x) Confirmation

h) Review running list of cross references we used

i) Any questions?

PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

1) Ephesians Chapter 1, Verses 3-6
   - **a)** Context-
     - i) Who is writing?
     - ii) Who are they writing to?
     - iii) When are they writing? (dispensation)
     - iv) What is going on in the previous/following chapters?
     - v) Historical, Doctrinal, Devotional
     - vi) Mention that we have notes with this information and we will give to you if you want them
   - **b)** READ WHOLE PASSAGE (Eph. 1:3-6)
   - **c)** Some people read this passage and use it to teach that God predestinates/chooses those who will/won't be saved
     - i) When you run into issues doctrinally, you find out that a lot of the time, they are defining words/terms incorrectly based on how they are privately interpreting the bible and not based on how the bible uses terms
   - **d)** Defining terms/phrases (use example of "world" earth, and "world" in John 3:16)
   - **e)** What are some key words/phrases you think we should define?
     - i) Holy
       - (1) There are over 600 references to holy, so does anyone know of any key verses pertaining to us living holy lives that can help trim that list down?
       - (2) Lev. 20:7; 1 Pet. 1:15-16
     - ii) Without blame
       - (1) What is another word for without blame? Blameless
       - (2) Phil. 2:15; 1 Thess. 5:23
         - (a) What are some words that keep showing up in these verses? (sanctified, sanctification) These words are always about becoming holy, sanctified, more like Christ, more like God, etc…. not about being saved!
         - (b) Is there any mention of salvation anywhere in these verses? Saved, justified, salvation, etc..? any?
     - iii) Predestinated (predestin*)
       - (1) Rom. 8:29 (conformed)
       - (2) Rom. 12:1-2 (living more for God, more sacrificial, not being in the world, being sanctified, being holy, set apart, etc…)
   - **f)** **Review the rules of bible study we used**
     - i) Context
     - ii) People Group
     - iii) Time Period
     - iv) Application
     - v) Every Word/Event
     - vi) Comparing Scripture
     - vii) Consistency (law of first mention)
     - viii) Literal
     - ix) Confirmation
   - **g)** **Review running list of cross references we used**
   - **h)** **Any questions?**

PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

1) 1 John Chapter 5, Verse 7
   - **a)** Context-
     - i) Who is writing?
       - (1) What do you know about John? Anything pertaining to who he was and who he was called to reach?
       - (2) Hint: Paul was the apostle to the Gentiles and James, Peter, and John were to the Jews (Gal. 2:8-9)
       - (3) Talk about how after Hebrews we have James, and John, and Peter that write the General Epistles for this reason
     - ii) Who are they writing to?
     - iii) When are they writing? (dispensation)
     - iv) What is going on in the previous/following chapters?
     - v) What is the tone of this book in terms of who he is writing to?
     - vi) Are there doctrinal implications of this book that effect the way it is written?
     - vii) Historical, Doctrinal, Devotional
     - viii) Mention that we have notes with this information and we will give to you if you want them
   - **b) READ WHOLE PASSAGE (1 John 5:1-12)**
   - **c)** Defining Terms:
     - i) Most of this passage is self explanatory, however in the context of what John is trying to convey, what key word do we maybe need to define here? (WORD)
       - (1) John 1:1-14; Hebrews 4:12-14; Rev. 19:13
   - **d) 2 KEY DOCTRINES FOUND IN THIS VERSE/PASSAGE**
   - **e)** What are 2 key doctrines that we find in this verse/passage?
     - i) These verses are clearly teaching that Jesus Christ is God and that he is a part of this Godhead (3 parts of God)
     - ii) Lets do some bible cross referencing and study and see whether these things are so; give at least 3 references to prove each point
       - (1) God is a 3 part being made up of the Father, Jesus Christ, and the Holy Ghost (Gen 1:16; 11:7; Matt. 3:16-17; 2 Cor. 13:14)
       - (2) Jesus Christ is fully God/ equal with God (Jn. 10:30; Col. 2:9; John 1:1-14; 1 Tim. 3:16; Jn. 14:9-10; 17:21)
   - **f) 2 BONUS QUESTIONS WE CAN CONSIDER**
     - i) Are they all equally God?
       - (1) Yes, refer to verses about the trinity
     - ii) Are they all equal in authority?

(1) No they aren't, the Bible does teach us a hierarchy of authority to the Godhead much like there is even within our own person

(a) 1 Cor. 3:23; 11:3; 15:28

g) Review the rules of bible study we used

i) Context

ii) Clarity

iii) People Group

iv) Time Period

v) Application

vi) Every Word/Event

vii) Comparing Scripture

viii) Consistency (law of first mention)

ix) Literal

x) Confirmation

h) Review running list of cross references we used

i) Any questions?

PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

1) The Acts of the Apostles Chapter 2, Verse 38

a) Today we will be getting into groups and working this passage out all on our own with the guidance of your other leaders. We will then get back together and share what we have found.

b) KEY THINGS TO BE READY TO SHARE

i) Context- Give us all that you found that pertains to context

ii) What does the verse actually mean AND what does it NOT mean?

(1) Give references

iii) What rules of bible study did you use?

c) KEY THINGS TO CONSIDER/HINTS

i) **CONTEXT is very important here:**

(a) Remember the bleeding in and out of dispensations (talk about transitional books)

(b) The 2 preceding verses in this passage will help a lot

ii) **THE CLARITY FACTOR AND COMPARING SCRIPTURE FACTOR are very important here**

(a) What are these 2 rules?

iii) **I would look at the phrase "remission* sin*" in your BLB app**

(a) Check where it is written that applies directly to us (Acts 8-Philemon)

d) Review the rules of bible study we used

i) Context
ii) Clarity
iii) People Group
iv) Time Period
v) Application
vi) Every Word/Event
vii) Comparing Scripture
viii) Consistency (law of first mention)
ix) Literal
x) Confirmation

e) Review running list of cross references we used

f) Any questions?

PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

1 JOHN CHAPTER 5, VERSE 7

PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

THE ACTS OF THE APOSTLES CHAPTER 2, VERSE 38

PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

JAMES CHAPTER 2, VERSE 17

Here are a few indisputable key facts when considering who the beasts are in Revelation chapter four:

- You will never be able to find a mention of Cherub or Cherubim with any description of them that matches up with the description of the four beasts in Revelation chapter four.
- In order to try to make the four beasts in Revelation chapter four Cherubim you will have to assume that either John or Ezekiel saw and then wrote their description incorrectly under the inspiration of the Holy Ghost. Some people have a problem with this statement but it is simply true. You cannot approach the Revelation given to John or the vision given to Ezekiel assuming that every thing they wrote was correct as pertaining to what is actually in heaven if you think that both are Cherubim. There is an absolute truth of what is in heaven. That is if you were to ask God to give you a description of Cherubim or Seraphim or the four beasts, there is the absolute truth of what they actually look like in reality. You cannot assume that Ezekiel and John got that absolute truth correct and say that the Cherubim are the four beasts in Revelation chapter four.
- You CAN 100% assume that every detail Ezekiel, Isaiah, and John wrote in all of their Revelations were 100% correct under the inspiration of the Holy Ghost and preserved for us correctly today, when you believe that the beasts in Revelation chapter four are Seraphim.
- You cannot find any discrepancies between the description of the Seraphim in Isaiah chapter 6 and the four beasts in Revelation chapter four.
- To not believe that the beasts in Revelation chapter four are Cherubim creates no issues pertaining to any description given of Cherubim in the entire Bible. That includes their description, duties, position in relation to the throne, etcetera…
- To explain away the differences between Cherubim and the four beasts in Revelation chapter 4, you will have to go to other more obscure passages with vague details. You will have to ignore the clear detailed visions of Ezekiel specifically of what the throne and its surroundings look like and go to passages that have vague descriptions of “God dwelling between Cherubim” or the descriptions of the ark of the covenant. This is against the keys of Bible study.

SERAPHIM	CHERIBUM	REV. 4 BEASTS
WINGS- 6 (Isa. 6:2)	WINGS- 4 (Eze. 1:6,11; 10:21-22)	WINGS-6 (Rev. 4:8)
FACES- 1 (Isa. 6:2 "face")	FACES- 4 EACH (Eze. 1:6-11; 10:14, 21)	FACES- 1 (Rev. 4:7)
WHAT THEY SAY- "HOLY, HOLY, HOLY" (Isa. 6:3)	WHAT THEY SAY- "...."	WHAT THEY SAY- "HOLY, HOLY, HOLY" (Rev. 4:8)
WHEELS- 0	WHEELS- 4 (Eze.1:15-21; 10:6, 9-13)	WHEELS- 0
WHERE THEY ARE- above the temple, which is also where the throne is (Isa. 6:1-2) "his train filled the temple. Above it stood the seraphims:"	WHERE THEY ARE- under the firmament which is under the throne (Eze. 1:22-26; 10:1)	WHERE THEY ARE- in the midst of and round about the throne (Rev. 4:6)
Lion, Calf, Man, Eagle mentioned: NO	Lion, Calf, Man, Eagle mentioned: YES (Eze. 1:10; 10:14)	Lion, Calf, Man, Eagle mentioned: YES (Rev. 4:7)

MATCH REV. 4 BEASTS	GREEN
DON'T MATCH REV. 4 BEASTS	RED

Practical Bible Study

1) Revelation Chapter 4
   - **a)** Context-
     - i) Who is writing?
     - ii) Who are they writing to?
     - iii) When are they writing? (dispensation)
     - iv) What is going on in the previous/following chapters?
     - v) Historical, Doctrinal, Devotional
     - vi) Example of Acts 2
     - vii) Mention that we have notes with this information and we will give to you if you want them
       - (1) Questions: What rules of Bible study have we used so far?
   - **b)** READ WHOLE PASSAGE (chapter 4)
   - **c)** Examine vs. 1-3
     - i) What does this sound like? Is this familiar to anyone? (rapture, end of the church age, immediately in the spirit and in heaven)
     - ii) We want to examine this in the bible and see where else it shows up
       - (1) Key words; voice trump* (search in blb)
       - (2) Tsk those verses and build cross references
       - (3) Any other bible examples of this rapture (Enoch, Noah, Lot)
   - **d)** Examine vs. 4
     - i) Who does this sound like? White raiment and crowns on their heads?
       - (1) Vs 10 later in the chapter
       - (2) Tsk the verse (rev. 20:4)
       - (3) Search (judgment was given) (these elders on thrones are saints)
       - (4) Does the bible talk anywhere else about saints (believers) being judges? (maybe use tsk on Daniel 7:22)
       - (5) Back to verse 4- Use concordance to show what “seats” these are (thronos)
         - (a) NOBODY TRULY KNOWS exactly who these guys are, some think they represent all saints in heaven (12 disciples and 12 tribes; 2 foundations) BUT should we take this literally? (ask to look at rules)
         - (b) We can and so we probably should, we don’t know who these 24 are but they are saints and we know that we are seated and look just like them somewhere in heaven at this point, we just aren’t sure where. Or maybe God is trying to tell us these are us (instead of saying “I saw 1,250,546,987 elders around the throne”)
   - **e)** Examine vs. 5-11
     - i) Example of self defining and why we read the whole passage first
       - (1) “and there were seven lamps of fire burning before the throne, which are the seven Spirits of God.”
     - ii) Sea of glass
       - (1) TSK- Rev. 15:2
       - (2) Where is this sea located? Where is John when he sees it? (heaven, specifically directly below Gods throne)
       - (3) Where else can we find this mass of water? Search (sea heaven)
         - (a) Rev. 21:1
       - (4) Anywhere else where we can find how this water got there?
         - (a) Gen. 1:6-8
       - (5) Why is it there? (It separates God from his sinful and judged creation, and when God has no more need of it he gets rid of it in Revelation 21 (context of these verses is God dwelling with man, no more separation)
     - iii) Four Beasts
       - (1) TSK verse 8- (Isa. 6:1-3; Eze. 1:4-10; Eze. 10:14-22)
       - (2) Search Cherub* in blb

(a) Talk about law of first mention
(b) Genesis (they guard the garden)
(c) Exodus (they cover/guard the ark of the covenant)

(3) The four beasts are Seraphim (Isaiah and John are the only to mention them), which are special creatures which are given extra wings to guard the throne of God in heaven. They praise God also in heaven, just as Isaiah and John both saw

(4) Their position in relationship to the throne is closer to that of Rev. 4; Ezekiel has them below where the throne is, below the firmament

(5) Cherub are NEVER found named in the Bible with any description that matches closely to that of the Rev. 4 beasts

(6) IF the cherubim match anything described in Rev. 4, by cross referencing, we can figure out that it would be the 7 spirits
(a) They are described as burning lamps (Rev. 4:5; Ez. 1:13)
(b) They are described as spirits (Rev. 4:5; Ez. 1:20-21; 10:17)
(c) They are around/before the throne (Rev. 4:5; Ez. 1:5)

(7) Review page attached about this subject

f) Review the rules of bible study we used

i) Context
ii) People Group
iii) Time Period
iv) Application
v) Every Word/Event
vi) Comparing Scripture
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Practical Bible Study

Revelation chapter 4

PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

EPHESIANS CHAPTER 1, VERSES 3-6

S03 / TEACHING SERIES

Life of a Disciple

Eight weeks addressing spiritual growth, warfare, intimacy, suffering, communion, and warnings in the life of a disciple.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Teaching and discipleship-resource preparation.

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Luke Johnston's selected teaching, writing or development sample; original bylines and citations retained.

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Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

The Life of a Disciple

1) Throughout this series we will dive into exactly what the life of someone who is a disciple of Jesus Christ looks like. We will examine the characteristics of this life, what this life entails, the hardships of this life, and even look at some examples of disciples in the Bible and examine their lives. Today we will see that disciples are heavily involved in the spiritual warfare going on every day. They are not just passively involved, but are consciously and **purposefully** involved because they are following Jesus Christ and desire to please God.

2) DISCIPLES ARE INVOLVED IN A SPIRITUAL WAR

i) The moment you receive Jesus Christ as your Lord and Savior, you are entered into an eternal battle between God and the Devil for souls and an eternal throne. This warfare is serious and immediately gives you enemies who are trying to take you out

ii) Everyone from the moment of their birth is involved in some way in the war, whether they want to be or not. But disciples who follow God will be front line soldiers in this war and they are actively involved in the war

b) The War

i) The war is being fought between the two ultimate forces in this universe: God and the Devil
(1) There are 2 sides in this war and you are on one or the other

ii) The war is being fought for the throne of God (Isa. 14:12-13; Rev. 12:7-9)

iii) The war is being fought for the souls of men (The life of Job; 2 Pet. 3:9; 1 Pet. 5:8)
(a) Kingdom of God and Kingdom of Heaven; the 2 thrones

c) Our Enemies

i) The war is being fought by 3 enemies
(1) The Devil (1 Pet. 5:8; Job 41:22)
(2) The World (1 Jn. 2:15-17; Rom. 12:2; James 4:4; 2 Tim. 2:2-4)
(3) The Flesh (Gal. 5:17; 1 Pet. 2:11; Rom. 7:18-25)

d) Our Weapons/Armor (1 Cor. 10:3-6; Eph. 6:10-18)

i) Truth (vs. 14)

ii) Righteousness (vs. 14)

iii) Preparation of the gospel of peace (vs. 15)

iv) Faith (vs. 16)

v) Salvation (vs. 17)

vi) Word of God (vs. 17)

vii) Prayer (vs. 18)

e) Our Goal in the War

i) Assist God in his pursuit for the throne

(1) One day we will be a part of the takeover of this world with Jesus Christ when he gains the **physical** throne of this world (Rev. 19:11-15; Jude 1:14-15)

(2) Today we are a part of the pursuit of God for the **spiritual** throne of each and every soul in this world. We help God in the war to reign in the lives of individuals through sharing the gospel and discipling others to do the same (Luke 17:20-21; 1 Cor. 6:19-20)

3) We all are in this war from the moment we are born, whether we desire to be or not. The difference in a Christian and a disciple is that a disciple is completely and totally aware of the war, the enemy, the tactics, the weapons, and fully given to the mission of the war. They are seeking each and everyday to be good soldiers of Jesus Christ in order to bring glory to God and win souls in this spiritual war between God and the Devil. We must be prepared to **fight** each and every day if we are going to be true disciples of Jesus Christ.

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The Life of a Disciple

1) A disciple of Jesus Christ will always be involved in a pattern of growth. There are levels of maturity that we see in the Bible and we must constantly be evaluating where we are at and where it is that we want to be. If we are not growing then we are **regressing**, there is no staying the same. Today we will examine these levels of growth/maturity.

2) DISCIPLES ARE ALWAYS IN A PATTERN OF GROWTH

a) Babe in Christ

i) Doesn't have spiritual understanding, still thinks/lives carnally (1 Cor. 3:1)

(1) We need to be understanding of new Christians. They don't know a lot, they will still think and live carnally, they need patience and help; just like a newborn baby. A lot of patience and help and not high expectations

ii) Has a great hunger for the Word of God. They desire to learn and grow (1 Pet. 2:2)

(1) What they lack in understanding and maturity, they make up for in their hunger to learn and grow! They will soak up everything that they are taught, so we must be careful what we feed them/teach them

iii) Unskillful in understanding/explaining the Word of God. They need someone to help feed them and help them grow (Heb. 5:13)

(1) If they try to bite off more than they can chew from the Bible, it can be deadly for them. They need to stick to milk and foundational stuff and not be given too much until they are ready. They need discipled and someone to help them along until they are ready to feed themselves

b) Children

i) Have a hard time with selflessness/charity (1 Cor. 13:11; 1 Jn. 3:18)

(1) Children in Christ will have a hard time living charitably. They are still very dependent on others helping them along and are not ready to bear the burdens of others yet

ii) Know they are saved and know who their Father is (1 Jn. 2:12-13)

(1) They are still young in their faith and so they don't struggle with assurance of salvation. They know they are saved and they know they are in the family of God

iii) Still struggle with sin (1 Jn. 2:1; 2 Tim. 2:22; 1 Jn. 5:21)

(1) This is a common struggle for young Christians. Sin will keep you from being used by God and so the Devil really uses your youthfulness and immaturity to keep you in small sins that he knows will grow into larger ones. Especially beware of the sin of idolatry. Starting to become complacent and putting other things before God in your life.

c) Young Men/Women

i) Young men tend to be rash and quick to act. They know the Word of God well and they are strong in their faith. However, this makes them susceptible to attacks from the devil, false doctrines, and starting down the wrong path. They have overcome the childish sin in their lives (Titus 2:6-8; 1 Jn. 2:13-14)

ii) Young women are maturing to a point where they are becoming ready enough to be a godly helpmeet, mother, and home keeper. They are ready to bear the burdens of these responsibilities, unlike children. They are warned to not do anything that will shame God/her family. The devil turns the attack up on young women at this maturity level. Be ready (1 Tim. 5:14-15; Titus 2:4-5)

d) Fathers/Mothers

i) Fathers KNOW God. They are matured to a point where they don't doubt who God is, his existence, or what he is doing. They have proved him over and over (1 Jn. 2:13-14)

ii) They are patient, charitable, sound, and sober minded. They are under control and fully balanced in their Christian life. This takes a long time to learn and years of faithfulness and walking with God (Titus 2:2)

iii) Because of their spiritual maturity they are able to reproduce spiritually and make disciples. They are equipped to help others along

iv) Mothers are also balanced in their Christian lives. They are blameless in Christian conversation. They live lives that are discreet and not seeking glory for what they do. This will have a great reward in heaven (Luke 14:11). They are tasked with reproducing spiritually as well through teaching the younger women (Titus 2:3-5)

3) As a disciple of Jesus Christ we must always be growing. These maturity levels we see in the Bible are a good way for us to measure where we are at and if we are growing. Each of us needs to evaluate where we are at on this spectrum and where we want to be. We need to take the necessary steps to get to where we want to be and pick people who are further along to follow, but we must always keep **growing**!

The Life of a Disciple

1) A disciple of Jesus Christ will always be involved in a pattern of growth. There are levels of maturity that we see in the Bible and we must constantly be evaluating where we are at and where it is that we want to be. If we are not growing then we are _____, there is no staying the same. Today we will examine these levels of growth/maturity.

2) DISCIPLES ARE ALWAYS IN A PATTERN OF _____

a) Babe in Christ

i) Doesn't have spiritual understanding, still thinks/lives carnally (1 Cor. 3:1)

ii) Has a great hunger for the Word of God. They desire to learn and grow (1 Pet. 2:2)

iii) Unskillful in understanding/explaining the Word of God. They need someone to help feed them and help them grow (Heb. 5:13)

b) Children

i) Have a hard time with selflessness/charity (1 Cor. 13:11; 1 Jn. 3:18)

ii) Know they are saved and know who their Father is (1 Jn. 2:12-13)

iii) Still struggle with sin (1 Jn. 2:1; 2 Tim. 2:22; 1 Jn. 5:21)

c) Young Men/Women

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The Life of a Disciple

1) Today we will examine the different types of disciples we see in the Bible. There are many disciples but they all choose how close they will be to God and they are all at different levels of intimacy with God. We would all say we want to be close to God, but the truth is that not all of us are willing to do what it takes to make that happen. After today, it will be clear what it takes to be a disciple who is not just following Jesus, but **closer** to Jesus than anyone else.

2) **THERE ARE DIFFERENT LEVELS OF CLOSENESS TO GOD AMONG DISCIPLES**

   a) **The Multitudes**

      i) They will be fed the word of God (John 6:26)

      ii) They will experience miracles (Matt. 12:15)

      iii) They will walk away when things are tough (John 6:66; Jesus going to the cross)

      iv) They only follow for themselves and are not willing to sacrifice

         (1) When things are hard at all they are gone. They won't follow Jesus to his/their death

         (2) When Jesus says something they don't like, they are gone

         (3) When he calls them out for only living selfishly and not actually to follow him, they are gone

   b) **The Seventy**

      i) They will be involved in the work of the Lord. They will share his message and labor for him (Luke 10:1)

      ii) They will do miracles, not just experience them (Luke 10:17)

         (1) Being saved, leading someone to the Lord, discipling someone to walk closer with God, being conformed to the image of Jesus Christ through the reading of the word of God and prayer, these are all miracles!! Have you experienced miracles in your life?

      iii) While they truly desired to serve the Lord, they are not willing to do it once it costs them too much

         (1) As Jesus ministry progressed toward the cross, pressure and persecution built more and more. Things got harder and as we will see, the disciples that follow Jesus dwindle

         (2) We aren't told for certain what happens to these seventy (12 remained) but some potential things could be:

            (a) They feared what would happen to their family

            (b) They didn't like the ridicule they received from those they shared Jesus message with

            (c) They feared what would happen to their business (nobody would want to do business with some radicals following a radical teacher who was hated)

            (d) They feared that they may lose their lives

            (e) They realized they didn't have time to follow him EVERYWHERE he went because they had other things they were involved in. They had friends, activities, family, jobs, all good stuff that there was nothing wrong with. They weren't wiling to give it up.

            (f) They weren't willing to obey the "radical" things he was asking them to do (leave father and mother, leave family, not go back to bury your parents, forgive others, be in ministry with tax collectors and sinners, share his message that the kingdom was coming, etc…)

            (g) They weren't willing to let go of sin in their lives and simply felt unworthy to follow Jesus any further or share his message anymore

               (i) If you obey the Bible exactly as it says and exactly what is written to you today, YOU WILL BE CONSIDERED RADICAL, EVEN BY THOSE CLOSEST TO YOU

   c) **The Twelve**

      i) They are given power to preach and do miracles on Jesus behalf (Luke 9:1-2)

      ii) They are given special authority and power in eternity future for their service to God in this life (Matt. 19:28)

(1) You have this same ability to have this in eternity, but only if you are walking close to God like this. If you aren't a part of the "12" you won't be trusted with heavenly responsibility because he couldn't trust you with earthly responsibility

iii) They are shown some special things by God that the multitudes and the seventy will never be shown. God reveals special truths to them (Matt. 13:11)

iv) When things get tough they trust in God and pray, they don't run (Acts 1:13-14)

v) They do great things that will last for eternity for the Lord and will impact billions (Matthew, John, James, 1 & 2 Peter, 1 & 2 & 3 John, Jude, Revelation)

(1) These books were written by some of these 12 disciples and they will last for eternity and they have helped and impacted billions of people

vi) A small part of these 12 can be imposters and traitors (Matt. 26:47; Mark 14:10)

(1) It can be very easy to fake all of these things, but only for a season. Some that appear to be a part of this twelve will experience miracles, do miracles, be shown special revelation by God, etc… and yet they were faking it all along and they betray him

(a) At this level of discipleship you are following God in true charitable love for him. You cannot have this type of intimate relationship to God when you are just obeying on duty alone. Dutiful obedience is fine, but will only take you so far.

d) The Three

i) They will see the true full power and glory of Jesus (Matt. 17:1-9)

(1) There are many disciples who will serve and follow Jesus as far as he will take them but these 3 desired to KNOW HIM above all else. If you desire to know God like this, you will spend more time in his word and more time in prayer with him than anyone else. You only get to know Jesus the living Word this well through the written word. These disciples will see his glory and power in ways that so few will in their lives.

ii) Jesus depends on them and desires to have them near to him (Matt. 26:36-38)

(1) Would it hurt God's heart if you walked away? Do you have such a deep relationship with him that he desires for you to be the one near to him when things are hard? When the world is rejecting him, walking away from God, refusing to believe in him and thousands are heading to hell each day, does he look forward to his time with you, his faithful disciple he can count on

iii) They will see amazing miracles that even the other 12 will never see (Luke 8:49-56)

e) The One

i) They are so close to Jesus they KNOW they would never betray him; they have no doubt (John 13:23-25; Matt. 26:22)

ii) They will never walk away from Jesus. At risk of their life they will be with him all the way to the end, even when everyone else is gone (John 19:26)

(1) At this point, all others are gone. Even Peter, one of the 3, at this point had denied Jesus for fear of his own life. But John goes with him all the way to the cross

iii) God will show them unimaginable, amazing things that others will never understand. He reveals all truth to them and holds nothing back (Rev. 1:9-11; 10:4)

3) As we have seen today, there are many different levels to how closely we can walk with God. All of these people we have examined today were true disciples of Jesus, but not all disciples are the same. We can be as close to God as we desire to be, all we must do is make the choices that will make that possible. These are not easy choices but are well worth the amazing life that awaits when you are **the one** disciple among many disciples of Jesus Christ (*James 4:8- Draw nigh to God, and he will draw nigh to you..."*

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The Life of a Disciple

1) Today we will examine the part of the life of a disciple that nobody truly wants to experience, but we all must experience. If we are following Jesus as true disciples, we absolutely will and must **suffer**. This is a great way of knowing just how much of a disciple we are. The closer we are to Jesus, the more we will suffer.

2) THE SUFFERING OF A DISCIPLE

a) **DISCIPLES WILL SUFFER:**

i) Persecution- *2 Timothy 3:12- Yea, and all that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution.*

(1) (Matt. 10:22; Jn. 15:19; 16:33; 1 Thess. 3:2-4; 1 Pet. 4:12-13)

(a) This is just in general, we will all suffer troubles, battles, temptations, etc… this is a part of the life of a disciple

ii) Physical danger/harm (2 Cor. 11:23-27; Acts 7:59; 14:19; Jesus death and suffering; deaths of the disciples)

(1) **Bartholomew** was beaten with rods; and after having been thus scourged, to be beheaded.

(2) **James son of Alphaeus**, according to Fox's' Book of Martyrs, was beaten, stoned and clubbed to death.

(3) **Andrew** might have been martyred in Achaia or Patrae, both of which are places in the western part of Greece. According to the Catholic Encyclopedia, "It is generally agreed that he was crucified by order of the Roman Governor, Aegeas or Aegeates, at Patrae in Achaia, and that he was bound, not nailed, to the cross, in order to prolong his sufferings. The cross on which he suffered is commonly held to have been the decussate cross, now known as St. Andrew's, though the evidence for this view seems to be no older than the fourteenth century. His martyrdom took place during the reign of Nero

(4) **Peter** was crucified upside down in Rome during the 60s

(5) **John** was the last to be killed. It is said that he was boiled in oil but did not die, so they exiled him to the isle of Patmos where he was to die of natural causes. This is where he wrote Revelation and shortly thereafter died.

(6) **Thomas** was killed with a spear, according to Foxs' Book of Martyrs: "Called Didymus, preached the Gospel in Parthia and India, where exciting the rage of the pagan priests, he was martyred by being thrust through with a spear."

(7) The martyrdom of **James son of Zebedee** is recorded in the New Testament of the Bible, in Acts 12:1-2. He was executed, with a sword, by order of King Herod Agrippa I in the year 44 AD:

(8) **Matthew** was killed with a spear, according to Foxs' Book of Martyrs: "The scene of his labors was Parthia, and Ethiopia, in which latter country he suffered martyrdom, being slain with a halberd in the city of Nadabah, A.D. 60."

(9) **Jude** was crucified, according to Foxs' Book of Martyrs: "The brother of James, was commonly called Thaddeus. He was crucified at Edessa, A.D. 72."

(10) **Philip** was crucified, according to Foxs' Book of Martyrs: "He labored diligently in Upper Asia, and suffered martyrdom at Heliopolis, in Phrygia. He was scourged, thrown into prison, and afterwards crucified, A.D. 54.

(11) **Simon** was crucified, according to Foxs' Book of Martyrs: "Surnamed Zelotes, preached the Gospel in Mauritania, Africa, and even in Britain, in which latter country he was crucified, A.D. 74.

iii) Evil speaking (1 Pet. 2:12; 3:16; Matt. 5:11; Acts 7:54)

(1) People will speak evil of you and will gnash on your with their teeth when you are a disciple. This is the lost world, but quite honestly is even MORE THE CHRISTIAN WORLD. The devil will use them to hurt you the most. Those closest to you.

iv) The burdens of other believers (Gal. 6:2; Rom. 15:1; Eph. 4:1-3; 2 Cor. 11:28; 12:15)

(1) Paul puts this right up there with the physical harm he endured. He sees it as just as much of a problem for him. When we do this correctly, we will SUFFER for LONG time.

v) Temptation- *1 Corinthians 10:13- There hath no temptation taken you but such as is common to man: but God is faithful, who will not suffer you to be tempted above that ye are able; but will with the temptation also make a way to escape, that ye may be able to bear it.*

(a) (1 Pet. 1:6-7; James 1:12; Matt. 4:1,11)

3) As we have seen today, all disciples must suffer. While it is nothing that any of us enjoy, it shows us that we are doing something right for God. If we are not suffering, we are not **disciples**, and if we are suffering we are suffering for good reason. Ultimately we will all suffer as Christians, the question is whether we want to suffer now temporarily, or later in eternity (1 Cor. 3:15)

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The Life of a Disciple

1) Today we will be looking at a very important part of the life of a disciple. Many Christians who are truly saved, spend little to no time communing with God. We are called to a relationship/walk with God and we cannot have this if we are not **talking** with God regularly. Disciples who truly follow Jesus Christ will talk with him, know him, and walk with him. Today we will examine some practical ways to do this in an effective way.

2) DISCIPLES COMMUNE WITH GOD

a) Talking to God

(1) Always begin your time with prayer. It will help get your heart/mind ready and prepare you to hear what God has to say to you. Even if it is just a quick prayer. Whatever you have time for.

ii) Get to a private/quiet place- Mark 1:35

iii) Ask for God to show you things out of his word – Psalm 119:18

iv) Ask for God to give you wisdom from his word- James 1:5

v) Ask for God to give you your "daily bread" from his word; exactly what you need to sustain you TODAY- Job 23:12; Matt. 6:11

vi) Ask for God to search you and show you the right way- Psalm 129:23-24

b) Hearing from God

(1) The way we hear from God, is through the word of God, the Bible

ii) Be alone and in a quiet place (Psa. 46:10; 1 Kings 19:12; 1 Thess. 4:11)

iii) Seek him early (Prov. 8:17; Exo. 16:11-21; Gen. 3:8)

iv) Be willing to "do" what God says and not just "hear" what he says (James 1:22-25; Matt. 7:24; John 13:17; Rom. 2:13)

v) Study the Bible for God to show you even more than you would get from just "reading" (2 Tim. 2:15; 1 Pet. 3:15; Acts 17:11)

vi) Meditate on what you read; think on it all during the day (Psa. 1:2; 119:15,97,99; Josh. 1:8)

3) As we have seen, the Bible shows us a lot about how we can commune with God. There are countless things we see in the Bible that we can take and directly apply to our lives that will help us commune with God. This is something that is required to be a true disciple of Jesus Christ, rather than just a "Christian" who has no real **relationship** with God.

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The Life of a Disciple

1) Today we will begin our examination of the warnings that God gives us to "be not deceived" as disciples. He only uses this phrase **5** times in the Bible and so we must pay great attention to what he is warning us of. After today, we will see exactly why God draws such attention to these 2 great deceptions in his word and why he is trying to warn those who follow him to not be deceived by them.

2) BE NOT DECEIVED- Don't serve other gods

i) There are 5 times that this exact phrase, "be not deceived" shows up in your Bible. All of the verses are speaking to those who follow God as disciples. God uses this phrase sparingly in order to draw our attention to warn us! When we see it we must beware. Because of this, we will examine these warnings to disciples over the coming weeks.

b) Deut. 11:16- Take heed to yourselves, that your heart **be not deceived**, and ye turn aside, and serve other gods, and worship them;

i) This is the first commandment in the Bible (Exo. 20:3; Deut. 5:7)

ii) This is the GREAT commandment according to Jesus (Matt. 22:36-40; Deut. 6:5)

(1) Why is this the great commandment? Because like we have talked about in the past, if you love God above all else and put him first in your life, this takes care of ALL of lifes issues. You won't sin against him, you won't put other gods before him, you will spend time with him in prayer and in the Word of God, you will serve him, etc…)

iii) Young disciples are especially vulnerable to idol worship (1 John 5:21)

iv) What are examples of gods we see in our world today?

(1) Money, job, education, sports, music, theatre, celebrities, influencers, social media, phones, computers, video games, fleshly pleasures, sex, popularity, physical appearance, parents, spouse, girlfriend/boyfriend, friends, etc…

(a) A good way to know if you are treating something as a god/idol, a good way to know who your god is in your life, if you are putting other gods before the God, it to ask a few simple questions:

(i) Where Do I Spend My Time?

(ii) Where Do I Spend My Money?

(iii) Where Do I Get My Joy?

(iv) What's Always On My Mind?

v) God will tear down the idols in his temple (your life) if you will not because he is a jealous God (1 Cor. 6:19-20; 1 Samuel 5:1-5; Exo. 34:14; 20:5; Deut. 4:24; 5:9; 6:15; Josh. 24:19; Sng. 2:16; 6:3)

vi) FINAL WORD- Choose who you will serve today! (Joshua 24:14-15)

3) BE NOT DECEIVED- Beware of false Christs

a) Luke 21:8- And he said, Take heed that ye **be not deceived**: for many shall come in my name, saying, I am Christ; and the time draweth near: go ye not therefore after them.

(1) Most people do not think that this prophesy is really being fulfilled today because there aren't a bunch of people out there claiming to be the Messiah for Israel, however, as we will see today there are many false Christs that even true believers can at times follow after

b) Who Jesus Christ was and was NOT

i) He WAS God manifest in the flesh, who came to seek and save that which was lost (1 Tim. 3:16; John 1:1-3,14; Col. 2:8-9; John 3:16-18; 1 John 2:1-2; John 14:9; Luke 19:10)

ii) He was NOT just a lesser god, prophet, good man/teacher, etc..

(1) Liar, Lunatic, Lord

(2) Jehovah's Witness, Mormons,

(3) Charismatics (Faith Family and this Asbury University where so called "revival" is happening(a biblical revival looks like Acts 2, where the word of God is preached: judgment, doctrine, reproof, correction, and instruction in righteousness and thousands of people get saved and repent and start living lives for Christ, sharing the gospel and discipling. Not some emotion filled, feel good sing along with false tongues, false healings, false casting out of devils. It is all nonsense!) (show doctrine on screen and video)

(4) Campbellites ("First Christian" churches) (show on screen)

(5) Calvinists ("Reformed" Baptists, the chain of Chapel's like Green, NC, Wadsworth, Akron, etc…SHOW ON SCREEN)

(6) Jews, Muslims

(7) Catholics (Part 1, Section 2, Chapter 3, Article 10, lines 977 and 980 of the Vatican Roman Catholic Catechism "Our Lord tied the forgiveness of sins to faith and Baptism; It is through the sacrament of Penance that the baptized can be reconciled with God and with the Church") (show on screen)

iii) He WAS The Way, the Truth, and the Life

iv) He was NOT the false ways, truths, and lives that other ascribe to him

(1) FALSE WAY- Jesus Christ the social justice warrior (John 8:31-36; Acts 10:38)

(i) Jesus was THE WAY and pointed THE WAY to God. He never wasted time preaching about the injustices in government, treatment of social groups/classes. That is a false WAY.

(b) Jesus was a Jew under the rule of Rome: they were guaranteed no freedoms, forced to pay whatever taxes they were told, forced to obey whatever laws the king made, etc.. They were systemically OPPRESSED and under the fierce iron rod rule of Caesar. Yet Jesus NEVER fights for his rights, freedoms, speech, fair treatment under the law, etc… He is only concerned with the spiritual oppression of the world he created.

(2) FALSE TRUTH- Peace/Love only Jesus Christ (John 2:13-16; Mark 7:24-20; Matt. 23:13-26)

(i) Jesus was THE TRUTH and he spoke THE TRUTH that would lead people to everlasting life in him. He did not waste time lying to people to not hurt their feelings and just preach peace and love only as people died and went to hell around him. That is a false TRUTH.

(b) Matt. 23:13-36: He calls them:

(i) Hypocrites 7x

(ii) Children of Hell

(iii) Serpents

(iv) Vipers

(v) Blind Guides

(vi) White Sepulchers filled with dead men's bones

(vii) Murderers

(viii) Children of Murderers

(ix) He says "how can you escape the damnation of hell"

(x) Tells them they are full of iniquity

(xi) Tells them they stain at a gnat and swallow a camel

(c) Jesus was a preacher of TRUTH! He loved the sinners and repentant but despised the unrepentant religious leaders who led people away from the Lord. He was not a peace/love only God.

(3) FALSE LIFE- Jesus Christ the Humanitarian (Luke 4:40-44; 6:18-20; John 6:26-27)

(i) Jesus was the LIFE and preached to people how to have everlasting LIFE. He was not interested in just feeding the hungry, giving to the poor, healing the sick, etc.. and not using that as an opportunity to show them their need for everlasting life. This is a false LIFE.

(b) Jesus NEVER focused only on the humanistic needs of man. He did not come to just heal, feed, and give temporary physical comfort to people who were on their way to hell. He used these as signs for people to believe in him and his message of eternal life through him!

4) As we have seen today, God gives warning all over the Bible to his disciples to not be deceived. He uses this phrase sparingly to bring our attention to it and to learn to be on the look out. These deceptions was saw today are so subtle and so **PREVALENT** in our world today. We can all be guilty of falling into these deceptions at times, but if we are going to be successful disciples of Jesus Christ, we must heed our masters warning and not be deceived by idolatry and false Christs if we are going to bring glory to God in our lives.

The Life of a Disciple

1) Today we will begin our examination of the warnings that God gives us to "be not deceived" as disciples. He only uses this phrase **5** times in the Bible and so we must pay great attention to what he is warning us of. After today, we will see exactly why God draws such attention to these 2 great deceptions in his word and why he is trying to warn those who follow him to not be deceived by them.

2) BE NOT DECEIVED- Don't serve other _____

a) Deut. 11:16- Take heed to yourselves, that your heart **be not deceived**, and ye turn aside, and serve other gods, and worship them;

i) This is the first commandment in the Bible (Exo. 20:3; Deut. 5:7)

ii) This is the GREAT commandment according to Jesus (Matt. 22:36-40; Deut. 6:5)

iii) Young disciples are especially vulnerable to idol worship (1 John 5:21)

iv) God will tear down the idols in his temple (your life) if you will not because he is a jealous God (1 Cor. 6:19-20; 1 Samuel 5:1-5; Exo. 34:14; 20:5; Deut. 4:24; 5:9; 6:15; Josh. 24:19; Sng. 2:16; 6:3)

v) FINAL WORD- Choose who you will serve today! (Joshua 24:14-15)

3) BE NOT DECEIVED- Beware of false Christs

a) Luke 21:8- And he said, Take heed that ye **be not deceived**: for many shall come in my name, saying, I am Christ; and the time draweth near: go ye not therefore after them.

b) Who Jesus Christ was and was NOT

i) He WAS God manifest in the flesh, who came to seek and save that which was lost (1 Tim. 3:16; John 1:1-3,14; Col. 2:8-9; John 3:16-18; 1 John 2:1-2; John 14:9; Luke 19:10)

i) He was NOT just a lesser god, prophet, good man/teacher, etc..

ii) He WAS The Way, the Truth, and the Life

iii) He was NOT the false ways, truths, and lives that other ascribe to him

(1) FALSE WAY- Jesus Christ the social justice warrior (John 8:31-36; Acts 10:38)

(a) Jesus was a Jew under the rule of Rome: they were guaranteed no freedoms, forced to pay whatever taxes they were told, forced to obey whatever laws the king made, etc.. They were systemically OPPRESSED and under the fierce iron rod rule of Caesar. Yet Jesus NEVER fights for his rights, freedoms, speech, fair treatment under the law, etc… He is only concerned with the spiritual oppression of the world he created.

(2) FALSE TRUTH- Peace/Love only Jesus Christ (John 2:13-16; Mark 7:24-20; Matt. 23:13-26)

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The Life of a Disciple

1) Today we will be looking at two more warnings given from God's word about not being deceived as disciples. If we are going to live successfully as disciples of Jesus Christ in this world, then we must heed these **warnings** that God is drawing our attention to and make proper adjustments in our lives where they are needed.
2) **BE NOT DECEIVED- Evil communications corrupt good manners**
3) 1 Cor. 15:33- *Be not deceived: evil communications corrupt good manners.*
   a) **In the context, bad doctrine/teachings will corrupt your actions**
      i) Vs. 12-17,32- This church was falling into a false teaching that Jesus did not rise from the dead. Paul writes this to them to tell them that he did, he had to, and then gives this warning (Matthew 7:21-23; Rom. 10:1-2; Gal. 1:11-14; Acts 18:24-28)
         (1) Doctrine (beliefs) effect what you do. That is why we emphasize good doctrine so much because it is what steers what you do, who you are, your lifestyle, your ministry, etc…Paul even says that if Christ did not rise from the dead, forget sacrifice, forget preaching the gospel, forget this whole Christian life; eat, drink, do what you want because tomorrow we die and it all didn't matter!
         (2) Explain Historical to Doctrinal to Devotional pattern that must be followed
      ii) **Devotionally, we also see that evil communications (what we say, hear, who we hang out with, etc…) will corrupt how we live (2 Pet. 2:7-8; Job 31:1; Gen 6:2; 2 Sam. 11:2-4; Prov. 4:25-27; Gen. 13:10-13)**
         (1) Notice the connection God makes with what we see, hear, who we are with, etc.. all non physical things that effect how we behave and live. Don't miss it, they are connected and evil communications will corrupt good manners (actions and how you live) (*be careful little eyes what you see, be careful little ears what you hear)*
4) **BE NOT DECEIVED- The unrighteous shall not inherit the Kingdom of God**
5) 1 Cor. 6:9-11- *Know ye not that the unrighteous shall not inherit the kingdom of God? **Be not deceived**: neither fornicators, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor effeminate, nor abusers of themselves with mankind, Nor thieves, nor covetous, nor drunkards, nor revilers, nor extortioners, shall inherit the kingdom of God. And such were some of you: but ye are washed, but ye are sanctified, but ye are justified in the name of the Lord Jesus, and by the Spirit of our God.*
   a) The Kingdom of God (Lk. 17:21; Romans 14:17; John 3:3)
      i) When you receive Jesus Christ as your savior and you are born again, the kingdom of God now resides within you
      ii) That is why when Paul is contrasting the unrighteous and the believers in this chapter, he is saying "why are you letting the unrighteous judge your legal matters? Don't you know that you will be judges of greater things in the future? The unrighteous won't inherit the kingdom of God because they are these things (list of sins)"

b) What the unrighteous do

i) **Fornicators**- The incontinence or lewdness of unmarried persons, male or female; also, the criminal conversation of a married man with an unmarried woman. (1 Cor. 5:1)

ii) **Idolaters**- A worshiper of idols; one who pays divine honors to images, statues, or representations of any thing made by hands; one who worships as a deity that which is not God; a pagan.

iii) **Adulterers**- Violation of the marriage bed; a crime, or a civil injury, which introduces, or may introduce, into a family, a spurious offspring.

iv) **Effeminate**- Having the qualities of the female sex; soft or delicate to an unmanly degree; tender; womanish; voluptuous.

v) **Abusers of themselves with mankind**- *arsenokoitēs*; one who lies with a male as with a female, sodomite, homosexual (same word as in 1 Tim. 1:10, same context of type of sin)

vi) **Thieves**- Those who commit the act of stealing. In law, the private, unlawful, felonious taking of another person's goods or movables, with an intent to steal them.

vii) **Covetous**- Those who desire inordinately; to desire that which it is unlawful to obtain or possess; in a bad sense.

viii) **Drunkard**- One given to ebriety or an excessive use of strong liquor; a person who habitually or frequently is drunk.

ix) **Revilers**- Those who reproach; to treat with opprobrious and contemptuous language.

x) **Extortioners**- Anyone who commits the act of extorting; the act or practice of wresting any thing from a person by force, duress, menaces, authority, or by any undue exercise of power; illegal exaction; illegal compulsion to pay money, or to do some other act.

c) Are you unrighteous?

i) Are you saved but just living in the flesh? (Gal. 5:16-26; Rom. 7:14-25)

(1) Walk in the Spirit and you won't fulfill the lusts of the flesh

(a) Read the word of God daily (Eph. 6:17; Eph. 5:26; John 17:17)

(b) Pray about and Obey what God is telling you to do; EVERY day (Matthew 26:41)

ii) OR, are you still unsaved?

(1) Have you ever had a moment in your life where you prayed to receive the gift of salvation through the death, burial, and resurrection of Jesus Christ? (Romans 10:9,13; 1 Cor. 15:1-4)

6) As we have seen today, God is trying to warn us about living like the unrighteous and what communications we have in our lives. No doubt these two warnings are connected because when we allow evil communications in our lives, we will end up living like the unrighteous. This will cause a host of issues in our lives and cause us to doubt salvation, make fleshly decisions, and ultimately live **fruitless** lives as disciples. We all ought to listen to our Lord's plee and be not deceived by these things in order to live lives that bring God glory as his disciples.

The Life of a Disciple

1) Today we will be looking at two more warnings given from God's word about not being deceived as disciples. If we are going to live successfully as disciples of Jesus Christ in this world, then we must heed these _____ that God is drawing our attention to and make proper adjustments in our lives where they are needed.
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The Life of a Disciple

1) Today we will examine the final warning God gives to disciples to not be deceived by in this world. This warning is the most somber and probably the most important to our every day lives. If we can take hold of this warning we are getting today, it will take care of a host of issues in our lives and allow us to live **successfully** as his disciples.
2) **BE NOT DECEIVED- You will reap what you sow**
3) Gal. 6:7-9 *Be not deceived; God is not mocked: for whatsoever a man soweth, that shall he also reap. For he that soweth to his flesh shall of the flesh reap corruption; but he that soweth to the Spirit shall of the Spirit reap life everlasting. And let us not be weary in well doing: for in due season we shall reap, if we faint not.*
   a) We know exactly what will come from what we are sowing
      (1) There are no surprises. God is not mocked, you will receive exactly what you are sowing. Would you act surprised if you sowed apple seeds in a field and an apple tree came from them? Of course not! It is the same in our lives, expect the end of what you are sowing to be exactly what God says it will be
      (2) There are only two things that we can sow in this world, there are no exceptions! Paul tells us what they both are and the result of each.
   ii) Flesh ⟶ Corruption
      (1) Eternal Corruption for those you won't reach (Acts 2:31: 1 Cor. 15:50)
         (a) When you are living in your flesh, you are not sowing the seed of the gospel and peoples souls will suffer for eternity because of it. Most likely those closest to you will suffer for all of eternity because of it.
      (2) Corruption/Death in your life (Rom. 5:12; 6:21,23; 7:5; 8:6,13; Jam. 1:15; Prov. 22:8)
         (a) What does this look like in real life? Loneliness, depression, hopelessness, no directions in life, no drive in life, nothing to get you up each day, trouble understanding the Bible, not seeing answers to prayers, emptiness (vanity), physical ailments/issues (see 1 Cor. 6:18), miserable life (2 Pet. 2:20-22)
      (3) How do we live in the flesh? (Gal. 5:19-21)
         (a) Living in the flesh does not always have to be expressly stated sin but just living for what feels good to you. We ought to be in the habbit of living our lives for others, denying ourselves, denying our flesh, taking up our cross daily and dying to ourselves daily. This means even when you have the "right" to do something that you want to do because it is good for you, you live for others and not for your flesh.
   iii) Spirit ⟶ Life Everlasting
      (1) Eternal Life for those around you that you reach with the gospel (Rom. 1:9; 15:19; Luke 4:18)
         (a) When you are living in the Spirit, you will be ready to preach the gospel and you will desire to share the gospel. This will lead to life everlasting for many around you!

(2) A full life with Jesus Christ today (Gal. 5:22-23; Rom. 8:1)

(a) This is the life that everyone desires. It won't be perfect, it will be full of persecution, but will a greater purpose and peace. You will have clear direction, you will hear from God in his word, you will see answered prayers, people get saved, peoples lives change, those around you will be better off

(b) Whatever you sow, you will reap! Time in the Bible/prayer vs sleeping in. Sharing the gospel vs not. Discipling vs not. Mercy, you will be shown mercy. Anger, you will have a chaotic and angry life. Peace, you will have peace in life, etc…

(3) How do we live in the Spirit?

(a) Spend time in the word of God (Jn. 17:17; 16:13; 1 Cor. 2:10-11)

(b) Spend time in prayer (Rom. 8:26-27; Eph. 2:18)

(c) Mortify the deeds of the flesh and mind the things of the Spirit (Rom. 8:5,13)

(i) When you are minding the things that the spirit of God cares about, you are walking in the spirit. (Souls, the gospel, the word of God, bringing glory to God, etc..)

(ii) When you are mortifying what your flesh desires, you are walking in the spirit. This can even be "good things" that are necessarily wrong but just what feeds your fleshes desires. (this is a big part of fasting, it is just another way to deny your flesh and allow the spirit of God to have more reign in your body)

b) We DO NOT know exactly how much we will sow from what we reap

(1) When you plant a seed, do you always just get 1 single piece of fruit? No! Usually you get multitudes of fruit from one seed!

ii) There can be great amounts of good fruit that come from one small seed (Matthew 13:3-8)

(1) Tell story of Mark Trotter and his fruit tree

(2) Tell Story of Pastor Tom and his fruit tree

(3) Tell Story of Pastor Jay and his fruit tree

(4) Tell Story of Howard Hendricks and his fruit tree

iii) There can be great amounts of bad fruit that come from one small bad seed (Matthew 7:15-20; 12:33)

(1) Multitudes of fruit can come from one seed, good or bad; and there are bad and good examples of trees/fruit in the Bible

(2) Don't ever make the mistake of thinking that your actions don't matter. Don't think you know the outcome of the decisions you make. They grow into a huge tree of effects that you could never have imagined; for good and bad

4) As we have seen today, God emphasizes this issue of flesh vs. spirit in his word. The bottom line is that as disciples, each and every day, sometimes without even knowing it, we are sowing something. It is our job to heed the warning of our Lord and make sure we are sowing what will reap life everlasting and not corruption. This will ultimately put us on the path to living as **true** disciples of Jesus Christ, who follow in Jesus's footsteps and bring glory to God.

The Life of a Disciple

1) Today we will examine the final warning God gives to disciples to not be deceived by in this world. This warning is the most somber and probably the most important to our every day lives. If we can take hold of this warning we are getting today, it will take care of a host of issues in our lives and allow us to live _____ as his disciples.
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         (1) Eternal Corruption for those you won't reach (Acts 2:31: 1 Cor. 15:50)
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         (3) How do we live in the flesh? (Gal. 5:19-21)
      ii) Spirit ⟹ Life Everlasting
         (1) Eternal Life for those around you that you reach with the gospel (Rom. 1:9; 15:19; Luke 4:18)
         (2) A full life with Jesus Christ today (Gal. 5:22-23; Rom. 8:1)
         (3) How do we live in the Spirit?
            (a) Spend time in the word of God (Jn. 17:17; 16:13; 1 Cor. 2:10-11)
            (b) Spend time in prayer (Rom. 8:26-27; Eph. 2:18)
            (c) Mortify the deeds of the flesh and mind the things of the Spirit (Rom. 8:5,13)
   b) We DO NOT know exactly how much we will sow from what we reap
      i) There can be great amounts of good fruit that come from one small seed (Matthew 13:3-8)
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4) As we have seen today, God emphasizes this issue of flesh vs. spirit in his word. The bottom line is that as disciples, each and every day, sometimes without even knowing it, we are sowing something. It is our job to heed the warning of our Lord and make sure we are sowing what will reap life everlasting and not corruption. This will ultimately put us on the path to living as _____ disciples of Jesus Christ, who follow in Jesus's footsteps and bring glory to God.

S04 / TEACHING SERIES

Revelation

Weekly Revelation lessons with teacher/student resources, presentations, and a review.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Teaching and adaptation of study materials; source material is credited.

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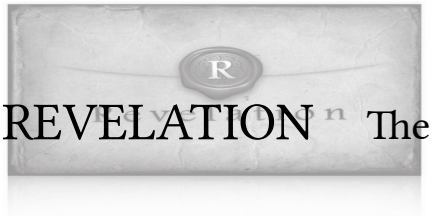
Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.



REVELATION The Revelation of Jesus Christ

INTRODUCTION: *CONTEXT & CHAPTER 1*

1. **CONTEXT INFORMATION**

Definition of "Revelation" = "To reveal, divulge, disclose, expose; to make known for _____ to see"

Author: _____, the beloved disciple of Jesus Christ, the son of Zebedee

Time of Writing: 90-96 AD (Historically); the day of the Lord (Rev. 1:10)

Theme: The revelation of Jesus Christ and the ____ ___ ___ _____

Key Verses: 1:1-3, 7, 10, 19; 19:11-16

Key Chapter: 1

Basic Outline: 1-3 - Church History
4-19:10 - Tribulation
19:11 - 22 - 2nd Coming/Millennial Reign/Judgment/New Heaven and New Earth

3 Applications:

1. **Historical:** Written to the 7 churches in Asia Minor, the servants of Christ, and to all who will read it to reveal the events of the coming "day of the Lord"
2. **Doctrinal:** Written to the servants of Christ and to all who will read it during the tribulation period to reveal the events that are unfolding all around them at that present time
3. **Devotional:** Written to teach us (the servants of Christ) the history of the church age, the events that will take place at the close of the church age dispensation, and the events surrounding the soon coming "day of the Lord"

2. **CHAPTER 1**

- Vs. 1-8 - John and Jesus' personal introduction to the book of Revelation
- Vs. 9-20 - John gives and honest witness of what he sees and hears

CHURCH HISTORY: *CHAPTER 2-3 - "…the things which thou hast seen…"*

1. **EPHESUS** - 2:1-7 (90 - 175/200 AD)
   - Ephesus = "_____ _____"
   - This is the era after the apostles where the church gradually fell away from their first love (Rev. 2:4)
   - Satan's attack method: _____
     - ✓ Wear down pastors, leaders, and congregations through fighting theological battles
     - ✓ Persuade congregations to rely too much on their pastors rather than personally contend for the faith
     - ✓ Draw their hearts away from their first love… Jesus Christ

   The Commendation:
   - Vs. 2 - They rooted out false teachers with the words of God and proved them to be liars (Tts 1:10-16; 3:8-10; Jude 3)
   - Vs. 3 - They knew their mission and were patient and faithful to labour in the work of the Lord (2Tim. 2:1-4, 20-26; 3:1-5, 10-14; 4:1-8)

- Vs. 6 - They hated the deeds of the Nicolaitans (vs. 15)

  → "Nico" = victor; _____

  → "Laitans" = of the _____

The Condemnation:

- Vs. 4 - They left their first love, the Lord Jesus Christ (the Word of God)

  → They started to use words and phrases not found in the scriptures, and they started focusing more on the concepts of God rather than the words of God:

  → The Alexandrian School (Is. 31:1; 30:1-3; Ex. 13:3; Acts 18:24-19:7)

  - Started and led by a man named Philo (120-200 AD), then led by Clement (150-215 AD), and then by Origen (184-254 AD)

  - Facts about Origen:

The Correction:

- Vs. 5, 7 - Remember their first love, repent, and do the first works and you will overcome!

Application for Bible-believers:

Do you truly love the words of God? (Psalm 119:65, 97; Prov 30:5-6; Jn 1:1; Rev 19:13; Heb. 4:12-13; Ps 138:2; 1Cor 2:16; Rom 10:17; Jn 17:17) STICK TO WHAT THE BIBLE SAYS AND NOTHING MORE!

2. SMYRNA - 2:8-11 (175/200 - 325 AD)

- Smyrna = "_____ "; _____
- This is the era of the persecutions from the pagan Roman empire
- Satan's attack method: Severe Persecution

  ✓ Use persecution and public pressure/opinion to stop the saved from doing the work of the Lord (evangelism and discipleship)

  ✓ Use persecution and public pressure/opinion to stop the lost from receiving Christ

The Commendation:

- This church was filled with workers that suffered tribulation and poverty (vs. 9)
- During this period in history, Christians suffered 10 rounds of persecution by the hand of Rome/the devil (vs. 10)

  1. 67 AD - Nero, 81 AD – Domitian, 108 AD – Trajan, 162 AD - Marcus Aurelius Antoninus, 192 AD – Severus, 235 AD – Maximus, 249 AD – Decius, 257 AD – Valerian, 274 AD – Aurelian, 303 AD - Diocletian

The Condemnation:

- There were some that called themselves _____ but were not (vs. 9)… The misplacing of the Jew in the bible has led to many corrupt false doctrines:

  1. Covenant/Reformed Theology
  2. Calvinism/Predestination
  3. Baptismal Regeneration (Acts 2:38)
  4. Tongues (1Cor 1:22; 14:22)

5. Apostolic Healing (Deut 18:15; Ex 4; Mk 16:20)
6. No eternal security (Mt 24; Heb 3; 6:10; James, etc.)
7. Postmillennialism & Amillennialism (Rev 20:1-7)

The Correction:

- Believe God's wisdom over man's wisdom! God means what He says and says what He means (Rom 11:25).

Application for Bible-believers:

Persecution is a part of the Christian life and it will only get worse as you grow closer to the Lord and as we get closer to the end. Stay close to God! There is a reward awaiting you for your suffering. You are in great company and have a long lineage of brothers/sisters who went through the same/worse!

2 Timothy 3:12 Yea, and all that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution.

James 1:12 - Blessed is the man that endureth temptation: for when he is tried, he shall receive the crown of life, which the Lord hath promised to them that love him.

Revelation 2:10 - Fear none of those things which thou shalt suffer: behold, the devil shall cast some of you into prison, that ye may be tried; and ye shall have tribulation ten days: be thou faithful unto death, and I will give thee a crown of life.

3. PERGAMOS - 2:12-17 (325 - 500 AD)

- Pergamos = "_____ _____"
- This is the era when the pagan Roman empire is united (married) with "Christianity"
- Satan's attack method: Compromise

✓ Rescue them from the cruel public pressure and persecution and offer Christianity liberty

✓ Propagate the gospel through compromise and sometimes by force

✓ Mix pagan Rome with Christian Rome and everyone will have "peace"

The Commendation:

- Held fast to Christ's name and did not deny Christ's faith in the face of persecution (vs. 13)

The Condemnation:

- They dwelt where Satan's seat is [_____] (vs. 13, 10)
- They held the doctrine of Balaam (vs. 14)
- They held the doctrine of the Nicolaitans (vs. 15)

1. Matthew 13:33 with Revelation 17:3 ("a woman", not good like bride, wife, virgin, etc…

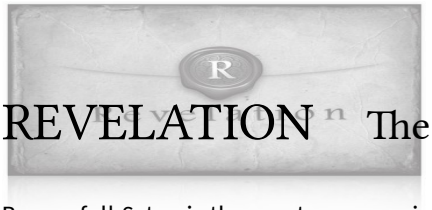
Significant historical events during this time period…

2. **Constantine's vision and "conversion" to Christianity**
3. **Edict of Milan:**
4. **Council of Nicaea** - All clergymen are invited to an all-expenses paid meeting to help determine the fundamental doctrines of the "Church"
5. **Paganism that flooded into Christianity once the doors were opened:**

The Correction:

- "Repent; or else I will come unto thee quickly, and will fight against them with the sword of my mouth." (vs. 16)

Application for Bible-believers:



REVELATION The Revelation of Jesus Christ

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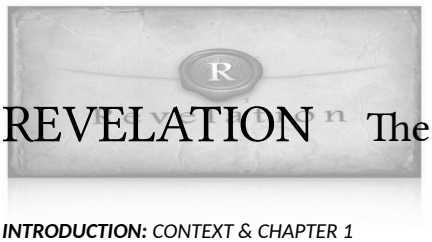

EDGE Youth Ministries

REVELATION The Revelation of Jesus Christ

INTRODUCTION: *CONTEXT & CHAPTER 1*

1. **CONTEXT INFORMATION**

Definition of "Revelation" = "To reveal, divulge, disclose, expose; to make known for all to see"

Author: John, the beloved disciple of Jesus Christ, the son of Zebedee

Time of Writing: 90-96 AD (Historically); the day of the Lord (Rev. 1:10)

Theme: The revelation of Jesus Christ and the day of the Lord

Key Verses: 1:1-3, 7, 10, 19; 19:11-16

Key Chapter: 1

Basic Outline: 1-3 - Church History
4-19:10 - Tribulation
19:11 - 22 - 2nd Coming/Millennial Reign/Judgment/New Heaven and New Earth

3 Applications:

1. **Historical:** Written to the 7 churches in Asia Minor, the servants of Christ, and to all who will read it to reveal the events of the coming "day of the Lord"
2. **Doctrinal:** Written to the servants of Christ and to all who will read it during the tribulation period to reveal the events that are unfolding all around them at that present time
3. **Devotional:** Written to teach us (the servants of Christ) the history of the church age, the events that will take place at the close of the church age dispensation, and the events surrounding the soon coming "day of the Lord"

2. **CHAPTER 1**

- Vs. 1-8 - John and Jesus' personal introduction to the book of Revelation
- Vs. 9-20 - John gives and honest witness of what he sees and hears
    1. Vs. 4 (is, was, is to come)
    2. Vs. 8 (is, was, is to come)
    3. Vs. 19 (thou hast seen, which are, shall be hereafter)

CHURCH HISTORY: *CHAPTER 2-3 - "…the things which thou hast seen…"*

1. **EPHESUS** - 2:1-7 (90 - 175/200 AD)
    - Ephesus = "Fully purposed"
    - This is the era after the apostles where the church gradually fell away from their first love (Rev. 2:4)
    - Satan's attack method: Heresy
        - ✓ Wear down pastors, leaders, and congregations through fighting theological battles
        - ✓ Persuade congregations to rely too much on their pastors rather than personally contend for the faith
        - ✓ Draw their hearts away from their first love… Jesus Christ

The Commendation:

- Vs. 2 - They rooted out false teachers with the words of God and proved them to be liars (Tts 1:10-16; 3:8-10; Jude 3)
- Vs. 3 - They knew their mission and were patient and faithful to labour in the work of the Lord (2Tim. 2:1-4, 20-26; 3:1-5, 10-14; 4:1-8)
- Vs. 6 - They hated the deeds of the Nicolaitans (vs. 15)

→ "Nico" = victor; conquerer

→ "Laitans" = of the people

→ (SHOW CATHOLIC TEACHINGS)

The Condemnation:

- Vs. 4 - They left their first love, the Lord Jesus Christ (the Word of God)

→ They started to use words and phrases not found in the scriptures, and they started focusing more on the concepts of God rather than the words of God:

- **Clement of Rome** - Spoke of a division between the pastor and the common man
- **Ignatius** - "Catholic" and "Son of the Church"
- **Papias** - Wrote the "Explanation of the Lord's Discourses"
- **Epicurus** - Merged Christianity with Philosophy
- **Basilides** - Promoted higher learning and said that Christ was only human in appearance
- **Polycarp** - "Faith is the mother of us all"
- **Justin Martyr** - Believed in baptismal regeneration
- **Origen** - Believed in the allegorical interpretation method

→ The Alexandrian School (Is. 31:1; 30:1-3; Ex. 13:3; Acts 18:24-19:7)

- Started and led by a man named Philo (120-200 AD), then led by Clement (150-215 AD), and then by Origen (184-254 AD)
- Facts about Origen:

✓ Called "the greatest Church father" by many church historians

✓ Believed God wrote the Bible

✓ Believed Jesus was the Son of God born of a virgin

✓ Believed Jesus died on a cross, was buried, and rose again the 3rd day

- Believed Genesis 1-3 was not literal

- Believed in the allegorical interpretation method

- Believed Jesus was a created sub-god, not God

- Believed the Holy Spirit was a created being

- Believed in Salvation by works, not grace

- Believed in baptismal regeneration and sprinkling of babies

- Believed that Jesus' death was a ransom paid to Satan

- Believed in "purgatory" and not in a literal Hell
- Believed in universal salvation for all mankind
- Believed that Satan would be saved one day
- Believed that there is no bodily resurrection, but spiritual only
- Believed that there is no millennial kingdom of Jesus Christ
- Believed in the pre-existence of the human soul
- Called the "Father of textual criticism"
- Established another school in Caeserea
- Wrote over 6000 volumes
- Persecuted and tortured during the Decian persecution (249 AD)
- Died from the bodily injuries of the torture in 254 AD
- His library was left to his favorite student - Pamphilus (Pamphilus would end up leaving his library to one of his disciples Eusebius)

The Correction:

- Vs. 5, 7 - Remember their first love, repent, and do the first works and you will overcome!

Application for Bible-believers:

Do you truly love the words of God? (Psalm 119:65, 97; Prov 30:5-6; Jn 1:1; Rev 19:13; Heb. 4:12-13; Ps 138:2; 1Cor 2:16; Rom 10:17; Jn 17:17) STICK TO WHAT THE BIBLE SAYS AND NOTHING MORE!

2. **SMYRNA** - 2:8-11 (175/200 - 325 AD)
   - Smyrna = "Myrrh"; bitterness
   - This is the era of the persecutions from the pagan Roman empire
   - Satan's attack method: Severe Persecution
     - ✓ Use persecution and public pressure/opinion to stop the saved from doing the work of the Lord (evangelism and discipleship)
     - ✓ Use persecution and public pressure/opinion to stop the lost from receiving Christ

   The Commendation:

   - This church was filled with workers that suffered tribulation and poverty (vs. 9)
   - During this period in history, Christians suffered 10 rounds of persecution by the hand of Rome/the devil (vs. 10)
     1. 67 AD - Nero
        - "In particular, he had some sewed up in skins of wild beasts, and then [worn out] by dogs until they expired; and others dressed in shirts made stiff with wax, fixed to axletrees, and set on fire in his gardens, in order to illuminate them. This persecution was general throughout the whole Roman Empire; but it rather increased than diminished the spirit of Christianity. In the course of it, St. Paul and St. Peter were martyred."
     2. 81 AD - Domitian
     3. 108 AD - Trajan
     4. 162 AD - Marcus Aurelius Antoninus
     5. 192 AD - Severus

6. 235 AD - Maximus
7. 249 AD - Decius
8. 257 AD - Valerian
9. 274 AD - Aurelian
10. 303 AD - Diocletian

The Condemnation:

- There were some that called themselves Jews but were not (vs. 9)… The misplacing of the Jew in the bible has led to many corrupt false doctrines:
  1. Covenant/Reformed Theology
  2. Calvinism/Predestination
  3. Baptismal Regeneration (Acts 2:38)
  4. Tongues (1Cor 1:22; 14:22)
  5. Apostolic Healing (Deut 18:15; Ex 4; Mk 16:20)
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Application for Bible-believers:

Persecution is a part of the Christian life and it will only get worse as you grow closer to the Lord and as we get closer to the end. Stay close to God! There is a reward awaiting you for your suffering. You are in great company and have a long lineage of brothers/sisters who went through the same/worse!

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3. **PERGAMOS** - 2:12-17 (325 - 500 AD)

- Pergamos = "Much marriage"
- This is the era when the pagan Roman empire is united (married) with "Christianity"
- Satan's attack method: Compromise
  - ✓ Rescue them from the cruel public pressure and persecution and offer Christianity liberty
  - ✓ Propagate the gospel through compromise and sometimes by force
  - ✓ Mix pagan Rome with Christian Rome and everyone will have "peace"

The Commendation:

- Held fast to Christ's name and did not deny Christ's faith in the face of persecution (vs. 13)

The Condemnation:

- They dwelt where Satan's seat is [Rome] (vs. 13, 10)
- They held the doctrine of Balaam (vs. 14)
- They held the doctrine of the Nicolaitans (vs. 15)
  1. The church went from HATING the deeds of the Nicolaitans, to holding their doctrine (they have been conquered)
  2. Matthew 13:33 with Revelation 17:3 ("a woman", not good like bride, wife, virgin, etc…)

Significant historical events during this time period…

3. **Constantine's vision and "conversion" to Christianity**

   - "Constantine, in his journey drawing toward the city, and casting up his eyes many times to heaven, in the south part, about the going down of the sun, saw a great brightness in heaven, appearing in the similitude of a cross, giving this inscription, In hoc vince, that is, 'In this overcome.' Eusebius Pamphilus doth witness that he had heard the said Constantine himself oftentimes report, and also to swear this to be true and certain, which he did see with his own eyes in heaven, and also his soldiers about him. At the sight whereof when he was greatly astonished, and consulting with his men upon the meaning thereof, behold, in the night season in his sleep, Christ appeared to him with the sign of the same cross which he had seen before, bidding him to make the figuration thereof, and to carry it in his wars before him, and so should we have the victory. Constantine so established the peace of the Church that for the space of a thousand years we read of no set persecution against the Christians, unto the time of John Wickliffe."

   - After that vision, Constantine wins the battle of Milvian Bridge and swears by the name of Christ. The symbol of the cross is placed on the helmets and shields of the soldiers.

4. **Edict of Milan:**

   ✓ Granted Christians total religious freedom

   ✓ Church property confiscated was to be returned

   ✓ Pagan temples particularly offensive to Christians were to be destroyed

   ✓ Christian clergy were exempted from taxation and soon to be paid by the State

   ✓ By 321 AD Sunday was declared a day of rest

   ✓ By 324 all new converts were given 20 pieces of gold and a white robe (to convert, one had to be baptized… 12,000 men were baptized in the 1st year!)

5. **Council of Nicaea** - All clergymen are invited to an all-expenses paid meeting to help determine the fundamental doctrines of the "Church"

   - All clergymen are invited to an all expenses paid meeting to determine the doctrines of the Church. Close to 318 attended (1/6 of all bishops in the empire). Eusebius is opens the council and sits at the right hand of Constantine. During the council they come to a doctrinal agreement on the Trinity and document the Nicene Creed, which ends with anyone that doesn't believe these things "are condemned by the holy catholic and apostolic Church." They put on the show of "championing sound doctrine" while Satan runs the show… Satan will always give you something "good" in exchange for the "better" or "best"!

   - The final authority for the Bride of Christ has now been replaced

6. **Paganism that flooded into Christianity once the doors were opened:**

   - Christmas = Saturnalia (worship of Roman god Saturn)
   - Easter = Ishtar (fertility and immortality)
   - Worship of Mary = Queen of Heaven
   - The Rosary = Counting prayers to Ashtar
   - Idols = Renamed Roman gods to Peter, Jesus, and Saints
   - Roman Emperor = Pope
   - Roman Senate = College of Cardinals
   - Imperial Governors = Archbishops
   - Provincial Governors = Bishops
   - Civitas = Priests

- Temple Virgins = Nuns
- Counterfeit Bibles = Constantine orders the publishing of 50 new bibles from Eusebius for Rome (all modern translations are traced back through these 50 bibles)

The Correction:

- "Repent; or else I will come unto thee quickly, and will fight against them with the sword of my mouth." (vs. 16)

Application for Bible-believers:

Be careful! Satan is the great compromiser and counterfeiter… He will do whatever it takes to get you to compromise and pull you away from the Truth! He is more than willing to give you something "good" in order to steal away what is "best".

4. **THYATIRA** - 2:18-29 (500 - 1000 AD)
   - Thyatira = "Odor of affliction"; continual sacrifice
   - This is the era of the scriptural heresy and human atrocities of Papal Rome
   - Satan's attack method: _____!

     ✓ Further the heresy, persecution, and compromise

     ✓ Advance forward all in the name of "Jesus" and "Christianity"

   The Commendation:

   - They had charity, service, patience, and works… and their last was more than their first (vs. 19)

   The Condemnation:

   - They suffered that woman _____ (vs. 20)

     1. She calls herself a prophetess (vs. 20)
     2. She teaches and seduces God's servants to commit fornication and eat things sacrificed to idols (vs. 20)
     3. God's judgment upon her:

        - He will cast her and her adulterers into tribulation if they continue to be unrepentant (vs. 22)
        - He will kill her children with death (vs. 23)
        - Everyone will know that God is a just judge (vs. 23)

   IT IS IMPORTANT TO REMEMBER… There are some during this time that choose not suffer that woman Jezebel and choose not know the depths of Satan (vs. 24)

   Significant historical events during this time period…

   - RCC continues to gain power and rule the world by controlling truth
   - Black Death (plague)
   - Mohammad
   - Dark Ages

     1. Why was this age dark? (Psalm 119:105,130; 1 Jn 1:5; Jn 8:12)

   The Correction:

   - Stay away from the doctrine of Balaam/Jezebel and the depths of Satan (vs. 24)
   - Hold fast to what you have until Christ comes (vs. 25)
   - Overcome and keep Christ's works unto the end (vs. 26)

     1. Will be given power over the nations (vs. 26)
     2. Rule the nations with a rod of iron (vs. 27)
     3. Will be given the morning star (vs. 28)

Application for Bible-believers:

This church (believers) was connected with the world and false religion in such a way that those who "fornicated" were judged accordingly. God sees us as his bride, and when we choose to connect ourselves with other religions or this world, we are fornicating. Are you faithful to God? Are there areas of your life you aren't faithful to God?

If you were married to someone and they:

- Spent more time with other men/women than you
- Talked about other men/women more than you
- Had a passion for other men/women more than you

How would you feel? God feels this way about us when we treat him like that (James 4:4; 1 Jn. 2:15-16)

5. **SARDIS** - 3:1-6 (1000 - 1500 AD)
   - Sardis = "_____ _____"
   - This is the era of the Dark Ages where horrific and murderous events took place by the hand of the Holy Roman Empire (Papal Rome)
   - Satan's attack method: _____ _____!
     1. Keep pressing ***harder*** on all fronts - Heresy, Persecution, and Compromise… All in the name of "Christ"

   The Commendation:

   - There was still some good in them that they received and heard, and that needs to be strengthened (vs. 1)
   - There was a remnant of believers that remained undefiled (vs. 4)

   The Condemnation:

   - They had the name that represents life, but in reality they were _____ (vs. 1)
   - The good they had was about to die (vs. 2)
   - Their works were not perfect before God (vs. 2)

   Significant historical events during this time period…

   - Crusades - Many refuse to submit to the words of God because of these Crusades. "Christians" conquered over Bible believers, Muslims, and any non-conformist people in the name of God.
   - Bible believers were severely persecuted and tortured and murdered by the millions (approx. 50 million) - "The _____ _____ of Papal Power" (Rev 17:6, 9, 18)

   The Correction:

   - Be watchful; strengthen the little truth they had; remember the truth they heard and received, and hold fast, and repent (vs. 2-3)… overcome (vs. 5)

Application for Bible-believers:

This church had been beaten down so badly by their enemies, that eventually they were not bearing fruit. They were saved (had a name that represents life) but were dead. Is your Christian life dead? Your purpose of your life is to glorify God through bearing much fruit (John 15:8). What was the last thing in your life that was fruitful that you can point to?

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   - Satan's attack method: ADVANCE!
     - ✓ Further the heresy, persecution, and compromise
     - ✓ Advance forward all in the name of "Jesus" and "Christianity"

The Commendation:

- They had charity, service, patience, and works… and their last was more than their first (vs. 19)

The Condemnation:

- They suffered that woman Jezebel (vs. 20)
  1. She calls herself a prophetess (vs. 20)
  2. She teaches and seduces God's servants to commit fornication and eat things sacrificed to idols (vs. 20)
     - Connected with worship of Baal due to the fact that Jezebel caused Israelites to worship Baal
     - BAALISM OF THE OT IS ROMAN CATHOLICISM IN THE NT; they are the same exact system, to see the details of this, read Judges chapter 17-18 and 1 Kings 16-18 (there are black robed priests who like to be called "father" who are hiring themselves out as priests and using little household idols for people to worship and set up in their homes (teraphims)
  3. God's judgment upon her:
     - He will cast her and her adulterers into tribulation if they continue to be unrepentant (vs. 22)
     - He will kill her children with death (vs. 23)
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IT IS IMPORTANT TO REMEMBER… There are some during this time that choose not suffer that woman Jezebel and choose not know the depths of Satan (vs. 24)

Significant historical events during this time period…

1. The Roman Catholic Church (RCC) officially removed the words of God from the common people and replaced the Bible's authority with the RCC institution. Therefore, almost everyone is duped into believing that the RCC is the one true church. Anyone that wouldn't align themselves with the Holy Roman Empire was snuffed out by force.
2. The "black death" began in the year 541. The disease was also known as the "bubonic plague" and it was carried all around Europe through trade routes during this church period. By the end of the dark ages, some 25 million people had died from this plague.
   1. Vs. 22-24 seem to say that God will spare those who don't fall into this trap of Jezebel's teachings
   2. Sildes of Baptists in Poland/Germany
   3. A simple study of the OT would have stopped the plague. It began due to excrement in the streets which drew in rodents and insects carrying disease. Beyond this, following the OT laws of cleanliness such as running water and isolation would have prevented the spread of the disease. Their sin of ignoring and persecuting the word of God was their demise as God said it would be!!!!

3. Mohammad (570-632 AD), motivated by the RCC's cruelty in the name of "God", started the religion of Islam. He claimed to be visited by the angel Gabriel.

4. This church period begins the "dark ages". One must not study long in order to find out that the height of the power of the RCC and the "dark ages" ran hand and hand for years. As Rome gained full power and until they lost it, the world was a dark place of death and misery. Once they lost their grip on the world during the "reformation", a time of "enlightenment", the world took a turn for the better

    1. Why was this age dark? (Psalm 119:105,130; 1 Jn 1:5; Jn 8:12)

5. True preachers and Bible believers were persecuted to the utmost, and because of this they did not have a completed bible. They preached from whatever they had, won many to Christ, and discipled many to carry on our biblical heritage… they were the Cathari, Montanists, Novatians, Donatists, Euchites, Messalines, Nestorians, Paulicians, Bogomiles, Albigenses, Picards, etc. Later they would be called Waldensees, Anabaptists, Mennonites, Hussites, Brethren, and Baptists

    I. Quotes from trail of blood

The Correction:

- Stay away from the doctrine of Balaam/Jezebel and the depths of Satan (vs. 24)
- Hold fast to what you have until Christ comes (vs. 25)
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- Sardis = "Red ones"
- This is the era of the Dark Ages where horrific and murderous events took place by the hand of the Holy Roman Empire (Papal Rome)
- Satan's attack method: KEEP ADVANCING!

    1. Keep pressing ***harder*** on all fronts - Heresy, Persecution, and Compromise… All in the name of "Christ"

The Commendation:

- There was still some good in them that they received and heard, and that needs to be strengthened (vs. 1)
- There was a remnant of believers that remained undefiled (vs. 4)

The Condemnation:

- They had the name that represents life, but in reality they were dead (vs. 1)

- The good they had was about to die (vs. 2)
- Their works were not perfect before God (vs. 2)

Significant historical events during this time period…

- This time period is often referred to as "the midnight of the dark ages"
- Increase in Asian culture, Hinduism, Muslim
- Start of the Renaissance
- Bubonic Plague reaches its peak and kills millions
- Roman religious councils totally replace the authority of the bible, and the RCC completely controlled the world through religion
- The events of the Crusades, Spanish Inquisitions, Invasions of Saladin, and Genghis Khan

1. Crusades - Many refuse to submit to the words of God because of these Crusades. "Christians" conquered over Bible believers, Muslims, and any non-conformist people in the name of God.
    - 1 - 1095 to 1099 AD (Captured Jerusalem)
    - 2 - 1147 to 1149 AD (Postponed the fall of Jerusalem)
    - 3 - 1189 to 1191 AD (Army failed to reach Jerusalem)
    - 4 - 1201 to 1204 AD (Captured and plundered Constantinople)
    - 5 - 1228 to 1229 AD (Took Jerusalem, but soon lost it)
    - 6 - 1248 to 1254 AD (Failure)
    - 7 - 1270 to 1272 AD (Came to naught)

2. Rome claimed 3 reasons for the Crusades:
    1. Conquer and assume the Holy Land
    2. Stop the spread of the Islamic religion
    3. Unite the East and West branches of Catholicism

…but really Satan wanted to secure control of Jerusalem and wipe out all adversaries to establish the throne of the antichrist

…and God used the Crusades to weaken the RCC's grip on power to usher in the Reformation in 1517 AD

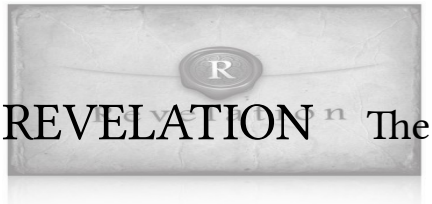
- Bible believers were severely persecuted and tortured and murdered by the millions (approx. 50 million) - "The Golden Age of Papal Power" (Rev 17:6, 9, 18)

1. Albigenses, Bulgarians, Waldenses, Cathari, Petrobusians, Arnoldists, Hussites, Hericians, New Manichaeans, Lollards, and Anabaptists… all branded "Heretics" by the RCC… they were never a part of the RCC, and therefore didn't need to come out from them (Reformation - 1517 AD)

The Correction:

- Be watchful; strengthen the little truth they had; remember the truth they heard and received, and hold fast, and repent (vs. 2-3)… overcome (vs. 5)

Application for Bible-believers:



The Revelation of Jesus Christ

This church had been beaten down so badly by their enemies, that eventually they were not bearing fruit. They were saved (had a name that represents life) but were dead. Is your Christian life dead? Your purpose of your life is to glorify God through bearing much fruit (John 15:8, 16). What was the last thing in your life that was fruitful that you can point to?

Have you:

- Led someone to Christ
- Discipled someone to the point that their life was changing and they were bearing more fruit
- Do you exemplify the fruit of the spirit in your life

6. PHILADELPHIA - 3:7-13 (1500 - 1900 AD)

- Philadelphia = "_____ _____"
- The era of the incredible revival of humanity as world missions takes the English Bible to the ends of the earth
- Satan's attack method: Regroup…

The Commendation:

- They have little strength, kept the Lord's word, and have not denied his name (vs. 8) (2Cor. 12:9)
- Because of their faithfulness, the Lord has opened a door of ministry unto them that no one can shut (vs. 7-8), he will cause those that were the true heretics to come to their feet in repentance to God (vs. 9), and he will keep them from the hour of temptation (vs. 10)

The Condemnation:

- NONE!

Significant historical events during this time period…

- _____ was almost completely dismantled and discredited
- God preserved his words in the English language and propagated it throughout the whole world with the invention of Gutenberg's printing press in 1439… Bible texts from Antioch were translated into German, English, and over 800 other languages! **(Ps. 12:6-7)**

1. Wycliffe Bible (1382)
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8. King James Bible (1611)

- These quotes are from one of the frontrunners for the Bible being translated into English, a great man of God, a lover of the word of God and eventual martyr, William Tyndale:

- Prior to the King James Bible there were "coincidental" counter attacks:

1. Invasion of England by the Spanish Armada (July 29th, 1588)
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- God had preserved and protected the land of the US for this time in history. It was basically uninhabited for the majority of history until God knew he could use it to be the launching pad for world missions because of it's ability based on geographic location, natural resources, and eventual freedom of

religion, economic status, and governmental system that allowed for the worldwide publication of the gospel (to be like England was for years but with better global positioning)

- God protected the mainland from the voyage of Catholic Christopher Columbus (he stopped at the first sight of land instead of continuing toward the final destination of the mainland due to pressure from his shipmates)
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- God raised up men and women that were willing to take the words of God to the ends of the earth… These faithful born again believers did not back down when the job was offered!"

- Count Zizendorf, John Bunyan, Jonathan Edwards, John Wesley, George Whitfield, David Brainerd, Billy Bray, Robert Morrison, Peter Parker, Adoniram Judson, William Carey, George Muller, David Livingstone, Hudson Taylor, CT Studd, etc.

The Correction:

- None! Continue! Endure! Press on! Hold fast what you have! Overcome! (vs. 11-12)

Application for Bible-believers: Love God's words (the key of David), believe God's words, obey God's words, and never compromise!

- Do you have the key of David? Are there any of these kind of missionaries and Bible believers left with this kind of passion for the word and the world?

(Ps. 119: 97,113,119,127,159,163,165,167)

7. LAODICEA - 3:14-22 (1900 AD - Present Day)

- Laodicea = "_____ _____"; the rights of the people; my personal rights
- This is the era just prior to the rapture and tribulation where the deceived church is apathetic towards God's words, and consequently in lukewarm a state of unprofitable worldliness
- Satan's attack method: Counterfeit and Deception

The Commendation:

- NONE! …and yet they believe they have it all together…

The Condemnation:

- They are lukewarm… not cold… not hot… (vs. 15-16) God **prefers** that they are **cold or hot** (Josh. 24:14-15)
- They make God want to vomit! (vs. 16)
- They say (vs. 17a):
    1. I am rich
    2. I am increased with goods
    3. I need nothing
- And they do not realize they are (vs. 17b):
    1. Wretched
    2. Miserable
    3. Poor
    4. Blind
    5. Naked

Significant historical events during this time period…

- IN A WORD: **HUMANISM**-
    1. an outlook or system of thought attaching prime importance to human rather than divine or supernatural matters. Humanist beliefs stress the potential value and goodness of human beings, **emphasize human needs and desires**, and seek solely rational ways of solving human problems
    2. In other words: its all about _____
- Materialism, Intellectualism, Relativism, Evolution, Advances in Technology, Scientific knowledge and inventions, but they do not increase one's life (More efficiently kill one another, Advanced Communication and Travel), More people are recognizing Rome as their spiritual ancestor, World War I and II, Middle Eastern conflict between Arabs and Jews, Ecumenical-ism, compromise to offend no one, all join hands in the name of "peace", The church becomes more "social" in nature rather than biblical, They assume prosperity is God's blessing and fool themselves into thinking God is pleased with them (2Timothy 3:1-13)
- **Some Major events that changed the world around this time**
    1. WW1 and WW2 (1914-1945)
    2. Pentecostalism begins in Topeka Kansas (1901)
    3. Darwin writes his Orgin of Species book from Brahmley, London (1859)
    4. The Revised Version of the Bible is published (1885). This is the FIRST NT ENGLISH BIBLE TRANSLATION IN 275 YEARS that is printed and it was based on corrupt manuscripts from Alexandria, Egypt (Catholic MSS). The ONLY BIBLE OF THE FRUITFUL, WORLD REACHING, BIBLE PREACHING, DISCIPLE MAKING OPEN DOOR OF PHILADELPHIA WAS THE KJB!
    5. The Scopes Trial blazes the trail for evolution to be taught in school in the stead of creation (1925)

6. Karl Marx writes his "Communist Manifesto" (1848)
7. Papal Infallibility is declared by the RCC (1870)
8. The first dinosaur bones are discovered (1858)
9. The Progressive Era begins (1890)
10. Israel becomes a nation again for the first time in almost 2000 years! (1948)

How you can identify a Laodicean:

- They think they can love God and _____ at the same time (1Tim. 6:10; Matt. 6:24)
- They think they are worshiping God while in the process of _____ him (Mal. 3:8; Hag. 1:6)
- They think they know God but never win anyone to saving faith in Christ (Jn. 15:1-5; Tts. 1:16)
- They think they are _____ but never suffer persecution (2Tim. 3:12; Jn. 16:33; Acts 14:22; 1Pt. 2:20-21)
- They have no need to trust God because they have provided everything on their own (Jn. 15:5; Lk. 12:15-21)
- They are confident and _____ about their spiritual state (Ezek. 33:30-33)
- They think lukewarm is good - they call it being "balanced" and "relatable" and obeying 1 Cor. 9:19-23

They are, in truth, sickening to God, miserable, poor, blind, and naked… and their **only hope is the Word of God*

The Correction (…and application for Bible believers today)

1. Buy from the Lord true and eternal riches that have been tried in the fire (vs. 18a)
    a. Gold tried in the fire = Eternal riches! Invest in the eternal, the things which are not seen as Paul says. Laodiceans are taught to see only the temporal and the here and now and we don't live for the eternal riches of God (2 Cor. 4:17-18; 1 Cor. 3:11-15)
2. Cover your nakedness with the white raiment of God's righteousness (vs. 18b)
    a. White raiment = _____ (Rev. 3:5; 4:4; Matt. 17:2; 28:3; 1 Peter 1:15-16; 1 Thess. 4:7)
3. Anoint your eyes with eye salve so you can clearly see (vs. 18c)
    a. Eye salve = _____ the Bible (Mk. 8:22-25; Jn. 9:6-11; 1Jn. 2:27)
    b. In order to believe the Bible, you have to choose to…
        i. Seek it out and read it - Is. 34:16
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        iii. Meditate therein day and night - Josh. 1:8
        iv. Apply thine heart unto it - Prov. 23:12
4. Receive the rebuke and chastening of the Lord **and zealously repent from your Laodicean mindset** (vs. 19)
5. Hear Christ's knock and open the door to let him back in where he belongs… on your throne (vs. 20)

6. **PHILADELPHIA** - 3:7-13 (1500 - 1900 AD)
   - Philadelphia = Brotherly Love"
   - The era of the incredible revival of humanity as world missions takes the English Bible to the ends of the earth
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   The Commendation:

   - They have little strength, kept the Lord's word, and have not denied his name (vs. 8) (2Cor. 12:9)
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   The Condemnation:

   - NONE!

   Significant historical events during this time period…

   - Rome was almost completely dismantled and discredited
     1. The Reformation occurs during this time and while it was not God's people coming out of the reformation, he used it for his purposes.
     2. Don't forget, the reformation was exactly that, "reforming" the RCC, they came out from the RCC, WE NEVER DID, and so we are not "reformed" as they are. God's people from the time of Christ were doing the work underground and being persecuted all along the way.
     3. Explain reformation and it's part in God's plan against RCC
        - Martin Luther and Zuingli (famous reformers) were both murderers of our ancestors in the faith "anabaptists" Zuingli even talked about "baptizing" them by drowning them if that is what they wanted to badly
     4. ALL reformed churches will one day go back to their "mother" under the antichrist. They are already going that way today. Many churches have since aligned with the RCC in many ways as they have believe the LIE that the RCC is "reformed" and not crusading anymore, not seeking to rule the world, not seeking to murder millions, etc.. That is the thing about the RCC as described in proverbs 7 "her ways are moveable"
   - God preserved his words in the English language and propagated it throughout the whole world with the invention of Gutenberg's printing press in 1439… Bible texts from Antioch were translated into German, English, and over 800 other languages! **(Ps. 12:6-7)**

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   - The word of God was in the hands of almost all common men who wanted it during this time due to the mass printing of the Bible in the language of the world. The entrance of the word of God "gave light" to the world and the holder of the "key of David" gave this church this key! (David's mark of his life was his love for the word of God).
   - Many will say that certain doctrines or teachings did not show up until around this church period, and in so saying they state that it cannot be biblical. HOWEVER, the earlier churches were NOT marked for their doctrine (except for where it was bad) like this

one! This church HAD the word of God like NONE OTHER (not even close) and KEPT his word as he says to them. This was a time of understanding that the world had never seen and God was giving this to common men.

- These quotes are from one of the frontrunners for the Bible being translated into English, a great man of God, a lover of the word of God and eventual martyr, William Tyndale:
    1. While debating a Catholic priest in his day, Tyndale was defending the English Bible, to which the priest responded, "We were better to be without God's law than the pope's." to which Tyndale famously responded "I defy the pope and all of his laws! If God spare my life, ere many years I will cause a boy who drives a plough to know more of the scriptures than thou dost."
    2. After being captured by the RCC and jailed and tormented for 16 months, Tyndale was about to be strangled and burned at the stake at the hands of the RCC when he famously cried out his last words, "Oh Lord, open the King of England's eyes" Less than 80 years later, the KJB was printed and mass produced, Tyndale's translation of the Antiochian manuscripts to English were used to translate an estimated 80% of the final product of the KJB

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--- God had preserved and protected the land of the US for this time in history. It was basically uninhabited for the majority of history until God knew he could use it to be the launching pad for world missions because of it's ability based on geographic location, natural resources, and eventual freedom of religion, economic status, and governmental system that allowed for the worldwide publication of the gospel (to be like England was for years but with better global positioning)

- God protected the mainland from the voyage of Catholic Christopher Columbus (he stopped at the first sight of land instead of continuing toward the final destination of the mainland due to pressure from his shipmates)
- God later used the Pilgrims (Bible believers) to settle on the mainland instead and create a God blessed nation to reach the world by (open door no man can shut)

"It is well known unto the godly and judicious, how ever since the first breaking out of the light of the gospel in our honourable nation of England, (which was the first of nations whom the Lord adorned therewith after the gross darkness of popery which had covered and overspread the Christian world), what wars and oppositions ever since, Satan hath raised, maintained and continued against the Saints, **1** from time to time, in one sort or other. Sometimes by bloody death and cruel torments; other whiles imprisonments, banishments and other hard usages; as being loath his kingdom should go down, the truth prevail and the churches of God revert to their ancient purity and recover their primitive order, liberty and beauty.---

--- God raised up men and women that were willing to take the words of God to the ends of the earth… These faithful born again believers did not back down when the job was offered!"

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1. Story of the Moravian Slave Missionaries- Johann Leonhard Dober and David Nitschmann, were two young Moravian Brethren from Herrnhut, Germany. They were called in 1732 to minister to the African slaves on the islands of St. Thomas and St. Croix in the Danish West Indies. When they were told that they would not be allowed to do such a thing, Dober and Nitschmann sold themselves to a slave owner and boarded a ship bound for the West Indies. As the ship pulled away from the docks, it is said that they called out to their loved ones on shore, "May the Lamb that was slain receive the reward of His suffering!"
2. Jonathan Edwards Famous Revival Sermon "Sinners In the Hands of an Angry God"
    - Reverend Stephen Williams was in attendance at the Enfield sermon, with his diary entry for that day containing the following account of the congregation's reactions during and after the sermon:

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[B]efore the sermon was done there was a great moaning and crying out through the whole house — "What shall I do to be saved?" "Oh, I am going to hell!" "Oh what shall I do for a Christ?" and so forth — so that the minister was obliged to desist. [The] shrieks and cries were piercing and amazing. After some time of waiting, the congregation were still, so that a prayer was made by Mr. Wheelock, and after that we descended from the pulpit and discoursed with the people, some in one place and some in another. And amazing and astonishing: the power [of] God was seen and several souls were hopefully wrought upon that night, and oh the cheerfulness and pleasantness of their countenances that received comfort. Oh that God would strengthen and confirm [their new faith]! We sang a hymn and prayed, and dispersed the assembly.

The Correction:

- None! Continue! Endure! Press on! Hold fast what you have! Overcome! (vs. 11-12)

Application for Bible-believers: Love God's words (the key of David), believe God's words, obey God's words, and never compromise!

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   - Laodicea = "Civil rights"; the rights of the people; my personal rights
   - This is the era just prior to the rapture and tribulation where the deceived church is apathetic towards God's words, and consequently in lukewarm a state of unprofitable worldliness

     1. **Abolitionist Movement** (18th-19th centuries): Fought for the abolition of slavery, gaining momentum in the United States, the United Kingdom, and other parts of the world.
     2. **Women's Suffrage Movement** (late 19th to early 20th century): Advocated for women's right to vote and broader gender equality, leading to significant social and political changes.
     3. **Labor Rights Movement** (late 19th century onwards): Focused on improving working conditions, fair wages, and workers' rights, addressing issues like child labor and excessive working hours.
     4. **Civil Rights Movement** (1950s-1960s, USA): A prominent movement combating racial segregation and discrimination, seeking equal rights and opportunities for African Americans.
     5. **Anti-Apartheid Movement** (mid-20th century to early 1990s, South Africa): Opposed the institutionalized racial segregation and discrimination in South Africa, leading to the eventual dismantling of apartheid
     6. **Gay Rights Movement** (late 20th century onwards): Advocated for LGBTQ+ rights, including the decriminalization of homosexuality, anti-discrimination laws, and marriage equality.
     7. **Environmental Movement** (mid-20th century onwards): Focused on environmental conservation, sustainability, and raising awareness about issues like pollution and climate change.
     8. **Indigenous Rights Movement** (ongoing): Seeks recognition, respect, and protection of the rights of indigenous peoples, addressing issues like land rights, cultural preservation, and self-determination (ex. American Indians)
     9. **Human Rights Movement** (20th century onwards): Works towards the protection and promotion of fundamental human rights globally, addressing issues such as torture, discrimination, and political repression.
     10. **Disability Rights Movement** (late 20th century onwards): Advocated for equal opportunities, accessibility, and rights for people with disabilities, leading to legislation like the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA).
     11. **Animal Rights Movement** (20th century onwards): Advocates for the ethical treatment of animals, addressing issues like animal cruelty, factory farming, and the use of animals in research. These movements have significantly influenced societal values, legislation, and international norms, contributing to the ongoing pursuit of justice and equality.
     12. **The list goes on and on……**

   - Satan's attack method: Counterfeit and Deception

The Commendation:

- NONE! …and yet they believe they have it all together…

The Condemnation:

- They are lukewarm… not cold… not hot… (vs. 15-16) God **prefers** that they are **cold or hot** (Josh. 24:14-15)
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    1. These thoughts and ways of the world eventually creep into the church, even the strongest and most biblical churches can fall into this way of thinking if they are not careful and constantly anointing their eyes with the eye salve of the word of God!
        - Some believe "to be saved from hell" (to save their own skin), some follow "because it makes my life better", some study the Bible to **know** more and look better, some serve to look good and feel good as a Christian, etc… WHEN IN REALITY we need to serve God and do all of these things for NO REASON other than the fact that he tells us to and he deserves our obedience
- Some Major events that changed the world around this time
    1. WW1 and WW2 (1914-1945)
    2. Pentecostalism begins in Topeka Kansas (1901)
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    4. The Revised Version of the Bible is published (1885). This is the FIRST NT ENGLISH BIBLE TRANSLATION IN 275 YEARS that is printed and it was based on corrupt manuscripts from Alexandria, Egypt (Catholic MSS). The ONLY BIBLE OF THE FRUITFUL, WORLD REACHING, BIBLE PREACHING, DISCIPLE MAKING OPEN DOOR OF PHILADELPHIA WAS THE KJB!
    5. The Scopes Trial blazes the trail for evolution to be taught in school in the stead of creation (1925)
    6. Karl Marx writes his "Communist Manifesto" (1848)
    7. Papal Infallibility is declared by the RCC (1870)
    8. The first dinosaur bones are discovered (1858)
    9. The Progressive Era begins (1890)
        - This era is aimed at "social activism and reform across the US focused on defeating corruption and human injustice. This was a time of great technological and social advancement."
    10. Israel becomes a nation again for the first time in almost 2000 years! (1948)
        - The prime minister of Israel at this time writes extensively about the major pushback that was given for this decision on the part of the Vatican at the UN proceedings!

How you can identify a Laodicean:

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- They think they can love God and money at the same time (1Tim. 6:10; Matt. 6:24)
- They think they are worshiping God while in the process of robbing him (Mal. 3:8; Hag. 1:6)
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The Correction (…and application for Bible believers today)

1. Buy from the Lord true and eternal riches that have been tried in the fire (vs. 18a)
    a. Gold tried in the fire = Eternal riches! Invest in the eternal, the things which are not seen as Paul says. Laodiceans are taught to see only the temporal and the here and now and we don't live for the eternal riches of God (2 Cor. 4:17-18; 1 Cor. 3:11-15)
2. Cover your nakedness with the white raiment of God's righteousness (vs. 18b)
    a. White raiment = Holiness (Rev. 3:5; 4:4; Matt. 17:2; 28:3; l
        i. Quit thinking somehow that God's holy standard has changed! He desires for you to be holy and separate from this world! The Laodicean FOOLS themselves into believing that God does not care about this anymore since we are "saved"
3. Anoint your eyes with eye salve so you can clearly see (vs. 18c)
    a. Eye salve = Believing the Bible (Mk. 8:22-25; Jn. 9:6-11; 1Jn. 2:27)
    b. In order to believe the Bible, you have to choose to…
        i. Seek it out and read it - Is. 34:16
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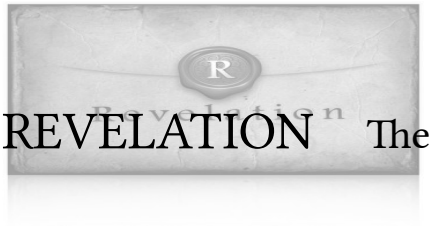

REVELATION The Revelation of Jesus Christ

THE RAPTURE & 4 TRIBULATION ACCOUNTS: *CHAPTER 4-19 - "…the things which are…"*

**We just came through a study of church history and how each of the churches this book was written to was doctrinally a picture of a period of church history. The word church shows up 19x in the book of Revelation and 18 of those times is in chapters 1-3. We will not see the word church again until the close of this book in chapter 22. This is another significant sign to show us exactly what the first part of this book was all about ("the things which thou hast seen") and also what we will be looking at next ("the things which are" → (Revelation 1:10- "on the Lord's Day)

1. **THE _____ AND THE IMMEDIATE SCENE IN HEAVEN** - Rev. 4-5
    a. **Where else is the rapture described in the Bible-**
        i. Direct References- 1Cor. 15:50-55; 1 Thess 4:16-17
        ii. Pictures- Gen 5:24; Heb 11:5-6; Gen 19; 2 Peter 2:6-9
    a. **When will this take place?**
        iii. We do not know the "day or the hour" (Matt. 24:36) but WE DO KNOW the "times and seasons" (1 Thess. 5:1-2)
        i. Signs of the Rapture
            1. 2 Tim. 3; Gen 6 (Noah/Enoch)- Matt. 24:37; Luke 17:26; Gen 19 (Lot); 2 Pet 3:3-9 (Days of the Week) 7th Day of Rest/7000th year on of rest; Books of OT (**2 Chron**.- Jews told to go home, **Ezra**/**Neh**- Israel goes home and restores nation, **Esther**- Jewish Bride replaces Gentile bride, **Job**- time of tribulation, **Psalms**- Millennial Kingdom); Parable of the laborers (Matthew 20- brings us to about 2033) ; Revelation 2-3 ending with Laodicean church; Matthew 24:32-35 (Song of Sol. 2:10-13)- the Fig tree
                - All of these passages would bring you to the clear conclusion that the rapture will occur between now and 2061 (with the likely year being around 2033)
    b. **Are there other raptures in the Bible?**
        ii. Yes! This is why so many people get this messed up, by misplacing the different raptures. There are a few in Revelation we will see at the end of the tribulation and there was one when Christ first ascended (Matthew 27:52-53; Prov. 25:7)
    c. **Four Beasts-** Seraphim or Cherubim? (**Rev. 4:6-8**; Isa. 6:2-3 **VS.** Eze. 1:6-21; 10: 1-21)
    d. **Elders-** Who are they? (**Rev. 4:4**, 10; 5:9)
        i. They have white robes; They have crowns; They are in heaven during the tribulation; They were redeemed by the blood of the lamb
    a. **The 7 Sealed Book- Rev. 5** (Eph. 1:13-14; 4:30; 2 Cor. 1:22; 5:5; Lev. 25:23-46)
        1. **Earnest**- "*First fruits; that which is in advance, and gives promise of something to come. Thus the earnest of the spirit is given to saints, as a pledge or assurance of their future enjoyment of God's presence and favor.*"
        2. **Redeem-** "*To purchase back; to ransom; to liberate or rescue from captivity or bondage, or from any obligation or liability to suffer or to be forfeited, by paying an equivalent*"
        ii. What is the 7 Sealed Book? _____ _____
            1. ****The Land Grant to the Earth**- God just redeemed us to himself (vs 9) at the rapture and now he is opening the book of the whole tribulation to redeem the earth to himself
            2. **The Book of Daniel** and it's judgements/prophesies (Daniel 12:4)

3. **The Book of Revelation**- This book contains all the rest of the contents of Revelation

2. **TRIBULATION ACCOUNT 1-** Rev. 6-7

   1. **The ____ _____ – Rev. 6; 8:1-6**

      a. The rider on a white horse… The _____ (**Rev. 6:1-2**)

      b. The rider on a red horse… _____ (**Rev. 6:3-4**)

      c. The rider on a black horse… _____ (**Rev. 6:5-6**)

      d. The rider on a pale horse… _____ (**Rev. 6:7-8**)

      e. The persecution of the Tribulation saints (**Rev. 6:9-11**)

      f. The Earth is shaken and the Son of God is revealed (**Rev. 6:12-17**)

   2. **Parenthesis describing other events during these seals- Rev. 7**

      a. The 144,000 witnesses- **Rev. 7:1-8** (Matt. 25:1-13; Rev. 14:4; James 1:1)

      b. **The _____/ Tribulation Saints Rapture** (**Rev. 7:14**; 14:14-16; 11:12; Ps. 50:1-6; Is. 26:20-21; Matt. 24:40-42, 29-31)

         i. This rapture is called the "gleanings" because the 3 main Bible raptures are equated to harvesting

            1. Jesus Christ and the OT saints- **The First fruits** (1 Cor. 15:20,23; Matt. 27:52-52)

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            3. The Tribulation Saints- **The Gleanings** (Rev. 7:14; 14:14-16; 11:12; Ps. 50:1-6; Is. 26:20-21; Matt. 24:40-42, 29-31)

   3. **The Final Seal Opened**- Rev. 8:1-6

      a. The Seventh Seal opens to reveal the 7 Trumpet judgements and 7 Vial Judgements (**8:1-6**)

         i. What does this tell us? *All of the Seals, Trumpets, and Vials are all connected. They are all accounts of the same period of time during the tribulation, from different perspectives (much like the gospels and the book of Daniel concerning prophesy)*

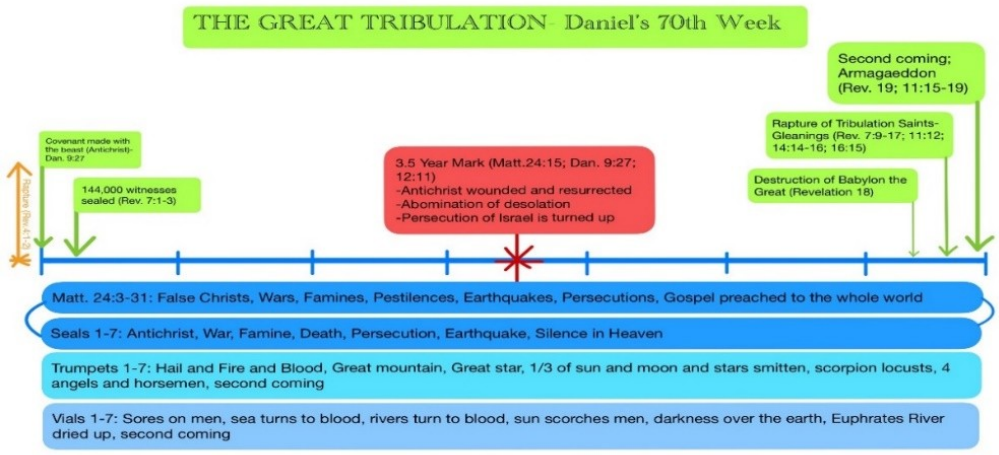
   4. Application for us today:

      a. **Are you Rapture Ready**?

         i. Are you wearing white raiment? Is your life Holy? (Rev. 3:18)

         ii. Will you have crowns to cast back to the Lord? (Rev. 3:18)

      b. **Who do you know who will be here for these events? Do you care**?


THE GREAT TRIBULATION Daniel's 70th Week
Second coming; Armagaeddon (Rev. 19; 11:15-19)
Rapture of Tribulation Saints- Gleanings (Rev. 7:9-17; 11:12; 14:14-16; 16:15)
Destruction of Babylon the Great (Revelation 18)
Covenant made with the beast (Antichrist)- Dan. 9:27
144,000 witnesses sealed (Rev. 7:1-3)
3.5 Year Mark (Matt.24:15; Dan. 9:27; 12:11)
-Antichrist wounded and resurrected
-Abomination of desolation
-Persecution of Israel is turned up
Rapture (Rev 4:1-2)
Matt. 24:3-31: False Christs, Wars, Famines, Pestilences, Earthquakes, Persecutions, Gospel preached to the whole world
Seals 1-7: Antichrist, War, Famine, Death, Persecution, Earthquake, Silence in Heaven
Trumpets 1-7: Hail and Fire and Blood, Great mountain, Great star, 1/3 of sun and moon and stars smitten, scorpion locusts, 4 angels and horsemen, second coming
Vials 1-7: Sores on men, sea turns to blood, rivers turn to blood, sun scorches men, darkness over the earth, Euphrates River dried up, second coming

REVELATION The Revelation of Jesus Christ

THE RAPTURE & 4 TRIBULATION ACCOUNTS: *CHAPTER 4-19 - "...the things which are..."*

**We just came through a study of church history and how each of the churches this book was written to was doctrinally a picture of a period of church history. The word church shows up 19x in the book of Revelation and 18 of those times is in chapters 1-3. We will not see the word church again until the close of this book in chapter 22. This is another significant sign to show us exactly what the first part of this book was all about ("the things which thou hast seen") and also what we will be looking at next ("the things which are" (Revelation 1:10- "on the Lord's Day) →

1. **THE RAPTURE AND THE IMMEDIATE SCENE IN HEAVEN** - Rev. 4-5
    a. **Where else is the rapture described in the Bible-**
        i. Direct References- 1Cor. 15:50-55; 1 Thess 4:16-17
        ii. Pictures- Gen 5:24; Heb 11:5-6; Gen 19; 2 Peter 2:6-9
    b. **When will this take place?**
        i. We do not know the "day or the hour" (Matt. 24:36) but WE DO KNOW the "times and seasons" (1 Thess. 5:1-2)
        ii. Signs of the Rapture
            1. 2 Tim. 3; Gen 6 (Noah/Enoch)- Matt. 24:37; Luke 17:26; Gen 19 (Lot); 2 Pet 3:3-9 (Days of the Week) 7th Day of Rest/7000th year on of rest; Books of OT (**2 Chron**.- Jews told to go home, **Ezra**/**Neh**- Israel goes home and restores nation, **Esther**- Jewish Bride replaces Gentile bride, **Job**- time of tribulation, **Psalms**- Millennial Kingdom); Parable of the laborers (Matthew 20- brings us to about 2033) ; Revelation 2-3 ending with Laodicean church; Matthew 24:32-35 (Song of Sol. 2:10-13)- the Fig tree
                - All of these passages would bring you to the clear conclusion that the rapture will occur between now and 2061 (with the likely year being around 2033)
    c. **Are there other raptures in the Bible?**
        i. Yes! This is why so many people get this messed up, by misplacing the different raptures. There are a few in Revelation we will see at the end of the tribulation and there was one when Christ first ascended (Matthew 27:52-53; Prov. 25:7)
    d. **Four Beasts-** Seraphim or Cherubim? (**Rev. 4:6-8**; Isa. 6:2-3 **VS.** Eze. 1:6-21; 10: 1-21)
    e. **Elders-** Who are they? (**Rev. 4:4**, 10; 5:9)

i. They have white robes

ii. They have crowns

iii. They are in heaven during the tribulation

iv. They were redeemed by the blood of the lamb

f. **The 7 Sealed Book- Rev. 5** (Eph. 1:13-14; 4:30; 2 Cor. 1:22; 5:5; Lev. 25:23-46)

1. **Earnest**- "*First fruits; that which is in advance, and gives promise of something to come. Thus the earnest of the spirit is given to saints, as a pledge or assurance of their future enjoyment of God's presence and favor.*"

2. **Redeem-** "*To purchase back; to ransom; to liberate or rescue from captivity or bondage, or from any obligation or liability to suffer or to be forfeited, by paying an equivalent*"

ii. What is the 7 Sealed Book? **NOBODY KNOWS**

1. ****The Land Grant to the Earth**- God just redeemed us to himself (vs 9) at the rapture and now he is opening the book of the whole tribulation to redeem the earth to himself

- Lion and Lamb
- Kingdom of God and Kingdom of Heaven
- Vs 9-10 "thou HAST redeemed us…. And we SHALL reign on the earth" (because you are taking it back)
- This is why John weeps and then is comforted
- The Seals are directly connected with God taking back the earth by force

2. **The Book of Daniel** and it's judgements/prophesies (Daniel 12:4)

3. **The Book of Revelation**- This book contains all the rest of the contents of Revelation

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1. The 7 Seals – Rev. 6; 8:1-6

a. The rider on a white horse… The **Antichrist** (**Rev. 6:1-2**)

b. The rider on a red horse… **War** (**Rev. 6:3-4**)

c. The rider on a black horse… **Famine** (**Rev. 6:5-6**)

d. The rider on a pale horse… **Death** (**Rev. 6:7-8**)

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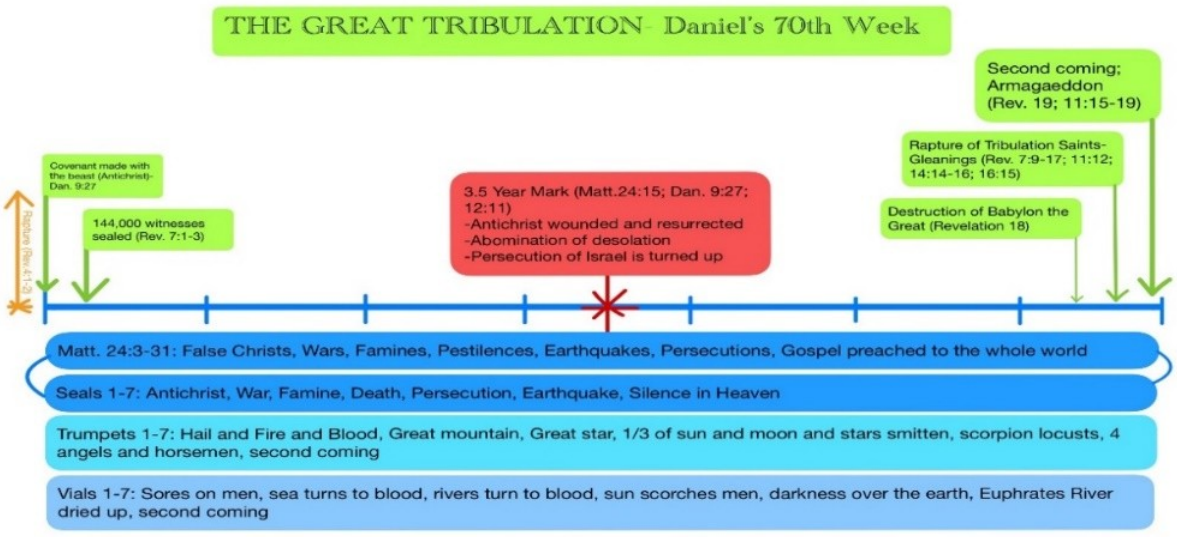

REVELATION The Revelation of Jesus Christ

THE RAPTURE & 4 TRIBULATION ACCOUNTS: *CHAPTER 4-19 - "…the things which are…"*

1. **2nd Account of the Tribulation-** The 7 Trumpets - Rev. 8:2-11:19
    a. **Trumpet 1-** Hail and fire mingled with blood cast upon the Earth (Rev. 8:2-7)
        i. 1/3 of the trees and grass of the Earth are burned up
    b. **Trumpet 2-** A great mountain burning with **fire** is cast into the sea (Rev. 8:8-9)
        i. 1/3 part of the sea becomes blood
        ii. 1/3 of the sea animals dies
        iii. 1/3 of the ships are destroyed
    c. **Trumpet 3-** A great star, called "**Wormwood**" falls from heaven to the Earth (Rev. 8:10-11)
        i. Falls on 1/3 of the rivers and fountains of waters and makes them bitter
        ii. Many men died because of the water
    d. **Trumpet 4-** 1/3 of the Sun, Moon, and stars are smitten (Rev. 8:12-13)
        i. 1/3 of the lights of heaven are taken away, reducing the 24-hour day to a 16-hour day
        ii. A woe is declared to the inhabitants of the Earth!
    e. **Trumpet 5-** Scorpion-like **locusts** are released from the bottomless pit, ruled by Abbaddon/Apollyon (Rev. 9:1-12)
        i. They are commanded to not hurt the grass, anything green, trees, and the 144,000 witnesses
        ii. They do not kill people, but torture them for 5-months… Those struck by them will seek death but will not find it
        iii. They're appearance are like a horse with the face of a man, a crown on the head, hair like a woman, teeth like a lion, breastplate of iron, wings, tails like a scorpion with a stinger
        iv. These are not ordinary locusts:
            1. They come out of smoke (locusts hate smoke)
            2. They have a king (Proverbs 30:27)
            3. They are not hurting vegetation (this is what locusts are known for) BUT HUNTING DOWN MEN
            4. Their description is clearly not that of normal locusts but of supernatural beasts from inside of the earth
        v. Joel 2:1-11 gives us even more detail about this trumpet
    f. **Trumpet 6-** 4 angels are released and **200 million** horsemen to kill 1/3 of men (Rev. 9:13-21)
        i. There are 4 angels currently bound in the Euphrates River that are loosed to lead a cavalry that will kill 1/3 of mankind

ii. The cavalry have breastplates of fire, jacinth, and brimstone; the horse's head is like a lion, has the ability to breathe fire, smoke, and brimstone, their tails are like serpents

iii. This judgment is described in Isaiah 5:24-30

PARENTHETICAL CHAPTERS (describing other events that occurred during these 6-6 ½ years)

g. **Mighty Angel and the little book-** (Rev. 10)

i. This angel matches the exact description given of Jesus Christ elsewhere in Revelation (Rev. 1:12-16; 4:3; 1:7)

ii. He calls the 2 witnesses of God in chapter 11, "my witnesses" (11:3)

iii. He has a "little book" opened in his hand

iv. He clearly shows up during the tribulation (likely early on)

v. It is emphasized that he is a "mighty angel", just as Jesus Christ was referred to as an angel in multiple ways throughout the OT, this would resonate with the Jews

vi. This angel is Jesus Christ and the book is likely the book of Daniel

1. This event seems to describe Jesus Christ showing up to the Jews during the Tribulation (likely year 2- Gen. 45:1, 4-6) much like he did to Paul (a great picture of a tribulation saint) to convert him and use him for a specific mission) preaching to them the prophesies of Daniel and the things still to come and fulfilling the "day" in which Israel will be born again (Isa. 66:7-8) and the appearing of Christ right around the time of the temple being rebuilt (Ezekiel 40-43:2; Rev. 10-11)

h. **Measuring of the Temple** (Rev. 11:1-2)

i. The temple will be built before/during the tribulation. God is drawing our attention to the fact that the temple is up and that it is different than the other temples from before

ii. SLIDE

iii. Based on recent archaeological digs, scientists have almost conclusively proven that the center of the location would be about 100 yards from the dome of the rock

1. This puts the "outer court" RIGHT WHERE THE DOME OF THE ROCK SITS

iv. The temple will likely be built before the rapture in my opinion based on the pattern of books as God set them

1. 2 Chronicles- Israel told to go home
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i. **2 Witnesses and the Rapture of Tribulation Saints** (Rev. 11:3-14)

i. The two witnesses of the OT as a whole are the Law and the Prophets (Represented by Moses and Elijah) Two of the most prominent figures to Jews

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1. Make it not rain for 3 ½ years (1 Kings 17:1; James 5:17)
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    a. Many of the plagues that they cause on the earth in Revelation line up with the plagues of Exodus that Moses did (Rev. 16:1-21; Exo. 9:8-12; 7:19-21; 10:21-23; 9:22-26)
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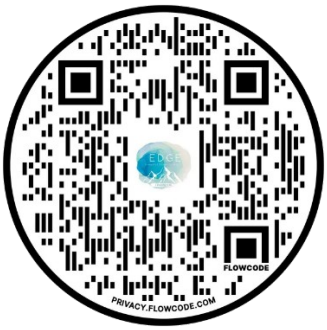

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            1. I would tend to believe that these creatures are of course supernatural beings, but that they are in fact spirit beings.
            2. They:
                a. Come out of the bottomless pit

b. Have a similar mixed behemoth type description like other spiritual beings (4 beasts)

c. Have no characteristics of normal locusts other than appearance

d. They have the ability to keep men from being able to kill themselves (possibly they possess their host when they sting them)

i. This would mean that they are invisible to the human eye at this time (remember, in context, John in "in the spirit" on the Lord's day)

ii. This reminds me of the movie bird box

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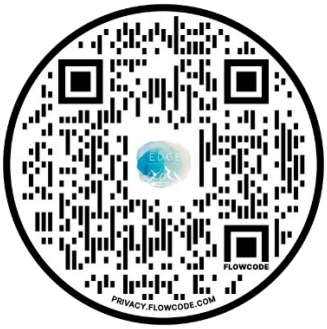

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1. **3rd Account of the Tribulation-** The 7 Personages – Rev. 12-15
    a. **Personage 1-** The Woman (Rev. 12:1-2)
        i. This woman is the nation of _____(Gen 37:9-10; Rev. 12:5; 19:15)
        ii. She gives birth to a manchild who will rule the nations with a rod of iron (12:5)
        iii. She is on the run from the dragon for 3 ½ years in the wilderness (12:6,14) where God miraculously feeds and protects her (Exodus; Matt. 24:15-21; Rev. 12:14-16)
    b. **Personage 2-** The Great Red _____ (Rev. 12:3-4)
        i. He has multiple heads and is described as a dragon just like Leviathan (Psa. 74:14; Job 41; Isa. 27:1; Rev. 12:9)
        ii. He seeks to devour the "man-child" of Israel that was to be born and rule the world (Gen. 3:15; 4:8; Matt. 2:16)
        c. He has seven heads with seven crowns upon his heads - These are the demonic Gentile kings and kingdoms that Satan used to control the world until the first coming of the Messiah. They are seven kings and kingdoms. They are described throughout scripture. They are:
            i. Nimrod, king of Babel - Genesis 10:8- 10
            ii. Pharaoh, king of Egypt - Exodus 5:2; Ezk. 29:3
            iii. Sennacherib, king of Assyria - 2 Kings 18:13
            iv. Nebuchadnezzar, king of Babylon- Daniel 1:3; Jer. 51:34
            v. Darius, king of the Medo-Persian empire - Daniel 5:31
            vi. Alexander the great, king of Greece - Daniel 8:21; 10:20; 11:2
            vii. Caesar, emperor (king) of Rome- Luke 1:68-71; 2:1
        d. He has a tail with which he drew/draws 1/3 of the angels/stars to the earth with him (Rev. 12:4,9)
        e. He has angels (called the stars of heaven) – (Job 38:7; Ps. 147:4; Is. 14: 13; Rev, 1:20)
        f. He is that old serpent (connects him with the serpent that has been causing trouble since the garden)
        g. He is the Devil/Satan (accuser)- Rev. 12:9-10
    h. **Personage 3-** The Man child (Rev. 12:5)
        i. This is no doubt Jesus Christ (Psa. 2:7-9; Micah 5:2-3; Rev. 19:15)
    i. **Personage 4-** Michel the Archangel (Rev. 12:7)
        i. He is the "prince" who stands for Israel (the highest ranking Angel who God has commissioned to protect Israel)- Dan. 10:13, 21; 12:1

j. **Personage 5-** Remnant of the Seed of the woman (Rev. 12:17)

k. Those who are considered part of the "remnant" at this time:

i. Keep the commandments of God

ii. Have the Testimony of Jesus Christ

iii. They will be the focus of the attacks of the devil at this time, unlike anything the world has ever seen (Daniel 7:25; Rev. 14:12; 6:9; 20:4)

l. **Personage 6-** The 1st Beast (Revelation 13:1-10)

m. He comes out of the Sea (Mediterranean)- He is a composite of multiple nationalities

i. He will have connections to the area known as Assyria - Dan. 8:8-9; Is. 10:5-25; 14:25-27; Mic. 5

ii. He has connections to Israel (likely the tribe of Dan) - Dan. 11:37; Gen. 49:16-17; Deut. 33:22

iii. He has connections to the Roman Empire - Dan. 9:26

n. He is connected with the Dragon BUT is not the Dragon

Chapter 12	Chapter 13
Great red dragon	Like a leopard with bear's feet and a lion's mouth
7 heads and ten horns…	7 heads and ten horns…
7 crowns on *each* of *his 7 heads*	10 crowns on the 10 horns (no crowns on the 7 heads)
No *name written* on *his heads*	Name of blasphemy written on his heads
Comes from *heaven*	Comes from the sea
	Receives his power and seat of authority from the Dragon

o. He represents a king **and** a kingdom (these terms as used interchangeably in the Bible)- Daniel 7:7, 17, 23

p. His kingdom is the 7th and final head of this beast (also the 8tH- Rev. 17:10-11) likely be a composite of Britain, Russia, and the United States (Daniel 7:1-8 with Rev. 13:1-2) but in total made up of 10 kings (Rev. 13:12) of which 3 are replaced by the antichrist's kingdom/country he rules (Dan. 7:8, 24; Rev. 17:8-11)

i. It is important to remember none of these pictures are clear cut and 100% at all times; the beast is clearly a man, clearly a kingdom, and also clearly described as a singular head of the beast at times (Rev. 17:11)

ii. The bottom line is that it seems a 10 kingdom federation will be formed, with the character qualities/makeup of Britain, Russia, and the US (among other small nations/kingdoms as well) and the antichrist will be handed power over this kingdom (beast; Rev. 6:1-2) as the final head of the beast and will replace 3 of the kingdoms with himself/his kingdom, making him the 8th and final one

q. One of his heads (the implication is the last one, who is this beast, _____ _____) is killed and resurrected (Rev. 13:3-4) after he is possessed by the Devil himself (dragon who was just kicked out of heaven) where he commits the abomination of desolation (Daniel 9:27; 12:11; Matt. 24:15-21)

r. This is the antichrist the 2nd member of the Satanic trinity (Dragon-Satan/devil; antichrist)

s. These are just some of the highlights of who this antichrist is; he is maybe the most prominent character in the Bible outside of God himself, so there is an endless amount we could say about him (for more details, refer to the chart)

t. **Personage 7-** The 2nd Beast (Rev. 13:11-18)

u. This beast has power like the first beast and speaks as a dragon but with the appearance of a lamb (vs 11-13)

i. They have power that is supernatural to do miracles and they look like a harmless lamb (associated with Christ and Christianity) but speaks as a dragon (what they are saying is of the devil)

v. They cause the first beast to be worshipped (much like the Holy Ghost causes Christ to be worshipped) (vs 12)

w. They perform miracles and convince men to worship idols/image of the beast (vs. 14-15)

x. Causes the world to take the mark of the beast (vs 16-18)

y. This beast is the false prophet (Rev. 19:20); the 3rd member of the satanic trinity (Rev. 16:13)

2. **The Tribulation Saints in Heaven** (Rev. 14:1-5)

a. This again shows us the rapture of the saints of the tribulation before the 2nd coming

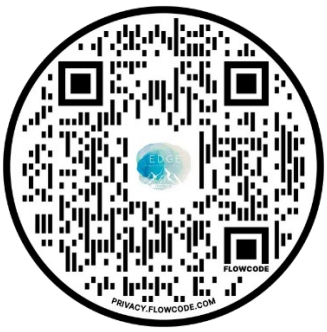
3. **The Second Coming** (Rev. 14:14-20)

a. Here we have another account of the "day of the Lord" the second coming with some gruesome details

b. Joel 3:11-17 gives us this account of this day as well

c. Here we have the description of blood on the day of the 2nd coming. The battle will end with blood in the valley of Jehoshaphat up to the horses bridle (4-6 feet) for about 200 miles

4. **7 angels prepare to pour the 7 final vials of judgment** (Revelation 15)



REVELATION The Revelation of Jesus Christ

THE RAPTURE & 4 TRIBULATION ACCOUNTS: *CHAPTER 4-19 - "…the things which are…"*

1. **3rd Account of the Tribulation-** The 7 Personages – Rev. 12-15
    a. **Personage 1-** The Woman (Rev. 12:1-2)
        i. This woman is the nation of **Israel** (Gen 37:9-10; Rev. 12:5; 19:15)
        ii. She gives birth to a manchild who will rule the nations with a rod of iron (12:5)
        iii. She is on the run from the dragon for 3 ½ years in the wilderness (12:6,14) where God miraculously feeds and protects her (Exodus; Matt. 24:15-21; Rev. 12:14-16)
    b. **Personage 2-** The Great Red **Dragon** (Rev. 12:3-4)
        i. He has multiple heads and is described as a dragon just like Leviathan (Psa. 74:14; Job 41; Isa. 27:1; Rev. 12:9)
        ii. He seeks to devour the "man-child" of Israel that was to be born and rule the world (Gen. 3:15; 4:8; Matt. 2:16)
        c. He has seven heads with seven crowns upon his heads - These are the demonic Gentile kings and kingdoms that Satan used to control the world until the first coming of the Messiah. They are seven kings and kingdoms. They are described throughout scripture. They are:
            i. **Nimrod, king of Babel** - Genesis 10:8- 10
            ii. Pharaoh, king of Egypt - Exodus 5:2; Ezk. 29:3
            iii. Sennacherib, king of Assyria - 2 Kings 18:13
            iv. **Nebuchadnezzar, king of Babylon**- Daniel 1:3; Jer. 51:34
            v. Darius, king of the Medo-Persian empire - Daniel 5:31
            vi. Alexander the great, king of Greece - Daniel 8:21; 10:20; 11:2
            vii. Caesar, emperor (king) of Rome- Luke 1:68-71; 2:1
        d. He has a tail with which he drew/draws 1/3 of the angels/stars to the earth with him (Rev. 12:4,9)
        e. He has angels (called the stars of heaven) – (Job 38:7; Ps. 147:4; Is. 14: 13; Rev, 1:20)
        f. He is that old serpent (connects him with the serpent that has been causing trouble since the garden)
        g. He is the Devil/Satan (accuser)- Rev. 12:9-10
    h. **Personage 3-** The Man child (Rev. 12:5)
        i. This is no doubt Jesus Christ (Psa. 2:7-9; Micah 5:2-3; Rev. 19:15)
    i. **Personage 4-** Michel the Archangel (Rev. 12:7)
        i. He is the "prince" who stands for Israel (the highest ranking Angel who God has commissioned to protect Israel)- Dan. 10:13, 21; 12:1
    j. **Personage 5-** Remnant of the Seed of the woman (Rev. 12:17)
        k. Those who are considered part of the "remnant" at this time:
            i. Keep the commandments of God
            ii. Have the Testimony of Jesus Christ
                1. This is like it was in the Old Testament except for the fact that you will have to trust in Jesus Christ as well. Theses are considered part of the "remnant" of the seed of Israel due to the fact that those who want to be saved at this time will have to become part of Israel as it were (ex. Rahab) just like proselytes in the Old Testament

iii. They will be the focus of the attacks of the devil at this time, unlike anything the world has ever seen (Daniel 7:25; Rev. 14:12; 6:9; 20:4)

l. **Personage 6-** The 1st Beast (Revelation 13:1-10)

m. He comes out of the Sea (Mediterranean)- He is a composite of multiple nationalities

i. He will have connections to the area known as Assyria - Dan. 8:8-9; Is. 10:5-25; 14:25-27; Mic. 5

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7 heads and ten horns…
7 crowns on each of his 7 heads
No *name written* on *his heads*
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Name of blasphemy written on his heads
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w. They perform miracles and convince men to worship idols/image of the beast (vs. 14-15)
x. Causes the world to take the mark of the beast (vs 16-18)
y. This beast is the false prophet (Rev. 19:20); the 3rd member of the satanic trinity (Rev. 16:13)
    i. It is very likely that this is the Pope; the leader of the mystery form Roman kingdom that has ruled and will rule the world to this very day!

2. **The Tribulation Saints in Heaven** (Rev. 14:1-5)
    a. This again shows us the rapture of the saints of the tribulation before the 2nd coming
3. **The Second Coming** (Rev. 14:14-20)
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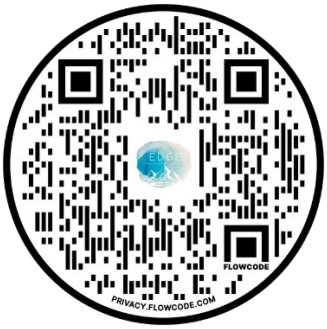

REVELATION The Revelation of Jesus Christ

1) **The 7 Vials** - Rev. 16:1-19:6

i) **Vial 1-** A noiseome and grevious **sore** upon men/women that receive the mark of the beast and worship the beast's image (Rev. 16:2)

(1) This lines up with the 1st trumpet (Rev. 8:7) where hail and fire mingled with blood rain down. This no doubt would cause serious sores on men if they came into contact with this hail, fire, and blood

ii) **Vial 2-** The sea becomes blood and every living soul in the sea dies (Rev. 16:3)

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iii) **Vial 3-** The rivers and fountain of waters become blood (Rev. 16:4-7)

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iv) **Vial 4-** The **sun** scorches men with fire and great heat (Rev. 16:8-9)

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v) **Vial 5-** The kingdom of the Antichrist becomes full of **darkness** (Rev. 16:10-11)

(1) This lines up with the 5th trumpet (Rev. 9:1-12) where bottomless pit is opened and the "sun and the air were darkened by reason of the smoke of the pit."

vi) **Vial 6-** The river Euphrates is dried up to make a way for an invasion (Rev. 16:12-16)

(1) This lines up with the 6th trumpet (Rev. 9:13-21) where the angels that are bound in the Euphrates river are freed to go and judge the earth. Evidently they are released by the drying up of the river and it also makes the way for the "kings of the east" to gather for the battle of Armageddon.

RAPTURE OF THE TRIBULATION SAINTS - "The Gleanings" (Rev. 16:15)

vii) **Vial 7-** The Revealing and Destruction of BABYLON THE GREAT (Rev. 16:17-19:6)

(1) Who is the Mystery of Babylon the Great?

(2) There is only ONE thing this woman can be describing. A UNIVERSAL (Catholic) church (**vs. 1, 15**) located in the city of seven hills (**vs. 9**- Rome), whose colors are scarlet and purple (bishops and cardinals- **vs. 4**), whose main symbol is a GOLDEN CHALICE (**vs. 4**) filled with FERMENTED BLOOD (**vs. 2, 6**- alcohol they say is transformed into blood) who is called a MOTHER (**vs. 5**) and out of who

comes many HARLOTS/STRANGE WOMEN (**vs. 5-** false religions), who is responsible for the deaths of MILLIONS OF MARTYRS (**vs. 6**) who sells herself for MONEY (**vs. 1**) and who reigns over the kings of the earth (**vs. 18**). This is NOT PAGAN ROME, the only qualities that apply to them would be being located in Rome and killing martyrs. EVERY QUALITY OF THIS WOMAN APPLIES ONLY TO THE UNHOLY MOTHER ROMAN CATHOLIC CHURCH!

(a) We see this same system in Judges 16-17

(i) 16:4-5- Delilah sells out a Mighty Man (Prov. 7:26) for 1100 pieces of silver

(ii) 16:1- She is a harlot

(iii) 17:1- An unnamed "mother" RIGHT AFTER THIS STORY has 1100 pieces of silver

1. Using our rules of bible study such as comparing scripture with scripture and consistency factor, we find out that this woman in chapter 17 is very likely Delilah. Making her a Mother and a Harlot and a Philistine who worships Dagon (16:

(iv) 17:3-4- She uses blood money (some of which she holds back) to pay for a house of idols dedicated to the "Lord" Money she won by killing a man of God (martyr)

(v) 17:5- The son has a house of idols (some of which likely were Dagon statues who the Philistines- 16:23- like his mother worshipped CHART)

(vi) 17:10- The son then hires a priest who he calls "father" who wears a robe (ephod) adorned with colors (such as purple and Scarlett) and jewels/precious stones

1. To sum it up, we have here: "religious" (names God but worships idols) harlot mother who makes martyrs of God's men and uses the money she makes to build houses of idol worship for her sons who are priests called "father" who wear multi colored robes (purple and scarlet) covered with precious stones

a. In Rev. 18:20 we find out this woman has killed not only God's Apostles but also his prophets! (goes back to at least Abraham- Gen. 20:7 who was called a prophet) which goes back almost 4,000 years! (1898 BC to when John records her destruction which is still future)

b. This religious system has been THE SAME ONE at play since the very beginning!

(3) She is in the business of making money off of "slaves" and the "souls of men" (18:12-13)

(4) She will be burned with fire and yet shall drown as a millstone into the sea (Rev. 18:8,9,18,21)

(a) The millstone is a heavy and dense stone that drowns easily and quickly

(b) How does this work? (CHART)

(i) It seems very likely that the earthquake (Rev. 16:18-19) that was so great there has never been another like it, will actually cause the ground to open up and swallow this great city into the middle of the earth

1. THE 2ND COMING OF THE LORD JESUS CHRIST; THE GREATEST DAY ON GOD'S CALENDAR (Rev. 19:11-20:3)

a. The glorified Jesus Christ returns as King of kings and Lord of lords riding on a white horse with great power and authority to judge and make war - vs. 11, 16; Ps. 96:13; Jer. 23:5-6

b. When Jesus' feet touch Mount of Olives, the whole mountain is split in two - Acts 1:11; Zec. 14:4

c. His eyes are as a flame of fire, his countenance is as the sun in its strength, and his clothes will be stained with the blood of his enemies - vs. 12-13, 15; Rev. 1:14-16; 2:18; Is. 63:1-5; Jdg. 13:18

d. There is an army that follows him clothed in white and riding on white horses - vs. 14; Jude 14-15; Zec. 14:5; 2Thess 1:7
e. An angel declares victory for Jesus Christ before the battle even takes place - vs. 17-18; Is. 9:5; 34:1-17
f. The antichrist (beast) and his army prepare themselves for the battle, but they are quickly defeated. The Antichrist and the false prophet are thrown alive into the lake of fire, and the remaining armies of the Antichrist are slain by the word of the Lord. - vs. 19-21; Dan. 7:21-22; 8:25; 2Thess. 2:8; Is. 14:15-17; Ezek. 28:18; Rev.14:20; Ps. 58:10

2. **THE MILLENNIAL REIGN OF THE LORD JESUS CHRIST** (Rev. 20:3-10)
   a. Satan is bound in the bottomless pit for 1,000 years by an angel - vs. 1-3; 2Pt. 2:4; Jude 6; Lk. 8:31
   b. The Lord Jesus Christ makes a covenant with the physical remnant of Israel that survived the Tribulation - Zec. 12:10-14; Is. 59:20; Heb. 9:28; 8:8-12; Jer. 31:31-37
   c. Those were partakers of the 1st resurrection (the firstfruits, harvest, and gleanings of the rapture) live and reign with Christ for 1,000 years, and they are also given the privilege of carrying out the judgment of the nations and rulership over cities - vs. 4-6; Dan. 7:22; Matt. 25:31-46; 13:47-50; 19:28; 1Cor. 6:2-3; Rev. 1:6; 3:21
      i. We will be given/not given responsibility over cities and kingdoms in the future based upon our faithfulness during our lives, this will be our purpose from here into eternity future (Luke 19:11-27; Rev. 1:6; 5:10; Rom 8:17)
   d. When 1,000 years have transpired, Satan is loosed from the bottomless pit and he quickly amasses an army for another coup d'état attempt against the Lord Jesus Christ - vs. 7-8
   e. Satan's final rebellion is speedily and soundly squelched when God sends fire down from heaven to devour them all - vs. 9; Ps. 125:1-2
   f. Satan is cast into the lake of fire and brimstone and "shall be tormented day and night for ever and ever" - vs. 10; Rom. 16:20; Job 40:11-14; Mal. 4:3

REVELATION 20:11-22:21- "*the things which shall be hereafter*"

3. **THE GREAT WHITE THRONE JUDGMENT** (Rev. 20:11-15)
   a. The Lord Jesus Christ is seated on a great white throne as the Judge - vs. 11; Jn. 5:22-30; Rom. 2:16; Eccl. 11:9; 12:14
   b. The earth and heaven flee away and those that were not part of the first resurrection are bodily resurrected to be judged; the dead from the sea and hell are also bodily resurrected to stand before God with nowhere to hide - vs. 11-13; Ezek. 37:1-14; 2 Pt. 3:7, 10-12; 2:4; Jude 6
   c. All those that stand before God the Son are judged according to their works based on things written in a book of books (the Bible!) - vs. 12-13; Dan. 7:9-10
   d. Death and hell are cast into the lake of fire - vs. 14 and whosoever is found in the book of life is permitted into life eternal, but whosoever is not found written in the book of life is cast into the lake of fire - vs. 15
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a. The glorified Jesus Christ returns as King of kings and Lord of lords riding on a white horse with great power and authority to judge and make war - vs. 11, 16; Ps. 96:13; Jer. 23:5-6

b. When Jesus' feet touch Mount of Olives, the whole mountain is split in two - Acts 1:11; Zec. 14:4

c. His eyes are as a flame of fire, his countenance is as the sun in its strength, and his clothes will be stained with the blood of his enemies - vs. 12-13, 15; Rev. 1:14-16; 2:18; Is. 63:1-5; Jdg. 13:18

d. There is an army that follows him clothed in white and riding on white horses - vs. 14; Jude 14-15; Zec. 14:5; 2Thess 1:7

e. An angel declares victory for Jesus Christ before the battle even takes place - vs. 17-18; Is. 9:5; 34:1-17

f. The antichrist (beast) and his army prepare themselves for the battle, but they are quickly defeated. The Antichrist and the false prophet are thrown alive into the lake of fire, and the remaining armies of the Antichrist are slain by the word of the Lord. - vs. 19-21; Dan. 7:21-22; 8:25; 2Thess. 2:8; Is. 14:15-17; Ezek. 28:18; Rev.14:20; Ps. 58:10

2. THE MILLENNIAL REIGN OF THE LORD JESUS CHRIST (Rev. 20:3-10)

a. Satan is bound in the bottomless pit for 1,000 years by an angel - vs. 1-3; 2Pt. 2:4; Jude 6; Lk. 8:31

b. The Lord Jesus Christ makes a covenant with the physical remnant of Israel that survived the Tribulation - Zec. 12:10-14; Is. 59:20; Heb. 9:28; 8:8-12; Jer. 31:31-37

c. Those were partakers of the 1st resurrection (the firstfruits, harvest, and gleanings of the rapture) live and reign with Christ for 1,000 years, and they are also given the privilege of carrying out the judgment of the nations and rulership over cities - vs. 4-6; Dan. 7:22; Matt. 25:31-46; 13:47-50; 19:28; 1Cor. 6:2-3; Rev. 1:6; 3:21

   i. We will be given/not given responsibility over cities and kingdoms in the future based upon our faithfulness during our lives, this will be our purpose from here into eternity future (Luke 19:11-27; Rev. 1:6; 5:10; Rom 8:17)

d. When 1,000 years have transpired, Satan is loosed from the bottomless pit and he quickly amasses an army for another coup d'état attempt against the Lord Jesus Christ - vs. 7-8

e. Satan's final rebellion is speedily and soundly squelched when God sends fire down from heaven to devour them all - vs. 9; Ps. 125:1-2

f. Satan is cast into the lake of fire and brimstone and "shall be tormented day and night for ever and ever" - vs. 10; Rom. 16:20; Job 40:11-14; Mal. 4:3

REVELATION 20:11-22:21- "*the things which shall be hereafter"*

3. **THE GREAT WHITE THRONE JUDGMENT** (Rev. 20:11-15)

a. The Lord Jesus Christ is seated on a great white throne as the Judge - vs. 11; Jn. 5:22-30; Rom. 2:16; Eccl. 11:9; 12:14

b. The earth and heaven flee away and those that were not part of the first resurrection are bodily resurrected to be judged; the dead from the sea and hell are also bodily resurrected to stand before God with nowhere to hide - vs. 11-13; Ezek. 37:1-14; 2 Pt. 3:7, 10-12; 2:4; Jude 6

c. All those that stand before God the Son are judged according to their works based on things written in a book of books (the Bible!) - vs. 12-13; Dan. 7:9-10

d. Death and hell are cast into the lake of fire - vs. 14 and whosoever is found in the book of life is permitted into life eternal, but whosoever is not found written in the book of life is cast into the lake of fire - vs. 15

e. Sin is judged once and for all, and now all things can be restored to what they were intended to be in the original Garden of Eden…

REVELATION The Revelation of Jesus Christ

1) **THE MILLENNIAL REIGN OF THE LORD JESUS CHRIST** (Rev. 20:3-10)

a) Satan is bound in the bottomless pit for **1,000** years by an angel - vs. 1-3; 2Pt. 2:4; Jude 6; Lk. 8:31

b) Thus begins the 1000 year millennial reign of Christ

i) It is important to note that there are 3 views on the millennial kingdom in Christianity. Premillennial (Christ comes back before the millennium and starts the era of peace through force), post millennialism (Christ comes back after the church has done its job and ushered in 1000 years of peace on the earth, it's our job to do this), and amillennialism (there is no millennial reign of Christ on the earth, it is all spiritual and metaphorical)

ii) These matter because what you believe about this will change how you view the world and how you live your life and what you live it for. Many churches focus on humanitarian work and social work to try and make the world a better place and don't teach biblical truth or the gospel because they think their job is to bring peace on earth.

iii) The devil is in the business of trying to create a 1000 year "peace" kingdom. He will start his next and final "kingdom" with a false peace treaty (HITLER SLIDE)

(1) FINALLY- It is important to remember that in contrast to the eternity future which would be more like the time of the original plan/design of God in Genesis 1:1 to the fall of Lucifer , this would be more like the time of the garden of Eden (the devil is not finished, man/Christ have dominion over the earth, perfect earth but not a perfect universe yet, etc…)

c) Those were partakers of the 1st resurrection (the firstfruits, harvest, and gleanings of the rapture) live and reign with Christ for 1,000 years, and they are also given the privilege of carrying out the judgment of the nations and rulership over cities - vs. 4-6; Dan. 7:22; Matt. 25:31-46; 13:47-50; 19:28; 1Cor. 6:2-3; Rev. 1:6; 3:21

i) We will be given/not given responsibility over cities and kingdoms in the future based upon our faithfulness during our lives, this will be our purpose from here into eternity future (Luke 19:11-27; Rev. 1:6; 5:10; Rom 8:17; Isa. 9:6-7)

d) SOME AMAZING FACTS ABOUT THIS TIME

i) We will have supernatural glorified bodies as Christ's, able to do and understand things in an amazing way- 1 Cor. 15:42-42; Isaiah 40:31; Phil 3:21; 2 Cor. 13:4; Luke 20:35-36; 1 Jn 3:2

(1) We see angels in the Bible kill tens of thousands of soldiers (one angel), we see them able to fly (they have no wings), we see them change their appearance (sometimes very bright and glorious, sometimes people think they are just a normal person), the offspring of fallen angels and women created giants. All of this to say, angels are super powerful, able to travel at immeasurable speeds, and change appearance

(2) This is all **Not** those who made it through the tribulation and judgement of nations, they will be the ones populating the earth that we will reign and judge over

ii) The world will be in perfect harmony with **nature** again- Isaiah 11:6-10

iii) Human life will be prolonged- Isa. 65:20, 22

iv) The light of day and night will be increased- Isa. 30:26

(1) This is not about the new heaven and earth because God is the light of those in eternity future, there is no more sun/moon

v) The earth will be extremely fruitful again- Joel 3:18; Amos 9:13; Isa. 55:13

e) When 1,000 years have transpired, Satan is loosed from the bottomless pit and he quickly amasses an army for another attempt for the throne against the Lord Jesus Christ - vs. 7-8

f) Satan's final rebellion is quickly stopped when God sends fire down from heaven to devour them all - vs. 9; Ps. 125:1-2

g) Satan is cast into the lake of fire and brimstone and "shall be tormented day and night for ever and ever" - vs. 10; Rom. 16:20; Job 40:11-14; Mal. 4:3

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d) Death and hell are cast into the lake of fire - vs. 14 and whosoever is found in the book of life is permitted into life eternal, but whosoever is not found written in the book of life is cast into the lake of fire - vs. 15

i) Understand that YOU WILL BE HERE ON THIS DAY. Everyone will be here including us. We will be on thrones watching this judgment take place, there is nowhere else to be at this time (vs. 11; Rev. 21:1; 2 Peter 3:7,10)

(1) Who will you watch be judged to an eternity in hell NOT because you shared the truth with them and they denied it, BUT BECAUSE YOU DID NOT SPEAK UP!

(2) I am not over stating it to say that they may look at you, sitting on the other side of this judgment, knowing this day was coming and yet having not said anything, and they will ask why you didn't tell them

ii) Any who have yet to bow to God and confess Jesus as Lord, on this day they will! You can do it today and be free from this judgment but regardless you will one way or another on this day (Phil. 2:10-11)

e) Sin is judged once and for all, and now all things can be restored to what they were intended to be in the original Garden of Eden…

i) This all sounds terrible and the sorrow will be terrible but the ultimate purpose is so that those who have chosen God can spend eternity with him, free from sin and death and all of its consequences

REVELATION The Revelation of Jesus Christ

1) **THE MILLENNIAL REIGN OF THE LORD JESUS CHRIST** (Rev. 20:3-10)
   a) Satan is bound in the bottomless pit for _____ years by an angel - vs. 1-3; 2Pt. 2:4; Jude 6; Lk. 8:31
   b) Thus begins the 1000-year millennial reign of Christ
   c) Those were partakers of the 1st resurrection (the first fruits, harvest, and gleanings of the rapture) live and reign with Christ for 1,000 years, and they are also given the privilege of carrying out the judgment of the nations and rulership over cities - vs. 4-6; Dan. 7:22; Matt. 25:31-46; 13:47-50; 19:28; 1Cor. 6:2-3; Rev. 1:6; 3:21
      i) We will be given/not given responsibility over cities and kingdoms in the future based upon our faithfulness during our lives, this will be our purpose from here into eternity future (Luke 19:11-27; Rev. 1:6; 5:10; Rom 8:17; Isa. 9:6-7)
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      ii) The world will be in perfect harmony with _____ again- Isaiah 11:6-10
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REVELATION The Revelation of Jesus Christ

1) **THE NEW HEAVEN AND NEW EARTH** (Rev. 21:1)

(1) In contrast to the millennial kingdom which would be more like the time of the garden of Eden (the devil is not finished, man/Christ have dominion over the earth, perfect earth but not a perfect universe yet, etc…); this New Heaven and Earth would be more like the original plan/design of God in Genesis 1:1 to the fall of Lucifer

ii) **New Heaven**- Notice this is "Heaven" singular. Just as God originally created in Genesis 1:1 before the fall of Lucifer, this is all the way back to God's original plan as it would have been during that time

(a) New Heaven is important because there is no more space, no more vacuum of darkness or sea of glass or atmosphere between earth and heaven. There is one heaven and one earth in which all the universe dwells

(2) We are **not** absolutely certain of what this time was like but we know that Lucifer at times dwelt with God in Heaven and at times he was on the earth reigning as king over this world (Ezekiel 28:13-17)

(a) SEEMINGLY:

(i) He was an "anointed" cherub that covered God's throne at times of corporate worship (vs. 14, 13b "tabrets and pipes")

(ii) He was also the king over the earth (vs. 13; Isaiah 14:4-12, 18-19; Eze. 28:12-13)

(iii) He likely lived and dwelt on the earth but traveled to heaven at appointed times for worship maybe even partaking of a tree of life as it seems in Revelation 22:2

1. We don't know how often but they (the nations) have to come and eat of this tree in the future every so often

iii) **New Earth**- This new earth will be a **paradise**. This earth will be even more beautiful than the millennial earth or the garden of Eden because there is absolutely no sin, no tempter (Satan), and no more rebellion

(1) It will be occupied by the nations that are "saved" through not rebelling against God in the millennium and who obey the millennial laws and make it through the great white throne judgement (Rev. 21:24)

(a) We also see in the book of Psalms (doctrinally the millennium with David/Christ ruling) that the righteous are told they will "inherit the earth" 4x (Psa. 25:13; 37:9, 11, 22) and the other time the phrase shows up its about the millennial kingdom/law of the land in the book of Matthew (Matt. 5:5)

(2) It will be a place of no day or night, it is lit by the glory of God coming from the New Jerusalem city (Rev. 21:24)

(3) These people will be multiplying and reproducing for all of eternity, they are flesh and blood. Since this process is no longer cursed (22:3) it will be quick and the earth and consequently the universe will begin to populate at an extremely high rate (Isa 9:7)

(4) The other planets in the universe will be populated and need kings to rule over them just as God's original plan with Lucifer and the fallen angels would have been

iv) **New Jerusalem**- This is the city in which God's throne/presence will be and where all of the **saints** will live and have a permanent place of dwelling

(1) This city is called a bride (21:2) and a wife (21:9)

(a) We were the bride of Christ (are now) but become the wife of the Lamb (Christ) after the marriage supper of the lamb which already took place

(b) This city would cover over half of the United States land mass (vs. 15-17)

(c) It is made up of all sorts of gems and precious stones (vs. 18-21)

(d) It's streets are made up of gold that is clear because it is so pure (vs. 21)

(e) This city is where the mansions will be that Christ promised he was going to prepare for us (John 14:2)

(f) God's presence and throne are in the city (vs. 22)

(g) God is the light of the city (vs. 23)

(h) There is a river flowing out of the throne, with trees of life on either side of it bearing fruit and leaves that are for the "healing of the nations" (22:1-3)

v) **All things new-** These characteristics apply to "all things" in the universe now that God has made new (21:4-5)

vi) **Our eternity is certain**

(1) If our eternity is so closely connected with the one that Lucifer and the fallen angels had in eternity past, why do we know that we won't fall just the same as he did?

(a) Ezekiel 28:15-

_____

_____

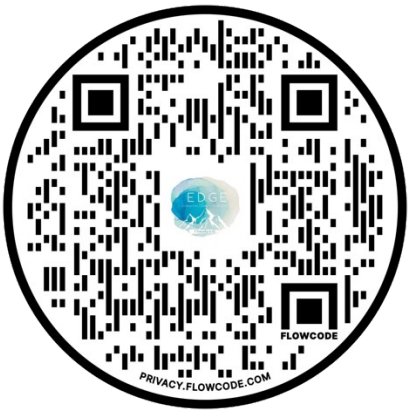
_____

(b) Romans 5:12; Rev. 22:11

_____

_____

_____



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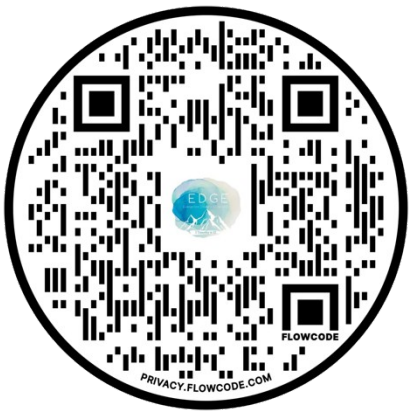

S05 / TEACHING SERIES

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Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

CATHOLICISM WEEK 2

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Catholic Bible**

   ✓ Contains additional books (the Apocrypha)- Romans 3:2

   ✓ This Bible is traced back to Alexandria, Egypt to the Codex's Sinaiticus and Vaticanus and also from the Latin Vulgate primarily translated by Jerome. ALL modern translations in existence today trace back to this corrupt line of manuscripts EXCEPT for the KJV

   ✓ Many verses have been altered or removed similar to translations like the NIV, NASB, etc. (Ex – Acts 8:37-38) Most do not believe in the final authority or preservation of God's Word.

   WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

   God promised to keep and preserve His words - Psalm 12:6-7; Psalm 119:89; Matthew 24:35

   God's words are magnified above His name - Psalm 138:2; 1 Tim. 6:1; Titus 1:2; Jn. 1:1; Rev. 19:13

   His word IS TRUTH, it is where we get the truth. It is our authority!- John 17:17

2. **Traditions**

   ✓ Traditions that were handed down by papal and/or council decree:

   - Infallibility of the Pope, Worship of Mary (Immaculate Conception, Ascension of Mary), Purgatory, using Latin language, kissing the Pope's feet, celibacy of the priesthood, Lent, Canonization of dead saints, Holy water, Indulgances, Transubstantiation, Confession of sins to a priest, refusing the bible to be studied by laymen, clothing, jewelry, chants, decorations/icons, rosary, statues, pilgrimages, etc.

   ✓ The "spiritual experiences" of Catholics around the world (Statue of Mary crying; healing by touching the Pope; image of Mary in grilled cheese sandwich; etc. – These things end up becoming sacred)

   WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

   Mankind habitually makes the commandments of God of none effect through tradition - Matthew 15:1-3, 6; Colossians 2:8; Titus 1:10-16; Isaiah 29:13; 2 Timothy 3

3. **Magisterium of the Church** (Modeled after Pagan Rome)**:**

RCC		ROME
Pope	⁉	Emperor
Cardinals	⁉	Senate
Archbishops	⁉	Imperial Governors
Bishops	⁉	Provincial Governors
Priests	⁉	Civitas (Mayor)

   The RCC will say that their leaders word is greater than or equal to the authority of scripture or tradition. Even calling them infallible!

WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

Each local church is independent and self-governing – Acts 14:23

There are only 2 offices in the local church:

1) Bishop (Elder, Pastor) – 1 Tim. 3:1-2; Titus 1:5-7; Acts 20:17, 28
2) Deacons – 1 Tim. 3:8-13

The word of God is the source of truth, nothing/nobody else!- John 17:17; John 1:1

DOCTRINE

1. Salvation- Faith PLUS works

"Sometimes people make it sound like the Catholic understanding of how to get to heaven is really complex. It's not. While you can go into any of Christ's teachings in a lot of very rich detail, he made sure that this one can be understood even by a child. I can summarize it in two sentences. The two sentences are these: To come to God and be saved, you need to repent, have faith, and be baptized. If you commit mortal sin, you need to repent, have faith, and go to confession."- Catholic Answers

What Catholicism Believes:

- The Sacraments are all different ways of earning grace toward salvation
    - **Baptism**: the first sacrament of initiation, which cleanses the soul of original sin and welcomes the individual into the Church.
    - **Confirmation**: the second sacrament of initiation, which strengthens the individual's faith and commitment to the Church.
    - **Eucharist**: the sacrament of the Body and Blood of Christ, which nourishes the soul and unites the individual with the Church and with Christ.
    - **Penance**: the sacrament of reconciliation, which allows the individual to confess their sins and receive absolution from a priest.
    - **Anointing of the Sick**: the sacrament of healing, which provides spiritual and physical comfort to those who are ill or suffering.
    - **Holy Orders**: the sacrament through which men are ordained as deacons, priests, or bishops to serve the Church.
    - **Marriage**: the sacrament of union between a man and a woman, which reflects the union between Christ and the Church.
- You CANNOT be saved if you are not a part of the Catholic Church (since the Catholic church is the only one true church and they are the ones who administer the sacraments)
    - The Catholic Church still holds that the Church is necessary for salvation and that no one knowing this can reject it and be saved. Vatican II teaches: "Whosoever knowing that the Catholic Church was made necessary by God through Jesus Christ would refuse to enter her or to remain in her could not be saved" (Lumen Gentium, no. 14).- Catholic Answers
- **Scripture passages they use**- James 2:17-26; John 6:53 (Eucharist); John 3:5 (baptism)
- **What they say about passages like Ephesians 2:8-9**

What the Bible Says:

- Salvation is by grace through faith alone (John 3:16; Eph. 2:8-9; Rom. 3:20-30; 6:23; 10:9-10,13; Galatians 2:16; 3:10-12; 5:4; Titus 3:5; Philippians 3:9; 1 Cor. 6:11; John 20:31)
- Anyone can be saved, no matter what church or denomination they belong to (Romans 10:13; John 3:16)
- The Bible says absolutely NOTHING about confessing to a priest or doing acts of penance (1 Tim. 2:5)
- The Bible says absolutely NOTHING about confirmation
- The Bible says absolutely NOTHING about sprinkling of babies for baptism to wash away sin

- The Bible says absolutely NOTHING about a separate office of a bishop (bishops are pastors in the Bible)
- The Bible says absolutely NOTHING about extra grace being given to people who are married
- The Bible says absolutely NOTHING about "healings" of people who are dying, that may or may not work (if it "works" then it's a miracle and if it doesn't then God did not want it to)

2. The Pope

- The first pope was Peter (Matt. 16:18)
- The pope is to remain celibate (Matthew 8:14)
- The pope and priests are called "Father" (Matt. 23:1-10)
- The pope is "infallible" when they speak from "the chair" (Psalm 138:2; John 17:17)
- The popes is the Vicar of Christ "Christ on this earth" (Luke 21:8)

3. Mary the Mother of Jesus

- SHE was immaculately conceived and ascended to heaven without dying
- She was perfect and sinless (Rom. 3:23; 1 Jn. 1:8-10; Luke 1:46-47)
- She is the "queen of heaven" (Jeremiah 7:18; 44:17-25)
    - This is a false goddess that Israel was worshipping and it made God angry

4. The Ten Commandments

- "The Ten Commandments guide Catholics on how to live a righteous life and form the basis for Catholic moral teaching. Here is a list of the Ten Commandments as presented by the Catholic Church:" (Exodus 20:2-17)
    - I am the Lord thy God: thou shalt not have strange gods before me.
    - Thou shalt not take the name of the Lord thy God in vain.
    - Remember to keep holy the Lord's Day.
    - Honor thy father and thy mother.
    - Thou shalt not kill.
    - Thou shalt not commit adultery.
    - Thou shalt not steal.
    - Thou shalt not bear false witness against thy neighbor.
    - Thou shalt not covet thy neighbor's wife.
    - Thou shalt not covet thy neighbor's goods
        - They are missing the commandment about idolatry and making idols out of images!

5. Purgatory

- "The Church gives the name Purgatory to this final purification of the elect, which is entirely different from the punishment of the damned. The Church formulated her doctrine of faith on Purgatory especially at the Councils of Florence and Trent"- Pope John XIX 1031 AD
- The "scripture" they use comes from the apocryphal book of 2 Maccabees
- The ACTUAL Bible says (Matthew 25:46; Daniel 12:2; John 5:29)

WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

CATHOLICISM WEEK 2

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Catholic Bible**

   ✓ Contains additional books (the Apocrypha)- Romans 3:2

   ✓ This Bible is traced back to Alexandria, Egypt to the Codex's Sinaiticus and Vaticanus and also from the Latin Vulgate primarily translated by Jerome. ALL modern translations in existence today trace back to this corrupt line of manuscripts EXCEPT for the KJV

   - ALL MODERN BIBLES COME FROM THE VATICAN, EXCEPT FOR YOUR KJB!

   ✓ Many verses have been altered or removed similar to translations like the NIV, NASB, etc. (Ex – Acts 8:37-38) Most do not believe in the final authority or preservation of God's Word.

WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

God promised to keep and preserve His words - Psalm 12:6-7; Psalm 119:89; Matthew 24:35

God's words are magnified above His name - Psalm 138:2; 1 Tim. 6:1; Titus 1:2; Jn. 1:1; Rev. 19:13

His word IS TRUTH, it is where we get the truth. It is our authority!- John 17:17

2. **Traditions**

   ✓ Traditions that were handed down by papal and/or council decree:

   - Infallibility of the Pope, Worship of Mary (Immaculate Conception, Assumption of Mary), Purgatory, using Latin language, kissing the Pope's feet, celibacy of the priesthood, Lent, Canonization of dead saints, Holy water, Indulgences, Transubstantiation, Confession of sins to a priest, refusing the bible to be studied by laymen, clothing, jewelry, chants, decorations/icons, rosary, statues, pilgrimages, etc.

   ✓ The "spiritual experiences" of Catholics around the world (Statue of Mary crying; healing by touching the Pope; image of Mary in grilled cheese sandwich; etc. – These things end up becoming sacred)

WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

Mankind habitually makes the commandments of God of none effect through tradition - Matthew 15:1-3, 6; Colossians 2:8; Titus 1:10-16; Isaiah 29:13; 2 Timothy 3

3. **Magisterium of the Church** (Modeled after Pagan Rome)**:**

RCC		ROME
Pope	⁉	Emperor
Cardinals	⁉	Senate
Archbishops	⁉	Imperial Governors
Bishops	⁉	Provincial Governors

Priests ⁉ Civitas (Mayor)

The RCC will say that their leaders word is greater than or equal to the authority of scripture or tradition. Even calling them infallible!

WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

Each local church is independent and self-governing – Acts 14:23

There are only 2 offices in the local church:

1) Bishop (Elder, Pastor) – 1 Tim. 3:1-2; Titus 1:5-7; Acts 20:17, 28
2) Deacons – 1 Tim. 3:8-13

The word of God is the source of truth, nothing/nobody else!- John 17:17; John 1:1

DOCTRINE

1. Salvation- Faith PLUS works

"Sometimes people make it sound like the Catholic understanding of how to get to heaven is really complex. It's not. While you can go into any of Christ's teachings in a lot of very rich detail, he made sure that this one can be understood even by a child. I can summarize it in two sentences. The two sentences are these: To come to God and be saved, you need to repent, have faith, and be baptized. If you commit mortal sin, you need to repent, have faith, and go to confession."- Catholic Answers

What Catholicism Believes:

- The Sacraments are all different ways of earning grace toward salvation
    - **Baptism**: the first sacrament of initiation, which cleanses the soul of original sin and welcomes the individual into the Church.
    - **Confirmation**: the second sacrament of initiation, which strengthens the individual's faith and commitment to the Church.
    - **Eucharist**: the sacrament of the Body and Blood of Christ, which nourishes the soul and unites the individual with the Church and with Christ.
    - **Penance**: the sacrament of reconciliation, which allows the individual to confess their sins and receive absolution from a priest.
    - **Anointing of the Sick**: the sacrament of healing, which provides spiritual and physical comfort to those who are ill or suffering.
    - **Holy Orders**: the sacrament through which men are ordained as deacons, priests, or bishops to serve the Church.
    - **Marriage**: the sacrament of union between a man and a woman, which reflects the union between Christ and the Church.
- You CANNOT be saved if you are not a part of the Catholic Church (since the Catholic church is the only one true church and they are the ones who administer the sacraments)
    - The Catholic Church still holds that the Church is necessary for salvation and that no one knowing this can reject it and be saved. Vatican II teaches: "Whosoever knowing that the Catholic Church was made necessary by God through Jesus Christ would refuse to enter her or to remain in her could not be saved" (Lumen Gentium, no. 14).- Catholic Answers
- **Scripture passages they use**- James 2:17-26; John 6:53 (Eucharist); John 3:5 (baptism)
- **What they say about passages like Ephesians 2:8-9-** "One passage Fundamentalists often cite as a proof against the Catholic view of salvation is Ephesians 2:8-9: "For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith—and this not from yourselves, it is the gift of God—not by works, so that no one can boast." Though this passage can often stymie Catholics in conversation, it is nothing to be threatened by. Even if we assume that Paul is speaking of "good works" when he says we have not been saved by works, this in no way conflicts with Catholic theology. Notice that the passage speaks of salvation in the past tense—"you have been saved." In Greek this is the perfect tense, which denotes a past, completed action."

What the Bible Says:

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3. Mary the Mother of Jesus

- SHE was immaculately conceived and ascended to heaven without dying
    - In the Gospel of Luke an angel visits a young woman in Nazareth named Mary and asks if she will bear the Messiah. Mary says yes. Then, presto! Mary becomes pregnant with Jesus. This is known as the immaculate conception, right? Wrong. Even though many Catholics connect this story in Luke's gospel with the term immaculate conception, the doctrine itself refers to something different. It still refers to Mary, but it is not about how Mary became pregnant with Jesus. It is about how Mary's mother became pregnant with her—deemed immaculate due to the absence of transmitting original sin. Pope Pius IX declared doctrine of the immaculate conception in his 1854 apostolic constitution Ineffabilis Deus (Ineffable God). Later, it was grandfathered into the First Vatican Council's declaration of papal infallibility in 1870. It is one of only two teachings to be declared ex cathedra, or infallibly, by a pope. The other is Mary's bodily assumption into heaven that was declared by Pope Pius XII in 1950.
- She was a lifelong virgin (Mark 6:3; Matt. 13:55; Gal. 1:19)
- She was perfect and sinless (Rom. 3:23; 1 Jn. 1:8-10; Luke 1:46-47)
- She is the "queen of heaven" (Jeremiah 7:18; 44:17-25)
    - This is a false goddess that Israel was worshipping and it made God angry

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WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

WHY THIS STUDY?

Most people in our world today still believe in some sort of God. Though it can feel at times like the prevailing belief is Atheism (no God), the reality is that most people ascribe to some sort of religion. The reason for this study is to answer the age-old/tough question, "There are so many religions out there, how can we possibly know which one is right?" As we go through this study and examine the major religions of the world, we will come to a greater understanding of why we believe what we believe and we will be equipped to show people the truth about what the Bible says and what the truth is.

_____

FOUNDER

1. **Constantine (272-337 AD)**

   ✓ Provided the structure of the Catholic church

   ✓ Emperor of Rome from 306-337

   ✓ Fought victoriously against Maxentius over right for sole rulership

   ✓ 312 - Battle of Milvian Bridge the two meet.

   ✓ Constantine has a vision at some point during or before the battle.

   ✓ The vision consists of a cross in the shape of the first 2 letters of the Greek word for "Christ":

   ✓ He hears a voice saying "By this sign, thou shalt conquer" and proceeds to place this symbol on his soldier's helmets and shields. Because of his experience, Constantine now considers himself a "Christian".

   ✓ <u>Edict of Milan – 313</u>

   - A proclamation of "religious tolerance" in the entire Roman Empire with special benefits to "Christians".

   - Christians were granted absolute freedom and had property previously confiscated returned to them.

- Pagan temples offensive to Christianity were destroyed.
- Clergy were exempt from taxes and became paid by the state.
- By 324 Constantine promises 20 pieces of gold and a white robe for all new "converts".
- This begins the marriage of the church with the state.

✓ Council of Nicaea - 325

- Constantine invites all clergy to this "all expenses paid" meeting to determine the official doctrines of the Catholic Church. Delegates came from every region of the Roman Empire EXCEPT BRITAIN.
- The focus was on Christ and His relationship to God. They concluded with what is known as the Nicene Creed
- This would be revised in 381 with the additional doctrines adopted by the RCC.

Constantine married the pagan Roman system to "Christianity" in 313 AD with the Edict of Milan. Satan's counterfeit church was born. See Acts 19:35-37 for God's commentary on what would eventually take place. Also, remember that this system was not really new because of a man named Nimrod and the Tower of Babel. (Genesis 10:8-10)

✓ It is important to note that the Catholic church would say they began in Matthew 16:13-20

- The problem with this:
  - The word "Catholic" is not used until a few hundred years later
  - Jesus is the "Rock" all throughout the Bible, not Peter (Exo. 17:6; 1 Cor. 10:4; Luke 6:46-49)
  - The word he uses for Peter in vs. 18 is "petros" (little rock, stone) and the one he uses for "upon this **rock,** I will build my church" is "Petra" (large rock, boulder). Two different words for two different people.

✓ **Does the Bible talk about the RCC? (Revelation 17:1-9, 15, 18)**

- *What city/church has an affinity for drinking blood, has control over kings of the earth, has birthed the most false teachings/religions in the world, is "universal" (many waters), is known for killing the most Christians, their leaders where purple and scarlet, whose symbol is the golden cup (last supper), that is known as a "mother", and that sits on 7 hills?*

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✓ **Does the Bible talk about the RCC? (Revelation 17:1-9, 15, 18)**

✓ *Whoever this "woman" is…*

- *She is also known as "that great city, which reigneth over the kings of the earth" (Rev 17:18) We call it Vatican City today, and history reveals that city is the only city on earth who has ever reigned over kings of many nations. Ask Charlemagne about it! She is a political power who even has a seat in the United Nations! This "city" has a seat at the UN, and its leader is also its religious leader (pope) just like the bible describes the kingdom of the anti-christ*
- *She is the "mother of harlots and abominations of the earth" (meaning she birthed or many religions came from her) (Proverbs 7 shows the strange woman as a false religion)*
  - *Major religions that came from RCC (Presbyterians, Church of Christ, Episcopalians, Anglicans, Church of Nazarenes, Methodists, United Church of Christ, Congregationalists, 7th Day Adventists, Pentecostals, Lutherans, Assemblies of God, Church of God, Pietists, Eastern Orthodox, Restorationists, Disciples of Christ, Holiness Churches, etc…)*
  - *They would say that baptists came from them as well, however we have a different history completely, a history from those who fought and were martyred by Catholics throughout history (refer to the "trail of blood" booklet)*
- *She is "drunken with the blood of the saints, and with the blood of the martyrs of Jesus" (Rev 17:6) Through the centuries, the Roman Catholic Church has persecuted, tortured and murdered more Bible-believing Christians than pagan Rome ever thought to! Some historians estimate that the Roman Catholic Church is guilty of producing well over 50 million martyrs! (Some estimates go as high as 150 million!)*
- *The colors of the woman are "purple and scarlet" (the colors of clerical non-liturgical dress) and her symbol is a "golden cup" (a major feature in mass) according to Revelation 17:4.*

- *And if that weren't enough, Revelation 17:9 says that the woman sits on seven mountains. Rome has historically been known as the city on seven hills. Just type that into Google and see what the first result is!*

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WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

THE CHARISMATIC MOVEMENT (*Pentecostalism*)

DOCTRINE

***The great error of the Charismatic movement is that they think they are of the "apostle" lineage and can do the miracles and works of the apostles with the same authority. NONE of them have the power or display the miracles that the apostles did! (2 Corinthians 11:12-15; Rev. 2:2; Eph. 2:20)

- Jesus came to seek and to save Israel. Israel was told to look for someone who does signs like Moses (Deut. 18:15-18) who would do signs to prove he was from God (like Moses did in Egypt; Exo. 4:8; Deut. 34:11; 1 Cor. 1:22)
- Jesus gave that power and authority to the apostles, so they could do the signs for Israel to believe
- As God moved on to the rest of the world and as the Bible was being completed, signs were not needed anymore because God said there was a more perfect way coming, a **more sure** word of prophesy (1 Cor. 13:10; 2 Peter 1:19)

TONGUES

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- Speaking in tongues means that one speaks in an unintelligible/unknown language by the aid of the Holy Ghost, and this language is also referred to as a "heavenly language" spoken by angels (1Cor. 13:1).
- Speaking in tongues is the outward evidence of salvation and/or the outward evidence of a second outpouring of the Spirit on an individual (Acts 1:5; 2:1-21; 10:44-48; 19:4-7; Lk. 24:49; Mk. 16:15-20).
- The gift of tongues can be exercised in private and/or in public church services, and should not be forbidden (1 Cor. 14; Rom. 8:26)

What the Bible Says:

- Speaking in "tongues" is the ability to supernaturally and fluidly speak in a **known** language previously unknown to the speaker (Acts 2:1-21)
- Tongues is a sign gift for **unbelieving** Jews (Ex. 4; 1 Cor. 1:22; 14:22; Mk. 16:20; Acts 2:1-13; 10; 18:24-19:7)
- Tongues (and other sign gifts) progressively ceased with the completion of the New Testament scriptures and Church-Age transition (1 Cor. 13:8-13)
- When you are saved, the Holy Ghost lives and dwells in you permanently, it does not come and go (1 Cor. 6:18-20; 3:16; Eph. 1:14; 4:30)

HEALING

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- All sicknesses and physical ailments can be divinely healed by God through the prayer of **faith** (Mk. 16:17-18)
- The gift of healing can be a gift that a person possesses, but it can also be a gift that one may possess spontaneously at the discretion of the Holy Ghost (Acts 3:6-8; 5:15-16; 8:7; 9:34; 19:11-12; 28:8-9).
- **Faith** is key element for divine healing to work (Matt. 9:22, 28-29; Mk. 1:40-41; Acts 14:9-10; Jas. 5:15; Heb. 10:35-36; 1 Jn. 5:4-5).

What the Bible Says:

- Healing is a sign gift (Mk. 16:17-18; Ex. 4).
- Healing (and other sign gifts) progressively ceased with the completion of the New Testament scriptures and Church-Age transition (1 Cor. 13:8-13; 2 Tim. 4:20; Philippians 2:25-27)
- God is still heals people, but at His discretion and for His purposes (Rev. 1:9; current examples)

PROPHESYING

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- Anyone who is saved can at any moment become "spirit filled" and prophesy concerning any subject. Because it is from the spirit of God, it is taken as absolutely true and valid (Joel 2:28; 1 Cor. 14:1,5)

What the Bible says:

- Prophesying is simply God's people sharing God's already spoken words about future events (Ezekiel 13:1-3; 22:25,28; Jeremiah 14:13-14)

- What made any of the major or minor prophets prophets was the fact that they heard the word of God and shared it; we have the entire perfect word of God now already (Psalm 12:6-7)

- When the word of God is finished, prophesying will be done away with; it is not needed anymore (1 Cor. 13:9-10)

BAPTISMAL REGENERATION

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- You must be baptized to be saved (1 Peter 3:18-22; Acts 2:38)
- When you are baptized, you will be filled with the Holy Ghost and speak in tongues (Acts 2:1-5)

What the Bible says:

- Baptism is NOT required for salvation (Acts 8:37; Romans 6:23; 10:9-10,13; John 3:16; Eph. 2:8-9; Gal. 2:16; 3:10-12; 5:4; Titus 3:5; 1 Cor. 6:11; John 20:31)
- Speaking in tongues was a sign for unbelieving Jews, at a time the Bible was not completed (the NT had just begun), for them to trust in Christ, as the disciples were baptized with the Holy Ghost (not water) in the transitional book of Acts

LOSING SALVATION

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- Salvation is earned through works (baptism) and so it can be lost by works (or the lack thereof) (Matt. 7:21-23; 10:22)

What the Bible says:

- Salvation is a gift freely given, not earned by any works we do, it is solely by God that we are saved, therefore we cannot lose it, it is begun and finished by God (John 3:16; Romans 5:21; 6:23; Titus 3:7; 2 Corinthians 1:22; Eph. 1:13; 4:30; Romans 8:38-39)

KEY SUBJECTS CONCERNING THE CHARISMATIC MOVEMENT

A LOOK AT 1 CORINTHIANS 14 (1 Corinthians 14)

- Tongues vs Unknown Tongues

    - This church has people speaking in _____ tongues, out of order in services (people yelling out), women usurping authority in services, and absolute craziness happening in the church (1 Cor. 14:26-40)

    - If it is an unknown tongue, you SHOULD NOT be using it. It edifies nobody but yourself and creates chaos!

IF MIRACLES DO OCCUR, CAN WE TRUST THEM?

- The Bible tells us that miracles like this were for the Jews, done by the apostles, and they have ceased!

- If miracles are occurring, can we trust them? (Rev. 13:13-14; 16:13-14; 19:20; Matt. 24:24; Mark 13:22; 2 Thess. 2:9; Exodus 7:11, 20-22; 8:5-7)

WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE?
WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

THE CHARISMATIC MOVEMENT (*Pentecostalism*)

FOUNDERS

1. **Charles F. Parham (1873-1929)** - "American Pentecostal pioneer and author. He formulated classical Pentecostal theology in Topeka, Kansas, in 1901 and thus deserves recognition as the founder of the Pentecostal movement" *(Dictionary of Pentecostal and Charismatic Movements; pg. 660)*. Converted to Christianity at the age of thirteen he believed God had called him to the ministry. He entered college at the age of seventeen. Shortly thereafter, he recovered from a severe attack of rheumatic fever (he had an experience that drove his theology). This left him with the firm belief in the doctrine of divine healing. He left college three years later to assume the pastorate of a Methodist church. It was through this contact that he ultimately became enamored with the theology of the Holiness Movement (from the RCC). He left the Methodist church in 1895 to assume an independent ministry. He later married and began the Bethel Bible School. It was at this school that he developed the theology concerning speaking in tongues as the evidence of baptism in the holy spirit *(he originally believed them to be known foreign languages that thousands of missionaries would speak in order to evangelize the world before the second coming of Christ)*. **Agnes N. Ozman** was the first person to speak in unknown tongues at Parham's Bethel Bible School in Topeka, Kansas. Her experience is credited with validating Parham's assertion that tongues speech evidenced spirit baptism. She later became an evangelist. While the immediate impact of Parham's theology was limited, it gained more momentum several years later in a revival meeting held outside of Houston, Texas. From there **William J. Seymour**, a black holiness preacher convinced of the truth of Parham's teachings, traveled to Los Angeles, California, to preach the new message. The ensuing revival at the **Azusa Street Mission** (1906-1909) represented an anomaly on the American religious scene. In 1906 Parham's prominence in the new movement (not yet known as Pentecostal) was coming to an end due to rumors of him being a homosexual. In the summer of 1907 he was arrested on the charge of Sodomy. All charges were later dropped but the damage to his reputation was already done. Because the Holiness movement taught a person could come to a point of sinless perfection and Parham was a leader, his work was over.

2. **William J. Seymour** - William is a Holiness preacher that founded the Azusa Street Mission in Los Angeles, California. It was there that the "gift" of spirit baptism emerged and spread abroad in a religious wildfire. The sign gifts of the Holy Spirit, understood by other denominations throughout history as having ceased in the first century, had now been miraculously ***restored***. Evangelistic tent meetings were used across the U.S. by Pentecostals to spread the word.

Summary: Although Pentecostals and Charismatics claim that believers throughout the centuries spoke in tongues, they originally claimed these were known foreign languages used by missionaries to preach the gospel to foreigners. After decades of speaking in unknown tongues, Pentecostal theology was restructured and retro-fitted to work with the obvious experiences of their followers. Now they claim believers throughout history spoke in unknown tongues (Proverbs 5:6). **It is important to realize that most all Pentecostals and Charismatics do not know facts about Church History or facts concerning their own history**…

While the Charismatic movement is not necessarily the name of a particular group of churches, it is a religion that is very popular especially in todays world. It has infiltrated all sorts of churches under many names. Apostolic churches, primitive churches, church of Christ churches, and MANY "non-denominational" churches all fall under the charismatic movement. It is popular due to the "experience" factor that many people go to church to enjoy, and they find it at charismatic churches

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Bible** (translations vary, though most use modern versions)

2. **The personal ecstatic experiences of each believer** - Without realizing it, those that believe in charismatic doctrines have elevated their experience over the clear teaching of God's words, thus making their experience equal to, or greater than, the bible. Once a person has an "experience", it is almost impossible to convince them that what they are doing is unbiblical.

3. **The gift of prophesy -** One with this gift is "anointed" to fore-tell and/or forth-tell a message from God through preaching, speaking, and/or writing. They basically believe this gift to be a benefit to the church as it faces the challenges of the new millennium. The main problem is how to verify whether a "prophetic message" is from God or not. A whole theological system had to be developed by wresting the scriptures and historical facts to make this gift valid for today, but it is clearly no longer needed because everything we need can be found in a completed copy of the scriptures.

   → **Important Consideration – If it is not in the Bible, I do not need it; if it is in the Bible, I already have it!** So what is the purpose? God has laid out very plainly in His Word the fact that we can get clear answers to any and all areas of our life – 2 Peter 1:3-4.

Summary: Although the Bible clearly tells us not to "Judge not according to the appearance, but judge righteous judgment" (John 7:24), most Pentecostal/Charismatic believers that have experienced these gifts will not receive any scriptural truth that comes against their false teachings. All experiences must be judged by the infallible standard that is GREATER than any experience - the bible

DOCTRINE

***The great error of the Charismatic movement is that they think they are of the "apostle" lineage and can do the miracles and works of the apostles with the same authority. NONE of them have the power or display the miracles that the apostles did! (2 Corinthians 11:12-15; Rev. 2:2; Eph. 2:20)

- Jesus came to seek and to save Israel. Israel was told to look for someone who does signs like Moses (Deut. 18:15-18) who would do signs to prove he was from God (like Moses did in Egypt; Exo. 4:8; Deut. 34:11; 1 Cor. 1:22)
- Jesus gave that power and authority to the apostles, so they could do the signs for Israel to believe
- As God moved on to the rest of the world and as the Bible was being completed, signs were not needed anymore because God said there was a more perfect way coming, a **more sure** word of prophesy (1 Cor. 13:10; 2 Peter 1:19)

TONGUES

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- Speaking in tongues means that one speaks in an unintelligible/unknown language by the aid of the Holy Ghost, and this language is also referred to as a "heavenly language" spoken by angels (1Cor. 13:1).
- Speaking in tongues is the outward evidence of salvation and/or the outward evidence of a second outpouring of the Spirit on an individual (Acts 1:5; 2:1-21; 10:44-48; 19:4-7; Lk. 24:49; Mk. 16:15-20).
- The gift of tongues can be exercised in private and/or in public church services, and should not be forbidden (1 Cor. 14; Rom. 8:26)

What the Bible Says:

- Speaking in "tongues" is the ability to supernaturally and fluidly speak in a known language previously unknown to the speaker (Acts 2:1-21)
- Tongues is a sign gift for unbelieving Jews (Ex. 4; 1 Cor. 1:22; 14:22; Mk. 16:20; Acts 2:1-13; 10; 18:24-19:7)
- Tongues (and other sign gifts) progressively ceased with the completion of the New Testament scriptures and Church-Age transition (1 Cor. 13:8-13)
- When you are saved, the Holy Ghost lives and dwells in you permanently, it does not come and go (1 Cor. 6:18-20; 3:16; Eph. 1:14; 4:30)

**VIDEO

HEALING

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- All sicknesses and physical ailments can be divinely healed by God through the prayer of faith (Mk. 16:17-18)
- The gift of healing can be a gift that a person possesses, but it can also be a gift that one may possess spontaneously at the discretion of the Holy Ghost (Acts 3:6-8; 5:15-16; 8:7; 9:34; 19:11-12; 28:8-9).
- Faith is key element for divine healing to work (Matt. 9:22, 28-29; Mk. 1:40-41; Acts 14:9-10; Jas. 5:15; Heb. 10:35-36; 1 Jn. 5:4-5).

What the Bible Says:

- Healing is a sign gift (Mk. 16:17-18; Ex. 4).
- Healing (and other sign gifts) progressively ceased with the completion of the New Testament scriptures and Church-Age transition (1 Cor. 13:8-13; 2 Tim. 4:20; Philippians 2:25-27)
- God is still heals people, but at His discretion and for His purposes (Rev. 1:9; current examples)

**VIDEO

PROPHESYING

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- Anyone who is saved can at any moment become "spirit filled" and prophesy concerning any subject. Because it is from the spirit of God, it is taken as absolutely true and valid (Joel 2:28; 1 Cor. 14:1,5)

What the Bible says:

- Prophesying is simply God's people sharing God's already spoken words about future events (Ezekiel 13:1-3; 22:25,28; Jeremiah 14:13-14)

- What made any of the major or minor prophets prophets was the fact that they heard the word of God and shared it; we have the entire perfect word of God now already (Psalm 12:6-7)

- When the word of God is finished, prophesying will be done away with; it is not needed anymore (1 Cor. 13:9-10)

BAPTISMAL REGENERATION

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- You must be baptized to be saved (1 Peter 3:18-22; Acts 2:38)
- When you are baptized, you will be filled with the Holy Ghost and speak in tongues (Acts 2:1-5)

What the Bible says:

- Baptism is NOT required for salvation (Acts 8:37; Romans 6:23; 10:9-10,13; John 3:16; Eph. 2:8-9; Gal. 2:16; 3:10-12; 5:4; Titus 3:5; 1 Cor. 6:11; John 20:31)
- Speaking in tongues was a sign for unbelieving Jews, at a time the Bible was not completed (the NT had just begun), for them to trust in Christ, as the disciples were baptized with the Holy Ghost (not water) in the transitional book of Acts

LOSING SALVATION

What Pentecostals/Charismatics Believe:

- Salvation is earned through works (baptism) and so it can be lost by works (or the lack thereof) (Matt. 7:21-23; 10:22)

What the Bible says:

- Salvation is a gift freely given, not earned by any works we do, it is solely by God that we are saved, therefore we cannot lose it, it is begun and finished by God (John 3:16; Romans 5:21; 6:23; Titus 3:7; 2 Corinthians 1:22; Eph. 1:13; 4:30; Romans 8:38-39)

KEY SUBJECTS CONCERNING THE CHARISMATIC MOVEMENT

A LOOK AT 1 CORINTHIANS 14 (slides) (1 Corinthians 14)

- Tongues vs Unknown Tongues (show slides of bible versions)
- This church has people speaking in **unknown** tongues, out of order in services (people yelling out), women usurping authority in services, and absolute craziness happening in the church (1 Cor. 14:26-40)
- If it is an unknown tongue, you SHOULD NOT be using it. It edifies nobody but yourself and creates chaos!

IF MIRACLES DO OCCUR, CAN WE TRUST THEM?

- The Bible tells us that miracles like this were for the Jews, done by the apostles, and they have ceased!
- If miracles are occurring, can we trust them? (Rev. 13:13-14; 19:20; Matt. 24:24; Mark 13:22; 2 Thess. 2:9; Exodus 7:11, 20-22; 8:5-7)

WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

MORMONISM (LDS AND FLDS)

FOUNDERS

1. **Joseph Smith Jr. (1805-1844)**
2. **HISTORY OF THE FLDS (FUNDAMENTALIST LATTER-DAY SAINTS)**

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Book of Mormon**

   **What does the Bible say about this kind of prophesying/new doctrine? (Gal. 1:8; 2 Cor. 11:13-14; Rev. 22:18; Matt. 11:13; Luke 16:16)

   **The Book of Mormon is nothing more than a made up copy of the Bible intermixed with a deceitful man's own set of beliefs. Much of the book is stolen and twisted directly from the Bible.

2. **Doctrine & Covenants, present Mormon prophets' words and writings** *(a.k.a. - the authority of men)*
3. **"The Pearl of Great Price"** - A selection of choice materials touching many significant aspects of the faith and doctrine of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints. These items were produced by Joseph Smith Jr. and were published in the Church periodicals of his day.

DOCTRINE

1. **Deny salvation by grace alone, the authority of the Bible alone, and the deity of Christ**
   a. They believe we can be saved "after all we can do" (2 Nephi 25:23)
2. **Jesus is Satan's brother** - Jesus was a created spirit and "son of God" before being given a physical body, just like all humans. In the Mormon text "Book of Moses," Satan and Jesus contend for the privilege of taking a body of flesh in order to become the redeemer, with Jesus winning the contest
3. **Afterlife and Hell** - All spirits go to the spirit world, undergo preparation, then rejoin with bodies in the resurrection. The good spend the intervening time in spirit paradise, while the wicked go to an unpleasant spirit prison. After that, only the most obstinately wicked (like Satan) will be consigned to "Outer Darkness" for eternity. They believe that there are levels to heaven as well
4. **Baptismal Regeneration** - Mormon's believe in baptism by immersion for the remission of sins. This would be for adults only (unless a child is old enough to make his/her own choice). The laying on of hands follows baptism for the receiving of the Holy Ghost (Mosiah 18:8-10; John 3:5)
5. **Polygamy** – This practice began with Joseph Smith after he received a "revelation" from God that this needed to start taking place again. He went on to quickly marry over 40 women, many already married, and many much younger than him (lower twenties and a 14 year old). The church "stopped practicing" this technically in 1890 after receiving threat to their money, property, and power; however the true fundamentalists still practice this to this very day, just like their founder did and as their ancient texts tell them to
6. **Baptism for the Dead** - Deemed a "sacred" ceremony, it is a proxy baptism by a living relative for their dead non-Mormon relative. This is absolutely necessary for the dead non-Mormon if he is to have any chance at eternal life in the afterworld. However, no chance of godhood exists for them. They will live in eternity as a type of sub-god (1 Cor. 15:29)
7. **Celestial Wedding** - Deemed "sacred" this is a temple ceremony only. A Mormon can only participate if he/she is recommended by their local bishop. This ceremony marries the couple for all eternity thus assuring eternal life to the wife and giving the man assurance of procreation when he becomes a god himself (Doctrine and Covenants 131:1-4)

8. **Other Strange Doctrines**

    a. **Melchizedekian Priesthood-** Those deemed worthy for this special priesthood after the order of Christ are given gifts to bless, heal, speak, etc… with apostle like authority

    b. **God the Father-** They believe that he is a fleshly being, not spiritual (John 1:18; Col. 1:15; John 4:23-24; 1 Tim. 1:17) They also believe that he had sex with multiple goddesses of heaven (spiritual beings) to produce all the spirits who would later become people. Also they believe that he had sex with Mary (Jesus mother) to create Jesus

    c. **The atonement for sin-** They believe that the atonement for sin was made in the garden of Gethsemane and not so much so on the cross (Eph. 2:16; Col. 1:20; 2:14)

    d. **Charismatic doctrines-** They practice healing, prophesying, speaking in unknown tongues, and many other charismatic doctrines

    e. **Jesus came to America-** After he rose from the dead, they believe Jesus came to a group of Jews that had migrated to America and he spoke with and ministered to them there. They believe this group later became the Native Americans

    f. **Jesus had children-** They believe that Jesus had multiple children with Mary Magdelene and Joseph Smith came from this lineage

NOTE: Obviously a faith plus works system. This even adds to faith plus works, in a sense, by what they call the "sacred" ordinances. These are blatant occult rituals that not every Mormon will be able to participate in. Thus they have a class of "better" heaven bound Mormons and a class of regular Mormons

JEHOVAH'S WITNESSES

FOUNDERS

1. **Charles Taze Russell (1852-1916)**
2. **Joseph F. Rutherford**

AUTHORITIES

1. **The "bible"**
    - *The New World Translation* – published 1961
    - Translation committee remained anonymous
    - Translated from same corrupt sources as all other modern translations
2. **The JW's Governing Body / World HQ in Brooklyn, New York**
    - Responsible for formulating policy and doctrines, producing material for publications and conventions, and administering its worldwide branch office staff
    - Membership is unelected; existing members invite new members to join the body

DOCTRINE

1. **Salvation**

    …WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

    Salvation comes through Jesus Christ alone, not through membership with any group, religion, organization, etc… (John 14:6; Acts 4:12)

    Salvation is **NOT** by any work that man can do - Eph 2:8-9; Matt 7:21-23; Titus 3:5

    You must believe that Jesus is the Son of God whose death on the cross paid the price for YOUR sin and receive that gift! - Rom 10:9-10; John 3:16; 1 John 1:9, 2:1-2

2. **Deny the triune nature of God** - JW's declare that God is one and that any doctrine that presents God as a 3-in-1 being is blasphemous (Deut. 6:4; Gal. 3:20; 1 Jn. 5:7; Gen. 1:26; John 1:1-2,14)

3. **Deny the deity of Jesus Christ** - JW's believe that Jesus is a created being with no divinity, the same as you and me (Matt. 19:17; John 1:1 (NWT); they also believe that Jesus is Michael the archangel

   **They say that Michael the archangel was in Heaven and when he needed to come to earth to save mankind, he became Jesus Christ

   The Bible teaches clearly that Michael the archangel and Jesus are not the same person

   -Jesus rebukes the devil, Michael does not- Matt. 4:10; Jude 9

   -Michael is an angel, Jesus is clearly shown as being distinctly better than and above angels- Hebrews chapters 1 & 2

   The Bible as a whole clearly teaches Jesus is fully God (slides)

   Jesus himself claims to be God - John 8:12-59, 10:22-33; Heb 1:8; Rev 1:8

   Titles reserved only for Jehovah are applied to Jesus:

   - *Creator* - Isaiah 44:24; John 1:1-3; Colossians 1:16
   - *Rock* - Deuteronomy 32:3-4, 12; 2 Samuel 22:1-2, 32…1 Corinthians 10:4
   - *Savior* - Isaiah 43:10-11…Titus 2:13; 2 Peter 1:1; Acts 20:28

4. **Other Strange Doctrines**

   - The earth will never be destroyed (Compare to: 2 Peter 3:7, 10-13; Isaiah 66:15,22; Rev 21:1-3)
   - No celebration of holidays or birthdays (Compare to: Ex 12:14-20; Col 2:16; Rom 14:5-8)
   - Baptism - This is performed in order for a person to become a member of the Society, and they are baptized in the name of the Father, the Son, and the organization (Compare to: Matt 28:19)
   - The Memorial of Christ's Death at Passover - This is the only ceremony that the JW's observe. At this ceremony, held in a large auditorium, all members are expected to be present. The elements of the Lord's Supper are passed through the audience, but only those of the anointed or heavenly class are allowed to partake (That number is now fewer than 9,000 worldwide since no one born after AD 1914 is considered eligible).
   - No blood transfusions (Gen. 9:4; Lev. 17:14)
   - Only 144,000 elect (Rev. 7:4-8) will be able to enter heaven, the rest who believe will be allowed to a type of purgatory here on earth

WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

MORMONISM (LDS AND FLDS)

FOUNDERS

1. **Joseph Smith Jr. (1805-1844)** - Original founder of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints. He claimed to have encountered God the Father and Jesus Christ who commissioned him to restore the "true church" and the "lost priesthood" to the earth. He claims that an angel named Moroni showed him an ancient book, which he translated using magical stones. In 1830 this book, known as the Book of Mormon, was published. On April 6, 1830, he founded his new church and his followers became known as Mormons. He was a very controversial man who was known as a charlatan and huckster. Everywhere he went he stirred up trouble because of his anti-biblical lifestyle. He ran for president of the U.S., established a private army, built a well-planned city named "Nauvoo" located in Illinois, elaborated his own theological belief structure, introduced new religious practices, and married over forty-nine women, at least twelve of whom had husbands and one of whom was only 14 years old (he was 37). He was ultimately arrested for these, and other, unlawful practices. On June 27, 1844, a lynch mob attacked the Carthage jail where he was held, and he and his brother Hyrum were murdered. His death provided his church with a martyr and created the transformation of an American folk religion into an international faith.
    2. "*I have more to boast of than ever any man had. I am the only man that has ever been able to keep a whole church together since the days of Adam. A large majority of the whole have stood by me. Neither Paul, Peter, nor Jesus ever did it. I boast that no man ever did such a work as I. The followers of Jesus ran away from Him; but the Latter-day Saints never ran away from me yet*." - ***Joseph Smith***
        i. His reputation:
        ii. Known con man
        iii. Hired himself out as a master treasure Hunter without ever finding any treasure
        iv. Arrested multiple times for charges of banking fraud, assault, conspiracy to commit murder, assembling his own aggressive militia, etc…
        v. Never shared/was able to prove any of his visions, golden tablets, seer stones, etc…
        vi. Caught by his wife having sex with 14 year old maid in barn (this is when he explains to his wife God gave him the revelation of polygamy)
        vii. Threatened to exterminate every non Mormon in Missouri
        viii. Ordered the assassination of Missouri's governor
        ix. Ordered the burning down and looting of villages in Missouri
        x. Constantly has new visions that conflict with old visions and the Bible whenever is clearly best suited his interests
        xi. He was a confused man (lived in a time of religious "awakening" in America, also in an area known for folk magic/ treasure hunting, and all sorts of pagan practices), with deceitful/cunning skills, poor moral character, who saw an opportunity and took it. When it didn't make much progress at first, he continued in slowly until he garnered a following.
3. **Brigham Young (1801-1877)-** - The Second leader of the church (Utah Mormons) after the death of Joseph Smith. He was originally ordained into the ministry as an apostle by Joseph Smith himself. Young led the exodus from Illinois to the Great Salt Lake Basin (1846-1848) after the death of Smith. As the head leader and administrator of the saints, he instructed his followers in everything from doctrine, architecture, and agriculture, to fashion and family relations. He ultimately became the governor of the Utah Territory. He used the immense power he possessed to establish some 350 communities and numerous economic ventures. He was so influential that the college (BYU) was named for him and has a STRONG Mormon population

a. Commonly taught that anyone who married interracially would be condemned to there version of Hell
b. Taught that the only way for people who leave Mormonism to be redeemed is through there own blood being spilt (death)

4. **HISTORY OF THE FLDS (FUNDAMENTALIST LATTER-DAY SAINTS)**- In 1890, when the leaders of mainstream Mormonism abandoned the practice of polygamy in a deal with the federal government to gain statehood for Utah, one group of adherents refused to give in. The resulting splinter group, the Fundamentalist Church of Latter-day Saints (FLDS) has continued the practice to this day, residing for most of the 20th century in or around the twin towns of Hildale and Colorado City on the Utah-Arizona border. It is important to note that these are the group that truly follows fundamental Mormon beliefs as stated by Joseph Smith and the original writings/prophesies. The modern day "Mormon (LDS)" group branched off of true theology of Mormons in order to keep peace with the government, keep statehood, power, money, and their organization.

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Book of Mormon** - The Book of Mormon has been proven to be scientifically, anthropologically, archeologically and historically inaccurate Even beyond inaccurate, it is a total and blatant fairy tale. It is a proven fact that the book is theologically contradicting to itself. These seem like harsh words to use, however, basic investigation proves this book to be nothing more than fiction. Read the following excerpt from the book "Joseph Smith and Money Digging" as to how Joseph Smith received some revelation concerning the Book of Mormon:
"Smith put a magical 'seer' stone into a hat, and then buried his face in the hat to exclude the light. Next, words in 'reformed Egyptian' (*no such language exists*) magically appeared with their translation, and Smith spoke the translation to a scribe who wrote it down. One of Smith's many wives, Emma Smith, confesses: 'In writing for your father, I frequently wrote day after day…He sitting with his face buried in his hat, with a stone in it, and dictating hour after hour.'"

   In addition, Smith claims that an angel named Moroni gave him the location of gold plates containing ancient writings in which he later translated the Book of Mormon. The gold plates were never seen by anyone nor do they exist today. Smith claimed the angel revisited him and took the plates back to God the Father. If he indeed did receive these plates and the visions, he did not get them from God (1 John 4:1-3)

   **What does the Bible say about this kind of prophesying/new doctrine? (Gal. 1:8; 2 Cor. 11:13-14; Rev. 22:18; Matt. 11:13; Luke 16:16)

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DOCTRINE

1. **Deny salvation by grace alone, the authority of the Bible alone, and the deity of Christ (**1 John 4:1-3)
   a. They believe Jesus was a created "sub-god" and not actually God in human flesh. He was the spirit son of the "heavenly father and heavenly mother" (they believe in both and that the heavenly mother is Mary). They do not believe he always was but believe he will continue to exist from here on forever.
   b. They believe we can be saved "after all we can do" (2 Nephi 25:23)
2. **Jesus is Satan's brother** - Jesus was a created spirit and "son of God" before being given a physical body, just like all humans. In the Mormon text "Book of Moses," Satan and Jesus contend for the privilege of taking a body of flesh in order to become the redeemer, with Jesus winning the contest

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JEHOVAH'S WITNESSES

The Jehovah's Witnesses (JW) intensely train (disciple) their people concerning their false doctrines. Though today they do not experience substantial growth, those who do become members of the organization are well indoctrinated. They say they are learned in the scriptures, but are only familiar with the scriptures that seemingly support their wrested doctrines. They practice their witnessing techniques amongst themselves to better confound you. They can be very intimidating, but always remember that they do not know the Bible.

FOUNDERS

1. **Charles Taze Russell (1852-1916)** - Original founder of the Watchtower Bible and Tract Society. He was born February 16, 1852, near Pittsburgh. In 1870, while still in his teens and without any theological training, Russell organized a Bible class whose members eventually made him their "Pastor". The group also became known as "Russellites". He eventually married Maria Ackley, a woman who attended the Bible studies. In 1879 he founded the magazine *Zion's Watchtower* in which he published his own unique interpretation of the Bible, and in 1886, the first volume of seven books entitled *The Millennial Dawn* was published (later retitled Studies in the Scriptures). Russell's secret agenda was to make money. He developed multiple schemes for earning his filthy lucre from his followers and was taken to court on several occasions. His wife ultimately divorced him due to his lack of moral character and conman like persona.
    - → Russell's family background was Seventh Day Adventist… This is where the foundation of his false theology really began. Seventh Day Adventism has taken Bible truth that applies to Israel and adopted it for themselves. This is a grave theological error that shows up within the theology of the Jehovah's Witnesses. God gives His commentary on those people and organizations that do this deed (Rev. 2:9, 3:9). Russell did not like the idea of Hell and the founder of 7th day Adventism William Miller, taught that there was no hell. Russell followed Miller for years until the infamous "Great Disappointment" prophesy of Millers concerning the second coming of Christ occurring in 1874. When the prophesy failed Russell started to develop more of his own theology and garner more of a following of his own.
        - o Tried to predict the end of the world multiple times (1874, 1975, 1925, 1814, 1914) all were of course wrong
        - o He was also charged with profiteering for selling "miracle wheat" which was supposed to grow faster and be more healthy (it of course was not and did not)
        - o His wife divorced him for his immoral character and conman like persona
2. **Joseph F. Rutherford -** A few months after the death of Russell (1916), the society's legal counselor, Joseph Franklin "Judge" Rutherford, became the second president of the *Watchtower Society*. It was under his leadership that the name "Jehovah's Witnesses" was adopted. Rutherford moved the society's headquarters to Brooklyn, New York. He also moved toward theocratic control with the sole power to make all policy decisions. Rutherford saw the dangers of remaining "Russellites" and over a period of fifteen years labored to cover up the "Pastor's" unpleasant past.

AUTHORITIES

1. **The "bible"**
    - *The New World Translation* – published 1961
    - Translation committee remained anonymous
    - Translated from same corrupt sources as all other modern translations
2. **The JW's Governing Body / World HQ in Brooklyn, New York**
    - Responsible for formulating policy and doctrines, producing material for publications and conventions, and administering its worldwide branch office staff
    - Membership is unelected; existing members invite new members to join the body

The society is set up almost exactly like the RCC but without the formality. The leaders speak for God and what they say is equal (actually more so) with scripture. Without the JW leadership a person cannot understand what the Bible says. Men becoming the standard instead of God's Word is always a mark of a false teacher propagating false doctrine, and this is why God hates it (Rev. 2:6, 15).

DOCTRINE

1. **Salvation** - Salvation is only by joining the JW organization because it's the only way a person can learn Jehovah's will. If a person will faithfully carry out Jehovah's will in obedience to the instructions of the organization for the rest of their life, the reward is everlasting life on earth, and this is because there is almost NO chance of being with Jesus in heaven for all eternity. This special privilege is reserved for and already filled by a special class

(known as the anointed or heavenly class) of JW's limited to 144,000. If a person does good enough to pass the test, Jehovah will resurrect them on earth for another test of goods works and obedience which lasts 1,000 years. IF a person makes it through that successfully, and IF at the end Jehovah deems them worthy, then they will live on a renewed earth in a perfect human condition… and this will last as long as they do not rebel against Jehovah throughout eternity future

…WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

Salvation comes through Jesus Christ alone, not through membership with any group, religion, organization, etc… (John 14:6; Acts 4:12)

Salvation is **NOT** by any work that man can do - Eph 2:8-9; Matt 7:21-23; Titus 3:5

You must believe that Jesus is the Son of God whose death on the cross paid the price for YOUR sin and receive that gift! - Rom 10:9-10; John 3:16; 1 John 1:9, 2:1-2

2. **Deny the triune nature of God** - JW's declare that God is one and that any doctrine that presents God as a 3-in-1 being is blasphemous (Deut. 6:4; Gal. 3:20; 1 Jn. 5:7; Gen. 1:26; John 1:1-2,14)

3. **Deny the deity of Jesus Christ** - JW's believe that Jesus is a created being with no divinity, the same as you and me (Matt. 19:17; John 1:1 (NWT); they also believe that Jesus is Michael the archangel

**They say that Michael the archangel was in Heaven and when he needed to come to earth to save mankind, he became Jesus Christ

The Bible teaches clearly that Michael the archangel and Jesus are not the same person

-Jesus rebukes the devil, Michael does not- Matt. 4:10; Jude 9

-Michael is an angel, Jesus is clearly shown as being distinctly better than and above angels- Hebrews chapters 1 & 2

The Bible as a whole clearly teaches Jesus is fully God (slides)

Jesus himself claims to be God - John 8:12-59, 10:22-33; Heb 1:8; Rev 1:8

Titles reserved only for Jehovah are applied to Jesus:

- *Creator* - Isaiah 44:24; John 1:1-3; Colossians 1:16
- *Rock* - Deuteronomy 32:3-4, 12; 2 Samuel 22:1-2, 32…1 Corinthians 10:4
- *Savior* - Isaiah 43:10-11…Titus 2:13; 2 Peter 1:1; Acts 20:28

4. **Other Strange Doctrines**

- The earth will never be destroyed (Compare to: 2 Peter 3:7, 10-13; Isaiah 66:15,22; Rev 21:1-3)
- No celebration of holidays or birthdays (Compare to: Ex 12:14-20; Col 2:16; Rom 14:5-8)
- Baptism - This is performed in order for a person to become a member of the Society, and they are baptized in the name of the Father, the Son, and the organization (Compare to: Matt 28:19)
- The Memorial of Christ's Death at Passover - This is the only ceremony that the JW's observe. At this ceremony, held in a large auditorium, all members are expected to be present. The elements of the Lord's Supper are passed through the audience, but only those of the anointed or heavenly class are allowed to partake (That number is now fewer than 9,000 worldwide since no one born after AD 1914 is considered eligible).
- No blood transfusions (Gen. 9:4; Lev. 17:14)
- Only 144,000 elect (Rev. 7:4-8) will be able to enter heaven, the rest who believe will be allowed to a type of purgatory here on earth

WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

MENNONITE

FOUNDER- Menno Simons (1530)

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Bible**
2. **Tradition-** While they would claim that the Bible is their only authority, they have traditions within the church that usurp the biblical authority that does not force such traditions (peace/pacifism, washing of feet, clothing/dress (some not all))

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. **Scripture** - "Mennonites believe that all Scripture is inspired by God through the Holy Spirit for instruction in salvation and training in righteousness. We accept the Scriptures as the Word of God and as the fully reliable and trustworthy standard for Christian faith and life…"
2. **Salvation through Jesus Christ**- They believe in salvation by grace through faith alone
3. **Biblical Ordinances** – They believe in the two biblical ordinances of baptism and communion, however they do not baptize biblically in that they allow for sprinkling, pouring, and complete immersion. They do not teach complete immersion as the biblical way to baptize (Acts 8:38; Matt. 3:16)
4. **Eternal Security-** They do not believe in the eternal security of the believer. Because of their emphasis on holy living, law keeping, traditional living, they believe that you can become "apostate" and lose your salvation (1 Peter 1:15; 1 John 3:8-9; John 3:16; 2 Cor. 1:22; Eph. 1:13; 4:30; Romans 8:35-39)
5. **Emphasis of Peace/Pacifism-** They do not believe in preparing for war, participating in war or military service or any sort of actions that would go against their pacifist position (Ecc. 3:1-3; 1 Sam. 15:18; Jer. 50; 21)

AMISH

FOUNDER- Jakob Ammann (1693)

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Bible**
2. **Tradition-** While they would claim that the Bible is their only authority, they have traditions within the church that usurp the biblical authority that does not force such traditions (peace/pacifism, washing of feet, clothing/dress, no technology, lifestyle of 17th and 18th century Europe, shunning and excommunication of members, living separated from the rest of the world in the literal sense, etc…)

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. **Scripture** – "The Amish see the Bible as the inspired, inerrant Word of God." (many even use KJV)

2. **Salvation through Jesus Christ**- They believe in salvation by grace through faith alone

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6. **Separation**- Isolating themselves from the rest of society is one of the key Amish beliefs. They think secular culture has a polluting effect that promotes pride, greed, immorality and materialism. Therefore, to avoid the use of television, radios, computers, and modern appliances, they do not hook up to the electrical grid (Rom. 12:2; 2 Cor. 6:17; John 17:13-21)

7. **Evangelism**- Originally, the Amish evangelized, as do most Christian denominations, but over the years seeking converts and spreading the gospel became less and less of a priority, to the point that it is not done at all today (Matt. 28:19-20; Mark 16:15; Rom. 1:16; 2 Tim. 4:5)

8. **Shunning**- One of the controversial Amish beliefs, shunning, is the practice of social and business avoidance of members who violate the rules. Shunning is rare in most Amish communities and is only done as a last resort. Those who are excommunicated are always welcomed back if they repent (1 Cor. 5:1-5; 1 Tim. 1:20; Gal. 6:1-2; 2 Thess. 3:14-15)

WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

MENNONITE

FOUNDER- Menno Simons (1530)
Menno Simons (1496 – 31 January 1561) He was a Roman Catholic priest from the Friesland region of the Low Countries who was excommunicated from the Catholic Church and became an influential Anabaptist religious leader. Simons was a contemporary of the Protestant Reformers and it is from his name that his followers became known as Mennonites. His time as a Roman Catholic Priest for 20 years of his life and his time as a young man in a war torn country both greatly influenced his theology over the years. Although he was considered as a branch off from Anabaptists, he was highly influenced by his Catholic doctrine, traditions of men, and distaste for war.

AUTHORITIES

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2. **Tradition-** While they would claim that the Bible is their only authority, they have traditions within the church that usurp the biblical authority that does not force such traditions (peace/pacifism, washing of feet, clothing/dress (some not all))

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1. **Scripture** - "Mennonites believe that all Scripture is inspired by God through the Holy Spirit for instruction in salvation and training in righteousness. We accept the Scriptures as the Word of God and as the fully reliable and trustworthy standard for Christian faith and life…"

2. **Salvation through Jesus Christ**- They believe in salvation by grace through faith alone

    a. They do emphasize repentence as a part of salvation which can be taken multiple ways. They make your actions of repentance a large part/sign of salvation, so much so that they almost add works to salvation and as we will see, believe you can "lose" salvation

3. **Biblical Ordinances** – They believe in the two biblical ordinances of baptism and communion, however they do not baptize biblically in that they allow for sprinkling, pouring, and complete immersion. They do not teach complete immersion as the biblical way to baptize (Acts 8:38; Matt. 3:16)

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a. The issue with this is the idea that they are adding undue burdern/law to believers lives by adding to the bible laws that God has not enforced us to obey. Nowhere in the Bible are we ordered not to participate in wars or conflicts, especially when necessary. We ought to keep peace when possible, but if not possible we are absolutely allowed to war/fight

AMISH

FOUNDER- Jakob Ammann (1693) Jakob Ammann was a Mennonite pastor and, via a church schism, founder of the Amish branch of Anabaptism. Ammann sought reform in the form of more frequent communion services and the practice of regular social avoidance (shunning), which others practiced only symbolically. Amman's conflicts with other leaders which he perceived as spiritually lax proved unresolvable. He consistently called for harsher enforcement of rules, regulations, traditions of men, and undue burdens on fellow believers that are not found as such in the Bible. These issues ultimately caused him and his followers to split off from the Mennonites and form what came to be known as the Amish.

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Bible**
2. **Tradition-** While they would claim that the Bible is their only authority, they have traditions within the church that usurp the biblical authority that does not force such traditions (peace/pacifism, washing of feet, clothing/dress, no technology, lifestyle of 17th and 18th century Europe, shunning and excommunication of members, living separated from the rest of the world in the literal sense, etc…)

    a. Here are some weird amish traditions/beliefs

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

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2. **Salvation through Jesus Christ**- They believe in salvation by grace through faith alone

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    a. If a miser does not turn from his fornication, and a drunkard from his drunkenness, or other immoralities, they are thereby separated from the kingdom of God, and if he

does not improve himself through a pious, penitent life, such a person is no Christian and will not inherit the Kingdom of God.

5. **Emphasis of Peace/Pacifism-** They do not believe in preparing for war, participating in war or military service or any sort of actions that would go against their pacifist position (Ecc. 3:1-3; 1 Sam. 15:18; Jer. 50; 21)

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WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

PROTESTANTISM

<u>3 Major Branches of Protestantism:</u>

1. Lutheran (Martin Luther- 1520)
2. Anglican/Church of England (King Henry VIII- 1521)
3. Reformed (John Calvin- 1530)

LUTHERAN

FOUNDERS

1. **Martin Luther (1483-1546)**

AUTHORITIES

- The Bible
- Creeds/Church Tradition

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. Grace Alone… Faith Alone… Scripture Alone… (Eph. 2:8-9; Rom. 1:16-17; 10:17)
2. Baptismal Regeneration (Acts 8:36-38; 10:47-48; Rom. 10:9-10, 13; 6:3-4; 1Pt. 3:21)
3. Confession and Absolution of Sins to Pastors (1 Tim. 2:5; Is. 64:6; 59:2; Phil. 3:9; Rom. 3:21-26)
4. Transubstantiation (John 6:41-71; Acts 15:20, 29; Gen. 9:4; Lev. 17:11)

PRESBYTERIAN

FOUNDERS

1. **John Calvin (1509-1564)**
2. **John Knox (1514-1572)**

AUTHORITIES

- The Bible
- Teachings of John Calvin/other commentators

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. Grace Alone… Faith Alone… Scripture Alone… (Eph. 2:8-9; Rom. 1:16-17; 10:17)

2. Salvation by Predestination - *Calvinism* (1Jn. 2:2; 2Pt. 3:9; Jn. 3:16; Romans 8:29)

3. Replacement Theology - *God is done with Israel* (Rom. 9-11; Heb. 8; Ezek. 36-37; Am. 9; Zech. 8, 12, 14; Is. 49, 54, 60; Rom. 11:1-2, 25-26)

4. Churches should be governed by an overseeing Presbytery (Acts 14:23; Tts. 1:5; 1Pt. 5:1-4; 1 Tim. 4:14)

****CALVINISM**- This is the description of overarching teachings of John Calvin that can be found in any church (of course Presbyterian but also non denominational and even many Baptist churches)

- Calvinism holds to teachings 1-3 listed above but does not teach/emphasize the extra office of the presbytery. They are more liberal generally speaking and don't have quite the Catholic feel (special clergy clothing, services, etc…) that Presbyterian churches have. Most "Calvinist" churches have "reformed" in their name and services/churches would look very similar to ours in most other ways.
- Out of the Presbyterian Denomination came the **Church of Christ** and the **Disciples of Christ**

ANGLICAN

FOUNDERS

1. **King Henry VIII (1521)**

AUTHORITIES

- The Bible
- Creeds/Church Tradition

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. The Holy Scriptures of the Old and New Testaments, as "containing all things necessary to salvation," and as being the rule and ultimate standard of faith (2Tim. 3:16-17; 2Pt. 1:19-21)

2. The Creeds (*specifically, the Apostles' and Nicene*) as the sufficient statement of Christian faith (Rev. 2:6; 1Pt. 1:23; Rom. 10:17)

3. Infant Baptist/Baptism for salvation (Eph. 2:8-9; Acts 8:36-38; John 3:16; Rom. 10:9-10,13)

4. The historic episcopate locally adapted - *a hierarchy of bishops that oversee congregations* (Acts 14:23; Tts. 1:5; Phill. 1:1)

WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

METHODIST

FOUNDER- John Wesley

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. **Scripture**
2. **Salvation through Jesus Christ**
3. **Sanctification**
4. **Eternal Security/Holiness-** While they emphasize personal holiness and sanctification, Methodists go too far with this and state that if you don't live "good enough" that you can lose your salvation (1 Peter 1:15; 1 John 3:8-9; John 3:16; 2 Cor. 1:22; Eph. 1:13; 4:30; Romans 8:35-39)
5. **Connectional Model of Church Government** - Pastors are appointed to congregations by bishops, and lay members have limited representative authority in the local business of the church and national Methodist councils and conferences (Acts 14:23; Tts. 1:5; 1Pt. 5:1-4)
6. **Women Pastors/Supports LGBTQ community**- This church ordains women to be pastors, supports the LGBTQ community, and even flies their flag at the Methodist headquarters in London (1 Tim. 3:1-2; Titus 1:6; Lev. 20:13; 18:22; Rom. 1:26-32)

Out of the Methodist denomination came the **United Methodist**, **Salvation Army**, **Pentecostal**, **Assembly of God**, **Foursquare Gospel**, and the **Church of the Nazarene** denominations.

SEVENTH DAY ADVENTISM

FOUNDERS

1. **William Miller (1782-1849)**
2. **Ellen Gould White (1827-1915)**

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Bible**
2. **The Writings of Ellen White (their prophetess)** - The church believes her writings to be "inspired commentary on the Bible, not of human origin, contain doctrinal authority, and are unquestionable." It is important to note that the SDA website only speaks of the Holy Bible as the final authority, but Adventists will use her writings to reinforce their unbiblical doctrines.

DOCTRINE

HELL IS NOT ETERNAL

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ Hell does not currently exist and that it is temporary.
- ✓ All unbelievers will be annihilated after they have suffered long enough (Mal. 4:1, 3)

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Hell does currently exist (Lk. 16:19-31; Jon. 2:1-2)
- ✓ Hell is eternal (Matt. 18:8; 25:41; Jde. 1:7)
- ✓ The dead are not consumed (Mk. 9:42-48; Rev. 14:11)

"SABBATH" KEEPING

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ Keeping the Sabbath is still required by God and that it is the seal of a true believer

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Keeping the Sabbath was a sign for the Jews (Eze. 20:12, 20)
- ✓ Jesus expressly "broke" the Sabbath (Ex. 16:22-26 cf. Matt. 12:1-8)
- ✓ The Sabbath was a day of rest (Ex. 31:12-17)
- ✓ Our rest is in Jesus and not in a day of the week (Matt. 11:28; Heb. 4:1-10; Col. 2:16; Gal. 4:10-11)
    - Every other commandment is found in the NT as something that believers ought to follow (9/10 commandments) except for this one. It is finished, it was for the Jews.

"Holiness" type living

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ They focus on keeping the OT law as Christians today. They apply much of the OT to us today and therefore cast undue burdens onto the lives of Christians that Christ came to bear for us. With this belief comes the teaching that salvation can be earned/lost if you do not keep the law to an "unknown standard"

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Once you are saved, you are ALWAYS SAVED (John 3:16; 2 Cor. 1:22; Eph. 1:13; 4:30; Romans 8:35-39)
- ✓ We ought to strive to live holy lives (sanctified/separated) but sin is a daily fight/battle that ALL Christians struggle with (Rom. 7:14-20)

SATAN BEARS OUR SINS

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ "It was seen, also, that while the sin offering pointed to Christ as a sacrifice, and the high priest represented Christ as a mediator, the scapegoat typified Satan, the author of sin, upon whom the sins of the truly penitent will finally be placed" *The Great Controversy*
- ✓ "Their sins are transferred to the originator of sin" *Testimonies for the Church*

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Jesus Christ bore our sins in his body (Is. 53:4-6; Jn. 1:29; 1 Pet. 2:24)
- ✓ To say that Satan takes the sin of mankind is to make him the savior! This is blasphemy!

OUR BAPTIST HERITAGE

AUTHORITY

1. **The Bible** - 1Cor. 2:16; Ps. 138:2; Jn. 1:1, 14; Rev. 19:13; Jn. 10:35; Prov. 30:5-6; Ps. 12:6-7; 119:89; Jn. 10:35; Matt. 5:18; Rev. 20:12

DOCTRINE

1. **The Bible, Rightly-Divided and Correctly Applied**
    - ✓ Our doctrine comes as we believe what the bible says (2Pt. 1:3, 16-21; 2Tim. 3:15-17; 1Cor. 2:11-16)
    - ✓ Salvation by grace, through faith in the finished work Christ ALONE (Jn. 3:16, 36; 1Jn. 2:2; 2Cor. 5:17-21)

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4. Churches should be governed by an overseeing Presbytery (Acts 14:23; Tts. 1:5; 1Pt. 5:1-4; 1 Tim. 4:14)

-This phrase shows up on 1x in your whole Bible, and they take it to be some new/different office of church leadership that is not biblical and is not biblically mandated. This simply is a word for the church leadership.

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DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. The Holy Scriptures of the Old and New Testaments, as "containing all things necessary to salvation," and as being the rule and ultimate standard of faith (2Tim. 3:16-17; 2Pt. 1:19-21)

2. The Creeds (*specifically, the Apostles' and Nicene*) as the sufficient statement of Christian faith (Rev. 2:6; 1Pt. 1:23; Rom. 10:17)

3. Infant Baptist/Baptism for salvation (Eph. 2:8-9; Acts 8:36-38; John 3:16; Rom. 10:9-10,13)

4. The historic episcopate locally adapted - *a hierarchy of bishops that oversee congregations* (Acts 14:23; Tts. 1:5; Phill. 1:1)

WHAT DO WORLD RELIGIONS BELIEVE? WHAT DOES THE BIBLE SAY?

METHODIST

FOUNDER- John Wesley

DOCTRINAL BELIEFS TODAY

1. **Scripture** - The writings in the Old Testament and New Testament are the inspired word of God (2Tim. 3:16-17; 2Pt. 1:19-21)
2. **Salvation through Jesus Christ** - God's redeeming love is active to save sinners through Jesus' incarnate life and teachings, through his atoning death, his resurrection, his sovereign presence through history, and his promised return (Eph. 2:8-9; Rom. 1:16-17; 10:17)
3. **Sanctification** - The grace of sanctification draws one toward the gift of Christian perfection, which Wesley described as a heart "habitually filled with the love of God and neighbor" and as "having the mind of Christ and walking as he walked." (Rom. 8:29; 1Cor. 1:2, 30; 1Thess. 4:3)
4. **Eternal Security/Holiness-** While they emphasize personal holiness and sanctification, Methodists go too far with this and state that if you don't live "good enough" that you can lose your salvation (1 Peter 1:15; 1 John 3:8-9; John 3:16; 2 Cor. 1:22; Eph. 1:13; 4:30; Romans 8:35-39)
5. **Connectional Model of Church Government** - Pastors are appointed to congregations by bishops, and lay members have limited representative authority in the local business of the church and national Methodist councils and conferences (Acts 14:23; Tts. 1:5; 1Pt. 5:1-4)
6. **Women Pastors/Supports LGBTQ community**- This church ordains women to be pastors, supports the LGBTQ community, and even flies their flag at the Methodist headquarters in London (1 Tim. 3:1-2; Titus 1:6; Lev. 20:13; 18:22; Rom. 1:26-32)

Out of the Methodist denomination came the **United Methodist**, **Salvation Army**, **Pentecostal**, **Assembly of God**, **Foursquare Gospel**, and the **Church of the Nazarene** denominations.

SEVENTH DAY ADVENTISM

FOUNDERS

1. **William Miller (1782-1849)**
2. **Ellen Gould White (1827-1915)**

AUTHORITIES

1. **The Bible** (translations vary, some use KJV or multiple versions, Clear Word Bible is a SDA paraphrase though may not be in use today)
2. **The Writings of Ellen White (their prophetess)** - The church believes her writings to be "inspired commentary on the Bible, not of human origin, contain doctrinal authority, and are unquestionable." It is

important to note that the SDA website only speaks of the Holy Bible as the final authority, but Adventists will use her writings to reinforce their unbiblical doctrines.

DOCTRINE

HELL IS NOT ETERNAL

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ Hell does not currently exist and that it is temporary.
- ✓ All unbelievers will be annihilated after they have suffered long enough (Mal. 4:1, 3)

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Hell does currently exist (Lk. 16:19-31; Jon. 2:1-2)
- ✓ Hell is eternal (Matt. 18:8; 25:41; Jde. 1:7)
- ✓ The dead are not consumed (Mk. 9:42-48; Rev. 14:11)

"SABBATH" KEEPING

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ Keeping the Sabbath is still required by God and that it is the seal of a true believer. Those who do not keep the Sabbath will take the mark of the beast due to their ignorance of the scriptures. This is the main focus of the religion and look down upon those who do not observe a sundown Friday to sundown Saturday Sabbath (See any OT reference to "Sabbath")

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Keeping the Sabbath was a sign for the Jews (Eze. 20:12, 20)
- ✓ Jesus expressly "broke" the Sabbath (Ex. 16:22-26 cf. Matt. 12:1-8)
- ✓ The Sabbath was a day of rest (Ex. 31:12-17)
- ✓ Our rest is in Jesus and not in a day of the week (Matt. 11:28; Heb. 4:1-10; Col. 2:16; Gal. 4:10-11)
    - Every other commandment is found in the NT as something that believers ought to follow (9/10 commandments) except for this one. It is finished, it was for the Jews.

"Holiness" type living

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ They focus on keeping the OT law as Christians today. They apply much of the OT to us today and therefore cast undue burdens onto the lives of Christians that Christ came to bear for us. With this belief comes the teaching that salvation can be earned/lost if you do not keep the law to an "unknown standard"

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Once you are saved, you are ALWAYS SAVED (John 3:16; 2 Cor. 1:22; Eph. 1:13; 4:30; Romans 8:35-39)
- ✓ We ought to strive to live holy lives (sanctified/separated) but sin is a daily fight/battle that ALL Christians struggle with (Rom. 7:14-20)

SATAN BEARS OUR SINS

What Seventh Day Adventists Believe:

- ✓ "It was seen, also, that while the sin offering pointed to Christ as a sacrifice, and the high priest represented Christ as a mediator, the scapegoat typified Satan, the author of sin, upon whom the sins of the truly penitent will finally be placed" *The Great Controversy*
- ✓ "Their sins are transferred to the originator of sin" *Testimonies for the Church*

What the Bible Says:

- ✓ Jesus Christ bore our sins in his body (Is. 53:4-6; Jn. 1:29; 1 Pet. 2:24)
- ✓ To say that Satan takes the sin of mankind is to make him the savior! This is blasphemy!

OUR BAPTIST HERITAGE

HISTORY

AUTHORITY

1. **The Bible** - 1Cor. 2:16; Ps. 138:2; Jn. 1:1, 14; Rev. 19:13; Jn. 10:35; Prov. 30:5-6; Ps. 12:6-7; 119:89; Jn. 10:35; Matt. 5:18; Rev. 20:12

DOCTRINE

1. **The Bible, Rightly-Divided and Correctly Applied**
   - ✓ Our doctrine comes as we believe what the bible says (2Pt. 1:3, 16-21; 2Tim. 3:15-17; 1Cor. 2:11-16)
   - ✓ Salvation by grace, through faith in the finished work Christ ALONE (Jn. 3:16, 36; 1Jn. 2:2; 2Cor. 5:17-21)

FUNDAMENTAL DOCTRINES OF A BIBLICAL, NEW TESTAMENT CHURCH *("Trail of Blood" by Dr. J. M. Carroll)**:***

1. *A spiritual Church, Christ its founder, its only head and law giver.* (Lk. 17:21; Rom. 14:17; 12:5; Acts 20:28; Eph. 5:23; 4:12; Col. 1:14, 18, 27)
2. *Its ordinances: Only two, Baptism and the Lord's Supper. They are typical and memorial, not saving.* (Matt. 28:19-20; Acts 10:47; 1Pt. 3:21; 1Cor. 12:13; 11:24-25)
3. *Its officers: Only two, bishops or pastors and deacons; they are servants of the church.* (1 Tim 3:1-2, 8-13; Titus 1:5-7; Acts 20:17, 28)
4. *Its Government: A pure Democracy, and that executive only, never legislative.* (Acts 6:1-7; 14:21-23; Tts. 1:5; 1Tim., 2Tim., Tts.)
5. *Its laws and doctrines: The New Testament and that only.* (Acts 10 - Philemon)
6. *Its members: Believers only, they saved by grace, not works, through the regenerating power of the Holy Spirit.* (Rom. 10:9-10, 13; 8:9; Eph. 1:13-14; 2:8-9; 2Cor. 5:17, 21; Tts. 3:4-6)
7. *Its requirements: Believers on entering the church to be baptized, that by immersion, then obedience and loyalty to all New Testament laws.* (Acts 8:35-38; 16:14-15, 29-34, 40)
8. *The various churches -- separate and independent in their execution of laws and discipline and in their responsibilities to God--but cooperative in work.* (Acts: Church in Jerusalem vs. Antioch vs. Corinth, etc.)
9. *Complete separation of Church and State.* (Lk. 20:20-26; Jn 18:36; Dan. 2:44; 7:14)
10. *Absolute Religious liberty for all.* (Eccl. 11:9-10; 12-13-14; Jn. 6:44; 12:32; 2Pt. 3:8; 1Jn. 2:2; 2Cor. 5:14-15)

Anabaptists → Baptists

1. Montanists (190AD - 500AD)
2. Donatists (300AD - 800AD)
3. Paulicans (700AD - 1200AD)

4. Arnoldists (1200AD - 1300AD)
5. Albigenses (1300AD - 1400AD)
6. Waldenses (1300AD - 1700AD)
7. Baptists(1550AD-TODAY)

- What she wears
- The drinking of blood
- The seven hills of Rome
- She is the mother of harlots (false religions)
- She is universal (many waters)
- She has killed many martyrs
- She has control over the kings of the Earth
- Her symbol is a golden cup
- She is known as “mother”

Name ways in which the woman described in Revelation chapter 17 lines up with the Roman Catholic Church

S06 / TEACHING SERIES

Why We Use the KJB

Seven weeks on Bible authority, manuscripts, translation, differences, and review.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Teaching and resource adaptation, with credit retained for manuscript-evidence sources.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

30 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

Why We Use the KJB

Luke Johnston's selected teaching, writing or development sample; original bylines and citations retained.

Full teaching files

STUDENT COPY WEEK 1 UPDATED	*2 pages*
TEACHER COPY WEEK 1	*3 pages*
STUDENT COPY MSS EVIDENCE PT 1	*3 pages*
TEACHER COPY MSS EVIDENCE PT 1	*3 pages*
STUDENT WEEK 3 MSS EVIDENCE PT 2	*2 pages*
TEACHER WEEK 3 MSS EVIDENCE PT 2	*2 pages*
STUDENTS COPY WEEK 4	*3 pages*
TEACHERS COPY WEEK 4	*4 pages*
WEEK 5 STUDENT COPY	*1 pages*
WEEK 5 TEACHER COPY	*2 pages*
DOCTRINAL ISSUES IN NEW BIBLE VERSIONS	*2 pages*
FINAL JEOPARDY ANSWER	*1 pages*
FINAL JEOPARDY QUESTION	*1 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

Wednesday, August 31, 2022- EDGE Youth

Why We Use the KJV

I. For the next few weeks we will be looking at one of the most important topics concerning our Christian lives. We will be examining why we believe the King James Bible is the perfect and infallible word of God that we can trust 100% in our lives today. This issue is not really about being a historian, expert at manuscript evidence, or Greek/Hebrew scholars; it is about believing the biblical promises that God has made to us concerning having his pure words that we can trust as our **final authority** for all eternity.

II. **FINAL AUTHORITY**

A. This whole study is really going to be about having a final authority you can trust 100% without changing, adding to, or taking away from it

B. God has set authorities in all of our lives that we are to follow

1. God, the Bible, our parents, husband, government, our employers, teachers, elders, etc…

C. Where does what I believe about God, eternity, Jesus, salvation, etc.. come from?

D. Key questions concerning this topic of a Final Authority

1. Do different bibles say different things?
2. Do I have THE word of God that I can trust 100%?
3. Do I have a final authority?

III. **Faith Based View of Scripture-**

A. **God promises his word is inspired**

1. 2 Tim. 3:16; 2 Pet. 1:21; Acts 1:16; 28:25
2. **Inspiration (**as it pertains to the Bible)- *"the supernatural influence upon the sacred writers of the books of the Bible which enabled them to receiver and record with preciseness, the Divine revelation"*

B. God promises to preserve his inspired word

1. Psalm 12:6-7; 119:89,111,152,160; Isa. 40:8; Matt. 5:17-18; 24:35; Mark 13:31; 1 Pet. 1:23-25
   a) Almost everyone in the Christian world believes that the word of God was inspired ("God breathed") at its inception. When any author of the books of the Bible wrote what they did, they were inspired by God to write exactly what they wrote. However, most deny its **preservation**
2. The bible refers to copies of copies of copies of the originals as **scripture**
   a) 2 Tim. 1:13; 2:15; 3:15

C. God promises there will always be a _____ word of God which will be our final authority

1. Prov. 30:5; Psalm 12:6-7; 19:7; 119:40
2. Pure- 1. *"Free from moral defilement; without spot; not sullied or tarnished; incorrupt; undebased by moral turpitude; holy." 2. "Separate from all heterogeneous or extraneous matter; clear; free from mixture;"*

D. **God is _____ from his words. He is known by his words (Prov. 30:5; 138:2; Titus 1:2)**

E. A story of God inspiring, preserving, and even purifying his word (Jeremiah 36)

1. **Verses 1-18-** The process of inspiration and documentation (writing down what God said)

2. **Verses 20-23-** Men hearing and rejecting the words of God
3. **Verses 27-32-** God preserves and even purifies his words

F. Summary of our Faith Based View

1. The perfectly preserved and inerrant word of God is available today
    a) It is not just preserved and available in "idea" or amongst all the different Bible translations, it is preserved in "every word" as the Bible promises us
2. We can fully trust in the Bible we hold in our hands today to be 100% without error and exactly as God wants us to have it
3. The Bible we hold in our hands today is even better than the original manuscripts that were written by the original authors

IV. Understanding this introductory week will be key to understanding the upcoming weeks in this study. This issue is not about history, manuscripts, and translating; as much as it is about faith, biblical promises, and having a final authority in our lives. We have to trust that God can and will keep the promises he made to preserve his pure word for us forever. If we don't trust in these promises and understand that there can only be one _____ preserved word of God, then we ultimately have no final authority we can trust with our everyday lives and our eternity. Today we affirmed that there must be and can only be ONE perfectly preserved word of God, in the coming weeks, we will find where it is.

Wednesday, August 31, 2022- EDGE Youth

WHY WE USE THE KJV

I. For the next few weeks we will be looking at one of the most important topics concerning our Christian lives. We will be examining why we believe the King James Bible is the perfect and infallible word of God that we can trust 100% in our lives today. This issue is not really about being a historian, expert at manuscript evidence, or Greek/Hebrew scholars; it is about believing the biblical promises that God has made to us concerning having his pure words that we can trust as our **final authority** for all eternity.

II. **FINAL AUTHORITY**

- A. This whole study is really going to be about having a final authority you can trust 100% without changing, adding to, or taking away from it
  1. New bible versions are all about taking away your final authority, we will prove this throughout the course of this class
  2. ***STORY ABOUT HOW THIS ALWAYS COMES UP WHEN IN MINISTRY
- B. God has set authorities in all of our lives that we are to follow
  1. God, the Bible, our parents, husband, government, our employers, teachers, elders, etc…
     a) Where we learn about all of these authorities and the source of all truth is what is known as our final authority: the Bible
- C. Where does what I believe about God, eternity, Jesus, salvation, etc.. come from?
  1. The Bible! Would you be willing to stake your eternity on a book you can trust 90% or even 99% of the time?
- D. Key questions concerning this topic of a Final Authority
  1. Do different bibles say different things?
     a) If they do, especially when they say opposite things, which can I trust? Which is my final authority? And which is the book that is 90% correct that I am staking my eternity on?
     b) SLIDES OF BIBLE VERSES DIFFERENCES
  2. Do I have THE word of God that I can trust 100%?
     a) SLIDES OF DIFFERENT CHURCHES DOCTRINES
  3. Do I have a final authority?
     a) SLIDE OF MESSAGE FROM SAM

III. **Faith Based View of Scripture-**

- A. **God promises his word is Inspired**
  1. 2 Tim. 3:16; 2 Pet. 1:21; Acts 1:16; 28:25
  2. **Inspiration (**as it pertains to the Bible)- *"the supernatural influence upon the sacred writers of the books of the Bible which enabled them to receiver and record with preciseness, the Divine revelation"*

a) God is in the business of revealing truth. He does not want us in the dark on important issues. He wrote the Bible through the inspiration of the original authors in order to reveal truth to us through the Bible; however, this cannot be done without preservation as well.

b) Why would God waste time inspiring the Bible if he would not preserve it? If the word of God is only contained within the original inspired autographs of the original authors, then we would not have the word of God today because NONE of the original manuscripts exist today!

B. God promises to Preserve his inspired word

1. Psalm 12:6-7; 119:89,111,152,160; Isa. 40:8; Matt. 5:17-18; 24:35; Mark 13:31; 1 Pet. 1:23-25
    a) Almost everyone in the Christian world believes that the word of God was inspired ("God breathed") at its inception. When any author of the books of the Bible wrote what they did, they were inspired by God to write exactly what they wrote. However, most deny its **preservation**
        (1) What good is inspiration without preservation? If only the original manuscripts were the word of God, then the word of God only existed for maybe a maximum of 40-50 years at a time, and never all together
2. The bible refers to copies of copies of copies of the originals as **scripture**
    a) 2 Tim. 1:13; 2:15; 3:15

C. God promises there will always be a Pure word of God which will be our final authority

1. Prov. 30:5; Psalm 12:6-7; 19:7; 119:40
2. Pure- 1. *"Free from moral defilement; without spot; not sullied or tarnished; incorrupt; undebased by moral turpitude; holy." 2. "Separate from all heterogeneous or extraneous matter; clear; free from mixture;"*
3. The bottom line is this: God inspired his words to be written, he then promised to preserve and even purify them over time. We are promised that his words are pure/perfect words and that they will be preserved that way for us for all time!

D. **God is inseparable from his words. He is known by his words (Prov. 30:5; 138:2; Titus 1:2)**

1. God is perfect and he cannot lie, he cannot say things multiple ways. When God speaks he does not need to say it many ways, he speaks and it is perfect and exactly as he wants it to be said

E. A story of God inspiring, preserving, and even purifying his word (Jeremiah 36)

1. **Verses 1-18-** The process of inspiration and documentation (writing down what God said)
2. **Verses 20-23-** Men hearing and rejecting the words of God
3. **Verses 27-32-** God preserves and even purifies his words

F. Summary of our Faith Based View

1. The perfectly preserved and inerrant word of God is available today
    a) It is not just preserved and available in "idea" or amongst all the different Bible translations, it is preserved in "every word" as the Bible promises us
2. We can fully trust in the Bible we hold in our hands today to be 100% without error and exactly as God wants us to have it

3. The Bible we hold in our hands today is even better than the original manuscripts that were written by the original authors
    a) God has purified his word as he promised. He chose to use the English language in order to do it. This is not just some close minded view that we blindly believe because it is the language we speak, it is based on logical reasons that line up with biblical timelines
        (1) English is the universal language in business, politics, economics, etc…
        (2) It is the most descriptive language to have ever existed on the planet. One Greek, Hebrew, Aramaic, etc… word usually equates to 2-4 English words because it is such a descriptive language
            (a) English has a vocabulary size of about 800,000 words, the next highest amount in any language is only about half of that (440,000)
        (3) There are many words with similar and yet very precise meanings/connotations within our language. That does not happen in many languages. This allows God to convey meaning in a very deep way
        (4) The Bible that will be forever settled in heaven is Gods purified, preserved English King James Bible. Just like the purified and preserved copy of God's word that God commanded to be made in Jeremiah 36

IV. Understanding this introductory week will be key to understanding the upcoming weeks in this study. This issue is not about history, manuscripts, and translating; as much as it is about faith, biblical promises, and having a final authority in our lives. We have to trust that God can and will keep the promises he made to preserve his pure word for us forever. If we don't trust in these promises and understand that there can only be one **perfect** preserved word of God, then we ultimately have no final authority we can trust with our everyday lives and our eternity. Today we affirmed that there must be and can only be ONE perfectly preserved word of God, in the coming weeks, we will find where it is.

Wednesday, September 21, 2022- EDGE Youth

Why We Use the KJV Bible

I. Last week we saw how God promises over and over again throughout the Bible that he would preserve his words for us perfectly for all eternity. We saw how God purifies his words along the way and how English would be the perfect language for God to finalize his words in. Today, we will examine the _____ for the OT of the KJV vs. the OT of all other Bible versions. It is a fact that the KJV is based solely on a set of MSS that no other bible version has chosen to base their translations on. That sets the AV (Authorized Version aka KJV) apart from all other bibles.

II. A Biblical Study of <u>Alexandria, Egypt</u> & <u>Antioch, Syria</u>

A. Egypt in the Bible

1. First mention- Gen.12:10
2. Other mentions- Rev. 11:8; Gen. 13:10; Israel's captivity in Egypt in Exodus

B. Alexandria, Egypt

1. Acts 6:9; 18:24-28

C. Antioch, Syria

1. Acts 11:26; 13:1-3

III. **Survey of the Old Testament Manuscripts** (MSS= Manuscripts)

A. Romans 3:2- *"What advantage then hath the Jew? or what profit is there of circumcision? Much every way: chiefly, because that **<u>unto them were committed the oracles of God</u>**."*

1. The keeping of the scriptures, specifically as it pertains to the OT, was committed to the **Jews**: specifically to the Levites, priests, scribes, and the Jews as whole (Deut. 17:18; 31:24-26; Neh. 8:7-8; Deut. 4:1-2)

B. MASORETIC _____

1. This is the **Hebrew OT** that the **KJV** is translated from
2. The Masoretes were a group of conservative Jewish scribes who were committed to keeping the OT scripture perfectly intact and without error as commanded by God
3. Some rules they followed when copying the OT
   a) *A roll must be written on the skins of a clean animal*
   b) *It must be prepared for use by a Jew*
   c) *It must be fastened together with strings from a clean animal*
   d) *Every skin must contain ascertain number of columns and they must be equal throughout the entire codex (MSS document)*
   e) *The length of every column must be 48 and 60 lines long*
   f) *The length of each line must be exactly 30 letters*
   g) *The whole copy must be lined*
   h) *The ink must be black prepared according to a particular recipe (non metallic)*
   i) *An authorized copy must be the exemplar (one being copied from)*
   j) *No word, not even a letter, can be written from memory*
   k) *Between every letter there must be the space of a hair or thread*

l) Between every new section there must be the space of 9 letters
m) Between every book there must be 3 lines
n) The 5th book of Moses (Deuteronomy) must end exactly with a line
o) The copyist must sit in full Jewish dress
p) The copyist must have just washed his whole entire body
q) The copyist must write the name of God with a pen newly dipped in ink. He must again wash his whole body before writing the name of the Lord. And should a king address him while he is writing that name, he must ignore the king

(1) God preserved his OT words through the "priesthood" of believing Jews

4. It is worthy of note that the KJV is the only Bible to use an entirely Hebrew (some Aramaic) Old Testament to translate from. All other Bibles are translated from Greek OT MSS (we will examine those next)

C. THE SEPTUAGINT (_____ LXX) or Origen's Hexapla

1. This is the **Greek OT** that **ALL OTHER modern bible versions** are translated from
2. There is NO other historical evidence to suggest that a Greek OT existed before 300 AD other than the "Letter to Aristeas"
3. The OT of new versions of the Bible are actually translated from a document known as **Origen's Hexapla** in his 5th column (Hexpla=5 columns)
   a) He poorly tried to translate the Hebrew OT all on his own
   b) He was from the philosophical, bible rejecting, heretical college at Alexandria, Egypt
   c) All modern bible versions OT are based on his translation of the OT into Greek
4. Who was **Origen**?
   a) Believed Genesis 1-3 was not literal
   b) Believed in the allegorical interpretation method
   c) Believed Jesus was a created sub-god, not God
   d) Believed the Holy Spirit was a created being
   e) Believed in Salvation by works, not grace
   f) Believed in baptismal regeneration and sprinkling of babies
   g) Believed that Jesus' death was a ransom paid to Satan
   h) Believed in "purgatory" and not in a literal Hell
   i) Believed in universal salvation for all mankind
   j) Believed that Satan would be saved one day
   k) Believed that there is no bodily resurrection, but spiritual only
   l) Believed that there is no millennial kingdom of Jesus Christ
   m) Believed in the pre-existence of the human soul
   n) Called the "Father of textual criticism"
      (1) NOTE: A pattern is developing of bad manuscripts, Bible changing, heresy, etc… coming out of **Alexandria, Egypt**
5. These manuscripts contained the **Apocrypha** mixed in amongst the canonical books (inspired/preserved books) (Luke 24:27,44)

IV. Based on our faith based view of scripture, we know that within all of these manuscripts and English translations, somewhere in there we can find the perfectly pure and preserved word of God. Based on scripture promises that God would keep his OT words with the Jews and based on the great differences we see from

where these two sets of MSS come from, we can fully trust that our KJB in the OT is the perfect, preserved, pure word of God; _____ as he wants us to have it.

Wednesday, September 21, 2022- EDGE Youth

Why We Use the KJV Bible

I. Last week we saw how God promises over and over again throughout the Bible that he would preserve his words for us perfectly for all eternity. We saw how God purifies his words along the way and how English would be the perfect language for God to finalize his words in. Today, we will examine the **evidence** for the OT of the KJV vs. the OT of all other Bible versions. It is a fact that the KJV is based solely on a set of MSS that no other bible version has chosen to base their translations on. That sets the AV (Authorized Version aka KJV) apart from all other bibles.

II. A Biblical Study of Alexandria, Egypt & Antioch, Syria

A. Egypt in the Bible

1. First mention- Gen.12:10
2. Other mentions- Rev. 11:8; Gen. 13:10; Israel's captivity in Egypt in Exodus
   a) Egypt is a picture of the world (world system) in the Bible; never good

B. Alexandria, Egypt

1. Acts 6:9; 18:24-28
   a) A place where opposition to the truth and heresy come from

C. Antioch, Syria

1. Acts 11:26; 13:1-3
   a) The place where they were first called Christians and the central hub for worldwide missions to the rest of the world
   b) We use the missions model from what we see going on in Antioch as the model for our missions we do as a church

III. **Survey of the Old Testament Manuscripts** (MSS= Manuscripts)

A. Romans 3:2- *"What advantage then hath the Jew? or what profit is there of circumcision? Much every way: chiefly, because that **unto them were committed the oracles of God**."*

1. The keeping of the scriptures, specifically as it pertains to the OT, was committed to the **Jews**: specifically to the Levites, priests, scribes, and the Jews as whole (Deut. 17:18; 31:24-26; Neh. 8:7-8; Deut. 4:1-2)

B. MASORETIC TEXT

1. This is the **Hebrew OT** that the **KJV** is translated from
2. The Masoretes were a group of conservative Jewish scribes who were committed to keeping the OT scripture perfectly intact and without error as commanded by God
3. Some rules they followed when copying the OT
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   d) Every skin must contain ascertain number of columns and they must be equal throughout the entire codex (MSS document)
   e) The length of every column must be 48 and 60 lines long
   f) The length of each line must be exactly 30 letters
   g) The whole copy must be lined
   h) The ink must be black prepared according to a particular recipe (non metallic)

i) An authorized copy must be the exemplar (one being copied from)
j) No word, not even a letter, can be written from memory
k) Between every letter there must be the space of a hair or thread
l) Between every new section there must be the space of 9 letters
m) Between every book there must be 3 lines
n) The 5th book of Moses (Deuteronomy) must end exactly with a line
o) The copyist must sit in full Jewish dress
p) The copyist must have just washed his whole entire body
q) The copyist must write the name of God with a pen newly dipped in ink. He must again wash his whole body before writing the name of the Lord. And should a king address him while he is writing that name, he must ignore the king
(1) God preserved his OT words through the "priesthood" of believing Jews

4. It is worthy of note that the KJV is the only Bible to use an entirely Hebrew (some Aramaic) Old Testament to translate from. All other Bibles are translated from Greek OT MSS (we will examine those next)
a) How does this go with Romans 3:2 and the other verses where God promised the OT would be kept by the Jews?

C. THE SEPTUAGINT (GREEK LXX) or Origen's Hexapla

1. This is the **Greek OT** that **ALL OTHER modern bible versions** are translated from
a) The actual existence of this MSS is highly debated. The **only** historical record of it ever existing comes from a "Letter from Aristeas" where Aristeas writes to his brother Philocrates about how the Pharaoh of Egypt at the time, Ptolomy Philadelphia, was trying to get a Greek translation of the OT Hebrew scriptures for there library. The story states that 72 Jewish elders (six from each of the twelve tribes) were hired for the job to go to **Alexandria, Egypt** to translate this great work. They supposedly translated it all in 72 days and gave it to the Pharaoh. It became known as the Septuagint because of the 72 translators who created the translation (inaccurately so, since Septuagint means "70" and there were 72 translators who took 72 days).
2. There is NO other historical evidence to suggest that a Greek OT existed before 300 AD other than the "Letter to Aristeas"
3. The OT of new versions of the Bible are actually translated from a document known as **Origen's Hexapla** in his 5th column (Hexpla=5 columns)
a) He poorly tried to translate the Hebrew OT all on his own
b) He was from the philosophical, bible rejecting, heretical college at Alexandria, Egypt
c) All modern bible versions OT are based on his translation of the OT into Greek
4. Who was **Origen**?
a) Believed Genesis 1-3 was not literal
b) Believed in the allegorical interpretation method
c) Believed Jesus was a created sub-god, not God
d) Believed the Holy Spirit was a created being
e) Believed in Salvation by works, not grace
f) Believed in baptismal regeneration and sprinkling of babies
g) Believed that Jesus' death was a ransom paid to Satan
h) Believed in "purgatory" and not in a literal Hell
i) Believed in universal salvation for all mankind
j) Believed that Satan would be saved one day

k) Believed that there is no bodily resurrection, but spiritual only
l) Believed that there is no millennial kingdom of Jesus Christ
m) Believed in the pre-existence of the human soul
n) Called the “Father of textual criticism”
(1) NOTE: A pattern is developing of bad manuscripts, Bible changing, heresy, etc… coming out of **Alexandria, Egypt**
(2) Not a guy you want to trust when it comes to translating your Bible
(3) Who do you trust with translating the word of God; the ones God gave the task of translation and keeping to who follow the rules of the Masoretes, or this guy?

5. These manuscripts contained the **Apocrypha** mixed in amongst the canonical books (inspired/preserved books) (Luke 24:27,44)
a) Jesus did not use or condone the acceptance of the Apocrypha as scripture, neither did any Jews (to who is was committed to know what was scripture)

IV. Based on our faith based view of scripture, we know that within all of these manuscripts and English translations, somewhere in there we can find the perfectly pure and preserved word of God. Based on scripture promises that God would keep his OT words with the Jews and based on the great differences we see from where these two sets of MSS come from, we can fully trust that our KJB in the OT is the perfect, preserved, pure word of God; **exactly** as he wants us to have it.

Wednesday, August 31, 2022- EDGE Youth

Why We Use the KJV Bible

I. Last week we looked at the evidence for the OT MSS of the KJV vs. all other modern bible versions. This week we will be examining the NT MSS of the same. After this lesson, we will have a perfect understanding of the origins of both our King James Bible and all other bibles. Since we know God has promised to _____ and keep his word pure for us for all eternity, we must now examine where it can be found. After today, we will have a very good idea of exactly where it is.

II. Survey of the New Testament Manuscripts

A. TEXTUS RECEPTUS ("_____ Text")

1. Other names for these texts: **Eastern, Antiochan, Syrian, Byzantine, and Majority text**
2. They come from the **Antioch, Syria**
3. The New testament priesthood
    a) Rev. 1:6; 20:6; 1 Pet. 2:9
4. The Holy Spirit is preserving the word of God just as he inspired it; through holy men of God 1 Cor. 3: 16; 6:19
    a) This led to the majority of MSS out there lining up with the Textus Receptus as opposed to the Western Texts (hence majority text)
        (1) There are **5,210 MSS** in existence today that line up with the **Textus Receptus**
5. The Textus Receptus MSS did not survive long for the most part
    a) They were written on poor mans paper
    b) They were burned along with the families of those who held them and lived by them
6. Scholars often say that these are not the "oldest" MSS
    a) The **Peshitta Syriac** dates to **100-150 AD** and belongs to the TR family
    b) **Papyrus #66** dates **100-200 AD** and belongs to the TR family
    c) There are 2,630 documented scripture quotes from early church Chrisitians (church fathers) that line up with the TR as opposed to the Western texts from **68-400 AD**
        (1) Iranaeus (**130-202 AD**)- "Also towards the conclusion of his gospel, Mark says: "So then after the Lord Jesus had spoken to them, he was received up into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God. " (*AGAINST HERESIES III: 10:6)*
        (2) Cyprian (**200-258 AD**)- "The Lord says, "I and my Father are one," and again it is written of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit, " and these three are one." (*THE TREATISE OF CYPRIAN I:1:6)*

B. **WESTERN TEXTS (**aka _____ **Texts)**

1. They come from Alexandria, Egypt
2. They were rejected and not in use by the Christians of the early church and became the minority text
    a) There are only **45 MSS** in existence today that line up with the **Western Texts**
    b) Of these 45, only 3 are heavily used in the translating of modern versions
        (1) **Vaticanus**- 350-375 AD (kept under lock and key by the Catholic church)

(a) Leaves out over 1,000 sentences
(b) Adds over 500 words
(c) Changed approximately 2,000 words
(d) In 17,000 places it differs from Sinaiticus
(e) It leaves out books of the NT and adds in books that are not found in the Bible

(2) **<u>Sinai</u>ticus**- 300-400 AD (found at the base of Mt. Sanai in **Egypt** in a kindling bin in a monastery)
(a) Leaves out 4,000 words from the gospels alone
(b) Adds over 1,000 words
(c) Changes the reading of the text in 1,500 other places

(3) **<u>Alexandri</u>nus**- 400-500 AD (created in **Alexandria, Egypt**)
(a) None of these three MSS that scholars absolutely love and worship, are older than the oldest MSS of the TR
(b) They were all rejected by Christians as a whole, hence why there are so few in existence. They were not being copied and used.

c) These MSS were often preserved in large portions of writing
(1) This was due to the fact that they were:
(a) Written on expensive paper
(b) Kept locked away for hundreds of years and not in use
(c) Kept mostly by the Catholic church (they were not suffering persecution and being burned along with their MSS, they were the ones doing this to those who had the TR)

III. We have seen the whole of the matter. God is not absent from this issue of manuscript evidence. God has spoken expressly about who/how he would preserve his words that he promised us would be kept pure forever. He used his people the Jews with the OT and he used his people the born again believers, under the guidance of his spirit, to preserve the NT. The Bible also tells us the tale of two cities from which all bibles come; Antioch and Alexandria. The issue comes down to having _____ in what God has told us concerning the keeping of his word.

Wednesday, August 31, 2022- EDGE Youth

WHY WE USE THE KJV BIBLE

I. Last week we looked at the evidence for the OT MSS of the KJV vs. all other modern bible versions. This week we will be examining the NT MSS of the same. After this lesson, we will have a perfect understanding of the origins of both our King James Bible and all other bibles. Since we know God has promised to **preserve** and keep his word pure for us for all eternity, we must now examine where it can be found. After today, we will have a very good idea of exactly where it is.

II. Survey of the New Testament Manuscripts

A. TEXTUS RECEPTUS ("Received Text")

1. Other names for these texts: **Eastern, Antiochan, Syrian, Byzantine, and Majority text**
2. They come from the **Antioch, Syria**
   a) We learned last week about Antioch vs Alexandria. These MSS come from Antioch and were in heavy use by the faithful, mission minded, disciples of Jesus Christ
3. The New testament priesthood
   a) Just as the OT was entrusted to the Jewish priests to be kept; so God has also entrusted his NT priesthood of believer to do the same
   b) Rev. 1:6; 20:6; 1 Pet. 2:9
4. The Holy Spirit is preserving the word of God just as he inspired it; through holy men of God 1 Cor. 3: 16; 6:19
      (1) The Holy Ghost lives inside each and every believer, this is how God chose to preserve his word in the NT. Believers all either accepted or rejected manuscripts that were being passed around as scripture or false copies (false copies were going around at the time (2 Thess. 2:2)
   b) This led to the majority of MSS out there lining up with the Textus Receptus as opposed to the Western Texts (hence majority text)
      (1) There are **5,210 MSS** in existence today that line up with the **Textus Receptus**
      (2) (DON'T SAY THE NUMBER FOR THE WESTERN TEXTS YET)
5. The Textus Receptus MSS did not survive long for the most part
   a) They were written on poor mans paper
   b) They were burned along with the families of those who held them and lived by them
6. Scholars often say that these are not the "oldest" MSS
   a) The **Peshitta Syriac** dates to **100-150 AD** and belongs to the TR family
   b) **Papyrus #66** dates **100-200 AD** and belongs to the TR family
   c) There are 2,630 documented scripture quotes from early church Chrisitians (church fathers) that line up with the TR as opposed to the Western texts from **68-400 AD**
      (1) Give example of 1 John 5:7 and Mark 16:9-20 on Holy Bible app
      (2) Iranaeus (**130-202 AD**)- "Also towards the conclusion of his gospel, Mark says: "So then after the Lord Jesus had spoken to them, he was received up into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God. " (*AGAINST HERESIES III: 10:6)*

(3) Cyprian (**200-258 AD**)- “The Lord says, “I and my Father are one,” and again it is written of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit, “ and these three are one.” (*THE TREATISE OF CYPRIAN I:1:6)*

B. **WESTERN TEXTS (**aka **Alexandrian Texts)**

1. They come from Alexandria, Egypt
    a) We learned last week about Egypt, the bibles view of Egypt, the men from Egypt who believed and taught heresy, and the college in Alexandria that was a center for heresy as well
2. They were rejected and not in use by the Christians of the early church and became the minority text
    a) There are only **45 MSS** in existence today that line up with the **Western Texts**
    b) Of these 45, only 3 are heavily used in the translating of modern versions
        (1) **Vaticanus**- 350-375 AD (kept under lock and key by the Catholic church)
            (a) Leaves out over 1,000 sentences
            (b) Adds over 500 words
            (c) Changed approximately 2,000 words
            (d) In 17,000 places it differs from Sinaiticus
                (i) How do they reckon these differences when translating? They pick the reading they like best!
            (e) It leaves out books of the NT and adds in books that are not found in the Bible
        (2) **Sinaiticus**- 300-400 AD (found at the base of Mt. Sanai in **Egypt** in a kindling bin in a monastery)
            (a) Leaves out 4,000 words from the gospels alone
            (b) Adds over 1,000 words
            (c) Changes the reading of the text in 1,500 other places
        (3) **Alexandrinus**- 400-500 AD (created in **Alexandria, Egypt**)
            (a) None of these three MSS that scholars absolutely love and worship, are older than the oldest MSS of the TR
            (b) They were all rejected by Christians as a whole, hence why there are so few in existence. They were not being copied and used
    c) These MSS were often preserved in large portions of writing
        (1) This was due to the fact that they were:
            (a) Written on expensive paper
            (b) Kept locked away for hundreds of years and not in use
            (c) Kept mostly by the Catholic church (they were not suffering persecution and being burned along with their MSS, they were the ones doing this to those who had the TR)

III. We have seen the whole of the matter. God is not absent from this issue of manuscript evidence. God has spoken expressly about who/how he would preserve his words that he promised us would be kept pure forever. He used his people the Jews with the OT and he used his people the born again believers, under the guidance of his spirit, to preserve the NT. The Bible also tells us the tale of two cities from which all bibles come; Antioch and Alexandria. The issue comes down to having **faith** in what God has told us concerning the keeping of his word.

Wednesday, November 8th, 2022- EDGE Youth

Why We Use the KJV Bible

I. Today we will be looking at the Men and the Methods that were used in translating our KJB vs. all other modern bibles. As with all the other topics we have discussed, there are only two lines to follow. One group of men and methods were used for our KJB and another group of men and methods were used to translate all other bibles in existence. After careful consideration, we will see clearly once again the hand of God in _____ his words for us for all eternity and where we can find them.

II. The Superior Translators and Methods for Translating the KJV

A. The Superior _____

1. Lancelot Andrews
2. John Bois
3. Henry Saville
4. Edward Lively

a) The other 50 men were just as qualified and scholarly as these 4

B. The Rules they used for translating

1. The basic text shall be that of the Bishop's Bible, with as little altered as the truth of the original will permit.
2. People's names, including those of the authors of Biblical books, shall be retained in the ordinary spelling as far as might be.
3. The old ecclesiastical words shall be retained (ex: "church").
4. Words of more than one meaning shall be used in the sense found in most of the ancient fathers, appropriate to the context and consistent with the analogy of the faith (In addition, to avoid any formalistic, stilted literary style, a variety of English words were used to render the same Hebrew or Greek word).
5. The chapter divisions shall follow those of the Bishop's Bible.
6. No marginal notes shall be added, except for the explanation of the Hebrew or Greek words which cannot be briefly and fitly expressed in the text.
7. Cross-references shall only relate to the relevant passages elsewhere in Scripture.
8. Translations and revisions were to be done first by individual then submitted to the whole company for scrutiny, criticism, and final approval.
9. As each section of Books are completed, they shall be submitted to the other companies, "to be considered of seriously and judiciously, for his Majesty is very careful in this point."
10. If any company, upon reviewing a Book, doubt or differ upon any place, they shall notify the original company. If their objection is declined, the matter shall be settled at a general meeting.
11. In cases of special obscurity the translators shall be entitled to request assistance form any learned man in the land.
12. Each bishop shall seek the judgment of those among his clergy who are "skillful in tongues" upon the work at hand.
13. The directors of each company shall be Deans of Westminster and Chester, and the Regius Professors of Oxford and Cambridge universities.
14. The following translations shall be used when they agree better with the text than the Bishop's Bible - Tyndale, Coverdale, Matthew, the Great Bible, and the Geneva Bible.

15. Three or four of the most ancient and grave divines, from either of the universities and not employed in the translating, shall be overseers of the work.

C. The Order and Method they used for translating

1. The Order of Translating
    a) Fifty-four men were chosen for the task and were divided into six companies: Westminster (2), Oxford (2), Cambridge (2)
    b) Each member in each company made his own translation first
    c) The members of each company met to compare one another's work, reading passages out loud while comparing written notes
    d) When each company completes a Book, it was sent to the other five companies for their independent assessment
    e) When the complete Bible was translated, it came before a select committee of twelve men, two From each company; in 1609, this group met daily for nine months as the Stationer's Hall in London; they acted as a "referral committee" in areas of difficulty or disputed passages
    f) As the final step, the entire work was to be assembled and "polished" by a publication committee of two men, before being sent to the Royal Printer
    g) Going through all of these steps, each passage in translation was scrutinized at a minimum of fourteen times
2. The Method of Translating
    a) They also followed what is called **"formal equivalence"** when translating words into English. This means that each word is translated literally and as a word for word translation. This is the most honest, true to the text, conservative way of translating
    b) Definition of formal equivalence- Formal equivalence in translation, broadly speaking, seeks to translate the text word-for-word, tacking as close to the original source material as the recipient language allows.

III. The Inferior Translators and Methods for Translating modern versions

A. The Inferior Translators

1. **Brooke Foss Westcott** & **Fenton John Anthony Hort**
2. Their translation materials, methods, and order has been followed by ALL modern bible versions when translating all new bibles
3. **The Ghostly Guild**
    a) These two men were also a part of and in fact started a ghost conjuring, spiritualistic group known as the ghostly guild. This is well documented in their own diaries of their lives which were since published by their children after their deaths.

B. The Inferior Translation _____

1. They used what is known as **"dynamic equivalence"** when translating words/phrases into English
    a) **Definition of Dynamic Equivalence-** The counterpart to formal equivalence is dynamic equivalence, or functional equivalence. Here, rather than seeking to translate as close to word for word as possible, dynamic equivalence attempts to translate "thought for thought.
2. The translation committee and process for checking work was simple, these two men did all the work and checking of work themselves
3. All modern versions of the Bible that have come out since Westcott and Hort's translation have used their own translators for their versions, however all based their work on the work of these 2 men. If we were to analyze the translators of any other Bible version, none would compare to the translators/methods of the KJV!

IV. As we have seen today, the men and the methods used for translating your KJB are far and away better than the ones used for translating modern bible versions. The scholarship of this group of 54 men was amazing and was used by God to ensure his words were not messed with and were _____ preserved for us. The men who translated what is now used for all modern bible versions were corrupt, did not use a word for word translation method, and were Bible

heretics. There is no question that our KJB was translated and handled correctly so that we could have God’s words preserved perfectly for us today.

Wednesday, November 8th, 2022- EDGE Youth

Why We Use the KJV Bible

I. Today we will be looking at the Men and the Methods that were used in translating our KJB vs. all other modern bibles. As with all the other topics we have discussed, there are only two lines to follow. One group of men and methods were used for our KJB and another group of men and methods were used to translate all other bibles in existence. After careful consideration, we will see clearly once again the hand of God in **preserving** his words for us for all eternity and where we can find them.

II. The Superior Translators and Methods for Translating the KJV

A. The Superior Translators

1. Lancelot Andrews

a) During his 1-2 month vacations with his family, he would find a master of a language he did not know and learn the language before returning home
b) He studied Oriental languages and Divinity at Cambridge
c) He became the lecturer of Divinity at Cambridge
d) At 24 he became the Master at Pembroke Hall
e) He left the college to be the chaplain in ordinary to Queen Elizabeth, and then later he would become the Dean of Westminster
f) Concerning his translation work, his work was the best among the others in his company
g) He wrote all his personal devotions in Greek

2. John Bois

a) At 5 yrs old he read through the Hebrew Bible
b) At 6 yrs old he was able to write the Greek language in a “fair and elegant manner”
c) At 15 yrs old he was enrolled at St. John’s College in Cambridge, and at the halfway mark of his first year he was writing letters in Greek to his Masters
d) While studying under one of his Masters, he had read through 12 Greek authors in verse and prose in the most difficult dialects and phrases that could be found
e) It was common for him to go to the library at 4am and stay until 8pm
f) At old age he still studied for 8 hours a day, reading and correcting ancient authors
g) He would preach without notes because he wanted to be heard and understood by the most humble and ignorant hearers

3. Henry Saville

a) He was educated at Brazen Nose College in Oxford, and then soon after traveled to France to perfect himself in literature
b) His specialty was Greek and Math, and he would end up becoming the tutor of these subjects to Queen Elizabeth; his tutoring was so successful that her study habits were clearly seen into her old age
c) He was the first person to completely translate the entire work of Chrysostom (8 huge folios); he translated many works into Latin and English

d) He served as the Warden of Merton College, Provost of Eton College

4. **Edward Lively**
    a) He was said to be one of the best linguists in the known world
    b) He was so skilled that he was the King's professor of Hebrew
    c) He was said to be the 2 nd best Hebrew scholar on the translation committee
    d) He died before the translation work was completed

B. The Rules they used for translating

1. The basic text shall be that of the Bishop's Bible, with as little altered as the truth of the original will permit.
2. People's names, including those of the authors of Biblical books, shall be retained in the ordinary spelling as far as might be.
3. The old ecclesiastical words shall be retained (ex: "church").
4. Words of more than one meaning shall be used in the sense found in most of the ancient fathers, appropriate to the context and consistent with the analogy of the faith (In addition, to avoid any formalistic, stilted literary style, a variety of English words were used to render the same Hebrew or Greek word).
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7. Cross-references shall only relate to the relevant passages elsewhere in Scripture.
8. Translations and revisions were to be done first by individual then submitted to the whole company for scrutiny, criticism, and final approval.
9. As each section of Books are completed, they shall be submitted to the other companies, "to be considered of seriously and judiciously, for his Majesty is very careful in this point."
10. If any company, upon reviewing a Book, doubt or differ upon any place, they shall notify the original company. If their objection is declined, the matter shall be settled at a general meeting.
11. In cases of special obscurity the translators shall be entitled to request assistance form any learned man in the land.
12. Each bishop shall seek the judgment of those among his clergy who are "skillful in tongues" upon the work at hand.
13. The directors of each company shall be Deans of Westminster and Chester, and the Regius Professors of Oxford and Cambridge universities.
14. The following translations shall be used when they agree better with the text than the Bishop's Bible - Tyndale, Coverdale, Matthew, the Great Bible, and the Geneva Bible.
15. Three or four of the most ancient and grave divines, from either of the universities and not employed in the translating, shall be overseers of the work.

C. The Order and Method they used for translating

1. The Order of Translating
    a) Fifty-four men were chosen for the task and were divided into six companies: Westminster (2), Oxford (2), Cambridge (2)
    b) Each member in each company made his own translation first
    c) The members of each company met to compare one another's work, reading passages out loud while comparing written notes

d) When each company completes a Book, it was sent to the other five companies for their independent assessment
e) When the complete Bible was translated, it came before a select committee of twelve men, two From each company; in 1609, this group met daily for nine months as the Stationer's Hall in London; they acted as a "referral committee" in areas of difficulty or disputed passages
f) As the final step, the entire work was to be assembled and "polished" by a publication committee of two men, before being sent to the Royal Printer
g) Going through all of these steps, each passage in translation was scrutinized at a minimum of fourteen times

2. The Method of Translating
   a) They also followed what is called **"formal equivalence"** when translating words into English. This means that each word is translated literally and as a word for word translation. This is the most honest, true to the text, conservative way of translating
   b) Definition of formal equivalence- Formal equivalence in translation, broadly speaking, seeks to translate the text word-for-word, tacking as close to the original source material as the recipient language allows.

III. The Inferior Translators and Methods for Translating modern versions

A. The Inferior Translators

1. **Brooke Foss Westcott** & **Fenton John Anthony Hort**
   a) These were two men who in the mid 1800's began to undertake a "new translation" of the Bible, using what they thought were better, older manuscripts (we now know this to be untrue, the manuscripts they used were the corrupt ones from Egypt we have examined over the past few weeks)
2. Their translation materials, methods, and order has been followed by ALL modern bible versions when translating all new bibles
3. Here are some details about these men and the materials and methods they used to translate
   a) Quotes from Westcott and Hort:
      (1) **Baptismal Regeneration**- "…at the same time in language stating that we maintain 'Baptismal Regeneration' as the most important of doctrines … the pure 'Romish' view seems to me nearer, and more likely to lead to, the truth than the Evangelical."
      (2) **Evolution**- ""But the book which has most engaged me is Darwin. Whatever may be thought of it, it is a book that one is proud to be contemporary with. I must work out and examine the argument in more detail, but at present my feeling is strong that the theory is unanswerable."
      (3) **Worshiping of Mary**- "I have been persuaded for many years that Mary-worship and 'Jesus'-worship have very much in common in their causes and their results."
      (4) **On the Textus Receptus**- ""I had no idea till the last few weeks of the importance of texts, having read so little Greek Testament, and dragged on with the villainous Textus Receptus. Think of that vile Textus Receptus leaning entirely on late MSS.; it is a blessing there are such early ones"

(5) **The First 3 chapters of Genesis-** "No one now, I suppose, holds that the first three chapters of Genesis, for example, give a literal history – I could never understand how anyone reading them with open eyes could think they did"

b) The Ghostly Guild

(1) These two men were also a part of and in fact started a ghost conjuring, spiritualistic group known as the ghostly guild. This is well documented in their own diaries of their lives which were since published by their children after their deaths.

B. The Inferior Translation Methods

1. They used what is known as **"dynamic equivalence"** when translating words/phrases into English
   a) This is a more liberal type of translating method where the words can be translated "dynamically" rather than literally, in order to fit the translation the translators think best fits. Where the literal translation may be a certain word, they can decide that they think another word was likely what was meant based on the way we use it today.
   b) **Definition of Dynamic Equivalence-** The counterpart to formal equivalence is dynamic equivalence, or functional equivalence. Here, rather than seeking to translate as close to word for word as possible, dynamic equivalence attempts to translate "thought for thought.
2. The translation committee and process for checking work was simple, these two men did all the work and checking of work themselves
3. All modern versions of the Bible that have come out since Westcott and Hort's translation have used their own translators for their versions, however all based their work on the work of these 2 men. If we were to analyze the translators of any other Bible version, none would compare to the translators/methods of the KJV!
   a) There are homosexuals, Atheists, Agnostics, politicians, etc… all on the translation committees of all new bibles. They are not nearly as qualified to translate these works as the translators of the KJV and they don't have the character these men did

IV. As we have seen today, the men and the methods used for translating your KJB are far and away better than the ones used for translating modern bible versions. The scholarship of this group of 54 men was amazing and was used by God to ensure his words were not messed with and were **perfectly** preserved for us. The men who translated what is now used for all modern bible versions were corrupt, did not use a word for word translation method, and were Bible heretics. There is no question that our KJB was translated and handled correctly so that we could have God's words preserved perfectly for us today.

Wednesday, November 16th, 2022- EDGE Youth

Why We Use the KJV Bible

I. Today we will be examining just a few of the features that make your KJB very unique from any other bible translations. The King James Bible is also called the _____ Version and has been called this for years, that is a title that only belongs to our Bible because of it's preeminence over all other bible versions. We will find that many of these unique features of our Bible help us to study the Bible in a deep way that other bibles miss out on. There will be no doubt that our Bible is the perfect preserved word of God in every single way.

II. _____ Features of the KJB

- A. **A it was authorized by a King** (1 Peter 2:17; Ecc. 8:4)
- B. **No copyright** (2 Tim. 2:9)
- C. **Scientific** (Job 25:5; Gen. 7:11; Gen. 17:12
- **D. Use of Italics**
- E. **Self Defining** (Gen. 8:1-5; Judges 9:24,56)
- F. **The time in history of its translation**
- **G. The preeminence it gives to the Lord Jesus Christ**
    1. Verses kept intact (1 Ti. 3:16; 1 Jo. 5:7; Phil. 2:6)
- **H. Signs and Maps (The use of key words and phrases and other built-in study tools)**
    1. That Day/The Day of the lord
    2. Those Days
    3. Serpent; Beast; Dragon
    4. It came to pass
    5. Sword
    6. Selah
    7. Third Day / Three Days
    8. The use of Numerology
    9. The Law of First Mention
    10. The use of Repetition
    11. Self-defining / Built-in Dictionary
- **I. The geographic location from whence it came**
- **J. The fruit it has borne**
    1. Greatest time in world missions
    2. More folks get saved under its preaching; more sustained growth is measured
    3. The fear it creates
    4. The enemies it has made and the controversy always surrounding it (like none other)
    5. Its popularity

III. As we have seen, the King James Bible is the Bible among all bibles. It is the _____ word of God, greatest selling book of all time, not copyrighted, authorized by a King, world changing, Authorized Version Bible. No other bible version compares to it and they never will. There are so many unique features in your KJB that God has placed there that are simply missing in new versions because new versions lose power trying to simply change the words of God just to come out with a new version to make money on. You can have full confidence that your Bible you hold, the KJB, is the perfect word of God!

Wednesday, November 16th, 2022- EDGE Youth

Why We Use the KJV Bible

I. Today we will be examining just a few of the features that make your KJB very unique from any other bible translations. The King James Bible is also called the **Authorized** Version and has been called this for years, that is a title that only belongs to our Bible because of it's preeminence over all other bible versions. We will find that many of these unique features of our Bible help us to study the Bible in a deep way that other bibles miss out on. There will be no doubt that our Bible is the perfect preserved word of God in every single way.

II. **Unique** Features of the KJB

A. **A it was authorized by a King** (1 Peter 2:17; Ecc. 8:4)

B. **No copyright** (2 Tim. 2:9)

C. **Scientific** (Job 25:5; Gen. 7:11; Gen. 17:12 (show website)

1. https://evidence-for-the-bible.com/scientific-evidence-for-the-bible/scientific-evidence-for-circumcision-on-the-eighth-day/

D. Use of Italics

1. This is the only honest translation method because it marks all connective language additions needed when making any translation
2. The way that languages work and translating between languages is that there is never a 100% exact translation for every phrase word into another language. Some words just don't translate. In English we have sayings and parts of speech and vowels which don't/didn't exist in many other languages.
3. For this reason, the KJV translators used italics for any words they "added" that would translate the best into English in order to make sense in our language. However, to be as honest and open in translation as possible, they italicized the words to let you know this. No other translation does this even though they all add words just the same.

E. **Self Defining** (Gen. 8:1-5; Judges 9:24,56)

F. **The time in history of its translation**

1. A major, yet often dismissed, factor concerning the KJv is the time in history when it was translated. There are many schools of thought today that deeply affect our mindset concerning life's issues. These schools of thought affect us every day and cause different outcomes to take place in a plethora of circumstances and situations. For example: Atheism, Rationalism and Deism effect the decisions our government and business leaders make concerning a whole host of issues (abortion, homosexuality, prayer in schools, domestic laws, availability of anti-biblical products, etc.). At the time of the writing of the King James Bible none of these things were established arenas of thinking. French Atheism was not in vogue, German Rationalists did not exist, therefore had no influence on anyones thinking. English Deism was not around so no one thought that God was "dead" or absent from his creation. Thus men could produce a Bible that without objection, a Bible that could be believed by the common man!

G. The preeminence it gives to the Lord Jesus Christ

1. Verses kept intact (1 Ti. 3:16; 1 Jo. 5:7; Phil. 2:6)

H. Signs and Maps (The use of key words and phrases and other built-in study tools)

1. That Day/The Day of the lord
2. Those Days
3. Serpent; Beast; Dragon
4. It came to pass (show this on BLB)
5. Sword
6. Selah
7. Third Day / Three Days
8. The use of Numerology
9. The Law of First Mention
10. The use of Repetition
11. Self-defining / Built-in Dictionary

I. The geographic location from whence it came

1. England is the standard for world time and direction

J. The fruit it has borne

1. Greatest time in world missions
    a) John Wesley, George Whitfileld, Adinirom Judson, Hudson Taylor, William Carey, David Livingstone, etc…)
2. More folks get saved under its preaching; more sustained growth is measured
3. The fear it creates
4. The enemies it has made and the controversy always surrounding it (like none other)
5. Its popularity

III. As we have seen, the King James Bible is the Bible among all bibles. It is the **preserved** word of God, greatest selling book of all time, not copyrighted, authorized by a King, world changing, Authorized Version Bible. No other bible version compares to it and they never will. There are so many unique features in your KJB that God has placed there that are simply missing in new versions because new versions lose power trying to simply change the words of God just to come out with a new version to make money on. You can have full confidence that your Bible you hold, the KJB, is the perfect word of God!

Wednesday, December 7th, 2022- EDGE Youth

Why We Use the KJV Bible

I. Today we are going to get into groups and take a look at some bible passages that can be found in modern versions of the Bible and compare them with the verses in your KJB. After today we will clearly see that new versions of the Bible are not just “easier to read” while maintaining good doctrinal teachings, but they in fact teach false doctrines and contradict themselves in many places.

II. Group 1

A. John 1:1 (NWT)- In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was a god.

B. Matt. 5:22 (NIV)- But I tell you that anyone who is angry with a brother or sister will be subject to judgment. Again, anyone who says to a brother or sister, ‘Raca,’ is answerable to the court. And anyone who says, ‘You fool!’ will be in danger of the fire of hell.

C. Mark 15:28 (NIV)- MISSING

D. Mark 16:9-20 (NASB)- MISSING

E. Phil. 2:6 (ESV)- who, though he was in the form of God, did not count equality with God a thing to be grasped,

III. Group 2

A. Luke 4:4 (ESV)- And Jesus answered him, “It is written, ‘Man shall not live by bread alone.’”

B. Acts 8:27 (NIV)- MISSING

C. Col. 1:14 (ESV)- in whom we have redemption, the forgiveness of sins.

D. Psalm 12:6-7 (NIV)- And the words of the LORD are flawless, like silver purified in a crucible, like gold refined seven times. You, LORD, will keep the needy safe and will protect us forever from the wicked,

E. Isaiah 14:12 & Revelation 22:16 (NIV)

1. Isaiah 14:12- How you have fallen from heaven, morning star, son of the dawn! You have been cast down to the earth, you who once laid low the nations!
2. Revelation 22:16- “I, Jesus, have sent my angel to give you this testimony for the churches. I am the Root and the Offspring of David, and the bright Morning Star.”

IV. Group 3

A. Gen. 3:16 (ESV)- To the woman he said, I will surely multiply your pain in childbearing; in pain you shall bring forth children. Your desire shall be contrary to your husband, but he shall rule over you.

B. 2 Sam. 21:19 (ESV)- And there was again war with the Philistines at Gob, and Elhanan the son of Jaare-oregim, the Bethlehemite, struck down Goliath the Gittite, the shaft of whose spear was like a weaver's beam.

C. Mark 10:24 (NASB)- And the disciples were amazed at His words. But Jesus responded again and said to them, "Children, how hard it is to enter the kingdom of God!

D. 1 John 5:7 (ESV)- MISSING

E. John 7:8-10 (NIV)- You go to the festival. I am not going up to this festival, because my time has not yet fully come. After he had said this, he stayed in Galilee. However, after his brothers had left for the festival, he went also, not publicly, but in secret.

V. Group 4

A. Mark 1:41 (NIV)- Jesus was indignant. He reached out his hand and touched the man. "I am willing," he said. "Be clean!"

B. John 1:18 (NASB)- No one has seen God at any time; the only begotten God who is in the bosom of the Father, He has explained Him.

C. Rev. 5:10 (NLT)- And you have caused them to become a Kingdom of priests for our God. And they will reign on the earth.

D. 1 Pet. 1:23 (NIV)- For you have been born again, not of perishable seed, but of imperishable, through the living and enduring word of God.

E. Micah 5:2 (NLT)- But you, O Bethlehem Ephrathah, are only a small village in Judah. Yet a ruler of Israel will come from you, one whose origins are from the distant past.

VI. Today we have seen in 20 places where there are major doctrinal contradictions found in new versions of the Bible. These are just a few of the thousands of differences that are found in modern versions that affect key bible doctrines. We cannot buy into the lie that new bibles are just about being easier to understand and really aren't that different from the KJV. If you have staked your eternity on the Bible then you need a Bible that you can trust 100% of the time because that is what God promised us!

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How many NT MSS in existence today line up with the NT of all modern bible versions?

S07 / TEACHING SERIES

Neglect Not Thy Gift / Spiritual Gifts

An introductory lesson and six teaching weeks on spiritual gifts, with a questionnaire and summary resources.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Teaching, lesson preparation, and adaptation of supporting resources.

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WEEK 6 STUDENT COPY FAITH, PROPHESY, AND OUTRO	*3 pages*
WEEK 6 TEACHER COPY FAITH, PROPHESY, AND OUTRO	*4 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

Wednesday, April 27th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

NEGLECT NOT THY GIFT- 1 COR. 12:1-7, 11-31

I. It is of utmost importance that each and every believer realizes their importance in the grand plan of God. There is a plan that involves eternity, souls, the great battle between good and evil (God and the Devil), and the future kingdoms of the world; and God has made it so that he needs each and every one of us to be involved in this plan. God saw you as so valuable that he gave his own life for you. The value he sees in you does not stop there, but continues into the plan God has for each and every one of us in this grand plan of his. Knowing your _____in this fight and what role God MADE YOU TO PLAY is necessary in order to be successful for the Lord. Over the course of the coming weeks we are going to look at these gifts and each and every one of us that are a part of the family of God will see how great a role we play in this _____ _____, and exactly what God made you to do in it.

II. DON'T BE IGNORANT ABOUT SPIRITUAL GIFTS (vs. 1)

A. This issue is of such importance! This can help us find our place in the body of Christ and give us a purpose.

1. Prov. 16:3- "Commit thy works unto the LORD, and thy thoughts shall be established.
2. "Spiritual Gifts vs. Natural Gifts

a) Natural Gifts- We are all made by God a certain way and with certain gifts. Some of these gifts could be artists, musicians, speakers, influencers, leaders, servants, athletes, etc…These are not "spiritual gifts" but gifts that we are born with that we can use to serve the Lord. Some of these gifts cross over into our spiritual gifts when we become a part of the body of Christ at salvation. (if you are a good speakers naturally, you likely will have the spiritual gift of teacher/evangelist; and so on with other gifts)

b) Spiritual Gifts- When we have the spirit of God move into us at the moment of salvation, we are given some spiritual gifts that we need to find out what they are. These gifts may come to us as a result of how we are naturally gifted, but may not always. We are able to desire and ask for and be given (develop) new spiritual gifts. This is a unique thing about spiritual gifts that is not the case with our natural gifts. (1 Cor. 14:1; 1 Cor. 14:12)

(1) As we go through this series, analyze what your spiritual gifts are and maybe how they relate to your natural gifts. And also, don't be upset about the gifts you don't have, but desire spiritual gifts that you want to develop and ask God for them. These spiritual gifts will be the gifts that our series is focused on.

III. THE SAME SPIRIT WORKETH IN US ALL (vs. 2-7)

A. We all will have different gifts and ways that come easier for us to serve the Lord, we need to not be jealous/envious over others and rather understand our gifts and help others with our gifts

1. 1 Cor. 14:12- "Even so ye, forasmuch as ye are zealous of spiritual gifts, seek that ye may **excel to the edifying of the church**."

a) We can seek to find/have spiritual gifts, but for the purpose of serving God and _____others where they may lack in these gifts. NOT FOR OURSELVES.
b) KEY: WE CANNOT SEE THIS ISSUE WITH PRIDE AND NOT WITH CHARITY. We have to be honest and own the gifts that God has given us, but we cannot let it become about us. It is not prideful to say you have certain gifts since it is important we recognize our gifts, but we must give God the credit and glory with them.
(1) 1 Cor. 1:26-31- "For ye see your calling, brethren, how that not many wise men after the flesh, not many mighty, not many noble, *are called*: But God hath chosen the foolish things of the world to confound the wise; and God hath chosen the weak things of the world to confound the things which are mighty; And base things of the world, and things which are despised, hath God chosen, *yea*, and things which are not, to bring to nought things that are: That no flesh should glory in his presence. But of him are ye in Christ Jesus, who of God is made unto us wisdom, and righteousness, and sanctification, and redemption: **That, according as it is written, He that glorieth, let him glory in the Lord."**

IV. THE BODY OF CHRIST (vs. 11-31)

A. We are all a part of the body of Christ (vs. 11-20)
1. Like in our bodies, all of our parts contribute to the whole of us. The sum of all of our parts is called our body.
2. Each of us has a role in the body (just as each part of our bodies has a role). This role is greatly influenced by our spiritual gifts. We are made by God to have a specific function in the church. We are not just some random part of the body, we are _____ by God for a purpose
a) Jer. 1:5- "Before I formed thee in the belly I knew thee; and before thou camest forth out of the womb I sanctified thee, *and* I ordained thee a prophet unto the nations."
b) Psalm 139:13-14- "For thou hast possessed my reins: thou hast covered me in my mother's womb. I will praise thee; for I am fearfully *and* wonderfully made: marvellous *are* thy works; and *that* my soul knoweth right well."

B. The seemingly most insignificant, are the most significant with God (vs. 21-31)
1. Think of some of the smallest parts of the body. They may seem insignificant at first glance, but they are essential in order to function best and even survive
2. No role in the body of Christ is insignificant. We often look at the pastors, teachers, or people who know a lot about the bible and think of them as extra spiritual. THIS IS WRONG THINKING AND CAN ONLY CAUSE ISSUES IN THE BODY. We need to understand that the groups of people that do the things that are not out in the open are just as important as the other parts of the body.
a) If I asked you what the heart or brain were and what they do, all of us know. However, as we just saw, the parts of the body you may never have even heard of are just as essential to survival.
b) It is also good to know that while the body can survive without certain parts, or with injured parts; it _____function at full capacity and may be severely

maimed. THIS IS WHY IT IS OF UTMOST IMPORTANCE THAT WE ALL KNOW OUR GIFTS/ROLES AND USE THEM AS GOD MADE US TO DO. WE ARE ALL NEEDED AS A PART OF THE BODY!!!

V. As we begin our journey looking at spiritual gifts, we must realize the importance God has placed on this subject in his word. Many people don't want any part of the Christian life because they see it as boring and uninteresting. This could not be further from the truth.When you understand your place in the body of Christ and the ways God has gifted you to serve him, you will feel like you are doing what you were made to do (because you quite literally are), and your life will be _____and joyful! It will come with persecution and hard times, but you will have a purpose and a reason for living. As we go through gifts, we will all evaluate how God has gifted us and we will use these gifts to better serve the Lord and one another.

1 Cor. 14:12- "Even so ye, forasmuch as ye are zealous of spiritual *gifts*, seek that ye may excel to the edifying of the church."

Wednesday, April 27th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

NEGLECT NOT THY GIFT- 1 COR. 12:1-7, 11-31

I. It is of utmost importance that each and every believer realizes their importance in the grand plan of God. There is a plan that involves eternity, souls, the great battle between good and evil (God and the Devil), and the future kingdoms of the world; and God has made it so that he needs each and every one of us to be involved in this plan. God saw you as so valuable that he gave his own life for you. The value he sees in you does not stop there, but continues into the plan God has for each and every one of us in this grand plan of his. Knowing your giftedness in this fight and what role God MADE YOU TO PLAY is necessary in order to be successful for the Lord. Over the course of the coming weeks we are going to look at these gifts and each and every one of us that are a part of the family of God will see how great a role we play in this grand plan, and exactly what God made you to do in it.

II. DON'T BE IGNORANT ABOUT SPIRITUAL GIFTS (vs. 1)

A. This issue is of such importance! This can help us find our place in the body of Christ and give us a purpose.

B. So many people won't serve or commit to God once they are saved because they think it's boring. BUT once you find your place in the body and you find your gifts, you will love the work of the Lord and this will in turn establish your correct thinking, time in the Bible, prayer life, etc….

1. Prov. 16:3- "Commit thy works unto the LORD, and thy thoughts shall be established."

C. TELL MY TESTIMONY ABOUT EVANGELISM, GIFTS, AND THE VERSE ABOVE

D. Spiritual Gifts vs. Natural Gifts

1. This issue is another part of the spiritual gifts that we cannot be ignorant about.
2. Natural Gifts- We are all made by God a certain way and with certain gifts. Some of these gifts could be artists, musicians, speakers, influencers, leaders, servants, athletes, etc…These are not "spiritual gifts" but gifts that we are born with that we can use to serve the Lord. Some of these gifts cross over into our spiritual gifts when we become a part of the body of Christ at salvation. (if you are a good speakers naturally, you likely will have the spiritual gift of teacher/evangelist; and so on with other gifts)
3. Spiritual Gifts- When we have the spirit of God move into us at the moment of salvation, we are given some spiritual gifts that we need to find out what they are. These gifts may come to us as a result of how we are naturally gifted, but may not always. We are able to desire and ask for and be given (develop) new spiritual gifts. This is a unique thing about spiritual gifts that is not the case with our natural gifts. (1 Cor. 14:1; 1 Cor. 14:12)
    a) As we go through this series, analyze what your spiritual gifts are and maybe how they relate to your natural gifts. And also, don't be upset about the gifts you don't have, but desire spiritual gifts that you want to develop and ask God for them. These spiritual gifts will be the gifts that our series is focused on.

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    a) We can seek to find/have spiritual gifts, but for the purpose of serving God and helping others where they may lack in these gifts. NOT FOR OURSELVES.
    b) KEY: WE CANNOT SEE THIS ISSUE WITH PRIDE AND NOT WITH CHARITY. We have to be honest and own the gifts that God has given us, but we cannot let it become about us. It is not prideful to say you have certain gifts since it is important we recognize our gifts, but we must give God the credit and glory with them.
        (1) 1 Cor. 1:26-31- "For ye see your calling, brethren, how that not many wise men after the flesh, not many mighty, not many noble, *are called*: But God hath chosen the foolish things of the world to confound the wise; and God hath chosen the weak things of the world to confound the things which are mighty; And base things of the world, and things which are despised, hath God chosen, *yea*, and things which are not, to bring to nought things that are: That no flesh should glory in his presence. But of him are ye in Christ Jesus, who of God is made unto us wisdom, and righteousness, and sanctification, and redemption: **That, according as it is written, He that glorieth, let him glory in the Lord."**

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A. We are all a part of the body of Christ (vs. 11-20)

1. Like in our bodies, all of our parts contribute to the whole of us. The sum of all of our parts is called our body.
2. Each of us has a role in the body (just as each part of our bodies has a role). This role is greatly influenced by our spiritual gifts. We are made by God to have a specific function in the church. We are not just some random part of the body, we are handcrafted by God for a purpose
    a) Jer. 1:5- "Before I formed thee in the belly I knew thee; and before thou camest forth out of the womb I sanctified thee, *and* I ordained thee a prophet unto the nations."
    b) Psalm 139:13-14- "For thou hast possessed my reins: thou hast covered me in my mother's womb. I will praise thee; for I am fearfully *and* wonderfully made: marvellous *are* thy works; and *that* my soul knoweth right well."
        (1) When you begin to look at people how God sees them, and you really understand that God MADE and FORMED specifically each and every person that was born, you will not be a respecter of persons and you will see that everyone is essential in God's grand plan for the universe!

B. The seemingly most insignificant, are the most significant with God (vs. 21-31)

1. Think of some of the smallest parts of the body. They may seem insignificant at first glance, but they are essential in order to function best and even survive
    a) The eye and the fingers (specifically the thumb). The smallest bone in the body is the Stapes and it is essential to hearing. When fractured it causes severe hearing

loss and most commonly will cause deafness. The smallest organ in the body is the Pineal gland located in the center of the brain. When damaged, it becomes almost impossible to sleep or to have a sense of direction. Finally, we can look at the cell. The cells of our bodies, which are the foundation for life, are so intricate and necessary, we cannot live without cells or without healthy functioning cells. Cells that are not healthy, when they multiply, are what we call cancer.

2. No role in the body of Christ is insignificant. We often look at the pastors, teachers, or people who know a lot about the bible and think of them as extra spiritual. THIS IS WRONG THINKING AND CAN ONLY CAUSE ISSUES IN THE BODY. We need to understand that the groups of people that do the things that are not out in the open are just as important as the other parts of the body.
    a) If I asked you what the heart or brain were and what they do, all of us know. However, as we just saw, the parts of the body you may never have even heard of are just as essential to survival.
    b) It is also good to know that while the body can survive without certain parts, or with injured parts; it cannot function at full capacity and may be severely maimed. THIS IS WHY IT IS OF UTMOST IMPORTANCE THAT WE ALL KNOW OUR GIFTS/ROLES AND USE THEM AS GOD MADE US TO DO. WE ARE ALL NEEDED AS A PART OF THE BODY!!!

V. As we begin our journey looking at spiritual gifts, we must realize the importance God has placed on this subject in his word. Many people don't want any part of the Christian life because they see it as boring and uninteresting. This could not be further from the truth.When you understand your place in the body of Christ and the ways God has gifted you to serve him, you will feel like you are doing what you were made to do (because you quite literally are), and your life will be fulfilling and joyful! It will come with persecution and hard times, but you will have a purpose and a reason for living. As we go through gifts, we will all evaluate how God has gifted us and we will use these gifts to better serve the Lord and one another.

1 Cor. 14:12- "Even so ye, forasmuch as ye are zealous of spiritual *gifts*, seek that ye may excel to the edifying of the church."

Wednesday, May 11th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

NEGLECT NOT THY GIFT- EPHESIANS 4:11-12

I. Today we will be looking at the 3 gifts found in Ephesians chapter 4: **evangelist, pastor, and teacher**. These gifts are some of the gifts that are seen by some as "more important" because they are done more publicly. Again, as we looked at and talked about last week, that is not how gifts work. In fact, with these gifts being more public by nature, they come with a greater _____. They can come with the burden of responsibility for teaching others, pastoring well, and the burden of the eternal destination of souls. When they are not carried out properly many souls can suffer for all of eternity. This is why we must recognize and _____the gifts God has given us, no matter what they may be.

II. Ephesians 4:11-12

A. _____

1. The word evangelist shows up only 3x in the bible
    a) Acts 21:8; 2 Tim. 4:5
2. Philip is called "Philip the Evangelist". He is the only one called an evangelist in the Bible.
    a) Marks of an evangelist as shown by "the evangelist" **(Acts 8:4-40**)
        (1) Meeting people where they are at (vs. 5)
        (2) They are good and persuasive at sharing the gospel (vs. 6-13)
        (3) They can sometimes focus so much on the gospel, that they have a hard time with follow up/discipleship (vs. 14)
        (4) They have an ability to see who/when/where to share the gospel successfully and effectively (vs.26-29)
        (5) They have an ability to ask the right questions, preach the gospel creatively, and lead people to the Lord because of it (vs. 30-40)
3. If you feel that this may be a gift you have, you are responsible to use it. This means if you slip and get lazy or fall away, you will have the most blood on your hands (Eze. 33:1-6).

B. _____

1. A pastor in the Bible is someone who is responsible for the shepherding and care of a flock of people. (*pastor="pasture" or "shepherding")* It is an ordained office in the structure of the local church as we find in the pastoral epistles (specifically 1 Timothy and Titus).
    a) The words Elder, Bishop, and Pastor are all used interchangeably in the Bible talking about the official position of a pastor in a church.

2. The gift of pastoring and the call to be a pastor do not necessarily go directly hand in hand.
    a) Some have the gift of pastoring, the heart of a pastor, and they will never be in an official, full time, vocational ministry position as they don't feel that call.
3. Responsibilities of those who have this gift
    a) 1 Pet. 5:1-4; John 10:11-14
        (1) Those who have this gift, have such a heart for the church of God and of caring for the "sheep" of God, that they are consumed with the care of the sheep at all times.
4. Examples of people who were gifted with the heart of a pastor
    a) Jesus Christ
        (1) Luke 13:34-35; Matt. 18:10-14; Heb. 13:20
    b) David
        (1) Eze. 34:23; Ezek. 37:24; Psalm 23:1; 1 Sam. 17:34-36

C. _____

1. A teacher is someone who is able to communicate information in an effective way so as to inform and "teach" others about the Bible in a very practical way.
2. Different ways that someone with the gift of a teacher can teach
    a) **Publically**- Someone who is a gifted teacher is able to teach the Bible publically in an effective and clear way. They may experience less fear of public speaking than some, but will most likely experience the fear of public speaking to some extent regardless. (this gift does not necessarily mean that you won't be bothered by public speaking but that you will be able to do it regardless by the gift God gave you)
    b) **Individually**- Someone who is a gifted teacher is able to teach the Bible privately in an effective and clear way. They are engaging and practical in how they teach the Bible to their disciples, friends, co-workers, family, etc… on a personal and private basis.
3. Examples of biblical teachers both private and public
    a) Apollos and Aquila and Priscilla - Acts 18:24-28
    b) Paul- 1 Tim. 2:7
    c) Aaron (Exo. 4:14)

III. As we saw in the first 3 gifts today, there is so much that the Bible has to say about each of these gifts. They are all very important within the body of Christ and they are all important to God. These gifts are all more publicly seen, but no more important than the gifts we will look at in the coming weeks. If anything, they just come with a greater burden of responsibility and can be detrimental to the body if they are not used correctly.

Wednesday, May 11th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

NEGLECT NOT THY GIFT- EPHESIANS 4:11-12

I. Today we will be looking at the 3 gifts found in Ephesians chapter 4: **evangelist, pastor, and teacher**. These gifts are some of the gifts that are seen by some as "more important" because they are done more publicly. Again, as we looked at and talked about last week, that is not how gifts work. In fact, with these gifts being more public by nature, they come with a greater burden. They can come with the burden of responsibility for teaching others, pastoring well, and the burden of the eternal destination of souls. When they are not carried out properly many souls can suffer for all of eternity. This is why we must recognize and use the gifts God has given us, no matter what they may be.

II. Ephesians 4:11-12

A. Evangelist

1. The word evangelist shows up only 3x in the bible
   a) Acts 21:8; 2 Tim. 4:5
2. Philip is called "Philip the Evangelist". He is the only one called an evangelist in the Bible.
   a) Marks of an evangelist as shown by "the evangelist" (**Acts 8:4-40**)
      (1) **Meeting people where they are at (vs. 5**)
         (a) At this time many still struggled with preaching and teaching to gentiles, but Philip was right away "going down" to Samaria to preach. Evangelists will share the gospel with anyone that will listen. They have such a burden for souls to hear the gospel.
      (2) **They are good and persuasive at sharing the gospel (vs. 6-13)**
         (a) For evangelists, sharing the gospel is easy, they enjoy it, and they do it well. They are able to persuade and lead others to Christ. They are able and responsible to help those who struggle to evangelize to be better at it and to encourage others.
         (b) It is interesting that Philip could do miracles, and yet he was known for his evangelism and his preaching was what persuaded them.
         (c) This is another reason why we know that some of the old gifts (tongues, healings, interpretation of tongues, apostleship, etc… are not used anymore, the gifts that remain are GREATER and more useful for the majority gentile world. Signs are for the Jews.
      (3) **They can sometimes focus so much on the gospel, that they have a hard time with follow up/discipleship (vs. 14)**
         (a) Here we see that when the disciples heard about the souls being saved in Samaria, they sent Peter and John down to help establish the new believers. When they arrive, we find the new converts are still needing straightened out on some basic things. Peter and John take care of this, with no mention of Philip being involved.
      (4) **They have an ability to see who/when/where to share the gospel successfully and effectively (vs.26-29)**

(a) Here Philip is called on by the Lord to go to a specific place, where at a specific time, he is told to go talk with a specific person who happens to be reading about the prophecy of Jesus' death in Isaiah, and he is wondering what the prophecy means. Evangelists have a leading from God that helps them to find these ideal circumstances and have these appointments from God that are divine. We can all experience these, however, the reason evangelists may see them more often, may just be because of their willingness to take the opportunities.

(5) **They have an ability to ask the right questions, preach the gospel creatively, and lead people to the Lord because of it (vs. 30-40)**

(a) Philip asks the perfect question to this man he was sent to preach to. His question opens the door to preach Christ to this man and then not just leave it there (he has sown the seed) but to lead him to get saved and get baptized

3. If you feel that this may be a gift you have, you are responsible to use it. This means if you slip and get lazy or fall away, you will have the most blood on your hands (Eze. 33:1-6). You will also be responsible to train, encourage, and help others who really struggle with evangelism. Those who don't have this gift, can get very nervous about evangelizing, you have to be one who can help them along. Souls are at stake.

B. Pastor

1. A pastor in the Bible is someone who is responsible for the shepherding and care of a flock of people. (*pastor="pasture" or "shepherding")* It is an ordained office in the structure of the local church as we find in the pastoral epistles (specifically 1 Timothy and Titus).
   a) The words Elder, Bishop, and Pastor are all used interchangeably in the Bible talking about the official position of a pastor in a church.
2. The gift of pastoring and the call to be a pastor do not necessarily go directly hand in hand. Some that feel the call to be in full time ministry as a pastor, do not naturally have all of the characteristics of a gifted pastor. They may have to work harder at some things and God will teach them those things because they are desiring a good thing, (1 Tim. 3:1) if it is in fact God calling them to ministry.
   a) Some have the gift of pastoring, the heart of a pastor, and they will never be in an official, full time, vocational ministry position as they don't feel that call.
   b) Today we are talking specifically about the gift of a heart of a pastor that anyone can possess, and some may use in an official capacity and some may not.
3. Responsibilities of those who have this gift
   a) 1 Pet. 5:1-4; John 10:11-14
      (1) Those who have this gift, have such a heart for the church of God and of caring for the "sheep" of God, that they are consumed with the care of the sheep at all times. They think about others, pray for others, ask how others are doing, bear the burdens of others, give help and council to others, and overall are willing to lay down their lives for others (in both the literal and physical sense)
4. Examples of people who were gifted with the heart of a pastor
   a) Jesus Christ
      (1) Luke 13:34-35; Matt. 18:10-14; Heb. 13:20
   b) David
      (1) Eze. 34:23; Ezek. 37:24; Psalm 23:1; 1 Sam. 17:34-36
5. Those entrusted with this gift have been put in a position that God takes very seriously. God has a deep love for his people (he is the great shepherd) and if he has entrusted

you to take care of his sheep, you ought to be very vigilant about it. Especially if God calls you to use this gift in a vocational/official ministry capacity. Some can misuse this gift to take advantage of, lord over, or lead sheep astray. This type of misuse of this gift will result in eternal consequences for souls around you.This is a large burden to bear and it cannot be taken lightly.

C. Teacher

1. A teacher is someone who is able to communicate information in an effective way so as to inform and "teach" others about the Bible in a very practical way.
    a) Someone with the gift of a teacher is someone who can take biblical principles that they have been taught and clearly communicate them to others in such a way that they can clearly understand it and apply it to their lives.
2. Different ways that someone with the gift of a teacher can teach
    a) **Publically**- Someone who is a gifted teacher is able to teach the Bible publically in an effective and clear way. They may experience less fear of public speaking than some, but will most likely experience the fear of public speaking to some extent regardless. (this gift does not necessarily mean that you won't be bothered by public speaking but that you will be able to do it regardless by the gift God gave you)
    b) **Individually**- Someone who is a gifted teacher is able to teach the Bible privately in an effective and clear way. They are engaging and practical in how they teach the Bible to their disciples, friends, co-workers, family, etc… on a personal and private basis.
        (1) Having the gift of teaching does not mean that you will necessarily have just one or both of these types of teaching abilities. You may be able to teach well just privately, or just publically, or both.
3. Examples of biblical teachers both private and public
    a) Apollos and Aquila and Priscilla - Acts 18:24-28
    b) Paul- 1 Tim. 2:7
    c) Aaron (Exo. 4:14)
4. Teachers are not those who are responsible for finding new biblical truth, conveying wisdom, or prophesying of future events; they are those that are needed to convey what God has said and teach biblical truth in an effective way that helps the hearers to learn. Teachers are especially gifted at this and they are needed within the local church. Teachers have a great responsibility to use their gifts because if they do not, then there will be a lack of learning and of knowledge in the church (Prov. 1:1-7)
    a) Knowledge is important. When we get biblical knowledge, it allows us the opportunity to obey and live godly lives. The fear of the Lord is the beginning of knowledge and there are many important things to learn after that; teachers help us to learn those things.

I. As we saw in the first 3 gifts today, there is so much that the Bible has to say about each of these gifts. They are all very important within the body of Christ and they are all important to God. These gifts are all more publicly seen, but no more important than the gifts we will look at in the coming weeks. If anything, they just come with a greater burden of responsibility and can be detrimental to the body if they are not used correctly.

Wednesday, May 18th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

NEGLECT NOT THY GIFT- ROMANS 12:6-8

I. Today we will be looking at 3 more of the spiritual gifts that we find in the Bible. These gifts are not as acclaimed by many as some of the other more public gifts, but are just as, if not more important. These gifts get no glory, they have no luster, and they are often done _____ ____ _____, but they are listed by God as spiritual gifts for a reason. This reason is because they are hard to do because they don't come naturally to most. Anyone with these gifts is essential to the body of Christ and the body cannot function without them.

II. Romans 12:6-8

A. _____ with simplicity

1. This is for those who find it easier to give freely and more abundantly than most. It says giving with simplicity, implying that the giving is not complicated or with any strings attached, but given freely and of a good heart attitude.
2. The story of the "Giver" and the "Goer"
3. Biblical examples of givers and their impact on the ministry
    a) Phill. 4:14-17- Giving to the ministry that fruit may abound to your account
    b) 1 Cor. 16:1-3- When and how we ought to give (liberality=abundance of your money)
    c) 2 Cor. 8:1-5- The testimony of the giving of the church in Macedonia who was funding work in other churches
4. The heart of the gifted giver
    a) 2 Cor. 9:6-7
5. Giving is not just talking about money exclusively, we can also give of our time and talents with the same heart of giving.

B. _____ with diligence

1. This gift describes those who are supernaturally gifted at ruling and leading God's people in the execution of a plan. The gift of the pastor is more about the heart of leading God's people, while this gift of ruling with diligence is more about the execution and practical ways that someone leads and executes the mission at hand for the Lord.
2. People who have this gift, as we see in the Bible, they have a strong personality and are strong leaders who are able to pull people along and lead them. This is how things get done!

(1) Exo. 18:21,25; 1 Kings 11:28; Romans 13:1-7

(2) First mention of ruler; Gen. 41:43

b) Rulers are people that are wise and have understanding

(1) Deut. 1:13

c) Rulers are people that fear God and are just

(1) 2 Sam. 23:3; Lev. 25:43

d) Rulers are people who diligently command and get things done in a correct way; not like a dictator

(1) Prov. 6:6-8; 12:24; 28:15

3. Examples of biblical rulers

(1) Moses- Acts 7:35;

(2) David- 2 Sam. 7:8; 1 Chron. 11:2

C. Shewing _____ with cheerfulness

1. Those with this gift are able to show mercy to others even in the most difficult and darkest of situations where others may not be able to show mercy. Mercy is when someone is willing to forgive and overlook offenses when punishment is rightly deserved. Those with this gift do not show mercy grudgingly, but with cheerfulness.
2. This gift is special in that it is very close to the heart of God
   a) Num. 14:18; 1 Kings 3:6; 2 Chron. 1:8; Psa. 145:8; 57:10; 86:13; 103:11; 108:4; Eph. 2:4; Lam. 3:22-23
3. Mercy must be mixed with truth
   a) Psalm 85:10; 86:15; 100:5
4. Biblical examples of those with this gift
   a) Jesus- John 8:1-11; Matt. 18:21-22; Luke 23:34
   b) Joseph- Gen. 50:15-21
   c) David- Isa. 55:3; Acts 13:34

III. Many of us here may not have these gifts, however we all need to be doing these things regardless of how easy it comes to us. For those here with some of these gifts, you are _____and especially gifted by God to use your gift not only for its natural purpose, but also for helping others who struggle to do these things. We all can and should desire to be gifted in these areas. If you struggle in any of these but desire to do better, pray and ask God. Desire spiritual gifts, to edify and help the body of Christ. He will answer this prayer and he will help you or send someone who has these gifts to help you. Finally, reach out and find those around you with these gifts and listen to and learn from them.

Wednesday, May 18th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Neglect not thy gift- Romans 12:6-8

I. Today we will be looking at 3 more of the spiritual gifts that we find in the Bible. These gifts are not as acclaimed by many as some of the other more public gifts, but are just as, if not more important. These gifts get no glory, they have no luster, and they are often done behind the scenes, but they are listed by God as spiritual gifts for a reason. This reason is because they are hard to do because they don't come naturally to most. Anyone with these gifts is essential to the body of Christ and the body cannot function without them.

II. Romans 12:6-8

A. Giving with simplicity

1. This is for those who find it easier to give freely and more abundantly than most. It says giving with simplicity, implying that the giving is not complicated or with any strings attached, but given freely and of a good heart attitude.
    a) Those with this gift bless the church in ways that others never can. The people who give this way make the work and the ministries and missions we do possible.
2. Those with this gift also have a supernatural ability to see and meet needs within the body. They see where they can give towards the work and they do it with a cheerful heart!
3. The story of the "Giver" and the "Goer"
    a) Say there is someone who wants to use their gifts and go on a missions trip that God has called them to. They don't have a lot of extra money but they know God is calling them and so they sign up and they trust God with the rest. Then someone who is a gifted giver, gives to help pay to fund the way of the person going on the trip. Is the person who is hands on serving the Lord across the world more important than the gifted giver who is funding their way? Of course not. That gifted Giver made this missions trip

possible for that person who was called on the missions trip. Many will never even hear or know about the person who gave the money and made all of this possible. That does not mean that they are any less important in the work of the Lord.

4. We all must use the gifts that God has given us for the betterment of the ministry and glory of God. No matter what the gifts are, or how they are seen by others, they are gifts from God and they ALL matter!
5. Biblical examples of givers and their impact on the ministry
    a) Phill. 4:14-17- Giving to the ministry that fruit may abound to your account
    b) 1 Cor. 16:1-3- When and how we ought to give (liberality=abundance of your money)
    c) 2 Cor. 8:1-5- The testimony of the giving of the church in Macedonia who was funding work in other churches
6. The heart of the gifted giver
    a) 2 Cor. 9:6-7
7. Giving is not just talking about money exclusively, we can also give of our time and talents with the same heart of giving.
    a) If you are someone who gives of your time and talents in an extraordinary way, you are also a gifted giver; don't let anyone fool you into thinking that giving is just about your money, it is only 1 of the 3 things you can give!
    b) We focused a lot of our attention on giving of money, this is because according to the bible, if you are unwilling to give of your money, they you likely won't give of your time/talent. It is a good indicator of where your heart is, so it is a good way to judge how you are as a giver.
        (1) Luke 12:34- For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also.

B. Ruling with diligence

1. This gift describes those who are supernaturally gifted at ruling and leading God's people in the execution of a plan. The gift of the pastor is more about the heart of leading God's people, while this gift of ruling with diligence is more about the execution and practical ways that someone leads and executes the mission at hand for the Lord.

2. People who have this gift, as we see in the Bible, they have a strong personality and are strong leaders who are able to pull people along and lead them. This is how things get done!
    (1) Exo. 18:21,25; 1 Kings 11:28; Romans 13:1-7
    (2) Industrious- Diligent in business or study. Consistent, regularly and habitually involved in hard work
    (3) First mention of ruler; Gen. 41:43

b) Rulers are people that are wise and have understanding

(1) Deut. 1:13

c) Rulers are people that fear God and are just

(1) 2 Sam. 23:3; Lev. 25:43

d) Rulers are people who diligently command and get things done in a correct way; not like a dictator

(1) Prov. 12:24; 28:15

3. Examples of biblical rulers
    (1) Moses- Acts 7:35
    (2) David- 2 Sam. 7:8; 1 Chron. 11:2

C. Shewing mercy with cheerfulness

1. Those with this gift are able to show mercy to others even in the most difficult and darkest of situations where others may not be able to show mercy. Mercy is when someone is willing to forgive and overlook offenses when punishment is rightly deserved. Those with this gift do not show mercy grudgingly, but with cheerfulness.
2. This gift is special in that it is very close to the heart of God
    a) PICK STUDENTS TO READ EACH OF THESE OUT LOUD
    b) Num. 14:18; 1 Kings 3:6; 2 Chron. 1:8; Psa. 145:8; 57:10; 86:13; 103:11; 108:4; Eph. 2:4; Lam. 3:22-23
        (1) So many times, some of us are only merciful to a point, and we tend to remember the old things we “forgave” people for. Thank God that he is not like that. His mercies are new each and every day!

c) This type of mercy simply comes easier for some, some are gifted with this heart. However, we are all still called to be merciful (Luke 6:35-36; Micah 6:8)

3. Mercy must be mixed with truth
   a) Psalm 85:10; 86:15; 100:5
   b) Having this gift, you will always tend to want to show mercy in all situations. Your heart is burdened for the downtrodden and the broken. However, you must mix this mercy with the truth of God. It cannot be all mercy, or all truth; it must always be a healthy mix of both.
4. Biblical examples of those with this gift
   a) Jesus- John 8:1-11; Matt. 18:21-22; Luke 23:34
   b) Joseph- Gen. 50:15-21
   c) David- Isa. 55:3; Acts 13:34
      (1) We don't have time to study out these "sure mercies" tonight, however it is a good study into the life of David, and as a man after God's own heart, David shares in this gift that is close to the heart of God as well.
5. If you have this gift you have the ability to reach people that are downtrodden and in bad situations, when most write them off. You have the ability to restore brethren who are far from the Lord for whatever reason or circumstance. You must use this gift or so many people will go unreached.

III. Many of us here may not have these gifts, however we all need to be doing these things regardless of how easy it comes to us. For those here with some of these gifts, you are responsible and especially gifted by God to use your gift not only for its natural purpose, but also for helping others who struggle to do these things. We all can and should desire to be gifted in these areas. If you struggle in any of these but desire to do better, pray and ask God. Desire spiritual gifts, to edify and help the body of Christ. He will answer this prayer and he will help you or send someone who has these gifts to help you. Finally, reach out and find those around you with these gifts and listen to and learn from them.

Wednesday, May 25th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Neglect not thy gift- Romans 12:6-8

I. Today we will be looking at two gifts that are absolutely essential in the body of Christ: ministering and exhorting. The importance of each of these cannot be overstated, yet they are very different and separate gifts. Anyone who has either of these gifts is _____ for much because of how hurt the body of Christ would be in ministry if they were not using these gifts for the Lord. Anyone who feels that they do not have these gifts ought to consider praying to the Lord and asking him to bestow these gifts to them. We all must be doing these things regardless of if we are gifted in it or not, and we all should desire these gifts so that we might edify the body of Christ even more!

II. Romans 12:6-8

A. _____

1. This gift describes those who are supernaturally gifted at “serving” with special talents and abilities within the body of Christ. This term is most closely associated with “servant”.
2. **People with this gift may find the following are true about themselves:**
   a) They are always serving in multiple areas of ministry
   b) They are always seeking out people/circumstances where they can serve/minister to help the body of Christ
   c) Their first response when approached about new ministry opportunities is to always say yes (this needs to be balanced, however, people with this gift are burdened to serve everywhere they can)
3. **Some examples of ministers in the Bible**
   a) Levites (priests)- Jer. 33:21-22; Eze. 40:46; 42:14; Joel 1:9
   b) Angels- Mark 1:13; Psa. 104:4; Heb. 1:7; Matt. 4:11; 2 Cor. 11:14-15
      (1) The angels are the servants of God. They are his messengers, carry out heavenly duties (in Revelation you can clearly see the angels ministering all over the place), and are involved in many acts of service for God
      (1) Rev. 8:3, 6-7; 9:11; 14:6; 16:3-4
   c) The disciples and followers of Jesus
      (1) Matt. 8:15; 27:55-The women who followed Jesus
      (2) Acts 1:15-17; 6:1-4- The disciples and deacons
   d) Pastors

(1) 1 Thess. 3:2; 1 Tim. 4:6; 2 Cor. 11:23; 1 Cor. 3:5

4. **Those who are great ministers, make the best leaders**
    a) Mark 10:35-45

B. _____

1. This gift describes those who have the supernatural ability to encourage, persuade, and inspire others
    a) Those with this gift are able to spur others on to do things that they maybe normally would not. They have an ability to encourage and inspire others when others are not
2. **Exhorting has two guidelines in the bible** (2 Tim. 4:2)
    a) **Exhort with longsuffering**- We are to exhort and not stop exhorting. When people don't take to it and they don't listen to it. Continue to exhort! You cannot grow weary in well doing with this. People who are gifted with exhortation are gifted with passion. Passion is what makes effective exhorting. If you give up on it too soon, people will see right through it and won't believe what you say. (Prov. 25:15)
    b) **Exhort with doctrine-** Exhort in the truth. Exhort by teaching things that are correct and godly and not leading people astray. This gift is very powerful in that it has the ability to change people's minds and to persuade them; this means that it comes with a GREAT responsibility to not steer people the wrong way with bad doctrine.
3. **Biblical examples of people with this gift**
    a) Peter- Acts 2:37-41; Luke 22:32
    b) Barnabas- Acts 4:36-37; 11:19-26
        (1) He was so known for his gift of exhortation, he was nicknamed Barnabas, which means " son of consolation", by the other apostles!
    c) Paul- Acts 13:43; 18:4, 13; 19:8; 14:19-22
4. **We all must be exhorters in some way or another**

III. All of us are called to be servants (ministers) and to passionately preach the gospel and make disciples (exhort). For those of us who are gifted at these things it will come much easier and so we must help those who struggle with these things. For those who struggle at these, reach out to those who you see as ministers and exhorters; reach out to people who serve constantly and who passionately preach and _____ others. They will help you to desire these gifts to edify the body of Christ and bring glory to Jesus Christ!

Wednesday, May 25th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Neglect not thy gift- Romans 12:6-8

I. Today we will be looking at two gifts that are absolutely essential in the body of Christ: ministering and exhorting. The importance of each of these cannot be overstated, yet they are very different and separate gifts. Anyone who has either of these gifts is responsible for much because of how hurt the body of Christ would be in ministry if they were not using these gifts for the Lord. Anyone who feels that they do not have these gifts ought to consider praying to the Lord and asking him to bestow these gifts to them. We all must be doing these things regardless of if we are gifted in it or not, and we all should desire these gifts so that we might edify the body of Christ even more!

II. Romans 12:6-8

A. Ministering

1. This gift describes those who are supernaturally gifted at "serving" with special talents and abilities within the body of Christ. This term is most closely associated with "servant".
    a) People with this gift are able to serve more abundantly and naturally than most. They may be one who serves in multiple areas of ministry and are constantly reminded to not "burn out" as they are known to "burn the candle at both ends"
2. **People with this gift may find the following are true about themselves:**
    a) They are always serving in multiple areas of ministry
        (1) Many people simply sign up for serving in a ministry because they are tired of being hounded on by the other members in the church about where they are serving. This is a dutiful service. This is not the heart of someone with this gift. They desire deeply to serve anywhere they can.
    b) They are always seeking out people/circumstances where they can serve/minister to help the body of Christ
    c) Their first response when approached about new ministry opportunities is to always say yes (this needs to be balanced, however, people with this gift are burdened to serve everywhere they can)
3. **Some examples of ministers in the Bible**
    a) Levites (priests)- Jer. 33:21-22; Eze. 40:46; 42:14; Joel 1:9

(1) In Exodus and Numbers alone the word “minister” shows up 31x referring to the Levites and priests

(2) These were those who were in charge of the many laws, sacrifices, keeping of the Lords house, etc… Their whole life was devoted to “serving” the Lord in all of these aspects. They were the Lord’s servants (just like modern day pastors are supposed to be servants; also called “ministers”)

b) Angels- Mark 1:13; Psa. 104:4; Heb. 1:7; Matt. 4:11; 2 Cor. 11:14-15

(1) The angels are the servants of God. They are his messengers, carry out heavenly duties (in Revelation you can clearly see the angels ministering all over the place), and are involved in many acts of service for God

(a) Pick Students to read: Rev. 8:3, 6-7; 9:11; 14:6; 16:3-4

c) The disciples and followers of Jesus

(1) Matt. 8:15; 27:55-The women who followed Jesus

(2) Acts 1:15-17; 6:1-4- The disciples and deacons

d) Pastors

(1) 1 Thess. 3:2; 1 Tim. 4:6; 2 Cor. 11:23; 1 Cor. 3:5

4. **Those who are great ministers, make the best leaders**

a) Mark 10:35-45 (MUST READ)

(1) Those who seek a position (Jesus compares them to worldly Gentile leaders) are NOT good leaders, they are “lorders” over the people. Ministers and servants are those who are the best leaders.

(2) Also notice that Jesus was a minister. This issue was close to his heart. He was not a “lorder” over people, but he was a leader and he was a minister.

B. Exhorting

1. This gift describes those who have the supernatural ability to encourage, persuade, and inspire others

a) Those with this gift are able to spur others on to do things that they maybe normally would not. They have an ability to encourage and inspire others when others are not

b) They are different than rulers in that ruling deals with the ways someone is gifted to organize and practically carry out a plan. Exhorting is more about giving people a spirited push to do something. It speaks to the ability to influence people and their thinking and not just carry out a plan

2. **Exhorting has two guidelines in the bible** (2 Tim. 4:2)

(1) The context is Paul talking to Timothy, a pastor, about preaching! Preaching and exhorting are very closely connected.

b) **Exhort with longsuffering**- We are to exhort and not stop exhorting. When people don’t take to it and they don’t listen to it. Continue to exhort!

You cannot grow weary in well doing with this. People who are gifted with exhortation are gifted with passion. Passion is what makes effective exhorting. If you give up on it too soon, people will see right through it and won't believe what you say. (Prov. 25:15)

c) **Exhort with doctrine-** Exhort in the truth. Exhort by teaching things that are correct and godly and not leading people astray. This gift is very powerful in that it has the ability to change people's minds and to persuade them; this means that it comes with a GREAT responsibility to not steer people the wrong way with bad doctrine.

3. Biblical examples of people with this gift

a) Peter- Acts 2:37-41; Luke 22:32

(1) Peter was a man who was not perfect. His passions caused him to make many mistakes and put his foot in his mouth many times. For these same reasons, Peter was chosen to lead the disciples when Jesus left. For these same reasons, Peter was an amazing exhorter and was able to influence people for Christ in a great way! Passionate people have a great ability to have and use this gift for the same influence for Christ.

b) Barnabas- Acts 4:36-37; 11:19-26

(1) He was so known for his gift of exhortation, he was nicknamed Barnabas, which means " son of consolation", by the other apostles!

c) Paul- Acts 13:43; 18:4,13; 19:8; 14:19-22

4. We all must be exhorters in some way or another

a) We are all called to preach the gospel and to be disciples. When we truly believe in what we are teaching, we will teach with passion (we will exhort) and this will make us persuasive. We cannot afford to not exhort during our Christian lives

III. All of us are called to be servants (ministers) and to passionately preach the gospel and make disciples (exhort). For those of us who are gifted at these things it will come much easier and so we must help those who struggle with these things. For those who struggle at these, reach out to those who you see as ministers and exhorters; reach out to people who serve constantly and who passionately preach and encourage others. They will help you to desire these gifts to edify the body of Christ and bring glory to Jesus Christ!

Wednesday, June 1st, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

NEGLECT NOT THY GIFT- 1 COR. 12:8-10, 28; 7:7-8

I. Today we will be looking at three new spiritual gifts. Two of these gifts may be more prevalent in our church because of the fact that we are so well taught and trained on the bible and because we do biblical discipleship (word of knowledge and word of wisdom). This means that we are more _____than most for what we know and using what we know. For those in here who have maybe wondered if they are gifted with singleness, we will see what a unique and special gift this is. You will be left with no doubt as to what you need to do to examine if you have this gift, or to not neglect this gift if you do in fact have it.

II. 1 Corinthians 12:8-10, 28

A. Word of _____

1. This gift is for those who are supernaturally gifted with the ability to not just retain biblical facts/knowledge, but to also apply this knowledge to the right situation at the right time in order to help the body of Christ.
2. Their are differences between knowledge, wisdom, and understanding in the bible (Prov. 2:1-11)
    a) **Knowledge**- facts/information that is learned
    b) **Wisdom**- the correct use/application of knowledge
    c) **Understanding**- getting the bigger purpose behind the knowledge and wisdom you have. Seeing and applying it through a godly lens. (Psa. 73:17)
3. How this works out in the world
    a) An **uneducated** person may have wisdom but not knowledge
    b) An **educated** person may have knowledge but not wisdom
    c) **Anyone** with knowledge/wisdom, without the spirit of God, will not have true understanding
4. Biblical examples of people with wisdom
    a) **Solomon**- He is perhaps the most famous “wise person” in the bible. This makes sense since he is the wisest person who ever lived (1 Kings 3:6-12; 16-28; 4:29-30)
    b) Joseph- He was supernaturally gifted wisdom just as Solomon was (Acts 7:9-10)
5. Just as we saw these men in the Bible supernaturally given the gift of wisdom, we too can ask for wisdom and God says he gives it **liberally!** (James 1:5; Prov. 4:5-7)
    a) Those with this gift need to heed this biblical reminder (James 3:13)

B. Word of _____

1. People who are gifted with this are supernaturally gifted at recalling and presenting correct biblical facts, information, doctrine, etc… (Prov. 19:27; Prov. 23:12)
2. People with this gift are able to edify the body when they apply the gift and the knowledge they know. Ways this can be done may include:
    a) Giving answers to tough bible questions

b) Helping new/immature Christians to learn the bible
c) Gaining interest from non-believers and believers who are not interested in the bible simply by talking about the bible in a way that is interesting and makes sense
d) Being the person that people go to with Bible questions
e) Typically being able to explain the bible with many biblical proofs/references off hand in the right situations/times
f) Combatting false teachers/doctrines

3. Those with this gift can often times here or read something one time and be able to recall it, by the aid of the Holy Ghost, at the right time/situation
4. People with this gift can be written off at times as "know it alls" or as being "puffed up". These accusations can be true of anyone, but especially those with this gift if it is not used correctly (1 Cor. 8:1)
5. Biblical examples of people with this gift
   a) Job- (Job 33:1-5; 35:16)
   b) Stephen- (Acts 7:1-53)
   c) Apollos- (Acts 18:24-28)

III. 1 Corinthians 7:7-8

A. _____

1. People with this gift have a supernatural ability to serve the Lord untethered. They are free to go and do whatever/whenever the Lord calls them. They are especially gifted to do this without the need of a spouse who is there to support them as many others who serve the Lord have.
2. Those with this gift are supernaturally enabled to stay single by the grace of God, but they are not alone
3. This is a rarer gift than most. It is a calling that God makes clear in ones life and that he honors and empowers them to do. The bible calls for us to not be alone (Gen. 2:18; Ecc. 4:9-12) but to marry, however, with this gift you are enabled by God himself to stay single and mind only the things of the Lord (1 Cor. 7:32-35)
4. Biblical examples of people with this gift
   a) Paul (1 Cor. 7:7-8; 27-28)
   b) Jesus (Matt. 8:18-22)
   c) Jeremiah (Jer. 16:1-4)

IV. We have all been trained so well and taught the bible so well at our church that many may feel they have the gifts of word of wisdom and knowledge. Since these gifts are able to be obtained, this very well may be the case. However, to whom much is given, much is required. We must use our knowledge and wisdom with _____, which comes from having a close walk with the Lord. For those who are wondering about if they may have the gift of singleness, do not be afraid of having or not having it. Simply walk with the Lord and pray about these things and it will be abundantly clear if you have this gift. It is such a special gift to have and a rare gift; a gift that people like Jesus, Paul, and Jeremiah had (good company to be in). Do not neglect your gifts, embrace and use them to bring glory to God!

Wednesday, June 1st, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Neglect not thy gift- 1 Cor. 12:8-10, 28; 7:7-8

I. Today we will be looking at three new spiritual gifts. Two of these gifts may be more prevalent in our church because of the fact that we are so well taught and trained on the bible and because we do biblical discipleship (word of knowledge and word of wisdom). This means that we are more **responsible** than most for what we know and using what we know. For those in here who have maybe wondered if they are gifted with singleness, we will see what a unique and special gift this is. You will be left with no doubt as to what you need to do to examine if you have this gift, or to not neglect this gift if you do in fact have it.

II. 1 Corinthians 12:8-10, 28

A. Word of Wisdom

1. This gift is for those who are supernaturally gifted with the ability to not just retain biblical facts/knowledge, but to also apply this knowledge to the right situation at the right time in order to help the body of Christ.
2. Their are differences between knowledge, wisdom, and understanding in the bible (Prov. 2:1-11)
    a) **Knowledge**- facts/information that is learned
    b) **Wisdom**- the correct use/application of knowledge
    c) **Understanding**- getting the bigger purpose behind the knowledge and wisdom you have. Seeing and applying it through a godly lens. (Psa. 73:17)
3. How this works out in the world
    a) An **uneducated** person may have wisdom but not knowledge
    b) An **educated** person may have knowledge but not wisdom
    c) **Anyone** with knowledge/wisdom, without the spirit of God, will not have true understanding
4. Biblical examples of people with wisdom
    a) **Solomon**- He is perhaps the most famous “wise person” in the bible. This makes sense since he is the wisest person who ever lived
        (1) 1 Kings 3:6-12; 16-28; 4:29-30
            (a) When you are given wisdom and understanding supernaturally from the Lord, you will have more wisdom than anything the world has to offer. Not only does God

show you knowledge applied, but you are able to understand it in the greater picture as well (Egypt is a type of the world). The world may continue to grow in knowledge, and maybe even some wisdom, but not understanding.

b) Joseph- He was supernaturally gifted wisdom just as Solomon was

(1) Acts 7:9-10

5. Just as we saw these men in the Bible supernaturally given the gift of wisdom, we too can ask for wisdom and God says he gives it **liberally!**
   a) James 1:5; Prov. 4:5-7
   b) The body of Christ desperately needs people with this gift. They are able to bring comfort and practical advise to those in need of it.
   c) At times, people with this gift can be too heavily relied upon and can cause laziness in others, however, that cannot stop them from using their gift to edify the body.
   d) Those with this gift need to heed this biblical reminder
      (1) James 3:13

B. Word of Knowledge

1. People who are gifted with this are supernaturally gifted at recalling and presenting correct biblical facts, information, doctrine, etc…
   a) Prov. 19:27; Prov. 23:12
   b) People with this gift are not necessarily naturally gifted with a good memory. This can be the case, however, many times it is also not the case, which even greater shows the supernatural aspect of these gifts
2. People with this gift are able to edify the body when they apply the gift and the knowledge they know. Ways this can be done may include:
   a) Giving answers to tough bible questions
   b) Helping new/immature Christians to learn the bible
   c) Gaining interest from non-believers and believers who are not interested in the bible simply by talking about the bible in a way that is interesting and makes sense
   d) Being the person that people go to with Bible questions
   e) Typically being able to explain the bible with many biblical proofs/references off hand in the right situations/times
   f) Combatting false teachers/doctrines
3. Those with this gift can often times here or read something one time and be able to recall it, by the aid of the Holy Ghost, at the right time/situation

4. People with this gift can be written off at times as “know it alls” or as being “puffed up”. These accusations can be true of anyone, but especially those with this gift if it is not used correctly (1 Cor. 8:1)
    a) The key is to use the gift with charity and with a desire to help edify the body, not to just look ultra “spiritual” and smart
5. Biblical examples of people with this gift
    a) Job- (Job 33:1-5; 35:16)
        (1) He showed he had much knowledge, but not much wisdom
    b) Stephen- (Acts 7:1-53)
        (1) He gives this amazing, detailed, off the cuff message displaying his gift of word of knowledge (he has wisdom as well but knowledge is shown here even greater)
    c) Apollos- (Acts 18:24-28)
        (1) It is said of him that he was eloquent and mighty in the scriptures, however, he was still believing and preaching the baptism of John, which showed a lack of wisdom and understanding

III. 1 Corinthians 7:7-8

A. Singleness

1. People with this gift have a supernatural ability to serve the Lord untethered. They are free to go and do whatever/whenever the Lord calls them. They are especially gifted to do this without the need of a spouse who is there to support them as many others who serve the Lord have.
2. Those with this gift are supernaturally enabled to stay single by the grace of God, but they are not alone
3. This is a rarer gift than most. It is a calling that God makes clear in ones life and that he honors and empowers them to do. The bible calls for us to not be alone (Gen. 2:18; Ecc. 4:9-12) but to marry, however, with this gift you are enabled by God himself to stay single and mind only the things of the Lord (1 Cor. 7:32-35)
    a) Some becomes scared that they may have this gift after they haven’t found someone to be with after many years. However, gifts are not a curse, but a blessing and something that is bound within us. If you do not desire to be single, you very likely are not gifted in this and should not worry, but rather you should pray about this.
4. Biblical examples of people with this gift
    a) Paul (1 Cor. 7:7-8; 27-28)
        (1) He wrote many of the words that we read above about this gift. It is evident that this attitude of singleness is abounding from him and it is clear he was called to it and gifted at it

b) Jesus (Matt. 8:18-22)

(1) Jesus was single for many reasons but the fact that he was not bound in his work here is a huge example for singles to follow. He was 100% focused on making disciples and the word of the Lord

c) Jeremiah (Jer. 16:1-4)

(a) He was called by God to be single. He was a great prophet who never had any visible fruit of his ministry, maybe the Lord needed him to be 100% focused on him alone.

(i) Jeremiah does contain some of the most prophecy of any book of the bible

IV. We have all been trained so well and taught the bible so well at our church that many may feel they have the gifts of word of wisdom and knowledge. Since these gifts are able to be obtained, this very well may be the case. However, to whom much is given, much is required. We must use our knowledge and wisdom with **understanding**, which comes from having a close walk with the Lord. For those who are wondering about if they may have the gift of singleness, do not be afraid of having or not having it. Simply walk with the Lord and pray about these things and it will be abundantly clear if you have this gift. It is such a special gift to have and a rare gift; a gift that people like Jesus, Paul, and Jeremiah had (good company to be in). Do not neglect your gifts, embrace and use them to bring glory to God!

Wednesday, June 8th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Neglect not thy gift- 1 Cor. 12:8-10,28

I. Today we will look at 3 more spiritual gifts as they are found in the bible. Many will probably find that they can relate to at least 1 or more of these gifts we will look at today. They may be more common than other gifts, but they come with the same level of _____and care that any gift requires. If you think you may have any of these, listen closely and examine whether or not you are using your gifts in the way God desires.

II. 1 Corinthians 12:8-10, 28

A. _____ ____ _____

1. This gift is for those who can sense whether something being said or done is godly, righteous, biblically correct or not. They can rightly interpret statements, situations, environments, and people in general (1 John 4:1-6)
2. **People with this gift are able to:**
   a) Discern between those who really love and serve the Lord and those who are faking it (Malachi 3:18)
   b) Discern the real meaning behind peoples statements (John 3:1-10)
   c) Discern the deeper things of the world because of the spirit of God in them revealing it to them (1 Cor. 2:9-15)
3. **This gift can be obtained just like any other gift**
   a) Solomon asks for this gift of discerning of spirits and he gets it (1 Kings 3:9)
   b) People who are older and have had their senses exercised obtain this gift (Hebrews 5:14)
   c) When you spend time in the word of God long enough and you allow the word of God to sink deep into your heart, you can use it to discern, and maybe even obtain this gift (Heb. 4:12)
4. **This gift does not guarantee 100% success of discerning in all situations**
   a) This can lead to people with this gift sounding "judgmental" or always pessimistic
   b) The only thing to do is continue to use your gift and try the spirits the best you can. Time will prove all things
5. **Biblical examples of people with this gift**
   a) Jesus- Matt. 15:7-9; Luke 9:46-50
   b) Paul- Acts 16:16-18

B. _____

1. Those with this gift are supernaturally able to see and meet the needs of others (oftentimes even before they know they have a need), and to do it with great quietness and ease.
2. **The heart of those with this gift**

a) Prov. 3:27; Gal. 6:10

3. **People with this gift go out of their way to help others**
    a) Duet. 22:4
4. **Ways that people with this gift demonstrate help (these are just a few examples):**
    a) Prayer (2 Cor. 1:11)
    b) Providing meals, rides, clothes, cleaning, helping someone move, helping someone who is going through a loss, etc…. (innumerable ways)
    c) Being a fatherly/motherly/brotherly/sisterly figure in someones life
    d) Using a trade/talent you have to help someone in need
    e) Providing good biblical advice to someone going through a tough time
    f) Etc….
5. **Biblical examples of people with this gift**
    a) Moses- Exodus 2:16-19
    b) Aquila and Priscilla- Romans 16:3
    c) Urbane- Romans 16:9

C. _____

1. People with this gift are able to put together creative, effective, organizational plans in an area(s) of ministry in the church that causes it to function well
2. While rulers are all about executing plans and achieving goals through leading people, this gift is for those who are good at organizing and creating and doing behind the scenes "administrative" things that help the work of the Lord to be done at the highest level possible.
    a) James 3:4 displays this relationship perfectly
3. **Those with this gift are organized people who are good at helping to establish order**
    a) 1 Cor. 11:34; 14:40; 16:1; Col. 2:5
4. **God loves order and so people with this gift have the special ability to help the ministry and please the Lord by bringing order**
    a) Num. 24:5
5. **People with this gift have leadership qualities, but are typically better at the "governing" part of things than the "enacting" of plans**
    a) Aaron and Moses worked together in this way (Exodus 4:14-16; 7:1-2)
6. **Biblical examples of people with this gift**
    a) Jethro- Exodus 18:13-27
    b) Luke- Luke 1:1-4; Acts 1:1
    c) Titus- Titus 1:5

III. Any of us that feel that we have any of these gifts is responsible to use them. We cannot neglect the gifts God has entrusted us with. The body of Christ will _____if you choose to neglect your gift, no matter what it is. If you don't have these, but desire to develop them, pray and ask God to help you with that. If you have these gifts and you are not using them to the extent that you need to be, search the word of God about your gift and do everything that God is calling you to do with your gift in order to bring glory to God!

Wednesday, June 8th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

NEGLECT NOT THY GIFT- 1 COR. 12:8-10,28

I. Today we will look at 3 more spiritual gifts as they are found in the bible. Many will probably find that they can relate to at least 1 or more of these gifts we will look at today. They may be more common than other gifts, but they come with the same level of **responsibility** and care that any gift requires. If you think you may have any of these, listen closely and examine whether or not you are using your gifts in the way God desires.

II. 1 Corinthians 12:8-10, 28

A. Discerning of Spirits

1. This gift is for those who can sense whether something being said or done is godly, righteous, biblically correct or not. They can rightly interpret statements, situations, environments, and people in general (1 John 4:1-6)
2. **People with this gift are able to:**
   a) Discern between those who really love and serve the Lord and those who are faking it (Malachi 3:18)
   b) Discern the real meaning behind peoples statements (John 3:1-3)
   c) Discern the deeper things of the world because of the spirit of God in them revealing it to them (1 Cor. 2:9-15) **(READ IN BIBLES)**
      (1) This can include a deeper understanding of the spiritual aspects to the events going on in the world and more. It's a deeper judgment of all things and how they relate to the spiritual warfare going on behind the scenes
      (2) An example could be someone having the ability to foresee the evil that will come from major political decisions, elections, world events, wars, etc… that others may not see as that big of a deal
      (3) Write down Matt. 16:3. It says "And in the morning, It will be foul weather to day: for the sky is red and lowring. O ye hypocrites, ye can discern the face of the sky; but can ye not discern the signs of the times?"
         (a) This is another example of this gift. Discernment about the times and seasons of the end. Understanding the "spirits" of the world and how they are signs of the coming end times
3. This gift can be obtained just like any other gift

a) Solomon asks for this gift of discerning of spirits and he gets it (1 Kings 3:9)
b) People who are older and have had their senses exercised obtain this gift (Hebrews 5:14)
(1) Typically, older people can be seen as pessimistic and they can sound as though everything is the end of the world. The truth is, they have had their senses exercised and they have seen enough to know the truth behind what can be seemingly insignificant circumstances, events, instances, etc…
c) When you spend time in the word of God long enough and you allow the word of God to sink deep into your heart, you can use it to discern, and maybe even obtain this gift (Heb. 4:12)
(1) For this same reason, if you have this gift, you must always run your "discernment" through the word of God

4. This gift does not guarantee 100% success of discerning in all situations
a) This can lead to people with this gift sounding "judgmental" or always pessimistic
(1) Especially when they get it wrong, people will make sure and point it out
b) The only thing to do is continue to use your gift and try the spirits the best you can. Time will prove all things
5. Biblical examples of people with this gift
a) Jesus- Matt. 15:7-9; Luke 9:46-50
b) Paul- Acts 16:16-18

B. Helps

1. Those with this gift are supernaturally able to see and meet the needs of others (oftentimes even before they know they have a need), and to do it with great quietness and ease.
2. The heart of those with this gift
a) Prov. 3:27; Gal. 6:10
3. People with this gift go out of their way to help others
a) Duet. 22:4
(1) This may seem like the simple and obvious choice in this situation, but many people see similar situations all the time and either choose not to help, or they simply aren't paying attention and they miss it. PEOPLE WITH THIS GIFT DO NOT MISS THESE OPPORTUNITIES LIKE MOST WOULD. They easily see and act on these chances to help
4. Ways that people with this gift demonstrate help (these are just a few examples):
a) Prayer (2 Cor. 1:11)

b) Providing meals, car rides, clothes, cleaning, helping someone move, helping someone who is going through a loss, etc…. (innumerable ways)
c) Being a fatherly/motherly/brotherly/sisterly figure in someones life
d) Using a trade/talent you have to help someone in need
e) Providing good biblical advice to someone going through a tough time
f) Etc….

5. Biblical examples of people with this gift
   a) Moses- Exodus 2:16-19
   b) Aquila and Priscilla- Romans 16:3
   c) Urbane- Romans 16:9
      (1) Most of you have probably never heard of Urbane, his name only shows up this one time in the Bible. The lesson here; ANYONE CAN BE A HELPER. He isn't mentioned much as being a huge part in the work of the Lord, being an evangelist, teacher, preacher, prophet, etc… it says he was a helper. Maybe he simply opened up his home to Paul at some point. We don't know. All we know is that it meant such a deal to Paul that he mentions it here
      (2) Helpers have an opportunity to bless others and have an impact on the work of the Lord in amazing and simple ways that others miss. Don't neglect this gift

C. Governments

1. People with this gift are able to put together creative, effective, organizational plans in an area(s) of ministry in the church that causes it to function well
2. While rulers are all about executing plans and achieving goals through leading people, this gift is for those who are good at organizing and creating and doing behind the scenes "administrative" things that help the work of the Lord to be done at the highest level possible.
   a) James 3:4 displays this relationship perfectly
      (1) While the driving force of the ship is the wind, without the "governer" to guide it, the ship will move, but maybe not in the direction desired. The governor has to make sure that everyone is doing there jobs and that all details are in place to move in the correct direction
      (2) Think of the ship captains in old movies and all the jobs of all the deckhands. This requires organizational skills and order to be able to move large ships
3. Those with this gift are organized people who are good at helping to establish order
   a) 1 Cor. 11:34; 14:40; 16:1; Col. 2:5

b) Notice who so many of these instructions and statements are written to. Corinth! They were an unorganized mess and their ministry suffered because of it.

4. God loves order and people with this gift have the special ability to help the ministry and pleasing the Lord by bringing order
    a) Num. 24:5
    b) SHOW PHOTO ON SLIDESHOW
5. People with this gift have leadership qualities, but are typically better at the "governing" part of things than the "enacting" of plans
    a) Aaron and Moses worked together in this way (Exodus 4:14-16; 7:1-2)
        (1) Moses had the ruler quality, while Aaron was more eloquent and able to help him in the wording of and planning of things behind the scenes
6. Biblical examples of people with this gift
    a) Jethro- Exodus 18:13-27 (READ IN BIBLES)
        (1) Moses had the heart to do this for the Lord no matter how hard. His father however (probably where Aaron his brother got this from) was able to help him organize this into a more manageable/reasonable plan without compromising the purpose of what he was doing
    b) Luke- Luke 1:1-4; Acts 1:1
        (1) He was not there for the gospels, but did his due diligence to learn of all the things that Jesus did and write the record of it. This has now helped millions throughout the centuries to learn of the life of Christ
    c) Titus- Titus 1:5
        (1) Paul knew the personality of and gifts of Titus and he knew/trusted that he would set things in order in Crete. Titus was likely known for having orderliness and having this gift.

III. Any of us that feel that we have any of these gifts is responsible to use them. We cannot neglect the gifts God has entrusted us with. The body of Christ will **suffer** if you choose to neglect your gift, no matter what it is. If you don't have these, but desire to develop them, pray and ask God to help you with that. If you have these gifts and you are not using them to the extent that you need to be, search the word of God about your gift and do everything that God is calling you to do with your gift in order to bring glory to God!

Wednesday, June 15th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Neglect not thy gift- 1 Cor. 12:8-10,28

I. Today, we will look at the final two spiritual gifts in our series and then the most important aspect surrounding all spiritual gifts. Understanding today's message is key in _____ using our gifts in order to function at full capacity as the body of Christ and to bring glory to God in our lives and ministries.

II. 1 Cor. 12:8-10,28

A. _____

1. Those with this gift are supernaturally gifted to see God's way by faith more than others or at times when others will not or cannot, and then communicate that faith confidently to edify the body of Christ
2. People with this gift are able to have faith in **what God says**. Others may "say" that they do as well, but people with this gift can more easily show their faith in their actions
    a) Heb. 11:7-10
3. People with this gift can more easily display faith even in situations where faith completely defies common sense
    a) Dan. 3:16-18; Matt. 14:28-29; Joshua 6 (the conquest at Jericho)
4. Someone with this gift has the ability to cause and see amazing things to happen
    a) Matt. 17:20; 21:21; Matt. 15:28; 9:2,22; Mark 2:5; 5:34; Luke 8:48
5. Biblical examples
    a) Everyone in the "Hall of Faith" in Hebrews 11
    b) Abraham- Rom. 4:20-21; Heb 11:8-10, 17-19
6. Faithful Gentile Centurion
    a) Matt. 8:5-13; Luke 7:1-10

B. _____

1. A person with this spiritual gift has the supernatural ability to understand and declare the prophesies of God in a meaningful way (edifying) to others. They will declare specific insightful things to all regarding the future that they glean from the words of God.
2. Prophesying in the bible is simply this: declaring unknown things or things that are yet to come as God reveals it to you through his words.
    a) In the OT, we called a person a prophet who
        (1) Heard the words of God concerning future events
        (2) Foretold of those events to others

3. The official office of “prophet” is clearly shown to have ended with John the Baptist (Matt. 11:13; Luke 16:16)
4. There are boundaries for prophesying today that were not in place during the OT. This is because we have “that which is perfect” and the “more sure word” today
    a) 2 Pet. 1:16-19; Rev. 22:19; 1 Cor. 13:8-10
5. People with this gift can really draw peoples interest in the Bible
6. Prophesying needs to result in edification
    a) 1 Cor. 14:-3-4, 23-25; Acts 15:32
7. Biblical examples of those with this gift
    a) John the Baptist (John 1:29 **with** Gen. 22:8; Exo. 12:3-13; Isa. 53:5-7)
    b) Jeremiah (Jer. 1:7)

C. The More Excellent Way- _____ (1 Cor. 12:31-13:1)

1. Charity is not a gift but something that we are all called to do. We are all supernaturally enabled to do this through the spirit of God, as God has shown us the most excellent display of charity that this universe has ever seen!
2. Biblical charity is an unconditional and sacrificial love shown through action (vs 4-7)
3. We can have all the gifts we want, but without charity none of it will matter (vs 1-2)
    a) Successful biblical ministries show charity (they are willing to sacrifice and put words into action) (Rev. 3:7-22)
        (1) The church in Philadelphia “brotherly love” was successful
        (2) The church in Laodicea “the rights of the people” was a failure
4. Gifts can/will fail but having charity will never fail (vs. 8-10)
5. God connects having charity and mixing it with these gifts, to maturing and growing up (vs 11)
6. God connects having a close relationship with him and having an intimate closeness to him, to charity (vs 12)
7. God considers charity to be the greatest quality to have (vs 13)
8. How do we get charity?
    a) Since charity is all about choice and not feelings, we need to make choices that are selfless and sacrificial (it costs us something))
        (1) Use all the gifts God has given you and do the work of the Lord especially when you don’t feel like it
        (2) Do things that you don’t want to do, that make you uncomfortable, that you “don’t have time” to do, etc… When you start obeying the Lord in this, you are showing charity
        (3) Grow closer in your walk with the Lord through the word and prayer

III. As we close out our series on Spiritual Gifts there is no better way to sum it up than the way the word of God does. “But covet earnestly the best gifts: and yet shew I unto you a more excellent way.” Desire spiritual gifts and use the gifts you are given, but never forget the more excellent way is charity. A heart of genuine love and sacrifice will _____ fail in your work for the Lord. This comes, like many things, only through a close personal walk with the Lord. There is no way around it: he is the one who gives us the gifts and enables us to do the work we do. We cannot do it

without him. If we are going to bring glory to God and have fruitful lives and ministries, we cannot do it without him or without one other as his body.

Wednesday, June 15th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Neglect not thy gift- 1 Cor. 12:8-10,28

I. Today, we will look at the final two spiritual gifts in our series and then the most important aspect surrounding all spiritual gifts. Understanding today's message is key in **successfully** using our gifts in order to function at full capacity as the body of Christ and to bring glory to God in our lives and ministries.

II. 1 Cor. 12:8-10,28

A. Faith

1. Those with this gift are supernaturally gifted to see God's way by faith more than others or at times when others will not or cannot, and then communicate that faith confidently to edify the body of Christ
2. People with this gift are able to have faith in **what God says**. Others may "say" that they do as well, but people with this gift can more easily show their faith in their actions
    a) Heb. 11:7-10
3. People with this gift can more easily display faith even in situations where faith completely defies common sense
    a) Dan. 3:16-18; Matt. 14:28-29; Joshua 6 (the conquest at Jericho)
        (1) In all of these stories faith was without common sense. People with this gift are able to have and act upon faith in these impossible situations.
        (2) In the story in Joshua, we also see that this faith is shown consistently and with persistence. People with this gift completely lean upon faith in God no matter the amount of time that passes.
4. Someone with this gift has the ability to cause and see amazing things to happen
    a) Matt. 17:20; 21:21; Matt. 15:28; 9:2,22; Mark 2:5; 5:34; Luke 8:48
        (1) Almost always, faith is what precedes amazing miracles!
5. Biblical examples
    a) Everyone in the "Hall of Faith" in Hebrews 11
    b) Abraham- Rom. 4:20-21; Heb 11:8-10, 17-19
        (1) What was so great about the faith of Abraham? He was consistent and patient in his faith. We give up faith so easily many times in our lives. There were many promises made to Abraham and they all took a while to actually happen. He waited 25 years before his promised son was born and then he was told by God to offer this son up and without hesitation he did it having full faith in God. Consistency is key!
6. Faithful Gentile Centurion
    a) Matt. 8:5-13 (READ IN BIBLES); Luke 7:1-10

(1) Jesus says of this Gentile man who never met Jesus before, that he had not found so great faith in all Israel. What a statement!
(2) In Luke we see that this centurion had never met Jesus, only heard of Jesus. Yet without ever seeing a miracle (as many unbelieving Jews had) he had full faith that Jesus could not only heal his servant, but do it from a far distance (blessed are those who have not seen and yet believe)!

B. Prophesy

1. A person with this spiritual gift has the supernatural ability to understand and declare the prophesies of God in a meaningful way (edifying) to others. They will declare specific insightful things to all regarding the future that they glean from the words of God.
2. Prophesying in the bible is simply this: declaring unknown things or things that are yet to come as God reveals it to you through his words.
    a) With this in mind, we cannot overcomplicate what this means for us today. God has revealed specific truths about the future all over the bible. People with this gift have a special interest/gift in knowing and declaring these future events. They clearly understand many different future biblical prophesies that some other may know some or even nothing about.
    b) In the OT, we called a person a prophet who
        (1) Heard the words of God concerning future events
        (2) Foretold of those events to others
            (a) We can do the exact same today
3. The official office of "prophet" is clearly shown to have ended with John the Baptist (Matt. 11:13; Luke 16:16)
4. There are boundaries for prophesying today that were not in place during the OT. This is because we have "that which is perfect" and the "more sure word" today
    a) 2 Pet. 1:16-19; Rev. 22:19; 1 Cor. 13:8-10
        (1) The office of a prophet would have included "special" revelation from God, possibly outside of his words. Today it cannot and will not since it is a gift drawn from understanding the written prophesies and not an office where God gives you some "new" revelation
5. People with this gift can really draw people's interest in the Bible
    a) People love to hear about the end times, prophecies, tribulation, rapture, anti-christ and his kingdom, the kingdoms who will be around during the end, etc…. People with this gift have a good understanding of these things (you could say they specialize in this area) and this can be used for drawing peoples interest in the Bible
6. Prophesying needs to result in edification
    a) 1 Cor. 14:-3-4, 23-25; Acts 15:32
7. Biblical examples of those with this gift
    a) John the Baptist (GET READERS FOR EACH) (John 1:29 **with** Gen. 22:8; Exo. 12:3-13; Isa. 53:5-7)
        (1) John was known as the greatest prophet and was called such by Jesus himself (Luke 7:28) and yet he prophesied from the scripture!
    b) Jeremiah (Jer. 1:7)
        (1) Jeremiah is one of the major prophets in the OT. It has some of the most prophecy of any book! Yet, all that Jeremiah did was told of what God told

him. He heard from God and then foretold what God told him to the people

C. The More Excellent Way- Charity (1 Cor. 12:31-13:1) (OPEN TO IN BIBLES)

1. Charity is not a gift but something that we are all called to do. We are all supernaturally enabled to do this through the spirit of God, as God has shown us the most excellent display of charity that this universe has ever seen!
2. Biblical charity is an unconditional and sacrificial love shown through action (vs 4-7)
    a) We often relate "love" to a feeling. However, love in the bible is most closely associated with charity as it is an action or pattern of sacrificing unconditionally.
3. We can have all the gifts we want, but without charity none of it will matter (vs 1-2)
    a) Successful biblical ministries show charity (they are willing to sacrifice and put words into action) (Rev. 3:7-22)
        (1) The church in Philadelphia "brotherly love" was successful
        (2) The church in Laodicea "the rights of the people" was a failure
            (a) One church focused on love (unconditional sacrifice) and one focused on selfishness (their own rights and what they wanted)
            (b) The church in Corinth is another example of the selfish failing ministry; Paul was constantly telling them to stop worrying about what they can do/get away with and rather worry about what is BEST and able to reach the most people
4. Gifts can/will fail but having charity will never fail (vs. 8-10)
    a) You can have few gifts and even feel as though those gifts aren't very strong, but if you have true charity, you will glorify God in amazing ways!
5. God connects having charity and mixing it with these gifts, to maturing and growing up (vs 11)
6. God connects having a close relationship with him and having an intimate closeness to him, to charity (vs 12)
7. God considers charity to be the greatest quality to have (vs 13)
    a) When we have charity, we are ready to use our spiritual gifts; however, having spiritual gifts without charity means nothing. Charity is the greatest attribute any of us can possess. Without it, our spiritual gifts are useless.
8. How do we get charity?
    a) We all would say that we want to have this heart of charity so we can be useful for the Lord, however, it can be hard to have and it can be hard to know how to have it.
    b) Since charity is all about choice and not feelings, we need to make choices that are selfless and sacrificial (it costs us something))
        (1) Use all the gifts God has given you and do the work of the Lord especially when you don't feel like it.
            (a) It may feel odd at first but the Lord will change your heart when you commit your works to him. (Prov. 16:3)
        (2) Do things that you don't want to do, that make you uncomfortable, that you "don't have time" to do, etc… When you start obeying the Lord in this, you are showing charity.

(a) Think: if we only did the things that we felt love, excitement, joy, or happiness doing, then we wouldn't be sacrificing anything/as much (charity costs something)

(3) Grow closer in your walk with the Lord through the word and prayer

(i) Even when you feel like your not getting a great understanding of what you are reading and like you are "feeling" much, YOU ARE SPENDING TIME WITH GOD AND HE IS GOING TO WORK! It takes time! (charity suffereth long) It takes continued sacrifice!

(ii) There is no quick and easy path to just obtaining charity and to obtaining a close relationship with the Lord. Like other relationships it takes work, time, commitment, and it grows as you go along!

(a) READ THE WORD OF GOD WILL CHANGE YOUR HEART

(b) PRAYER WILL CHANGE YOUR HEART

(c) Our problem is that we usually give up way too soon and don't give it time. But God will change you through these things and you will grow closer to him. There is no replacement for a close and intimate walk with the Lord!

III. As we close out our series on Spiritual Gifts there is no better way to sum it up than the way the word of God does. "But covet earnestly the best gifts: and yet shew I unto you a more excellent way." Desire spiritual gifts and use the gifts you are given, but never forget the more excellent way is charity. A heart of genuine love and sacrifice will **never** fail in your work for the Lord. This comes, like many things, only through a close personal walk with the Lord. There is no way around it: he is the one who gives us the gifts and enables us to do the work we do. We cannot do it without him. If we are going to bring glory to God and have fruitful lives and ministries, we cannot do it without him or without one other as his body.

S08 / TEACHING SERIES

Character Qualities

Nine weeks addressing 27 character qualities through teacher/student resources, presentations, and a quiz.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Teaching and adaptation; the underlying course credits Stephen Wineka.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

53 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

The cumulative teacher and student materials cover the nine-week sequence.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

Character Qualities

Character Qualities teaching materials adapted for youth instruction from the source course by Stephen Wineka.

Cumulative teacher and student editions covering the Character Qualities course.

Full teaching files

quiz for character qualities 1	*2 pages*
Edge youth Character Qualities - student Copy WEEK 9 final copy	*25 pages*
Edge youth Character Qualities - teacher Copy WEEK 9 final copy	*25 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

1. **According to the notes, what is the primary reason "blameless" is the first quality listed for a pastor and deacon?**

A) It ensures popularity with the congregation.

B) It is the easiest character quality to maintain.

C) It is the foundation for all other character qualities and part of God's great plan for your life.

D) It relates only to public reputation.

2. **Why is it important for a believer to be blameless before others according to the study?**

A) So that accusations can never be made.

B) So that when accusations arise, they do not stick.

C) To avoid church discipline.

D) To never have to apologize for mistakes.

3. **How should single people apply the quality of being "the husband of one wife" to their lives according to the notes?**

A) By focusing on finding a spouse quickly.

B) By applying it to their spiritual relationship with Jesus Christ.

C) By dating multiple people to learn what they like.

D) By ignoring this quality until marriage.

4. **"Vigilant" encompasses which of the following according to the notes?**

A) Being aware of physical dangers only.

B) Being watchful for temptation, spiritual dangers, and guarding over others.

C) Only praying when trouble arises.

D) Never trusting anyone around you.

5. **According to the study, how are "sober" and "vigilant" connected?**

A) They are unrelated qualities.

B) Both require you to avoid all forms of entertainment.

C) Both involve self-control and being alert to spiritual dangers.

D) Both emphasize isolation from others.

6. **What practical application is given for being "grave"?**

A) Always being quiet and reserved.

B) Taking serious things seriously, such as sin, salvation, and personal holiness.

C) Ignoring lighthearted situations.

D) Refusing to smile or laugh in public.

7. **Why is "hospitality" important toward non-believers, according to the study?**

A) To gain respect and popularity in the community.

B) It reflects God's heart for loving strangers and can be a means to share the gospel.

C) To increase attendance at church events.

D) To fulfill social obligations.

8. **What is required to be "apt to teach" beyond just knowing Scripture?**

A) Natural speaking ability.

B) A desire to be noticed by others.

C) Learning the Word, applying it personally, and being willing to teach others what you have been taught.

D) Memorizing large portions of the Bible.

9. **Why is being “doubletongued” dangerous according to the notes?**

A) It leads to public embarrassment.

B) It is a form of lying that can kill a ministry and destroy relationships.

C) It makes conversations confusing.

D) It results in a bad reputation only among friends.

10. **What is the biblical reasoning against being “greedy of filthy lucre”?**

A) Money should never be pursued for any reason.

B) It is the love of money and improper methods of gain that corrupt character and ministry.

C) Only rich people are affected by this issue.

D) The Bible says to avoid earning any wealth.

11. **How is “patience” developed according to the notes?**

A) By avoiding all stressful situations.

B) By enduring temptations, trials, and trusting God through adversity.

C) Through relaxation techniques.

D) By living in isolation.

12. **What is the primary caution behind the instruction to be “not a brawler”?**

A) To never stand up for oneself.

B) Constant confrontation and fighting, whether verbal or physical, disqualifies one from ministry.

C) To avoid heated debates in public.

D) To stay away from athletic competitions.

13. **Why must a leader in the church “not be a novice”?**

A) Novices are too young to serve.

B) Without experience, they risk being lifted up with pride and falling into the condemnation of the devil.

C) They cannot be trusted with money.

D) They won’t be able to preach effectively.

14. **Why is having “a good report to them which are without” important?**

A) It prevents any criticism from the world.

B) To maintain personal pride in public settings.

C) So that the lost world has fewer reasons to criticize Christianity and believers can be more effective witnesses.

D) To receive community awards.

15. **What does it mean to be “faithful in all things” according to the notes?**

A) Being perfect in every area of life.

B) Being full of faith and consistently trustworthy in all responsibilities.

C) Attending every church service.

D) Memorizing the entire Bible.

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

Week 1

Introduction

During this study we will examine 27 character qualities of a man or woman of God. It is important for us to understand that even though these character qualities are found in the texts dealing with the qualifications for a Pastor and Deacon, they are also the standard for every believer (both men and women).

- Acts 6:3; Acts 14:23; Titus 1:5

What are the character qualities?

- A multitude of evident personal character qualities - 1 Timothy 3:1-13; Titus 1:5-9
- The qualities are as follows:

1. Blameless
2. The husband of one wife
3. Vigilant
4. Sober
5. Grave
6. Of good behavior
7. Given to hospitality
8. Apt to teach
9. Not given to wine
10. Not doubletongued
11. No striker
12. Not greedy of filthy lucre
13. Patient
14. Not a brawler
15. Not slanderers
16. Not covetous
17. Ruleth well his own house
18. Not a novice
19. A good report to them which are without
20. Faithful in all things
21. Not self-willed
22. Not soon angry
23. A lover of good men
24. Just
25. Holy
26. Temperate
27. Holding fast the faithful word

**DURING THIS CLASS WE WILL BE MOVING THROUGH A LOT IN A SHORT TIME, THE KEY TO HELPING WITH THIS AND FOR YOU TO WALK AWAY WITH SOMETHING EACH WEEK IS THIS: MARK DOWN WITH A STAR/NOTES, 3 THINGS ON THE NOTES EACH WEEK THAT STAND OUT TO YOU THAT YOU NEED TO WORK ON. NO MORE THAN THIS, AND NO LESS!

#1 - Blameless

1 Timothy 3:2, 10 - 2 A bishop then must be **blameless**, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach; …10 And let these also first be proved; then let them use the office of a deacon, being found **blameless**.

Titus 1:6-7 - 6 If any be **blameless**, the husband of one wife, having faithful children not accused of riot or unruly. 7 For a bishop must be **blameless**, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre.

Definition of "Blameless":	*"free from blame or the just imputation of fault, **NOT** sinless or un-accused"*

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

1st Mention:	Genesis 44:10 - "And he said, Now also let it be according unto your words: he with whom it is found shall be my servant; and ye shall be blameless."

Having a blameless character means that others are not able to justly accuse you of being wrong or doing wrong. When accusations are thrown, they will not stick. Since no one is perfect, we will all likely violate this character quality, along with the others we will be studying. When this happens in our life and we are aware of it, we need to accept personal responsibility, confess our sin, deal with the consequences, and move forward with Christ!

Blameless is the most important character quality…

- It is the first quality listed in 1 Timothy 3:2, and it is mentioned twice in Titus 1:6-7
- It is the standard for all believers - Phil. 2:13-15; 1 Thess. 5:23; 2 Pt. 3:14; 1 Jn. 3:3
- It is the foundation for all the other character qualities and it is part of Gods great plan for your life– Eph. 1:4
- Your behavior can cause your MINISTRY to be blamed; therefore we must remain blameless- 2 Cor. 6:3

As followers of the Jesus Christ, we ought to be blameless before the Lord, other believers, and the world…

- 1 Cor. 10:31-32; 11:1; 2 Cor. 1:12; 6:3; Phil. 1:10; 3:17; 1 Tim. 5:14; 6:1; Tts. 2:5; 2 Sam. 12:14; 1 Pt. 2:21-23
  - When you follow the Lord, you can and will be blamed for many things, especially as a leader. What you need to do is make sure that it is not able to stick because you are blameless. Sometimes this means simply making a wrong doing, right; or it can mean to simply stay out of situations where you can be blamed.
  - We all WILL make mistakes, misspeak, and let others down; they key is humility to make it right always so that you are blameless. This is a non-negotiable in ministry. If you cannot do this then you will not be fruitful in your ministry.

#2 - The husband of one wife

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, **the husband of one wife**, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach;

Titus 1:6 - If any be blameless, **the husband of one wife**, having faithful children not accused of riot or unruly.

The husband of one wife = "Complete and total devotion to one mate; a one-woman man"

(Since nobody in here is married yet, apply these to your spiritual husband, Jesus Christ)

- ✓ Faithful with eyes - Job 31:1
- ✓ Faithful with mind - 2 Cor. 11:2-3
- ✓ Faithful with heart - Dan. 1:8; Matt. 15:18-19

Single people need to develop this area properly

- Some things are reserved for marriage only - Heb. 13:4; Gen. 1:27-28; 2:21, 24
- Singleness is a high calling - 1 Cor. 7:17-24; Phil 4:11; Heb. 13:5
- The advantages of singleness - 1 Cor. 7:32-45; Matt. 13:22
- Be pure - 1 Cor. 6:15-20; Rom. 6:12-13; 1 Pt. 2:11; Eph. 5:3

- Be someone who is FAITHFUL: to God now, to your spouse later. This can even start now with your dating/engagement time of life.
- Someone who is a "flirt" is not a good person to pursue. They are already showing signs of not being a "one woman kind of man" or a "one man kind of woman".

#3 - Vigilant

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, **vigilant**, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach;

Vigilant = "to watch; to keep watch; stay awake; alert and watchful especially to danger; to be ready; surveillance; prepared; focused (*The guard was on an all-night vigil*)"

- ✓ Watchful is a good synonym

  Genesis 2:15 - "And the LORD God took the man, and put him into the garden of Eden to dress it and *to keep it*."

Watchful for yourself

- ✓ Watch and pray concerning areas of fleshly temptation/personal weakness - Matt. 26:38-41; 1 Cor. 10:12-13

Watchful for those whom God has given you

- ✓ Watch to feed - Acts 20:28; 1 Pt. 5:2-3
- ✓ Watch for wolves from without - Acts 20:29; 2 Pt. 2:1
- ✓ Watch for wolves from within - Acts 20:30-31; Ezek. 34:1-4
- ✓ Watch in prayer for all the saints - Eph. 6:18; 1:15-16
- ✓ Watch and pray for open doors - Col. 4:2-4; Eph. 6:19
- ✓ Watch for the tendency to be pulled away from preaching of the word - 2 Tim. 4:1-5; Jer. 5:31; Lk. 6:26; 2 Pt. 2:1-3
  - Is your life in a place that you are able to help others?
  - Who have you helped in this ministry? How?
  - How is your prayer life for this ministry?

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

Week 2

#4 - Sober

1 Timothy 3:2, 11 - 2 A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, **sober**, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach; …11 Even so must their wives be grave, not slanderers, **sober**, faithful in all things.

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, **sober**, just, holy, temperate;

Sober = "to be sensible; to have control of your mind, emotions, senses and impulses in all circumstances"

- This is especially true of young people (young men are warned of this as we will see later). You have a zeal and fire in you that helps BUT can hinder you if you are not careful

- Sober and vigilant (watchful) are closely related - 1 Tim. 3:2
  - ✓ 1 Pt. 1:13 - "…gird up the loins of your mind, be sober…"
  - ✓ Phil. 4:5 - "Let your moderation be known to all men…"
  - ✓ 1 Cor. 9:25 - "…temperate in all things…"
- Important questions to ask yourself…
  1. What are the things that take control of my **mind**?- Titus 2:6
  2. What are the things that take control of my **emotions**?- Daniel 1:8; Ephesians 5:26
     - These verses show us that the world is trying to bring you "under the influence", maybe using things like "influencers" and social media. To think, believe, and act differently than you know to when you are "sober"
     - It is great to have zeal, but if you are not sober minded and you are brought under the influence of something else then you will make unwise choices that have lasting effects, BUT YOU WONT KNOW IT IN THE MOMENT
     - Interestingly enough, water is what is used to "sober" people up, and we see in Ephesians 5:26 that this water for us, is the word of God

#5 - Grave

1 Timothy 3:4, 8, 11 - 4 One that ruleth well his own house, having his children in subjection with all **gravity**; …8 Likewise must the deacons be **grave**, not doubletongued, not given to much wine, not greedy of filthy lucre; …11 Even so must their wives be **grave**, not slanderers, sober, faithful in all things.

Grave = "Something momentous, weighty, influential, of great importance; to be serious, solemn, sober"

- ✓ It means to take things that are serious seriously
  - There is a time for joking and fun, BUT there are times and things that require full attention and all seriousness.
- ✓ Do you take seriously:
  - Your sin?- Galatians 6:7-8
  - The salvation of those around you?- Rev. 20:15
  - The growth of this ministry?
  - The word of God?- John 1:1

- Personal holiness?- 1 Thess. 4:3-4
- Prayer?- Luke 22:44
- Etc..

#6 - Of good behaviour

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, **of good behaviour**, given to hospitality, apt to teach;

Of good behaviour = "Orderly; well-arranged"- 1 Sam. 18:14

*9/20 mentions of "behave" in the Bible are talking about how David "behaved" himself

Good behaviour has to do with specific areas:

- ✓ Orderly in our daily life - 1 Thess. 2:10; 2 Cor. 4:2
- ✓ Orderly in our work ethic - 2 Thess. 3:6-11; 1 Pt. 5:2-3

It is becoming of the gospel for us to be of good behaviour:

Note: We are His ambassadors (ambassadors of good will) - 2 Cor. 5:20

#7 - Given to hospitality

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, **given to hospitality**, apt to teach;

Titus 1:8 - But **a lover of hospitality**, a lover of good men, sober, just, holy, temperate;

Given to hospitality = "Giving; Friendly; Being sensitive to the needs of others; Developed from the word hospital…to care for; A friendly treatment of guests and strangers."

Hospitable toward:

- Believers
  - Gal. 6:10 - "…especially unto them who are of the household of faith."
  - 1 Jn. 3:17 - "But whoso hath this world's good, and seeth his brother hath need…"
- Non-Believers
  - Hospitality tested:
    - ✓ Heb. 13:2 - "Be not forgetful to entertain strangers…" (Entertain strangers = Hospitality!)
  - Strangers typified:
    - ✓ Lev. 19:34 - "…for ye were strangers in the land of Egypt:"

      * Loving strangers is the heart of God - Deut. 10:17-19; Lev. 19:34

Note: How we respond to the lost is a great indicator of our love for God!

Hospitality is the willingness to let God use whatever he has given you to help others…

- ✓ What are ways in which you can exercise hospitality to believers?
- ✓ What are ways in which you can exercise hospitality to non-believers?

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

#8 - Apt to teach

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, **apt to teach**;

Titus 1:9 - Holding fast the faithful word as he hath been taught, that he may be able by sound doctrine both to **exhort and to convince the gainsayers**.

This is a learned character quality for every child of God to develop (Some are gifted to teach, this goes beyond one's ability to learn - Eph. 4:8, 11)

The first mention:

- Exodus 4:10-12 - **Availability**, not ability, is the key
  - Are you available to open your mouth and "teach" the Bible to those who you interact with? Are you willing?

This also means we need to be investing in " learning" the word, so that we can be ready to "teach" it

You can only teach what you have been taught - 2 Tim. 2:2; 2 Tim. 2:15; 1 Tim. 4:16

- ✓ What kind of learner am I?
- ✓ How well do I pay attention?
- ✓ How well do I listen to others?
- ✓ How is my Bible study time?
- ✓ Do I learn from circumstances of life easily?
- ✓ Do I seek out opportunities to learn from/follow others who I know can help me learn even more?

- You are at a time in life where you can/should be building a large foundation of your learning the Bible. You have the time, resources, lower level of responsibility, and God tells us that it should be one of the focuses of your age (1 Jn. 2:14)

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

Week 3

#9 - Not given to wine

1 Timothy 3:3, 8 - 3 **Not given to wine**, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous; … 8 Likewise must the deacons be grave, not doubletongued, **not given to much wine**, not greedy of filthy lucre;

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, **not given to wine**, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;

The word of God condemns drunkenness:

- ✓ Eph. 5:18 - "And be not drunk with wine…"
- ✓ 1 Pt. 4:2-3 - "…the time past of our life…when we walked in…excess of wine…"
- ✓ Prov. 20:1 - "Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging: and whoever is deceived thereby is not wise."
- ✓ Prov. 23:29-35 - "…it biteth like a serpent…"

The wise man or woman avoids it:

- ✓ Lev. 10:9 - No alcohol permitted while serving in the capacity of a priest
- ✓ Prov. 31:4 - Kings and priests were to avoid strong drink - 1 Pt. 2:5, 9; Rev. 1:6; 5:10

The bible very carefully and specifically defines our attitude toward alcohol:

- ✓ Allowances were only for medicinal purposes - 1 Tim. 5:23
- ✓ Interpreting our culture:
  - → The #1 killer of teenagers is alcohol related auto accidents
  - → The #1 factor in domestic violence is alcohol
  - → A major component of immorality is intoxication

Note: You can justify anything if you really want to. The Bible does NOT make provisions for us to drink socially. Total abstinence is the best policy regarding alcohol consumption. However, if you really want to violate God's word, God will let you fool yourself - Ezek. 14:1-4, 9; Matt. 13; Jer. 23.

The Bible says that nothing should control our lives but the Holy Spirit… and we can be drunk on many things

- ✓ 1 Co. 6:12; 1 Thess. 5:5-8; Ephesians 5:18

#10 - Not doubletongued

1 Timothy 3:8 - Likewise must the deacons be grave, **not doubletongued**, not given to much wine, not greedy of filthy lucre;

Doubletongued = "double in speech; saying one thing with one and another thing with another; a type of lying"

- ✓ This is the only time this word in used in the Bible
- ✓ See James 1:8; 3:3-12(verse 10 especially)
  - o Our tongue should not be a place where we bless God and yet curse others
  - o This kind of speaking will kill a ministry. Gossip and ill speaking will kill a ministry, friendships, and your personal walk with the Lord. (Jeremiah 9:3,5,,8-9)

- God HATES this kind of behavior (Prov. 6:16-19)

This can be best understood by just reading the scripture…

- ✓ Watch out for flatterers - Ps. 12:1-3; 5:9
- ✓ Watch out for liars - Ps. 50:19; 52:2; Rom. 3:13; Eph. 4:25; James 5:12 (let your yea be yea and your nay be nay)
- ✓ What your mouth should be: a well of life, ministering to others- Prov. 10:11; Eph. 4:29
- ✓ The Bottom Line- A mature Christian who is to lead God's people, cannot and will not participate in this kind of behavior. It will **kill** your ministry and any chance of growth you have in it.

#11 - No striker

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, **no striker**, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous;

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, **no striker**, not given to filthy lucre;

No striker = "**Uncontrolled** anger to the point of physical violence"

- ✓ A Striker is someone who is ready to fight

There are striking biblical examples:

- ✓ Genesis 4:8- And Cain talked with Abel his brother: and it came to pass, when they were in the field, that Cain rose up against Abel his brother, and slew him.
  - We can fight or strike our brethren out of jealousy/envy to tear them down
- ✓ Exodus 2:11-12- And it came to pass in those days, when Moses was grown, that he went out unto his brethren, and looked on their burdens: and he spied an Egyptian smiting an Hebrew, one of his brethren. And he looked this way and that way, and when he saw that *there was* no man, he slew the Egyptian, and hid him in the sand.
- ✓ John 18:10-11- Then Simon Peter having a sword drew it, and smote the high priest's servant, and cut off his right ear. The servant's name was Malchus.
  - We can fight/strike others for "just causes". We should not find ourselves in a constant state of fighting and turmoil, it may show we have a "striker" nature.
- ✓ Don't always be so quick to "vindicate yourself" and make yourself have to be "right" in all situations. Seek peace first. Oftentimes this means bearing the **burdens** of others!- Rom. 15:1-3; Luke 6:29
  - It is our "American" posture, but it was NOT the posture of Christ to always "be made right" and make sure they were treated justly and that they were vindicated. Not being a striker means to seek peace and bearing burdens.

Violent abuse can also be verbal

- ✓ A striker usually begins with **verbally** abusing others
- ✓ James 3:1-10 - There is more than one way to hurt someone
- ✓ Proverbs 10:19; 17:27-28 - A man or woman of God should be known for their good words as well as for their good works
  - Don't be QUICK to fight. With your words or your actions. Seek peace (Romans 12:18) when at all possible.

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

#12 - Not greedy of filthy lucre

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, **not greedy of filthy lucre**; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous;

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, **not given to filthy lucre**;

Filthy lucre = "Money received through improper methods or motives"

→ A.K.A. - "Dirty Money"

Improper methods:

- Usury (interest): exploiting the crisis of others - Prov. 28:8; Lev. 25:35-37
- Get rich quick schemes - gambling, lottery, high risk investments, etc. - Prov. 13:11

  *Vanity = Empty; with no value - Jer. 17:11; Prov. 28:8, 20, 22
- Bribes and deceit: Deut. 16:19; Prov. 17:23; 1 Sam. 8:1-3

Improper motives:

- Greed – Matthew 6:24
- Desire for power – Matt. 23:12
- Covetousness/Security through materialism – Luke 12:15-21

Money problems are generally not an issue of amount but of attitude

The proper attitude is one of contentment - 1 Tim. 6:6-8; Prov. 30:8-9; Heb. 13:5

✓ A man must be proven in this area before becoming a pastor - 1 Pt. 5:2

#13 - Patient

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but **patient**, not a brawler, not covetous;

Patient = "the ability to bear adversity without complaint"

Patience is a developed character quality.

- It is often associated with being developed in times of temptations and trials- James 1:2-4

→ Patience is learned, but it does not always have to be learned the hard way!

Patience is a requirement for those who minister God's word and lead others

- It is a key quality for God's leaders in ministry -2 Corinthians 6:4-10
  - While we endure these trials and persecutions, God is teaching us patience. It is a quality you can only learn really through time and experience
- Ministry is oftentimes loveless, burdensome, and has little "reward" in it for the minister from those they minister to. Therefore patience in pressing forward is needed- 2 Cor. 12:15
  - Patience in serving, giving, ministering, loving, taking criticism, taking hatred, taking evil speaking, etc.. is needed
- Patience truly is learning to trust God and his word in times of troubles and persecutions. Abraham was a great example- Gen. 12:1-3; 13:15; 15:1-6; 16:1-3; 17:15-19; 21:1-2; Heb 11:8-10,17
  - When God's promises and his "word" start to not make sense because of troubles around us, when we learn to trust his word anyway and wait on him, we are learning patience.

#14 - Not a brawler

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, **not a brawler**, not covetous;

Brawler = "one who constantly seeks a confrontation; one who enjoys a fight; macho-man; armed for combat"

Some causes of brawling:

✓ Pride - Prov. 13:10

- Do you find yourself in constant contention, drama, or surrounded by issues? You are called to not be a brawler. Pride comes with contention. This is the opposite of the "burden bearing" leader

✓ Proud Debating - 2 Tim. 2:23; Titus 3:9

- Even when dealing with other believers or the lost about things, don't find yourself in constant struggles and "debates". It is a sign of immaturity
- There is nothing wrong with helping others and teaching them (Adam, London) but if you find yourself in contention, pride is somewhere.

Note: Satan started the brawl…"I will be like the most high." - Isaiah 14:13-14

→ Some people just seem to consistently find themselves in conflict

Some questions to ask yourself

- ✓ Do I have a team-mentality, or am I totally independent? - Eph. 4:1-3
- ✓ Do I display a servant's **heart** or self-centeredness? - Phil. 2:1-5
- ✓ Do I seek areas of agreement or disagreement? – Rom. 12:18
- ✓ Do I look for people's strengths or their weaknesses?- Rom. 15:1-2
- ✓ Would my authorities (employer, husband, etc.) say I was submissive in heart? - 2 Pt. 2:10; Jude 8

#15 - Not slanderers

1 Timothy 3:11 - Even so must their wives be grave, **not slanderers**, sober, faithful in all things.

Slanderer = "one that falsely accuses another; acting the part of the devil"

- ✓ Satan is known as the "accuser of our brethren" - Rev. 12:9-10; 2 Tim. 3:3
- ✓ They are false accusations against "brethren" (i.e. soundly saved Christians) because Jesus Christ took our iniquity upon Himself and we received His spotless righteousness in return- Is. 53:4-6; 2 Cor. 5:19-21
  - → We are to follow the biblical procedure to restore our brothers/sisters who are overtaken in a fault; not doing so and simply slandering our brothers/sisters will KILL our ministry (Gal. 6:1-2; 2 Sam. 12:1-15; Psalm 51; Matt. 18:15-17)

What this does not mean…

It is not slander to warn others of **false** teachers and heretics. It is not godly to remain silent when false prophets are leading others "off the cliff" of sound doctrine. We still apply Galatians 6:1-2 first, but after that it's time to contend for the faith…loudly if necessary! Eternity is at stake for billions of people! - Titus 1:9-11

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

Week 5

#16 - Not covetous

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, not a brawler, **not covetous**;

Covetousness is defined as idolatry in Colossians 3:5 and Ephesians 5:3-7 - Eager to have more…

- Covetousness declares that God is not enough - Ps. 119:57; 73:25-26

Covetousness is the root cause of much sin

- It is the root of all evil - 1 Tim. 6:10
- It is at the heart of false teaching - 1 Tim. 6:10; 2 Pt. 2:1-3
- It is worthy of separation - 1 Cor. 5:11

Covetousness can become a lifestyle, if it is not controlled

- In relation to material things – Luke 12:15-21
    - The problem with covetousness is that it goes directly against relying upon God, it is directly against the life of FAITH (God is everything, trusting him in everything)
    - God emphasized the sabbath with Israel so much because it was an issue of FAITH and GOD over MONEY and COVETEOUSNESS

Always Remember…

- ✓ A godly man or woman should hate covetousness! - Ex. 18:21 (first mention)
- ✓ The word of God can replace covetousness - Ps. 119:36
    - Think of the KEY of David, THE LOVE OF THE WORD OF GOD; verses the ROOT OF all evil, the LOVE OF MONEY (ye cannot serve God and mammon. You will love one master and hate the other)

#17 - Ruleth well his own house

1 Timothy 3:4-5 - 4 One that **ruleth well his own house**, having his children in subjection with all gravity; 5 (For if a man know not how to **rule his own house**, how shall he take care of the church of God?)

Titus 1:6 - If any be blameless, the husband of one wife, **having faithful children not accused of riot or unruly**.

Ruleth well his own house = "One that rules (or leads) his home in a godly, upright manner, fitting of a true follower of Jesus Christ"

→ Defining this quality is easy: *it means what it says, and says what it means…*

This qualification is a noticeable test for leadership:

-How a man rules his home will be how he rules the church - 1 Tim. 3:5

The principle is clear:

- ✓ My family is the mirror God uses to expose my areas of weakness

How this work in your life today as a youth:

- ✓ Your disciples are a reflection of you (your "spiritual child")- 1 Tim. 1:2; 2 Tim. 2:1
  - o If you have none or you have never led anyone to the Lord, then that is a reflection of you (not an exact but a measurement)
- ✓ Your ministry is a reflection of you
  - o What are you doing for the Lord?
  - o What place do you have in this ministry?
  - o What have you contributed?
  - o Do you have a "ministry" within this "ministry"?
- ✓ Your "fruit" is a reflection of you
  - o The fruit of your life speaks of who you are
  - o What fruit do you have?
  - o How well do you rule what God has entrusted to you (whatever it is)?

#18 - Not a novice

1 Timothy 3:6 - **Not a novice**, lest being lifted up with pride he fall into the condemnation of the devil.

Novice - "Someone in a position of leadership before they are qualified… not experienced"

- → The term refers specifically to a new believer, but carries with it the idea of someone who has not been trained, tested, and proven
- → It is possible to be saved for a long time and still be a novice - 1 Cor. 3:1; Heb. 5:12-13.
- → The issue is one of maturity rather than time

A novice has a special danger of pride. Authority and power can, and usually does, corrupt. Therefore, it is vital that they be tested and proven.

- ✓ Children's ministry - No glory, just responsibility…How does he serve?
- ✓ Adult ministry - Is he diligent? Does he take initiative? Do godly people follow him?
- ✓ Discipleship - How seriously does he approach his commitment to others?
- ✓ General volunteer work - Does he have a submissive heart attitude?

A novice cannot develop these character qualities overnight or by going to school - They must be lived daily…

- ✓ Abraham was 25 years in preparing to be a father
- ✓ Moses was 40 years in preparing to be a deliverer
- ✓ Paul was at least 15 years preparing for his first missionary journey

Note: It is the responsibility of leadership to guard the body of Christ from a novice. Proper testing and training must be part of any local New Testament church structure

#19 - A good report to them which are without

1 Timothy 3:7 - Moreover he must have **a good report of them which are without**; lest he fall into reproach and the snare of the devil.

A good report to them which are without - "Having a good testimony in the **lost** world"

There is no other option…It does matter what the world thinks of us:

→ That we might be able to win them - 1 Cor. 9:19-22; 10:31-33

→ To keep criticism of Christianity at a minimum - 2 Cor. 6:3; 1 Pt. 2:12, 15

→ Note: Remember what the apostle Paul wrote in Philippians 2:14-16…

Test yourself:

- ✓ What is my testimony in the lost world?
- ✓ Is there truth in the lost world's criticism of me?
- ✓ Is it my beliefs or my attitude that people reject?
- ✓ Would my financial report allow me to witness to an employee at my bank?
- ✓ If someone referenced you in a conversation, would that person's ability to be a witness be helped or hindered?

Caution: We are at odds with the lost world because of the word of God and the testimony of Jesus. We will be criticized even when we have not done anything wrong. Give other believers the benefit of the doubt when hearing criticisms concerning them. Keep this in mind when attacks focus on our personalities and characters. Remember, we will suffer for this testimony, so do not expect to get an award from the lost world for witnessing to them.

A great example:

- Timothy- Acts 16:1-3

#20 - Faithful in all things

1 Timothy 3:11 - Even so must their wives be grave, not slanderers, sober, **faithful in all things**.

Faithful in all things - "faithful in everything; worthy of trust in all things"

- ✓ This is also specifically addressed to wives of deacons. Men (or in this case deacons) obviously should also be faithful in all things. In fact, the husbands should be spiritually teaching and leading their wives in this area- 1 Cor. 14:34-35; 1 Tim. 2:11-14; Eph. 5:22-24

Faithful can be broken down as someone who is "full of faith"; is this descriptive of your life?

- ✓ Hebrews 11- Do you trust God/his word even when the world tells you it is crazy?
- ✓ Are you someone that can be counted on? By God and other people?- Luke 16:10

#21 - Not self-willed

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; **not selfwilled**, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;

Self-Willed = "Not yielding to the wishes of others; stubborn; obstinate; willful adherence to one's own desires or ideas; controlled by one's own will; someone full of self (pride); one who only wants things done their way"

Note: This is especially prevalent in false teachers - 2 Pt. 2:10; Jude 8

→ Therefore, someone who is not self-willed wants things done God's way…

When we are not self-willed we will tend to give God the glory rather than ourselves:

- He should have the pre-eminence - Col. 1:18; 3 Jn. 9
- HIS will, not OUR will, should be our focus- Mt. 26:39, 42
    - This is all about the will of God, seeking God and his kingdom, his glory first. NOT our plans, our will, our thoughts.
    - We can have and express our thoughts to God, but we must be willing to submit, and not be selfwilled.

Personal evaluation:

- ✓ Would the people in my home, office, or sphere of influence say that I am self-willed?
- ✓ Does everything usually end up going my way?
- ✓ Do people seem to adjust to or work around my personality?
- ✓ Am I a quitter (do I give up easily)?
- ✓ Am I a good follower?

WEEK 6

#22 - Not soon angry

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, **not soon angry**, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;

Not soon angry = "A person who is seldom angry; a person who is not angered easily; a person who, when angry for a just cause, is not angry for long (Jas. 1:19)

Anger is not always sin… proper, biblical anger exists - Mk. 3:5; Ps. 7:11

- Matthew 5:22 - Without a cause… there must be a time when there is a cause
- Ephesians 4:26-27 - Be ye angry and sin not… there must be a sinless anger

Anger is sin when:

- When it is kept in and not dealt with - Eph. 4:26-27
  - ✓ If we do not deal with anger we give the Devil a foot-hold
- When it seeks revenge - Rom. 12:19-21
  - ✓ Taking vengeance is taking the position of God
  - ✓ It means I have been overcome
- When it is for selfish reasons - Gen. 4:1-8; Jonah 4:1; Lk. 15:28
  - ✓ Would it bother me as bad if this was done to someone else?

Note: Jesus' anger was always in regard to the violation of God's righteousness or God's people - Matt. 21:12-13; Mk. 3:1-5

Anger is caused by:

- Pride: When my **rights** have been violated - Jas. 4:1
  - ✓ We cannot consider ourselves spirit controlled when bitterness remains a part of our lives - Jas. 3:13-18
- Insecurity/Envy: A result from feeling threatened in position or relationships - 1 Sam. 18:6-9
  - o Saul Jealous over David and the people reverencing David and his victories
  - ✓ How do I respond to those who question my authority?
  - ✓ Do I become frustrated when my routines are interrupted?
  - ✓ How do I react when my control is lost?
- Foolishness: Anger is evidence of lack of wisdom - Prov. 12:16; 27:3; Eccl. 7:9
- Anger is a secondary emotion: it is always caused by something else: the root of the problem is **something else**

Anger results in:

- Vulnerability: Spiritual sickness…You become easily controlled by the enemy and predictable - Prov. 25:28; 16:32
  - ✓ Open to demonic influence: Eph. 4:26-27
    - o Neither give place to the devil

Anger is to be dealt with biblically:

- ✓ **Yield your rights to God…you are His** - 1 Cor. 6:19-20; **Learn to rest in him** - Ps. 37:7-8; **Use a soft answer** - Prov. 15:1; **Walk in the spirit** - Gal. 5:16-25; **Pass over faults…remember, he passed over our faults** - Prov. 12:16; 19:11; **Listen twice as much as you speak** - Jas. 1:20; 3:2-10; **Saturate your mind with scripture dealing with anger** - Ps. 119:9-11

#23 - A lover of good men

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, **a lover of good men**, sober, just, holy, temperate;

A Good Man = "An upright and **perfect** man" (Prov. 2:20-21)

→ Although we are all sinners and are careful not to define ourselves as good, the Bible clearly tells us to be lovers of good men. This obviously means there must be good, godly men. (Not good in and of ourselves…)

Additional biblical credentials of a good man:

- ✓ Saved men - Matthew 13:38
- ✓ Fruit-bearing men - Matthew 13:23; 7:15-20
- ✓ Stable men - Psalm 37:23-24
- ✓ Benevolent and honest men - Psalm 112:5
  - o Who you are surrounded by WILL EFFECT YOU. It is a reflection of you. It says a lot about you. Be careful of who you are surrounded by. Make sure they are good men/women according to the BIBLE!

Some practical things that identify good men:

- ✓ A good man lives by faith - Romans 4, Hebrews 11
- ✓ A good man is hated by evil and wicked men - Prov. 29:27
- ✓ A good man avoids evil - Prov. 16:17
- ✓ A good man desires to be sharpened by his friends - Prov. 27:17
  - → *A good man is not intimidated, but rather challenged, by the goodness of others*
- ✓ A good man will find encouragement in his friend's counsel - Prov. 27:9
  - → *Our intimate friendships reveal much about our character*

WEEK 7

#24 - Just

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, **just**, holy, temperate;

Just - "Right or righteous; Good **judgment**"

→ The word "just" carries the sense of having wisdom and the ability to judge matters properly according to the word of God; to discern between right and wrong and have the strength of character to make right decisions even it is difficult

The practical ways of becoming just are given in the word of God:

- ✓ It is the result of denying your own agenda in order to accomplish His - John 5:30
- ✓ When your judgments are not based on circumstances - John 7:24
- ✓ When you live by faith in God's truth not your perspective - Romans 1:17
- ✓ When you fear God - Acts 10:22, 34-35
- ✓ When you fall (because you will, nobody's perfect), you get back up – Prov. 24:16, Ecclesiastes 7:20
- ✓ God's word is just - Romans 7:12
    - Someone who ***JUST*** does the right thing. Makes the right judgement call. This comes from a deep wisdom and relationship with the word of God alone!

Some biblical examples of just men:

- Joseph: Matthew 1:19 -
- John the Baptist: Mark 6:20-
- Solomon: 1 Kings 3:16-28 –

#25 - Holy

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, just, **holy**, temperate;

Holy = "Not a state of sinless perfection, but a daily lifestyle **set apart** unto God and from the world (Lev. 20:24-26; Rom. 12:1-2)"

- ✓ We are called to be holy (set apart) - 2 Cor. 6:14-18; Rom. 1:7
- ✓ We are to be holy because we are to be like Him - 1 Pt. 1:15-16
    - Some people over emphasize holiness (holiness movement, people who say salvation can be lost), but WE LAODICEANS underemphasize it (white raiment to be clothed)
        - Sexual sin; disgusting music, movies, tv shows, language, social media, conversations, jokes, dress (immodesty), etc… We are the church of "mixing the world with God"
        - Could anyone tell you were a Christian based on your: Spotify playlist, Netflix recently watched, social media feed, way you dress, the way you talk, the jokes you make? IF NOT, YOU ARE NOT LIVING SET APART

→ Holiness emphasized in the OT

The priests were to wash with water before entering the tabernacle, or they would die (Exo. 30:20-21)

- God takes our holiness very seriously!
- It is one of the things we will be judged on at the judgment seat of Christ (gold=holiness/sanctification to God)
- Of course, today we have the Holy Ghost living inside of us if we are saved and we can enter God's presence at any time because of the blood of Christ, but we still need to separate ourselves from sin and wickedness in our lives.
- What we do, we drag God into!!

How can we live a Holy life?

→ We are made holy by:

The holy blood that cleanses - 1 Pt. 1:18-19

The Holy Spirit that anoints - 2 Cor. 1:21-22; 1Jn. 2:27

The holy word that washes - Eph. 5:26; Jn. 17:17

**Holiness is the LIFE CALLING of a ministry leader! You will always be held to a higher standard! Just like the OT priests.

#26 - Temperate

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, just, holy, **temperate**;

Temperate = "Moderate, not **excessive** in any area, having our actions and emotions under the Spirit's control… self-controlled" (1 Cor. 9:25; Php. 4:5; James 1:8)

Temperance is part of the fruit of the Spirit

- Temperance is the result of a daily walking in obedience to His Spirit - Gal. 5:23
- As such "intemperance" would be proof of being under the influence of the flesh
    - When my desires and emotions get the best of me it is evidence that I am not yielding to the working of God's Spirit in me at that moment - Gal. 5:23

Temperance is also a learned quality of character

- Just like holiness or love, God gives it to us by way of His Spirit at salvation…We have the responsibility to develop it through abiding in His word - 2 Pt. 1:5-8
- Temperance is seen in our willingness to surrender our own desires and preferences for the greater cause of reaching people - 1 Cor. 9:19-27
    - He equates this kind of living to an athlete. Discipline, training, and playing with PURPOSE and a GOAL, not out of control, willy nilly
    - Temperance is about being in control of your impulses, emotions, whims, etc. It relates to many other qualities we have looked at
    - Are you someone who is disciplined? Someone solid who can be counted on? Or are you prisoner to your every emotion, whim, and desire?

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

#27 - Holding fast the faithful word

Titus 1:9 - **Holding fast the faithful word** as he hath been taught, that he may be able by sound doctrine both to exhort and to convince the gainsayers.

Hold fast = "confidently holding the word of God, without wavering, even unto the end"

- 1 Sam. 3:19- As a young man, Samuel held onto every word of God dearly
  - Notice God was with him AND he grew. Why? Because he loved and dearly the word of God!

The man or woman of God must be doctrinally sound

- ✓ Proverbs 4:13- Refusing to let go the word of God (instruction) you've been given
- ✓ 2 Thess. 2:15 - Holding fast to what you have been taught from the word of God
- ✓ 2 Tim. 1:13-14 - Holding fast to the sound words committed to thee…
  - We must realize that someone is trying to take this truth out of our hands – 1 Tim. 4:1-2, 2 Tim. 4:1-4… Therefore we must be prepared to "earnestly contend for the faith" - Titus 1:9-11; Jude 3; 1 Pet. 3:15

A man or woman of God must learn how to use the Bible

- ✓ We must study the Bible so we will not be ashamed - 2 Tim. 2:15
- ✓ We must exercise in the word to become strong in the word - Heb. 5:11-14
  - We cannot stay "babies" in the word; we MUST grow up!
  - We may not know all we think we do; the devil has those who know much more than us, he is preparing and training up his false ministers too.
  - Our over confidence could make a mockery of the faith if we are not ready!
  - I'd watch videos of people we disagreed with and it would scare me to death to not have the answers needed, so I STUDIED! I studied what they believe, critics of what we believe, other faiths, etc. TO BE READY!

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

YOUNG WOMEN

"We all want clear, obvious, direct words from God on what he wants from us TODAY in our lives. For the next two weeks are are in luck. If you want to please God and know EXACTLY what his purpose is for you TODAY, we will be looking at his direct words to young men/women. God has a specific purpose/plan for how your life ought to look RIGHT NOW. If we listen and obey what he says, we can live in the purpose he has called us to"

Titus 2:4-5- That they may teach the young women to be sober, to love their husbands, to love their children, *To be* discreet, chaste, keepers at home, good, obedient to their own husbands, that the word of God be not blasphemed.

1 Timothy 5:14-15- I will therefore that the younger women marry, bear children, guide the house, give none occasion to the adversary to speak reproachfully. For some are already turned aside after Satan.

**NOTICE FIRST- the aged women are told to instruct the young women, NOT TITUS. There is a correct order to things here.

Make sure you are connecting to older women who you see living out the qualities that the Bible gives, not what YOU think a woman should be/do

Today the "young women" we will discuss are definitely right at/around the age of the young women in here today, however, due to culture differences of the time, they are assumed to be married and having kids already. Application can be made for preparing for this time in life, living these qualities with the authorities/opportunities given in your life now, and spiritually with Jesus Christ.

1. **Sober**- Thinking clearly; not "under the **influence**" of the world, flesh, devil; but the word of God
    a. We have looked at this quality many times already so we won't expound too much upon it. However, I believe God put this first to get our attention.
        i. He is saying: "LISTEN TO ME, don't be influenced by the world, or even the modern church, and all the feminist movement around the world; that is not how/what I made you for. It is a lie! Don't be under its influence!"
    b. Be open to the word of God today. Be under its influence and NOT under the influence of anything or anyone else. If you can't be "sober" on this, then you won't get the rest.
2. **Love their husbands and their children (in that order)**
    a. When connected with 1 Tim. 5:14-15, we see the reverence God gives to women who will be married, have kids, and guide/give for their home (live selfless)
        i. This is not the "popular, freeing, powerful, feminist" thing to do today, but God values it still.
    b. The enemy knows the power/influence of the home, that is why a MAJOR attack against the church in the last days is in the home (2 Tim. 3:1-6)
    c. To have a family like this and to love it (sacrifice/charity) is work and it is selfless. God values you not living for yourself, your desires, your dreams, your career, your…..(fill in the blank) BUT for a greater cause.
        i. God set the family order for a reason. To think your way is better or that usurping his order of things is better, is a lack of faith.
        ii. Loving your husband first, ultimately affects your kids the most!
            1. **Many studies have shown that kids who viewed their parents as "being in love" have a much higher rate of success in finance, education, less behavioral issues, etc.**
    d. Your influence on your husband and your kids and how that affects eternity is INCALCULABLE. But, it takes faith. It is not satisfying in the short term (instant gratification).
    e. Read these quotes from/about great missionaries and Christians through the years and what they say about this
3. **Discreet-** The literal sense is, separate, **reserved**, wary; prudent

a. The other 3 uses in the Bible of this word show the word associated with being "behind the scenes" or "unseen" (Gen. 41:33, 39; Mark 12:34)
b. We see this same posture for women talked about elsewhere in the Bible (1 Cor. 14:34-35; 1 Tim. 2:11-12)
    i. The fact that these verses cannot often even be talked about the correct biblical way in churches today is evidence of two things:
        1. The wresting (twisting) and mis-use of these verses for "lording" over women by insecure/ little men
        2. The feminist attitude and posture of many women today seeking to live how the world says they ought to, and not how the word of God commands they should
            a. Neither side would admit to these accusations, and both would give you "scripture" out of context in order to excuse their behavior, but these statements are still absolutely true.
    ii. It is a virtuous quality for a woman to have this posture. It shows humility, faith in God's word, self-control, and sober mindedness. They are influenced by God and nothing else.
        1. The point of these verses is not that women are less, should not ever talk, or are not needed; but rather that WHEN DONE THE PROPER WAY, they have the MOST influence possible doing it God's way, with the countenance and attitude God made them to have!
        2. No man likes a loud, contentious, busy-body woman. You are not made to like that. (Prov. 27:15; 21:9, 19; 9:13; 7:11)
            a. I have heard women pride themselves on being loud, stubborn, abrasive, having a "fighting spirit". This is not what you want to be associated with. Be what God says you should be, not anyone else.

4. **Chaste-** Pure; genuine; uncorrupt
    a. When we see this word used elsewhere in the Bible, it typically deals with **purity**
        i. Purity in sexuality- 2 Cor. 11:2
            1. Don't compromise on your purity sexually. God values it so much that he equates it to our faithfulness to him in our marriage to his son
            2. The world says that exploring your sexuality is freeing and the feminist movement teaches you that it is freeing/liberating; but God says that it is imprisoning/bondage to you (Prov. 5:22; 7:22-27; Rom. 6:16; 2 Pet. 2:19; John 8:34)
        ii. Purity in modesty- 1 Pet. 3:1-5
            1. Dressing modestly is directly linked by God in these verses to your submissive heart, meekness, and quietness.
            2. He is implying that to not be modest is connected to not being quiet, meek, submissive, AND VISE VERSA.
            3. Would anyone know you were a Christian by what you wear ALONE?
            4. Is your dress LOUD? Drawing unnecessary attention?
            5. This is why he connects the two. Wanting/desiring attention, whether in dress, speech, lifestyle, etc.. is not a godly attribute
5. **Keepers at home/Good/Obedient to Husbands**
    a. I linked these three together because they are similar to previous points and they speak to the same thing
    b. They all speak to a **submissive** attitude
        i. **Keepers at home**- Prov 7:11
            1. Notice where the strange woman's feet are; NOT AT HOME.
            2. This point is not just about being married and having kids (although this is a good thing to do) but about not living for yourself

a. The godly woman is not living HER LIFE, FOR HER, HER HAPPINESS, HER JOY, HER CAREER, ETC.. she is living for others (her family, disciples, church body, etc..)
    i. We see this all the time today with social media: me time, I need to find myself, my passion, my interests, my career, etc.. IT IS UNGODLY
b. If you are married/have kids or not, your life ought to be focused on helping and living for those around you/that you are close to (home); NOT YOURSELF

ii. **Good**- "Complete or sufficiently **perfect** in its kind; having the physical qualities best adapted to its design and use" (In the context of this passage and based on the law of first mention)- Gen. 1
    1. Doing what God made you to do, not what you think/desire to do in your flesh

iii. **Obedient to their own husbands**
    1. Submitting to the **authorities** in your life, as God placed them, the proper way (Eph 5:22)
        a. For married woman, to your OWN husbands, NOT all men everywhere
        b. For all: to government, to the ordained authorities in your life (pastor), to your bosses at work, teachers, etc..
        c. How you submit to the authorities in your life is how you submit to God
    2. Being able to submit to the authorities in your life as God has placed them, speaks volumes about your character and virtue as a woman
        a. God can use you in great ways, when you are willing to obey in these areas

6. That the word of God be not blasphemed/ That the name of God and his doctrine be not blasphemed

a. When these qualities are out of line and we choose to live based on how we think, the world dictates, or how we feel; then we give place for the word of God to be blasphemed! (2 Sam. 12:14; Rom. 2:24; 1 Tim. 6:1)
    i. When we subvert the word of God by thinking our way, our thinking, our feelings, are right and God is wrong; we give place for the enemies of God to blaspheme.
    ii. It is the same thing people say of those under them that they cannot control but they are supposed to (kids, workers, students, etc.. out of line)
        1. "Get your house/class/employees in order"
        2. "He can't even handle his own…"
            a. This is the enemies accusations of us when we don't submit to God's word

b. Today, let God be true and every man a liar. The Bible gives us CLEAR, NT passages on how we ought to live, specifically as young men/women. Don't listen to any other voices telling you anything outside of what God's word says on this. Submit and obey today and God will be glorified and not blasphemed.

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

YOUNG MEN

Titus 2:6-8- <u>Young men</u> likewise exhort to be sober minded. In all things shewing thyself a pattern of good works: in doctrine shewing uncorruptness, gravity, sincerity, Sound speech, that cannot be condemned; that he that is of the contrary part may be ashamed, having no evil thing to say of you.

1 John 2:13-14- I write unto you, fathers, because ye have known him that is from the beginning. I write unto you, **<u>young men</u>**, because ye have overcome the wicked one. I write unto you, little children, because ye have known the Father. I have written unto you, fathers, because ye have known him that is from the beginning. I have written unto you, **<u>young men</u>**, because ye are strong, and the word of God abideth in you, and ye have overcome the wicked one.

1. **Sober minded**- Thinking clearly; not "under the _____ " of the world, flesh, devil; but the word of God
    a. Be open to the word of God today. Be under its influence and NOT under the influence of anything or anyone else. If you can't be "sober" on this, then you won't get the rest.
    b. Especially for young men, God emphasizes this point in his word
2. **In all things shewing thyself a pattern of good works:-** A life that <u>consistently</u> shows a pattern of obedience and service to God
    a. Do you have this consistent pattern of good works? Are you someone that can be counted on, or are you showing signs of immaturity and always in a pattern of extreme highs and lows?
        i. Where does this pattern of good works come from?- 2 Tim. 3:16-17
        ii. What does this pattern of good works look like?- Neh.2:18; Titus 2:14
3. **In doctrine shewing…**
    a. **Uncorruptness/Gravity-** You need to be solid in your _____ and bible understanding, making sure you are not easily corrupted- 2 Cor. 2:17; 2 Tim. 1:13; Titus 2:1; 1:9
        i. You are at the place in life as a young man where God says you should be solid doctrinally
        ii. You should be able to not only stand in sound doctrine, but you should be able to defend the faith, defend the word of God, and convince others of the truth
        iii. We see this same idea in 1 Jn. 2:14- "the word of God abideth in you"
    b. **Sincerity-** To be _____ up with knowledge does you no good, charity edifieth. Are you sincere in your doctrine?- 2 Cor. 1:12; Philippians 1:9-10; Josh. 24:14 (1st mention)
        i. God says that young men are expected to be at this place in their walk. Understanding it is not about just your knowledge, but charity
        ii. People don't care about how much you know, until they know how much you care.
    c. **Sound speech that cannot be condemned-** Ultimately good doctrine should effect the way that you _____. When it is understood correctly and paired with sincerity, your speech will be sound and unable to be condemned- Eph. 4:19; 1 Cor. 15:33
4. **Ye are strong, and the word of God abideth in you, and ye have overcome the wicked one. -** God says that young men are expected to be in the place where they have overcome the devil BECAUSE they are strong/the word of God abideth in them- Matt. 13:19; Eph. 6:10-11; James 4:7
    a. The first mention of "wicked one" is in Matthew 13:19- From this we learn that one of the primary ways you can overcome the devil is by receiving and responding to the word of God whenever it is preached
    b. Think about _____ - What made David great, the KEY to his life, was that from the very time he was a young man, until he was an old king, with power, wisdom, money, etc.. HE LOVED THE WORD OF GOD and IT ABODE IN HIM- Psalm 119:11, 97, 104, 128, 163, 159, 167, etc

i. If you want to have victories like this, you must make sure you are strong in the Word of God!! To overcome the "wicked one"

c. Have you seen victory in your life over the devil? Is it consistent?

i. The answer to this is directly connected to your relationship to the word of God. Are you spending the time studying, loving, obeying it?

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

Week 1

Introduction

During this study we will examine 27 character qualities of a man or woman of God. It is important for us to understand that even though these character qualities are found in the texts dealing with the qualifications for a Pastor and Deacon, they are also the standard for every believer (both men and women).

- Acts 6:3; Acts 14:23; Titus 1:5

What are the character qualities?

- A multitude of evident personal character qualities - 1 Timothy 3:1-13; Titus 1:5-9
- The qualities are as follows:

1. Blameless
2. The husband of one wife
3. Vigilant
4. Sober
5. Grave
6. Of good behavior
7. Given to hospitality
8. Apt to teach
9. Not given to wine
10. Not doubletongued
11. No striker
12. Not greedy of filthy lucre
13. Patient
14. Not a brawler
15. Not slanderers
16. Not covetous
17. Ruleth well his own house
18. Not a novice
19. A good report to them which are without
20. Faithful in all things
21. Not self-willed
22. Not soon angry
23. A lover of good men
24. Just
25. Holy
26. Temperate
27. Holding fast the faithful word

**DURING THIS CLASS WE WILL BE MOVING THROUGH A LOT IN A SHORT TIME, THE KEY TO HELPING WITH THIS AND FOR YOU TO WALK AWAY WITH SOMETHING EACH WEEK IS THIS: MARK DOWN WITH A STAR/NOTES, 3 THINGS ON THE NOTES EACH WEEK THAT STAND OUT TO YOU THAT YOU NEED TO WORK ON. NO MORE THAN THIS, AND NO LESS!

#1 - Blameless

1 Timothy 3:2, 10 - 2 A bishop then must be **blameless**, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach; …10 And let these also first be proved; then let them use the office of a deacon, being found **blameless**.

Titus 1:6-7 - 6 If any be **blameless**, the husband of one wife, having faithful children not accused of riot or unruly. 7 For a bishop must be **blameless**, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre.

Definition of "Blameless":	*"free from blame or the just imputation of fault, **NOT** sinless or un-accused"*

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

1st Mention:	Genesis 44:10 - "And he said, Now also let it be according unto your words: he with whom it is found shall be my servant; and ye shall be blameless."

Having a blameless character means that others are not able to justly accuse you of being wrong or doing wrong. When accusations are thrown, they will not stick. Since no one is perfect, we will all likely violate this character quality, along with the others we will be studying. When this happens in our life and we are aware of it, we need to accept personal responsibility, confess our sin, deal with the consequences, and move forward with Christ!

Blameless is the most important character quality…

- It is the first quality listed in 1 Timothy 3:2, and it is mentioned twice in Titus 1:6-7
- It is the standard for all believers - Phil. 2:13-15; 1 Thess. 5:23; 2 Pt. 3:14; 1 Jn. 3:3
- It is the foundation for all the other character qualities and it is part of Gods great plan for your life– Eph. 1:4
- Your behavior can cause your MINISTRY to be blamed; therefore we must remain blameless- 2 Cor. 6:3

As followers of the Jesus Christ, we ought to be blameless before the Lord, other believers, and the world…

- 1 Cor. 10:31-32; 11:1; 2 Cor. 1:12; 6:3; Phil. 1:10; 3:17; 1 Tim. 5:14; 6:1; Tts. 2:5; 2 Sam. 12:14; 1 Pt. 2:21-23
  - When you follow the Lord, you can and will be blamed for many things, especially as a leader. What you need to do is make sure that it is not able to stick because you are blameless. Sometimes this means simply making a wrong doing, right; or it can mean to simply stay out of situations where you can be blamed.
  - We all WILL make mistakes, misspeak, and let others down; they key is humility to make it right always so that you are blameless. This is a non-negotiable in ministry. If you cannot do this then you will not be fruitful in your ministry.

#2 - The husband of one wife

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, **the husband of one wife**, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach;

Titus 1:6 - If any be blameless, **the husband of one wife**, having faithful children not accused of riot or unruly.

The husband of one wife = "Complete and total devotion to one mate; a one-woman man"

(Since nobody in here is married yet, apply these to your spiritual husband, Jesus Christ)

- ✓ Faithful with eyes - Job 31:1
- ✓ Faithful with mind - 2 Cor. 11:2-3
- ✓ Faithful with heart - Dan. 1:8; Matt. 15:18-19

Single people need to develop this area properly

- Some things are reserved for marriage only - Heb. 13:4; Gen. 1:27-28; 2:21, 24
- Singleness is a high calling - 1 Cor. 7:17-24; Phil 4:11; Heb. 13:5
- The advantages of singleness - 1 Cor. 7:32-45; Matt. 13:22
- Be pure - 1 Cor. 6:15-20; Rom. 6:12-13; 1 Pt. 2:11; Eph. 5:3

- Be someone who is FAITHFUL: to God now, to your spouse later. This can even start now with your dating/engagement time of life.
- Someone who is a "flirt" is not a good person to pursue. They are already showing signs of not being a "one woman kind of man" or a "one man kind of woman".

#3 - Vigilant

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, **vigilant**, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach;

Vigilant = "to watch; to keep watch; stay awake; alert and watchful especially to danger; to be ready; surveillance; prepared; focused (*The guard was on an all-night vigil*)"

- ✓ Watchful is a good synonym

  Genesis 2:15 - "And the LORD God took the man, and put him into the garden of Eden to dress it and *to keep it*."

Watchful for yourself

- ✓ Watch and pray concerning areas of fleshly temptation/personal weakness - Matt. 26:38-41; 1 Cor. 10:12-13

Watchful for those whom God has given you

- ✓ Watch to feed - Acts 20:28; 1 Pt. 5:2-3
- ✓ Watch for wolves from without - Acts 20:29; 2 Pt. 2:1
- ✓ Watch for wolves from within - Acts 20:30-31; Ezek. 34:1-4
- ✓ Watch in prayer for all the saints - Eph. 6:18; 1:15-16
- ✓ Watch and pray for open doors - Col. 4:2-4; Eph. 6:19
- ✓ Watch for the tendency to be pulled away from preaching of the word - 2 Tim. 4:1-5; Jer. 5:31; Lk. 6:26; 2 Pt. 2:1-3
  - Is your life in a place that you are able to help others?
  - Who have you helped in this ministry? How?
  - How is your prayer life for this ministry?

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

Week 2

#4 - Sober

1 Timothy 3:2, 11 - 2 A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, **sober**, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach; …11 Even so must their wives be grave, not slanderers, **sober**, faithful in all things.

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, **sober**, just, holy, temperate;

Sober = "to be sensible; to have control of your mind, emotions, senses and impulses in all circumstances"

- This is especially true of young people (young men are warned of this as we will see later). You have a zeal and fire in you that helps BUT can hinder you if you are not careful

- Sober and vigilant (watchful) are closely related - 1 Tim. 3:2
  - ✓ 1 Pt. 1:13 - "…gird up the loins of your mind, be sober…"
  - ✓ Phil. 4:5 - "Let your moderation be known to all men…"
  - ✓ 1 Cor. 9:25 - "…temperate in all things…"
- Important questions to ask yourself…
  1. What are the things that take control of my **mind**?- Titus 2:6
  2. What are the things that take control of my **emotions**?- Daniel 1:8; Ephesians 5:26
     - These verses show us that the world is trying to bring you "under the influence", maybe using things like "influencers" and social media. To think, believe, and act differently than you know to when you are "sober"
     - It is great to have zeal, but if you are not sober minded and you are brought under the influence of something else then you will make unwise choices that have lasting effects, BUT YOU WONT KNOW IT IN THE MOMENT
     - Interestingly enough, water is what is used to "sober" people up, and we see in Ephesians 5:26 that this water for us, is the word of God

#5 - Grave

1 Timothy 3:4, 8, 11 - 4 One that ruleth well his own house, having his children in subjection with all **gravity**; …8 Likewise must the deacons be **grave**, not doubletongued, not given to much wine, not greedy of filthy lucre; …11 Even so must their wives be **grave**, not slanderers, sober, faithful in all things.

Grave = "Something momentous, weighty, influential, of great importance; to be serious, solemn, sober"

- ✓ It means to take things that are serious seriously
  - There is a time for joking and fun, BUT there are times and things that require full attention and all seriousness.
- ✓ Do you take seriously:
  - Your sin?- Galatians 6:7-8
  - The salvation of those around you?- Rev. 20:15
  - The growth of this ministry?
  - The word of God?- John 1:1

- Personal holiness?- 1 Thess. 4:3-4
- Prayer?- Luke 22:44
- Etc..

#6 - Of good behaviour

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, **of good behaviour**, given to hospitality, apt to teach;

Of good behaviour = "Orderly; well-arranged"- 1 Sam. 18:14

*9/20 mentions of "behave" in the Bible are talking about how David "behaved" himself

Good behaviour has to do with specific areas:

- ✓ Orderly in our daily life - 1 Thess. 2:10; 2 Cor. 4:2
- ✓ Orderly in our work ethic - 2 Thess. 3:6-11; 1 Pt. 5:2-3

It is becoming of the gospel for us to be of good behaviour:

Note: We are His ambassadors (ambassadors of good will) - 2 Cor. 5:20

#7 - Given to hospitality

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, **given to hospitality**, apt to teach;

Titus 1:8 - But **a lover of hospitality**, a lover of good men, sober, just, holy, temperate;

Given to hospitality = "Giving; Friendly; Being sensitive to the needs of others; Developed from the word hospital…to care for; A friendly treatment of guests and strangers."

Hospitable toward:

- Believers
  - Gal. 6:10 - "…especially unto them who are of the household of faith."
  - 1 Jn. 3:17 - "But whoso hath this world's good, and seeth his brother hath need…"
- Non-Believers
  - Hospitality tested:
    - ✓ Heb. 13:2 - "Be not forgetful to entertain strangers…" (Entertain strangers = Hospitality!)
  - Strangers typified:
    - ✓ Lev. 19:34 - "…for ye were strangers in the land of Egypt:"

      * Loving strangers is the heart of God - Deut. 10:17-19; Lev. 19:34

Note: How we respond to the lost is a great indicator of our love for God!

Hospitality is the willingness to let God use whatever he has given you to help others…

- ✓ What are ways in which you can exercise hospitality to believers?
- ✓ What are ways in which you can exercise hospitality to non-believers?

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

#8 - Apt to teach

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, **apt to teach**;

Titus 1:9 - Holding fast the faithful word as he hath been taught, that he may be able by sound doctrine both to **exhort and to convince the gainsayers**.

This is a learned character quality for every child of God to develop (Some are gifted to teach, this goes beyond one's ability to learn - Eph. 4:8, 11)

The first mention:

- Exodus 4:10-12 - **Availability**, not ability, is the key
  - Are you available to open your mouth and "teach" the Bible to those who you interact with? Are you willing?

This also means we need to be investing in " learning" the word, so that we can be ready to "teach" it

You can only teach what you have been taught - 2 Tim. 2:2; 2 Tim. 2:15; 1 Tim. 4:16

- ✓ What kind of learner am I?
- ✓ How well do I pay attention?
- ✓ How well do I listen to others?
- ✓ How is my Bible study time?
- ✓ Do I learn from circumstances of life easily?
- ✓ Do I seek out opportunities to learn from/follow others who I know can help me learn even more?

- You are at a time in life where you can/should be building a large foundation of your learning the Bible. You have the time, resources, lower level of responsibility, and God tells us that it should be one of the focuses of your age (1 Jn. 2:14)

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

Week 3

#9 - Not given to wine

1 Timothy 3:3, 8 - 3 **Not given to wine**, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous; … 8 Likewise must the deacons be grave, not doubletongued, **not given to much wine**, not greedy of filthy lucre;

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, **not given to wine**, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;

The word of God condemns drunkenness:

- ✓ Eph. 5:18 - "And be not drunk with wine…"
- ✓ 1 Pt. 4:2-3 - "…the time past of our life…when we walked in…excess of wine…"
- ✓ Prov. 20:1 - "Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging: and whoever is deceived thereby is not wise."
- ✓ Prov. 23:29-35 - "…it biteth like a serpent…"

The wise man or woman avoids it:

- ✓ Lev. 10:9 - No alcohol permitted while serving in the capacity of a priest
- ✓ Prov. 31:4 - Kings and priests were to avoid strong drink - 1 Pt. 2:5, 9; Rev. 1:6; 5:10

The bible very carefully and specifically defines our attitude toward alcohol:

- ✓ Allowances were only for medicinal purposes - 1 Tim. 5:23
- ✓ Interpreting our culture:
  - → The #1 killer of teenagers is alcohol related auto accidents
  - → The #1 factor in domestic violence is alcohol
  - → A major component of immorality is intoxication

Note: You can justify anything if you really want to. The Bible does NOT make provisions for us to drink socially. Total abstinence is the best policy regarding alcohol consumption. However, if you really want to violate God's word, God will let you fool yourself - Ezek. 14:1-4, 9; Matt. 13; Jer. 23.

The Bible says that nothing should control our lives but the Holy Spirit… and we can be drunk on many things

- ✓ 1 Co. 6:12; 1 Thess. 5:5-8; Ephesians 5:18

#10 - Not doubletongued

1 Timothy 3:8 - Likewise must the deacons be grave, **not doubletongued**, not given to much wine, not greedy of filthy lucre;

Doubletongued = "double in speech; saying one thing with one and another thing with another; a type of lying"

- ✓ This is the only time this word in used in the Bible
- ✓ See James 1:8; 3:3-12(verse 10 especially)
  - o Our tongue should not be a place where we bless God and yet curse others
  - o This kind of speaking will kill a ministry. Gossip and ill speaking will kill a ministry, friendships, and your personal walk with the Lord. (Jeremiah 9:3,5,,8-9)

- God HATES this kind of behavior (Prov. 6:16-19)

This can be best understood by just reading the scripture…

- ✓ Watch out for flatterers - Ps. 12:1-3; 5:9
- ✓ Watch out for liars - Ps. 50:19; 52:2; Rom. 3:13; Eph. 4:25; James 5:12 (let your yea be yea and your nay be nay)
- ✓ What your mouth should be: a well of life, ministering to others- Prov. 10:11; Eph. 4:29
- ✓ The Bottom Line- A mature Christian who is to lead God's people, cannot and will not participate in this kind of behavior. It will **kill** your ministry and any chance of growth you have in it.

#11 - No striker

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, **no striker**, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous;

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, **no striker**, not given to filthy lucre;

No striker = "**Uncontrolled** anger to the point of physical violence"

- ✓ A Striker is someone who is ready to fight

There are striking biblical examples:

- ✓ Genesis 4:8- And Cain talked with Abel his brother: and it came to pass, when they were in the field, that Cain rose up against Abel his brother, and slew him.
  - We can fight or strike our brethren out of jealousy/envy to tear them down
- ✓ Exodus 2:11-12- And it came to pass in those days, when Moses was grown, that he went out unto his brethren, and looked on their burdens: and he spied an Egyptian smiting an Hebrew, one of his brethren. And he looked this way and that way, and when he saw that *there was* no man, he slew the Egyptian, and hid him in the sand.
- ✓ John 18:10-11- Then Simon Peter having a sword drew it, and smote the high priest's servant, and cut off his right ear. The servant's name was Malchus.
  - We can fight/strike others for "just causes". We should not find ourselves in a constant state of fighting and turmoil, it may show we have a "striker" nature.
- ✓ Don't always be so quick to "vindicate yourself" and make yourself have to be "right" in all situations. Seek peace first. Oftentimes this means bearing the **burdens** of others!- Rom. 15:1-3; Luke 6:29
  - It is our "American" posture, but it was NOT the posture of Christ to always "be made right" and make sure they were treated justly and that they were vindicated. Not being a striker means to seek peace and bearing burdens.

Violent abuse can also be verbal

- ✓ A striker usually begins with **verbally** abusing others
- ✓ James 3:1-10 - There is more than one way to hurt someone
- ✓ Proverbs 10:19; 17:27-28 - A man or woman of God should be known for their good words as well as for their good works
  - Don't be QUICK to fight. With your words or your actions. Seek peace (Romans 12:18) when at all possible.

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

#12 - Not greedy of filthy lucre

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, **not greedy of filthy lucre**; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous;

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, **not given to filthy lucre**;

Filthy lucre = "Money received through improper methods or motives"

→ A.K.A. - "Dirty Money"

Improper methods:

- Usury (interest): exploiting the crisis of others - Prov. 28:8; Lev. 25:35-37
- Get rich quick schemes - gambling, lottery, high risk investments, etc. - Prov. 13:11

  *Vanity = Empty; with no value - Jer. 17:11; Prov. 28:8, 20, 22
- Bribes and deceit: Deut. 16:19; Prov. 17:23; 1 Sam. 8:1-3

Improper motives:

- Greed – Matthew 6:24
- Desire for power – Matt. 23:12
- Covetousness/Security through materialism – Luke 12:15-21

Money problems are generally not an issue of amount but of attitude

The proper attitude is one of contentment - 1 Tim. 6:6-8; Prov. 30:8-9; Heb. 13:5

✓ A man must be proven in this area before becoming a pastor - 1 Pt. 5:2

#13 - Patient

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but **patient**, not a brawler, not covetous;

Patient = "the ability to bear adversity without complaint"

Patience is a developed character quality.

- It is often associated with being developed in times of temptations and trials- James 1:2-4

→ Patience is learned, but it does not always have to be learned the hard way!

Patience is a requirement for those who minister God's word and lead others

- It is a key quality for God's leaders in ministry -2 Corinthians 6:4-10
  - While we endure these trials and persecutions, God is teaching us patience. It is a quality you can only learn really through time and experience
- Ministry is oftentimes loveless, burdensome, and has little "reward" in it for the minister from those they minister to. Therefore patience in pressing forward is needed- 2 Cor. 12:15
  - Patience in serving, giving, ministering, loving, taking criticism, taking hatred, taking evil speaking, etc.. is needed
- Patience truly is learning to trust God and his word in times of troubles and persecutions. Abraham was a great example- Gen. 12:1-3; 13:15; 15:1-6; 16:1-3; 17:15-19; 21:1-2; Heb 11:8-10,17
  - When God's promises and his "word" start to not make sense because of troubles around us, when we learn to trust his word anyway and wait on him, we are learning patience.

#14 - Not a brawler

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, **not a brawler**, not covetous;

Brawler = "one who constantly seeks a confrontation; one who enjoys a fight; macho-man; armed for combat"

Some causes of brawling:

✓ Pride - Prov. 13:10

- Do you find yourself in constant contention, drama, or surrounded by issues? You are called to not be a brawler. Pride comes with contention. This is the opposite of the "burden bearing" leader

✓ Proud Debating - 2 Tim. 2:23; Titus 3:9

- Even when dealing with other believers or the lost about things, don't find yourself in constant struggles and "debates". It is a sign of immaturity
- There is nothing wrong with helping others and teaching them (Adam, London) but if you find yourself in contention, pride is somewhere.

Note: Satan started the brawl…"I will be like the most high." - Isaiah 14:13-14

→ Some people just seem to consistently find themselves in conflict

Some questions to ask yourself

- ✓ Do I have a team-mentality, or am I totally independent? - Eph. 4:1-3
- ✓ Do I display a servant's **heart** or self-centeredness? - Phil. 2:1-5
- ✓ Do I seek areas of agreement or disagreement? – Rom. 12:18
- ✓ Do I look for people's strengths or their weaknesses?- Rom. 15:1-2
- ✓ Would my authorities (employer, husband, etc.) say I was submissive in heart? - 2 Pt. 2:10; Jude 8

#15 - Not slanderers

1 Timothy 3:11 - Even so must their wives be grave, **not slanderers**, sober, faithful in all things.

Slanderer = "one that falsely accuses another; acting the part of the devil"

- ✓ Satan is known as the "accuser of our brethren" - Rev. 12:9-10; 2 Tim. 3:3
- ✓ They are false accusations against "brethren" (i.e. soundly saved Christians) because Jesus Christ took our iniquity upon Himself and we received His spotless righteousness in return- Is. 53:4-6; 2 Cor. 5:19-21
  - → We are to follow the biblical procedure to restore our brothers/sisters who are overtaken in a fault; not doing so and simply slandering our brothers/sisters will KILL our ministry (Gal. 6:1-2; 2 Sam. 12:1-15; Psalm 51; Matt. 18:15-17)

What this does not mean…

It is not slander to warn others of **false** teachers and heretics. It is not godly to remain silent when false prophets are leading others "off the cliff" of sound doctrine. We still apply Galatians 6:1-2 first, but after that it's time to contend for the faith…loudly if necessary! Eternity is at stake for billions of people! - Titus 1:9-11

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

Week 5

#16 - Not covetous

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, not a brawler, **not covetous**;

Covetousness is defined as idolatry in Colossians 3:5 and Ephesians 5:3-7 - Eager to have more…

- Covetousness declares that God is not enough - Ps. 119:57; 73:25-26

Covetousness is the root cause of much sin

- It is the root of all evil - 1 Tim. 6:10
- It is at the heart of false teaching - 1 Tim. 6:10; 2 Pt. 2:1-3
- It is worthy of separation - 1 Cor. 5:11

Covetousness can become a lifestyle, if it is not controlled

- In relation to material things – Luke 12:15-21
    - The problem with covetousness is that it goes directly against relying upon God, it is directly against the life of FAITH (God is everything, trusting him in everything)
    - God emphasized the sabbath with Israel so much because it was an issue of FAITH and GOD over MONEY and COVETEOUSNESS

Always Remember…

- ✓ A godly man or woman should hate covetousness! - Ex. 18:21 (first mention)
- ✓ The word of God can replace covetousness - Ps. 119:36
    - Think of the KEY of David, THE LOVE OF THE WORD OF GOD; verses the ROOT OF all evil, the LOVE OF MONEY (ye cannot serve God and mammon. You will love one master and hate the other)

#17 - Ruleth well his own house

1 Timothy 3:4-5 - 4 One that **ruleth well his own house**, having his children in subjection with all gravity; 5 (For if a man know not how to **rule his own house**, how shall he take care of the church of God?)

Titus 1:6 - If any be blameless, the husband of one wife, **having faithful children not accused of riot or unruly**.

Ruleth well his own house = "One that rules (or leads) his home in a godly, upright manner, fitting of a true follower of Jesus Christ"

→ Defining this quality is easy: *it means what it says, and says what it means…*

This qualification is a noticeable test for leadership:

-How a man rules his home will be how he rules the church - 1 Tim. 3:5

The principle is clear:

- ✓ My family is the mirror God uses to expose my areas of weakness

How this work in your life today as a youth:

- ✓ Your disciples are a reflection of you (your "spiritual child")- 1 Tim. 1:2; 2 Tim. 2:1
  - o If you have none or you have never led anyone to the Lord, then that is a reflection of you (not an exact but a measurement)
- ✓ Your ministry is a reflection of you
  - o What are you doing for the Lord?
  - o What place do you have in this ministry?
  - o What have you contributed?
  - o Do you have a "ministry" within this "ministry"?
- ✓ Your "fruit" is a reflection of you
  - o The fruit of your life speaks of who you are
  - o What fruit do you have?
  - o How well do you rule what God has entrusted to you (whatever it is)?

#18 - Not a novice

1 Timothy 3:6 - **Not a novice**, lest being lifted up with pride he fall into the condemnation of the devil.

Novice - "Someone in a position of leadership before they are qualified… not experienced"

- → The term refers specifically to a new believer, but carries with it the idea of someone who has not been trained, tested, and proven
- → It is possible to be saved for a long time and still be a novice - 1 Cor. 3:1; Heb. 5:12-13.
- → The issue is one of maturity rather than time

A novice has a special danger of pride. Authority and power can, and usually does, corrupt. Therefore, it is vital that they be tested and proven.

- ✓ Children's ministry - No glory, just responsibility…How does he serve?
- ✓ Adult ministry - Is he diligent? Does he take initiative? Do godly people follow him?
- ✓ Discipleship - How seriously does he approach his commitment to others?
- ✓ General volunteer work - Does he have a submissive heart attitude?

A novice cannot develop these character qualities overnight or by going to school - They must be lived daily…

- ✓ Abraham was 25 years in preparing to be a father
- ✓ Moses was 40 years in preparing to be a deliverer
- ✓ Paul was at least 15 years preparing for his first missionary journey

Note: It is the responsibility of leadership to guard the body of Christ from a novice. Proper testing and training must be part of any local New Testament church structure

#19 - A good report to them which are without

1 Timothy 3:7 - Moreover he must have **a good report of them which are without**; lest he fall into reproach and the snare of the devil.

A good report to them which are without - "Having a good testimony in the **lost** world"

There is no other option…It does matter what the world thinks of us:

→ That we might be able to win them - 1 Cor. 9:19-22; 10:31-33

→ To keep criticism of Christianity at a minimum - 2 Cor. 6:3; 1 Pt. 2:12, 15

→ Note: Remember what the apostle Paul wrote in Philippians 2:14-16…

Test yourself:

- ✓ What is my testimony in the lost world?
- ✓ Is there truth in the lost world's criticism of me?
- ✓ Is it my beliefs or my attitude that people reject?
- ✓ Would my financial report allow me to witness to an employee at my bank?
- ✓ If someone referenced you in a conversation, would that person's ability to be a witness be helped or hindered?

Caution: We are at odds with the lost world because of the word of God and the testimony of Jesus. We will be criticized even when we have not done anything wrong. Give other believers the benefit of the doubt when hearing criticisms concerning them. Keep this in mind when attacks focus on our personalities and characters. Remember, we will suffer for this testimony, so do not expect to get an award from the lost world for witnessing to them.

A great example:

- Timothy- Acts 16:1-3

#20 - Faithful in all things

1 Timothy 3:11 - Even so must their wives be grave, not slanderers, sober, **faithful in all things**.

Faithful in all things - "faithful in everything; worthy of trust in all things"

- ✓ This is also specifically addressed to wives of deacons. Men (or in this case deacons) obviously should also be faithful in all things. In fact, the husbands should be spiritually teaching and leading their wives in this area- 1 Cor. 14:34-35; 1 Tim. 2:11-14; Eph. 5:22-24

Faithful can be broken down as someone who is "full of faith"; is this descriptive of your life?

- ✓ Hebrews 11- Do you trust God/his word even when the world tells you it is crazy?
- ✓ Are you someone that can be counted on? By God and other people?- Luke 16:10

#21 - Not self-willed

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; **not selfwilled**, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;

Self-Willed = "Not yielding to the wishes of others; stubborn; obstinate; willful adherence to one's own desires or ideas; controlled by one's own will; someone full of self (pride); one who only wants things done their way"

Note: This is especially prevalent in false teachers - 2 Pt. 2:10; Jude 8

→ Therefore, someone who is not self-willed wants things done God's way…

When we are not self-willed we will tend to give God the glory rather than ourselves:

- He should have the pre-eminence - Col. 1:18; 3 Jn. 9
- HIS will, not OUR will, should be our focus- Mt. 26:39, 42
    - This is all about the will of God, seeking God and his kingdom, his glory first. NOT our plans, our will, our thoughts.
    - We can have and express our thoughts to God, but we must be willing to submit, and not be selfwilled.

Personal evaluation:

- ✓ Would the people in my home, office, or sphere of influence say that I am self-willed?
- ✓ Does everything usually end up going my way?
- ✓ Do people seem to adjust to or work around my personality?
- ✓ Am I a quitter (do I give up easily)?
- ✓ Am I a good follower?

WEEK 6

#22 - Not soon angry

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, **not soon angry**, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;

Not soon angry = "A person who is seldom angry; a person who is not angered easily; a person who, when angry for a just cause, is not angry for long (Jas. 1:19)

Anger is not always sin… proper, biblical anger exists - Mk. 3:5; Ps. 7:11

- Matthew 5:22 - Without a cause… there must be a time when there is a cause
- Ephesians 4:26-27 - Be ye angry and sin not… there must be a sinless anger

Anger is sin when:

- When it is kept in and not dealt with - Eph. 4:26-27
  - ✓ If we do not deal with anger we give the Devil a foot-hold
- When it seeks revenge - Rom. 12:19-21
  - ✓ Taking vengeance is taking the position of God
  - ✓ It means I have been overcome
- When it is for selfish reasons - Gen. 4:1-8; Jonah 4:1; Lk. 15:28
  - ✓ Would it bother me as bad if this was done to someone else?

Note: Jesus' anger was always in regard to the violation of God's righteousness or God's people - Matt. 21:12-13; Mk. 3:1-5

Anger is caused by:

- Pride: When my **rights** have been violated - Jas. 4:1
  - ✓ We cannot consider ourselves spirit controlled when bitterness remains a part of our lives - Jas. 3:13-18
- Insecurity/Envy: A result from feeling threatened in position or relationships - 1 Sam. 18:6-9
  - o Saul Jealous over David and the people reverencing David and his victories
  - ✓ How do I respond to those who question my authority?
  - ✓ Do I become frustrated when my routines are interrupted?
  - ✓ How do I react when my control is lost?
- Foolishness: Anger is evidence of lack of wisdom - Prov. 12:16; 27:3; Eccl. 7:9
- Anger is a secondary emotion: it is always caused by something else: the root of the problem is **something else**

Anger results in:

- Vulnerability: Spiritual sickness…You become easily controlled by the enemy and predictable - Prov. 25:28; 16:32
  - ✓ Open to demonic influence: Eph. 4:26-27
    - o Neither give place to the devil

Anger is to be dealt with biblically:

- ✓ **Yield your rights to God…you are His** - 1 Cor. 6:19-20; **Learn to rest in him** - Ps. 37:7-8; **Use a soft answer** - Prov. 15:1; **Walk in the spirit** - Gal. 5:16-25; **Pass over faults…remember, he passed over our faults** - Prov. 12:16; 19:11; **Listen twice as much as you speak** - Jas. 1:20; 3:2-10; **Saturate your mind with scripture dealing with anger** - Ps. 119:9-11

#23 - A lover of good men

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, **a lover of good men**, sober, just, holy, temperate;

A Good Man = "An upright and **perfect** man" (Prov. 2:20-21)

→ Although we are all sinners and are careful not to define ourselves as good, the Bible clearly tells us to be lovers of good men. This obviously means there must be good, godly men. (Not good in and of ourselves…)

Additional biblical credentials of a good man:

- ✓ Saved men - Matthew 13:38
- ✓ Fruit-bearing men - Matthew 13:23; 7:15-20
- ✓ Stable men - Psalm 37:23-24
- ✓ Benevolent and honest men - Psalm 112:5
  - o Who you are surrounded by WILL EFFECT YOU. It is a reflection of you. It says a lot about you. Be careful of who you are surrounded by. Make sure they are good men/women according to the BIBLE!

Some practical things that identify good men:

- ✓ A good man lives by faith - Romans 4, Hebrews 11
- ✓ A good man is hated by evil and wicked men - Prov. 29:27
- ✓ A good man avoids evil - Prov. 16:17
- ✓ A good man desires to be sharpened by his friends - Prov. 27:17
  - → *A good man is not intimidated, but rather challenged, by the goodness of others*
- ✓ A good man will find encouragement in his friend's counsel - Prov. 27:9
  - → *Our intimate friendships reveal much about our character*

WEEK 7

#24 - Just

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, **just**, holy, temperate;

Just - "Right or righteous; Good **judgment**"

→ The word "just" carries the sense of having wisdom and the ability to judge matters properly according to the word of God; to discern between right and wrong and have the strength of character to make right decisions even it is difficult

The practical ways of becoming just are given in the word of God:

- ✓ It is the result of denying your own agenda in order to accomplish His - John 5:30
- ✓ When your judgments are not based on circumstances - John 7:24
- ✓ When you live by faith in God's truth not your perspective - Romans 1:17
- ✓ When you fear God - Acts 10:22, 34-35
- ✓ When you fall (because you will, nobody's perfect), you get back up – Prov. 24:16, Ecclesiastes 7:20
- ✓ God's word is just - Romans 7:12
    - Someone who ***JUST*** does the right thing. Makes the right judgement call. This comes from a deep wisdom and relationship with the word of God alone!

Some biblical examples of just men:

- Joseph: Matthew 1:19 -
- John the Baptist: Mark 6:20-
- Solomon: 1 Kings 3:16-28 –

#25 - Holy

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, just, **holy**, temperate;

Holy = "Not a state of sinless perfection, but a daily lifestyle **set apart** unto God and from the world (Lev. 20:24-26; Rom. 12:1-2)"

- ✓ We are called to be holy (set apart) - 2 Cor. 6:14-18; Rom. 1:7
- ✓ We are to be holy because we are to be like Him - 1 Pt. 1:15-16
    - Some people over emphasize holiness (holiness movement, people who say salvation can be lost), but WE LAODICEANS underemphasize it (white raiment to be clothed)
        - Sexual sin; disgusting music, movies, tv shows, language, social media, conversations, jokes, dress (immodesty), etc… We are the church of "mixing the world with God"
        - Could anyone tell you were a Christian based on your: Spotify playlist, Netflix recently watched, social media feed, way you dress, the way you talk, the jokes you make? IF NOT, YOU ARE NOT LIVING SET APART

→ Holiness emphasized in the OT

The priests were to wash with water before entering the tabernacle, or they would die (Exo. 30:20-21)

- God takes our holiness very seriously!
- It is one of the things we will be judged on at the judgment seat of Christ (gold=holiness/sanctification to God)
- Of course, today we have the Holy Ghost living inside of us if we are saved and we can enter God's presence at any time because of the blood of Christ, but we still need to separate ourselves from sin and wickedness in our lives.
- What we do, we drag God into!!

How can we live a Holy life?

→ We are made holy by:

The holy blood that cleanses - 1 Pt. 1:18-19

The Holy Spirit that anoints - 2 Cor. 1:21-22; 1Jn. 2:27

The holy word that washes - Eph. 5:26; Jn. 17:17

**Holiness is the LIFE CALLING of a ministry leader! You will always be held to a higher standard! Just like the OT priests.

#26 - Temperate

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, just, holy, **temperate**;

Temperate = "Moderate, not **excessive** in any area, having our actions and emotions under the Spirit's control… self-controlled" (1 Cor. 9:25; Php. 4:5; James 1:8)

Temperance is part of the fruit of the Spirit

- Temperance is the result of a daily walking in obedience to His Spirit - Gal. 5:23
- As such "intemperance" would be proof of being under the influence of the flesh
    - When my desires and emotions get the best of me it is evidence that I am not yielding to the working of God's Spirit in me at that moment - Gal. 5:23

Temperance is also a learned quality of character

- Just like holiness or love, God gives it to us by way of His Spirit at salvation…We have the responsibility to develop it through abiding in His word - 2 Pt. 1:5-8
- Temperance is seen in our willingness to surrender our own desires and preferences for the greater cause of reaching people - 1 Cor. 9:19-27
    - He equates this kind of living to an athlete. Discipline, training, and playing with PURPOSE and a GOAL, not out of control, willy nilly
    - Temperance is about being in control of your impulses, emotions, whims, etc. It relates to many other qualities we have looked at
    - Are you someone who is disciplined? Someone solid who can be counted on? Or are you prisoner to your every emotion, whim, and desire?

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

#27 - Holding fast the faithful word

Titus 1:9 - **Holding fast the faithful word** as he hath been taught, that he may be able by sound doctrine both to exhort and to convince the gainsayers.

Hold fast = "confidently holding the word of God, without wavering, even unto the end"

- 1 Sam. 3:19- As a young man, Samuel held onto every word of God dearly
  - Notice God was with him AND he grew. Why? Because he loved and dearly the word of God!

The man or woman of God must be doctrinally sound

- ✓ Proverbs 4:13- Refusing to let go the word of God (instruction) you've been given
- ✓ 2 Thess. 2:15 - Holding fast to what you have been taught from the word of God
- ✓ 2 Tim. 1:13-14 - Holding fast to the sound words committed to thee…
  - We must realize that someone is trying to take this truth out of our hands – 1 Tim. 4:1-2, 2 Tim. 4:1-4… Therefore we must be prepared to "earnestly contend for the faith" - Titus 1:9-11; Jude 3; 1 Pet. 3:15

A man or woman of God must learn how to use the Bible

- ✓ We must study the Bible so we will not be ashamed - 2 Tim. 2:15
- ✓ We must exercise in the word to become strong in the word - Heb. 5:11-14
  - We cannot stay "babies" in the word; we MUST grow up!
  - We may not know all we think we do; the devil has those who know much more than us, he is preparing and training up his false ministers too.
  - Our over confidence could make a mockery of the faith if we are not ready!
  - I'd watch videos of people we disagreed with and it would scare me to death to not have the answers needed, so I STUDIED! I studied what they believe, critics of what we believe, other faiths, etc. TO BE READY!

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

YOUNG WOMEN

"We all want clear, obvious, direct words from God on what he wants from us TODAY in our lives. For the next two weeks are are in luck. If you want to please God and know EXACTLY what his purpose is for you TODAY, we will be looking at his direct words to young men/women. God has a specific purpose/plan for how your life ought to look RIGHT NOW. If we listen and obey what he says, we can live in the purpose he has called us to"

Titus 2:4-5- That they may teach the young women to be sober, to love their husbands, to love their children, *To be* discreet, chaste, keepers at home, good, obedient to their own husbands, that the word of God be not blasphemed.

1 Timothy 5:14-15- I will therefore that the younger women marry, bear children, guide the house, give none occasion to the adversary to speak reproachfully. For some are already turned aside after Satan.

**NOTICE FIRST- the aged women are told to instruct the young women, NOT TITUS. There is a correct order to things here.

Make sure you are connecting to older women who you see living out the qualities that the Bible gives, not what YOU think a woman should be/do

Today the "young women" we will discuss are definitely right at/around the age of the young women in here today, however, due to culture differences of the time, they are assumed to be married and having kids already. Application can be made for preparing for this time in life, living these qualities with the authorities/opportunities given in your life now, and spiritually with Jesus Christ.

1. **Sober**- Thinking clearly; not "under the **influence**" of the world, flesh, devil; but the word of God
    a. We have looked at this quality many times already so we won't expound too much upon it. However, I believe God put this first to get our attention.
        i. He is saying: "LISTEN TO ME, don't be influenced by the world, or even the modern church, and all the feminist movement around the world; that is not how/what I made you for. It is a lie! Don't be under its influence!"
    b. Be open to the word of God today. Be under its influence and NOT under the influence of anything or anyone else. If you can't be "sober" on this, then you won't get the rest.
2. **Love their husbands and their children (in that order)**
    a. When connected with 1 Tim. 5:14-15, we see the reverence God gives to women who will be married, have kids, and guide/give for their home (live selfless)
        i. This is not the "popular, freeing, powerful, feminist" thing to do today, but God values it still.
    b. The enemy knows the power/influence of the home, that is why a MAJOR attack against the church in the last days is in the home (2 Tim. 3:1-6)
    c. To have a family like this and to love it (sacrifice/charity) is work and it is selfless. God values you not living for yourself, your desires, your dreams, your career, your…..(fill in the blank) BUT for a greater cause.
        i. God set the family order for a reason. To think your way is better or that usurping his order of things is better, is a lack of faith.
        ii. Loving your husband first, ultimately affects your kids the most!
            1. **Many studies have shown that kids who viewed their parents as "being in love" have a much higher rate of success in finance, education, less behavioral issues, etc.**
    d. Your influence on your husband and your kids and how that affects eternity is INCALCULABLE. But, it takes faith. It is not satisfying in the short term (instant gratification).
    e. Read these quotes from/about great missionaries and Christians through the years and what they say about this
3. **Discreet-** The literal sense is, separate, **reserved**, wary; prudent

a. The other 3 uses in the Bible of this word show the word associated with being "behind the scenes" or "unseen" (Gen. 41:33, 39; Mark 12:34)
b. We see this same posture for women talked about elsewhere in the Bible (1 Cor. 14:34-35; 1 Tim. 2:11-12)
    i. The fact that these verses cannot often even be talked about the correct biblical way in churches today is evidence of two things:
        1. The wresting (twisting) and mis-use of these verses for "lording" over women by insecure/ little men
        2. The feminist attitude and posture of many women today seeking to live how the world says they ought to, and not how the word of God commands they should
            a. Neither side would admit to these accusations, and both would give you "scripture" out of context in order to excuse their behavior, but these statements are still absolutely true.
    ii. It is a virtuous quality for a woman to have this posture. It shows humility, faith in God's word, self-control, and sober mindedness. They are influenced by God and nothing else.
        1. The point of these verses is not that women are less, should not ever talk, or are not needed; but rather that WHEN DONE THE PROPER WAY, they have the MOST influence possible doing it God's way, with the countenance and attitude God made them to have!
        2. No man likes a loud, contentious, busy-body woman. You are not made to like that. (Prov. 27:15; 21:9, 19; 9:13; 7:11)
            a. I have heard women pride themselves on being loud, stubborn, abrasive, having a "fighting spirit". This is not what you want to be associated with. Be what God says you should be, not anyone else.

4. **Chaste-** Pure; genuine; uncorrupt
    a. When we see this word used elsewhere in the Bible, it typically deals with **purity**
        i. Purity in sexuality- 2 Cor. 11:2
            1. Don't compromise on your purity sexually. God values it so much that he equates it to our faithfulness to him in our marriage to his son
            2. The world says that exploring your sexuality is freeing and the feminist movement teaches you that it is freeing/liberating; but God says that it is imprisoning/bondage to you (Prov. 5:22; 7:22-27; Rom. 6:16; 2 Pet. 2:19; John 8:34)
        ii. Purity in modesty- 1 Pet. 3:1-5
            1. Dressing modestly is directly linked by God in these verses to your submissive heart, meekness, and quietness.
            2. He is implying that to not be modest is connected to not being quiet, meek, submissive, AND VISE VERSA.
            3. Would anyone know you were a Christian by what you wear ALONE?
            4. Is your dress LOUD? Drawing unnecessary attention?
            5. This is why he connects the two. Wanting/desiring attention, whether in dress, speech, lifestyle, etc.. is not a godly attribute
5. **Keepers at home/Good/Obedient to Husbands**
    a. I linked these three together because they are similar to previous points and they speak to the same thing
    b. They all speak to a **submissive** attitude
        i. **Keepers at home**- Prov 7:11
            1. Notice where the strange woman's feet are; NOT AT HOME.
            2. This point is not just about being married and having kids (although this is a good thing to do) but about not living for yourself

a. The godly woman is not living HER LIFE, FOR HER, HER HAPPINESS, HER JOY, HER CAREER, ETC.. she is living for others (her family, disciples, church body, etc..)
    i. We see this all the time today with social media: me time, I need to find myself, my passion, my interests, my career, etc.. IT IS UNGODLY
b. If you are married/have kids or not, your life ought to be focused on helping and living for those around you/that you are close to (home); NOT YOURSELF

ii. **Good**- "Complete or sufficiently **perfect** in its kind; having the physical qualities best adapted to its design and use" (In the context of this passage and based on the law of first mention)- Gen. 1
    1. Doing what God made you to do, not what you think/desire to do in your flesh

iii. **Obedient to their own husbands**
    1. Submitting to the **authorities** in your life, as God placed them, the proper way (Eph 5:22)
        a. For married woman, to your OWN husbands, NOT all men everywhere
        b. For all: to government, to the ordained authorities in your life (pastor), to your bosses at work, teachers, etc..
        c. How you submit to the authorities in your life is how you submit to God
    2. Being able to submit to the authorities in your life as God has placed them, speaks volumes about your character and virtue as a woman
        a. God can use you in great ways, when you are willing to obey in these areas

6. That the word of God be not blasphemed/ That the name of God and his doctrine be not blasphemed

a. When these qualities are out of line and we choose to live based on how we think, the world dictates, or how we feel; then we give place for the word of God to be blasphemed! (2 Sam. 12:14; Rom. 2:24; 1 Tim. 6:1)
    i. When we subvert the word of God by thinking our way, our thinking, our feelings, are right and God is wrong; we give place for the enemies of God to blaspheme.
    ii. It is the same thing people say of those under them that they cannot control but they are supposed to (kids, workers, students, etc.. out of line)
        1. "Get your house/class/employees in order"
        2. "He can't even handle his own…"
            a. This is the enemies accusations of us when we don't submit to God's word

b. Today, let God be true and every man a liar. The Bible gives us CLEAR, NT passages on how we ought to live, specifically as young men/women. Don't listen to any other voices telling you anything outside of what God's word says on this. Submit and obey today and God will be glorified and not blasphemed.

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

YOUNG MEN

"We all want clear, obvious, direct words from God on what he wants from us TODAY in our lives. For the next two weeks are are in luck. If you want to please God and know EXACTLY what his purpose is for you TODAY, we will be looking at his direct words to young men/women. God has a specific purpose/plan for how your life ought to look RIGHT NOW. If we listen and obey what he says, we can live in the purpose he has called us to"

Titus 2:6-8- Young men likewise exhort to be sober minded. In all things shewing thyself a pattern of good works: in doctrine shewing uncorruptness, gravity, sincerity, Sound speech, that cannot be condemned; that he that is of the contrary part may be ashamed, having no evil thing to say of you.

1 John 2:13-14- I write unto you, fathers, because ye have known him that is from the beginning. I write unto you, **young men**, because ye have overcome the wicked one. I write unto you, little children, because ye have known the Father. I have written unto you, fathers, because ye have known him that is from the beginning. I have written unto you, **young men**, because ye are strong, and the word of God abideth in you, and ye have overcome the wicked one.

1. **Sober minded**- Thinking clearly; not "under the **influence**" of the world, flesh, devil; but the word of God
    a. We have looked at this quality many times already so we won't expound too much upon it. However, I believe God put this first to get our attention.
        i. He is saying: "LISTEN TO ME, don't be influenced by the world, or even the modern church, and all the feminist movement around the world; that is not how/what I made you for. It is a lie! Don't be under its influence!"
    b. Be open to the word of God today. Be under its influence and NOT under the influence of anything or anyone else. If you can't be "sober" on this, then you won't get the rest.
    c. Especially for young men, God emphasizes this point in his word
        i. Think clearly! Don't be out of control, under the influence of anything/anyone else, and submit to the word of God this morning. It should guide you, not your emotions/whims
2. **In all things shewing thyself a pattern of good works:-** A life that consistently shows a pattern of obedience and service to God
    a. Do you have this consistent pattern of good works? Are you someone that can be counted on, or are you showing signs of immaturity and always in a pattern of extreme highs and lows?
        i. Where does this pattern of good works come from?- 2 Tim. 3:16-17
        ii. What does this pattern of good works look like?- Neh.2:18; Titus 2:14
            1. It is associated with a burden for the work/people of God and with zealousness
3. **In doctrine shewing…**
    a. **Uncorruptness/Gravity-** You need to be solid in your **doctrine** and bible understanding, making sure you are not easily corrupted- 2 Cor. 2:17; 2 Tim. 1:13; Titus 2:1; 1:9
        i. You are at the place in life as a young man where God says you should be solid doctrinally
        ii. You should be able to not only stand in sound doctrine, but you should be able to defend the faith, defend the word of God, and convince others of the truth
        iii. We see this same idea in 1 Jn. 2:14- "the word of God abideth in you"
            1. God is assuming that young men are at the place where the word of God abides in them and they are able to stand against false doctrine and handle the word of God effectively
            2. Are you spending the time/study/effort needed to be at this place? Don't be fooled into thinking that you know more than you do, there are those out there who are on the other side who the

devil is using greatly for his cause and they don't stop studying, they commit their lives to it

b. **Sincerity-** To be **puffed** up with knowledge does you no good, charity edifieth. Are you sincere in your doctrine?- 2 Cor. 1:12; Philippians 1:9-10; Josh. 24:14 (1st mention)
   i. Doctrine is not meant for loveless, insincere knowledge to beat others down with, it is supposed to be paired with sincerity and love to effect others
   ii. God says that young men are expected to be at this place in their walk. Understanding it is not about just your knowledge, but charity
   iii. People don't care about how much you know, until they know how much you care.

c. **Sound speech that cannot be condemned-** Ultimately good doctrine should effect the way that you **speak**. When it is understood correctly and paired with sincerity, your speech will be sound and unable to be condemned- Eph. 4:29; 1 Cor. 15:33

4. **Ye are strong, and the word of God abideth in you, and ye have overcome the wicked one. -** God says that young men are expected to be in the place where they have overcome the devil BECAUSE they are strong/the word of God abideth in them- Matt. 13:19; Eph. 6:10-11; James 4:7
   a. The first mention of "wicked one" is in Matthew 13:19- From this we learn that one of the primary ways you can overcome the devil is by receiving and responding to the word of God whenever it is preached
      i. You are not going to overcome the devil by will power, strength, or your own means; the only way it can be done is with God! That is why it is so important that the word of God abides in you first!
      ii. You are only "strong" because the word of God abideth in you, and you can only "overcome the wicked one" because the word of God abideth in you
   b. Think about **David**- What made David great, the KEY to his life, was that from the very time he was a young man, until he was an old king, with power, wisdom, money, etc.. HE LOVED THE WORD OF GOD and IT ABODE IN HIM- Psalm 119:11, 97, 104, 128, 163, 159, 167, etc
      i. Think about David and Goliath; why did David win? Was it his strength? His cleverness? IT WAS HIS FAITH IN GOD/HIS WORD
      ii. If you want to have victories like this, you must make sure you are strong in the Word of God!! To overcome the "wicked one"
   c. Don't be so concerned with not making mistakes, as you are with not obeying the word of God and repenting when God speaks to you
      i. Life is not about "never messing up", read the bible and see if its true.
      ii. It is about who hears and responds to the word of God when it is preached! Who loves it above all else
   d. Have you seen victory in your life over the devil? Is it consistent?
      i. The answer to this is directly connected to your relationship to the word of God. Are you spending the time studying, loving, obeying it?

S09 / TEACHING SERIES

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MY CONTRIBUTION

Teaching and lesson preparation.

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Luke Johnston's selected teaching, writing or development sample; original bylines and citations retained.

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Q and A week 3	*3 pages*
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Q and A week 6	*2 pages*
Q and A week 6 student 2	*2 pages*
Q and A week 6 student part 2	*2 pages*
Q and A week 7	*3 pages*
Q and A week 7 student	*2 pages*
Q and A week 8	*2 pages*
Q and A week 8 student	*2 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

Q & A- EDGE YOUTH WEDNESDAY NIGHT SERIES

1. ***Could Jesus have sinned?***
   How did Jesus face every temptation that we have if not everything was the same (for example scrolling endlessly online because there we're no phones or lust because he didn't have a girlfriend/wife)?
   Key Passage:
   a. Hebrews 4:15 – "For we have not an high priest which cannot be touched with the feeling of our infirmities; but was in all points tempted like as we are, yet without sin."
      i. Jesus COULD have sinned- He was fully God and fully man. He had to be given a genuine choice to understand our temptations, humanity, and to be able to be the spotless lamb of our salvation
         1. This is one of the things that makes our God so much greater than any other God; he became one of us, he understands: pain, sorrow, hurt, exhaustion, work, etc.... he was the God-Man.
      ii. The Devil knew this and wanted to exploit it at Jesus weakest moment in his human form- Matt. 4:1-11
   b. Jesus may have lived at a different time than us, but the Bible is clear about temptations and the **root** of them ALL- 1 John 2:16
      i. **ALL** that is in the world
      ii. The tactics of temptation are technically different in the exact avenues he uses, but the root temptations are the same from the beginning- Gen. 3:6
         1. All three temptations are seen in the very beginning, and they are seen today
2. ***Is there any biblical evidence connecting the flood in Genesis to the scientific theory of Pangaea/The Continental Split?***
   a. This idea comes from Genesis 1:9-10; Genesis 10:25; and 1 Chron. 1:19
   b. Some other evidence to support this idea would be:
      i. Genesis 7:11- The tectonic plates **broken**
         1. Research has revealed that enormous quantities of water are stored deep within the Earth's mantle, primarily within a mineral called **ringwoodite**. This mineral, located approximately 400 miles beneath the surface, can trap water within its crystal structure. Studies suggest that the amount of water contained in ringwoodite could be **three times the volume of all Earth's surface oceans combined**. **Study Reference:** A 2014 study published in *Science* provided seismic evidence supporting the presence of water-rich ringwoodite in the Earth's transition zone.
         2. Some would say that the deep referred to here is the sea of glass, however, it seems clear that these are "fountains" under the ocean that were broken up. These fountains have since been found.
            a. Also the "deep" shows up in the Bible 65x:
               i. It refers to the deep as a prison/hell/maybe the bottomless pit 3x
               ii. It refers to the deep 8x very obscurely (even of these, it is associated with water/seas 6 of those 8 times)
               iii. It refers to the general use of the word deep 33x (a deep pit, a deep well, etc.)

iv. It refers to the oceans/seas specifically on the earth 21x as the deep

3. Fossils- Found to match at coastlines across the ocean
4. Geological- Matching mountain ranges such as the Appalachian and Caledonian Mountains in Scotland and Scandinavia
5. Fit of Continents- The coastlines of continents such as South America and Africa seem to fit together like puzzle pieces

c. Other thoughts
   i. God uses the same "**divided**" language in Deut. 32:7-8
   ii. A practical view of this idea- It would seem to reason that such cataclysmic event as the actual plates of the earth shifting hundreds/thousands of miles would be found in history somewhere. We are not explicitly told this is the Bible and so we cannot be sure of it. And we are not told this from any history, so we don't have that evidence either.
      1. Also, the smallest of shifts of tectonic plates causes massive earthquakes and tsunamis. We don't want to take any "God-factor" out of it, but reasonably, this would have likely killed many or even everyone living
   iii. A more plausible explanation
      1. The GREAT flood and total destruction of the earth during the gap is a very plausible place/time for this to have happened- Genesis 1:1-2; Jeremiah 4:23-27
      2. The Gap- Genesis 1:1-2
         a. We see in Genesis 1:1-2 a clear gap in time (not uncommon, there are gaps in between commas that span thousands of years in the Bible)- Isa. 9:6-7; 61:1-3; Dan. 9:26-27; Zech. 9:9-10; Luke 1:31-32
         b. The presence of **Darkness**- 1 John 1:5; Rev. 21:23
         c. Fall of Lucifer- Ezek. 28; Isa. 14
         d. Replenish- Gen. 1:28; Gen 9:1 (both first usages after a flood)
         e. Created Vs. Made- Gen. 1:1, 27 ---- 1:7, 16, 25, 31---- Gen. 2:3
         f. Heaven/Heavens- If Gen. 1:1-2 was a preliminary statement on the entirety of creation, God would have said in vs. 1 "heavens" not heaven. They became "heavens" as he separated them during creation
         g. God does not create in **vain**- Isa. 45:18
         h. Paul's comparison- 2 Cor. 4:6- Paul compares how the gospel shined into our hearts with Christ to how God introduced light into darkness at creation
         i. Psalm 104:30- A look back at Gen. 1:1-2; the spirit was Renewing the face of the earth
         j. Job 38:4,7- The angels were there at the foundation (very beginning) of the earth; not created on days 1-3 when the earth was already there. They were rejoicing at the earths creation
      3. This was the destruction of the **whole world** and included the heavens; NOT Noah's flood- 2 Pet. 3:5-7
         a. The way that God describes this destruction is different than Noah's flood, the whole world was destroyed, the heavens affected, it was an "old earth" not even the same at all
         b. Also the context was vs. 4 "all things continue as they were from the beginning of the creation". They are referring to the creation, not the time of Noah
      4. During the destruction of the earth when Lucifer fell would be a plausible time that this kind of plate shifting, mountain moving, land dividing could have happened. When God remakes the world, the earth is already there underneath the water, all he does is move the water for the land to appear- Gen. 1:9

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   How did Jesus face every temptation that we have if not everything was the same (for example scrolling endlessly online because there we're no phones or lust because he didn't have a girlfriend/wife)?
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   b. Jesus may have lived at a different time than us, but the Bible is clear about temptations and the _____ of them ALL- 1 John 2:16
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Q & A- EDGE YOUTH WEDNESDAY NIGHT SERIES

1. ***Without Judas' betrayal, Jesus wouldn't have been crucified and then people wouldn't be saved. was Judas always doomed to betray Jesus? Was that always part of Gods plan or did God have a different plan?***
    a. To answer this question, we must first examine who Judas was:
        i. He was called a **devil**- John 6:70- *Jesus answered them, Have not I chosen you twelve, and one of you is a devil?*
        ii. He was indwelt by Satan at one point- Luke 22:3- *Then entered Satan into Judas surnamed Iscariot…* ALSO IN John 13:27- *And after the sop Satan entered into him. Then said Jesus unto him, That thou doest, do quickly.*
        iii. He is the **antichrist**
            1. He was called the son of perdition, the only other one that title is used for is the antichrist- John 17:12; 2 Thess. 2:3
            2. He went "to his own place"- Acts 1:25; Rev. 17:8
        iv. He is very possibly the actual offspring of Satan
            1. In Acts 1:16-20 Peter refers to a passage in Psalms as being about Judas and his betrayal- Psalm 109:8-15
            2. Also, nobody else is called "a devil" but Judas. He was not "possessed" with a devil, but was "a devil"
        v. Prophesies of his betrayal
            1. Psalm 41:9 and John 13:18
            2. Zechariah 11:12-13 and Matthew 26:14-15; 27:3-10
            3. Psalm 109:6-8 and Acts 1:20
    b. The Verdict
        i. God in his omniscience absolutely foreknew that Judas would betray Jesus, but that does not mean that he MADE him
            1. God knows all things and therefore he can prophesy anything he wants; for him to be accused of MAKING people do things, just because he says he knows what will happen, is not reasonable
        ii. Even in the case of Judas: a devil, the antichrist, and possible child of Satan; he had a choice to make; he could have chosen anything he wanted
            1. We see fallen angels seemingly given space to repent in the Bible- Psalm 82
        iii. Judas is as close to an exception to the rule of choice as you can get, but even in his case, I would say that he was still given a genuine choice and he chose to betray Christ
2. ***What is the difference between a biblical view of free will and a Calvinist's view of free will?***
    a. A Calvinists view of free will
        i. **Compatibilism**- You choose freely—but **only** what your heart wants—and God controls what your heart wants- John 6:37,44
            1. Imagine a lion. You put a bowl of lettuce and a steak in front of it. The lion "freely" chooses the steak every time—not because it's forced, but because that's its nature.
            2. It is not just that you will always want to choose evil because of your sinful nature, but that you are only CAPABLE of choosing evil because of your sinful nature. (it is impossible for the lion to not eat the steak)
            3. This is where their idea of Total Depravity Comes in. You are so totally depraved in your sin that God must first save you and then you believe

4. Calvinism says that God chose before the foundation of the world those who he would draw to himself to be saved. Only those who he would draw could be saved and this was already determined before the world began. You can dress it up and make it look Christian, but this leaves no room for evangelism, prayer for the lost, discipleship, etc.. it was ALREADY DETERMINED. To live otherwise is a lie.
5. video

b. A Biblical view of free will
   i. **Libertarian Free Will**- You have the genuine ability to choose between two or more possible options—and **nothing**, not even God, predetermines your choices in such a way that you *must* choose one over the other.
   ii. Biblical support of this idea and against Calvinists view- Deut. 30:19; Josh. 24:15; Isa. 1:18-20; John 3:16; John 1:12; Eph. 1:13; Acts 7:51; 2 Pet. 3:9; Rom. 10:13; Eze. 18:21, 23, 32
   iii. God draws ALL men to himself, not all answer the call- John 12:32; Titus 2:11
      1. **The Master Chess Player Illustration**
         a. Imagine God is a **chess grandmaster** playing against a free-willed human being.
         b. The human player is completely free to make **any move** he wants on the chessboard—good moves, bad moves, smart moves, foolish moves.
         c. God **never forces** him to make a certain move. He lets the man play freely.
         d. **But**, because God is infinitely wise and sees the end from the beginning, **He always responds** to each move in a way that keeps His ultimate victory certain.
         e. No matter what the man does—aggressive move, trick play, or foolish blunder—God already knows how to counter it and still bring the game to His intended outcome. **The freedom of the human player never threatens the outcome** of the game.
         f. **Key Point**: God doesn't need to control every move. He is so much more powerful than that. (That is called rigging the game). He knows the end from the beginning, he knows all things, he can counter any move made to still get to the end he desires.

3. Does God have favorites since the Israelites are "his people"?

   i. This goes into more ideas that relate to Calvinism or the idea of God "randomly selecting" those he would love/prefer vs those he would hate/condemn

b. **Predestination/Election**- Election refers to God's selection of a group or body of people for a purpose—usually to represent Him on earth and to carry His message—not to exclusive salvation. Election in Scripture is often corporate, functional, and missional, not individualistic.
   i. Pre (before) destination (where you are going)- God's plan from the past for his people/children and what he wants them to do on this earth.

c. God elected to use Abraham and his lineage as a representative group to go and bless **all** the earth- Gen. 12:1-3
   1. Abraham could have rejected this offer, he is the example of faith for us today because he believed and obeyed God when he called. Who knows how many were asked before Abraham or would have been asked after him.
   2. God wanted a vessel that would obey him, through which he could reach the world. That is what he predestinates. He elects the group through which this is to be done, NEVER INDIVIDUAL SALVATION
   ii. Israel was called to be:
      1. Holy- Exo. 19:5-6
      2. Representatives to bring the whole world to God- Isa. 42:6; Isa. 55:6-7
   iii. We today are called to be:
      1. Holy- Eph. 1:4-5
      2. Representatives to bring the whole world to God- 1 Pet. 2:9

d. Election is not about exclusivity into God's "special chosen club". It is about God picking a vehicle through which to bring the entire **world** to himself (his ultimate goal/destiny for the world)

Q & A- EDGE YOUTH WEDNESDAY NIGHT SERIES

1. ***Without Judas' betrayal, Jesus wouldn't have been crucified and then people wouldn't be saved. was Judas always doomed to betray Jesus? Was that always part of Gods plan or did God have a different plan?***
    a. To answer this question, we must first examine who Judas was:
        i. He was called a _____- John 6:70- *Jesus answered them, Have not I chosen you twelve, and one of you is a devil?*
        ii. He was indwelt by Satan at one point- Luke 22:3- *Then entered Satan into Judas surnamed Iscariot…* ALSO IN John 13:27- *And after the sop Satan entered into him. Then said Jesus unto him, That thou doest, do quickly.*
        iii. He is the _____
            1. He was called the son of perdition, the only other one that title is used for is the antichrist- John 17:12; 2 Thess. 2:3
            2. He went "to his own place"- Acts 1:25; Rev. 17:8
        iv. He is very possibly the actual offspring of Satan
            1. In Acts 1:16-20 Peter refers to a passage in Psalms as being about Judas and his betrayal- Psalm 109:8-15
            2. Also, nobody else is called "a devil" but Judas. He was not "possessed" with a devil, but was "a devil"
        v. Prophesies of his betrayal
            1. Psalm 41:9 and John 13:18
            2. Zechariah 11:12-13 and Matthew 26:14-15; 27:3-10
            3. Psalm 109:6-8 and Acts 1:20
    b. The Verdict
        i. God in his omniscience absolutely foreknew that Judas would betray Jesus, but that does not mean that he MADE him
        ii. Even in the case of Judas: a devil, the antichrist, and possible child of Satan; he had a choice to make; he could have chosen anything he wanted
            1. We see fallen angels seemingly given space to repent in the Bible- Psalm 82
        iii. Judas is as close to an exception to the rule of choice as you can get, but even in his case, I would say that he was still given a genuine choice and he chose to betray Christ
2. ***What is the difference between a biblical view of free will and a Calvinist's view of free will?***
    a. A Calvinists view of free will
        i. **Compatibilism**- You choose freely—but _____what your heart wants—and God controls what your heart wants- John 6:37,44
            1. **The Lion and Food Illustration**
    b. A Biblical view of free will
        i. **Libertarian Free Will**- You have the genuine ability to choose between two or more possible options—and _____, not even God, predetermines your choices in such a way that you *must* choose one over the other.

ii. Biblical support of this idea and against Calvinists view- Deut. 30:19; Josh. 24:15; Isa. 1:18-20; John 3:16; John 1:12; Eph. 1:13; Acts 7:51; 2 Pet. 3:9; Rom. 10:13; Eze. 18:21, 23, 32

iii. God draws ALL men to himself, not all answer the call- John 12:32; Titus 2:11

1. **The Master Chess Player Illustration**

3. Does God have favorites since the Israelites are "his people"?

a. **Predestination/Election**- Election refers to God's selection of a group or body of people for a purpose—usually to represent Him on earth and to carry His message—not to exclusive salvation. Election in Scripture is often corporate, functional, and missional, not individualistic.

b. God elected to use Abraham and his lineage as a representative group to go and bless _____the earth- Gen. 12:1-3

i. Israel was called to be:

1. Holy- Exo. 19:5-6
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ii. We today are called to be:

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1. ***What are the Dead Sea scrolls and why do people use them? And are they credible?***
    a. The Dead Sea scrolls are a collection of over 950 ancient Jewish manuscripts, discovered between 1947 and 1956 in eleven caves near Qumran, on the northwestern shore of the Dead Sea in modern-day Israel. These texts were written primarily on parchment and papyrus, and are dated from 250 B.C. to A.D. 68. The scrolls are attributed to a Jewish sect, widely believed by most to be the Essenes, who lived in the Qumran settlement during the Second Temple period.
        i. **Biblical Manuscripts**: Over 230 manuscripts represent portions of every Old Testament book except Esther, comprising approximately 25% of the total finds. The most represented books include: **Psalms** – 39 manuscripts; **Deuteronomy** – 33 manuscripts; **Isaiah** – 22 manuscripts (including the nearly complete Great Isaiah Scroll, 1QIsaa)
        ii. When these were discovered, they were the oldest existing manuscripts of the old testament that had been found to date. This was a major discovery since it allowed everyone to see if the existing manuscripts we had and also the translations that came from them, were accurate
        iii. For us who believe by faith the word of God, and have faith that God will preserve his word, this was not a discovery that changed anything really. We believed by faith that God would preserve and purify his word through time. This merely helped to confirm what we already believed to be true
    b. At first glance, many "so called scholars" were enabled to look through fragments of these manuscripts and immediately concluded that they proved the "Septuagint" was the older and more original text; however, over the years that passed, as more people were given access to them, all manuscripts have been thoroughly studied, and **new evidence**/technologies have come to light, and here is what has been found- CHART
        i. In fact, in the greatest manuscript (1QIsaiahA/ The Great Isaiah Scroll) amongst what is considered the greatest archeological find of the 21st century, it aligns with the Masoretic text 95% of the time! (exact mss used for your kjv)
        ii. What about the other 5%?- There was another archeological find in 1993, the Tel Dan Stele, which talks about the "House of David". It was found in Israel and dates back to the 9th century BC! Only about 100-200 years after David lived!
            1. The oldest archaeological inscription mentioning David—the **Tel Dan Stele**—spells the name **DWD** (דוד), which is a consonantal spelling without vowels, dating to the **9th century BCE**.
            2. The **Great Isaiah Scroll (1QIsa^a)** from around 150 BCE **uses a later spelling**, **DWYD** (דויד), inserting a **yod** to function like a vowel.
            3. The **Masoretic Text**, although copied in the **Middle Ages**, preserves the **older form** (DWD), the same as the Tel Dan inscription. In that sense, the MT retains the *more ancient textual form*.

4. This shows us that the Masoretes kept the OT down to the very letters exactly as it was originally written and copied! That 5% variance is where the dead sea scrolls are off, not the Masoretic text!

c. What does this all mean?
   i. The Dead Sea scrolls were a great archeological discovery, that did not change **anything** we believed about God's word, his preserving of it, his purifying of it, etc.. But only confirmed that which we already knew based on Romans 3:2
      1. God's word was kept by HIS people, in Hebrew, not Greek, down to the very letters and symbols!- Matt. 5:18; Psa. 12:6-7
      2. It also confirms the the Bible is not a "game of telephone" translation of a translation of a translation of a translation, etc…as some critics say

2. Some people say that we won't know each other in heaven, is that true?

a. Key Verse: **Acts 3:20–21-** *And he shall send Jesus Christ, which before was preached unto you: Whom the heaven must receive until the times of restitution of all things, which God hath spoken by the mouth of all his holy prophets since the world began.*

b. A major theme of the Bible from the very beginning, has been God's ultimate plan to redeem and **restore** all things to their original, perfect, sinless state. To examine God's plan for the future/heaven, we can observe the past.
   i. Genesis 3:6-13- The original relationship of man, woman, and God
      1. Adam and Eve had a relationship- vs 6; 1:28
      2. Adam and Eve both had a relationship to God- vs 8-9
         a. Adam and God talk- vs 9-12
         b. Eve and God talk- vs 13
         c. They seemed to have an appointed time each day of conversation and fellowship- vs 8
         d. They not only had a "general" relationship, but a specific relationship where they talked by name

c. Our God is a God of personal relationships- Exo. 33:11; Psa. 139:1-4; Isa. 43:1-2; John 10:14-15; 15:15; Jer. 24:7; Eze 36:28; SOS 2:16; 6:3; 7:10; 8:6-7

d. We see specific examples of personal knowledge of others in the future and a personal relationship with them- Matt. 8:11; Luke 16:23-25; Rev 21:3; 1 Cor. 13:12

e. I believe that this teaching comes from "religion"
   i. Some people who are well meaning have heard, been taught, or been convinced of thinking certain cold and religious views. These often stem simply from a misrepresentation of God and his character! I believe that is where this idea comes from.

3. I know that drinking is wrong but where does it say in the Bible?

a. First mention of alcohol- Gen. 9:20-21
   i. It is almost exclusively used in a negative context in the Bible- Gen. 19:30-38

b. Abstaining from drinking alcohol is over and over again shown as a mark of a more **mature** follower of God:
   i. **Leviticus 10:9** – Priests forbidden to drink when ministering
   ii. **Numbers 6:3** – Nazarites abstain totally from the vine
   iii. **Daniel 1:8** – Daniel refused Babylon's wine
   iv. **1 Timothy 3:3, Titus 1:7** – Bishops and elders not to be given to wine
   v. **Proverbs 31:4** – Kings and leaders are warned not to drink
      1. If you want to consume alcohol, you have liberty to do that. The Bible unquestionably gives you liberty to do anything you want BUT NOT ALL THINGS WILL EDIFY YOU, especially what brings you under its power (1 Cor. 6:12; 10:23)

a. Notice who God says this to! The carnal, immature church who was more concerned with "what they can technically do/get away with" than glorifying God to the max!

c. Final Thoughts
   i. People will find reasons to drink if they want to drink
      1. "Jesus turned water to wine/Jesus drank"- John 2:1-11
         a. The word *wine* can refer to **grape juice or fermented wine**, so the context matters.
         b. Jesus created **135 gallons** of wine. If it were alcoholic, it would be enough to make an entire town drunk, violating *Habakkuk 2:15* ("Woe unto him that giveth his neighbour drink…")
         c. If Jesus himself drank, he violated the word of God in Lev. 10:10-11 and Proverbs 31:4; as the High Priest and the King of Kings
      2. "It is technically allowed for medical purposes and for those struggling mentally/emotionally"- 1 Tim. 5:23; Prov. 31:6
         a. If you are looking for reasons to drink, you can make these fit your life at any given time. There are many other solutions to these issues besides self-medicating with alcohol!
         b. At the end of the day God could not/did not absolutely 100% forbid alcohol for two reasons:
            i. It was necessary for some medically at this time in history since little/no other options were available for medication.
            ii. As a stumbling block to those who are seeking to live in their flesh and not actually follow God at all costs, to the maximum extant possible.
            iii. He gave enough warnings and clues about it biblically that you would understand, a mature Christian who seeks God's glory and to serve him above all else would not partake of alcohol. – John 6
            iv. Eph 5:18- And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit;
   ii. At the end of the discussion/debate on this subject, this is the absolute best you can say about alcohol consumption: IT IS FOR FOOLS AND IT IS SIN- Prov. 20:1; 24:9; Psa. 69:5; Num. 12:11

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    a. To answer this question, we will work this out together, comparing scripture with scripture, not changing, reading into, or altering at all what any of the passages SAY. The conclusion we come to will be based on what the bible ALONE states
        i. Revelation 4:6-8- ***4 Beasts***
        ii. Ezekiel 1:3-28; 10:1-22- ***Cherubim***
        iii. Isaiah 6:1-3- ***Seraphim***
    b. What is clung onto by those who want to believe that these are cherubim:
        i. Pictures, types, shadows, or **vague** descriptions of Cherubim mentioned elsewhere
            1. OT ark of the covenant; only 2 cherubim and they only have 2 wings, not the same description we see elsewhere
            2. OT references to God dwelling "between the cherubim" (2 Sam. 19:15; Psa. 80:1; 99:1; etc..)
                a. We believe exactly what these passages teach about him dwelling between the cherubim, however, we understand it based on the CLEAR, SPECIFIC, DETAILED passages where we are shown the throne of God in visions/revelations from God (Ezekiel, Isaiah, Revelation). Not the other way around (violating the CLARITY FACTOR)
        ii. The animals mentioned in Ezekiel and Revelation (Lion, Ox, Cherub, Man, Eagle)
            1. This is where the similarities between the two end
            2. It is the differences that make the difference

	Water	Methanol
Appearance	Clear, colorless liquid	Clear, colorless liquid
Effect	Sustains life, hydrates the body	Causes blindness, organ failure, and death
Smell/Taste	No smell, no taste	Slight alcohol-like smell, but hard to detect
Toxicity	Safe to drink	As little as a few tablespoons can kill an adult

                a. Just because 1 thing about them is mentioned in both places does not make them the same
        iii. "Seraphim are only mentioned one time in the Bible"
            1. This is used to say that we cannot say they are seraphim because they are only mentioned one other time in the bible (we cannot base a doctrine on a single verse)
            2. First, this is not true. They are talked about in Isaiah 6 and Revelation 4 based on the connections God makes in his word
            3. Second; the idea that the beasts in revelation 4 are cherubim is based on ZERO other scripture references
                a. You will never be able to find a mention of Cherub or Cherubim with any description of them that matches up with the description of the four beasts in Revelation chapter four.

b. In order to try to make the four beasts in Revelation chapter four Cherubim you will have to assume that either John or Ezekiel saw and then wrote their description incorrectly under the inspiration of the Holy Ghost and it was preserved for us this way (incorrectly, no matter what you "say" that is what this would mean). Some people have a problem with this statement but it is simply true. You cannot approach the Revelation given to John or the vision given to Ezekiel assuming that every thing they wrote was correct as pertaining to what is actually in heaven if you think that both are Cherubim. There is an absolute truth of what is in heaven. That is if you were to ask God to give you a description of Cherubim or Seraphim or the four beasts, there is the absolute truth of what they actually look like in reality. You cannot assume that Ezekiel and John got that absolute truth correct and say that the Cherubim are the four beasts in Revelation chapter four.

iv. "Ezekiel saw them when they were carrying the throne of God down from heaven and so he saw the 4 wings and the other 2 were flying/carrying the throne" ALSO "John was standing in heaven stationary, while Ezekiel saw them flying and moving, hence why John only saw one face and Ezekiel saw all of them"

1. This is a dangerous way of reading the bible, and it assumes that John/Ezekiel saw and recorded God's revelation to them incorrectly- Ezekiel 1:1; Rev. 4:1-2
2. We know that this is not how we are to read the bible, especially when God connects the dots for us and shows us exactly who matches the same description in Isaiah 6 (Holy, holy, holy; wings, face: CONSISTENCY FACTOR, COMPARING SCRIPTURE WITH SCRIPTURE FACTOR)
3. ALSO- Ezekiel 1:11, 23
    a. Almost as if God saw this coming, he makes sure to specify to everyone exactly how many of each wings do what job. He breaks it down into 2 and 2, 2 times!
    b. Also notice, Ezekiel does not say he "perceived" or "saw" that they had 4 wings and 4 faces, he says "THEY HAD" emphatically! An absolute statement of truth, not a perception or observation

v. Why does this **matter**?- 2 Pet. 1:20

1. Ultimately, this issue does not change much for us doctrinally, however, as with anything we come across in the Bible, we want to know and believe what God says about it, period.
2. A few rules of Bible study that are violated to "make it fit" the belief many have that these are cherubim:
    a. Every word/event factor
    b. Comparing scripture factor
    c. Consistency factor
    d. Literal factor
    e. Clarity factor

c. What do they represent?

i. It has been said that the beasts represent all of creation and also different aspects of Jesus Christ, that they align with the gospels:

1. Matthew- Jesus as King (Lion)
2. Mark- Jesus as servant (Ox/calf)
3. Luke- Jesus as man (man)
4. John- Jesus as God (eagle)

2. ***Who are the 24 elders in Revelation?***
    a. The elders are:
        i. **Wearing white raiment**- Rev. 4:4 WITH Rev. 3:5, 18; Isa. 61:10
        ii. **Wearing crowns**- Rev. 4:4 WITH 2 Tim. 4:8; James 1:12; 1 Pet. 5:4; 1 Cor. 9:25
        iii. **Sat on seats/thrones**- Rev. 4:4 WITH 2 Tim. 2:12; Dan. 7:22; Rev. 20:4
        iv. **Priests**- Rev. 5:8-10 WITH Rev. 1:5-6; 1 Pet. 2:5, 9
        v. **Kings**- Rev. 5:8-10 WITH Rev. 1:6; 2:12
        vi. **Worshipping God**- Rev. 4:10-11; 5:14
        vii. **In heaven at the rapture and thereafter**- Rev. 4:1-2 WITH 1 Thess. 4:16-17; 1 Cor. 15
            1. These are all things that apply to saints/believers of the church age
    b. The **apostles** are referred to/connected with "elder" 11x (Acts 15:2, 4, 6, 22, 23; 16:4; 21:18; 1 Pet. 5:1; 2 Jn. 1:1; 3 Jn. 1:1
    c. The 12 sons of Jacob (Israel) could be seen as the foundation of all Old Testament saints (representative of them all)- Acts 7:8-9
    d. We see this distinction and place of prominence for these groups in the future perfect kingdom- Rev. 21:12, 14
        i. It would make sense that the 12 sons of Jacob who are the fathers of all of the tribes of Israel would represent all OT saints and that the 12 apostles would represent all NT saints (Eph. 2:20)
    e. Normally, we would take the passage literally and not read into it what it does not say; however, Revelation 5:8-9 give us a reason to think they represent more than just 24 saints
        i. Their song of redemption through the blood of Christ and the fact that they come from EVERY KINDRED, EVERY TONGUE, EVERY PEOPLE, AND EVERY NATION; says that they must represent a much larger group than these 24 alone
        ii. Also because every aspect of them aligns with things that are said of the church and OT saints

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vi. **Worshipping God**- Rev. 4:10-11; 5:14

vii. **In heaven at the rapture and thereafter**- Rev. 4:1-2 WITH 1 Thess. 4:16-17; 1 Cor. 15

b. The _____ are referred to/connected with "elder" 11x (Acts 15:2, 4, 6, 22, 23; 16:4; 21:18; 1 Pet. 5:1; 2 Jn. 1:1; 3 Jn. 1:1

c. The 12 sons of Jacob (Israel) could be seen as the foundation of all Old Testament saints (representative of them all)- Acts 7:8-9

d. We see this distinction and place of prominence for these groups in the future perfect kingdom- Rev. 21:12, 14

i. It would make sense that the 12 sons of Jacob who are the fathers of all of the tribes of Israel would represent all OT saints and that the 12 apostles would represent all NT saints (Eph. 2:20)

e. Normally, we would take the passage literally and not read into it what it does not say; however, Revelation 5:8-9 give us a reason to think they represent more than just 24 saints

Q & A- EDGE YOUTH WEDNESDAY NIGHT SERIES

1. ***What/who is a leviathan and why is it a thing?***
    a. To begin, let's look at some theories out there as to who this creature is
    b. Job 41- The great chapter on this creature- CONSIDER THE CONTEXT FIRST
        i. In the first chapters of the book we are shown a great spiritual battle going on over the life of Job, then suddenly we are shown the events on earth in his life as a result of this: Bad things happen to him, he complains, his friends convince him he must have done something wrong to deserve it (using all sorts of "biblical reasoning"), to the point Job wants to die, and then God begins to rebuke and teach him near the end of the book (chapter 41) about what is REALLY going on (he became convinced that he must have done something to deserve this).
        ii. The very sight of him causes people to fall (vs 9)
        iii. Nobody can stand against him (vs 10)
        iv. He is proud (vs. 15)
        v. He breathes fire (vs. 21)
        vi. The sorrow of others is joy to him (vs. 22)
        vii. He is hard hearted (vs. 24)
        viii. He is extremely strong (vs. 26-30)
        ix. There is nobody else like him who has no fear (vs. 33)
        x. He is the king over all the children of pride (vs 34)
    c. Other passages- Psa 74:14; 104: 26; Isa. 27:1
        i. Combining this all: He is a multi-headed fire breathing dragon, who will be killed on "that day", he is a serpent, he is the ultimate image of pride, he is ultimately strong, hard hearted, proud, no other creation is like him, he loves the sorrow of others, and he is a king
    d. Connect the multi-headed, serpent/**dragon** with Rev. 12:3, 9
        i. This is none other than the Devil himself!
        ii. God was showing Job the true power behind his suffering! It was not his sin, it was not something he did wrong, it was Satan who was taking everything from him to see if he would turn on God. God was revealing this to Job in GREAT detail.
        iii. Job teaches us some of the most information on the devil that we have
    e. Devotional- Hearing the right voices
        i. Even the most well intentioned, bible quoting people, can be under influence at any given moment by the enemy (Matt. 16:23)
            1. Get advice from a multitude of counselors, BUT always weight what they say against the word of God (it is your final authority)
        ii. Have a growing, thriving, relationship with God through his word. This is the only way to truly 100% have understanding about issues in your life
2. ***Why do new versions like the NIV take out the fasting parts in some verses (Matthew 17:21)?***
    a. From their own words: *"The verse is not included in the newer Bibles because the older and better manuscripts of Matthew do not include it."*
    b. Is this true? What manuscripts include this verse?
        i. Codex C (5th century)
        ii. Codex D (5th century)
        iii. Codex K (9th century)
        iv. Codex L (8th century)
        v. Majority of Byzantine manuscripts
        vi. Other early quotes
    c. If this is not true, then why do they REALLY do it?

i. There is an **enemy** that is behind the changing of God's word since the beginning (Gen. 3:1-6)
ii. God specifically warns about people that would add to, subtract from, and change his word (Deut. 4:2; 12:32; Prov. 30:5-6; Jer. 26:2; Rev. 22:18-19; 2 Thess. 2:2)
    1. To not believe that this is still the way that the devil is trying to attack God's people is simply ignorant of biblical truth and ignorant of the enemy (as we saw with leviathan)
    2. It is not simply about "seeking to take all of the manuscripts and examine and take the best parts of them all to create the "best we can get". It is about a biblical understanding of the manuscripts, where they came from, what they teach, and using this BIBLICAL information to find your ultimate final authority"
iii. This is ultimately done in order to take away bible truth that God wants you to have
    1. Here in Matthew 17:21, it is about not understanding the power of prayer and fasting together for some circumstances that simply need it (to rid people of devils in this context)
        a. There are other places where "fasting" is taken out of verses but prayer is kept (Mark 9:29; 1 Cor. 7:5). The reasoning they give is the same, the answer is the same, and the ultimate attack of the enemy is the same: to HIDE FROM PEOPLE THE POWER OF PRAYER AND FASTING TOGETHER OVER ISSUES THAT PRAYER ALONE CANNOT SOLVE
    2. In 1 John 5:7, it is to take away the greatest verse in your bible about the trinity and Jesus Christ's deity
    3. In Mark 16, they take out the last 11 verses of this gospel, with such verses as "And he said unto them, Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature." And the record of Jesus ascension. (nothing important)
    4. In Isaiah 14, they replace the very name of the Devil from before his fall, to conceal his name, identity, and what he was doing and when he fell (Lucifer only shows up in the KJV and NKJV)

3. What would biblical fasting be?

a. **What is fasting**- Fasting simply means: not to eat; to abstain from food; to abstain from nourishment. Jesus referred to not eating as fasting – Matthew 15:32; Mark 8:3
b. **Biblical fasting**- A biblical fast is a periodic, deliberate, voluntary, abstinence from food in order to accomplish a **special** God- directed, spiritual purpose.
    i. It can be done in times of grief, sickness, death, danger, anguish, etc.. – 2 Sam. 12:6; 1 Sam. 31:13; 2 Chron. 20:3; 2 Kings 25:1
    ii. Jesus promoted fasting- Mt. 4:1-2; 9:14-15; 17:14-21; Mk. 9:29
    iii. The early church practiced fasting- Acts 13:1-3
    iv. Paul fasted- 2 Cor. 6:4-5; 11:27
        1. It was used by all of these for things that were very serious: sins that could not be shaken, devils that could not be cast out, missionary journeys/seeking God and where he wanted them to go, Jesus just beginning his public ministry, and many very serious things
        2. Is there something in your life you have prayed and prayed about, sought counsel over, read about in the word, and done all you can to handle it (anxiety, sin, grief, sorrow, etc.) HAVE YOU FASTED OVER IT? Sometimes this is the extra needed to see God move in big ways.
c. What it is NOT- It is not something to do to earn extra favor with God, some higher spiritual attainment, or monkish lifestyle to show your commitment
    i. Some view fasting as a way to earn extra favor with God or as a religious thing we can do to get God to do what we want
    ii. It is simply saying no to your flesh and saying you desire to be full spiritually more than you are physically. When we do this, we walk in the spirit and not the flesh and we seek a closer communion with God through it
    iii. The fasting itself does not get you closer to God, it is about the heart desire to be closer to him and give up anything else that gets in the way

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c. If this is not true, then why do they REALLY do it?
   i. There is an /_____ that is behind the changing of God's word since the beginning (Gen. 3:1-6)
   ii. God specifically warns about people that would add to, subtract from, and change his word (Deut. 4:2; 12:32; Prov. 30:5-6; Jer. 26:2; Rev. 22:18-19; 2 Thess. 2:2)
   iii. This is ultimately done in order to take away bible truth that God wants you to have
      1. Matthew 17:21 (fasting); 1 John 5:7 (Jesus Deity); Mark 16 (the gospel/ascension); Isaiah 14 (ID of the Devil)

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b. **Biblical fasting**- A biblical fast is a periodic, deliberate, voluntary, abstinence from food in order to accomplish a /_____ God- directed, spiritual purpose.
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c. What it is NOT- It is not something to do to earn extra favor with God, some higher spiritual attainment, or monkish lifestyle to show your commitment

Q & A- EDGE YOUTH WEDNESDAY NIGHT

1. ***What is the point of a new and old testament? Why not just the old? Why not just the new?***
    a. Why not just the OT? – Because the Old Testament gives the law and promises but not their **fulfillment**, which comes only through Jesus Christ in the New Testament (Hebrews 10:1; Galatians 3:24)
        1. All "dispensations" (how God deals with mankind during certain times) were offered to man as genuine offers (don't eat of this tree and you will live in peace with me; keep these laws and live in this orderly way and love me and you will be a great kingdom and be blessed; etc..)
        2. However, God KNEW that mankind would not obey him long-term under ANY of these systems; so he continued to use new ones; the OT was never a long-term solution
        3. As these were not kept, mankind is proving themselves that without God dealing with sin in the universe, they could never be at peace with him
        4. Even when God dies for everyone, giving his own life, giving his Spirit to live in those who trust in him, giving them his written/perfect word; with sinners still in the world, the devil still at work, and sin not FULLY DEALT WITH; this will still not work
        5. God didn't send Jesus right after Adam fell because man had to first see that he couldn't save himself—by conscience, law, religion, or even signs and wonders. The history of the Old Testament proves this.
        6. Even the history of the NT proves this. With believers who are given the righteousness of Christ and their sins fully forgiven, he still will have to come back and set things right on this earth and give us glorified bodies in order to fulfill his promises because we as the church of God; the body of Christ, will fail in our mission.
        7. God dealt with man in different ways in different ages so as to demonstrate the failure of man under every test.
        8. That is why the judgment of God is so important: there has to come a day where God draws a line in the sand and says you are either with me (you chose me) or against me. If you have not chosen him but have chosen sin; he HAS TO JUDGE you in order to eventual rid the universe of sin, death, sorrow, etc..
    ii. The OT was a shadow of the ultimate fulfillment of the NT; it was genuinely offered as a way for peace/government/dealing with sin in the world, but was never going to work because of human nature
        1. It also showed the inability of man to do this on his own without ultimate judgment of sin
    b. Why not just the NT?- Because the New Testament reveals Christ, but you can't understand who He is or why He came without the Old Testament's prophecies, types, and foundation (Luke 24:27; Romans 15:4)
        i. The Bible says there was a right time for Jesus to come- **Galatians 4:4-** *"But when the fulness of the time was come, God sent forth his Son…"*
            1. This means that it was in the plan of God to do this all along (knowing man would not obey his commandments) at the right time
        ii. Again, the question being asked here is basically "Why didn't Jesus just come right away in Genesis after Adam and Eve sinned?" – To show man they could not do it on their own without God. God needed to intervene and deal with sin in the universe. It was the right/just way to do it. – Eph. 2:8-9
2. ***When someone falls away, is there a way to still tell if they are truly saved?***
    a. Yes there is- but how?
        i. Fruit? (Mt. 7:15-23; 13:1-8, 18-23)
            1. Sure there is **evidence** that accompanies a believers life
                a. Love other believers- 1 Jn. 3:14; 4:7
                b. Chastening of God in your life- Heb. 12:6-8
                c. Turning from sin/sensitivity to sin- 1 Jn. 3:6-9
                d. Changed life- 2 Cor. 5:17 (new creature)
                e. Fruit of the spirit- Gal. 5:22-23
                    i. But these are all part of the sanctification of the life of the believer as they WALK IN THE SPIRIT and grow in their relationship with God, NOT guarantees for anyone who is saved

2. Look at these examples of "saved" people in the bible:
    a. **Lot**- chose Sodom, offered daughters, drunk, incest; CALLED JUST- 2 Pet. 2:7-8
    b. **Corinthian believers**- sexual immorality, lawsuits, abuse of communion- 1 Cor. 1:2; 3:1-3; 5:1-5; 6:1-8; 11:17-22
    c. **Demas**- a believer and fellow worker with Paul who left the work having loved this present world- Col. 4:14; Philemon 24; 2 Tim. 4:10
    d. **Ananias and Sapphira**- Part of the early church/believers, lied, stole, hid valuables from the church and died for it- Acts 5:1-11
    e. **Hymenaeus and Philetus**- believers who fell into false doctrine and false teaching- 2 Tim. 2:17-18; 1 Tim. 1:19-20

ii. Profession of faith? (Rom. 10:9-10; 1 Jn. 5:13; John 3:16)
1. The only **TRUE** test to tell if someone is truly saved, is what they have professed about WHAT THE BIBLE SAYS IS NECESSARY FOR SALVATION
    a. RELIGION, wants to slowly and surely add "works" as proof of salvation
    b. We are saved to good works and for good works BUT NOT BY good works
    c. Is someone saved? Did they confess that they believed and received the gift of God which is Jesus Christ's death and resurrection? If they received it, they are saved. (Jn. 1:12)
    d. "Well yeah but… you should….. their life should look…." RELIGION!
    e. It is not that you make salvation cheap, you make it what the Bible says it is. A gift, a gift you receive through faith. There is no other sure way to KNOW if someone is saved, other than what they profess about their belief in Christ for salvation
    f. VIDEOS OF SALVATION STATEMENTS
    g. Only God can judge hearts, if someone says that they prayed to received Christ alone, they have done all a person can do to be saved; this is the greatest evidence of salvation

3. What REALLY happened before the NT started when God wasn't talking back to the people for the dark ages (*400 years of silence)*?

a. The last book of the OT was Malachi. Then there were 400 years where there was no prophet and no inspired writing from God (Amos 8:11)
b. It is **CRUCIAL** to understand that during these years, there was NO NEW SCRIPTURE being written, no new inspiration/revelation from God through the prophets (Mal. 4:5-6; Luke 1:17; Matt. 11:14)
    i. False religions hold to books that are known as the "Apocrypha", all of which were written during this time- Tobit (200 BC); Judith (150 BC); Wisdom of Solomon (50 BC); Sirach (180 BC); Baruch (100 BC); 1 and 2 Maccabees (100-150 BC); etc….
    ii. By the witness of the Bible itself, Jesus Christ, the Apostles, etc.. these are NOT scripture. They were never referred to as scripture by any of these
c. Other attacks/influences from the devil during this time
    i. Philosophy- Plato (427-347 BC); Arisotle (384- 322 BC); Epicurus (341-270 BC); etc..
    ii. Religious movements- Pharisees; Sadducees; Essenes; Zealots; Samaritans; Buddhism (500 BC); Confucianism (551-479 BC)
    iii. Others- The "Septuagint" (supposed Greek translation of the Hebrew bible); Oral Jewish traditions began (later the "Mishnah", expanded bible meaning beyond the Torah)
d. World power shifts- Persia (539-331 BC); Greece (331-167 BC); Rome (63 BC)
    i. Just as Daniel prophesied in Daniel 2, 7, and 8 the kingdoms preceding his first coming; so John prophesied the kingdoms directly preceding his second coming
    ii. The world was in a flurry of changes during the years of silence; during the time of a "famine of the word of God" preceding Christ's first coming
    iii. The world in in a flurry of changes during these years of "famine of the word of God" preceding Christ's second coming (wars and rumors of wars- Britain, Russia, USA)
    iv. Let this be a reminder to us that where the word of God is not being preached, where there is a famine like this, things get crazy FAST! (Prov. 29:18)

Q & A- EDGE YOUTH WEDNESDAY NIGHT

1. ***What is the point of a new and old testament? Why not just the old? Why not just the new?***
    a. Why not just the OT? – Because the Old Testament gives the law and promises but not their _____, which comes only through Jesus Christ in the New Testament (Hebrews 10:1; Galatians 3:24)
        i. The OT was a shadow of the ultimate fulfillment of the NT; it was genuinely offered as a way for peace/government/dealing with sin in the world, but was never going to work because of human nature
    b. Why not just the NT?- Because the New Testament reveals Christ, but you can't understand who He is or why He came without the Old Testament's prophecies, types, and foundation (Luke 24:27; Romans 15:4)
        i. The Bible says there was a right time for Jesus to come- **Galatians 4:4-** *"But when the fulness of the time was come, God sent forth his Son…"*
        ii. Again, the question being asked here is basically "Why didn't Jesus just come right away in Genesis after Adam and Eve sinned?" – To show man they could not do it on their own without God. God needed to intervene and deal with sin in the universe. It was the right/just way to do it. – Eph. 2:8-9
2. ***When someone falls away, is there a way to still tell if they are truly saved?***
    a. Yes there is- but how?
        i. Fruit? (Mt. 7:15-23; 13:1-8, 18-23)
            1. Sure there is _____ that accompanies a believers life
                a. Love other believers- 1 Jn. 3:14; 4:7
                b. Chastening of God in your life- Heb. 12:6-8
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                d. Changed life- 2 Cor. 5:17 (new creature)
                e. Fruit of the spirit- Gal. 5:22-23
                    i. But these are all part of the sanctification of the life of the believer as they WALK IN THE SPIRIT and grow in their relationship with God, NOT guarantees for anyone who is saved
            2. Look at these examples of "saved" people in the bible:
                a. **Lot**- chose Sodom, offered daughters, drunk, incest; CALLED JUST- 2 Pet. 2:7-8
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                c. **Demas**- a believer and fellow worker with Paul who left the work having loved this present world- Col. 4:14; Philemon 24; 2 Tim. 4:10
                d. **Ananias and Sapphira-** Part of the early church/believers, lied, stole, hid valuables from the church and died for it- Acts 5:1-11

e. **Hymenaeus and Philetus-** believers who fell into false doctrine and false teaching- 2 Tim. 2:17-18; 1 Tim. 1:19-20

ii. Profession of faith? (Rom. 10:9-10; 1 Jn. 5:13; John 3:16)

1. The only _____, test to tell if someone is truly saved, is what they have professed about WHAT THE BIBLE SAYS IS NECESSARY FOR SALVATION
    a. Is someone saved? Did they confess that they believed and received the gift of God which is Jesus Christ's death and resurrection? If they received it, they are saved. (Jn. 1:12)
    b. Only God can judge hearts, if someone says that they prayed to received Christ alone, they have done all a person can do to be saved; this is the greatest evidence of salvation

3. What REALLY happened before the NT started when God wasn't talking back to the people for the dark ages (*400 years of silence)*?

a. The last book of the OT was Malachi. Then there were 400 years where there was no prophet and no inspired writing from God (Amos 8:11)

b. It is _____, to understand that during these years, there was NO NEW SCRIPTURE being written, no new inspiration/revelation from God through the prophets (Mal. 4:5-6; Luke 1:17; Matt. 11:14)

i. False religions hold to books that are known as the "Apocrypha", all of which were written during this time- Tobit (200 BC); Judith (150 BC); Wisdom of Solomon (50 BC); Sirach (180 BC); Baruch (100 BC); 1 and 2 Maccabees (100-150 BC); etc….

c. Other attacks/influences from the devil during this time

i. Philosophy- Plato (427-347 BC); Arisotle (384- 322 BC); Epicurus (341-270 BC); etc..

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Q & A- EDGE YOUTH WEDNESDAY NIGHT SERIES

1. ***How does the holy spirit intercede our prayers, like what does he do? What does he make them sound like?***
    a. Key Passage: Romans 8:26-27
        i. This seems to say that when we pray, because we don't pray as we ought to always, the spirit of God intercedes on our behalf to align it with the will of God
        ii. Some may say that our prayers are guided by the spirit and that is all that is meant here, but if that was the case, we would hear the "groanings", but the passage tells us clearly that we don't hear them and they "cannot be uttered". Therefore it cannot be the prayer/words you are praying.
    b. The whole **trinity** is involved in our prayers:
        i. We pray to the Father- Mt. 6:9; Eph. 3:14
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    c. Takeaway: Pray without ceasing! (1 Thess. 5:17)
        i. There is such power in prayer that too often is untapped by us simply because we do not pray or we do not pray as often as we ought to. Read and meditate on these promises associated with prayer and let it change how you pray!
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   i. That means the apostles did not “tamper with” the words of God- 2 Tim. 3:16; 2 Pet. 1:20-21
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      1. God commands Jeremiah to write down His words in a scroll (Jer. 36:1–2).
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c. The content of the Bible testifies that it is not some manmade document of conjured up stories, but the very word of God
   i. Fulfilled **Prophecy** (Only God can predict the future):
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3. **If all the other versions, except KJV, are wrong why do people still preach and talk with them?**
   a. The word of God has been under the same attack since the very **beginning**- Gen. 3:1-5
   b. The enemy of God has been countering the working of God since the very beginning- Genesis 1:28; 2:16–17; 3:1–7, 15, 21; 4:3–5; 6:1–9; 10:8–10; 11; 13:10–11; 18:17–19; 25:29–33
      i. The BIBLICAL evidence for why we use the King James Bible, and why we believe it is the pure word of God, as opposed to the other versions out there, is not the thing we are proving today. However, we believe based on the evidence that the pure word of God exists and also the changed and perverted word of the Devil exists, since we see both in play from the very beginning

ii. The purpose of the ever so slightly changed word of the devil is to cause death, separation from God, and to promote his kingdom, gospel, seed, king, etc.. NOT God's
iii. Genesis 3:1-5 example

c. There are different groups in this issue
   i. MOST people are ignorant of this issue, they are told it is about "readability" or "older and better manuscripts". These things are not true however.
   ii. Some are being used due to a lack of knowledge (Hosea 4:6)
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      1. Specifically, the bibles, doctrines, kingdoms, etc.. all run back to ONE "anti-religious" system, to support it and its doctrines- The Roman Catholic Church (Vaticanus, doctrines such as purgatory, baptism of infants, prayers to mary/mother goddesses, etc..)
         a. Rev. 2:20- Chart

d. Different bibles say different things, teach different things, and ultimately lead to different results (like they did for Adam and Eve) and THERE IS AN ENEMY who has been at work since the very beginning to trick people by slightly changing God's word, to bring death to many

Q & A- EDGE YOUTH WEDNESDAY NIGHT SERIES

1. ***How does the holy spirit intercede our prayers, like what does he do? What does he make them sound like?***
    a. Key Passage: Romans 8:26-27
        i. This seems to say that when we pray, because we don't pray as we ought to always, the spirit of God intercedes on our behalf to align it with the will of God
        ii. Some may say that our prayers are guided by the spirit and that is all that is meant here, but if that was the case, we would hear the "groanings", but the passage tells us clearly that we don't hear them and they "cannot be uttered". Therefore it cannot be the prayer/words you are praying.
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How did they determine when time actually began, the time we know now?

a. Time in the absolute/linear sense, began in Genesis 1:1 "In the ***beginning*** God created the heaven and the earth."
   i. God is outside of time because he created it (Psa. 90:2; 2 Pet. 3:8)
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b. Time how we **measure** it today (calendrical/cyclical) was established in Genesis 1:14-18
   i. Measuring seasons, times, days, hours, etc.. all began with the institution of it by God in these verses. These are not "man-made" constructs but in fact follow the time set by God
      1. Hours- while the division into 24 hours was more culturally defined later, daylight hours were naturally divided by the sun's movement across the sky
         a. In Jesus' time, people referred to the "third hour," "sixth hour," "ninth hour," based on the sun's position.- John 11:9
      2. Days- one full rotation of the earth on its axis
      3. Months- following the phases of the moon (about 29.5 days)
      4. Years- one full orbit of the earth around the sun (about 365 days)

c. The Storybook Illustration
   i. Absolute time- The book, the story, and the flow of it all is time itself. One day the author decided to start writing a book, he controlled the story but was not "inside of the book/story"
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   iii. We are in the story as characters; we can look back and live up to the current page we are on but we cannot see the whole story from beginning to end; only the author knows that (outside of the book/writing the book)
      1. It is not a perfect illustration but it works for our purposes today

2. Why do priests bless houses?

a. This is a Catholic practice known as a "***sacramental***"- **CCC 1667** – "Sacramentals are sacred signs which bear a resemblance to the sacraments. They signify effects, particularly of a spiritual nature, which are obtained through the intercession of the Church."
   i. These have been practiced for years usually around January 6th (Ephiphany) remembering the visit of the Magi to the house where Jesus was (cf. *Matthew 2:11*)

ii. They typically involve: prayer by a priest over the home, sprinkling of holy water, and writing with chalk above the door "May Christ Bless this Home"

iii. The reasons for this being done are many but could include: moving into a new home, for peace/protection, inviting an extra blessing from God to the home, as a witness that the home worships Christ, etc..

1. The issue is: THIS IS NOT BASED ON SCRIPTURE BUT RATHER TRADITION
2. Traditions that have roots in pagan Roman, Egyptian, Grecian, Europian, etc… practices

b. Conclusion: Unfortunately, as it is with many Roman Catholic practices, this is NOT a biblical practice but rather **tradition** of the Catholic church which they first took from multiple pagan practices. Blessing of houses in this way looks more like false pagan rituals than ANYTHING you find the New Testament church doing in the Bible (Mk. 7:7-13; Col. 2:8; Mt. 15:3,6; Titus 1:14)

3. ***How would you go about not being hopeless knowing you'll probably never live past a certain age because everyone is saying the world is ending and all the pieces are falling into place? I've been told that the same things were said when my parents were young, but what if it really is different now?***

i. While I understand the question from a human perspective, the Bible does give us clear answers on this

b. First; the signs are absolutely there…Unlike ever before- The signs of: **ISRAEL**, wars, global alignments/currencies, apostacy, homosexuality, rise of the Catholic Church and its alignments with other major religions, Laodicea and its relation to church history, technology booms, increase in natural disasters, constant calls for peace in the middle east, 7,000 years of human history, order of 2 Chron-Psalms doctrinally, etc…

c. These words are supposed to "comfort" us and bring us hope!- 1 Thess. 4:13-18; 5:27

d. These words are supposed to bring us closer together- Heb. 10:25

e. We can receive a crown for having the right heart/perspective on Jesus coming back- 2 Tim. 4:7-8

f. When we don't look forward to his coming, it may be a sign that our priorities/values are out of order- Col. 3:1-5

i. We may be valuing earthly things too much- vs 1-2

ii. This causes us to not look forward to his appearing- vs 3-4

iii. This is usually accompanied by living in the flesh and after the ways of the world- vs 5

g. We need to have eternal perspective- 2 Cor. 4:18

h. We don't belong to this world and we should feel like strangers in it- Phili. 3:20; Heb. 11:13-16

i. When we see Jesus and we enter into glory, we won't give a second thought to the cares of this world- Psa. 16:11; Rev. 21:4; Isa. 65:17

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S10 / TEACHING SERIES

2 Timothy 4

Five weeks through 2 Timothy 4, with teacher/student lessons and slides. Earlier chapter studies are retained within the same book-study collection.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Bible teaching and lesson preparation.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

27 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

2 Timothy 4

Luke Johnston's selected teaching, writing or development sample; original bylines and citations retained.

Full teaching files

2 Timothy 1 1-5	*3 pages*
2 Timothy 1 7-12	*2 pages*
2 Timothy 1 13	*2 pages*
2 Timothy 2 2 Teacher's Copy	*3 pages*
2 Timothy 4 1-4 student	*1 pages*
Teacher 2 Timothy 4 1-4 copy	*2 pages*
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student 2 Timothy 4 8	*1 pages*
Teacher 2 Timothy 4 8	*2 pages*
student 2 Timothy 4 9-22	*1 pages*
Teacher 2 Timothy 4 9-22	*2 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

2 Timothy: Iron sharpening Iron

I. This week we will be introduced to one of the greatest example of discipleship at its truest form in the Bible. This letter written to Timothy from his disciple Paul, is the perfect example of how practical _____brings better service, more love, and more glory to God. In our relationships between one another as Christians we should always be seeking to push each other closer to God. Throughout this series we will see how among ourselves we can live differently to help encourage one another to serve God better and glorify him more.

II. 2 Timothy overview

A. **Historical**- This letter was written near the year _____ . The letter was written by Paul to his beloved disciple Timothy, shortly before his martyrdom (2 Timothy 4:6-8) This is Paul's final letter he wrote, that we have recorded in the Holy Bible.

B. **Doctrinal**- This letter is a picture of the deeper meaning to discipleship. The book as a whole is a very great example of the relationship between a disciple and discipler and how discipleship helps us to endure in our Christian lives to the end. Also, chapter 3 of this epistle is a prophecy of the end times, and can be used to determine just how close we are to the end now.

C. **Devotional**- We can learn so much about how we ought to treat each other practically as brothers and sisters in Christ. The overall goal of discipleship is to _____ closer with God in the end, and this book will show us key ways to do this!

III. 1 Timothy 1: 1-5

A. Vs. 2 "Dearly beloved son"

1. Think of one another as family

a) **Romans 12:10**- “Be kindly affectioned one to another with brotherly love; in honour preferring one another;”
b) **1 Thessalonians 3:12**- “But as touching brotherly love ye need not that I write unto you: for ye yourselves are taught of God to love one another.”
c) **Revelation 3:7-13**- **“**_____**”**- From the name of a city in Asia Minor mentioned in Revelation in the New Testament. The name of the city meant "brotherly love" from Greek φιλεω (phileo) "to love" and αδελφος (adelphos) "brother". It is also the name of a city in the United States.

B. Vs 3 “without ceasing I have remembrance of thee in my prayers night and day”
   1. We need to be praying for each other
      a) **1 Thessalonians 5:17**- “Pray without ceasing.”
      b) **Matthew 9:38**- “Pray ye therefore the Lord of the harvest, that he will send forth labourers into his harvest.”
      c) **Matthew 26:41**- “Watch and pray, that ye enter not into temptation: the spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.”
      d) **Mark 11:24**- “Therefore I say unto you, What things soever ye desire, when ye pray, believe that ye receive them, and ye shall have them.”
         (1) Ultimately we need to be _____ for God’s will to be done! Pray for him to be glorified, and always keep in mind that if you don’t believe he will answer then he won’t!

C. Vs. 4 “Greatly desiring to see thee, being mindful of thy tears, that I may be filled with joy:”
   1. We need this kind of affection; to bear the burdens of our family!
      a) **John 15:13**- “Greater love hath no man than this, that a man lay down his life for his friends.”
      b) **Romans 15:1-3**- “We then that are strong ought to bear the infirmities of the weak, and not to please ourselves. Let every one of us please his neighbour for his good to

edification. For even Christ pleased not himself; but, as it is written, The reproaches of them that reproached thee fell on me."

(1) This is discipleship; iron sharpening iron! If we want to succeed as Christians we need one another to strengthen each other

(a) Romans 15:30- "Now I beseech you, brethren, for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake, and for the love of the Spirit, that ye strive together with me in your prayers to God for me;"

IV. In these first 5 verses of the epistle of love from the discipler Paul, to his disciple Timothy, we have so much we can learn. Discipleship in the Bible is a pattern of _____ discipleship, but the practical everyday iron sharpening iron relationship between Christians is there as well! In order to reach our lost friends at school and in our lives, we need to sharpen and pray for one another! Alone, we may lead even 15-20 lost friends to salvation in high school, **but** _____ one another, we can reach 10x that through discipleship. Next week, let's try again to double in size by each one of us bringing just 1 friend to Bible study! This is the work of the Lord.

2 Timothy: Iron sharpening Iron

I. This week we will be discussing the Biblical mandate to go and do the work of the Lord, despite what the world throws our way. In these few verses found in chapter one of 2 Timothy, we will find that we are all called to be _____of the gospel of Christ. When these afflictions arise, we must be able to continue on and endure to the end, or else we may fail in our mission. Paul is writing to his disciple Timothy to encourage him to press forward despite _____. Discipleship is the only means by which we will be able to endure to the end of our mission. Without each other, we would grow weary fast and never be able to glorify God with our lives.

II. 2 Timothy 1:7-8, 12

A. Vs. 7- fear is NEVER from God

1. **Proverbs 3:5-7**- “Trust in the Lord with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding. In all thy way acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths.”
2. **Isaiah 55:8**- “For my thoughts are not your thoughts, neither are your ways my ways, saith the LORD.”
    a) So often we like to try to make our own plans in our lives. If we believe in God and who the Bible says he is, then we should always be consulting God in our decisions! Then he will direct your paths. We can see the here and now. God can see the beginning from the end. The more time we spend with him, the more prepared he will make us for what he sees lying ahead in our lives.

B. Vs. 7- his spirit gives us power, love, and a sound mind

1. Our God is a God of peace. He wants nothing more than for our lives to be _____ and glorifying to him at the same time!
    a) **Matthew 11: 28-30**- “Come unto me, all *ye* that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest. Take my yoke upon you, and learn of me; for I am meek and lowly in heart: and ye shall find rest unto your souls. For my yoke *is* easy, and my burden is light.”

C. Vs. 8- _____ is apart of the true Christian life!

1. **2 Timothy 3:12**- “Yea, and all that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution.”

2. **John 15:18**- “If the world hate you, ye know that it hated me before it hated you.”
3. **John3:19-20**- “ And this is the condemnation, that light is come into the world, and men loved darkness rather than light, because their deeds were evil. For every one that doeth evil hateth the light, neither cometh to the light, lest his deeds should be reproved.”
    a) This is why people hate and persecute those that do good! They hate the light. They don’t want to have to change.
4. **2 Corinthians 4:6-18**- READ
    a) Paul calls this a _____ How much lighter is our affliction in our lives!

D. Vs. 12- Trusting in God to bring us through to the end

1. **Hebrews 12:1-2**
    a) **Our example of enduring persecutions**: Jesus Christ
    b) **How he endured:** The joy that was set before him
    c) **How we must endure**: The _____. Eternal life with God! We know he promises eternal salvation. Now that we are saved, the worst that can happen is we are killed for our faith and we go to heaven! That is the joy set before us.
2. Discipleship
    a) In Paul’s final letter to Timothy, he says the word “endure” 4x!
        (1) 2 Tim. 2:3,10; 4:3,5
            (a) Discipleship….. This is the iron sharpening iron relationship we need! Paul knew his disciple Timothy would face great persecution. So he writes a final letter to his disciple to say “endure” In ALL of Paul’s epistles he says “endure” 7x. 4 are in this letter!

III. God has a huge mission for us this year! We are called to reach this school with the glorious gospel of Jesus Christ! It will be tough, embarrassing, and scary at times; but that is NOT from God. Satan’s plan is to scare us to the point where we don’t share the gospel. If he wins at making us fear, then he will win in his pursuit of stopping the _____ God has given us! In order to reach our friends, we cannot let him win. For the joy God has set before us, let’s endure to the end this week. Be bold to invite friends and share the good news this week.

2 Timothy: Iron sharpening Iron

I. Today we continue to take a look at the final letter of Paul to his disciple Timothy. Paul is writing to Timothy to encourage him to press forward and to continue on in the faith for Jesus Christ. Today we examine Paul telling Timothy to hold fast to the form of sound words, which he heard of Paul (also would be known to us as the Bible or the Word of God). In order to be faithful disciples of Jesus Christ we need to be spending time with him, and that can only be done through reading his words and praying to him.

II. 2 Tim. 1:13-14

A. "Hold fast"- This term as it is used in the Bible is used to describe much zeal for something. You grab ahold of it quickly because it is so dear to you.

1. **Job 27:6**- "My righteousness I hold fast, and will not let it go: my heart shall not reproach me so long as I live."
2. **Proverbs 4:13**- "Take fast hold of instruction; let her not go: keep her; for she is thy life."
3. **Psalm 119: 97,113,163,165**
    a) This is the kind of desire we must have for the Word of God! If we love something we will not let it go. We will keep in it our close reach.

B. Our love for God IS shown by our love for his Word

1. God is perfect; therefore he cannot say anything he would take back. His words are a TRUE reflection of who he is!
    a) **Psalm 138:2**- "I will worship toward thy holy temple, and praise thy name for thy lovingkindness and for thy truth: for thou hast magnified thy word about all thy name."
    b) **John 1:1**- "In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God."
        (1) God and his words are ONE. They are inseparable.

C. "form of sound words"

1. We must make sure that the words we are hearing are sound words
    a) **1 Cor. 14:33,40**- "For God is not the author of confusion, but of peace, as in all churches of the saints. Let all things be done decently and in order."
        (1) God is a God of order and reason. He will never not make sense, contradict, cause chaos, or confusion.

b) **2 Tim. 4:3**- “For the time will come when they will not endure sound doctrine; but after their own lusts shall they heap to themselves teachers, having itching ears;”

(1) Men’s words cannot be more important than God’s Word.This is why we must learn to study the Bible for ourselves so that we can have a personal relationship with God.

D. “which thou hast heard of me, in faith and love which is in Christ Jesus. That good thing which was committed unto thee keep by the Holy Ghost which dwelleth in us.”

1. Paul is expounding on the Word of God to his disciple (**Acts 8:26-31; Vs. 14**)
    a) We cannot depend on another person to tell us what the scriptures say. But one way or another we will have to learn how to read and apply the scriptures.
        (1) **1 Cor. 12:8**- “For to one is given by the Spirit the word of wisdom; to another the word of knowledge by the same Spirit;”
2. Pray to God to help us understand the Bible or to send someone our way to help us understand
    a) Acts 8:26-31
        (1) God has a divine appointment where he sends Philip to this man who wants to know more about the Word of God and what it means! God is faithful to help out those who are truly seeking to know him more

E. What we must now do

1. Be saved (without the Holy Spirit we cannot understand the Bible well)
2. Commit to be in the Word of God and actively pray for God to help you understand it/ if you don’t still, actively pray for God to send someone your way to help you understand (Acts 8)
3. Take the Bible for what it says. STUDY it (it will be WORK, you will have to take many things into consideration when studying the Bible: find context, rightly divide the Word, who God is speaking to, etc.)
    a) **2 Timothy 2:15**- “Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed, rightly dividing the word of truth.”
    b) **1 Corinthians 2:15**- “Which things also we speak, not in the words which man’s wisdom teacheth, but which the Holy Ghost teacheth; comparing spiritual things with spiritual.”
    c) **Colossians 3:16**- “Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly in all wisdom; teaching and admonishing one another in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing with grace in your hearts to the Lord.”

2 Timothy: Iron sharpening Iron

I. Today we will discuss the topic of discipleship in the Bible. Discipleship is the believers ministry; without it we can have no fruit that remains, we cannot glorify God, and we cannot fulfill our mission as believers. In this key verse for discipleship in the bible, Paul is writing to his DISCIPLE Timothy to tell him to pass on the things he has taught him to other faithful men who will teach others as well. This is a key part of our lives as Christians and a clear cut example and command given by Jesus after he left this world. In order to be true Christians "little Christs" following in our saviors footsteps, we must fulfill this biblical mandate.

II. 2 Timothy 2:2

A. "And the things that thou hast heard of me among many witnesses"

1. First, Timothy must know that these are true words Paul is speaking

a) **2 Timothy 1:13-** "Hold fast that form of sound words, which thou hast heard of me, in faith and love which is in Christ Jesus."

b) **2 Peter 3:15-** "And account that the longsuffering of our Lord is salvation; even as our beloved brother Paul also according to the wisdom given unto him hath written unto you; As also in all his epistles, speaking in them of these things; in which are some things hard to be understood, which they that are unlearned and unstable wrest, as they do also the other scriptures, unto their own destruction."

(1) No matter who is telling us what to believe we need to ALWAYS search the scriptures to find out the truth of the matter. The Word of God is the final authority for true Christians: not the words of imperfect men.

(2) Timothy knew he could hearken to the words of Paul because Paul was known to write under the inspiration of

God. Obviously we have his words recorded in the Holy Bible today and even Peter said Paul was inspired.

2. 2 Corinthians 11:2-4, 13-15

a) Here we see false gospels, <u>false Jesus</u> (there is such a thing; there is only one true Jesus), and false spirits. In general there are false doctrines which are being preached all over!

b) Who is preaching them? (vs. 13-15)

(1) False apostles, deceitful workers, who TRANSFORM THEMSELVES INTO ANGELS OF LIGHT.

(2) "¨<u>his</u> ministers". Satan has ministers, who show themselves to be angels of light, or ministers of righteousness

(3) We can weed these false ministers out by simply reading, studying, and believing the Word of God. They cannot teach from the Word or else they would be found out to be false ministers

B. "the same commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also."

1. "faithful men"

a) John 17:4-8

(1) Here Jesus is praying to his Father and states that he has finished the work that he gave him to do. But Jesus had not died yet? So what was this work? Discipleship (vs. 5-8)

(2) Jesus did not pick the holiest men. He did not pick the men who claimed to know the OT the best (Pharisees). He didn't pick the men that tithed the most, loved the most, knew the most, or even believed the most. He picked the faithful men who would continue on after he died and left! If the 12 were not faithful after Jesus death we would not be here today! (Acts 1:1-11)

b) Discipleship is about faithful men who will endure to the end, teach others what God has shown them, and multiply believers! We need to invest in faithful men who will not fall away and quit!

III. After looking at this simple verse in Paul's second letter to his beloved disciple Timothy, we can learn about our whole ministry as believers! With discipleship alone, we can

learn to discern from true and false teachers, learn to find faithful men, and multiply believers to reach the whole lost world! Without encouraging and discipling other believers we would become a few saved people who never learned to share the gospel, read the Bible, or have a personal walk with God; and we would die off fast. It is because of discipleship that we are here today, because of faithful men who taught others also!

Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

I. The _____ - 2 Tim. 4:1

   a. Always live with two judgments in the front of your mind

      i. Judgment of the "quick" (Judgment Seat of Christ)- Romans 14:10-12; 2 Cor. 5:9-10; Luke 19:11-27; 1 Cor. 3:11-15

      ii. Judgment of the "_____" (Great White Throne Judgment)- Dan. 12:2; John 5:28-29; Ecc. 12:14; Rev. 20:11-15

II. The _____ - 2 Tim. 4:2-4

   a. Preach the word (the gospel, coming judgement, righteousness and truth in all situations)- Mark 16:15; 1 Cor. 15:1; Col. 1:28

      i. In Season, Out of Season- Acts 5:40-42; Acts 16:23-25, 30-32

      ii. Reprove, Rebuke, Exhort with all longsuffering and doctrine- 2 Tim. 3:16-17; Jer. 1:9-10; 2 Tim. 2:24-25

      iii. Especially against the poor doctrine and lust fulfilling preaching/teachers who lead people away from the truth and only tell stories- Amos 8:11-12; 1 Tim. 4:1-3; 2 Pet. 2:1-3

III. We have a responsibility to preach the word of God (the gospel and biblical truths- 1 Tim. 3:15- *But if I tarry long, that thou mayest know how thou oughtest to behave thyself in the house of God, which is the church of the living God, the pillar and ground of the truth.)* We live in perilous times of false teachings, worldliness, and a famine of the word of God. With coming _____ and eternity in mind, we can preach as we are called to and actually make a difference.

Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

I. A quick background on this chapter: Paul is in prison, in Rome, writing his last book/letter ever to his beloved disciple Timothy. He is about to be executed and these are his final words of charge to his disciple (and to all those who have read them the last 2,000 years).

II. The **Motivation**- 2 Tim. 4:1

- a. Always live with two judgments in the front of your mind
  - i. Judgment of the "quick" (Judgment Seat of Christ)- Romans 14:10-12; 2 Cor. 5:9-10; Luke 19:11-27; 1 Cor. 3:11-15
    1. This is the **judgment** seat, it is a day of "judgment" and of "suffering loss" BUT it can and should be a day of "reward" and of hearing "well done thou good and faithful servant"
    2. Gold- Deity/Holiness- How holy are you living your life? Are you being conformed to the image of Christ everyday? Or are you being conformed to this world?- Exo.25:11; 1 Kings 6:22; Rev. 21:18
    3. Silver- Redemption/Purchasing- Are you leading people to the Lord? God gives the increase when we share the gospel, sometimes we don't see it because we aren't sowing consistently enough.- Num. 3:47-48; 18:15-16; Zach. 11:12-13; Matt. 26:15
    4. Precious Stones- Connected to people/sons- Discipleship and building people up. Are you investing in others? Are you seeing someone grow in Christ under your guidance as a "child"?- Mal. 3:17; 1 Pet. 2:5
    5. What you are doing on a day to day basis has eternal implications: every idle moment, worthless effort, investment in the fleshly and temporal world, will amount to nothing but wood, hay, and stubble and it will burn up at this judgment. You will watch your life and all of your time, effort, and all you built apart from God, BURN UP into nothing; wasted
  - ii. Judgment of the "**dead**" (Great White Throne Judgment)- Dan. 12:2; John 5:28-29; Ecc. 12:14; Rev. 20:11-15
    1. This is a day of wrath, final judgment, wailing, horror, and the result is eternal burning, suffering, and torment
    2. Those who are dead and in "Hell" now will be raised from the dead bodily, to then be judged by God for their sin, and then Death and Hell are thrown into the Lake of Fire, and then these are judged and thrown in. NEVER TO LEAVE AGAIN.
    3. We need to keep this judgement in mind at all times. No, we won't be judged at this, our sins are forgiven and were judged at the cross, but WHAT ABOUT THOSE we know that will be here? WE WILL BE IN ATTENDANCE HERE. Who do you still need to reach?

III. The **Mandate**- 2 Tim. 4:2-4

a. Preach the word (the gospel, coming judgement, righteousness and truth in all situations)- Mark 16:15; 1 Cor. 15:1; Col. 1:28
    i. In Season, Out of Season- Acts 5:40-42; Acts 16:23-25, 30-32
    ii. Reprove, Rebuke, Exhort with all longsuffering and doctrine- 2 Tim. 3:16-17; Jer. 1:9-10; 2 Tim. 2:24-25
    iii. Especially against the poor doctrine and lust fulfilling preaching/teachers who lead people away from the truth and only tell stories- Amos 8:11-12; 1 Tim. 4:1-3; 2 Pet. 2:1-3
        1. Amos 8:11-12- **hearing of the words of the Lord**; *the word of God does not exist anymore in the opinion of the majority today*
        2. 1 Tim. 4:1-3- **seducing spirits**; *charismatic movement, fake miracles, lies, experience over everything, not biblical.* **Doctrines of devils**; *what are devilish doctrines?* (Rev. 2:9; 3:9) *replacement theology. (1 Jn. 2:22; 4:3; 2 Jn. 1:7) denying the deity of Christ (JW'S, Mormons, Muslims, etc..)*
        3. 2 Pet. 2:1-3- **damnable heresies;** *denying the Lord that bought them, adding to salvation or misrepresenting salvation (Calvinists, most protestant groups, anyone who adds baptism to salvation);* **make merchandise of you;** *prosperity gospel preaching, many non denominational groups, music, worship, experience, a good time (they are buying you with seeker friendly services) because they are more interested in numbers, money, tithing, than preaching the truth*
            a. Interestingly, one group is a catch all for all of these: the Catholic Church (**no final authority**, they are the authority; **seducing spirits**; charismatic teachings, miracles, experiences, fake healings, etc..; **doctrines of devils and damnable heresies**, the original replacement theologians, against the jews, denying Jesus as God by making men into mediators, worshipping Mary, adding to salvation with the "sacraments"; **making merchandise of you**, indulgences (paying money for less time in purgatory for you/your family), relics of healing/blessing (Churches displayed relics (bones of saints, pieces of the cross, etc.), charging money to view them or promising spiritual benefit); Masses for the Dead (Families could pay priests to say Masses for souls in purgatory, believed to reduce their suffering)

IV. We have a responsibility to preach the word of God (mostly the gospel; also Biblical truths- 1 Tim. 3:15-*But if I tarry long, that thou mayest know how thou oughtest to behave thyself in the house of God, which is the church of the living God, the pillar and ground of the truth.)* We live in perilous times of false teachings, worldliness, and a famine of the word of God. With coming **judgment** and eternity in mind, we can preach as we are called to and actually make a difference.
    a. Are you prepared to preach? Do you know the gospel/bible truths?
    b. Are you prepared to do it "out of season"
    c. Are you living with the coming judgement and eternity in mind daily?

Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Timothy 4:5

1) _____ thou in all things
   a) Watch out for yourself- Mark 14:38; 1 Cor. 16:13
   b) Watch out for those around you- Eze. 33:1-7
   c) Watch as the time of the end gets closer- 1 Pet. 4:7; Mark 13:33-37; Matt. 24:42
      i) Quit living like nothing is happening, like there are no changes coming, like he isn't coming back- Matt. 24:37-39
2) Endure _____
   a) Don't just "get through" them, expect them and "endure through" them- 2 Tim. 1:8; 2:3,10; 3:10-12
   b) 1 Pet. 5:8-11- You endure afflictions:
      i) With other believers (vs. 9)
      ii) To be perfected (vs. 10)
      iii) To bring God glory (vs. 11)
   c) Two ways to live and their two outcomes
      i) Heb. 11:25-26- Temporary pleasure- Eternal Loss
      ii) 2 Cor. 4:17-18- Temporary affliction- Eternal Gain
         (1) What are you enduring?
3) Do the _____ of an evangelist
   a) Why does Paul remind Timothy of this? <u>Evangelism is lacking in the last days</u>
   b) Evangelist/evangelism shows up 3x in the Bible
      i) Eph. 4:11- One of the spiritual gifts
      ii) 2 Tim. 4:5- Paul reminding the young pastor Timothy to do this work of evangelism
      iii) Acts 21:8- Philip the evangelist
         (1) We see Philip in Acts a few times preaching Jesus Christ- Acts 8:4-5,12,35
   c) What is evangelism?
      i) Preaching Jesus Christ! His life, death, and resurrection; preaching the gospel
      ii) It is work
   d) The Biblical command to share the gospel/be evangelists is clear

i) Matt. 4:23; 9:35; 10:7; 11:5; 24:14; 26:13; Mark 1:14–15; 1:38–39; 3:14; 6:12; 13:10; 14:9; 16:15–16; 16:20; Luke 4:18–19; 4:43–44; 7:22; 8:1; 9:2; 9:6; 16:16; 24:47; Acts 5:42; 8:4; 8:5; 8:12; 8:25; 8:35; 8:40; 9:20; 10:36; 10:42; 11:20; 13:5; 13:32; 13:38; 13:49; 14:7; 14:15; 14:21; 15:7; 15:35; 16:10; 17:18; 20:25; 28:31; Rom. 1:15; 10:14–15; 15:19–20; 1 Cor. 1:17; 1:21; 1:23; 9:14; 9:16; 9:18; 15:1; 15:11; 15:14; 2 Cor. 4:5; 10:16; 11:7; Gal. 1:8–9; 1:11; 1:16; 1:23; 2:2; 2:7; 3:8; 4:13; Eph. 2:17; 3:8; 4:11; 6:19; Phil. 1:14–18; Col. 1:23; 1:28; 1 Thess. 2:2; 2:4; 2:9; 1 Tim. 2:7; 3:16; 2 Tim. 1:11; 4:2; 4:5; Titus 1:3; Heb. 4:2; 4:6; 1 Pet. 1:12; 1:25; 4:6

4) Make _____ proof of thy ministry

a) Finish the job, don't do half of the job, don't quit early- Col 4:17; John 17:4; Gal 6:9

Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Timothy 4:5

1) **Watch** thou in all things
   a) Watch out for yourself- Mark 14:38; 1 Cor. 16:13
   b) Watch out for those around you- Eze. 33:1-7
   c) Watch as the time of the end gets closer- 1 Pet. 4:7; Mark 13:33-37; Matt. 24:42
      i) Wake up!
      ii) Quit living like nothing is happening, like there are no changes coming, like he isn't coming back- Matt. 24:37-39
      iii) Live like it is your last day, your last chance to reach those around you! WATCH!
      iv) The signs are there! Don't make the same mistake as so many others have, heed the warning of Jesus himself and watch!
2) Endure **afflictions**
   a) Don't just "get through" them, expect them and "endure through" them- 2 Tim. 1:8; 2:3,10; 3:10-12
   b) 1 Pet. 5:8-11- You endure afflictions:
      i) With other believers (vs. 9)
      ii) To be perfected (vs. 10)
      iii) To bring God glory (vs. 11)
   c) Two ways to live and their two outcomes
      i) Heb. 11:25-26- Temporary pleasure- Eternal Loss
         (1) Moses chose not to live for the temporary pleasure of this "world" (Egypt) and will have eternal reward
         (2) Theses verses show us that to choose temporary pleasure in this life means to choose eternal loss of reward
      ii) 2 Cor. 4:17-18- Temporary affliction- Eternal Gain
         (1) Paul said that while our affliction is "but for a moment" but it brings a FAR MORE eternal weight of glory, eternal reward and gain
      iii) What are you enduring?
         (1) Loss of friends? Ridicule at school? Any sort of backlash for your beliefs/sharing Christ with people? For your testimony?
         (2) What have you "suffered" because you gave it up?
            (a) Moses gave up the riches of Egypt (all the world had to offer) for wandering in the wilderness (but later eternal reward)
            (b) Have you given up anything that has "afflicted" you? Something you gave up to follow Jesus Christ that caused you suffering, loss, affliction?
               (i) social media, sports, relationships, boyfriend, girlfriend, personal aspirations, sex, alcohol, partying, the "high school experience", etc..
3) Do the **work** of an evangelist
   a) Why does Paul remind Timothy of this? Evangelism is lacking in the last days
   b) Evangelist/evangelism shows up 3x in the Bible
      i) Eph. 4:11- One of the spiritual gifts
      ii) 2 Tim. 4:5- Paul reminding the young pastor Timothy to do this work of evangelism

iii) Acts 21:8- Philip the evangelist
(1) We see Philip in Acts a few times preaching Jesus Christ- Acts 8:4-5,12,35

c) What is evangelism?
i) Preaching Jesus Christ! His life, death, and resurrection; preaching the gospel
(1) Paul reminds Timothy over and over to preach the gospel (lookup "preach" almost always, the gospel!), do the work of an evangelist!
ii) It is work
(1) It is not easy, it takes time, effort, being willing to be uncomfortable, willing to GO out, FISH for men, NOT BE ASHAMED, etc.. (Matt. 4:19; Mk. 1:17)
(2) It is an active work, not passive, too many spend their whole lives trying to maneuver, connive, plan, strategize, etc.. and do anything they can to NOT JUST DO THE WORK of an evangelist
(a) Imagine trying to fish by:
(i) waiting for the fish to jump into the boat
(ii) only "casting out a line" to try and catch a fish whenever you happened to see a fish directly in the water
(iii) trying to befriend the fish first; you need to have a relationship with the fish before you can catch them
(iv) trying to catch the fish by making it clear to all of the fish that you are a fishermen and that is your job; hoping that they will see that you are a fisherman and want to be one too
(3) Friendship evangelism, testimony evangelism, not involved in corporate evangelism, NO evangelism, etc..

d) The Biblical command to share the gospel/be evangelists is clear
i) Matt. 4:23; 9:35; 10:7; 11:5; 24:14; 26:13; Mark 1:14–15; 1:38–39; 3:14; 6:12; 13:10; 14:9; 16:15–16; 16:20; Luke 4:18–19; 4:43–44; 7:22; 8:1; 9:2; 9:6; 16:16; 24:47; Acts 5:42; 8:4; 8:5; 8:12; 8:25; 8:35; 8:40; 9:20; 10:36; 10:42; 11:20; 13:5; 13:32; 13:38; 13:49; 14:7; 14:15; 14:21; 15:7; 15:35; 16:10; 17:18; 20:25; 28:31; Rom. 1:15; 10:14–15; 15:19–20; 1 Cor. 1:17; 1:21; 1:23; 9:14; 9:16; 9:18; 15:1; 15:11; 15:14; 2 Cor. 4:5; 10:16; 11:7; Gal. 1:8–9; 1:11; 1:16; 1:23; 2:2; 2:7; 3:8; 4:13; Eph. 2:17; 3:8; 4:11; 6:19; Phil. 1:14–18; Col. 1:23; 1:28; 1 Thess. 2:2; 2:4; 2:9; 1 Tim. 2:7; 3:16; 2 Tim. 1:11; 4:2; 4:5; Titus 1:3; Heb. 4:2; 4:6; 1 Pet. 1:12; 1:25; 4:6
(1) People will make their lives about anything and everything else, all the minor issues, BUT WILL NOT DO THE WORK OF AN EVANGELIST

4) Make **full** proof of thy ministry
a) Finish the job, don't do half of the job, don't quit early- Col 4:17; John 17:4; Gal 6:9
i) Don't do half of a job; don't ONLY watch, or ONLY endure affliction, or ONLY evangelize; DO THE WHOLE JOB
ii) Don't quit early; keep going! Time is short!
iii) Many people do elements of the work of ministry for a time; BUT FEW do all of it and don't quit early (Paul and those he ministered with)
iv) Seniors; don't stop now, do more than you have ever done. See to this ministry God has given you (EDGE) and the one he has given you at school, sports, clubs, etc…
v) Younger students; start growing in this process, keep growing, don't stop growing and serving more each day
vi) If you aren't growing; you are dying

Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Timothy 4:6-7

1) _____ the Good Fight
    i) Paul talks over and over again about the Christian life being like a war, here he compares his life to that of a solider- 1 Tim. 6:12; Phil. 2:25; Philemon 1:2; 2 Tim. 2:3-4
    ii) Here, Paul lays out the nature of this "battle" and how to be ready for it- Eph. 6:10-18
  b) Finish your _____
    i) The Christian life is compared to here by Paul to the life of an athlete
      (1) Running with the end/prize in mind- Heb. 12:1-2; Phillip. 3:13-14; 1 Cor. 9:24-27
      (2) The need for training and discipline
        (a) Paul emphasizes that you don't get the prize by "chance" or with laziness but with hard work, temperance, and discipline- 1 Cor. 9:24-27
  c) Keep the _____
    i) Paul ends by saying he "kept the faith"
      (1) We know he is not referring to "keeping" his salvation faith; so what does this mean?
    ii) Our entire Christian lives from salvation on is about "faith- Jude 3; Col. 2:6-7
      (1) Faith shows itself in many ways:
        (a) Obedience to the word of God- Rom. 10:17; Heb. 4:2
        (b) Prayer lives- Jude 20; James 1:5-6
        (c) Our dependance on God- John 15
          (i) Abide in Christ; are you living your life in your power or in his?
      (2) We all need to be able to say with Paul by the end of our lives "I have kept the faith", otherwise we will not have been successful- Heb. 11:6

Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Timothy 4:6-7

Paul just told timothy to make full proof of his ministry (keep going, don't stop short, finish the job); and then follows up by telling him HOW he finished his ministry and that his time in life was coming to an end

1) **Fight the Good Fight**
   - i) Paul talks over and over again about the Christian life being like a war, here he compares his life to that of a solider- 1 Tim. 6:12; Phil. 2:25; Philemon 1:2; 2 Tim. 2:3-4
   - ii) Here, Paul lays out the nature of this "battle" and how to be ready for it- Eph. 6:10-18
     - (1) Truth- Are you standing for the truth, do you share it with others when you can
     - (2) Righteousness- Best definition of righteousness; are you doing what is right? Is your life, actions, testimony, speech, etc.. RIGHT?
     - (3) Preparation of the gospel of peace- Are you prepared to share the gospel?
       - (a) So many people are simply NOT PREPARED, and that is why they let opportunities go or don't share the gospel at all
     - (4) Faith- Are you resting in God's power? Belief/trust in God is your main line of defense. God is the true source of power in your Christian life and IT it meant to block the attacks of the "wicked"
     - (5) Helmet of salvation- Assurance of your salvation protects your "head" (your thinking). If you constantly struggle with assurance of your salvation, you don't know that you are saved, then you will not think right and your head is vulnerable to the enemy
     - (6) Sword of the Spirit/Word of God- This is the only offensive/defensive weapon. It is also the only real part of the armor that you must train on to use. The more trained you are with this, the more of a threat you are and the more you can defend yourself.
       - (a) It is the spirit of God who teaches us, the sword/word of God is HIS weapon, we must lean on him to be able to understand/use it
         - (i) ALL OF THE PIECES OF ARMOR ARE NEEDED DAILY to SURVIVE. "to stand". Missing any of them by not making "full proof" of your ministry, can be deadly when you are actively engaged in battle.
         - (ii) If you feel that you don't have these and yet are "unscathed" you are probably not in the battle at all

b) Finish your course

- i) The Christian life is compared to here by Paul to the life of an athlete
  - (1) Running with the end/prize in mind- Heb. 12:1-2; Phillip. 3:13-14; 1 Cor. 9:24-27
    - (a) Jesus Christ endured the cross with the end in mind. We can endure this life with the same mindset
    - (b) Paul talks about running life more like a "marathon" than a spring "with patience/endurance"
    - (c) Paul talked about running to obtain a prize. He ran toward the prize of the high calling of God in Christ Jesus. The prize is the calling, the chance to serve him!

(d) He also talks about running to obtain! Think of the parable of the pounds (I am sure Paul was). He wants to have reward to cast back to Jesus, and that mean running to "obtain". Otherwise you will LOSE out on your reward that you even have.

(2) The need for training and discipline

(a) Paul emphasizes that you don't get the prize by "chance" or with laziness but with hard work, temperance, and discipline- 1 Cor. 9:24-27

(i) The lost world spends HOURS per day, 7 DAYS per week, EVERY WEEK, MONTH, and YEAR to master: sports, academics, acting, music, etc.. YET CHRISTIANS don't work 1% of that to obtain in INCORRUPTIBLE CROWN! Eternal rewards! Souls at stake!

1. If we worked as hard to "obtain" that prize as we do for "corruptible" crowns, this world would be flipped upside down immediately!

(ii) Are you disciplined? In reading, prayer, service, etc.. or are you up and down/inconsistent?

c) <u>Keep the Faith</u>

i) Paul ends by saying he "kept the faith"

(1) We know he is not referring to "keeping" his salvation faith; so what does this mean?

ii) Our entire Christian lives from salvation on is about "faith- Jude 3; Col. 2:6-7

(1) Faith shows itself in many ways:

(a) Obedience to the word of God- Rom. 10:17; Heb. 4:2

(b) Prayer lives- Jude 20; James 1:5-6

(c) Our dependance on God- John 15

(i) Abide in Christ; are you living your life in your power or in his?

1. Do I consistently set aside time to seek Christ through His Word and prayer?
2. When I face decisions, do I turn first to my own reasoning, or do I stop to ask, *"What would the Lord have me do?"*
3. Is my heart more stirred by time with Jesus than by entertainment, work, or achievements?
4. Do I often feel like I can "handle life" on my own, or do I truly recognize, *"Without Him I can do nothing"* (John 15:5)?
5. Am I more quick to worry and stress — or to pray and trust?
6. Do I obey God's Word even when it is inconvenient or costly?
7. How often do I talk with Him throughout my day, not just in "set prayer times"?

(2) We all need to be able to say with Paul by the end of our lives "I have kept the faith", otherwise we will not have been successful- Heb. 11:6

2) Are you in a spiritual battle? If you are, are you prepared for the war?

3) Are you training and disciplined? What reward will you have in heaven to show for it?

4) Are you living in faith? Without faith we cannot please God. What in your life can you point to and be able to say you are "keeping the faith"

Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Timothy 4:8

1) There are two kinds of _____ that we lay up for ourselves each day (vs. 8a)
   a) Eternal treasure vs. Earthly treasure (vs. 8; Matt. 6:19-20; 1 Tim. 6:17-19)
      i) There are only two things on this earth that are eternal:
         (1) Souls of men- Mt. 25:46; Jn. 5:28-29
         (2) Word of God- Isa. 40:8; Psa. 119:89; Mt. 24:35; 1 Pet. 1:23-25
2) Crown of _____ (vs. 8b)
   a) Paul says that this crown is specifically for those who look forward to Jesus return- Titus 2:13; Luke 12:35-37
   b) There is more to this than simply being happy about Jesus coming back; we need to "watch" and be aware of the events surrounding us, and he will honor this- Mk. 13:33-37; Mt. 24:42-44; 1 Thess. 5:1-6; Prov. 27:18
   c) What is so important about this crown/the other crowns?
      i) These crowns are separate and specific reward (beside our gold, silver, precious stones from the judgment seat of Christ); these are for specific things we are called to do and can earn crowns for- 1 Thess. 2:19; 2 Tim. 4:8; James 1:1-2; 1 Pet. 5:4
      ii) These crowns are meant to be cast back at Jesus's feet in worship- Rev. 4:4; 10-11

Questions to Consider:

- What are you investing in? Eternal things for an eternal reward? Or temporary things for a temporary/earthly reward?
- Are you living each day WATCHING carefully, living in urgency and anticipation of Jesus return?
- Will you have this crown of righteousness to cast back to Jesus on judgement day?

Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Timothy 4:8

1) There are two kinds of **treasure** that we lay up for ourselves each day (vs. 8a)
   i) Looked up this term "laid up; laying up" and God connected the dots
   b) Eternal treasure vs. Earthly treasure (vs. 8; Matt. 6:19-20; 1 Tim. 6:17-19)
   i) Paul knew what kind of treasure he was laying up; his was an eternal reward
   ii) Will have eternal treasure? Or will you suffer loss? (1 Cor. 3:15)
   iii) There are only two things on this earth that are eternal:
   (1) Souls of men- Mt. 25:46; Jn. 5:28-29
   (2) Word of God- Isa. 40:8; Psa. 119:89; Mt. 24:35; 1 Pet. 1:23-25
   (a) A simple test to know if you will have eternal reward? How is your investment into these two things?
   (b) If you are investing time into studying, teaching, preaching the word of God, sharing the gospel, edifying the body of Christ, discipling, etc..) then you are investing in these two eternal investments.
   (c) KEY: ANYTHING AND EVERYTHING ELSE IN YOUR LIFE THAT YOU INVEST IN, even if it may be important, is temporal and laying up treasure on this earth, NOT ETERNAL REWARD
   (d) Anytime you invest in the "necessary evils" of this world (things we all have to do and that our lives require of us) can still build eternal reward WHEN WE USE IT FOR GOD and don't just "drag through"

2) Crown of **righteousness** (vs. 8b)

   This is one of the crowns that we can get based on our service to God in this life

   a) Paul says that this crown is specifically for those who look forward to Jesus return- Titus 2:13; Luke 12:35-37
   i) This goes along with the last point also: if you are earthly minded and fully invested here, you will find this world/life hard to leave and you WONT look forward to his return; BUT if you are heavenly/eternally minded, and investing there, you will not be able to wait to get home!
   b) There is more to this than simply being happy about Jesus coming back; we need to "watch" and be aware of the events surrounding us, and he will honor this- Mk. 13:33-37; Mt. 24:42-44; 1 Thess. 5:1-6; Prov. 27:18
   i) Paul is reminding us to WAKE UP!!

ii) Look around you, look at the world, look at the hatred of God's people Israel, and don't be ignorant of it.

(1) Some Christians talk about this like they don't need/want to look at prophesy or they don't care about it; but we are RESPONSIBLE to know the times and seasons and signs; we will be honored for "waiting for our master" and for "looking forward to his appearing". There is a crown for this! God wouldn't give us the details of the signs and tell us to WATCH, over and over and over and over again, if he didn't care and didn't want us to care

(2) Why is there a crown for this? Because when we watch like this and we are living in anticipation of it, it spurs us to serve more zealously. It give us a sense of urgency! Which we desperately need!

c) What is so important about this crown/the other crowns?

i) These crowns are separate and specific reward (beside our gold, silver, precious stones from the judgment seat of Christ); these are for specific things we are called to do and can earn crowns for- 1 Thess. 2:19; 2 Tim. 4:8; James 1:1-2; 1 Pet. 5:4

ii) These crowns are meant to be cast back at Jesus's feet in worship- Rev. 4:4; 10-11

(1) In this amazing moments of millions of Christians casting crowns back to Jesus to worship him, will you have anything to cast back to him? Or will you stand ashamed and empty handed on that day?

3) What are you investing in? Eternal things for an eternal reward? Or temporary things for a temporary/earthly reward?

4) Are you living each day WATCHING carefully, living in urgency and anticipation of Jesus return?

5) Will you have this crown of righteousness to cast back to Jesus on judgement day?

Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Tim. 4:9-22- Finishing Well

1. Demas- This is an example of a believer who starts out _____but does not finish well- Col 4:14; Philemon 24; vs. 10
    a. Loving the world will pull you away from God- 1 John 2:15-16; Luke 8:14
    b. If you love the pleasures of the world more than God? If you do, your life will lack power- 2 Tim. 3:4-5
2. Marcus/Mark- This is an example of a believer who starts out strong, walks away for a _____, but then ends strong- vs. 11
    a. Mark ministered with Paul early on- Col. 4:2; Philemon 24; Acts 12:2, 25
    b. Mark walked away during this time for some reason or another- Acts 13:13; 15:37-39
    c. Mark repented and came back and was profitable- vs. 11; 1 Pet. 5:13
        i. He becomes a disciple of Peter and then writes the gospel of Mark
        ii. No matter where you are today, God's desire is for your repentance, not to wallow in shame/pity- John 8:11; Isa. 55:7; Eze. 18:30-32; Joel 2:12-13; Luke 15:7, 20-24
3. Lucas/Luke & Priscilla and Aquila- These are examples of believers who start out strong, don't become "weary in well doing", and then finish _____- vss. 11, 19
    a. Luke was Paul's personal traveling physician for Paul's thorn in the flesh. He travelled with Paul through the book of Acts all the way to the end of Paul's life- Acts 16:10-11, 12-17; 20:5-6; 21:1,17; 27:1; 28:16; Col. 4:14; Philemon 24
    b. Priscilla and Aquilla were a husband and wife. They were tent makers (like Paul) who faithfully served God wherever he called them- Acts 18:3, 18-19
        i. They had churches meet in their home- 1 Cor. 16:19; Rom. 16:5
        ii. They instructed others who were off in doctrine (discipled)- Acts 18:26
        iii. They laid down their lives for the ministry- Rom. 16: (1 Cor. 15:58)

Paul's Last, Last Words-
2 Timothy 4

2 Tim. 4:9-22- Finishing Well

1. Demas- This is an example of a believer who starts out **strong** but does not finish well- Col 4:14; Philemon 24; vs. 10
    a. Loving the world will pull you away from God- 1 John 2:15-16; Luke 8:14
        i. Too many people start off great, but later they fall off, they slowly but surely start to love the world and end up far from God, forsaking him
        ii. Demas traveled with Paul, endured persecution, preached, saw people saved, etc.. but in the end he loved the world more than God
    b. If you love the pleasures of the world more than God? If you do, your life will lack power- 2 Tim. 3:4-5
        i. How do you know if you love somehting? What do you spend your time thinking about? Spend your time with? Spend your energy on? What do you desire/choose the most?
            1. God or: BF/GF, sports, school, video games, tv shows, music, social media, clubs, parties, money, family, social gatherings/places you hangout, etc...
            2. Write it out, what do you spend the most time on? What occupies your time/thinking the most? Be honest: write 1-3 down now.
        ii. Loving this world is a slippery slope, it will lead you away from God
2. Marcus/Mark- This is an example of a believer who starts out strong, walks away for a **season**, but then ends strong- vs. 11
    a. Mark ministered with Paul early on- Col. 4:2; Philemon 24; Acts 12:2, 25
    b. Mark walked away during this time for some reason or another- Acts 13:13; 15:37-39
        i. Maybe he was fearful (they were enduring a lot of persecution during this time), maybe he had business to take care of back home (family member care/funeral), maybe he lacked the faith needed to rely on the provision of God and wanted to go back to his buiness at home.
        ii. Why do we walk away? Sin, cares of the world, fear of persecution/riducule, lack of care for the work/no burdern, too involved in other things, etc.. Whatever it is, we can do what mark did at times
    c. Mark repented and came back and was profitable- vs. 11; 1 Pet. 5:13
        i. He becomes a disciple of Peter and then writes the gospel of Mark
        ii. No matter where you are today, you have fallen away, not kept your commitments (camp), are living a lie/sham, aren't walking with God, have fallen in love iwht the world, have left the work; God's desire is for your repentance,

not to wallow in shame/pity- John 8:11; Isa. 55:7; Eze. 18:30-32; Joel 2:12-13; Luke 15:7, 20-24

1. There are plenty of "pharisean" people out there who want to condemn you; this is Satanic. If you are a believer in here the bible says "There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus". He does not condemn you, he wants your repentance!
2. Think of all the self righteous people who probably heard of this situation with Mark, they probably mocked it and made fun of it; I wonder how many of them got to pen words of the eternally preserved word of God that will last for eternity! God is more interested in your repentance than in your being perfect all the time!

3. Lucas/Luke & Priscilla and Aquila- These are examples of believers who start out strong, don't become "weary in well doing", and then finish **strong**- vss. 11, 19
    a. Luke was Paul's personal traveling physician for Paul's thorn in the flesh. He travelled with Paul through the book of Acts all the way to the end of Paul's life- Acts 16:10-11, 12-17; 20:5-6; 21:1,17; 27:1; 28:16; Col. 4:14; Philemon 24
        i. He was specially trained to be able to write detailed accounts of the gospel and of the early church. Many refer to his writings as being that of a trained "historian" during a time where literacy was very low!
        ii. His training allowed him to help/serve the ministry specially, not being up front but using his skills to serve Paul all the way to the end, and even penning 2 NT books that have eternal impact
    b. Priscilla and Aquilla were a husband and wife. They were tent makers (like Paul) who faithfully served God wherever he called them- Acts 18:3, 18-19
        i. They had churches meet in their home- 1 Cor. 16:19; Rom. 16:5
        ii. They instructed others who were off in doctrine (discipled)- Acts 18:26
        iii. They laid down their lives for the ministry- Rom. 16:4
            1. We can learn a lot from all of these. Even liviing normal lives, normal jobs, etc.. we can use these to serve God WHEN we give them up 100% for him. At risk of our lives, livelihoods, time, home, personal time, WHATEVER THE COST. Our "daily duties" never overtake our commitment to the ministry.
            2. Then we can learn from them in their tenacity. They never gave up, they went all the way to the end. Never fell away. Consistent and reliable.
            3. I hope to hear reports of all of you that you are walking with God, serving faithfully. Whether you faltered for a time (it's better not to), or if you are strong today and stay strong; wherver you find yourself, DRAW CLOSE TO GOD. If you are close today, draw closer. If you fall away, draw closer. Don't be like Demas. Don't let the last word on you be that you loved the world and left the work (1 Cor. 15:58)

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1 John *The Challenging Letter*

November 18, 2016

I. Today we will take a look at the next verse in 1 John. It may not be a lengthy verse to read, however when we cross reference and study it out as the Bible tells us to (2 Timothy 2:15; 1 Corinthians 2:13) we find there are many things to learn from it! First, how Jesus was clearly shown as the_____. Second, how if we accept that, that we should live our lives to share that great news; through our actions and sharing _____of Jesus with all those around us.

II. 1 John 1:2

A. "(For the life was manifested,"....

1. The life is _____

a) **1 John 5:20**- " And we know that the Son of God is come, and hath given us an understanding, that we may know him that is true, and we are in him that is true, even in his Son Jesus Christ. This is the true God, and eternal life."

b) **1 John 5:11**- " And this is the record, that God hath given to us eternal life, and this life is in his Son."

2. Manifest- "Plain, open, clearly visible to the eye or obvious to understanding, _____to be seen or understood."

a) Jesus was made manifest!

(1) Prophesies

(a) Micah 5:2- Born in Bethlehem (Luke 2:11)

(b) Genesis 12: 1-3- Descendant of Abraham (Luke 3:23-38)

(c) 2 Samuel 7:12-13- Descendant of David (Luke 3:23-38)

(d) Isaiah 7:14- Born of a virgin (Luke 1:27)

b) These were ALL things the Jews were waiting for!

(1) Matthew 15:1-11

(a) The pharisees and scribes knew a lot about the bible!

(i) Their hearts were _____though! They had their own traditions!

(ii) Are we having hard hearts to God's Word? To who Jesus is and what he did? God made it CLEAR! (manifest)

B. "and bear witness, and shew unto you that eternal life, which was with the Father, and was manifested unto us;)"

1. Instead of having hard hearts, we see Jesus is clearly God, sent of the Father, and we _____!

a) Romans 8:16- "The spirit itself beareth witness with our spirit, that we are the children of God:"

(1) The Holy Spirit in us should shine through!

(2) God is light, this world is dark (Eph. 5:8). We are commanded to walk as children of _____since God is light!

b) Matthew 28:19-20- "Go ye therefore, and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost: Teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you: and, lo, I am with you alway, even unto the end of the world. Amen.

(1) Clear command from Jesus himself. His last words to his disciples.

(a) Sharing the gospel! That is what we are doing when we baptize in the name of God (Father, Son, Holy Ghost) Spiritual baptism is what he is talking about!

(2) Baptize- The literal translation from Hebrew is to be completely immersed.

(a) Be completely immersed in God (by the Spirit of God, the blood of Jesus)

(b) When we are saved we are covered completely by the_____. Our sins are covered and forgotten.

(3) What Jesus is saying is basically, share the gospel and bring people to the saving grace of Jesus Christ and salvation! As someone did for us. (it was made manifest to us)

III. In conclusion today we learned in this one simple verse how Jesus was clearly shown to be the Son of God, and how if we accept that as we should what to then do with it; share it through how we _____and our actions, and through _____and sharing the gospel (good news) with others. Will you be faithful to share your faith this week? Do you have faith, and know Jesus is the Son of God? If so, have you ever prayed and told him that and been saved? That is the first step.

1 John *The Challenging Letter*

December 2, 2016

I. Last week we talked about how Jesus was made manifest as the the Christ! Also, since he was made_____, how when we accept that, to now share that news of who Jesus is with those around us. This week we look at the next two verses in 1 John and we will see how when we share that news and other people accept it, that now we naturally have _____with them. They are now our family in Christ, hence why our fellowship is with the Father, and his son Jesus.

II. 1 John 1:3(a)

A. "That which we have seen and heard declare we unto you,"

1. When we have received Jesus, we are then commissioned to share that news of what God did in us!

a) This is John, Jesus beloved disciple speaking, and he is referring to what he literally saw and heard while with Christ.

(1) Also referring to salvation and knowing God

B. " that ye also may have fellowship with us:"

1. **Fellowship**- Companionship; society; consort; mutual association of persons on equal and friendly terms; familiar acquaintance.

a) **1 John 3:1**- "Behold, what manner of love the Father hath bestowed upon us, that we should be called the sons of God: therefore the world knoweth us not, because it knew him not."

b) **Romans 8:14**- "For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, they are the sons of God."

c) **John 1:12**- "But as many as received him, to them gave he power to become the sons of God, even to them that believe on his name:"

(1) All of these verses speak of us being the sons of God (the children of God) when we are saved and have accepted Christ. We are immediately entered into the_____!

(a) We have a natural fellowship together as part of the same family of God!

C. “and truly our fellowship is with the Father, and with his Son Jesus Christ.”
    1. We have fellowship with other_____, but that fellowship is also joined with the Father and Jesus Christ
        a) When we are in the family of God, we now have fellowship with God again, as the advocate Jesus makes our plea for us after we have accepted his sacrifice!
            (1) This is amazing that now we sinners can know God again because we have been forgiven from our sin and can now talk and walk with God again!
        b) How we have fellowship with _____
            (1) Salvation
                (a) Admitting we’re sinners and need a savior;
                (b) believing Jesus died for us and rose again defeating sin and death;
                (c) asking God to save you.
                    (i) Romans 10:9- “That if thou shalt confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and shalt believe in thine heart that God hath raised him from the dead, thou shalt be saved.”
            (2) Walking with God daily
                (a) Reading the _____daily to hear from God and learn his heart and know him more.
                (b) Praying to God, bringing your cares and worries to him in prayer, and talking to God.
                (c) _____ what God calls you to do according to his Word;

D. “And these things write we unto you, that your joy may be full.”
    1. This is a father writing to his children
        a) The father wants what is best for his children, and only wishes to offer the best advice from personal experience, for his kids to live joyful lives
        b) He says:
            (1) Your joy can be _____ in knowing that you have a savior, and an advocate that I can vouch for when I say that he is God!
                (a) 1 John 3:1
            (2) Your joy can be full in knowing that you may face trouble from the world, but you have a family and

fellowship with your brothers and sisters in the greatest _____of all; the family of God!

(3) Your joy can be full in knowing that you have fellowship with God himself! (the creator of all the universe) and that he died on a cross, in the body of his creation (human), JUST TO SAVE AND KNOW YOU! That is how much God loves you

(a) Also that since when were saved were in the family of God, we stay there! We can't change the fact that we're in his family it is _____! Our joy can be full knowing that God will not leave us!

III. In conclusion today we have seen how this letter written from a father to his children, shows us the_____! He wants to know us, but can only do so if we know him! We do that by first receiving Christ and being saved! Then we read and pray and talk to him to know him more, and _____him! This is a great picture of God the Father writing to us children to tell us how our joy can be full in knowing we have an advocate in Christ, a _____ family in Christ, and fellowship with God if we allow him to because he wants to know us that bad!

1 John *The Challenging Letter*

December 8, 2016

I. Today we will be discussing what it takes to walk as children of God. These verses will reveal to us what it means to walk as we should; in _____. God longs for us to walk in light with him because we are now _____ of light! When we walk as he calls us to we will find that it will bring the most satisfying feeling of anything this world has to offer! It full cause our joy to be _____! We will have fellowship with God and our fellow brothers and sisters in Christ as well.

II. 1 John 1:5- "This then is the message which we have heard of him, and declare unto you, that God is light and in him is no darkness at all."

A. Jesus

1. Rev. 1:16- "And he had in his right hand seven stars: and out of his mouth went a sharp twoedged sword: and his countenance was as the sun in his strength."
2. Acts 9:3-9*
    a) This is important to us because God (Jesus) is perfect, this is why he is so glorious and bright! He had to be perfect in order to save us on the cross!

B. God the Father

1. Exodus 33:18-23

2. Exodus 34:5, 29-35***
    a) Moses is in the _____ of a rock
    b) God the Father has to turn his back to him
    c) Also God is in a _____
    d) Also God's hand is covering Moses
        (1) Yet, Moses is still glowing that the people notice and are afraid because of how glorious God's light is!

C. Holy Spirit (in us)
1. Eph. 5:8- "For ye were sometimes darkness, but now are ye light in the Lord: walk as children of light:"
2. 2 Cor. 4:6- "For God, who commanded the light to shine out of darkness, hath shined in our hearts, to give the light of the knowledge of the glory of God in the face of Jesus Christ."
    a) When we are saved the _____restores our dead spirit in us and lives in us forever!
        (1) Genesis 2:16-17, 3:6, ch. 5
        (2) Eph. 4:30- "And grieve not the holy Spirit of God, whereby ye are sealed unto the day of redemption."

D. 1 John 1:6- "If we say that we have fellowship with him, and walk in darkness, we lie, and do not the truth:"
1. Exodus 34:29-35

a) Moses spent time with God and was in the presence of God!
    (1) Fellowship- Companionship; society; consort; mutual association of persons on equal and friendly terms; familiar acquaintance.
        (a) This would be somebody you spend time with, hang out with, and talk with daily!
b) If we have fellowship and spend time with God we should be _____ his light!
    (1) If we are walking with him then the same will be known of us!
    (2) Others will be able to see it (Exo. 34:29-35)! And they may even be scared and not want to be around you! Especially those in darkness!
        (a) John 3:19- “And this is the condemnation, that light is come into the world, and men loved darkness rather than light, because their deeds were evil.”
c) If we’re in darkness and not shining God’s glory forth (the spirit inside of us) then we are either:
    (1) Not saved- Eph. 5:8
    (2) Not _____with God- Eph. 5:8

(a) If we are not walking as children of light we will look just like the dark world!

E. 1 John 1:7- “But if we walk in the light, as he is in the light, we have fellowship one with another, and the blood of Jesus Christ his Son cleanseth us from all sin.”

1. How we walk in light; we spend time with God by:

a) Reading his Word and obeying it

(1) Psalm 119:105- “Thy word is a lamp unto my feet, and a light unto my path.”

(a) The Word is a light

(2) 1 John 5:7- “For there are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost: and these three are one.”

(a) Jesus is called the Word

(3) John 1:1 “In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.”

(a) Jesus and the Word are the same

(i) If Jesus is light: the _____is light

b) Prayer

(1) Come into God’s presence in prayer

(a) When we pray to God we come before him to make requests. We talk with him!

(i) Phil. 4:6- “Be careful for nothing, but in everything by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your requests be made known unto God.”

(b) This will also shine through and show when we go about our day! People will notice!

2. Fellowship with one another

a) 1 John 1:3

(1) John wants his “children” to understand this message, and says that then they can have fellowship with one another! True fellowship!

(2) Brotherly fellowship comes from _____ together in light!

(a) Amos 3:3- “Can two walk together, except they be agreed?”

3. The blood of Jesus Christ cleanseth us from all sin

(1) When we walk in darkness we may either be;

(a) Not walking with God <u>or</u>

(b) _____!

b) Salvation & light

(1) When we are saved we receive the Holy Spirit! (Eph. 4:30)

(a) The Holy Spirit is light because God is light! (1 John 5:7)

(2) Therefore we should be walking in light we should be _____

(a) Titus 2:14- “Who gave himself for us, that he might redeem us from all iniquity, and purify unto himself a peculiar people, zealous of good works.”

III. As we have seen today God is_____! If we are his children then we should be walking in light! First, we need to make sure we know him and are_____! Then, we need to make sure that we spend time with him, and then our countenance will show to others how we’re different! People will know your a child of light! Do you need saved today! Do you maybe just need to spend more time with God, and live different? One thing is for sure; we cannot be living in darkness, and then say we know God, else we’re lying!

A Challenging Letter 1 John

1. John 1:1-2
    a. It is our job to show others where we have found **eternal** life (if we truly have found it)- John 4:28-30, 39; John 1:40-42, 45-46; John 14:6
        i. Who are you showing "the life" you have found to? Matt. 5:16; Mk. 5:19
2. John 1:3a
    a. John says that they are declaring what they have **seen** and heard
    b. What have you seen and heard?- Psa. 66:16; Acts 22:15
        i. What has God shown you? Have you seen life change? Led others to salvation? Seen miracles? Learned things from God personally?- (2 Cor. 5:17)
            1. If you have not seen these things, it could be that you are not saved.
                a. You are not seeing fruit, not experiencing life change (2 Cor. 5:17), not caring to share "the light" of the gospel with others (maybe you don't have the light yourself) **BUT ONE THING IS FOR CERTAIN, IF WE HAVE SEEN AND HEARD OF JESUS PERSONALLY, WE SHOULD BE SHOWING OTHERS**
3. John 1:3b-4
    a. Fellowship **together** is a sign of fellowship with Jesus- Phil. 2:1-2; Acts 2:42
        i. Do you care to/try to fellowship with other believers? Do you desire to be part of this youth ministry?
            1. If not, it is a sign you don't have fellowship with Christ!
            2. You may not have a RELATIONSHIP with him (salvation)
    b. Fellowship together and with Jesus brings TRUE JOY- John 15:11; Psa. 16:11
4. John 1:5-7
    a. If we walk in **darkness** and say we know him, we are lying- John 3:19-20; 1 Jn. 2:4, 9, 11; John 8:12; Eph. 4:17-18
    b. A sign of walking in light is fellowship with one another- 1 Jn. 3:14; 4:7, 20-21; John 13:34-35

KEY QUESTIONS:

1. Where is the **evidence** of your salvation? Is there any?
2. If you KNOW you are saved, are you showing others what you have seen and heard? If not, your life isn't matching what you are claiming.
3. Do you enjoy fellowship with light or with darkness in your life?

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A Challenging Letter 1 John

1. John 2:1-2 Do you have an advocate with the father? Who is paying for your sin?
    - Propitiation- Satisfactory payment (Romans 6:23)

How do I know if I am his child, if he is my advocate, and who is **paying** for my sin?

a. John 2:3-5 Do you keep his **commandments**?

a. Who would say, "I know him"? Are you keeping his commandments? If not, then look what he says, "is a liar and the truth is not in him". Who is the way, **the truth**, and the life?

b. Simple Test of if we are keeping his commandments:

- ☐ You shall have no other gods before Me- Exodus 20:3, Deuteronomy 5:7
- ☐ You shall not make idols or worship images- Exodus 20:4-6, Deuteronomy 5:8-10
- ☐ You shall not take the name of the LORD your God in vain- Exodus 20:7, Deuteronomy 5:11
- ☐ Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it holy- Exodus 20:8-11, Deuteronomy 5:12-15
- ☐ Honor your father and your mother- Exodus 20:12, Deuteronomy 5:16
- ☐ You shall not murder- Exodus 20:13, Deuteronomy 5:17
- ☐ You shall not commit adultery- Exodus 20:14, Deuteronomy 5:18
- ☐ You shall not steal- Exodus 20:15, Deuteronomy 5:19
- ☐ You shall not bear false witness- Exodus 20:16, Deuteronomy 5:20
- ☐ You shall not covet- Exodus 20:17, Deuteronomy 5:21
- ☐ Love the Lord your God with all your heart, soul, and mind- Matthew 22:37, Deuteronomy 6:5
- ☐ Love your neighbor as yourself- Matthew 22:39, Leviticus 19:18
- ☐ Love one another- John 13:34-35
- ☐ Love your enemies- Matthew 5:44
- ☐ Forgive others- Matthew 6:14-15, Matthew 18:21-22
- ☐ Pray- Matthew 6:6-13, Luke 18:1
- ☐ Seek first the kingdom of God- Matthew 6:33
- ☐ Preach the gospel- Mark 16:15
- ☐ Be holy- 1 Peter 1:15-16
- ☐ Do not be conformed to this world- Romans 12:2
- ☐ Flee sexual immorality- 1 Corinthians 6:18

a. John 2:6- Are you **walking** as he walked?

a. Jesus was perfect, holy, loving, forgiving, etc.. he was perfect in keeping all of the commandments. How can we be "Christians" (little Christs) if we don't walk like he did?

i. If we don't walk as he walked, then we are not in him, according to these verses

ii. Our actions will show who we truly are and who we truly belong to

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Word of God= Water for cleaning

- Ephesians 5:26 – “washing of water by the word”
- John 15:3 – “ye are clean through the word”
- Psalm 119:9 – “cleanse his way… by taking heed according to thy word”

Jesus “breaking” Sabbath

1. Works of mercy are lawful on the Sabbath: Matthew 12:10-13; Mark 3:1-5; Luke 6:6-10
2. Works of necessity are lawful: Matthew 12:1-4; Mark 2:23-26; Luke 6:1-4
3. Priests work on the Sabbath and are blameless: Matthew 12:5
4. Jesus is greater than the temple: Matthew 12:6
5. The Son of Man is Lord of the Sabbath: Matthew 12:8; Mark 2:28; Luke 6:5
6. The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath: Mark 2:27
7. The Father works and so does the Son: John 5:8-18
8. Setting people free is fitting on the Sabbath: Luke 13:10-17
9. Compassion outweighs ceremonial restriction: Luke 14:1-6
10. Sabbath laws pointed to Christ as fulfillment: Colossians 2:16-17

Not dying if you believe in Him

John 11:25-26

Jesus said unto her, I am the resurrection, and the life: he that believeth in me, though he were dead, yet shall he live.

And whosoever liveth and believeth in me shall never die. Believest thou this?

John 6:47

Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that believeth on me hath everlasting life.

John 3:36

He that believeth on the Son hath everlasting life: and he that believeth not the Son shall not see life; but the wrath of God abideth on him.

John 5:24

Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that heareth my word, and believeth on him that sent me, hath everlasting life, and shall not come into condemnation; but is passed from death unto life.

John 10:27-28

My sheep hear my voice, and I know them, and they follow me.

And I give unto them eternal life; and they shall never perish, neither shall any man pluck them out of my hand.

1 John 5:11-13

And this is the record, that God hath given to us eternal life, and this life is in his Son.

He that hath the Son hath life; and he that hath not the Son of God hath not life.

These things have I written unto you that believe on the name of the Son of God; that ye may know that ye have eternal life, and that ye may believe on the name of the Son of God.

Resurrection of the dead at His resurrection

Matthew 27:52-53

And the graves were opened; and many bodies of the saints which slept arose,

And came out of the graves after his resurrection, and went into the holy city, and appeared unto many.

Future Resurrection for Believers (rapture)

1 Thessalonians 4:13-18

The dead in Christ rise first and living believers are caught up together with them to meet the Lord in the air.

1 Corinthians 15:50-54

In a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, the dead are raised incorruptible and the living are changed.

Resurrection of the dead at the Great White Throne

Revelation 20:11-15

And I saw a great white throne, and him that sat on it, from whose face the earth and the heaven fled away; and there was found no place for them.

And I saw the dead, small and great, stand before God; and the books were opened: and another book was opened, which is the book of life: and the dead were judged out of those things which were written in the books, according to their works.

And the sea gave up the dead which were in it; and death and hell delivered up the dead which were in them: and they were judged every man according to their works.

And death and hell were cast into the lake of fire. This is the second death.

And whosoever was not found written in the book of life was cast into the lake of fire.

Scriptures Spoke of Jesus

Luke 24:27

And beginning at Moses and all the prophets, he expounded unto them in all the scriptures the things concerning himself.

Luke 24:44

And he said unto them, These are the words which I spake unto you, while I was yet with you, that all things must be fulfilled, which were written in the law of Moses, and in the prophets, and in the psalms, concerning me.

John 1:45

Philip findeth Nathanael, and saith unto him, We have found him, of whom Moses in the law, and the prophets, did write, Jesus of Nazareth, the son of Joseph.

Acts 10:43

To him give all the prophets witness, that through his name whosoever believeth in him shall receive remission of sins.

The Law brings Knowledge of Sin; it cannot bring eternal life because we cannot keep it

Romans 3:20

Therefore by the deeds of the law there shall no flesh be justified in his sight: for by the law is the knowledge of sin.

Galatians 2:16

Knowing that a man is not justified by the works of the law, but by the faith of Jesus Christ, even we have believed in Jesus Christ, that we might be justified by the faith of Christ, and not by the works of the law: for by the works of the law shall no flesh be justified.

Galatians 3:10

For as many as are of the works of the law are under the curse: for it is written, Cursed is every one that continueth not in all things which are written in the book of the law to do them.

Galatians 3:11

But that no man is justified by the law in the sight of God, it is evident: for, The just shall live by faith.

Galatians 3:12

And the law is not of faith: but, The man that doeth them shall live in them.

Romans 7:7

What shall we say then? Is the law sin? God forbid. Nay, I had not known sin, but by the law: for I had not known lust, except the law had said, Thou shalt not covet.

John 4:7–15 — The Living Water

Isaiah 12:3

Therefore with joy shall ye draw water out of the wells of salvation.

Isaiah 44:3

For I will pour water upon him that is thirsty, and floods upon the dry ground: I will pour my spirit upon thy seed, and my blessing upon thine offspring.

Jeremiah 2:13

For my people have committed two evils; they have forsaken me the fountain of living waters, and hewed them out cisterns, broken cisterns, that can hold no water.

John 7:37-39

In the last day, that great day of the feast, Jesus stood and cried, saying, If any man thirst, let him come unto me, and drink.

He that believeth on me, as the scripture hath said, out of his belly shall flow rivers of living water.

(But this spake he of the Spirit, which they that believe on him should receive: for the Holy Ghost was not yet given; because that Jesus was not yet glorified.)

Revelation 22:17

And the Spirit and the bride say, Come. And let him that heareth say, Come. And let him that is athirst come. And whosoever will, let him take the water of life freely.

John 4:16–18 — Jesus Reveals Her Sin

Hebrews 4:12-13

For the word of God is quick, and powerful, and sharper than any twoedged sword, piercing even to the dividing asunder of soul and spirit, and of the joints and marrow, and is a discerner of the thoughts and intents of the heart.

Neither is there any creature that is not manifest in his sight: but all things are naked and opened unto the eyes of him with whom we have to do.

Psalm 139:1-4

O Lord, thou hast searched me, and known me.

Thou knowest my downsitting and mine uprising, thou understandest my thought afar off.

Thou compassest my path and my lying down, and art acquainted with all my ways.

For there is not a word in my tongue, but, lo, O Lord, thou knowest it altogether.

John 4:19–24 — True Worship

Malachi 1:11

For from the rising of the sun even unto the going down of the same my name shall be great among the Gentiles; and in every place incense shall be offered unto my name, and a pure offering: for my name shall be great among the heathen, saith the Lord of hosts.

Philippians 3:3

For we are the circumcision, which worship God in the spirit, and rejoice in Christ Jesus, and have no confidence in the flesh.

Romans 12:1-2

I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that ye present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable unto God, which is your reasonable service.

And be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind, that ye may prove what is that good, and acceptable, and perfect, will of God.

John 4:25–26 — The Messiah Revealed

John 1:41

He first findeth his own brother Simon, and saith unto him, We have found the Messias, which is, being interpreted, the Christ.

Luke 24:27

And beginning at Moses and all the prophets, he expounded unto them in all the scriptures the things concerning himself.

John 4:27–30 — The Woman Becomes a Witness

Mark 5:19-20

Howbeit Jesus suffered him not, but saith unto him, Go home to thy friends, and tell them how great things the Lord hath done for thee, and hath had compassion on thee.

And he departed, and began to publish in Decapolis how great things Jesus had done for him: and all men did marvel.

Romans 10:14-15

How then shall they call on him in whom they have not believed? and how shall they believe in him of whom they have not heard? and how shall they hear without a preacher?

And how shall they preach, except they be sent? as it is written, How beautiful are the feet of them that preach the gospel of peace, and bring glad tidings of good things!

John 4:31–38 — Spiritual Food and Harvest

Deuteronomy 8:3

And he humbled thee, and suffered thee to hunger, and fed thee with manna, which thou knewest not, neither did thy fathers know; that he might make thee know that man doth not live by bread only, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of the Lord doth man live.

Luke 10:2

Therefore said he unto them, The harvest truly is great, but the labourers are few: pray ye therefore the Lord of the harvest, that he would send forth labourers into his harvest.

1 Corinthians 3:6-8

I have planted, Apollos watered; but God gave the increase.

So then neither is he that planteth any thing, neither he that watereth; but God that giveth the increase.

Now he that planteth and he that watereth are one: and every man shall receive his own reward according to his own labour.

John 4:39–42 — Many Samaritans Believe

Isaiah 49:6

And he said, It is a light thing that thou shouldest be my servant to raise up the tribes of Jacob, and to restore the preserved of Israel: I will also give thee for a light to the Gentiles, that thou mayest be my salvation unto the end of the earth.

Luke 2:30-32

For mine eyes have seen thy salvation,

Which thou hast prepared before the face of all people;

A light to lighten the Gentiles, and the glory of thy people Israel.

1 John 4:14

And we have seen and do testify that the Father sent the Son to be the Saviour of the world.

John 4:43–54 — Healing the Nobleman’s Son

Matthew 8:8, 10, 13

The centurion answered and said, Lord, I am not worthy that thou shouldest come under my roof: but speak the word only, and my servant shall be healed.

When Jesus heard it, he marvelled, and said to them that followed, Verily I say unto you, I have not found so great faith, no, not in Israel.

And Jesus said unto the centurion, Go thy way; and as thou hast believed, so be it done unto thee. And his servant was healed in the selfsame hour.

Romans 10:17

So then faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.

Hebrews 11:1, 6

Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.

But without faith it is impossible to please him: for he that cometh to God must believe that he is, and that he is a rewarder of them that diligently seek him.

John 14:6 cross references (not in John 14)

Proverbs 14:12
"There is a way which seemeth right unto a man, but the end thereof are the ways of death."

Proverbs 16:25
"There is a way that seemeth right unto a man, but the end thereof are the ways of death."

Acts 4:12
"Neither is there salvation in any other: for there is none other name under heaven given among men, whereby we must be saved."

1 Timothy 2:5
"For there is one God, and one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus;"

Hebrews 10:19–20
"Having therefore, brethren, boldness to enter into the holiest by the blood of Jesus,
By a new and living way, which he hath consecrated for us, through the veil, that is to say, his flesh;"

Ephesians 2:18
"For through him we both have access by one Spirit unto the Father."

Matthew 7:13–14
"Enter ye in at the strait gate: for wide is the gate, and broad is the way, that leadeth to destruction, and many there be which go in thereat:
Because strait is the gate, and narrow is the way, which leadeth unto life, and few there be that find it."

Isaiah 35:8
"And an highway shall be there, and a way, and it shall be called The way of holiness; the unclean shall not pass over it; but it shall be for those: the wayfaring men, though fools, shall not err therein."

Psalm 25:4–5
"Shew me thy ways, O LORD; teach me thy paths.
Lead me in thy truth, and teach me: for thou art the God of my salvation; on thee do I wait all the day."

Psalm 43:3
"O send out thy light and thy truth: let them lead me; let them bring me unto thy holy hill, and to thy tabernacles."

John 17:17 (not John 14, but still John)
"Sanctify them through thy truth: thy word is truth."

Colossians 2:8–10
"Beware lest any man spoil you through philosophy and vain deceit, after the tradition of men, after the rudiments of the world, and not after Christ.
For in him dwelleth all the fulness of the Godhead bodily.
And ye are complete in him, which is the head of all principality and power:"

John 14:15 cross references (love proved by obedience, consistency between words and life, not in John 14)

Luke 6:46
"And why call ye me, Lord, Lord, and do not the things which I say?"

Matthew 7:21–23
“Not every one that saith unto me, Lord, Lord, shall enter into the kingdom of heaven; but he that doeth the will of my Father which is in heaven.
Many will say to me in that day, Lord, Lord, have we not prophesied in thy name? and in thy name have cast out devils? and in thy name done many wonderful works?
And then will I profess unto them, I never knew you: depart from me, ye that work iniquity.”

James 1:22
“But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves.”

James 2:17–18
“Even so faith, if it hath not works, is dead, being alone.
Yea, a man may say, Thou hast faith, and I have works: shew me thy faith without thy works, and I will shew thee my faith by my works.”

1 Samuel 15:22
“Hath the LORD as great delight in burnt offerings and sacrifices, as in obeying the voice of the LORD? Behold, to obey is better than sacrifice, and to hearken than the fat of rams.”

Deuteronomy 10:12–13
“And now, Israel, what doth the LORD thy God require of thee, but to fear the LORD thy God, to walk in all his ways, and to love him, and to serve the LORD thy God with all thy heart and with all thy soul,
To keep the commandments of the LORD, and his statutes, which I command thee this day for thy good?”

Psalm 119:1–3
“Blessed are the undefiled in the way, who walk in the law of the LORD.
Blessed are they that keep his testimonies, and that seek him with the whole heart.
They also do no iniquity: they walk in his ways.”

Titus 1:16
“They profess that they know God; but in works they deny him, being abominable, and disobedient, and unto every good work reprobate.”

1 John 2:3–6
“And hereby we do know that we know him, if we keep his commandments.
He that saith, I know him, and keepeth not his commandments, is a liar, and the truth is not in him.
But whoso keepeth his word, in him verily is the love of God perfected: hereby know we that we are in him.
He that saith he abideth in him ought himself also so to walk, even as he walked.”

2 John 6
“And this is love, that we walk after his commandments. This is the commandment, That, as ye have heard from the beginning, ye should walk in it.”

1 In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.

2 The same was in the beginning with God.

3 All things were made by him; and without him was not any thing made that was made.

4 In him was life; and the life was the light of men.

5 And the light shineth in darkness; and the darkness comprehended it not.

6 There was a man sent from God, whose name was John.

7 The same came for a witness, to bear witness of the Light, that all men through him might believe.

8 He was not that Light, but was sent to bear witness of that Light.

9 That was the true Light, which lighteth every man that cometh into the world.

10 He was in the world, and the world was made by him, and the world knew him not.

11 He came unto his own, and his own received him not.

12 But as many as received him, to them gave he power to become the sons of God, even to them that believe on his name:

13 Which were born, not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man, but of God.

14 And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us, (and we beheld his glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father,) full of grace and truth.

15 John bare witness of him, and cried, saying, This was he of whom I spake, He that cometh after me is preferred before me: for he was before me.

16 And of his fulness have all we received, and grace for grace.

17 For the law was given by Moses, but grace and truth came by Jesus Christ.

18 No man hath seen God at any time, the only begotten Son, which is in the bosom of the Father, he hath declared him.

19 And this is the record of John, when the Jews sent priests and Levites from Jerusalem to ask him, Who art thou?

20 And he confessed, and denied not; but confessed, I am not the Christ.

21 And they asked him, What then? Art thou Elias? And he saith, I am not. Art thou that prophet? And he answered, No.

22 Then said they unto him, Who art thou? that we may give an answer to them that sent us. What sayest thou of thyself?

23 He said, I am the voice of one crying in the wilderness, Make straight the way of the Lord, as said the prophet Esaias.

24 And they which were sent were of the Pharisees.

25 And they asked him, and said unto him, Why baptizest thou then, if thou be not that Christ, nor Elias, neither that prophet?

26 John answered them, saying, I baptize with water: but there standeth one among you, whom ye know not;

27 He it is, who coming after me is preferred before me, whose shoe's latchet I am not worthy to unloose.

28 These things were done in Bethabara beyond Jordan, where John was baptizing.

29 The next day John seeth Jesus coming unto him, and saith, Behold the Lamb of God, which taketh away the sin of the world.

30 This is he of whom I said, After me cometh a man which is preferred before me: for he was before me.

31 And I knew him not: but that he should be made manifest to Israel, therefore am I come baptizing with water.

32 And John bare record, saying, I saw the Spirit descending from heaven like a dove, and it abode upon him.

33 And I knew him not: but he that sent me to baptize with water, the same said unto me, Upon whom thou shalt see the Spirit descending, and remaining on him, the same is he which baptizeth with the Holy Ghost.

34 And I saw, and bare record that this is the Son of God.

35 Again the next day after John stood, and two of his disciples;

36 And looking upon Jesus as he walked, he saith, Behold the Lamb of God!

37 And the two disciples heard him speak, and they followed Jesus.

38 Then Jesus turned, and saw them following, and saith unto them, What seek ye? They said unto him, Rabbi, (which is to say, being interpreted, Master,) where dwellest thou?

39 He saith unto them, Come and see. They came and saw where he dwelt, and abode with him that day: for it was about the tenth hour.

40 One of the two which heard John speak, and followed him, was Andrew, Simon Peter's brother.

41 He first findeth his own brother Simon, and saith unto him, We have found the Messias, which is, being interpreted, the Christ.

42 And he brought him to Jesus. And when Jesus beheld him, he said, Thou art Simon the son of Jona: thou shalt be called Cephas, which is by interpretation, A stone.

43 The day following Jesus would go forth into Galilee, and findeth Philip, and saith unto him, Follow me.

44 Now Philip was of Bethsaida, the city of Andrew and Peter.

45 Philip findeth Nathanael, and saith unto him, We have found him, of whom Moses in the law, and the prophets, did write, Jesus of Nazareth, the son of Joseph.

46 And Nathanael said unto him, Can there any good thing come out of Nazareth? Philip saith unto him, Come and see.

47 Jesus saw Nathanael coming to him, and saith of him, Behold an Israelite indeed, in whom is no guile!

48 Nathanael saith unto him, Whence knowest thou me? Jesus answered and said unto him, Before that Philip called thee, when thou wast under the fig tree, I saw thee.

49 Nathanael answered and saith unto him, Rabbi, thou art the Son of God; thou art the King of Israel.

50 Jesus answered and said unto him, Because I said unto thee, I saw thee under the fig tree, believest thou? thou shalt see greater things than these.

51 And he saith unto him, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Hereafter ye shall see heaven open, and the angels of God ascending and descending upon the Son of man.

1And the third day there was a marriage in Cana of Galilee; and the mother of Jesus was there:

2And both Jesus was called, and his disciples, to the marriage.

3And when they wanted wine, the mother of Jesus saith unto him, They have no wine.

4Jesus saith unto her, Woman, what have I to do with thee? mine hour is not yet come.

5His mother saith unto the servants, Whatsoever he saith unto you, do it.

6And there were set there six waterpots of stone, after the manner of the purifying of the Jews, containing two or three firkins apiece.

7Jesus saith unto them, Fill the waterpots with water. And they filled them up to the brim.

8And he saith unto them, Draw out now, and bear unto the governor of the feast. And they bare it.

9When the ruler of the feast had tasted the water that was made wine, and knew not whence it was: (but the servants which drew the water knew;) the governor of the feast called the bridegroom,

10And saith unto him, Every man at the beginning doth set forth good wine; and when men have well drunk, then that which is worse: but thou hast kept the good wine until now.

11This beginning of miracles did Jesus in Cana of Galilee, and manifested forth his glory; and his disciples believed on him.

12After this he went down to Capernaum, he, and his mother, and his brethren, and his disciples: and they continued there not many days.

13And the Jews' passover was at hand, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem,

14And found in the temple those that sold oxen and sheep and doves, and the changers of money sitting:

15And when he had made a scourge of small cords, he drove them all out of the temple, and the sheep, and the oxen; and poured out the changers' money, and overthrew the tables;

16And said unto them that sold doves, Take these things hence; make not my Father's house an house of merchandise.

17And his disciples remembered that it was written, The zeal of thine house hath eaten me up.

18Then answered the Jews and said unto him, What sign shewest thou unto us, seeing that thou doest these things?

19Jesus answered and said unto them, Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up.

20Then said the Jews, Forty and six years was this temple in building, and wilt thou rear it up in three days?

21But he spake of the temple of his body.

22When therefore he was risen from the dead, his disciples remembered that he had said this unto them; and they believed the scripture, and the word which Jesus had said.

23Now when he was in Jerusalem at the passover, in the feast day, many believed in his name, when they saw the miracles which he did.

24But Jesus did not commit himself unto them, because he knew all men,

25And needed not that any should testify of man: for he knew what was in man.

1There was a man of the Pharisees, named Nicodemus, a ruler of the Jews:

2The same came to Jesus by night, and said unto him, Rabbi, we know that thou art a teacher come from God: for no man can do these miracles that thou doest, except God be with him.

3Jesus answered and said unto him, Verily, verily, I say unto thee, Except a man be born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God.

4Nicodemus saith unto him, How can a man be born when he is old? can he enter the second time into his mother's womb, and be born?

5Jesus answered, Verily, verily, I say unto thee, Except a man be born of water and of the Spirit, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God.

6That which is born of the flesh is flesh; and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit.

7Marvel not that I said unto thee, Ye must be born again.

8The wind bloweth where it listeth, and thou hearest the sound thereof, but canst not tell whence it cometh, and whither it goeth: so is every one that is born of the Spirit.

9Nicodemus answered and said unto him, How can these things be?

10Jesus answered and said unto him, Art thou a master of Israel, and knowest not these things?

11Verily, verily, I say unto thee, We speak that we do know, and testify that we have seen; and ye receive not our witness.

12If I have told you earthly things, and ye believe not, how shall ye believe, if I tell you of heavenly things?

13And no man hath ascended up to heaven, but he that came down from heaven, even the Son of man which is in heaven.

14And as Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness, even so must the Son of man be lifted up:

15That whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have eternal life.

16For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life.

17For God sent not his Son into the world to condemn the world; but that the world through him might be saved.

18He that believeth on him is not condemned: but he that believeth not is condemned already, because he hath not believed in the name of the only begotten Son of God.

19And this is the condemnation, that light is come into the world, and men loved darkness rather than light, because their deeds were evil.

20For every one that doeth evil hateth the light, neither cometh to the light, lest his deeds should be reproved.

21But he that doeth truth cometh to the light, that his deeds may be made manifest, that they are wrought in God.

22After these things came Jesus and his disciples into the land of Judaea; and there he tarried with them, and baptized.

23And John also was baptizing in Aenon near to Salim, because there was much water there: and they came, and were baptized.

24For John was not yet cast into prison.

25Then there arose a question between some of John's disciples and the Jews about purifying.

26And they came unto John, and said unto him, Rabbi, he that was with thee beyond Jordan, to whom thou barest witness, behold, the same baptizeth, and all men come to him.

27John answered and said, A man can receive nothing, except it be given him from heaven.

28Ye yourselves bear me witness, that I said, I am not the Christ, but that I am sent before him.

29He that hath the bride is the bridegroom: but the friend of the bridegroom, which standeth and heareth him, rejoiceth greatly because of the bridegroom's voice: this my joy therefore is fulfilled.

30He must increase, but I must decrease.

31He that cometh from above is above all: he that is of the earth is earthly, and speaketh of the earth: he that cometh from heaven is above all.

32And what he hath seen and heard, that he testifieth; and no man receiveth his testimony.

33He that hath received his testimony hath set to his seal that God is true.

34For he whom God hath sent speaketh the words of God: for God giveth not the Spirit by measure unto him.

35The Father loveth the Son, and hath given all things into his hand.

36He that believeth on the Son hath everlasting life: and he that believeth not the Son shall not see life; but the wrath of God abideth on him.

Genesis 2:17

But of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, thou shalt not eat of it: for in the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die.

2 Corinthians 5:17

Therefore if any man be in Christ, he is a new creature: old things are passed away; behold, all things are become new.

Galatians 6:15

For in Christ Jesus neither circumcision availeth any thing, nor uncircumcision, but a new creature.

1 Peter 1:23

Being born again, not of corruptible seed, but of incorruptible, by the word of God, which liveth and abideth for ever.

Titus 3:5

Not by works of righteousness which we have done, but according to his mercy he saved us, by the washing of regeneration, and renewing of the Holy Ghost.

Numbers 21:4–9

And they journeyed from mount Hor by the way of the Red sea, to compass the land of Edom: and the soul of the people was much discouraged because of the way.

And the people spake against God, and against Moses, Wherefore have ye brought us up out of Egypt to die in the wilderness? for there is no bread, neither is there any water; and our soul loatheth this light bread.

And the LORD sent fiery serpents among the people, and they bit the people; and much people of Israel died.

Therefore the people came to Moses, and said, We have sinned, for we have spoken against the LORD, and against thee; pray unto the LORD, that he take away the serpents from us. And Moses prayed for the people.

And the LORD said unto Moses, Make thee a fiery serpent, and set it upon a pole: and it shall come to pass, that every one that is bitten, when he looketh upon it, shall live.

And Moses made a serpent of brass, and put it upon a pole, and it came to pass, that if a serpent had bitten any man, when he beheld the serpent of brass, he lived.

John 3:27

John answered and said, A man can receive nothing, except it be given him from heaven.

John 14:26

But the Comforter, which is the Holy Ghost, whom the Father will send in my name, he shall teach you all things, and bring all things to your remembrance, whatsoever I have said unto you.

John 16:13

Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth: for he shall not speak of himself; but whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak: and he will shew you things to come.

1 John 2:27

But the anointing which ye have received of him abideth in you, and ye need not that any man teach you: but as the same anointing teacheth you of all things, and is truth, and is no lie, and even as it hath taught you, ye shall abide in him.

Isaiah 40:3

The voice of him that crieth in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the LORD, make straight in the desert a highway for our God.

Matthew 3:1–3

In those days came John the Baptist, preaching in the wilderness of Judaea, And saying, Repent ye: for the kingdom of heaven is at hand. For this is he that was spoken of by the prophet Esaias, saying, The voice of one crying in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make his paths straight.

Mark 1:2–3

As it is written in the prophets, Behold, I send my messenger before thy face, which shall prepare thy way before thee.

The voice of one crying in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make his paths straight.

Luke 3:4

As it is written in the book of the words of Esaias the prophet, saying, The voice of one crying in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make his paths straight.

John 1:23

He said, I am the voice of one crying in the wilderness, Make straight the way of the Lord, as said the prophet Esaias.

John 3:35–36

The Father loveth the Son, and hath given all things into his hand.

He that believeth on the Son hath everlasting life: and he that believeth not the Son shall not see life; but the wrath of God abideth on him.

1 When therefore the Lord knew how the Pharisees had heard that Jesus made and baptized more disciples than John,

2 (Though Jesus himself baptized not, but his disciples,)

3 He left Judaea, and departed again into Galilee.

4 And he must needs go through Samaria.

5 Then cometh he to a city of Samaria, which is called Sychar, near to the parcel of ground that Jacob gave to his son Joseph.

6 Now Jacob's well was there. Jesus therefore, being wearied with his journey, sat thus on the well, and it was about the sixth hour.

7 There cometh a woman of Samaria to draw water. Jesus saith unto her, Give me to drink.

8 (For his disciples were gone away unto the city to buy meat.)

9 Then saith the woman of Samaria unto him, How is it that thou, being a Jew, askest drink of me, which am a woman of Samaria? for the Jews have no dealings with the Samaritans.

10 Jesus answered and said unto her, If thou knewest the gift of God, and who it is that saith to thee, Give me to drink, thou wouldest have asked of him, and he would have given thee living water.

11 The woman saith unto him, Sir, thou hast nothing to draw with, and the well is deep. From whence then hast thou that living water?

12 Art thou greater than our father Jacob, which gave us the well, and drank thereof himself, and his children, and his cattle?

13 Jesus answered and said unto her, Whosoever drinketh of this water shall thirst again,

14 But whosoever drinketh of the water that I shall give him shall never thirst, but the water that I shall give him shall be in him a well of water springing up into everlasting life.

15 The woman saith unto him, Sir, give me this water, that I thirst not, neither come hither to draw.

16 Jesus saith unto her, Go, call thy husband, and come hither.

17 The woman answered and said, I have no husband. Jesus said unto her, Thou hast well said, I have no husband.

18 For thou hast had five husbands, and he whom thou now hast is not thy husband. In that saidst thou truly.

19 The woman saith unto him, Sir, I perceive that thou art a prophet.

20 Our fathers worshipped in this mountain, and ye say that in Jerusalem is the place where men ought to worship.

21 Jesus saith unto her, Woman, believe me, the hour cometh, when ye shall neither in this mountain, nor yet at Jerusalem, worship the Father.

22 Ye worship ye know not what. We know what we worship, for salvation is of the Jews.

23 But the hour cometh, and now is, when the true worshippers shall worship the Father in spirit and in truth, for the Father seeketh such to worship him.

24 God is a Spirit, and they that worship him must worship him in spirit and in truth.

25 The woman saith unto him, I know that Messias cometh, which is called Christ. When he is come, he will tell us all things.

26 Jesus saith unto her, I that speak unto thee am he.

27 And upon this came his disciples, and marvelled that he talked with the woman. Yet no man said, What seekest thou, or, Why talkest thou with her?

28 The woman then left her waterpot, and went her way into the city, and saith to the men,

29 Come, see a man, which told me all things that ever I did. Is not this the Christ?

30 Then they went out of the city, and came unto him.

31 In the mean while his disciples prayed him, saying, Master, eat.

32 But he said unto them, I have meat to eat that ye know not of.

33 Therefore said the disciples one to another, Hath any man brought him ought to eat?

34 Jesus saith unto them, My meat is to do the will of him that sent me, and to finish his work.

35 Say not ye, There are yet four months, and then cometh harvest. Behold, I say unto you, Lift up your eyes, and look on the fields, for they are white already to harvest.

36 And he that reapeth receiveth wages, and gathereth fruit unto life eternal, that both he that soweth and he that reapeth may rejoice together.

37 And herein is that saying true, One soweth, and another reapeth.

38 I sent you to reap that whereon ye bestowed no labour. Other men laboured, and ye are entered into their labours.

39 And many of the Samaritans of that city believed on him for the saying of the woman, which testified, He told me all that ever I did.

40 So when the Samaritans were come unto him, they besought him that he would tarry with them, and he abode there two days.

41 And many more believed because of his own word,

42 And said unto the woman, Now we believe, not because of thy saying, for we have heard him ourselves, and know that this is indeed the Christ, the Saviour of the world.

43 Now after two days he departed thence, and went into Galilee.

44 For Jesus himself testified that a prophet hath no honour in his own country.

45 Then when he was come into Galilee, the Galilaeans received him, having seen all the things that he did at Jerusalem at the feast, for they also went unto the feast.

46 So Jesus came again into Cana of Galilee, where he made the water wine. And there was a certain nobleman, whose son was sick at Capernaum.

47 When he heard that Jesus was come out of Judaea into Galilee, he went unto him, and besought him that he would come down, and heal his son, for he was at the point of death.

48 Then said Jesus unto him, Except ye see signs and wonders, ye will not believe.

49 The nobleman saith unto him, Sir, come down ere my child die.

50 Jesus saith unto him, Go thy way, thy son liveth. And the man believed the word that Jesus had spoken unto him, and he went his way.

51 And as he was now going down, his servants met him, and told him, saying, Thy son liveth.

52 Then enquired he of them the hour when he began to amend. And they said unto him, Yesterday at the seventh hour the fever left him.

53 So the father knew that it was at the same hour, in the which Jesus said unto him, Thy son liveth, and himself believed, and his whole house.

54 This is again the second miracle that Jesus did, when he was come out of Judaea into Galilee.

1After this there was a feast of the Jews; and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.

2Now there is at Jerusalem by the sheep market a pool, which is called in the Hebrew tongue Bethesda, having five porches.

3In these lay a great multitude of impotent folk, of blind, halt, withered, waiting for the moving of the water.

4For an angel went down at a certain season into the pool, and troubled the water: whosoever then first after the troubling of the water stepped in was made whole of whatsoever disease he had.

5And a certain man was there, which had an infirmity thirty and eight years.

6When Jesus saw him lie, and knew that he had been now a long time in that case, he saith unto him, Wilt thou be made whole?

7The impotent man answered him, Sir, I have no man, when the water is troubled, to put me into the pool: but while I am coming, another steppeth down before me.

8Jesus saith unto him, Rise, take up thy bed, and walk.

9And immediately the man was made whole, and took up his bed, and walked: and on the same day was the sabbath.

10The Jews therefore said unto him that was cured, It is the sabbath day: it is not lawful for thee to carry thy bed.

11He answered them, He that made me whole, the same said unto me, Take up thy bed, and walk.

12Then asked they him, What man is that which said unto thee, Take up thy bed, and walk?

13And he that was healed wist not who it was: for Jesus had conveyed himself away, a multitude being in that place.

14Afterward Jesus findeth him in the temple, and said unto him, Behold, thou art made whole: sin no more, lest a worse thing come unto thee.

15The man departed, and told the Jews that it was Jesus, which had made him whole.

16And therefore did the Jews persecute Jesus, and sought to slay him, because he had done these things on the sabbath day.

17But Jesus answered them, My Father worketh hitherto, and I work.

18Therefore the Jews sought the more to kill him, because he not only had broken the sabbath, but said also that God was his Father, making himself equal with God.

19Then answered Jesus and said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, The Son can do nothing of himself, but what he seeth the Father do: for what things soever he doeth, these also doeth the Son likewise.

20For the Father loveth the Son, and sheweth him all things that himself doeth: and he will shew him greater works than these, that ye may marvel.

21For as the Father raiseth up the dead, and quickeneth them; even so the Son quickeneth whom he will.

22For the Father judgeth no man, but hath committed all judgment unto the Son:

23That all men should honour the Son, even as they honour the Father. He that honoureth not the Son honoureth not the Father which hath sent him.

24Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that heareth my word, and believeth on him that sent me, hath everlasting life, and shall not come into condemnation; but is passed from death unto life.

25Verily, verily, I say unto you, The hour is coming, and now is, when the dead shall hear the voice of the Son of God: and they that hear shall live.

26For as the Father hath life in himself; so hath he given to the Son to have life in himself;

27And hath given him authority to execute judgment also, because he is the Son of man.

28Marvel not at this: for the hour is coming, in the which all that are in the graves shall hear his voice,

29And shall come forth; they that have done good, unto the resurrection of life; and they that have done evil, unto the resurrection of damnation.

30I can of mine own self do nothing: as I hear, I judge: and my judgment is just; because I seek not mine own will, but the will of the Father which hath sent me.

31If I bear witness of myself, my witness is not true.

32There is another that beareth witness of me; and I know that the witness which he witnesseth of me is true.

33Ye sent unto John, and he bare witness unto the truth.

34But I receive not testimony from man: but these things I say, that ye might be saved.

35He was a burning and a shining light: and ye were willing for a season to rejoice in his light.

36But I have greater witness than that of John: for the works which the Father hath given me to finish, the same works that I do, bear witness of me, that the Father hath sent me.

37And the Father himself, which hath sent me, hath borne witness of me. Ye have neither heard his voice at any time, nor seen his shape.

38And ye have not his word abiding in you: for whom he hath sent, him ye believe not.

39Search the scriptures; for in them ye think ye have eternal life: and they are they which testify of me.

40And ye will not come to me, that ye might have life.

41I receive not honour from men.

42But I know you, that ye have not the love of God in you.

43I am come in my Father's name, and ye receive me not: if another shall come in his own name, him ye will receive.

44How can ye believe, which receive honour one of another, and seek not the honour that cometh from God only?

45Do not think that I will accuse you to the Father: there is one that accuseth you, even Moses, in whom ye trust.

46For had ye believed Moses, ye would have believed me: for he wrote of me.

47But if ye believe not his writings, how shall ye believe my words?

1After these things Jesus went over the sea of Galilee, which is the sea of Tiberias.
2And a great multitude followed him, because they saw his miracles which he did on them that were diseased.
3And Jesus went up into a mountain, and there he sat with his disciples.
4And the passover, a feast of the Jews, was nigh.
5When Jesus then lifted up his eyes, and saw a great company come unto him, he saith unto Philip, Whence shall we buy bread, that these may eat?
6And this he said to prove him: for he himself knew what he would do.
7Philip answered him, Two hundred pennyworth of bread is not sufficient for them, that every one of them may take a little.

8One of his disciples, Andrew, Simon Peter's brother, saith unto him,

9There is a lad here, which hath five barley loaves, and two small fishes: but what are they among so many?

10And Jesus said, Make the men sit down. Now there was much grass in the place. So the men sat down, in number about five thousand.

11And Jesus took the loaves; and when he had given thanks, he distributed to the disciples, and the disciples to them that were set down; and likewise of the fishes as much as they would.

12When they were filled, he said unto his disciples, Gather up the fragments that remain, that nothing be lost.

13Therefore they gathered them together, and filled twelve baskets with the fragments of the five barley loaves, which remained over and above unto them that had eaten.

14Then those men, when they had seen the miracle that Jesus did, said, This is of a truth that prophet that should come into the world.

15When Jesus therefore perceived that they would come and take him by force, to make him a king, he departed again into a mountain himself alone.

16And when even was now come, his disciples went down unto the sea,

17And entered into a ship, and went over the sea toward Capernaum. And it was now dark, and Jesus was not come to them.

18And the sea arose by reason of a great wind that blew.

19So when they had rowed about five and twenty or thirty furlongs, they see Jesus walking on the sea, and drawing nigh unto the ship: and they were afraid.

20But he saith unto them, It is I; be not afraid.

21Then they willingly received him into the ship: and immediately the ship was at the land whither they went.

22The day following, when the people which stood on the other side of the sea saw that there was none other boat there, save that one whereinto his disciples were entered, and that Jesus went not with his disciples into the boat, but that his disciples were gone away alone;

23(Howbeit there came other boats from Tiberias nigh unto the place where they

did eat bread, after that the Lord had given thanks:)

24When the people therefore saw that Jesus was not there, neither his disciples, they also took shipping, and came to Capernaum, seeking for Jesus.

25And when they had found him on the other side of the sea, they said unto him, Rabbi, when camest thou hither?

26Jesus answered them and said, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Ye seek me, not because ye saw the miracles, but because ye did eat of the loaves, and were filled.

27Labour not for the meat which perisheth, but for that meat which endureth unto everlasting life, which the Son of man shall give unto you: for him hath God the Father sealed.

28Then said they unto him, What shall we do, that we might work the works of God?

29Jesus answered and said unto them, This is the work of God, that ye believe on him whom he hath sent.

30They said therefore unto him, What sign shewest thou then, that we may see, and believe thee? what dost thou work?

31Our fathers did eat manna in the desert; as it is written, He gave them bread from heaven to eat.

32Then Jesus said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Moses gave you not that bread from heaven; but my Father giveth you the true bread from heaven.

33For the bread of God is he which cometh down from heaven, and giveth life unto the world.

34Then said they unto him, Lord, evermore give us this bread.

35And Jesus said unto them, I am the bread of life: he that cometh to me shall never hunger; and he that believeth on me shall never thirst.

36But I said unto you, That ye also have seen me, and believe not.

37All that the Father giveth me shall come to me; and him that cometh to me I will in no wise cast out.

38For I came down from heaven, not to do mine own will, but the will of him that sent me.

39And this is the Father's will which hath sent me, that of all which he hath given me I should lose nothing, but should raise it up again at the last day.

40And this is the will of him that sent me, that every one which seeth the Son, and believeth on him, may have everlasting life: and I will raise him up at the last day.

41The Jews then murmured at him, because he said, I am the bread which came down from heaven.

42And they said, Is not this Jesus, the son of Joseph, whose father and mother we know? how is it then that he saith, I came down from heaven?

43Jesus therefore answered and said unto them, Murmur not among yourselves.

44No man can come to me, except the Father which hath sent me draw him: and I will raise him up at the last day.

45It is written in the prophets, And they shall be all taught of God. Every man therefore that hath heard, and hath learned of the Father, cometh unto me.

46Not that any man hath seen the Father, save he which is of God, he hath seen the Father.

47Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that believeth on me hath everlasting life.

48I am that bread of life.

49Your fathers did eat manna in the wilderness, and are dead.

50This is the bread which cometh down from heaven, that a man may eat thereof, and not die.

51I am the living bread which came down from heaven: if any man eat of this bread, he shall live for ever: and the bread that I will give is my flesh, which I will give for the life of the world.

52The Jews therefore strove among themselves, saying, How can this man give us his flesh to eat?

53Then Jesus said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Except ye eat the flesh of the Son of man, and drink his blood, ye have no life in you.

54Whoso eateth my flesh, and drinketh my blood, hath eternal life; and I will raise him up at the last day.

55For my flesh is meat indeed, and my blood is drink indeed.

56He that eateth my flesh, and drinketh my blood, dwelleth in me, and I in him.

57As the living Father hath sent me, and I live by the Father: so he that eateth me, even he shall live by me.

58This is that bread which came down from heaven: not as your fathers did eat manna, and are dead: he that eateth of this bread shall live for ever.

59These things said he in the synagogue, as he taught in Capernaum.

60Many therefore of his disciples, when they had heard this, said, This is an hard saying; who can hear it?

61When Jesus knew in himself that his disciples murmured at it, he said unto them, Doth this offend you?

62What and if ye shall see the Son of man ascend up where he was before?

63It is the spirit that quickeneth; the flesh profiteth nothing: the words that I speak unto you, they are spirit, and they are life.

64But there are some of you that believe not. For Jesus knew from the beginning who they were that believed not, and who should betray him.

65And he said, Therefore said I unto you, that no man can come unto me, except it were given unto him of my Father.

66From that time many of his disciples went back, and walked no more with him.

67Then said Jesus unto the twelve, Will ye also go away?

68Then Simon Peter answered him, Lord, to whom shall we go? thou hast the words of eternal life.

69And we believe and are sure that thou art that Christ, the Son of the living God.

70Jesus answered them, Have not I chosen you twelve, and one of you is a devil?

71He spake of Judas Iscariot the son of Simon: for he it was that should betray him, being one of the twelve.

1. John 6:5–6

Jesus proving us and our faith in him

John 6:5–6

When Jesus then lifted up his eyes, and saw a great company come unto him, he saith unto Philip, Whence shall we buy bread, that these may eat?

And this he said to prove him: for he himself knew what he would do.

Deuteronomy 8:2

And thou shalt remember all the way which the LORD thy God led thee these forty years in the wilderness, to humble thee, and to prove thee, to know what was in thine heart, whether thou wouldest keep his commandments, or no.

Psalm 66:10

For thou, O God, hast proved us: thou hast tried us, as silver is tried.

2 Chronicles 32:31

Howbeit in the business of the ambassadors of the princes of Babylon, who sent unto him to enquire of the wonder that was done in the land, God left him, to try him, that he might know all that was in his heart.

1 Peter 1:6–7

Wherein ye greatly rejoice, though now for a season, if need be, ye are in heaviness through manifold temptations:

That the trial of your faith, being much more precious than of gold that perisheth, though it be tried with fire, might be found unto praise and honour and glory at the appearing of Jesus Christ.

James 1:2–3

My brethren, count it all joy when ye fall into divers temptations;

Knowing this, that the trying of your faith worketh patience.

2. John 6:13

Living for God gives what you need and overflow

John 6:13

Therefore they gathered them together, and filled twelve baskets with the fragments of the five barley loaves, which remained over and above unto them that had eaten.

Psalm 23:1, 5

The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want.

Thou preparest a table before me in the presence of mine enemies: thou anointest my head with oil; my cup runneth over.

Malachi 3:10

Bring ye all the tithes into the storehouse, that there may be meat in mine house, and prove me now herewith, saith the LORD of hosts, if I will not open you the windows of heaven, and pour you out a blessing, that there shall not be room enough to receive it.

Luke 6:38

Give, and it shall be given unto you; good measure, pressed down, and shaken together, and running over, shall men give into your bosom. For with the same measure that ye mete withal it shall be measured to you again.

John 10:10

The thief cometh not, but for to steal, and to kill, and to destroy: I am come that they might have life, and that they might have it more abundantly.

2 Corinthians 9:8

And God is able to make all grace abound toward you; that ye, always having all sufficiency in all things, may abound to every good work.

Philippians 4:19

But my God shall supply all your need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus.

Ephesians 3:20

Now unto him that is able to do exceeding abundantly above all that we ask or think, according to the power that worketh in us.

3. John 6:14–15

Jesus as King and “that prophet” promised in the Old Testament

John 6:14–15

Then those men, when they had seen the miracle that Jesus did, said, This is of a truth that prophet that should come into the world.

When Jesus therefore perceived that they would come and take him by force, to make him a king, he departed again into a mountain himself alone.

Deuteronomy 18:15

The LORD thy God will raise up unto thee a Prophet from the midst of thee, of thy brethren, like unto me; unto him ye shall hearken.

John 1:45

Philip findeth Nathanael, and saith unto him, We have found him, of whom Moses in the law, and the prophets, did write, Jesus of Nazareth, the son of Joseph.

Acts 3:22

For Moses truly said unto the fathers, A prophet shall the Lord your God raise up unto you of your brethren, like unto me; him shall ye hear in all things whatsoever he shall say unto you.

Zechariah 9:9

Rejoice greatly, O daughter of Zion; shout, O daughter of Jerusalem: behold, thy King cometh unto thee: he is just, and having salvation; lowly, and riding upon an ass, and upon a colt the foal of an ass.

Isaiah 9:6–7

For unto us a child is born, unto us a son is given: and the government shall be upon his shoulder: and his name shall be called Wonderful, Counseller, The mighty God, The everlasting Father, The Prince of Peace.

Of the increase of his government and peace there shall be no end, upon the throne of David, and upon his kingdom, to order it, and to establish it with judgment and with justice from henceforth even for ever. The zeal of the LORD of hosts will perform this.

4. John 6:18–21

Jesus and Peter walking on the water

John 6:18–21

And the sea arose by reason of a great wind that blew.

So when they had rowed about five and twenty or thirty furlongs, they see Jesus walking on the sea, and drawing nigh unto the ship: and they were afraid.

But he saith unto them, It is I; be not afraid.

Then they willingly received him into the ship: and immediately the ship was at the land whither they went.

Matthew 14:25, 28–31

And in the fourth watch of the night Jesus went unto them, walking on the sea.

And Peter answered him and said, Lord, if it be thou, bid me come unto thee on the water.

And he said, Come. And when Peter was come down out of the ship, he walked on the water, to go to Jesus.

But when he saw the wind boisterous, he was afraid; and beginning to sink, he cried, saying, Lord, save me.

And immediately Jesus stretched forth his hand, and caught him, and said unto him, O thou of little faith, wherefore didst thou doubt?

Job 9:8

Which alone spreadeth out the heavens, and treadeth upon the waves of the sea.

Psalm 77:19

Thy way is in the sea, and thy path in the great waters, and thy footsteps are not known.

Isaiah 43:2

When thou passest through the waters, I will be with thee; and through the rivers, they shall not overflow thee: when thou walkest through the fire, thou shalt not be burned; neither shall the flame kindle upon thee.

5. John 6:47–69

Jesus saying hard things to sift and divide true followers

Hebrews 4:12

For the word of God is quick, and powerful, and sharper than any twoedged sword, piercing even to the dividing asunder of soul and spirit, and of the joints and marrow, and is a discerner of the thoughts and intents of the heart.

Matthew 10:34

Think not that I am come to send peace on earth: I came not to send peace, but a sword.

Luke 14:26–27, 33

If any man come to me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and brethren, and sisters, yea, and his own life also, he cannot be my disciple.

And whosoever doth not bear his cross, and come after me, cannot be my disciple.

So likewise, whosoever he be of you that forsaketh not all that he hath, he cannot be my disciple.

1 John 2:19

They went out from us, but they were not of us; for if they had been of us, they would no doubt have continued with us: but they went out, that they might be made manifest that they were not all of us.

1After these things Jesus walked in Galilee: for he would not walk in Jewry, because the Jews sought to kill him.

2Now the Jews' feast of tabernacles was at hand.

3His brethren therefore said unto him, Depart hence, and go into Judaea, that thy disciples also may see the works that thou doest.

4For there is no man that doeth any thing in secret, and he himself seeketh to be known openly. If thou do these things, shew thyself to the world.

5For neither did his brethren believe in him.

6Then Jesus said unto them, My time is not yet come: but your time is alway ready.

7The world cannot hate you; but me it hateth, because I testify of it, that the works thereof are evil.

8Go ye up unto this feast: I go not up yet unto this feast; for my time is not yet full come.

9When he had said these words unto them, he abode still in Galilee.

10But when his brethren were gone up, then went he also up unto the feast, not openly, but as it were in secret.

11Then the Jews sought him at the feast, and said, Where is he?

12And there was much murmuring among the people concerning him: for some said, He is a good man: others said, Nay; but he deceiveth the people.

13Howbeit no man spake openly of him for fear of the Jews.

14Now about the midst of the feast Jesus went up into the temple, and taught.

15And the Jews marvelled, saying, How knoweth this man letters, having never learned?

16Jesus answered them, and said, My doctrine is not mine, but his that sent me.

17If any man will do his will, he shall know of the doctrine, whether it be of God, or whether I speak of myself.

18He that speaketh of himself seeketh his own glory: but he that seeketh his glory that sent him, the same is true, and no unrighteousness is in him.

19Did not Moses give you the law, and yet none of you keepeth the law? Why go ye about to kill me?

20The people answered and said, Thou hast a devil: who goeth about to kill thee?

21Jesus answered and said unto them, I have done one work, and ye all marvel.

22Moses therefore gave unto you circumcision; (not because it is of Moses, but of the fathers;) and ye on the sabbath day circumcise a man.

23If a man on the sabbath day receive circumcision, that the law of Moses should not be broken; are ye angry at me, because I have made a man every whit whole on the sabbath day?

24Judge not according to the appearance, but judge righteous judgment.

25Then said some of them of Jerusalem, Is not this he, whom they seek to kill?

26But, lo, he speaketh boldly, and they say nothing unto him. Do the rulers know indeed that this is the very Christ?

27Howbeit we know this man whence he is: but when Christ cometh, no man knoweth whence he is.

28Then cried Jesus in the temple as he taught, saying, Ye both know me, and ye know whence I am: and I am not come of

myself, but he that sent me is true, whom ye know not.

29But I know him: for I am from him, and he hath sent me.

30Then they sought to take him: but no man laid hands on him, because his hour was not yet come.

31And many of the people believed on him, and said, When Christ cometh, will he do more miracles than these which this man hath done?

32The Pharisees heard that the people murmured such things concerning him; and the Pharisees and the chief priests sent officers to take him.

33Then said Jesus unto them, Yet a little while am I with you, and then I go unto him that sent me.

34Ye shall seek me, and shall not find me: and where I am, thither ye cannot come.

35Then said the Jews among themselves, Whither will he go, that we shall not find him? will he go unto the dispersed among the Gentiles, and teach the Gentiles?

36What manner of saying is this that he said, Ye shall seek me, and shall not find me: and where I am, thither ye cannot come?

37In the last day, that great day of the feast, Jesus stood and cried, saying, If any man thirst, let him come unto me, and drink.

38He that believeth on me, as the scripture hath said, out of his belly shall flow rivers of living water.

39(But this spake he of the Spirit, which they that believe on him should receive: for the Holy Ghost was not yet given; because that Jesus was not yet glorified.)

40Many of the people therefore, when they heard this saying, said, Of a truth this is the Prophet.

41Others said, This is the Christ. But some said, Shall Christ come out of Galilee?

42Hath not the scripture said, That Christ cometh of the seed of David, and out of the town of Bethlehem, where David was?

43So there was a division among the people because of him.

44And some of them would have taken him; but no man laid hands on him.

45Then came the officers to the chief priests and Pharisees; and they said unto them, Why have ye not brought him?

46The officers answered, Never man spake like this man.

47Then answered them the Pharisees, Are ye also deceived?

48Have any of the rulers or of the Pharisees believed on him?

49But this people who knoweth not the law are cursed.

50Nicodemus saith unto them, (he that came to Jesus by night, being one of them,)

51Doth our law judge any man, before it hear him, and know what he doeth?

52They answered and said unto him, Art thou also of Galilee? Search, and look: for out of Galilee ariseth no prophet.

53And every man went unto his own house.

1. John 7:1–19

Jesus testified of the Father, preached truth, and was hated for it. The world will hate us also.

John 3:19–20
And this is the condemnation, that light is come into the world, and men loved darkness rather than light, because their deeds were evil.
For every one that doeth evil hateth the light, neither cometh to the light, lest his deeds should be reproved.

John 15:18–19
If the world hate you, ye know that it hated me before it hated you.
If ye were of the world, the world would love his own: but because ye are not of the world, but I have chosen you out of the world, therefore the world hateth you.

John 15:20
Remember the word that I said unto you, The servant is not greater than his lord. If they have persecuted me, they will also persecute you; if they have kept my saying, they will keep yours also.

Matthew 10:22
And ye shall be hated of all men for my name's sake: but he that endureth to the end shall be saved.

2 Timothy 3:12
Yea, and all that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution.

1 John 3:13
Marvel not, my brethren, if the world hate you.

2. John 7:31

His miracles proved He was the Messiah, the Christ.

John 5:36
But I have greater witness than that of John: for the works which the Father hath given me to finish, the same works that I do, bear witness of me, that the Father hath sent me.

John 10:25
Jesus answered them, I told you, and ye believed not: the works that I do in my Father's name, they bear witness of me.

John 10:37–38
If I do not the works of my Father, believe me not.
But if I do, though ye believe not me, believe the works: that ye may know, and believe, that the Father is in me, and I in him.

Acts 2:22
Ye men of Israel, hear these words; Jesus of Nazareth, a man approved of God among you by miracles and wonders and signs, which God did by him in the midst of you, as ye yourselves also know.

John 20:30–31
And many other signs truly did Jesus in the presence of his disciples, which are not written in this book:
But these are written, that ye might believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God; and that believing ye might have life through his name.

3. John 7:33–34

God gives a time of repentance, then it becomes too late.

John 7:33–34
Then said Jesus unto them, Yet a little while am I with you, and then I go unto him that sent me.
Ye shall seek me, and shall not find me: and where I am, thither ye cannot come.

John 8:21
Then said Jesus again unto them, I go my way, and ye shall seek me, and shall die in your sins: whither I go, ye cannot come.

Proverbs 29:1
He, that being often reproved hardeneth his neck, shall suddenly be destroyed, and that without remedy.

Genesis 6:3
And the LORD said, My spirit shall not always strive with man, for that he also is flesh: yet his days shall be an hundred and twenty years.

Isaiah 55:6
Seek ye the LORD while he may be found, call ye upon him while he is near.

2 Corinthians 6:2
(For he saith, I have heard thee in a time accepted, and in the day of salvation have I succoured thee: behold, now is the accepted time; behold, now is the day of salvation.)

Hebrews 3:7–8
Wherefore (as the Holy Ghost saith, To day if ye will hear his voice,
Harden not your hearts, as in the provocation, in the day of temptation in the wilderness.

4. John 7:37–39

The Spirit and the word of God as living water.

John 4:13–14
Jesus answered and said unto her, Whosoever drinketh of this water shall thirst again:
But whosoever drinketh of the water that I shall give him shall never thirst; but the water that I shall give him shall be in him a well of water springing up into everlasting life.

Isaiah 55:1
Ho, every one that thirsteth, come ye to the waters, and he that hath no money; come ye, buy, and eat; yea, come, buy wine and milk without money and without price.

Isaiah 44:3
For I will pour water upon him that is thirsty, and floods upon the dry ground: I will pour my spirit upon thy seed, and my blessing upon thine offspring.

Ephesians 5:26
That he might sanctify and cleanse it with the washing of water by the word.

Revelation 22:1
And he shewed me a pure river of water of life, clear as crystal, proceeding out of the throne of God and of the Lamb.

Revelation 22:17
And the Spirit and the bride say, Come. And let him that heareth say, Come. And let him that is athirst come. And whosoever will, let him take the water of life freely.

5. John 7:42

The prophecy it refers to: Christ of the seed of David, out of Bethlehem.

Micah 5:2
But thou, Bethlehem Ephratah, though thou be little among the thousands of Judah, yet out of thee shall he come forth unto me that is to be ruler in Israel; whose goings forth have been from of old, from everlasting.

2 Samuel 7:12–13
And when thy days be fulfilled, and thou shalt sleep with thy fathers, I will set up thy seed after thee, which shall proceed out of thy bowels, and I will establish his kingdom.
He shall build an house for my name, and I will establish the throne of his kingdom for ever.

Psalm 132:11
The LORD hath sworn in truth unto David; he will not turn from it; Of the fruit of thy body will I set upon thy throne.

Jeremiah 23:5
Behold, the days come, saith the LORD, that I will raise unto David a righteous Branch, and a King shall reign and prosper, and shall execute judgment and justice in the earth.

Matthew 2:4–6
And when he had gathered all the chief priests and scribes of the people together, he demanded of them where Christ should be born.
And they said unto him, In Bethlehem of Judaea: for thus it is written by the prophet,
And thou Bethlehem, in the land of Juda, art not the least among the princes of Juda: for out of thee shall come a Governor, that shall rule my people Israel.

6. John 7:43

Jesus divides and causes division between people.

Luke 12:51–53
Suppose ye that I am come to give peace on earth? I tell you, Nay; but rather division:
For from henceforth there shall be five in one house divided, three against two, and two against three.
The father shall be divided against the son, and the son against the father; the mother against the daughter, and the daughter against the mother; the mother in law against her daughter in law, and the daughter in law against her mother in law.

Matthew 10:34–36
Think not that I am come to send peace on earth: I came not to send peace, but a sword.
For I am come to set a man at variance against his father, and the daughter against her mother, and the daughter in law against her mother in law.
And a man’s foes shall be they of his own household.

John 9:16
Therefore said some of the Pharisees, This man is not of God, because he keepeth not the sabbath day. Others said, How can a man that is a sinner do such miracles? And there was a division among them.

1 Peter 2:7–8
Unto you therefore which believe he is precious: but unto them which be disobedient, the stone which the builders disallowed, the same is made the head of the corner,
And a stone of stumbling, and a rock of offence, even to them which stumble at the word, being disobedient: whereunto also they were appointed.

1 Corinthians 1:23
But we preach Christ crucified, unto the Jews a stumblingblock, and unto the Greeks foolishness.

1Jesus went unto the mount of Olives.

2And early in the morning he came again into the temple, and all the people came unto him; and he sat down, and taught them.

3And the scribes and Pharisees brought unto him a woman taken in adultery; and when they had set her in the midst,

4They say unto him, Master, this woman was taken in adultery, in the very act.

5Now Moses in the law commanded us, that such should be stoned: but what sayest thou?

6This they said, tempting him, that they might have to accuse him. But Jesus stooped down, and with his finger wrote on the ground, as though he heard them not.

7So when they continued asking him, he lifted up himself, and said unto them, He that is without sin among you, let him first cast a stone at her.

8And again he stooped down, and wrote on the ground.

9And they which heard it, being convicted by their own conscience, went out one by one, beginning at the eldest, even unto the last: and Jesus was left alone, and the woman standing in the midst.

10When Jesus had lifted up himself, and saw none but the woman, he said unto her, Woman, where are those thine accusers? hath no man condemned thee?

11She said, No man, Lord. And Jesus said unto her, Neither do I condemn thee: go, and sin no more.

12Then spake Jesus again unto them, saying, I am the light of the world: he that followeth me shall not walk in darkness, but shall have the light of life.

13The Pharisees therefore said unto him, Thou bearest record of thyself; thy record is not true.

14Jesus answered and said unto them, Though I bear record of myself, yet my record is true: for I know whence I came, and whither I go; but ye cannot tell whence I come, and whither I go.

15Ye judge after the flesh; I judge no man.

16And yet if I judge, my judgment is true: for I am not alone, but I and the Father that sent me.

17It is also written in your law, that the testimony of two men is true.

18I am one that bear witness of myself, and the Father that sent me beareth witness of me.

19Then said they unto him, Where is thy Father? Jesus answered, Ye neither know me, nor my Father: if ye had known me, ye should have known my Father also.

20These words spake Jesus in the treasury, as he taught in the temple: and no man laid hands on him; for his hour was not yet come.

21Then said Jesus again unto them, I go my way, and ye shall seek me, and shall die in your sins: whither I go, ye cannot come.

22Then said the Jews, Will he kill himself? because he saith, Whither I go, ye cannot come.

23And he said unto them, Ye are from beneath; I am from above: ye are of this world; I am not of this world.

24I said therefore unto you, that ye shall die in your sins: for if ye believe not that I am he, ye shall die in your sins.

25Then said they unto him, Who art thou? And Jesus saith unto them, Even the same that I said unto you from the beginning.

26I have many things to say and to judge of you: but he that sent me is true; and I speak to the world those things which I have heard of him.

27They understood not that he spake to them of the Father.

28Then said Jesus unto them, When ye have lifted up the Son of man, then shall ye know that I am he, and that I do nothing of myself; but as my Father hath taught me, I speak these things.

29And he that sent me is with me: the Father hath not left me alone; for I do always those things that please him.

30As he spake these words, many believed on him.

31Then said Jesus to those Jews which believed on him, If ye continue in my word, then are ye my disciples indeed;

32And ye shall know the truth, and the truth shall make you free.

33They answered him, We be Abraham's seed, and were never in bondage to any man: how sayest thou, Ye shall be made free?

34Jesus answered them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Whosoever committeth sin is the servant of sin.

35And the servant abideth not in the house for ever: but the Son abideth ever.

36If the Son therefore shall make you free, ye shall be free indeed.

37I know that ye are Abraham's seed; but ye seek to kill me, because my word hath no place in you.

38I speak that which I have seen with my Father: and ye do that which ye have seen with your father.

39They answered and said unto him, Abraham is our father. Jesus saith unto them, If ye were Abraham's children, ye would do the works of Abraham.

40But now ye seek to kill me, a man that hath told you the truth, which I have heard of God: this did not Abraham.

41Ye do the deeds of your father. Then said they to him, We be not born of fornication; we have one Father, even God.

42Jesus said unto them, If God were your Father, ye would love me: for I proceeded forth and came from God; neither came I of myself, but he sent me.

43Why do ye not understand my speech? even because ye cannot hear my word.

44Ye are of your father the devil, and the lusts of your father ye will do. He was a murderer from the beginning, and abode not in the truth, because there is no truth in him. When he speaketh a lie, he speaketh of his own: for he is a liar, and the father of it.

45And because I tell you the truth, ye believe me not.

46Which of you convinceth me of sin? And if I say the truth, why do ye not believe me?

47He that is of God heareth God's words: ye therefore hear them not, because ye are not of God.

48Then answered the Jews, and said unto him, Say we not well that thou art a Samaritan, and hast a devil?

49Jesus answered, I have not a devil; but I honour my Father, and ye do dishonour me.

50And I seek not mine own glory: there is one that seeketh and judgeth.

51Verily, verily, I say unto you, If a man keep my saying, he shall never see death.

52Then said the Jews unto him, Now we know that thou hast a devil. Abraham is

dead, and the prophets; and thou sayest, If a man keep my saying, he shall never taste of death.

53Art thou greater than our father Abraham, which is dead? and the prophets are dead: whom makest thou thyself?

54Jesus answered, If I honour myself, my honour is nothing: it is my Father that honoureth me; of whom ye say, that he is your God:

55Yet ye have not known him; but I know him: and if I should say, I know him not, I shall be a liar like unto you: but I know him, and keep his saying.

56Your father Abraham rejoiced to see my day: and he saw it, and was glad.

57Then said the Jews unto him, Thou art not yet fifty years old, and hast thou seen Abraham?

58Jesus said unto them, Verily, verily, I say unto you, Before Abraham was, I am.

59Then took they up stones to cast at him: but Jesus hid himself, and went out of the temple, going through the midst of them, and so passed by.

God's Desire for Repentance

Ezekiel 18:23
"Have I any pleasure at all that the wicked should die? saith the Lord GOD: and not that he should return from his ways, and live?"

Ezekiel 18:32
"For I have no pleasure in the death of him that dieth, saith the Lord GOD: wherefore turn yourselves, and live ye."

Ezekiel 33:11
"As I live, saith the Lord GOD, I have no pleasure in the death of the wicked; but that the wicked turn from his way and live: turn ye, turn ye from your evil ways; for why will ye die, O house of Israel?"

Isaiah 55:6–7
"Seek ye the LORD while he may be found, call ye upon him while he is near: Let the wicked forsake his way, and the unrighteous man his thoughts: and let him return unto the LORD, and he will have mercy upon him; and to our God, for he will abundantly pardon."

Joel 2:12–13
"Therefore also now, saith the LORD, turn ye even to me with all your heart… And rend your heart, and not your garments, and turn unto the LORD your God: for he is gracious and merciful, slow to anger, and of great kindness, and repenteth him of the evil."

2 Peter 3:9
"The Lord is not slack concerning his promise, as some men count slackness; but is longsuffering to us-ward, not willing that any should perish, but that all should come to repentance."

God's Willingness to Forgive

Psalm 86:5
"For thou, Lord, art good, and ready to forgive; and plenteous in mercy unto all them that call upon thee."

Psalm 103:8–12
"The LORD is merciful and gracious, slow to anger, and plenteous in mercy… As far as the east is from the west, so far hath he removed our transgressions from us."

Micah 7:18–19
"Who is a God like unto thee, that pardoneth iniquity… he delighteth in mercy. He will turn again, he will have compassion upon us; he will subdue our iniquities; and thou wilt cast all their sins into the depths of the sea."

Isaiah 1:18
"Come now, and let us reason together, saith the LORD: though your sins be as scarlet, they shall be as white as snow; though they be red like crimson, they shall be as wool."

Isaiah 43:25
"I, even I, am he that blotteth out thy transgressions for mine own sake, and will not remember thy sins."

Continuing in His Word as the Mark of a True Disciple

John 15:4–7
"Abide in me, and I in you… If ye abide in me, and my words abide in you, ye shall ask what ye will, and it shall be done unto you."

John 14:23–24
"If a man love me, he will keep my words… He that loveth me not keepeth not my sayings."

Colossians 1:23
"If ye continue in the faith grounded and settled, and be not moved away from the hope of the gospel…"

2 John 1:9
"Whosoever transgresseth, and abideth not in the doctrine of Christ, hath not God. He that abideth in the doctrine of Christ, he hath both the Father and the Son."

Psalm 119:11
"Thy word have I hid in mine heart, that I might not sin against thee."

Truth Known and Lived Bringing Freedom

Psalm 119:45
"And I will walk at liberty: for I seek thy precepts."

James 1:25

“But whoso looketh into the perfect law of liberty, and continueth therein… this man shall be blessed in his deed.”

James 2:12
“So speak ye, and so do, as they that shall be judged by the law of liberty.”

Psalm 19:7
“The law of the LORD is perfect, converting the soul…”

Freedom Comes From God Alone, Not Lineage or Profession

Romans 8:2
“For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus hath made me free from the law of sin and death.”

Romans 6:18
“Being then made free from sin, ye became the servants of righteousness.”

Galatians 5:1
“Stand fast therefore in the liberty wherewith Christ hath made us free, and be not entangled again with the yoke of bondage.”

Isaiah 61:1
“The Spirit of the Lord GOD is upon me… to proclaim liberty to the captives, and the opening of the prison to them that are bound.”

Obedience to God as True Freedom

Romans 6:16–18
“Know ye not, that to whom ye yield yourselves servants to obey, his servants ye are… whether of sin unto death, or of obedience unto righteousness?”

Psalm 119:60
“I made haste, and delayed not to keep thy commandments.”

Deuteronomy 10:12–13
“And now, Israel, what doth the LORD thy God require of thee… To keep the commandments of the LORD, and his statutes, which I command thee this day for thy good?”

1 Peter 1:14–16
“As obedient children… Be ye holy; for I am holy.”

All Else Is Slavery or Bondage

Romans 6:20
“For when ye were the servants of sin, ye were free from righteousness.”

2 Peter 2:19
“While they promise them liberty, they themselves are the servants of corruption: for of whom a man is overcome, of the same is he brought in bondage.”

Proverbs 5:22
“His own iniquities shall take the wicked himself, and he shall be holden with the cords of his sins.”

Isaiah 42:6–7
“I the LORD have called thee… to bring out the prisoners from the prison, and them that sit in darkness out of the prison house.”

Sonship Versus Servanthood Without Freedom

Romans 8:15
“For ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear; but ye have received the Spirit of adoption, whereby we cry, Abba, Father.”

Galatians 4:7
“Wherefore thou art no more a servant, but a son; and if a son, then an heir of God through Christ.”

Hebrews 2:14–15
“That through death he might destroy him that had the power of death… And deliver them who through fear of death were all their lifetime subject to bondage.”

Association With the Devil Shown by Lies and Falsehood

Genesis 3:1–4
“Now the serpent was more subtil than any beast of the field… And the serpent said unto the woman, Ye shall not surely die.”

2 Corinthians 11:3

“But I fear, lest by any means, as the serpent beguiled Eve through his subtilty, so your minds should be corrupted from the simplicity that is in Christ.”

2 Corinthians 4:4
“In whom the god of this world hath blinded the minds of them which believe not…”

1 John 2:21–22
“No lie is of the truth. Who is a liar but he that denieth that Jesus is the Christ?”

Revelation 12:9
“That old serpent, called the Devil, and Satan, which deceiveth the whole world…”

Association With the Devil Shown by Hatred and Murder

Genesis 4:8
“And Cain talked with Abel his brother: and it came to pass… that Cain rose up against Abel his brother, and slew him.”

1 John 3:12
“Not as Cain, who was of that wicked one, and slew his brother.”

1 John 3:15
“Whosoever hateth his brother is a murderer: and ye know that no murderer hath eternal life abiding in him.”

Titus 3:3
“For we ourselves also were sometimes foolish… hateful, and hating one another.”

Not Hearing God’s Word as Evidence of Not Being of God

John 10:26–27
“But ye believe not, because ye are not of my sheep… My sheep hear my voice, and I know them, and they follow me.”

Matthew 13:13–15
“For this people’s heart is waxed gross, and their ears are dull of hearing…”

Romans 8:7
“Because the carnal mind is enmity against God: for it is not subject to the law of God, neither indeed can be.”

2 Timothy 4:3–4
“For the time will come when they will not endure sound doctrine… and shall be turned unto fables.”

Association With God Shown by Truth

John 14:6
“I am the way, the truth, and the life: no man cometh unto the Father, but by me.”

John 17:17
“Sanctify them through thy truth: thy word is truth.”

Psalm 25:10
“All the paths of the LORD are mercy and truth unto such as keep his covenant and his testimonies.”

1 John 5:20
“And we know that the Son of God is come… that we may know him that is true.”

Association With God Shown by Love

John 13:34–35
“A new commandment I give unto you, That ye love one another… By this shall all men know that ye are my disciples.”

1 John 4:7–8
“Beloved, let us love one another: for love is of God… God is love.”

Romans 12:9
“Let love be without dissimulation. Abhor that which is evil; cleave to that which is good.”

Ephesians 5:1–2
“Be ye therefore followers of God, as dear children; And walk in love…”

Hearing and Keeping God’s Word as Evidence of Being of God

John 14:15
“If ye love me, keep my commandments.”

John 17:8
“For I have given unto them the words which thou gavest me; and they have received them…”

Luke 8:15
“But that on the good ground are they, which in an honest and good heart, having heard the word, keep it…”

James 1:22
“But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves.”

<u>Life Promised to Those Who Keep His Word</u>

John 5:24
“He that heareth my word, and believeth on him that sent me, hath everlasting life…”

Psalm 119:160
“Thy word is true from the beginning: and every one of thy righteous judgments endureth for ever.”

Proverbs 8:34–35
“Blessed is the man that heareth me… For whoso findeth me findeth life…”

1And as Jesus passed by, he saw a man which was blind from his birth.

2And his disciples asked him, saying, Master, who did sin, this man, or his parents, that he was born blind?

3Jesus answered, Neither hath this man sinned, nor his parents: but that the works of God should be made manifest in him.

4I must work the works of him that sent me, while it is day: the night cometh, when no man can work.

5As long as I am in the world, I am the light of the world.

6When he had thus spoken, he spat on the ground, and made clay of the spittle, and he anointed the eyes of the blind man with the clay,

7And said unto him, Go, wash in the pool of Siloam, (which is by interpretation, Sent.) He went his way therefore, and washed, and came seeing.

8The neighbours therefore, and they which before had seen him that he was blind, said, Is not this he that sat and begged?

9Some said, This is he: others said, He is like him: but he said, I am he.

10Therefore said they unto him, How were thine eyes opened?

11He answered and said, A man that is called Jesus made clay, and anointed mine eyes, and said unto me, Go to the pool of Siloam, and wash: and I went and washed, and I received sight.

12Then said they unto him, Where is he? He said, I know not.

13They brought to the Pharisees him that aforetime was blind.

14And it was the sabbath day when Jesus made the clay, and opened his eyes.

15Then again the Pharisees also asked him how he had received his sight. He said unto them, He put clay upon mine eyes, and I washed, and do see.

16Therefore said some of the Pharisees, This man is not of God, because he keepeth not the sabbath day. Others said, How can a man that is a sinner do such miracles? And there was a division among them.

17They say unto the blind man again, What sayest thou of him, that he hath opened thine eyes? He said, He is a prophet.

18But the Jews did not believe concerning him, that he had been blind, and received his sight, until they called the parents of him that had received his sight.

19And they asked them, saying, Is this your son, who ye say was born blind? how then doth he now see?

20His parents answered them and said, We know that this is our son, and that he was born blind:

21But by what means he now seeth, we know not; or who hath opened his eyes, we know not: he is of age; ask him: he shall speak for himself.

22These words spake his parents, because they feared the Jews: for the Jews had agreed already, that if any man did confess that he was Christ, he should be put out of the synagogue.

23Therefore said his parents, He is of age; ask him.

24Then again called they the man that was blind, and said unto him, Give God the praise: we know that this man is a sinner.

25He answered and said, Whether he be a sinner or no, I know not: one thing I know, that, whereas I was blind, now I see.

26Then said they to him again, What did he to thee? how opened he thine eyes?

27He answered them, I have told you already, and ye did not hear: wherefore would ye hear it again? will ye also be his disciples?

28Then they reviled him, and said, Thou art his disciple; but we are Moses' disciples.

29We know that God spake unto Moses: as for this fellow, we know not from whence he is.

30The man answered and said unto them, Why herein is a marvellous thing, that ye know not from whence he is, and yet he hath opened mine eyes.

31Now we know that God heareth not sinners: but if any man be a worshipper of God, and doeth his will, him he heareth.

32Since the world began was it not heard that any man opened the eyes of one that was born blind.

33If this man were not of God, he could do nothing.

34They answered and said unto him, Thou wast altogether born in sins, and dost thou teach us? And they cast him out.

35Jesus heard that they had cast him out; and when he had found him, he said unto him, Dost thou believe on the Son of God?

36He answered and said, Who is he, Lord, that I might believe on him?

37And Jesus said unto him, Thou hast both seen him, and it is he that talketh with thee.

38And he said, Lord, I believe. And he worshipped him.

39And Jesus said, For judgment I am come into this world, that they which see not might see; and that they which see might be made blind.

40And some of the Pharisees which were with him heard these words, and said unto him, Are we blind also?

41Jesus said unto them, If ye were blind, ye should have no sin: but now ye say, We see; therefore your sin remaineth.

Bad Things Turning for God's Glory

John 9:3
Jesus answered, Neither hath this man sinned, nor his parents: but that the works of God should be made manifest in him.

John 11:4
When Jesus heard that, he said, This sickness is not unto death, but for the glory of God, that the Son of God might be glorified thereby.

Romans 8:28
And we know that all things work together for good to them that love God, to them who are the called according to his purpose.

Genesis 50:20
But as for you, ye thought evil against me; but God meant it unto good, to bring to pass, as it is this day, to save much people alive.

2 Corinthians 12:9
And he said unto me, My grace is sufficient for thee: for my strength is made perfect in weakness. Most gladly therefore will I rather glory in my infirmities, that the power of Christ may rest upon me.

Job 1:22
In all this Job sinned not, nor charged God foolishly.

Blindness as a Picture of the Lost Condition

Isaiah 6:9–10
"Hear ye indeed, but understand not; and see ye indeed, but perceive not… and convert, and be healed."

Isaiah 42:18–20
"Hear, ye deaf; and look, ye blind, that ye may see."

Isaiah 59:9–10
"We wait for light, but behold obscurity… we grope for the wall like the blind…"

Matthew 15:14
"Let them alone: they be blind leaders of the blind. And if the blind lead the blind, both shall fall into the ditch."

Romans 11:8
"God hath given them the spirit of slumber, eyes that they should not see…"

2 Corinthians 4:3–4
"But if our gospel be hid, it is hid to them that are lost… the god of this world hath blinded the minds of them which believe not."

Sight as a Picture of Salvation and Spiritual Illumination

Psalm 146:8
"The LORD openeth the eyes of the blind: the LORD raiseth them that are bowed down…"

Isaiah 35:5
"Then the eyes of the blind shall be opened…"

Isaiah 42:6–7
"To open the blind eyes, to bring out the prisoners from the prison…"

Luke 4:18
"The Spirit of the Lord is upon me… to recover sight to the blind…"

Acts 26:17–18
"To open their eyes, and to turn them from darkness to light, and from the power of Satan unto God…"

Coming to Jesus as the Turning Point From Blindness to Sight

John 8:12
"I am the light of the world: he that followeth me shall not walk in darkness, but shall have the light of life."

John 12:46
"I am come a light into the world, that whosoever believeth on me should not abide in darkness."

Ephesians 5:8
"For ye were sometimes darkness, but now are ye light in the Lord: walk as children of light."

Colossians 1:12–13
"Who hath delivered us from the power of darkness, and hath translated us into the kingdom of his dear Son."

Testimony of Personal Transformation

Psalm 66:16
"Come and hear, all ye that fear God, and I will declare what he hath done for my soul."

Psalm 40:2–3
"He brought me up also out of an horrible pit… And he hath put a new song in my mouth… many shall see it, and fear, and shall trust in the LORD."

Isaiah 12:4–5
"Declare his doings among the people, make mention that his name is exalted."

Mark 5:19–20
"Go home to thy friends, and tell them how great things the Lord hath done for thee, and hath had compassion on thee."

The Power of Changed Life Over Perfect Words

2 Corinthians 3:2–3
"Ye are our epistle written in our hearts, known and read of all men… written not with ink, but with the Spirit of the living God."

1 Peter 2:12
"Having your conversation honest among the Gentiles: that… they may by your good works… glorify God."
1 John 1:1–3
"That which we have seen and heard declare we unto you…"

Statements That God Does Not Hear the Wicked

Psalm 66:18
"If I regard iniquity in my heart, the Lord will not hear me."

Proverbs 15:29
"The LORD is far from the wicked: but he heareth the prayer of the righteous."

Proverbs 28:9
"He that turneth away his ear from hearing the law, even his prayer shall be abomination."

Isaiah 1:15
"And when ye spread forth your hands, I will hide mine eyes from you: yea, when ye make many prayers, I will not hear: your hands are full of blood."

Micah 3:4
"Then shall they cry unto the LORD, but he will not hear them… as they have behaved themselves ill in their doings."

Iniquity as the Barrier Between God and Us

Isaiah 59:1–2
"Behold, the LORD'S hand is not shortened, that it cannot save… but your iniquities have separated between you and your God, and your sins have hid his face from you, that he will not hear."

Jeremiah 11:11
"Then shall they cry unto me, but I will not hearken unto them."

Jeremiah 14:10–12
"…when they fast, I will not hear their cry; and when they offer burnt offering… I will not accept them."

God Hearing the Righteous and Those Who Fear Him

Psalm 34:15–17
"The eyes of the LORD are upon the righteous, and his ears are open unto their cry… The righteous cry, and the LORD heareth."

Psalm 145:18–19
"The LORD is nigh unto all them that call upon him, to all that call upon him in truth. He will fulfil the desire of them that fear him: he also will hear their cry."

Proverbs 15:8
"The sacrifice of the wicked is an abomination to the LORD: but the prayer of the upright is his delight."

1 Peter 3:12
"For the eyes of the Lord are over the righteous, and his ears are open unto their prayers: but the face of the Lord is against them that do evil."

What does all of this saying about my life & having it again mean?

1Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that entereth not by the door into the sheepfold, but climbeth up some other way, the same is a thief and a robber.

2But he that entereth in by the door is the shepherd of the sheep.

3To him the porter openeth; and the sheep hear his voice: and he calleth his own sheep by name, and leadeth them out.

4And when he putteth forth his own sheep, he goeth before them, and the sheep follow him: for they know his voice.

Do you know God's voice? How you ever heard from him?

5And a stranger will they not follow, but will flee from him: for they know not the voice of strangers.

6This parable spake Jesus unto them: but they understood not what things they were which he spake unto them.

*Likes/How did Jesus tell them?

7Then said Jesus unto them again, Verily, verily, I say unto you, I am the door of the sheep.

8All that ever came before me are thieves and robbers: but the sheep did not hear them.

9I am the door: by me if any man enter in, he shall be saved, and shall go in and out, and find pasture.

10The thief cometh not, but for to steal, and to kill, and to destroy: I am come that they might have life, and that they might have it more abundantly.

11I am the good shepherd: the good shepherd giveth his life for the sheep. What is this referring to?

12But he that is an hireling, and not the shepherd, whose own the sheep are not, seeth the wolf coming, and leaveth the sheep, and fleeth: and the wolf catcheth them, and scattereth the sheep.

13The hireling fleeth, because he is an hireling, and careth not for the sheep.

14I am the good shepherd, and know my sheep, and am known of mine.

15As the Father knoweth me, even so know I the Father: and I lay down my life for the sheep.

said 2x now, pay close attention!

16And other sheep I have, which are not of this fold: them also I must bring, and they shall hear my voice; and there shall be one fold, and one shepherd.

17Therefore doth my Father love me, because I lay down my life, that I might take it again.

18No man taketh it from me, but I lay it down of myself. I have power to lay it down, and I have power to take it again. This commandment have I received of my Father.

19There was a division therefore again among the Jews for these sayings.

20And many of them said, He hath a devil, and is mad; why hear ye him?

21Others said, These are not the words of him that hath a devil. Can a devil open the eyes of the blind?

22And it was at Jerusalem the feast of the dedication, and it was winter.

23And Jesus walked in the temple in Solomon's porch.

24Then came the Jews round about him, and said unto him, How long dost thou make us to doubt? If thou be the Christ, tell us plainly.

25Jesus answered them, I told you, and ye believed not: the works that I do in my Father's name, they bear witness of me.

26But ye believe not, because ye are not of my sheep, as I said unto you.

27My sheep hear my voice, and I know them, and they follow me:

* Do you hear God's voice regularly? Does he know you? *

If you want this you need to answer this.

28And I give unto them eternal life; and they shall never perish, neither shall any man pluck them out of my hand.

29My Father, which gave them me, is greater than all; and no man is able to pluck them out of my Father's hand.

30I and my Father are one.

* answers to us: 24-25 again!

31Then the Jews took up stones again to stone him.

They know what he was claiming; they just didn't like the answer!

32Jesus answered them, Many good works have I shewed you from my Father; for which of those works do ye stone me?

33The Jews answered him, saying, For a good work we stone thee not; but for blasphemy; and because that thou, being a man, makest thyself God.

34Jesus answered them, Is it not written in your law, I said, Ye are gods?

35If he called them gods, unto whom the word of God came, and the scripture cannot be broken;

36Say ye of him, whom the Father hath sanctified, and sent into the world, Thou blasphemest; because I said, I am the Son of God?

37If I do not the works of my Father, believe me not.

38But if I do, though ye believe not me, believe the works: that ye may know, and believe, that the Father is in me, and I in him.

* Actions speak louder than words! What do your actions say about your life?

39Therefore they sought again to take him: but he escaped out of their hand,

40And went away again beyond Jordan into the place where John at first baptized; and there he abode.

41And many resorted unto him, and said, John did no miracle: but all things that John spake of this man were true.

42And many believed on him there.

* Some seek to kill Jesus for his claims & works (miracles) WHILE some simply believe in him. It is the same today. The question is; what will you do with the word of God / things he has shown you today? Some word to all their people; very different reactions!

1Then Jesus six days before the passover came to Bethany, where Lazarus was which had been dead, whom he raised from the dead.

2There they made him a supper; and Martha served: but Lazarus was one of them that sat at the table with him.

3Then took Mary a pound of ointment of spikenard, very costly, and anointed the feet of Jesus, and wiped his feet with her hair: and the house was filled with the odour of the ointment.

4Then saith one of his disciples, Judas Iscariot, Simon's son, which should betray him,

5Why was not this ointment sold for three hundred pence, and given to the poor?

6This he said, not that he cared for the poor; but because he was a thief, and had the bag, and bare what was put therein.

7Then said Jesus, Let her alone: against the day of my burying hath she kept this.

8For the poor always ye have with you; but me ye have not always.

9Much people of the Jews therefore knew that he was there: and they came not for Jesus' sake only, but that they might see Lazarus also, whom he had raised from the dead.

10But the chief priests consulted that they might put Lazarus also to death;

11Because that by reason of him many of the Jews went away, and believed on Jesus.

12On the next day much people that were come to the feast, when they heard that Jesus was coming to Jerusalem,

13Took branches of palm trees, and went forth to meet him, and cried, Hosanna: Blessed is the King of Israel that cometh in the name of the Lord.

14And Jesus, when he had found a young ass, sat thereon; as it is written,

15Fear not, daughter of Sion: behold, thy King cometh, sitting on an ass's colt.

16These things understood not his disciples at the first: but when Jesus was glorified, then remembered they that these things were written of him, and that they had done these things unto him.

17The people therefore that was with him when he called Lazarus out of his grave, and raised him from the dead, bare record.

18For this cause the people also met him, for that they heard that he had done this miracle.

19The Pharisees therefore said among themselves, Perceive ye how ye prevail nothing? behold, the world is gone after him.

20And there were certain Greeks among them that came up to worship at the feast:

21The same came therefore to Philip, which was of Bethsaida of Galilee, and desired him, saying, Sir, we would see Jesus.

22Philip cometh and telleth Andrew: and again Andrew and Philip tell Jesus.

23And Jesus answered them, saying, The hour is come, that the Son of man should be glorified.

24Verily, verily, I say unto you, Except a corn of wheat fall into the ground and die, it abideth alone: but if it die, it bringeth forth much fruit.

25He that loveth his life shall lose it; and he that hateth his life in this world shall keep it unto life eternal.

26If any man serve me, let him follow me; and where I am, there shall also my servant be: if any man serve me, him will my Father honour.

27Now is my soul troubled; and what shall I say? Father, save me from this hour: but for this cause came I unto this hour.

28Father, glorify thy name. Then came there a voice from heaven, saying, I have both glorified it, and will glorify it again.

29The people therefore, that stood by, and heard it, said that it thundered: others said, An angel spake to him.

30Jesus answered and said, This voice came not because of me, but for your sakes.

31Now is the judgment of this world: now shall the prince of this world be cast out.

32And I, if I be lifted up from the earth, will draw all men unto me.

33This he said, signifying what death he should die.

34The people answered him, We have heard out of the law that Christ abideth for ever: and how sayest thou, The Son of man must be lifted up? who is this Son of man?

35Then Jesus said unto them, Yet a little while is the light with you. Walk while ye have the light, lest darkness come upon you: for he that walketh in darkness knoweth not whither he goeth.

36While ye have light, believe in the light, that ye may be the children of light. These things spake Jesus, and departed, and did hide himself from them.

37But though he had done so many miracles before them, yet they believed not on him:

38That the saying of Esaias the prophet might be fulfilled, which he spake, Lord, who hath believed our report? and to whom hath the arm of the Lord been revealed?

39Therefore they could not believe, because that Esaias said again,

40He hath blinded their eyes, and hardened their heart; that they should not see with their eyes, nor understand with their heart, and be converted, and I should heal them.

41These things said Esaias, when he saw his glory, and spake of him.

42Nevertheless among the chief rulers also many believed on him; but because of the Pharisees they did not confess him, lest they should be put out of the synagogue:

43For they loved the praise of men more than the praise of God.

44Jesus cried and said, He that believeth on me, believeth not on me, but on him that sent me.

45And he that seeth me seeth him that sent me.

46I am come a light into the world, that whosoever believeth on me should not abide in darkness.

47And if any man hear my words, and believe not, I judge him not: for I came not to judge the world, but to save the world.

48He that rejecteth me, and receiveth not my words, hath one that judgeth him: the word that I have spoken, the same shall judge him in the last day.

49For I have not spoken of myself; but the Father which sent me, he gave me a commandment, what I should say, and what I should speak.

50And I know that his commandment is life everlasting: whatsoever I speak therefore, even as the Father said unto me, so I speak.

Now before the feast of the passover, when Jesus knew that his hour was come that he should depart out of this world unto the Father, having loved his own which were in the world, he loved them unto the end.

2And supper being ended, the devil having now put into the heart of Judas Iscariot, Simon's son, to betray him;

3Jesus knowing that the Father had given all things into his hands, and that he was come from God, and went to God;

4He riseth from supper, and laid aside his garments; and took a towel, and girded himself.

5After that he poureth water into a bason, and began to wash the disciples' feet, and to wipe them with the towel wherewith he was girded.

6Then cometh he to Simon Peter: and Peter saith unto him, Lord, dost thou wash my feet?

7Jesus answered and said unto him, What I do thou knowest not now; but thou shalt know hereafter.

8Peter saith unto him, Thou shalt never wash my feet. Jesus answered him, If I wash thee not, thou hast no part with me.

9Simon Peter saith unto him, Lord, not my feet only, but also my hands and my head.

10Jesus saith to him, He that is washed needeth not save to wash his feet, but is clean every whit: and ye are clean, but not all.

11For he knew who should betray him; therefore said he, Ye are not all clean.

12So after he had washed their feet, and had taken his garments, and was set down again, he said unto them, Know ye what I have done to you?

13Ye call me Master and Lord: and ye say well; for so I am.

14If I then, your Lord and Master, have washed your feet; ye also ought to wash one another's feet.

15For I have given you an example, that ye should do as I have done to you.

16Verily, verily, I say unto you, The servant is not greater than his lord; neither he that is sent greater than he that sent him.

17If ye know these things, happy are ye if ye do them.

18I speak not of you all: I know whom I have chosen: but that the scripture may be fulfilled, He that eateth bread with me hath lifted up his heel against me.

19Now I tell you before it come, that, when it is come to pass, ye may believe that I am he.

20Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that receiveth whomsoever I send receiveth me; and he that receiveth me receiveth him that sent me.

21When Jesus had thus said, he was troubled in spirit, and testified, and said, Verily, verily, I say unto you, that one of you shall betray me.

22Then the disciples looked one on another, doubting of whom he spake.

23Now there was leaning on Jesus' bosom one of his disciples, whom Jesus loved.

24Simon Peter therefore beckoned to him, that he should ask who it should be of whom he spake.

25He then lying on Jesus' breast saith unto him, Lord, who is it?

26Jesus answered, He it is, to whom I shall give a sop, when I have dipped it. And when he had dipped the sop, he gave it to Judas Iscariot, the son of Simon.

27And after the sop Satan entered into him. Then said Jesus unto him, That thou doest, do quickly.

28Now no man at the table knew for what intent he spake this unto him.

29For some of them thought, because Judas had the bag, that Jesus had said unto him, Buy those things that we have need of against the feast; or, that he should give something to the poor.

30He then having received the sop went immediately out: and it was night.

31Therefore, when he was gone out, Jesus said, Now is the Son of man glorified, and God is glorified in him.

32If God be glorified in him, God shall also glorify him in himself, and shall straightway glorify him.

33Little children, yet a little while I am with you. Ye shall seek me: and as I said unto the Jews, Whither I go, ye cannot come; so now I say to you.

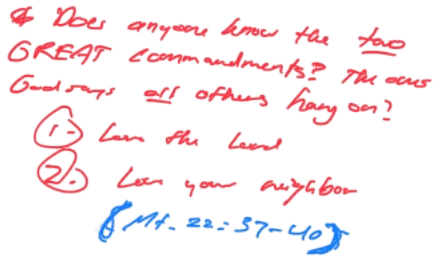
34A new commandment I give unto you, That ye love one another; as I have loved you, that ye also love one another.

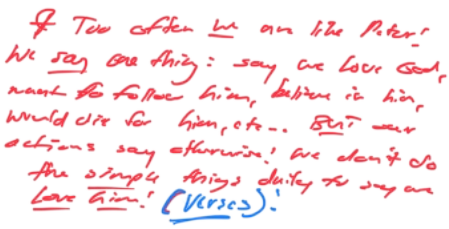
35By this shall all men know that ye are my disciples, if ye have love one to another.

36Simon Peter said unto him, Lord, whither goest thou? Jesus answered him, Whither I go, thou canst not follow me now; but thou shalt follow me afterwards.

37Peter said unto him, Lord, why cannot I follow thee now? I will lay down my life for thy sake.

38Jesus answered him, Wilt thou lay down thy life for my sake? Verily, verily, I say unto thee, The cock shall not crow, till thou hast denied me thrice.





1Let not your heart be troubled: ye believe in God, believe also in me.

2In my Father's house are many mansions: if it were not so, I would have told you. I go to prepare a place for you.

3And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again, and receive you unto myself; that where I am, there ye may be also.

4And whither I go ye know, and the way ye know.

5Thomas saith unto him, Lord, we know not whither thou goest; and how can we know the way?

6Jesus saith unto him, I am the way, the truth, and the life: no man cometh unto the Father, but by me.

7If ye had known me, ye should have known my Father also: and from henceforth ye know him, and have seen him.

8Philip saith unto him, Lord, shew us the Father, and it sufficeth us.

9Jesus saith unto him, Have I been so long time with you, and yet hast thou not known me, Philip? he that hath seen me hath seen the Father; and how sayest thou then, Shew us the Father?

10Believest thou not that I am in the Father, and the Father in me? the words that I speak unto you I speak not of myself: but the Father that dwelleth in me, he doeth the works.

11Believe me that I am in the Father, and the Father in me: or else believe me for the very works' sake.

12Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that believeth on me, the works that I do shall he do also; and greater works than these shall he do; because I go unto my Father.

13And whatsoever ye shall ask in my name, that will I do, that the Father may be glorified in the Son.

14If ye shall ask any thing in my name, I will do it.

15If ye love me, keep my commandments.

16And I will pray the Father, and he shall give you another Comforter, that he may abide with you for ever;

17Even the Spirit of truth; whom the world cannot receive, because it seeth him not, neither knoweth him: but ye know him; for he dwelleth with you, and shall be in you.

18I will not leave you comfortless: I will come to you.

19Yet a little while, and the world seeth me no more; but ye see me: because I live, ye shall live also.

20At that day ye shall know that I am in my Father, and ye in me, and I in you.

21He that hath my commandments, and keepeth them, he it is that loveth me: and he that loveth me shall be loved of my Father, and I will love him, and will manifest myself to him.

22Judas saith unto him, not Iscariot, Lord, how is it that thou wilt manifest thyself unto us, and not unto the world?

23Jesus answered and said unto him, If a man love me, he will keep my words: and my Father will love him, and we will come unto him, and make our abode with him.

24He that loveth me not keepeth not my sayings: and the word which ye hear is not mine, but the Father's which sent me.

25These things have I spoken unto you, being yet present with you.

26But the Comforter, which is the Holy Ghost, whom the Father will send in my name, he shall teach you all things, and bring all things to your remembrance, whatsoever I have said unto you.

27Peace I leave with you, my peace I give unto you: not as the world giveth, give I unto you. Let not your heart be troubled, neither let it be afraid.

28Ye have heard how I said unto you, I go away, and come again unto you. If ye loved me, ye would rejoice, because I said, I go unto the Father: for my Father is greater than I.

29And now I have told you before it come to pass, that, when it is come to pass, ye might believe.

30Hereafter I will not talk much with you: for the prince of this world cometh, and hath nothing in me.

31But that the world may know that I love the Father;
and as the Father gave me commandment, even so I
do. Arise, let us go hence.

1I am the true vine, and my Father is the husbandman.

2Every branch in me that beareth not fruit he taketh away: and every branch that beareth fruit, he purgeth it, that it may bring forth more fruit.

3Now ye are clean through the word which I have spoken unto you.

4Abide in me, and I in you. As the branch cannot bear fruit of itself, except it abide in the vine; no more can ye, except ye abide in me.

5I am the vine, ye are the branches: He that abideth in me, and I in him, the same bringeth forth much fruit: for without me ye can do nothing.

6If a man abide not in me, he is cast forth as a branch, and is withered; and men gather them, and cast them into the fire, and they are burned.

7If ye abide in me, and my words abide in you, ye shall ask what ye will, and it shall be done unto you.

8Herein is my Father glorified, that ye bear much fruit; so shall ye be my disciples.

9As the Father hath loved me, so have I loved you: continue ye in my love.

10If ye keep my commandments, ye shall abide in my love; even as I have kept my Father's commandments, and abide in his love.

11These things have I spoken unto you, that my joy might remain in you, and that your joy might be full.

12This is my commandment, That ye love one another, as I have loved you.

13Greater love hath no man than this, that a man lay down his life for his friends.

14Ye are my friends, if ye do whatsoever I command you.

15Henceforth I call you not servants; for the servant knoweth not what his lord doeth: but I have called you friends; for all things that I have heard of my Father I have made known unto you.

16Ye have not chosen me, but I have chosen you, and ordained you, that ye should go and bring forth fruit, and that your fruit should remain: that whatsoever ye shall ask of the Father in my name, he may give it you.

17These things I command you, that ye love one another.

18If the world hate you, ye know that it hated me before it hated you.

19If ye were of the world, the world would love his own: but because ye are not of the world, but I have chosen you out of the world, therefore the world hateth you.

20Remember the word that I said unto you, The servant is not greater than his lord. If they have persecuted me, they will also persecute you; if they have kept my saying, they will keep yours also.

21But all these things will they do unto you for my name's sake, because they know not him that sent me.

22If I had not come and spoken unto them, they had not had sin: but now they have no cloke for their sin.

23He that hateth me hateth my Father also.

24If I had not done among them the works which none other man did, they had not had sin: but now have they both seen and hated both me and my Father.

25But this cometh to pass, that the word might be fulfilled that is written in their law, They hated me without a cause.

26But when the Comforter is come, whom I will send unto you from the Father, even the Spirit of truth, which proceedeth from the Father, he shall testify of me:

27And ye also shall bear witness, because ye have been with me from the beginning.

These things have I spoken unto you, that ye should not be offended.

2They shall put you out of the synagogues: yea, the time cometh, that whosoever killeth you will think that he doeth God service.

3And these things will they do unto you, because they have not known the Father, nor me.

4But these things have I told you, that when the time shall come, ye may remember that I told you of them. And these things I said not unto you at the beginning, because I was with you.

5But now I go my way to him that sent me; and none of you asketh me, Whither goest thou?

6But because I have said these things unto you, sorrow hath filled your heart.

7Nevertheless I tell you the truth; It is expedient for you that I go away: for if I go not away, the Comforter will not come unto you; but if I depart, I will send him unto you.

8And when he is come, he will reprove the world of sin, and of righteousness, and of judgment:

9Of sin, because they believe not on me;

10Of righteousness, because I go to my Father, and ye see me no more;

11Of judgment, because the prince of this world is judged.

12I have yet many things to say unto you, but ye cannot bear them now.

13Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth: for he shall not speak of himself; but whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak: and he will shew you things to come.

14He shall glorify me: for he shall receive of mine, and shall shew it unto you.

15All things that the Father hath are mine: therefore said I, that he shall take of mine, and shall shew it unto you.

16A little while, and ye shall not see me: and again, a little while, and ye shall see me, because I go to the Father.

17Then said some of his disciples among themselves, What is this that he saith unto us, A little while, and ye shall not see me: and again, a little while, and ye shall see me: and, Because I go to the Father?

18They said therefore, What is this that he saith, A little while? we cannot tell what he saith.

19Now Jesus knew that they were desirous to ask him, and said unto them, Do ye enquire among yourselves of that I said, A little while, and ye shall not see me: and again, a little while, and ye shall see me?

20Verily, verily, I say unto you, That ye shall weep and lament, but the world shall rejoice: and ye shall be sorrowful, but your sorrow shall be turned into joy.

21A woman when she is in travail hath sorrow, because her hour is come: but as soon as she is delivered of the child, she remembereth no more the anguish, for joy that a man is born into the world.

22And ye now therefore have sorrow: but I will see you again, and your heart shall rejoice, and your joy no man taketh from you.

23And in that day ye shall ask me nothing. Verily, verily, I say unto you, Whatsoever ye shall ask the Father in my name, he will give it you.

24Hitherto have ye asked nothing in my name: ask, and ye shall receive, that your joy may be full.

25These things have I spoken unto you in proverbs: but the time cometh, when I shall no more speak unto you in proverbs, but I shall shew you plainly of the Father.

26At that day ye shall ask in my name: and I say not unto you, that I will pray the Father for you:

27For the Father himself loveth you, because ye have loved me, and have believed that I came out from God.

28I came forth from the Father, and am come into the world: again, I leave the world, and go to the Father.

29His disciples said unto him, Lo, now speakest thou plainly, and speakest no proverb.

30Now are we sure that thou knowest all things, and needest not that any man should ask thee: by this we believe that thou camest forth from God.

31Jesus answered them, Do ye now believe?

32Behold, the hour cometh, yea, is now come, that ye shall be scattered, every man to his own, and shall leave me alone: and yet I am not alone, because the Father is with me.

33These things I have spoken unto you, that in me ye might have peace. In the world ye shall have tribulation: but be of good cheer; I have overcome the world.

1When Jesus had spoken these words, he went forth with his disciples over the brook Cedron, where was a garden, into the which he entered, and his disciples.

2And Judas also, which betrayed him, knew the place: for Jesus ofttimes resorted thither with his disciples.

3Judas then, having received a band of men and officers from the chief priests and Pharisees, cometh thither with lanterns and torches and weapons.

4Jesus therefore, knowing all things that should come upon him, went forth, and said unto them, Whom seek ye?

5They answered him, Jesus of Nazareth. Jesus saith unto them, I am he. And Judas also, which betrayed him, stood with them.

6As soon then as he had said unto them, I am he, they went backward, and fell to the ground.

7Then asked he them again, Whom seek ye? And they said, Jesus of Nazareth.

8Jesus answered, I have told you that I am he: if therefore ye seek me, let these go their way:

9That the saying might be fulfilled, which he spake, Of them which thou gavest me have I lost none.

10Then Simon Peter having a sword drew it, and smote the high priest's servant, and cut off his right ear. The servant's name was Malchus.

11Then said Jesus unto Peter, Put up thy sword into the sheath: the cup which my Father hath given me, shall I not drink it?

12Then the band and the captain and officers of the Jews took Jesus, and bound him,

13And led him away to Annas first; for he was father in law to Caiaphas, which was the high priest that same year.

14Now Caiaphas was he, which gave counsel to the Jews, that it was expedient that one man should die for the people.

15And Simon Peter followed Jesus, and so did another disciple: that disciple was known unto the high priest, and went in with Jesus into the palace of the high priest.

16But Peter stood at the door without. Then went out that other disciple, which was known unto the high priest, and spake unto her that kept the door, and brought in Peter.

17Then saith the damsel that kept the door unto Peter, Art not thou also one of this man's disciples? He saith, I am not.

18And the servants and officers stood there, who had made a fire of coals; for it was cold: and they warmed themselves: and Peter stood with them, and warmed himself.

19The high priest then asked Jesus of his disciples, and of his doctrine.

20Jesus answered him, I spake openly to the world; I ever taught in the synagogue, and in the temple, whither the Jews always resort; and in secret have I said nothing.

21Why askest thou me? ask them which heard me, what I have said unto them: behold, they know what I said.

22And when he had thus spoken, one of the officers which stood by struck Jesus with the palm of his hand, saying, Answerest thou the high priest so?

23Jesus answered him, If I have spoken evil, bear witness of the evil: but if well, why smitest thou me?

24Now Annas had sent him bound unto Caiaphas the high priest.

25And Simon Peter stood and warmed himself. They said therefore unto him, Art not thou also one of his disciples? He denied it, and said, I am not.

26One of the servants of the high priest, being his kinsman whose ear Peter cut off, saith, Did not I see thee in the garden with him?

27Peter then denied again: and immediately the cock crew.

28Then led they Jesus from Caiaphas unto the hall of judgment: and it was early; and they themselves went not into the judgment hall, lest they should be defiled; but that they might eat the passover.

29Pilate then went out unto them, and said, What accusation bring ye against this man?

30They answered and said unto him, If he were not a malefactor, we would not have delivered him up unto thee.

31Then said Pilate unto them, Take ye him, and judge him according to your law. The Jews therefore said unto him, It is not lawful for us to put any man to death:

32That the saying of Jesus might be fulfilled, which he spake, signifying what death he should die.

33Then Pilate entered into the judgment hall again, and called Jesus, and said unto him, Art thou the King of the Jews?

34Jesus answered him, Sayest thou this thing of thyself, or did others tell it thee of me?

35Pilate answered, Am I a Jew? Thine own nation and the chief priests have delivered thee unto me: what hast thou done?

36Jesus answered, My kingdom is not of this world: if my kingdom were of this world, then would my servants fight, that I should not be delivered to the Jews: but now is my kingdom not from hence.

37Pilate therefore said unto him, Art thou a king then? Jesus answered, Thou sayest that I am a king. To this end was I born, and for this cause came I into the world, that I should bear witness unto the truth. Every one that is of the truth heareth my voice.

38Pilate saith unto him, What is truth? And when he had said this, he went out again unto the Jews, and saith unto them, I find in him no fault at all.

39But ye have a custom, that I should release unto you one at the passover: will ye therefore that I release unto you the King of the Jews?

40Then cried they all again, saying, Not this man, but Barabbas. Now Barabbas was a robber.

1Then Pilate therefore took Jesus, and scourged him.

2And the soldiers platted a crown of thorns, and put it on his head, and they put on him a purple robe,

3And said, Hail, King of the Jews! and they smote him with their hands.

4Pilate therefore went forth again, and saith unto them, Behold, I bring him forth to you, that ye may know that I find no fault in him.

5Then came Jesus forth, wearing the crown of thorns, and the purple robe. And Pilate saith unto them, Behold the man!

6When the chief priests therefore and officers saw him, they cried out, saying, Crucify him, crucify him. Pilate saith unto them, Take ye him, and crucify him: for I find no fault in him.

7The Jews answered him, We have a law, and by our law he ought to die, because he made himself the Son of God.

8When Pilate therefore heard that saying, he was the more afraid;

9And went again into the judgment hall, and saith unto Jesus, Whence art thou? But Jesus gave him no answer.

10Then saith Pilate unto him, Speakest thou not unto me? knowest thou not that I have power to crucify thee, and have power to release thee?

11Jesus answered, Thou couldest have no power at all against me, except it were given thee from above: therefore he that delivered me unto thee hath the greater sin.

12And from thenceforth Pilate sought to release him: but the Jews cried out, saying, If thou let this man go, thou art not Caesar's friend: whosoever maketh himself a king speaketh against Caesar.

13When Pilate therefore heard that saying, he brought Jesus forth, and sat down in the judgment seat in a place that is called the Pavement, but in the Hebrew, Gabbatha.

14And it was the preparation of the passover, and about the sixth hour: and he saith unto the Jews, Behold your King!

15But they cried out, Away with him, away with him, crucify him. Pilate saith unto them, Shall I crucify your King? The chief priests answered, We have no king but Caesar.

16Then delivered he him therefore unto them to be crucified. And they took Jesus, and led him away.

17And he bearing his cross went forth into a place called the place of a skull, which is called in the Hebrew Golgotha:

18Where they crucified him, and two other with him, on either side one, and Jesus in the midst.

19And Pilate wrote a title, and put it on the cross. And the writing was, JESUS OF NAZARETH THE KING OF THE JEWS.

20This title then read many of the Jews: for the place where Jesus was crucified was nigh to the city: and it was written in Hebrew, and Greek, and Latin.

21Then said the chief priests of the Jews to Pilate, Write not, The King of the Jews; but that he said, I am King of the Jews.

22Pilate answered, What I have written I have written.

23Then the soldiers, when they had crucified Jesus, took his garments, and made four parts, to every soldier a part; and also his coat: now the coat was without seam, woven from the top throughout.

24They said therefore among themselves, Let us not rend it, but cast lots for it, whose it shall be: that the scripture might be fulfilled, which saith, They parted my raiment among them, and for my vesture they did cast lots. These things therefore the soldiers did.

25Now there stood by the cross of Jesus his mother, and his mother's sister, Mary the wife of Cleophas, and Mary Magdalene.

26When Jesus therefore saw his mother, and the disciple standing by, whom he loved, he saith unto his mother, Woman, behold thy son!

27Then saith he to the disciple, Behold thy mother! And from that hour that disciple took her unto his own home.

28After this, Jesus knowing that all things were now accomplished, that the scripture might be fulfilled, saith, I thirst.

29Now there was set a vessel full of vinegar: and they filled a spunge with vinegar, and put it upon hyssop, and put it to his mouth.

30When Jesus therefore had received the vinegar, he said, It is finished: and he bowed his head, and gave up the ghost.

31The Jews therefore, because it was the preparation, that the bodies should not remain upon the cross on the sabbath day, (for that sabbath day was an high day,) besought Pilate that their legs might be broken, and that they might be taken away.

32Then came the soldiers, and brake the legs of the first, and of the other which was crucified with him.

33But when they came to Jesus, and saw that he was dead already, they brake not his legs:

34But one of the soldiers with a spear pierced his side, and forthwith came there out blood and water.

35And he that saw it bare record, and his record is true: and he knoweth that he saith true, that ye might believe.

36For these things were done, that the scripture should be fulfilled, A bone of him shall not be broken.

37And again another scripture saith, They shall look on him whom they pierced.

38And after this Joseph of Arimathaea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, besought Pilate that he might take away the body of Jesus: and Pilate gave him leave. He came therefore, and took the body of Jesus.

39And there came also Nicodemus, which at the first came to Jesus by night, and brought a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about an hundred pound weight.

40Then took they the body of Jesus, and wound it in linen clothes with the spices, as the manner of the Jews is to bury.

41Now in the place where he was crucified there was a garden; and in the garden a new sepulchre, wherein was never man yet laid.

42There laid they Jesus therefore because of the Jews' preparation day; for the sepulchre was nigh at hand.

John 21

1After these things Jesus shewed himself again to the disciples at the sea of Tiberias; and on this wise shewed he himself.

2There were together Simon Peter, and Thomas called Didymus, and Nathanael of Cana in Galilee, and the sons of Zebedee, and two other of his disciples.

3Simon Peter saith unto them, I go a fishing. They say unto him, We also go with thee. They went forth, and entered into a ship immediately; and that night they caught nothing.

4But when the morning was now come, Jesus stood on the shore: but the disciples knew not that it was Jesus.

5Then Jesus saith unto them, Children, have ye any meat? They answered him, No.

6And he said unto them, Cast the net on the right side of the ship, and ye shall find. They cast therefore, and now they were not able to draw it for the multitude of fishes.

7Therefore that disciple whom Jesus loved saith unto Peter, It is the Lord. Now when Simon Peter heard that it was the Lord, he girt his fisher's coat unto him, (for he was naked,) and did cast himself into the sea.

8And the other disciples came in a little ship; (for they were not far from land, but as it were two hundred cubits,) dragging the net with fishes.

9As soon then as they were come to land, they saw a fire of coals there, and fish laid thereon, and bread.

10Jesus saith unto them, Bring of the fish which ye have now caught.

11Simon Peter went up, and drew the net to land full of great fishes, an hundred and fifty and three: and for all there were so many, yet was not the net broken.

12Jesus saith unto them, Come and dine. And none of the disciples durst ask him, Who art thou? knowing that it was the Lord.

13Jesus then cometh, and taketh bread, and giveth them, and fish likewise.

14This is now the third time that Jesus shewed himself to his disciples, after that he was risen from the dead.

15So when they had dined, Jesus saith to Simon Peter, Simon, son of Jonas, lovest thou me more than these? He saith unto him, Yea, Lord; thou knowest that I love thee. He saith unto him, Feed my lambs.

16He saith to him again the second time, Simon, son of Jonas, lovest thou me? He saith unto him, Yea, Lord; thou knowest that I love thee. He saith unto him, Feed my sheep.

17He saith unto him the third time, Simon, son of Jonas, lovest thou me? Peter was grieved because he said unto him the third time, Lovest thou me? And he said unto him, Lord, thou knowest all things; thou knowest that I love thee. Jesus saith unto him, Feed my sheep.

18Verily, verily, I say unto thee, When thou wast young, thou girdedst thyself, and walkedst whither thou wouldest: but when thou shalt be old, thou shalt stretch forth thy hands, and another shall gird thee, and carry thee whither thou wouldest not.

19This spake he, signifying by what death he should glorify God. And when he had spoken this, he saith unto him, Follow me.

20Then Peter, turning about, seeth the disciple whom Jesus loved following; which also leaned on his breast at supper, and said, Lord, which is he that betrayeth thee?

21Peter seeing him saith to Jesus, Lord, and what shall this man do?

22Jesus saith unto him, If I will that he tarry till I come, what is that to thee? follow thou me.

23Then went this saying abroad among the brethren, that that disciple should not die: yet Jesus said not unto him, He shall not die; but, If I will that he tarry till I come, what is that to thee?

24This is the disciple which testifieth of these things, and wrote these things: and we know that his testimony is true.

25And there are also many other things which Jesus did, the which, if they should be written every one, I suppose that even the world itself could not contain the books that should be written. Amen.

S13 / TEACHING SERIES

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Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

I) The Religiosity of God's People

- Before revival comes, there must be a period of "dead" religiosity. If the people of God are not "dead" spiritually, producing no fruit, simply coasting along, then they need no "revival." (***Revive — bring back to life***)
- When Josiah shows up, his father and grandfather had been idolatrous, ungodly, awful men/kings of Judah. The state of God's people had never been so dire. God had pronounced judgment on his people and that he was going to judge them and bring them into captivity.

A) Their "religious" services were thriving, they still had:

1) The Temple, the High Priest and other Priests, Levites, Scribes, Officers and Porters, money and workers for God's House, Musicians, the Ark, and Prophets or other spiritual authorities— 2 Kgs. 22:3–20; 2 Chr. 34:8–18, 22–28; 35:2–6.

B) They did not have the Word of God — 2 Kings 22:8,13; 2 Chr. 34:14-15,21

1) They were doing all of their serving, sacrificing, giving of time, money, worshipping, etc.. all without the Word of God even present.
2) When we are busy "serving" but without the Word of God as the center, as the guide, as the thrust of our service; then we become "religious" and our worship is in vain and we end up and our children end up worshipping other "gods" — Matthew 15:8–9
3) This message is not just about churches or God's people as a whole, it is also about our individual lives! We can at times be busy in religious work, serving, sacrificing, etc.. but without the Word of God as our basis, we will fail!
4) That means our serving should involve personal reading, studying, obeying, and sharing of the Word of God. If it is not central to our lives as Christians, we are going about it the wrong way!
   (i) You may be thinking, "We have the Bible. I have the Bible. We talk about and teach the Bible. Etc... But we aren't talking about simply having it, but loving it, obeying it, and making it central to our Christian lives! "Finding the Law of the Lord" again! If we truly had, "found the law of the Lord" again as they did in Josiah's day, we would have radically changed lives, hearts, families, and entire counties, and countries turning to God as we will see happens in our story later.
5) I have discussed before how the "key of David" is a love for the Word of God; this is a theme throughout the Bible, Israel's history, and our lives! Without it, we are busy in vain. It is no coincidence that it was said of Josiah, 2 Kings 22:2 "And he did that which was right in the sight of the LORD, and walked in all the way of David his father, and turned not aside to the right hand or to the left."

C) Because they were busy in their traditions and religious services, without the Word of God as the driving force: they and their children had begun worshipping many false gods— 2 Chr. 34:3–7; 2 Kgs. 23:4–15; 2 Kgs. 23:19–20; 2 Kgs. 23:24

1) This is one of the most common patterns we see in the Bible. Those who claim to be God's people: discussing God, worshipping God, sacrificing to God, giving their lives for God, etc.. all outside of what God said he wants them to do in his word!
2) **KEY COMPARISON: Consider the relationship to Jesus day**:
   (i) They still had the temple, sacrifices, chief priests, scribes, elders, synagogues, tithes, fasts, prayers, etc. (Matt. 21:12–13; 23:1–7, 23; Jn. 2:13–16). They set aside the commandment of God in order to keep their traditions (Mark 7:8–9, 13; Matt. 15:1–6). Their real "gods" were the praise of men, outward appearance, self-righteousness, and money (Matt. 23:5–7, 25–28; Luke 16:14; Jn. 12:42–43).

II) The Rumblings of Revival

A) Jeremiah began ministering in Josiah's thirteenth year—five years before the Book was found in Josiah's eighteenth year— Jer. 1:2

B) Zephaniah ministered "in the days of Josiah", against worship of false gods— Zeph. 1:1–6

C) Josiah had been named centuries earlier in prophecy: 1 Kgs. 13:1–2

D) Josiah had already begun seeking the LORD in his eighth year and cleansing Judah and Jerusalem of idols in his twelfth year—six years before the Book was found in his eighteenth year— 2 Chr. 34:3, 8

1) God was already moving 300+ years before Josiah, prophesying of the revival under his reign, and preparing the environment and hearts of the people to receive it!
2) Again, this message is not just about churches or God's people as a whole, it is also about our individual lives!
3) In my life, before I had a real commitment to studying the Bible, loving and preaching the Bible; there were rumblings of God moving in my life. He took friends away, brought in new friends, set me up with the right discipler, had me in youth group, gave me people in my life to encourage me and tell me God had a plan for me, etc.. These were not the revival, but when that moment came, I was able to see the rumblings God had in my life to prepare me for that moment, that got me to that moment. The moment when I truly "found the word and tasted the honey, as David said in Psalm 119:103, "How sweet are thy words unto my taste! yea, sweeter than honey to my mouth!" When it became about more than knowing stories, and knowing information, but really forming a love for the Bible and a desire to share it with others!
4) **KEY COMPARISON: Consider again the relationship to Jesus day**:
   (i) Before the living Word, Jesus Christ, came, God gave prophecies of the Messiah and sent John the Baptist to prepare His way (Isa. 40:3; Mal. 3:1; Matt. 3:1–3; John 1:1, 14); likewise, before

the written Word was found in Josiah's day, Jeremiah and Zephaniah were already prophesying and preparing the people (Jer. 1:2; Zeph. 1:1–6; 2 Kgs. 22:8; 2 Chr. 34:14–15)

(ii) Before Jesus Christ ever came, God had given many prophecies concerning the coming Messiah (**Gen. 3:15; Isa. 7:14; 9:6–7; 53:1–12; Mic. 5:2; Zech. 9:9**). God also foretold that a messenger would come before Him to prepare His way (**Isa. 40:3; Mal. 3:1; 4:5–6**). Jn. the Baptist was that promised forerunner, crying in the wilderness and pointing men to Christ (**Matt. 3:1–3; 11:10; Luke 1:13–17, 76; Jn. 1:19–23**). In a similar pattern, Josiah's day had its own rumblings before the Book of the Law was found: Jeremiah and Zephaniah were already prophesying, preparing the way (**Jer. 1:2; Zeph. 1:1–6**). God was preparing the way for the appearing of His written Word in Josiah's day (**2 Kgs. 22:8; 2 Chr. 34:14–15**), as He was preparing the way for the living Word in Jesus' day (**Jn. 1:1, 14; Mark 1:1–3**).

III) The Return of The Word of God

A) In the midst of the religiosity and idolatry of Josiah's day, after God had prepared the people through rumblings of revival; the Word of God was found — 2 Chr. 34:14–15; 2 Kgs. 22:8

B) Josiah is the first to repent when confronted with the Word of God — 2 Kings 22:10-13; 2 Chr. 34:19–21, 27

1) Revival in our lives, our homes, our families, our churches, etc.. starts with the head.

(i) If you want a full revival in your personal life, it will come through your decisions alone. Nobody else is responsible for your actions, your life, your choices, and your life direction. Life is about your choices.

(ii) Anything you lead: business, family, home, etc.. revival will always depend on you as the leader. It starts with the head. This is a great responsibility, with great potential for good (and bad) — Jonah 3:6-7

C) When the Word of God is found and it is embraced with a humble, obedient heart, there will be a "reviving" (bringing to life) of things that were dead — Psalm 119:93,107,154; Jn. 5:24; Heb. 4:12; 1 Pet. 1:23

(i) The Word was read publicly, the idols were removed, idolatrous priests and high places were put away, occult practices, images, and other abominations were removed ,the priests and Levites were restored , the Passover was restored , the people were caused to serve the LORD for the rest of Josiah's days.

(ii) Revival had begun! Not some fake "manufactured" revival that we here too often about today. Not revival based on unbiblical practices, appealing to carnal desires, and manufacturing numbers to look like a big "Christian" movement.

(iii) REAL REVIVAL, based on the appearing of the Word of God again. Real revival that caused SIN TO CEASE, LIVES TO BE CHANGED, AND HEARTS TO BE COMMITED TO GOD AGAIN!

2) **KEY COMPARISON: Consider again the relationship to Jesus day**:

(i) When the living Word, Jesus Christ, showed up, He disrupted false worship, exposed the empty religious traditions of God's people, and caused a major stir in the whole region; and through the appearing of the living Word of God, many people have been "revived" and made alive through salvation in Jesus Christ.

IV) Next Week:

A) The Removal of the Idols

B) The Return of Passover

I) The _____ of God's People

A) Their "religious" services were thriving, they still had:

1) The Temple, the High Priest and other Priests, Levites, Scribes, Officers and Porters, money and workers for God's House, Musicians, the Ark, and Prophets or other spiritual authorities— 2 Kgs. 22:3–20; 2 Chr. 34:8–18, 22–28; 35:2–6.

B) They did not have the Word of God — 2 Kings 22:8,13; 2 Chr. 34:14-15,21

C) Because they were busy in their traditions and religious services, without the Word of God as the driving force: they and their children had begun worshipping many false gods— 2 Chr. 34:3–7; 2 Kgs. 23:4–15; 2 Kgs. 23:19–20; 2 Kgs. 23:24

1) This is one of the most common patterns we see in the Bible. Those who claim to be God's people: talking about God, worshipping God, sacrificing to God, giving their lives for God, etc. all outside of what God said he wants them to do, as stated in his Word!

2) **KEY COMPARISON: Consider the relationship to Jesus' day**:

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III) The _____ of The Word of God

A) Amid the religiosity and idolatry of Josiah's day, after God had prepared the people through rumblings of revival; the Word of God was found — 2 Chr. 34:3–7, 14–15; 2 Kgs. 22:8

B) Josiah is the first to repent when confronted with the Word of God — 2 Kings 22:10-13; 2 Chr. 34:19–21, 27

C) When the Word of God is found and it is embraced with a humble, obedient heart, there will be a "reviving" (bringing to life) of things that were dead — Psalm 119:93,107,154; Jn. 5:24; Heb. 4:12; 1 Pet. 1:23

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I) Rededication to the **Word**

A) Josiah makes a covenant to obey the Word — 2 Kgs. 23:3; 2 Chr. 34:31

B) The people stand to the covenant —2 Kgs. 23:3; 2 Chr. 34:32; Josh. 24:22–25

1) The Hebrew phrase used here for "make a covenant" is in Hebrew to "cut a covenant". It is a callback to the Hebrew practice of cutting an animal in half and walking through it: saying in affect, "If we don't keep this covenant/deal, let us be as this animal."

2) It was very serious business. Yet, we see all over the Bible man making covenants with God and to God. Getting together and saying we promise to obey the Word of God, we are taking it that seriously. If we don't, God let us be as this animal.

3) Genesis 15:10, 17–18— Abraham divides the animals, and the LORD symbolically passes between the pieces when He makes His covenant with Abraham.

4) No doubt, it is intense, and not to be taken lightly. The bible says, "When thou vowest a vow unto God, defer not to pay it; for he hath no pleasure in fools: pay that which thou hast vowed. Better is it that thou shouldest not vow, than that thou shouldest vow and not pay." Ecclesiastes 5:4–5

II) Removal of **Idolatry**

A) All of the idolatry, and everything associated with it, was finally removed — 2 Kgs. 23:4–20, 24; 2 Chr. 34:3–7, 33

1) Idols, images, groves, and pagan vessels; altars and high places; Baal worship; worship of the sun, moon, planets, and host of heaven; idolatrous priests; horses and chariots dedicated to the sun; Topheth and other pagan worship sites; houses connected with immoral idol worship; familiar spirits, wizards, teraphim, and other abominations — ALL removed!

2) This was no doubt painful, it was painful to the idolatrous people of Judah who loved their sin and comfortable "religiosity" — Jud. 18:24; Num. 11:4–6; 14:2–4; Mark 6:17–20

(i) In the book of Judges, we have a story of a guy named Micah from Israel, who built false idols and this was his response when they were taken away: "Ye have taken away my gods which I made, and the priest, and ye are gone away: and what have I more?" (Judg. 18:24)

(ii) Israel missed what they had left behind in Egypt and longed for the old food and lifestyle (Num. 11:4–6; 14:2–4).

(iii) Herod was unwilling to give up his sinful relationship when John the Baptist confronted him about it (Mark 6:17–20).

B) Josiah did not manage the idols or relocate the idols. He destroyed them — 2 Kgs. 23:4, 6, 8, 12, 14–15, 24

1) We are told he burned, stamped to powder, brake down, cut down, defiled, put away the idolatry

2) Similarly, we must do the same thing in our lives: we must completely rid our lives of whatever it is that is exalting itself against God in our lives — Rom. 13:14; Eph. 4:27; 1 Cor. 5:7

(i) What is taking most of our time? Our energy? Our thoughts? Our finances? Our concern? What are we paying attention to? If there are things that are keeping us from God and what he wants us to do, they MUST GO! Completely! As we will see next, any partial removal will not last and will only make matters worse!

(ii) Again, this is why "finding" the word of God again in our lives is so key. When we have truly "found" it again and it reigns in our lives: it is our desire, what we think/meditate on, what we live by, what we are concerned with, etc.. SO THAT WE CAN OBEY AND KNOW GOD.... then other "gods" cannot reign in our lives. Our life is already occupied with God and his Word!

C) Other kings had attempted reform before Josiah, but repeatedly left things behind

1) Asa, 1 Kgs. 15:14; Jehoshaphat, 1 Kgs. 22:43; Joash, 2 Kgs. 12:3; Amaziah, 2 Kgs. 14:4; Azariah, 2 Kgs. 15:4; Jotham, 2 Kgs. 15:35.

2) The only true "revival" of things that are dead and entrenched in sin and idolatry, comes through a "finding" of the word of God

(i) Many people try programs, self-help, counseling, psychology, accountability, conferences, seminars, new methods, new music, new leadership, new ministries, emotional experiences, resolutions, and behavior modification. BUT TRUE "revival", true lasting change comes through a renewed love for God through His word!

3) You want your life cleaned up? (Eph. 5:26; John 15:3) You want a thriving, exciting life; not deadness, purposeless, and just dragging through life? (Heb. 4:12; Ps. 119:25, 50; 1 Pet. 1:23) You want a changed life? To be transformed? To break old habits and become someone new? (Rom. 12:2; Col. 3:9–10; 2 Cor. 5:17)

(i) The Word of God is the answer: it is God's mind, how we know God in this world, it is the source of our salvation (Rom. 10:17; 1 Pet. 1:23), the truth we live by (John 17:17), what washes us (Eph. 5:26), changes and transforms us (Rom. 12:2; Jas. 1:21–25), renews us (Eph. 4:23), comforts us (Rom. 15:4), gives us guidance (Ps. 119:105), gives us wisdom and understanding (Ps. 119:98–100, 130), keeps us from sin (Ps. 119:11), corrects and instructs us (2 Tim. 3:16), gives us hope (Rom. 15:4), strengthens us (Ps. 119:28), helps us resist temptation (Matt. 4:4, 7, 10), builds us up (Acts 20:32), it is the source of the faith we are required to have in order to please God (Heb. 11:6; Rom. 10:17); it is the key to a successful Christian life and fruitfulness as servants of God (Psa. 1:1-3); and it is what thoroughly furnishes us "unto all good works" (2 Tim. 3:17).

(ii) Here are a few quotes on the Bible that pertain to all we have been discussing

III) Reinstating of the **Passover**

A) After false worship was removed, biblical worship was restored – 2 Kgs. 23:21–23; 2 Chr. 35:1–19

B) The Passover reminded them that they had been redeemed by blood — Exo. 12:13

1) The Passover lamb was pointing forward to Jesus Christ — 1 Cor. 5:7; Jn. 1:29; 1 Pet. 1:18-19

(i) When revival truly comes, people are brought back to the Lamb.

(ii) It is impossible to miss the connection here. They had moved beyond empty religiosity, rediscovered the Word of God, humbled themselves before it, rededicated themselves to obey it, removed the idols and false worship from the land, and restored their lives and worship according to what was written. And now, after all of that, they reinstitute something that had not been observed like this for hundreds of years: the Passover.

(iii) The Passover brought them back to the very foundation of their redemption: a spotless lamb was slain, the blood was applied, and judgment passed over because of the blood (Ex. 12:5–13). That makes this a tremendous picture of what happens in true revival today. The Word of God returns to its rightful place, sin and idols are confronted and removed, and then people are brought back to Jesus Christ, the Lamb of God

(iv) When the word of God is "found" again in our lives, we will see our family, friends, strangers, many people come to Christ for salvation! We will see them "revived", born again by the word of God!

IV) Conclusion

A) We are going to begin to close out, and so let's go ahead and have the musicians come forward

B) Consider: Where are you today?

1) **Do you feel like you are busy serving, going through the motions of Christian service but without any fruit to show for it?** YOU NEED TO CONSIDER REDEDICATING YOURSELF TO THE WORD OF GOD, SO YOU CAN DO THE WORK OF GOD EFFECTIVELY. CONSIDER PRAYING TO GOD AND ASKING HIM TO REIGNITE YOUR ZEAL FOR HIS WORD AND HIS WORK. WE CANNOT DO THE WORK WITHOUT HAVING FOUND THE WORD OF GOD AGAIN IN OUR LIVES.

   (i) TAKE THE DEDICATION SERIOUSLY, REMEMBER THE COVENANT THAT THEY TOOK IN JUDAH, IT WAS VERY SERIOUS BUSINESS, BUT GOD BLESSED THEM GREATLY, WITH REVIVAL, BECAUSE OF IT

2) **Maybe you are here and feel like your life is dead, you are dragging through life, and there seems to be trouble, sin, and issues everywhere you turn**. This was the state of Judah in Josiah's day. Their idols had taken over their lives, their homes, their worship, and even the house of God.

   (i) There may be some idols in your life that need removed. Maybe there are habits, relationships, desires, priorities, entertainment, possessions, or sins that have slowly taken a place that belongs to God. WHEN THE WORD OF GOD BEGINS TO REIGN, THE IDOLS HAVE TO GO. Do not manage them. Do not excuse them. Do not keep the "high places" around. Let the Word of God expose them, and determine today that whatever God says is wrong must go (2 Kgs. 23:24; Ps. 119:9, 11). If it is in a place in your life that the Word of God should be, it must go!

      (a) I'm sure many are thinking, "okay we get it, we need to read the Bible more." But that is missing the point. The point is, if you are giving other things in your life precedence over God and his Word, IT NEEDS TO CHANGE for "revival" to happen in your life!

   (ii) Maybe you have tried everything else to change. Programs, accountability, counseling, new routines, or simply trying harder. Those things may have their place, but lasting spiritual change comes as the Word of God gets into us and begins changing us from the inside out (Rom. 12:2; Jas. 1:21–25). Get back into the Book. Let God clean you, renew you, strengthen you, and transform you through His Word.

3) **Finally, maybe you are here and you have never truly been saved**. You need to receive Jesus Christ. We are told, "So then faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the Word of God. (Rom. 10:17). You have heard the Word of God today, Jesus died and bled for your sin (the lamb of God), and rose again, so that you could receive him and be "revived" and never die. You need to pray and receive Jesus Christ today!

   (i) For believers, once we see revival in our lives, through the word of God, we will see a reinstitution of the Passover: people will start being born again around us! We must return to the word of God, we must find it, so that this can happen!

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III) Reinstating of the _____

A) After false worship was removed, biblical worship was restored – 2 Kgs. 23:21–23; 2 Chr. 35:1–19

B) The Passover reminded them that they had been redeemed by blood — Exo. 12:13

1) The Passover lamb was pointing forward to Jesus Christ — 1 Cor. 5:7; Jn. 1:29; 1 Pet. 1:18-19

(i) When revival truly comes, people are brought back to the Lamb.

S14 / TEACHING SERIES

Gathering from the Garden

Two Genesis 3 lessons with teacher and student materials.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Teaching and lesson preparation.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

7 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

Gathering from the Garden

Teacher and student lessons prepared for EDGE Youth instruction; existing source acknowledgments retained.

Full teaching files

STUDENT WEEK 1 GATHERING FROM THE GARDEN *1 pages*

STUDENT WEEK 2 GATHERING FROM THE GARDEN *1 pages*

TEACHER WEEK 1 GATHERING FROM THE GARDEN *2 pages*

TEACHER WEEK 2 GATHERING FROM THE GARDEN *2 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

Sunday, July 24th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Gathering From The Garden

I. For the next 2 weeks we will be checking out the story of the fall of man in Genesis chapter three. Here in the very beginning of the Bible, we find many lessons that we can learn from to this very day. The devil works with the same basic _____ today that he did all the way back in the beginning, and similarly, we will see that God works very similarly to how he did back then today as well. We will see sin, death, sadness, shame, depression, and lust, but we will also see life, love, restoration, a relationship with God, peace, and purpose. We will see the eternal struggle between the devil and God in each of our lives and how the devil so desperately is trying to rob us of the fulfilling life that God has for us. We will learn to combat these attacks and have lives that are full in Christ.

II. **Genesis 3:1-10**

A. Knowing Your Enemy (2 Cor. 2:11) (verses 1-13)

1. The _____

a) He tries to convince you that you are missing out from more the world has to offer (vs. 1)

(1) His offers always result in death, chaos, and emptiness

(2) The world will not fulfill you (Hebrews 11:25)

b) He tries to convince you that there are no _____ to your decisions (vs. 2-4)

(1) He knew the result of sin for them would be death and he knows it will be for you as well! (Romans 6:23; James 1:15)

(2) He wants to turn your joy into sorrow (Job 41:22)

(3) He wants to destroy you and take you out of the battle (1 Pet. 5:8; John 8:44)

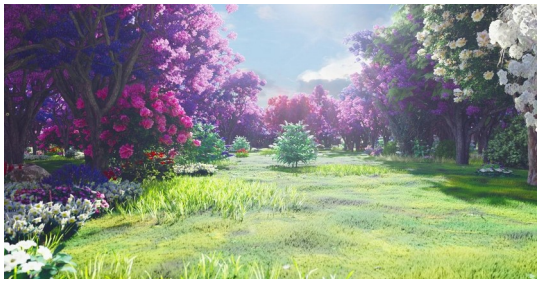
c) He tries to convince you that God is withholding from you (or that he has nothing to offer you) while he has something you want (vs. 5)

(1) The only thing they gain is the knowledge of evil. They already knew good. They were good.

d) He uses your 2 other main enemies against you to take you down (vs. 6)

(1) Your Flesh & The World (1 John 2:16)

III. We cannot be ignorant of the devices of the devil. He is our enemy, seeking to devour and destroy us. God is our ally, seeking only to protect us and give us the life he always intended for us to have; a life of purpose, peace, joy, and fulfillment in him. We all must be sober and vigilant to see that the devil is working to ruin all God wants for us and we must take action to prevent it. The Bible says in James 4:7 “Submit yourselves therefore to God. Resist the devil, and he will _____ from you.” After looking this week at “knowing your enemy”, we will next week be looking at “knowing God”, out of the same Genesis chapter three passage. We will look at the fulness of the life God desires for us to have in Christ and how to obtain it.



Sunday, July 24th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Gathering From The Garden

I. Last week we looked at our enemy and how he desires to destroy us in our lives (take our peace, purpose, joy, and fulfillment and turn it to sorrow, depression, and hopelessness). This week we will see conversely how God wants us to live lives that are full. This kind of life only comes through glorifying him, spending time with him, being conformed by him, and ultimately _____him. All of this we find all the way back in the garden with Adam and Eve in the beginning.

II. Knowing God (verses 8-10)

A. He made us to have this type of close and intimate _____ with him (vs 8a)

1. God made you to have a purpose (Jer. 29:11)
2. That purpose is to have a close relationship with him (Jer. 29:12-13)
3. That relationship will cause us to be changed and conformed into the image of Jesus Christ (Romans 9:29-29)
4. Being conformed into his image and being more like him each day will cause us to bear much fruit for him and bring him glory; this is our ultimate purpose; this will fulfill you unlike anything the world has to offer! (John 15:8) (1 Cor. 10:31)

B. Proof that they had that kind of intimate relationship with him is that they knew his _____ (vs. 8b)

1. Do you know the voice of God?
   a) You can even be faithful and serve God and not know his voice (1 Sam. 3:1-7)
   b) You cannot have a life of peace and joy without hearing from God consistently (Isa. 16:3; Psalm 119:105; Prov. 3:5-6)
   c) You may need the help of someone who is further along. They can help show you the ways of the Lord, how he works, and how to hear his voice (1 Sam. 3:8-10)

C. Shame from _____ can cause you to miss out on spending time with God. Deal with your sin and move forward (vs. 8-10)

1. Repent of sin and move forward (1 Jn. 1:9)
2. The only person who wants you to "hide from God" and not meet him in the garden is the devil

III. God has unfolded the whole plan and story of the Bible in order to restore things to how he originally intended them to be when he made man in his own image in Genesis. We can live lives today that have this kind of relationship with God that gives us peace, purpose, joy, and fulfillment. God is faithful to meet us each day if we are willing to meet him. We cannot let the enemy win and convince us that God wants anything less for us than lives that are 100% _____ in him!

Sunday, July 24th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Gathering From The Garden

I. For the next 2 weeks we will be checking out the story of the fall of man in Genesis chapter three. Here in the very beginning of the Bible, we find many lessons that we can learn from to this very day. The devil works with the same basic **attacks** today that he did all the way back in the beginning, and similarly, we will see that God works very similarly to how he did back then today as well. We will see sin, death, sadness, shame, depression, and lust, but we will also see life, love, restoration, a relationship with God, peace, and purpose. We will see the eternal struggle between the devil and God in each of our lives and how the devil so desperately is trying to rob us of the fulfilling life that God has for us. We will learn to combat these attacks and have lives that are full in Christ.

II. **Genesis 3:1-10**

A. Knowing Your Enemy (2 Cor. 2:11) (verses 1-13)

1. The **Devil** (he is your main enemy)

a) He tries to convince you that you are missing out from more the world has to offer (vs. 1)

(1) His offers always result in death, chaos, and emptiness

(a) The things of the world are empty and vain. They give temporary pleasure, but no lasting joy.

(b) Think about it. When you devote your life to something the world offers and it makes you happy for a while and then at the end of it all you see it is actually empty; how devastating. This is why the famous and rich all drown themselves in drugs and alcohol even though by the world's standards they have everything you could want! This is no coincidence.

(2) The world will not fulfill you (Hebrews 11:25)

(a) The devil wants you to enjoy the things of the world and so when it all comes crashing down, you feel hopeless and want to end it all!

(b) Take the example of drugs; people fall in love with drugs and the high, but eventually they need more of it to feel something since their body becomes accustomed to it. They take more and more and more, until it is never enough or at the point of killing you. This is how the things of the world are. At the end, it will leave you feeling empty and depressed and hopeless.

b) He tries to convince you that there are no consequences to your decisions (vs. 2-4)

(1) He knew the result of sin for them would be death and he knows it will be for you as well! (Romans 6:23; James 1:15)

(a) Feeling dead inside, death of relationships, death of opportunities you could have had, death to those you weren't able to reach because you were in sin, sickness, and even literal death

(2) He wants to turn your joy into sorrow (Job 41:22)

(a) He wants you depressed, anxious, upset, angry, and confused. It brings him joy

(3) He wants to destroy you and take you out of the battle (1 Pet. 5:8; John 8:44)

(a) He is a murderer and he wants to devour you. Not to simply hurt you, but to completely destroy you and ultimately kill you!

c) He tries to convince you that God is withholding from you (or that he has nothing to offer you) while he has something you want (vs. 5)

(1) The only thing they gain is the knowledge of evil. They already knew good. They were good.

(a) The devil has nothing to offer you that is worth while. God is not withholding from you. It may seem that way at times, but what the devil is offering is to destroy you and not to help you. It is a trick that will result in only bad things.

(b) Good (God) and Evil (Devil). They knew God, and he convinced them that they were missing out on knowing him

d) He uses your 2 other main enemies against you to take you down (vs. 6)

(1) Your Flesh & The World (1 John 2:16)

(a) These enemies are powerful enemies that the devil uses to help bring you down. Beware of them! They are not fulfilling, they will not bring you the happiness you think they will. They are temporary.

III. We cannot be ignorant of the devices of the devil. He is our enemy, seeking to devour and destroy us. God is our ally, seeking only to protect us and give us the life he always intended for us to have; a life of purpose, peace, joy, and fulfillment in him. We all must be sober and vigilant to see that the devil is working to ruin all God wants for us and we must take action to prevent it. The Bible says in James 4:7 "Submit yourselves therefore to God. Resist the devil, and he will **flee** from you." After looking this week at knowing our enemy, we will next week be looking at knowing God out of the same Genesis chapter three passage. We will look at the fulness of the life God desires for us to have in Christ and how to obtain it.

Sunday, July 24th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

Gathering From The Garden

I. Last week we looked at our enemy and how he desires to destroy us in our lives (take our peace, purpose, joy, and fulfillment and turn it to sorrow, depression, and hopelessness). This week we will see conversely how God wants us to live lives that are full. This kind of life only comes through glorifying him, spending time with him, being conformed by him, and ultimately **knowing** him. All of this we find all the way back in the garden with Adam and Eve in the beginning.

II. Knowing God (verses 8-10)

A. He made us to have this type of close and intimate walk with him (vs 8a)

a) He was walking in the garden to meet them as they were accustomed to him doing. He was looking for them to spend time with them.

2. God made you to have a purpose (Jer. 29:11)
3. That purpose is to have a close relationship with him (Jer. 29:12-13)
4. That relationship will cause us to be changed and conformed into the image of Jesus Christ (Romans 9:29-29)
5. Being conformed into his image and being more like him each day will cause us to bear much fruit for him and bring him glory; this is our ultimate purpose; this will fulfill you unlike anything the world has to offer! (John 15:8) (1 Cor. 10:31)

B. Proof that they had that kind of intimate relationship with him is that they knew his voice (vs. 8b)

1. Do you know the voice of God?
   a) You can even be faithful and serve God and not know his voice (1 Sam. 3:1-7)
      (1) He was serving the Lord and yet did not know him or his voice
   b) You cannot have a life of peace and joy without hearing from God consistently (Isa. 16:3; Psalm 119:105; Prov. 3:5-6)
      (1) When you are consistently spending time with God, you will have clarity which will bring you peace
   c) You may need the help of someone who is further along. They can help show you the ways of the Lord, how he works, and how to hear his voice (1 Sam. 3:8-10)
      (1) This is discipleship! Somebody showing you how to have a walk/relationship with the Lord; how to hear from him, talk with him,

learn from him, etc… Discipleship is to show you the way to know the Lord on your own!

C. Shame from sin can cause you to miss out on spending time with God. Deal with your sin and move forward (vs. 8-10)

1. Repent of sin and move forward (1 Jn. 1:9)
    a) God died and paid for your sin!! Stop staying away from him because of sin and cling to him. Repent and cling to him. That is what he desires.
2. The only person who wants you to "hide from God" and not meet him in the garden is the devil
    a) God shows up to meet us each and every day. Regardless of where you are in your life, he is there ready to meet you. He is calling out for you! (He was calling out to Adam and Eve to meet them even though they had just brought sin, death, suffering, sickness, etc.. into the world)
    b) Don't hide from God in your life because of shame! Meet with him! If we hide, he cannot help us deal with our sin. If we meet him, we will still have to deal with sin, but he will help show us the way to do that (Gen. 3:21)

III. God has unfolded the whole plan and story of the Bible in order to restore things to how he originally intended them to be when he made man in his own image in Genesis. We can live lives today that have this kind of relationship with God that gives us peace, purpose, joy, and fulfillment. God is faithful to meet us each day if we are willing to meet him. We cannot let the enemy win and convince us that God wants anything less for us than lives that are 100% **full** in him!

S15 / TEACHING SERIES

Men’s Bible Study: Spiritual Leadership

Lessons on prayer and dependence, being a man of the Word, burden and courage, and character and integrity.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Adult teaching and study-resource preparation.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

9 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

Men's Bible Study: Spiritual Leadership

Luke Johnston's selected teaching, writing or development sample; original bylines and citations retained.

Full teaching files

burden and courage (final)	*2 pages*
Character and Integrity pdf	*2 pages*
man of the word	*2 pages*
prayer and dependence on God	*2 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

GUYS BIBLE STUDY: LEADERSHIP KEYS FROM EZRA & NEHEMIAH

1) A Man with A Burden for God's People:

a) Spiritual leaders must carry a deep burden for the well-being of God's people

b) Nehemiah's concern for Jerusalem's physical and spiritual state drove him to action (Nehemiah 1:4; 2:17-20)

c) Ezra similarly showed a burden for the people's spiritual condition (Ezra 9:5-15).

i) Questions to consider

(1) When I see spiritual needs around me, do I respond with prayer and a burden like Nehemiah and Ezra, or am I indifferent? How can I grow in my sensitivity to the needs of God's people/work?

(2) In what areas of my life am I being called to take action because of a burden God has placed on my heart?

(3) How often do I bring the needs of others before God in prayer, as Nehemiah did?

2) A Man of Courage and Determination:

a) Nehemiah confronted adversaries with unwavering resolve, and he ensured the completion of the wall despite threats (Nehemiah 4:7-23; 6:1-14)

b) Ezra displayed courage in addressing the people's sins and guiding them through difficult decisions to restore righteousness (Ezra 9:5-15; 10:1-17).

i) Questions to consider

(1) When faced with opposition or discouragement, do I remain firm in following God's call, like Nehemiah, or do I become easily discouraged?

(2) Am I willing to confront sin and lead people back to righteousness as Ezra did, even when it is very uncomfortable?

(3) In what areas of leadership is God calling me to greater boldness?

(4) How do I respond when the work of God faces external threats or internal challenges? Am I determined to keep building and moving forward?

_____

_____

GUYS BIBLE STUDY:

7 LEADERSHIP KEYS FROM EZRA & NEHEMIAH

I. <u>A Man of Character and Integrity:</u>

a. A spiritual leader must exhibit godly character and integrity, serving as a model for others. This includes being above reproach, self-controlled, respectable, and blameless (**1 Timothy 3:2-7; Titus 1:6-9**)

b. Nehemiah showed integrity by focusing on God's glory rather than personal gain, refraining from exploiting his position (**Nehemiah 2:17; 5:14-19**)

c. Ezra also showed integrity by challenging the people to align with God's standards, motivated by a desire to honor God (**Ezra 7:10; 9:1-4**)

II. <u>A Man of Servanthood</u>

a. Spiritual leaders are called to serve others, following the example of Jesus (**Mark 10:42-45; John 13:1-17**)

b. Nehemiah displays servanthood in the entire book. His whole mindset was service, right on the front lines with everyone else. He delegated jobs and did jobs himself as well.

c. Ezra displayed servanthood by leading the people in worship and repentance (**Ezra 9:5-15**).

d. Another key to this is bearing burdens of the weak. Bearing the burden of the less mature is a STAPLE of leaders and more mature disciples (**Rom. 14:1; 15:1-3; Gal. 6:1-2**)

III. <u>A Man of Humility</u>

a. A large part of <u>humility</u> as a leader is getting/taking counsel and delegating

   i. Nehemiah- **Nehemiah 2:11-18; Neh. 8:1-8** (Ezra is reading and leading the people in a great revival and preaching chapter)

   ii. Ezra- **Ezra 9:1; Ezra 5: 1-3; Haggai 1:1-13** (the leadership in Ezra takes the counsel of God's prophets Haggai and Zechariah)

   iii. Hezekiah- **2 Chron. 32:1-3; 2 Kings 19:1-7; Isa. 37:1-7**

   iv. David- **2 Samuel 19:1-8; 2 Samuel 12:1-14**

v. Countless Biblical Examples: Josiah (**2 Kings 22:11-20**), Jehoshaphat (**2 Chron. 18:4-7**), Joash (**2 Kings 12:1-2**), Esther (**Esther 4:12-16**), Rehoboam (**12:6-8**; good advice vs bad advice), etc.

IV. <u>A Man of the Word of God:</u>

a. A deep knowledge of God's Word is essential for spiritual leaders, guiding them in making wise decisions (**James 1:5; Proverbs 4:7; 1 Kings 3:9**)
b. Ezra was known for his dedication to studying, practicing, and teaching God's Word, which provided the foundation for his leadership (**Ezra 7:6, 10; Neh. 8**)
c. Nehemiah also relied on God's wisdom, as seen in his strategic actions during the rebuilding process (**Nehemiah 1:8**)
d. This is also seen in Jesus great teaching on Leadership and Fruitfulness in discipleship (**John 15**)

V. <u>A Man of Prayer and Dependence on God:</u>

a. A consistent prayer life and complete reliance on God are foundational to spiritual leadership
b. Nehemiah exemplified this by constantly turning to God in prayer for guidance, protection, and strength in the face of opposition (**Nehemiah 1:4-11; 2:4; 4:9; 6:9, 14; 13:14, 22**)
c. Ezra also led the people in prayer and fasting, emphasizing dependence on God for protection during their journey (**Ezra 8:21-23**; **9:5; 10:1)**
d. The Bible shows all over the place the importance of continuous prayer and <u>complete</u> reliance on God in leadership (**2 Chron. 16:7-9; 20:12-17; Judges 7:2-7; John 15**)

VI. <u>A Man with A Burden for God's People:</u>

a. Spiritual leaders must carry a deep burden for the well-being of God's people
b. Nehemiah's concern for Jerusalem's physical and spiritual state drove him to action (**Nehemiah 1:4; 2:17-20**)
c. Ezra similarly showed a burden for the people's spiritual condition (**Ezra 9:5-15**).

VII. <u>A Man of Courage and Determination:</u>

a. Nehemiah confronted adversaries with unwavering resolve, ensuring the completion of the wall despite threats (**Nehemiah 4:7-23; 6:1-14**)
b. Ezra displayed courage in addressing the people's sins and guiding them through difficult decisions to restore righteousness (**Ezra 9:5-15; 10:1-17**).

GUYS BIBLE STUDY: LEADERSHIP KEYS FROM EZRA & NEHEMIAH

1) **<u>A Man of the Word of God:</u>**
   a) A deep knowledge of God's Word is essential for spiritual leaders, guiding them in making wise decisions (**James 1:5; Proverbs 4:7; 1 Kings 3:9**)
   b) Ezra was known for his dedication to studying, practicing, and teaching God's Word, which provided the foundation for his leadership (**Ezra 7:6, 10; Neh. 8**)
   c) Nehemiah also relied on God's wisdom, as seen in his quoting and knowledge of the Law (**Nehemiah 1:8**)
   d) The key to their relationship to the word of God, was that they loved it and they showed this through their obedience to it (**1 Cor. 8:1**)
      i) To not allow ourselves to be "puffed up" we must use the knowledge we have and obey the word of God. A great place to use this effectively for God is in a leadership role.
2) **Questions to Consider**
   a) How often do I turn to God's Word for guidance in my daily decisions? Do I rely on it consistently, or only in moments of uncertainty or need?
   b) When I study Scripture, am I intentional about applying it to my life and actions, as Ezra did? How can I ensure that I am not just a hearer but also a doer of the Word?
   c) Do I find joy and delight in reading and obeying God's Word, or do I approach it as a task or obligation? How can I grow in my love for Scripture? Am I modeling a love for God's Word and a reliance on prayer to those I lead? (**1 Cor. 8:3**)
   d) In what ways does my knowledge of God's Word influence **my leadership**? Am I leading with humility and obedience, or do I sometimes let knowledge "puff me up"?
   e) Do I intentionally make time to teach or share God's Word with others, as Ezra did? What steps can I take to grow in my ability to encourage others with Scripture?

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GUYS BIBLE STUDY: LEADERSHIP KEYS FROM EZRA & NEHEMIAH

GUYS BIBLE STUDY: LEADERSHIP KEYS FROM EZRA & NEHEMIAH

1. A Man of Prayer and Dependence on God:

i. A consistent prayer life and complete reliance on God are foundational to spiritual leadership

ii. Nehemiah exemplified this by constantly turning to God in prayer for guidance, protection, and strength in the face of opposition (Nehemiah 1:4-11; 2:4; 4:9; 6:9, 14; 13:14, 22)

iii. Ezra also led the people in prayer and fasting, emphasizing dependence on God for protection during their journey (Ezra 8:21-23; 9:5; 10:1)

iv. The Bible shows all over the place the importance of continuous prayer and complete reliance on God in leadership (2 Chron. 16:7-9; 20:12-17; Judges 7:2-7; John 15)

1) Questions to Consider

i) How regular is your prayer life? Do you find yourself turning to God only in times of need, or do you maintain a consistent dialogue with Him?

ii) When faced with decisions, do you first seek God's direction through prayer? Can you recall instances where this led to clarity or peace?

iii) In challenging situations, how often do you rely on prayer for strength and protection? Have you experienced moments where prayer provided you with the strength you needed?

iv) Do you trust God to meet your needs, both big and small? Are there areas in your life where you struggle to rely on Him fully?

v) Reflecting on Nehemiah and Ezra's dedication to prayer, how can you emulate their commitment in your own life? What steps can you take to deepen your reliance on God through prayer?

vi) If you hold a leadership role, how does your prayer life influence your leadership style? Do you seek God's wisdom and guidance in your decisions, and how does this affect those you lead?

vii) Beyond formal prayer times, how do you maintain a spirit of prayer throughout your day? Are there practices you can adopt to "pray without ceasing"?

viii) When prayers seem unanswered, how do you respond? Do you maintain trust in God's timing and sovereignty, or do you struggle with doubt and impatience?

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GUYS BIBLE STUDY: LEADERSHIP KEYS FROM EZRA & NEHEMIAH

S16 / TEACHING SERIES

Walking with God

A discipleship study with teacher/student master resources through Week 12 and supporting classroom files.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Teaching and adaptation of the MBC Next Steps course.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

83 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

Walking with God

Walking with God materials adapted for Millheim instruction; existing source-course credits retained.

Full teaching files

millheim walking with God student	*38 pages*
millheim walking with God teacher	*38 pages*
pdf millheim walking with God teacher	*3 pages*
week 1 student	*3 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

WALKING WITH GOD

MBC – "Next Steps" Bible Study

The Goal of this Series

To teach the Bible Believer the basics of his past, present, and future relationship to Jesus Christ *in order to have victory over sin and bring glory to God on a daily basis*.

Some of the issues we will deal with in this series are as follows:

1. The nature and condition of mankind
2. The enemies of a Believer and the ensuing warfare that is encountered
3. Living a life of Victory
4. Justification and sanctification
5. Spiritual development and reproduction

Key Text: Galatians 5:25

Galatians 5:25 - *"If we **live** in the Spirit, let us also **walk** in the Spirit."*

Week 1

Introduction

1. The Spiritual Christian

Our salvation introduced us to an intense struggle for true, biblical spirituality. A battle now exists between our flesh and our spirit *(Galatians 5:17)*.

KEY This battle ***cannot be won*** by suppressing the desires of the flesh through our own willpower.

Yet, God made us to have _____ over the flesh. Unfortunately, many believers seem to be losing that battle. As in any warfare there must be an equipping with the proper weapons, accompanied by ample training to use them.

We will seek to accomplish this "equipping and training" in order to achieve the overall goal of this series.

As we begin our study, let's consider some Biblical facts about our relationship with God:

a. We must allow God's truth to _____ us, not merely inform us – Philippians 4:9; James 1:21-25

NOTE *Informed* = Learned, Received, Heard, Seen

Transformed = _____ in form…*and the God of peace shall be with you.*

b. Spirituality is not determined by what we do for God, but rather, it is who we are _____ God – Genesis 3:8, 5:21-24; Hebrews 11:5

NOTE A real, truly Biblical Christian is one who doesn't just do all the right things, but one who knows God! Superficiality breaks down eventually. One who is truly spiritual is changed from deep within and it then works its way out!

c. True Biblical spirituality is determined by our _____ to know God and to have an intimate relationship with Him – Mark 14:18-19; John 13:21-25; Luke 10:38-42; Philippians 3:8-10; James 4:8

NOTE Knowing God is what this is all about…

d. The desire to know Him was placed in our hearts at salvation and is made operative by the _____ _____– Romans 8:15; Galatians 4:6

NOTE The Holy Spirit lives inside of us. You can't get more intimate than that! Yet, we don't often think of it in these terms.

e. It is possible to quench and _____ the working of God's Spirit within us – 1 Thessalonians 5:19; Ephesians 4:30 (25-30)

NOTE Because He is so close to us…because He is Holy…our sin and our apathy hurts Him!

f. Walking by faith and not by sight ... becoming a Biblically spiritual Christian is a _____ – Hebrews 11:25 (23-26); Daniel 3:16-18

NOTE At some point in our Christian life, we must wake up to the realization that we make ***critical choices daily*** for God's glory or for our own.

Week 2

2. The Nature and Condition of Man

a. The Beginning – The Creation of Man **(OUR PAST)**

- Man was originally made in God's **IMAGE** *(before the fall)* – Genesis 1:27

God – Gen. 1:26; 1 John 5:7; John 1:1-2, 14; Gen. 1:1-3

1 - Father
2 - Son *(Word)*
3 - Holy Spirit

Man – Gen. 2:7; 1 Thess. 5:23; Heb. 4:12

1 - Soul – (Father)
2 - Body – (Son)
3 - Spirit – (Holy Spirit)

KEY *Man's* **SOUL** *is not necessarily visible to the naked eye but includes a person's character, uniqueness, and giftedness. It is comprised of such elements as the mind, the will, and the emotions (God gave man the ability to exercise his own free will as seen by the insertion of the "tree of the knowledge of good and evil" in Genesis).*

Man's **BODY** *is what the Bible calls* ***the flesh****.*

Man's **SPIRIT** *is what the Bible calls the* ***inner man****, a part of man designed by God to be strengthened/empowered by close, personal, "spiritual" fellowship with God through the Spirit of God (Eph. 3:16).*

b. The Problem – The Fall of Man

KEY This is very important and why we have problems.

- Man **DISOBEYED** God – Gen. 2:16-17; 3:1-6
- Man's **spiritual** part died immediately upon sinning – Gen. 3:8
- Man's **physical** body now ages and eventually **DIES** – Gen. 5:5
- As a result of his **spiritual** and **physical** condition, man's **soul** also suffers a slow decay – Gen. 3:17-19; Ps. 90:10

- Man's children are now born in his own image, not in the image of God – Gen. 5:1-3; Rom. 5:12, 14-19

Important Considerations:

*We **do not cease to exist** at death, but our soul separates from our bodies, from this world, and potentially from God forever (aka… "give up the ghost" – Gen. 25:8, 17; John 19:30; Acts 5:5). This same type of separation is seen as Adam immediately becomes estranged from God, unable to have* **FELLOWSHIP** *with Him until God reveals His redemptive plan.*

This is the spiritually dead condition of every man and woman at birth. This is where all of our troubles began.

We often refer to lost man as being a TWO *part being. This is only true in the sense that man's spirit is dead (unable to fellowship with God). Lost man is still a* THREE *part being with a body (#1), a soul (#2), and a* **DEAD** *spirit in relation to God (#3).*

c. Saved Man **(OUR PRESENT)**

- As the result of Jesus substitutionary death, burial, and bodily resurrection *(the gospel*), all who trust in Christ's finished work now have the image of God restored. When we believe the gospel we are "born again" and our once "dead" spirit is brought back to life *(fellowship is restored with God)*.

  - His Spirit makes **our spirit** alive, or quickened – Eph. 2:1; Rom. 8:16; 1 Co. 2:11; 6:16; Col 2:11-12

  - **Our soul** is now able to **CHOOSE** to meditate on life – Psalm 19:7; 23:3; 42:2...or death – Jud.16:16; 2 Pet. 2:8

  - **Our dying body** is still in this world – Rom. 7:23-24, but it is powerless over us – Ro. 6:6-9 and scheduled to be replaced – Php. 3:21

d. Glorified Man **(OUR FUTURE)**

- When we were born again, **our spirit** was made alive and joined to His Spirit, **our soul** was given the ability to be renewed by His Word and we were given the promise of **a new body**. When we see Him we shall be **LIKE** Him, for we shall see Him as He really

is in the fullness of all of His glory – 1 John 3:2; Rom. 8:29-31

- The Holy Spirit and His working in our lives was meant to be the **DOWN** payment, or earnest of our promised glorious inheritance – 2 Co. 1:22; 5:5; Eph. 1:13-14. This is the reason why we should so "earnestly" seek to be **filled with** and **walk after** His Spirit.

- Our born-again, Spirit-filled lives are God's manifestation to the **physical world**, and the **UNSEEN** **supernatural world** of God's eternal plan, wisdom, and glory – Col. 1:27; Eph 3:10-11, 21

KEY He designed us when reborn to display ***His glory*** in and through us to all…as fallen, yet **RESTORED** creations of God!

That is what our mission is…

That is our purpose as individuals…

That is our purpose as a group of believers (church)…

This information should change how we view everything about our lives!!!

Week 3

3. The Warfare of a Christian – The Flesh vs the Spirit

a. The nature of this warfare – Galatians 5:17; Romans 7:21-25; Matthew 26:41

- We face three enemies as born again Bible Believers

1 - The **WORLD** – John 17:10, 12-15; James 4:4

2 - The **FLESH** – Romans 7:24

3 - The **DEVIL** – 1 Peter 5:8; Luke 22:31-32

NOTE God's Spirit in union with our spirit is in a battle with these 3 enemies:

- All three enemies have already been defeated! (Good news!)

1 - The world is defeated by the **WORD** – 1 John 5:4-5; Romans 10:17

2 - The flesh is defeated by the **WORD** – Psalm 119:9-11; Romans 12:1-2

3 - The devil is defeated by the **WORD** – 1 John 2:12-14; Eph. 6:10-17

NOTE They are already defeated in that we have the competed Word of God!

- Winning or losing this warfare is our **CHOICE**!

NOTE Remember…faith is a choice. Heb 11:25

b. The nature of the flesh

- The flesh is defiled, corrupted, and rotten – 2 Peter 2:10-22; Rom 7:18

KEY The real problem is authority, who is in control: God or **SELF**? Remember the definition of the "Kingdom of God"…Jesus ***rules*** from the inside!

Consider what the Bible says about the flesh…

- It is **WEAK** toward God – Matthew 26:41

- It cannot please God – Romans 8:8

- It will **KILL** you – Romans 8:6,13

NOTE This is true both physically and spiritually (eternally).

- It cannot inherit God's kingdom – Romans 8:23; I Cor 15:50

- It seeks to persecute the Spirit – Galatians 4:29; 5:17

NOTE Ishmael was the ***natural*** son of a carnal choice. Isaac was the ***supernatural*** son of a work completed by God.

c. The works of the flesh

Text – Galatians 5:19-21

- Sins which defile the body:

  - Adultery – being **UNFAITHFUL** to your spouse or spiritual adultery.

  NOTE The strange woman...Proverbs 5…Rev 17:5…

  - Fornication – any sexual sin outside of the marriage covenant.

  - Uncleanness – any pollution or impurity of the flesh starting with a dirty, lustful mind.

  NOTE Generally, this applies to sexual sin, but it also refers to "dirty"…

  - Lasciviousness – lewd and **LOOSE** behavior, uncontrolled sensual (alluring; carnal; erotic; lustful; provocative;

sexual) desire.

- Communion with Satanic forces:
  - Idolatry – anything **BETWEEN** me and God.
  - Witchcraft – use of satanic power, occult activity (and rebellion) - I Sam 15:23. Also associated with drug use (witchcraft = ***pharmakeia*** in Greek)

- Pride (ungodly love of self) – the root of ***all*** sin:
  - Hatred – internal hostile feelings.
  - Variance – quarreling, **CONTENTION**.
  - Emulations – jealousy and envy of others. Trying to be superior.
  - Wrath – **ACTING** on anger/hatred…can be in the form of violence.
  - Strife – surrounded in controversy; causing division and factions

- Religion and its fruits:
  - Sedition – uprising against God-ordained authorities
  - Heresies – denying essential **BIBLE** truth/doctrine
  - Envyings – not satisfied, wanting what others have in the way of position, power, or persons.
  - Murders – to **KILL** another through literal or verbal means – James 4:1-3

  NOTE Verbal includes breaking someone's spirit creating deep, life-long, emotional scars…

- General vices:
  - Drunkenness – anything that **CONTROLS** your life.
  - Revellings – wild partying; disorderly, outlandish behavior
  - Such like – not just the law, but the spirit of the principles

of God

KEY The issue is not what is wrong with it, but rather what is right about it!

Week 4

- The works of the flesh in a Christian's life…

- All of the items from God's "flesh list" are a potential threat inside of us.

NOTE It is not the **DEVIL**, it is my flesh. We do have a very real enemy…but we can't blame the devil for our fleshly desires!

- The works of the flesh are activated OR deactivated by our yielding:

To the *flesh* …OR

To *the Spirit*.

KEY This is the key to walking with God!!!! – Ro. 6:13, 19; Gal. 5:16

- We must not **LET** the works of the flesh reign – Ro. 6:12

NOTE Are you a slave to our own lusts? If so, you are a freed slave.

Your Master has purchased you…you are free now…to serve Him and to bring glory to Him **right now** – John 8:36; Gal. 4:9!

- Romans 8:8 - *"So then they that are in the flesh **CANNOT** please God."* The biblical reality is that nothing accomplished in my Christian life, done in my flesh alone, is pleasing to God.

- Winning or losing this warfare is my **CHOICE**...

NOTE God allows us a free will, even after salvation, to

choose right from wrong.

Josh. 1:5-9; 24:15

a. Sin and self – Understanding the enemy that resides **INSIDE** of us!

- The Christian's relationship to sin:
  - My sin was dealt with on the cross – Ro. 6:6-7; Gal. 2:20; Col. 2:13-14.
  - I am **DEAD** to sin – Ro. 6:2

    NOTE It ceased to have power over my eternity the moment I was saved!
  - Sin **CANNOT** control me – Ro. 6:14
  - I sin because I **CHOOSE** to sin – James 1:14

    KEY *If uncontested, sin can **again** become a way of life* (*like we did when we were lost!)*

    We ***must*** do what Daniel did…Dan. 1:8.
- The Christian's relationship to self:
  - It is possible to do biblical things in the power of the flesh – Php. 1:16-18

    EXAMPLE Satan tempted Eve to do God's will (to be like God), but in the way of **SELF**.

    EXAMPLE Satan tempted Jesus to do what was His right to do, but on **SELF**'s schedule…instead of God's schedule.
  - The issue for every pastor, missionary, church leader and church member to consider is this: Under who's

CONTROL am I doing what I do? We should always be in a mode of SELF-examination.

KEY QUESTION Am I under God's control or self's control?

- We can lead people to Christ and even teach the word of God, all in the power of our flesh…and appear very spiritual.

- The truth is that living in the flesh is *pseudo spirituality*

Pseudo – Artificial; Bogus; Counterfeit; Fake; False; Phony; Quasi

Pseudo Spirituality describes the "bridges" Christians try to build from flesh to Spirit, attempting to live in both worlds at the same time.

- Ways our flesh can attempt to be spiritual:

  - LEGALISM

    Man-made **SYSTEMS** of preferences that force someone to obey a set of rules or standards in order to be spiritual...we all must be careful!

    Obedience is **EXTERNAL**, yet true biblical submission is ***internal***.

    Disciplined flesh does not necessarily represent true spirituality or victory. Instead, it can lead to SELF-righteousness – Luke 18:9-14.

    Legalism is man's attempt to live with the appearance of spirituality with an unchanged spirit towards God's commands… ending up no different than the Pharisees – Matt. 23:1-12; Mark 7.

    Legalism often breeds a "secret" double life...

    NOTE This occurs when someone acts one way at church or around certain people and acts like someone else with others or in private – James 1:8.

    Legalism is more than hair length and dress codes...

    NOTE *Qualities that often accompany legalism: A legalistic heart often questions the motives and character of **others**. A legalistic person is often looking for "**DIRT**" on others. A legalistic person often thinks others have "something to hide". Be careful when you begin to think everyone else is wrong…*

Week 5

- Ways our flesh can attempt to be spiritual continued…

  - GOOD WORKS

    If I do enough **GOOD** things, then I am spiritual.

    My flesh can do many "good" things.

    The main issue is BEING, not DOING – Lk.10:38-42; Mt. 22:36-37

    Good works can make us feel like we are victorious...

    TRUTH Biblical men/women who **WALK** with God God the credit for every good works – James genuinely give thing...including good 1:17.

  - The "good" works of the flesh:

    The flesh is capable of doing good things – Lk. 11:42 – Good works are right…using them to glorify our flesh instead of God is not!

    When the flesh learns it is no longer allowed to do evil, it will do good in order to maintain **CONTROL**. Once control is established, it will soon revert to evil again - 1 Sam. 15:10-23.

  KEY We cannot fight our flesh with our **FLESH** – Gal. 3:1-3; 2:16; 1 Cor. 1:26-31; 2 Cor. 10:1-5.

  - RECOGNIZING the "good" works of the flesh:

    Self-willed is not easily led (lack of humbleness)
    Self-disciplined is not easily adjusted (entrenchedness)
    Self-confidence is not easily criticized (closedness)
    Self-motivated is not easily led (stubbornness)

- The RESULTS of the "good" works of the flesh:

  Self leads the way and asks **GOD** to come along.
  - Your self-control results from a self-led life. This is a lot of work to maintain, and yet Jesus' burden is to be light - Matt. 11:28-30.
    Self- righteousness will ultimately result in **unrighteousness** (pride, judging, etc.) – Matt. 27:3-7.

KEY The whole goal of true spirituality is the absolute lack of confidence in self and the flesh. To come to the place where all of our confidence is in God, **His** power, **His** Spirit and **His WORD** to direct us.

- Satan's Role with our flesh:

The flesh is Satan's workshop. Though evicted at salvation, he left his estate behind – Eph. 2:1-3.

When overt sin is prohibited, he can fill our lives with so much GOOD looking works that there is no room for GOD. Remember: Satan's sin was not immorality or murder, it was self-will (pride).

KEY All unrighteousness in the world has at its root **PRIDE** – Is.14:12-14!

As long as we are doing God's stuff for self, the spiritual powers know the difference – Acts 19:13-17.

NOTE Satan seeks a throne to rule. Though he CANNOT possess a believer sealed by the Spirit of God, he CAN "rule" them through their flesh…**the enemy inside**.

- Religion's Role with our flesh:

Religion is man working his way to be justified with God. Genuine salvation is God justifying those who could **NEVER** justify themselves.

- It is very easy for us to live in religious systems we've created:

Church attendance, tithing, baptism, visitation,

*discipleship, mission trips, etc…all good things that **CAN** become religious.*

Consider what your spiritual life would be like in solitary confinement for 3 months…if all religious things were removed?

- The Role of Knowledge and our flesh:

  Knowledge in the ***head*** does not necessarily mean spirituality in the ***heart***.

  Contrary to popular belief, knowledge is **NOT** power...Knowledge is potential power – 1 Cor. 8:1: Eph. 3:14-19.

  One of the biggest battles faced by those who have been Christians for any length of time is their "familiarity" with the Word of God.

  It is easy to be fooled by the flesh into thinking we are spiritual because we "know" a verse/passage and we "understand" the "concept" of it, and we can automatically believe we are doing it. We think we believe it, but in reality, we may not...

- Spiritual Experiences and our flesh:

  - Listening to "Christian" music

    Listening/singing along with Christian music is very beneficial and can truly minister to us in our Christian walk (Eph. 5:18-20; Col. 3:16), but it also has the strange potential to make us feel spiritual and strong when we actually aren't.

  - Listening to audio sermons

  - Reading "Christian" books

    *Like audio sermons, they can be good…however they cannot replace the Bible as the **AUTHORITY** of our lives!*

  - Exciting, emotional "spiritual experiences"

*They make us "feel good"…but it does not necessarily make us closer to God! They make us "feel religious"…but it can be prostitute spirituality! Many people are into these "experiences" and come to prefer the **FEELING** over the Word of God – 2 Tim. 4:3-4!*

KEY Believing the Word of God and acting upon those beliefs are the only truly "spiritual" things we can do! - Luke 11:27-28

Week 6

4. Keys to empowering the Spirit of God as we seek to walk with God

a. Getting victory over my deceitful flesh

- God reveals a relatively **SIMPLE** Biblical process to us in Romans 6:

  - **First**, we must understand the doctrinal truth that we are not stuck to our sinful flesh anymore being forced to obey it. We are **FREE** through Christ's Spirit to obey – Ro. 6:6-7, 18-22; Col. 2:10-12.

- **Second**, we must ALWAYS reckon these things to be so. *Reckon* = recognize. I must see it the way it is and call it for what it is every day – Ro. 6:11; Gal. 2:20.

  A very handy phrase to use when reckoning the flesh as dead - "Dead men don't **CARE**!"

- **Third**, we must not **LET** sin reign in our mortal bodies - Ro. 6:12-13. *Reign = When a sovereign rules on a throne*.

  Our battles with our flesh can be a very taxing burden. It can become easy to just give up and turn over the controls to the flesh. It seems easier – Php. 4:13. We must fight and die **DAILY** to walk with God - 1 Cor. 15:31.

- **Finally**, we must guard OUR members…am I yielding them unto sin, or unto God as one WHO IS ALIVE from the dead? – Ro. 6:13,16

  Feet – Where do I ALLOW my feet to take me?
  Eyes – What do I ALLOW my eyes to view?
  Mouth – What do I ALLOW my mouth to say/consume?
  Ears – What do I ALLOW my ears to hear?
  Hands/Fingers – What do I ALLOW my hands/fingers to touch?

  NOTE ***"Let"*** *and* ***"yield"*** *are words of choice. We do not have to lose our battles or our war with our flesh. It is truly* ***OUR*** *choice* – 2 Tim. 4:6-7; Rom. 7:14-25.

  KEY *Why are OUR CHOICES so important?* – 1 Cor. 6:20.

- Other practical battlefield tips to empower God's Spirit and kill our flesh:

  NOTE *God sees* **NO** *hope for our flesh…Therefore, the*

only solution for the flesh until our body is redeemed is a daily death!

- Consider that if you are in Christ (*i.e.* saved) and continue to live after the flesh, you will **DIE** – Ro. 8:10-13

  An inside struggle and fight is a good, healthy thing!

- The Holy Spirit within us battles against our flesh – Gal. 4:29; 5:17

- Remember that the battlefield starts in the **MIND** – 2 Cor. 10:3-5

- Failure will result if we **only kill fleshly things** but do not empower spiritual things – Col. 3.

  NOTE Failure will ALSO result when we **only empower spiritual things**, but don't deal with the flesh.

- We must make no provisions for the flesh…**STARVE** it – Ro. 13:14

- RESULTS of empowering God's Holy Spirit:

  - The Holy Spirit always **MAGNIFIES** the Lord Jesus – John 16:12-15

  - Following the Spirit eliminates failure. God doesn't fail.

  - Following the Spirit produces **FRUIT** – John 15:16; Gal. 5:22-23

Homework: Read Romans 6-8 before next Wednesday.

These chapters are the basis for this study.

Week 7

b. Practical, Biblical activities that will empower the Spirit and strengthen our walk with God

- **READ** your Bible every day – Is. 34:16; 1 Tim. 4:13; Luke 4:16

  NOTE Reading is not studying. The Bible is a **consistent diet** of God's food for us… packed with "vitamins" which yields fruit in our life. Most times God's Word is working inside of us when we read it, just like food does in our bodies, in ways we do not understand for our good – Job 23:12; Jer. 15:16.

- **STUDY** your Bible – 2 Tim. 2:15

  NOTE Don't let others do all the studying for you! God wants to use you in your walk with Him to get others answers – 1 Pet 3:15.

- **PRAY** every day – Luke 18:1; Phil. 4:6; 1 Thess. 5:17

  NOTE Prayer is our personal connection and opportunity to talk with God! Pray expecting God to respond. Watch and listen for His direction – James 1:5-7; Eph. 6:18; Col. 4:2.

- Be with the church when they assemble – Acts 2:42-47; Heb.10:25; Jude 19

  - **CHANGE** your lifestyle to accommodate gathering with God's people
  - Prepare for Sunday on Saturday, **NOT** Sunday morning
  - Have a servant's heart when you come (Be submissive…) – Eph. 5:21.
  - Have a **TENDER** heart when you come (Be willing to change…)

NOTE We have no idea what God has in mind for us to give and get at any given meeting as we gather together in His name. But we must come prepared and expecting of God to do great things!

- **GIVE** cheerfully – 2 Cor. 9:7
  - Your time … does God get much of your time?
  - Your talents … do your talents get used by God for His glory?
  - Your treasures... start by tithing *(10%)* from your total earnings

    NOTE We can rob God by how we handle our finances! Mal 3:8

    REMEMBER *God loveth a cheerful giver.*

- Do the work of the Lord
  - Tell the lost about Christ – Rom. 1:16
  - Strengthen believers in the Lord (disciple) – Matt. 28:18-20; 2 Tim. 2:2

    NOTE God wants our lives to abound in the work of the Lord! – 1 Cor. 15:58

- Be forgiving and **HUMBLE** toward others – 1 Cor. 3:1-4; Eph. 4:31-32; 5:21

  NOTE If you cannot…you are not walking with God in the Spirit! You are living carnally (that old fleshly way)!

FINAL THOUGHT These are all important Biblical areas that accompany a healthy walk with God. How are you doing in each of these areas? Talk with God about them, and then walk with God in them.

Week 8

c. The necessity and consistency of God's Word in our walk with God

- The Bible is **ALIVE** – Heb. 4:12.

  - There is no other book on this planet like the Bible. It is supernatural…given from above. We read it, and it reads us. It is a perfect mirror – James 1:22-25.

  - We must be careful how we approach it (Him) – John 1:1-5, 14-15; 1 John 5:7; Mark 11:27-33.

  - The Bible is **GOD'S** book…it is not open to private interpretation – 2 Pet. 1:20-21.

- The Bible is compared to water – Is. 55:10-11; Eph. 5:25-26.

  - The maximum time a person can go without consuming water is a week under normal conditions. Every cell in our body uses water. Water sustains us **inside** and also keeps us clean on the outside.

- The Bible is compared to food. Jesus specifically compares it to bread…supernatural, **daily bread** (daily = every day) – Luke 4:4,11:3.

  - Manna was supernatural bread that God consistently gave the nation of Israel – Ex. 16:15-21.

    ***v. 15a* – Manna =** what is it**?**
    v. 15b – This Lord gave them this bread.
    v. 16a – **Every man** was to gather it.
    v. 16b – Share it with those you live with.
    v. 17-18 – Share it with others so no one lacks (**FELLOWSHIP**)
    v. 19-20 – Be careful not to gather it and just let it sit.
    v. 21a – Gather it every morning.
    v. 21b – If not gathered, the blessing provided for that day disappears.

    NOTE God faithfully delivered His supernatural bread to

His people every day for **40** years! – Ex. 16:35-36

- Planning a **place** to meet with God every day…for a "Quiet Time"
  - God is **consistently** there with His provision for each day. We must work to have **CONSISTENCY** on our end of the relationship.
  - Pick a quiet place – Ps. 46:10; 1 Thess. 4:11
  - Remove distractions – Mark 1:35
  - Pick a place in the Bible – 2 Tim. 3:16; Is. 55:11

- A Powerful Quiet Time…more than just reading the Bible

P **Pray** to begin your time with God – Ps. 119:18

O **Open** yourself before God…be **VULNERABLE** – Heb. 4:13

W Word of God – **Read**

E **Expect** to hear from God – James 1:5-7

R **Respond** to what God gives you…journal, memorize, **MEDITATE** – Josh. 1:8; Psalm 119:15, 97, 99; James 1:22-25

FINAL THOUGHT

Imagine walking with someone and never interacting with them. God designed our walk with Him through this world to be an interactive adventure. As Adam and Eve once did, we again can walk and talk with God in the cool of the day. He has given us a **living Spirit** and a **living Book** to enable us to do so.

Week 9

5. The next 3 weeks will detail the doctrines of Justification, Sanctification & Glorification as they concern our Walk with God.

a. Justification

- **DEFINING** justification

- Justification means to "prove as just"; to declare "not guilty" or to declare "righteous." Justification, in a court of law, is a settled legal matter pronouncing a proper **LEGAL** standing or position. It often involves acquittal, vindication, or acceptance before a judge.

- Deuteronomy 25:1 - The question is **NOT** one of moral improvement. Judges do not make the right person a better person. They simply render a decision vindicating a person's position as satisfactory or unsatisfactory according to the law.

- **WHO** is Biblically justified and who is the justifier?

- Rom. 3:23-27, 8:33 – A person is justified **FREELY** by God's grace through the redemption found in Christ alone. **GOD** declares that person "just" in His sight when he meets God's conditions.

NOTE Luke 16:15. Justification in the New Testament is solely based upon the grace of God through Christ's sacrifice.

- **HOW** and **WHEN** is a person justified? What exactly are God's conditions?

- Rom. 3:28 – *"Therefore we conclude that a man is justified **by faith** without the deeds of the law."* See also Gal. 2:16.

- To better understand how justification is obtained by faith

alone, God refers us the testimonies of Abraham and David – Rom. 4:1-8.

Gen 15:1-6 – Why was Abraham justified? He heard what God said and simply believed God by faith. This is the **first mention** of the word "believe" in the Bible.
Rom. 4:5 summarizes **how/when** a person is justified by faith.
David was a murderer/adulterer and should have received no grace from God. Yet God did not *impute* his sin (*put on his account*) upon him, but God did *impute* righteousness upon him – Acts 13:26-39.

- **WHAT** actually happens the moment God justifies a person?

  - Rom. 5:1 – Receiving God's satisfactory payment for sins causes God to declare us justified. At that moment we are justified in Heaven by faith in Christ alone and ARE at **PEACE** with God forever.

  - Justification is the ***legal act***, the ***Heavenly transaction,*** whereby a person's guilty status before God is forever changed based on Christ's merits. He becomes a Christian… or little "Christ."

    Because of Christ's *imputed* righteousness, a Christian becomes good and righteous, sinless in the eternal eyes of God – 1 John 3:9.

    A Christian is only seen, and will only be seen as ***NOT GUILTY*** before God because of genuine faith in Christ.

- Confusion between Romans vs. James?

  Romans 4:1-5 God declares in Romans that it was through faith that Abraham was justified before God.

  James 2:20-26 James declares that Abraham's works justified him.

  So which is it? First of all, these passages are referring to two different "faith" events in Abraham's life. **Romans** is referring to Gen. 15:1-6 and the stars incident, while **James** is referring to an incident 40 years later in Abraham's life concerning sacrificing his only son Isaac – Gen. 22.

Faith alone, without any accompanying proofs, is dead. There's no proof it exists! Justifying faith will not only be faith, but will have Godly **WORKS** that accompany (or justify) and prove it – see Eph. 2:8-**10**; Heb. 11.

SUMMARY Human judges justify the innocent – God only justifies the guilty!

Man justifies on the basis of self-merit – God justifies on the basis of Christ's merit.

I should walk with God understanding I am justified through faith in His son Jesus Christ…free from **GUILT** – 2 Cor. 7:8-11.

Rom 5:1-2 – *"Therefore being justified by faith, **we have peace with God** through our Lord Jesus Christ: By whom also **we have access by faith into this grace** wherein we stand, **and rejoice** in hope of the glory of God."*

Week 10

Reminder of the Goal of this Series…*Walking with God* - To teach the Bible Believer the basics of his past, present, and future relationship to Jesus Christ in order to have victory over sin and bring glory to God on a daily basis.

Reviewing Biblical Justification:

- Biblical Justification = A Christian's position and **LEGAL** standing before Holy God. A Christian is at peace with God and completely righteous in God's sight for eternity because of **FAITH** in the finished work of Jesus Christ **alone** – Rom. 5:1.

- Why is the doctrine of justification important as we seek to walk with God?

- John 5:24 – *"Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that **heareth** my word, and **believeth** on him that sent me, hath everlasting life, and shall not come into condemnation; but is passed from death unto life."*

b. Sanctification

- **DEFINING** sanctification

  - Sanctification means to "set apart" or to be "separated." See its first uses in the Bible – Gen. 2:3; Ex. 13:2.

  - Sanctification is the **FRUIT** of a justified life. Once a believer is justified by faith in Christ, sanctification (separation) occurs **immediately**, can occur **daily**, and will occur **forever**.

- **THE ORDER** of sanctification

  - **Separated POSITIONALLY** at the moment of salvation by the Holy Spirit - 1 Cor. 6:11; Heb. 10:8-10; 2 Thess. 2:13; Col. 2:11-12.

  - **Separated PRACTICALLY** on a **DAILY** basis by our choices
    Sanctification in our daily life is based on our interactions with God's **WORD** and God's Spirit – John 17:17; Eph. 5:26.
    Jesus is our model of a set apart life – John 17:19; Rom. 15:3.

When we allow ourselves to be set apart, we can be used by the Master in any way he chooses – 2 Tim. 2:19-21; 1 Thess. 4:3-8.
This sanctification causes separation – Acts 13:2; Php. 3:7-8.

c. Comparing Justification vs. Sanctification

- In justification, our standing is changed before God. Sanctification deals with the nature of our character before God.

- Justification is what God does **FOR** us. Sanctification is what God can do **IN** us.

- Justification is an act. Sanctification is a work.

- Justification is safe. Sanctification is sound.

- Justification removes the guilt of sin. Sanctification keeps in check the potential to sin.

- Justification is the means. Sanctification is the end.
  As believers, we have been justified and sanctified enabling us to grow, mature, and walk **WITH** God now and forever.

Next week: Our last stage of sanctification

- Future **Separation PHYSICALLY** in a new body – *1 Thess. 5:23*; *Rm 8:29-39*

  .

  NOTHING is going to stop the eternal sanctification of the believer!
  A Christian will be eternally separated from sin, death, and hell.

Week 11

Reviewing Biblical Justification:

- Biblical Justification = A Christian's position and legal standing before a Holy God. A Christian is at peace with God and completely righteous in God's sight for eternity because of **FAITH** in the finished work of Jesus Christ alone. Justification is instant at _____ salvation – Rm. 5:1.

Reviewing Biblical Sanctification:

- Biblical Sanctification = A Christian's practical **DAILY** separation from the world unto God and His Will. This separation comes through choices, interactions and responses to God's word and God's Spirit, allowing the Christian to be used by the Master in any way He chooses. Sanctification is an ongoing process – Eph. 5:26

d. Glorification

- Defining Glorification

- Glorification means exaltation to honor and dignity. It's elevation to glory. We see this with the glorification of Christ *after* His resurrection and ascension – Lk. 24:26-27; Jn. 7:39; 12:16, 23-24; Acts 3:13-15

  Glorification involves a DEATH and a RESURRECTION… ending with an ascension**.**

- Glorification to the believer is NOT an elevation for our glory, but rather for us to be **WITH** the Glorified Christ **IN** Glory – Ps. 73:24; 113:4; Rm. 8:29-30; I Tim. 3:16; Heb. 2:10; I Pet. 5:10

  Future: The last stage of sanctification when believers will be separated **PHYSICALLY** and ETERNALLY from earth in a new body – II Cor. 3:18 4:6-7; I Thess. 5:23;

Col. 1:27; 3:4.
Nothing is going to stop the eternal sanctification of the believer – Rm. 8:29-39.
A Christian will be eternally separated from sin, death, and hell –
II Thess. 2.

- This is also called adoption – Rm. 8:23; I Cor. 15:42-58; Eph. 4:30

There's a **SPIRITUAL** adoption at the moment of salvation – Gal. 4:5-6; Rm. 8:14-16.
There's a **PHYSICAL** adoption at the Rapture – Rm. 8:17-19; Eph. 1:5, 11-14.

6. *Knowing that God* has called man to justification by means of salvation, and has predestinated the believers unto sanctification and future glorification, it should provoke us to **RESPOND** zealously and in all humility!

- *Knowing that God*, willing to save man from the consequences of his own sin, yet loved us enough to send His Son to die for us…
- *Knowing that God* didn't just want to save us and then abandon us, but desires a relationship with his redeemed, and so sent his Spirit to live inside of the believer…
- *Knowing that God,* Who now lives within us and us in Him, is still quenched and grieved by our sin…
- *Knowing that God*, despite our sin, still allows us to remain in him and receive the inheritance of blessings, even being made joint heirs with His Son…
- *Knowing that God* has prepared a place for his church to help rule and reign with Him for all eternity…
- *Knowing* that God did all this for us and so much more…it should cause us to change our **BEHAVIOUR** and live according to his Will, and not our own!!

KEY: Remember **WHO** you're walking with, and what He's done for you!

Next Week

In our last week, we will look at God's growth model for every believer. Come see

where you are in God's process of growth and where **EVERY** believer should be headed!

Week 12

Keys to remember as we approach this last topic…

- When proper discipleship takes place, the disciple will grow through a seven stage process as he or she walks with God.
- This pattern was established by the Lord Jesus Christ with His twelve disciples and then with the seventy.
- These same seven stages can be observed in the development of the apostle Paul.
- It is important for us to understand these stages and identify where we are in our personal ***walk with Christ***.
- Close observation of any Christian will reveal their present stage of spiritual growth.
- This process is not only for pastors, missionaries or those who are called to vocational ministry. ***This process should unfold in the life of every believer.***

7. Spiritual Development and Reproduction (also known as the NT Process of Discipleship)

   a. The Seven Stages of a Disciple

#1 - Repentance – The starting point

- Repent means to turn and **CHANGE** beliefs, directions, etc. – Mt. 21:28-29.

- God desires all men to repent and be saved – Acts 17:30-31, 20:21; 2 Pet. 3:9.
- **GENUINE** repentance and faith results in a changed life – Acts 26:20; 2 Cor. 5:21.

#2 - Enlightenment – Getting to know God…*"learn of me;" "come and see"*

- God desires to enlighten us as to who he is – Matt. 11:25-29; John 1:1, 14, 37-50.
- Learning from mature believers is God's plan (discipleship) – Matt. 28:18-20; Acts 8:29-35; 2 Tim. 2:2.
- Some Biblical examples of discipleship: Moses/Joshua, Elijah/Elisha, Naomi/Ruth, Priscilla/Aquila and Apollos, Jesus and the Twelve, Luke/Theopholis (Luke/Acts), Paul/Titus, Paul/Timothy
- John 13:15 – *"For I have given you an example, that ye should do as I have done to you."*

#3 - Life Application – Applying what you know to life

- Knowledge brings **ACCOUNTABILITY**…a desire to pass on what has been learned.
- Luke 12:48…*For unto whomsoever much is given, of him shall be much required…*
- Practical life application of Biblical truth will be evidenced in a disciple's life:

    * Follows Christ in obedience *(baptism, giving, etc.)*
    * Follows Christ in **SUBMISSION** *(attitude)* Col. 3:22-23
    * Ambassador for Christ – 2 Cor. 5:18-20; 1 Cor. 3:9; Acts 9:15-23
    * Persecuted as Christ's servant – 2 Tim. 3:12; 1 Pet. 4:1-4
    * Successfully works through the trials/tests of life – James 1:2-5

#4 - **LEADERSHIP** Development – Becoming a powerful influence for Christ

- ***Followers*** become leaders. A ***good follower*** will make a ***good leader*** – Mark 9:35.
- **EVERY** follower, to some degree or another, is purposed to become a good leader...
- Jesus' focus was to develop leaders to lead others. True leaders follow His pattern.

KEY Genuine leaders have genuine followers whom they are training. False leaders have "blind" followers. Blind followers have trouble doing anything that has lasting value, just like their leaders – Matt 15:13-14.

- While everyone has a capacity to be a leader, church leadership is ordained by God and will be successful with obedience – 1 Cor. 12:12-27; Eph. 4:11-16; Acts 6:1-7.
- Godly leadership is the key to success - Prov. 29:2.
- Is there anyone following you?

#5 - Testing and Separation - A trial(s) that puts faith severely to the test

- God proves (**TESTS**) every disciple for the next level – 1 Pet.1:6-7, 4:12-13.
- A good teacher gives his students hard tests to prove them.
- This testing is ***not*** like the normal problems of everyday life.
- This testing is ***not*** connected to sin in the disciple's life.
- This testing involves a ***crisis*** that leads to a "point of no return."
- These tests lead to an "all our nothing" attitude.
- The results:
    * A completely transformed life that will **NEVER** be the same.
    * Separation from the world on a grander scale occurs.
- The proper foundation of strong biblical discipleship is key at this point because ***everyone*** who makes it to this stage will eventually come to this crossroad. This is to be expected, do not be surprised. Abraham was likely not surprised by God's testing – James 2:19-23; Heb. 11:17-19.
- This proving is often intense/severe – John 6:66-70; 1 Kings 2:1-6; Job 13:15.

#6 - **LEADERSHIP** after testing – a new look and outlook

- On the other side of this testing, the disciple looks differently.
- The disciple has clear evidence of ***fruit*** after **PURGING** – John 15:1-2.
- They are now a better leader. At this time the disciple is empowered for greater responsibility.
- This stage is important because the disciple must put into **PRACTICE** what has been learned. They now live out their decisions made during testing time.
- There are no textbooks that can make a person this kind of a leader. It must be learned by experience – Rom. 5:3-5.
- Leaders who have been through the fire themselves exemplify maturity in their character *(temperance, extra compassion for others, empathy, tolerance, etc.)* – Matt. 15:21-32; 20:30-34; 23:37; Luke 19:41-42.

#7 - World Vision – a consistently sanctified life

- All major principles of the Christian life have been learned, practiced, and tested – Php. 3:10.
- The disciple sees this world the way God sees it in every capacity – Gal. 6:14.

- The disciple knows what he/she is to do because they know God deeply.
- The disciple has a life that truly exemplifies being a stranger/pilgrim in this world – Heb. 11:13; 1 Pet. 2:11-12.

KEY The disciple is commissioned to reach the world and ***entirely expects*** to ***accomplish that mission***.

b. Summarizing this Process of Growth…

- Not everyone is called to vocational ministry *(pastor or missionary)*, but everyone is called to the ministry. **EVERYONE** can do something important for God. How this calling works out practically in the lives of people will differ. However, **EVERY** believer is designed to come through this process successfully. God gave us a Book with everything we need and placed His Holy Spirit inside us at the moment of salvation. There is no excuse.

KEY "**WALKING** with God" is not always the easiest journey, but it is the best journey with the best intentions of our great God always at work – Rom. 8:28! God promises to always walk with us through all things – Heb. 13:5!

WALKING WITH GOD

MBC – "Next Steps" Bible Study

The Goal of this Series

To teach the Bible Believer the basics of his past, present, and future relationship to Jesus Christ *in order to have victory over sin and bring glory to God on a daily basis*.

Some of the issues we will deal with in this series are as follows:

1. The nature and condition of mankind
2. The enemies of a Believer and the ensuing warfare that is encountered
3. Living a life of Victory
4. Justification and sanctification
5. Spiritual development and reproduction

Key Text: Galatians 5:25

Galatians 5:25 - *"If we **live** in the Spirit, let us also **walk** in the Spirit."*

Week 1

Introduction

1. The Spiritual Christian

Our salvation introduced us to an intense struggle for true, biblical spirituality. A battle now exists between our flesh and our spirit *(Galatians 5:17)*.

KEY This battle ***cannot be won*** by suppressing the desires of the flesh through our own willpower. (2 Corinthians 10:3-5; Romans 8:13)

Yet, God made us to have **VICTORY** over the flesh. Unfortunately, many believers seem to be losing that battle. As in any warfare there must be an equipping with the proper weapons, accompanied by ample training to use them.

We will seek to accomplish this "equipping and training" in order to achieve the overall goal of this series.

As we begin our study, let's consider some Biblical facts about our relationship with God:

a. We must allow God's truth to **TRANSFORM** us, not merely inform us – Philippians 4:9; James 1:21-25

NOTE *Informed* = Learned, Received, Heard, Seen

Transformed = **CHANGED** in form…*and the God of peace shall be with you.*

b. Spirituality is not determined by what we do for God, but rather, it is who we are **WITH** God – Genesis 3:8, 5:21-24; Hebrews 11:5; Rev. 2:2-5

NOTE A real, truly Biblical Christian is one who doesn't just do all the right things, but one who knows God! Superficiality breaks down eventually. One who is truly spiritual is changed from deep within and it then works its way out!

c. True Biblical spirituality is determined by our **DESIRE** to know God and to have an intimate relationship with Him – Mark 14:18-19; John 13:21-25; Luke 10:38-42; Philippians 3:8-10; James 4:8

NOTE Knowing God is what this is all about…

d. The desire to know Him was placed in our hearts at salvation and is made operative by the **HOLY SPIRIT** – Romans 8:15; Galatians 4:6

NOTE The Holy Spirit lives inside of us. You can't get more intimate than that! Yet, we don't often think of it in these terms.

e. It is possible to quench and **GRIEVE** the working of God's Spirit within us – 1 Thessalonians 5:19; Ephesians 4:25-30

f. Many have pointed out this progression, where we grieve the Spirit of God, this is the internal conviction when we sin. And, when we continue to do this, we quench (put out the fire/conviction/etc..) the Spirit of God.

g. When we stop feeling conviction, BEWARE! This is a dangerous spot for us to be in!

h. When we are quenching the Spirit, we are not "feeding" the Spirit, we are putting it out by our works of the flesh!

NOTE Because He is so close to us…because He is Holy…our sin and our apathy hurts Him!

f. Walking by faith and not by sight ... becoming a Biblically spiritual Christian is a **CHOICE** – Hebrews 11:23-26; Daniel 3:16-18

NOTE At some point in our Christian life, we must wake up to the realization that we make ***critical choices daily*** for God's glory or for our own.

Week 2

2. The Nature and Condition of Man

a. The Beginning – The Creation of Man **(OUR PAST)**

- Man was originally made in God's **IMAGE** *(before the fall)* – Genesis 1:27

God – Gen. 1:26; 1 John 5:7; John 1:1-2, 14; Gen. 1:1-3

1 - Father
2 - Son *(Word)*
3 - Holy Spirit

Man – Gen. 2:7; 1 Thess. 5:23; Heb. 4:12

1 - Soul – (Father)
2 - Body – (Son)
3 - Spirit – (Holy Spirit)

KEY *Man's* **SOUL** *is not necessarily visible to the naked eye but includes a person's character, uniqueness, and giftedness. It is comprised of such elements as the mind, the will, and the emotions (God gave man the ability to exercise his own free will as seen by the insertion of the "tree of the knowledge of good and evil" in Genesis).*

Man's **BODY** *is what the Bible calls* ***the flesh****.*

Man's **SPIRIT** *is what the Bible calls the* ***inner man****, a part of man designed by God to be strengthened/empowered by close, personal, "spiritual" fellowship with God through the Spirit of God (Eph. 3:16).*

b. The Problem – The Fall of Man

KEY This is very important and why we have problems.

- Man **DISOBEYED** God – Gen. 2:16-17; 3:1-6
- Man's **spiritual** part died immediately upon sinning – Gen. 3:8
- Man's **physical** body now ages and eventually **DIES** – Gen. 5:5
- As a result of his **spiritual** and **physical** condition, man's **soul** also suffers a slow decay – Gen. 3:17-19; Ps. 90:10

- Man's children are now born in his own image, not in the image of God – Gen. 5:1-3; Rom. 5:12, 14-19

Important Considerations:

*We **do not cease to exist** at death, but our soul separates from our bodies, from this world, and potentially from God forever (aka… "give up the ghost" – Gen. 25:8, 17; John 19:30; Acts 5:5). This same type of separation is seen as Adam immediately becomes estranged from God, unable to have* **FELLOWSHIP** *with Him until God reveals His redemptive plan.*

This is the spiritually dead condition of every man and woman at birth. This is where all of our troubles began.

We often refer to lost man as being a TWO *part being. This is only true in the sense that man's spirit is dead (unable to fellowship with God). Lost man is still a* THREE *part being with a body (#1), a soul (#2), and a* **DEAD** *spirit in relation to God (#3).*

c. Saved Man **(OUR PRESENT)**

- As the result of Jesus substitutionary death, burial, and bodily resurrection *(the gospel*), all who trust in Christ's finished work now have the image of God restored. When we believe the gospel we are "born again" and our once "dead" spirit is brought back to life *(fellowship is restored with God)*.

  - His Spirit makes **our spirit** alive, or quickened – Eph. 2:1; Rom. 8:16; 1 Co. 2:11; 6:16; Col 2:11-12

  - **Our soul** is now able to **CHOOSE** to meditate on life – Psalm 19:7; 23:3; 42:2...or death – Jud.16:16; 2 Pet. 2:8

  - **Our dying body** is still in this world – Rom. 7:23-24, but it is powerless over us – Ro. 6:6-9 and scheduled to be replaced – Php. 3:21

d. Glorified Man **(OUR FUTURE)**

- When we were born again, **our spirit** was made alive and joined to His Spirit, **our soul** was given the ability to be renewed by His Word and we were given the promise of **a new body**. When we see Him we shall be **LIKE** Him, for we shall see Him as He really

is in the fullness of all of His glory – 1 John 3:2; Rom. 8:29-31

- The Holy Spirit and His working in our lives was meant to be the **DOWN** payment, or earnest of our promised glorious inheritance – 2 Co. 1:22; 5:5; Eph. 1:13-14. This is the reason why we should so "earnestly" seek to be **filled with** and **walk after** His Spirit.

- Our born-again, Spirit-filled lives are God's manifestation to the **physical world**, and the **UNSEEN** **supernatural world** of God's eternal plan, wisdom, and glory – Col. 1:27; Eph 3:10-11, 21

KEY He designed us when reborn to display ***His glory*** in and through us to all…as fallen, yet **RESTORED** creations of God!

That is what our mission is…

That is our purpose as individuals…

That is our purpose as a group of believers (church)…

This information should change how we view everything about our lives!!!

Week 3

3. The Warfare of a Christian – The Flesh vs the Spirit

a. The nature of this warfare – Galatians 5:17; Romans 7:21-25; Matthew 26:41

- We face three enemies as born again Bible Believers

1 - The **WORLD** – John 17:10, 12-15; James 4:4

2 - The **FLESH** – Romans 7:24

3 - The **DEVIL** – 1 Peter 5:8; Luke 22:31-32

NOTE God's Spirit in union with our spirit is in a battle with these 3 enemies:

- All three enemies have already been defeated! (Good news!)

1 - The world is defeated by the **WORD** – 1 John 5:4-5; Romans 10:17

2 - The flesh is defeated by the **WORD** – Psalm 119:9-11; Romans 12:1-2

3 - The devil is defeated by the **WORD** – 1 John 2:12-14; Eph. 6:10-17

NOTE They are already defeated in that we have the competed Word of God!

- Winning or losing this warfare is our **CHOICE**!

NOTE Remember…faith is a choice. Heb 11:25

b. The nature of the flesh

- The flesh is defiled, corrupted, and rotten – 2 Peter 2:10-22; Rom 7:18

KEY The real problem is authority, who is in control: God or **SELF**? Remember the definition of the "Kingdom of God"…Jesus ***rules*** from the inside!

Consider what the Bible says about the flesh…

- It is **WEAK** toward God – Matthew 26:41

- It cannot please God – Romans 8:8

- It will **KILL** you – Romans 8:6,13

NOTE This is true both physically and spiritually (eternally).

- It cannot inherit God's kingdom – Romans 8:23; I Cor 15:50

- It seeks to persecute the Spirit – Galatians 4:29; 5:17

NOTE Ishmael was the ***natural*** son of a carnal choice. Isaac was the ***supernatural*** son of a work completed by God.

c. The works of the flesh

Text – Galatians 5:19-21

- Sins which defile the body:

  - Adultery – being **UNFAITHFUL** to your spouse or spiritual adultery.

  NOTE The strange woman...Proverbs 5…Rev 17:5…

  - Fornication – any sexual sin outside of the marriage covenant.

  - Uncleanness – any pollution or impurity of the flesh starting with a dirty, lustful mind.

  NOTE Generally, this applies to sexual sin, but it also refers to "dirty"…

  - Lasciviousness – lewd and **LOOSE** behavior, uncontrolled sensual (alluring; carnal; erotic; lustful; provocative;

sexual) desire.

- Communion with Satanic forces:
  - Idolatry – anything **BETWEEN** me and God.
  - Witchcraft – use of satanic power, occult activity (and rebellion) - I Sam 15:23. Also associated with drug use (witchcraft = ***pharmakeia*** in Greek)

- Pride (ungodly love of self) – the root of ***all*** sin:
  - Hatred – internal hostile feelings.
  - Variance – quarreling, **CONTENTION**.
  - Emulations – jealousy and envy of others. Trying to be superior.
  - Wrath – **ACTING** on anger/hatred…can be in the form of violence.
  - Strife – surrounded in controversy; causing division and factions

- Religion and its fruits:
  - Sedition – uprising against God-ordained authorities
  - Heresies – denying essential **BIBLE** truth/doctrine
  - Envyings – not satisfied, wanting what others have in the way of position, power, or persons.
  - Murders – to **KILL** another through literal or verbal means – James 4:1-3

  NOTE Verbal includes breaking someone's spirit creating deep, life-long, emotional scars…

- General vices:
  - Drunkenness – anything that **CONTROLS** your life.
  - Revellings – wild partying; disorderly, outlandish behavior
  - Such like – not just the law, but the spirit of the principles

of God

KEY The issue is not what is wrong with it, but rather what is right about it!

Week 4

- The works of the flesh in a Christian's life…

- All of the items from God's "flesh list" are a potential threat inside of us.

NOTE It is not the **DEVIL**, it is my flesh. We do have a very real enemy…but we can't blame the devil for our fleshly desires!

- The works of the flesh are activated OR deactivated by our yielding:

To the *flesh* …OR

To *the Spirit*.

KEY This is the key to walking with God!!!! – Ro. 6:13, 19; Gal. 5:16

- We must not **LET** the works of the flesh reign – Ro. 6:12

NOTE Are you a slave to our own lusts? If so, you are a freed slave.

Your Master has purchased you…you are free now…to serve Him and to bring glory to Him **right now** – John 8:36; Gal. 4:9!

- Romans 8:8 - *"So then they that are in the flesh **CANNOT** please God."* The biblical reality is that nothing accomplished in my Christian life, done in my flesh alone, is pleasing to God.

- Winning or losing this warfare is my **CHOICE**...

NOTE God allows us a free will, even after salvation, to

choose right from wrong.

Josh. 1:5-9; 24:15

a. Sin and self – Understanding the enemy that resides **INSIDE** of us!

- The Christian's relationship to sin:
  - My sin was dealt with on the cross – Ro. 6:6-7; Gal. 2:20; Col. 2:13-14.
  - I am **DEAD** to sin – Ro. 6:2

    NOTE It ceased to have power over my eternity the moment I was saved!
  - Sin **CANNOT** control me – Ro. 6:14
  - I sin because I **CHOOSE** to sin – James 1:14

    KEY *If uncontested, sin can **again** become a way of life* (*like we did when we were lost!)*

    We ***must*** do what Daniel did…Dan. 1:8.
- The Christian's relationship to self:
  - It is possible to do biblical things in the power of the flesh – Php. 1:16-18

    EXAMPLE Satan tempted Eve to do God's will (to be like God), but in the way of **SELF**.

    EXAMPLE Satan tempted Jesus to do what was His right to do, but on **SELF**'s schedule…instead of God's schedule.
  - The issue for every pastor, missionary, church leader and church member to consider is this: Under who's

CONTROL am I doing what I do? We should always be in a mode of SELF-examination.

KEY QUESTION Am I under God's control or self's control?

- We can lead people to Christ and even teach the word of God, all in the power of our flesh…and appear very spiritual.

- The truth is that living in the flesh is *pseudo spirituality*

Pseudo – Artificial; Bogus; Counterfeit; Fake; False; Phony; Quasi

Pseudo Spirituality describes the "bridges" Christians try to build from flesh to Spirit, attempting to live in both worlds at the same time.

- Ways our flesh can attempt to be spiritual:

  - LEGALISM

    Man-made **SYSTEMS** of preferences that force someone to obey a set of rules or standards in order to be spiritual...we all must be careful!

    Obedience is **EXTERNAL**, yet true biblical submission is ***internal***.

    Disciplined flesh does not necessarily represent true spirituality or victory. Instead, it can lead to SELF-righteousness – Luke 18:9-14.

    Legalism is man's attempt to live with the appearance of spirituality with an unchanged spirit towards God's commands… ending up no different than the Pharisees – Matt. 23:1-12; Mark 7.

    Legalism often breeds a "secret" double life...

    NOTE This occurs when someone acts one way at church or around certain people and acts like someone else with others or in private – James 1:8.

    Legalism is more than hair length and dress codes...

    NOTE *Qualities that often accompany legalism: A legalistic heart often questions the motives and character of **others**. A legalistic person is often looking for "**DIRT**" on others. A legalistic person often thinks others have "something to hide". Be careful when you begin to think everyone else is wrong…*

Week 5

- Ways our flesh can attempt to be spiritual continued…

  - GOOD WORKS

    If I do enough **GOOD** things, then I am spiritual.

    My flesh can do many "good" things.

    The main issue is BEING, not DOING – Lk.10:38-42; Mt. 22:36-37

    Good works can make us feel like we are victorious...

    TRUTH Biblical men/women who **WALK** with God God the credit for every good works – James genuinely give thing...including good 1:17.

  - The "good" works of the flesh:

    The flesh is capable of doing good things – Lk. 11:42 – Good works are right…using them to glorify our flesh instead of God is not!

    When the flesh learns it is no longer allowed to do evil, it will do good in order to maintain **CONTROL**. Once control is established, it will soon revert to evil again - 1 Sam. 15:10-23.

  KEY We cannot fight our flesh with our **FLESH** – Gal. 3:1-3; 2:16; 1 Cor. 1:26-31; 2 Cor. 10:1-5.

  - RECOGNIZING the "good" works of the flesh:

    Self-willed is not easily led (lack of humbleness)
    Self-disciplined is not easily adjusted (entrenchedness)
    Self-confidence is not easily criticized (closedness)
    Self-motivated is not easily led (stubbornness)

- The RESULTS of the "good" works of the flesh:

  Self leads the way and asks **GOD** to come along.
  - Your self-control results from a self-led life. This is a lot of work to maintain, and yet Jesus' burden is to be light - Matt. 11:28-30.
    Self- righteousness will ultimately result in **unrighteousness** (pride, judging, etc.) – Matt. 27:3-7.

KEY The whole goal of true spirituality is the absolute lack of confidence in self and the flesh. To come to the place where all of our confidence is in God, **His** power, **His** Spirit and **His WORD** to direct us.

- Satan's Role with our flesh:

The flesh is Satan's workshop. Though evicted at salvation, he left his estate behind – Eph. 2:1-3.

When overt sin is prohibited, he can fill our lives with so much GOOD looking works that there is no room for GOD. Remember: Satan's sin was not immorality or murder, it was self-will (pride).

KEY All unrighteousness in the world has at its root **PRIDE** – Is.14:12-14!

As long as we are doing God's stuff for self, the spiritual powers know the difference – Acts 19:13-17.

NOTE Satan seeks a throne to rule. Though he CANNOT possess a believer sealed by the Spirit of God, he CAN "rule" them through their flesh…**the enemy inside**.

- Religion's Role with our flesh:

Religion is man working his way to be justified with God. Genuine salvation is God justifying those who could **NEVER** justify themselves.

- It is very easy for us to live in religious systems we've created:

Church attendance, tithing, baptism, visitation,

*discipleship, mission trips, etc…all good things that **CAN** become religious.*

Consider what your spiritual life would be like in solitary confinement for 3 months…if all religious things were removed?

- The Role of Knowledge and our flesh:

  Knowledge in the ***head*** does not necessarily mean spirituality in the ***heart***.

  Contrary to popular belief, knowledge is **NOT** power...Knowledge is potential power – 1 Cor. 8:1: Eph. 3:14-19.

  One of the biggest battles faced by those who have been Christians for any length of time is their "familiarity" with the Word of God.

  It is easy to be fooled by the flesh into thinking we are spiritual because we "know" a verse/passage and we "understand" the "concept" of it, and we can automatically believe we are doing it. We think we believe it, but in reality, we may not...

- Spiritual Experiences and our flesh:

  - Listening to "Christian" music

    Listening/singing along with Christian music is very beneficial and can truly minister to us in our Christian walk (Eph. 5:18-20; Col. 3:16), but it also has the strange potential to make us feel spiritual and strong when we actually aren't.

  - Listening to audio sermons

  - Reading "Christian" books

    *Like audio sermons, they can be good…however they cannot replace the Bible as the **AUTHORITY** of our lives!*

  - Exciting, emotional "spiritual experiences"

*They make us "feel good"…but it does not necessarily make us closer to God! They make us "feel religious"…but it can be prostitute spirituality! Many people are into these "experiences" and come to prefer the **FEELING** over the Word of God – 2 Tim. 4:3-4!*

KEY Believing the Word of God and acting upon those beliefs are the only truly "spiritual" things we can do! - Luke 11:27-28

Week 6

4. Keys to empowering the Spirit of God as we seek to walk with God

a. Getting victory over my deceitful flesh

- God reveals a relatively **SIMPLE** Biblical process to us in Romans 6:

  - **First**, we must understand the doctrinal truth that we are not stuck to our sinful flesh anymore being forced to obey it. We are **FREE** through Christ's Spirit to obey – Ro. 6:6-7, 18-22; Col. 2:10-12.

- **Second**, we must ALWAYS reckon these things to be so. *Reckon* = recognize. I must see it the way it is and call it for what it is every day – Ro. 6:11; Gal. 2:20.

  A very handy phrase to use when reckoning the flesh as dead - "Dead men don't **CARE**!"

- **Third**, we must not **LET** sin reign in our mortal bodies - Ro. 6:12-13. *Reign = When a sovereign rules on a throne*.

  Our battles with our flesh can be a very taxing burden. It can become easy to just give up and turn over the controls to the flesh. It seems easier – Php. 4:13. We must fight and die **DAILY** to walk with God - 1 Cor. 15:31.

- **Finally**, we must guard OUR members…am I yielding them unto sin, or unto God as one WHO IS ALIVE from the dead? – Ro. 6:13,16

  Feet – Where do I ALLOW my feet to take me?
  Eyes – What do I ALLOW my eyes to view?
  Mouth – What do I ALLOW my mouth to say/consume?
  Ears – What do I ALLOW my ears to hear?
  Hands/Fingers – What do I ALLOW my hands/fingers to touch?

  NOTE ***"Let"*** *and* ***"yield"*** *are words of choice. We do not have to lose our battles or our war with our flesh. It is truly* ***OUR*** *choice* – 2 Tim. 4:6-7; Rom. 7:14-25.

  KEY *Why are OUR CHOICES so important?* – 1 Cor. 6:20.

- Other practical battlefield tips to empower God's Spirit and kill our flesh:

  NOTE *God sees* **NO** *hope for our flesh…Therefore, the*

only solution for the flesh until our body is redeemed is a daily death!

- Consider that if you are in Christ (*i.e.* saved) and continue to live after the flesh, you will **DIE** – Ro. 8:10-13

  An inside struggle and fight is a good, healthy thing!

- The Holy Spirit within us battles against our flesh – Gal. 4:29; 5:17

- Remember that the battlefield starts in the **MIND** – 2 Cor. 10:3-5

- Failure will result if we **only kill fleshly things** but do not empower spiritual things – Col. 3.

  NOTE Failure will ALSO result when we **only empower spiritual things**, but don't deal with the flesh.

- We must make no provisions for the flesh…**STARVE** it – Ro. 13:14

- RESULTS of empowering God's Holy Spirit:

  - The Holy Spirit always **MAGNIFIES** the Lord Jesus – John 16:12-15

  - Following the Spirit eliminates failure. God doesn't fail.

  - Following the Spirit produces **FRUIT** – John 15:16; Gal. 5:22-23

Homework: Read Romans 6-8 before next Wednesday.

These chapters are the basis for this study.

Week 7

b. Practical, Biblical activities that will empower the Spirit and strengthen our walk with God

- **READ** your Bible every day – Is. 34:16; 1 Tim. 4:13; Luke 4:16

  NOTE Reading is not studying. The Bible is a **consistent diet** of God's food for us… packed with "vitamins" which yields fruit in our life. Most times God's Word is working inside of us when we read it, just like food does in our bodies, in ways we do not understand for our good – Job 23:12; Jer. 15:16.

- **STUDY** your Bible – 2 Tim. 2:15

  NOTE Don't let others do all the studying for you! God wants to use you in your walk with Him to get others answers – 1 Pet 3:15.

- **PRAY** every day – Luke 18:1; Phil. 4:6; 1 Thess. 5:17

  NOTE Prayer is our personal connection and opportunity to talk with God! Pray expecting God to respond. Watch and listen for His direction – James 1:5-7; Eph. 6:18; Col. 4:2.

- Be with the church when they assemble – Acts 2:42-47; Heb.10:25; Jude 19

  - **CHANGE** your lifestyle to accommodate gathering with God's people
  - Prepare for Sunday on Saturday, **NOT** Sunday morning
  - Have a servant's heart when you come (Be submissive…) – Eph. 5:21.
  - Have a **TENDER** heart when you come (Be willing to change…)

NOTE We have no idea what God has in mind for us to give and get at any given meeting as we gather together in His name. But we must come prepared and expecting of God to do great things!

- **GIVE** cheerfully – 2 Cor. 9:7
  - Your time … does God get much of your time?
  - Your talents … do your talents get used by God for His glory?
  - Your treasures... start by tithing *(10%)* from your total earnings

    NOTE We can rob God by how we handle our finances! Mal 3:8

    REMEMBER *God loveth a cheerful giver.*

- Do the work of the Lord
  - Tell the lost about Christ – Rom. 1:16
  - Strengthen believers in the Lord (disciple) – Matt. 28:18-20; 2 Tim. 2:2

    NOTE God wants our lives to abound in the work of the Lord! – 1 Cor. 15:58

- Be forgiving and **HUMBLE** toward others – 1 Cor. 3:1-4; Eph. 4:31-32; 5:21

  NOTE If you cannot…you are not walking with God in the Spirit! You are living carnally (that old fleshly way)!

FINAL THOUGHT These are all important Biblical areas that accompany a healthy walk with God. How are you doing in each of these areas? Talk with God about them, and then walk with God in them.

Week 8

c. The necessity and consistency of God's Word in our walk with God

- The Bible is **ALIVE** – Heb. 4:12.

  - There is no other book on this planet like the Bible. It is supernatural…given from above. We read it, and it reads us. It is a perfect mirror – James 1:22-25.

  - We must be careful how we approach it (Him) – John 1:1-5, 14-15; 1 John 5:7; Mark 11:27-33.

  - The Bible is **GOD'S** book…it is not open to private interpretation – 2 Pet. 1:20-21.

- The Bible is compared to water – Is. 55:10-11; Eph. 5:25-26.

  - The maximum time a person can go without consuming water is a week under normal conditions. Every cell in our body uses water. Water sustains us **inside** and also keeps us clean on the outside.

- The Bible is compared to food. Jesus specifically compares it to bread…supernatural, **daily bread** (daily = every day) – Luke 4:4,11:3.

  - Manna was supernatural bread that God consistently gave the nation of Israel – Ex. 16:15-21.

    ***v. 15a* – Manna =** what is it**?**
    v. 15b – This Lord gave them this bread.
    v. 16a – **Every man** was to gather it.
    v. 16b – Share it with those you live with.
    v. 17-18 – Share it with others so no one lacks (**FELLOWSHIP**)
    v. 19-20 – Be careful not to gather it and just let it sit.
    v. 21a – Gather it every morning.
    v. 21b – If not gathered, the blessing provided for that day disappears.

    NOTE God faithfully delivered His supernatural bread to

His people every day for **40** years! – Ex. 16:35-36

- Planning a **place** to meet with God every day…for a "Quiet Time"
  - God is **consistently** there with His provision for each day. We must work to have **CONSISTENCY** on our end of the relationship.
  - Pick a quiet place – Ps. 46:10; 1 Thess. 4:11
  - Remove distractions – Mark 1:35
  - Pick a place in the Bible – 2 Tim. 3:16; Is. 55:11

- A Powerful Quiet Time…more than just reading the Bible

P **Pray** to begin your time with God – Ps. 119:18

O **Open** yourself before God…be **VULNERABLE** – Heb. 4:13

W Word of God – **Read**

E **Expect** to hear from God – James 1:5-7

R **Respond** to what God gives you…journal, memorize, **MEDITATE** – Josh. 1:8; Psalm 119:15, 97, 99; James 1:22-25

FINAL THOUGHT

Imagine walking with someone and never interacting with them. God designed our walk with Him through this world to be an interactive adventure. As Adam and Eve once did, we again can walk and talk with God in the cool of the day. He has given us a **living Spirit** and a **living Book** to enable us to do so.

Week 9

5. The next 3 weeks will detail the doctrines of Justification, Sanctification & Glorification as they concern our Walk with God.

a. Justification

- **DEFINING** justification

- Justification means to "prove as just"; to declare "not guilty" or to declare "righteous." Justification, in a court of law, is a settled legal matter pronouncing a proper **LEGAL** standing or position. It often involves acquittal, vindication, or acceptance before a judge.

- Deuteronomy 25:1 - The question is **NOT** one of moral improvement. Judges do not make the right person a better person. They simply render a decision vindicating a person's position as satisfactory or unsatisfactory according to the law.

- **WHO** is Biblically justified and who is the justifier?

- Rom. 3:23-27, 8:33 – A person is justified **FREELY** by God's grace through the redemption found in Christ alone. **GOD** declares that person "just" in His sight when he meets God's conditions.

NOTE Luke 16:15. Justification in the New Testament is solely based upon the grace of God through Christ's sacrifice.

- **HOW** and **WHEN** is a person justified? What exactly are God's conditions?

- Rom. 3:28 – *"Therefore we conclude that a man is justified **by faith** without the deeds of the law."* See also Gal. 2:16.

- To better understand how justification is obtained by faith

alone, God refers us the testimonies of Abraham and David – Rom. 4:1-8.

Gen 15:1-6 – Why was Abraham justified? He heard what God said and simply believed God by faith. This is the **first mention** of the word "believe" in the Bible.
Rom. 4:5 summarizes **how/when** a person is justified by faith.
David was a murderer/adulterer and should have received no grace from God. Yet God did not *impute* his sin (*put on his account*) upon him, but God did *impute* righteousness upon him – Acts 13:26-39.

- **WHAT** actually happens the moment God justifies a person?

  - Rom. 5:1 – Receiving God's satisfactory payment for sins causes God to declare us justified. At that moment we are justified in Heaven by faith in Christ alone and ARE at **PEACE** with God forever.

  - Justification is the ***legal act***, the ***Heavenly transaction,*** whereby a person's guilty status before God is forever changed based on Christ's merits. He becomes a Christian… or little "Christ."

    Because of Christ's *imputed* righteousness, a Christian becomes good and righteous, sinless in the eternal eyes of God – 1 John 3:9.

    A Christian is only seen, and will only be seen as ***NOT GUILTY*** before God because of genuine faith in Christ.

- Confusion between Romans vs. James?

  Romans 4:1-5 God declares in Romans that it was through faith that Abraham was justified before God.

  James 2:20-26 James declares that Abraham's works justified him.

  So which is it? First of all, these passages are referring to two different "faith" events in Abraham's life. **Romans** is referring to Gen. 15:1-6 and the stars incident, while **James** is referring to an incident 40 years later in Abraham's life concerning sacrificing his only son Isaac – Gen. 22.

Faith alone, without any accompanying proofs, is dead. There's no proof it exists! Justifying faith will not only be faith, but will have Godly **WORKS** that accompany (or justify) and prove it – see Eph. 2:8-**10**; Heb. 11.

SUMMARY Human judges justify the innocent – God only justifies the guilty!

Man justifies on the basis of self-merit – God justifies on the basis of Christ's merit.

I should walk with God understanding I am justified through faith in His son Jesus Christ…free from **GUILT** – 2 Cor. 7:8-11.

Rom 5:1-2 – *"Therefore being justified by faith, **we have peace with God** through our Lord Jesus Christ: By whom also **we have access by faith into this grace** wherein we stand, **and rejoice** in hope of the glory of God."*

Week 10

Reminder of the Goal of this Series…*Walking with God* - To teach the Bible Believer the basics of his past, present, and future relationship to Jesus Christ in order to have victory over sin and bring glory to God on a daily basis.

Reviewing Biblical Justification:

- Biblical Justification = A Christian's position and **LEGAL** standing before Holy God. A Christian is at peace with God and completely righteous in God's sight for eternity because of **FAITH** in the finished work of Jesus Christ **alone** – Rom. 5:1.

- Why is the doctrine of justification important as we seek to walk with God?

- John 5:24 – *"Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that **heareth** my word, and **believeth** on him that sent me, hath everlasting life, and shall not come into condemnation; but is passed from death unto life."*

b. Sanctification

- **DEFINING** sanctification

  - Sanctification means to "set apart" or to be "separated." See its first uses in the Bible – Gen. 2:3; Ex. 13:2.

  - Sanctification is the **FRUIT** of a justified life. Once a believer is justified by faith in Christ, sanctification (separation) occurs **immediately**, can occur **daily**, and will occur **forever**.

- **THE ORDER** of sanctification

  - **Separated POSITIONALLY** at the moment of salvation by the Holy Spirit - 1 Cor. 6:11; Heb. 10:8-10; 2 Thess. 2:13; Col. 2:11-12.

  - **Separated PRACTICALLY** on a **DAILY** basis by our choices
    Sanctification in our daily life is based on our interactions with God's **WORD** and God's Spirit – John 17:17; Eph. 5:26.
    Jesus is our model of a set apart life – John 17:19; Rom. 15:3.

When we allow ourselves to be set apart, we can be used by the Master in any way he chooses – 2 Tim. 2:19-21; 1 Thess. 4:3-8.
This sanctification causes separation – Acts 13:2; Php. 3:7-8.

c. Comparing Justification vs. Sanctification

- In justification, our standing is changed before God. Sanctification deals with the nature of our character before God.

- Justification is what God does **FOR** us. Sanctification is what God can do **IN** us.

- Justification is an act. Sanctification is a work.

- Justification is safe. Sanctification is sound.

- Justification removes the guilt of sin. Sanctification keeps in check the potential to sin.

- Justification is the means. Sanctification is the end.
  As believers, we have been justified and sanctified enabling us to grow, mature, and walk **WITH** God now and forever.

Next week: Our last stage of sanctification

- Future **Separation PHYSICALLY** in a new body – *1 Thess. 5:23*; *Rm 8:29-39*

  .

  NOTHING is going to stop the eternal sanctification of the believer!
  A Christian will be eternally separated from sin, death, and hell.

Week 11

Reviewing Biblical Justification:

- Biblical Justification = A Christian's position and legal standing before a Holy God. A Christian is at peace with God and completely righteous in God's sight for eternity because of **FAITH** in the finished work of Jesus Christ alone. Justification is instant at _____ salvation – Rm. 5:1.

Reviewing Biblical Sanctification:

- Biblical Sanctification = A Christian's practical **DAILY** separation from the world unto God and His Will. This separation comes through choices, interactions and responses to God's word and God's Spirit, allowing the Christian to be used by the Master in any way He chooses. Sanctification is an ongoing process – Eph. 5:26

d. Glorification

- Defining Glorification

- Glorification means exaltation to honor and dignity. It's elevation to glory. We see this with the glorification of Christ *after* His resurrection and ascension – Lk. 24:26-27; Jn. 7:39; 12:16, 23-24; Acts 3:13-15

  Glorification involves a DEATH and a RESURRECTION… ending with an ascension**.**

- Glorification to the believer is NOT an elevation for our glory, but rather for us to be **WITH** the Glorified Christ **IN** Glory – Ps. 73:24; 113:4; Rm. 8:29-30; I Tim. 3:16; Heb. 2:10; I Pet. 5:10

  Future: The last stage of sanctification when believers will be separated **PHYSICALLY** and ETERNALLY from earth in a new body – II Cor. 3:18 4:6-7; I Thess. 5:23;

Col. 1:27; 3:4.
Nothing is going to stop the eternal sanctification of the believer – Rm. 8:29-39.
A Christian will be eternally separated from sin, death, and hell –
II Thess. 2.

- This is also called adoption – Rm. 8:23; I Cor. 15:42-58; Eph. 4:30

There's a **SPIRITUAL** adoption at the moment of salvation – Gal. 4:5-6; Rm. 8:14-16.
There's a **PHYSICAL** adoption at the Rapture – Rm. 8:17-19; Eph. 1:5, 11-14.

6. *Knowing that God* has called man to justification by means of salvation, and has predestinated the believers unto sanctification and future glorification, it should provoke us to **RESPOND** zealously and in all humility!

- *Knowing that God*, willing to save man from the consequences of his own sin, yet loved us enough to send His Son to die for us…
- *Knowing that God* didn't just want to save us and then abandon us, but desires a relationship with his redeemed, and so sent his Spirit to live inside of the believer…
- *Knowing that God,* Who now lives within us and us in Him, is still quenched and grieved by our sin…
- *Knowing that God*, despite our sin, still allows us to remain in him and receive the inheritance of blessings, even being made joint heirs with His Son…
- *Knowing that God* has prepared a place for his church to help rule and reign with Him for all eternity…
- *Knowing* that God did all this for us and so much more…it should cause us to change our **BEHAVIOUR** and live according to his Will, and not our own!!

KEY: Remember **WHO** you're walking with, and what He's done for you!

Next Week

In our last week, we will look at God's growth model for every believer. Come see

where you are in God's process of growth and where **EVERY** believer should be headed!

Week 12

Keys to remember as we approach this last topic…

- When proper discipleship takes place, the disciple will grow through a seven stage process as he or she walks with God.
- This pattern was established by the Lord Jesus Christ with His twelve disciples and then with the seventy.
- These same seven stages can be observed in the development of the apostle Paul.
- It is important for us to understand these stages and identify where we are in our personal ***walk with Christ***.
- Close observation of any Christian will reveal their present stage of spiritual growth.
- This process is not only for pastors, missionaries or those who are called to vocational ministry. ***This process should unfold in the life of every believer.***

7. Spiritual Development and Reproduction (also known as the NT Process of Discipleship)

   a. The Seven Stages of a Disciple

#1 - Repentance – The starting point

- Repent means to turn and **CHANGE** beliefs, directions, etc. – Mt. 21:28-29.

- God desires all men to repent and be saved – Acts 17:30-31, 20:21; 2 Pet. 3:9.
- **GENUINE** repentance and faith results in a changed life – Acts 26:20; 2 Cor. 5:21.

#2 - Enlightenment – Getting to know God…*"learn of me;" "come and see"*

- God desires to enlighten us as to who he is – Matt. 11:25-29; John 1:1, 14, 37-50.
- Learning from mature believers is God's plan (discipleship) – Matt. 28:18-20; Acts 8:29-35; 2 Tim. 2:2.
- Some Biblical examples of discipleship: Moses/Joshua, Elijah/Elisha, Naomi/Ruth, Priscilla/Aquila and Apollos, Jesus and the Twelve, Luke/Theopholis (Luke/Acts), Paul/Titus, Paul/Timothy
- John 13:15 – *"For I have given you an example, that ye should do as I have done to you."*

#3 - Life Application – Applying what you know to life

- Knowledge brings **ACCOUNTABILITY**…a desire to pass on what has been learned.
- Luke 12:48…*For unto whomsoever much is given, of him shall be much required…*
- Practical life application of Biblical truth will be evidenced in a disciple's life:

    * Follows Christ in obedience *(baptism, giving, etc.)*
    * Follows Christ in **SUBMISSION** *(attitude)* Col. 3:22-23
    * Ambassador for Christ – 2 Cor. 5:18-20; 1 Cor. 3:9; Acts 9:15-23
    * Persecuted as Christ's servant – 2 Tim. 3:12; 1 Pet. 4:1-4
    * Successfully works through the trials/tests of life – James 1:2-5

#4 - **LEADERSHIP** Development – Becoming a powerful influence for Christ

- ***Followers*** become leaders. A ***good follower*** will make a ***good leader*** – Mark 9:35.
- **EVERY** follower, to some degree or another, is purposed to become a good leader...
- Jesus' focus was to develop leaders to lead others. True leaders follow His pattern.

KEY Genuine leaders have genuine followers whom they are training. False leaders have "blind" followers. Blind followers have trouble doing anything that has lasting value, just like their leaders – Matt 15:13-14.

- While everyone has a capacity to be a leader, church leadership is ordained by God and will be successful with obedience – 1 Cor. 12:12-27; Eph. 4:11-16; Acts 6:1-7.
- Godly leadership is the key to success - Prov. 29:2.
- Is there anyone following you?

#5 - Testing and Separation - A trial(s) that puts faith severely to the test

- God proves (**TESTS**) every disciple for the next level – 1 Pet.1:6-7, 4:12-13.
- A good teacher gives his students hard tests to prove them.
- This testing is ***not*** like the normal problems of everyday life.
- This testing is ***not*** connected to sin in the disciple's life.
- This testing involves a ***crisis*** that leads to a "point of no return."
- These tests lead to an "all our nothing" attitude.
- The results:
    * A completely transformed life that will **NEVER** be the same.
    * Separation from the world on a grander scale occurs.
- The proper foundation of strong biblical discipleship is key at this point because ***everyone*** who makes it to this stage will eventually come to this crossroad. This is to be expected, do not be surprised. Abraham was likely not surprised by God's testing – James 2:19-23; Heb. 11:17-19.
- This proving is often intense/severe – John 6:66-70; 1 Kings 2:1-6; Job 13:15.

#6 - **LEADERSHIP** after testing – a new look and outlook

- On the other side of this testing, the disciple looks differently.
- The disciple has clear evidence of ***fruit*** after **PURGING** – John 15:1-2.
- They are now a better leader. At this time the disciple is empowered for greater responsibility.
- This stage is important because the disciple must put into **PRACTICE** what has been learned. They now live out their decisions made during testing time.
- There are no textbooks that can make a person this kind of a leader. It must be learned by experience – Rom. 5:3-5.
- Leaders who have been through the fire themselves exemplify maturity in their character *(temperance, extra compassion for others, empathy, tolerance, etc.)* – Matt. 15:21-32; 20:30-34; 23:37; Luke 19:41-42.

#7 - World Vision – a consistently sanctified life

- All major principles of the Christian life have been learned, practiced, and tested – Php. 3:10.
- The disciple sees this world the way God sees it in every capacity – Gal. 6:14.

- The disciple knows what he/she is to do because they know God deeply.
- The disciple has a life that truly exemplifies being a stranger/pilgrim in this world – Heb. 11:13; 1 Pet. 2:11-12.

KEY The disciple is commissioned to reach the world and ***entirely expects*** to ***accomplish that mission***.

b. Summarizing this Process of Growth…

- Not everyone is called to vocational ministry *(pastor or missionary)*, but everyone is called to the ministry. **EVERYONE** can do something important for God. How this calling works out practically in the lives of people will differ. However, **EVERY** believer is designed to come through this process successfully. God gave us a Book with everything we need and placed His Holy Spirit inside us at the moment of salvation. There is no excuse.

KEY "**WALKING** with God" is not always the easiest journey, but it is the best journey with the best intentions of our great God always at work – Rom. 8:28! God promises to always walk with us through all things – Heb. 13:5!

WALKING WITH GOD

MBC – "Next Steps" Bible Study

The Goal of this Series

To teach the Bible Believer the basics of his past, present, and future relationship to Jesus Christ *in order to have victory over sin and bring glory to God on a daily basis*.

Some of the issues we will deal with in this series are as follows:

1. The nature and condition of mankind
2. The enemies of a Believer and the ensuing warfare that is encountered
3. Living a life of Victory
4. Justification and sanctification
5. Spiritual development and reproduction

Key Text: Galatians 5:25

Galatians 5:25 - *"If we **live** in the Spirit, let us also **walk** in the Spirit."*

Week 1

Introduction

1. The Spiritual Christian

Our salvation introduced us to an intense struggle for true, biblical spirituality. A battle now exists between our flesh and our spirit *(Galatians 5:17)*.

KEY This battle ***cannot be won*** by suppressing the desires of the flesh through our own willpower. (2 Corinthians 10:3-5; Romans 8:13)

Yet, God made us to have **VICTORY** over the flesh. Unfortunately, many believers seem to be losing that battle. As in any warfare there must be an equipping with the proper weapons, accompanied by ample training to use them.

We will seek to accomplish this "equipping and training" in order to achieve the overall goal of this series.

As we begin our study, let's consider some Biblical facts about our relationship with God:

a. We must allow God's truth to **TRANSFORM** us, not merely inform us – Philippians 4:9; James 1:21-25

NOTE *Informed* = Learned, Received, Heard, Seen

Transformed = **CHANGED** in form…*and the God of peace shall be with you.*

b. Spirituality is not determined by what we do for God, but rather, it is who we are **WITH** God – Genesis 3:8, 5:21-24; Hebrews 11:5; Rev. 2:2-5

NOTE A real, truly Biblical Christian is one who doesn't just do all the right things, but one who knows God! Superficiality breaks down eventually. One who is truly spiritual is changed from deep within and it then works its way out!

c. True Biblical spirituality is determined by our **DESIRE** to know God and to have an intimate relationship with Him – Mark 14:18-19; John 13:21-25; Luke 10:38-42; Philippians 3:8-10; James 4:8

NOTE Knowing God is what this is all about…

d. The desire to know Him was placed in our hearts at salvation and is made operative by the **HOLY SPIRIT** – Romans 8:15; Galatians 4:6

NOTE The Holy Spirit lives inside of us. You can't get more intimate than that! Yet, we don't often think of it in these terms.

e. It is possible to quench and **GRIEVE** the working of God's Spirit within us – 1 Thessalonians 5:19; Ephesians 4:25-30

f. Many have pointed out this progression, where we grieve the Spirit of God, this is the internal conviction when we sin. And, when we continue to do this, we quench (put out the fire/conviction/etc..) the Spirit of God.

g. When we stop feeling conviction, BEWARE! This is a dangerous spot for us to be in!

h. When we are quenching the Spirit, we are not "feeding" the Spirit, we are putting it out by our works of the flesh!

NOTE Because He is so close to us…because He is Holy…our sin and our apathy hurts Him!

f. Walking by faith and not by sight ... becoming a Biblically spiritual Christian is a **CHOICE** – Hebrews 11:23-26; Daniel 3:16-18

NOTE At some point in our Christian life, we must wake up to the realization that we make ***critical choices daily*** for God's glory or for our own.

WALKING WITH GOD

MBC – "Next Steps" Bible Study

The Goal of this Series

To teach the Bible Believer the basics of his past, present, and future relationship to Jesus Christ *in order to have victory over sin and bring glory to God on a daily basis*.

Some of the issues we will deal with in this series are as follows:

1. The nature and condition of mankind
2. The enemies of a Believer and the ensuing warfare that is encountered
3. Living a life of Victory
4. Justification and sanctification
5. Spiritual development and reproduction

Key Text: Galatians 5:25

Galatians 5:25 - *"If we **live** in the Spirit, let us also **walk** in the Spirit."*

Week 1

Introduction

1. The Spiritual Christian

Our salvation introduced us to an intense struggle for true, biblical spirituality. A battle now exists between our flesh and our spirit *(Galatians 5:17)*.

KEY This battle ***cannot be won*** by suppressing the desires of the flesh through our own willpower.

Yet, God made us to have _____ over the flesh. Unfortunately, many believers seem to be losing that battle. As in any warfare there must be an equipping with the proper weapons, accompanied by ample training to use them.

We will seek to accomplish this "equipping and training" in order to achieve the overall goal of this series.

As we begin our study, let's consider some Biblical facts about our relationship with God:

a. We must allow God's truth to _____ us, not merely inform us – Philippians 4:9; James 1:21-25

NOTE *Informed* = Learned, Received, Heard, Seen

Transformed = _____ in form…*and the God of peace shall be with you.*

b. Spirituality is not determined by what we do for God, but rather, it is who we are _____ God – Genesis 3:8, 5:21-24; Hebrews 11:5

NOTE A real, truly Biblical Christian is one who doesn't just do all the right things, but one who knows God! Superficiality breaks down eventually. One who is truly spiritual is changed from deep within and it then works its way out!

c. True Biblical spirituality is determined by our _____ to know God and to have an intimate relationship with Him – Mark 14:18-19; John 13:21-25; Luke 10:38-42; Philippians 3:8-10; James 4:8

NOTE Knowing God is what this is all about…

d. The desire to know Him was placed in our hearts at salvation and is made operative by the _____ _____– Romans 8:15; Galatians 4:6

NOTE The Holy Spirit lives inside of us. You can't get more intimate than that! Yet, we don't often think of it in these terms.

e. It is possible to quench and _____ the working of God's Spirit within us – 1 Thessalonians 5:19; Ephesians 4:30 (25-30)

NOTE Because He is so close to us…because He is Holy…our sin and our apathy hurts Him!

f. Walking by faith and not by sight ... becoming a Biblically spiritual Christian is a _____ – Hebrews 11:25 (23-26); Daniel 3:16-18

NOTE At some point in our Christian life, we must wake up to the realization that we make ***critical choices daily*** for God's glory or for our own.

S17 / TEACHING SERIES

Biblical Relationships

Teacher and student introductory lessons for a biblical relationships course.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Teaching and adaptation; the underlying course credits Stephen Wineka.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

5 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

Biblical Relationships

Introductory teaching notes adapted by Luke Johnston from the Biblical Relationships course by Stephen Wineka.

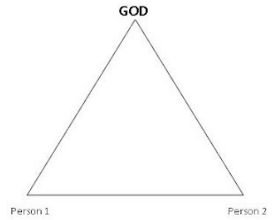
Full teaching files

student bib relationships *2 pages*

teacher bib relationsips *2 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

BIBLICAL RELATIONSHIPS



Introduction:
Before we begin discussing the topic of various relationships, what the Bible says about having healthy, fruitful, godly, enjoyable, and long-lasting relationships, and studying various examples in the Bible, we must ask a very important question and set the proper context so we can see things from God's perspective.

A very important question…
When faced with God's word, are you willing to _____ what you believe, repent, and obey?

In the spiritually deceitful time of Laodicea that we live in, "Christians" are often interested to know what God has to say, but never let it truly effect the way we think and behave (Ezek. 33:30-33; Lk. 6:46; Rev. 3:14-17; Jer. 17:9-10; Jas. 1:22-25; 2 Tim. 3:7).

You have to always remember that God and the world are polar opposites - the way this world's system defines relationships will never be the way God defines relationships and will never be given God's stamp of approval (Jas. 4:4; Jn. 15:18-20; 1Jn. 2:15-17).

If you are willing to believe what God has said, you must repent from your own ideas, and obey the word of God. BUT BE WARNED! ...You will be met with resistance on every front (especially from your own self! - Rom. 7:18; Prov. 28:26; Jas. 1:14-15).

Remember, God will always give you the strength, wisdom, and boldness to obey if you have a humble and submissive heart attitude (Jas. 1:5; Prov. 2:6; 1 Cor. 1:30; 10:13)

Setting the proper context…

1. Remember the theme of the Bible: The _____ for the Throne / The Glorification of God (Is. 42:8; 48:11; Num. 14:21; Is. 52:10; Matt. 6:10; Acts 3:21; Ezek. 39:8; Rev. 21:6)

God created mankind to be relational creatures, so we can certainly say that He created the ability for us to have relationships for our personal benefit, but we must never forget that everything that God does and allows is for His glorification (Rev. 4:11). This means that every relationship must be a relationship that gives God honour and glory, and if it does not then it is robbing God of the glory he deserves!

There are three basic relationships found in the bible:

- God and Mankind (Gen. 1:26-28; 2:7-8,15-22; 3:8-24; 4:4-16)
- Mankind and Mankind (Gen. 2:18-25; 3:6-20; 4:3-8)
- Parents and Children (Gen. 3:15-16; 4:1-2, 25-26)
-

All relationships will fit somewhere into the three basic relationships. We must also begin this study understanding that the relationship between God and Mankind is the foundation for all other relationships. If this relationship isn't right, no relationships will be right (Prov. 23:26; 4:23, 26; Deut. 6:5; Ps. 119:2; Matt.10:37-38; Lk. 14:26; 2Cor. 8:5; Amos 3:3)

#1 - God and Mankind
The relationship between God and mankind is the most important relationship because it is the foundation for all other relationships. God created us on purpose, for a purpose, and for His pleasure (not our own! - Rev. 4:11)... If our relationship with God is not it the proper place, there is no way we will be able to have proper relationships with anyone! - Prov. 23:26; 4:23, 26; Deut. 6:5; Matt. 10:37-38; Amos 3:3

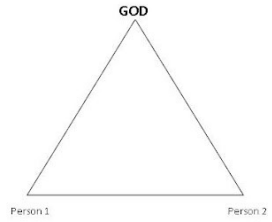
As we proceed into Genesis 1-3 make sure you focus your attention on the importance of the relationship between God and man & God and woman…

God and Man

1. Why was Man created?

-Gen. 1:26 - Have dominion over all the creatures and all the earth
- Gen. 1:28 - Be fruitful, multiply, and replenish the earth, and subdue it… and have dominion
- Gen. 2:5, 8, 15 - To till the ground, to dress and keep the garden of Eden ü Gen. 3:8a - To have a personal, intimate relationship with God

BIBLICAL RELATIONSHIPS



2. What did God require of Man?
-Gen. 1:28 - Be fruitful, multiply, and replenish the earth, and subdue it… and have dominion
- Gen. 2:16-17 - Freely eat from every tree of the garden, but do not eat from the tree of knowledge of good and evil

God and Woman
1 .Why was Woman created?
- Gen. 2:18-25 - To be man's help meet by helping him to fulfill his God-given _____
- Gen. 3:8a - To have a personal, intimate relationship with God
2. What did God require of Woman?
-Gen. 2:18-25 - To help Adam be fruitful, multiply, and replenish the earth, and subdue it
- Notice that both Man and Woman had responsibilities to fulfill, but their first obligation is to their beloved Creator. As we will see, it will be impossible for Man and Woman to fulfill any of their personal responsibilities unless they are keeping their personal relationship with God right, pure, and in its proper place.

The Relationship between God and Mankind is _____ right away (Gen. 3:1-13)
The Serpent's Subtil Plan of Attack
1. Question the Word of God - Gen. 3:1
2. Contradict the Word of God - Gen. 3:4
3. Change the Word of God - Gen. 3:5
4. Focus on the Woman (the help meet) - Gen. 3:1

5. End Goal: To destroy fellowship with God by attacking the foundation of God's Word so that God's plans and purposes cannot come to pass to bring God glory..
The Battle For The Throne!

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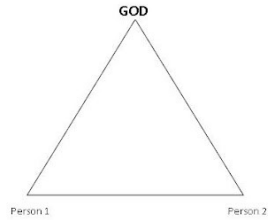

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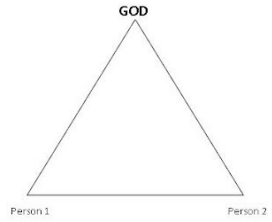

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The Battle For The Throne!

M01 / MISSIONS AND TRAINING

Evangelism Class

A three-week evangelism course with teacher/student resources and presentations.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Evangelism training and resource preparation.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

15 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

Evangelism Class

Luke Johnston's selected teaching, writing or development sample; original bylines and citations retained.

Full teaching files

student evangelism week 1 overcoming the laodicean mindset	*2 pages*
teacher evangelism week 1 overcoming the laodicean mindset	*2 pages*
2STUDENT WEEK 2 EVANGELISM CLASS	*2 pages*
2TEACHER WEEK 2 EVANGELISM CLASS	*2 pages*
evangelism training week 3 student	*3 pages*
evangelism training week 3 teacher	*3 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

EDGE YOUTH MINISTRY

BIBLICAL EVANGELISM

Overcoming the Laodicean Mindset- Rev. 3:14-22

I. The prevailing issue of our age of Christianity is _____ _____; and NONE of us are exempt (vs. 17)
   a. 2 Tim. 3:13; 1 Tim. 4:1; 2 Pet. 3:3-4; Matt. 24:3-5)

II. Because of this we must constantly evaluate ourselves honestly
   a. The self-evaluation we must do revolves around our works; NOT OUR WORDS (vs. 15, 17)
   b. The works we will be judged on are simple: evangelism and discipleship

III. The Laodicean Mindset
   a. Balance/Palatable Christianity (neither cold nor hot)- vs. 15
   b. We have all we need and we are doing well (rich, have many goods, don't need anything)- vs. 15

IV. God's Mindset
   a. He wants _____- vs. 15, 19
   b. Palatable Christianity makes him want to PUKE- vs. 16
   c. We are wretched, miserable, poor, blind, and naked- vs. 17
   d. He still loves us and wants us to repent. Repentance for us, is to be zealous- vs. 19

V. How this looks for us
   a. No more middle of the road Christianity. It is _____
      i. The Devil has convinced us that a "palatable" Christianity is good and God will be happy with it when in reality God says….. (1 Cor. 9:16; Mark 16:15)
   b. Be ZEALOUS for God
      i. When you think of a zealot, you think of an extremist (like Simon zealotous in the bible, he was a zealot which was a terrorist during that day who hated Rome)
      ii. We are too afraid of this kind of Christian life too often. This is the kind of Christianity that Jesus, Paul, John, Peter, the disciples, and all early Christians were known for and KILLED for. They stood out! They went against the world as Christ told them to and as we are commanded to! (James 4:4; Jn. 15:19)
   c. Quit deceiving yourself

i. To not be zealous for God and to simply blend in (even though you go to church, read your bible, memorize verses, are a good student, good athlete, don't have crazy sin in your life, etc..) IS SIN!
    1. You can argue it is worse than other sins in many ways, it is a sin that DAMNS PEOPLE TO HELL EVERY DAY
ii. It is time to evaluate your _____ for God and your ZEAL for God honestly
    1. NOT:
        a. "I am doing well not sinning"
        b. "I read my Bible"
        c. "I don't party or cuss"
        d. "I have a good testimony because I get good grades/do well in sports"
    2. BUT:
        a. "In what ways am I HATED like Jesus and the disciples were?" (2 Tim. 3:12; Jn. 15:19)
        b. "What people have I led to Christ/discipled recently?"
        c. "How many people have I shared the gospel with this month?" (Mk. 16:15; 1 Cor. 9:16)
        d. "Would the people at my school call me a zealot for God" (Rev. 3:19)

d. Biblical Evangelism
    i. This class will help you to take the first steps toward overcoming Laodicea
    ii. Truly sharing the Gospel will make you stand out from 90% of Laodicean Christians in the world today. It is the first ministry we are given and is 100% necessary, it is required, it is a command, and not to do it is as much a sin if not MORE SO than any other sin

EDGE YOUTH MINISTRY

BIBLICAL EVANGELISM

Overcoming the Laodicean Mindset- Rev. 3:14-22

I. The prevailing issue of our age of Christianity is **self deception**; and NONE of us are exempt (vs. 17)
   a. The world we live in, major events surrounding us, pressure from peers, politics, culture, what we have been taught from a young age, etc. all give us this bend toward Laodicean Christianity
   b. As we saw in church history in our Revelation study, the Devil found the most success through his subtilty (same way he got Adam and Eve to sin according to 2 Cor. 11:3). This attack plan comes to full fruition in this last age of the Christianity, Laodicea. A time marked by the most deception this world has ever seen (2 Tim. 3:13; 1 Tim. 4:1; 2 Pet. 3:3-4; Matt. 24:3-5)

II. Because of this we must constantly evaluate ourselves honestly
   a. The self-evaluation we must do revolves around our works; NOT OUR WORDS (vs. 15, 17)
   b. The works we will be judged on are simple: evangelism and discipleship
      i. All ministry, the work of the Lord that we are called to, revolves around these two things. Whether it is sharing the gospel, teaching the Bible, counseling someone, preaching a sermon, praying for someone, comforting someone, exhorting a brother or sister, etc.. All fall under this umbrella

III. The Laodicean Mindset
   a. Balance/Palatable Christianity (neither cold nor hot)- vs. 15
   b. We have all we need and we are doing well (rich, have many goods, don't need anything)- vs. 15

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   c. We are wretched, miserable, poor, blind, and naked- vs. 17
   d. He still loves us and wants us to repent. Repentance for us, is to be zealous- vs. 19

V. How this looks for us
   a. No more middle of the road Christianity. It is **UNBIBLICAL**
      i. God never tells us to be good Christians, not cuss, smoke, drink, party, have sex, get good grades, be good at sports, be great musicians, etc.. Just for the sake of it. That is the Laodicean mindset. The Devil will gladly allow a bunch of "do-gooders" because they will

NEVER reach the world for God and they will never see the power of God in their lives. That is why Laodicea is such a failure.

ii. The Devil has convinced us that a "palatable" Christianity is good and God will be happy with it when in reality God says..... (1 Cor. 9:16; Mark 16:15)

b. Be ZEALOUS for God

i. When you think of a zealot, you think of an extremist (like Simon zealotous in the bible, he was a zealot which was a terrorist during that day who hated Rome)

ii. We are too afraid of this kind of Christian life too often. This is the kind of Christianity that Jesus, Paul, John, Peter, the disciples, and all early Christians were known for and KILLED for. They stood out! They went against the world as Christ told them to and as we are commanded to! (James 4:4; Jn. 15:19)

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1. You can argue it is worse than other sins in many ways, it is a sin that DAMNS PEOPLE TO HELL EVERY DAY

ii. It is time to evaluate your **WORKS** for God and your ZEAL for God honestly

1. NOT:
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    b. "I read my Bible"
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ii. Truly sharing the Gospel will make you stand out from 90% of Laodicean Christians in the world today. It is the first ministry we are given and is 100% necessary, it is required, it is a command, and not to do it is as much a sin if not MORE SO than any other sin

EDGE YOUTH MINISTRY

BIBLICAL EVANGELISM

THE BIBLICAL PATTERNS FOR EVANGELISM

1. 1 Thessalonians 2:1-13
    a. Evangelism will be accompanied by persecution (vs. 1-2)- Acts 17:1-9; 2 Tim. 3:12
    b. Evangelism is _____ about your ability to speak, comprehend, remember information, convince, etc.... (vs. 3,5)- 2 Cor. 4:2
    c. Evangelism is about _____ God, not men (vs. 4)
        i. This means you will have to speak the truth in love, but the whole truth nonetheless
        ii. You will have to talk about sin, hell, judgment, and plainly tell people they are wrong and heading down a bad path at times
    d. Evangelism must be done:
        i. Gently, as though you are speaking to your own children (vs. 7,11)
        ii. With true charity and desire for their souls (vs. 8)- 1 Cor. 13:1-3
        iii. With a good testimony and countenance. It is NOT just about speaking words (vs. 8,10)
        iv. With labor and work. It is hard work to do it well and not just give a presentation and move on (vs. 9)
            1. Paul did not want their blood on his hands and so he felt he had to do it FULLY and to the very best of his ability. Not a half done job but truly give it all he had (vs. 9)
    e. Only then can the gospel be received as the “word of God” and not the “words of men”
        i. If you find you share the gospel with people and you never see any fruit from it, you feel no power in the message, or there is never anyone you have respond to it; you are likely missing some key parts of this pattern and therefore you are missing the POWER of the gospel as the “word of God” and are just making it your own words
2. Corporate Evangelism
    a. “_____ ____ _____” evangelism- Mk. 6:7-13; Lk. 9:1-6
        i. Jesus sent the disciples out 2 by 2 into the cities to preach the gospel
        ii. They were not to simply just wait for open doors, only preach to friends, acquaintances, neighbors, etc...
        iii. THE BIBLICAL PATTERN FOR EVANGELISM all over the NT is to “GO” and preach the gospel to everyone. Going into the cities, preaching the gospel, places you have never been, places with strangers

iv. It can be scary and hard BUT IT IS NECESSARY. It is our biblical example
v. You will have to talk about sin, hell, judgment, and plainly tell people they are wrong and heading down a bad path at times
vi. Jesus equates it with “fishing”. We need to be active in “going out” and preaching the gospel to all people (Matt. 4:19; Mk 1:17)

3. Keys from The Parable of the Sower- Matt. 13:1-9
   a. Key 1- Sow a lot of _____

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

   b. Key 2- Understand your role

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

   c. Key 3- Expect to see the results Christ tells us we will see

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

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            1. Paul did not want their blood on his hands and so he felt he had to do it FULLY and to the very best of his ability. Not a half done job but truly give it all he had (vs. 9)
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        i. If you find you share the gospel with people and you never see any fruit from it, you feel no power in the message, or there is never anyone you have respond to it; you are likely missing some key parts of this pattern and therefore you are missing the POWER of the gospel as the "word of God" and are just making it your own words
2. Corporate Evangelism
    a. "**Two by Two**" evangelism- Mk. 6:7-13; Lk. 9:1-6
        i. Jesus sent the disciples out 2 by 2 into the cities to preach the gospel
        ii. They were not to simply just wait for open doors, only preach to friends, acquaintances, neighbors, etc...
        iii. THE BIBLICAL PATTERN FOR EVANGELISM all over the NT is to "GO" and preach the gospel to everyone. Going into the cities, preaching the gospel, places you have never been, places with strangers
        iv. It can be scary and hard BUT IT IS NECESSARY. It is our biblical example
        v. You will have to talk about sin, hell, judgment, and plainly tell people they are wrong and heading down a bad path at times
        vi. Jesus equates it with "fishing". We need to be active in "going out" and preaching the gospel to all people (Matt. 4:19; Mk 1:17)
3. Keys from The Parable of the Sower- Matt. 13:1-9

a. Key 1- Sow a lot of **seed**
    i. We have no control over what does or does not grow, we just need to SOW
    ii. Play the odds, the more you sow, the more will grow!
b. Key 2- Understand your role
    i. We are not called to make the seed grow, IN REAL LIFE AND EVANGELISM SPIRITUALLY, ONLY GOD CAN DO THAT
    ii. We are however called to try and prepare the soil, sow as much seed as possible, follow up (sow again, maybe find better ground), and pray for God to give the increase
c. Key 3- Expect to see the results Christ tells us we will see
    i. Don't be surprised when we sow and things come up in peoples lives and they forget what we told them (the birds/devils). The enemy will do this, God warns us
    ii. Don't be surprised when people get saved (spring up) and never bare fruit that shows it (stony ground and thorns). This is the majority situation God tells us will happen. The cares of the world and sin will keep some from growing and also trials and troubles will keep others. Expect it!
    iii. Don't underestimate what God can do will ONE SEED
    iv. We see one seed can become 30 fold, sixty fold, or 100 fold
        1. You never know what all God can do with the seed you sow, it can become more than you ever imagined!

BIBLICAL EVANGELISM

SHARING THE GOSPEL WITH THE ASK METHOD

I. Our conversations are exactly that. Conversations; not presentations. Each person you meet will have a different opinion, even if they share the same denomination. Use where they are at to best minister to them.

A. A- _____

1. Asking questions is good for provoking thought in people. Jesus often asked questions for this very reason. Realistically, Jesus never had to ask questions to learn more about people because he knew everything about them. Jesus asked questions so often because he was provoking thought into the hearts of the listeners. (**Matt. 16:13-16**; John 21:15-17; Matt. 21:24-27)
    a) Jesus was the question master! Asking questions can be our most effective tool when witnessing to the lost

B. S- _____

1. This cannot be overstated. This is our **number one goal** when we are out witnessing. All these things we will go over are great tools when time allows for them, but sharing the gospel must be done at all costs! God will take care of the rest if we are faithful to do this! (Rom. 1:16; Phil.1:14-18; Psalm 40:9-10; 71:15-16; 119:46; Rom. 10:17; 1 Cor. 2:4; 9:16; Jer. 20:7-9)
2. What is the gospel?
    a) The **good news**, not just the bad news
    b) 1 Cor. 15:3-4
        (1) Jesus died for our sins and rose from the dead 3 days later, **according to the scriptures.**
3. Ways to Give the Gospel
    a) Good Test
        (1) Go through the law (10 commandments) and show them the penalty of their sin and the price Jesus paid for it (Romans 3:23; 6:23; 10:9-10,13)
    b) Problem: Solution

(1) Problem- We are sinful, (Rom 3:23; Ecc. 7:20; Gal. 3:22; 1 John 1:8-10; Rom. 5:12; Rom. 6:23a) but God is Holy, which means he must judge sin righteously, and also he cannot be in the presence of sin (Habb. 1:13; Psalm 5:4-5; 11:4-7; 34:15-16; 1 Pet. 1:15-16)

(2) Solution- God became a man in the form of Jesus Christ, and lived a perfect and holy life. Jesus lived for about 33 years and allowed his creation to crucify him on a cross so he could take the punishment for sin for all men. (John 3:16-19; Rom. 6:23; 10:9-10, 13; Eph. 2:8-9)

c) Romans Road

(1) Romans 3:23 (We have all sinned but God is perfect)

(2) Romans 6:23 (the price for our sin is death- eternal death in hell seperated from God), BUT Jesus paid for this for you so you don't have to

(3) Romans 10:9,13 (The way to receive Jesus gift of salvation and the price he paid for your sin is to believe and pray to God to receive this gift)

d) ***Testimony**

(1) You can give your personal testimony in any gospel conversation and often times it could be very helpful. Your testimony is a good tool, but remember the POWER is in the word of God/the Gospel. Giving your testimony will always need to include the word of God and a clear gospel from the Bible

C. K-_____

1. At this point we are looking for any opportunity to follow up with the person we are talking to. Whether this includes asking for their phone number and if they would like to meet sometime to continue this conversation, or inviting them to church possibly and giving them the church's information. (Matt.13:4,19)
2. This point is too often missed even by faithful evangelists. This is very important to do!
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    a) (DISCIPLESHIP) This point is where discipleship meets evangelism. The most fruit we have isn't going to be from leading hundreds to Christ, but from faithfulness to grow, reach out to, and disciple those who do come to Christ. (Matt. 13:8- "some an hundredfold, some sixtyfold, some thirtyfold") This is how we can help make sure we are sowing seeds to the good ground and produce multiplied fruit!

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4. When we are witnessing to someone, you will have to get a feel for the conversation. If you have time, take time. If you can tell they are ready to go, then ask if you can share what you wanted to when you asked them who Jesus is to them, and then hand them a tract. At the very least, try to leave them with a tract and ask them to read it and consider what it says. DO NOT BE AFRAID TO STEER CONVERSATIONS. People want to talk about these things and they will not think twice about sharing what they think with you, so do not be afraid to share with them.

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M02 / MISSIONS AND TRAINING

3–2–1 Outreach

Two outreach-preparation lessons with teacher/student resources and presentations.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Outreach training and lesson preparation.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

5 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

3-2-1 Outreach

Luke Johnston's selected teaching, writing or development sample; original bylines and citations retained.

Full teaching files

OUTREACH LESSSON STUDENT *1 pages*

OUTREACH LESSSON TEACHER *2 pages*

TEACHER 321 EVENT NUMBER 2 final (1) *1 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

CAN ANYBODY TELL ME THE TRUTH? 3, 2, 1 EDGE OUTREACH EVENT

1) There are many beliefs, teachings, and opinions in the world today. Everyone thinks that what they think is correct; however there is only one TRUTH. There is only one reality and it must be out there somewhere. Tonight, we don't want to give our opinions on the world or talk about what we "think", we want to examine the facts and see what the TRUTH is.
   - **a) THE TRUTH ABOUT _____**
     - **i) How can there possibly NOT be a God?**
     - ii) Genesis 1:1; John 1:1-3; Hebrews 1:10; Neh. 9:6
   - **b) THE TRUTH ABOUT THE _____**
     - i) The Bible is unique among all the books in the world
     - ii) 48 PROPHESIES; 1 in 10000000000

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   - **a) THE TRUTH ABOUT GOD**
     - **i) How can there possibly NOT be a God?**
     - ii) The belief that there is no God is a growing belief today. Many of the most famous people in all of history did not share this belief. Some of the greatest minds and most famous people of all time all believed in God: Albert Einstein, Isaac Newton, George Washington, Thomas Jefferson, Leonardo Da Vinci, Ben Franklin, Abraham Lincoln, Plato, Aristotle, and the list goes on and on and on….
     - iii) The reality is that atheism is a minority belief, even in todays world where it seems God is being taken out of everything. And throughout all of history, atheism was a radically minority belief as people saw the universe for what is was and knew a God must have created it
     - iv) Genesis 1:1; John 1:1-3; Hebrews 1:10; Neh. 9:6
       - (1) LEGO/BUILDING ILLUSTRATION
       - (2) VIDEO
       - (3) THERE IS A GOD. IT IS IMPOSSIBLE THAT THIS COULD HAVE ALL HAPPENED BY ACCIDENT. NOTHING AROUND US HAPPENED ON ACCIDENT, IT WAS ALL MADE/CREATED. THE UNIVERSE IS THE SAME
   - **b) THE TRUTH ABOUT THE BIBLE**
     - i) The Bible is unique among all the books in the world
       - (1) Its message is unified throughout all 66 books. It was written by over 40 different writers, including shepherds, kings, priests, scholars, fishermen, and prophets, over a span of 1,500 years. However, the Bible remains unified in its message even though it displays a wide variety of genres and its authors wrote for a variety of purposes and exhibited a broad range of emotions
     - ii) 48 PROPHESIES; 1 in 10000000000

here as well. It is a place of torment, burning, wailing, and suffering; and it is eternal. Once you are here, you will never leave. God never desired for anyone to end up here. (Matt. 25:41; 13:41-42; Mark 9:45; Luke 16:22-24; Rev. 20:14-15)

(a) Is your name written in the book of life?

(b) Have you ever sinned even once?

(c) Where would you be going if you were to die tonight?

(d) THERE IS ONLY ONE ANSWER TO THIS QUESTION

d) **THE TRUTH ABOUT JESUS CHRIST**

i) Romans 6:23(b)

ii) John 3:16; Romans 10:9, 13

(1) Jesus payment for your sin is a gift! It is the only way to pay for your sin other than paying for it yourself by spending an eternity in Hell. Just knowing that he died for you is not enough; you must receive him!

(a) It is like if you are drowning at a pool; it is not enough to simply know the lifeguard exists and it there, you must call out for help and ask them to save you. It is moment in time choice that you make!

iii) I know men and I tell you that Jesus Christ is no mere man. Between Him and every other person in the world there is no possible term of comparison. Alexander, Caesar, Charlemagne, and myself founded empires; but what foundation did we rest the creations of our genius? Upon force. Jesus Christ founded an empire upon love; and at this hour millions of men would die for Him." — **Napoleon Bonaparte**

iv) I am a Jew, but I am enthralled by the luminous figure of the Nazarene. Jesus is too colossal for the pen of phrase-mongers, however artful¡¨. He further added: "No man can read the gospels without feeling the actual presence of Jesus. His personality pulsates in every word. No myth is filled with such life. Theseus and other heroes of his type lack the authentic vitality of Jesus." — **Albert Einstein**

v) "A man who was completely innocent, offered himself as a sacrifice for the good of others, including his enemies, and became the ransom of the world. It was a perfect act." — **Mahatma Gandhi**

2) Many of these men I read these quotes from knew much about Jesus and clearly they even respected him. However, based on their stories it is very likely that none of them are in heaven right now. They knew about Jesus and they clearly could see the facts for what they are, but they never received him. Don't make that same mistake. Know what awaits on the other side of this life and take action NOW. This is the Truth no matter what you may "think" or "believe"; and the stakes are too high to ignore it.

Jesus Christ: The Truth

3, 2, 1 EDGE OUTREACH EVENT

1) What does the Bible say about truth?
   a) **John 14:6**- Jesus saith unto him, **I am** the way, **the truth**, and the life: no man cometh unto the Father, but by me.
   b) **1 Timothy 3:15-16**- But if I tarry long, that thou mayest know how thou oughtest to behave thyself in the house of God, which is **the church of the living God, the pillar and ground of the truth.** And **without controversy** great is the mystery of godliness: God was manifest in the flesh, justified in the Spirit, seen of angels, preached unto the Gentiles, believed on in the world, received up into glory.
2) If Jesus Christ is TRUE (truly who he said he was; God), where is the evidence?
   a) The Bible is what tells us about who Jesus is and the truth about him. If we can trust the Bible then we can know the TRUTH about Jesus
   b) Antient Writings
      i) Plato, Julius Caesar, Aristotle, Socrates, Alexander the Great, Jesus Christ
   c) Historical Evidence
      i) Josephus (Jewish Historian), Tacitus (Roman Historian), Celsus (Greek Historian), Thallus (Greek Historian)
   d) Scientific Evidence
   e) Archaeological Evidence
   f) Biblical Evidence
      (1) Remember, the Bible is not some "religious book". It is accounts of actual historical events with ZERO contradictions to other places in the bible or other historical accounts. You can trust these accounts MORE THAN you can trust the lives of Julius Caesar, Plato, Alexander the Great, etc…
      (2) Here is what Issac Newton said about the Bible's historical record
      ii) Acts 22:1-10
         (1) Paul was a Jew and an enemy of Christ, until he had an encounter with the risen Jesus Christ and he was converted. What did he have to gain for lying? Lifelong persecution, stonings, lashings, and eventual beheading at Rome
      iii) 1 Corinthians 15:1-6
         (1) There were over 500 people who saw Jesus risen from the dead after he died. Many have tried to disprove this historical claim but cannot. No group of 500 people have ever lied and kept a lie well enough to last like this one. And nobody ever died for something they KNEW was a lie.
      iv) Countless other NT miracles, resurrections, healings, and teachings in the gospels, all HISTORICALLY VALIDATED
   g) Quotes about Jesus
      i) Alexander the Great
      ii) Ghandi
      iii) Albert Einstein
3) What do I do with this truth?
   a) We are all sinners- Romans 3:23
   b) The Payment for our sin is death- Romans 6:23
   c) Somebody has to pay the price for our sin- Romans 6:23
   d) Jesus Christ paid for the sins of the world through his death and resurrection. If we call out to him in prayer and tell him we believe he did this for us (died and rose again) and ask him to save us, he will save you in a moment- Romans 10:9, 13; John 3:16

M03 / MISSIONS AND TRAINING

Portland Mission Team Training

Instructional material and encouragement verses prepared for a six-week mission-team preparation schedule in 2025, including gospel conversations, anticipated questions, and roleplay.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Training prepared and adapted by Luke Johnston from a mission-team training template credited to Jay Baughman; original source credits retained.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

Teaching material from the available Portland mission-team manual. Personal contacts, costs and travel administration are omitted.

The six-week preparation plan includes five training meetings and a family gathering. The available instructional text and encouragement verses are included; travel administration and the security appendix are omitted.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

Portland Mission Team Training

Training adapted and prepared by Luke Johnston using an inherited mission-team training framework; original source credits retained. Based on a mission-team training template credited to Jay Baughman.

Complete available instructional text; travel administration and the security appendix omitted. The source plan includes five formal training meetings and a sixth family gathering.

Full teaching files

encouragement verses	*2 pages*
M03 Portland Complete Available Teaching Text	*9 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

Verses for Encouragement

Rom. 1:16 – *For I am not ashamed of the gospel of Christ: for it is the power of God unto salvation to every one that believeth; to the Jew first, and also to the Greek.*

Ezek. 3:17-19 –*Son of man, I have made thee a watchman unto the house of Israel: therefore hear the word at my mouth, and give them warning from me. When I say unto the wicked, Thou shalt surely die; and thou givest him not warning, nor speakest to warn the wicked from his wicked way, to save his life; the same wicked man shall die in his iniquity; but his blood will I require at thine hand.*

Yet if thou warn the wicked, and he turn not from his wickedness, nor from his wicked way, he shall die in his iniquity; but thou hast delivered thy soul.

Isa. 55:11 – *So shall my word be that goeth forth out of my mouth: it shall not return unto me void, but it shall accomplish that which I please, and it shall prosper in the thing whereto I sent it.*

2 Tim. 4:2 – *Preach the word; be instant in season, out of season; reprove, rebuke, exhort with all longsuffering and doctrine.*

1 Cor. 15:58 – *Therefore, my beloved brethren, be ye stedfast, unmoveable, always abounding in the work of the Lord, forasmuch as ye know that your labour is not in vain in the Lord.*

Prov. 11:30 – *The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life; and he that winneth souls is wise.*

Matt. 5:16 – *Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven.*

John 15:5 – *I am the vine, ye are the branches: He that abideth in me, and I in him, the same bringeth forth much fruit: for without me ye can do nothing.*

1 Thess. 2:4 – *But as we were allowed of God to be put in trust with the gospel, even so we speak; not as pleasing men, but God, which trieth our hearts.*

Gal. 6:9 – *And let us not be weary in well doing: for in due season we shall reap, if we faint not.*

Matt. 28:19–20 – *Go ye therefore, and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost: Teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you: and, lo, I am with you alway, even unto the end of the world. Amen.*

2 Cor. 5:20 – *Now then we are ambassadors for Christ, as though God did beseech you by us: we pray you in Christ's stead, be ye reconciled to God.*

Acts 4:31 – *And when they had prayed, the place was shaken where they were assembled together; and they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and they spake the word of God with boldness.*

1 Corinthians 9:16- *For though I preach the gospel, I have nothing to glory of: for necessity is laid upon me; yea, woe is unto me, if I preach not the gospel!*

Eph. 6:19 – *And for me, that utterance may be given unto me, that I may open my mouth boldly, to make known the mystery of the gospel,*

Col. 4:3 – *Withal praying also for us, that God would open unto us a door of utterance, to speak the mystery of Christ, for which I am also in bonds:*

Mark 16:15 – *And he said unto them, Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature.*

Rom. 10:14 – *How then shall they call on him in whom they have not believed? and how shall they believe in him of whom they have not heard? and how shall they hear without a preacher?*

Jer. 20:9 – *Then I said, I will not make mention of him, nor speak any more in his name. But his word was in mine heart as a burning fire shut up in my bones, and I was weary with forbearing, and I could not stay.*

Luke 14:23 – *And the lord said unto the servant, Go out into the highways and hedges, and compel them to come in, that my house may be filled.*

Ps. 27:1 – *The Lord is my light and my salvation; whom shall I fear? the Lord is the strength of my life; of whom shall I be afraid?*

Portland Mission Team Training

Complete available teaching text with administration omitted

This portfolio edition contains the available instructional text from the Portland mission teacher manual: the training sequence, participant devotions, prayer, cultural preparation, gospel instruction, conversation practice, Scripture assignments, and team preparation. Travel arrangements, costs, contacts, and the travel security appendix have been omitted.

Training adapted and prepared by Luke Johnston using an inherited mission-team training framework; original source credits retained. Based on a mission-team training template credited to Jay Baughman.

Six week training sequence

Week 1 Prayer for Portland, culture of Portland, and defining the gospel.

Week 2 Watchmen chapters 1–3; the A.S.K. method; promoting good conversations.

Week 3 Watchmen chapters 4–6; anticipating encounters; practice with the A.S.K. method.

Week 4 Watchmen chapters 7–9; practice with the A.S.K. method.

Week 5 Watchmen chapters 10–14; continued A.S.K. practice and team preparation.

Week 6 Family cookout and team fellowship. The source schedule does not list an additional formal lesson for this session.

The original plan also includes participant devotions: share a verse or passage that encourages, motivates, and inspires service, followed by devotion and prayer time. Watchmen is retained as the reading label used in the source schedule.

Devotion Ideas

Share a verse/passage that really encourages you in the work of the Lord and tell why it encourages, motivates, and inspires you. We will have time to meet together at the beginning of each day for this devotion and prayer time.

Prayer Requests For Portland Gospel Church

1. Pray for Portland Gospel Church as they are on the streets doing the work.

Pray for their open doors

Pray for people to respond, surrender, and join the church/discipleship

2. Pray for their disciples to stand strong and continue to grow

3. Pray that they will make new disciples

5. Pray for our team to be unified and as prepared as we can be!

Pray for our open doors and appointments to be from God

Pray for our distractions to be minimal and our focus to remain strong

Culture Of Portland Notes

Understanding Portland's Culture for Evangelism

Portland is known for its progressive, independent, and countercultural spirit. The city has a reputation for being highly secular, socially liberal, and environmentally conscious. Understanding all of this will only help you in your gospel conversations you will have.

1. Demographics and General Worldview

• Highly Secular Population – Portland is one of the most unchurched cities in America. Many people identify as "spiritual but not religious" or hold to atheism, agnosticism, or alternative spiritualities (New Age, Wicca, Eastern religions)

• Young & Progressive– The city attracts young professionals, artists, and activists. Many Portlanders are passionate about social justice, environmentalism, and LGBTQ+ rights

• DIY and Independent Thinking – Portland's culture values individualism, anti-corporate sentiment, and personal freedom. This can make them resistant to authority, tradition, or absolute truth

• Homelessness and Drug Addiction – Portland has one of the largest populations of homeless individuals, many of whom struggle with drug addiction, mental illness, and poverty

2. The Religious and Spiritual Climate

• Post-Christian and Anti-Church Sentiment – Many Portlanders have a negative view of organized religion, particularly Christianity. To them it is associated with hypocrisy, old thinking, conservatism, and in many ways what is wrong with the world

• New Age and Mysticism – While many reject Christianity, there is an interest in mysticism, astrology, tarot, and alternative spirituality

• Liberal Theologies and Universalism – Some churches in Portland embrace a progressive, universalist approach to Christianity. They emphasize social justice over doctrine and rejecting traditional views of sin, judgment, and salvation

3. Cultural Priorities and Beliefs

• Tolerance and Inclusivity – Portland places a high value on acceptance of all lifestyles, beliefs, and identities. The idea that Jesus is the only way to salvation is seen as narrow minded or even offensive

• Environmentalism and Sustainability – Many residents view caring for the environment as a major moral issue, sometimes with religious devotion

• Anti-Authority and Anti-Corporate – Portlanders tend to distrust large institutions, including government, corporations, and churches. They favor grassroots movements, local businesses, and alternative lifestyles (against the grain/progressively minded)

• Justice and Activism – Issues like racial justice, LGBTQ+ rights, feminism, and economic equality dominate much of the cultural and political discourse

4. Effective Evangelism Strategies with Culture in Mind

A. Engaging Intellectuals and Skeptics

• Ask questions instead of just preaching – Instead of immediately stating biblical truths, ask “What do you think happens after death?” or “Do you think objective morality exists?”

• Use reason – Many are skeptical of the Bible, so be prepared to discuss historical evidence for Christ, the reliability of Scripture, and moral arguments for God’s existence

This is NOT necessary to know to share the gospel or reach people effectively. The power is in the GOSPEL (Rom. 1:16). Being prepared for your encounters through prayer and a consistent walk with the Lord is invaluable.

However, some people will respond well to any answers you can give them in this area (Isaiah 1:18; Acts 17:2-4; 18:4; 1 Pet. 3:15).

• Be ready for anti-Christian objections – Expect challenges about the problem of evil, Christianity’s role in history, and accusations of intolerance.

B. Engaging the “Spiritually Curious”

• Speak about Jesus rather than ‘Christianity’ – Many reject the institutional church but have never truly encountered Jesus. Religion vs Relationship.

• Share testimonies – Personal stories of how God has impacted your life can be more effective than doctrinal arguments (2 Cor. 3:2-3).

C. Evangelizing to Activists

• Avoid political debates – Stick to Jesus and the Gospel, not cultural wars or conservative vs. liberal arguments. Do not even entertain political debates. Politics is the poor man’s religion. It is not worth the possibility of it interfering with their opportunity to hear the gospel.

• Gently challenge their worldview – Many see morality as relative. Ask: “Where do you think justice comes from? If there’s no God, why does right and wrong matter?”

5. Overcoming Resistance

• On RARE occasions, people may passionately disagree with you; or even more rare, they may be angry with you. Do not let this sidetrack you from the mission.

Firstly, it is a rare occurrence. It likely won’t happen to you.

Secondly, we are to expect persecution as believers who live godly in boldly sharing the gospel (2 Tim. 3:12)

Thirdly, this may in fact show a deep-down working of God in their hearts. Some of the people who show the most outward rejection are in fact battling deep down against God pricking their hearts (Acts 9:5; 26:14)

The Gospel

1. Defining the gospel. What exactly is it?

The clearest definition – 1 Corinthians 15:1-4

Where do we start with it?

Key elements

God became a man in the form of Jesus Christ

Jesus lived a perfect, sinless life

Jesus laid His life down in the stead of sinful man – John 1:29; Rom. 3:25; 1 John 4:10.

He then rose again from the dead three days later conquering sin, the grave, and hell for the sinner.

Jesus must be recognized and received by man, trusting in Jesus Christ alone, to be redeemed by God – John 1:12

2. Our obedience to give the gospel

Romans 1:16, 10:15, 15:16; 1 Cor. 1:17-18, 9:16; 2 Cor. 4:3-4; Gal. 1:8-9, 11; Eph. 1:13, 6:19; Php 1:12; 1 Thess. 2:4, 8; 2 Thess. 1:8; 1 Tim. 1:11; Heb. 4:2.

The gospel is the power of God and we must trust in the authority of God that the gospel will do its work.

The ASK method

Our conversations are exactly that. Conversations; not presentations. Each person you meet will have a different opinion, even if they share the same denomination. Use where they are at to best minister to them.

A Ask Questions

Asking questions is good for provoking thought in people. Jesus often asked questions for this very reason. Realistically, Jesus never had to ask questions to learn more about people because he knew everything about them. Jesus asked questions so often because he was provoking thought into the hearts of the listeners. (Matt. 16:13-16; John 21:15-17; Matt. 21:24-27)

ASK permission to begin a conversation… “Can I ask you a question?”

ASK their opinion… “Who do you believe Jesus was/is?” – Matt. 16:13-15; John 10:7-9, 14:6.

We can debate/argue many foolish questions with them, but what they believe about Jesus will be what matters most – Matt. 12:19; 2 Tim. 2:23-26.

Respond to their answers respectfully and kindly… “That’s really interesting” or “I really appreciate your opinion” or “Where did you learn that?”

As we continue into “S” and “K”…we will continue to ask questions.

Key Questions

Who do you believe Jesus is/was?

If you died tonight, where would you go AND why?

Do you believe in God? Heaven/Hell?

Do you go to church anywhere?

Do you have any kind of spiritual belief?

If what you believe were not true, would you want to know it?

At the close of the conversation based on what we just discussed

Are you a sinner?

Do you want forgiveness for your sins?

Do you believe that Jesus was God and died on the cross and rose again for YOUR SINS?

Are you willing to surrender your life to Jesus Christ and ask him to save you?

S Share the Gospel

This cannot be overstated. This is our number one goal when we are out witnessing. All these things we will go over are great tools when time allows for them, but sharing the gospel must be done at all costs! God will take care of the rest if we are faithful to do this! (Rom. 1:16; Phil.1:14-18; Psalm 40:9-10; 71:15-16; 119:46; Rom. 10:17; 1 Cor. 2:4; 9:16; Jer. 20:7-9)

Next we teach them what the Bible says about Jesus…the Gospel – Matt. 28:19a.

Teach the gospel in the way in which you are comfortable or the situation dictates.

Ways to Give the Gospel

Good Test

Go through the law (10 commandments) and show them the penalty of their sin and the price Jesus paid for it (Romans 3:23; 6:23; 10:9-10,13)

Problem Solution

Problem- We are sinful, (Rom 3:23; Ecc. 7:20; Gal. 3:22; 1 John 1:8-10; Rom. 5:12; Rom. 6:23a) but God is Holy, which means he must judge sin righteously, and also he cannot be in the presence of sin (Habb. 1:13; Psalm 5:4-5; 11:4-7; 34:15-16; 1 Pet. 1:15-16)

Solution- God became a man in the form of Jesus Christ, and lived a perfect and holy life. Jesus lived for about 33 years and allowed his creation to crucify him on a cross so he could take the punishment for sin for all men. (John 3:16-19; Rom. 6:23; 10:9-10, 13; Eph. 2:8-9)

Romans Road

Romans 3:23 (We have all sinned but God is perfect)

Romans 6:23 (the price for our sin is death- eternal death in hell seperated from God), BUT Jesus paid for this for you so you don't have to

Romans 10:9,13 (The way to receive Jesus gift of salvation and the price he paid for your sin is to believe and pray to God to receive this gift)

Testimony

You can give your personal testimony in any gospel conversation and often times it could be very helpful. Your testimony is a good tool, but remember the POWER is in the word of God/the Gospel. Giving your testimony will always need to include the word of God and a clear gospel from the Bible

This is a good time to make this point as well: the power is in the word of God not your words, arguments, reasoning, etc.. memorize and share the word of God in your conversations! (1 Thess. 2:13)

Then ASK them for a response “What do you think about that?” or “Does that make sense to you?” or “Have you ever heard anything like that before?”

Continue the conversation by responding to their responses.

We are looking to share the gospel with as many people as we can…that’s the command and where the power of God lies – Mark 16:15.

We are looking for receptive people that God brings our way – John 5:17.

Lead them to pray to receive Christ if they are ready!

Practice and be ready for how you might lead them to pray to receive Christ.

When we are witnessing to someone, you will have to get a feel for the conversation. If you have time, take time. If you can tell they are ready to go, then ask if you can share what you wanted to when you asked them who Jesus is to them, and then hand them a tract. At the very least, try to leave them with a tract and ask them to read it and consider what it says. DO NOT BE AFRAID TO STEER CONVERSATIONS. People want to talk about these things and they will not think twice about sharing what they think with you, so do not be afraid to share with them.

K Keep the Conversation Going

“We do not want to give up on any conversation until we have to.” – Pastor Thomas Harding

If you’ve had a good conversation (they get saved…or just a great, interactive conversation), ASK if they’d like to continue the discussion over coffee or whatever method Portland Gospel Church gives us.

“We don’t just want to throw seeds to the wind. Seek for a second encounter”

Portland Gospel Church is a disciple-making church. Their role once we leave will be to nurture any fruit so that it might remain – John 15:8, 16; Matt. 28:19b.

Qualities that promote good conversations

1. Prepare

Pray- Ask God to give you boldness (Acts 4:29), wisdom (James 1:5), and divine appointments (Eph. 6:19; Col. 4:3)

Trust God with the results- Your job is to share, not convert. You can't fail if you share your faith. You fail only if you don't share it.

2. Make eye contact

Do not be afraid of them – 2 Tim. 1:7; Jer. 1:6-10, 17.

If God did not give us the fear we are feeling, then it's from our flesh or the devil.

3. Listen, and use their names

Using their names makes it personal and lets them know you care about them personally.

Use tricks to help you remember.

4. Listen and affirm them as individuals with souls – 2 Pet. 3:9; Col. 1:28-29.

If we are going to interrupt their day to A.S.K. them about Jesus, they expect to be heard.

It is SO IMPORTANT that they see we will genuinely listen, care, and be interested in them.

The balance is for us to be more interested in communicating Jesus to them.

Don't argue. Just say, "Hmm," and listen. (William Fay calls this the "hmm principle" in his book "Sharing Jesus Without Fear)

It is a way to actively engage with what they are saying and it matters more than you'd think

5. Speak in a tone that is conducive to a conversation – Pr. 15:1.

Remember, our gospel presentations are a conversation. Each will ebb and flow a little differently.

Seek to project softly and kindly…yet be bold, confident, and persuasive – 1 Thess. 2:7.

Consider that your posture and countenance will speak to them as importantly as your words – Ps. 4:6.

A quote regarding posture – "Your uplook determines your outlook"

A quote regarding tone – "I could hear your voice, but not your words"

6. Be honest and put yourself out there with each conversation – 2 Cor. 4:1-10

Work hard for the Lord believing each swing you take might be a homerun – 1 Thess. 2:8

Make sure, make sure, make sure that your motivations are right each day – 1 Thess. 2:1-6

7. Remember two important factors as you speak

The Bible describes those who don't know God as lost and blind, yet not far from God – 2 Cor. 4:3; Matt. 15:14; Is. 42:7; Acts 17:27-28.

Consider each person you meet as a divine appointment. We should be thinking…who did God arrange for me to speak to today? – Acts 8:26-39

Homework: Before our trip…look up, read, and write out the following verses about the gospel and include it in your binder for review and encouragement:

Romans 1:16, 10:15, 15:16; 1 Cor. 1:17-18, 9:16; 15:1-4; 2 Cor. 4:3-4; Gal. 1:8-9, 11; Eph. 1:13, 6:19; Php 1:12; 1 Thess. 2:4, 8; 2 Thess. 1:8; 1 Tim. 1:11; Heb. 4:2.

Anticipating our Encounters

When we ask: Who do you believe Jesus was? Transition from this response…

I don't believe He ever existed

I'm an atheist

Science explains everything…I believe in science

He was just a man like us

I believe He was God's son

Will this be quick?

When we ask: What do you think about that (after the gospel)? How would you respond?

How can you believe there's only one way that is right?

I already go to church.

I've been baptized

I am Muslim

You don't believe in creation…do you?

I'm an atheist

I believe we evolved and that there is no God

I'm a good person

The Bible was just written by man

What about dinosaurs?

That's good for some people, but that's not what I believe.

Good questions to ask additional

Do you have a spiritual background?

Have you ever read the Bible?

Biggest Issue we ll likely encounter

People are in too big of a hurry…and don't want to be bothered – I'm alright mate!

Seven team preparation principles

Thing #1:We need to operate as a team

Operating as a team involves two important things:

To operate as a team, we must all be likeminded about our mission and purpose

To operate as a team, we must say the same things..

Thing #2:We need to diligently prepare for our mission

Prayer

Training

Walk with the Lord

Encouragement

Thing #3:We need to understand that some will need to be in charge of certain matters

Thing #4:We will for sure have fun, but there can be no practical jokes

Practical jokes are neither practical nor funny

Thing #5:We will leave arrogance at home; there is no place for it on this trip

Q: What will destroy team unity faster than anything else?

A: Someone seeking preeminence; selfishness; arrogance

Thing #6:We plan on being opposed and attacked

The physical factor:

The emotional factor:

Thing #7:We will travel by a common creed…

Motto: We are the “no excuses” short-term missionary team

Attitude: No problem… be flexible

M04 / MISSIONS AND TRAINING

Booth Evangelism / HEM ASK Training

Reusable booth-evangelism and A.S.K. training materials, conversation scenarios, and participant resources.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Volunteer training and resource adaptation, with original source credit retained.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

18 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

Booth Evangelism / HEM ASK Training

Booth evangelism and ASK teaching materials prepared and adapted by Luke Johnston; inherited method and resource credits retained.

Full teaching files

2Copy of Copy of SINGLES HEM Training (1) (1) *2 pages*

GENIUS - GOOD TEST 2024 FINAL EDITABLE *8 pages*

STUDENT SINGLES HEM Training *3 pages*

TEACHER SINGLES HEM Training *4 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

BIBLICAL EVANGELISM

SHARING THE GOSPEL WITH THE ASK METHOD

I. Our conversations are exactly that. Conversations; not presentations. Each person you meet will have a different opinion, even if they share the same denomination. Use where they are at to best minister to them.

A. A- _____

1. In order to most effectively minister to people, we should gather as much information about them as we can
2. Asking questions is good for provoking thought in people. Jesus often asked questions for this very reason. Realistically, Jesus never had to ask questions to learn more about people because he knew everything about them. Jesus asked questions so often because he was provoking thought into the hearts of the listeners. (**Matt. 16:13-16**; John 21:15-17; Matt. 21:24-27)
    a) Jesus was the question master! Asking questions can be our most effective tool when witnessing to the lost

B. S- _____

1. This cannot be overstated. This is our **number one goal** when we are out witnessing. All these things we will go over are great tools when time allows for them, but sharing the gospel must be done at all costs! God will take care of the rest if we are faithful to do this! (Rom. 1:16; Phil.1:14-18; Psalm 40:9-10; 71:15-16; 119:46; Rom. 10:17; 1 Cor. 2:4; **9:16; Jer. 20:7-9)**
2. What is the gospel?
    a) The **good news**, not just the bad news
    b) 1 Cor. 15:3-4
        (1) Jesus died for our sins and rose from the dead 3 days later, **according to the scriptures.**
3. Problem: Solution
    a) Problem- We are sinful, (Rom 3:23; Ecc. 7:20; Gal. 3:22; 1 John 1:8-10; Rom. 5:12; Rom. 6:23a) but God is Holy, which means he must judge sin righteously, and also he cannot be in the presence of sin (Habb. 1:13; Psalm 5:4-5; 11:4-7; 34:15-16; 1 Pet. 1:15-16)
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4. **When we are witnessing to someone, you will have to get a feel for the conversation. If you have time, take time. If you can tell they are ready to go, then ask if you can share what you wanted to when you asked them who Jesus is to them, and then hand them a tract. At the very least, try to leave them with a tract and ask them to read it and consider what it says. DO NOT BE AFRAID TO STEER CONVERSATIONS. People want to talk about these things and they will not think twice about sharing what they think with you, so do not be afraid to share with them.**

C. K-_____

1. At this point we are looking for any opportunity to follow up with the person we are talking to. Whether this includes asking for their phone number and if they would like to meet sometime to continue this conversation, or inviting them to church possibly and giving them the church's information. (Matt.13:4,19)
2. This point is too often missed even by faithful evangelists. This is very important to do!
3. What is our most important ministry as Christians?
    a) (DISCIPLESHIP) This point is where discipleship meets evangelism. The most fruit we have isn't going to be from leading hundreds to Christ, but from faithfulness to grow, reach out to, and disciple those who do come to Christ. (pastor Tom example). (Matt. 13:8- "some an hundredfold, some sixtyfold, some thirtyfold") This is how we can help make sure we are sowing seeds to the good ground and produce multiplied fruit!

II. With our evangelism training coming to an end, we are left with no excuses. We have seen evangelism in the Bible and how we can use multiple methods of witnessing to the lost world. Now we will have to answer to God tonight for what we have learned/heard. Do we care enough to do something about it? If we do, it will show in what we do, not what we say. (Luke 12:48)

III. QUESTIONS?

IV. PRAY

V. MOCK CONVERSATION WITH TREY

VI. VOLUNTEERS FOR MOCK CONVERSATION

VII. PARTNER UP

ARE YOU A GENIUS?

1. An electric train is moving north at 100mph, and a wind is blowing to the west at 10mph. Which way does the smoke blow?
2. Eskimos are very good hunters, but they never hunt Penguins. Why not?
3. What has a head and a tail, but no body?
4. How many times can you fold a piece of paper in half?
5. What starts with an “e” and ends with an “e”, but only has one letter in it?

ARE YOU A GENIUS?

1. **An electric train is moving north at 100mph, and a wind is blowing to the west at 10mph.**

   Which way does the smoke blow?

   a. **There is no smoke with an electric train**

2. **Eskimos are very good hunters, but they never hunt Penguins. Why not?**

   a. **Eskimos live in the North Pole, Penguins live in the South Pole**

3. **What has a head and a tail, but no body?**

   a. **A coin**

4. **How many times can you fold a piece of paper in half?**

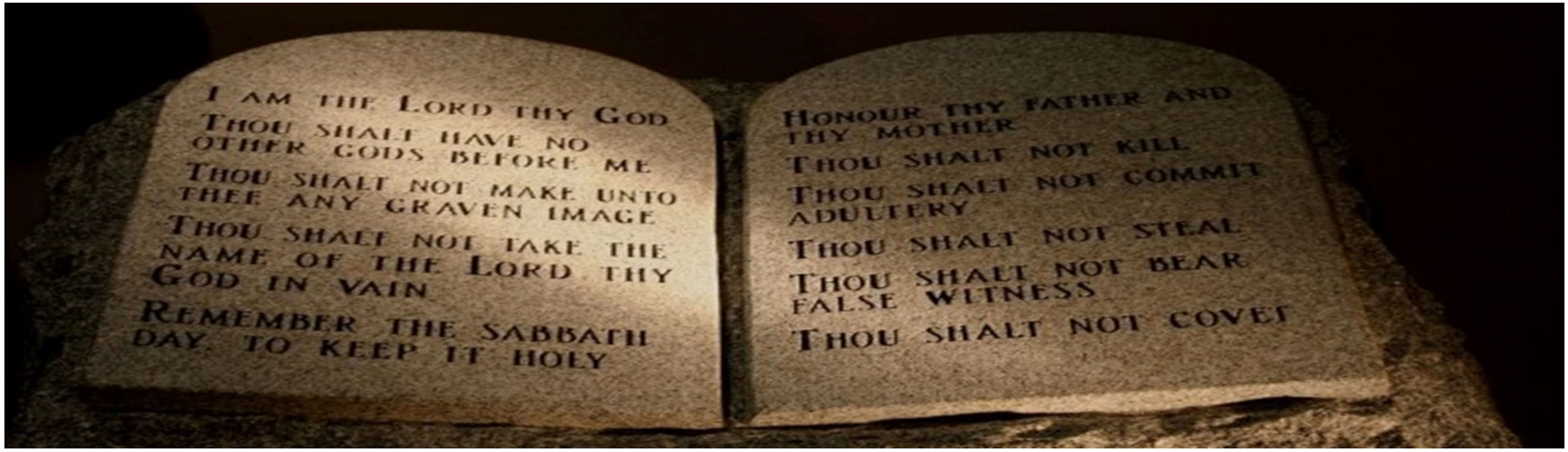
   a. **Once, because after that it would be folded in quarters, then eighths, etc.**

5. **What starts with an “e” and ends with an “e”, but only has one letter in it?**

   a. **An envelope**

I.Q. TEST

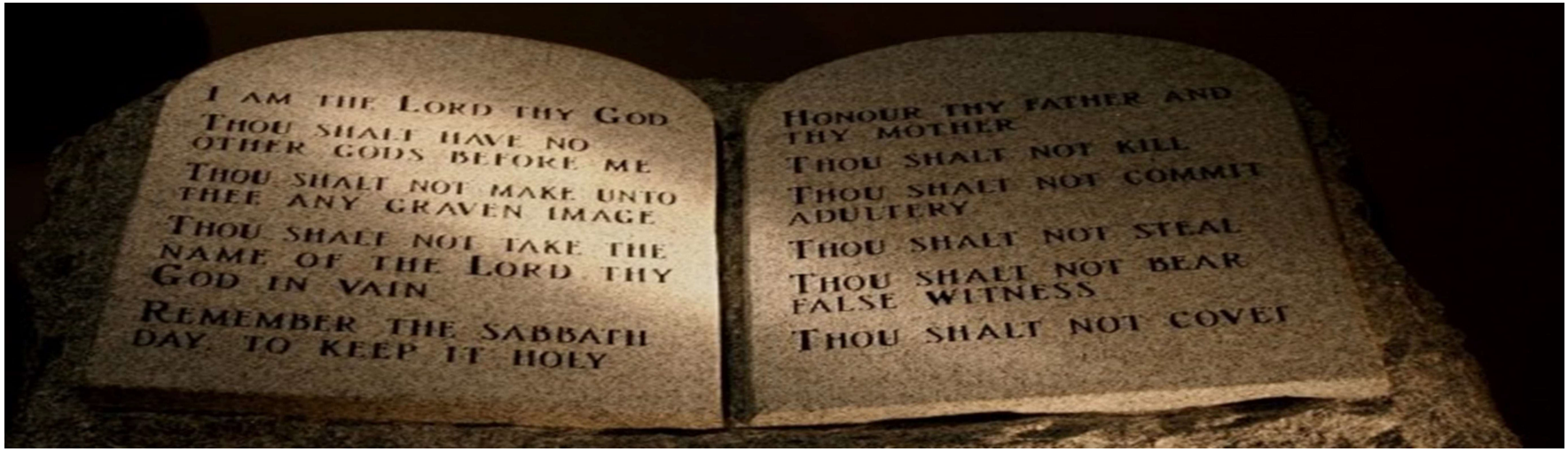
Read OUT LOUD each triangle.



GOOD TEST

Question: Do You Consider Yourself To Be A Good Person?

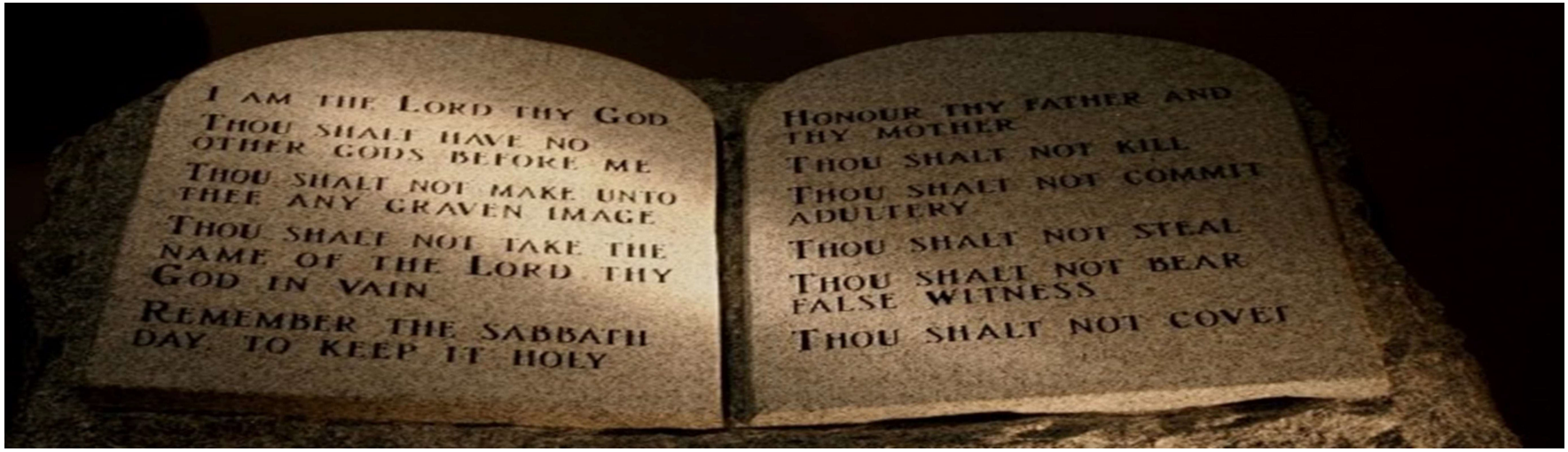
1. Have you ever told a LIE before?
2. Have you ever stolen anything before?
3. Have you ever hated someone before?
4. Have you ever taken the Lord's name in vain?
5. Have you ever looked at someone with lust?



GOOD TEST

Question: Do You Consider Yourself To Be A Good Person?

1. Have you ever told a LIE before? What does that make you? A LIAR
2. Have you ever stolen anything before? What does that make you? A THIEF
3. Have you ever hated someone before? God equates that with murder (1 Jn. 3:15)
4. Have you ever taken the Lord's name in vain? According to the Bible, that makes you a BLASPHEMER
5. Have you ever looked at someone with lust? Jesus says that is the same as committing adultery (Matt. 5:28)



GOOD TEST-KIDS

Question: Do You Consider Yourself To Be A Good Person?

1. Have you ever told a LIE before?
2. Have you ever stolen anything before?
3. Have you ever disobeyed/dishonored your parents?
4. Have you ever taken the Lord's name in vain?
5. Have you ever been jealous (coveted) of something someone else has that you don't?

TRANSITION POINT

"And so based on just 5 of the 10 Commandments that we've looked at from the Bible, you would be found guilty before a holy God on judgment day."

"Let me tell you what the Bible says about what you can do to be ready for this day."

THE GOSPEL

1 Corinthians 15:1-4- "***Moreover, brethren, I declare unto you the gospel*** *which I preached unto you, which also ye have received, and wherein ye stand; By which also ye are saved, if ye keep in memory what I preached unto you, unless ye have believed in vain. For I delivered unto you first of all that which I also received, how that* ***Christ died for our sins according to the scriptures****; And that* ***he was buried****, and that* ***he rose again the third day according to the scriptures****:"*

- There is a price to pay for your sin, and that price is death and eternal separation from God in Hell. The gospel (good news) is that Jesus paid that price FOR YOU through his death on the cross, his burial, and resurrection from the dead three days later. If you believe this and desire to receive Christ as your savior you can call out to God and ask him to save you. ↓

"Is that something you would want to do today?"

A good way to receive the gift of salvation is to use ABC:

Admit you are a sinner in need of God

Believe Jesus died and rose from the dead three days later to pay the price for your sin

Call out to God in prayer telling him you believe these things and ask him to save you

KEEP THE CONVERSATION GOING- FOLLOW UP

"Is this something you might want to talk about further with someone at some place like a coffee shop?

Hand them a form to fill out and ask them to give as much information as they are willing to. Reiterate to them that we WILL NOT hound them, we will just reach out to them about visiting our church or setting up a meeting to continue to talk about these things with them.

Some Key Gospel Verses

- Romans 3:23- "For all have sinned, and come short of the glory of God;"
- Romans 6:23- "For the wages of sin is death; but the gift of God is eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord."
- Romans 10:9, 13- "That if thou shalt confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and shalt believe in thine heart that God hath raised him from the dead, thou shalt be saved. For whosoever shall call upon the name of the Lord shall be saved."
- John 3:16- "For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life."
- Romans 5:8- "But God commendeth his love toward us, in that, while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us."
- Ephesians 2:8-9- "For by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God: Not of works, lest any man should boast."
- 2 Pet. 3:9- "The Lord is not slack concerning his promise, as some men count slackness; but is longsuffering to us-ward, not willing that any should perish, but that all should come to repentance."
- John 1:12-13- "But as many as received him, to them gave he power to become the sons of God, even to them that believe on his name: Which were born, not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man, but of God."

SINGLES Evangelism Training: ASK Method

05-15-2019

I. Last week we talked about how important and effective our personal testimony can be when we are trying to witness to the lost world. Today, we will expound upon how we can effectively evangelize to the lost world in a few very practical ways. However, no matter how much we learn about witnessing and even practice our witnessing, our best tool will be a sincere heart to see lost souls saved, and Jesus receiving the reward of his suffering for an undeserving world.

II. ASK method

- A- _____
    1. In order to most effectively minister to people, we should gather as much information about them as we can
    2. Asking questions is also good for provoking thought in people. Jesus often asked questions for this very reason. Realistically, Jesus never had to ask questions to learn more about people because he knew everything about them. Jesus asked questions so often because he was provoking thought into the hearts of the listeners. (**Matt. 16:13-16**; John 21:15-17; Matt. 21:24-27)
        a) Jesus was the question master! Asking questions can be our most effective tool when witnessing to the lost
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    1. This cannot be overstated. This is our **number one goal** when we are out witnessing. All these things we will go over are great tools when time allows for them, but sharing the gospel must be done at all costs! God will take care of the rest if we are faithful to do this! (Rom. 1:16; Phil.1:14-18; Psalm 40:9-10; 71:15-16; 119:46; Rom. 10:17; 1 Cor. 2:4; **9:16; Jer. 20:7-9)**
    2. What is the gospel?

a) The _____**,** not just the bad news

b) 1 Cor. 15:3-4

(1) Jesus died for our sins and rose from the dead 3 days later, **according to the scriptures.**

3. Problem: Solution

a) Problem- We are sinful, (Rom 3:23; Ecc. 7:20; Gal. 3:22; 1 John 1:8-10; Rom. 5:12; Rom. 6:23a) but God is Holy, which means he must judge sin righteously, and also he cannot be in the presence of sin (Habb. 1:13; Psalm 5:4-5; 11:4-7; 34:15-16; 1 Pet. 1:15-16)

b) Solution- God became a man in the form of Jesus Christ, and lived a perfect and holy life. Jesus lived for about 33 years and allowed his creation to crucify him on a cross so he could take the punishment for sin for all men. (John 3:16-19; Rom. 6:23; 10:9-10, 13; Eph. 2:8-9;

4. ABC

a) Admit your a sinner (Rom. 3:23)

b) Believe Jesus died on the cross for your sins, and then rose from the dead three days later defeating sin and death (John 3:16; Rom. 10:9-10)

c) Call out to God in prayer, admitting these things to him and asking him to save you (Rom. 10:9-10,13)

- K-_____

1. At this point we are looking for any opportunity to follow up with the person we are talking to. Whether this includes asking for their phone number and if they would like to meet sometime to continue this conversation, or inviting them to church possibly and giving them the church's information. (Matt.13:4,19)
2. This point is too often missed even by faithful evangelists. This is very important to do!
3. What is our most important ministry as Christians?

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(1) This point is where discipleship meets evangelism. The most fruit we have isn't going to be from leading hundreds to Christ, but from faithfulness to grow, reach out to, and

disciple those who do come to Christ. (pastor Tom example). (Matt. 13:8- “some an hundredfold, some sixtyfold, some thirtyfold”) This is how we can help make sure we are sowing seeds to the good ground and produce multiplied fruit!

III. With our evangelism training coming to an end, we are left with no excuses. We have seen evangelism in the Bible and how we can use multiple methods of witnessing to the lost world. Now we will have to answer to God tonight for what we have learned/heard. Do we care enough to do something about it? If we do, it will show in what we do, not what we say. (Luke 12:48)

IV. Do you care enough? Will you commit to doing what God has called you to do for him in evangelising the lost world? Do you care enough to do something about it?

_____

_____

_____

_____

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II. INTRO- Do we care? ----- Do we care enough to do something about it?------We will have to answer this to God personally tonight. Each of us will have to answer this to God.

III. ASK method

A. Our conversations are exactly that. Conversations; not presentations. Each person you meet will have a different opinion, even if they share the same denomination. Use where they are at to best minister to them.

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    a) Jesus was the question master! Asking questions can be our most effective tool when witnessing to the lost

C. S- _____

1. This cannot be overstated. This is our **number one goal** when we are out witnessing. All these things we will go over are great tools when time allows for them, but sharing the gospel must be done at all costs! God will take care of the rest if we are faithful to do this! (Rom. 1:16; Phil.1:14-18; Psalm 40:9-10; 71:15-16; 119:46; Rom. 10:17; 1 Cor. 2:4; **9:16; Jer. 20:7-9)**
2. What is the gospel?
    a) The _____ not just the bad news
    b) 1 Cor. 15:3-4
        (1) Jesus died for our sins and rose from the dead 3 days later, **according to the scriptures.**
3. Problem: Solution
    a) Problem- We are sinful, (Rom 3:23; Ecc. 7:20; Gal. 3:22; 1 John 1:8-10; Rom. 5:12; Rom. 6:23a) but God is Holy, which means he must judge sin righteously, and also he cannot be in the presence of sin (Habb. 1:13; Psalm 5:4-5; 11:4-7; 34:15-16; 1 Pet. 1:15-16)
    b) Solution- God became a man in the form of Jesus Christ, and lived a perfect and holy life. Jesus lived for about 33 years and allowed his creation to crucify him on a cross so he could take the punishment for sin for all men. (John 3:16-19; Rom. 6:23; 10:9-10, 13; Eph. 2:8-9;
4. ABC
    a) Admit your a sinner (Rom. 3:23)
    b) Believe Jesus died on the cross for your sins, and then rose from the dead three days later defeating sin and death (John 3:16; Rom. 10:9-10)
    c) Call out to God in prayer, admitting these things to him and asking him to save you (Rom. 10:9-10,13)
    d) When we are witnessing to someone, you will have to get a feel for the conversation. If you have time, take time. If you can tell they are ready to go, then ask if you can share what you wanted to when you asked them who Jesus is to them, and then hand them a tract. At the very least, try to leave them with a tract and ask them to read it and consider what it

says. DO NOT BE AFRAID TO STEER CONVERSATIONS. People want to talk about these things and they will not think twice about sharing what they think with you, so do not be afraid to share with them.

D. K-_____

1. At this point we are looking for any opportunity to follow up with the person we are talking to. Whether this includes asking for their phone number and if they would like to meet sometime to continue this conversation, or inviting them to church possibly and giving them the church's information. (Matt.13:4,19)
2. This point is too often missed even by faithful evangelists. This is very important to do!
3. What is our most important ministry as Christians?
    a) _____
        (1) This point is where discipleship meets evangelism. The most fruit we have isn't going to be from leading hundreds to Christ, but from faithfulness to grow, reach out to, and disciple those who do come to Christ. (pastor Tom example). (Matt. 13:8- "some an hundredfold, some sixtyfold, some thirtyfold") This is how we can help make sure we are sowing seeds to the good ground and produce multiplied fruit!

IV. With our evangelism training coming to an end, we are left with no excuses. We have seen evangelism in the Bible and how we can use multiple methods of witnessing to the lost world. Now we will have to answer to God tonight for what we have learned/heard. Do we care enough to do something about it? If we do, it will show in what we do, not what we say. (Luke 12:48)

V. Do you care enough? Will you commit to doing what God has called you to do for him in evangelising the lost world? Do you care enough to do something about it?

_____

_____

VI. **QUESTIONS?**

VII. **PRAY**

VIII. **MOCK CONVERSATION WITH TREY**

IX. **VOLUNTEERS FOR MOCK CONVERSATION**

X. **PARTNER UP**

M05 / MISSIONS AND TRAINING

Church Training Pathway

A click-through presentation showing a church training progression.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Training-pathway organization and presentation design.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

5 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

Church Training Pathway

Visual learning pathway designed to explain the church training sequence.

Full teaching files

NEWEST - church-training-pathway-finished-morph (click-through) *4 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

MILLHEIM BAPTIST CHURCH GROWTH & TRAINING PATHWAY

Follow the path from connection to ministry training.

1 MEMBERSHIP

Let's Get Acquainted Luncheon ⟶ Membership course
Connect with the church family

2 JOURNEY

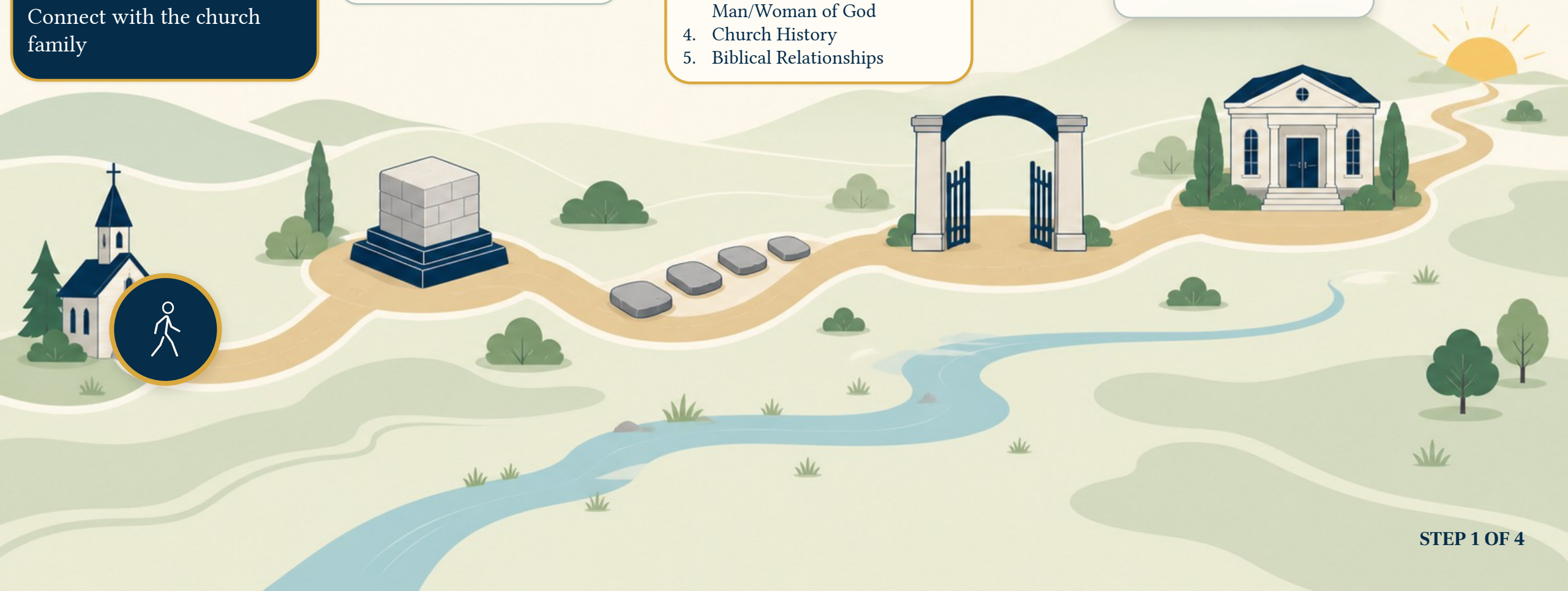
One-on-one discipleship
12–18 months

3 FIVE ELECTIVES

1. How To Study the Bible
2. Walking with God
3. Character Qualities of a Man/Woman of God
4. Church History
5. Biblical Relationships

4 BIBLE INSTITUTE

Four years
Bible + ministry training



MILLHEIM BAPTIST CHURCH
GROWTH & TRAINING PATHWAY

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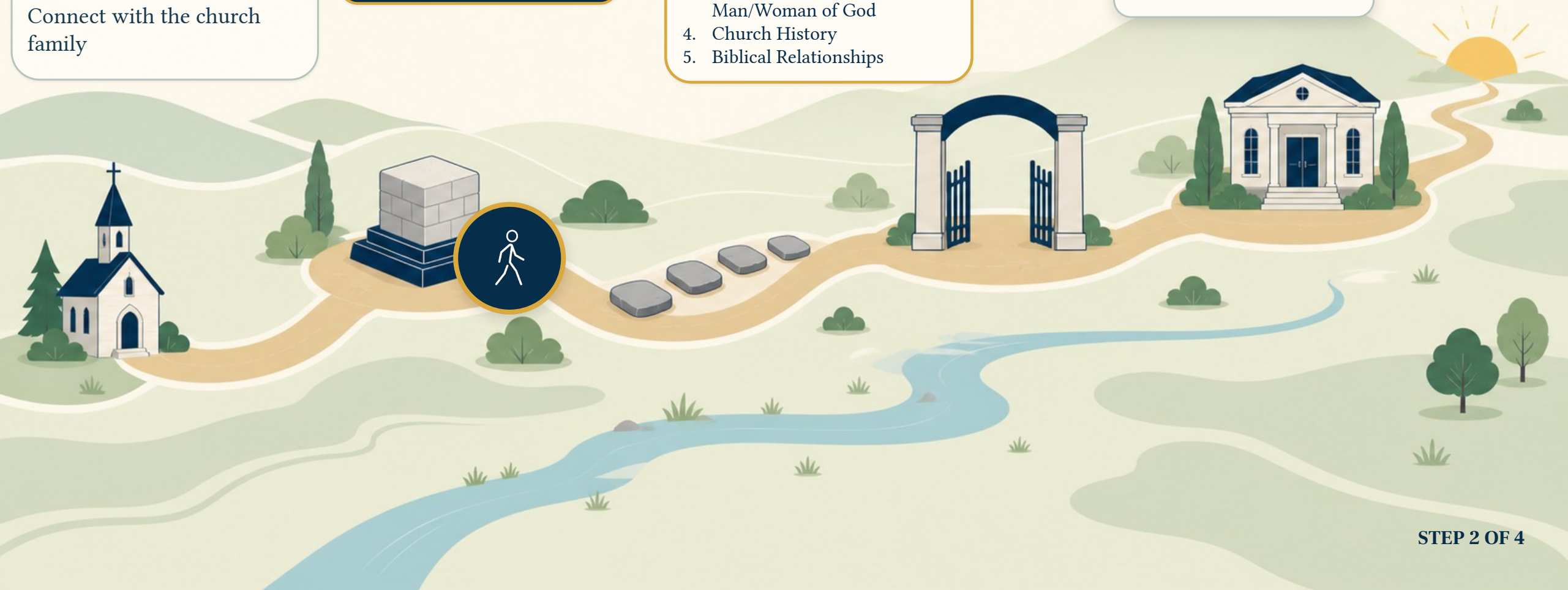

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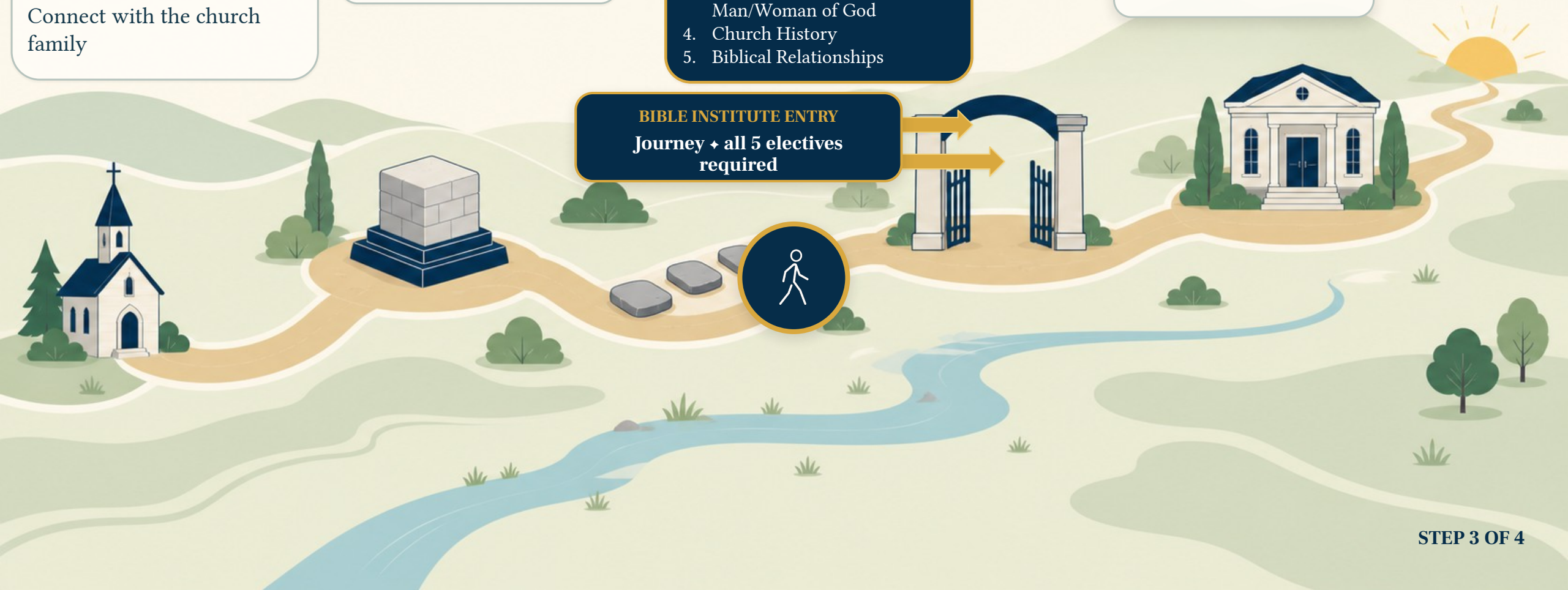
BIBLE INSTITUTE ENTRY
Journey + all 5 electives required

4 BIBLE INSTITUTE

Four years
Bible + ministry training



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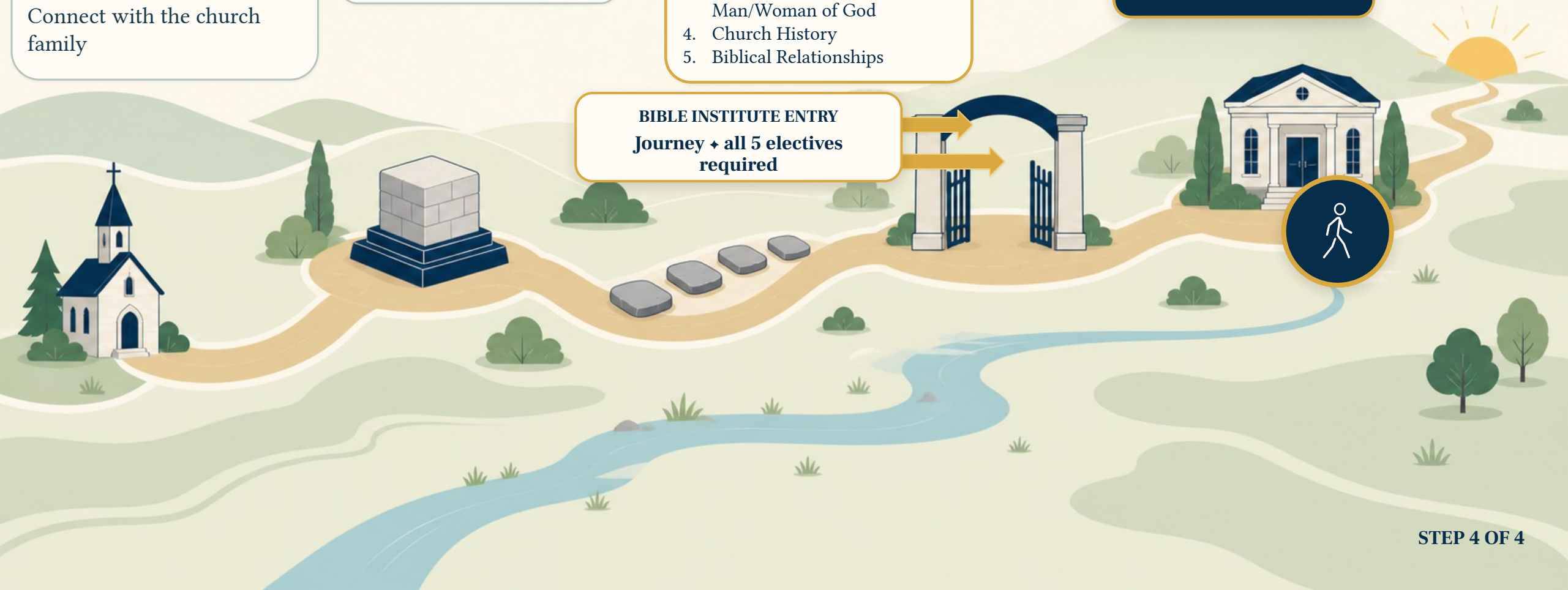

A01 / TEACHING AND DESIGN SAMPLES

Selected stand-alone Bible lessons

Stand-alone Bible lessons, children’s activities, worksheets, teacher notes, student resources, and presentations.

MY CONTRIBUTION

Original and adapted lesson preparation, with teacher and student resources and source credits retained. The JBI demonstration applies the established Seven Laws of the Teacher method.

INSIDE THIS SECTION

76 pages of teaching materials and review navigation.

View or download this collection online >

The source pages that follow retain their original pagination, wording and credits.

Selected stand-alone Bible lessons

Selected original and adapted Bible lessons, with teacher and student resources and source acknowledgments retained. The JBI demonstration applies the established Seven Laws of the Teacher method.

Full teaching files

abide in christ millheim- student	*1 pages*
abide in christ millheim- teacher	*2 pages*
ENCOUNTERING GOD STUDENT NEW	*1 pages*
encountering GOD TEACHER NEW	*3 pages*
Genesis 6 5 KIDS WS	*3 pages*
JBI Lesson for kids abridged 5-7 minutes; psalm 12 6-7	*3 pages*
JBI Lesson for kids Psalm 12 6-7	*3 pages*
KIDS CLASS EASTER 2ND GRADE 2021	*1 pages*
MISSIONS CONFERENCE KIDS CURRICULUM SAINT PATRICK	*13 pages*
STUDENT COPY ISSUES OF LIFE STUDY	*2 pages*
TEACHER COPY ISSUES OF LIFE STUDY	*2 pages*
student CLOSE TO CHRIST	*1 pages*
teacher CLOSE TO CHRIST	*4 pages*
student COPY FUNDAMENTALS OF THE FAITH (1)	*1 pages*
TEACHER COPY FUNDAMENTALS OF THE FAITH (1)	*2 pages*
God moves satan counters	*5 pages*
God moves satan counters student new	*2 pages*
JBI LAWS OF THE TEACHER LESSON (1)	*1 pages*
key of david student	*2 pages*
key of david teacher	*6 pages*
laodicea	*5 pages*
laodicea student	*1 pages*

Selected stand-alone Bible lessons continued

STUDENT prayer study	*1 pages*
TEACHER prayer study	*1 pages*
Proverbs 11 High School Devotional Lesson	*4 pages*
TEARS OF CHRIST student	*1 pages*
TEARS OF CHRIST teacher	*3 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

1. The Real Vine — vs. 1
    a. Vs. 1- Jesus is painting a picture of a vine and branches on the vine. There is much to learn from this relationship and our relationship to Christ (he made the vine and branches!)
    b. Jesus calls himself the "true vine" not just the vine (Prov. 16:25: John 14:6)
2. The Refining of the Branches — vss. 2–3
    a. There is a refining of fire (trouble, hurt, pain; **not Hell**) for branches who do not bear fruit (2a, 6) AND, there is a refining by the word of God for those who bear fruit (2b)
    b. If we allow God to purge our lives through his word, trials, persecution, etc.. we will bear more fruit (Eph. 5:26; Psa. 119:9-11; 1 Peter 1:6–7; James 1:2-4)
    c. We also see that, if we do not allow God to purge us, so that we can bring forth fruit, we will still endure hardship (Hebrews 12:6; Galatians 6:7–8; Proverbs 13:15; Jeremiah 2:19)
3. The Reliance of the Branches — vss. 4–5
    a. We are totally and completely reliant on Jesus Christ in our Christian lives
    b. There was nothing we could do to earn our salvation, and there is nothing we can do in our own power to bear fruit as his disicples
    c. True fruitfulness in our lives comes from our "abiding" in him. Our connection to him through prayer and the Word of God (**vs. 7, if his "words abide in us"**) (Psalm 127:1; 2 Corinthians 3:5; Psa. 1:1-3; 2 Cor. 12:9-10; 1 Cor. 1:25-29)
4. The Results of Abiding—or Not Abiding — vss. 6–8
    a. When We Abide
        i. God is glorified- This is our ultimate goal in life and the result of bearing fruit for God (vs. 8; Phili. 1:11; 1 Cor. 10:31; Isa. 43:7)
        ii. We Become Disciples- This is the result of bearing fruit, not a prerequisite to it. If you are not bearing fruit, you are not a disciple (vs. 8)
    b. When We Do Not Abide
        i. Our lives will "burn up" in the end as dead wood (vs. 6; 1 Cor. 3:11-15)
        ii. We show that we are not truly disciples (John 8:31)
        iii. God cannot be glorified in our lives- vs. 8

1. The Real Vine — vs. 1
    a. Vs. 1- Jesus is painting a picture of a vine and branches on the vine. There is much to learn from this relationship and our relationship to Christ (he made the vine and branches!)
        i. Romans 1:20- For the invisible things of him from the creation of the world are clearly seen, being understood by the things that are made, even his eternal power and Godhead; so that they are without excuse:
        ii. The Vine (Jesus)- Provides sap, water, nutrients, and gives life to the branches. The Vine is essential for the growth of the branches. Without the vine, the branches do not exist, and they have no life.
        iii. The Branches (Us/believers)- They exist to produce fruit and carry the fruit of the vine. They cannot of themselves produce fruit, YET if they are not allowing the nutrients of the vine to flow through them, if they are refusing to grow, they cannot bear/hold fruit.
            1. It is not about the ability of the branch to produce fruit, but its ability to allow the vine to grow it and allow the vine to use it to bear fruit
    b. Jesus calls himself the "true vine" not just the vine (Prov. 16:25: John 14:6)
        i. Right from the beginning he is reminding us that there are many "vines" out there. Things that we try to go to for our sustanance. What Jesus alone can provide us, we are looking for elsewhere.
        ii. This is an age old issue. Israel did this in the OT. When they served other gods, they did it because of what those gods promised to provide for them.
            1. Baal, the Canaanite god of storms, rain, and agriculture.
            2. Ashtoreth- The Promise of Fertility
                a. We do the same thing when we covet after and live for other things above God. We have to be careful. There is only one true vine.
2. The Refining of the Branches — vss. 2–3
    a. There is a refining of fire (trouble, hurt, pain; **not Hell**) for branches who do not bear fruit (2a, 6) AND, there is a refining by the word of God for those who bear fruit (2b)
    b. If we allow God to purge our lives through his word, trials, persecution, etc.. we will bear more fruit (Eph. 5:26; Psa. 119:9-11; 1 Peter 1:6–7; James 1:2-4)
        i. It is a process of pain. It is not comfortable. It includes submitting to what God says over what you want. It includes going through persecution. These are how God purges us
    c. We also see that, if we do not allow God to purge us, so that we can bring forth fruit, we will still endure hardship (Hebrews 12:6; Galatians 6:7–8; Proverbs 13:15; Jeremiah 2:19)
        i. Following God is hard. 2 Tim. 3:12 tell us that, "Yea, and all that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution." It is part of the Christian life, but God uses it for our good! To purge out sin and things that weigh us down and keep us from bearing fruit! AND NOT FOLLOWING GOD IS HARD. He equates the life of a believer who is not bearing fruit (disciples) to being taken away and cast into fire. Your life will be full of trouble BUT WITH NO DESIRED END. NO FRUIT. NO REWARD.
        ii. Choose the hardship you want. Be pruned now or be burned later.
3. The Reliance of the Branches — vss. 4–5
    a. We are totally and completely reliant on Jesus Christ in our Christian lives

b. There was nothing we could do to earn our salvation, and there is nothing we can do in our own power to bear fruit as his disicples

c. True fruitfulness in our lives comes from our "abiding" in him. Our connection to him through prayer and the Word of God (**vs. 7, if his "words abide in us"**) (Psalm 127:1; 2 Corinthians 3:5; Psa. 1:1-3; 2 Cor. 12:9-10; 1 Cor. 1:25-29)

i. We must understand that fruit will only come in our lives through abiding and trusting in God's power through us. The branch has no ability in itself, it simply allows the vine to work through it and bear fruit on it.

ii. What are we relying on to be fruitful? Our talents, our wisdom, our methods, etc.. IF SO, WE WILL NOT BE FRUITFUL.

iii. He commands us to abide. It is not a request. And He definitevely says that if we don't we can do NOTHING OUTSIDE of a growing, thriving, abiding relationship with him on a daily basis.

1. That is what **abiding** means. Not occasionally reading our Bible, praying only when we need something, or seeking Christ only during difficult times, but continually remaining close to Him through daily prayer, dependence, obedience, and the Word of God. Abiding is a consistent way of life.

2. CAN WE TRULY SAY WE ARE ABIDING IN HIM? If we see no fruit in our lives/ministries, then maybe we are not connected to the VINE in the way we ought to be. AND…

3. We must understand, there is no way to abide in Christ but through his word and prayer. This is our abiding. This is how the Spirit of God teaches us, moves us, empowers us, etc.. How well are we abiding?

4. The Results of Abiding—or Not Abiding — vss. 6–8

a. When We Abide

i. God is glorified- This is our ultimate goal in life and the result of bearing fruit for God (vs. 8; Phili. 1:11; 1 Cor. 10:31; Isa. 43:7)

ii. We Become Disciples- This is the result of bearing fruit, not a prerequisite to it. If you are not bearing fruit, you are not a disciple (vs. 8)

b. When We Do Not Abide

i. Our lives will "burn up" in the end as dead wood (vs. 6; 1 Cor. 3:11-15)

ii. We show that we are not truly disciples (John 8:31)

iii. God cannot be glorified in our lives- vs. 8

AN ENCOUNTER WITH GOD

1) With summer camp coming up next week, today we will examine a biblical response to encountering God. We will look at Paul on the road to Damascus and how God intersected his life at a time that Paul was not expecting. We will then see how Paul responded and how we ought to respond as we prepare for our lives to be _____ by God in the same way at camp next week.

2) **Acts 9:1-23**

   a) GETTING CAUGHT IN A _____ SITUATION (vs 1-4a)

      i) Paul is carrying letters that give him permission to seize and kill anyone who professes Christ

      ii) Are we carrying anything that would embarrass/frighten us if we encountered God at camp?

   b) GETTING CALLED OUT AND _____ DOWN (vs. 4b-5)

      i) Paul gets called out by name

      ii) Paul is told the severity of what he has done 2x

      iii) God says that Paul has been kicking against the pricks

         (1) What are you kicking against in your life? (Psalm 10:11-15; Prov. 1:24-30; 29:1)

   c) A BIBLICAL RESPONSE (vs. 6a)

      i) Fearfully and humbly respond "Lord, that wilt thou have me to do?" (Acts 2:37; 16:28-30; Isa. 6:8)

         (1) Notice the godly fear and humility that is accompanied with an encounter with God. You MUST respond this way to God when he shows up. If not, there are consequences. (Luke 20:17-18)

   d) WAITING AND _____ (vs. 6b-12)

      i) In verses 11-12 we see exactly what Paul did. He took a step of faith and went to Damascus like he was told and he PRAYED waiting for God to show him what to do. (he likely didn't know how to/wasn't sure of how to pray, everything he believed before he now is shown was not true) (Lam. 3:25; Psalm 27:14; Col. 4:2)

   e) UNUSUAL PEOPLE/CIRCUMSTANCES (vs. 10-19)

      i) God uses Ananias to lead Paul to salvation and tell him what he is supposed to do. This is the only account we have on this disciple in the Bible.

   f) POWERFUL TRANSFORMATION MET WITH PERSECUTION (vs. 20-23)

      i) Just a few days after he was traveling to Damascus and seize and kill Christians, he was now preaching Christ to people in such a way that amazed and confounded the hearers!

      ii) Just as quickly as Paul changed, so came with it sever persecution (2 Tim. 3:12)

3) As we have seen today, having an encounter with God is very serious business. We cannot take it lightly. As we approach summer camp, I am confident that all of us will encounter God in some way as we here from the word of God daily and are secluded from our usual distractions. No doubt we need to be preparing so that we are not caught off guard and so we can respond to God and what he wants us to do. Our preparedness and response can be what changes our lives _____, from this camp moving forward.

AN ENCOUNTER WITH GOD

1) With summer camp coming up next week, today we will examine a biblical response to encountering God. We will look at Paul on the road to Damascus and how God intersected his life at a time that Paul was not expecting. We will then see how Paul responded and how we ought to respond as we prepare for our lives to be **intersected** by God in the same way at camp next week.

2) **Acts 9:1-23**

   a) GETTING CAUGHT IN A BAD SITUATION (vs 1-4a)

      i) Paul is carrying letters that give him permission to seize and kill anyone who professes Christ

         (1) Imagine God showing up in front of you, and you have all of these papers you are carrying that say that you are allowed to kill anyone who professes Jesus Christ

         (2) This light was so bright that it caused Paul to fall to the ground and be temporarily blinded

         (3) No doubt these papers would have fallen to the ground also and would have been all over the place

         (4) Imagine the fear in Paul's heart. Just a few moments prior, he was so confident that Jesus was a heretic and dead that he was confident to kill anyone who followed him, and now to realize in a moment that you were wrong this whole time and the guy you were persecuting against is alive and he is God!

      ii) Are we carrying anything that would embarrass/frighten us if we encountered God at camp?

         (1) Are you involved in sin?

         (2) Are you not obeying something God is telling you to do?

         (3) Are you involved in friendships you ought not to be?

         (4) What baggage are you carrying that will embarrass and even scare you when God shows up at camp?

            (a) God will speak to you at camp. You don't want to be in a situation where you are going to encounter God and be completely caught off guard because you weren't ready and because you didn't truly believe that God was going to speak to you and require of you what he has been calling you to do (get out of sin, read/pray more consistently, break up with significant other, quit sport/show/theater/etc.. that has been taking all of your time, etc..)

   b) GETTING CALLED OUT AND KNOCKED DOWN (vs. 4b-5)

      i) Paul gets called out by name

         (1) Don't make the mistake of thinking that God will not be speaking to you individually with what you have been dealing with

         (2) Don't focus on what God is saying to your friends, guests, bf/ gf, etc.. Focus on what God is saying to you! Unless you are perfect going into camp, God has something to say to you specifically

      ii) Paul is told the severity of what he has done 2x

         (1) What Paul may have thought was innocent (he didn't think he was persecuting Jesus personally and he did not believe in Jesus as Lord) was NOT and when he was called out by Jesus here, Jesus calls him out (he says the Paul persecuted HIM twice)

(2) Don't make the mistake of thinking that what you are doing is no big deal. God will call you out personally and he will call you out based on his standards, not yours!

(3) If God has to stop you in the middle of your journey, you think you are just going to camp for fun and games and friends, but God will BREAK YOU and BLIND YOU and KNOCK YOU DOWN at camp AND HE WILL CALL YOU OUT on your sin and disobedience to him. This is not a good feeling and you don't have to endure this if you simply correct course now.

iii) God says that Paul has been kicking against the pricks

(a) He is saying that Paul was purposely and knowingly kicking against belief in him (Jesus) even at his own expense (pain)

(b) This is what we do. We come to church week after week and discipleship meeting after meeting and we hear from God and we are told to make changes and then we continue on and don't change anything. This causes us internal pain as we know what we are supposed to do and we know we aren't doing it. If we won't obey, Jesus will call us out on it and it will not be pleasant!

(2) What are you kicking against in your life? (Psalm 10:11-15; Prov. 1:24-30; 29:1)

(a) What has God been calling you to do that you have been putting off?

(b) What do you know you are supposed to do that you have been refusing to simply obey and do?

c) A BIBLICAL RESPONSE (vs. 6a)

i) Fearfully and humbly respond "Lord, that wilt thou have me to do?" (Acts 2:37; 16:28-30; Isa. 6:8)

(1) Notice the godly fear and humility that is accompanied with an encounter with God. You MUST respond this way to God when he shows up. If not, there are consequences. (Luke 20:17-18)

d) WAITING AND PRAYING (vs. 6b-12)

i) In verses 11-12 we see exactly what Paul did. He took a step of faith and went to Damascus like he was told and he PRAYED waiting for God to show him what to do. (he likely didn't know how to/wasn't sure of how to pray, everything he believed before he now is shown was not true) (Lam. 3:25; Psalm 27:14; Col. 4:2)

ii) God is standing right in front of Paul in person, you would think this would be a perfect time for God to tell him what he is supposed to do, but God says to go to Damascus (continue the way you were going) and then it will be told you what to do

e) UNUSUAL PEOPLE/CIRCUMSTANCES (vs. 10-19)

i) God uses Ananias to lead Paul to salvation and tell him what he is supposed to do. This is the only account we have on this disciple in the Bible.

(1) Other than being in the right place at the right time, it seems like he is not an overly significant disciple at this time. God uses him because he was in the right path of where Paul was going.

(2) Be ready for God to use unusual or just different people than you are used to, to reach you and speak to you at camp

f) POWERFUL TRANSFORMATION MET WITH PERSECUTION (vs. 20-23)

i) Just a few days after he was traveling to Damascus and seize and kill Christians, he was now preaching Christ to people in such a way that amazed and confounded the hearers!

(1) Do not undersell what God can do with you in just a few days! You can go into camp as far away from God as possible and leave camp on fire for the Lord and amazing those back home!

(2) Do not undersell what an encounter with GOD can do to you! He did it to me at camp in 2016!

ii) Just as quickly as Paul changed, so came with it sever persecution (2 Tim. 3:12)

(1) Do not be fooled into thinking that you won't be met with all sorts of persecution when you get home and God has changed you completely!

(2) Do not be surprised by where it comes from. It comes from those closest to you! (vs. 23- The Jews, among whom he was chiefest just a few days prior, now are seeking to kill him. Those CLOSEST to you will be those who bring the most persecution to the new you. It is not because they are evil, but because the enemy that is using them is evil!

3) As we have seen today, having an encounter with God is very serious business. We cannot take it lightly. As we approach summer camp, I am confident that all of us will encounter God in some way as we here from the word of God daily and are secluded from our usual distractions. No doubt we need to be preparing so that we are not caught off guard and so we can respond to God and what he wants us to do. Our preparedness and response can be what changes our lives **forever**, from this camp moving forward.

Hebrews 11:1,6

Practice 1

Now faith is the _____ of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen. But without _____ it is impossible to please him: for he that _____ to God must _____that he is, and that he is a _____ of them that _____ seek him.

Word Bank:

substance

faith

Believe

cometh

Diligently

Rewarder

Practice 2

Practice 2

Now _____ is the _____ of things hoped for, the _____ of things not seen. But without _____ it is _____ to please him: for he that _____ to God must _____that he is, and that he is a _____ of them that _____

Word Bank:

substance

Faith

faith

Cometh

evidence

believe

rewarder

Diligently

impossible

THEME: God's word is perfect and we can FULLY trust it. Therefore, we should obey it!

I. Today we will be looking at two verses out of Psalm chapter 12. These verses are absolutely important to us in our everyday lives, and understanding them is key to walking closely with God everyday. By understanding these verses we can; fully trust in the Bible as our guide for our lives, find comfort in time of need, and find answers to many questions we have in life and that we will have throughout our lives.

   A. Our verses are in Psalm chapter 12, verses 6 and 7

II. ***"The words of the Lord are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times. Thou shalt keep them, O Lord, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever."***

   A. First it is important to mention that when this says "the words of the Lord" it is talking about the Bible. The Bible is God's Word to us, it is how he talks with us.

   B. What does the word pure mean?

      1. Pure- "unmixed, incorrupt, without spot, not dirtied; perfect; or to be clear"
      2. **HOOK-** Now to demonstrate what the word pure means I brought 2 cups of water and this cup of dirt from my yard
         a) Water cup 1 is the word of God
         b) Water cup 2 is the word of God
         c) The dirt represents the ways that the devil tries to attack the word of God and dirty it up. Subtracting to it, adding to it, and changing what it says wherever he can.
         d) Add dirt to the second cup
         e) Now is this a cup of water? NO! It has water, but it also contains dirt. What we would call this now is MUD!! Not water. This (glass 1) is clean, fresh, and PURE water!

f) In this same way, when the word of God is changed, added to, or subtracted from, it may contain the words of God some places, but it is not the word of God. And you definitely wouldn't want to drink it!

C. "As silver tried in a furnace of earth"

1. Here, God compares his word to silver. God is comparing his Word to something that is beautiful and of very high value!

D. "Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever."

1. God not only says his Word is pure, but he promises to keep and preserve it forever!
2. **PRESERVE**- To keep from destruction, or from corruption. To keep PURE, from decay.
3. Think of something you had that was very special to you. Maybe a really nice toy or game or present that you got. Think of how well you took care of it. Did you let it out of your sight? Did you know where it was at all times? Would you let it be broken or lost if you could help it at all? Absolutely NOT!
    a) God has taken care to keep and to preserve his pure word from being corrupted. This means that the pure word of God exists out there somewhere! This is the Bible we have today, the King James Bible.
    b) THIS IS THE KEY: We can know that the Bible we hold is the word of God, and that God is speaking to us directly from it. We can trust every single word in it! Knowing this, we should obey what it tells us to do, and we should treat it as a great gift, something of high value, like silver!

E. What do we do now?

1. We know that our Bible is the perfect and pure word of God. We know all the trouble God went through in order to keep and preserve it for us, and how important it is to him that we have it. So

we MUST BELIEVE AND OBEY EVERY WORD IT SAYS. Read the bible with full confidence God is speaking to you through it, and obey what it says. We should be excited to know we hold the pure word of God in our hands and that God is trying to speak to us through it. So read it daily, and obey what it says to do!

2. Also, thank God for all he has done to keep his word for us to have today. We should be thankful for this everyday!

THEME: God's word is perfect and we can FULLY trust it. Therefore, we should obey it!

I. Today we will be looking at two verses out of Psalm chapter 12. These verses are absolutely important to us in our everyday lives, and understanding them is key to walking closely with God everyday. By understanding these verses we can; fully trust in the Bible as our guide for our lives, find comfort in time of need, and find answers to many questions we have in life and that we will have throughout our lives.

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II. "The words of the Lord are pure words"

A. First it is important to mention that when this says "the words of the Lord" it is talking about the Bible. The Bible is God's Word to us, it is how he talks with us.

B. What does the word pure mean?

1. Pure- "perfect, clean, flawless (no flaws in it)"
2. **HOOK-** Now to demonstrate what the word pure means I brought 2 cups of water and this cup of dirt from my yard
    a) Water cup 1 is the word of God
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    c) The dirt represents the ways that the devil tries to attack the word of God and dirty it up. Subtracting to it, adding to it, and changing what it says wherever he can.
    d) Now is this a cup of water? NO! It has water, but it also contains dirt. What we would call this now is MUD!! Not water. This (glass 1) is clean, fresh, and PURE water!

e) In this same way, when the word of God is changed, added to, or subtracted from, it may contain the words of God some places, but it is not the word of God. And you definitely wouldn't want to drink it!

III. "As silver tried in a furnace of earth"

A. Here, God compares his word to silver. Silver is a very precious and valuable metal that forms inside of the earth at very high temperatures.

B. The Bible is very precious to God, it is of very high value to him. So it should be to us as well!!!

IV. "Thou shalt keep them, O Lord, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever."

A. **KEEP-** To have in your possession in order to secure; to not lose or part with"

B. **PRESERVE**- To keep from destruction, or from corruption. To keep PURE, from decay.

C. Think of something you had that was very special to you. Maybe a really nice toy or game or present that you got. Think of how well you took care of it. Did you let it out of your sight? Did you know where it was at all times? Would you let it be broken or lost if you could help it at all?

D. GOD HIMSELF has taken the responsibility to take care of his word. He says here that he will keep them, he will protect them and keep them secure himself! And that he will preserve it, he will keep it from harm, for ever! The Bible is in good hands!

V. What do we do now?

A. We know that our Bible is the perfect and pure word of God. We know all the trouble God went through in order to keep and preserve it for us, and how important it is to him that we have it. So we MUST BELIEVE AND OBEY EVERY WORD IT SAYS. Read the bible with full confidence God is speaking to you through it, and obey what it says. We should be excited to know we hold the pure word of God in our hands and that God is trying to speak to us through it. So read it daily, and obey what it says to do!

B. Also, thank God for all he has done to keep his word for us to have today. We should be thankful for this everyday! Because God not only kept the bible pure, but he promised to preserve it, so that we could always have access to it and be able to hear from and walk with him.

KIDS CLASS EASTER 2ND GRADE 2021

1. Hand out class material (word symbol fill in)
2. Get apple tv hooked up and ready to use with video
3. Kids to music
4. Snack
    a. Pray
    b. Eat
    c. WATCH VIDEO AND EXPLAIN
5. LESSON PART 1 (no PPT yet)
    a. Jesus death (ask about good friday)
        i. Luke 23:32-48
6. LESSON PART 2 (pull up PPT)
    a. Jesus Resurrection
        i. Matt. 27:62- 28:10
7. GIVE THE GOSPEL AND EXPLAIN WHY THIS WAS ALL SO IMPORTANT (JESUS DEATH AND RESURRECTION)

MISSIONS CONFERENCE: SAINT PATRICK

LESSON THEME: ***"ANSWERING THE CALL OF GOD TO THE MISSION FIELD"***

I. HOOK:

A. Begin the lesson by giving the kids a brief overview of what will be taking place today. Something along the lines of **"In class today, we will be taking a look at a very famous missionary in history, his name is Patricius (Patrick), or as many of you may know him, Saint Patrick. (ask how many of the kids have heard of saint patrick)."**

B. From here you may also want to explain to the kids that there is a lot of confusion about who Patrick was, and there are many lies out there about who he was. Explain that Patrick wasn't really a saint in the way that the world and the Catholic Church try to say, but that he was a saint in the way the Bible explains because the Bible calls anybody who is saved and has been born again by the blood of Jesus a saint. Patrick was a true born again believer and missionary.

C. From here it may be a good idea to share with the kids the key verses we will be sticking to for this lesson. Read them to the kids, and tell them to think on the verses as they watch the life of Patrick on the video.

   1. **Acts 1:8; Matt. 28:19-20; ***Acts 16:9-12*****

D. Say something along the lines of “**Before we begin our lesson, let's first watch a quick video that will tell us a lot about Saint Patrick.”**

E. Accessing the video

1. Video URL

a) https://youtu.be/A6ZbN1R7Bos

2. OR type--- Saint Patrick explainED---- this should be the first video to come up, it is on Youtube, and it is 5:16 long. If this fails, typing the URL in exactly should work 100% of the time. But if all fails, I can share the link with whoever needs it. Just reach out to me and I can send it to you.

II. BOOK

A. **STUDY FOR THE TEACHER:** As a teacher, you will first want to come to class prepared knowing much of the story of Saint Patrick. Even the video we are showing to the class, while it does not have very much of a Catholic tint, it still does have some of one. However, then again, so did the life of Patrick because of where and when he grew up. Consider the following from the video:

1. Patrick had no access to the word of God fully as we do, this was only a few hundred years after Christ. With a pure heart, young, unlearned, and repentant, he had dreams to go and obey the command of God, which he otherwise had never heard. He never had dreams that told him contrary to the word of God.

2. He was called a bishop in Ireland. Not a priest or monk as many were at the time. He was a bishop, which is biblically a PASTOR!
3. The video calls out specifically that he was a church planter, NOT a church builder or some catholic held position not doing the work of the Lord.
4. He never in his writing mentions Holy mother Mary or baptism for salvation. He does specifically give credit to and call our that salvation is from the death, burial, and resurrection of Christ solely.
5. Although it is pointed out that his parents were “religious” it does not say that his conversion was that of repenting and realizing his parents were right all along, though he denied when he was young. He converted and repented and prayed to God for salvation, and he was a true born again believer!

B. FOR THE KIDS

1. Retell in a short manner the story of Patrick, explaining along the way whatever you feel needs explained to tell the kids what a true born again believer, missionary, church planting man Patrick was.
    a) Patrick was born in a place called Brittania in the United Kingdom. He was born into a “religious” family, his parents were clergy people in their churches (official church leaders). When he was very young, he was out working one day when Invaders from Ireland came and took him and many others to be slaves in Ireland. While he was in Ireland serving as a

shepherd he was very lonely. Many times Patrick did not have enough food or water to eat and drink, he was very cold, and did not have many clothes to wear. While he was working in the field as a shepherd he would pray many times a day, it took him being in these terrible situations to realize that there was a God and he knew he had rejected him for too long and it was time for him to get right. During this time Patrick prayed and repented of who he was and his sin, and believed in Jesus Christ for salvation. After this, one night Patrick had a dream where God was telling him there was a ship waiting for him about 200 miles away and that he should take it and flee back to his home. Patrick woke up and made the 200-mile journey to the shore and got on the boat that was waiting for him, and although they didn't want to let him on at first he was eventually allowed to board the ship and go. When Patrick returned home he eventually found and reunited with his family. After a while Patrick had another dream of somebody he knew from Ireland who was holding a stack of letters. On one of the letters Patrick read, “THE VOICE OF THE IRISH, WE APPEAL TO YOU, YOUNG HOLY BOY, TO COME AND WALK AMONG US”. This moment was the time that Patrick first felt the call to going to the mission field. He had a heart for the people of Ireland, the very people who took him captive

as a young 16 year old boy. After years of training in Bible School, Patrick finally made the voyage back to Ireland and became a missionary. The culture was full of idols, uncleanness, and ungodliness, but by the time Patrick died, the country had seen churches planted and many people leave their idols and ungodliness and repent and believe in Jesus Christ for salvation. (***THIS PART NEEDS TO BE SAID, AS IT WILL RELATE TO THE CRAFT FOR THIS LESSON**) *We all know that Saint Patrick's we relate to the color green, the Irish, and clovers. Why is this? This was actually because of a very creative thing Patrick did to share the gospel with people. Patrick would use 3 leaf plants which are found all over Ireland, in order to explain to people the Trinity. God is 3 parts and yet still 1 God. The Father, the Son, and the Holy Ghost. This is where the tradition of wearing green and clovers all over the place on Saint Patrick's Day originated from. This may even be a great opportunity to share the gospel with others on Saint Patrick's day, explaining the history of the clover on the holiday to other people, and then using it to share the gospel with them.*

2. Take the kids to **Acts 16:9-12** again and read the story of Paul and his dream of the people of Macedonia calling for him to come to them. This story is very similar to the story of Patrick, they both

answered the call and we need to answer the call God had made to us.

III. LOOK

A. Here as teachers You're going to want to now bring the call to the mission field home for the students. If Patrick and Paul are are examples of people who answered the call to the mission field, then the students need to hear that same call in order to answer it.

B. Going back to our key passages

1. **Acts 1:8-** "**8** But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me both in Jerusalem, and in all Judaea, and in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part of the earth."
2. **Matt. 28:19-20-** "Go ye therefore, and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost: **20** Teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you: and, lo, I am with you always, even unto the end of the world. Amen.
    a) Explain to the kids that in these passages we are told to go to all the world, preach the gospel, and make disciples. And all the while God is going to be with us!
    b) Because the Bible is God's word, when we read these commands to go, we can immediately apply these to

ourselves, God is calling YOU to GO, just like he did Patrick and Paul!

IV. TOOK

A. Here we need to really hit home with the students that they need to be in prayer and God's word to hear his direction on where, when, and to whom God is calling them to go to.
    1. Where is God calling you to? Where are there places with a lot of people that God has put in your life that you can reach?
    2. Who has God called you to? When you think of someone who you're close to, who comes to mind right now that you know you need to share Jesus with?
B. THIS IS YOUR MISSION FIELD, AND YOU HAVE BEEN CALLED TO IT
    1. Will you answer the call to the mission field God has given you, and called you to go to?
    2. You can be creative about it, just like Patrick. You can even use clovers to explain the trinity to people, or to explain the ABC's of salvation
C. What can you do THIS WEEK, to immediately answer this call?

V. LESSON CRAFT- Three Leaf Clover Gospel

A. Materials you will need
    1. 3 green heart cutouts
    2. 1 rectangle piece for stem

3. Admit, Believe, Call print outs (for older kids they can write out the ABCs on their clover leaves)
4. Brass fastener

B. How to assemble

1. Cut out three green hearts, template provided, and one rectangle stem
2. Line up all pieces in clover shape and fasten with brass fastener
3. Cut out Admit, Believe, Call statements and attach each one to a different clover leaf. Older kids can write out Admit, Believe, Call on each leaf and write what each step means!

VI. POTENTIAL LESSON REVIEW GAME

A. Lesson review jeopardy

1. For this game you can split into two teams. Boys vs. girls is easy to do, but you can split however you want. From here your going to want to draw the jeopardy board on the board, and make the number categories.

a)

2. Once you have the board drawn, consider explaining to the kids how the game works. In case anyone reading does not know, the basic idea is you pick a category and a wager. The amount you pick you will win if you get correct, and lose if you are wrong. The higher the wager the harder the question. Once a category is picked and a wager, cross it off. You play until all squares have been used. If for some reason there is a tie, or a close match. You may feel free to do a final question where the teams can decide to wager as much or as little as they would like, up to the amount of points the team has. After the question is answered, again, you may win or lose the points wagered, depending on if you gave the correct answer or not.

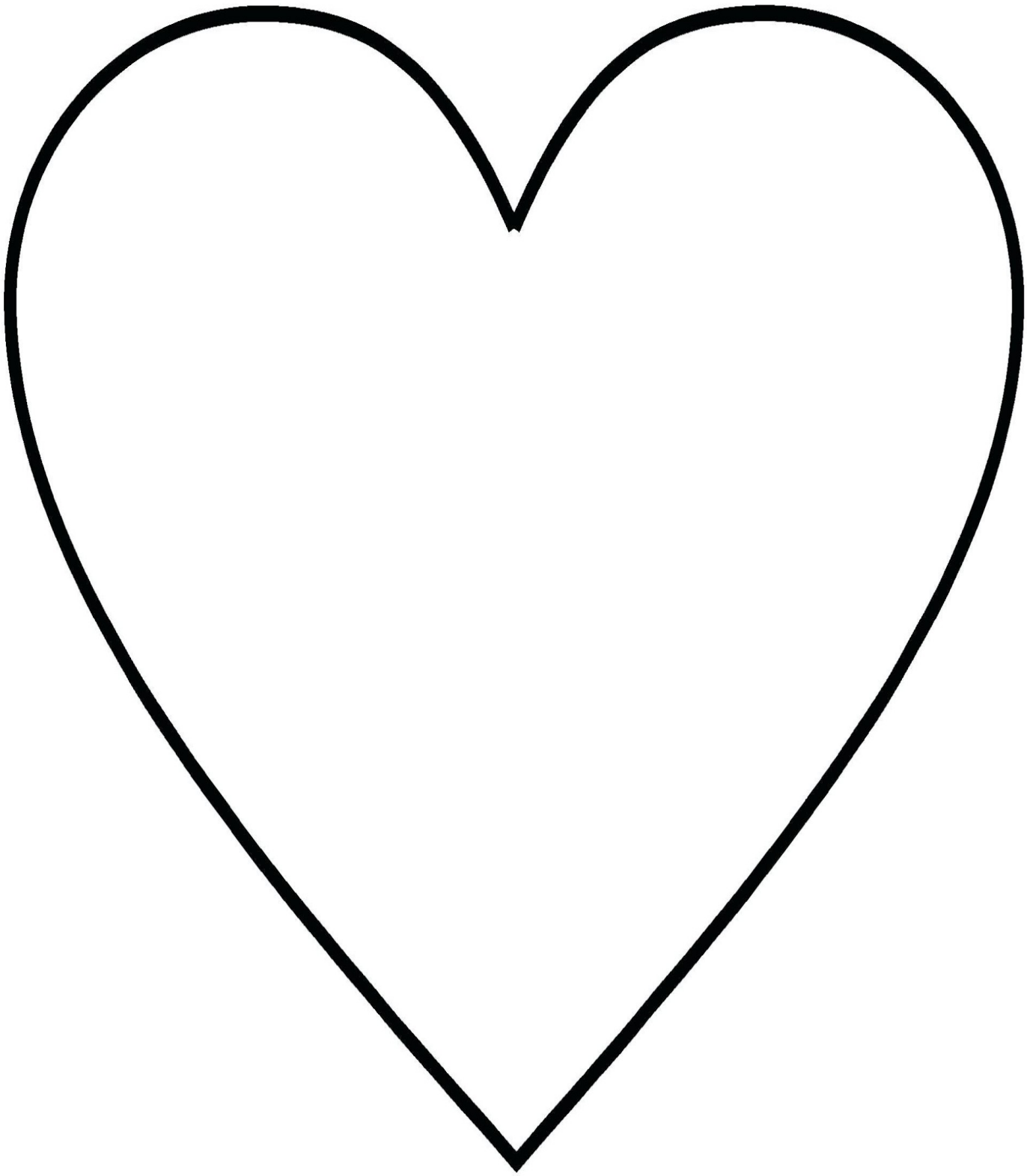
3. I play this game with 1st and 2nd grade often. They get the idea of the game, and it is their favorite game to play!

B. Potential jeopardy categories

1. The life of Patrick
2. Finish the verse (fill in the missing word in the verse)
3. Random facts about Patrick
4. The ministry of Patrick

C. Potential jeopardy questions

1. Where was Patrick born
2. About when was patrick born
3. What were Patrick's parents? Their jobs?
4. How old was Patrick when he was kidnapped?
5. Who was Patrick captured and enslaved by?
6. What county was Patrick taken to, to be a slave?
7. How many dreams did Patrick claim to have from God?
8. What did Patrick do special with clovers?
9. What did our story tell us Patrick planted all across Ireland?
10. What job did Patrick have when he was first enslaved?
11. Where was Patrick when he first had a dream from God?
12. What age/when did Patrick get saved?
13. Why did Patrick go back to Ireland after getting back home to the UK?
14. ETC….



ADMIT

You are a sinner

BELIEVE

That Jesus died on the

Cross and rose again

CALL

Out to God and ask

Him to save you

Teacher: Luke Johnston
Wed PM (11/30/22)

I. The issues of depression and anxiety are becoming more and more prevalent today than they have ever been. With the increase in the world of materialism, pride, selfishness, bad news, tragedy, mistrust, etc… it can easily become overwhelming even for Christians. The good news is that the word of God speaks expressly on this _____ of life. God has given us very clear signs in his word as to how depression can happen, how to avoid it, and how to deal with it when it inevitably comes to us. Today we will examine exactly what God has to say on this issue and how to handle it.

II. What is Depression/Anxiety?

A. **Depression/Anxiety** according to Websters 1828

1. The act of pressing down; or the state of being pressed down; a low state.
2. The act of humbling; abasement; as the depression of pride; the depression of the nobility.
3. A sinking of the spirits; dejection; a state of sadness; want of courage or animation; as depression of the mind.
4. In medical language, uneasiness; unceasing restlessness in sickness.

B. **Depression/Anxiety according to the Bible**

1. Proverbs 12:25- Heaviness in the heart of man maketh it **stoop**: but a good word maketh it glad.
2. Psalm 38:6- I am troubled; I am **bowed down** greatly; I go **mourning** all the day long.
3. Psalm 42:11- Why art thou **cast down**, O my soul? and why art thou **disquieted** within me? hope thou in God: for I shall yet praise him, who is the health of my countenance, and my God.

III. What can cause Depression/Anxiety according to the _____?

A. Sin/Pride- Psalm 38:1-10; Luke 14:11; Isa. 14:12-20

B. Investing wholly in wordly, temporary, vain things- Ecc. 1:16-18; Matt. 16:26

C. Hard times/circumstances- 1 Sam. 1:7,10; Job 3:11; 1 Kings 19:4

IV. How do we deal with Depression/Anxiety according to the Bible?

A. Cast all our cares to our Lord in prayer

1. Phil 4:6-7 ;1 Pet. 5:7; Psalm 55:22; 1 Sam. 1:11; 1 Kings 19:5-8,12,18; **Matt. 26:38-39**

B. Fasting

1. 1 Sam. 1:8; 2 Sam. 12:15-16; Matt. 17:21

C. Faithfully search the scriptures and obey what God is telling you to do

1. Prov. 16:3; Matt. 11:28-30

V. Should I take _____ for my Depression/Anxiety?

A. We have looked at exactly what the Bible says about these issues and dealing with these issues. The short answer is, yes, you can; but you may not necessarily have to
B. There is no substitute for the Bible's prescription for these issues. The steps we looked at are irreplaceable. They can however have medication mixed with them. Whatever decision we make needs to be **BY FAITH**.
C. Col. 2:6; Hebrews 11:6; Romans 10:17; Romans 14:23; Prov. 3:5-7
D. The only way to answer this question will be through the steps mentioned above of spending time in prayer and the word of God. This will direct your decision and show you exactly what you ought to do **BY FAITH**! If God is showing you that you ought to take medication, then you better do exactly that **BY FAITH**! It's by faith because you acknowledged him and now trust he is directing your paths.
E. It is key to remember and BELIEVE BY FAITH what the Bible tells us in Mark 10:27- ***And Jesus looking upon them saith, With men it is impossible, but not with God: for with God all things are possible.***

VI. As we have seen today, this issue of depression/anxiety is clearly spoken about in the word of God. Many people in the Bible dealt with it to varying degrees, just as many of us do. All of us in some way and at some time will deal with it, and when we do, we must turn to what God tells us to do to handle it. The only 100% sure way to handle it is with God. There is no _____ for exercising faith through prayer and the reading of the word of God when we are faced with this issue of life.

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3. Psalm 42:11- Why art thou **cast down**, O my soul? and why art thou **disquieted** within me? hope thou in God: for I shall yet praise him, who is the health of my countenance, and my God.
    a) The theme we see with depression/anxiety is that they are equated with bringing us down and pressing down on us. No doubt this is what the devil wants us to feel. He is a roaring lion seeking to DEVOUR us and to do that, he has to bring us down (just as he was brought down)
    b) I didn't have time to really dive into this tonight but there is a great correlation in the Bible with pride/humility and depression/being exalted & joyful

III. What can cause Depression/Anxiety according to the **Bible**?

A. Sin/Pride- Psalm 38:1-10; Luke 14:11; Isa. 14:12-20

B. Investing wholly in wordly, temporary, vain things- Ecc. 1:16-18; Matt. 16:26

1. Solomon the richest and wisest man to ever live, had all that you could want by the worlds standards; riches, power, wisdom, etc… and yet when he was wholly given to these things and not submitted to the Lord, he was depressed. That is the mood of the whole book of Ecclesiastes, ALL IS VAIN, according to the man who had it all, except to fear the Lord and keep his commandments!

2. Think about the nature of investing in temporary, worldly, vain things: they are not valuable. They will perish, they will change, they will let you down, you will lose them, they won't satisfy you. Only God, who offers eternal, spiritual, godly joy can fulfill you completely. All else is vain! They will lead to sorrow.

3. America is the 2nd most depressed country by prevalence in the world!

C. Hard times/circumstances- 1 Sam. 1:7,10; Job 3:11; 1 Kings 19:4

1. We can all experience these times of extreme sorrow, hurt, fear, and loss that can lead us to a place where we weep for days, wish we were never born, or wish we were dead.
2. It's certainly something nobody wants to talk about, but also certainly something we all feel at times to some degree or another. We can have these feelings. Life is hard. We just cannot allow ourselves to stay in these places when the Bible promises peace, joy, and lightness to those who know/walk with the Lord.

IV. How do we deal with Depression/Anxiety according to the Bible?

A. Cast all our cares to our Lord in prayer

1. Phil 4:6-7 ;1 Pet. 5:7; Psalm 55:22; 1 Sam. 1:11; 1 Kings 19:5-8,12,18; **Matt. 26:38-39**

B. Fasting

1. 1 Sam. 1:8; 2 Sam. 12:15-16; Matt. 17:21

C. Faithfully search the scriptures and obey what God is telling you to do

1. Prov. 16:3; Matt. 11:28-30
   a) We so often are very quick to take on the cumbersome "yokes" of the world but very hesitant to believe God by faith when he says that his yoke is light. We will still have a "yoke" (be involved in work) but it's a good yoke. When we stop clinging to the things of this world and we simply commit ourselves to the work of the Lord, he establishes our thoughts and our burdens are made light.

V. Should I take **medication** for my Depression/Anxiety?

A. We have looked at exactly what the Bible says about these issues and dealing with these issues. The short answer is, yes, you can; but you may not necessarily have to

B. There is no substitute for the Bible's prescription for these issues. The steps we looked at are irreplaceable. They can however have medication mixed with them. Whatever decision we make needs to be **BY FAITH**.

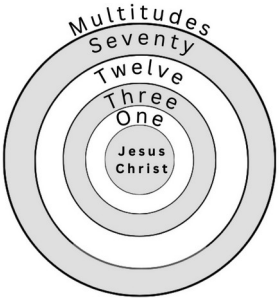
C. Col. 2:6; Hebrews 11:6; Romans 10:17; Romans 14:23; Prov. 3:5-7

D. The only way to answer this question will be through the steps mentioned above of spending time in prayer and the word of God. This will direct your decision and show you exactly what you ought to do **BY FAITH**! If God is showing you that you ought to take medication, then you better do exactly that **BY FAITH**! It's by faith because you acknowledged him and now trust he is directing your paths.

1. All situations of depression/anxiety are not the same. They range from temporary and mild to long term and severe. Most cases we are talking about will never require medication, they are simple cases that come and go. This would be a serious consideration for someone with something more long term and severe.

E. It is key to remember and BELIEVE BY FAITH what the Bible tells us in Mark 10:27- ***And Jesus looking upon them saith, With men it is impossible, but not with God: for with God all things are possible.***

VI. As we have seen today, this issue of depression/anxiety is clearly spoken about in the word of God. Many people in the Bible dealt with it to varying degrees, just as many of us do. All of us in some way and at some time will deal with it, and when we do, we must turn to what God tells us to do to handle it. The only 100% sure way to handle it is with God. There is no **substitute** for exercising faith through prayer and the reading of the word of God when we are faced with this issue of life.

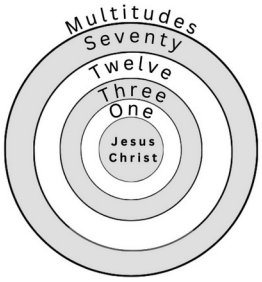


Close to Christ

Today we will examine the different types of disciples we see in the Bible. Though there are many disciples, each one chooses how close they will be to Jesus, and each experiences a different level of intimacy with Him. We would all say we want to be close to Christ, but the truth is that not all of us are willing to do what it takes to make that happen. By the end of today's lesson, it will be clear what it means to be a disciple who is not merely following Jesus, but _____ to Him than the rest.

1) There are different levels of closeness to Jesus amongst his disciples
   - **a) The** _____
     - i) They will be fed the word of God- Mark 6:34; 4:1-2; Luke 5:1; Matt. 13:1-3
     - ii) They will experience miracles- Matt. 12:15; 14:14; 15:30
     - iii) They enjoy the benefits of following Jesus- John 6:26
     - iv) They will walk away when things are tough- John 6:51-66
   - **b) The** _____
     - i) They will be involved in the work of the Lord. They will share his message and labor for him- Luke 10:1
     - ii) They will do miracles, not just experience them- Luke 10:17
     - iii) They will be entrusted with more than the "multitudes"- Romans 16:7
     - iv) While they truly desired to serve the Lord, they are seemingly not willing to do it once it costs them too much
   - **c) The** _____
     - i) They are given power to preach and do miracles on Jesus' behalf- Luke 9:1-2; Matt. 10:1, 7-8; Mark 3:13-15; Mk. 6:7, 12-13
     - ii) They are given special authority and power in eternity future for their service to God in this life- Matt. 19:28; Luke 22:28-30
     - iii) They are shown some special things by God that the multitudes and the seventy will never be shown. God reveals special truths to them- Matt. 13:10-11; Mark 4:33-34
     - iv) When things get tough, though they may falter for a time, ultimately they trust in God and pray, they don't run- Acts 1:13-14
     - v) They do great things with an eternal impact for the Lord and will impact multitudes (Matthew, John, James, 1 & 2 Peter, 1 & 2 & 3 John, Jude, Revelation)
     - vi) A small part of these 12 can be imposters and traitors- Matt. 26:47; Mark 14:10
   - **d) The** _____
     - i) They will see the true full power and glory of Jesus in ways that nobody else will- Matt. 17:1-9
     - ii) Jesus depends on them and desires to have them near to him- Matt. 26:36-38; Mk. 14:33-34
     - iii) They will see amazing miracles that even the other 12 will never see- Luke 8:49-56; Mk. 5:37-43
   - **e) The** _____
     - i) They are so close to Jesus they KNOW they would never betray him; they have no doubt- John 13:23-25; Matt. 26:22
     - ii) They will never walk away from Jesus. At risk of their life, they will be with him all the way to the end, even when everyone else is gone- John 19:26
     - iii) God will show them unimaginable, amazing things that others will never understand. He reveals all truth to them and holds nothing back- Rev. 1:9-11; 10:4

As we have seen today, there are many different levels to how closely we can walk with God. All these people we have examined today were true disciples of Jesus, but not all disciples are the same. We can be as close to God as we desire to be, all we must do is make the choices that will make that possible. These are not easy choices but are well worth the amazing life that awaits when you are _____ _____ disciple among many disciples of Jesus Christ. *James 4:8- "Draw nigh to God, and he will draw nigh to you..."*



Close to Christ

1) Today we will examine the different types of disciples we see in the Bible. Though there are many disciples, each one chooses how close they will be to Jesus, and each experiences a different level of intimacy with Him. We would all say we want to be close to Christ, but the truth is that not all of us are willing to do what it takes to make that happen. By the end of today's lesson, it will be clear what it means to be a disciple who is not merely following Jesus, but **CLOSER** to Him than the rest.

2) There are different levels of closeness to Jesus amongst his disciples (CONSIDER TODAY; 'WHERE ARE YOU AT IN THIS LIST? HOW CLOSE TO CHRIST ARE YOU REALLY?"

a) The Multitudes

i) They will be fed the word of God (Mark 6:34; 4:1-2; Luke 5:1; Matt. 13:1-3)

(1) There will be many people who here about/of the teachings of Christ. They have heard the gospel, heard the bible; yet what they do with it differs greatly

ii) They will experience miracles (Matt. 12:15; 14:14; 15:30)

(1) Miracle of salvation (WHAT A MIRACLE THAT IS), miracle of answered prayer, a changed life, etc.

iii) They enjoy the benefits of following Jesus (John 6:26)

iv) They will walk away when things are tough (John 6:51-66)

(1) They are following for miracles, the benefits of following Jesus, and for physical provision, but when the truth of the word of God is preached, and they have to make a hard decision for him, they stumble at it and fall away

(2) Are you following Jesus because it gives you a place to hangout? Because you want him to answer your prayers ONLY for your physical needs? When the word of God is preached it divides (Heb. 4:12), which side will you be on? Do you give it the benefit of the doubt?

v) They only follow for themselves and are not willing to sacrifice

(1) When things are hard at all they are gone. They won't follow Jesus to his/their death

(2) When Jesus says something they don't like, they are gone

(3) When he calls them out for only living selfishly and not actually to follow him, they are gone

(4) If you are only following for your own benefit; and not out of true Faith, trust, and love for Jesus Christ, then you are in danger of leaving following him when he says/does things you don't like

vi) Notice the response of the twelve (John 6:67-69)

(1) They don't say "we fully understand everything that you just said. They say, "we know who you are! The Christ! Because of that, even if we don't get it yet, we believe you."

(a) Giving the word of God the benefit of the doubt, is a key to God opening its understanding to you!

(b) Later on, Jesus expounds on this teaching at the Lords supper, and the twelve disciples come to understand it, unlike those who walked away here. They didn't want to believe it, they weren't really following Jesus.

(c) Man says, "Show me and I will believe."; God says, "Believe and I will show you."

(d) ALSO NOTE: this is where the MOST "followers" walk away. More than 5,000 were at the feeding with the fishes and loaves (Matt. said it didn't include women and children), and so thousands walk away here. Hard sayings from the Bible

b) The Seventy

i) They will be involved in the work of the Lord. They will share his message and labor for him (Luke 10:1)

(1) Maybe this is you, you have taken it a step further than experiencing the miracles, being fed, and being taught the word of God; you actually serve the Lord in some capacity

ii) They will do miracles, not just experience them (Luke 10:17)

(1) Leading someone to the Lord, discipling someone to walk closer with God, being conformed to the image

of Jesus Christ through the reading of the word of God and prayer, these are all miracles!! Have you experienced miracles in your life?

iii) They will be entrusted with more than the "multitudes"

(1) These become "sent forth ones" (apostles), given authority and ability to do things that almost nobody else gets to do (Romans 16:7)

iv) While they truly desired to serve the Lord, they are seemingly not willing to do it once it costs them too much

(1) As Jesus ministry progressed toward the cross, pressure and persecution built more and more. Things got harder and as we will see, the disciples that follow Jesus dwindle. These 70 are not mentioned outside of here in Luke

(2) We aren't told for certain what happens to these seventy (12 remained) but some potential things could be:

(a) They feared what would happen to their family

(b) They didn't like the ridicule they received from those they shared Jesus message with

(c) They feared what would happen to their business (nobody would want to do business with some radicals following a radical teacher who was hated)

(d) They feared that they may lose their lives

(e) They realized they didn't have time to follow him EVERYWHERE he went because they had other things they were involved in. They had friends, activities, family, jobs, all good stuff that there was nothing wrong with. They weren't willing to give it up. THEY WEREN'T WILLING TO LEAVE THEIR NETS OR LEAVE FATHER AND MOTHER AS THE 12 WERE

(f) They weren't willing to obey the "radical" things he was asking them to do (forgive others, be in ministry with tax collectors and sinners, share his message that the kingdom was coming, seek FIRST his kingdom and allow God to take care of your physical needs, etc…)

(g) They weren't willing to let go of sin in their lives and simply felt unworthy to follow Jesus any further or share his message anymore

c) The Twelve

i) They are given power to preach and do miracles on Jesus behalf (Luke 9:1-2; Matt. 10:1, 7-8; Mark 3:13-15; Mk. 6:7, 12-13)

ii) They are given special authority and power in eternity future for their service to God in this life (Matt. 19:28; Luke 22:28-30)

(1) You have this same ability to have this in eternity, but only if you are walking close to God like this. If you aren't a part of the "12" you won't be trusted with heavenly responsibility because he couldn't trust you with earthly responsibility

(2) When you have followed Christ this far, you will receive responsibility and reward in heaven that others simply won't

(3) The "judgment seat of Christ" is real, that day is coming. We will be "judged" on that day, and if we have fainted before we got to this point with Christ, we will "suffer loss" (1 Cor. 3:15)

iii) They are shown some special things by God that the multitudes and the seventy will never be shown. God reveals special truths to them (Matt. 13:10-11; Mark 4:33-34)

(1) Do you wonder why you don't feel that you see the amazing, deeper things of the word of God that others seem to? God shows more and more as we go along to those who are closest to him. The more you draw close to him, he will draw closer to you (***James 4:8- Draw nigh to God, and he will draw nigh to you. Cleanse your hands, ye sinners; and purify your hearts, ye double minded***.)

iv) When things get tough, though they may falter for a time, ultimately they trust in God and pray, they don't run (Acts 1:13-14)

v) They do great things with an eternal impact for the Lord and will impact multitudes (Matthew, John, James, 1 & 2 Peter, 1 & 2 & 3 John, Jude, Revelation)

(1) These books were written by some of these 12 disciples and they will last for eternity and they have helped and impacted billions of people

vi) A small part of these 12 can be imposters and traitors (Matt. 26:47; Mark 14:10)

(1) It can be very easy to fake all of these things, but only for a season. Some that appear to be a part of this twelve will experience miracles, do miracles, be shown special revelation by God, etc… and yet they were

faking it all along and they betray him

(a) At this level of discipleship you are following God in true charitable love for him. You cannot have this type of intimate relationship to God when you are just obeying on duty alone. Dutiful obedience is fine, but will only take you so far.

(b) A good question to ask yourself at this point, "why am I following?"

(c) Its good that you are following him, but the "why" becomes important. Many believe that Judas was disappointed that Jesus was not the "conquering king messiah" that he expected him to be. Some believe he turned Jesus in to try and force his hand to rebel against Rome and takeover.

(d) REFER TO OTHER PAPER

(e) Whatever his reason was, we need to be careful of our reasons for following Christ. He is the Lord, our Master; not us. If we have expectations for what he should do, how things should go, we may be sorely disappointed and walk away even at this level.

(f) Even a "good desire" (Judas desire for Jesus kingdom was biblical and good); but not on God's timing, following him wherever he leads, whenever he leads, can be DETRIMENTAL

d) The Three

i) These would be Peter, James, and John

ii) They will see the true full power and glory of Jesus in ways that nobody else will (Matt. 17:1-9)

(1) There are many disciples who will serve and follow Jesus as far as he will take them but these 3 desired to KNOW HIM above all else. If you desire to know God like this, you will spend more time in his word and more time in prayer with him than anyone else. You only get to know Jesus the living Word this well through the written word. These disciples will see his glory and power in ways that so few will

iii) Jesus depends on them and desires to have them near to him (Matt. 26:36-38; Mk. 14:33-34)

(1) Would it hurt God's heart if you walked away? Do you have such a deep relationship with him that he desires for you to be the one near to him when things are hard? When the world is rejecting him, walking away from God, refusing to believe in him and thousands are heading to hell each day, does he look forward to his time with you, his faithful disciple he can count on

iv) They will see amazing miracles that even the other 12 will never see (Luke 8:49-56; Mk. 5:37-43)

(1) Here Jesus invites ONLY these 3 to come and see this miracle of him raising from the dead the daughter of Jairus. He then tells them not to tell ANYONE else what they have seen.

(2) Again, the closer you are to him, the further you follow him, the more he shows you.

e) The One

i) **This is John, the beloved disciple; we all should strive to be in this place**

ii) They are so close to Jesus they KNOW they would never betray him; they have no doubt (John 13:23-25; Matt. 26:22)

(1) Also notice, that the other disciples, even among the closest 3, knew who was the closest to Christ. Peter asks John to ask Jesus.

(2) John does not ask, "is it I?" he asks "who is it?" HE KNOWS IT IS NOT HIM

iii) They will never walk away from Jesus. At risk of their life they will be with him all the way to the end, even when everyone else is gone (John 19:26)

(1) At this point, all others are gone. Even Peter, one of the 3, at this point had denied Jesus for fear of his own life. But John goes with him all the way to the cross

iv) God will show them unimaginable, amazing things that others will never understand. He reveals all truth to them and holds nothing back (Rev. 1:10-11; 10:4)

(1) John was shown "The Revelation of Jesus Christ" (first 5 words of the book)

(2) Many see this book as a book all about the end times, prophesy, judgement, etc.. AND ALL ARE TRUE. **But the Theme, and message of the book is all about "revealing Jesus Christ: who he is, his Glory, his Kingdom, his Judgement, his People, and his Ultimate Victory and Throne**

(3) John was shown things hidden to even us at this very day (thunders). It is between him and God alone.

3) As we have seen today, there are many different levels to how closely we can walk with God. All of these people we have examined today were true disciples of Jesus, but not all disciples are the same. We can be as close to God as we desire to be, all we must do is make the choices that will make that possible. These are not easy choices but are well worth the amazing life that awaits when you are **the one** disciple among many disciples of Jesus Christ (*James 4:8- Draw nigh to God, and he will draw nigh to you..."*

What do you need to do today to go further in your closeness to Christ? What do you need to sacrifice? What is standing between you and this level of intimacy/closeness to Jesus Christ?

Fundamentals of the Faith

I. Today we will be looking at an overview of the fundamentals of the Christian life. When it comes to sports, music, academics, and anything else we do in life, we all know the _____ of having the fundamentals down perfectly. The best people at all of these things know and can do these fundamentals with ease. We want to examine what the fundamentals of the Christian life are and how we can do them and live our lives successfully for God.

II. What is the Goal?

A. Bring glory to God (John 15:8; 1 Cor. 6:20)

1. **1 Cor. 10:31-** ***Whether therefore ye eat, or drink, or whatsoever ye do, do all to the glory of God.***

III. Time to _____

A. Prayer (James 1:5; 5:16; Psalm 10:17; James 4:8)

1. **Psalm 145:18-** ***The LORD is nigh unto all them that call upon him, to all that call upon him in truth.***

B. The word of God (1 Thess. 2:13; Heb. 4:12; Eph. 5:26; James 1:22-25)

1. **John 17:17-** ***Sanctify them through thy truth: thy word is truth.***

IV. Game Time

A. Evangelism- (Matthew 28:19; 2 Cor. 5:18; 2 Tim. 4:5)

1. **Mark 16:15-** ***And he said unto them, Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature.***

B. Discipleship- (Matt. 28:20; 2 Tim. 4:2; Eph. 4:12; 1 Cor. 14:12)

1. **2 Tim 2:2-** ***And the things that thou hast heard of me among many witnesses, the same commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also.***

V. The Other _____

A. The WORLD – John 17:10, 12-15; James 4:4

1. Be careful what you are consuming

B. The FLESH – Romans 7:24

C. The DEVIL – 1 Peter 5:8; Luke 22:31-32

Fundamentals of the Faith

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III. Time to Train

A. Prayer (James 1:5; 5:16; Psalm 10:17; James 4:8)

1. **Psalm 145:18-** ***The LORD is nigh unto all them that call upon him, to all that call upon him in truth.***
2. Prayer must come first! Prayer gets your heart right to seek God, it sets the tone for reading his word and listening for God's response to your prayers. If you ask him to speak to you he will.

B. The word of God (1 Thess. 2:13; Heb. 4:12; Eph. 5:26; James 1:22-25)

1. **John 17:17-** ***Sanctify them through thy truth: thy word is truth.***
   a) The place where you are going to do the most training and learn to train yourself for the rest of your life is discipleship. If you are looking for answers, you feel you don't have the answers and you don't know the Bible and you don't know how to pray and how to really have a relationship with God, this is where you will learn it! Get discipled! This is your sign, it is the first thing the first step you need to take for things to start making sense!

IV. Game Time

1. There are only two ministries, two things we are called to do in this life! All other things fall under these categories. This is because there are only 2 types of people in the world today and each is a ministry to one or the other!

B. Evangelism- (Matthew 28:19; 2 Cor. 5:18; 2 Tim. 4:5)

1. **Mark 16:15-** ***And he said unto them, Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature.***

C. Discipleship- (Matt. 28:20; 2 Tim. 4:2; Eph. 4:12; 1 Cor. 14:12)

1. **2 Tim 2:2-** ***And the things that thou hast heard of me among many witnesses, the same commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also.***
2. All of your Christian life you should be involved in sharing the gospel or building up/helping other Christians along in their Christian lives by helping them, edifying them, teaching them, comforting them, etc… all a part of discipleship!

V. The Other Team

A. The WORLD – John 17:10, 12-15; James 4:4
   1. This is the "way of the world". It tries to get you to think how it thinks, feel how it feels, and compromise and be apart of it
   2. Be careful what you are consuming

B. The FLESH – Romans 7:24
   1. Your daily battle against your flesh. Your bodily desires (laziness, lust, coveting, jealousy, etc..) What feels good to you!

C. The DEVIL – 1 Peter 5:8; Luke 22:31-32
   1. He is the power behind it all. He is using the world, to get your flesh to desire more and lust more. He uses the world and the flesh both with one another to get you to fall. He wants to see your life miserable.

GOD MOVES SATAN COUNTERS

As we have seen in this class, looking back at history with a biblical understanding and worldview, can make history become clear as to the work of God and the countering of the devil. What can be hard at times is to clearly see this struggle taking place in real time, and even more difficult to estimate how it will play out into the future. However, with a clear understanding of history and with a heart of belief in the word of God, we can see the future clearly. God has always been in the business of giving his people prophesies to know what is coming. While we may not know the exact details, we can have a good idea of what is coming, especially with where we are located in history. As events unfold, times goes on, and we get closer to the end, it is easier to interpret history, see the Bible come true, and ultimately to understand what may come next. This is what we will attempt to look at this morning.

I. **Signs** of the Times
   a. One of our greatest "sign of the times" is Israel- Pro. 27:18; Matt. 24:32-34; Song of Sol 2:10-13
      i. People often look around for all sorts of different signs (heavens, stars, eclipses, etc..) but we know the signs to look for, and the greatest sign/miracle occurred less than 100 years ago when Israel became a nation after almost 2000 years!

II. Following Israel in **Recent** History
   a. **WW1**- Where God is establishing a growing movement of "Zionism" in the world of people who support a Jewish State, the Devil is trying to create world war, killings, confusion, and world takeover through the Central Powers. God then uses WW1 as an opening for the land to be given back to Israel through the Balfour Declaration.
      i. At this time, Israel was spread around the world. There were pockets of Jewish people in the Russian empire (Ukraine, Belarus, and Lithuania; the majority of Jews during this time), Central Europe (Germany, the Austro-Hungarian empire), Western Europe (France and Britain), and a small population in the Ottoman Empire area of Palestine.
      ii. A Jewish scientist during WW1 helped to develop a method for producing Acetone which was crucial to the making of smokeless gunpowder which Britain needed to help win the war. For his contributions, he had contact with high ranking British officials such as David Lloyd George and Arthur Balfour which he leveraged to push for a homeland for the Jewish people.
         1. Their were others in the "Zionist" movement who were in positions to try and push for this as well during this time. God's people believing and acting on biblical prophesies has been a part of what God has used to enact these plans in the past (Daniel and Cyrus)
   b. WW2- When the Devil was trying to take over the world through Germany and a picture of the antichrist in Adolph Hitler, and to exterminate the Jews from off the face of the planet, God is using it to bring Israel back home to their land and solidify Israel as a sovereign state
      i. During this time, Jews were still largely spread out around the world even though many more moved to the British controlled but Jewish recognized area of Palestine. The holocaust and atrocities the Jews faced in WW2 lead to the Jewish people being led to go back home to their land. The UN Partition Plan Resolution 181 proposed a Jewish State, Arab State, and Jerusalem as a UN controlled international city. On May 14, 1948 Israel declared independence as a sovereign state.
      ii. **Clarence Larkin**- We have a great example of a Bible believer who read and believed the word of God, studied prophesy, and had a good idea of events soon to transpire around him. In 1918 he finished his work "Dispensational Truth" (21 years before WW2 began)
      iii. a. Gathered Back UNCONVERTED- "I will take you from among the heathen, and gather you out of all countries, and will bring you into your own land. **THEN will I sprinkle clean water upon you,** and ye shall be clean: from all your filthiness, and from all your idols will I cleanse you. A **New Heart** also will I give you, and a **New Spirit** will I put within you: and I will give you an **Heart of Flesh.** And I will put **My Spirit within you,** and cause you to walk in my statutes; and ye shall keep my judgments, and do **them.'** Ezek. 36:24-26.
      iv. b. Before Conversion They Are To Be JUDGED. "I will bring you out from the people, and will gather you out of the countries wherein ye are scattered, with a mighty hand, and with a stretched out

arm, and with **fury poured out.** And I will bring you into the wilderness of the people, and there will 1 plead with you face to face. And I will cause you to **'Pass Under The Rod, '** and I will bring you into the bond of the Covenant; and I will **purge out from among you the rebels,** and them that **transgress against Me: I** will bring them forth out of the country where they sojourn, and they shall **not enter into the Land of Israel.''** Eze. 20:34-36. Then God will cast them into His **'Melting Pot.'** "Therefore thus saith the Lord God; Because ye are all become **dross,** behold, therefore I will gather you into the **midst of Jerusalem.** As they gather silver, and brass, and iron, and lead, and tin. into the midst of the furnace, to blow the fire upon it, to melt it; so **will I gather you in mine anger and in My fury and I will leave you there, and MELT YOU.** Yea I will gather you. and blow upon you in the fire of my wrath, and ye shall be I **melted in the midst thereof.** As silver is melted in- the midst of the furnace, **so shall ye be melted in the midst thereof;** and ve shall know that I the Lord have poured out my fury upon you." Eze. 22:19-21.

c. **War the day after Israel's declaration-** After God has solidified Israel back as a nation in their land for the first time in almost 2000 years, the Devil uses Israels enemies to try and strike the young and weak Israel the following day. God uses this to expand Israel's land and establish their new place in this land.
    i. The next day, five Arab states (**Egypt, Jordan, Syria, Iraq, Lebanon**) invaded Israel, alongside Palestinian Arab forces. The war, known as the **1948 Arab-Israeli War**, lasted until early 1949. Israel not only defended its sovereignty but also expanded its territory, securing **78% of Mandatory Palestine**, including western Jerusalem.

d. **Six-Day War**- The Devil uses lies and confusion to try to destroy Israel again as a nation, Israel gets wind of this and preemptively strikes her enemies. Through MIRACULOUS victories God used this for Israel to expand her land and gain full control of Jerusalem for the first time in 2000 years.
    i. In May 1967, the Soviet Union erroneously informed Egypt that Israel was massing troops on the Syrian border, preparing for an imminent attack. This misinformation heightened regional tensions. In June 1967, facing imminent attacks by neighboring states, Israel launched a preemptive strike, defeating Egypt, Jordan, and Syria within six days.
    ii. **Miracle stories during this war**:
        1. There were reports of enemy shells hitting Israeli munitions but failing to detonate, preventing potential disasters.
        2. An Israeli infantry recruit recounted encountering a truck with 18 armed Egyptian soldiers. Despite being outnumbered and under-armed, the Israeli soldiers were able to capture the Egyptians without resistance. An Egyptian sergeant later explained that his body became paralyzed, rendering him unable to act.
        3. Gershon Salomon, a member of the Israel Defense Forces (IDF), recounted an incident where he lay wounded on the battlefield, facing imminent capture by Syrian soldiers. He reported that the Syrians suddenly fled, leaving their weapons behind. Later, it was revealed that the Syrian soldiers claimed to have seen "thousands of angels" surrounding the injured Israeli soldiers, prompting their retreat.

e. **Israel-Hamas War**- God moved Red Heifers to Israel for the purification for the temple to be rebuilt. Shortly after this occurred, Hamas attached Israel on October 7, 2023 at the influence of the Devil. What is God's next move?
    i. In September 2022, five red heifers were imported from Texas to Israel by a group of Jewish activists. The ashes of a red heifer are required for ritual purification, a prerequisite for rebuilding the Third Temple in Jerusalem. Hamas spokesman Abu Ubaydah stated that their attacks on October 7, 2024 were in response to the importation of the red heifers, viewing it as a provocation related to the Temple Mount.
    ii. **PHOTOS**

III. What is **next**?

a. Does America play a part in the rebuilding of the temple, the end times, the antichrist, etc…

b. Daniel's 4 Beast Prophesy and John's Vision of the Beast- Daniel 7:1-8 and Revelation 13:1-2

i. Historically these beasts "shall arise" out of the earth it says, and this was given during the reign of the final king of Babylon. The beasts historically were

1. Lion- Media-Persia
2. Bear- Greece
3. Leopard- Rome
4. 4th Beast- Antichrist Final kingdom (same as Revelation 13)

ii. However, this is seemingly a dual prophesy (common in the Bible) about other kingdoms that would show up directly before the antichrists final kingdom. The clue word is that he had the vision in the "night" (he says this 3 times). The night is used in the Bible as a picture of the church age

iii. Also, the only prophetic vision of Daniels that we see in the book of Revelation is this one from Daniel 7 where each of these beasts is mentioned. This would indicate that this prophesy also deals with the end times kingdoms directly leading into the antichrists final kingdom. None of his other visions are directly talked about in Revelation. To understand Daniel you need Revelation and to understand Revelation you need Daniel. To understand both and how they work in history, you need TIME to pass to see it clearer. We see clearer today than ever before!

1. **The Lion** prophetically talks about **Britain** (eagles wings plucked, is the young US being removed from Britain)
    a. Go to London, there are giant lion statues all over the place
2. **The Bear** prophetically talks about **Russia** (always associated with the bear, the Eurasian Brown Bear is the national animal of Russia)
3. **The Leopard** prophetically speaks of the **United States** in its fullest power today.
    a. The Leopard is a melting pot animal. It is yellow, black, and white which is representative of the US since its inception. It also has 4 heads which could be looked at a few ways: (major powers in America: President, Senate, House, Supreme Court, we often think of 3 powers but really the legislative branch is made up of 2 very important and powerful parts SOME people see it as the 3 branches of government and the 4th being the people or the media as the common saying goes)
    b. Look at the similarities in Rome and the US
    c. History Repeats itself! Just as God gave the details exactly of the kingdoms directly preceding his first coming, he also gave the details of the kingdoms directly preceding his 2nd coming!
    d. If these only represent the historical kingdoms before his first coming, then we can only assume that means the Beast of Revelation 13 and of Daniel 7 shows that the antichrists final kingdom will be a mix of: MEDIA PERSIA, GREECE, AND ANCIENT ROME
    e. That does not make sense! Persia no longer exists, Greek culture influences the world but the country is a non player, and Rome as a country does not have power/influence, they are IN MYSTERY FORM, working behind the scenes!!! (Rev. 17)

c. Understanding Americas place in the end, lets consider a few facts:

i. Order of the books

1. 2 Chronicles- Israel told to go home; Ezra/Nehemiah- Rebuilt temple, walls, and city; Ester- Rapture; Job- Tribulation (42 chapters/months of great tribulation); Psalms- Millennial Reign with David (Jesus Christ) as king with peace (selah)

ii. Israel and Trump

1. In 2017 President Trump recognized Jerusalem as the capital of Israel and moved our embassy to Jerusalem as a gesture of this statement, since this move many in Israel (especially the religious leaders) view Israel as a modern day Cyrus

a. He said, "I have determined that it is time to officially recognize Jerusalem as the capital of Israel."
b. He also called the move, ""a long-overdue **step** to advance the peace process and to work towards a lasting agreement."
c. **Historical Context:** President Trump referenced the **Jerusalem Embassy Act of 1995**, which called for the U.S. Embassy to be moved to Jerusalem but allowed presidents to issue waivers delaying the move for national security reasons. He noted that for over 20 years, previous presidents had exercised these waivers, but he chose to act on the legislation. (PBS)
d. The U.S. Embassy in Jerusalem officially opened on May 14, 2018, coinciding with the 70th anniversary of Israel's founding. The ceremony was attended by U.S. officials, including Ivanka Trump and Jared Kushner, and was met with both celebration and protest. (The Christian Post)
e. Since this time Israelis have compared Trump to Cyrus and have long thought he would be the one to rebuild the temple (hand coin around)

2. Trump has been hated, reviled, tried to be killed, tried to be jailed, tried to be impeached, had never before seen political maneuvers run against him, etc.. since he first won in 2016. The hate for him and the divine providence to keep him alive reads like the pages of a history book and the next chapter is God using him for a purpose. (VIDOES)
3. God used Trump to get that embassy to Jerusalem when presidents for over 20 years waived the Jerusalem Embassy Act to do so. Israel was attacked for bringing the heifers necessary to build the temple to Israel and started their longest and deadliest war yet (all while trump was out of office). Now he has the chance to come back into office, during a time of war in Israel, and create promised peace (he has already written peace treaties in the middle east).
4. Every major war in Israel, God has used for their furtherance and for moving us to the end. (this is their largest war yet)
    a. He has the man in place who Israel believes will do it and who the world/devil has seemingly desperately tried to keep out of office (the very thing they did to keep him out got him in- devil countering, God moving)
    b. He is in during the time to do it (major war in Israel) and has the courage to do it, the family and motivation to do it (senior advisor Jared Kushner is a Jew who influences these decisions)
    c. The Jewish people are more prepared for it now than ever (go home and check out the temple institute website, it is amazing to see)
5. His senior advisor Jewish son in law AUTHORED the **Abraham accords** (peace treaty in Israel) and led the brand new unit in the Trump administration called the "**Office of American Innovation**" to Advance Technological Innovation and to Integrate cutting-edge technologies into government processes.
6. It was through this office that Jared Kushner met Elon Musk, the famed innovator and businessman who:
    a. Is the richest man in the world ($**290B**)
    b. Involved in AI (**Tesla/ xAI**, also co-founded **OpenAI**, **ChatGPT**)
    c. Involved in cryptocurrency
    d. Involved in space travel (**Space X**)
    e. Involved in developing high-bandwidth brain-machine interfaces to connect the human brain with computers, with potential applications in treating neurological conditions and enhancing human cognition (**Neuralink**)
    f. Now will head up the new "**Government Efficiency Commission**" in the Trump administration to keep government spending under control

g. Is **associated with the letter X: X (used to be twitter), name of his son with the letter X (X Æ A-Xii), SpaceX, Tesla Model X, xAI, X.com (His first venture, was an online banking and financial services)**

7. **JD Vance, Donald Trump's VP is of course Catholic, but what kind of Catholic is he?**
   a. If you have read or know history, this sounds an awful lot like Jesuits. They have the same ideology and plot to infiltrate and use government to promote their way of thinking and religion.

iii. What does this all mean?
   1. If we look at history, believe the Bible, and try to interpret the events going on around us from a Biblical worldview (not political) then we can try and understand an idea of what may be coming next.
   2. Keeping an eye on Israel is key. Whether or not America is the main body of the antichrists kingdom or whether Trump will build the temple, we know that the end is nearer now than ever. We have to keep our eyes open, the word of God as our guide, and work like it's our last day, every day.

GOD MOVES SATAN COUNTERS

I. _____ of the Times
   a. One of our greatest "sign of the times" is Israel- Pro. 27:18; Matt. 24:32-34; Song of Sol 2:10-13

II. Following Israel in _____ History
   a. **WW1**- Where God is establishing a growing movement of "Zionism" in the world of people who support a Jewish State, the Devil is trying to create world war, killings, confusion, and world takeover through the Central Powers. God then uses WW1 as an opening for the land to be given back to Israel through the Balfour Declaration.
   b. WW2- When the Devil was trying to take over the world through Germany and a picture of the antichrist in Adolph Hitler, and to exterminate the Jews from off the face of the planet, God is using it to bring Israel back home to their land and solidify Israel as a sovereign state
   c. War the day after Israel's declaration- After God has solidified Israel back as a nation in their land for the first time in almost 2000 years, the Devil uses Israels enemies to try and strike the young and weak Israel the following day. God uses this to expand Israel's land and establish their new place in this land.
   d. **Six-Day War**- The Devil uses lies and confusion to try to destroy Israel again as a nation, Israel gets wind of this and preemptively strikes her enemies. Through MIRACULOUS victories God used this for Israel to expand her land and gain full control of Jerusalem for the first time in 2000 years.
   e. **Israel-Hamas War**- God moved Red Heifers to Israel for the purification for the temple to be rebuilt. Shortly after this occurred, Hamas attached Israel on October 7, 2023 at the influence of the Devil. What is God's next move?

III. What is _____?
   a. Does America play a part in the rebuilding of the temple, the end times, the antichrist, etc…
   b. Daniel's 4 Beast Prophesy and John's Vision of the Beast- Daniel 7:1-8 and Revelation 13:1-2
      i. Historically these beasts "shall arise" out of the earth it says, and this was given during the reign of the final king of Babylon. The beasts historically were
         1. Lion- Media-Persia
         2. Bear- Greece
         3. Leopard- Rome
         4. 4th Beast- Antichrist Final kingdom (same as Revelation 13)
      ii. However, this is seemingly a dual prophesy (common in the Bible) about other kingdoms that would show up directly before the antichrists final kingdom. The clue word is that he had the vision in the "night" (he says this 3 times). The night is used in the Bible as a picture of the church age
         1. **The Lion** prophetically talks about **Britain** (eagles wings plucked, is the young US being removed from Britain)
            a. Go to London, there are giant lion statues all over the place

2. **The Bear** prophetically talks about **Russia** (always associated with the bear, the Eurasian Brown Bear is the national animal of Russia)
3. **The Leopard** prophetically speaks of the **United States** in its fullest power today.
    a. History Repeats itself! Just as God gave the details exactly of the kingdoms directly preceding his first coming, he also gave the details of the kingdoms directly preceding his 2nd coming!

c. Understanding Americas place in the end, lets consider a few facts:
    i. Order of the books
        1. 2 Chronicles- Israel told to go home; Ezra/Nehemiah- Rebuilt temple, walls, and city; Ester-Rapture; Job- Tribulation (42 chapters/months of great tribulation); Psalms- Millennial Reign with David (Jesus Christ) as king with peace (selah)
    ii. Israel and Trump
        1. In 2017 President Trump recognized Jerusalem as the capital of Israel and moved our embassy to Jerusalem as a gesture of this statement, since this move many in Israel (especially the religious leaders) view Israel as a modern day Cyrus
        2. Every major war in Israel, God has used for their furtherance and for moving us to the end. (this is their largest war yet)
    iii. What does this all mean?
        1. If we look at history, believe the Bible, and try to interpret the events going on around us from a Biblical worldview (not political) then we can try and understand an idea of what may be coming next.
        2. Keeping an eye on Israel is key. Whether or not America is the main body of the antichrists kingdom or whether Trump will build the temple, we know that the end is nearer now than ever. We have to keep our eyes open, the word of God as our guide, and work like it's our last day, every day.

HIDING THE GOSPEL

Teacher: Luke Johnston

JBI 7 LAWS OF THE TEACHER MESSAGE (05/04/23)

1. **HOOK**- VIDEO
2. **BOOK- 2 Corinthians 4:3-4**
3. **LOOK-**
    a. **This scenario is a perfect picture of the spiritual problems we see in the Bible**
        i. Our eyes are open and we have the news that can save someone from certain death
        ii. Their death is not only falling off of a cliff, but eternal death and separation from God for eternity in Hell (Romans 6:23)
        iii. They are blind and don't know any better, they are doing what they best know to do, and many are even seeking guidance but unfortunately those who have it will NOT share it
    b. **We are actively HIDING the light of the gospel from those that are lost and blinded when we are not sharing it**
        i. If we are saved then we have already obeyed the gospel and now we carry that light everywhere we go. If we are not sharing it then we are actively hiding it.
    c. **We emphasize not sinning when we are no longer even under the law. We ought to care about what God cares about and talks about and commands over and over again in the NT: SHARING THE GOSPEL**
        i. 1 Corinthians 9:16- For though I preach the gospel, I have nothing to glory of: for necessity is laid upon me; yea, woe is unto me, if I preach not the gospel!
        ii. Think about the Great White Throne Judgment. What excuses will be good enough on that day? In the video we thought that the excuses of the one friend were so ridiculous it was comical; BUT on that day, it will be much worse, and the stakes will be much higher
4. **TOOK- Share the gospel with 1 more person this week than you did last week**
    a. Luke 15:10- Likewise, I say unto you, there is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner that repenteth.

The Key of David: The Key to Everything

1) The Key of David- Love for the Word of God

a) Psalm 112:1; 119: 47, 48, 97, 113, 119, 127, 140, 159, 165, 167

i) We love, study, think about, and obey the word of God, because that is how we love, study, think about, and obey the God of the Word.

2) Psalm 1:1-3

a) ***The Key to staying away from sin, bad counsel, and scornfulness*** (vs. 1-2)

i) Psalm 119:9-11; 101

(1) What does it mean to "delight" and "meditate" on God's word?

(a) Delight- A high degree of pleasure, or satisfaction of mind; joy.

(2) What does it mean to "meditate" on God's word?

(a) Meditate- "To dwell on any thing in thought; to contemplate; to _____:"

(3) What does it mean to "keep" God's word?

(a) Keep- To hold; to retain in one's power or possession; not to lose or part with. To have in custody for security or preservation.

(i) It is much more than just "having" something in the Bible; it is an intimate word meaning to care for, watch over, hold close, LOVE!

b) ***The Key to*** _____(vs. 2)

i) Isa. 26:3; Psa. 119:165; Prov. 3:1-2

(1) When your mind is truly stayed on God, meditating on his word, seeking to share his word, investing his word in others: your whole life is about his word: you will be in perfect peace.

c) ***The Key to*** _____***in ministry*** (vs. 3)

i) John 15:1-8; Rev. 3:7-8

(1) Jesus makes it clear that without him (the word) we can do NOTHING! The word of God is key to fruitfulness (you will bear fruit in your season, you may not always know when that will be)

d) ***The Key to*** _____***in everything you do*** (vs. 3)

i) Joshua 1:7-8; Deut. 29:9; 30:9-10; 1 Kings 2:3; 1 Chron. 22:12-13; 2 Chron. 31:20-21

(1) These verses all connect in showing us that EVERYTHING ELSE, not included in the above list, also with prosper when we love, keep, and meditate on the word of God. When our lives are built on and around the word of God:

e) Do you possess this key today?

i) What consumes your mind, your thoughts, your time?

ii) Who are you thinking about the most? You? Or are you seeking God and what he wants, his desires?

iii) If you life is full of sin, lacks peace, lacks fruit, and is not prospering in all things; ask yourself, why? How is your relationship to the word of God today?

The Key of David: The Key to Everything

The heavy steel door slammed shut, and the digital timer on the wall immediately began counting down from 60:00.

Miles didn’t waste a second. He was a whirlwind of energy. He tore the room apart—ripping books off shelves, flipping over mattress cushions, forcefully yanking on locked cabinets, and punching random sequences into the keypad by the door. Sweat dripped down his face. He was working harder than anyone I’ve ever seen. He was frantic, exhausting himself, convinced that if he just tried enough combinations, one of them would eventually work.

Jonah stood still. He didn't move a muscle for the first two minutes. He just scanned the room until his eyes locked on a small, unassuming framed manifest hanging near the floor. He walked over, slid the backing off the frame, and a small, silver skeleton key fell into his palm.

Miles was panting, his knuckles white as he tried to pry a drawer open with his bare hands. He looked back at Jonah and snapped, "Are you going to help, or just stand there?"

Jonah didn’t answer. He walked past Miles, stepped up to the massive, locked chest in the center of the room—the one Miles had been kicking in frustration—and inserted the silver key.

The chest clicked and popped right open. Inside wasn't the exit, but the guide. It was a map. It revealed every hidden compartment, every code, and the exact sequence needed to escape.

Miles froze. He looked at the chaos he had created—the overturned furniture, the mess, the wasted energy. Then he looked at the map in Jonah’s hands.

You see Miles had all of the desire in the world to win this escape room, but what he didn’t have was the key. He rushed to get to work instead of getting that all important key first. He wanted to get out more than anything. But Jonah had the key. And in that room, effort without the key wasn't just difficult—it was useless.

This is how too many of us live our Christian lives. We run around frantically: serving, ministering, teaching, giving, and doing all “good things” we should be doing; but all too often we do it running around without the key, ultimately not accomplishing anything for the Lord.

This key is what we want to find in the word of God today. The Bible calls this the “key of David”

> **Isaiah 22:22-** “And the key of the house of David will I lay upon his shoulder; so he shall open, and none shall shut; and he shall shut, and none shall open.”
>
> **Rev. 3:7-** “These things saith he that is holy, he that is true, he that hath the key of David, he that openeth, and no man shutteth; and shutteth, and no man openeth.”

When you study out these two passages you find that the key of David opens doors that can only be opened with this key and it leads to houses of treasure that only God can give access to. It is given this title because this key was the “key” quality of David/his life” that made him a man after God’s own heart. This is the key we will be looking for today in the word of God.

So today, we want to look at this key to the life of David and see how this passage in psalms lays out for us how it really is the key to everything in our lives: our ministries, peace of mind, families, fruitfulness, joy, service, etc..

1) The Key of David- Love for the Word of God
   a) Psalm 112:1; 119: 47, 48, 97, 113, 119, 127, 140, 159, 165, 167
      i) We love, study, think about, and obey the word of God, because that is how we love, study, think about, and obey the God of the Word.
   b) The passage we are going to be focusing in on today is Psalm 1. This chapter gives us a great view of this "key" in the Bible. God begins the Psalms (which were written primarily by David) with the key to the life of David.
      i) David was not a great guy by any means, it was not for his outstanding character and perfect living that he was called "a man after God's own heart"
         (1) a. Adultery with Bathsheba
         (2) b. Murder of Uriah
         (3) c. Multiple Wives
         (4) d. Concubines
         (5) e. Numbering the people resulting in death of 70,000 people of Israel
         (6) f. Bad handling of his family matters resulting in rebellion of his children
         (7) g. His personal sin and its consequences on the sins of his children
            (a) It was his love for God and his word that made him who he was! A man who loves the word of God may fall and sin, BUT HE WILL REPENT! You may not be the best at something, the most skilled, you may be a screw up (I know I am, my family can vouch for that), but THE KEY YOU NEED IS THIS LOVE FOR THE WORD OF GOD, IT COVERS A MUTLTITUDE OF SINS!
            (b) HOLD YOUR PLACE IN PSALM 119 AND GO TO PSALM 1

2) Psalm 1:1-3
   a) ***The Key to staying away from sin, bad counsel, and scornfulness*** (vs. 1-2)
      i) Psalm 119:9-11; 101
         (1) Verse 4 indicates the same idea! ("the ungodly are not so")
         (2) We cannot just try and live lives as "good little Christian boys and girls" and make our whole lives about "who sins the least". That is not what life is about!! That is a religious made up idea. (not saying we ought to sin)
         (3) However, a bi product of loving and meditating on the word of God is that we will be more like Christ and we won't be involved in these things anymore (Jn. 17:17- "Sanctify them through thy truth, thy word is truth")
         (4) What does it mean to "delight" and "meditate" on God's word?

(a) Delight- A high degree of pleasure, or satisfaction of mind; joy.

(i) Believe it or not, you can actually find pleasure in God's word and in reading and obeying it! Our world has conditioned us so much to think that we can't and that it is boring. That is a lie!!!

1. Can you honestly say you "delight" in God's word? Or is it a task, dragging yourself to read it and barely spending time in it, being distracted reading it? How much time do you spend in it vs. other things?
2. The opposite of this is those who Paul says in the end times are "lovers of pleasures more than lovers of God". This is all to often an accurate depiction of us.

(5) What does it mean to "meditate" on God's word?

(a) Meditate- "To dwell on any thing in thought; to contemplate; to **study**;"

(i) What is on your mind constantly? How much money is in the bank? The next big game being played? The ending to your favorite show? Work needing to be done? The things you want to buy?

(ii) What occupies your thinking the most? Is it the word of God? Chewing on the thing you are studying and praying to God to help reveal to you? Meditating on how that applies in your life right now? Thinking about how you can share that truth with those around you each day at work/school? Too often, this is not true of us. David said in Psalm 119:36 "Incline my heart unto thy testimonies, and not to covetousness.". Too often, we are meditating on covetousness (idolatry) not on God/his Word

(6) What does it mean to "keep" God's word?

(a) Keep- To hold; to retain in one's power or possession; not to lose or part with. To have in custody for security or preservation.

(i) It is much more than just "having" something in the Bible; it is an intimate word meaning to care for, watch over, hold close, LOVE!!!

b) ***The Key to peace*** (vs. 2)

i) Isa. 26:3; Psa. 119:165; Prov. 3:1-2

(1) So many people struggle with peace today. Anxiety, depression, purposelessness, etc.. all run rampant today more than ever. It is not ALWAYS THE CAUSE, but has a high causal link to "covetousness" (idolatry) for worldly things and NOT for the word of God.

(2) The word of God is eternal and brings joy that is fulfilling and lasting. Nothing else in this world can do that. It is all empty (vanity)

(3) When your mind is truly stayed on God, meditating on his word, seeking to share his word, investing his word in others: your whole life is about his word: you will be in perfect peace.

c) ***The Key to fruitfulness in ministry***(vs. 3)

i) John 15:1-8; Rev. 3:7-8

(1) Jesus makes it clear that without him (the word) we can do NOTHING! The word of God is key to fruitfulness (you will bear fruit in your season, you may not always know when that will be)

(2) The church of Philadelphia possessed the key of David, they "kept" (held close, loved, cherished) the word of God and they FLOURISHED. The church of Laodicea keep the word of God outside (Jesus knocking at the church door). **We have the door locked, the key of David is gone, and jesus is on the outside of the church locked out of his own church!**

(3) People died for the scriptures, took it to the ends of the earth, sold their lives for it and GOD MOVED!! When the word of God has preeminence in our lives/ministries, in the right season, there will be fruit from it!

d) ***The Key to prospering in everything you do*** (vs. 3)

i) Joshua 1:7-8; Deut. 29:9; 30:9-10; 1 Kings 2:3; 1 Chron. 22:12-13; 2 Chron. 31:20-21

(1) These verses all connect in showing us that EVERYTHING ELSE, not included in the above list, also with prosper when we love, keep, and meditate on the word of God. When our lives are built on and around the word of God:

(a) Families will prosper

(b) Jobs will prosper

(c) Ministries will prosper

(d) Churches will prosper

(e) Marriages will prosper

(f) Children will prosper

(g) Finances will prosper

(h) Mental Health/Physical Health will prosper

(i) Etc…

(2) When we hear prosper we think "prosperity gospel" BUT THAT IS NOT WHAT THIS IS! THAT IS A LIE/CHEAPENING THE WORD OF GOD FOR COVETEOUSNESS SAKE!

(a) True prosperity isn't getting rich BUT being content with what God has given you (1 Timothy 6:6-10- But godliness with contentment is great gain. And having food and raiment let us be therewith content.)

(b) True prosperity isn't God healing you miraculously BUT God giving you grace to sustain you and see the bigger picture (blind man and Lazarus; not for sin, but for the glory of God to be displayed)

(c) True prosperity isn't as easy life with no trials BUT realizing that all that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution and that there is a reward for this persecution and a purpose for it!

(d) Etc.. the bottom line is, prosperity is a BIBLE WORD that we ought not be ashamed of because some idol worshipping (covetous) group has taken it and twisted it to mean something it isn't.

(i) When you have this kind of love for the word of God, your life and viewpoint is that it is NOT ALL ABOUT YOU, BUT ABOUT HIM! And so whatever he does/chooses to use you for, you PROSPER,

because you see he is working, he is in it!!! Even if it isn't "convenient" for you. Because you are not concerned about you, your desires, but him, his glory, and his word!!

e) Do you possess this key today?
   i) What consumes your mind, your thoughts, your time?
   ii) Who are you thinking about the most? You? Or are you seeking God and what he wants, his desires?
   iii) If you life is full of sin, lacks peace, lacks fruit, and is not prospering in all things; ask yourself why? How is your relationship to the word of God today?
   iv) David was a VERY FLAWED MAN. Yet, he was able to be called a man after God's own heart, he was considered the greatest king in Israel; all because of ONE KEY THING: his relationship to and love for the word of God (the God of the word).
   v) If you don't, it doesn't matter how hard you try to live a "good" life, how hard you work, how skilled you are, etc.. you don't have the KEY needed to open the doors only God can open.

Lessons for Laodiceans- Rev. 3:14-21

1) Revelation 3:14-22

- This letter was to an actual historical church that existed in around 90AD in Asia minor BUT
- This passage I believe represents the modern church (about 1900-today). There are many reasons for this, but namely, in chapters 1-3 "church" is mentioned 19x, but from chapter 4-20, "church" is not mentioned even once.
- It seems the letters to these churches in Revelation 2-3 represent periods of church history up to the rapture (chap. 4) and on into the tribulation and eternity future (chap. 6-22)
- Vs. 14- "the Amen (the "truth") In Isa. 65:16 God calls himself the God "of truth" 2x (in Hebrew, literally "Amen"). We live in days of "relative truth" unparalleled any other time in history.
- Vs. 14- "the faithful and true witness"- We live in the information age, yet with more confusion, lies, deceit, and a lack of trust (faith) in anything we hear because of misinformation, Jesus says HE IS THE FAITHFUL AND TRUE WITNESS
- Vs. 14- the "beginning of the creation of God"- Jesus Christ is the creator of the universe. Something that was largely believed in one way or another for most of history until the "theory of evolution" (Charles Darwin and his book "On the Origin of Species" in 1859 & Georges Lemaître (George La-Matre) with the big bang theory in 1927)
- Industrial Revolution (create much more wealth), Civil Rights Movement (BOTH did a lot of good and also created potential pitfalls in many ways)
- For all of these reasons, I believe 100% that if Jesus could be here this morning to share any message with the church, this is what he would have to say; this is what he says of the church today, the modern church as a whole, these are our struggles (even when we do well, because of the nature of the world we live in, these will still be our struggles).

a) Laodicea is a **self-centered** church (vs. 14)

i) The name Laodicea translates literally to "the people's rights/justice to the people; civil rights"

ii) The church "of the Laodiceans" (Rev. 2:1, 8, 12, 18; 3:1, 7, 14)

iii) The church where everything is about "me, my rights, my way, doing right by me"

(1) When your Christian life becomes all about you, even when you are in the right, you are slipping into the Laodicean way- 2 Tim. 3:1-2; Luke 9:23; Phillip. 2:3-4; Rom. 12:10; Eph. 5:21

(a) The first response of Laodicean many times is "justice", getting what we are due, not allowing ourselves to be wronged, we must vindicated, and justice must be served

(b) We love to see justice when we aren't the ones on the receiving end, we tend to like justice to be done to others, especially when we have been wronged.

(c) Laodiceans struggle with this idea. Jesus is showing us that as a whole, the church in this day is marked by self centeredness and selfishness. The church cannot grow/be fruitful this way!

(d) It is contrasted with the church before it, Philadelphia (brotherly love). That church was loving/giving and therefore successful, Laodicea is selfish/interested in taking, and not successful

(2) You may have the "right" to something but is it what is best?- Gal. 5:13; 1 Cor. 10:23-24; Rom. 15:1-2

(a) The Laodicean mindset is to do whatever makes me feel best, whatever I want, what I am entitled to, etc.. be careful of this trap! Just because you have the "right" to something does not make it the best option!

(b) Are you making decisions based on what you can "get away with technically". It is a sign of immaturity in your walk (like Corinth and what paul said to them).

(c) Are you more interested in satisfying your fleshly desire to be vindicated, or more interested in the betterment of others?

(d) This can be seen a lot in the political arena. No doubt our rights allow us to do many things, they allow us freedoms which help our mission BUT if you life becomes about preserving those rights, or arguing for your rights, and NOT about the main things: the gospel and making disciples; then we are out of order. We serve God: rights or no rights. Like Jesus, the disciples, and the early Christians! Rights are not our main focus: they are the focus of Laodiceans.

(e) Your life is not meant to be lived for yourself only OR even primarily, but for God and for others!

(i) Love the Lord your God with all your heart, soul, mind, strength

(ii) Love your neighbor as yourself

1. You are not the top of the list: God and others are

a. Who are you thinking most about in your daily decisions? Daily life? God? Others? Or is it always all about you…

b. Humility- Not thinking less of yourself; but thinking of yourself less

b) Laodiceans' **works** show that they are lukewarm (vss. 15-16)

(1) The modern church as a whole is lukewarm in their works, they ride the fence, they refuse to choose a side; in their **works**; notice their "words" don't match their "works" (thou sayest; I know thy works)

(2) God says he would prefer them to choose; hot or cold. Our lukewarm works make him sick- 1 Kings 18:21; Josh. 24:14-15; Eze. 20:39; Jer. 3:10-11

(a) Our mindset is that if we don't fully commit and do all we should, our nature is to at least "act the part", serve, keep the image, etc.. God says, if you want to be half in and half out, if you want to serve false gods (idols) and me, DON'T; he would rather you just leave him and serve them OR BETTER YET, leave them and serve him; but CHOOSE

(b) God says this church, this behavior makes him SICK (want to throw up). Consider, even Israel made Jesus weep and lament (Matt. 23:37-O Jerusalem, Jerusalem, thou that killest the prophets, and stonest them which are sent unto thee, how often would I have gathered thy children together, even as a hen gathereth her chickens under her wings, and ye would not!) BUT THIS CHURCH doesn't make him weep, it makes him sick!

(c) What do your **works** say about your relationship with God? Not your **words**. Are you cold? Hot? Or, the only place you cannot be; lukewarm.

c) Laodiceans serve the god of **materialism** (vs. 17)

i) Covetousness=Idolatry (Eph. 5:5; Col. 3:5)

ii) This idolatry is the root issue of Laodicea

(1) Judah didn't serve "gods" because they felt like making God mad! False gods promised prosperity and help (Baal was the god of rain, agriculture, and fertility). He represented help in times of drought and mans attempt to make his own way.

(2) It is easy for us to judge when we see them leave God to worship false gods, BUT WE DO THE SAME THING! God has provided for us, and yet we leave him to seek prosperity, wealth, help, from other sources!

(3) They sought what we seek today, maybe our greatest enemy today as the church, the thing that steals us away from God: MATERIALISM

(4) According to a recent study done by Forbes: The average American today is approximately 90 times wealthier than the average person throughout most of human history.

(5) Materialism is not about what you have so much as your "heart desire" towards it

(a) Philadelphia- had the key of David- All good said of them

(b) Laodicea- has material wealth- all bad things said of them

(c) A successful ministry/church/person (Philadelphia)- Loving (coveting) above all else the word of God- Key of David- Psalm 119:36; Psalm 1

(d) A failed ministry/church/person (Laodicea)- Loving (coveting) money/materialism- the Root of all evil- 1 Tim. 6:10

(i) How do you know if you love something? What do you spend the most time thinking about, what do you choose to spend your free time/thoughts on? How would you feel if you lost it?

1. God says we should be content with food and raiment!-1 Tim. 6:6-8

(ii) This is why God says you can't serve him and mammon- Luke 16:13

1. It is NOT POSSIBLE to truly serve God and material possession, money, fortune, prosperity on your own, etc.. (trying to do so will result in "lukewarm middle ground" Laodiceanism that God despises!

d) Laodiceans lack **three** major things (vs. 18)

i) Gold- Eternal reward in Heaven (1 Cor. 3:12-14)

(1) They have the earthly wealth but lack eternal wealth

(2) They will have NOTHING TO show for their lives on judgement day, no eternal reward.

(3) Also related to persecution and trials (1 Pet. 1:7) Laodiceans are so worried about preserving rights, when we in reality need to be worried more about enduring PERSECUTION. Persecution and church growth go hand in hand throughout the Bible and history; whereas easy times and "ease" and church decay go hand in hand as well

ii) White Raiment- Righteousness (Rev. 19:8)

(1) They will be ashamed on judgement day: God uses the language of nakedness to explain the shame they will feel (no white garments) for the unrighteous lives they lead. Laodiceans mix with the world.

iii) Eye Salve- the word of God that helps us see clearly (Psa. 19:8)

(i) Are you seeing clearly or are you walking around blind? If you are not making decisions DAILY through the lens of the word of God, you are walking around blind!

e) The cure for the Laodicean lukewarm condition: **Zealous Repentance** (vss. 19-22)

i) Zeal- "One who engages warmly in any cause, and pursues his object with earnestness."

(1) Zealots- The **Zealots** were a Jewish political and religious movement in the 1st century AD that strongly opposed Roman rule over Judea. They were known for their **militant nationalism, radical resistance to foreign domination, and willingness to use violence** in their pursuit of Jewish independence.

(a) In a word- Terrorists (against Rome)

(b) Simon Zelotes- He was part of this group before his conversion

(2) Those who live this way will be seen as "radical", peculiar, and different than the rest; especially in the midst of a lukewarm time!- Titus 2:14

(a) This world is FULL of "palatable Christianity", people who talk about Jesus, talk about the Bible, but don't obey it zealously like the prophets, disciples, and Jesus himself did!

(b) We don't need anymore middle of the road Christians. JESUS SAID WE NEED MORE ZEALOUS CHRISTIANS TO REPENT AND JUST GO FOR IT.

(3) Our Examples:

(a) The disciples and Jesus- John 15:19; 17:14; Acts 17:6

(b) The prophets of the Old Testament

(i) Jeremiah-

1. Told to not marry or have kids because of the suffering the people would go through- Jeremiah 16:1-2

(ii) Isaiah-

1. Preached naked and barefoot for 3 years- Isaiah 20:2-4

(iii) Ezekiel-

1. Laid on his left side for 390 days, then on his right side for 40 days (symbolizing the sins and consequences of the sins of Israel and then of Judah)- Eze. 4:4-6
2. Cooked his food over dung to show the food Israel would eat in exile- Eze. 4:12-15
3. Shaved his head and beard and then burnt a third of the hair, hit a third of it with the sword, and scattered the rest of it, to show the fate of Jerusalem- Eze. 5:1-4
4. His wife died and he was told to not mourn to show how God's people would lose everything and not be able to mourn- Eze. 24:15-18

(iv) Hosea-

a. Told to marry a prostitute to show the humiliation of being married to an unfaithful person and to show how Judah and Israel have made God feel- Hos. 1:2-3

2) If Jesus could be here this morning, these are the words he would remind us of, this is the warning he gives to our modern church age.

a) Are you living for yourself or others?

b) Are you investing in this world (materialism) or eternity (gospel/discipleship, righteousness, the word of God)?

c) Are you trying to serve God and be “palatable” at the same time? If so, you are in the only place God can’t use you, right in the middle, lukewarm. Be zealous and repent! Choose you this day whom you will serve!

Lessons for Laodiceans- Revelation 3:14-22

1) Revelation 3:14-22
   a) Laodicea is a _____ _____ church (vs. 14)
      i) The name Laodicea translates literally to “the people’s rights/justice to the people; civil rights”
      ii) The church “of the Laodiceans” (Rev. 2:1, 8, 12, 18; 3:1, 7, 14)
      iii) The church where everything is about “me, my rights, my way, doing right by me”
         (1) When your Christian life becomes all about you, even when you are in the right, you are slipping into the Laodicean way- 2 Tim. 3:1-2; Luke 9:23; Phillip. 2:3-4; Rom. 12:10; Eph. 5:21
         (2) You may have the “right” to something but is it what is best?- Gal. 5:13; 1 Cor. 10:23-24; Rom. 15:1-2
   b) Laodiceans’ _____ show that they are lukewarm (vss. 15-16)
      (1) God says he would prefer them to choose; hot or cold. Our lukewarm works make him sick- 1 Kings 18:21; Josh. 24:14-15; Eze. 20:39; Jer. 3:10-11
   c) Laodiceans serve the god of _____ (vs. 17)
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      ii) This idolatry is the root issue of Laodicea
         (a) A successful ministry/church/person (Philadelphia)- Loving (coveting) above all else the word of God- Key of David- Psalm 119:36; Psalm 1
         (b) A failed ministry/church/person (Laodicea)- Loving (coveting) money/materialism- the Root of all evil- 1 Tim. 6:10; 1 Tim. 6:6-8
            (i) This is why God says you cant serve him and mammon- Luke 16:13
   d) Laodiceans lack _____ major things (vs. 18)
      i) Gold- Eternal reward in Heaven (1 Cor. 3:12-14)
      ii) White Raiment- Righteousness (Rev. 19:8)
      iii) Eye Salve- the word of God that helps us see clearly (Psa. 19:8)
   e) The cure for the Laodicean lukewarm condition: _____ _____ (vss. 19-22)
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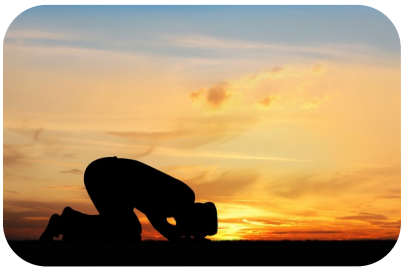


BIBLICAL PRAYER

I. _____ for Prayer (Matt. 6:9-13; Acts 2-4)

a. Jesus gave us an example of prayer to follow; NOT to repeat mindlessly- Matt. 6:9-13

i. Show God reverence- vs 9

ii. Seek His Kingdom and His will today, not ours- vs 10

iii. Ask for our physical needs BUT also deeper spiritual needs today- vs 11 (Jn. 6:51; Job 23:12; Psa. 119:18; 1 Sam. 3:10; James 1:5)

iv. Pray for forgiveness- vs 12 (1 Jn. 1:9)

v. Pray to be led away from temptation and for God's help to deliver you from sin/evil, SO THAT you are prepared to live for ETERNAL THINGS- vs 13

b. Corporate Prayer- Acts 2-4

i. Over and over again we see the early church praying with "one accord", together for the ministry. This is a biblical pattern for us to follow if we want to have successful ministries (Acts 1:13-14; 2:42; 4:24-31)

II. _____ of Prayer

a. Praying in Jesus Name (Jn. 14:13-14)

b. Casting our Cares to Him (1 Pet. 5:7)

c. We can pray about ALL things to Him (Phil. 4:6; Psa. 55:22)

d. All we have to do is ASK (Mat. 7:7-12)

e. He will direct us (Prov. 3:5-6)

f. Prayer brings comfort (Rom. 8:26; 2 Cor. 1:3-4)

III. _____ of Prayer

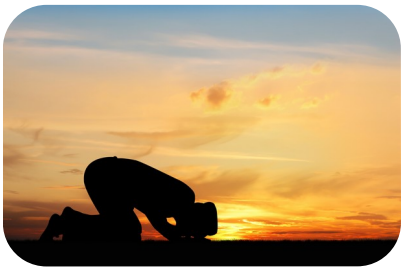
a. Praying effects things- James 5:16-17

b. Prayer effects God- Gen 18:23-33; 2 Kings 20:1-6; Exo. 32:7-14

IV. _____ in Prayer

a. Persistence is necessary- Luke 18:1-8

b. A constant remembering and thoughtfulness about prayer is necessary- 1 Thess. 5:17



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II. **Promises** of Prayer
   a. Praying in Jesus Name (Jn. 14:13-14)
   b. Casting our Cares to Him (1 Pet. 5:7)
   c. We can pray about ALL things to Him (Phil. 4:6; Psa. 55:22)
   d. All we have to do is ASK (Mat. 7:7-12)
   e. He will direct us (Prov. 3:5-6)
   f. Prayer brings comfort (Rom. 8:26; 2 Cor. 1:3-4)
      i. Greek word "parakaleo" also translated elsewhere 6x as "prayer"

III. **Power** of Prayer
   a. Praying effects things- James 5:16-17
   b. Prayer effects God- Gen 18:23-33; 2 Kings 20:1-6; Exo. 32:7-14
      i. Consider the FIRST AND GREATEST SUPERNATURAL act in your life, your salvation. This was done through PRAYER.
      ii. We can plan, maneuver, coordinate, organize, etc…for good things and be very busy, BUT if our work is not bathed in prayer, God's power in it is AT BEST limited. We are trusting our own abilities to make change.
      iii. Prayer is not FLASHY and out front, it is hidden and quiet and doesn't showcase our "talents". Yet it is necessary in order to see an impact made on eternity!

IV. **Persistence** in Prayer
   a. Persistence is necessary- Luke 18:1-8
   b. A constant remembering and thoughtfulness about prayer is necessary- 1 Thess. 5:17

Proverbs 11

Wisdom for Young People

High school devotional lesson • 20–25 minutes

Teaching pace: Opening 2 minutes; four points 4–5 minutes each; closing 2–3 minutes. Read the passages aloud, explain the key words, and allow a brief response to each question.

Opening

Proverbs 11 places the ways of the upright beside the ways of the wicked. We will consider four choices that affect us now: honesty, humility, speech, and generosity. As we read, ask the Lord to show you where His wisdom needs to change your daily walk.

1 Walk Honestly

A God delights in honest dealings

> **Proverbs 11:1** — "A false balance is abomination to the LORD: but a just weight is his delight."

Words and setting: A balance was a scale used in buying and selling. False weights cheated the other person; a just weight gave the proper amount. Abomination means something God detests. The verse concerns actual business dealings, and it reveals how seriously God regards honesty.

> **Leviticus 19:35–36** — "Ye shall do no unrighteousness in judgment, in meteyard, in weight, or in measure. Just balances, just weights, a just ephah, and a just hin, shall ye have: I am the LORD your God, which brought you out of the land of Egypt."

Meteyard refers to measuring length; an ephah was a dry measure and a hin a liquid measure. God required fair measurements in ordinary trade.

B Let integrity guide your choices

> **Proverbs 11:3** — "The integrity of the upright shall guide them: but the perverseness of transgressors shall destroy them."

Words to understand: Integrity is moral soundness and uprightness. Perverseness is crookedness or the deliberate twisting of what is right. The contrast is between a life directed by what is right and a life ruined by its own dishonesty.

> **Ephesians 4:25** — "Wherefore putting away lying, speak every man truth with his neighbour: for we are members one of another."

> **Luke 16:10** — "He that is faithful in that which is least is faithful also in much: and he that is unjust in the least is unjust also in much."

Short devotion: The Lord delights in truthfulness. We can seek His pleasure in an ordinary decision, even when telling the truth costs us something. Ask Him for an honest heart, and correct what you know has been dishonest.

Discuss: According to verse 3, what should guide a decision before we consider what we might gain from it?

2 Receive Counsel Humbly

A A humble heart can receive wisdom

Proverbs 11:2 — “When pride cometh, then cometh shame: but with the lowly is wisdom.”

Words to understand: Pride here is an arrogant, self-important attitude. Lowly means humble or modest. A lowly person is willing to acknowledge his need for God and for instruction. Humility makes us teachable.

Proverbs 16:18 — “Pride goeth before destruction, and an haughty spirit before a fall.”

Haughty means arrogantly lifted up. Pride makes a person confident in himself while he is moving toward trouble.

James 4:6 — “But he giveth more grace. Wherefore he saith, God resisteth the proud, but giveth grace unto the humble.”

James takes humility beyond our relationships with people. Our proud resistance places us against God; a humble heart receives His grace.

B Godly counsel helps protect your steps

Proverbs 11:14 — “Where no counsel is, the people fall: but in the multitude of counsellors there is safety.”

Words and setting: Counsel means guidance or wise advice. The people points first to a community that needs sound leadership. The same need for counsel in an individual life is stated directly in Proverbs 12:15.

Proverbs 12:15 — “The way of a fool is right in his own eyes: but he that hearkeneth unto counsel is wise.”

Hearkeneth means listens with attention and regard. Being sure of our own opinion does not make it right. Seek counsel from people who know Scripture and will help you obey it. A multitude of opinions cannot overrule what God has said.

Short devotion

We often want advice that agrees with a decision we have already made. A humble heart is willing to be corrected. When Scripture exposes something wrong, we can confess it and receive the help God gives. That willingness to listen is itself a mark of wisdom.

Discuss: How does Proverbs 12:15 help us recognize pride in our response to advice?

Personal response: Ask the Lord to make you willing to hear biblical counsel from your parents, pastor, or another mature believer, especially where you tend to become defensive.

3 Speak Carefully

A Understanding teaches us when to be quiet

> **Proverbs 11:12** — “He that is void of wisdom despiseth his neighbour: but a man of understanding holdeth his peace.”

Words to understand: Void of wisdom means lacking sound understanding. Despiseth means treats as contemptible or looks down on. Holdeth his peace means restrains his speech. The wise person refuses to use words to belittle his neighbour.

> **James 1:19–20** — “Wherefore, my beloved brethren, let every man be swift to hear, slow to speak, slow to wrath: For the wrath of man worketh not the righteousness of God.”

Swift to hear means ready to listen. Slow to speak calls for restraint; slow to wrath means we should not rush into anger. Our anger does not accomplish the righteousness God desires.

B A faithful spirit handles information carefully

> **Proverbs 11:13** — “A talebearer revealeth secrets: but he that is of a faithful spirit concealeth the matter.”

Words to understand: A talebearer carries private information from person to person. A faithful spirit is trustworthy and loyal. Concealeth the matter means keeps it from needless exposure. This describes faithfulness toward a neighbour, not permission to cover up harm or wrongdoing.

> **Proverbs 11:9** — “An hypocrite with his mouth destroyeth his neighbour: but through knowledge shall the just be delivered.”

Notice the damage a mouth can do. What we say about another person matters to God even when that person is absent.

> **Ephesians 4:29** — “Let no corrupt communication proceed out of your mouth, but that which is good to the use of edifying, that it may minister grace unto the hearers.”

Corrupt communication is harmful, rotten speech. Edifying means building up. Paul directs us to words that benefit those who hear.

Short devotion

The Lord cares about the person we are talking about. Before we speak, we should consider whether our words are faithful, necessary, and helpful. The same responsibility applies to a message we type. Ask God to help you restrain hurtful words and speak what will strengthen someone else.

Discuss: What do Proverbs 11:13 and Ephesians 4:29 tell us to consider before repeating something about another person?

4 Give Willingly

A Refuse to hold back what you ought to give

> **Proverbs 11:24** — "There is that scattereth, and yet increaseth; and there is that withholdeth more than is meet, but it tendeth to poverty."

Words to understand: Scattereth here means distributes generously. More than is meet means more than is proper or right: a person holds back what he ought to share. The verse contrasts generosity with grasping selfishness.

> **2 Corinthians 9:7** — "Every man according as he purposeth in his heart, so let him give; not grudgingly, or of necessity: for God loveth a cheerful giver."

Purposeth means decides or intends. God values willing giving from the heart. Grudgingly means reluctantly; of necessity means under compulsion.

B Seek to refresh others

> **Proverbs 11:25** — "The liberal soul shall be made fat: and he that watereth shall be watered also himself."

Words and picture: Liberal means generous. Made fat is an old expression for being enriched or well supplied. Watereth pictures refreshing and sustaining others. These words describe the blessing of generosity; they do not promise a fixed financial return.

> **2 Corinthians 9:8** — "And God is able to make all grace abound toward you; that ye, always having all sufficiency in all things, may abound to every good work:"

> **Acts 20:35** — "I have shewed you all things, how that so labouring ye ought to support the weak, and to remember the words of the Lord Jesus, how he said, It is more blessed to give than to receive."

Scripture connection: Paul connects God's provision with continued good works. In Acts, he connects labour and giving with helping the weak.

Short devotion: Generosity grows as we trust God with what He has given us. We can help someone with what we have now. Ask the Lord to show you a need you can meet willingly, without seeking attention or repayment.

Discuss: What do these passages say about the purpose and the attitude of our giving?

Closing Respond to the Lord

> **Ephesians 2:8–10** — "For by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God: Not of works, lest any man should boast. For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus unto good works, which God hath before ordained that we should walk in them."

Salvation is God's gift, received through faith in Jesus Christ. The good works of verse 10 follow the salvation of verses 8–9. As believers, we should let His Word shape our conduct. Which area needs your attention today: honesty, humility, speech, or generosity? Name one obedient step before the Lord and ask Him for help to take it.

Closing prayer: Lord, show us where we are resisting Your Word. Give us humble hearts to receive it and willing hearts to obey it. Help our choices and our words honour You. In Jesus' name, amen.

THE TEARS OF [redacted]

I. **Tears of Love: Jesus Wept in** _____ (*John 11:35*)

a. Why did He cry? He knew he was going to raise Lazarus from the dead, that was nothing for him. He cried because he understood the pain of those, he loved around him and it hurt him! (*John 11:33)*

b. We read that Jesus was "deeply moved in spirit and troubled" when He saw their sorrow. He felt their pain. He entered their suffering.

c. God is acquainted with our sufferings! -Hebrews 4:15

d. We are called to do the same thing! We need to meet others where they are at! - Romans 12:15

II. **Tears of Lament: Jesus Wept Over the Spiritual** _____ **of Others** (*Luke 19:41*)

a. Here Jesus laments over Israel and what they could have been and the peace they could have had- Matthew 23:37

i. Jesus lamented their spiritual blindness. He knew they had rejected Him, their Messiah, and because of that, they would face judgment. They could've had peace, but they chose pride and sin instead.

ii. This story is a warning for us. When we refuse to repent and reject God's truth, we miss out on His peace. We can end up wandering through life, suffering unnecessarily because of our stubbornness- Proverbs 29:1; Galatians 6:7-8; Proverbs 1:24-31

b. This applies to us personally, but it also applies to those around us. Jesus wept over Jerusalem because He loved them, even though they were far from God. Do we weep over the lost and the wayward?

i. Look at Paul's heart for those he knew that were lost- Romans 9:1-3; 10:1; 1 Corinthians 9:19-22

c. We are called to the ministry of reconciliation- 2 Corinthians 5:18-20

III. **Tears of Loyalty: Jesus Wept in** _____ **to God's Will**- Hebrews 5:7-9

a. Sometimes, God calls us to do hard things

i. When God calls us to do something, no matter how hard it is, we must be willing to submit. Luke 9:23

ii. Imagine if he had not obeyed. Where would we be?

iii. Do you want to be made perfect before God? Troubles, agony, and hard decisions are required! (vs 9)

IV. How can you:

a. Meet others where they are at and empathize for them?

b. Lament the spiritual state of those around you and be part of reconciling them to God?

c. Submit to God in something that is extremely hard to do but can give him the most glory and perfect you in the process?

THE TEARS OF [illegible]

I. **Tears of Love: Jesus Wept in Empathy** (*John 11:35*)
   a. Why did He cry? He knew he was going to raise Lazarus from the dead, that was nothing for him. He cried because he understood the pain of those, he loved around him and it hurt him! (*John 11:33*)
   b. We read that Jesus was "deeply moved in spirit and troubled" when He saw their sorrow. He felt their pain. He entered their suffering.
   c. God is acquainted with our sufferings! -Hebrews 4:15
      i. Think about all of the things Jesus went through on this earth: Pain, Sickness, heartache, hard work (for 30 years he worked before he began his ministry), hunger and thirst, fatigue, anger, temptation, learning new things (he grew in wisdom), subjected himself to a physical body and could not be all places at once (he limited himself), and eventually was even obedient to death!
      ii. What a God we have that understands us!!!
   d. We are called to do the same thing! We need to meet others where they are at! -Romans 12:15
      i. Have you ever considered why we go through trouble in this life? Why would God allow us to go through trouble? He loves us and wants to give us everything! But trouble and pain help us to help others and meet them where they are at. They grow us. They are necessary, even for Jesus!

II. **Tears of Lament: Jesus Wept Over the Spiritual Decay of Others** (*Luke 19:41*)
   a. Here Jesus laments over Israel and what they could have been and the peace they could have had- Matthew 23:37
      i. Jesus lamented their spiritual blindness. He knew they had rejected Him, their Messiah, and because of that, they would face judgment. They could've had peace, but they chose pride and sin instead.
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1. This is a WARNING. Get right, receive the word of God (Jesus/Bible) when it comes to you or else you are in danger of a life of death and chaos (look at ISRAEL). You are offered peace and safety with God if you repent!

b. This applies to us personally, but it also applies to those around us. Jesus wept over Jerusalem because He loved them, even though they were far from God. Do we weep over the lost and the wayward?

i. Think about this kind of burden Jesus had for them. Is this your attitude towards those who are lost or who are not walking with the Lord?

ii. When was the last time you checked up on those in this church/youth group who aren't here anymore? The people who have come and go from the group?

iii. Look at Paul's heart for those he knew that were lost- Romans 9:1-3; 10:1; 1 Corinthians 9:19-22

c. We are called to the ministry of reconciliation- 2 Corinthians 5:18-20

i. Paul again reminds us of the simplest ministry we have been given, reconciliation. Reconciling the lost to Christ and the saved to Christ. If someone is not saved, we bring them to salvation in Christ, if someone is saved, we are to be always bringing them closer to Christ. In drama or issues between the body of Christ, we reconcile others and ourselves.

III. **Tears of Loyalty: Jesus Wept in Submission to God's Will**- Hebrews 5:7-9

a. This verse points us to Gethsemane, where Jesus prayed when he was preparing to go to the cross

b. Jesus knew the cross was coming. He knew the physical agony He would endure and the weight of the world's sin He would bear. But despite His fear, He submitted fully to the Father's plan.

c. Sometimes, God calls us to do hard things

i. When God calls us to do something, no matter how hard it is, we must be willing to submit. Luke 9:23

ii. Again, Jesus is our great example of this, he was GOD and yet he chose to submit (obedient unto death) when it was the hardest you could possibly imagine. HE COULD HAVE BEEN DELIVERED AND DECIDED NOT TO DO IT (vs 7)

iii. None of us will be asked to do something like what Jesus did here, this was much harder than anything we could imagine. This is our God, he does the

hardest things, endures the most agony, feels the emotion of fear, all FOR US and so that we know HE UNDERSTANDS.

iv. Imagine if he had not obeyed. Where would we be?

v. Where will others around you be if you refuse to obey? Can your disobedience be the reason they die and go to hell? Can it be the reason others do because you refuse to go and reach out to someone who needs it who is already saved? Who could THEY have reached?

vi. We NEVER KNOW the fullness of Gods plans and we cannot afford to cut and run when it gets tough. Eternities depend on it.

1. Think about this when you go to invite your friends to the outreach, when you go to share the gospel with them, when you don't reach out to that youth group friend you haven't seen in a while.

vii. Do you want to be made perfect before God? Troubles, agony, and hard decisions are required! (vs 9)

IV. How can you:

a. Meet others where they are at and empathize for them?
b. Lament the spiritual state of those around you and be part of reconciling them to God?
c. Submit to God in something that is extremely hard to do but can give him the most glory and perfect you in the process?

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EPHESIANS

King James Version

Ephesians 1

1 Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ by the will of God, to the saints which are at Ephesus, and to the faithful in Christ Jesus:

2 Grace be to you, and peace, from God our Father, and from the Lord Jesus Christ.

3 Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath blessed us with all spiritual blessings in heavenly places in Christ:

4 According as he hath chosen us in him before the foundation of the world, that we should be holy and without blame before him in love:

5 Having predestinated us unto the adoption of children by Jesus Christ to himself, according to the good pleasure of his will,

6 To the praise of the glory of his grace, wherein he hath made us accepted in the beloved.

7 In whom we have redemption through his blood, the forgiveness of sins, according to the riches of his grace;

8 Wherein he hath abounded toward us in all wisdom and prudence;

9 Having made known unto us the mystery of his will, according to his good pleasure which he hath purposed in himself:

10 That in the dispensation of the fulness of times he might gather together in one all things in Christ, both which are in heaven, and which are on earth; even in him:

Notes

Ephesians 1 continued

11 In whom also we have obtained an inheritance, being predestinated according to the purpose of him who worketh all things after the counsel of his own will:

12 That we should be to the praise of his glory, who first trusted in Christ.

13 In whom ye also trusted, after that ye heard the word of truth, the gospel of your salvation: in whom also after that ye believed, ye were sealed with that holy Spirit of promise,

14 Which is the earnest of our inheritance until the redemption of the purchased possession, unto the praise of his glory.

15 Wherefore I also, after I heard of your faith in the Lord Jesus, and love unto all the saints,

16 Cease not to give thanks for you, making mention of you in my prayers;

17 That the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of glory, may give unto you the spirit of wisdom and revelation in the knowledge of him:

18 The eyes of your understanding being enlightened; that ye may know what is the hope of his calling, and what the riches of the glory of his inheritance in the saints,

19 And what is the exceeding greatness of his power to usward who believe, according to the working of his mighty power,

20 Which he wrought in Christ, when he raised him from the dead, and set him at his own right hand in the heavenly places,

Notes

Ephesians 1 continued

21 Far above all principality, and power, and might, and dominion, and every name that is named, not only in this world, but also in that which is to come:

22 And hath put all things under his feet, and gave him to be the head over all things to the church,

23 Which is his body, the fulness of him that filleth all in all.

Notes

Ephesians 2

1 And you hath he quickened, who were dead in trespasses and sins;

2 Wherein in time past ye walked according to the course of this world, according to the prince of the power of the air, the spirit that now worketh in the children of disobedience:

3 Among whom also we all had our conversation in times past in the lusts of our flesh, fulfilling the desires of the flesh and of the mind; and were by nature the children of wrath, even as others.

4 But God, who is rich in mercy, for his great love wherewith he loved us,

5 Even when we were dead in sins, hath quickened us together with Christ, (by grace ye are saved;)

6 And hath raised us up together, and made us sit together in heavenly places in Christ Jesus:

7 That in the ages to come he might shew the exceeding riches of his grace in his kindness toward us through Christ Jesus.

8 For by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God:

9 Not of works, lest any man should boast.

10 For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus unto good works, which God hath before ordained that we should walk in them.

11 Wherefore remember, that ye being in time past Gentiles in the flesh, who are called Uncircumcision by that which is called the Circumcision in the flesh made by hands;

Notes

Ephesians 2 continued

12 That at that time ye were without Christ, being aliens from the commonwealth of Israel, and strangers from the covenants of promise, having no hope, and without God in the world:

13 But now in Christ Jesus ye who sometimes were far off are made nigh by the blood of Christ.

14 For he is our peace, who hath made both one, and hath broken down the middle wall of partition between us;

15 Having abolished in his flesh the enmity, even the law of commandments contained in ordinances; for to make in himself of twain one new man, so making peace;

16 And that he might reconcile both unto God in one body by the cross, having slain the enmity thereby:

17 And came and preached peace to you which were afar off, and to them that were nigh.

18 For through him we both have access by one Spirit unto the Father.

19 Now therefore ye are no more strangers and foreigners, but fellowcitizens with the saints, and of the household of God;

20 And are built upon the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Jesus Christ himself being the chief corner stone;

21 In whom all the building fitly framed together groweth unto an holy temple in the Lord:

22 In whom ye also are builded together for an habitation of God through the Spirit.

Notes

Ephesians 3

1 For this cause I Paul, the prisoner of Jesus Christ for you Gentiles,

2 If ye have heard of the dispensation of the grace of God which is given me to youward:

3 How that by revelation he made known unto me the mystery; (as I wrote afore in few words,

4 Whereby, when ye read, ye may understand my knowledge in the mystery of Christ)

5 Which in other ages was not made known unto the sons of men, as it is now revealed unto his holy apostles and prophets by the Spirit;

6 That the Gentiles should be fellowheirs, and of the same body, and partakers of his promise in Christ by the gospel:

7 Whereof I was made a minister, according to the gift of the grace of God given unto me by the effectual working of his power.

8 Unto me, who am less than the least of all saints, is this grace given, that I should preach among the Gentiles the unsearchable riches of Christ;

9 And to make all men see what is the fellowship of the mystery, which from the beginning of the world hath been hid in God, who created all things by Jesus Christ:

10 To the intent that now unto the principalities and powers in heavenly places might be known by the church the manifold wisdom of God,

11 According to the eternal purpose which he purposed in Christ Jesus our Lord:

Notes

Ephesians 3 continued

12 In whom we have boldness and access with confidence by the faith of him.

13 Wherefore I desire that ye faint not at my tribulations for you, which is your glory.

14 For this cause I bow my knees unto the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ,

15 Of whom the whole family in heaven and earth is named,

16 That he would grant you, according to the riches of his glory, to be strengthened with might by his Spirit in the inner man;

17 That Christ may dwell in your hearts by faith; that ye, being rooted and grounded in love,

18 May be able to comprehend with all saints what is the breadth, and length, and depth, and height;

19 And to know the love of Christ, which passeth knowledge, that ye might be filled with all the fulness of God.

20 Now unto him that is able to do exceeding abundantly above all that we ask or think, according to the power that worketh in us,

21 Unto him be glory in the church by Christ Jesus throughout all ages, world without end. Amen.

Notes

Ephesians 4

1 I therefore, the prisoner of the Lord, beseech you that ye walk worthy of the vocation wherewith ye are called,

2 With all lowliness and meekness, with longsuffering, forbearing one another in love;

3 Endeavouring to keep the unity of the Spirit in the bond of peace.

4 There is one body, and one Spirit, even as ye are called in one hope of your calling;

5 One Lord, one faith, one baptism,

6 One God and Father of all, who is above all, and through all, and in you all.

7 But unto every one of us is given grace according to the measure of the gift of Christ.

8 Wherefore he saith, When he ascended up on high, he led captivity captive, and gave gifts unto men.

9 (Now that he ascended, what is it but that he also descended first into the lower parts of the earth?

10 He that descended is the same also that ascended up far above all heavens, that he might fill all things.)

11 And he gave some, apostles; and some, prophets; and some, evangelists; and some, pastors and teachers;

12 For the perfecting of the saints, for the work of the ministry, for the edifying of the body of Christ:

Notes

Ephesians 4 continued

13 Till we all come in the unity of the faith, and of the knowledge of the Son of God, unto a perfect man, unto the measure of the stature of the fulness of Christ:

14 That we henceforth be no more children, tossed to and fro, and carried about with every wind of doctrine, by the sleight of men, and cunning craftiness, whereby they lie in wait to deceive;

15 But speaking the truth in love, may grow up into him in all things, which is the head, even Christ:

16 From whom the whole body fitly joined together and compacted by that which every joint supplieth, according to the effectual working in the measure of every part, maketh increase of the body unto the edifying of itself in love.

17 This I say therefore, and testify in the Lord, that ye henceforth walk not as other Gentiles walk, in the vanity of their mind,

18 Having the understanding darkened, being alienated from the life of God through the ignorance that is in them, because of the blindness of their heart:

19 Who being past feeling have given themselves over unto lasciviousness, to work all uncleanness with greediness.

20 But ye have not so learned Christ;

21 If so be that ye have heard him, and have been taught by him, as the truth is in Jesus:

22 That ye put off concerning the former conversation the old man, which is corrupt according to the deceitful lusts;

Notes

Ephesians 4 continued

23 And be renewed in the spirit of your mind;

24 And that ye put on the new man, which after God is created in righteousness and true holiness.

25 Wherefore putting away lying, speak every man truth with his neighbour: for we are members one of another.

26 Be ye angry, and sin not: let not the sun go down upon your wrath:

27 Neither give place to the devil.

28 Let him that stole steal no more: but rather let him labour, working with his hands the thing which is good, that he may have to give to him that needeth.

29 Let no corrupt communication proceed out of your mouth, but that which is good to the use of edifying, that it may minister grace unto the hearers.

30 And grieve not the holy Spirit of God, whereby ye are sealed unto the day of redemption.

31 Let all bitterness, and wrath, and anger, and clamour, and evil speaking, be put away from you, with all malice:

32 And be ye kind one to another, tenderhearted, forgiving one another, even as God for Christ's sake hath forgiven you.

Notes

Ephesians 5

1 Be ye therefore followers of God, as dear children;

2 And walk in love, as Christ also hath loved us, and hath given himself for us an offering and a sacrifice to God for a sweetsmelling savour.

3 But fornication, and all uncleanness, or covetousness, let it not be once named among you, as becometh saints;

4 Neither filthiness, nor foolish talking, nor jesting, which are not convenient: but rather giving of thanks.

5 For this ye know, that no whoremonger, nor unclean person, nor covetous man, who is an idolater, hath any inheritance in the kingdom of Christ and of God.

6 Let no man deceive you with vain words: for because of these things cometh the wrath of God upon the children of disobedience.

7 Be not ye therefore partakers with them.

8 For ye were sometimes darkness, but now are ye light in the Lord: walk as children of light:

9 (For the fruit of the Spirit is in all goodness and righteousness and truth;)

10 Proving what is acceptable unto the Lord.

11 And have no fellowship with the unfruitful works of darkness, but rather reprove them.

12 For it is a shame even to speak of those things which are done of them in secret.

13 But all things that are reproved are made manifest by the light: for whatsoever doth make manifest is light.

Notes

Ephesians 5 continued

14 Wherefore he saith, Awake thou that sleepest, and arise from the dead, and Christ shall give thee light.

15 See then that ye walk circumspectly, not as fools, but as wise,

16 Redeeming the time, because the days are evil.

17 Wherefore be ye not unwise, but understanding what the will of the Lord is.

18 And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit;

19 Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord;

20 Giving thanks always for all things unto God and the Father in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ;

21 Submitting yourselves one to another in the fear of God.

22 Wives, submit yourselves unto your own husbands, as unto the Lord.

23 For the husband is the head of the wife, even as Christ is the head of the church: and he is the saviour of the body.

24 Therefore as the church is subject unto Christ, so let the wives be to their own husbands in every thing.

25 Husbands, love your wives, even as Christ also loved the church, and gave himself for it;

26 That he might sanctify and cleanse it with the washing of water by the word,

Notes

Ephesians 5 continued

27 That he might present it to himself a glorious church, not having spot, or wrinkle, or any such thing; but that it should be holy and without blemish.

28 So ought men to love their wives as their own bodies. He that loveth his wife loveth himself.

29 For no man ever yet hated his own flesh; but nourisheth and cherisheth it, even as the Lord the church:

30 For we are members of his body, of his flesh, and of his bones.

31 For this cause shall a man leave his father and mother, and shall be joined unto his wife, and they two shall be one flesh.

32 This is a great mystery: but I speak concerning Christ and the church.

33 Nevertheless let every one of you in particular so love his wife even as himself; and the wife see that she reverence her husband.

Notes

Ephesians 6

1 Children, obey your parents in the Lord: for this is right.

2 Honour thy father and mother; (which is the first commandment with promise;)

3 That it may be well with thee, and thou mayest live long on the earth.

4 And, ye fathers, provoke not your children to wrath: but bring them up in the nurture and admonition of the Lord.

5 Servants, be obedient to them that are your masters according to the flesh, with fear and trembling, in singleness of your heart, as unto Christ;

6 Not with eyeservice, as menpleasers; but as the servants of Christ, doing the will of God from the heart;

7 With good will doing service, as to the Lord, and not to men:

8 Knowing that whatsoever good thing any man doeth, the same shall he receive of the Lord, whether he be bond or free.

9 And, ye masters, do the same things unto them, forbearing threatening: knowing that your Master also is in heaven; neither is there respect of persons with him.

10 Finally, my brethren, be strong in the Lord, and in the power of his might.

11 Put on the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil.

12 For we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world, against spiritual wickedness in high places.

Notes

Ephesians 6 continued

13 Wherefore take unto you the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand.

14 Stand therefore, having your loins girt about with truth, and having on the breastplate of righteousness;

15 And your feet shod with the preparation of the gospel of peace;

16 Above all, taking the shield of faith, wherewith ye shall be able to quench all the fiery darts of the wicked.

17 And take the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God:

18 Praying always with all prayer and supplication in the Spirit, and watching thereunto with all perseverance and supplication for all saints;

19 And for me, that utterance may be given unto me, that I may open my mouth boldly, to make known the mystery of the gospel,

20 For which I am an ambassador in bonds: that therein I may speak boldly, as I ought to speak.

21 But that ye also may know my affairs, and how I do, Tychicus, a beloved brother and faithful minister in the Lord, shall make known to you all things:

22 Whom I have sent unto you for the same purpose, that ye might know our affairs, and that he might comfort your hearts.

23 Peace be to the brethren, and love with faith, from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

24 Grace be with all them that love our Lord Jesus Christ in sincerity. Amen.

Notes